

Concordia Antaro

TWO LIVES

Volume III

Chapter 1

Arrival to Ali's estate.

The first impressions and meetings

We were travelling with I. for a very, very long time until we reached India. I. often used to stop somewhere for a long time not only for the rest, but also because he wanted to give an opportunity to me to observe the nations' life, their customs and nature.

A bend after bend, partly for his own business, but mostly by broadening my "universities", he took me to Bagdad and he persuaded me jokingly that I certainly had to feel the charm of the real Bagdad and not to judge about it only by the taste of the sweet cakes.

Our journey that lasted for several months, not only hardened my organism, but also changed my character because of the daily I.'s care and influence. I've already almost grown out of the habit of "catching crows", my attention submitted to discipline and – I didn't even know myself how it happened – I didn't get irritated anymore.

It is impossible to tell about all the miracles which we've seen, like it is impossible to represent the whole complicated life of the nations of modern times in one sculpture. I can tell you only this: however I. was preparing me for that what I would see in India, it surprised me more than all other miracles which I saw during the long journey. I knew that we were going to the foot of the Himalaya, that Ali's estate was in a wonderful, picturesque valley, but I didn't expect to get into such spellbinding beauty.

Judging by those little houses of I.'s friends in which we used to stop, I expected to see the same small and dazzlingly clean house with a plot of soil in Ali's estate, the only one fireplace and only the most needed housekeeping articles. As in many other places, here too, I absolutely missed the mark. The house in Ali's estate was wonderful, it was made of the white stone similar to marble, with a lot of pillars and separate rooms.

Two great rooms on the first floor with balconies were waiting for us with I. As soon as I went to the balcony I was so enchanted by the view that opened up for me from it that I forgot about everything, I turned into the previous Lovushka and "I was catching crows" until the sun hid behind the mountain, while I was still standing, having forgotten about everything.

I came to myself when I. touched my hand lightly. Ah, how charming he was! I'd never seen him so unusually handsome as now when he was standing before me. He was wearing an orange chiton, his hair had already grown long again and curled, while his topaz eyes were just as good as Ananda's stars.

I wanted to cry for him: "How wonderfully handsome you are, I.!" – but I couldn't utter a word. For the first time I felt how great my friend was, how he surpassed everything what was daily and human. I was covered with feeling of my devotion and loyalty for him, of a sacred honour and gratitude for everything what he had done for me. I was looking at him silently. I. understood my feelings, he gave a smile to me and uttered.

"I didn't disturb you, Lovushka, because I knew how this house and this view affected the man who's seen it for the first time, but the evening is nearing already, and it is growing dark here instantly. We have to be in time to the dining-room for the supper. Come, I will show you where the bath and the

shower is, I will introduce you to the house-manager and the servant who will be for both of us. You can put some Indian clothes on which everybody is wearing here, or you can stay with your European ones if you prefer them more, but to come in time to the dining-room – this is the only rule which everybody keeps here very strictly. Don't worry, you'll be in time," I. smiled when he saw my anxiety not to be late.

We went to the house-manager who was wearing the white Indian clothes like everybody else and who was, judging by his appearance, a typical native. He was handsome, still young, slender and agile, his oblong face was sunburnt, he had a dark, little Spanish beard, dark eyes and the white turban on his head. He answered in English to my greeting him, but with a sharp accent and melodiously. His voice was melodious and tender, his look was kind, but attentive and concentrated, as if he had tried to remember me, to discover or understand something within me. I didn't have time to think about it, I only memorized that his name was Kastanda. I was very surprised by this name, but I remembered the bath immediately and I scuttled there with the only thought: to come back to I. as soon as possible.

One surprise after another was waiting for me. I was hoping to see an ordinary washbasin like the ones which I saw on my way here – in most cases the shower with water warmed by the sun, which was arranged in the remote corner of the garden, - and I got into an excellent bathroom with tile floor and walls, with hot and cold water that was running from the water supply taps. And what is more, as soon as I had time to take off my clothes, the servant... a Chinese entered the bathroom. By smiling benevolently, he announced that Kastanda sent him to help me. Without even allowing me to recollect myself, he threw something warm and liquid on me from a jug instantly – it turned out that it was a liquid, smelling sweet soap. He soaped all of me instantly with a soft loofa, placed me under the shower and then he started shampooing my head in such a way that I had only to cover my face with my hands.

Having snorted and by not bringing myself to open my eyes, I felt that the servant was taking me somewhere carefully from the shower.

"Now, sit down in the bath, monsieur Leon," I heard him say in French.

I was prepared for everything, but having heard French language from Chinese who was hardly speaking English not so long time ago, I couldn't bear it anymore and I roared with laughter so strongly that the soap got into my eyes.

Having jumped into the excellent bath that was made of the same white stone like the house, I was rubbing my eyes and choking with laughter.

"Young Ali told me exactly this that monsieur Leon was very merry," I heard the servant's voice again.

"Do you know young Ali?" I was surprised.

"How could I not know him? I brought up the young Ali. He sent me to you and to brother I. He will come here himself. Then I will have three masters," the servant answered me by pronouncing the words in a funny way.

Having jumped out of the bath, I wiped myself dry and put the Indian suit on quickly, which I knew well already. Having thanked Chinese for his help sincerely, I asked him what his name was. Having been silent for a while, he answered me.

"What's my name – that's another business. Address me as Yassa – young Ali and everybody else here call me like this."

"I will call you Yassa only when you start addressing me as Lovushka, as young Ali calls me and as everybody else here is going to call me."

The Chinese gave a laugh and told me.

"Agreed, if I. tells me to do like this."

"He will certainly tell you this, you can be calm."

I rushed to I., but I turned to the opposite direction, and again only with help of the same Yassa I found I. in his study, talking to Kastanda.

"Am I not too late, I.?" I came running into the room and gave a joyous shout.

"The gong will be only in fifteen minutes," Kastanda answered me. "Please don't be surprised if your and I.'s places in the dining-room are decorated with flowers. Our dear host Ali Mahomet warned us about the arrival of his friends, and every dweller here soon wanted to express their greeting for the coming guests in some way, while elder Ali himself is greeting you with his presents which you will find in your places at the table, too."

Kastanda left, while I. explained to me.

"Lovushka, simplicity prevails both here and in the dining-room, but it doesn't mean that man loses his comfort. Now you became blind, absent-minded and you knew neither where nor at what to look. Tomorrow you will perceive the surroundings better. Now let's go to have our supper, don't be embarrassed because of many strange people. Many women will be there as well."

I felt sick at heart. Anna flashed before my eyes like a living ghost. Oh, how clearly I could feel her pain now. She could have been here, with us. Ananda could take her here himself, but one moment of her doubts and jealousy – and everything disappeared.

"Anna didn't disappear irreversibly," I. told me silently and tenderly. "She will become stronger and she will come. The storm of jealousy won't rise within her anymore, but she will be here only when Ali's daughter Nal with her husband, your brother, comes here as well. Then Ali will bring Anna here himself. Don't be sad for her. Help her with thoughts of your joyous love. Every morning, every evening send help of your cheerfulness and courage for her. You won't be able to help her with anything more active in this moment, but don't think that it isn't much. This is a very big help. A daily joyous thought about a man is like the quick building of a bridge on which you can learn to meet that man in your thoughts, about whom you will be thinking with joy, purely, attentively and constantly."

The gong rang out. As always I. guessed my embarrassment, he took my arm and we went downstairs.

It was almost dark already, it was warm, almost hot. To my amazement, the electricity lit up the hall of the dining-room clearly. All the doors in it were opened, the windows were covered with moist material, tens of big ventilators were spinning under the ceiling by raising the cool wind, but it was stuffy anyway.

I understood how strong I became. I wouldn't have held out such heat before at all. The stuffiness of Constantinople seemed to be ridiculously weak in comparison to it. I would have fainted away here instantly several months ago, and now it was only stuffy for me. The Indian suit and the sandals on my bare feet helped me a lot.

We were among the first ones who entered. Kastanda approached us immediately and he accompanied us to our places. They were by the edge table which was laid already, just like all the other ones. Many who entered were greeting I. like their old friend, the others were bowing to us from the distance like to the friends who came back. Apparently, everybody here knew one another and they didn't feel shy. When everybody was seated in their own places, the tables were being served in a very original way. The bowls and small dishes were drawing up on the little, very beautiful pushing tables, from which everybody was taking that what he wanted and as much as he wanted to. We were sitting at the edge, by the window, and the food came rolling to us from the window side.

I. proposed me to put some food for him and for myself, while I was unable to decide what and how they were eating here. When I noticed tomato salads, potatoes and cauliflowers I began to put them into our plates, but suddenly I saw an excellent melon. Having remembered that "the wise man without a melon wasn't any wise man", I already wanted to take it, too, but I. gave a laugh and held me.

"Lovushka, as soon as we eat the vegetables, the little table will come rolling soon again, you better pay attention to the flowers dedicated to you and to something else. Perhaps, Ali's greeting will move you."

I directed my look at the flowers and I saw that the white lily was put in a high green vase before me. Ali must have had his own hothouse here as well; but I was unable to concentrate my attention on anything at all. There were so many faces before me – the ones of men, women, young, elderly and old - and what kind of faces were here! I wanted to take a peep at all of them in passing, but every face to which I directed my look seemed to me to be unusual and I could hardly take my eyes off it.

"No, Lovushka, don't even try to take in all of them and everything at once," I heard I.'s voice. "More than a hundred people are here, and you will become acquainted with them little by little. Eat, look at the plates and at least at those who sit at our table."

I gave a sigh by comprehending how far I still was till I. who could take in a hundred people at once and describe everyone's characteristic in several minutes, tell exactly that what was important for everybody and keep the energy in everyone with his only word or look.

These I.'s qualities didn't surprise me anymore. I had seen enough of such Florentian's and Ananda's qualities. I was surprised by something in the very hall full of people. I had seen a lot of people lately, too, but there was something especial in this hall, something what I hadn't yet seen anywhere else. It had to do not with the hall itself, but with people in it, with their inner side which I couldn't feel with my eyes, but I could feel the spiritual culture clearly. Now I could feel this crowd of people in an absolutely different way. It was impossible to imagine here that suddenly, in some corner of the hall a sharp cry, a sarcastic laughter or a vicious phrase could be heard...

I. distracted my attention again and he forced me to eat by telling me that the little table would come soon, while I was behind. I began to chew something by not understanding what I was eating, I cast a glance at the table-napkin and I was dumbfounded. The napkin was put through a wonderful ring with Ali's name which was laid out from tiny, green jewels and white pearls.

"I told you, look round you, didn't I?" I. said to me by smiling from my stunning absent-mindedness.

I wanted to know what kind of I.'s ring was, and... I was dumbfounded again. The ring of his napkin was made of the white wood on which it was written "Ali" with white coral. Then there was an inscription in the language which I didn't know.

"When I was going from C. with Florentian," I said to I., "I didn't understand a single word what he was talking to the natives. I was always irritated and dispirited. Then I swore to myself to learn that language, because I was enraged with my ineptitude of it. I still didn't started fulfilling my first oath, but in spite of it I swear for the second time: to learn that language in which the inscription is written on your ring. I don't get irritated anymore. My ignorance doesn't oppress me anymore. With my current self-control I can see it even better. I., will you help me to fulfil both of these oaths for me?"

"My dear friend, I only ask you, please don't take any hasty pledges anymore, because here, in Ali's community you'll have to live for many years, while I took you here only for a short time, so that you could prepare yourself for your future life next to Florentian."

"Ali's community?" I asked I. in an absolute amazement.

"Yes, but I will tell you everything later. Now eat, look round, answer the questions, although I think that nobody will ask you anything."

In this way I began to examine our neighbours attentively by listening attentively to the conversation at our table. I touched the flowers next to my plate and suddenly I noticed two little envelopes among them. There was my name written on each of them. I recognized the large and clear elder Ali's handwriting immediately and the same clear, but much smaller and womanly young Ali's one.

The whole cloud of memories together with great joy poured into me. I relived the feast at Ali's again, as well as the separation with my brother, meeting with Florentian and the episodes of my travelling with him. Love for my brother in my heart was always the same strong, only now not the separation of my parting with him was buzzing in my memory like the most resounding string, but joy for him, joy because he was happy, safe and because he was living next to Florentian. I was thinking about the elder Ali with great gratitude not only because now I was sitting under his roof, but because he did so much for my brother and because both of us were really indebted to him for everything.

All of a sudden I could feel the already familiar trembling of my entire organism. It seemed to me that I could see Ali who was standing in the distance by the round window, that I could see his burning eyes and that I could hear his strong, clear voice: "Learn, Lovushka. Your first task – to learn self-control, the second one – to learn fearlessness, the third one – to learn tact. When you acquire these qualities you can go to the world to work again and to serve people. I. will help you, while I will accept you to the circle of my co-workers."

Ali disappeared, it seemed to me that it became much darker in the dining-room. I came to myself, because I. obligingly helped me to stand up. The sickly state of the illusive views didn't repeat for a long time already, I thought that I was recovered from them completely and now I was distressed, because I understood that I didn't become strong enough.

Everybody was rising from their places, the supper must have been ended. By submitting to I.'s hand, I also rose and I saw Kastanda next to myself.

"Lovushka, apparently you were very tired after your journey and from the heat. I will tell them to bring your flowers to the balcony, and maybe you would like to take your letters now, immediately," Kastanda told me by extending them to me.

I thanked him, took both letters, I also wanted to take the ring, but I. told me that we would inspect it tomorrow, in the daylight. He introduced me to some of his friends who approached him, but I was still like in the mist and I could hardly see their faces which seemed to me so significant not so long time ago. We went out to the park. For the first time I could watch the sky in such big space, but I had so

little strength that I asked I. to sit down on the first bench. I pressed myself to I. The vital energy was flowing from him to me. Little by little I became calm and I felt that my heart was already beating normally. I said to I. that I wanted to go to my room and to read both Ali's letters.

"Soon, much sooner than it seems to you, Lovushka, you will learn to control yourself and to hear your friends' voices through big distances, without any strain," I. was talking to me tenderly by accompanying me home.

Now I was able to comprehend only one thing from the entire surroundings: the silence of the night corresponded to the silence within myself. Dark shadows in groups, in couples and alone were moving along the paths of the parks. While the walking people were passing by, I felt their goodwill spreading to me again, like in the dining-room. I didn't know how it manifested itself and how I could feel it, but I was absolutely certain that nobody here was going to condemn me, to dismantle me, but that they would accept me to their community with love and very easily.

I. was leading me in a roundabout paths, and I understood that he wanted to give me a chance to calm down completely. All of a sudden it seemed even funny to me: was I. really thinking that I was the previous Lovushka, that an irritation could remain in any little crack of my essence?

"My dear I., I'm ready to read my letters for a long time already, everything is all right with my head. Could you really suspect that I got irritated today? I've already forgotten how one did it," I looked at I.'s face merrily in the light of the stars shining brightly.

"Lovushka, I know that you cannot get irritated anymore, and if I'm leading you in the park for so long, then I do it so that already in the very first night when you enter Ali's house, you would enter it with the perfect balance of your strength and feelings. We are in Ali's community. Every one of us by coming here has already covered the path of the cross of our lives, but not every one of us who was able to cover it could come up to this house. You'll see only those here who became bright in their suffering, who understood, accepted and blessed their circumstances, who wanted to live by serving people, by thinking about the common welfare. Today by entering this house, think, my dear boy, about everybody who was left in Constantinople, about everybody who now is next to Ananda and Florentian, also remember sir Vomi and everybody who stayed with us and who left comforted and gladdened. Both Alis will talk to you through their letters, thank life for meeting them. Throw off the whole burden of your former pain and misunderstandings. Enter under Ali's roof by being free, light and joyous. Don't think what tomorrow prepares for you, but end today with such completeness for your feelings that your entire organism could gather to itself the words of elder Ali written to you."

We entered the house, went upstairs, and I said good-bye to I. so that I could read Ali's letter alone, whose wonderful face looking at me from the ether through the round window I saw not so long time ago.

My friend, my brother and dear son!

Neither distance nor conditional separation exists for those whose hearts are burning with inextinguishable love. Death doesn't exist for those whose consciousness has comprehended the living Eternity within themselves.

Today you entered my home in the East. Enter it not as a guest or a family friend, but as the member of my family enjoying equal rights. Everybody whom you'll meet here, - all of them are your brothers and sisters who are walking the path of their development and work.

You were endowed more than many of them. You have the power to see and hear me, Florentian, Ananda, sir Vomi at any time. I. is going to lead you by always helping you to develop your psychic powers into the highest levels of knowledge. You are going to control your inner and your outer powers.

What is needed from you, so that everything would happen successfully and all your creative powers of spirit would open within yourself?

Your loyalty is needed. What is the disciple's loyalty for his Teacher? That is his eternal unity with his work and his paths. If you are going to light the heroic strain of your strength and your thoughts, you will unite with the intensive flame of your Teachers' creation, and Eternity is going to open all your talents within yourself, but your loyalty – that's the only key to all your knowledge.

Live freely, easily and without any fear. Those who are unable to live like this every day, the knowledge is out of reach for them, even if they stepped over the threshold of the Community. One can live among perfect people and see only their external manners anyway. One can live among the same people like you are, imperfect, but who are striving for joy of knowledge, and who see the sparkle of fire of Eternity in them. Then you will try not to disturb this sparkle of fire within man and you will try to help him, so that he would turn from the sparkle into the bonfire in an easier, simpler and merrier way. I repeat to you that neither the Community nor people, not even the nature with its beauties is going to give the key to such path to anybody. The key is within yourself, in your loyalty.

There isn't any "special" knowledge which opens for man with efforts of his will in special places during some special rituals. The black occultists are engaged in these affairs. Their knowledge acquired in such a way is poor, and you already had the possibility to make sure of it. But the temptation which they are spreading in the world, the wounds which they leave are terrible, and they destroy ignorant people. By acting through egoistic passions, the black occultists recruit their own armies, they burn down the will for kindness within man with their hypnosis.

That Community in which you are living now, - that's the net of salvation where the soldiers for fight against the evil, robbery and burning passions are trained. The hearts of those become hardened here, who want to live for the common welfare, for the people's calm and joy.

Knowledge – that's the engine of life, while joy – that's the lubricant for it. From this moment on when you've entered under the roof of my Community, perceive the new order of things and notice the new present which Great Life gives to you.

You have the period of entire seven years before you of complete liberation from all troubles of your practical life. While being completely liberated from your private burden, perceive your great inner freedom. Perceive that your I which is free from passions is able to move heaven and earth if your loyalty is really whole, and if no doubt or fear is able to beat the smallest crack through it.

My friend, accept my energetic handshake and walk through life with an ordinary kindness. As soon as your kindness becomes daily and usual engine of your life – you will be able to begin and to start your every meeting calmly and joyfully.

Believe me – everything what man must achieve in his meeting – that's to begin and to start **each** of them calmly, with compassion and kindness.

The time which I mentioned to you – seven years which seem like an eternity to you now, - would fly past like a single moment. When you leave the hospitable shelter of the Community, you will

persuade yourself that you still don't feel enough strength within yourself to go to the practical life and to create the paths for people to the common welfare and calm.

*But... everybody has **his own** time, **his own** hour of creation, his own time of development and actions of his heroic powers.*

That person who hurries – doesn't reach. That person who lags behind and lingers – finds only death. Don't lose your courage, my friend. You've started your path well – continue it in exactly the same way. If you need my help in the moment of disharmony, think about me strongly and firmly, call me by name, and I will respond to you immediately. Accept my regards and calm.

Your friend Ali Mahomet

I put out the light, took the letter and went to the balcony. The dark and silent night with the sky studded with stars surrounded me. The glamorous contours of the big palms were difficult to see. The unknown sounds of this night, some rustles, a very distant voice of the little pipe, the aroma of roses and pinks – everything merged into still unexperienced calm and bliss for me. The harmony reigning in this night seized me as well. I stopped feeling to be a separate living being, I felt a joy of existence, a happiness to live in this wonderful universe where I perceived myself to be a little living part of it.

Having pressed the letter to my lips, I was thanking Ali for his entire benefaction for me and for my brother. I read the letter again not with my eyes and mind, but with my heart. My love for Ali poured in a hot wave by opening his great strength for me. I perceived another aspect of my great friend – love. I wanted to come nearer to knowledge so that I could come nearer to him as well. I was standing for so long in the balcony that the stars began to go out already, and the east began to grow red. I remembered the young Ali's letter and I hurried to my room. I opened all windows one after another and I began to watch how the red band swimming out from the tops of the mountains was widening and becoming bright. Suddenly the little edge of the sun slipped off, and I could hardly refrain from shouting with fascination. The row of the mountains with snow-capped tops, illuminated with reddish light opened in the distant horizon. The wide valley with picturesque settlements, the changing gardens, clearings and the forests were spreading up to the foot of the mountains. I stepped back from the window only when I saw the gardeners leaving the distant buildings of the Community. Life started awakening in many places instantly. I saw how the people dressed in white, with frottier towels on their shoulders were going to bathe in the small river of the mountains. I sat down on the chair and I started reading the second letter.

"My dear Lovushka, my dear brother," the young Ali was writing to me in a fine and unusually beautiful handwriting. By looking at this strong-willed handwriting of his, I imagined him in an especially clear way. I remembered the first moments of our meeting when he, by not seeing us, put the querulous aunt off the cart and how he was smiling to Nal stealthily. I remembered him in that moment when Nal gave the flower to my brother Nikolay... I saw him dressed in Indian clothes in his uncle Ali's estate. How this man had to suffer back then, whose letters of the writing were winding in an even line like some harmoniously knitted knitting. What kind of endurance of his will and love has to live in this harmonious living being that after the deadly blow he could live the life of full value again, he could smile and be happy. Now it was clear to me that exactly when Nal gave the flower not to him, but to my brother Nikolay, Ali was dead. The careless Ali in love was dead, the groom who was dreaming about love and

family was dead, and the new man remained to live, the warrior, the creator of life who was next to the elder Ali and who's already forgotten about himself forever.

Now I didn't ask myself already: "Why was there so much pain in the world?" I knew why it was needed, I knew that only through pain people were coming to knowledge, only by overcoming obstacles they grew and hardened themselves. I started reading the letter again:

The whole troubled life of your late months rises before me. Suffering was breaking my heart many times, I wanted to exchange my role with you and to take your entire heroic deed upon myself by giving the peaceful life next to uncle Ali to you. But... you cannot choose your path. The path stretches there and in such a way as man himself has paved it.

You cannot tell everything what you would like to pour out of your heart, and our words are too small for that what I would like to share with you. I certainly have to tell you one thing: worry neither about myself nor about your brother.

You see, your life on the earth – that's your liberation through work. We are created in such a way that we bring onto the earth and we grow within ourselves many passions and superstitions which tangle us round like some adhesive lianas. The more beautiful the blossoms of our lianas are, the stronger we attach to them, the stronger we are seeking after them. When the time of our inner maturing comes, we have to break off the chains of our illusions, and if they have been rooted deep in our hearts, then in that moment when we pull them out, we die. Sometimes the entire parts of our essence die, so that joy of liberation would grow in the place of our passions which were chaining us.

I cannot state that I've conquered the levels of my growth and liberation in an easy and simple way. I died many times from lianas of my passions which caught hold of me and I rose again by always thanking Life for sending me the lesson of my liberation.

I can see how tens of lessons fell on you instantly. I can see in what stoical way you withstand them, my dear friend Lovushka. It seems to you that there's too much suffering around you, that Compassion of Life could have cared better for people's joy. No, Lovushka. Not Life gives awards, good luck or punishments, but man himself gathers that during his days what he has scattered round him during the centuries with his creation.

It is impossible to dry up or to take out the turbid water with a jug, which you've poured into your life yourself. You need to pass it through your consciousness and work. Only then the water that has passed through the filters of man's own kindness would soak into the soil and leave the crystals of pure Love around him on its surface. These radiating crystals can neither become turbid nor break. They are the little pieces of eternal Love that exists in you and in everybody else. They are light and pure, and they are pouring out of us like the rain of diamonds if we think not about ourselves, but about the people whom we meet during our current earthly commonness.

The more love we have in our free and purified heart, the clearer and wider is radiating the carpet of love around us, on which we meet our own people. While you are still only coming nearer to a man, you feel the aroma of the atmosphere of his carpet of love from the distance. That man whose atmosphere captivates you with energy of his tenderness and power was always dying from his passions for many, many times before they became the crystals of his liberated Love.

Lovushka, you had to suffer a lot, but you still have a big and long life before you. You still are going to experience a lot of things along your way, but know only one thing: such stages of development

doesn't exist, which would fall on a man's shoulders from heaven by themselves as from the horn of plenty, which somebody's hand is holding by strewing his path with flowers. Each flower – that's the labour of a man himself. Your every good fortune – that's your victory against yourself.

"Good fortune" which you will call by this name, - that's only your knowledge, your achievements along your path of liberation. That will be your inner strength and victory, and not that external welfare which people call to be good fortune by trying to amass as much wealth as possible by using strange hands and their work.

If you ever feel especially unwell, know firmly that you already end one of the levels of your liberation, that a part of your illusions dies within you. The organism of the earth always withstands their death with very much difficulty, because it possesses the consciousness, strength and feelings of the both worlds – the ones of heaven and of the earth.

By knowing this, when pain already winds round you, remember and lean on such people like I. whose shining carpet of love has already grown into the big sphere that encompasses both himself and everybody else who came up to him. My uncle Ali told me that he would send me to you, to the Community. I've already been there twice and I would be glad if I meet you there.

My dear friend, accept my sincere regards. It is not worth even talking how I will be glad if you don't refuse our friendship and you write to me. While I'm always with you in my thoughts and I dare to call myself your loyal friend.

Ali Machmed

This was the second letter received from younger Ali. It flowed by itself from my memory how I was protecting Florentian's sleep and how I was reading his first letter in the stuffiness of the carriage.

In comparison not so much time had passed, even less than a year from our first meeting with Ali, and there were so many events already. Such events that buried the boy who came to his brother's to K. I gave a smile to myself when I remembered that naïve, always irritated Lovushka who was going to Ali's feast and who imagined that he was a hero of the masquerade. It seemed to me that now I couldn't have even felt so expansively as back then. I remembered my disappointment, my solitude, the tears of the abandoned living being which excited the sensation of the grave within myself, and I understood clearly that I had already stepped over the certain level of my consciousness and that I would never search for happiness in life in the external form again.

Probably I would have still reflected on different questions of life for a long time, which were rising from associations of my recollections, but a flower thrown through the window drew my attention. I picked it up, went to the balcony and I saw I. who invited me to bathe in the small river of the mountains.

"Lovushka, but you haven't slept. You cannot do like that," my friend and guardian told me in a falsely austere tone. "Today I want to introduce you to many of my friends, there will be many charming ladies among them, and I don't want you to make an impression on them of sleepy and boring Lovushka during the breakfast."

I assured him that I wouldn't disgrace him, I hid the letters, snatched the towel and caught up with I. quickly.

Now we were walking along that picturesque valley which I saw from my balcony. The path suddenly turned left, we went round a little garden, and I was taken aback by the view that opened again. The small river of the mountains came flowing from far away, it was falling down in cascades, it was roaring and foaming, but by the sandy shoal where I took me, it poured out in a big lake like a cup and then it was flowing again in a narrow little river, plunging into waterfalls.

Palms were growing around the lake, and there were many bathing places constructed. The lake was deep, the water was cold, and only few, the best swimmers and athletes used to swim across it. There were many bathing places on its another side, too, I could see some moving people.

It was hot already, I was dreaming about getting into the water as soon as possible, but I took me further, towards the upper reaches, to another terrace of the mountain. Here I saw the same view, the river poured out into a lake and then it kept flowing down, but this lake was smaller and shallower. I explained to me that those who came to the Community for the first time were not allowed to bathe in the lower lake instantly, because too low temperature of the water could provoke one's cramps and even harm one's organism to death, but by inuring oneself to the high air temperature and the cold water little by little, which had many curative characteristics, one could not only cure many physical illnesses, but also revive one's organism. Many people who lived in the Community for six or seven years left it looking ten years younger and they almost stopped being ill.

I didn't want to leave me alone, so he was bathing together with me in the upper lake. I don't know how I would have felt in the lower lake, but the water of this lake simply enchanted me. After the sea in which I often used to bathe during our long journey, the soft, absolutely clear and pleasantly cool water of the lake in which I could see the smallest stones, the ground of which was like a velvet and in which there wasn't a single jellyfish, seemed like the real bliss to me. I couldn't get out of the water in any way, and only I's threat that the hour of the women's bathing was drawing nearer, while I detained the ladies, forced me to go ashore, although I sighed and I promised I to find one more lake for myself tomorrow already where I could bathe as much as I wanted to, without being afraid of being taken by surprise of the ladies.

I was laughing and he frightened me that he would introduce me to one American, very rich lady who didn't like recluse youths and who turned all of them into her pages. I was filled with indignation and I asked him to remember that I wouldn't go to America for anything and that I wanted to become acquainted only with Russians. As soon as I had time to finish my tirade, voices and laughter were heard behind the bathing places.

"What does it mean?" I heard a joyous, very young womanly voice that was speaking in English. "Are the lords still in the lake? Didn't seven strike already?"

"No, dear ladies," I answered, "the lords still have three minutes left. Besides, one of the Russian counts who's just come, was late on purpose, so that he could become acquainted with American lady. He heard so much about her mind and talent of education that he was dreaming of becoming her page."

I was telling all of it to somebody on the small bridge of the bathing place by imitating the intonation of the womanly voice and her somewhat incorrect accent that I was holding for a while, but then I couldn't bear it anymore and I burst out laughing in my previous boyish way. I opened the door of the bathing place, took me to the bank and... I got stiff by becoming Lovushka, the Catcher of Crows.

Two women were standing before me. One of them was stout, of middle height, with curly hair, unattractive brown-haired woman. Her big, grey, goggled, unquiet, commanding eyes as though didn't

fit in this corpulent body. It seemed to me that these eyes needed to know everything, to poke her nose everywhere, to participate everywhere. She was about thirty years old by appearance.

A girl was standing next to her. She was young and small, looked sickly, dark-haired, very neat, very kind and... rather sad. I couldn't understand anything. The voice must have been of the young one's? But then the elder one began to speak – and as though it gave me the shivers: the voice was hers. To whom of them did I. promise me as a page? Probably I couldn't please in any way to these electric wheels and not womanly eyes.

The elder lady smiled – as though she drilled a hole in my heart – and she began to speak again.

"If there was my will, and if my great respect for you, doctor I., didn't hinder me, then I would forbid the children younger than seventeen years old to come to the Community. Especially for such nervous ones like your friend."

"It's nothing, Nataliya Vladimirovna, my friend has already outrun many, and the most importantly – we should have to start applying the prohibition from you. You came here when you were still younger than seventeen, didn't you? And anyway you were accepted with joy, and life here didn't harm you."

I. introduced me to both women by calling one of them Nataliya Vladimirovna Andreyeva, and another one – lady Berdran.

"In a day or two you will call me Nataliya anyway, so you may not memorize my patronymic," Andreyeva told me by extending her hand to me.

How subtle and pleasant this hand was! I felt friendliness for her instantly and I stopped being afraid of her eyes.

"Well, you have awls, and not eyes!"

"My God, and I just wanted to say that your eyes – that's electric wheels! Probably they would find even a nail on the sea ground. I already felt how you drilled me through with them, Nataliya Vladimirovna."

"Well, who am I then?" lady Berdran gave a laugh. "I have neither awls nor wheels and I cannot drill any holes. To which circle of mortals do I belong?"

"Lady, you are the star of fortune. I'm sure that you always bring luck to people whom you meet. Your sadness arises, because you take heartbreak from everybody and you give your kindness to them in exchange."

"Have pity on us, I., you needed to bathe your friend in the lower lake instantly," Andreyeva burst out laughing.

I. took my arm, looked at the ladies merrily, gave even a merrier laugh, made an appointment for them in the dining-room and ran by dragging me along with himself, as the schoolchildren were doing.

I was surprised again. Indeed when I settled in the Community I couldn't do anything else, but only to be surprised. I. who was so serious, so solid, who laughed so rarely, who always only smiled, here he was absolutely different. I couldn't imagine that I. could run and play pranks with me like a child.

Soon I asked I. to walk as slowly as possible. There wasn't any sign left from my bathing. I was wet, while my sandals were full of dust. It seemed that I. had just left the sitting-room.

"Don't be sad, Lovushka, you will get used to the climate, you will learn to walk and run without raising any dust. Go, change your clothes, take a shower, invite Yassa, he will help you. I will wait for you here."

I. sat down on the bench in the shadow by the porch, and I didn't have time even to go upstairs when a big crowd of people surrounded him already.

Yassa advised me to take a cold shower, and I did it with pleasure. He gave a clean chiton and sandals to me, and he explained to me that in the mornings everybody was walking only in a light chiton, while for their dinner they were wearing two of them. The dinner was early here, at two o'clock.

I was amazed how they could eat in such heat, but I didn't say anything. Yassa who as though understood my thoughts explained to me that the morning dining-room to which we would go now, - was in the west. They were dining in the very end of the park, by the small river, in the northern open dining-room which was overgrown with lianas and creepers, while the tea-room was in the eastern part of the park, by the rock. The hottest was not during the dinner where they were always watering the verdure which was would round the dining-room and where the wind of ventilators was blowing, but in the tea-room. There was even a grotto arranged here in the rock for those who couldn't bear the heat. It was always chilly in the grotto, and many people were working there during the midday heat.

I went downstairs together with the gong. I. introduced me to some of his friends, he took my arm, and all of us went to the dining-room.

I looked round by being worried, because I thought that my new acquaintances were late for the breakfast. And a surprise was waiting for me here as well. Andreyeva and lady Berdran were going from the opposite side of the park. There must have been another, shorter path from the river straight to the park.

Now I could examine both ladies better. Andreyeva was walking in a heavy gait, as the stout people were doing it. Her eyes really looked like electric wheels. Again she made an impression of a magnetized person on me. It seemed to me that her friend was keeping some distance from her consciously. Lady Berdran gave a smile to us and settled at the adjacent table where a not young man was sitting. He was very handsome, shaved, agile, with excellent manners. I considered him to be a Frenchman. He greeted his neighbour, pulled the chair for her deftly and sat down himself only when she settled at the table conveniently.

I. explained to me that he was Pole, an ordinary worker who achieved the higher education himself and who was fighting against the czar's yoke many times. His name was Jan Sinecki, he wasn't for the first time here.

I saw a man of short stature next to Andreyeva with beautiful, kind and childish naïve eyes. His luxuriant, grey beard and the same curly hair, his big, short-sighted blue eyes were merry and comically roguish, so everything was so beautiful and nice that even the glasses didn't spoil this face. His cheeks were reddish, his lips were red, he had teeth like a pearl - he could be a model of a kind-hearted man for a sculptor. The smile almost never disappeared from his lips, he was dressed with light, irreproachably white suit made of the very thin silk. Neatness and good order were blowing from him, what emphasized the contrast with his neighbour even more.

The rough features of the commanding Andreyeva's face, the unusual alertness and attentive look of her eyes, the stern power spreading from her made an absolute contrast for her neighbour. Everything was untidy in her. The white lacy headscarf covering her hair was tied slovenly, her dress was crumpled, the book in her hand was ragged, the bare rods were stuck out of her umbrella. Both of them, so contrasting, drew my entire attention immediately. Every one of them looked attractive in their own way, and I thought: however differently these two people would reflect, they could solve some task of life together and supplement each other harmoniously.

When I already wanted to ask I. whether they weren't husband and wife, I heard the loud, joyous Andreyeva's laughter, and she told us across the table.

"I., I told you that you needed to bathe that count-awl of yours in the cold lake instantly. He found a subject for his future novel, and poor mister Oldenkot got among the first of his heroes."

"I don't think so, Nataliya Vladimirovna. You've frightened Lovushka so much that probably he would be searching for a subject of his works in other sectors of the Community," I. answered her by flashing his eyes comically.

Regardless of Andreyeva's external rudeness, the power of benevolence was blowing from her when she was looking at me. Inside of me I struck up a friendship with her instantly, what I was surprised myself of. I understood clearly for the first time that Andreyeva didn't possess any external tact; but her wisdom was greater than everybody else's who was sitting next to her. I gave a smile and I told her by not being afraid of her eyes at least a little anymore.

"I don't know what would have happened if I. had told me to bathe in the cold lake, but the warm one excited the only wish for me: to become your page."

Not only I., Oldenkot, Sinecki and lady Berdran, but also those who were sitting further from our table couldn't refrain from laughing. Kastanda who approached I. to ask him what dietetic table he had to give to me was laughing until he began to cry. Nataliya Vladimirovna waited until her neighbours calmed down and again she began to speak in a clear, sharp voice that was unusually young according to her age.

"Lovushka, remember this day and this laughter well. It will be a great excuse for me when Ali comes here and asks me what I've done for the man who desired to become my page voluntarily. The joint laughter of my friends tells in what tyranny I held my young friends. Only always everything ends in such a way that I fall into their clutches and become an object of their escapades and amusements."

I didn't understand very well what was hidden behind this joint laughter and what was the essence of Andreyeva's words. I. was looking at me merrily, he forced me to eat the vegetables salad, then a very tasty porridge and finally to drink some excellent coffee which I had missed during the long time of our trip, because I used to get only cacao and chocolate everywhere.

A tall, slender, neatly shaved youth – mister Chergiston was sitting next to me. He turned out to be mathematician by education, but he studied history in this moment. He also was for the first time in the Community and he came here only several weeks ago. I felt that he hadn't yet been accustomed here. Mister Chergiston had a letter for I., of what I said to my friend instantly.

"Yes, I know, mister Chergiston. Your friend wrote to me when I still was in Constantinople that he sent you here. He asked me to be your guide, which I undertake to do with great joy. Ananda also told me about you. I brought his letter and a small parcel for you," he said to the Englishman tenderly.

I will never forget what happened to the youth when he heard that Ananda sent the letter and the parcel to him. The reserved and strict Englishman gave a start, the fork and the napkin fell out of his hands, he flushed and uttered with his eyes full of tears.

"Did Ananda himself really write a letter for me?"

"Yes, mister Chergiston, not only he wrote it, but also explained scrupulously to me how I had to prepare you for meeting him. When he comes here, you must be ready to accompany him to the distant and long journey. Ananda asked me to tell you that you would try to overcome your shyness, because you would have to live in big, noisy cities among people and to communicate with them constantly."

"Apparently, I'm not destined to live in such a way as I would like to," mister Chergiston gave a sigh. "I was dreaming about a monastery, and I would get into the world and even to the racket of the city, but in order for me to be next to Ananda, I will walk any path with joy."

The breakfast was over, we said good-bye to our neighbours and the new acquaintances, and we went upstairs to our rooms together with Englishman.

"Please, doctor I., and you, Lovushka, call me Alver," Chergiston uttered. "My dearest people call me like this, and I would like to hear how both of you address me like this."

"Great, Alver, we'll do exactly like this," I. told him and gave the letter and the parcel to him. "Come to the park in half an hour by the most distant pond along the hundred-year-old palms if that doesn't disturb the program of your day. I want to take Lovushka to the foot of the near, green mountains and to acquaint him with environs a little, and at the same time with botany."

"How happy I am that you will take me together with you! I will be by the palms in half an hour."

Alver left by carrying his dear letter and the small, but rather heavy box.

"Alver has suffered a lot during his life," I. told me when we left for the park, armed with shovels, big felt hats, knives and baskets. "His life until the last two years was the entire horror in the family of his stepmother and her children, which he supported by working without taking a rest. When the youth was already falling into despair, one of Ananda's disciples met him. He took him to Ananda when he was on his way to Dover, and since then Alver rose again. Ananda also helped him to get here."

"Ah, I., how difficult it is for me to concentrate my attention here. I would like at least to take in everybody who is living here with my eyes, and now as soon as I look at one of them – I'm immersed in him and I forget about everybody else. Until now I used to concentrate my attention in such a way that I could see both a man – even a very exceptional one – and I could take in the whole surroundings. While here my attention is enough only for one person."

"Lovushka, this is not because you are absent-minded, but only because your attention became concentrated, and you started feeling the emanations and vibrations of your encountered people in a more subtle and stronger way. Your organism, its psychic and physical characteristics became hardened in comparison to your previous ones, and you can see a man clearer. If you remember your sensations during your meetings since you left C. you'll notice that the streams spreading from people were always destroying you. Even after your communication with such high and bright powers like Ali, Florentian and Ananda we always needed to strengthen you with sap of herbs and plants through the sweets, pills and drops. Now you've forgotten about all these means even during such stormy meeting with Andreyeva. And besides, namely she could destroy your peace, and it could still happen in the future. Did you notice that

the American who's living next to her for a long time already is trying to keep aloof from Nataliya Vladimirovna? Everybody next to Andreyeva felt anxiety since her very childhood, while things used to jump as soon as she used to come nearer to them. And now she isn't allowed to enter the studies with medical electric devices. The electric devices become corrupt even from her presence, because they don't sustain that enormous electric strength which her organism radiates. All psychic powers are uncovered within her. She is one of those suddenly renewed people in whom Eternity absorbed her bestial origin instantly and returned all her previous talents and knowledge, but the power of divine fire isn't flowing in harmony with fire of the earth within her, which slips out of her like tongues of her flame, although the fire of Light always surpasses and calms it. Both these fires don't merge into harmony within her, besides she is prone to get irritated, that's why she might infect also others with her instability. And anyway you remained completely controlled before her, although she saw and read all your peculiarities in your aura."

Alver approached us, for whom we've been waiting for several minutes already by standing in the nook of the fantastic beauty, under the hundred-year-old palms surrounding the pond, the huge, spread wide crowns of which were reflected on the water. Black and white swans were swimming in the pond, while the reddish flocks of flamingos and some other unseen birds were standing about among the palms.

Several little houses could be seen further in the thick verdure, and the white peacocks were walking about with dignity and their wonderful trains stretched out. People dressed in white always used to go past us. Apparently, all of them knew I. well, as well as he knew them. I was amazed by his memory. He used to greet everybody by calling him by his name, he used to ask different questions for everybody, but the result was always one and the same: the people's faces used to brighten up, joy and cheerfulness like the sunbeams used to shine in them.

While we were walking slowly down the shady park, I was sighing in my thoughts: what an enormous gap was between me and I. in comparison to our knowledge, strength, talents and finally love! From where could burn such inextinguishable bonfire of this love within him so that he wouldn't dry and empty his heart with streams of his attention and warmth with which he simply would pour every person encountered?

"Well, Lovushka, no melancholy thoughts may exist in the Community. Only those got here who've overcome all the possibilities to deny, to grieve, to be sad and to complain within themselves. Throw off all your doubts and prepare for the first test of the desert. As soon as we leave the shade of the park, the heat will overtake us from all sides."

I. pulled the big felt hat on my head strongly and lowered the net from it on my shoulders which I hadn't noticed up to now. Indeed, as soon as I stepped behind the gates of the park I felt like in the fire stove instantly. I appreciated Yassa's care to put on high sandals with thick soles for me. The sand which I touched unintentionally was as hot as the charcoal. I began to sweat in streams, all my clothes got wet immediately, then they got dry and wet again, the vapour was rising from my body. I got befogged so much that I could hardly lumber till the foot of the mountains where the streamlets were oozing, the springs were spurting by irrigating the luxuriant vegetation, the grass and the flowers. I. showed several bushes of wild blackberries to me, which were big, ripe, they were hanging till the very ground with their weight. I fell upon them and I told them that I had never eaten anything more tasty during my life.

"And how about melon? Aren't you a wise man?" I. was laughing.

All of a sudden I gave a cry, because I almost trod on a snake which crawled out of my feet.

"This isn't a snake," Alver uttered by taking the disgusting hissing slug into his hands peacefully. "This is grass-snake, Lovushka, it isn't dangerous. Not so long time ago I was really shocked by a wandering snakecharmer whom Kastanda told me to feed, while he showed gratitude to us and performed the whole performance with his cobras and the big rattle-snake. The snakes submitted to the sad, plaintive melody of his little pipe and in the beginning as though they were demonstrating a dance by becoming straight and swaying on their tails, what I found to be disgusting. The all of them together began to attack their master. Many of us were frightened, we thought that his own snakes would strangle their master, but he kept playing in a cheerful mood, while the snakes hung on his neck, hands, legs and hips like living beads. I was looking at him as bewitched and I couldn't understand in any way how the man was controlling these scarecrows, because if they had stung him, he would have died in several minutes. Finally the master sent the snakes to the baskets and sacks, he left only one of them and offered somebody to take it to his hands. He persuaded us that the snake wouldn't bite that one who wouldn't be afraid of it. Oldenkot was already extending his hand to take the snake, but suddenly Andreyeva seized his hand, even faster snatched the snake and threw it to the master. It happened so fast that nobody had time even to react. "Did Ali send you here to teach charlatanism?" Andreyeva shouted so loudly, in such commanding voice, the sparkles began to pour from her eyes in such a way that many of us moved backwards. The snake that was flung aside with such disrespect flew into a rage. The rest of them began to coil in their sacks menacingly, luckily the sacks were tied up already. The master was crying something to Kastanda in the language which I didn't know, probably some not very respectful words. Kastanda interpreted to Andreyeva that the master reproached her for the evil spirit aroused in the snake and that now, if she didn't tame it herself, the snake certainly would bite somebody. Only he didn't take the blame upon himself, because he didn't control any evil spirits. All of a sudden Andreyeva uttered several words to him in the same language, while Kastanda interpreted them to us: "Take your snake as soon as possible and get out of here immediately; if you delay for at least five minutes, I will set the horn on your head of that deer that already comes running here." I couldn't describe in any words what happened to the haughty and arrogant snakecharmer. He snatched the furious snake in a flash, shoved it into his bosom, grasped his sacks, baskets and scuttled off like the deer. He was mumbling some enchantments and he always kept turning back to look at Andreyeva."

"Alver, please put down this unbearable grass-snake," I was asking him bitterly. "I'm not Andreyeva, I cannot cry commandingly, but I'm so tired of that grass-snake of yours that most likely I would whirl away like the snakecharmer."

I made my fellow-travellers laugh, but I gave a lighter sigh when the Englishman let the grass-snake go on the grass.

I went up to I. and asked him why he didn't warn me that there were many snakes in the mountains.

"Because, Lovushka, you will see here not only snakes, but also tigers, lions, you'll also get used not to be afraid of them. And now, my friends, let's mow down the grass, these flowers, let's gather the leaves from those distant bushes. Today is the last day when we can gather them for a treatment goals."

I. showed us how we needed to mow down the grass carefully, without grazing the ground, and on the contrary, how we needed to tear the flowers up by the roots, how carefully we needed to cut only young little leaves off the bushes.

It seemed to us that the work would be easy, but until we with Alver filled up our baskets we were dead-beat. If I wasn't afraid of the snakes, then I would have lain on the grass a long time ago. I.'s basket was full to the brim, he could hardly close it, while he himself was fresh and charming. He was

casting looks on us with a roguery in his eyes. I wanted to ask him very much what he was thinking about Andreyeva, but he was humming a tune, he was telling me that it was time for me to learn to play and to sing, because otherwise I would always remain know-nothing in this field. He didn't allow us not even to rest, he told us that it was time to come back home, because we would be late for dinner. None of my requests to rest helped. I. was laughing at my fear to come back during the heat, he damped my hat in the streamlet, pulled it on my head again and he was looking at my sad expression joyfully.

"But this reminds me of the dervish cap. What will happen if I fall sick?"

I. laughed even more joyously, he seized my hand and started running down. Only now I understood why I got so tired by climbing up the mountain through the grass. The grass was slippery, and I perceived it only now when I was running down with I. I even wasn't running, he was running, while I was only sliding like with skis by catching hold of his hand and shoulder. We must have been going down like this only for several minutes, but they seemed to me like the hours of Dante's Inferno. I was only thinking that I would stumble over some hummock and lie with broken arm or leg. When we descended successfully and stopped by the foot, I. was red in the face, his eyes were shining not worse than the sun, he was so happy, he was so glad that I couldn't utter a single word of reproach to him, although I was prepared to pour a hundred of them and to tell him that I didn't play like this anymore, that I wasn't ready to fly down from the mountains. I. looked back, I did the same. By catching hold of a tree, Alver was standing in the middle of the mountain helplessly. He was big, broad-shouldered and he must have gotten stiff with amazement by looking at our Valkyric flight. His entire pose with his opened wide mouth was so ridiculous that I gave a jump up and I was rocking with laughter by having forgotten about everything in the world.

I. got to Alver in a flash like a cat. He heaped him on his shoulders and ran down as though by carrying a bird. I was so surprised that I even stopped laughing, but then I burst out laughing again until I. told me that he would tell Alver to bring the grass-snake in order to restore my balance.

Alver himself was so dumbfounded that he couldn't recover, so I wasn't afraid of any slugs. I caught hold of I. and I was choking with laughter for nearly a half of the way. Apparently, the event on the mountain, the whole its comicality, the up to now unknown I.'s characteristic – his swiftness, - which excited such enthusiasm within me, obsessed me so much that I completely forgot that we still had a long way to go, that the heat was exhausting us and that there was a storm of sand which the caravan of the walking camels stirred up. When we reached the shade of the park, I. took us along the absolutely different way. Alver looked round surprised and uttered.

"It is so strange, doctor I., I'm here for the second week already, and until now I've seen neither this part of the park nor those beautiful little houses in the distance. They are like toy, white, shining. What kind of the settlement is there?"

"You haven't seen this part of the park, because only the narrow path through the gorge connects it with the big park. Probably you used to come up to the gorge and think that the whole Community ended in that place. In truth, exactly here the Community's activity begins. Those houses about which you ask me – that's the first children's colony. There are tens of such colonies in the Community. They are located around the park and along the river. You can see the school in the distance, while the hospital is in the very border of the settlement, on the right. The shelter and the school of the deaf-mutes are on the left. After some time when both of you with Lovushka get used to the climate and learn to ride on camels, I will take you for a three or four weeks trip, or perhaps even for longer. We'll ride around the whole Community. You'll make yourselves familiar with activity of those who are always living here and who don't come here for several years like you do."

Soon we went up to the gorge, and it seemed to me that there wasn't any way further, but I. went round the big stone, and I saw a beautiful little path which reminded me of the bed of a dried up river. By walking down the path we struck against another side of the gorge, against the monolithic wall. Suddenly I. stooped, entered a grotto that opened for us on the left side, and after a while we already were by those hundred-year-old palms from which we started our journey, only from the absolutely different side of the pond. I glanced back and I couldn't decide from which crack of the mountain we came out. There were many caves behind our backs, which were woven by lianas, roses and other convolvuluses in the same way. There wasn't any time to reflect, because I. came up to the water earlier than we did, he untied a small boat, and in this way we rowed across the pond, while swans and flamingos weren't even afraid of us.

We were just in time for the dinner, because we still had time to take a shower and to change our clothes. When we took our places in the dinner dining-room which I saw for the first time, I noticed that all tables were round here, while our neighbours at the tables were the same. I met attentive Andreyeva's look from the adjacent table. The scene with snakes rose clearly in my imagination, especially when Oldenkot moved the chair up for his neighbour, gathered her belongings thrown everywhere carefully and put them onto the special, side shelves dedicated for various things. I noticed that the rods weren't stuck out of her umbrella anymore, I was moved when I thought that he sewed them like a careful nurse for her.

I forgot to tell you that all chairs in all the dining-rooms were the same – the trunks of palms and bamboos covered with buffalo skins. It was easy to fold and to stretch them out, they were solid, convenient and low like the tables which were covered with clean white tablecloths, the vases with flowers were standing on all of them. The vases were ceramic, made by the locals, all of them were different and they seemed to be artistic for me. Several jugs with milk were standing on each table and they were as beautiful as the vases.

Everybody was dining calmly. Although a lot of people were eating, I couldn't feel any racket. I hadn't seen so many people at the single table d'hote, and it always used to be noisy everywhere; here each table had its own waiters, and everybody used to serve himself.

Once again I was surprised by the especial atmosphere of this crowd of people. Not everybody's manners were such elegant as the Pole worker Sinicki's, also their appearance was the most different, but each face which my look used to touch was marked by spirituality, from which kindness and tranquillity was spreading. Only several faces, among which the one of the wonderful American lady Berdran, were sad, perhaps even not sad, but sorrowfully beautiful, what was even more revealed by joviality of the rest.

Without even having time to ask myself why these several faces were marked with such especially strong and full of inspiration sorrow, I heard the unique Andreyeva's voice and its original accent addressing me.

"Dear and curious count, I propose you not to hurry and forestall the events. If you wish, tomorrow I will answer all your "whys" very comprehensively, while today direct your attention to joy. If you want to, you can join our excursion to the melon field after the dinner."

I became worried immediately. I was already used to get the answers to my mute questions instantly from I. or Florentian, Ananda or sir Vomi, but I didn't want at all that also this woman with her electric wheels would crawl about under my skull. I looked at I. who was sitting next to me, but it seemed to me that he didn't even feel or notice my addressing him.

"We haven't yet been introduced one to another," smiling Oldenkot said to me. "My friend Nataliya Vladimirovna told me about your talents. Don't pay attention to her escapades. No limits of human understanding are valid for her, and sometimes she shocks people, but actually she's the kindest person if you don't look at her like an ordinary woman and if you recognize her supernatural character. Then you will feel next to her absolutely calmly and safely. Indeed, she doesn't like snakes, but you have to put up with it," he added by pretending to be sighing and flinging his eyes mischievously at his neighbour.

Everybody's joint laughter and the requests of several neighbours to take them to the melon field helped me to avoid my answer. I shot a glance at Alver who was laughing, too, and he whispered me.

"Agree to go to gather the melons. It isn't far away, you need to go through the park, the field is almost next to it. The melons are great, they have an exceptional aroma, and most importantly is how she chooses them. She sits in the shade, she almost doesn't look at the field and she explains which melons they have to pick. The chief gardener himself and the market-gardeners are surprised how she does it, as though she could see through every melon."

I thought that this new acquaintance of mine could see through the earth as well. All of a sudden I. turned back to look at me and asked me absolutely seriously.

"Lovushka, do you think that it is impossible to see through the earth?"

I became embarrassed, I didn't even know how I had to react and understand his question. Everybody began to rise from their places and to place the folded chairs by the walls. I caught hold of I., I didn't want to go anywhere, I needed to stay in silence with my dear friend or at least alone, so that my stirred thoughts would calm down.

"I think, Lovushka, that we won't go for the melons, I'd better show Ali's favourite room to you. When Ali comes here, he always lives there. Nobody is permitted to enter the room except himself, but Kastanda received Ali's order to let you stay in his room whenever and for as much as you wanted it to. Here Kastanda comes, to all appearance he brings the key for you.

"Lovushka, I received an order from my dear Teacher and the host of this house to hand you the key from his room on the second day of your arrival. You may stay there for as long as you will need to. During my entire life here – soon twenty years – only the second person receives the right to enter that room freely during his first arrival to the Community. Young Ali was the first one – you are the second one. Apparently the Teacher has some weighty reasons to give such great honour to you. Accept my congratulation and respect, and consider me to be your zealous and happy servant. I'm ready to serve you in the same way as I would do it for him."

Kastanda bowed low to me, while I became completely confused, I was agitated and I gave a shout.

"Ali shows this honour not for me, he does it only as a great favour for me and from love for my brother. I still couldn't deserve such exceptional Ali's kindness with anything. If such unusual and exceptional attention is showed to me now, then apparently, my great friend Florentian asked Ali. It would be painful for me if you thought that I was worthy of this honour myself. I'm here only as modest servant of my brother, of Ali himself and of my guardian I. I., please take the key, I will use the room only when you allow me to do it."

I extended the key to I., but he didn't take it. On the contrary, he embraced and told me.

"Make bold, Lovushka, learn to carry the burden of happiness and misfortune in the same easy way."

We went up not to the big house, but to the small two-storied cottage with a little tower and the balcony, which was standing among powerful palms like in the separate little island to which one could get through the little bridge across the streamlet that surrounded the whole island. The place was wonderful, remote and poetic. The walls of the white house were made of an especial stone which was flat, shining and which looked like white coral. Calm and purity were prevailing here; squirrels were jumping in high cedars, birds were chirping. A white peacock came running to us, as though by wishing to greet us.

An old, toothless servant with Oriental clothes met us by the porch. Having seen the key in my hand, he bowed low and opened the door of the porch. We entered and went upstairs on the upper landing. The stairs were made of the same stone as the walls. Then we came to the door which I. told me to open with the key.

I cannot find any words to describe my feelings which surged me when I was unlocking the door. As though I was standing by the goal for which I was craving ardently and I could see clearly the alive, burning Ali's eyes, as though I could hear his voice telling me.

"Black pearls exist – those are the disciples who are walking along the path of sadness and carrying it for everybody whom they meet. That isn't your path. Disciples who are carrying reddish pearls of joy for everybody, - this path is for you. Go, my son, I congratulate you, be loyal and pure."

I thought for a while that I was delirious again, but having lent a more attentive ear, I could hear clearly the commanding elder Ali's voice which had a peculiar timbre.

"If you meet the disciple of sorrowful face who's walking along the path of sadness, come to love him doubly and extend the whole power of your cheerfulness and energy in order to help him, because his path is the most difficult one from all deeds of Love on the Earth."

How many words I had to utter now in order to tell you what I understood and heard back then, but actually all of it flew through me like a lightning whirl, it quivered my organism, eliminated any distance between me and Ali, merged me with his thoughts in an unusual way which I was unable to understand back then.

Finally the heavy door opened, and we saw the room. Right before the entrance the door to the balcony was opened wide, and the windows were opened till the end from both sides. Their frame was so narrow that it made an impression on me as though I was looking at the continuous panorama. The widest view to the valley, the mountains, the scattered settlements, the mosques, the gardens and the grazing herds of the cattle opened for me. Life was boiling everywhere, beauty opened for my look everywhere, from which it was impossible to tear myself away. We were standing with I. in the balcony in silence.

"Lovushka, look round the room, and I will interpret the inscriptions for you which you will see on the walls."

We came back to the room. Although the day was hot, it wasn't stuffy here, because the morning sun had already turned away, while the stairs and the tower covered the room from the south and the evening sun. The white inner walls were flat, the same was the floor – it was the real coral little house! That what I considered to be the thin borders of the walls turned out to be the inscriptions from the same little pieces of the stone like the walls, the floor and the whole house.

"Lovushka, memorize well the first, main inscription above the door of the balcony and the windows. It is written here:

Man's power – Love. It carries him from century to century. The power of love gives birth to man and it comes into being within him when his harmony matures.

Love – that's harmony, and man has seven paths into it.

"Know only this inscription for a while. You've sworn to learn the Oriental languages. Besides them you also have to learn Pali language in which these inscriptions are written. It opens the door to knowledge for those who knocks at it."

I was looking at the secret symbols of the inscriptions with sacred respect and I was thinking: "Will I find the key for the door of knowledge?"

Low white sofas were standing along the walls of the room. An armchair was standing by the white window, as well as by the fireside. The armchair by the fireside surprised me with its form. It was very artistic, very ancient, made of the big trunks of the dark, almost black wood. Only it alone like a black spot stood out in this brightly white room. The trunks were upholstered with fur which also seemed to be very old. Its hair was almost shed already, and the skin of unusual thickness could be seen.

The writing-table made of the white wood was standing by the window on the left, it was covered with a beautiful lid similar to the leaf of palm and it could be turned over in the middle to both sides. I didn't feel absolutely comfortably here. A sacred respect restricted me, as if I was standing in a temple. I wouldn't have agreed to sit down here anywhere for anything, because now the host of this room seemed for me to be so unreachably great. I didn't bring myself even to talk, I only gave a tug at I.'s sleeve and showed to the door with my eyes by inviting him to leave silently.

He smiled, examined the whole room again, as if by saying good-bye to all the inscriptions on the walls which I didn't understand yet, and we left. We closed the door in silence, we also crossed the whole island and the park in silence, and we came back home.

The white peacock and the Oriental servant accompanied us till the little bridge, the bird stretched out its wonderful train shining with gold and blue colour for farewell, and it bowed its head with little crest.

When we entered our rooms, I. told me.

"Lie down for a rest till the tea. You cannot get overtired here for a while. You need to habituate yourself to the climate of this land bit by bit."

I didn't contradict him with a single word, although I absolutely wanted neither to lie down nor to sleep. In the beginning the heat was tormenting me, but I didn't even feel how I fell asleep and I only woke up when Yassa was arousing me. I caught up with I. downstairs, who was walking with two men whom I hadn't seen yet. One of them Oswald Rasten was blond, typical Swede, what I successfully guessed. By appearance he seemed to be youth, and I was surprised when I found out that he was already for the second time in the Community. The second I.'s companion was brunette, Frenchman Jerome Manule. If the first one's language, manners, gait were rhythmically calm, then the second one was as lively as mercury. His gait, movements, language – everything showed his great temperament, but there wasn't any flounce: you could feel his benevolence, joviality and lightness. His eyes were dark, not very big, but they had beautiful form, they were shining with intelligence, they were looking often and attentively. He looked like a writer to me, and it was confirmed so later on.

The Swede was from the traders family, he chose the career of the scientist against the want of his relatives and he already was a chief of the department of history in one of the German universities. When I. introduced me to them, both of them cried out at the same time.

"How could it be? The captain T.?"

"No," I answered them. "I'm his brother."

"Soon you can read Lovushka's story and you will be glad by accepting one more young writer and the future scientist as your friend," smiling I. told them.

Both of my friends called me their colleague and on the way to the dining-room they introduced me to other two young ladies and to one elderly one. Not the young and beautiful ladies surprised me, but the elderly, grey woman. My first thought when I saw her was: "And they say that old age cannot be beautiful, womanly and charming."

Her tall, rather stout figure was embellished by – I cannot find any other word – a beautiful, grey head. The sunburn didn't ruin her regular face, her big black eyes and black eye-brows emphasized her greying hair. There weren't any wrinkles, her face seemed to be young. Only so much grief was in her eyes and in her smile that Ali's words which I heard before entering his room rose in my memory instantly: "If you meet the disciple with sorrowful face who is walking down the path of sadness, then come to love him doubly and extend the whole power of your cheerfulness and energy to help him, because his path is the most difficult one of all heroic deeds of Love on the Earth."

I bowed low to the elderly lady and kissed her extended hand sincerely. This hand, as well as the Andreyeva's one, was subtle, friendly, its form was almost perfect. Its fingers showed that she was a painter. This guess of mine was confirmed. I. called her Beata Skalradi and he explained to me that senora Beata was Italian painter who's won many prizes in the worldwide exhibitions, that her works hung in the picture-galleries of many capitals. When I was introduced to some other ladies whose names my memory haven't saved because of the impression which the painter left on me, an elderly, lean man with a tortured face of an ascetic approached us from the side alley. He must have been hurrying to I. The Swede Oswald Rasten whispered me that he was worldwide famous pianist and composer, Russian Sergey Aninov. While both celebrities were walking in front of the group, next to I., Jerome Manule explained to me.

"Sergey Aninov is living not in the Community, but in one small house in the park. Ali gives him the rest not for the first time already. He's very nervous, he comes here very rarely, but when he's playing in the evenings he allows everybody not only to listen to him, but also to order their favourite pieces. Oh, how he plays! It is impossible to imagine anything better."

Senora Skalradi and Aninov sat down at our table. I didn't participate in the conversation. By sitting a little further away from them, I took a good look at the faces of my new acquaintances. I liked the painter always more. Her melodious and slow Italian language reminded me of the Florentian's demonstrated to me many times talk of his nationals. That wasn't that rattling patter of senoras Galdoni, which I could hardly understand. I marked out every word in senora Beata's speech, which attracted me even more to her, but Aninov remained a riddle for me. His ascetic, wrinkled face, his sparkling eyes, his sudden movements, his protest and indignation at what was oppressing him, - everything seemed to me to be so far away from harmony that I remembered Ali's words again, only now as though the inscriptions on the walls lit up in my memory: "The power of love gives birth to man, and it is born within him only when his harmony matures."

I was talking to myself in my thoughts: "If he's famous, worldwide known musician, then he has to create in a harmonious way, otherwise neither his works nor his performance would conquer the world, only may this face be at least calm?"

All of a sudden Aninov fell silent, his look sank somewhere deeply into the space, his wrinkles smoothed down. Wisdom came to light on his face, as though he listened attentively to something what others were unable to hear, his eyes flashed, his pale cheeks turned red. Suddenly he became absolutely unfamiliar and handsome.

"Excuse me, my dear, till tomorrow. I hear that my muse is calling me. You've inspired me, I hurry to write. Come tomorrow in the evening and bring your friends along. I will play that what my muse Harmony has whispered me now."

Having uttered these words in a hurry and left the tea, Aninov left the dining-room quickly.

I was sitting immersed myself deeply into "catching of crows" and I couldn't take my eyes off the door through which the musician left.

"So what, count-awl," I heard next to me, and somebody's leaden hand, as it seemed to me, fell on my shoulder. "I've told you that you shouldn't forestall the events. You'd rather have been picking up the melons and not drilling the subtle matter with your awls. Here's a melon for you – the one of the highest quality. Every of its bits adds a pound of wisdom."

Andreyeva kept holding her hand on my shoulder, I felt bad from that weight, I even broke into a sweat. One more moment and probably I would have fainted away. I already was sickened and dizzy, but I. got next to me, his tender hand embraced me and pressed a cup to my lips.

"Nataliya Vladimirovna, Lovushka haven't yet become strong enough after his difficult illness. He doesn't have to feel the blows of your strength, while you aren't always capable of protecting a man from the heaviness of your vibrations. Today it is already the second case of your carelessness. Lady Berdran had to be laid up."

I.'s voice was silent and soft, but it seemed to me that it was beating Andreyeva with a stronger power than that one with which she was just pressing my shoulder. I felt so sorry for her that I seized I.'s hand and I said to the woman.

"I'm all right already, Nataliya Vladimirovna. Absolutely not your hand is to blame, but the cap of the dervish which once Ali pulled on my head. Then I fell sick and I still couldn't recover since that time. Please forgive me for the trouble caused to you. I'm glad that I got some wit from your melon."

"My child, I'm sorry, my dear," Andreyeva told me silently and tenderly, and I almost started "catching crows" again.

I couldn't imagine in any way that commanding and rather sharp voice of this woman with imperious intonations could be so tender, melodious and unspeakably kind.

Anyway I was unable to stand up for a long time, and it wasn't an easy task for me to reach our home even with I.'s help.

Yassa was keeping me in the bath for a long time, then he wiped and put me to bed. I took I.'s given drops, but I was distressed that the first day of my life in the Community ended rather sadly for me.

Chapter 2

The second day in the Community.

We visit a shrimp. Arab's presents. Francisco

I fell asleep with difficulty in the evening, but I was sleeping so soundly during the entire night that I didn't wake up for a single time until Yassa woke me up by saying that I. was already waiting for me to go to bathe together.

As soon as I opened my eyes I fixed my gaze on a fantastic landscape, I had a difficulty to comprehend where I was. During our long journey that turned into the way of my life I got used that every day – that's only a peculiar continuation of our trip, and now suddenly I understood that I've come here to stay for a long time, that finally I was at home. Having put my simple clothes on, I understood clearly that I couldn't waste my time by doing anything, that during the entire yesterday I didn't learn anything, except some knowledge from botany, and I didn't fulfil my pledge to learn the Eastern languages.

I could see clearly before me the inscriptions from Ali's room – I only needed to concentrate my thoughts on them and I was all overflowed with joy that Pali language would become the key for me, which would open everything what Ali wrote on the walls of his room. By burning with desire to learn as soon as possible, I broke into I.'s like the wind. He was sitting at the table and writing something, while I snapped out instantly.

"I., my dear, I spent the entire yesterday in vain. Give me the books as soon as possible, so that I could learn the necessary languages. Of course, first of all Pali and then the rest of them. My brother Nikolay used to say that I was gifted for languages. To tell you the truth I wasn't so sick back then, but perhaps my talents didn't become blunt. Only give the books to me quickly."

I. put the pen calmly on the table, he looked at my hair by smiling, which I had forgotten to comb, he looked at my sandals which were knotted anyhow and answered me.

"Your diligence is very praiseworthy, Lovushka, but who has dismissed you from the most elementary duties of your life on the earth now? Your hair is dishevelled, you tread the laces of your sandals, why the aesthetical feelings of your encountered people have to suffer when in the nature of such fabulous beauty they meet you such untidily dressed and combed person unexpectedly. The big mirror in your room is standing not because you would go past it, but because you would put your appearance in order before leaving to meet people. This is the first condition of communication from which nobody has dismissed you. While you are correcting the pleats of your clothes before the mirror, you have to think not about yourself, but about the people who may be irritated by your appearance if your untidiness strikes them, or if you look ridiculously. Remember, my friend, that in most cases those who are slovenly sink in poverty. Even for those who are very developed spiritually, their untidiness hinders them to continue their spiritual path. Every untidy room is disgusting for a very developed and pure man. The second condition of communication: "Hello," which people tell one to another, - who has dismissed you from this politeness in the Community which is accepted by everybody? Here you have to comprehend that word even clearer, as the greeting of love, as the honour for fire and Light within man. This isn't only a simple condition of the external politeness for you, but it is the basis of your own benevolence with which you illuminate the entire man whom you meet. My dear friend, start spreading your great nobility to people through all the cracks of the accustomed conditions of their communication. Become the link of the spiritual channel by

communicating with people in such forms which don't push them away from you or make them difficult to comprehend you, but which attract them to you."

I was very ashamed because of my light-mindedness. I looked at myself in the mirror and I became completely embarrassed. My grown long curls which were stuck out to all sides, my poorly girded and falling down aslant, long, white clothes made me look like a madman. Only now I understood that my egoistic thoughts only about myself choked everything around me so much that I broke into I.'s room like a wind without knocking at the door and without even asking him whether I wouldn't prevent him from working. I needed something and I rushed doing it, and it was all the same to me what was going on around me. When absolutely confused I was already prepared to make off the room, the tender I.'s hand embraced me.

"Now, Lovushka, don't hurry to be pained because an hour ago, having forgotten about everything in the world, you were searching for the book. If you want to win and achieve something you need to notice everything around you in every moment, and not to isolate yourself from the current conditions of communication by seeing only one narrow sector of your actions and by estimating the world only from your own tower, from your personal "I". Everybody is walking down different paths, but the stages of their spiritual growth are the same for everybody. From your very first days here pay attention to the constant politeness of everybody. Here you will meet many people who will seem to you to be both rather rude and odd, but don't focus your attention on it and remember that now the path of tact and charm is before you. In order for you to overcome it, you need to develop your politeness and calm, to make them your everyday habits. Go, my dear, dress up and come back in ten minutes. I will finish the letter, and we'll go bathing."

I ran to my room, but now I already didn't risk to rely upon my aesthetical skills, so I called Yassa and I asked him to inspect me from top to toe.

"Yassa, my dear, I'm a man without any balance. Don't let me leave the room without inspecting me well. I still cannot lace these sandals," I was begging my kind servant.

Yassa gave the other, closed sandals to me by saying that less dust would get into them, and that I would need to do only two buttons. He promised me to change the tying of my other sandals, too, he girded me with a beautiful string in a flash and he assured me that now I was combed and dressed like the real cavalier. I gave a sigh, I derived consolation from the thought that I ended yesterday badly and that today I started the new day exactly in the same bad way, and I knocked at I.'s door.

We were going to the lake already in a moment with the frottier towels put on our heads. Although I was walking down this path yesterday, although I had already seen the palms, magnolias, lemon and orange trees, bamboos and poplars of unusual height, cedars and platans, I couldn't accustom myself anyway that it was the living nature and not the gigantic decoration. We bathed without any interference and trouble.

"Lovushka, perhaps you would like to drop in at some patients' with me, whom Kastanda asked me to visit? This isn't far away, besides it is still early, and we'll come back for breakfast in time."

Of course, I became very glad and I was happy to go together with I. wherever he wanted to go, besides I wanted to get to know the new places. We crossed the streamlet through the bridge above the lake and along the path we turned not to the park, but to the real forest. Only it was very different than that what I used to call by this word up to now. The trunks of the big and thick trees, their branches which were as big as a good Russian pine or a hundred-year-old fir-tree, made such thick crown of trees that it was absolutely dark on the path where we were walking. The lianas at some places were intertwined into

such dense, blooming garlands that they formed some insurmountable walls. It was as cool here, even damp as in a grotto. I already wanted to say to I. that the woods here probably were full of tigers and jackals, but the path before us became bright, wide and it turned into a big, round clearing. Several white, little houses were standing on it, which reminded me of the Ukrainian cottages built of clay, but when I came up nearer I saw that they were built from the rough, porous stone with sparkling, very small crystals. Lit up by the sun, they looked like the cotton wool strewed with Berthelot's salt under the Christmas tree.

A middle-aged woman went out to meet us. She was stout, rather young, with white headscarf, white dress, white apron on which a wide red cross was sewed.

"Good morning, nurse Alexandra, Kastanda asked me to visit your patient who was put at yours yesterday. Did you give my sent medicine to him?"

"Yes, doctor I. The poor calmed down and fell into a doze after taking it for the second time. I dressed his wounds a little, as you told me to."

Nurse Alexandra accompanied us to the most remote house. Several little, white childish beds were standing in the clean and spacious room, but only one of them was occupied, and a slender, short girl dressed as nurse Alexandra was sitting by the bed.

"This is our new nurse who has just finished the courses of the trained nurses," nurse Alexandra introduced the charming girl to us. "Nurse Aldaz is Indian, she enslaved even our grumbler director of the courses, not only all the lecturers with her skills."

Aldaz lifted her dark, big, shining eyes to us and she reminded me of the icon of the Greek queen Eupraxia which I saw in one old orthodox church and I admired it for a long time.

We went up to the childish bed in which, according to the conversation heard, I was hoping to see a child who was bitten all over by a dog.

I was so surprised when in the little bed I saw sleeping a wrinkly... shrimp. He was so old and unhappy that I, of course, just got stiff to "catch crows". I must have looked like rather comically, because Aldaz looked at me unintentionally, she couldn't hold her laughter, and it rang out through the whole room. Nurse Alexandra looked at Aldaz strictly, but having seen me, she could hardly suppress her laughter.

Aldaz's laughter woke up the shrimp. He opened his little eyes, and I turned into the pillar of salt again. The shrimp's eyes were red, like two burning live coals.

As though not seeing anything around him except his patient, I. bent over the shrimp who was looking at him timidly. He uttered him several words that sounded very strangely to me. Here was another language which I didn't understand and which probably I would need to learn as well. If several species of shrimps were living here and the same amount of sects of Indians with different languages, then apparently, I wouldn't catch up with I. in my knowledge of languages.

Being obsessed with this thought, I distracted my attention from the patient and when I looked at him again I almost cried with horror. Three wounds were wide open on his little, bare body. One of them extended from his hip to his knee, the second one – from his throat to his belly, while the third one – from his collarbone to his elbow. The wounds were lacerated, as though scratched out with some claws. I. gave a pill and some drops to the poor. Both nurses were holding his suffering body, while I was told to hold his head that was hanging with weakness. Having poured some foaming liquid on his wounds, I. was dressing them quickly. To all appearance it didn't hurt the shrimp much from the wonderful touches of I.'s hands. The patient got better a little and he gave a friendly smile to his doctor. When he was moved to another little bed by the window, so that he could admire the clearing, he lifted his sound hand merrily,

directed it to Aldaz and said something to I. in his funny, sputtering dialect. This time I wasn't worried because of my ignorance, because both nurses, just like me, didn't understand a single word and they were looking at I., surprised.

I. explained to us that the patient asked that the merry bell, as he nicknamed Aldaz, wouldn't leave him. I. told to give some warm milk with biscuits to the patient immediately and he addressed me.

"Will you be able to find the path, so that you could bring some medicine for this poor thing after the breakfast? But if you think that tigers are going to eat you, then I will need to find some other way to deliver the medicine."

"I will find the way and I've already understood that tigers didn't exist here."

I took offence inside of me, because I. was laughing at me next to charming Aldaz, but she only wanted to cheer up the patient, she was chattering something what he didn't understand, but the intonation of her tender, womanly sympathy was penetrating into his heart.

"Very well, Lovushka. Nurse Alexandra, my friend Lovushka will bring the new medicine to you in a couple of hours. You will mix it with milk and honey, and give a quarter of a small glass to him every half an hour. I will visit you in the evening again. If his pain becomes more acute, give the yesterday's medicine to him again."

We approached the shrimp, he extended us his little hand, burning with temperature, then he put his little finger to his forehead in a funny way and uttered: "Maksa." He fixed his red, cunning eyes on me inquiringly. I. explained this movement and word of his to me. He was asking what my name was and he told me that his name was Maksa. I. told me to put my finger to my forehead, too, and to tell him my name. When I did it precisely, and the shrimp found out that my name was Lovushka, he gave a childish laugh, mumbled something and sputtered what I. interpreted to us as expression of his friendship and satisfaction.

Although I believed that I would find the way, anyway when I was going back I tried to memorize all the bends of the little path.

"I was delayed here for longer than I expected to. I won't have time to visit the other patients till breakfast. Lovushka, would you like to breakfast quickly and together with me visit the other two patients? Then you would bring the medicine for Maksa. Or would you prefer to spend that time for your books?"

"My dear I., if only I can be next to you, take me with yourself. I cannot help you much, but let me be your messenger, your servant. I want to walk through my life here in such a way as you see and know it. I want to learn so much just because I would become worthy of you quicker."

"Lovushka, you move forward very quickly, quicker than it was possible for your organism. Only because of this I hold you back. Although we've just bathed, after this patient we need to wash ourselves and change our clothes before going to the common dining-room. Still today I'm going to tell you who that Maksa is and what has happened to him."

While I. was taking a shower, I was standing in my balcony and I saw how the women covered with towels from the scorching sun were going to bathe. The heat seemed to me to be bigger than yesterday, and I was thinking with pleasure how I would be going through the shady, beautiful forest and see beautiful Aldaz. Finally, after the shower I put myself in order especially carefully, showed myself to Yassa and I decided to go downstairs where I could hear I.'s voice already.

When we entered the morning dining-room, everybody was already sitting in their places. Kastanda came hurriedly to us, asked about Maksa and added another request: to visit Aninov. His servant had come and told him that his master had a strong heart attack at night.

I saw Andreyeva and Oldenkot next to the adjacent table again, while lady Berdran's place was empty. I saw a new face next to the painter Skalradi who had captivated me. He occupied my entire attention instantly. The man who was sitting next to the painter wasn't handsome, but wherever he would go, whoever would surround him, - he would be noticed everywhere. He was so well-proportioned that his tall stature didn't strike the eye, and only when his look would slide to the people who were sitting next to him, you could evaluate his height.

He had grey hair, black eye-brows, big blue eyes with long black eyelashes, beautiful mouth and irreproachable teeth which one could see, while he was often smiling. In all his movements, in his manner to listen to his company, in his beautiful hands - his subtle nobility could be sensed everywhere. Something surprised me very much. This man was simple, open-hearted, it seemed that he was used to attract others attention and that he didn't feel shy at least a little because of it, but I could see clearly that he was modest, kind, intelligent and absolutely not haughty.

He darted a glance at I. several times. I understood that he knew who I. was, but he wasn't acquainted with him. Alver who was sitting next to me whispered me that he was one of the most famous actors whose name the entire world knew, - Stanislav Bronski, the Czech.

It seemed to me that Bronski who was talking to the neighbours of his table in such pleasant and polite way was looking at I. more and more often, and by the end of the breakfast it even seemed to me that I noticed a flash of anxiety in his lively and expressive face. I wasn't mistaken. When we finished our breakfast and when we were leaving the dining-room, hasty Kastanda's steps were heard behind our backs, and he asked I. to stop for a while. Kastanda apologized to I. for disturbing him so much from yesterday's evening.

"Doctor I., of course, you noticed the new face. He's actor Bronski, Florentian has sent him here. He has a letter for you and he knew beforehand that you would come here during these days. He came here from the distant house of the Community, to be precise, he came here on the camel with an Arab guide and with his disciple who is also actor. Bronski asked me to introduce him to you. I promised him to do it right after the breakfast, but the second message from Aninov prevented me from doing it. Aninov had a new attack. Lady Berdran is still very weak. Andreyeva is nursing her very carefully, but she doesn't feel better. Besides all that, also the Bronski's disciple fell sick after bathing in the lower lake after the journey in such heat. I don't even know to which one of them I should invite you first."

Kastanda seemed to be exhausted. I thought that he was worried about something very much and, apparently, he didn't sleep during the entire night. He was looking at I. pleadingly and, probably by concealing something, he was trying not to show his anxiety to him.

"Don't worry, Kastanda. First of all introduce me to Bronski, because he's worried about his friend's health very much. Then I will come to lady Berdran and then to Aninov. Give these drops to the pianist's servant, let Aninov take them with sugar and wait for me. I have the drops exactly for one time, because with such temperament we cannot allow him to cure himself, otherwise he will take all the medicine at once and he will be surprised that he's dying."

I. gave such small bottle to Kastanda that, having compared it to the musician's height and his big hand, I laughed imperceptibly.

Having turned back, we saw Bronski and Skalradi by the window, and I was surprised how sad the actor's face was. It was full of life and energy an hour ago, and now it was pale and it reflected his inner suffering. He kept listening to his companion in the same pleasant way, but his look was out, as though he had experienced a misfortune.

Having seen that we were coming to him, Bronski came to life again, the reddish colour came back to his face, his eyes sparkled, the smile showed up in his lips. He took several steps to meet us, he bowed low to I. and squeezed I.'s extended hand to him strongly with both of his hands.

"You are very kind, doctor I. Didn't my request disturb your agenda? I'm so happy to meet you, but my happiness would darken if I had disturbed you with anything."

Bronski's voice rather low and metallic. When he uttered the plosive constants, a little emphasis could be felt, which gave a unique originality to his uttered words and which didn't hinder the excellent manner of his speech.

I was looking at him and I wondered how immeasurable the charm of this man was! The white Indian clothes fitted very well, and I imagined him with a Bedouin cloak, riding on the camel. That would be a model for a painter! As always I forgot myself and I came to myself only from I.'s voice, who was telling me.

"Here's my friend Lovushka. He's writer. Forgive him for his absent-mindedness. I bet that he has already drawn your portrait in his imagination, he involved you in some action and he's forgotten where he was and who was next to him."

Bronski extended both of his hands to me and told me smiling that he was also suffering from the same living fantasy which often caused difficult situations for him, because then he would lose the thread of his conversation with others. I squeezed his hands with joy and I answered him by laughing.

"It is true, I imagined you with a Bedouin cloak, riding on the camel through the desert and I was dreaming that somebody could draw you like this. Only your compliments when you compare your fantasy to mine are not meant for me. I wander in my views in vain, while you move them into life and you let the entire world understand the beauty and nobility. I respect your energy and diligence of which I've heard."

"That man next to whom you are living now couldn't have called you to be his friend if he hadn't perceived your creative power. I hadn't done anything yet when I was your age and I've already read your story."

I. sent me to bring the medicine chest and he asked Alver to accompany me to that little house where lady Berdran was living. When I and Alver with medicine chest entered the hall of Andreyeva's and lady Berdran's house, we saw I., Bronski and Kastanda talking to Nataliya Vladimirovna.

"No, it won't work in this way, Nataliya Vladimirovna. Lady Berdran is sick namely because you are next to her, and she is unable to resist your vibrations. You are like a cold lake, and only very hardened people are able to come closer to you. Not only you cannot apply your treatment methods on lady Berdran, but even nurse her now."

I. was speaking to her with a smile, but nobody could have any doubts in seriousness of his words. Andreyeva seemed to be distressed, as though she was unsatisfied and she couldn't understand anything.

"Doctor I., do you really think that Oldenkot who considers to be his duty to stay next to me almost during the entire day is hardened against my vibrations? But he isn't sick, is he?" Andreyeva snapped out not in a very reserved way, but to all appearance, she was suppressing her temperament.

"Oh yes, the armour of mister Oldenkot's kindness and purity are so hardened that he isn't frightened of any vibrations, even of much stronger than yours."

Bronski was observing everything what was going on here in silence. It was absolutely clear to me that he wanted to ask I. to visit his friend, but he couldn't bring himself to do it. Suddenly I. himself addressed him.

"Please wait for me here. Then we'll go to your disciple's immediately. And for you, Nataliya Vladimirovna, I forbid to visit lady Berdran for ten days."

I. showed me to follow him. Accompanied by Kastanda, we went down the corridor till the end, climbed up the winding stairs to the first floor and knocked at the side door. A young native in the white clothes of trained nurses, only without headscarf and with a very small cross on her apron opened the door for us. She was the student of the trained nurses courses on duty.

We went up to lady Berdran, she was very weakened and she could hardly open her eyes. While we were still in the corridor, I. told Kastanda that he would manage without him.

The patient was lying on the sofa with white robe and she was so pale that she looked like a ghost. I. seated her carefully and said something in the native language to the trained nurse. She left the room immediately. I. told me to make a mixture from several bottles and he poured something into it from the Florentian's medicine chest. The liquid began to boil, I lifted the patient's head a little, while I. poured the medicine into her mouth. Lady Berdran didn't like it. She uttered a moan, she almost gave a shout and she frightened me so much that I almost dropped her beautiful little head out of my hands.

"Be careful, my friend, we were in time. Now the spasms will begin, but after this medicine they won't be deadly for her. Now hold both of her hands strongly, while I will hold her legs."

I could hardly hold the patient's hands which she was pulling from me with such a power that one probably could expect only from a man. I broke into a sweat, and it seemed to me that I wouldn't be able to hold her breaking away hands, but the spasms abated, and I. told me to let the patient go. I fell down on the chair, as if I had hewed the wood for several hours. I. took lady Berdran's hand and asked her.

"How do you feel?"

Lady Berdran opened her eyes, looked at I. and me amazed, gave a smile and answered him.

"Now I feel very well, but a moment ago I thought that I was dying and during all these days I had such a feeling as though my vital strength was leaving me. Especially when kind Nataliya Vladimirovna used to stay next to me, I was dizzy, and it always seemed to me that all my strength was flowing to her. I know that this is only my imagination, but I cannot describe my state in any other way."

"If I proposed you to move to that building temporarily where we with Lovushka are living? There's a separate northern room in it, and it would be convenient for me to observe you. Would you agree to move there?"

A complete confusion showed up in her face which was always sad anyway. She didn't answer him instantly, apparently she was fighting against something and she couldn't bring herself to tell it.

"I would like to fulfil this desire of yours very much, but I think that it would upset Nataliya Vladimirovna very much, who is so kind to me, she's done so much for me and helped me to get here. I cannot bring myself to upset her. I bring only misfortune to everybody who become good friends with me anyway."

Two big tears rolled down her cheeks. By seeing her suffering, I addressed Florentian with all might of my thoughts, I begged him to help and send me the strength so that I wouldn't burst into tears.

"Let me do everything myself. Even before coming to you I explained to Nataliya Vladimirovna that first we needed to harden you well, so that your communication with her boiling powers wouldn't exhaust you. Just answer me whether you want to rely upon me and to do a short treatment course under my supervision?"

"Not only I want to do it, I beg you, doctor I., to help me. Right from the first meeting with Nataliya Vladimirovna I understood that something was wrong with me, but lately I began to perceive clearly that I was dying," lady Berdran was talking to him through her tears.

"Well, it is still far away till this happens, but it is necessary to harden your organism and to give some systematic knowledge to you on how you could harden yourself later on."

The trained nurse came back and she told I. that the stretcher and the carriers were here already. I understood it from the gestures of her hands towards the palanquin that was waiting for her in the corridor. I. lifted the patient himself, he seated her onto the palanquin and tucked her in with pillows. The carriers carried her to our house. Soon Kastanda was found, the patient was settled under our rooms, while I. indicated her diet and ordered strictly not to let anybody to visit her. We hurried back to the hall where Bronski was waiting for us by having a chat with Oldenkot. The house where Bronski was living was rather far, but it was next to the Aninov's one.

Having entered the room of Bronski's friend and disciple, we saw, as it seemed to me, a not very young brunette who looked like Georgian, but who actually was Romanian. Having looked at him more attentively, I understood that he was young, only completely exhausted. He was lying and mumbling something.

"Why did you allow your friend to jump into the cold lake, although he was in a sweat and sunburnt? You not only did that yourself, but you were taking a warm bath."

"I was begging Igor not to do that, but Romanians are very obstinate and they think that they know their nature better. Besides, Igor's mother, the Hungarian Gipsy inured him to the constant changing of heat and cold from his childhood. He was never sick during the entire time of our acquaintance. I always had to think about my health, while my friend could waste it in a light-minded way, without any consequences. That's why now I'm so worried about his illness."

"Yes. He's very, very sick, and if he recovers, then it won't happen soon. Either you'll have to leave him here for me or you'll have to stay with him for a long time, no less than for a year," I. was talking to him by examining the patient. "I understand that you need to get back to your work. Apparently lots of contracts call you to different cities of the world. Don't worry about your friend's health, I and Lovushka will nurse him, and he will come back to you in a year."

"Doctor I., I won't leave my friend in bad luck. I know that I won't help you much, I know even better what a happiness it is for my friend to meet you, but for me, too, meeting with you in this moment of my life is more important than all my business and contracts, it is more important than the art itself for which I'm living up to now. I will leave this place only in that case if you drive me out of here."

Please, don't send me from here, read the letter from that man whom I met in London by chance several months ago. He called himself Florentian, in the name which you know well, and he gave a letter to me after our long conversation in my cloak-room of the theatre where I played the role of Othello. He explained the way here and gave his servant as an attendant to me when I decided to come here without doubting at least for a moment. Igor didn't let me go alone. When I introduced him to Florentian and explained to him that my friend wanted to accompany me, Florentian was looking at me for a long time and he said to me: "Let it be, but remember that I didn't send him with you. You can take him on your own responsibility." I didn't want very much that Igor would go with me. I was trying to dissuade him in every possible way, but I was unable to do it, in the same way as I was unable to show my will absolutely anywhere, except the art. I'm harmonious and I'm completely self-confident only in the art. I serve it without any compromises, and in the art nobody could ever lead me astray of the path in any way, which I've once chosen and understood. Don't push me away," all of a sudden Bronski went down on his knees and finished his speech with a grief and suffering in his voice.

I. went to him quickly, he lifted him up, embraced him and told him tenderly.

"Get up, my friend and my brother. I accept you as my disciple with joy. Don't worry about your friend. He will survive, and his character that tyrannized you so much will change for good very much. Only he will still have to be patient a great deal, because not only the roots of his nerves are in inflammation – that impermissible difference of temperatures has hurt his entire nervous system in spite of his imaginary hardening to which Igor's mother had inured him."

I. prepared the medicine, gave it for the patient to drink with Bronski's and my help, rubbed him with something that smelt unbearably strongly and said to the actor again.

"Now we absolutely don't need your help here. The patient will be sleeping for a long time and then he won't recognize anybody anyway. His illness reminds of typhus, but actually that's only a horrible shock of his entire organism, which could end in his insanity if you hadn't met me."

I. sent me to call for the trained nurse on duty, and he told Bronski to take his felt hat and his frottier towel from his room and to wait for us by the exit.

I came back to the patient with a trained male nurse. I. injected the patient with a rather thick needle and, having explained the course of nursing to the nurse, he promised to send the doctor's assistant to him in a couple of hours. We packed our medicine chests, washed our hands carefully and went downstairs where Bronski was waiting for us.

The weather was very hot already. I. pulled the hat over my eyes and lowered the net, he advised to do the same for his new disciple. Having walked down several little paths, we got to Aninov's.

Everything was original in this house. First of all I was surprised that the door from the small hall opened straight to the spacious, white sitting-room, in the middle of which a white grand piano was standing, also several hard, white sofas by the walls and a little statue of the black pedestal made of marble, which looked like Dante to me. Then I saw that it was Buddha's statue.

The servant took I. across the entire sitting-room to the next room, while me and Bronski remained waiting for him here. The actor began to tell me about Aninov, about his success, about his grief. The musician left his motherland a long time ago, he was suffering, because he missed it, but he never came back to it by riding around the entire world. Bronski didn't know what made Aninov leave his so passionately beloved motherland, but he thought that the great cause of his heart illness was his constant longing for it.

I. didn't come back for a rather long time. While seeing that I was interested in his impression of his meeting with Florentian, and since he was also influenced strongly by my great friend's beauty and wisdom, Bronski told me in detail how he came to Florentian's house in London, how he saw my brother there and received my story from him. He saw Nal and her friend Alyssa by whose beauty he was so surprised and captivated that he doesn't know up to now who of them is more beautiful. Alyssa – that's Desdemona, while Nal is so young and at the same time so grand that he didn't find any name for her in his theatrical vocabulary. He hadn't seen such woman yet and he would consider everybody to exaggerate if they told him about the inhabitants of Florentian's house.

"Even now I sometimes ask myself whether I've seen those people in my dream? Could there be so much beauty and kindness in one place of London?" Bronski fell to thinking, as though he went to some place in his thoughts and then he continued silently. "When I saw I. entering the dining-room I understood instantly that that was him, although nobody told me that. Besides his exceptional beauty, I. possesses something else what I cannot define, but especially he reminds me of Florentian. I still don't understand what it is, but that isn't characteristic to anybody else except both of them. I've seen a lot of people and very prominent ones, but I. and Florentian surprised me and they struck my eye with something divine – this is so grand."

The voices were heard at the door, and I. with Aninov entered the sitting-room. The musician's cheeks were burning, probably either he had a temperature or he was very excited. He greeted us politely, offered us all sorts of fruit and refreshing drinks, but I. didn't allow to take anything.

"So finish your work, Sergey Konstantinovich, and postpone the concert for several days. With your permission, I will bring a crowd of people who want to hear you. You are absolutely healthy. Not only you are healthy: you'll have to help me to cure two patients with your music. At this moment they won't recover without music. We will prepare a program with you, and I hope that we will get them back to their senses," I. was talking before saying good-bye to him.

That stunned me so much that I completely went astray by "catching crows." To cure one with music? I left like this without lining up my thoughts, and if not the heat, then probably I would have remained standing in one place. The sun was scorching without mercy even through the net, so I. moistened the thick, frottier Bronski's towel in the fountain and threw it on my head by relieving my state a little. I. told me to lie down for a while at home, while he prepared the medicine for Maksa and he asked Bronski to find Kastanda.

As soon as I lay down I fell asleep. It seemed that I was sleeping nobody knew for how long. Actually I was sleeping for about twenty minutes, but I rested perfectly. I. woke me up, he gave some tasty drink for me to drink and he explained to me that now I could drink already. I took the mixture for Maksa and some other medicine which I had to hand to nurse Alexandra, and on my way back home I had to take the trained nurse especially for Igor. I was glad that I would be walking down the fabulous forest. I.'s drink reduced my sensitiveness for the heat. I wanted to stay alone and to reflect on all the events of these days, but Bronski came back and, having found out that I was going to the unknown place to him, he looked at I. so pleadingly that he gave a laugh, looked at me cunningly and uttered.

"The chosen of Lovushka's heart Aldaz is there! If he decides to sacrifice himself and to take you with himself, I will be glad. You will find a lot to see there."

"Lovushka, I will be as silent as a stump, as obliging as a slave, as thankful as a baby. Take me with yourself."

I was choking with laughter, because such an unexpected expression, to be precise, the whole range of changing expressions, rippled through his face. Bronski stretched himself and he uttered like an oath with his thunderous voice.

“I will be as silent as a stump...”

Then he stooped, as though he all weakened like an indulging slave and uttered in a sweet voice.

“As obliging as a slave...”

Suddenly, having given a wide smile, he smoothed out all the wrinkles of bootlicking of his face and he uttered in a clear, childish voice by looking at my eyes naively and by lisping charmingly.

“As thankful as a child.”

All of it was so unexpected that, of course, having forgotten about everything, I fell on his neck and I declared that now I understood why he had enslaved the world.

While still laughing, we went to sister Alexandra's. I remembered the way well and, although Bronski was such an interesting companion that I could give in to my imagination easily, I felt doubly responsible both before I. and before my new acquaintance who fascinated me with many things. My attention was strained during the entire way, and I didn't mix a single turn.

Maksa was still sleeping, while nurse Aldaz was trying to explain to me with her gestures and mimic of her little charming face in a broken Russian language that poor Maksa was suffering very much. I promised her to tell I. about it and to come to her again if I. prescribes some sedatives for him.

Having seen nurse Alexandra, we hurried back together with the new Igor's nurse. While I was talking to Aldaz, Bronski couldn't take his fascinated eyes off her. When we were going through the forest where I expected to hear his interesting story again, I looked at him and I saw his sad face of a completely different man, gone deep into himself. A metamorphosis has happened within him. A wise tranquillity appeared, which reminded me of that expression that I often used to see in my brother Nikolay's face, but this wisdom in Bronski's face was marked by grief.

A wrinkle crossed his high forehead, his eyes as though couldn't see anything around him, his lips were strongly pressed together, as if he was solving the new, quick question. I didn't dare to disturb his concentration and I even was trying to go slower, more silently, so that I wouldn't disturb his thoughts. I imagined that Bronski became such wise man when he used to reflect on his roles in solitude. Almost by the edge of the forest he gave a deep sigh, passed his hand over his face, eyes and he smiled to me.

“Now I was so far away, Lovushka. Sometimes my fantasy carries me out of the reality, a deep state seizes me, and in my imagination I create the past of those characters whom I will have to perform on the stage, or of those alive people who've made a strong effect on me. I am right or not in my scenic creation – let the people decide and estimate my roles, but the most strange thing in the play of my imagination is that up to now I've never been wrong about the past of those alive people in whom I was interested very much. I don't know myself how and why, but I can see their past very clearly, like the sequence of the pictures which flash before me.

Now your friend Aldaz's appearance and her mimic captivated me so much that I was seized by that deep state of mine and I saw many scenes from her past. In the beginning I saw a little Indian who was sleeping in the sack on the back of a dark-skinned Indian. Her father with a heavy burden on his back was walking next to her. Then I saw the same mother with a teenage girl who was mourning over her killed

father. Then a tall, an unusually tall handsome man gave shelter to both poor things on his horse, while they were sitting by the bonfire in the night. Then I saw mother and her daughter with a caravan of camels, who were travelling across the desert, then – like a school where perhaps thirteen-year-old Aldaz was alone already, and finally a hospital where Aldaz gave the medicine to some old man.

This young life surprised me, it was so monotonous, without any joy, passing in the backwoods, while actually she possessed a great talent for mimic. According to her movements, to her exceptionally plastic gait and her proportional body constitution, she should dance like a goddess, charm people and awaken the highest and brightest joy within them, while she is living in poverty in the godforsaken place. Even in olden times she would have had a place where she could use her talent, she would have been a prophetess, a dancer of some temple. That's what I was thinking about, as always the people's destinies, their exceptional fabulousness stunned me this time, too. Who would have thought that in the depth of the jungle a knight appeared and saved mother and her daughter who were already calmly prepared to be torn by wild beasts! And why did he save them? So that the girl's talent of genius would be lost among the beds of patients!"

With my mouth opened I was standing by the edge of the forest, I was looking at Bronski and I was thinking which one of us has gone mad, and I didn't even see how impatient the trained nurse was, who was also native, who didn't know the Russian language in which we were talking with Bronski. Apparently she lost her patience completely and she told me in a broken English.

"Quickly, quickly, mister, let's move forwards. The doctor is waiting."

I apologized to her and I began to walk so quickly that my fellow-travellers could hardly keep pace with me. Having left the trained nurse and Bronski for Kastanda, I hurried to I. Of course, I would have broken into his room again with even a greater whirlwind than the first time, but luckily, I met him on the stair landing, he was going to meet me. Apparently he wanted to tell me something completely different, but having seen my face, he asked me.

"What has happened to you, my friend?"

"I., let's go to your room, I have something important to tell you. Do you know that Bronski is sorcerer. He can read people's past. I., my dear, can you know who was a man before meeting you?"

I hurried, I was talking complicatedly and very seriously, but anyway I noticed what a humour began to sparkle in I.'s eyes. I came to myself instantly and I told him everything from the beginning what Bronski had told me and how he could see Aldaz's past.

"How I would like to know whether Bronski saw the truth about Aldaz's life. I., my dear, can you find out about it?" I was asking him by burning with impatience and I couldn't understand in any way how I. could sit so calmly when I was telling him about such stunning things.

"Lovushka, I think that simply you could find out yourself whether Bronski could see nurse Aldaz's past correctly."

"How? However I was trying I had never seen any views. Do you think that I have to think about Florentian and ask him about it?" I told him by being blazed with ardour to find out the truth or make certain that Bronski was simply a maniac, obsessed with this passion.

I. gave a laugh, stroke my head, what helped me to calm down immediately and he told me.

"You are still such a little child, Lovushka. Could I really advise you to disturb your great friend for such a trifle. That would be the same if you asked him how you should lace your sandals or how

to put a patch on their soles. I was thinking about the simplest way that didn't surpass your strength at all," my idolized and indulgent friend was telling me by smiling to me and stroking my head in the same tender way. "Ask Aldaz about it yourself when we go to change Maksa's dressing in the evening, after tea. By the way, take this basket, everything is here what we'll need for our evening visitations, and now take a shower and take a nap in your room. You were running so fast that now you need to calm down. If I find you calmed down in half an hour when I come back here, we'll go to Ali's room, and I will give you books for your first knowledge of Pali language."

"Oh, I., you are so kind! I committed a crime again, while you didn't even scold me. You can be sure that you will find me calmed down."

"Look, don't commit a crime exactly now," I. joked by saying good-bye to me.

I didn't even notice how dusty I was, what footmarks I left on the shining floor. With Yassa's help I washed myself, put I.'s room in order and I began to wait for my friend who was delayed a little.

Bronski rose before my eyes again, and his story was restored to life in my fantasy. I imagined very lively the tall knight with a black beard who lifted mother and her baby on his saddle in the dark and horrible forest. Since I had never seen an alive knight, and since I had only one image of the tall, dark-haired man within myself, I connected the views seen by Bronski to Ali's personality.

Everything was getting on so perfectly later on in my poetical fantasy! Ali gave shelter to the unhappy mother and her daughter, he sent them to the Community with his caravan, and Aldaz began to attend the school in it. Ali's picture took possession of me. When I was already prepared to call him and ask whether he didn't gave shelter to the orphans whom he found on his way, the door opened, and I. called me.

"I already know who that knight was who saved Aldaz. Of course, that was Ali. And everything is in line later on," I dashed at I. even without letting him to come to himself.

"It isn't important whether Ali or not Ali saved Aldaz, but that anyway you didn't pay necessary attention to my words and you wanted to disturb Ali for the trifle – that's not good already. It is not worth to make such unhappy face now and torment yourself, but pay your attention to two things: don't utter any unnecessary word until you reconsider well everything what you want to say or to ask something. Second: if I gave a task to you and told you that we were going to Ali's room to learn, then you needed to prepare for that, to recover your balance, so that the place of work would correspond to all your creative abilities. We are going to the room of great man of wisdom. His compassion is equal to wisdom. His compassion for you is great. And your attention, is it concentrated now? Have you cleaned it from any small external thoughts? Do you comprehend that great joy to serve people some time when you acquire the knowledge which Ali decided to reveal for you by sending you here? Only then you will be able to meet Ali and Florentian, and to become colleague of their activity when you learn to concentrate your attention. You will comprehend the creative path of your great friends as much as your loyalty for them will always connect you with them in an easy and simple way, with path of their love for man. You aren't guest who's come here to renew your organism during several years and to leave for work again, with which you would rake the pearls of your genius, so that you would help and comfort people. Here you are guest of Eternity, the Eternity met you here, and you will leave this place with it. Every day of your life – that's the day of your duty on the threshold of Eternity. Not in the Community you "stayed for a while" and you would leave not for it – here is *the entire meaning* of your existence. You've come here from Eternity, you are living *in it* in the temporary form of Lovushka on the Earth and you will leave *to it* being enriched with new experience, opened eyes, by walking the path of development and by knowing how you should work with yourself in order to achieve your liberation. You will see many genii here, you will become acquainted with

their especial path on the earth. You will see even more ordinary people here, in whom only some features of talent open. Whether their path is difficult or an easy one – it depends on the amount of superstitions and their personal weaknesses which they manage to throw down, that is how they succeed to liberate the Eternity, chained with conditionalities.”

I. was telling all of it to me, while we were going to the little Ali's island where the watchman and the white peacock met us again. While I was climbing the stairs to Ali's room, I was full of respect and gratitude for my dear guardian. Today his every word fell especially clear to my heart. For the first time I came up to the bookcases boldly, easily and simply, without any doubts and regrets for my insignificance and inabilities.

I. pressed some spring, and a little wall drew back by opening another row of full bookshelves. And there were all kinds of books! I. took out three little books, they were very ancient, he pressed the invisible button again, the little wall went back to its place, and I couldn't see it anymore.

Having come up to Ali's writing-table, I. uncovered its domed, palm cover, which form was like two big leaves of latania. He seated me at the table and began to explain the letters and pronunciation of Pali language to me. Everything seemed to be very difficult for me, because I didn't know any Eastern languages, so absolutely strange roots and suffixes of the words tired me.

The talent of teaching of my wise Teacher did its job well, and when the first gong of dinner rang out, I could read the words freely already. I. showed me how to close and open the table, he set homework for tomorrow, and we hurried to the dinner dining-room.

Having entered the dining-room, first of all I paid attention to Andreyeva who was talking to some old man in the unknown language. From the intonation I understood that she demanded something from him, while the old man didn't give in and he was trying to persuade her in his turn. Oldenkot who was sitting next to them probably also didn't understand that language and he looked at I. helplessly when we going past them, as though by asking him to meddle in this business, but I. took my arm, bowed to them and went straight to our places.

The dining-room was being filled little by little, also Bronski with the painter came to their places. I noticed several impressive faces again, but I couldn't take in everybody at my glance who were sitting here in anyway.

“Lovushka, don't hurry to take in everybody at once, you will become acquainted with everybody little by little. You will have an opportunity to see many of them closer tomorrow at Aninov's, and now – I can see how you are interested in it, - I will explain to you why Nataliya Vladimirovna is arguing. She wants to see the ruins of one very old town. Since she's so temperamental she wants to leave immediately, while the old guide refuses to leave by persuading her that it is dangerous at the moment. They should travel there for eight days across the scorching, arid desert or through the boggy, gloomy jungle which is full of wild beasts and snakes. They need to wait. A caravan will be travelling there in three weeks, and they could join it and travel safely then.”

Andreyeva's face looked like a stormy hurricane to me now. Oldenkot turned around several times and told something silently to her neighbour. She gave a laugh, looked at me and declared across the whole table rather loudly.

“I gather the company of fearless people who love to travel across the desert. Would you like to travel with us to see one very interesting, ancient town, to be precise, its ruins? They say that during the day they are like dead, but when the sun sets, so many tigers, lions, jackals and monkeys come out of the ruins that all the buildings swarm with them.”

I was almost frightened, but then I decided that she was mocking at me and I answered her in the same tone.

"I don't have any desire to become charred while we are riding across the desert, and I have even less desire to spend the night in the pleasant company of tigers and lions. I still didn't have time to find a snakecharmer, and it seems that it is impossible to do without him in such honourable company."

Andreyeva gave a laugh and said something to the old guide. He greeted me in the Eastern way. I remembered the feast at Ali's. I rose and I bowed to him in the same Eastern way.

The guide with sunburnt till blackness face, with white turban and burnouse was peculiarly handsome. His grey beard made him look like a prophet. Having looked at me with his piercing, black eyes, he said something quickly to I. He smiled, bowed to him and interpreted the Arab's words into English for me.

"Zeiched-ogly asks you to accept his sincere greeting and he says that he can see your distant path. He asks you to accept a little, white peacock as his present to you, which he found lost in the forests, while he was riding on his way here."

I was extremely fascinated. To possess a white peacock! I didn't know what I had to answer him, because I remembered that according to the Eastern custom I needed to show gratitude for his present with my present to him, but I didn't have anything.

"Thank him and agree," I. whispered me.

I accepted I.'s advice with great pleasure and I felt happy like the one who received a treasure, but Andreyeva decided not to let me enjoy my instinct of ownership peacefully.

"The jewel on your chest is shining through your clothes. It is both priceless and of incredible beauty, but you don't even understand its meaning," she stung me, as though she was hewing wood, in Russian this time. "You carry the treasure for which hundreds of lives were sacrificed and many hundreds would do the same if only they could receive it. But you are happy not for it, but for the stupid bird."

Her eyes were sparkling. It seemed to me that their sparkles reached even the jewel itself on my chest and they affected me strongly. I pulled my clothes tighter, covered the treasure with my hand and pressed it to my heart by begging Florentian with sacred honour to teach me to protect his jewel better and to be able to keep it until that moment when we see each other and I return this thing to him, which once was stolen from him. Suddenly I heard the wonderful voice of my great friend.

"Be strong and calm. Everywhere you will walk pure, I also will walk with you. Feel my heartbeat in your pulse. Many paths lead to knowledge, but loyalty is the same everywhere. Learn to know the invisible grandeur of your encountered people and don't judge about them from their visible imperfect characteristics. Protect my jewel, because it is a protection not only for you alone."

Peace came back to my soul in a flash, I looked at Andreyeva joyfully, to whom something incomprehensible had happened. She turned pale, gave a start, bowed her head and as though she got stiff in a pose of a repentant. I looked at I. He was serious, even strict and he was looking at Andreyeva attentively. When finally she lifted her head, I. began to speak very silently, but I think that the woman heard his every word.

"If you try to awaken another person's energy and power, you need to be able to control your own strength. Even in jest you cannot touch that what you don't know well yourself. The retroactive

blow might be deadly. And if now it wasn't such one for you, then it happened only because I accepted it to myself."

Nobody noticed this little scene around us, in the joint background of conversations, and actually everybody had gotten used to eccentric Nataliya Vladimirovna's manner to talk and joke so much that they didn't attach any special importance to her words. Although I didn't understand everything till the end, anyway I perceived that I.'s words were very important for Andreyeva with something.

Her somewhat disdainful tone when she was indignant at my childish joy for the white peacock received as aa present upset me. I thought that I prompted her irritation without even feeling it myself. At the same time I remembered sir Vomi's words that everybody who entered the path of knowledge had to speak in such a way that none of his words would hurt and sting anybody.

I pressed the jewel to my chest again, I remembered the words of Ali's letter: "Everything what man has to achieve during his meetings – that's to start and to finish each of them calmly, with compassion and kindness," – and I decided to observe myself very strictly, so that other people's uttered word to me – in whatever tone uttered – wouldn't cause any bitterness or irritation for me.

The grey guide looked at me several times during the dinner, and I saw great favour in his eyes for me. Andreyeva was sitting with her downcast eyes, she was pale and she was listening in silence to what her neighbours were talking about by nodding her head from time to time. It seemed to me that something especial and very difficult for her was still happening within her, what she was trying to conceal.

Bronski was charming conversationist again, but I saw anxiety in his face. It seemed to me that only calm I.'s look would pour some confidence to him every time when their eyes would meet.

After the dinner I. offered me to go to Ali's room and to do my tomorrow's homework, and I became glad. I. allowed Bronski to sit by his sick friend's bed till tea, he invited Alver Chergiston to his room, and the youth's face brightened up.

The old Arab guide approached I. and he was telling him something quickly by looking at me, which made I. laugh. I promised myself again to learn the Eastern languages as diligently as possible. I. only told me that after the tea the Arab would bring the promised little peacock to me and explain how to look after him, how to feed him.

Being in a cheerful mood, I went to learn. As usually both the watchman and his peacock met me by greeting me with their bows. I wanted to ask the watchman what his and his peacock's name was, but I was similar to that servant who was dusting expensive books by not understanding their language. The books for the servant were lifeless, while here the living beings were before me, but I couldn't utter a single word which they could understand.

I was standing before the watchman completely embarrassed. A smile showed up in his face, he tapped on my shoulder, pointed at his ears and his mouth, and I understood that he was deaf-mute. Now it became clear to me why he was looking so attentively at the lips of the person with whom he was talking. The watchman gave even a wider smile to me, stroked the beautiful peacock's neck, then he tapped on his forehead, pointed at the peacock's head, rocked his head with dignity, made a helpless gesture with his hands, and I understood that he was explaining to me how unusually clever and perceptive his peacock was.

While I was trying to understand my homework, everything seemed to be very difficult for me, but as soon as I mastered it I wanted to keep learning. The language became pleasant and understandable to me. The longer I was sitting by it the more glad I was. Having forgotten about

everything, I missed the gong, I didn't even hear how I entered the room. I came to myself only from his hand which touched me.

"So I knew, my brother, that I needed to drop in here, otherwise you would forget about everything," my guardian closed the book without mercy, covered the table and took me out of the room.

"However you would hurry to fulfil the task given to you or undertaken, you have to respect your surrounding and everything with what you are connected with it. Food cannot wait for you, and the man who has promised to bring the present for you has to find you waiting for him. They say: "Accuracy – that's politeness of the kings." Self-discipline for a disciple – that's the greatest accuracy of his actions and words, the greatest politeness for those whom he meets. A living man – that's the most important task for you everywhere. He's the most important for you during your day, because that's the goal of your Teachers' activity. Notice it, Lovushka, and cherish your external neatness in the same way as your internal one."

We crossed the park quickly, in which the strong heat was hanging, which I couldn't feel at all in Ali's room. When we finished drinking the tea in the grotto, my new friend Arab appeared on the threshold, he was wrapped up in the white burnous from his head to toe, under the pleats of which he was carrying a beautiful little basket made of palm leaves with a nest made in it. A little white peacock who looked very unhappy was perched in the nest. I would have never thought that this long-necked, still almost not feathered hatch, deplorable and ugly, - he was the future king of the birds' beauty.

The Arab bowed and gave the little basket to me. Apparently I turned it strongly, because I was delighted with its exceptionally complicated weave. The little bird gave a sorrowful peep, and this sound squeezed my heart with a sorrow that was unexpected to myself. I felt sorry for the poor little peacock whom I frightened so incautiously. I didn't know how I had to comfort him and to correct my fault.

I was feeling helpless before raising him which was waiting for me, as he was helpless before me with his weakness. I was already about to give the present back to the Arab when he said to me in a horrifying, but absolutely understandable French language.

"Don't worry, aga, everything seems to be complicated until you don't understand how to do it. I've already prepared the food for him and I would tell you everything – how to give him to drink, how to take him for a walk and how to sleep him. You see, he's already used to me and he complains to me of why I gave him to you. These birds are very perceptive, not every man will be equal to them. Well, now I will explain to him that you are his real owner, while you give him this porridge to peck from your palm, and he will recognize you as his only owner."

The Arab took the little bird out of the basket carefully, perched him on the big palm of his left hand, while with the fingers of his right hand he was stroking the little, almost bald head of the bird like the most tender mother and in this way he handed him to me – he seated him on my left palm where he could hardly fit in.

The little bird looked at the Arab in a funny way, as though with dignity, then he pecked from my palm where the Arab had already put some porridge, he lifted his head, looked at me, he pecked a little more and peeped. The peep wasn't sorrowful anymore, but joyful, as if he had habituated himself to his new owner.

The Arab advised me to put the little bird back to the basket and to cover him with duvet shawl which he pulled out of his burnous, because although the heat was hanging, the hatch was frozen and he was trembling. I thanked the Arab sincerely for his present and I expressed my regret to him that I didn't know how I could return my kindness to him.

"That won't disappear anywhere. When you travel to see the desert next year, take me as your guide and visit my home for a rest. I am living in an oasis, it is two days from here."

I thanked him again, squeezed his hand, and together with Alver, Bronski and the painter Skalradi who were delighted with my little bird no less than myself, we took him to my room. I. and the Arab came after some time, now he explained to me in detail how I needed to look after the hatch.

"You know, my friend," Bronski said to the Arab, "your instructions, of course, are great and they show your love for birds, but they are so complicated as if they were given to a baby and not to a hatch. I think that Lovushka won't be able to come right alone, while the bird is still so little. Perhaps I could take part in the bird's care? It would give me pleasure and it would liberate Lovushka a little."

A smile appeared in the Arab's face.

"You and Lovushka will find out something about these birds in a minute. Then both of you will understand why they are so humanly perceptive and why their care is so thoughtful. I think that if doctor I. allows, it will really be very useful for you to watch the little bird's raising. You are kind, pure and you will be nice for the little peacock. He will reveal his talent faster next to such friend."

The Arab smiled again, he extended his hand to Bronski and he gave a small, dark stone pulled out of his little leather bag to him.

"This is a snake stone. An amulet from a snake's bite. It stops wounds' extravasation, heals them faster and saves one from death by cobra bite. If you use it from a snake's bite, its power will be sufficient only for four times. Then it will lose any of its power and I won't be useful for any other goals. Take it as a remembrance about me. You will need it soon."

Bronski reminded me of a weak little bird with his helpless embarrassment. I gave a laugh, because this comparison seemed to be so witty for me.

"Take it, Stanislav Nikolayevich. Both of us will be indebted to aga Zeiched-ogly. Perhaps we'll invent how we could return our kindness to him."

Now Bronski played such a trick that I almost dropped the little basket out of my hands. I hadn't yet finished my phrase, while Bronski embraced the powerful Arab's neck with both of his hands, he kissed his dark face and he was telling him something incomprehensibly, but so quickly that he reminded me of the sexton who was reading his tired palms in a hurry. Of course, Bronski's patter was very significant, and the Arab understood it perfectly, because he was laughing merrily and he responded to Bronski's supplications with his nods. Suddenly the actor dashed out of the room like a bullet, he even left the door opened wide. So how could I "not catch crows"? I was so stunned that I decided that I would rather sit down and put the little basket on the floor.

The Arab's eyes were looking at me with undisguised humour. I. was flashing his eyes, too, without uttering a word. Only Alver could comfort me, because he was good match for me. Now he was standing with his mouth opened like back then on the mountain when he was watching my and I.'s Valkyrish flight. Our joint silence, as it seemed to me, continued for a very long time, and this pause was already tiring me.

The Arab went up to me, he lifted the basket with little bird from the floor and put it on the leather stool at the head of my bed. He uncovered the duvet shawl and showed me how the little bird had burrowed in the nest's dawn by imagining that he was safe like under his mother's wings.

"You didn't understand anything from your friend's words. It is absolutely not surprising. I could hardly understand him as well, although he was talking in Turkish, and I know that language well. Apparently I pleased him very precisely and I gave him exactly that what he wanted to have. He asked me to accept a ring from him in exchange for the stone and he wanted to become brothers with me for the favour which he could feel in my words. According to the custom of my country, I cannot accept a present for the present, but in this case I also cannot insult the man who possesses so much childish naivety. I can see from his face that he was suffering a lot and he is still suffering. I will be happy if I can take away a part of his suffering with his ring."

Zeiched-ogly told me the last words more silently and slower, his face became so earnest that I was looking at him, surprised. I. was also serious, perhaps even a little sad. Finally, quick steps were heard downstairs, somebody was running quickly on the stairs, and then Bronski showed up. Apparently he was running here and there, he was sweated, and his clothes were wet.

"Well, here you are, please take it in order to remember our meeting. You are the first person who showed such confidence in me by seeing me for the first time. Usually people expect strong impressions from me and they meet me in a distrustful and cold way. In my unbearable solitude I'm happy by finding the man who's met me in such a tender and brotherly way."

Now Bronski was speaking in French, he was speaking slowly. I could see how strongly his heart was beating under his fine clothing.

The Arab took the case which Bronski gave to him, he opened it and nodded his head. He was examining the ring with black pearl that was changing in all colours of the rainbow. It was placed in the circle of shining diamonds, as though in the cup of the shining water. The Arab kept directing his look from the pearl to the exhausted actor's face, he was nodding his head and, having pressed the ring to his heart, he bowed to him in the Eastern way.

Then he bowed to I. in exactly the same way, as though by asking him to bless him for this step, he put the ring on the little finger of his left hand where it could hardly fit in, although it was made for the forefinger according to the fashion of that time.

"From this moment on, my dear brother, I accept all your sorrows to my heart, I share all the tears and misfortunes with you. Let it pour out in streamlets into my path. Perhaps my loyalty for friendship and my tender love will help you to pass on to the path of those who bring the reddish pearls to all their meetings with them. Glory to Allah, honour to your God and to you. Protect the remembrance about this day in your heart as about the happiest one in your life."

Zeiched-ogly bowed to I. again, he bowed to us and left the room silently. I saw that Bronski didn't understand anything from that what the Arab was telling him, while I understood only that the actor's trouble was that he was like a herald of misfortune to his encountered people, and they were afraid of him.

Again Ali's words which I heard by the door of his room began to sparkle in my memory: "When you meet the disciple who's walking down the path of sadness, come to love him doubly." In this moment I loved so much not only Bronski, but also that great man of wisdom who just was here as an ordinary dweller of the desert! How immense his heart was that was beating in his chest if he rejoiced at happiness to accept another person's sorrows to himself. I. embraced Bronski, gave a sweet to him, he offered him to take a shower and added that he would go to the distant little houses to visit sister Alexandra in fifteen minutes and that he would take all of us together with him.

I also wanted to bring my little bird with myself, but I didn't allow me to do it. Alver asked I timidly whether he also could go with us. I smiled and answered him.

"Of course, my friend, I didn't do any exceptions, did I? And I told you that I would take all of you with myself. Besides, from this day on you, like Lovushka, may consider yourself to be my disciple. Tomorrow I will specify the new daily routine for you. Both of you have to know that here, in these houses, the people are living who, for certain reasons, are in the initial stages of their discipleship. You can see here many people who visit the Community not for the first time already, but anyway they are living in these houses of neophytes. And on the contrary, you cannot see those whom you met on the first day, for example, Oswald Rasten and Jerome Manule."

Bronski came back to the room. He was refreshed, he changed his clothes which the almighty Yassa gave to him, and we left with our medicine chests. The heat was still scorching, I could feel it very strongly, but my fellow-travellers were walking in such a way as if our northern summer had been here. I noticed that I was walking with difficulty, he took my arm and flung my medicine chest over his shoulder by disregarding any of my protests.

"Lovushka, I promised to tell you something about shrimp Maksa. I think, my friends, that it'll be useful for all of you to find out about the destiny of this little man who is suffering so much now.

If every man could control all the powers hidden within himself, then there would be neither suffering nor mistakes in the world, the result of which is all people's misfortunes. The passions which surround man obstruct his entire earthly path. They take the possibility from him to see clearly and to recognize the true reality in the ocean of illusive beauties, which allures him and drags him to the imaginary, charming world of his personal life, of his personal love and happiness. Man isn't free. He is living chained with his conditional attachments, and finally when these oppressing bonds of bodily love fall off his eyes, it happens through great suffering.

The entire earthly life, while wisdom is awakening within a man, is nothing else as the great path of his liberation. If from his childhood man could be educated in such a way that his entire organism would grow harmoniously, then he would easily become free by maturing, because his consciousness, his nerve-knots and his heart wouldn't get overgrown with all sorts of lumps and tumours of his passion eruptions which people usually call diseases. Both man's hearing and his eyesight would develop not only physically, but also psychologically, while his organism would be absolutely harmonious.

Soon we'll see the victim of passions fight, the victim of good and evil, and again, unfortunately, we'll name it in the words of life vocabulary. In the presence of the truth, neither good nor evil exists, there's only a certain level of knowledge, a certain level of man's liberation, the moment of pure love and peace in his heart or the moment of his passions and ignorance.

People are living in gloomy forests which are impenetrable and surrounded by swamps, through which only narrow paths pass, who are trying to get the secrets of the nature. They are striving to achieve the ability to control the nature elements by using their knowledge.

The goal of these people is to rule the world. Their wants – that's to control all the wealth for their egoistic purposes in order to enslave other people and not for the work for everybody's general welfare. They are black occultists who often unite in horrible sects with all sorts of sexual perversions and often victims of people. By using their servants, they allure people everywhere where only they are living obsessed by envy, hatred and the passions of greediness, without any balance and who easily submit to irritation. These black powers entangle them in the nets of the illusory happiness, they help them to achieve several little victories so that they wouldn't allow them to become free of the nest of snakes, which

everyone will build for himself who is caught on these hooks by being tempted with charm of the imaginary wealth offered to him.

By taking advantage of their rather great knowledge – “great” until they act among the weak, enslaved people, and poor when they meet really free men, - they created the whole tribe of shrimps. These beings with their disfigured appearance are very angry, educated in insidiousness, deception and unfaithfulness, they have been taught a lot of tricks of hypnosis and magnetism. However, the black occultists who are striving for their personal goals through the occult knowledge not always succeed to ruin all the unfortunate ones till the end, whom they managed to take possession of. Often some martyrs are living among the shrimps, for whom the evil, hatred and hypocrisy is disgusting. They try to escape after their unbearable suffering and punishments for their dislike of evil, for their refusal to commit crimes. The Great workers of the Bright humanity often find such unfortunate ones, they save them and bring them to the Community of white Brothers. Now you will see one of such martyrs.”

We had covered a half of the way already. It was dark and humid in the forest, and I imagined how the unhappy shrimps had to suffer, because they were forced to live in impenetrable forests among dishonest people during their entire lives.

“If the great workers of the Bright humanity succeed to save such shrimps caught by the blacks, then especially favourable conditions are created for them, they are surrounded by the purest and most tender people, they learn to write, they develop in every possible way, and the workers try to raise their crushed spirit.

Anyway, having spent their childhood and youth in slavery, ignorance and being run down, these unhappy shrimps look like wrinkled, dried up mushrooms with their spiritual form. They don't control a single thread of spiritual powers for as much as to strike a spark from within themselves and set fire to those shoots of rough tissues which their cruel masters have squeezed into their organisms through fear and pain. They cannot incarnate as people anymore, because they would need to reanimate all the centres of their physical and spiritual powers instantly. The Compassionate Life sees their disability and helps them to live one life as a bird. They incarnate as white peacocks. That's why these birds are so perceptive, often they even can understand a language if people teach them do to it.”

All of us gave a shout in one voice with amazement.

“Only don't think that all the white peacocks are certainly incarnated, kind shrimps without exception. Life always leads those who are walking down this path to the Community of white brothers,” I. continued, as though by not noticing our excitement.

“And how about my little bird, I.? Is he also a former shrimp or simply an ordinary, wild peacock whom Zeiched-ogly found in the forest?” I asked him with my heart in my mouth with excitement that my peacock was an ordinary, wild one and that I wasn't destined to protect a dear man's life.

“Zeiched-ogly got your peacock in a special way. The Arab knew that he had to give the little bird to you and he came to the Community specially for this purpose. You will find out how, why and when you are connected to that unhappy shrimp through the karma of great gratitude, who now has come as white bird to you because of it, you also will find out that he was your most vicious enemy and murderer during one of your lives. In your turn now you have a chance to show gratitude with your care and love to him for your saved life in the distant past.”

We came to the clearing where it was hot again. Nurse Aldaz with very worried face was going to meet us.

"Miracles, miracles and miracles," Bronski whispered.

"Miracles don't exist, only knowledge, knowledge and knowledge exists," I. answered him.

Without any greeting nurse Aldaz began to tell I. something in a very excited voice. Her face which now I was observing very attentively after Bronski's story about her was changing like in a fairy-tale. She all was changing together with mimic of her face. Suddenly her figure as though used to grow heavier or it used to become absolutely light depending on her words which she was saying. Everything was so harmonious within her that it only intensified her expression, and I understood that the shrimp was fighting against someone, although I didn't understand her words. He was afraid of something and he tried to escape.

When we entered the room where the shrimp was sleeping, nurse Alexandra was holding the tossing patient's hands, who probably was delirious. I. was lingering with him for a long time, he would tell me to give him this and that until finally the patient calmed down and began to breathe evenly.

Having allowed him to rest and to have a nap, I. began to change his dressing. Since I saw his nasty, wide open wounds in the morning I prepared to see that horrible view again, but I was surprised when I saw that they didn't bleed anymore and they were covered with a greyish white coat. I. prepared a foamy liquid, he moistened with it the plasters prepared at home and stuck them on his wounds. The patient was flinching, but he didn't open his eyes and he kept dozing. Only when his wounds were already dressed and when I. stroked his little head, he opened his eyes and he was surprised when he saw so many people around him. He fixed his gaze on I. and smiled.

I. took the sound patient's hand and began to talk to him tenderly about something. In the beginning, as though he didn't want to answer him, but after a while he began to speak quickly, bitterly, he was asking him for something and he was afraid of something. I. calmed the patient down, he sent both nurses to have their supper and he told them to bring trained male nurse along with them on their way back, who would spend the night with patient and who would step aside from him only when the patient was sure that he wouldn't allow anybody to hurt him.

The trained male nurse came after a while. His face surprised me. I had seen many kind and bright faces during this time, but I hadn't yet met such stream of love which was pouring from this man's figure.

As soon as the shrimp flung his eyes at him he smiled instantly, he purred something, extended his sound hand and he wanted to lift it, but I. forbade him to do it instantly. This male nurse's name was Francisco. He looked at everybody's eyes and gave his hand, but both his look and the movements of his hand were so different when he greeted every one of us, that I became Lovushka the Catcher of Crows instantly.

He was looking at Alver attentively, he raised his hand high, smiled and told him in perfect French clearly and loudly.

"You are good lad. Keep walking as you've started – you will achieve a lot!"

He was looking at Bronski for a long time, he was nodding his head, bowed very low to him and he said to him silently.

"Enough solitude and wandering. Now you have a lot of friends. Here you will leave all your tears and sorrows, and you will leave with reddish cloak, while your black one will lie on my shoulders," he told him and bowed low to him again.

Bronski turned into the salt post, apparently he didn't have any strength to perceive everything what was going on here. I was the last one to whom Francisco came, because I was standing rather far, by the table and I was placing medicine chests until I started catching crows.

"Peace to you, my dear brother, carry joy for people. It is so rare when a disciple is walking with happiness to spread joy and light for his relatives. Don't stand in one place, live everywhere, carry peace wherever you would live. Your talent may turn other hearts to spirituality. Learn self-control here – then you will enter harmony and strengthen people with it."

Francisco extended both of his hands to me and as though the wave of peace and warmth poured into me from them. He sat down by the bed of the shrimp, moved a little nearer to him and began to feed him. The little red eyes of the unhappy martyr showed satisfaction. He forgot about everything and he was laughing merrily between his bits.

I. helped me to pick up things, because I simply wasn't suited for anything, as well as my friends, by the way. I. had to send all of us back to reality and remind us the elementary rules of courtesy, because we were already prepared to leave without saying good-bye. While saying good-bye, Francisco said to me.

"Take care of your peacock sincerely, my dear brother. This is the soul that has suffered a lot. The more attention you will give to her now, the higher she will rise later on. It will be a pleasure for me if you visit me. I will teach you to see "through the earth," he added with a slight smile.

Now already I was prepared to turn into the salt post, but I. said good-bye to Francisco by laughing and he took me and everybody else out of the room.

On our way back every one of us was immersed in our own thoughts. In spite of the cool of the forest, Bronski was wiping the pouring sweat off himself with his handkerchief. The Englishman was walking as though by leading a regiment behind himself, while I was dragging my legs along, held by I., and I was unable to comprehend the diversity of people's paths.

Now I remembered that there were millions of the paths, while the stages were the same for everybody, now I was thinking that many people's lives existed, while Life was one, and I couldn't understand how such small people like myself could enter that harmony about which Francisco was telling me. Indeed everything got mixed in my head.

"Lovushka, think about today. We'll come back, you will feed your little bird, he must have missed you already. Concentrate your attention on the current affairs, and pour fearlessness and nobility into them, while tomorrow you will think about tomorrow," my guardian was persuading me tenderly.

"Ah, I., my dear, if at least with a one hundredth part I could be such careful friend to my little bird as you are to me, then I would be happy that I do at least this lesson. How I would like to be worthy of your care," I answered him by drinking as always the calm and confidence that were spreading from my friend.

When we reached the Community, I. said good-bye to our friends by reminding them that they couldn't be late for the supper. As soon as I entered the room, a joyous peep of my new friend of my life met me. I dashed at him, took him out of the nest carefully and fed him from my palm. I. helped me to give him to drink, because that was a serious problem.

Having finished the procedure of feeding him, I stroked my white treasure and put him to the nest again. The gong was heard, and we hurried to the supper dining-room. It was bright here, the ventilators were cooling.

Many new people used to come to I. The painter who said good-bye to us after the tea now was asking me where I was and what I saw during the rest of the time. I answered her that I saw so much that I was unable even to find room for everything. Bronski interrupted our conversation and he declared that his friend was as though better already, but he wasn't yet allowed to visit him.

I didn't listen to the conversations around me. I didn't have any appetite. I didn't even look at what they gave to me, but I submitted to I.'s instruction to eat.

However strange it seemed to me, I was so drowsy that after the supper I went straight to my room. When I took a bath I finished my second day in the Community without even noticing myself how I fell asleep next to my new friend, the white peacock.

Chapter 3

An ordinary Francisco's day and my friendship with him.

The wicked shrimps, the fight against them and their liberation

A lot of time passed, maybe three or four weeks until finally I became acquainted with a big park of the Community and its ponds. Now I already knew well the suddenly opening views or the little houses that emerged at the bends.

My friend, the white peacock whom in the beginning I was always carrying in my arms, now began to run after me in a funny way everywhere by demanding with his peep and comical flapping of his slowly growing wings that I would take him in my arms when he was tired already.

Every day I was visiting Maksa alone or with I., sometimes – actually rarely – with Alver whom I. entrusted a part of nursing by Igor.

Bronski mostly used to spend the time with me between the tea and the supper, while during the entire day he was occupied in writing of some complicated work of his specialty, because he wanted to give to his students everything what genius of his creating actor has opened to him.

My learning in Ali's room was successful, it was so successful that I. offered me to learn the Arab language, too, because I wanted to understand my new friend Zeiched-ogly very much and not torment myself over trying to suppress my laughter fit from his French language.

Every time when I used to come to the hospital, to nurses Aldaz and Alexandra, I always met male nurse Francisco. He either used to walk with me in the forest if he had some time, or he used to invite me to the pharmacy where he produced the medicine, while I used to help him, or he used to take me to his room which stunned me when I saw it for the first time. From the balcony of the first floor of his little house that was standing in the clearing of the forest – above the chopped off tops of the trees – the view like from Ali's room opened to the distant settlements and to the mountain range.

Three rows of the parallel mountain groups called the green mountains, the lowest ones, overgrown with grass and luxuriant trees began right behind the valley. The herds were grazing there, one could see working people there. The range of infertile black mountains rose behind them. You could reach them only after crossing the desert. And finally the dazzling and stunning, snow-capped mountain tops which opened from here with their entire power and beauty. The mountains in this place were curved in semicircle, they formed as though an amphitheatre to which the balcony of Francisco's room was directed.

Room? Is it possible to find the words in order to describe Francisco's room or himself? Several bookcases with books were standing in the room, a small table of a strange shape, it was rather narrow, high, made of the white marble with red veins which were so dense that the marble itself seemed to be bright red. A big cross made of big red jewels was hanging above the table. When the sunbeam used to touch it, the warm, red colour used to sparkle by reminding me of the mixture of fire and blood, and it often attracted my attention. I used to think many times how simple and noble this cross was, how proportional this table was, but I was unable to decide in any way what its purpose was? To write? Too high. To eat? Inconvenient.

Anyway, the owner of the room himself used to enslave my entire attention so much that I never had any time to ask him what the purpose of this high table was. Three arm-chairs were also in the room if one could call three sitting places in this word, which only cavemen could possess. They were made of the palm logs and leather, they were big and beautiful in their own way anyway, and it was convenient to sit in them.

The wooden trestles covered with a cloth were standing by the wall instead of the bed. You could place the bedding on them anytime, but whether it was convenient to sleep on them I couldn't decide in any way. An ordinary washbasin, a little glass shelf for washing accessories and the towels above the washbasin, a writing-table, a hearth – these were all the furniture of the room.

When I came to Francisco for the first time, I was seized by a charm, almost the same feeling of happiness which I used to feel when I came to I., Ananda or sir Vomi. My eyes could see simple things, while with my entire heart I could feel not them, but that person who was living here, who has filled this entire room with atmosphere of calm and harmony. Whatever my look used to touch, as though I could see the words of love everywhere, cut on all the things by Francisco's heart.

From the very first impression of our meeting till this day, the charm of that personality was always growing. He didn't tell me any especial words, while I, by observing his behaviour in the most ordinary grey commonness, understood perfectly what a liberated man he was.

When I couldn't see him, it seemed to me that the day had lost something, some beam without which I already couldn't consider the day to be valuable. I saw that the others also – from small to big one – were searching for Francisco and that they respected him, they appreciated every moment of communication with him. Everywhere he would pass by, everybody would burst into bloom with their smiles, as if he had been walking and sowing smiles like flowers.

In the beginning he was duping me, because he was reading through every person's feelings and thoughts, but soon my astonishment grew into ecstasy of respect. From his example I comprehended clearly for the first time what love within a man was, love that was pouring in stream and not demanding anything in exchange for itself.

Francisco's love was flowing into the world of his day not because he comprehended with his mind how to liberate himself from his personal feelings, but because the word "to live" was the synonym for word "to love" for him.

My joy when I used to see him wasn't a simple joy. When I was with him, my entire egoism used to become numb. I wasn't thinking how I should prepare myself so that when I entered Francisco's room I would be worthy of him with my purity, but when I used to see him I would be filled with his atmosphere still from the distance. I was always feeling clearly – as though I had crossed the limit, – that Francisco wasn't far already, that the streams of his love were flowing into me.

Little by little I comprehended why Francisco could understand every man so well, as if he had known him from his very childhood. Nothing was disturbing him within himself. No partition existed between him and a man, the partitions which wouldn't allow him to accept the man such as he was, the whole, without any personal demands. His heart was opened till the end for such power of love that when a man would come to him with his entire heartbreak, his tears and doubts, he would unite that power, leave his passions in it and feel relief instantly. The man used to leave his bitterness to him and leave him comforted and gladdened.

Now I saw all those wise and great truths which I used to tell me and which I comprehended with my mind and heart, but which I considered for myself to be only as an ideal of my distant future, as the simple man's kindness in his everyday life.

Francisco was living not only by loving others. While he was communicating with people, he used to keep everybody under the influence of the power of his love in such a way that the man used to relax, stop raging and raving.

Once I was a witness of a shocking scene. A father who looked more like a furious buffalo than a man was chasing his son with a huge bludgeon. He had already almost caught up with unfortunate, he already raised his hand with bludgeon, but Francisco got in front of the furious father at two bounds and covered the youth with his body.

I gave a shout with horror and I rushed to help him, but the escaping youth who probably had lost his mind completely thought that I wanted to stop him. With all his strength of horror of approaching death he grasped my chest and pushed me. I didn't expect his attack and I stretched myself on my back; luckily I fell down on the net of lianas, I entangled in them, but I didn't hit myself very strongly. Anyway I felt an acute pain in my backbone and to all appearance I lost my consciousness for several minutes.

When I came to life, Francisco was on one of his knees and he was holding my head with his hands tenderly. The youth was sitting on the ground next to me and he was crying with his hidden face. His father was sitting on the trunk of the fallen down tree at a distance with his hung head and he was panting.

"My poor boy, you have a concussion again, while your organism needs a complete calm so much. I don't know whether you will be able to stand up, but anyway you won't be able to come back to I.'s, to the Community. I will bring you to my room."

As though Francisco wasn't telling anything special, but the tone of his voice, the expression of his face, his eyes were radiating an endless love and such calm, tranquillity, such tenderness and bliss as though the drama hadn't just happened, as though he had meditated about the growth of flowers and grass a moment ago and not saved the man from death by risking his life.

I had never felt such love, bliss and joy. As though a stream of warm blood was pouring from Francisco into me. I forgot about my pain, about the youth's cry which hadn't ceased yet, I became light, joyous and silent.

Francisco laid me on the ground conveniently, he wound his and my hats, put them for me instead of a pillow, he went up to the youth and put his hand on his head. The youth lapsed into silence, wiped his eyes with his sleeve, looked at Francisco and told him.

"Who are you? I've never seen you here before. Why were you running to the death instead of me? Oh, you are saint! I've seen an image of God at the missionary, it was exactly as yours. So, hence he showed you to me? What do I have to do now? You probably will demand me to take the monastic vows? I don't want to do it very much, but I know that anyway my life now belongs to you and that I have to live in such a way in the future as you will command me to. I submit to you, my saint brother, command me."

The youth was on his knees with his hands put on his chest like for a prayer. Only where could I find the words to describe Francisco's face? He was looking at the youth like the most tender mother, caressing her little son. He smiled, and his smile illuminated all of us like a bliss, like a ray of light.

This smile was ringing to me. It was ringing like Ananda's laughter which I called the clank of swords, like sir Vomi's laughter which reminded me of the jingle of the wonderful little bells and the babble

of the spring streamlets. This smile in the silence of the fabulous forest was ringing like the part and parcel of the whole nature, like the power to live in happiness of love.

I was so immersed in thought that I came round only when I heard Francisco's voice.

"My friend, the saints have nothing to do on the earth. They can work above us, where me and you still cannot reach. I'm as sinful as you are. I don't need your life, but you need it yourself; all your relatives, the earth on which you are walking, all the people with whom you communicate and all the children who will be born from you need you. Every man's life is needed and valuable only when his heart loses the ability to dread and to irritate all the people around him. You didn't want to marry that one whom your father has chosen for you. You could ask him to postpone the marriage, then everything would have ended well, because that one whom your father has chosen for you is in poor health. She won't be living for a long time. However, instead of a calm conversation you started reproaching your father. You were trying to insult him as much as possible. You were playing with your father's passions, but you didn't know their power and you pushed him into a rage. If this murder had happened, then your father would be less to blame than yourself. Your entire life from this moment till the very death has to become the continuous lesson of love. You won't dare to irritate any man, but you will have to learn to calm everybody whom you will meet. Well, that's the only of your pledges, it is a saint thing for you. Go, my friend, think about that what I've told you, and if you feel unwell, visit me at the hospital. You will always find me there, or they will tell you where I am."

Francisco took his hand off the youth's head, but he seized his clothes and told him pleadingly.

"Saint brother, put your hand on my head again, don't drive me away, accept me as your servant, I will be happy if I could live next to you."

Again Francisco's smile rang like the entire symphony of love, even wider than before, and he told him tenderly.

"Your wants are excellent like this flower. The flower will cease blooming in a week, while your beautiful wants will dry up in five days if you stay here. Your life – that's flowering of the earth in your body, while your spirit still only sets like buds on a tree. Live like your parents and your brothers are living, love the girl in the same way as you love your mother and your sister, create your own family, so that nobody ever would hear your strict or irritated voice as I've already told you. Go, try and be kind to everybody."

The youth stood up, bowed to Francisco and turned to leave. He was going slowly, as though with reluctance, while Francisco was looking at him always with the same smile of love which, as it seemed to me, overflowed the whole surrounding space. All of a sudden the youth came back, he went up to his father and told him with great effort by fighting against himself.

"Father, forgive me. He tells me to live in harmony with everybody. How will I be able to live in harmony with others if I don't become reconciled with you? Then I will have to die, because now he controls my life, and I won't be able to fulfil my pledge."

The thick-set, hefty figure of his father, his powerful neck of the bull, his downcast head – nothing gave a slightest stir. Francisco came up to him and touched his shoulder – his eyes full of rage, madness and anger rose, he fixed his gaze on Francisco's eyes, and at the same time the big father's hand rose. I was prepared to jump for help again, it seemed to me that now the disaster was inevitable, but the father's head hung again, his hand drooped on his knees. Francisco came up absolutely close to him, he stroked his head and said to him tenderly.

"Did you spend your youth without any sin? Why are you surprised now? Were you showing an example of kindness and tenderness to your children? If you really consider yourself to be without any sin, then throw a stone at your son. If you know how much difficulty lies in your heart, embrace your son, he will carry a part of your suffering and he will take a lot of it off you. Now he asks you to forgive him. Shouldn't you ask your son for forgiveness three times, because you've deceived him three times already?"

The man jumped up from the stump like a tiger, he seized the tender Francisco's hand with his big paws and exclaimed in a wild voice.

"Who's told you about it? Only I alone know it. Where have you been? Were you spying on me? Were you listening to me?"

"Calm down, father. Can't you see how tender the saint's hands are? You will break them."

The strong man let Francisco's hands go, the bluish red stripes and his strong fingerprints were left on them. I moaned when I saw these as though bleeding spots. The strong man himself probably didn't expect such an effect of his touch, he seemed to be very embarrassed and he whispered.

"Forgive me, saint brother."

Now his look became soft, a human expression appeared in his eyes.

"But you don't know what he conceived, do you?! You see, he needs to learn. He felt like learning the writing. He has heard a lot of it in the markets of the tale-tellers and he also struck up a friendship with one Arab, so he desired to read," again the father was shouting by raging always more, he as though was roaring.

"And how about you, didn't you ask your father to let you go to the school in your childhood? Didn't you cry when he didn't let you go there? But he didn't beat you for your wish to learn, did he? Why were you chasing your son by wishing to kill him? Think a little and confess: your envy for his destiny better than yours, that's what made you furious."

"Maybe it is so," the man rather gave a groan than uttered. "But I didn't want to kill him, but only to frighten him slightly. As though I'm not myself during all this time. And I don't understand what is going on with me. Some very disgusting two shrimps are turning round and running about me. As soon as they show up, as though the evil spirit gets into me. Everything irritates me, I rail at everybody, as though I become not myself. Well, now it happened too. I was walking with my son and talking to him, but suddenly those two little devils jumped out of somewhere and began to babble something, to poke their fingers into the hospital's direction. I understood that they needed to go there, but that they were afraid of the doctor. I took the hand of one of them by wishing to take him there, but he poked me with some sharp, little stick – my heart was pierced like with a piece of hot iron. I let his hand go, and both of them started running to the thick of the forest. Then my son said something to me, now I don't even remember what, but I became angry with him and I raised my hand with bludgeon against him," he was silent for a while, pulled the sleeve of his clothing and showed the big bruise next to his elbow, in the centre of which there was a little wound like a pin.

Francisco looked at his hand, he lifted the father from the trunk with an unexpected power and commanded him quickly.

"Follow me immediately. Death or something even more terrible is menacing you."

He took me in his arms, the youth helped him to carry me, and he broke into a run to the hospital by telling the peasant to go in front of him. In the beginning he was walking rather quickly, but by

the threshold he already had to lean upon his son and, as soon as he entered the room, he sank into an arm-chair almost without any strength.

Francisco put me to his bed – I still could feel an acute pain in my backbone – and he began to prepare some medicine quickly. Having given it to the father to drink, he lifted the cover of the marble table easily and took a little stick out of there, as it seemed to me – it was made of glass and it was sparkling in all the colours of the rainbow.

The fire that was burning on the tip of the stick surprised me mostly. While Francisco was humming something continuously, he touched the patient's wound with this fire. He gave a start, but evidently not from the pain, because his face remained calm. Francisco was touching the wound with his stick for many times, as though he had been sucking the poison with fire out of it. The blood came pouring from the wound in several minutes. But what kind of the blood it was! It was dark, clotted, it wasn't flowing, but it was breaking in some clots which looked like some dark corks. Francisco kept humming his continuous hymn, and finally the stream of the red blood appeared from the wound.

The foam showed up on the patient's lips, he coughed a little, and the blood appeared from his mouth. Francisco wiped it away quickly with towel. He put the stick in its place in the same careful way as he did it when he took it, he lifted the cover of the table a little and told the youth to go to the big house, to find the chief trained nurse and to ask her to come here immediately. He gave some liquid for the patient to rinse his mouth, waited until the extravasation stopped, then he gave some more drops to drink to him. Francisco dressed the patient's hand very skilfully, tied it under his neck and said to nurse Alexandra who came in in French.

"The patient needs an absolute calm. Besides, nobody could be allowed to get to him, as well as to your little patient. Fence in the little house very well, in which the little one lies, and tell brother Kastanda that I ask him to send two watchmen with white peacocks to me, to the hospital. He will understand everything. Send somebody to I., tell him that I ask him to come here immediately. He also will know what he needs to bring with him. And right now, immediately, tell nurse Aldaz to bring her patient here. Somebody, you also could do it, my dear friend," he addressed the young peasant in the native language again, who was so stunned with such unexpected events that he was standing with his mouth opened wide, "go together with chief and bring the little baby bed here which she will show to you. Help your father to come," Francisco continued.

While Francisco was talking, he pulled the screen aside, which in the beginning I considered to be a little wall. There was a niche there where a neatly laid bed was standing. They put the patient on it, and Francisco said to nurse Alexandra in French again.

"Hurry, because two shrimps are rambling about the forest, they are angry and dangerous. Neither the little patient, nor this strong man may be assaulted by them. Even meeting them may be dangerous for them. I will be protecting my patients and nurse Aldaz, while you hurry to fulfil everything what I've told you to."

When the nurse and the youth left, Francisco with his face shining like a quantity of sunbeams, moved some furniture about in the room, and I understood that he was preparing a place for the shrimp's little bed. While I was looking at him, I was always more surprised. My God! What kind of eyes he had, what kind of his movements were! I felt it with my entire body that Francisco carried not the chair to another place, but that he was praying. He wasn't just living on the earth by carrying out the most ordinary work, but he was glorifying God with his every movement. The smile didn't disappear from his face, the smile of happiness to live. He looked at the lying, gloomy peasant, he saw that suddenly the tears

began to stream down his cheeks, he went up to him and told him several words which I didn't understand in such tender voice that my heart even melted.

Having stroked the dishevelled man's head, he helped him to turn over on another side, and in a while I understood from his even, calm breathing that the man was sleeping.

I still could see the red spots which the strong man left on Francisco's hands with his clutches. Now they seemed to me even more terrible, I thought that soon the blood was going to pour from them. I wanted to say to him that it was the time to take care of himself, but nurse Aldaz carried in Maksa in her arms, who was covered with a bedsheet. The youth brought the little one's bed, and in his face now one could see only fascination in the girl's beauty. He was standing in the middle of the room just like that, without taking his eyes off the charming, little Aldaz's face by holding the light, little bed made of bamboo in his hands, absolutely unconscious. Evidently he was unable to perceive so many contradictory events that had happened in half an hour and he looked so comically that I couldn't suppress my laughter by seeing the living portrait of myself, Lovushka the Catcher of Crows.

Maksa assented to my laughter, Aldaz didn't hold her seriousness, too, while Francisco took the little bed, put it in the place prepared for it, put the shrimp into it and as though said to himself.

"Just in time, just in time."

I didn't understand the meaning of those words, but having looked at the youth, I saw the sudden change in his face. He turned grey, then a rage flashed up in his face, he extended his hand by showing something to Francisco through the window, he was sputtering curses quickly and he wanted to run there, but Francisco stopped him and explained something calmly to him in his dialect.

When Aldaz looked through the window, her face also changed, she seemed to be frightened and she was looking at Francisco sadly, while he, by not stopping to smile, seated her by Maksa's bed and told the little one.

"Sleep, my child, you need to sleep until doctor I. comes."

Maksa closed his eyes, and I was surprised how he fell asleep peacefully in a flash, even his laughter became silent instantly. Francisco told the youth to sit by his father's bed and explained to him that he would need to sit here and not to stand up until doctor I. came.

However I was trying to see through the window who had frightened Aldaz so much, who had enraged the youth, I couldn't see anybody except the wonderful forest view.

"Your eyes still cannot see "through the earth," Francisco sat down next to me and smiled. "Well, look there, at the jasmine bush. Can you see how several of its twigs are moving, although the others don't even stir. There isn't any wind. Who may be moving those several twigs? Somebody may move them only from below. Define the direction of the twig movement. It leads to the windows of that little house from which Maksa was just carried out. Now I can hear already how the watchmen with many white peacocks are coming here quickly, and I. is coming here even faster. I know that you are still unable to concentrate your attention like this, so that's why I advise you: don't take your eyes off the flower garden with jasmines and you will experience a great lesson of your life today, much greater even if I had been telling you three times of what the evil will and power in a man was."

Francisco told us once again not to move from our places in any way, even if an arrow flew in through the window; not to move or touch anything, even if something was thrown through the window. He left the room and stood up in the doorway of the porch.

I was watching the bushes and the flower garden, I saw that the twigs were still moving gently and I took a good look closer to the ground by trying to understand what could be the reason of such constant movement. It seemed to me for a couple of times that I could see some child among the flowers, but no matter however I was trying I couldn't see anything else. All of a sudden something fell down with noise and broke in the room where Maksa was lying before. In the silence that was reigning, this rather small noise seemed like a cannon shot to me. I was afraid that the patients might wake up, but the sound didn't make any impression on them.

I rose a little and I saw that now Francisco was standing in the middle of the clearing with his face towards the bushes and his back towards the former Maksa's room. The same expression was in his face, as if he had kept glorifying the happiness to live. Suddenly he extended his hand, and I trembled in such a way that I felt a sudden pain in my back again: an arrow was stuck up on the ground by his feet. I was looking at the bushes with all efforts of my will and now I saw how the second arrow flew out of there and pierced the ground next to the first one. I was all paralysed. I couldn't understand in any way why Francisco was standing by the bushes where death was menacing him. How could the man with such undisturbed love in his face stand by the boundary of the evil and death? The noise that was coming from the distance interrupted my thoughts. I was unable to decide in any way what kind of the noise it was. It seemed to me that several people were running.

All of a sudden, white peacocks covered the whole clearing like the cloud of snow. Several men were grouping the birds into three circles according to Francisco's instructions: one circle surrounded the flower garden with bush of jasmine, the second one with Francisco who was standing in the middle of it was protecting all the entrances to the hospital, while the third one – all the exits to the forest.

The people were holding the metal nets in their hands and they shared ten peacocks each. Having taken a better look at the man who was standing on the forest path straight before Francisco, I recognized I. The view was so fascinating and interesting that I had to concentrate all my strength so that I wouldn't distract my attention and start "catching crows."

The peacocks were making the first circle around the jasmine bushes and the flower garden narrow. Also the second circle was coming nearer to the bushes where Francisco and I. were standing one before another one. They raised their hands up both at the same time, and I was dumbfounded instantly. I.'s face was so strict and so commanding that I couldn't even imagine. He looked like a God of power whom nobody could resist, while Francisco looked like a God of love who possessed such power of love that nobody was able to withstand.

A wild scream was heard in the bushes. It was the scream of anger, fury and protest. A shrimp jumped out of there and he started running, but the peacocks closed ranks, stretched out their trains, they climbed one on another's backs, formed a white wall and blocked his way.

Then the shrimp dashed to another side where a gap appeared when the peacocks closed up. He was scuttling straight to I. with entire speed of his little legs, but I. seized the net which his nearest neighbour threw to him and cast it down on the shrimp. The shrimp who didn't expect any obstacles from above fell to the ground and screamed in a wild voice – how could such a small being give such a horribly loud and angry scream! – he began to roll by getting entangled into the net always more, which he was trying to tear with his hands and feet, to gnaw with his teeth, to cut with knife that nobody knew where and when showed up in his hands.

I. extended his hand towards the ball that was rolling at his feet and uttered something to him in a very commanding voice. The shrimp as though got stiff for a moment, but soon he started screaming even more terribly, he started spitting and, apparently, cursing. I. came nearer to him and told

him something again. This time a warning was heard in his voice. The shrimp fell silent, and suddenly simply satanic smile distorted his face. He huddled up into the ball, drew the bow with lightning speed and shot an arrow straight into I.'s chest. Nurse Aldaz, the youth and me cried with horror. Aldaz covered her face with her hands, I was trying to run for help, but I didn't have any strength not only to run, but also to rise a little. The arrow sang away up, and I expected to see how it pierced I.'s vertex. But instead of it, it fell down onto the clearing, just between I. and Francisco.

I.'s voice was heard again, but this time I didn't recognize it, which was so dear, wonderful and tender to me. It was like a thunder, as though an echo would join his every word, strengthen it a hundred of times and it would unite with whole nature.

The shrimp began to tremble. I saw that the net in which he got entangled began to turn red, as though it became heated. Having seen this horror, having understood that he would be burnt down alive if he didn't submit to I.'s order, the shrimp began to pull some rootlets, arrows, powder out of his clothes, he threw down his bow, some other bags and looked at I.

The net still became heated. I. warned the shrimp for something else, but he shook his head with disapproval. I.'s face changed, it became compassionate, but... I understood from the gesture of his hand that an inescapable death was waiting for the shrimp who didn't want to submit to I.'s demand and to give up the evil.

The shrimp also understood that he wouldn't succeed to deceive I. and that death already threatened him. He went down on his knees – his grey with fear face was simply disgusting – and dropped several black little stones. The flame of the net that was already coming nearer to the unfortunate one went out. I. went up next to the shrimp, pulled a little stick out of his belt, lifted the net with it, threw it aside and covered the shrimp with another one which his neighbour threw to him. The shrimp remained lying like this at I.'s feet. Now a scream was heard from the bushes, as though it was mourning over something. There was so much suffering in this sound that I all covered inside of me.

Francisco who was standing motionless up to now walked several steps towards the bushes, and the flock of the birds followed him. He stopped close to the flower garden and began to speak to somebody whom I couldn't see.

I understood neither his words nor the meaning of that what he was telling him, but his voice intonation, his endless tenderness, calm and kindness which I could hear within him told my heart that help of his love didn't know any limits or rejection. My heart simply fainted when I was looking at Francisco's face. Oh! This pale face in ecstasy of love and kindness used to rise before my eyes for so many times during the difficult and dangerous moments of my life, in the moments of disharmony and deadly longing.

Pale, with his big shining eyes, with smile of joy in his lips, he was extending his hand to him, and as though I could hear the words in this pose of his: "Come to me, and I will comfort you."

I saw how the second shrimp crawled out of the bushes on all fours. He was even more degenerated than the first shrimp. He was terribly disproportionate, because his head was rather big, his waist was long and his legs were short. Somehow he managed to stand up and he was going straight to Francisco by howling like a dog by the dead. His long hands were hanging below his knees, his protruded jaw had bare gums, while his mouth was from one of his ears to another one. This horrible, inconceivable parody of man stopped three steps away from Francisco, he was panting and gulping. I was expecting that now he would take him in his arms, but everything happened in a different way.

The first shrimp began to shout something for his associate by showing the arrow stuck in the middle of the path and those black little stones to him, which he had thrown out of his spacious

pockets. In the beginning the second shrimp was listening to him attentively by covering his monstrous jaw with his degenerative lips, then he looked at Francisco, jumped back and began to howl by covering his eyes with his hands.

The first shrimp began to shout even louder. Francisco waved his hand to him, and he became silent. Again the voice was heard, which I translated to myself: "Come to me, and I will comfort you."

The shrimp shot an arrow with lightning speed like his friend before, and it pierced the ground next to the first one. Then both shrimps as though went mad. They began to scream so loudly and to roll on the ground, even to gnaw it around themselves that Francisco took the net from his neighbour's hands and covered the degenerate with it tenderly, like with a cotton wool.

He also got entangled in the net like the first one. When Francisco came up to the raging degenerate and he was telling him something, his voice was sounding tenderly and calmly like a harp.

The second shrimp calmed down. He took everything calmly out of his pockets, put everything neatly in a little pile and put the same black little stones on top of it, which the first shrimp had thrown out. Then he went down on his knees, looked at Francisco's eyes attentively with his red eyes, and as though a smile of satisfaction distorted his lips. He extended his hands to Francisco pleadingly and pointed at the neat little pile of his wealth. He touched his heart and his throat, he ran his hand over his neck as though by showing to Francisco that his masters would take his head off.

Francisco said something to him again, and again his voice and his eyes penetrated into my heart: "Come to me, and I will comfort you." It seemed that the shrimp already understood that he found a great protection that wouldn't betray him. He knelt down again, uttered a friendly scream and touched the ground with his forehead.

"Lovushka, concentrate all your strength and come here," I heard I.'s voice.

I rose with difficulty, but without any special strain anyway by being surprised how I was unable to stand up when I was trying to do it. I left the house, and I. showed to me how I had to go past between the two rows of the peacocks, because they were running towards me from all sides.

The peacocks closed up into two thick rows and left a narrow gap between me and I., so that I could go past them. When I went up to I., he embraced my shoulders with one of his hands and said to me.

"Neither me nor Francisco may touch these unfortunate ones, because they will die instantly from our touches, in the same way as it would have happened to those whom you had to touch in Constantinople at sir Vomi's request. You had your loyal assistant, the brave captain there. Here you are alone. Do you want to help me and Francisco? Those people who are standing here may not help us because of their own reasons. Remember that in order to help us now you need not only an absolute fearlessness, but also your entire compassion, your entire joy, your entire human love for God. You need to forget about the whole external nastiness and to penetrate into the Light and Calm that are hidden within man. My friend, do you want to save these unfortunate ones?"

"Oh, I., how can you ask me whether I want to save them. The question is whether I will be able to be useful for you. And there may not be any fear within me when you are next to me. I would like to help these poor martyrs from the bottom of my heart, so that I could show gratitude to you at least a little for everything what you've done for me and what you are still doing for me. By calling for my dear Florentian, I will try to concentrate my entire attention. I'm ready, I obey you."

I. gave the little stick which he was holding in his hand to me.

“Hold the stick straight before the unfortunate’s heart. Love him in such a way as only your heart is able to understand this feeling. Be glad as Florentian is glad now by seeing your complete self-sacrifice and your desire to save these deplorable, angry beings. When I touch your hand, touch the shrimp’s forehead immediately, no matter what he would be up to. Try to do it with lightning speed and hold the stick at the level of his heart again.”

I took the stick. I was all embraced with a charming feeling of happiness and joy. I felt to be exceptionally calm. My feet which were walking so weakly here now as though grew to the ground, and I felt an infinite power in my entire body.

I. began to talk something continuously in Pali language, as though he was chanting a hymn. Now I already knew Pali language so much that I could recognize it. I could understand separate words, but I was unable to comprehend the whole contents. Suddenly I.’s intonation changed completely, the thundering was heard in his voice again. I squeezed the stick stronger, looked at the shrimp and I almost threw the stick out of my hands. By piercing me with his terrible eyes which didn’t affect me at all now, by drawing himself up and standing on tiptoe, he was trying to reach my stick, but his efforts were unsuccessful. As though he was stuck and he couldn’t move from his place. I felt I.’s touch above my wrist and at the same moment I put the stick to the shrimp’s forehead. He gave a shout, he wanted to seize it, he staggered and fell down.

I thought that he was dead. I. continued the hymn and he touched my hand again. I put the stick to the shrimp’s forehead again, he trembled, stretched himself and uttered a moan.

My eyes must have been tired from the strain in the bright sunlight, but it really seemed to me that the dark steam was rising from the shrimp’s mouth.

I.’s voice became stronger, so commanding notes were heard in it that even all peacocks bowed their heads to the ground. I. touched my hand for the third time. Again I put the stick to the shrimp’s forehead immediately. He sat up, looked round in amazement, stood up, looked at me, at I. and suddenly, having wrinkled his face childishly, he broke into bitter tears.

My heart was beating. I was ready to embrace and quiet him, but the other two hands already took the net off the poor one and they were stroking his dishevelled head tenderly. I. took him into his arms and he was pressing him to his chest, while he kept weeping bitterly.

Francisco gave me a sign with his hand, he said something loudly to the peacocks, they all ran to the second shrimp and surrounded him in a close circle. I. told me to put the stick into the case by his belt and to hide it in a special narrow pocket which I hadn’t noticed in his clothes up to now.

Now Francisco called me.

“Lovushka, this shrimp leaves his dirty trade of evil in his good will. While I’m telling the mantra, touch all the things from this pile which he put here with the stick one after another at my command. Here, take the stick. When the whole pile turns into ashes, lift the net with the stick, take the shrimp by his hand and bring him here, absolutely next to me. And when I indicate it to you, touch the vertex with the stick.

I did everything as Francisco had told me to do. While the things were turning into ashes, the effect was the same as in Constantinople. Only here everything also stuck together into a piece of tar. As soon as I touched the shrimp’s vertex, he also wanted to seize the stick, he even jumped up, but he didn’t

achieve any results as the first one. This shrimp wasn't angry. He didn't cry – he was laughing like a child and showing his satisfaction in every possible way.

Having received Francisco's command, I lifted the net with the stick, brought the shrimp to him, he dashed at his feet, embraced them and he was trying to express his love in every possible way. Francisco took him into his arms, he told to take out all the birds, except three of them, which he picked out himself. He also told to call nurse Alexandra.

When I returned the stick to Francisco and came up to I., the shrimp was sleeping calmly in his arms. When nurse Alexandra came, the second shrimp was already sleeping, too, and both of them were brought to the same room where Maksa was living.

Now the clearing looked like always again, all the tracks of the fight between the Light and the Darkness that took place in it were gone, and we went to the Francisco's room.

I was worried about Francisco's red spots on his hands, but he as though didn't notice them. When I was already ready to tell I. about them I heard his voice.

"Francisco, sit down, I will dress your wounds again. Otherwise you will be put to bed again."

Francisco and wounds? I couldn't perceive or imagine that Francisco who didn't worry, who was radiating, who in truth was pale, but who was so strong and calm, could suffer from wounds. Without having reproached with a single word, Francisco sat down on the chair, while I. rolled up his sleeves.

I could see the wounds above the red spots from the peasant's hands, they were like burns from which the blood was already oozing.

Neither before nor after that I had to feel such inner suffering. Francisco kept silent by enduring the pain calmly, while I. was dressing his bleeding wounds. Such an expression was in his face as though he would have glorified the entire universe, but I could hardly hold my tears.

Francisco looked like a saint to me and to the peasants whom he saved today. Why the saint had to suffer? I wanted to give my hands in exchange, only if I could save him from his suffering, only if I could always see this wonderful face in the ecstasy of kindness and love.

"Lovushka, I've already told you that the saints have nothing to do on the earth. Some divine messengers may exist on the earth, but I'm not the one of them. I'm a sinful man. And everything what I can do for people – that's actually only to exchange my blood with theirs. But there isn't any greater happiness for man on the earth. I'm not a leader of mankind. I'm an ordinary man. My path of kindness is leading me as harmony that is living within me. You have not to suffer by looking at my wounds, but to understand that every path is the karma of centuries which you cannot throw off. Well, you also have your own karma: you carry the wonderful jewel of your Teacher which was stolen, desecrated and purified again. Whether you know it or not, but it will be a great help for that person to whom you will return it. And all of us who help you to develop your psychic strength within yourself which you need in order to carry it and to return it to its owner, we are all tied up with a gigantic karma of gratitude and salvation with that person to whom you have to return the jewel."

I couldn't understand Francisco's words and everything what I had seen today till the end, but I didn't ask him anything, because now I already knew that I. would explain everything to me as soon as I have enough strength to understand it.

Having said good-bye to Francisco, I. and I left the hospital territory and came back home. I was walking with difficulty, I. was holding me and, as soon as we went upstairs to my room, he put me to bed.

Yassa took me to the bath in an hour. I. himself instructed him what kind of massage he had to apply for me, but I was still unwell both after the bath and the massage. I had to go to bed again.

I couldn't even comprehend all the events. I couldn't imagine what time it was, it gave me the shivers, I became always weaker until finally I dropped off to troubled sleep.

Chapter 4

I become acquainted with new home of the Community.

An orange little house. What I saw in it and what happened in it

I woke up from the weight on my shoulder and from the light tapping on my hand. I didn't comprehend instantly where I was and what was going on with me, I opened my eyes and I burst out laughing loudly.

My small friend peacock who now wasn't so small anymore climbed on my shoulder and he was waking me up in a funny way. Since he was used to go to bathe with us always at the same time, he wanted to tell me that it was time for me to get up already. Besides, the sensitive bird wasn't satisfied only by waking me up. He jumped off the bed, ran to the opened door of the balcony, looked at the distance and, while flapping his wings with anxiety and crying harshly as though by asking for something, he came back to the door. Having pulled my blanket with his beak, the peacock ran to the balcony again, then he came back to me again by crying even harsher. He was trying to tell me that I would look at what worried him.

I stood up by laughing merrily and went up to the balcony door. I was so surprised when in the distance, on the way to the lake I saw I. who was already close to the rock behind which he had to go soon. I covered my careful friend with kisses, he cooed with joy and made me laugh even more by doing so. I dressed myself in a flash without forgetting to comb my hair nicely this time, which Yassa had taught me, I took the towel and the peacock in my arms, and I rushed to chase I.

I was feeling completely healthy and in this early morning I didn't remember what had happened yesterday.

I was so used to the heat that the scorching sun didn't torment me anymore like in Constantinople or at my brother's in K. Now I could walk very quickly. I already almost learned to walk without raising dust and not to get tired.

When I came tearing along to the lower lake I saw I. who was standing by one of the bathing places with a tall man. The elegant stranger's figure and his face struck the eye. He didn't look like native, although he was brunette. His aquiline nose with nicely bent little hump – everything showed clearly that he was Georgian, and I recognized him to be a mountaineer from his light, graceful and hopping gait.

"Lovushka," I. turned his face joyfully to the loud greeting of my peacock. "How did you wake up, sleepy-head? We need to ascribe it to a miracle that me and Yassa didn't need to shake you by trying to wake you up."

He took the peacock in his arms, while he perched on his shoulder unconstrained and he began to rub his little head to his cheek. While I. was stroking the wonderful peacock's back next to the "mountain eagle" in the background of the blue lake, lit up by the sun, he was so charming that I couldn't hold the outburst of my feelings, I embraced my friend and I was begging him.

"I., my dear, don't refuse it! I want to have your portrait exactly like this, here, by the lake, with my peacock on your shoulder, in the morning. It seems to me that this pose of yours, your cheerfulness and energy as though bless the upcoming day and people by sending them strength to create

and love. Oh, I., don't refuse it. I will ask Bronski that his friend would paint you like this for me. Only agree to pose for senora Beata."

"Insatiable Lovushka, isn't it enough for you my constant stay next to you during the day? I have to hang above your bed during the night, too! And again, my friend, according to your words, you've committed a crime. Recover your balance, make yourself free from too great admiration in my personality and become acquainted with one of my and Ali's friends."

I. was talking so tenderly, his eyes were pouring such flows of love and joy which I hadn't noticed within him up to now as it seemed to me.

"Lovushka, this is my old friend, my brother in arms in many of my words, whom I haven't seen for a long time. His name is Nikita for you, while his surname is Davshchvil. And here is Lovushka, count T.," he introduced us one to another.

The stranger was surprised, he looked me up and down, looked at I. and all of a sudden, as though by having remembered and understood something, he began to nod, he gave a charming smile and extended both of his hands to me.

His mute greeting, his great sincerity which I felt with my entire heart surprised me. He was especial with something, I even thought whether he wasn't deaf-mute, because his look was so attentive.

Having extended both of my hands to him as well, I looked at his eyes by knowing that the deaf and the dumb were looking at people's lips, but Davshchvil was looking straight at my eyes. I couldn't tell whether he was deaf and I heard I.'s laughter and his words.

"Nikita, you aren't that dumb servant in the Caucasus mountains anymore, are you? The habit of your silence of many years surprised Lovushka, because he expected a verbal greeting from you. He must have decided that you were dumb person."

"Forgive me," Nikita said to me, "I got used to be silent in my long solitude so much that now I cannot use a language instantly and I mislead people. Only this time as it seems to me you were stunned not only by my silence. I couldn't hide my amazement when I heard your name. I was amazed, because many years ago a heavy snowstorm in the mountains brought an unexpected guest under my roof. The snowstorm was raging for nearly the whole week and it snowed up the roads so much that the traveller had to live in my cottage during all that time. The guest was an officer, and his name was exactly as yours. I didn't notice any resemblance between you and my guest in the first moment of meeting you. Now I remember his face clearly and I can guarantee that he was your brother. His oval-shaped face, the section of his eyes and his lips – they are absolutely the same, but your brother's hair was blonde, his eyes, too, while you are brunette. I remember faces especially well. If I. hadn't told your name to me, I would have asked it myself anyway."

Davshchvil was speaking in English with a strong accent. I thought that he should speak Russian with an accent, too. From the thought that he accepted my brother in a hospitable way, that maybe he even saved his life, Nikita became close and dear to me instantly. While still holding his hands, I told him passionately.

"Nikita, how I would like to hear the story from you about those days which my brother spent with you. I haven't seen him for so long time and I still wouldn't see him for so long time that I would be happy to talk to you about him."

"Lovushka, what is more important for you?" I. asked me by passing the peacock to me. "Is it my portrait or the story about your brother's life at Nikita's?"

"I., of course, your portrait is more important for me, because it symbolizes the entire life for me which I've understood through you. When I have your portrait I hope to put it into my heart forever as the path of happiness and power which you've taught me to understand. If now I heard how my brother was living in the godforsaken place of the mountains for a week, almost buried alive in the snowstorm, then probably I would understand many things about my life before meeting you differently. The symbol of the white peacock which I saw on Ali's, Florentian's and my brother's little boxes..."

I didn't finish my phrase. The alive peacock whom I was holding in my arms after taking him from I. suddenly as though tore the veil in my memory. I remembered yesterday's events. The whole view of the clearing, I. with Francisco in it, surrounded by the snow-white peacocks with their shining golden trains, rose so clearly in my memory that I forgot about everything else in a flash and I was standing dizzy from the new flow of my thoughts, from the new opening.

Yesterday I was unable to comprehend that great work in which the birds were taking place and helped to escape their brothers shrimps from the evil and suffering. I comprehended neither where nor for how long I was standing, as though I was reading the words of Ali's letter: "And let this white peacock be the symbol of peace and activity for people's happiness and welfare for you." An acute pain in the small of my back – I must have turned suddenly – forced me to come to myself: I was lying on the bathing place, the peacock was perched by my head, while I. and Nikita were standing next to me. Florentian's little bottle was in I.'s hands, I recognized it and I understood that I didn't manage without fainting away.

However strange it was, but now when I was looking at Nikita, some vogue recollections, something from my distant childhood rose in my memory. It seemed to me that his face which now was so worried was connected with the fragments of my recollections about a horse from the Caucasus mountains, about some journey, but I couldn't remember anything concrete, so I waved my hand and I decided that it was again due to the thick Dervish cap, but when Nikita touched me by helping me to stand up, this touch seemed to be familiar to me.

"Well, Lovushka, we'll try to bathe you in the cold lake, as Nataliya Vladimirovna recommended us to do," I. told me.

"So she, my dear friend, is here again?" Nikita was very surprised when he found out that Andreyeva was not only here again, but that she was still living in the houses of the first level, as he called our houses.

To my question what "the first level" meant, he answered me that there were many first levels in the sense of both the life of the Community and of one's private life and of the spiritual levels. The first level how one needs to understand it in the sense of the house, - that's some kind of a distributor, because a man himself doesn't choose the place which he likes in his life, he is living exactly there and in such a way where and how his spiritual strength allows him to do it. Namely this strength predestines his place in the Community and it doesn't give him a possibility to live differently, in another house of the Community.

He told about himself that this time he was living in the house of the fifth level, while many years ago he left this place after reaching the third one. Now when he came back he found his house in the fifth level, which he couldn't even see when he was living in the lower level.

I. told me that if I hold out the bathing successfully, then he would take me to those houses of the Community where my possessed strength already allowed me to live and to breathe. He added that one could possess a very developed psychic strength, even be the source of great enlightenment for people, but anyway, due to the lack of harmony in one's organism, one may not have enough strength to

withstand the vibrations of those levels, the atmosphere of which demands harmony as the initial point of existence. The man who is unable to control the powers which break out of him is suffocating in the atmosphere of higher harmony, he stops as before the most real wall, although there aren't any external obstacles before him. The flows that break out of him passionately create this wall by overshadowing his own spiritual and physical vision with a thick screen, and the man doesn't even see the entrance or the path to those places where more developed and high harmony beings are living.

Luckily, my bathing ended without any excesses, although the water temperature was really low in comparison to the weather temperature. Maybe actually it wasn't so low, but the water seemed to be ice-cold to me. When I dipped into it, it was fizzing like aerated water, and my entire body was covered with silver little bubbles. Even when I went ashore I was still all with silver armour and I was red as a lobster. I was still feeling the coolness during the entire way up to our home in the heat and I wasn't afraid of the heat anymore.

Andreyeva was the first who greeted me when I entered the dining-room.

"Ah, mister count-awl, how you've changed and become better-looking during that time while I didn't see you. Aren't you bathing in the lower lake?"

"You've guessed very precisely, Nataliya Vladimirovna. They bathed me in the lower lake today, and the experienced feeling reminds me of the state of the shaggy poodle if you threw it from the stove straight into the frozen pond. I don't know whether one becomes better-looking because of it, because I didn't have time to make certain of it."

"Ah, those writers," she gave a sigh by pretending to be unhappy. And suddenly she puckered her brows, relaxed her lips, gave an expression of kindness to her face with sharp features – she became the real Oldenkot.

I doubled up with laughter. I also remembered how Florentian in K. park was performing an English lord before the young officers – and there wasn't any end to my laughter. Andreyeva soon regained her usual facial expression and she was asking I. naively whether he didn't realize the course of my joviality. I. answered her that he didn't know it personally, but that he didn't doubt that mister Oldenkot really knew it.

"Oh yes, I know it and I'm not surprised that it is ridiculous for your friend," entering Oldenkot answered. "It is so unexpected to find a resemblance with me in Nataliya Vladimirovna's face that I would laugh myself if I wasn't afraid of making my friend angry."

For some reason today I was especially interested in all the people surrounding me. Up to now I was close only to Bronski who helped me to train my peacock, and our friendship was becoming always stronger. Since he knew the world and people well, he was observant and attentive, he could introduce a timely original example from his own life – he was a very interesting company and educator. He was always speaking in a picturesque, expressive way, in essence and, while I was associating with him, my perception about people and the art was growing within me.

I used to meet Alver Chergiston only at the table, as well as some others with whom I became acquainted during the first days. Only that what I. or Florentian were telling me attracted my attention up to now, but today after the bathing and after yesterday's events in the clearing of the forest I began to look more attentively at the gallery of the faces that were sitting around me.

For the first time I understood completely clearly that all the people gathered here at the same time were living also their inner, invisible to others life, that probably they were experiencing here the same miracles and events, the witness and even the participant of which I was myself.

I heard that Andreyeva was writing a work of the colossal importance, that she was charged with an especial mission for which she was preparing here not for a single time already and that now she was preparing again to spread to the wide world the whole flow of the new knowledge for people. The words that I heard from Nikita about her today interested me even more. I fixed my gaze on her and I met her look which was attentive and... sad. This face was changing amazingly! It was reflecting all her spiritual waves like the water on the lake surface. Not so long ago it was childishly mischievous, full of humour, and her rough, graceless features were irritating the eyes with their disproportionality. I cannot choose another word. It was really wonderful. Her features became soft, as though a miraculous shroud of kindness had covered them, her look wasn't burning and drilling anymore, but it loved, blessed and expressed respect. It was illuminated by wisdom. If I had met this Nataliya Vladimirovna from the beginning, I wouldn't have recognized that she was wild and noisy Oldenkot's friend. Her attractiveness and charm enchanted me, and when I heard her tender, velvet voice instead of the sharp one I didn't even understand in the first moment that she was talking.

"Not everyone is destined to enter Ali's room. Not everyone is allowed to contribute to the highest help for mankind. The path of joy – that's absolutely not the one of the perfect ones, but certainly the one of the calmed ones, while calm – that's not an external tranquillity, but peace which one carries inside of one, in one's heart. You can be loyal till the end, you can undertake the task of great importance and solve it successfully, but anyway you may fail to rise with your harmony. From today on you will begin to see not with your awls, but with that knowledge which your alive, calmed heart has opened for you. Only there's no sense to grieve for those whose faces seem to be sorrowful for you. The more sorrowful person you meet, the greater your joy must be, because only then he may throw the part of his grief to you. Grief and fear die next to Wisdom. Think not about me and about my secrets, but about those moments of happiness when you may remain absolutely self-controlled after meeting any man. Only then you will be a help for everybody who lack harmony when you learn to be glad after meeting the sad man."

Andreyeva was talking silently, her voice was lost in the background of sounds, but I could hear her every word so clearly, as though she had been talking straight into my ear.

When I was about to finish my breakfast I saw Nikita coming to us. Again I was seized by the strange feeling that I saw this man not for the first time. While he was greeting Kastanda and Andreyeva, I was always shooting glances at him, but I was unable to decide in any way where I could have seen him. I didn't remember such face from my meetings of late months, but at the same time I could feel closeness to him stronger than by the lake.

Having said good-bye to Andreyeva and thanked her sincerely for her words, I hurried after I. and Nikita who already went out to the alley of high and slim palms. My friends were walking down this alley till the very end of the park and turned to the narrow little path that opened on the left, straight before the bamboos which I thought I was unable to cross up to now.

"It is so wonderful, shady and cool here! This is the place where we need to hide from the heat. And it didn't occur to me before that I could find the path in this jungle?"

"For many times, Lovushka, you will be thinking like this while living in the Community, for many times you will discover Americas where you could see only the forest and the mountains before. Furthermore, you will know well where which house is, but depending on your inner high or low spirits, you will find the way to it easily or you will lose it completely. It is absolutely possible that one day you won't be

able to find the way to Ali's little island and you are unable to enter his room. One's purity and fearlessness – that's the first condition of one's spiritual vision. So, the wider a man is able to become free within himself, the faster all his characteristics pass on to the aspects of the Only One, until the whole the Only One bursts into flame in man while he's rising through the levels. So the houses of the Community are arranged according to these levels. It is already impossible to meet a man in the Community who would be swaying between the good and the evil. Only those are living here in whom all the aspects of the Only One are opened and operating. Since there isn't a single man in whom his liberation would happen in the same way as in the others, then the path of Light of those who were walking it down before is adapted in all sorts of possibilities for all those who are following them or who are searching for their liberation independently. Now we go to the second level houses. There are seven of them here. Why seven and why each of them has different colours, Lovushka, I. will tell you about it when the time comes for it."

With these Nikita's words we left the bamboo undergrowth and got into the wonderful outskirts of a field where all sorts of flowers were blooming in the green meadow. Many of them had such forms and colours which I had never seen before. The paths were spreading in beams through the meadow by moving away to different sides.

I. who led the way chose the central path which led straight to the hills overgrown with palms and eucalyptuses. When we climbed up to the top of the hill, I stopped in amazement. A wide plain was extending behind the row of the hills with very beautiful big, medium and very small houses.

The hills rose also another side of the valley, even a little higher than those on which we were standing. All their slopes were overgrown with great forest of the mixed leaf-bearing trees, but the powerful cedars stood out in some places with dark patches. The beautiful little houses of the most different colours, of the most fanciful and the simplest styles were standing in the green background of the palms and the forest, scattered like coloured little stones here and there. A violet house especially captivated me, it was like an old middle-aged castle with little towers, stairs and balconies.

The house looked like an amethyst in the bright greenness of the trees, it was lit up by the sunbeams, with a wide white central stair and a fanciful, also white spiral stair which descended from the side towers.

The red house stood out on the left, also surrounded by the forest. I saw the yellow house on the right side, behind it the blue, the green and the orange ones. These little houses of strange colours looked like flowers in the green thicket.

"It is beautiful, isn't it?" Nikita asked me.

"Yes, it is very, exceptionally beautiful. I only will confess that it is somehow inhumanly beautiful. They fit and flow here in such an artistic way that you accept their strangeness as if it should be like this. But could you imagine something like this in the conditions of an ordinary life? If somebody thought of building such little house – forget-me-not in his village or this one of ruby colour, such man would probably be considered to be a hotspur with wild fantasy or a man without taste. But here they are very nice, and I would like to live here for the entire century."

"Lovushka, many things seem to people to be incomprehensible and impossible only because in their daily routine they didn't have and see those things which they deny. To be precise, they used to pass by many things, but they could neither see nor feel them and they denied them due to their ignorance," I. was explaining to me. "Of course, if a man built such strange green dwelling without coordinating its colour with surroundings, if he painted its windows in white, the fences in yellow, the roof in red colour, then he would show only his poor taste. You can see here not only the harmonious range of

one colour in every house, but it is also coordinated with nature, while the groups of the trees of different colours only supplement each building. Besides, that what you see here is absolutely not the fruit of fantasy or certain conditions, that's the organic characteristics of people's lives and paths which painted these houses exactly like this. Here, look at this red house. The roses, geraniums, climbing lilies surround it, the red colour of which is bright like a flame. Actually this house is white like all those houses which you can see in the valley, but the people who are living here covered its walls with love emanations of their auras, - so the house is burning with colour of blood, and you can see it like this. Only if your spiritual vision hadn't opened within you, painted in this colour by your own characteristics, that is if you didn't possess the living love within yourself, then you couldn't see that colour which is burning in the auras of the people who are walking down the path of love, - the ray of the red colour. You could see only the white house or probably you couldn't see absolutely anything. Also hear the first rule for every disciple who enters the second level Community: not to tell anything about that what you see and hear to the person whom you meet and leave without your Teacher's permission. Learn to keep silent, learn to keep in secret that what your Teacher didn't allow you to tell to others. In this moment I'm your Teacher. Do you want me to lead you until Florentian comes here, and when you are ready you will go with him?"

I was very excited by that what I. told me.

"If only your love and patience is enough for such absent-minded disciple, I will be glad, because I love you from the bottom of my heart and I called you my Teacher in it for a long time already. I promise you to make all my efforts, to concentrate my entire attention in order to make your work easier, my dear guardian, my loyal friend and Teacher."

"I will be glad to help you, Lovushka, with my whole knowledge and with entire loyalty of my love and friendship. Don't understand my words about the secrets of the disciple's path wrongfully. We've already been talking with you many times that no secrets existed in the world of the spiritual powers, that only a certain level of knowledge, that is of liberation, existed. Therefore the people's convictions, their moral demands, their joy or sadness depend on the level of immersion into their personal passions or their liberation from them. A man's subjectivity and negation of his time for one or another reason is always a clear and real sign of his ignorance. Therefore, for you to think that you could lift somebody to a higher world lookout that has opened for you through your own activity of love is the same mistake as to try to explain the beauty of a song to an unmusical person. You won't reach any positive results by trying to give to another person your most precious truth that is unquestionable to you if your friend isn't ready to perceive it. In this way you always risk to profane your sanctity. Not because the man is bad or dishonourable to whom you revealed it, but only because he's still not prepared for it. They say about it: "Don't throw pearls to swine..." On the other hand, that one who's crossed all the levels of his liberation understood Love completely, which is creating in that part of the universe in which he is living. When he begins to understand this creation of Love, then all the cases of the man's body open for his outlook, and he's able to read not only another person's course of thoughts at the present moment, but also his entire karmic destiny. By revealing new things to you, I have to see what you can understand easily and simply now, what will cause a big strain for you and what you won't be able to perceive, because you haven't yet liberated those origins within yourself through which all individual powers may and have to flow in order to merge with your powers from birth. The entire category of knowledge exists, which only a man himself may acquire. You may not give it to him by any outside help. By developing and liberating man himself asks questions - his own and in his own way - to the mother nature, and it answers him. That doesn't mean that every man who still doesn't understand anything in his path of discipleship will be able to ask those questions which he thought of with help of his cunning mind. The man read ten or more intelligent books, he loaded himself with even bigger burden of relative concepts and he decided that now he is prepared, that he is leader of those or other people, that his knowledge - that's the top of wisdom. Here's the

beginning of all sad deviations. Here's the beginning of who is right and who is to blame of all divisions, stubbornness, doubts and arguments. Instead of benevolence one for another and peace, what the liberated people spread everywhere, the man who caught only the mirage of knowledge, rouses irritability, dissatisfaction and gloominess for others. Observe closely and learn to distinguish. That person who is able to forgive people for their sins easier than others, always gives kindness, compassion and calm with his every meeting. He begins his every meeting with them and he ends it with them. That person who came to somebody's home and brought irritability is always unjust, although he would explain his coming with the most important reasons."

Two men showed up behind the big, blooming bushes of azalea when we were standing on the top of the hill and looking at the valley. I recognized instantly tall Oswald Rasten and Jerome Manule. I. introduced them to me on the very first day of my arrival to the Community, and I didn't see them since that time. Now I understood that they were living here, so I didn't meet them in the park by our home.

A thought flashed that probably it was difficult for I. who was so wise to always live among the people without any equilibrium and also to have such sickly, absent-minded disciple so close to himself.

Both men greeted I. joyfully, but they did it not by squeezing his hand as in the dining-room of the park, but they bowed low to him as the monks do. By responding to their greeting, I. put his hand on everybody's head, as though by blessing them or asking them to bless somebody. He pointed to Nikita for them.

"Here's that brother from Caucasus, about whom I was telling you and to whom I entrust you as your closest guardian. Tomorrow he will come to you, and all of you will prepare the new learning program. Besides, we'll travel to the distant parts of the Community in tow or three weeks, and if brother Nikita finds the possibility he will bring you along. Now let's go to your house, so that Lovushka could see your life. Soon he will have to move here."

We climbed down the hill, crossed the valley and went out to the orange little house. It was charmingly revealed among the blue and white flowers, the dark maples, the big wonderful cedars and the white acacias which captivated me so much. These beauties were standing, decorated with big, snow-white caps and they were diffusing a heady aroma around themselves.

As soon as we entered through the gates of the hedgerow which was buried in blooms, two white peacocks came running before us, who were perched on the stair among the flowers. The birds were big, beautiful, and it seemed to me that they were very calm, as if somebody was training them in a special way.

Both peacocks were running straight to I., he gave a piece of sweet bread for each of them, he was stroking them, smiling and telling them something. While carrying the bread in their beaks, the birds jumped back to their places and they started pecking only there.

The wonderful house which we entered had the big hall with very beautiful stair made of the dark wood, which was decorated with flower-pots, the flowers looked like yellow, almost orange lilies and mimosas.

I remembered the stair with yellow flowers and blue flower-pots in sir Vomi's house in B. I remembered Chava about whom I hadn't heard anything for a long time and... Anna on whose shoulders once I saw the chiton of the same colour as these flowers.

Sometimes the thoughts about Anna used to come into my mind, and now I felt her especially sharply in my heart by thinking about her misfortune and my happiness. She could have been here, together with us, with Ananda and she could live this fabulous life which opens up for me.

"Lovushka, aren't you waiting for the door to open upstairs and Chava to come down here?" I.'s voice pulled me out of the "crow catching."

"You are right, I. The room and the stair indeed awakened my remembrances about B., about sir Vomi's house and, of course, about Chava, but now I fell to thinking so much not about her, but about Anna. About nice, dear Anna, about her music which we miss so much here and about her life in this moment. It seems to me that I would agree to live as a hermit for a couple of years and to take the pledge of silence, only if Anna stood here now, next to you. This little house makes no less impression on me than sir Vomi's house. It fascinates me with something, it enslaves me, and I fee such calm, such joy in my heart as if I entered Ali's room. Why?"

"Soon you'll become acquainted with this little room better and maybe you will solve this question yourself."

There was a big library on the left from the hall. Many people were here. Some of them were turning over catalogues, the others were sitting at the tables and leafing heaps of books, apparently they chose what they needed to. While the others were placing the books onto shelves, some of them were reading attentively by not paying attention to anything.

This room of the library was beautiful, too. I could see a row of books through three big windows made of the Venetian glass.

Two very young girls surprised me especially. They served out books from behind the beautiful desks, decorated with flowers. Having received an order, they were walking between the shelves silently and smoothly. One of the girls was an absolute blonde, while the other was brown-haired. Both of them were black-eyed, elegant and they were all alike. "Sisters", - I thought and when I already wanted to ask I. about them, the blonde saw Nikita, cried "Uncle!" and fell on his neck.

All of a sudden everybody became numb in the room, as if somebody had waved the magic stick. They got stiff in those poses as they were standing or sitting. My feet also grew to the ground and, like everybody else, I couldn't take my eyes off the girl who embraced Nikita and who was weeping on his chest.

What was in that cry which affected everybody so much? A joy? A pleading? No, most probably it was a piercing cry, asking for forgiveness, a happiness that the ills of life were over. I. came up to the girl, touched her shoulder and told her tenderly.

"Laliya, why are you crying? Your uncle Nikita is back now, isn't he? If you were suffering for your unwariness for so many years and now you see him alive and healthy, who has done the lesson for you. Don't create another drama, try to forget all the sorrows from the past."

"Oh, Teacher, if not your compassion, if you hadn't given shelter to me, this meeting had never happened. Forgive me my tears, once again I showed that I wasn't worthy of that what you and my uncle did for me."

Now Laliya was standing absolutely next to me, and I could see well that she wasn't more than sixteen or seventeen year old, while her hair was... grey. Absolutely naturally grey! What kind of drama this girl had to experience that even her hair turned white!

The second girl was standing behind Laliya and she was looking at Nikita by smiling silently, waiting for the moment to come up to him. Not only love was shining in her dark eyes. I felt that there weren't any limits for her loyalty. Having torn away Laliya somewhat from himself, Nikita extended his hand for the second girl.

"Nina, you are still strong like a rock when you were eight-year-old, when I left you to your elder sister. If I didn't give way to despair for a single time during those seven years which I've spent in the severe mountain-gorge when I parted with you, then my support, my hope from which I derived my strength was the reflection of the girl with burning heart. Thank you. Take Laliya, I will come to you both in several hours."

Nikita passed the sister to Nina, she embraced her tenderly and she was trying to comfort her. I. proposed to Laliya who was still sobbing silently to go home and to invite somebody else to work in her place. Laliya wiped her tears quickly, bowed low to I. and answered him.

"Teacher, forgive me once again, now I will never be crying anymore. Those were my last tears which were lying like a stone in my heart from the heartbreak that my disobedience destroyed the entire line of my uncle Nikita's life, who saved both of us with my sister from death. Now I'm breathing easily, my heart is liberated from my eternal sadness for my uncle. I will keep working."

"If during all these years you had carried not the stone of sorrow and regret in your heart, but your uncle's image in your thoughts by sending joy, cheerfulness and merry laughter to him, then you, my child, would have shortened the term of his living in the mountains and his separation with you in half. Remember that. And if you have strength to work now – work."

While still being affected by impression of the drama unknown to me, I left the library arm-in-arm with I. My joyous happiness, peace and tranquillity which I experienced when I entered this little house as though were shaken by the buzz of the blown over storm or cannons... "Is there a serene calm, a harmony anywhere in the world, which wouldn't be shaken by the dramas of people's hearts?" – I thought for a while and I heard my dear friend's answer, who as always managed to look under my skull.

"Lovushka, life is a fight and an eternal movement. No walls may protect a person from the riot of passions within himself. To open the new page of life – that doesn't mean to take the pledge and to enter an Order, to receive a rank or a degree. Undisturbed and strong tranquillity comes to a man's heart when his Love opens up and when he sees how the wave of the Only One life is rolling through himself and through the people, the flowers, the trees and the animals who surround him. Then both temporariness and conditionality disappear from man's comprehension. His heart cannot die out for Eternity at least for a second anymore, and he comprehends his encountered person without any case on his eyes. Until that time all people aren't protected from dramas and tragedies, from hesitations between their personal illusions and joy of Reality. The aura of their bodies is always excited. Man's development – that's constant change of his aura, while aura changes only in the activity of one's grey daily routine. To imagine that man's ordinary, grey daily routine on the earth – that's the sequence of people's interrelations, that's success and misfortunes, which depend on goodwill of the people from his surroundings who can help or harm him, – that's the lowest level in which creation of man's spirit hasn't yet flowed into the affairs of his day and into his meetings. He's still only a master who's doing his job by using only the skills and knowledge that rise only from the requirements of the elementary earthly science; he still isn't that inspired actor who pours his creation himself into his daily routine and for whom the entire universe is ringing. It is ringing not with a passing and temporary joy, but with love of Eternity which is already liberated from the earthly superstitions of life and death. The only eternal Life exists for him. Live your day by always seeing the stage in it into the perception of Joy that is ringing in the entire life, then no people's anxieties and heartbreaks will disturb your Harmony, because Harmony living inside of you will be stronger than all the swaying and

unstable powers surrounding you. Memorize it well. This house is the beginning of the same orange houses group. You will see them scattered in the park which you considered to be the forest.”

We were talking in the room on the left of the hall, the purpose of which I didn’t understand. Usually it could be a rest or a smoking room. The sofas upholstered with beautiful orange material were standing along all its walls. The fireside was bricked into its inner wall, an arm-chair was standing next to it, which form was similar to the arm-chair in Ali’s room. The floor was covered with mats of very beautiful, orange hues, they were woven very nicely.

I wanted to ask I. about the purpose of this room, but he took my arm and brought me upstairs.

“What a wonderful stair!” I shouted as soon as we climbed up on the first landing.

The scent of the wood and the flowers was so pleasant and refreshing like in the newly built house where the wood diffused the purest aroma of the sun and the air.

“This is the cedar, eucalyptus and camphor tree timber. All of them together diffuse this wonderful aroma. Now you will enter my room, Lovushka, which is closed for everybody like the white Ali’s room. Now you already know Pali language so much that you will be able to read all the inscriptions written in it.”

I was amazed. I imagined that Ali could have his own room in the Community, because he was the owner of this estate and he could act as he wanted to. Suddenly it turned out that I. also had his especial room here where the strangers were prohibited to enter!

We climbed up to the very top. We turned to the left by the corridor of the first floor, on the right side of which I could see many doors, we turned left and by climbing the same sweet-scented stair, decorated with flowers, we got onto some mezzanine, to be precise, a tower.

The room was rounded, the windows were rounded, with convex glass, absolutely like lamps. The balcony door was wisely opened. When I came up to it and looked down I stopped like rooted.

The avenue of high and branchy fir-trees was so long that it seemed that it had no end. It divided the park from this side into two parts. As far as my eyes could cover the small houses and several lakes were everywhere, while the forest was behind them again, up to the bare rocks.

The landscape ended in a severe way – with bare rocks. There wasn’t that joy and joviality in it, which I admired every morning, but there was no less charm. Of course, I forgot about everything, I went out to the balcony and I was even more surprised when I inspected the balcony and house construction.

The balcony was built on two trees, the trunks of which were intertwined. They were growing by the wall of the house, while the wall and the entire house was the rock in which the rooms were cut out and arranged. Remote ages began to blow. For the first time I could see such trees that would hold the house balcony. They were stout, powerful, knobby and they were simply buried in blossom. Their big, smelling sweet clusters reminded me of olives, but they were much bigger and they had orange colour.

“Lovushka, you are so surprised that you didn’t even read the inscription above the entrance, and it is as wonderful as the house in the rock.”

“Forgive me, I. I’m so rushing about from one surprise to another one that I’ve missed the most important one, although you were telling me about the inscriptions.”

I started looking for the inscription, but I couldn't find anything, only some artistic ornaments. When I already wanted to go to another place of the room, it seemed to me that I began to distinguish two hues of the ornaments. Having taken even a better look, I found the third orange hue and I could see clearly the contours of the Pali letters, but I couldn't comprehend in any way how those letters combined one with another. Finally I could see three inscriptions one under another and I even cried with joy when I understood the first words.

Don't try to understand the depth of meaning where you don't get any help from your own self-control, - I read the first inscription below of the darkest hue slowly, but without stopping short.

While you are looking at man, don't measure his height and spirit, but open the presents and joy of your spirit for him, - I was reading the second inscription.

Don't seek for knowledge when you are paralyzed with fear. Only the fearless man is able to find the temple of the truth, - I finished reading the third inscription above the door.

I already turned away from the entrance, while the words were still burning in my heart in the same way as the words from Ali's room from my first entering there, which were protected in my heart like the signs of fire.

"Now read the inscription above the balcony door. I think that you will be able to read it in the same easy way," I. told me by putting his hand on my shoulder.

I felt so strange now! For the first time some new feeling struck me. I could feel clearly how I.'s power was pouring into me, as if my spiritual eyes were opening.

In the beginning I couldn't see absolutely anything above the balcony door. The solid wall made of the yellow wood seemed to be monochrome. There wasn't anything like an ornament, any difference of hues.

All of a sudden something flashed quickly in my eyes like an electric sparkle. I thought that apparently the bright sun damaged my eyesight. When I already wanted to cover the eyes with my hand and to complain I. of my health, I noticed that the sparkle on the wall began to shine, it became straight like a small stick and turned into a big burning letter in a flash, then the second one appeared, the third one - and I read the entire word. My whole soul was filled with happiness. I couldn't move. Each new shining letter gave such charm to me, such pure joy which I could feel only in my childhood, on my brother Nikolay's hands. I read the phrase.

Vengeance, flattery, jealousy and hypocrisy died out in the hearts of those who entered here. That one who can read the signs of fire has awakened the fire within himself. Once the disciple is able to read the word of fire, he may not spend his time in vain anymore. His speech loses the sting of condemnation and waspishness.

The inscription went out. I. turned me to the left, and I saw the whole row of the burning words immediately.

The path is the man himself. Activity – that's his life of ages. His calm is pouring into the hearts of the people who surround him in every moment. By not reducing the fire within himself, the disciple is passing his light to his each encountered person, if he has mastered the fire by loving. And everybody's harmony becomes stronger, and fearlessness of his encountered person is growing.

The further I kept reading, the more my happiness and honour was growing. I. turned me to the right, and I saw the whole row of the words again, which was burning not in that monotonous yellow fire like the inscriptions read before, but here I saw the real effect of colours and light. The words were burning like wonderful fireworks in the white, blue, green, yellow, orange, red and violet fire.

The view was so attractive, the little flames were trembling and sparkling in different colours, as though by changing one with another. I didn't have any strength to tear myself away from this sight and, if not tender I.'s touch of my forehead with which he must have wanted to remind me that I came here not to be carried away, but to read, then I would have been "catching crows." I concentrated my entire attention from the beautiful sight into the letters and I read easily.

The people who are pure like the water pearls don't exist. The path of one's liberation goes through the ray, and there are seven of them. Everybody's consciousness possesses the rudiments of all seven rays, but one of them is prevailing. That person who had the strength to enter this house of light possesses the aspect of each ray that came to life again within himself, so he can see its light and calm in each of them. The door of all seven rays is opened before everybody. Nobody is left without any attention. When man is prepared – his Teacher is also prepared.

The wonderful flames went out. Suddenly I seemed to myself to be grey, everything around me as though became gloomy, faded, and even the bright sun wasn't shining so brightly.

I. took me to the balcony.

"Lovushka, you read the words which those who enter the second level of discipleship must observe. Did you understand from these inscriptions that the main axes which support all other characteristics in the man of this level – that's first of all his complete fearlessness and second – his complete self-control? Whatever talents would develop in man, whatever great qualities of spirit and heart he would possess, if he isn't completely fearless, if his self-control didn't bring him to an absolute calm in all the moments of his life, he won't be able to enter the second level – that's the most important action of his own spirit. Not that is important how and why you met a man or what kind of man came to you. It is important how you managed to pour your light into his aura and to penetrate to his light. It is important how your love and calm, your comfort for him poured into him. The rules of people's moral code, only the earthly rules don't exist for the disciple of the second level anymore. Only the rules of Love, of the entire Life exist for him. His acts are honourable, noble and wonderful not because the rules of moral require the ethics of conduct from him, but because his spirit has already united with fire of Eternity and his acts may be only the beauty of unity, because they are his own actions of Eternity, the actions of his revived aspects of the Only One which he carries within himself.

I don't ask you whether you are prepared to enter that temple which is called "the second level." If you hadn't been prepared, you wouldn't have been able to read the fire inscriptions in the room. Only don't think in a one-sided way. Don't imagine that you will meet only those here who can read the fire writing themselves. It isn't like this at all. There may not be any other people in the second level as only those who have reached fearlessness and complete self-control. This is an unquestionable truth. Only how they reached them, what the path of their liberation was, what other powers have developed within them except these two unchangeable axes, - this is already everybody's personal path which is unique, individual and especial.

It is rare when the man - the disciple of the second level - is reading and writing the signs of fire himself. In most cases, or always to be precise, he has a chance to receive the information from his guardian through some conductor whose path begins from developing of his psychic powers. Your path started from the same. You are happy friend and servant of your guardians, you can help those who are walking next to you, to make their life and spiritual growth easier in this difficult path of one's earthly incarnation. One of the happiest earthly paths - the path of joy - extends before you. You will never bring any sad news for a man, but you will enter his dwelling as the messenger of peace and help. By setting fire to your talents, the great Compassion gives you the new comprehension of the earthly activity and meaning.

Today you read: "By looking at a man, don't measure his spirit and height, but open the presents and joy of your spirit for him." Accept, my dear, beloved friend and brother, these great words as the landmarks of your grey daily routine. Remember your happiness during your every meeting: you are living by knowing, you are living by holding your Teacher's hand in your own, you are living surrounded by your loyal protectors and assistants, their loyalty to you always depends on your loyalty to them."

I.'s voice, his face and his entire body was radiating so much that even the room seemed to be brighter to me. We left it, we climbed down the smelling stairs again, we turned to the avenue which I considered to be the avenue of fir-trees from the balcony. Now I saw that they were cedars which filled the whole surrounding space with their tar aroma.

"Life is so wonderful!" I shouted by completely forgetting about myself, about the people's personalities and their characteristics, the only hymn of the universe was ringing for me now: the hymn of Triumphant Love.

We were walking down the avenue for a long time. Sometimes we used to meet some people who used to bow to I., but nobody interrupted our silence. Now I was so united with entire nature that simply I couldn't have listened to any man's voice. It seemed to me that I could see how the flowers and the grass were growing, how life was circulating in the tree trunks and thorns. We reached the end of the avenue by being in this silence, and we could already see the lake before us, but I. turned to the left, we crossed the long grotto and we saw an absolutely unexpected landscape...

I saw the same little island as in our Community where the white Ali's room was. The island with avenue of the mighty, broad-leaved palms, along which we were going now, was also connected with little bridge.

As soon as we got on the little bridge, through the thicket of the blooming trees in yellow I saw the exact copy of Ali's little house, only it was bright orange. I didn't ask I. anything. Along the narrow path through the thicket of the yellow trees we went out to a beautiful clearing which was flickering with many-coloured flowers and which surrounded the house from all sides.

Here a white peacock came running to meet us, and an elderly man with oriental clothes and orange turban, who was sitting by the wall of the house stood up. I. greeted him politely, they talked a little in his language which I didn't understand, and again I was convinced of my ignorance. I. stopped before the little house and told me.

"Here you will see that living Fire, the words of which you were reading in my closed room. This room is my working place, the place of meeting all of my disciples who follow my ray. Only not everybody who has the strength to enter it possesses enough strength and purity of his heart which would allow him to enter this house and to be taken to the fire of Eternity. The letters in my room where you read them light up with power of fire – the Power of inextinguishable Love. While in this house that sacred Fire is burning on the altar. Only that person who's reached an unshakable purity and loyalty is able to enter the room where it is burning. Nobody's compassion or help is able to help man to enter there. Only man himself with power of his spirit is able to enter it. Read, my friend, how the first inscription above the entrance to the house greets you. It is changing and it is given to man in such a way as his own activity during the centuries has woven it for him."

I lifted my head up and first of all I saw the white peacock with his wonderful, stretched out train, shining like gold in the sun. I was surprised how I didn't notice such beautiful bird instantly when I was examining the entrance door and I saw only the rounded, convex window above it, which the peacock covered now. It was burning in fire above the shining feathers of his train:

Enter by protecting the eternal memory about your activity during the ages. Gratitude and bliss of those meet you here, whom once, a long time ago you saved. Their hearts desire to give their duty of gratitude to you and to become your protection and help, traveller.

The greeting words touched me strongly, because I didn't expect that they would be dedicated personally to me. I didn't comprehend them, but having looked at I., I understood from his face that all the questions would be solved later.

Only how I understood that I didn't know myself. I. wasn't that I. anymore whom I knew so well, whom I saw shining in his room of the rock. That was a being of the unearthly world. Divinity was blowing from him that surpassed all the conceptions about physical beauty and love. He was the whole Love in which I couldn't exist as a separate consciousness anymore, but I perceived him, because I went up to the world of inspiration of higher consciousness where the words as the symbols describing the mode of life didn't have any sense anymore.

I. took my hand and brought me upstairs which were made of jasper, as it seemed to me. The stair, the walls – everything was telling about the indiscernible antiquity. I wasn't walking, but as though I was flying, because my body seemed to be so light.

When we climbed up to the upper landing of the stair, two men dressed in long, linen clothes, girded with golden ropelets approached us by bowing low to I. I didn't recognize them, and only when one of them took my hand, I recognized Nikita. My God! How could he change so much? His grey curls fell on his forehead and neck, and as though they framed his dark, sunburnt face.

I looked at the second man who also took my hand and I was surprised even more. That was Zeiched-ogly, the Arab guide who gave the peacock to me and who always showed so much undeserved attention to me.

Both of them took me to the room where the pool with flowing water was. Having showed how to climb into it, Nikita told me.

“Allow me to undress you like in your childhood in Caucasus and to help you to do the washing in this water before putting on the sacred clothes and going to the hall of altars. You forgot me, to be precise, you didn’t recognize me when we met by the lake. I’m happy to return the duty of the eternal gratitude to you. If you want to enter the second level of disciples you need two warrantors. A man can enter this level by using only his own personal efforts, but all his friends have to give their help of love for him. Let me pay you my karmic debt, and become your servant and friend in this happy moment of your life. I take the warranty for you upon myself, I will be the eternal lightning-conductor and protection of your irritation. I will draw all the blows of your anger and quick temper to my aura beforehand, so that the development of your self-control wouldn’t be disturbed at least for a moment.”

“In my turn,” the Arab uttered, “I warrant for you with joy by repaying you for saving my life from the dark powers. Once I was shrimp, and you, still being a little child, hid me among the toys and covered me with your body from death. Now I will make every your meeting with sad people easier, I will take a part of their heartbreak upon myself, so that your joy could penetrate into their hearts easily.”

When I got out of the pool, the water of which was almost hot, both my friends dressed me with the same linen clothes as theirs, they girded me with a golden ropelet, combed my hair. They put the same yellow sandals as theirs on my feet. They took my arms and brought me to the door where I. was waiting for me. He was also dressed in white, but his clothes were from the same material as that one which Ali gave to my brother on the day of the feast in K. The bottom, the sides and the sleeves of his clothes were embroidered in gold. An orange, flower wreath was on his head, while in his hand he had the little stick which I had already seen in the clearing of the forest by liberating the shrimps. When I approached the door opened wide I saw the burning letters on the floor, under my feet.

My home is everywhere. Man’s heart is my home. This is the home of peace and light. Only then the man who enters here will find the door when he creates my home within himself. Step into the sea of my fire without any fear if your heart is pure. My flame won’t burn you down, but it’ll temper the power and clarity of your speech.

I stepped straight onto the burning words by expecting that the fire of the letters would burn me, but to my amazement, as soon as I touched it with my foot, it went out in a flash.

Now I. took me from my warrantors’ hands and brought me to one of the several, high, marble tables which had the same form as the one which I saw in Francisco’s room, only it was almost red there – so many reddish and red little arteries were there.

I. lifted the lid of the table, and I saw a low altar below, in which the fire was burning and before which a high topaz cup was standing, in which the liquid, also of the fire colour, was bubbling.

I. plunged his little stick into the cup with liquid fire, brought it to the blazing fire of the altar, and it flared up brightly. Then as though by humming something which I didn’t understand, he touched my vertex with his stick. Of course, that wasn’t a blow, but this touch shook my entire organism so much that I couldn’t keep my feet and I stumbled. Both my warrantors put their hands on that place which the stick touched, and I felt as though the electric current was flowing from me into their hands.

They helped me to stand up and turned me with my back to I. Now I. touched me two times under both of my shoulder-blades. This time the stick's effect was also strong, but not only I kept my feet, I also felt a very strange feeling, as though the wings had grown behind my shoulders. The new power started flowing to me, and I felt again how the invisible, but strong threads connected me with my warrantors.

I. turned me with my face to the altar himself. Now the fire liquid in the cup wasn't bubbling anymore, the green coloured flames were rising from it in spiral, while the fire behind the cup divided up into three tongues: the orange one was in the middle, the white one – from the left and the green one from the right.

Having plunged the little stick into the cup which was blazing in green spirals, I. took it to the green tongue of the fire. It flared up brightly, the whole stick as though blazed up with green flame, then I. took it to the white tongue of the fire, and the white flame blazed up on the stick next to the green one. I. took the stick to the orange tongue of the fire, and the trident of the flame was formed on the stick: the green flame was in the centre, the white and the orange ones – from the sides.

I. took the golden sceptre from the altar, which was placed there, and by holding the stick in one of his hands and the sceptre in another one, he lifted both of his hands up, while still humming that what I couldn't understand in any way.

All of a sudden I heard clearly: "Florentian, Florentian, Florentian," – the dear name of my beloved and distant friend was repeated three times.

In the same moment I saw Florentian with white clothes, who was standing behind the altar.

"Ali, Ali, Ali," – again I was able to hear in I.'s humming. I saw Ali in a flash, who was standing next to Florentian.

I already prepared that now I. would summon both the young Ali and my brother Nikolay, but the fiery threads of the green hue stretched away from Florentian's forehead, throat, navel, shoulder-blades and heart and they merged with green flame of the stick.

The white threads of the fire stretched away from the same places of Ali and merged with white flame of the stick.

I. brought the sceptre to the flames of the stick, a strong and dry crackling was heard, and all the flames from the stick passed on to the bulge of the sceptre, and I. placed the extinguished stick on the altar. The orange threads stretched away from I. himself – again from the same places as from Florentian's and Ali's – to the sceptre. I. raised the sceptre high above his head and he struck up a mantra which was accompanied by the wonderful music.

Having finished the mantra, I. turned to me, I and my warrantors went down on our knees, and the sceptre touched my head. As though a thunder befell on me, I all trembled, but it lasted only for a moment.

The warrantors helped me to stand up. Now I felt strong, renewed, as though I grew a little instantly – as if all my tendons had been stretched, all my nerves and ligaments had become free from some burden. I was feeling so unusually, as though I was living full of knots and lumps up to this moment, while now everything was purified, all my pores opened, and I was breathing by feeling how the atmosphere of the room united with every cell of my body. I looked at I. and I saw that the sceptre in his hand was extinguished, while all three tongues of the flame were burning on his vertex, between the orange flowers of the wreath.

The fiery threads which connected me with Florentian, Ali and I. were fine and trembling in the beginning, but now they turned into the real streams of the fire. I was feeling clearly how they were penetrating into my body by vivifying and making my new state easier, by creating harmony. I. embraced me, he brought me to the altar, took my hands and told me.

“Protect the purity of these hands, they are given the power of joy to convey the word of the fire to those who are walking next to you.”

He put his hands on my eyes and told me again.

“Protect the purity of your eyes. Live in an easy way by comprehending the heartbreak of the earth as an inevitable stage of people’s liberation. Let not a single tear pour out of your eyes, because every tear – that’s weakness of man’s spirit, outburst of his egoism, although it seems to him that he isn’t crying for himself, that he takes compassion on another person. The man who feels for another person completely is pouring the power of courage out of his heart, and only such compassion helps the swaying harmony of the encountered person to be restored. Your eyes of spirit are destined to see the inner, spiritual world of the man. Protect the purity of your physical eyes, so that the veil of your private love wouldn’t obscure the vision of your spiritual eyes. Go and be connected with pure spiritual bond to those workers of the Bright humanity who provide you help, protection and love before the Fire of Eternity now. Carry the sparkles of their fire in your spirit, in your heart and don’t pass them to your encountered people in high ideas and words, but spread kindness, calm and rest to those who are walking next to you through your grey daily routine. You cannot react to work and people personally anymore. Every meeting – that’s the path of all your Fathers who have adopted you now to the Only One through all your meetings. There isn’t any other path for you as only to lead your encountered people to that circle of fire in which you are standing now across the bridge of fearlessness and courage.”

I.’s voice lapsed into silence. I looked down and I saw that the three-coloured circle of fire was burning on the floor, which surrounded us and the altar with a high wall of fire.

I. took my hands and dipped them into the fire on the altar. I trembled for a moment again, but soon I was embraced by a blissful state of silence, happiness and great love. I. bent my head, as though I dipped it to the fire three times, I was flinching with my entire body even more and then I calmed down – as though I was growing, rising with my spirit.

I. embraced me, pressed me to himself – and I together with him rose to such heights where I couldn’t distinguish anymore who I was and who I wasn’t, - I cannot find any words to convey the sensations of my blissful happiness.

When I came to myself I was feeling as though I had gotten into the case of the human body again. My previous state was so light, joyous and blissful that now I felt the terrestrial gravitation and my weight again.

Having looked round, I saw that the altar was already covered with marble lid, that only I. and my dear warrantors Nikita and Zeiched were in the room. I couldn’t see my guardians and friends Florentian and Ali anywhere anymore. For some reason I remembered how I saw Florentian in the ship during the storm, who was radiating the same whiteness as he was radiating it to me here, several minutes ago.

“Now, Lovushka, you’ve experienced how the limits between the heaven and the earth disappear. The whole Only One Life opened up for you. You understood that no conditional limits exist, created by agreed words like “death”, “birth”, “life”, which have taken root as the symbolic terms during the earth evolution, as the separate stages that designate man’s separation with sadness that accompanies

him or happiness with its tempting illusions. Your today's experience has brought you beyond all the conditional limits, and you've experienced the greatest happiness – knowledge of the Eternal Life. You understood that your life in this incarnation – that's that "now" in which you need to cover the part of the path of your eternal liberation from passions. Go and find the only one, unique book of your life, which is placed among many other books on the table. Everybody is searching for it and only he himself is able to find it in this room."

I turned towards many high, orange little tables made of marble, which looked like reading-desks. In the beginning I could see only all sorts of orange books on them. All of them were the same, and no life was blowing to me from any of them.

The silence of the room and the silence of Wisdom of the books which were placed in front of me filled my consciousness with a calm grandeur of holiness, as though I was walking between the beating hearts that were placed in these big, visually heavy books, but all of them were only the keepers of the wonderful secrets for me, and there wasn't any place for my heart.

I kept walking further. I. and my warrantors were following me at some distance. Now I already started seeing the books of different hues: red, blue, violet ones.

All of a sudden, my look touched a big, green book that was bound in the nephrite cover, wonderfully decorated with malachite. As though a warmth blew to me from this book. I simply dashed at it, I inspected the binding and I saw the white peacock in it, which was beautifully laid out of the small white and green jewels. His eyes were red, while his train had different yellowish hues: from the brightly yellowish brilliants to the darkest topazes. The drawing reminded me of my brother's note-book which I found with Florentian in Nikolay's room in K. and which I was protecting sacredly in Florentian's travelling-bag up to now.

The warmth that was blowing from the book, which I felt from the distance, now covered all of me. I put both of my hands on the green binding, I pressed my head to the white bird, and it seemed to me that Florentian's heart covered me with his love.

I was happy. I was happy in the real sense of that word. I felt absolutely free from all conditional grips of my personality, which were still holding me strongly in their clutches on the earth up to now.

"Open the book, my friend, and read what engagements you had already taken upon yourself during the centuries that you lived up to now: the ones that you've met already disappeared from the pages of your life's book by leaving blank pages; the ones that you've once taken upon yourself and which you didn't meet are burning with fire letters on its pages; the ones that you've taken upon yourself during this incarnation now are waiting for your confirmation by love and loyalty. If you confirm them, they also will flame up with fire light, although now you can hardly see them as an old and faded ink. In this important moment of your life you can ask for your friends and your enemies. You can write those engagements here which Love that is boiling inside of you dictates to you in this moment."

I. lapsed into silence. I opened the book and I noticed that many clean sheets were turning over together, as though they were stuck together. I understood that those were the traces of my activity of centuries and of my long ago finished karmas during my past lives. I turned over some more stuck together pages and finally I found a free page on the white background of which the phrase was burning:

I will achieve absolute self-control, so that I could work next to my Teacher for a long, long, long time.

“Oh, I., I’m so guilty before Florentian and you! I’ve even forgotten that I had already given this promise and that I’m still the same man without any balance! Now I confirm my loyalty for this promise to walk my path with love and tact three times.”

As soon as I uttered these words, the record faded away, the pages turned over themselves, and the same phrase flamed up in bright fire in another place already, and the signature “Florentian” began to shine under it, as though by confirming my promise.

Several pages of the book turned over back again, and on the same page I saw like faded or merged from tears letters. I read:

Let the big, infinite heartbreak never visit my consciousness when my heart and my brain are drowning in the sea of tears and sadness. I’ve experienced the whole abyss of the human heartbreak. I comprehended it as the path that leads to my liberation. I comprehended it, accepted it and I blessed it.

Be blessed my terrible enemy who took everything what I loved and possessed from me. Be blessed! Let my tears not burden your path with heartbreak, let them burst into blossom and decorate your path with joy.

Let you walk down the path of joy and let you go out to the path of Light. I promise you never shed the tears of heartbreak anymore. If some time I’m so weak that I cannot hold them back anymore, - let it be the tears of joy, the wine of God!

I bless the day and the hour of death of everything what I loved. Let me stay alone on the Earth, free from all my personal attachments. Let my days on the Earth fly past being only the servant of each of my encountered person, of my Teacher.

Those words which I was reading and which as though emerged from the sea of blood and tears touched me so strongly that I went down on my knees and I uttered.

“If I haven’t fulfilled my pledge up to now, then let this life of mine be dedicated to the real love for my enemy, for taking care of his family if he possesses it. I want to bring harmony to him. I want to turn his heart into the blooming garden if there’s still a waste land in it.”

I stood up and I read the flamed up letters on the new page:

Your enemy is living with you. You met him as a white peacock who was brought to you to take care of, to train and to raise. You have already met your enemy’s family, too: that’s those two shrimps whom you helped to get out of the trap of evil.

Concentrate your courage, go forward, overcome by loving. When karma with his relatives is opened for a man, then the hour of his actions strikes. And if he didn’t take the karmic knot showed to him upon himself, then the possibility to undo it moved away in time from him – it drifted away like a cloud. And

again he needs to wait until the integrity of man's loyalty, his love and his unconditional obedience for his Teacher grows so much that it impels the circumstances for the new meeting of centuries.

That one who has ears will hear the call, and his cleared consciousness will help him to fulfil the indicated task for him. The eyes and the ears are covered of those who have little love and loyalty. Only the one who believes till the end overcomes.

The man is unable to see the expediency of his meetings, but everybody's life is going only according to this law – the law of great necessity.

He's walking blindfold until that time when the image of the Only One begins to shine in his heart, but in order for it to shine he needs to learn to walk with complete obedience only in the moment of his Eternity.

Due to his blindness man cannot see that moment of the righteous person's path. He can see something completely different, he draws conclusions from it, he reacts in a very sensitive way by trying only to imitate. No creation exists in imitation. Man's heart isn't living yet, so the clearing of his consciousness still doesn't descend on him, therefore he is denying due to his ignorance.

Leave all your dreams, neophyte. Act, act in every moment by creating kindness. And if your heart is without any fear – then your spiritual eyes will open, you will see and hear.

The book closed, the warmth and the light blew to me again, and everything was gone. I couldn't see the desk of the book and even those ones through which I was going up to here. I turned to look at I., surprised.

"Keep walking, my friend. I cannot help you with anything here. I've already told you: everybody here finds himself that what he's destined to find."

I marched forward; my casual look slid down to the floor, and it seemed to me that a little path from small orange flowers was laid before me. I walked down it. It was so joyful and enjoyable to see how the little flowers jumped out before me as though by showing the way to me like in a fairy-tale. I kept following them, I blessed them and I was unable to suppress the joyful laughter that was pouring out of my heart.

Suddenly the little flowers turned to the left, and I saw the little, radiating, high, orange table by the wall. I quickened my step, I felt the warmth that was flowing to me from the little table and, having come closer, I could see the big book with brocade covers, decorated with topazes on it. The beauty of its binding occupied my attention, and I didn't understand instantly that the decorations from jewels and gold formed an inscription. I read in Pali language:

My ray welcomes you.

That one who is begging receives. That one who is searching finds.

Those who are living in their personalisms don't achieve any wisdom.

Only that one who has become free is able to see clearly.

I kissed the binding respectfully and I wanted to open the book, but it opened itself, and I read:

Step into the fifth ray. Here learn to see clearly, to read without any help of your physical eyes and to hear clearly, easily without any help of temporary forms. In every temporary form read her Eternity. Glorify the day and help the consciousness of your encountered person to broaden with your given talent of the writer.

I. came up to me, stood next to me, raised his hand and held his palm above the sheet of the book, a little lower of that place where I was reading. I was looking at the book and I saw that a clear phrase was formed on the sheet below his palm:

The fifth ray – that's the one of science and technology; the ray in every developed consciousness to serve directly the mankind by technically applying her entire spiritual power.

Walk down my ray and spread the perception that comes to you through Love as an ordinary, intuitive action.

Learn to pour your opening love into your little daily work. Only that love which may be poured into everyday work and realised will be a living Love, an action of the Only One.

Not a single man, a single his action may be forgotten in the universe, because everybody who is living and creating – that's only the technical paths and application of Life that is changing its forms.

In order for you to achieve the living Truth within yourself, you need to develop your love for man. By loving man, respect him, and by seeing him as the goal of your Teacher's activity, you will achieve your unity with your Teacher, and by uniting with the Only One in your Teacher you will unite with Eternity.

I.

The letters rose from under I.'s palm, they remained in the book while he was holding his hand, and they disappeared instantly as soon as he pulled it back. Then I. closed the book, bowed to me and told me.

"Today you entered the second level of discipleship. You can see how one person is marching through the levels easily and imperceptibly, while another one is doing it with much difficulty. In my ray, in your everyday joint work you will learn to control those psychic powers which used to cause you illness up to now. Look at brother Nikita. Perhaps now you'll remember more than you did during the first moments of your meeting him."

I turned to Nikita, looked at his kind eyes and suddenly I saw the clear view from my childhood instantly when I was riding on horseback in Nikita's arms, covered with his burqa from the rain and the wind. Then I saw him and myself in some room full of the book boxes... and at the same moment I threw myself on my dear friend's neck.

"My dear uncle who doesn't talk!" I gave a shout. "I called you like this in my childhood without parting with you when you used to come on horseback, and by crying when you used to ride out.

Oh, I didn't forget anything! My brother Nikolay told me that you saved my life when I was dead already. You brought the medicine to me."

"I was only the messenger of Ali who sent the medicine to you. From this moment on tell me "you". Those who had the happiness to stand one next to another in this room may not have the conditional address "You". Our friendship – that's our joint path of activity in which the limits for our devotion don't exist. I'm your servant, your friend, your assistant everywhere you will invite me to participate."

"Nikita, I don't know which words I have to use in order to express my gratitude. I only can say that the infinite feeling of respectful gratitude is beating in my heart for your entire tenderness. No veil is left in my memory anymore, I'm standing before you again like that helpless baby whom you were taking care of so much."

"Maybe now you will recognize me, too," Zeiched-ogly took my hand and told me.

As soon as he touched me, I saw the line of houses in the miserable street instantly, I saw an eight-year-old boy who was walking down the street and a frightened, ragged shrimp who was running towards him by searching for salvation from his chasers. I understood, to be precise I felt, that that boy – that was myself. I plunged in the past completely. I even could hear the steps of the running people and I understood that the shrimp would die if I didn't save him. I seized him by the hand, I dragged him into my house next to which I was standing. As soon as the door slammed, the steps hurried past it.

I saw the hall, how carefully I was taking the saved, trembling shrimp upstairs, how I seated him in the corner of the little room and loaded him with my toys, little horses, little carts...

"Now you saw the moment of one of our past lives and you know why I'm indebted to you. Accept my help as my returned debt to you."

I. joined our hands, embraced all three of us and uttered.

"Let's go all of us to work for the sake of our brothers. Let the unconditional obedience and unshakable loyalty help Love to unite us."

We left the room, went downstairs and entered the room which I hadn't noticed before. Here I took off the clothes with which Nikita and Zeiched had dressed me, I changed into my casual clothes which everybody in the Community was wearing. My friends and I. changed their clothes, too, and we left the house.

The servant was waiting for us downstairs and he handed a letter to I. by adding that the man who brought the letter was waiting for us behind the island. When we met him, I. told him without opening the envelope.

"Well, tell Aninov that we will visit him tomorrow, not today."

He turned to me and told me joyfully.

"Well, you see, Lovushka, how well everything is getting on. Aninov has migraine. He asks me to postpone the concert for tomorrow. You wouldn't be able to listen to him today, would you?"

"I couldn't do that and I've even forgotten about it. If Ananda was playing or singing, then it would be happiness," I told him and I moved to Constantinople in my recollections, again the human voice of Ananda's violoncello was ringing to me...

My state was unusual. I was walking, I could see people, trees, clouds, the sun, I could hear the birds chirping, but all of it seemed to be unreal for me, simply I couldn't fit in the form of this life. I was still flying somewhere and I almost couldn't hear anything what was told to me. Words used to reach my ears, but they would slip unnoticed. I came to myself a little only when we went out to the bamboo undergrowth.

"Lovushka, come to yourself," I. told me by taking my arm. "Now you will go out to the park and meet Bronski who misses you very much. You cannot leave your friend without any help in this happiest day of your life. Let the bright happiness that has covered you today be also his happiness and joy. That what you were unable to see in man yesterday you will see in him today. Give a part of Love to him, which you received so generously today. Not your personal path in the universe is the most important, but you yourself as the path of Light, the path of activity and meetings of your Teachers, which extends through the universe. Pour a part of your tranquillity into the suffering Bronski's soul. Then Francisco and the shrimps are waiting for you. We all together will be going to the hospital, invite Bronski as well."

A cloud of regret obscured my soul from I.'s words anyway. It was too difficult for me to descend onto the earth from the orbit of heaven, but I understood instantly how sad my life would be if the people who gave me help weren't next to me, which didn't know any limits and refusals. Suddenly as though some steering-wheel turned within me, I felt happiness to live on the earth, to be glad to help somebody.

"I'm ready, my dear I.," I told him, but anyway I still stopped for a while before coming out of the bamboo thicket. "I'm happy that I can meet Bronski on such important day of my life and give him first the whole clearness of my spirit and my knowledge. Let our meeting be blessed, let me start and finish it in a joyous, compassionate and noble way."

I tried to concentrate my entire attention and my thoughts on my sad and suffering dear friend.

Chapter 5

The day of happiness of my new knowledge and three meetings

Having taken several steps more, we went out to the path. I saw Bronski from the distance, he was walking slowly towards us. He was walking with his hung head, and the nearer he was coming, the clearer I could see what a sadness was covering my friend.

Compassion squeezed my heart that was overfilled with love and happiness. I felt such a flow of love for him, which I had never experienced for any stranger.

I hurried towards Bronski who didn't expect to meet me here, I opened my arms widely and embraced him. Only now I noticed unexpectedly how I grew up physically. I wasn't that small dawdle Lovushka anymore who was running away from K. together with Florentian. Having embraced Bronski, the tall man, I felt that my shoulders were already as high as his, while my eyes were almost in the same height as his.

I was surprised in my thoughts when I had time to grow up and to widen so much, but without going deep into reflections I was laughing at Bronski's fright who got into my arms so unexpectedly.

"Lovushka, my dear friend," he was talking in his charming voice, "from what heaven did you fall down? I'm so happy to meet you in this hour. My God! But you really look like the one who has descended from heaven. You are shining as touched by the holy spirit!"

"Oh yes, my dear Stanislav," I answered him by laughing merrily and for the first time I called my friend without his patronymic, which I couldn't do before regardless of all his requests, but today my tongue itself reflected that love in which I was all burning and it called him as my heart told it to. "Now I've really fallen down from heaven. Several minutes ago I still didn't understand what a great happiness it was to bring heaven onto the earth and to convey to the encountered man its beauty, absorbed with my entire heart. I love you, Stanislav, in that brotherly love in this moment, which needs neither words nor explanations anymore when we want to share our friend's heartbreak and to carry it together along our difficult path of life."

"Lovushka, Lovushka, of course, something extraordinary has happened to you," Bronski was talking silently by pressing my hands to his chest and looking at me with his excellent, sad eyes. "However, whatever has happened to you, however strong your happiness in this moment would be, - wait a little with your promise to share my heartbreak. I've been solving a difficult question during several days already: whether I had the right to associate so closely with you - so closely as I wanted it. My entire life is satiated with heartbreak exactly because wherever I would show up, whomever I would come to love, with whomever I would be friends, - I always used to bring misfortunes and sorrows for everybody inevitably in the end. I've enslaved so many people with my talent in my life!.. They were trying to become acquainted with me, they were proud of my closeness and friendship - the final was always one and the same: a misfortune used to overtake them, and I only had to comfort them. I don't know whether I used to comfort them, but the date of my meeting them was always the beginning of their misfortune without exception. My solitude - that's the result of my conclusions about associating with people. I started being afraid of any intimacy. Like a Wandering Jew I started wandering around the entire world and I haven't created any happy oasis of my personal feelings anywhere. I was immersed only in the art, I gave my entire life to it without any reservations, but people gave me no rest even for such mode of my life. They - it doesn't matter whether I want it or not - come up to me through the art which I give to them. My love for the art, that for what I was living and for what I am living, I was serving and I am serving for my God and for the general welfare, makes people to draw closer to me, while I'm forced to accept them as my students and colleagues. The view was and is inevitably one and the same: if I used to give people joy and self-disclosure through the art, then inevitably I used to predestine misfortunes in their personal life for them. That started oppressing me so much that I decided to get even with my life, to go out from the earth to the

Eternity in which I believe sacredly. When I was already prepared to fulfil my decision I met that great man whose letter I brought to the same great, as it seems to me, your amazing friend I. If not this extraordinary event, I would have never met you, Lovushka. The warmth is blowing from you to me. Your youth, your exceptional talent, your living fantasy and your ability to penetrate to the actor's experiences to the bottom of your heart, your interest and your friendship which you express to me, - everything draws me to you. Now I was walking and I was solving always the same question: whether I wouldn't bring a misfortune to you? Maybe I should step back, so that the heaven's wrath wouldn't flash across your young life?"

"My dear Stanislav," I gave a merry laugh, "I assure you that the heaven's wrath wasn't waiting for my meeting with you. It was flashing across my life in every possible way. I want to contradict you. First of all, where are we now? This isn't that open stage of life full of superstitions and conditional conceptions. Here we, as well as everybody else who come to the Community, can reach the Saint Earth as much as we are able to enter it. Here we are living without any superstitions, without any conditionalities of our private life and the external contacts, dictated by it. Here everybody is creating his day as much liberated as much he already was able to control his passions. Second, you are talking about those external signs which you caused in people's lives, but the heartbreak as the herald of which you were walking wasn't only suffering. It turned into the steps for the inner development of people's spirit. If you stop estimating your and your encountered people's lives one-sidedly by seeing only the earthly plan and if you connect your and all your encountered people's consciousness also with the plan of living and creating heaven, then you'll start living in Eternity yourself and you'll start estimating the facts of other people's lives in two plans by uniting them into one, indivisible totality. By estimating your meetings in such a way, you will find the greatest Wisdom within yourself, because you are awakening the possibilities within people to enter the forever running flow which is the Eternal Movement. Today I felt the bond of the earthly man with love and care of the creating heaven with my entire being. I understood that I had to convey the work of the great brothers of the living heaven to the earth not with my ideas or high words, but that I had to penetrate to the encountered man's spirit with my entire nobility. My love for my motherland doesn't have to manifest itself with theories and pledges. Love for brother man - that's not fantasy and dreams, a meditative form of mantras and prayers, but an effective form of activity in the most common daily routine. I. was telling me about all of it, he told me that there weren't any grey days, but that there was only that what we were creating during them ourselves, however I comprehended it only with my mind, I was delighted, I felt giddy, but... my love kept silent. It was always only a charming lighthouse until there was "love for strangers", but as soon as it used to touch "my own people" it used to grow into my irritation. Today, Stanislav, my entire being was trembling in the fire of Love which the elder compassionate brothers were pouring into me without asking me what I was going to give them in exchange, but they covered me with the net of love and protection, so that I could contribute to their activity with my purity. I can feel their power within myself like a powerful fire, and while talking to you now, I'm happy, because I feel how I give their motive power of fire to you. That what forces you to suffer for love for people when you would like to give only joy to everybody, your ability to push people into the path of suffering shouldn't worry you. Stop thinking about yourself, forget that you are a herald of their temporary suffering. A misfortune as the loss of welfare in one's private life is only an illusion. Only remember that you are worker of the living heaven and that you push people into the flow of sorrows which purifies them. People wake up for their inner life and receive an opportunity to throw off the grown bumps of their egoism, so that they could go out to the path of Light. Well, that's all what I can tell you. Of course, I. will tell you much more and he will lead you to the new level of perception and activity, while my meeting with you - that's only a blessed moment. I had an honour and happiness for you first to give the pearl of my pure joy, my wonderful pearl of Love which my great friends gave to me."

I was stroking the elegant actor's hands tenderly with which he had covered his face and through which his tears were rolling down. We were standing like this when somebody's hands embraced our shoulders, and I saw Francisco who came up to us.

"I was looking for you, my dear friends."

My God! There wasn't anything special in these most ordinary words, but Francisco's face, his eyes and intonation of his voice, - everything was radiating such love, such tenderness that I understood why people called him saint. His simple words reached my heart, as if they were uttered in other circumstances: "Come to me and I will comfort you."

Having heard Francisco's voice, Bronski cast down his hands, he looked at him and, apparently for the first time he understood in the same way as I did what Love within a man was. He went down on his knees, pressed himself to Francisco, took both of his hands and burst into tears.

My heart as though turned over from this lament. I also went down on my knees next to Bronski, I embraced him, I pressed myself to Francisco and I was praying the living heaven, my friends Florentian and Ali to share the burden of the actor's suffering, to help him to pass him into the new level of the Earthly life and activity in it.

An unbearable heartbreak, his accumulated suffering was felt in Bronski's lament. Francisco was stroking the suffering man's head, he leant to him and he was smiling silently, tenderly. I stopped seeing Francisco as a man who was standing before us. I could see only Light, only Love which was shining around his entire earthly form, which became wider, which grew into the bright cloud and covered him in a circle.

"My dear brother," Francisco continued in the same voice, "your today's tears - that's the fatal boundary of your life. You were liberating your encountered people by splitting their spiritual armour with your genius of the art. You were grieving and suffering by seeing how the transitory happiness was broken. Now you will understand that their happiness that was burnt down from the flame of the match would be changed into the Light of the incombustible Fire. Now you will become the power of comfort of their rebirth. You will understand that the great path of discipleship in the presence of Eternity is equally great both for those who carry the reddish pearls of joy in their cup and for those who carry the black ones of suffering. The cup of joy only seems to be lighter, but actually it is equally difficult to carry both joy and sadness for people in a honourable and well-balanced way. Stand up, my brothers, so that I could wish Love for each of you by greeting and meeting your new life."

Francisco helped us to stand up, and I was surprised again by the power of these delicate hands. He embraced Bronski, he pulled him to himself and he was telling something straight into his ear what I couldn't hear. The actor and his entire carriage changed so much when Francisco let him go from his arms! His face was radiating, his figure became straight and powerful, an energy began to shine in his eyes, now he all seemed to me like a incarnation of the creative energy. There wasn't any single wrinkle left on his such young face now, while in the beginning of our meeting it was furrowed with wrinkles of worries.

Francisco addressed me.

"Lovushka, your brother Nikolay sends kind regards to you. He gives his note-book to you, which you are protecting so sacredly for him up to now and at which you didn't even look for a single time by protecting another's secret, which is a rare honesty. Now the records of your brother's note-book aren't any secret anymore, you'll understand everything what is written there. Also accept my present of love and joy. Hang this modest, little ring on your peacock's neck. Here's the chain for you as well."

I was so happy with Francisco's present! Not only me, but also the peacock, my eternal enemy, received congratulation of love today. No words of gratitude could express the power of joy that filled me. I felt myself on Francisco's neck by crying and laughing at the same time and by drowning in his infinite kindness.

"Lovushka, you will suffocate Francisco," I heard I.'s voice behind my back.

While I hurried to meet Bronski, I didn't even notice how and when I lost I. and my friends warrantors. And also now I didn't even take thought how and from where they appeared next to me, - all today's events seemed to me to be clear, simple, easy by itself.

I. took us to the distant part of the park where I saw a beautiful orange summerhouse. Here Francisco said good-bye to us by reminding me that in the evening I should come to him and bring Bronski with myself in order to talk to the shrimp.

It seemed that it was difficult for the actor to part with Francisco, he was holding his new friend's hand without taking his eyes off him. Francisco gave a laugh, set his hand free, took both Bronski's hands and gave them to I.

"I'm only love," he uttered, "but the technique of its application, the development of your artistic talent, your ability to help people with tact, charm and compulsory self-control you'll find by I. and Florentian. All the knowledge that you need now you'll find by I. My and his Love will help you to enter the new level of your life, but only you can find the ability to apply this knowledge.

Francisco left us and soon he disappeared behind the summerhouse, but we didn't stay alone for a long time. As soon as I had time to press the Francisco's given ring to my lips again and to imagine how wonderfully the red chain would be sparkling on the white peacock's neck, I. told me.

"Lovushka, Nataliya Vladimirovna is coming here. Meet her in the same way as Francisco has just met you. Give all the power of your compassion to her in the same way as it was given to you today. If you are able to forget about yourself and, by thinking only about her, to press her to your heart without seeing anything in her, except her Love, - then you will help her to get into that height where she needs to find the new strength to end her previous and to start her new work. It is unimportant that you are still only neophyte. The paths of the secret work of people karmas' masters still may not be revealed to you. It is important that you could give the entire purity of your joy to her, which in this moment she can imbibe only through you. Not the man who is carrying a message is important, but the message itself and love of that person who is carrying the message. Help her by forgetting about yourself in the same way as you were helped today without seeing anybody else except you."

I. took Bronski's arm and left the summerhouse. Nikita and Zeiched smiled gently to me and left with them. Very little time passed, maybe ten or fifteen minutes. But what kind of the minutes they were! I didn't feel the weight of my body. The completeness of happiness of my existence, the sweet feeling of my heart, unexperienced up to now connected me the whole surroundings, as though the sun, the light and the flowers - everything was ringing. I could hear clearly how my own note was ringing in the joint symphony of the universe. I was a part of the whole, I couldn't tell anymore where "I" began and where "I" wasn't anymore.

A light rustle was heard, and I saw Andreyeva coming to the summerhouse. As always the white knitting headscarf covered her curly hair, but unfortunately, not as always her eyes were full of the greatest sadness. That weren't those electric wheels to which I had already got accustomed. Her eyes as though were extinct, and her clumsy figure seemed to be even heavier today. As though she was walking without seeing and noticing anything. I thought that perhaps some thought was oppressing her, perhaps

she didn't have strength to solve some important question that worried her? I went to meet her, but she still couldn't see me until I took her hand in which she was holding her closed umbrella.

"Dear Nataliya," I said to her with joy which I was full of today, "I'm so happy to meet you in this moment! I don't feel any partitions between you and myself. I know what worries you and I carry the elder Ali's help for you. Dear Nataliya, don't pay attention to my ill characteristics, I'm only that ant that carries Ali's news for you."

All of a sudden I felt already familiar trembling of my entire body and I heard Ali's voice.

"Take your sister by hand and bring her to my room. There you will take the book from the second shelf of the third bookcase, which will shine in your eyes. You will give it to your sister Nataliya, and with your pure harmony and devotion you will help her to read that what she needs without fail."

I was very glad and I was surprised that Andreyeva was standing next to me without any joy, as if she hadn't heard Ali's words which he told me. I retold the received instruction to her. She gave a start, as though she had awakened suddenly. Without allowing her to come to her senses, unexpectedly I comprehended the nearest way to Ali's island and I took my dear sister Nataliya there.

I was feeling strange when I was walking down the new path which I saw for the first time. I was living in the Community for so long time already that it seemed to me that I knew the whole park perfectly, but now I was walking along the new places again.

"Where are you taking me, brother?" Andreyeva's voice was that second one: soft and tender in which tenderness and charm were ringing.

"Can't you see, my dear sister, that we are going to Ali's room on his island? Here we can see it already. Actually I'm also going here, from another side," I answered her as tenderly as only my heart was able to open for it.

"On which island?" Nataliya was surprised. "As far as I know Ali's room is in the white rock, and I didn't hear anything about the island."

We went out of the tree thicket and came up to the little bridge that was tangled by blooming lianas and overgrown with high grass. That was only a narrow, hanging foot-bridge that was swinging above the water. Having put my foot on it, I had some doubts whether my lumbering sister would cross it, I turned back to look at her and... again I almost turned into Lovushka the Catcher of Crows. Instead of her sad, strict face that was reflecting the deepest inner reflections I saw the young and joyous one, with the flow of energies gushing from her eyes...

These eyes became the electric wheels again, which I knew well, but that wasn't that usual Andreyeva's, the middle-aged woman's face anymore with strict, determined features and tightly closed lips. I saw the face of a strange youth, radiant with inner light, which could hear what I couldn't hear, which could see what I couldn't see.

Only now I understood what I. was telling me: "Everybody is able to see and to hear only that for what he's matured. The wave of the sounds of the great importance in the constantly ringing universe may be spreading through a man, but it won't begin to ring for him if the harmonious, return note doesn't exist in his heart, which could absorb the harmony of that ether wave."

Several minutes ago I could hear that what Andreyeva's harmony was unable to absorb. Now she could hear something, and that was an indubitable fact for her, but I couldn't perceive that.

The strong feeling of respect for the silent inner conversation covered me, I took Andreyeva's hand tenderly and, while going backwards, I was taking her across the narrow foot-bridge. Earlier I could withstand not only her touch, but even her nearness used to affect me very strongly, and I knew that I could fall sick from it as lady Berdran did, whom I. was still treating. But today I was holding Andreyeva's hand calmly and joyfully, and there was a wonderful thing – I couldn't get rid of an impression that I was taking a youth with myself.

We crossed the swaying and bending foot-bridge under our feet successfully, we got onto the little island, and as always the white peacock and the watchman met us. When these kind dwellers of the island greeted us, we went to Ali's house which today seemed to me so radiating, as though the golden beams were spreading from the pores of all its stones.

"Stop, traveller, stop and think for a while why you came here," I read the inscription that blocked our way like a white band. I didn't understand where this inscription appeared from, but the fact was obvious: it blocked our way with only several steps till the house left.

"I came here to fulfil my Teacher's and my friend's task," I answered to it in my thoughts. The inscription didn't make any obstacle in the physical sense, which we would have needed to overcome with difficulty, but my feet as though grew into the soil, and there was such a feeling as though an insurmountable wall had risen before us.

As soon as I finished the phrase in my thoughts, the inscription faded away. We took several steps forward, and the second inscription blocked our way:

An unconditional obedience, joy and unselfishness may go through my gates, but only purity may help the neophyte to take away that soul whom he undertook to take into the house of power.

You will have time, traveller. If there's fear within you, if you are afraid of responsibility – come back and don't take the soul entrusted to you into my house.

"My Teacher told me to do like this, and I'm going," I answered loudly, I squeezed Nataliya's hand stronger and stepped straight into the letters of the burning inscription. I thought that I would run into the hot flame, I covered Nataliya with my body, but the inscription went out, and we entered the house.

Having gone upstairs, we stopped by the door of Ali's room. I raised my eyes up and I read merrily the inscription of the white flame above the door:

Be blessed, the one who comes in. Your knowledge broadens not because of your victories against the others or the ones that exalt you, but because of your wisdom, obedience and joy which you've developed within yourself when nobody could see you doing it.

By fulfilling the duty of love for your own people, you show your love for me. And by taking your sister into my house – you are doing my work on the Earth.

I looked at Nataliya and I understood again that she couldn't see any inscription. Her face was meek and chaste. She was standing and waiting patiently until I would take her into the room, and she

didn't remind me of that Nataliya by anything anymore, whose main character feature was impatience. Usually she couldn't wait for anybody anywhere for a single moment. Now she was an incarnation of calm.

I unlocked the door, seated Nataliya at the table where I always used to learn myself, I found the book as Ali had explained to me and I gave it to her.

Not only mine, but also any other man's pen could describe that joy and happiness which were reflected on Nataliya's face when I gave the precious book to her! She opened it immediately and, having forgotten about everything, she was absorbed in it. To my great disappointment I saw an unfamiliar type in her book and somehow I comprehended that it was the ancient Hebrew language.

Having expressed my silent respect for my friend's knowledge and smiled to my own ignorance again, I left her to read in silence and went to the depth of the room.

I had never stepped into this part of the room up to now. Every time when I entered through the door I used to turn to the left and go at the table where Ali seated me by using my dear I.'s hands.

Today I tried not to disturb the great concentration of Nataliya, I turned to the right, and the space that opened up for me surprised me. Only this room alone occupied the entire first floor of the house. There were also many books here, on its right side, another writing-table was standing on which the fresh flowers were put in the wonderful white vase. I thought that probably the dumb servant brought them here. The room's chastity stunned me, because it was all made of the white marble and as though it was just washed.

I looked at the books in the glassed bookcases and I was surprised again – my eyes saw such diversity of languages! For the first time after leaving Petersburg I wanted to write. I was so anxious that I was prepared to sit down at Ali's table immediately and to start writing the diary of my life about this nearly whole year that had flown by like the wind.

I already wanted to sit down at the table, but the little, hardly noticeable door on the right, behind the bookcase attracted my attention. That was very unexpected, because I imagined that only this big room occupied the whole upper floor, but now I understood that also another one was here.

I remembered Ananda's room in Constantinople how I. prepared the second, secret room for the "prince and wise man", which nobody was allowed to enter. I thought that Ali also had the same sacred, little corner here which only he could enter and also maybe his most close friends and disciples.

I was covered with respect for the saint secret of that dear friend whom I saw blessing me by the altar in I.'s little house not so long ago. I remembered my whole meeting with elder Ali – his face, his movements, his grandeur and his inexhaustible, inexpressible tenderness with which he used to address a man even when his words were strict and earnest. This wonderful face wasn't strict even when his burning eyes seemed to be reading the depths of a man's heart.

I remembered the feast and Ali's conversation with Nal and Nikolay before it. I remembered my walk in Ali's garden, his conversation with me, how he saw off us with Florentian, how he extended his hand to me for the last time, how he embraced me and pressed me to himself tenderly.

So much time flew past since those days, so many meetings and people were in my life, while that embrace and look remained in my memory like alive, as though only now Ali had let me go from his arms.

I also remembered Ananda and sir Vomi who endured their clumsy secretary so nobly, and I. who gave such big part of his life, troubles and attention to me. As though I was turning the pages over

from my life's book of the latest months by experiencing all my meetings strongly again. Young Ali, dear captain James, Anna and Stroganoff, Joan, her children, the kind duke, the Turks, Chava, Henry, finally the horrible Bracano and Bonda...

Such gratitude for all my great guardians for their supernatural kindness, extended to me in such a simple way, such compassion and sympathy for those unfortunate persons to whom I gave the kiss of my Love, but whom I was unable to help flooded me that my heart opened for the passionate prayer. I went down on my knees imperceptibly, pressed myself to the little door and I was calling for Ali, so that my love would reach the unfortunate Bracano through Ali, so that my prayer wouldn't be only a good thought, but that I could find such actions and energy which would turn my love into an active activity for rescuing and happiness of the unfortunate people.

I was immersed in prayer and with my pure heart I was spreading the joy of my new knowledge to all the suffering people who were still in the evil only because of their ignorance, darkness and passions. Neither sadness nor hesitation were left in my prayer as before when I used to pray for the unfortunate and suffering people. I was spreading the blessing for the whole existence with my prayer. Confidence and joy to live after getting to know the Eternal Life within myself didn't have those cracks anymore through which heartbreak always used to flow into my prayers before. The question why there was so much suffering in the world didn't worry me anymore, I understood: "Everything was for good." I couldn't feel myself anymore, I all melted in my blissful address Ali; I united with him...

A tender hand touched my head – I. was standing next to me. He was smiling, he lifted me silently and told me.

"You guessed it, my friend. The "saint" Ali's room is there. Only he can take you there. I don't doubt that he would do it after finding you here. Your pious gratitude for him opened the possibility for you to enter there, but in this moment of your happiness finish your meeting with Nataliya. Finish it with joy in the same way as you started it and be happy, because you received this task."

I went to Andreyeva. My soul was shining, there wasn't any single, at least somewhat darker spot within myself, I was all full of such power of love that I felt that I could move the mountains.

Andreyeva came up to me and raised her eyes at me, and I saw irritation and impatience in them. That only made me smile, I was prepared to accept not only her irritation, but everything whatever she would pour on me, only if I could make her life easier now and connect her to my joy. My love must have passed to her. She calmed down from my look, she gave a laugh and told me.

"Well, can I reproach you and tell you everything what I was going to? Forgive me, I already read everything what I needed to know from this book, I wanted to run and write my work as soon as possible, and I couldn't understand where the door was in this whole whiteness. You left me alone here – so I started growing restless. Besides, I have a strong headache from this dazzling light that is reflected from all the walls. I will fall sick if you don't take me from here immediately."

Her suffering made me hurry, and there wasn't any time to tell her how her words and her poor health surprised me. Hence, she didn't see that I was always here. The room was lit up wonderfully, it was cool in it in comparison with the heat outside, but there wasn't any time for reflections, I took the book, placed it back in the bookcase, I gave my hand to the poor woman, because she was already turning pale and suffocating, and I took her to the island where she felt better instantly.

I accompanied her across the well familiar bridge to that part of the park where the main part of the Community was, and only here her sickly appearance changed, she became cheerful, she started breathing more evenly.

"What a pity that I didn't take Ali's pills. You would get better from them instantly, your weakness would disappear and you would be cheerful again."

"I'm just in time. It would be great if you, sister Nataliya, would take one sweet," I. told her by extending the box with very small white pills to Andreyeva.

Andreyeva took one small pill, swallowed it and gave a deep sigh.

"What is going on with your Lovushka? How do you temper him? He became a mighty man in three months, not to mention this day. Today he's simply handsome."

"And you, Nataliya, sometimes are beauty as well," I answered her merrily, "but unfortunately, namely in those moments you don't see yourself, as well as I've never seen myself like this."

"My dear, if you had strength to overcome your impatience and irritability," I. took Andreyeva's hand and he was talking to her tenderly by stroking it, "already today you could have read the words that were burning for you in Ali's room. Namely about them Ali was writing to you in his last letter. You must read them yourself, without Lovushka's help, and only then you may continue working with Ali by bringing that knowledge to the world, for which the time has come to reach people. Ali entrusted me to tell you that that part of the work in which you are stuck now is difficult for you not because you don't know something, but because it requires much higher spirituality from you. You cannot change yourself, but you can put all your kindness and love for man into that work. Think not about your activity for mankind, but about your love for Ali. Try to rejoice so much with your happiness at serving him with the pen that your thought about your personal feat wouldn't unite with your efforts. Man perceives the concept "feat" personally. There may not be any other happiness in the disciple's daily routine as only the happiness to serve his Teacher by gushing with joy. The most ordinary action of every most ordinary day – that's what discipleship is, but not the feat or that work which make man famous."

While I. was talking, Andreyeva became always calmer. Her excitement was fading, her face was growing softer, while the fiery reflections in her eyes were going out.

"Doctor I., now you've opened the new world perception for me. I'm going to work differently than up to now. It seems to me that I understood everything what you told me," she uttered, bowed to us and left home.

When we were left alone, I. told me.

"Lovushka, do you still feel that power that you felt in Ali's room?"

"Oh, yes. Today I understood that love's quantity may become any quality, any energy. Now I understand what the Power of Love is."

"Then let's go to visit lady Berdran. She has already recovered, and tomorrow I want to let her come back from our building and to communicate with everybody. Also I want you to greet her on the great day of your happiness and to give the part of your purest vibrations to her, with which the great and compassionate brothers have cleared you.

"Dear I., I'm so glad that I can visit the patient and give the part of my joy to her, which is pouring round from me today. Your presence will help me to find the necessary words and the way how to share my joy with her."

"Don't think about that how the meeting will go. Feel that Ali and Florentian are next to you, and you will do everything as needed."

We entered the house and turned straight to lady Berdran: I didn't recognize her when I saw the charming, lifegiving and young woman with the light, white dress on which looked like a beautiful blossom, and not the sad, pale beauty whom I met on the first day of my arrival to the Community.

In her turn lady greeted I. merrily, while to my bow she responded in such a way as if she bowed to a man whom she saw for the first time in her life. Even some disappointment flashed in this charming face. I gave a laugh, I thought how we still didn't know anything one about another, how this woman didn't even suspect from where and why I came, she was even sad after seeing the "stranger".

"Lady Berdran, you didn't recognize me in exactly the same way as I wouldn't have recognized you if I. hadn't warned me that he was taking me to you. If you looked like a tended orchid before, then now you are simply a naughty, resistant flower of the mountains that is growing in these peaks. However you would try to bend it – it straightens itself anyway."

"Oh, now I recognized you from the style of your talking and your laughter," the kind hostess of the room answered me by extending both of her hands to me. "But how you've changed! If I surprised you with my health and even with my naughty appearance, then I don't even know whom I could compare you to. You were a lad and now you can be a model of the hero for Beata."

I answered her laughing that I already had the orders prepared for the painter for much more worthy works by examining the American attentively with my look. The more attentively I was examining her, the clearer I comprehended what power of love I. had to possess, so that another person could recover, become hardened and change radically during such short time.

"What were you doing during that entire long time, lady Berdran?" I asked the hostess when we sat down in the balcony where I. left us by saying to us that he would visit Igor and come back soon.

"I had so many different occupations that I don't even know from where to start my story. During the first days I always wanted to keep my bed, I was so weak that I couldn't even read, but your friend didn't want to hear anything about my weakness and first of all he told me to start from the physical work. It seemed to me that they needed to nurse and to take care of me as my dear friend Nataliya Vladimirovna was trying to do, but doctor I. told the trained nurse to leave immediately, on the third day already by assuring me that the housemaid would be enough for me. I obeyed not without my inner protest and astonishment, but I didn't feel worse when I was left without any care for entire hours. After next three days he told me, the serious patient as it seemed to me back then, to get up from the bed and go to bathe. Having finished all the medical procedures, - I cannot tell you that it was funny for me to weigh and to measure the powder and the mixtures myself, which were placed on the whole table, - I tried to go downstairs. It was strange, but nothing happened to me. In this way, accompanied by my housemaid, I went up to the lake, I bathed, I came back and I felt always better. In the evening the restless doctor told me to send my housemaid to her motherland, because the climate of this part of India harmed her. That came upon me as a shock. I was used to think that I was doing my servants a favour by allowing them to serve me, that the good salary was everything what the housemaid needed. And suddenly doctor I. says to me that the servant was going here with me only from love to me, out of pity for me, that it was very difficult for her to part with her big, very friendly family and that the girl was simply becoming worse, because everything here harmed her, starting with the climate and ending with spiritual vibrations of the Community. I couldn't comprehend it in any way. I was filled with indignation. Hence, doctor I. was thinking not about me, but about some girl from the common people. But... one of his looks and the question: "And actually, why did you come here?" – shocked and made me sober. He didn't add many words, but my entire life seemed to be the continuous parasitism and the cruel egoism. It never occurred to me to ask the girl where and what kind of her family was or to imagine her illness, her joy or her heartbreak. The classical differences seemed to be a legitimate and immovable wall for me. I won't tell you in detail my entire rather

boring inner metamorphosis. In a few words, I didn't expect myself that there was so much rubbish within myself. For example, it seemed such a difficult work and test for me to put my room in order myself. I don't even talk about the tragedy when I had to wash and to iron my white dress myself. Now when my whole mode of life has already become the usual beginning of every day, I don't even notice that physical work. I'm happy, I do the ordinary, little work and, namely by doing it especially concentrated, I glorify my life, my meeting with Nataliya Vladimirovna, because I met doctor I. through her. When we prepared to come here, Andreyeva was asking for permission from somebody whom she called her Teacher Ali. She was very glad when with great difficulty she was allowed to take me with her. Perhaps, Lovushka, you know who is that Ali?" lady Berdran finished her story.

"I know Ali, but everything what I know about him I can express in several words, because that knowing of mine is very limited. Ali – that is some exceptionally big amount of love in man, which is completely liberated from any superstitions and which has become an almost infinite power. Since I can see neither the beginning nor the end of his power, then it seems to be supernatural for me and it is shining to my little spirit like a divine phenomenon. And Ali's activity is also tireless, many-sided and inconceivable for me as I.'s one. There isn't any idle moment in each of these lives."

"It is terrible," lady Berdran continued, "how much time I've spent in vain. My whole life until I met Nataliya Vladimirovna was only searching for pleasures and amusements. Only now I begin to understand that in life not only joys bought for money exist. Anyway I. has taught me to consider everybody to be a human here. Lovushka, I want to beg your pardon. I was mocking at you, at your feebleness and at your eyes like awls. Now when I look at you I remember the fairy-tale about the ugly duckling. You really became the cob, while I didn't make any movement from the same place, and it seems that I might remain Cinderella forever. Will you forgive me for the stupid mockery? I cannot live with this nightmare in my heart anymore."

"Lady Berdran, I'm happy that that innocent mockery helped us to overcome the mountain of conditionalities and to come nearer one to another in such a way that we could notice both our own and our company's human characteristics. I've brought so much pure love in my heart to you that not a single drop of insultingness may remain within you. I still know very little in my life and I've seen even less. By starting the path of his knowledge, first of all every man begins to understand how he doesn't know anything. Today I understand especially clearly, I feel especially clearly how I still don't know absolutely anything. It seems to me, as well as to you, that the huge part of our lives has flown past in vain, although I'm still only learning. Today I understood two big moments of man's life on the Earth: first, that life – that is namely the usual daily routine and work; second, that only then your meetings in your everyday life will be real when you can see not the personal man's characteristics, but his Light and Calm. Now I'm learning to see only man's Light and Calm, and to give my love to them."

"You said it so simply to me, Lovushka. I cannot understand how I haven't found any expression to my thoughts up to now. My new thoughts were turning round all of it, but I couldn't find such words for them in any way. Lovushka," the American said to me, she stood up and went up to me, "today I see you in a special way. You seem to me to be so strong, self-confident and big. As though you know something new and wonderful what gives calm and self-confidence to you. I'm not self-confident at all. While I see I., I'm living with my noble flights, but when I'm left alone, my self-confidence clears away, and I don't know again what to do, what is important in my life, and what I should aspire to."

"I would like to pass that self-confidence which I feel now to you, but still no one has ever succeeded to live with a strange experience. If you saw I.'s wisdom and energy which have fascinated you, if Ali allowed you to come here, - believe me that namely here you will find the solutions to all your

questions and that something grand will happen in your life here, what maybe nobody else will notice, but it will light up and change your entire life.”

The American became so pale and sad that she reminded me of that lady Berdran again whom I met here during my first day.

“Lovushka, if you knew what a sore spot of mine you’ve touched. My chic, rich and independent external life was the real hell. I didn’t bring any happiness for a single living being. On the contrary, everybody who used to come nearer to me became unhappy. You told me that here I could find the answers to my unsolved questions, but who can explain to me what kind of a curse is hanging above me? No one knows it, right?”

“I think that many people exist who might know it, too, lady Berdran. The physical work seemed to be impossible to you a month ago. Now the man’s spiritual sagacity seems to be impossible to you. Where can you know from what knowledge will open up for you in seven years? I repeat my question to you: do you acknowledge I.’s wisdom and knowledge, so that you could confide your life to him and you wanted to strive for your development under his guidance?”

“Oh, of course, I bow to I., but... I feel so shy next to him. I couldn’t talk to him so easily and simply for anything as I’m doing it to you. I was surprised many times how boldly you were behaving, as if you were equal to him. I experience a feeling next to him as though I was hiding in my shell.”

“I don’t know, I cannot answer you how it happened that as though I grew together with I. I met him on the very sad hour of my life. Apparently, my childish and lonely heart, the heart of that “ugly duckling” at whom you were mocking, felt an infinite love for I. immediately, his compassion, his care, and they literally saved my life many times during our rather short acquaintance. There was a total mess in my head, I wasn’t sure of anything, I even couldn’t orient neither in myself, nor in the people surrounding me, nor in events. In truth I didn’t notice that I was always bringing suffering and misfortunes for people, but the question why man had to suffer so much in the world was oppressing me so heavily that I was prepared to deny the meaning of life. I. took me out of the deadlock with his wisdom and love. His life full of work, the everyday witness of which I was, which I could see the same here, - the life full of help and calm given to people, - has taught me where I should search for strength, so that I could enter the path of Love and walk at least the first step along it. That first step – that’s self-control. It was very difficult personally for me, much more difficult than for you, and I overcame it completely differently than you did it. When you were doing terrible things according to your understanding by obeying unconditionally, but you were doing them only because “the doctor I. told you to do so”, you found self-control which already allowed you to make the first, the most difficult step along the path about which I was talking. I’m sure that your shyness before I. will pass as unnoticed as you didn’t notice your first step. That is nothing else as your pride and self-love. As soon as you develop love for man instead of your self-love, you will make the second step, that is you will ask I. to help you find knowledge. If you are searching for it sincerely, then cast away all the trifles of the conditional traditions in which you’ve grown up and start the new life.”

“Lovushka, I won’t have enough courage to ask I. Perhaps you could ask him to teach me?”

“No, lady Berdran. Such actions in life exist, which people can do only themselves for themselves. You cannot decide blindfold to which side you need to go. Only man himself can choose in his life, as well as in his spiritual matters, in which way and in which form he will be striving for his development. Every man, as well as all the components of his life, is completely different than another one. I only can give my whole selflessness and love to you, personally to you. With the power of my loyalty to my Teacher I can help you to throw down the superstition of exceptionality that is tormenting you. I can try to inspire you with a heroic strain, so that your daily routine and monotonousness wouldn’t absorb you.

But only you yourself can rise to that heroic spirit of your feelings and thoughts in which your consciousness could broaden, your love would clean out and become free, in which you could find fearlessness to ask I."

"My God, how I would like to find that power within myself! Now when I have to come back to my room again, it grieves me so much to part with this house. Although I didn't see I. often and you at all, but I knew that he and you were living here, next to me. Now as though he discovered a brother within you, who's very close and dear to me, and I'm very sad to part with you."

"Lady Berdran, why should you part with Lovushka?" I.'s voice was heard, while we had forgotten our time in our conversation and we didn't even notice when he entered. "If Lovushka is so close and dear to you, if you want, I will oblige him to teach you the Sanskrit language?" I. was smiling by looking at me and he was radiating the flows of humour with his eyes.

"Oh, doctor I., Nataliya Vladimirovna must have told you about my ignorance for languages. Even if Lovushka possessed some supernatural skills to teach languages, even then he couldn't find the way to teach me the Sanskrit language and he wouldn't have enough patience for this."

"Of course, if you think that your laziness is equal to his patience, then there will be nothing from such lessons, but if you comprehend that you need to read something in that language, for example, why you bring misfortunes for people... And you can understand it only when you can read one papyrus in the Sanskrit language – only in Sanskrit and in any other, because such is the flow of your karma. In this case, probably you will stick to such teacher like Lovushka and try to make the lessons of patience and restraint easier for him with all your strength."

I looked at I. and I didn't even understand when the sparkles of humour disappeared from his eyes and when seriousness changed his jokes. The familiar, commanding, metallic notes were heard in his voice.

I stood up, bowed to him and I answered him merrily.

"I'm happy to accept this task namely today. I will make all my efforts of love, so that lady Berdran would read her papyrus as soon as possible."

Not that already familiar vibration rippled through me, which used to tell me that now I would hear or see something from the higher levels of consciousness. Now the new sensation surged over me, as though a turning mechanism had opened between my throat and my chest, which gave me strength to see with my inner eyes and to hear with my inner ears.

I saw Ali, I saw an ancient papyrus in his hands and I heard his words: "If that man doesn't make his sacrifice of love, to whom the lord of karmas assigned it, then it will be made anyway. In that case take it upon yourself. Start and finish the task with such purity which you possess now."

The feelings that I had never experienced before seized me: the ones of complete balance, unshaken calm and simplicity with respect to the man whom I didn't know very well. I came up to lady Berdran.

"Don't think that I know the Sanskrit language well myself, but by teaching you, I will keep learning myself. As soon as I. allows me to, I will come to you and I will bring the books with me. However difficult that language would be for you to learn, it will be easier anyway than carrying the burden of ignorance every day. If it is revealed to you where you should search for an explanation for your sadness, then apparently, also the way will be showed to you how to leave its circle or how to keep carrying it without any distress."

I said good-bye to lady Berdran, and we went downstairs. The gong was inviting us to the dining-room.

"Let's go to the olive grove. Today, Lovushka, it would be difficult for you in the big company. Nikita and Zeiched are waiting for us in a shady summerhouse, close to the grotto where only the four of us will have our dinner. This day, the day of your great happiness, is also the day of your great returns. Now you've finished the first, easier part of your old karmas, but after the dinner you will take your little bird who is already hungry and who misses you, and we together with the warrantors will go to Francisco's, so that you could start extinguishing the most difficult part of your karma with your angriest enemy. I know that you always want to ask me who "the lords of karmas" are, about whom you don't know anything. I will tell you about them, and also you will find out a little about them from your brother's note-book. Take a rest in this moment, my friend, in that love that now surrounds you so generously from all sides."

As soon as I. had time to finish his words, I saw my warrantors who were coming to meet us. Having entered the shady summerhouse, decorated with the most beautiful flowers, I saw the small table, covered with a white cloth and laid modestly for four persons, and also four tabourets made of palm-tree. The cold snacks and a lot of fruit were already placed on the table.

How different all my senses now and before were! If earlier, as soon as Andreyeva used to touch me, I was the patient already, then now as though my strength kept growing, and it seemed to me that the more love I gave to others, the stronger I became. I wasn't hungry and I was eating only because I. told me to play the master at the table and to show an example for the guests.

Nikita reminded me several times of the episodes from my distant childhood. I remembered them clearly and I understood always clearer how much I was indebted to my brother Nikolay and how little I comprehended about the real human form of my brother Nikolay, whom I loved so much. I believed that he knew about my current happiness. I didn't feel any bitterness that he wasn't here with me. I had the only one desire: to give the greeting of my love, the gratitude of brother-son to him for everything what my brother-father had done for me.

"Forgive your enemy and his family completely, and by doing so, you will do a great favour of centuries for your brother and for his future family," I. told me.

"I., is really everything so strongly connected in people's lives?" I asked him.

"Oh, yes. You are only entering that path in which you begin to comprehend the high laws, while they are namely the only laws of the movement of the universe: accuracy and regularity – remember them."

The light dinner didn't last long, and we went to my room to take the little peacock who – as lady Berdran put it – was becoming the wonderful, royal bird from the ugly duckling.

Chapter 6

Francisco and the shrimps.

My new standpoint of the things and people

As soon as I had time to enter the room, I literally got into my little bird's embrace immediately. Finally today I saw not the small bird, but already the young, strong bird who was ready to become the real beauty. For the first time my white friend didn't need any help and he jumped on my shoulder himself. Having spread his wings, he embraced my head and he was rubbing his little head to my cheek. I was even confused, because I was taken by surprise so unexpectedly and I really looked foolish when my head disappeared in the peacock's feathers, while I could hear only my friends' laughter who came together with me and who saw Lovushka with the peacock instead his head.

I. was teaching the calmed down peacock to bow to every guest, for which he received his favourite sweet bread. Finally, having pecked up and drunk to satiety, he flew on my shoulder again, and we left.

I was carrying the bird on my shoulder along the still heated valley, but I already could feel his weight, so I let him go on the ground in the forest. The peacock was running next to me, which now wasn't difficult for him anymore, but today I noticed something new within him, something which I didn't notice before. It seemed to me that as though the peacock became more spiritual, as though a light was twinkling above his little head and above the places where his wings began, while the new, mysterious, almost human expression appeared in his eyes.

"How will you call your student? It is time already for him to hear his name and to habituate himself to it."

"Zeiched, I want to call him in some beautiful name already, but I'm poor inventor and I cannot think of anything."

"Well, Lovushka, there's no need to think long about the peacock's name. Call him Eternal. Then it will remind you of the eternal memory and the bond with the enemy whom you forgive with such joy now and whom you want to comfort."

"You know, I., Eternal doesn't sound very well. I'd rather call him Eta, which means "age" in Italian. My beauty Eta will remember the short name easily, while I, by uttering it, will remember how much work I have to put in order to develop my self-control, without which, apparently, I was living in that age when I encouraged the hatred of my former enemy, current Eta."

We saw Francisco close to the hospitals of the Community, who was coming towards us. Only now I remembered that I had to bring Bronski along with me. I stopped confused, even my breathing became more frequent. I was so confused that I was lost in my egoistic bliss and I forgot to visit my suffering friend.

"I., my dear guardian, I committed a crime on such great day," I uttered. "I forgot to visit Bronski. I run back immediately. I cannot even understand how I got so absent-minded."

"Don't worry, my friend," Zeiched told me gently. "I'm your warrantor who shares all your worries for the sad ones with you, while Nikita overtakes all your worries for the joyous ones from you. I will take care that Bronski not only would come, but also that he would take Nataliya, for which I received I.'s consent. Aldaz will accompany both of them here in several minutes. Today she's working at Kastanda's, and he will give this instruction to her."

"Zeiched, your care and help moved me very much, but let it be the lesson to me that I need to remember everything, to keep everything in my mind, even if the heaven was shining in my soul. I will try that it would shine, but it wouldn't cover the earth for me, that it would pour to the earth through my work."

Francisco came up to me and looked at my eyes by smiling so pleasingly as only a baby or a saint could smile.

"My friend, that isn't your egoism, that is your inexperience. It is very difficult to carry the great happiness and not to give in to the temptation to sink in it. If you knew how greatly valuable your want is that the shining heaven would pour to the earth through your work! Only that already opens the possibility for you to provide help to your enemy's family. Let's go, both shrimps are very uneasy today. Foreboding of meeting your peacock excites them. Take the bird in your arms, because I cannot guarantee you that also he won't start worrying."

I took Eta in my arms and I already wanted to continue walking, but the quick steps were heard behind us, and Aldaz, Bronski and Nataliya came out of the thick verdure of lianas.

Young Aldaz led the way easily and quickly. It didn't mean anything for Bronski to keep pace with her, but poor corpulent and heavy Nataliya could hardly move after them. Her face was sweating, but it was calm now. I even noticed a mark of meekness in her face that was so unfamiliar to me now. I couldn't even imagine this being as rebelling and protesting Nataliya.

While still holding my hand, Francisco approached and told her, as though by flooding her with his love.

"I wanted you to be here today, my dear sister. You'll see not a performance or an interesting trick, but one of the greatest acts of love and selflessness of those who sent you here. Today you'll make certain what self-control in the earthly activity is, to which Ali is leading you so persistently. You'll understand that you cannot achieve it by will. It is born from the sense of bliss and happiness to live. Four elements from the wheel of this happiness to live.

The first element which man begins to feel – that's bliss of Love. Alive love within man – that isn't his personal quality or his virtue. That is such liberation of his heart and his thoughts from all the clutches of passions that nothing within man himself is preventing him from stepping into the sensation of blissful love anymore. And no superstitions of how you are going to provide help for people are characteristic for this inner light within yourself; it doesn't matter whether you are going to bring the news of joy or sadness to them, - it is important that you will be spreading the news of liberation, of that liberation which cleans the way to bliss of love for man.

The second element that allows you to perceive yourself as the unit of the eternal activity, that's the bliss of Heart's Calm. Man's liberated consciousness gives a possibility for him to see the entire great activity of life. To see not the deplorable human law of rightness, but the eternal laws of accuracy and regularity. Having seen the laws, man sees, comprehends his own place in the activity of the universe for everybody's welfare and joy, and he feels the bliss of his Heart's Calm.

The third element that opens up the consciousness of the bright, diligent person of the earth, - that's the Joy of Harmony in everything in his universal life. His liberated eyes from which the thick veil of bodily love has fallen down, allow him to see that neither evil nor good exist – that there's only a temporary slavery for good or evil. Both these concepts may become superstitions and both of them may hold the man's spirit equally strongly with sharp hooks. Liberated man feels the bliss of Joy as the most ordinary kindness which he's spreading in his every meeting, because that isn't his quality, but only the alive spreading of his inner bliss of Joy.

The fourth element that shuts down the door to everything what is personal and that connects the wheel of blisses in which the liberated soul is living, - that's the bliss of Fearlessness.

No higher happiness for man of the earth exists as to reach such liberation and such opening of his Love that it would flow into the wheel of Harmony of these four blisses. The whole grandeur of the spirit which the man of the earth may achieve is the wheel of self-control which people call harmony. Actually that's only the beginning of harmony, its initial component parts. That is only the quality that leads to the hall of the temple where the beings are standing, who don't have any superstitions of good and evil, and where you can find out what is the light within you and how you can spread it in your encountered person's way. Every, even a little educated man comes nearer to the eternal activity. He understands that the day as the concept doesn't exist in his life anymore, that only the day of man's duty on the Earth exists. The duty not as a heroic deed, but as the simple happiness to pour an effective energy of kindness into all affairs and meetings. The man who is restrained with the heaviest armour of "good and duty" is unable to develop in the same way as the one who has become heavy from superstitions of evil. Only that person is able to enter the circle of the disciples on duty who has forgotten about himself for at least that much that he's stopped take offence, punish somebody for something, threaten somebody or be afraid of something himself, have it out with somebody or make excuses to somebody. People who are inconstant, unprincipled, weak-willed, who doubt everything are searching for something to read or to philosophize in vain by imagining that that is their entire activity and aspirations by searching for the spiritual life. Not to mention those who see only sale and purchase everywhere. Today not only those who've come to act, but also everybody who is invited to see how love, liberated from the biggest splinters of passions is operating, need to concentrate on four blisses about which I was talking. Let's go, you'll see how the highest act of compassion will be performed: the absolution of the old karma of evil."

Francisco went forward by taking Nataliya's arm and still holding me with his other hand. Everybody followed him down the path to the hospital that was right here.

"If a man's karma with another man, close or distant to him, is already showed and opened to him, then he needs to make all efforts, to give all his love and devotion instantly, which are needed for the indicated karma to end, although due to his blindness the man wasn't thinking much about that another man with whom the karma showed to him as the most important and main action of his life," Francisco continued by slowing down his steps. "If an activity next to his former enemy was showed to a man, and he missed this possibility due to his light-mindedness and his former enemy died without him, then there's no need to moan and cry, or to make excuses that it was more important, useful and necessary to be somewhere else in that moment. It seems to man like this, because he doesn't know. If it has happened like this, then you need to understand and to know that no regrets, begging and justification will help you. He stopped, while the wheel of karma which the lords of karmas drew to him with their tireless work moved away from him without stopping. No one is able to direct the flow of the river back, not only the flow of the Eternal Life. There's only one way for the man who's let the wheel of liberation go: to achieve the total loyalty and to escape the circle of his own superstitions during the last days of his life. He cannot wait and tell himself: "I'm not completely prepared yet" – this egoistic action is unable to open the perception of grandeur of Compassion. Only the man who's forgotten about himself may be prepared for the activity next to his Teacher. Now visit two unfortunate persons full of joy and bliss, and protect the bliss of Calm in your hearts," Francisco finished his speech by leading us to the room which I knew already, where Maksa was lying before.

When we entered, both shrimps were building houses from baby bricks. Having seen Francisco and Aldaz entering first, whom they knew well and loved, the shrimps didn't show any anxiety. Even on the contrary, their eyes sparkled with joy. Only when I entered, and after him I with my peacock, they jumped up, they mumbled something with their wild voices, they began to swing their hands and they frightened my poor little bird so much that I could hardly hold him by trying to inspire my calm to him with

all my strength, but Eta was trembling and he was trying to run away from the room. I. put his hand on his back and calmed him down immediately.

Both shrimps didn't find any place where they could hide from the visitors, they caught hold of Francisco by trying to find shelter in the pleats of his clothes. They were shooting glances from there, they seemed to be safe there and they were looking at everybody who entered very attentively: one of their eyes was frightened, while it was interesting for another one.

That was so comical! Although it was clear that they were frightened and suspicious, both little men concentrated all their attention so that none of our movements would slip by, because with their behaviour they had already declared us to be their enemies.

I. came up to Francisco who was stroking the terrible heads of the degenerates who were pressed to him with such love as though they were the wonderful flowers. He opened the pleats of Francisco's clothes in which the shrimps were hiding.

The wicked shrimp who was fighting so terrible on the day of his liberation and who was sobbing bitterly on I.'s chest later on, now pressed himself to him trustfully. I. took him in his arms, he calmed down completely because of this and he began to explain something to him quickly by always showing to my Eta who I was still holding in my arms and who couldn't keep still.

While stroking the dishevelled, terrible shrimp's head, I. was moving always nearer to me. Zeiched whom Eta loved very much and whom he remembered as his first master, came closer to me and, by looking tenderly at my peacock, he extended a little piece of the red cloth to him.

That rag was smelling very nasty, it wasn't very clean, it must have experienced all the ills of the weather and the sun. Eta was looking at this stinking scrap very attentively, while I recognized the fragment from the wicked shrimp's little bag in which he was keeping his poisonous, black little stones, and he handed over them and the little bag only when the fire had already covered the whole net in which he was entangled, and death already threatened him.

I looked at the shrimp in I.'s arms, because he began to shout loudly and to strain after his recognized scrap. Apparently, he was asking I. to give that dirty rag back to him, he still highly appreciated it.

I. asked Zeiched to give the rest of his wealth to the shrimp. He seized it with his hands, but Eta almost ran away from my arms, in his turn he gave a sharp scream and with unexpected strength he pulled the rag out of the shrimp's hands with his beak.

The hand of the grown-up and strong shrimp must have been stronger than the beak of still immature peacock, but the blow was so unexpected, besides Eta's anger gave him strength and he defeated him.

As soon as Eta took the scrap in his beak, he calmed down immediately and he gave his prize to Zeiched. Having put a majestically haughty pose, again he settled calmly on my shoulder, as if nothing had happened.

This quick as lightning scene surprised so much not only me alone, but also Bronski, so both of us turned into the "catchers of crows". The wicked shrimp dispersed our absent-mindedness immediately. It was impossible to depict his anger and his grimacing. Francisco with the kind shrimp came up to him, he raised his hand and held it for a while by his eyes. The wicked shrimp stopped shrieking and coiling, but he kept howling silently like an injured dog.

The kind shrimp was smiling with his entire mouth and he extended his little hands to Eta. In spite of the shrimp's friendliness, I didn't trust Eta anymore and I wanted to step aside, so that I could escape the new tricks of the peacock. This thought of mine didn't have time to become an action, I felt a strong hand-shake from the right side and I saw Nikita who approached me.

He extended his hand to the shrimp, took his little hand and stroked Eta's head with it. While examining the shrimp very attentively and absolutely calmly, he allowed him to stroke his neck and his back. It seemed that after touching the peacock the shrimp went completely mad. He was clapping his hands, smacking his cheeks and his knees, he was rocking with laughter, he embraced Nikita's neck and he jumped in his arms. Without lingering at least for a moment, he crawled over on my shoulder so quickly that I didn't have time even to orient myself and he calmed down happy next to Eta who captivated him so much. I was waiting for excesses from my jealous ward, but he kept his majestic and haughty pose, he was perched on my shoulder calmly like on the king's throne.

Francisco went up to I. and took the wicked shrimp from him. Now he behaved very strangely. He couldn't take his attentive eyes off the other shrimp, he was observing Eta and he was grumbling silently like a naughty child, now by falling silent now by howling again.

As soon as he saw that the kind shrimp settled on my shoulder and that from time to time he was stroking Eta's neck, back and even my head, he clenched his fists, threatened his friend with them and he was champing his horrible jaws, as though by wishing to tear him to pieces. It seemed to me that he wasn't so angry as he pretended to be by wishing to do some duty till the end, which he understood as the opposition to the surrounding good. Francisco was persuading him tenderly and he showed to the red scrap again, which Zeiched was still holding in his hand. I couldn't understand what Francisco was telling to the shrimp, but from Francisco's movements I decided that the shrimp had to take the rest of his terrible bag benevolently himself and to put it by the threshold. The shrimp kept silent, he wrinkled, clenched his fists, as though by preparing for a fight.

Francisco put him on the ground. I. got next to me immediately and he was in time to cover me. The wicked shrimp was trying to hit me with his head and with his fists to my belly, but he jumped on I. instead of me. Of course, the shrimp couldn't even touch him and he fell down on the floor by howling, he knocked his head strongly and his fists to the bricks of the floor.

He got furious because of his fall, he attacked me again, now from Zeiched's side. I. extended his hand before him, and the final was repeated: the shrimp was lying stretched out with his broken, bleeding nose.

He was trying to attack me from Nikita's side for the third time, but the light I.'s gesture knocked the shrimp down, and he remained lying stretched out on the floor. I thought that he was dead already.

Francisco came up to him and lifted the unfortunate shrimp. His anger exhausted him so much that he was all trembling, he could hardly stand on his feet and he had become black. My heart was bursting with compassion. With the whole power of my love I was calling for Florentian to help me to liberate the unfortunate shrimp from his eternal anger and darkness. At the same time I understood that no one could help him to do his duty, in the same way as nobody could help me to find the altar with the book of my life several hours ago, but I kept calling for the rescuer who had showed his endless compassion many times to me.

Suddenly I felt the blissful trembling of my heart, I saw the wonderful Florentian's face and I heard his voice.

"Today you can ask for anything for the people's sake. I will help you. What are you going to ask me?"

"Let me instead of the shrimp put the rest of his vicious work where I. tells him to put it," I was begging Florentian by kneeling down with both my burdens.

"You cannot touch that power of evil, because then you will take the new, still unknown to you burden upon yourself, which will press down all your possibilities for many years to share the activity on the earth with me and other compassionate friends. But calmed down shrimp and your peacock, both of them together may drag the small scrap till the threshold. It will seem to be very heavy to them, but anyway they will manage to drag it there, because it is their burden. You can only follow them, you can encourage and help them with your love, you can suggest them, so that they weren't afraid of any difficulty. While you remember one and forever: never burden yourself, don't accumulate any debts and engagements without asking your Teacher whether you have to take them or not. By thinking that you are doing the good, you may put the new yoke of evil upon yourself and the whole circle of people. And act assured and easily where your Teacher instructed you to, although everything would witness the other way round and dangers would threaten."

The image of my wonderful friend disappeared. I stood up, and without even thinking how I would explain to Eta and to the kind shrimp that they needed to take the scrap and to drag it till the threshold, I put both of them by Zeiched's feet and I showed several times to the rag and to the threshold for them.

Eta was the first who understood what they needed to do. He jumped up, seized the scrap with his beak, but as if it had weighed a pood, he let it go on the floor helplessly. Now also the shrimp understood from my persistent look that they needed to drag the rag till the threshold, what I showed to him by swinging my hands. He gave a laugh, seized the scrap and he dragged it for two little steps with much difficulty, as if the rag had always been grown to every brick of the floor.

Encouraged by me, both poor things now one after another now both together dragged the burden till the middle of the room. It seemed that both the bird and the little man didn't have the strength anymore, while only a half of the job was done.

The drops of sweat like tears were rolling down the smiling shrimp's face. The strong Eta's legs and his wings were trembling, he opened his beak, his eyes were looking at me sadly. I felt as if I had pronounced a death sentence for my friends, but I was living in the Eternity so intensively, I felt its harmony within myself and around me so much that I was encouraging my dearest for this selfless work joyfully and cheerfully. The poor things dragged the burden almost till the threshold and they could hardly stand on their feet.

I was glorifying God and all His compassionate servants who helped one being to save himself with help of the work of the big circle of visible and invisible people. Actually, the living heaven was descending on the earth and acting through the hands and hearts of the people who surrounded me now. Both the work of these beings who were dragging the rag and the activity of the great brothers who now were standing next to us touched me equally.

Francisco was holding his hand on the wicked shrimp's head. He began to come to himself little by little, and now it seemed that he wasn't as much interested in the peacock's and his friend's work as he was stunned by it. He couldn't understand in any way why it was so difficult for them to drag the scrap of his little bag, the weight of which he knew well. Anger flashed up in his eyes again, he wanted to attack and to take his treasure back, but Francisco's voice stopped him. Francisco kept speaking in the same

language which I didn't know, but to my great amazement, I understood the meaning of his words perfectly, which opened to me in some views with his every word.

I understood that my dear friend was explaining to the shrimp again that if he didn't get free from the power of his wicked and terrible masters in time voluntarily, then they would take possession of his spirit as soon as it would leave his body; that Love gave an opportunity to him for the last time to escape the terrible trap; that if others put the scrap by the threshold, then nobody's love would be able to save him from his vicious masters hands anymore.

An inexpressible horror was reflected on the unfortunate shrimp's face. He got to the rag at two bounds, he seized it easily, ran to the threshold and threw it on it. Then he came back to Francisco and he was asking him bitterly to take him in his arms, which Francisco did by smiling and stroking the hideous shrimp's head.

Now it was the time for Eta and his colleague to be amazed. In the first moment they got stiff with amazement, then there weren't any limits for their joy. The shrimp was shouting with laughter, he was rolling, embracing Eta, he was running to every one of us and showing his work done.

I. seated Eta on one of my shoulders, the kind shrimp on another one and he brought me to Francisco. Having taken the rebel who was calmed down now from Francisco, he gave him into my arms.

Zeiched and Nikita crossed their hands with my hands, Francisco put his hands on my shoulders, while I. put one of his hands on my hand, the familiar stick flashed in his another hand, and I. drew the fire circle around our entire group with its fire. While still holding his hand on my head, he went round us three times, as though by weaving the net of fire with his stick.

Then he touched every one of us, he embraced us strongly by pressing to himself and he kissed our heads. Now the shrimps turned into the ordinary, joyous children, they forgot about everything and they were admiring the peacock. Francisco left and came back very quickly by carrying something, covered with a bed-sheet.

When he took the bed-sheet off, I was surprised by seeing Maksa. In the first moment, as if he didn't see anybody else, except me and I., then his look slid off to the shrimps, and he gave a very angry cry by trembling with fear and running after Francisco.

When the shrimps and Eta heard the wild Maksa's cry, they were looking at him surprised, in the same way as if one was looking at an absolutely strange living creature, while Maksa was holding Francisco firmly, he was crying and tossing in his arms. I. touched Maksa with the stick, he gave a start, he was sobbing for a while, then he calmed down, as though he had believed in the strong protection of his guardians.

I understood that these small, my eternal enemies who were just liberated from evil once and for all had made all the wounds on Maksa's body. But I was wrong by thinking that all the tracks of the evil were already eliminated. My karma with the shrimps was finished, but their karma with Maksa still needed love and work of our great guardians.

I. went up to the threshold where Francisco brought Maksa. He raised his little stick high above his head. The fire was still burning on its end. Suddenly the fire flamed up strongly, I. touched the rag with its flame, which was placed by the threshold. The stench which I could also smell before now spread across the whole room. The dark, dense smoke was breaking outside through the door. My recollection about the wicked Jinn from "A thousand and one nights" flashed in my imagination. The smoke cleared away soon, and the air smelt of the roses and jasmines again. I didn't have time to recollect myself, and the

shrimps were already talking to Maksa calmly by showing Eta and the little bricks to him. Only now I looked at Bronski and Nataliya.

Bronski was standing straight like a soldier on guard, who was protecting a powder depot. His face didn't show any signs of life. That was a white mask with stiff, glass eyes. Nataliya on the contrary, she shrank into a little ball, she even looked lean. Her facial features became stricter, she was all drowned in tears and she was clenching her fists so strongly that it was painful to look at her.

However strongly these actions excited me, I was still glorifying Life with the same infinite note of victorious love with which I had entered here. I bowed to the grandeur of the Power and Love given to me today again.

I. touched Bronski with the stick, and he would have fallen down on the floor if Zeiched and Nikita hadn't held him. It seemed that life was coming back to him. I. went up to him again and he touched his vertex with the little stick again. Bronski all trembled again, his cheeks turned red, his eyes lit up, he took I.'s hand and pressed it to his lips.

"That what you've seen here," I. said to Bronski and embraced him, "will teach you loyalty for those actions and meetings which Life will indicate to you. Don't try to make people's external life easier. Try to penetrate into every man's spiritual world, try to clean their rough tissues there, which prevent everybody from seeing the path of their Eternal Light on the earth.

I. went up to Nataliya, he touched her forehead, chest, shoulders crosswise with the little stick and told her.

"My sister, perform the feat of your activity for people's happiness and wellbeing till the end of this body on the earth. Search for complete self-control and, before you have time to leave this body, you will enter the new, young body, so that you could learn and teach again. Always remember that you won't rest from the activity on the earth at least for a moment and that you will start the new path here again only with such spiritual development which you will have time to achieve now. Fly on the wings of your spiritual enthusiasm with lightning speed, but always keep the thought in your consciousness that every discharge of your enthusiasm which you pollute with your irritation or tear is alienating you from the possibility to pass Ali's work to the moaning earth. You've seen the circle of former robbers and murderers here, the outcome of their old karma, their received liberation. Why could this drama of centuries end? Only because the youth who was always drowned in irritation found self-control and such power of pure love which burnt down all the dirty tissues of his passions and anger in his heart, which had grown into hard, toothed lumps. The youth at whom you were mocking arrogantly, my sister, succeeded to open the gates of his heart for the enemies during this meeting. He was pouring his compassion and sympathy into them, he forgot about everything, except their misfortune. One moment of a complete devotion to the activity of your Teacher, one moment of your opened loyalty and devotion till the end may create the new harmony within you, which is needed for the new activity of your Teacher with you. Don't grieve for the shock that you have to bring to people anymore. The clearer your heart will be by seeing people's misfortunes and sorrows, the faster you will forget about your "I" which accepts these disasters with such difficulty, and the nearer you will come to the unity in work with the selfless workers of the bright community whom only you can see. It is not enough for the true disciple to hear the working word of his Teacher. He also needs to tune his entire organism in such a way that the power of his thought and the accurate transmission could flow into the fire of his Teacher's stream. Forget your tears once and for all, laugh merrily, but observe vigilantly that none of your words would be stinging when you are talking to your brother. Accept the new rule of your conduct: never say anything about your sisters and brothers when they aren't next to you, say only that what you can utter without any irritation. Every time when a condemning word is about to slip off your tongue, remember how little time you still have to live in this

body and how every missed moment destroys not only your spirit, but also everybody else's one in that moment when you meet one another. The invisible circle of your assistants and guards may not protect the spiritual path that stretches from you to your Teacher. In order for them to protect your creative, spiritual channel, your main instrument – your organism – has to keep an unshakable self-control and loyalty. Be blessed. Go loved and loving, glad and gladdening, creating and encouraging creation."

I. touched Nataliya with his little stick crosswise again, who was on the knees before him.

"Come here, my child," I. uttered, and I didn't even understand whom he addressed with these words.

From the direction of his look I understood that he was inviting Aldaz who was hiding in the most remote corner of the room. The girl blushed and she became embarrassed. Having seen her coming, all three shrimps threw down their toys and surrounded her instantly by expressing their love to her in every primitive way. Francisco helped the girl to become free from tenacious shrimps hands, he brought the little ones to another end of the room, he blocked the way with little beds and forbade them to cross that boundary.

"Aldaz," I. continued, "you want to take the pledge of virginity, you want to become a nun and to stay in the Community forever. You love children and you want to become an educator in that house where the Community gives shelter to orphans and homeless children. You see the highest deed of love only in such a way. I don't argue with you: it is the real deed to replace mother for the orphans, but even a greater deed exists. There's a deed of great love: to forget about yourself, your wants and your choice, and to fulfil that lesson and that percept of love which the whole great Life of the universe needs in this hour. Every selfless and honest worker has to hear and to understand the strike of the hour of the highest wisdom, so that he could pour his activity into the wisdom of the hour that has struck in his motherland. Only then he will fulfil, understand and give the highest value of his incarnation. Aldaz, now your motherland is suffering mostly due to disappearance of the pure, honest and kind family. All its misfortunes arise due to the collapse of this primary link of calm and harmony. Now the call of Life is sounding for you through my lips. Do you want to accept this call of Wisdom and to become wife and mother, the centre of the new people family? If you accept this deed of motherhood and education with joy, already today you will give an opportunity for three beings who have gotten into the centre of evil due to their ignorance, to end the circle of their misfortunes. Think for a while, my friend. Don't forget that you are absolutely free to decide, that nobody forces you, that you can walk down the path of your deed – to take care of strange children – and you'll be blessed no less than here. Only you won't do the lesson of the greatest love during this incarnation, which you could do, but they say about it: "Let the one who can do it do it."

"My Teacher, I don't have to make any choice!" Aldaz answered him in her tender, silver voice. "If you think that I can create such a family which my motherland needs now, then let the will of God and You be."

"Your life is happy, my obedient sister, you give only joy to those souls who will be given to you to protect, to bear and to educate," I. told her, bent down to the charming girl and embraced her. "Now go to do your work calmly. I will indicate your fiancé for you and I will explain everything to you about those souls who will be fortunate to have you as their mother."

Aldaz bowed low to I., also she bowed low to all of us and she left the room silently.

Bronski came up to me, and again I was surprised by expression of his face and his entire figure. I thought for a while that probably he appeared like this for people when he was performing the

greatest heroes: shining eyes, energy, gushing power, self-confidence, joyfulness. I was standing, stiff with unexpectedness from this change, and I come to myself only when suddenly Eta flew up on my shoulder.

“Well, Lovushka,” I heard Nikita’s laughter, “your ward not only doesn’t ask your permission anymore, but he also brought all his new friends along with himself.”

And really the shrimps also were trying to jump on my shoulders by imitating Eta and skipping in a funny way. While seeing that it won’t work like this, they were climbing one on another’s shoulders like monkeys, they were clambering on me, and Maksa was the first who got on my head. My friends helped me to become free from this siege of the shrimps, they seated all three misfortunate shrimps on their shoulders, which made them exceptionally satisfied.

We left the room and turned to the nurse Alexandra’s dining-room. Here we gave our little friends to Aldaz and nurse Alexandra. The little ones didn’t want to leave their “camels” on whom they were sitting so conveniently and haughtily, but the smell of tasty food and Aldaz’s love lured them to the table quickly, at which many different people from the hospital were sitting today.

Francisco approached Nataliya and Bronski, he offered them to enter his room, while we came back home. I. offered us to take supper again, which made us all very happy.

My supper was more modest than the dinner, only the greens and the fruit. Although I always had a good appetite, this time I didn’t want to eat and I didn’t even notice what my friends put in their plates.

Contrary to the chaos that used to seize me before when I had to experience many different impressions, now all my thoughts were accurate, clear and they lined up easily into the ranks of harmonious views and recollections.

My dear warrantors rose from the table, they embraced me strongly, bowed to me, and Nikita told me on behalf of both of them.

“Let this day be blessed, with which you’ve started the new period of your life, our friend and brother Lovushka. Now never feel alone. You and your Lord – the two of you are always together. You and your great Teachers – the four of you are always together. You and your obedient warrantors – the three of you are always together. Besides, your eyes have opened up, today you saw an uncountable lot of the workers of the living heaven. Don’t divide the time into day and night anymore. Value only the moment of the eternal happiness – your duty next to your Teacher. Learn to live by working with him, that is to live in unity with all the workers of heaven and earth. We are your servants and assistants in all your matters and meetings to which you will want to invite us. It is a great happiness for those who could meet by the gates of Eternity and to know friendship and loyal devotion here, while still living on the Earth.”

Both my friends left. Me and I. came back home. I. embraced me by my room and he reminded me that my brother’s note-book was waiting for me.

Chapter 7

My brother's note-book

Awakened Eta met me affectionately and passionately when I entered the room. I still was unable to concentrate my thoughts for a long time, because I was so overfilled with the energies of joy. Finally my elated state turned into glorification of Life, I felt that great tranquillity, that harmony and light within myself with which I left the little orange house after reading the green book of my life.

I pressed to my dear friend Florentian in my thoughts, I asked him to help me to understand everything what my kind, dear brother wrote in his note-book and not to sully his sanctity, to be able to share those joys and suffering of the path of my brother Nikolay, about which I will have to read.

I kissed Eta tenderly, whose eyes were closing comically, although he was pretending that he wasn't sleeping and he was shaking his head when he noticed that I saw how he wanted to sleep. I put him to his couch and I pulled my brother's note-book out.

Now when I took it from the case, it surprised me with its appearance even more than during those two times when I was holding it in my hands. First time when Florentian gave it to me in my brother's room in K., it surprised me as the miracle of a jewelry work. Second time in the carriage, when I was placing the things which young Ali had sent to me, it already was a living secret to me, a segment of my brother-father's life, which I didn't consider myself to be worthy to touch.

Now when I was holding it in my hands for the third time, as though I was stunned threefold both for its unusual external beauty and for the light of the heights that opened up for my brother and for the unexpected courage that I felt within myself by preparing myself to read the secrets written by my brother.

I took the wonderful little peacock-shaped key and, having tried a little, I found a little lock that was fitted on the side, in one of the figures of the little white peacocks. This figure moved, and I saw the lock under it.

All of it took quite a lot of time, but I didn't recognize myself! I would have been trembling from my weakness, irritation and impatience several months ago, I would have thrown both the note-book and the case, and I would have poured my whole anger with tears and tramp of my feet. Now the more complicated the task seemed to be to me, the more complicated the mechanism of the lock was, the more delighted I was with the master who managed to fit it in like this, so that one couldn't see any signs of its complexity anywhere. I was laughing with joy when finally I grasped all the secrets of the lock. Now the note-book was opened, and I saw such dear handwriting of my only one relative in the entire world.

I was so surprised when I saw that it wasn't my native Russian language which I expected: page after page the whole note-book was written in Pali language.

I felt shyness and lack of self-confidence. I still didn't know this language very well and I thought that probably I wouldn't understand anything again, that I would be the servant who only cleaned the dust from expensive books, but this lack of my self-confidence lasted only for a moment. Florentian's, I.'s and my brother's images floated before my eyes like the great assistants, and courage flared up in my spirit again.

GLORY FOR THOSE WHO HAVE BROUGHT ME TO THIS

GREAT MOMENT OF MY LIFE.

GLORY FOR THOSE WHO WILL REACH IT AS I DID.

Such was the title on the first page. There was neither the date nor the location where it was written here. I kept reading:

"I was born today, although I'm twenty-four already. If somebody asked me now how old I was, I would answer him: a year and seven months. The fog obscured everything what was in my life up to

now. Everything was only the introduction into my life, while I understood Life only when I was born for the second time, a year and seven months ago.

I ask myself: and what especial has happened? As if nothing. Having lost my way in the mountains, I met a mountaineer and I stayed in his secluded dwelling to wait for the suddenly enraged storm to pass off.

It was an episode which everybody's life is full of. An episode which I had a thousand times and which I will probably still have a lot during my nomadic life.

Only this time the birth of the man began not from the meeting with the host of the cottage, but with his guest.

An Indian was sitting before me when I woke up in the night.

What can I tell about him? His eyes were burning through, one could call them the smouldering coals. This stranger horrified my heart which hadn't known any fear up to now, my whole body was nearly paralysed.

I couldn't move any of my joint. I didn't have any strength to shout. I couldn't answer myself who was sitting before me: a God, a devil or a result of my own fantasy.

The silence of this unusual being lasted only for a moment which turned into eternity for me, for a moment which stopped the beating of my heart and the rhythm of my breathing. I was growing weaker and I comprehended that I was dying from the light that was oppressing me.

All of a sudden, the stranger gave a smile, he lifted his hand with its palm towards me, and as though the power of the raging blizzard behind the window was pouring into me. The stranger's face, lit up by his smile, seemed to be like the God's face, and I couldn't comprehend why I considered the power that was oppressing me in the beginning to be devilish.

The power kept pouring from his look and from his big, perfectly shaped hand to me, which was shaking my whole body from head to foot. This power was piercing me like electric currents.

It seemed to me that I was all covered with a flame, my heart was broadening with joy. This joy was rising to my throat, it filled in my whole brain, and I thought that now, in this moment I would fly out, covered with ecstasy of happiness which I hadn't experienced up to now.

"My son," I heard the stranger's voice. "You are searching for knowledge. You crave for the answers that torment you: whether God exists? Who is He? Where is He? How did those reached Him, who were writing and talking about Him?"

In this moment you are in God, and God is in you. Now the entire universe has opened to you not because you've reached the top of your knowledge, but because your heart's purity, your life's purity in the ordinary actions of your everyday life helped you to accumulate joy of the divine power and to unite with it.

I a man doesn't live only by being lazy and by trying to call it meditation; if he's trying to pour his ordinary kindness into all his matters and meetings; if he's prepared to absorb the tears and sorrows of his encountered person; if he was able to develop his loyalty till the end somewhere; if his searching for God wasn't the desire of his personal development, but it gave a selfless activity, calm and rest to people – then the man has entered that level of his spiritual maturity when we, Indians say: "If the disciple is ready – then his Teacher is ready as well."

Today I've come to you not specially, but I responded to your constant call. Why could I approach you and why didn't my power burn you down? Because your heart is pure. And the flame that I have awakened within you now, - that's your own flame. It didn't burn your body down, it didn't bring your spirit beyond the limits of the earth, but it hardened all your consciousness for clearness and power.

Every moment of one's earthly life that flies past isn't a usual, everyday life of one's body and spirit, merged into one earthly form. That is the moment of Eternal Movement that is poured into every form of the earth as the little part of creation. And therefore, no other way of man's liberation exists as only the daily routine of his activity wherever he would be living.

If people are engaged only in meditation, if the power of their mind and heart is plunged only in searching of their personal development - then the path of the Eternal Movement is closed for them, because a possibility to live only one's personal life without joining the worldwide flow doesn't exist in life of the universe.

Man's consciousness is unable to rise if his heart is silent, and if he cannot see the same God in another being, whom he got to know within himself.

Your critical look at the person who came to you will remain an obstacle that is stronger than any metallic wall between you and him, although before he came to you, you experienced the most passionate flight of your searching for the path to the Truth.

Only when you understand that with your every encountered person the Truth itself came to open your own barriers for you, behind the walls of which you keep tied up bags with your love and the untied ones with your superstitions, - only then you will be able to come nearer to the second truth that became our nation's proverb: "No one is your friend, no one is your brother, but every man is great Teacher for you."

As much as you comprehended your lesson by associating with your encountered man, as much as you got irritated, condemned, told a lie, dissembled and weren't kindly disposed to him, - so much you showed to yourself your poverty and lack of love.

The more ordinary you were, the easier you were communicating with him, the kinder you were, - the more you forgot about yourself, the more important the interests of your encountered person were for you. And your meeting was effective, it absorbed the entire complexes of the atoms of benevolence from those invisible industrious persons who are always hurrying to the earth by searching for those whom they could give the work of their love.

No such path to man's development without activity exists on the Earth, which unites him with all the people who surround him. You cannot isolate yourself from any of the living beings who cross the orbit of your movement on the earth.

If you flew into a temper during your meeting - you opened "the jaws" for the bags of your superstitions which were untied anyway. And with yourself during all the work of that day you drew closer petty villains, spiritual vampires and debauchees to yourself to collaborate with you, who are searching greedily to whom to stick to in order to suppress thirst and hunger of their uncontrollable passions that don't die with one's body. The most painful path - that's the one of those who deny. Their eternal karma is accumulating again and again with the new bumps on their already horrible spiritual body.

Now when your state has become bright, the clearer life of the entire universe is for you, the pulse of which you can feel beating in your heart passionately, evenly and strongly, - the clearer is for you

also the path of love through the activity of the daily routine to that Life that is operating Itself everywhere and in everybody.

You had only one task up to now: to find yourself and to understand yourself. Now your task has become more difficult: not you yourself must find and understand, but you must become a servant for a great circle of people, so that you could awaken their consciousness, their activity, strength and aspiration to work for the general prosperity.

You love your motherland. Every day, as soon as you hear the signal of danger, you are ready to fight against its enemies without any fear, but that is not enough. You can see the sluggish crowds for which the word "motherland" is an empty sound. You can see hundreds and thousands who try to deceive their government's vigilance and to avoid the military service at any occasion. You can see cowards and idlers everywhere who pretend to be patients, if only dangers fell to another person's lot, while they could choose a better destiny.

Can you go past them calmly? Can you not awaken them? Is it necessary to go down to the hell, so that you could liberate the dark beings there? Crowds of lost people are swarming around you. They think that they are living with love and truth by spending the entire days in vain, by enjoying the happiness of their personal life and by glorifying their own God.

They understood God and his prophets in their own way, and they consider themselves to be farsighted people, favourites of fate, because they have stuck to a certain church or religion, and they glorify it. Only their glorification is inactive, it becomes any power neither for their motherland nor for their encountered man. It exhausts themselves by causing little ecstasies of delusive spectacles and prophecies for them. Don't allow them to hide calmly: find a thousand of reasons for them to work and act, take them out of their lazy happiness.

In your other meetings you will encounter a high spirit that is chained in the degenerate form of haughtiness and self-love. Show an example of ordinary and tender love, prove with your everyday work that nobody needs a man's knowledge if it is given from high and by bringing oneself to do it.

Even more often you will encounter a person who denies, who rails at his motherland for the disorder that is hanging there, for its vices and so on. Such people – always, without any exceptions – are mostly ill with their self-love. There's the same dirt, stench and disorder in their homes as in their entangled thoughts and desires. Their appearance, the manner of their actions and thoughts isn't aesthetical, as well as their manner to dress, to sit, to talk, to sleep. The more difficult task as to come out of their blind negation doesn't exist for them.

In this case find out carefully whom of them you could touch with your sacred love and sincerity, and when you should go past them by sending a blessing to their dark path which they have turned into such themselves.

Every dark path starts with negation. The fighter for the new development of evolution sees his motherland's suffering and he spreads his belief in the better tomorrow in the world by symbolizing the general prosperity with his flag of fight. He's prepared for his fight resolutely, his call tears thousands of consciousnesses out of despair and stagnation of death. He's illuminated by the liberated call of Life within himself and he is calling his brothers to the light and freedom. His path is bright, he illuminates the paths of his encountered people, too. He is working by always seeing millions of people before him, who are enslaved by their passions and who are unhappy.

If he becomes the leader of his nation, then the power of divine love illuminates him by helping him to carry the entire many-millioned nation to the light and glory on his shoulders. Such leader is

living by encompassing millions of his nation's hearts with his consciousness. He goes through both joy and pain with every member of his nation. He takes his nation where the Wisdom of the struck hour indicates him.

The dark occupants of power create staff from the people who deny for themselves, they establish their own – separate from the nation – happiness and welfare, they enslave the whole nation.

The leader of the dark powers doesn't call the nation to freedom by striving for power. He throws a bone of petty property to it, he is searching for possibilities to enslave it by thrusting a desire for it to profit by class superstitions, so that it would be easier for him to force his way through to the worldwide ruling.

Go past such people by finding out thoroughly whether your help for them will be well-timed and useful. You can spend much power of your love and sincerity yourself; you can deaden your mind, joy, energies and not achieve anything.

If the people who deny get into the zone of misfortunes, they will come to you themselves. They will accept your help and they will crawl away like satiated leeches, so that they could grow the fat on their body and spirit again as soon as you help them to cross the period of their temporary misfortunes safely.

The true sincerity of the man who has stepped on the path of comprehension of light and calm within himself must manifest itself in a vigilant identification where, when and how he should carry the treasure of his spirit.

It is absolutely meaningless to devote yourself to the religious glorification of your God in your life. If you still haven't reached the comprehension that the Only One God is for everybody and that all the paths lead to Him, the Only One – then your religious life failed. The man has become entangled in his virtues exactly in the same way as the man who denies in his evil. Not a single spiritual comprehension rose above wrongs, explanations, personal dramas, self-love and lashing with pride.

No stops may exist on the path which you are searching for. The power that is driving the universe gives man a possibility to work, work and work by becoming free within him. Sometimes a sickly man – a straw with his physical data – is pulling the sledge for many years with such load for the general prosperity that it is terrible for the one who's looking at him from the distance. Only for himself his life seems to be simple and easy, because he cannot see the meaning of life on the earth at all without becoming involved in his nation's activity.

Little by little the opening man's consciousness throws down the armour of superstitions. First of all the small brilliance of trifle falls down from consciousness of the brightened man – all the punishments and awards, conditional appreciations "for virtues" which he understands as a refusal of something by force by sacrificing himself for another person. He begins to understand the whole grandeur of Life. He starts feeling joy to live by working for another person. He is annoyed if today nobody needed him. If he's going through life with harmony and calm, then the concept "to be needed for somebody" becomes the imperceptible rhythm of his day – like the rhythm of his breathing.

Live your every day as the last one, but the last one not because of the greedy satisfaction of your desires and haste, or because of your spiritual strain, but the last one because of the activity and its unselfish harmony.

You are carrying the question in your heart: where is the personal "I" and where is "not I"? This difference doesn't exist for you anymore from your birth for the Only One Life. Everything with whom

you associate is only the path to Grandeur through the temporary form for you. For you an executioner, a victim and the death penalty – is always the same Only One Life, the part of which you are yourself and which you can see everywhere around you.

Live your every day calmly and honourably. Protect your chastity and purity, and you will be living among those who felt to be the part of the Only One Life, the part of the entire universe earlier than you did.

Your path – that's the path of serving God within man. Your activity – that's the path of knowledge which you apply in your everyday activity with love.

Suddenly I felt that the power, that gigantic power that was just pouring into me disappeared. The place where the stranger was sitting was empty."

The first my brother Nikolay's record ended like this. I went to bed when dawn was already coming, and my friend Eta woke me up in time, so that I could still catch up with I. on his way to the lake.

The records which I was reading during the entire night moved me so much that as soon as I greeted I. I blurted him out immediately.

"I was so surprised that my brother Nikolay could understand everything what Ali was telling him during their first meeting without any strange help and guidance."

"Why do you think that that was Ali?"

"Because the eyes described in the note-book may be only his, while the sensation that somebody is squeezing and oppressing you when you are next to Ali is so characteristic to him that you cannot confuse him with anybody else. Namely the light that is spreading from him dazzles and oppresses. And that feeling which I know so well changes instantly as soon as Ali smiles or touches you. Then his oppressing power drifts away somewhere, and bliss fills your heart. Neither next to you, my dear compassionate Teacher, nor next to Florentian, nor next to sir Vomi I could ever feel that power that shook the entire organism. That's why I recognized Ali from my brother's words instantly. It is enough to see him once, so that you could recognize him everywhere forever."

"Maybe you are right by feeling so well the exceptional Ali's power that is impossible for anybody else, but anyway during all those years here when you become strong disciple from neophyte, you will need to acquire such level of self-control that Ali's power wouldn't oppress your spirit, but open it for activity and fight. You see, Lovushka, that everybody who is living on the earth, everybody is fighting, but that person who understands his path on the earth as the greatest value, that one is fighting and working by forgetting about himself completely. In order for you to liberate your consciousness like this, you need to distinguish in lives that surround you every day: where man went past his "now" by uniting with people with his love and where he criticized them and remained ineffective. Understand, my friend, that many people "understand" high ideals, they accept religion and its requirements, but the only one real religion – that's the heart's love. Religion – that's not what man "knows and accepts", but that what he's able to apply for his work in his actions of the day."

An encounter interrupted our conversation, which reminded me of the first day when we came to the Community: we met Andreyeva and lady Berdran. But how different both friends were now! Lady Berdran's cheeks were flowering like roses, she was joyful and mischievous – the real beauty. Nataliya

Vladimirovna was rolling her imperious eyes like before, but she all became as wax. Not only her paleness prompted this comparison to me: she was smelling of softness and tenderness. Her well-wishing irony with which she used to meet me before turned into tenderness. Her voice was like mother's when she answered to my greeting and it caused a reciprocal wave of love and gratitude in my heart.

"My wonderful count, I'm very grateful student of yours. Till now I was thinking that the ranks and levels separated people. I used to accept everybody first by estimating his knowledge in that path after which I was straining myself. Having received the lesson of great obedience through you, I began to see the real knowledge clearly, which now is the most important and effective to me: the spirit, while striving for knowledge, has to open the bag of its love and to tie up strongly the bag of superstitions. Through my meeting with you I understood how many doubts were still within myself. I saw a tremendous lot of conditionalities within myself, which prevented me from communicating freely with people. Now it became easier for me, because I began to see things clearly and I saw where and what kind of the bolts of the greatest superstitions were hindering myself."

The words that she uttered now, namely the same ones which I had just read in my brother Nikolay's note-book surprised me mostly.

"Do really all people have to pass the same stages of their spiritual development?" I gave a shout imperceptibly, standing in the middle of the road.

"I don't know whether everybody passes the same stages," Nataliya Vladimirovna answered me, "but I don't doubt that I've found the strengthening spring within you and I thank you very much."

I, who came to us heard these words of hers, who was talking to lady Berdran up to now. He said to Andreyeva tenderly.

"My dear Nataliya Vladimirovna, the Truth that is living within you is liberated already. It is gushing from you like the purest fountain. The dense veil is covering only those conditionalities which one connected with the structure of the people's society and the hierarchy of the entire universe. You possess greatly developed spiritual power and, whether you want it or not, you are marching stronger and further in the spiritual world than on the earth. From here your certain external arrogance with respect to those people arise, who don't understand much that only the earthly path doesn't exist, or to whom it seems that they can achieve the knowledge with some gropingly learnt yoga exercises. The lessons of late – both with lady Berdran and with Lovushka – helped you to throw down the veils of sympathy or antipathy that oppressed your physical eyes, helped you to comprehend the personal helplessness to affect a man. You've learnt to reveal the joint value of the meetings as the whole creation of Life. Now no one is able to prevent you anymore from fulfilling the mission given to you by Ali. Soon you'll leave for America and Europe, you will leave a part of your work there and you will come here again to acquire strength, so that you could give the language of the ringing silence to people again. It was very strange for you to cover the difficult stage of your spiritual path with the youth's help. You were rebelling and you were prepared to deny the possibility to move forward with help of those who are "lower" than you. Now you felt clearly that nobody is "lower" or "higher". Neither the good nor the evil exist. Only that place in the universe exists for every man, to which he can step depending on the degree of his Love liberation within himself. It isn't important whether the man is literate or not, harmony is ringing within him with such power that none of his strength, even the strongest one, kills his encountered person, but only gives cheerfulness to everybody who comes to him. From this day on the activity of your psychic power won't be hindering anybody to live anymore. You've succeeded to set them in order in such a way that the power of your tact would open the possibility for you to become help for your own people who are next to you. Up to now you could serve only to the distant people by giving the knowledge to them, dictated by your Teacher to you. By pouring your heart's love, now you will open the stability of your encountered people with your harmony."

We said good-bye to our friends. After the breakfast I. took me to improving Igor whom I hadn't seen from the beginning of his illness. Igor was sitting in the balcony. Bronski, Alver and some other friends were next to him. Igor didn't recognize me. He was so surprised by the change that had happened within me that he told I.

"I always believed in your exceptional faculties, doctor I., and I have tried their effect upon myself, but that man could do miracles, I considered it to be the prerogative from the fairy-tales of the Persian life."

"Igor, if you can see such stunning change within myself, then what should I think about you? Not even I could recognize you, but I couldn't even believe that you could change so much during such short time."

In the beginning of our acquaintance Igor was a pale youth. Now he reminded me of Andreyeva. The black eyes in his sunburnt face were turning with such energy that unwillingly I remembered Nataliya Vladimirovna. His voice was strong, his movements were quick and masterful.

"I'm very glad that you were such obedient patient," I. told merrily and he put his hand on Igor's shoulder. "I understand how difficult it was for you to obey and not to leave the room when you were feeling completely healthy for several days already. Therefore, today you will be able to withstand a long walk. I invite everybody present here to the park. We'll find the gardener there, we'll arm ourselves with spades and we'll plant some sprouts of eucalyptus and cinchona for the future undergrowth. I've promised to take you to the distant Communities. Therefore, Zeiched will be teaching you every day to ride on camels. It doesn't matter whether you can ride the camel already or not – everybody needs to learn to control the camel perfectly, otherwise we won't be able to ride across the desert. I warn you that the journey won't be from the easiest ones."

"Are you really going to leave me by saying that I haven't yet recovered enough?" Igor began to bustle.

"I won't leave you, if you keep obeying the routine," I. gave a laugh.

"Marvellous! Namely today I was prepared to protest, while you as though read that what was in my thoughts already. Of course, doctor I., now I will be as meek as a lamb and as obedient as a domestic pigeon."

We left for the park and soon we set to great work. While we were working, we heard I.'s lecture about botany. Igor who was told to sit in the shade calmly joined the conversation and he surprised me with his botany and geology knowledge. Once again being terrified with my ignorance, I shouted out unwittingly.

"Igor, when did you have time to become a scientist? You gave your entire life to the theatre, didn't you?"

"I gave my soul to the theatre and people, but I didn't seal my brain. I was trying to penetrate into the highest life's wisdom and into the wisdom of our mute brothers of the earth – plants and animals. I don't know whether I've achieved much."

His answer stunned me. How little I was going into the surrounding nature myself. I could comprehend only man, and could I really do it?

We were planting the sprouts till dinner. Later I went to learn to Ali's room and as usually I forgot about the time, the place and my everyday duties. My compassionate Teacher I. visited me and after tea we went to the distant valley to learn to ride on the camels.

We were laughing much from our clumsiness, I showed myself in an especially stupid way, I couldn't keep the small saddle in any way, while I. was sitting as glued to it.

Nikita came to help me, and anyway I didn't overcome my first lesson. I could keep neither quick nor slow camel's pace, I always used to roll down – luckily successfully. The rational animal used to stop patiently, although he could tread on me several times.

Bronski outran all of us, and I was reproaching him jokingly that he kept a secret from us that he could ride, while he was persuading me absolutely seriously that he was sitting on the camel the only time when he was hurrying to the Community, and that I only needed to imagine myself to be an Arab and then I would scuttle by sitting correctly and by controlling the camel. Apparently, the great talent of this man helped him this time as well.

After the riding lesson that exhausted everybody so much we went to bathe, then to have our supper and to listen to Aninov's music in the evening.

On our way to the concert I remembered clearly Constantinople, Anna, her music and the divinely human voice of Ananda's violonchello. I could feel some confusion in my soul. I couldn't imagine that somebody could play better than Anna and Ananda. I was afraid that I wouldn't be able to remain as polite as I. was teaching me, that I wouldn't show my irritation for the man, the artist whose life was filled only by the music.

"Are you going there to compare talents? You go there to greet the man's path. You go there to find those high love characteristics within yourself, which could bring an inspiration for another person. Love the same Power within him, within his path, which is driving the universe, and it doesn't have to worry you in which level of development that Power has stopped within man now. It has to awaken the energy of your joy and to help to carry the greeting for man. Throw the ring into his temple as I was teaching you many times already, and don't criticize what kind of the temple it is, according to your understanding."

Late in the evening when I came back, I opened my brother's note-book again and I began to read the second record.

"The thoughts from my yesterday's words don't calm within you. You don't perceive how you could greet the Truth with your every meeting, who's come to you in some temporary form. Many of your meetings are disgusting for you. Also the constant drinking-bouts, cards, arguments and petty interests of your neighbours are disgusting for you.

But you haven't condemned them a single time. On the contrary, you succeeded to be so impartial for every one of them that all the soldiers and officers came to you with all their questions, they chose you as the judge of honour and they expected help from you when a misfortune befell on them.

Everybody, even the most ardent fighters, who were trying to insult or to frighten you in the beginning used to calm down after trying to challenge you for a personal argument. Your courage used to take any pretext from them to quarrel, while the power of your love for man used to force every one of them to respect you and your home. Some of them used to leave by understanding that they had acquired a friend, while others were surprised that nobody wanted to repeat an impudent prank.

Now refuse your understanding that love and God – that's only beauty. The worst what you can imagine is nothing else as the same love, only it is directed badly within man.

A thief's love for gold – that's the same love, only it is oppressed by the weight of his greediness and superstitions of possession. A husband's love for his wife, a mother's love for her children – that's the same love, only it doesn't possess any strength to untie the tight bonds of love and to see God within man beyond the limit of personal superstition "my" family.

After your consciousness expands, pass to another substance of comprehension of the living, temporary human forms that surround you. Read in them your lesson of the day during your every meeting. Understand one task: that person who came to you is the main and the most important of your business. That is exactly that your "now", it is the most important, give the whole completeness of your strength and feelings to it and don't keep the smallest parts of your spirit and mind for the future course.

While walking through your day, spread unselfishness for all your affairs, calm and rest for those who are working next to you. You are living in a chaste way, so remain like this. Only if you think that chastity by itself as an independent power may lead a man to the great path of his life – you are wrong. It is only one of many component parts of man's spiritual life that is leading him to harmony and liberation, but it doesn't possess any value by itself.

If man is full of superstitions of alienation, his entire possessed chastity won't move him from one place, although he will be trying to develop. And on the contrary, if man is searching for a contact with his Teacher and if he doesn't possess any strength to enter the path of chastity, then all his trials to enter the high spiritual union with his Teacher will be only impure trials that will always threaten to fling him down into the chaotic vortices of the astral plan.

Don't think about the future. Accept the given task "now" and the lesson of your chastity as the necessary link of your self-control today that is leading you to harmony.

There isn't anything unchangeable on a disciple's path, everything is flowing and changing, everything has only one dependency: the development of the disciple's creative powers lead him to perfection in which his self-control and harmony – that's the primary foundation.

They form the disciple's loyalty for his Teacher, they grow the equilibrium of his spiritual powers, but I repeat again, they are changing, because nothing lifeless in the earth and the heaven exists. The powers of spirit are moving within man and they lead him to fearlessness.

All the thoughts that gave joy to you have built the bridge from you to me. If your heart had kept silent and only your sound mind had been guiding you on the earth, then you couldn't have reached this moment when you can see me before yourself.

From now on all your meetings have only one meaning: to read your own lesson, to comprehend what prevented you to begin and to end your meeting with joy.

The disciple cannot form his character in the same way as an ordinary man is doing it. Man is searching for his greatest external happiness, while the disciple is searching for the greatest thoughts within himself, so that he could fill those hearts with them, who are associating with him at the current moment.

The outbursts of energies of man's brain centres aren't connected with his spiritual path and they don't lead him to any development. He only opens the path to the clearing of his consciousness and inspired creation, but they aren't the engine of spirit themselves.

That's why not very literate people may be wise men and prove to be higher than millions of scientists who comprehend only that what could be proved in a geometrical, physiological and other physical ways. However, where we are talking about the spirit's matter, that is about intuition, heart is talking there. That's why, from now on don't search for any answers to your questions in books.

Read the book of your life, live according to the Gospel of your working day and you will reach all the experiences of the world's yogis in your own – impossible for others – way.”

Imperceptibly I broke away from the note-book, and my thoughts came back to today's experiences. Again I saw those people before me whom I had to meet today. Their faces and words used to emerge like in the screen, and I understood perfectly how little the real disciple I was today.

With what kind of excellent thoughts was I filling the universe today? I remembered the evening at Aninov's very clearly. The musician met us with desire to play. His eyes were looking at us, but his look was sliding across our faces without distinguishing to whom he was extending to greet his beautiful, but so big hand that my palm was lost in it.

I was feeling very strangely in Aninov's sitting-room. I was observing every external detail, every musician's movement: how he went up to the great piano, how he lifted its lid, how he adjusted his European tail-coat by sitting on the chair, how he heightened the chair to his needed height, how he put his hands on the keys, as though he fell to thinking and forgot about all of us.

Anna and Ananda used to force me to forget about everything, except their faces which seemed to be supernatural for me. This time the musician's face seemed to be unattractive for me, although I had to admit that it was peculiar and original: the face of ascetic, strong, strict, gone deep, without any presumption for equality between himself and the people surrounding him.

I looked at I., and his goodwill surprised me, with which he was looking at the music. Aninov gave a sigh, he looked up at something, looked round and met I.'s look. As though the lightning flashed across him, he gave a start, smiled childishly and uttered.

“An Eastern song of victorious love, as my heart understands it.”

The sounds of the Eastern refrain poured from under his fingers, and they reminded me of Constantinople. Once I heard a little beggar singing there, who was beating the tambourine excitingly and dancing, while two blind violinists were accompanying her.

This view became always more apparent in my memory, while Aninov's theme was broadening and developing. I forgot both where I was and who surrounded me, I was in Constantinople, I saw its streets, Anna, Joan. I was living in the duke's house again. I was drifting among tears and moans, prayers and glorification, I felt the whole Eastern land with its superstitions, experience, passions and fight.

Here was the crowd of women slaves, wrapped in black shrouds. Here were their moans about freedom and independence, about free love; here were the melancholy caravan; the wrathful despot with his harem; here were the childish songs and finally, the calling cry of muezzin.

The Eastern song kept alluring, now it reached the wonderful harmony, and I remembered my friend Turk who used to say: “They can pray only in the East.”

Suddenly a hurricane broke into the music, and the sounds, the triumph of passions, the Earth, Earth, Earth were floating again...

Aninov lapsed into silence. His face was pale more than always, he waited for a moment and uttered again.

“The song of the Western oppression and the hymn of freedom.”

I could hear the sounds of the hymns of France, England and Germany which were interweaving with the sad motive of the orthodox panikhida in a brilliant way. All of a sudden, the Russian song of the Don Cossacks broke through these sounds that was alluring with the infinite wide open space of the steppes, and the lament of panikhida again...

I was all trembling from my never experienced feelings of love and devotion for my motherland and my nation. It seemed to me that I always loved my motherland, but through Aninov's music I understood the first man's duty about which Ali was talking to my brother, - love for one's motherland.

Here it was, everybody's own place, an especial, unique everybody's place on the Earth; Aninov was pouring his love for motherland to the world, although he had left it a long time ago and he hadn't come back to it for many years. I understood that his name wasn't international, but Russian. The home that was the wound of his heart.

A respect for his secret suffering rushed into me, which reached my soul only now, and I bowed to this heartbreak in the same way as once my dear friend captain James bowed to Joan's pain which he succeeded to read within her.

I understood how still far away it was for me till the vigilant recognition, till happiness to live by recognizing every being to be the divine power.

My spirit was shaken. I couldn't sleep and I went out to the park to wait for the dawn.

Chapter 8

An ordinary night of the Community, and what I saw during that night.

The second record of my brother Nikolay.

My helplessness before the concepts “to be” and “to become”.

My conversation with Francisco and his letters

I came back to my room only when it was possible to read, but I was destined to learn one more lesson during that wonderful and short night. I didn't have time to go far down the park lane when I noticed that I wasn't alone.

Figures were walking without any sound along the distant paths of the park, and when I spoke to one trained male nurse who was walking to and fro the lane leading to the end of the park and asked him whether he couldn't sleep in the night as I, he answered me.

"Oh no, my dear brother, I always sleep well, but it is my turn to be on duty during this night, and I will be glad to help you if only you need my help."

"The night duty? Why is it needed? Could we expect a night attack of the Community?"

"No, the Community doesn't have any enemies, although some wild beasts come running here sometimes. The trained nurses duty is needed to provide help for people round the clock, independent of if it is the day or the night."

"But who does need help in the night?" I was asking him by being amazed.

"Who?" the trained male nurse gave a laugh. "Apparently you are absolutely newly arrived to the Community. Let's go towards that light where I've just taken three travellers. You will be able to make certain yourself whether I'm right by thinking that they need help, although now the night is."

The light to which we were going and which seemed to be so small from the distance actually was far away from us, and it looked like a small lamp to me.

We came to the little house, the three windows of which were brightly lit up. The trained male nurse gave a sign, I went up to one of the windows and I saw a lean, exhausted woman with the tattered native clothes and with a baby in her arms. Another woman wearing the white clothes of the trained nurses of the Community was standing with her back to the window and she was offering a cup of hot milk, some bread with honey and some other food which I couldn't discern to the fellow-traveller.

Suddenly the trained nurse turned her face to the window, and I almost gave a shout: lady Berdran was feeding the unfortunate woman. The trained male nurse who was standing next to me saw that I jumped back and he decided that I already saw everything in this room, he took my hand and brought me carefully to the second lit up window, so that I wouldn't tread on the flowers.

Namely in that moment when I pressed myself to the window, the door in the depth of the room opened, and I saw an old man who probably came straight from the bath. A trained male nurse on duty helped him to dress with clean clothes. The nurse brought the old man to the table and seated him. I understood from the old man's manners that he was blind, although his eyes were opened.

The door opened again, and the young trained nurse brought in an eight-year-old boy who apparently was washed and combed, and she seated him at the table, next to the old man. I understood that the boy was his guide.

The same trained nurse brought a piala of hot, evaporating soup instantly for both of them, while the trained male nurse cut off a big chunk of bread for every one of them. I hadn't seen such hunger a long time ago, with which the old man and the boy dashed at the food.

Having come to the third window, I saw a woman who was sitting, wrapped in the widow's shawl. She was pressing her belly strongly with both of her hands and swinging to sides by moaning from time to time.

Two trained nurses were in the room and the doctor whom I knew. All of them were toiling at the woman by explaining something violently to her, by persuading of something which she didn't want to understand.

"I met her by the edge of the park and I took her out of the loop which she twisted from her own plait, with which she wanted to suffocate herself. She was resisting so strongly to me that I had to call other two trained male nurses to help me. Three of us could hardly bring her here. I suspect that this was one of a huge number of the widow dramas. The Community saved several women who wanted to commit suicide due to the horrible social superstitions that doomed all Indian widows for death. Ali and many of his friends are fighting against this Indian misfortune with all their might. There are some children shelters among the woods, in the Distant Communities where the unfortunate widows grow their own and strange children. Now, my dear brother, decide yourself whether the night help is needed for this little part of the world."

He brought me to the main lane, he said good-bye to me pleasingly and he turned to the edge of the park again to continue his night duty. Having separated with him, I stopped and I started looking around. Everywhere I could look I could see little lights, the meaning of which I understood well now.

A swarm of new thoughts began to stir within me. I began to understand what it meant not to waste a single moment in vain, "to be vigilant" and to serve the encountered person by serving Life itself through him.

I came back home and I began to read my brother's note-book again.

"We interrupted our conversation in that place where I described your activity as serving God within man," I was reading the follow-up of the second record, as if it was the continuation of my own thoughts. "This is the path of every man who is searching for discipleship. No other hours of life on the earth for a disciple exist as only the hours of his activity; and his entire day – that's his joyous duty which isn't as a duty or a deed for him, but as the most ordinary communication with his Teacher.

The disciple's joy – that's the result of his knowledge. All his superstitions about his difficult duty, his proper behaviour, boredom, tedium of his duty change till that time, his heart becomes free from thoughts about himself, about his "I" till that time.

As soon as it becomes easy for him, because his eyes will stop looking through the prism of his egoism, the disciple will be prepared already to communicate closer with his Teacher.

How do you imagine that mutual activity of the disciple and his Teacher? Do you think that Teacher is always guiding the whole day of his disciple by leading him with the towel under his arm as mother is leading her baby by trying to teach him to walk?

Teacher's tenderness, attention, love and help surpass any motherly care. And his nature is different than careful mother's wardship, because for her the most important are private, purely egoistic worries.

The stimulus of Teacher's activity by protecting his disciple depends on the disciple himself, on the breakthrough of his purity. Teacher doesn't offer his disciple any complex of conditional possibilities and recipe of how to develop, Teacher is awakening his disciple's spirit for activity that is necessary namely for him, for his highest development through which he could find Light and Truth himself, and he could understand that knowledge – that's not a word, a teaching, but that's an action. The knowledge means: to

be and to become, and not to listen, to criticize, to accept what suits him, to reject that what doesn't suit his own belief of the current moment, which is full of superstitions. The Teacher's spirit pushes his disciple to knowledge, to ability to observe his own thoughts freely.

The disciple's loyalty becomes stronger every day if he can see not himself in his everyday work, but that love that is flowing through him. Not "I" becomes his mode of life, but "through me". With every day he liberates from more and more of his rammed thoughts that were deep-rooted in his "I". The disciple's fearlessness that was only his enthusiasm driven by his mind before and that was ascribed to his virtues, now becomes his everyday atmosphere, his natural power.

Don't have a superstition that you aren't next to your Teacher only because of the distance that separates you. The distance exists till only the superstition of the earthly life is living in your heart. As soon as the knowledge broadens your outlook, the shadow of the distance and loneliness disappears.

The heaps of rubbish that were preventing the disciple from seeing Harmony don't obscure his cleared up look anymore. Harmony depends neither on the place nor on the temple in which one is praying, and it isn't the temple itself which admires one. Harmony can be reached as much as one possesses it oneself.

Through his inner self-discipline man begins to spread not only his spiritual creation during his day. By trying to comprehend in a new way what "character" is, he is also creating his entire external life newly. If before he used to jump quickly from the bed and run out of the room in the last moment only if he was in time to do his urgent business, then now it becomes clear to him that the atmosphere that surrounds him isn't separated from himself.

If before he was living a disorderly life by justifying himself of his talent and by accepting boheme as an inseparable part of the art, then he wasn't different from any other "theosophist seeker" in anything by considering his vanity as a free addition to "his" searching and to "his" theosophy.

The wider the spiritual horizon opens up for the disciple, the clearer it becomes for him how much beauty he can and he has to spread in his private life in order to become a living example to everybody with whom Life will bring him together.

An ordinary disciple's day, lived vigilantly by working, with attention and benevolence stops to be a boring, grey daily routine if only the concepts "to be and to become", and not "to search" exists in his task.

Only the panorama of the grey earthly facts stops turning before the disciple's eyes. His spirit is pouring into everything and it always connects all the daily events with the bonds of love, it always merges into oneness both working worlds: the one of the living heaven and the one of the living earth.

In order for you to become a high, spiritually developed living being yourself, who could become disciple, you need to understand, to accept and to bless all your external circumstances.

You need to understand that your body and your surroundings aren't the fruit of only this incarnation. They are always the karma of the ages. Not a single external circumstance may be rejected by the efforts of your will. The more persistently you will want to hurl away the certain people's characteristics or the row of circumstances from your path, the more persistently they will be following you, even if you succeeded to throw them away temporarily or to hide from them.

They will change their form, and sooner or later they will rise before you. Only the power of love may liberate the external and inner man's path, only she alone will turn the grey day into the happiness of shining creation.

It seems to every man in the beginning of his spiritual growth that the talent of creation – that's an externally expressed power of spirit. He doesn't evaluate his great, intangible inner strength: obedience, purity, love and joy if they don't sound for him as the useful activity of the earth.

Only every action of his spiritual and physical creation, only his long work by always expanding his consciousness is leading him purposefully to the goal of Eternity. His external order becomes the direct reflection of his inner order, exactly as every consideration of the breakthrough of his everyday creation may not flow into the actions of his day without the base of his dialectical thinking. If a sculptor wants to represent the striving for victory of his nation, he must delve deeply into its history, he must feel with his spirit the invisible pages of his nation's glory and national wisdom, he must feel with his heart its burden of ages, the principal ideas that make it develop – only then he will be able to hear the note with which its modernity is ringing for the nation.

Only then the sculptor will be able to create the living swiftness from the clay, because he has already gone through the whole cross path of the nation in his heart, all the pain of its crucifixion, its great walking along the historical stages of suffering and exaltation that lead to that culminating moment of manifestation of the nation's spirit power which the artist wants to perpetuate in history.

Neither clay nor canvas will sustain the several year test if their creators seized a theme and gave it to the masses as the well saleable and profitable goods. Their works, as the bad advertisement, will get among the similar, casual trash.

An accurate observation of the disciple's, as well as the talented doctor's, spiritual eyes is always leading his creation, which operates directly through his intuition. But intuition – that's not today's product, it's the synthesis of Wisdom that awakens also not in this visible, current moment, it is only the visible consequence of those many invisible, creative strains which are called – Love.

It is impossible to liberate Love within yourself by using the efforts of your mind and to reach the possibility to pour it into all your matters and meetings calmly and simply as your benevolence. While observing freely your flights, instability, scepticism or greediness, you can pave only narrow paths through which the power as the circulation of blood of a new organism will start flowing after some time.

What is the discipleship? That's only the path of one's liberation. Can you consider life without any world outlook to be the discipleship? Such discipleship may not exist. It isn't important for how long and through which ways man would be searching for his Teacher, he won't be able to find him if his world outlook is light-minded and if he's waiting naively that something will change by itself inside of him, that something will open up, burst like a festering ulcer, or on the contrary, that something will come into bloom like a double blossom.

The most boring "seekers" are those who always turn back and who are searching for confirmation or proof in the presence for those ravings about which they were dreaming in their youth. The most grand path of all work paths – that's the path of one's liberation.

Not a single moment exists which could fall out of the chain of karma without the greatest man's duty to take it upon himself again instantly, because it is always the call of Eternity, it is always leading him to liberation independent of how unimportant it would seem to be for a light-minded person.

The disciple who has evaluated not only his own, but also everybody else's path, that is after he understood the importance of his incarnation, may not be light-minded anymore. It doesn't mean that he has to walk with physiognomy of the one who is carrying out an important "mission" and who cannot laugh. It means to comprehend the value of the flying past "now" in every moment, to be able to take everything from it and to give back to it in a creative way.

One's body and spirit, as indivisible cells, may coordinate the heaven and the earth only by developing in a parallel way. And the more one's spirit is developing, the more one's body cells liberate, they prepare to imbibe the radiant solar matter into the organism.

Death is only the action of the greatest joy for a cleaned organism. Death is the cross road of liberation for a man who was filling the bags of superstitions during his entire life, although he was very honest and kind.

In most cases one's mode of life is namely those walls of superstitions which the departed is unable to overstep. The first rule of the disciple's conduct for you must be your day's easiness as a complicated combination of the mixed spiritual union with the living life of your every encountered man. "Day" for you – that's the invisible assistants who participate always and everywhere, who surround you in all your affairs and meetings independent of the place, time and distance. You are not alone anymore, you are always working with them.

Until the physical disciple's sensations develop, which allow him to feel the presence of the high powers clearly, his loyalty has to grow into great love. Love for whomever it would be dedicated – for God, for Teacher, for a beloved saint, - only then will bring you to your desired union with those whom you worship and for whom you call when it grows into serving people who are next to you, for whom the disciple will learn to bring love regards.

The path of the discipleship is the same for everybody: if the unfortunate people are knocking at your door – then you are on the right way."

The second record was over.

I didn't even feel how I covered my face with my hands and I was plunged in those great thoughts which I was reading. My God! How still far it was for me till those stages of the mature spirit, about which I was reading now. My thoughts strayed to my dear brother-father, twenty-four year old youth, an officer who almost daily used to encounter the mountaineers, who always risked to be wounded or killed, who always used to find tenderness, caress, a soothing smile for his small brother-son.

I remembered that constant brother Nikolay's calm, I meditated upon his entire life anew, and it seemed to be a heroic deed to me now. I couldn't remember a single woman in my brother Nikolay's path of life, and he was unquestionable handsome man.

Now I understood his painful, changed face beyond recognition anew when for the first time I saw Nal in K.'s avenue. Also I understood his suffering in Ali's garden before the feast. I remembered another man who chose the spiritual path, - young Ali. Tears came pouring from my eyes, but they weren't those tears with which one bemoaned mortal sufferings of one's dear people, but they were the tears, rolling down from the respect for a grandeur which man's spirit was able to withstand and what an example of shining help such man may become. My thoughts, my heart was trembling with respect for everybody whom I met lately. I was unable to find any words to tell my gratitude for I. and Francisco, I only could repeat my brother Nikolay's first words of his records:

GLORY FOR THOSE WHO HAVE BROUGHT ME TO THIS

GREAT MOMENT OF MY LIFE.

GLORY FOR THOSE WHO WILL REACH IT AS I DID.

I felt that Eta was pulling my sleeve, I took my wonderful bird, I pressed myself to his head and I couldn't hold my tears anymore. Eta embraced my head with his wings as if by understanding these tears and by comforting me. I. entered the room and found us sitting like this.

My dear Teacher's and friend's hand descended tenderly on my head, and his unique, tender voice was encouraging me.

"Why are you crying, my dear friend? That what you've read about dear people to you and about their great friends, and what has shaken you so much, only for you seems to be the heroism of renunciation, right? For them – that's the heroism of creation, the heroism of the greatest, invincible creative power and Joy. Memorize that what I will tell you now and try to apply my words for your actions as the laws of your new life. We were talking about tears with you several times already. And every time I was always explaining to you that tears, any tears were making a man weaker. While you, after entering the path of liberation, took the activity of joy upon yourself to become the power for a weak person, comfort for the suffering one and help for the one who's lost hope. Now don't try to hold your tears by using your will, but every time when a tear is ready to roll down from your eyes, rise up with your spirit and remember all the unfortunate people, there are so many of them in the world even without your tears. There are so many crying people in the universe that the disciple must dry their tears and not increase that flow. As soon as your thought rises above your egoism, you will see that every tear – that's the tear for yourself, however you would estimate it. Now when you can hear the voice of Silence and you can see the images of the people dear to you independent of the place and the distance, your every tear destroys one of the bridges through which you communicate with them. Start your day with a blissful joy to live one more day on the Earth, to have a chance again to greet God in man and to help him. The higher your own liberation is taking place, the clearer it becomes to you how easy man's path may be and into what hard life he turns his own and often his own people's days. My friend, mature in the family of the people who surround you now where you are free from all private worries, from all the conditionalities of your mode of life, mature for that period when you leave this place and you feel the strain of people's passions. Only now you can develop your self-control in an absolutely calm way. Very few people receive this happiness: to shape his mind, heart and character among the people who don't possess any egoism. All your meetings here – that's the meetings of your old and new karmas. In order for you not to miss the link of the meetings of those who love and care for you, only one task remains for you: not to pour your tears which obscure the spirit's eyes, but to pour joy which helps every living being who goes past you to stir beauty within herself, and not melancholy. Take Eta, we'll go to bathe and we won't come back – we'll visit Francisco. I need to talk to him about many things, and most importantly – to find out whether he will let me go to the distant Communities where I'm invited persistently. There's also much business here, and it will be difficult for Francisco without me. My dear, join the net of our common work interests and forget about the possibility to cry, although you would like to cry out of respect of others' heroism. That what today seems to be an unreachable heroism to you, tomorrow will become only a heavy burden, while on the day after tomorrow – it won't even seem to be heavy for you. The task of the day – not the heroism of your feelings itself, but that everything what you reach wouldn't seem to be reached by the cross road, but that it would come in an easy, joyous and simple way. Today you'll have a lot of work to do. Did you sleep in the night?" I. asked me by looking attentively at me.

I told him how I spent the night, what I saw and how surprised I was after seeing lady Berdran on duty.

"And again, my dear I., I made sure how immature my perception was, how blind I was by deciding about people, how I couldn't perceive anything in life that surrounded me."

"Everyone has his own path, Lovushka. Perhaps many thousands would like to exchange their roles with you, but the scene of life theatre submits to the laws of the universe, and the roles in this theatre may not be distributed according to personal favour of artistic director. The highest artistic direction brings everybody to his own working place in the universe, and how everybody is going to work there – that's individual and unique. It doesn't matter how many roles man would choose, he will be playing only that one for which his harmony has matured."

After having bathed, we went to the hospital to visit nurse Alexandra. For the first time I was so early in the hospital. The view which I saw here moved me. A lot of recovering children were sitting at the little childish tables in the big dining-room. The same older children and young nurses attended to them. Again I reproached myself that up to now I knew neither the size of the hospital nor the extent of help rendered for the inhabitants.

Many fascinated children were greeting I., while I didn't know again when and where they could become acquainted with him. The shrimps didn't pay attention to any discipline, they rushed at I. and they were hanging on him like grapes. Francisco came from the distant corner and he took us with the whole burden of the shrimps to his table. Cold vegetarian dishes were served for the breakfast, but everybody who wanted to could get the hot soup, potatoes, besides the fruit was put everywhere.

Francisco, as always when he met me, didn't let my hand go for a long time and he was smiling tenderly.

"Yes, Lovushka, yes, grow, handsome, grow. Soon you will see the unfortunate people's life, accumulate joy, so that you could flood them. You will see such unfortunate people about whose existence you didn't even know up to now. It is time, it is time to reach manhood for you. Don't worry I., take all of them and travel. They will help me here. Florentian will send somebody soon. Some helpers will show up for me."

"Francisco, you are always prepared to pile any burden on yourself, but will your health allow you to work so much? Sometimes you forget that Florentian has forbidden you to be on duty in the nights without any rest day."

"Don't worry, my friend. I regularly spend three hours a day by the books, and it gives such rest for me that I have enough strength to walk in the night. Tonight a great meeting happened. Oh, how happy I was that I could save the unfortunate woman brought by destiny from the real death! She was already prepared to drown her newborn baby and jump herself after it. Now both mother and her baby rejoice at life, and I'm sure that this baby will be a great man."

Francisco was all radiant. Love was pouring from him just like that. His face which never became tanned was almost transparent, with reddish cheeks it was notable not only for its whiteness among the dark and sunburnt faces. It would have been notable also among a thousand of white faces – such high power of spirit illuminated all his facial features.

I made certain clearly again what Love was and I remembered I.'s words which he told me not so long ago: "You think that noble people's behaviour – that's heroism of their renunciation. For them – that's heroism of creation, heroism of the greatest, invincible creative powers and Joy."

Now I could see the living example of these I.'s words, and I could feel the feeling of two kinds. On the one hand, I comprehended how now I still was unable to reach such psyche, on the other – I was still thinking anyway that man could reach such state only through many renunciations.

As though by having heard my thoughts, Francisco put his hand on my shoulder and looked at my eyes.

“Christ had twelve apostles, but only John alone was walking down the path of selfless love. All the rest of them were walking down the most different paths. And if every one of them did their own way of the cross, then it happened only because the power of their passions had to become an invincible fearlessness, loyalty and confidence. I’ve already told you that the meaning of the cross – that’s the combination of four blisses – love, calm, joy and fearlessness. These love aspects developed till the end within a man give harmony to him. Everybody is trying to enter it and to fortify their positions in it in their own way, but only that one will pick its fruit, who will find joy along his path of development. Life, the whole Life of the universe is always affirmative. You can create only by affirming. That one who is unable to learn the joy of affirmation in the daily routine of his life, in his circumstances, that one may not become the light for others along the path. However, Lovushka, you cannot try the cross of a strange life. Only one is suitable for your own shoulders: that what is your own. Now it seems to you that my path is impossible for you. Believe me that the same impossible your path seems to be to me. I cannot imagine that I could sit down and write some novel or narrative. Although I acknowledge the great significance of the writer, inventor and so on, I cannot even think about any of those paths. That would be only making people laugh. I can imagine myself in the roles of Bronski or Aninov even less, although I experienced myself not a single time what a wonderful power an artist’s talent was and how effective its influence was. Man’s talent illuminates all of him in a flash, while other paths of spiritual influence require long and tedious work. But why we are searching for examples of comparison. If I had to live and work instead of our mutual friend I., then I wouldn’t have the strength to, because I couldn’t wander among so many people and I would die without bringing neither use nor joy for anybody. The cross which man is carrying on his shoulders through his daily routine is always light, but man’s sight is so polluted that he’s hammering in nails to his own cross instead of the harmony with which he should create and make everybody’s lives who are walking next to him easier. Instead of the four blisses he’s carrying the cross with nails by rending lacerated wounds for himself.

Now we’ll go to my place. I will give several letters for my friends to you, who are now living in the distant Communities. By handing my letters to them, take a good look at them. Perhaps the man’s life in the secluded, unknown spot of the world without any noisy arena of actions will stop looking so terrible to you.”

We went to Francisco’s room, and I couldn’t stop wondering at how accurately and correctly he noticed my sensations and thoughts. Actually, I often used to think about lives of the people whom I met here, who were very developed and talented, who were always living in secluded settlements. Even more often it was sad and dreary for me when I used to imagine thousands of people who had never left their out-of-the-way places, who were satisfied with their modest fate in their homes and work one generation after another one, inherited from their forefathers. Francisco perceived all these thoughts of mine and he stirred them like ashes with the poker of his love.

When we entered Francisco’s room, first of all he lifted the lid of his marble table, and I saw a wonderful, high vase under it, as it seemed to me from the first look. But that was a cup made of the red jewel, maybe of ruby, and the liquid was bubbling in it by sparkling in all colours.

Now I understood that it was an altar. Francisco’s altar didn’t look like any of the altars which I had seen up to now.

A high, big red cup was standing in the middle, while some much smaller ones of the most different colours were lined in a semicircle behind it. In the beginning it seemed to me that there were

many cups, but having looked attentively, I saw that there were six of them without the red one. Three of them were standing from the right side and three from the left side.

I travelled to the little orange house in my thoughts where I was standing before the same altar not so long ago.

Francisco touched the red cup with both of his hands, its flame blazed brighter, and I heard his whisper: "Let my hands and my spirit be as pure as Your flame when I'm writing Your call for Your servants."

He stood for a while, concentrated like this, he went to the writing-table, took a sheet of paper and began to write. Like all people I often saw how others were writing. I also saw both the absent-minded ones, such like myself, and concentrated, attentive ones, but neither up to this hour, nor during my entire future life I didn't see such face and such figure as Francisco's at the writing-table.

Besides that it seemed that he had forgotten about everybody and everything, his expression was always changing. The mimic of his great face was so clear that as though I saw myself those to whom he was writing and I understood what he was writing.

I was observing Francisco and his work so deeply that I didn't even notice when I left. As though the personal Francisco's conversation with every correspondent was taking place before me. The entire gallery of faces swam past me. The heap of the letters grew, and it seemed to me that not the letters were put in it, but the little pieces of Francisco's soul which he was tearing from himself and putting in envelopes.

But then he concentrated in an especial way, he bent over the sheet of paper, began to write slower than other letters, as though the beams stretched to the lines of his writing from under his fingers, and it seemed to me that I could even see a woman who was pressing a seven-year-old boy to herself sorrowfully.

The illusion was so clear that I already wanted to leave the room and not to disturb the woman to talk to Francisco, but he looked at me and told me.

"Learn to control the space. I drew you into my work, so that it would be easier to give help for all my friends, including your own love."

Now I understood that those views that seemed to be only my fantasy actually were the result of Francisco's love, who connected me to his thoughts.

Having finished the last letter, he fell to thinking, he plunged in a deep prayer, stood up, took the letter into his hands and he went to the altar with it. Here he went down on his knees, put the letter on the fire of the cup, embraced the cup with both of his hands, pressed his forehead to it and became numb in the ecstasy of the prayer.

I was shaken by the power and energy that was spreading from the entire Francisco's being like a cry and demand. I also knelt down, shocked by the ecstasy of his love and self-sacrifice that he had forgotten about everything, except that woman for whom he was praying the higher living beings whom only he knew to help.

Sympathy for that woman for whom Francisco was praying crossed me like the flame of the fire. For the first time I understood the powerful power of the prayer and its true meaning.

I was begging for purity of my hands and my heart as much as I could, so that I would have enough strength to hand Francisco's letters and that I wouldn't pollute them with dregs of my own

weakness and passions. I needed plenty of effort in order to control the tears of my compassion and respect by seeing my friend's self-sacrifice and even his hardly bearable kindness.

My heart expanded, I remembered Ali's words for my brother about the impoverished God within a man again, for whom he needed to serve, and once again I perceived my helplessness before the barrier on which the words: "To be and to become" were shining.

Now I saw one of those who didn't need "to become" already, who already "was" an incarnated kindness. Francisco stood up and called me to himself. When I went up and stood next to him by the altar, he told me.

"If a disciple started communicating with one Teacher, then he started communicating with all of them. No separating screen may exist for the look of those who have become bright anymore. Teacher of the ray of Love gives you a task which I pass to you in this moment. Concentrate the entire purity of your heart and comprehend how everything is connected in the universe, how warranty of the ones for the other ones is taking place everywhere. A moment ago you still didn't know about the existence of the whole people company. Now they are your closest and the most sacred friends, because you give them help, while they are suffering. I will put the little scrap of the chiton of one of the purest and most loving living being. If in that moment when you hand this letter you can hold bliss and Light in your heart with which you are standing by the altar now, then rub the baby of that mother to whom I'm writing with this scrap of the chiton. If you feel that you became absent-minded, that my image isn't burning in your spiritual vision anymore, then give it to its mother, let her rub her son's little face herself. Comprehend now that service to your close person – that isn't an outburst of your kindness when you are prepared to give everything to him and then to think where to get something from what you gave again yourself. Service to your close person – that's the line of your behaviour, that's the everyday work which joy of life unites and feeds. Appreciate this joy to live not for the searching for Wisdom, not for the knowledge and your experienced love ecstasies, not for glorification of God as the top of happiness, but as the simple concept: everything is connected, you cannot isolate yourself from a single man, not only from the whole complex of your circumstances. The value of your lived days is measured with only one currency: where and how many threads of love you wove during the day, where and how many of them you were able to strengthen and with what you tied the supporting knots. Keep this moment in your memory and strengthen the tread of your work with me, also together with my Teacher, Teacher of Love, whose name is Jesus. I strengthen my knot that has tied the threads of work of both of us with the whole love of my heart and my entire purity. Accept my letters by the altar of love and take them with that harmony which you are full of now. Help given with joy and easily always reaches its goal. Man rises to the higher stage, and all the bright ones of the universe say: "We've overcome another stage." Because, as I've already mentioned, everything is connected, everything is unity, nobody may be kept separate from the encounters of life, although he doesn't imagine himself his connection with the Only One Life."

Francisco put the little scrap into the envelope, took the letter that didn't burn down in the flame of the cup, pressed it to his lips, crossed himself with it and uttered: "bliss of Love, bliss of Calm, bliss of Joy, bliss of Fearlessness, fly with the wings of harmony of my loyalty and flow into that heart for whom I pray you, my Teacher, my friend, my assistant of Light and Love."

The flame in the cup flared up. Francisco, and I after him, knelt down before the altar again and closed the lid of the table.

Having handed the whole heap of the letters – only a few words were in some of them – he wrapped them into the beautiful, silk headscarf which reminded me of the blue sir Vomi's one, only Francisco's one was of warm, red colour.

This comparison awakened my recollections about that wonderful man, and I asked Francisco whether he knew sir Vomi.

"I know, I know him, Lovushka, but I don't know Chava, I've never seen her. What do you think, would I be afraid of her blackness?" Francisco was laughing merrily, humour was shining in his eyes.

"Now I am very ashamed, Francisco, but I have to say that back then when I saw her I was so frightened that I remember that feeling up to now. After so long time when I'm among the people for so long time already, whose feelings and strength know neither fear nor irritation, I changed myself, and my perception changed. I couldn't even imagine before, not only to follow it, that every meeting – that's my the Only One. I didn't understand that it was unimportant what kind of his Only One was, but that it was important how my Only One who is living within myself greeted the divine fire of the encountered man. Now I cannot imagine how I could meet a man only according to his personal characteristics and not according to the fire of the Only One Life. Also I began to understand something else about which I used to tell me often that the healthy mind of the earth and the man's tact formed the integral mechanism without which it was impossible to be on duty and to be able to give Teacher's help to people. Now it is absolutely clear to me that "to know" means "to be able to do." In this moment something what was preventing me from "to be and to become" disappeared within me."

"Lovushka, this is a very big step of man's spiritual growth. Man can behave in an angelic way one or two times, and of course, it is much. But the path of man's liberation isn't based on these acts, but only on his ordinary working day. When you bring my letter to the old man Staranda, take a good look at him. Not only at him, but also at all those old men who are living with him in the same house. That entire big, remote house is full of people who were searching zealously for God and for the paths to Him during their entire lives. But none of them had and have till now the feeling of tact and comprehension of the true beauty. Their spiritual searching was contradicting their actions during their entire lives. All of them were kind without exception, they were prepared to give their last shirt and anyway, they couldn't sow anything round themselves, except irritation. Even after bearing lots of suffering, having reached the Community, and here they cannot be harmonious, their auras are always trembling with the sparkling fire and they disturb calm in any atmosphere, wherever they would get. For some of them, for example for Staranda, there isn't any hope anymore to reach tact in this incarnation and to develop the feeling of beauty. His own overestimation has taken root within him and stiffened from old age. Understanding that only he alone is right has penetrated into him like rust, while others are thinking about the great truths superficially. He thinks that if he understood his Teacher's words in his own way, then the truth is namely like this. When you see and know that he understood everything the other way round, - then you are helpless to explain it to him anyway, because his tedious, stiffened egocentrism makes him to listen to you silently and to think to himself: "All right, talk, I know myself what I need and what is better for me." Be vigilant when you become acquainted with these people. See clearly what affirmation of Life within oneself and around one is, and what a changed egoism is, which has turned into a stupid and stubborn overestimation of oneself. Such man, without arguing with you, as though by trying not to irritate you, as though by protecting your home and your meeting, doesn't see that he already condemned you even before meeting you, he decided beforehand that you acted not in such a way as it was needed according to his highest understanding. Also before meeting you, by praying for you, he was begging his God "to illuminate" you, but he didn't think that he should stretch the beam of joyous love from his heart, to concentrate his thoughts into the stream of Light and to spread them under your feet like the carpet of love. If a great disaster or trouble befalls you, he will tell you sorrowfully: "Apparently you deserve it," but he won't show big love to you or comfort you with a single word, what tact demands from him, not to speak of the dear energies of sympathy with which he would wash off your disaster or trouble and would help you to withstand them. If he excited your irritation, if he exhausted you with his tactless requests by often getting the things that you need out of you

and by bringing them to others, by giving charity at your expense, then his entire gratitude to you will be displayed only in that that he will say: "Anyway Teacher is teaching us to do differently, while you are in a rage here. He himself won't understand again that his heart has turned into a dry sponge and that he cannot give calm, because he doesn't love and he hardly ever loved anybody, although of course, he was thinking that he loved. Often these people were loved passionately, but their inner dryness, although it is covered with their external loveliness, used to alienate everybody from them. They exhausted and disappointed all their friends very much. They remained completely lonesome and anyway they couldn't understand their great guilt for Life. However, every one of them also has great merits, so these people are our own. Life itself finds the way to give longevity to them, so that they would have time to throw the superstition of the external humiliation off, behind which their great haughtiness is hiding. Life is waiting, it gives time to the old, dry sponge of their hearts to be filled with clean and joyous love again. Sometimes Life succeeds, and such man goes through his inner transformation during his old age, he achieves the real humiliation which helps him to bear losses easily. Their intolerance is the most sad thing. They long for a great deed during their entire lives. Often the thought begins to stir in their brain: "To sacrifice myself," but when they have to go through a hunger or cold, that becomes an especially difficult suffering for them. Namely here it turns out how much real heroism the man has accumulated in his spirit, although he was longing for the great deed during his entire life by refusing meat and fish, and when the time came to manage without that without what the great part of poor people manage to do during their entire lives, they don't have strength even to smile to such trifle as an external loss. Take a good look, Lovushka, and learn the lesson not for developing of psychological analysis of the writer, but for opening widely your love and compassion, joy of knowledge: how difficult everybody's path of liberation is and how you may not condemn a man, but only learn from him by opening to yourself your quite big faults and weaknesses. Before you give the letter to every of my addressee, prepare yourself for this sacred task. Remember how we were standing by the cup of the burning love, and before handing the letter, give a wash for your hands and your heart in its fire. Go, my friend. We won't see each other anymore before your departure, but I will be with you everywhere in my thoughts."

Francisco kissed me and added that I should go home alone, while I. will come back when he finishes his business, and that I shouldn't worry about him.

I left the territory of the hospital by carrying the dear letters. For the first time I received the task from the man who surpassed me with his spirit so much. I pressed to Florentian in my thoughts by asking him to help me to fulfil this task with the greatest self-control, tact and love. I was carrying the little packet like a sacred thing and only wanted not to meet and talk to anybody. I chose the most remote paths and I came back to my room unnoticed by anybody.

Having hidden Francisco's packet, I sat down to read my brother's note-book. My excited spirit couldn't pass to the earthly work immediately. I had to recover an absolute equilibrium and self-control, and my brother's note-book suited the best for this.

Chapter 9

Third brother Nikolay's record

"[...] During our last conversation we were talking about the paths of discipleship, about that that easy paths didn't exist, that man's development always required great effort in all the fields of creative work. And the higher man rises through his creation, the wider his horizon becomes, the further he is able to see his path and the possibilities of his achievements, the clearer he comprehends the infinity of his development and poor level of his own achievements.

That is characteristic to all who are really talented, to all who are creating, and not "contriving", to all who are working with inspiration, and not turning in the vortex of their imaginary expression and trying to put out the shining brightly primitivism of spirit, body and interests with their exalted passion instead of the real creation of the fiery inspiration.

Three paths exist among all different paths of discipleship, in which the difficulties are so big that only the chosen ones may walk them down, who themselves are already close to the limit of perfection.

The first of these paths – the path of love.

The second one – the path of sadness.

The third one – the path of clairvoyance.

I can see an amazement on your face. It seems to you that namely these paths which show the high level of one's development should be easier than others. Soon you will understand what the difficulty of each of these paths is and what every man has to overcome within himself in order to be able to walk them down.

Such path of love as people imagine it doesn't exist. The man who thinks that he understood what love is understood only one thing: compassion is endless and it never pushes him away, so for everything what he will do he will get not only indulgence from the Pope, but also the thorough absolution from heaven itself.

The man always cherishes a hope that those saints will stand up for him, whom he got used to address with his prayers, but what a prayer is, how to prepare for it, he didn't think about it or even knew that he needed to.

He knows how he needs to prepare himself for the meal, sleep, a serious conversation, but his point of view of the prayer is only like this: to cross himself hurriedly, to mumble the prayer even in more hurry or to weep bitterly for a while, to mumble for a long time and... the ritual necessary for "the saint" is done.

People's opinion about those who are walking down the path of love shows itself only in their exactingness for them. People visit disciples without restraint, they pour out all their rubbish on them, they pour their tears for their apparently injured vanity, arguments, lack of means and so on. They take offence if they don't meet them with their spread arms or stroke their heads, but look at this period of their confusion calmly. They came where they must hear them out and comfort them, didn't they?!

Since they still love only themselves and not people, they cannot even imagine what the disciple has seen within them, because he has already passed from the level of self-love to the real love for people a long time ago. Without comprehending it themselves, the people have lost their sensitiveness in the storm of the dregs of their benumbed egoism, which is bubbling within and around them, and which they spread in the disciple's home. They are convinced of their truth and they leave irritated, with their injured pride because of the imaginary coldness with which their "frankness", their complaints and moans were met.

Every disciple who is walking down the path of love experiences tens of such encounters every day. The cases of the real disaster beam like precious pearls in the heap of dung when the disciple, with his entire love, hurries to liberate and to open the eyes for man into the treasure of living Love which is within his heart.

The disciple of the path of love – that's the pure man who is standing by the edge of perfection, who has overcome all his passions. That is that man for whom his personal characteristics and advantages don't exist anymore, but in whom all the aspects of the Only One have come to life and are operating. Since all the aspects of the Only One are operating within him, such disciple isn't only the little

part of the entire universe anymore. He is the little part of the Eternal Movement, which is cleaned from self-love and which is spreading only joy of love for people on the Earth.

How do you imagine, how steady this disciple's harmony has to be? What is power have to be, so that he would withstand the constant blows of auras and that he wouldn't break from disharmony of his encounters?

Such power of will doesn't exist. There's only one power: merging with the Only One Life. Since the disciple of the path of love has already overcome his self-love, and love for people is burning within him in the constant flame, then no blows of egoistic auras and attacks are able to disturb his harmony. His spirit – that's fire. No efforts of the evil, dregs and complaints of those who are searching for the wealth of the Earth, but who insist that they are searching for the Light and for the paths to it may extinguish or die out this fire anymore, they may not even quiver it.

Such is the spirit of the disciple of the path of Love, but his body – the matter that submits to the laws of the earth – is often cracked, it is suffering from serious illnesses, because it draws the poisonous and irritable fires of the auras of his encountered people to himself.

A lot of body illnesses happen in all the paths of discipleship. They happen more often along the path of love. Only few masters of karmas who were prepared for serving the mankind in an especial way during the entire centuries are able to master the matter of the body and they overcome the eternal work lesson with good health. Also they are educated differently, they are protected only by using the means that allow to receive the highest knowledge, which you won't understand at the moment.

So, now it is clear to you that the path of love – that isn't a sentimental prayer for the people's sins or disasters. That isn't any comfort of crying juvenile children with fruit drops, but that is the great mission of help to open the veil of passions of every encountered person, which covers the living little parts of the Only One within man with dirty and dark layers.

If the disciple himself would still possess at least a drop of his egoistic "I", his path of love would become an unbearable suffering, and a sudden death would threaten him.

Lips of the loving man burst into bloom everywhere where only he is able to take the turbid wave of the crying encountered person into himself and to open his dense veils till the very heart, so that he could pour a drop of his Light there. And this pouring of spirit into another heart always has consequences for the matter of the disciple's body. During each of such encounters he takes into himself – into his nerves, his blood, his heart – the dirt and the flow of grief of the encountered person. Having made it easier for the encountered person, this strong poison and stench remain in the disciple's body.

Besides that difficulty, the path of love has another complicated side. With the spirit's eyes the disciple has perceived all the wounds of the man's spirit a long time ago, he comprehended all his possibilities, the whole truth and falsehood of his essence from the smouldering and twinkling fires of his aura a long time ago, while the talkative and complaining person is still talking his ear off by trying to exalt, expose and reveal his suffering as much as possible.

And here the complete inability to feel the irritating or indignant factor saves the disciple.

The disciple of the path of love is unable to walk through life by following only the laws of the earth anymore, only the narrow earthly rightness. He – like a living part of the constantly moving life – is living according to the universal law of Accuracy.

During those moments when people's emanations overload the cup of the disciple's everyday work especially and his spirit is suffering from that heaviness no less than his body, one of the

Teachers who is closest to him always comes hurriedly to help the disciple, even if he isn't his personal Teacher or a warrantor.

These moments of especially heavy cup – is always the new stage in the disciple's path to Light and development. Whatever the disciple's path would be, wherever and whatever he would do by saving his own people, these painful moments of crossing the stages of development lead everybody inevitably.

You are surprised. You've already understood the most important rule of the spiritual life: "To know – it means to be able to do" and you decide right by following the earthly logic. If the disciple "knows", it is also easy for him to act. That will be right in that case if all disciple's passions have already become the power of joy. Then the stages that seem to be the most difficult become always easier, and finally the disciple doesn't even notice them, he just feels a surge of an especial joy.

But as I already mentioned to you, only those disciples achieve such state of spiritual power, in whom all the aspects of their Only One have come to life and are operating. Then the spiritual "to know" means "to be able to do".

The path of love gives calming to each encountered person – that's its especial feature. Namely due to this peculiarity the path of love is valued the most from all the paths of discipleship.

In your encounters value not that love with which people are chanting the exalted hymns for their God, Teacher, friends or they are crying and burning with their devotion to you. Those who love like this actually don't care much about devotion and they are watching with envy, whether not too little merits they will get for their loyalty.

Appreciate and spread that love with which your encountered person didn't disturb another one's calm or make a strange heart angry. Now you pass on from the person who is glad and searching to the ranks of those for whom the only path of Life has opened and who has found it among a million of illusions.

But don't think that something changes in the disciple's psyche at that moment when he finds and sees his Teacher. I've already mentioned our proverb to you: "When the disciple is prepared – also his Teacher is prepared."

I've already been expressing my presence to you in different ways for a long time. Once I sent an old traveller to you, who taught you Pali language, but it didn't even occur to you to listen more attentively to his stories.

You were learning willingly, because you desired to read the ancient books which you happened to buy in the poor shack of the mountains and which were meant to be burn down. But your scepticism prevented you from listening attentively to the old traveller's words, to his stories about India. You didn't evaluate him sufficiently. You didn't pay enough attention to the meeting...

Now when I tell you about the difficulties of the path, I especially direct your attention to the feature of the human scepticism. That person who is unable to believe, to feel, to devote himself to a business completely and till the end, that one may not become disciple at all. However the sceptic would be searching for God and for the paths to Him, for his Teacher and for the meeting with him since his youth, if he's unable to stay loyal till the end, all his searching is in vain. With one of his hands he will be searching for books, he will write out the words of Wisdom, while with his other hand, with his everyday actions, a board after board, he will be destroying the bridge that leads him to that Wisdom, to his Teacher, to the living heaven.

Everybody is building the bridge that leads to his Teacher himself. The bridge grows out of his heart and it continues for as long as the man's loyalty is able to reach. Every disciple's bridge of his heart certainly leans upon his Teacher's heart with its another end. And the disciple's loyalty holds both ends.

Now try to understand whether the sceptic is able to build such bridge from his heart if doubts are always nagging his spirit?

I sent the old traveller to you. Why couldn't you believe him till the end? You were full of illusions about the exceptional radiance of the Teacher's appearance. You couldn't understand the primary truth: "No one is your friend or brother, but every man is great Teacher for you."

The superstition that you wanted to see your Teacher, shining with glory and luxury, with miracles of magic and external grandeur prevented you from seeing my messenger in the poor beggar. Remember forever: our messenger doesn't shout like in the market, and if we need it – then also the ant will be a messenger.

Now, in this moment there's left from your scepticism. The energy of loyalty is burning stably in your heart, but did it happen exactly in this moment? Didn't you whisper a month ago by saving the girl from the company of drunk bandits and by attacking five of them alone on not the most swift-footed horse: "Teacher, hurry to me"? And I heard your cry, I sent my help to you: the wind for your horse's feet, the power for your striking hand, sluggishness and horror for the bandits' hearts...

Not only the dragon of doubts, but also the one of kindness emerges before every disciple who is walking down the ray of Love.

The concept of the Earth "kind", that is seemingly kind, may not cross the gates of tests which lead into any path of discipleship. "Kind" that is understood like this won't overcome the gates that lead to the ray of Love. It will conquer the dragon of scepticism and doubts, but it will be helpless before the dragon of kindness.

In order for you to carry the cup of love through your daily routine, you need to possess and to pour not the ordinary human kindness into the actions of your day and not even the real kindness that is necessary for other rays, but that highest Kindness and Wisdom.

What is the difference between these kindnesses? What is characteristic to each of them? Both of them – are actions of compassion, but where the ordinary kindness will search for a possibility to comfort and to calm, the highest kindness will perceive the entire man's path – his past, his present and his future – and it will be searching for the most active means, so that it would awaken the man's own energy not only for comprehension of the facts of the Earth, but also for their connection with both plans, with the whole Life, with Eternity.

The highest kindness of the path of Love – that's the accumulation of tact, joy, self-expression and energy that awakens man's powers. The kind man's spirit is boiling in the cup of his Love. And the freer his spirit is, the more aspects of the movement of the Only One in his organism exist, the brighter the spirit of his creating powers is shining in the cup in all colours of the rainbow, which makes an impression of the bubbling, fiery liquid.

You could call the kindness of the ray of Love to be the kindness of foresight, because the disciple who possesses it sees the entire path in a flash, along which he could direct the encountered person's spirit into self-control, he perceives his strength, the possibilities of his wisdom and... he rarely strokes his head. In most cases he takes the whip and he's driving out sluggishness of the encountered person's heart, the superstitions of his self-love, he is lashing the narrowness of his spiritual horizons.

By penetrating into the most secret man's corners, the disciple of love breaks off the thread of petty complaints, with one strict gesture he shows to man the scars of those wounds which he has made to himself with his superstitions. These superstitions are looming around the man like the mountains of rubbish. If man is able to recover his sight and comprehend that he is sitting, encircled by this created superstitions, then he evaluates, accepts and blesses his present circumstances. And his bond with the disciple of the ray of Love is settled for ages. He is walking calmed, and sooner or later he achieves that spiritual plan when he is living in two worlds. If his pettiness weighed down the Light that opened in his heart for a moment and if the outbreak of his sacred joy is going out, then also his meeting is going out like the wick of the smouldering candle. And the entire centuries may pass until the new, dear and effective meeting happens.

There won't be any scar left for man from such meeting, and what about the disciple? Whether the meeting was effective or futile, the tracks are left within the disciple in both cases. The star of the meeting as the sign of the effective merging of Love remains in the disciple's aura from an effective meeting when the bond settles and man turns to liberation.

If the disciple pressed the cup of his Love to the man's lips, feet and heart uselessly and the meeting remained lifeless, then the bond of this unsuccessful meeting remains for his entire future life. And the record about his unfulfilled lesson appears in the book of his Life. The power of the disciple's unfulfilled duty will keep the pages of the book of his Life glued together until he reaches the creative result with the new meeting and often with the entire row of meetings and succeeds to direct the spirit of his encountered person to Light and calm.

Think about that what I've told you and never gather any duties and obligations which nobody gave to you.

It isn't absolutely clear to you why this law of the voluntary obedience of the discipleship is so strict and categorical. If this law wasn't unconditional and if it didn't protect disciples, then they would get entangled in meaningless obligations completely forever, which they chose through their ignorance.

The most important thing without which it is impossible to carry the cup of Love, - that's courage in the presence of suffering. It seems to man that compassion - that's the downy pillow under his aching head, while to the disciple it looks like the blade of the knife. The temporary pain saves one from the real and eternal destruction. Not the tender word and tears, but fearlessness and word that help to open spiritual mistakes fearlessly, to indicate the task of centuries and not the small piece of the earthly incarnation. The task of the disciple's meeting - that's the ability to find such means within himself and the encountered person, which would help both of them to set off the fire of calm and wisdom, and to merge them into the joint bonfire of harmony to which the thread of the Teacher would be extending uninterruptedly.

The disciple who is always holding the image of his Teacher on the creative bridge of his heart has to overcome the whole personal perception of the man who came to him. Only by holding your Teacher's hand firmly, by seeing with his eyes that Eternal who is put into the temporary form at this moment and who came to you as man, you - my disciple - will be able to be effectively useful for your company.

Imagine that your old acquaintance came to you, who once was your close friend, but when the years of your intensive spiritual growth interfered between you, they dug up the whole abyss between you. You've passed on to the absolutely different vibrations. Their frequency and length opened new sounds, colours and forms to you, but these achievements came to you through your individual, unique and impossible for another for another spiritual path. You can neither pass it on nor explain it to your old friend

who maybe was walking down his own path of liberation, but who cannot enter the phase of your liberation and development.

The oppressive dissatisfaction of your friend – that's almost constant final of the earthly friendships, because they are based on the absolute mutual incomprehension what friendship is, why it exists, where its value for man is.

The final of the friendships that arise only because one of them is lonely and he doesn't have any strength to live his daily routine joyfully and easily, without physical support for his spiritual strength, while the other one can't help enjoying his spiritual achievements, is keeping them in his heart and he has to pass "his" flow of light to somebody's ears and heart, - is always the same, because the failure is hiding already in the very embryo.

These friends weren't carrying the Light to each other's path. They didn't see the Only One's fire in each other by wishing to pour as much as possible calm into his friend's day, so that the power of Light would become stronger within him, so that it wouldn't twinkle and would burn in the even fire, but every one of them was searching only for how to strengthen himself, while the Only One was swinging like the pendant of the key chain among a thousand of trifles that support this friendship.

Also such friendships happen when one's devotion reaches fanaticism. One hurries to fulfil another one's desire, but he's always waiting that his friend would reward him for this devotion. In this case both of them are blind as well, because none of them may become absolutely indifferent and objective to another one's needs. In this case their hearts don't beat with the rhythm of the Teacher's heart, too, so that they would be living only in the creative work of the Eternal, in the two worlds, but not only on the Earth.

I don't even talk about that lot of cases of degeneration which are called friendship when the most important accent is exactingness for man. It isn't worth to talk about it, as well as about love based on exactingness for man. It is still only that low stage of spiritual development where discipleship and Light in one's path is out of the question. It is only the time before dawn where high feelings of devotion and selflessness only start setting, but they still pour into actions only like emotions and flights, and they don't grow into the Light and power.

What is that friendship of disciples? It is simple and the highest kindness without any conditionalities and superstitions. If the disciple gave help to his friend in the difficult hour – he gave it not to him concretely, not with his hand and not out of his generosity, but he was walking as the messenger of his Teacher, because he was sent by him and he was carrying his present for the encountered person.

If he committed himself to another person, he pledged himself to do it not alone, but with the whole circle of invisible assistants and protectors, hence he was the messenger of the two worlds and he fulfilled the task of the living heaven on the Earth. He felt himself to be namely such messenger of the living heaven, having forgotten that the entire wall of conditional formalities which are called the social state, age, wealth or poverty and so on were between him and his friend.

The friendship of disciples doesn't appear to order, just because both of them are walking down the path of discipleship and they "need" to develop the goodwill perceived by mind. Each disciple, if he's on duty next to his Teacher, understands all the incalculable paths of the Light. Therefore, he knows that no such possibility exists as to draw closer to those disciples who are walking down the path of stubborn people.

This is an especial path, and in this stage of your development you won't be able to comprehend why and how people go out to this path. I mentioned it to you, only because you would

remember and understand it when you meet very developed people to whom you won't be able to draw closer – not only to make friends with them.

In the beginning of discipleship, it seems to the disciple himself and to many people who surround him and know about his discipleship that he has to become almost saint with his kindness, restraint and tact, but it is thoughtless for himself and others to require some additional changes from the disciple.

This is the same light-mindedness as to imagine that death causes some stormy changes in the man's spirit and that he becomes either saint and goes to heaven, or he becomes sinner and goes to hell by squaring all accounts with his former life in a flash. Neither heaven nor hell exist. There's always the same Life that continues in a lighter form, exactly like there aren't any revolutionary changes in the path of the discipleship. All the incitements, all the ups and downs – that's the time before dawn of the discipleship.

Each strongest experience pushes man to the gorge where he is groping in the darkness until he sees the gate, shining before him. Having seen it, he goes towards it along such even path which he's built himself with his Wisdom during the period of his rushing about and suffering.

What is needed for the disciples, so that friendship would strike up between them? For both of them to be loyal to their Teacher. To be loyal till the end. This is the only condition. Everything else doesn't have any meaning.

But the path of the stubborn person is also an exception here. The stubborn person may be more loyal than all other loyal ones and anyway he will go down his earthly path without acquiring a single friend, he will fall out with everybody for all sorts of reasons.

By glancing over your day on duty, investigate the mistakes of your tact vigilantly – more vigilantly than anything else. Many things may slip by in the work of the day, one may do many things not till the end, but three moments of the disciple's conduct exist where no mistakes may happen. From the very first day of his discipleship, the disciple's attention has to be concentrated on these moments: tact, charm of his manners and not stinging speech.

Spiritual inequality, spiritual isolations don't exist for the disciple of the first level anymore. Of course, I don't talk about the disciples of the ray of Love, who need a high spiritual development in order to walk up that ray, the atmosphere of which is higher than other rays and which oppresses people more. Not a single disciple, however intemperate he would look by appearance, will bite a strange sin or passion anymore. Everybody who is accepted as the disciple merges with the Only One Life within himself.

If the disciple doesn't possess inner goodwill, he might lack some tact. And then external obstacles like chains woven from the thorns of roses and acacias rise on his path from all sides. In this way, having opened with his entire power of Wisdom in many cases, by surpassing many others with his knowledge and inner perfection, he might still be standing in one place, in his first stage.

Whatever the disciple would be doing during his ordinary day, if he doesn't improve the external form of his work presentation every day, if he doesn't develop his tact, then he won't achieve much from the point of view of his Teacher, although in people's opinion, he has achieved a lot.

The disciple cannot compete with an ordinary man with the external forms of his duty. You cannot achieve charm instantly if you don't possess it by nature, but you can observe vigilantly the disorder in your home, the manner of your dressing, your champing while you are eating, the buttons of your coat and the laces of your shoes...

Every meeting where only external, hypocritical politeness was demonstrated, while the thought: "You'd rather leave as soon as possible" inside of you was scraping, was only the same falling out of your duty as the meeting during which you gave a scoop of kindness, but you got irritated or you were unpleasant.

The third moment – a stinging word which slipped off the disciple's tongue has to show not an absolute his benevolence to himself. Hence, he needs to understand that in that moment the man fell out not only of the disciple's duty next to his Teacher, but also of the uniting with all the circles of invisible workers.

How could you develop a vigilant attention for these most important ways of your self-education?

If you concentrate your attention only on these three tasks, then your working day will become even more difficult than it was only from your present circumstances. But if you are simply working next to your Teacher in your thoughts and if you can feel his presence in all your actions, then your attention won't need any special additional tasks.

Besides, for his first steps every neophyte receives such big crew of invisible assistants who observe all his actions that his beginning is rather easy to him.

My friend, you still will have to overstep many fatal boundaries, but one of them is more important than others. Here it is: you've got accustomed to absolute independence, to an absolute freedom of movement, to searching for the Truth without the hands that direct you. Now, if my conversations have stirred the fire of creating spirit and heart within you, if you've understood me and believed in me, follow me, but walk in such a way as I will see and indicate it to you.

I explained to you that the law of unconditional obedience is voluntary and that it exists in discipleship not because it would oppress the disciple's will, but in order to protect him from his too passionate desire to serve everybody and to accumulate debts and obligations which surpass the disciple's strength due to lack of knowledge. This law protects the disciple from flounce. It helps him to stand firmly and joyfully in that place where his Teacher has put him and to not run from one place to another only because somebody uttered a cry that his help was more needed there, that he needed to leave off everything and to run to help namely there.

During disciple's duty next to his Teacher he has to perceive himself keeping watch with the bayonet by the powder depot where his Teacher put him. He cannot run from one place to another. If he receives his Teacher's instruction to go to another place or even to change the whole method or his path – then nobody will explain any details.

You need to understand yourself that the shoes bound with metal don't suit by the powder depot, and you don't climb the mountains with rubber soles.

The greatest independence in active daily actions is needed in the discipleship. And by developing such independence you need to learn to develop all your qualities and skills for your work on the earth among the most different characters, positions and people.

Now it is clear to you what the path of the disciple's liberation is. Understand it in a many-sided way, till the end. The disciple accepts not the obligations or the yoke of the monastic views, but he steps into the new, wide and joyful period of his life dedicated to knowledge which somebody's love gives to him after hearing the cry of his pure heart.

Next time I will tell you about the path of sadness."

My brother's inscription ended, and apparently, some time had passed between these just read and new lines, because both the ink and the manner of writing was different.

The words of the inscriptions enslaved me so much, the contents interconnecting with my own experience surprised me so much that I didn't even notice how the time flew past, how Eta began to appease his hunger and how the day was closing in behind the window. I opened another page and I started reading again.

"Having stayed alone, I came to myself not instantly. It always seemed to me that I could hear the deep, rich voice of my wonderful guest.

I was feeling strangely. It seemed to me that even the snowstorm behind the window was wailing somehow melodiously. The silence in the room was hanging around me, but for the first time in my life it was not mute and dead for me, but it was talking, singing, shining!"

Oh, how I could understand these words of my brother Nikolay now!

The silence of the nature began to speak to me not so long ago. I began to understand the voice of the silence not so long ago. I started feeling the life of the flowers, lawns, trees not so long ago...

Again my thoughts strayed to my brother-officer's life. Again I thought how it must have been difficult for him to live in the surroundings which were poor spiritually and mentally. And what kind of my brother's spiritual strength had to be that he succeeded to achieve an encounter with Ali independently. And that that was namely he, I didn't have any doubts anymore.

I remembered my brother's words and actions which only now were getting on into a logical row of views for me, I comprehended always clearer who was my brother Nikolay and how I was living next to him, even without thinking, next to how great man I was...

I didn't allow myself to stray to my recollections even more and I began to read again.

"I began to notice something new within myself, too, a certain recovery of sight. As though all my nerves became more sensitive, my ear – subtler, while my eyes could see clearer. It was very strange, and I myself was surprised. After my conversations with the wonderful friend the contours of his figure remain fixed in my memory, and it always seems to me that I can see the shining cloud in that place where he was sitting.

I comprehend my presence here little and I only notice that suddenly I come to myself, as though I fall down from heaven, because the dumb servant touches me and he shows with his gestures and smile that I need to go to eat and to sleep, or to go to visit the horses, or something else.

It is strange – it was stranger than everything else, - but I began to understand clearly that my servant wasn't dumb at all. And second – I really began to read all his thoughts, as though a thread of moving views would connect my and his heads. In the beginning it stunned me, and I got stiff by looking at the dumb servant, but having noticed the humour that lip up in his eyes and his naughty smile with which he was darting glances at me, I came to myself instantly.

I value absolutely soberly another new power that opened within myself: I know precisely when he, my wonderful friend, will come. And not only I know when he comes, but I can feel him coming from the distance, only I couldn't note the moment of the guest's coming a single time. Now I used to be exhausted and doze off from the great strain of waiting, now I used to gape at something, now the servant used to distract my attention with his expressive silence, but I used to give a start every time when my eyes met the stranger's ones absolutely unexpectedly.

The fire of his eyes still chains me, but I don't feel the pain from his unusually oppressing purity anymore, which surpasses me like an unattainable God's purity and love.

This time I also didn't detect when he came: I rose my eyes and I saw him sitting in the place of the shining little cloud, but even brighter and clearer than the last time. He didn't start talking instantly. Apparently, he didn't need the formality of greeting as well as I, because my entire being not only was waiting for him greedily, but I hadn't even parted with him by still chewing his left thoughts.

"Today I want to tell you about the most important path of discipleship, about the path of sadness.

First of all, what is the path of sadness? That isn't the path of liberation of the disciple himself, that is a great self-sacrifice by deciding to walk on the earth as the messenger of sadness, disasters and misfortunes for all of those whom the masters of karmas or the Teacher's hand sends to him.

What is the meaning of the path of sadness for people? According to the Christian belief, Christ descended to hell in order to save sinful souls from the eternal destruction. His descend to hell was Christianity's prediction which brought the law of karma for the new humanity and which dispersed the illusion of good-natured, moral indifference for every moment of life's flow, for that "now" with which man is living, which he can spend in vain by relying only on Providence.

The active energy which Christ has brought to people pulled the main support of hypocrisy from under the feet of ignoramuses and showed an example of the action "till the end", an example of the action of his personal kindness and love.

You can bring only the news of awakening for the sinful people, and only it will be the news of their salvation. But to bring the salvation itself for somebody – that means to turn man only into the big sheaf of straw that may be turned inconveniently and that complains of discomfort of his state, and Christ destroyed this illusion.

His mission – that's to awaken man for his spiritual growth of full value. He is still living now, he is living, working and creating by using people's hands and feet. Every disciple of the path of sadness is his closest worker, his primary weapon with which the spiritual path of the whole company of people is formed.

The messenger of sadness – that's always the man who is endowed with many great talents, who always possesses higher than mediocre skills. That is the last stage before incarnating as the genius.

There are many stages along the path of sadness as well as along any other. Some of the disciples of the path of sadness who are more developed spiritually are walking along by comprehending their strength completely, they give sadness to people by not suffering themselves from those blows as the messengers of which they come, and they come with the olive twig of peace in their hands. Such disciple, by hitting their encountered people, are pouring peace and strength for them not only to awaken, to recover their sight, but also to go out to the new life after learning to overcome by loving.

Their younger brothers of the path don't know that they are walking down the path of sadness. They notice that their approach with people, their love and friendship destroys people's wellbeing. With great suffering they learn to overcome their fear to bring disasters to people. Their talent helps them to break through to the knowledge in a certain way, they meet their Teacher, and then the path of Light begins for them.

Their consciousness becomes completely free, tranquillity comes to their shaken organism, and the disciple of the path of sadness is already walking down his own path easily. He understood, accepted and blessed all his circumstances which he considered to be tragical before. By understanding completely that not a segment of life exists – one separated incarnation, but that only Eternity exists, which is poured into the flying past “now” as into the form of his incarnation, the disciple begins to understand all his encountered people only as segments of Eternity.

While keeping watch of Eternity, the disciple of the path of sadness begins to comprehend all the misfortunes of the temporary forms as joy by understanding that the external man's path, the whole meaning of his presence – that's to achieve liberation as soon as possible, to throw down the oppressing screens of his understanding of life as forms of only the Earth and to start acting as the living consciousness of the two worlds.

All sorts of persons from the society flash before you. A row of births, a row of deaths. You are living in the atmosphere of the long, cruel war and you know that a bullet of the enemy may meet you from behind every cape of the mountain.

It seems why you, the man who is searching for high spirituality, with such development and erudition, possessing an exceptional intellect and talent, why you should live in the presence of constant death, among cretins and murderers, among dullards and libertines whom you must meet several times a day?

The question of the external justice isn't raised in the discipleship: why and for what purpose? The distance between the humanly “happiness” and the disciple's work – work of love and calm – is the same as the one between the primitive man who doesn't move away from his settlement further than 10 miles and the person of culture.

Even this comparison will help you little to understand your own and other people's earthly circumstances if your eyes still may cry, if your ears still may hear insults, and your tongue – to utter a stinging word.

Until these characteristics are still alive within you, you won't have enough strength to hold the cup of your Teacher in your hands, who has taken the common work on the earth with you upon himself.

Now rise with me above this small room where we are sitting, above your daily circumstances, above your worries about your brother, above the war and the constant encounters with the Caucasus mountaineers to the arena of the universal activity of Life.

Which of your fundamentals have remained unchanged within you now? What do you see now in the light surrounding you? You can see only two things – the fruit of which is the earth itself and everything what is on its surface, - love and work.

Love is creating without any stopping. Its work is of two kinds and inseparable from itself. It is toiling by awakening people to the high path and by helping them to develop. And at the same time it

pours with its actions through their work on the earth by bringing people together, by uniting them, by growing them like the flowers and the fruit for the future generations.

Among the thousands of chaotically moving forms – the twinkling and smouldering fires – you can see some separate fires which are burning evenly, you can see even some separate areas which are burning with a calm flame of the bonfire. What is it? Why are some of the fires – majority of them – twinkling and spreading stench around them? Why don't some separate little fires go out among these fires of the swamp? Why don't those burning posts and bonfires of the flame burn down everything around them?

The trembling and twinkling little fires – that's those who are working in the flow of passions and comprehension of only the earth alone. All the incarnations of these people don't have any sense, because nobody understood from them that they were standing by the Eternity. And their activity by developing their personality is unable to break through the conditional partitions and it doesn't grow into the eternal spiritual creation. Only their personal love, rare cases of their self-sacrifice, their desire for beauty revive their spirit, it begins to shine for a moment and then it plunges into the shell of their personality soon again.

You can also see some very tiny, hardly smouldering little spots. Take a good look at them, some of them are shining in a faint, but even little fire – that's the animals. Some of them are flashing. That's the wild beasts, as well as the faded away people's consciousnesses. Now you are still unable to distinguish the consciousness of the wild beasts who are splattering the beams of red sparkles from the dark, faded away human one, which also are flinging sparkles and flashes. Both of them now are equally repulsive for your consciousness and they are stinking.

Now look at the shining, wide, evenly burning areas of fire. Those are the little pieces of the Earth, which are cleaned from the human tears, sorrows and suffering. Those are the places where those who know are living. They know that life on the earth – that's the life of work when all passions experienced and you go to Eternity. Those are the places of the hearts who are happy, liberated from passions, who are working calmly.

To live without any work on the earth is the same as to live without any use for yourself and the entire universe. Nobody ever needs to be afraid of too hard work, because each heavy burden is forming a certain habit of the spirit discipline within man.

There are many people who are walking down their own paths of the earth and who are stooped from their back-breaking work. Never feel sorry for these people. They can form within themselves the habit of the disciplined obedience only through this compulsory work, the work for the bit of bread. And eventually the rudiments of this work discipline form the kernel of their spirit. Only that man may develop the entire spiritual power within himself who himself succeeded to create the basis of his spiritual kernel in this temporary earthly form, without any strange help. And for that he certainly needs to reach the heroic strain. He must turn it into his daily work form, then he has to achieve firm self-control of his entire organism, so that his work would become easy for him, and finally he has to rise to that inner harmony which gives the sense of charm and not difficulty to his entire working day.

Only from this moment on a possibility for the man opens to comprehend that "day" is only that what man put into it and not that what came to him from outside. The more persistently he is trying to perceive it, the clearer he can see and understand that he's carrying all the "miracles" within himself. He stops waiting, hoping for something and he starts acting.

Come back to your life in the small room again. Now you understood that nobody may be forgotten, left alone or given too little, because everybody is demonstrating his spirit himself – from the kernel till the whole his strength, and nobody except the man himself is able to force him to burn brighter, to die out or to twinkle.

Why are personally you living in such unsuitable surroundings for you now? Did it prevent you from meeting me? Did it move our meeting away?

My questions surprise you. Not only you showed any dissatisfaction for a single time that you were living among dunderheads, but you didn't even ask yourself why were you put away to such godforsaken place? Heaven could hear only your gratitude for the nature's beauty in which you were living from you, but nobody could hear any anger, dissatisfaction or envy from you. That what could disturb a doubting man made you only stronger. The more thieves of the state's property, bandits, deceivers and hypocrites you saw, the clearer the value of your each own word was for you, the more persistently you were searching for a possibility to awaken the perception of the Life's grandeur of your encountered man. You were growing in the surroundings which were toxic, shaky and where they were drinking hard, but you didn't fall down together with them. You strengthened and cleaned with your own living example everybody whom only you could help.

Now it is clear to you that your inner tranquillity, your calm approach to your surroundings, your blessing of all your circumstances and your pure searching for God not for meditations, but with your daily work, sped up our meeting, shortened your path to me.

You'll have to separate with your brother whom you love so much not because it would hurt your heart, but because the path of clairvoyance has to open up for him, in which neither you nor even I could help him.

He must cross the fire of his work himself, and the higher he will have to go, the denser the screen of his suffering will be, which he will have to rip open. His path – that's the path of clairvoyance, the third among the most difficult ones of the discipleship. We'll talk about it tomorrow."

The record ended again, and I kept reading after several slipped lines:

"You understood me correctly: everything is strictly logical along the path of discipleship, but the laws of the spirit's logic are completely different than the ones of the earth's logic.

From the point of view of inhabitants of the earth, the earth is turning in a dead space, in the ether which comes to life for them only when the Earth itself transmits its news through it or receives them with the waves which you can catch with physical means.

You need to attribute the discipleship to those phenomena where the physical means of reception and transmission play the most insignificant role.

The disciple's look that even doesn't possess a possibility to see more than others do, possesses an inner flexibility. He penetrates into the whole being of his encountered person with the warmth of his heart and he rejects his personal impression, because the fire of his own straining after the Superior burns down the conditional estimation within him instantly.

The disciple is trying not to hear or see the buzzing arrows with which his encountered person pours him. In the beginning it is difficult for him to hold out in the high waves of the ether. Then he

develops a habit to build the bridge of help from his heart, on which the image of his Teacher is shining, and finally he learns to stretch his hand always together with his Teacher's hand. From then on the disciple's life becomes easy and simple.

In this stage some psychic skill opens up for every disciple: either he begins to hear or to see, or a new talent of the artist opens up in his conductor.

Such is the path of development of the spiritual powers within man who has crossed the fiery wall of his suffering and who has lost his personal passions in that suffering. Having acquired the spiritual power, he threw out all the rags of his old and newly acquired passions, he entered the life of activity and collaboration with his Teacher naked in the same way as he came to this world when he was born on the earth. The path of one's liberation is the same for everybody in all the paths of discipleship.

But the third from the most difficult paths – the path of clairvoyance – doesn't submit to this law. This path is maturing for many centuries. Many times man brought it to the earth differently during each of his incarnations. Depending on the man's karma of centuries, he either possesses the talent of hearing and vision since his childhood, or it opens up for him only in his old age, or it shakes his youth unexpectedly with its sudden appearance.

This man's talent pours in the most different forms. His Teacher always shares with man the responsibility and difficulties of his talent. The whole high spiritual power of the clairvoyant not at all always reveals itself during each man's incarnation. Depending on the link of the man's brought karma, depending on the connection with the surroundings of that incarnation, one or another part of his talent reveals itself stronger.

The person who is walking down the path of clairvoyance meets two difficult tasks inevitably: either he is walking through the depth of passions and fire, and he has to live in them every day by cleaning himself and his path with the greatest tiredness, or the high assistants who take care of him are preparing him for this in a special way.

In the first case the work with the disciple's Teacher only on the earth, in its grey daily routine among working people is given to him. During the most difficult days the centres of help are created through him for those who want and who are searching for liberation and who cannot leave independently during the hour of their earthly suffering.

It is the most difficult for the disciple-clairvoyant who isn't distinguished for any other skills from his surroundings to associate with inconstant people and those who comprehend the life of two worlds with difficulty.

Their constant exactingness for the disciples whom they consider to be their servants, who have to show attention to them all twenty-four hours a day, often ruin the Teacher messenger's health, because he doesn't have enough strength to withstand the attacks of the restless auras that surround him. Only then the constant trembling of the entire disciple's aura grows into the post of fire when his Teacher covers him with his cloak, when he stands between him and people like a protective buffer. In these cases Teacher is always connected with the disciple in one or another way.

Why do I tell you about all of it? So that you would be calm and secure for your brother's fate. He will be walking protected by his high guardians, while you've understood and played your role – the role of brother-father – correctly. Now it is finished.

When man's Teacher shows to him that his role is finished somewhere, that his karma is finished in certain respects, then you need to understand that the paths of the disciple are opened till the end for the Teacher's clairvoyance.

Compare the Teacher's clairvoyance with that drop of knowledge which the disciple possesses.

During the moments of the disciple's spiritual concentration every disciple understands perfectly the big distance between both consciousnesses and the unreachable reference point of his Teacher. But having received the news from the messenger, he often tries to correct those places where he would like to see himself absolutely differently.

If it is necessary that he would know that his karma with those whom he loves and respects is finished, and if he's told about it, anyway he will explain persistently that his karma is old, that he is connected with eternal threads, as if the old karma had some advantage or value. All old karmas which really are important and valuable by something will always be felt only like a shining happiness and will never cause any mental diseases.

The people who are searching for the path of liberation don't expect anything for their spirituality from those for whom they serve sincerely, and they turn their karmic debt into work next to them. That's why they get overtired, irritated, they run to have a rest and so on. When they receive a news, an instruction or a task from the messenger they don't have enough strength to set heroically to the new action indicated to them, they are waiting for something to mature within themselves, while actually they are examining the news brought by the messenger. Often the work of the entire incarnation is lost, the indicated task, not undertaken instantly remains unfulfilled, and the karma with which he had to liberate his old debtor closes stronger than the snail's shell.

Besides those difficulties that arise in all the paths of discipleship, the path of clairvoyance has several peculiarities which aren't characteristic for other rays. Even before the least expressed clairvoyant when the disciple is only the channel who passes his Teacher's speech, three Earthly crosses of superstitions and false views arise:

1. The disciple's own fear. If this fear isn't overcome till the end, that is, if the disciple's loyalty hasn't poured out along his entire path till the end, then he is afraid that he can mislead somebody.
2. The disciple's courage. If his courage isn't poured together with his Teacher's courage till the end, then it will be neither courage nor compassion, but only a tear shedding and sentimentality. And the disciple is able neither to see clearly nor to hear that what his Teacher tells him due to this tear shedding, because compassion of the ray of clairvoyance which is based on courage is always calm and often even strict.
3. The vision which his Teacher gives to the disciple burns down his possibilities to communicate with the vulgar forms of communication. The disciple is destined for solitude, because he cannot go to the vulgar surroundings by holding his Teacher's hand, while his encountered lower middle classes consider him to be proud and insensitive man.

These three crosses of the initial path of clairvoyance become heavier also from the gap by comprehending the most ordinary daily things. Everybody who comes to the disciple is living with his

personal feelings: “My house”, “My family”, “My work and my achievements” and so on. The disciple is praying only for one thing: “Tear to pieces the conditionality of apprehensions in my consciousness, which prevent me from communicating with spirit and fire. Take the oppressing screens of conditional love off my physical eyes and lead me to the power of spirit where the living Love burns down the whole possibility of tears and suffering.”

Losing touch between the clairvoyant-disciple and the concepts of his surroundings falls on his path with the fourth cross, but only till that moment until he reaches an absolute loyalty. After his loyalty unites with his Teacher, the disciple's path becomes easy, simple and joyous.

Clairvoyance as the main work of your day doesn't exist along your path, but it is operating as reading of people's thoughts. The greater your purity, honour and calm will be, the clearer the spiritual development of your encountered person for your inner sight will be.

The advancement of disciples through the stages of spiritual growth doesn't depend at all on the powers of the higher consciousness which develop or hide within them. Such disciples in whom there wouldn't be a possibility to open for the powers of higher consciousness doesn't exist. Every kernel of the spirit who possesses the attraction to the fire of the Light also possesses the power of awakening within himself, to be precise, he possesses strength to wake up.

But also here, as down all the paths of liberation, fear is standing on the way. Man who has lived his entire life of searching in superstitions, in most cases shuts the door to knowledge himself. He is afraid of striving for some new stages of his development “without his Teacher”. He is reading in books about yoga that he may damage his health and brain without precise instructions. But he forgets that until that time when he can reach some knowledge which give a possibility to open powers within himself, he will have to clean, put himself in order and to tune at least his physical conductor, and only then to start thinking about harmony of his entire organism with the spiritual flows, about such harmony that would help him to achieve the first stage of self-discipline – self-control.

Everything in discipleship is based on the first rules of self-education: restraint and tact. When the external breeding is achieved, irritation overcome and when vigilant control of yourself has already taken root, only then a possibility appears to get into the range of vision of your Teacher. The flame stops twinkling and it may be noticed.

Vigilant control of yourself turns all the concepts of “my” into an easy apprehension of your modest place in the universe. And the higher man rises, the clearer he can see how distant the path is, how difficult it is to walk it down, and how little it is achieved.

Only from this moment on the cleaning of the man's organism begins, which always brings him to his Teacher.

The fears that he will become “obsessed” from yoga exercises, - that's only stupid fairy-tales of old women about kites and about the spirits that help or trouble them. If man has already tried his strength in black magic along his path, for which he also had neither tenacity nor self-control, then he will be ill with mental diseases during some of his incarnations. And nobody is able to liberate him from the law of the universe – the law of cause and effect.

You need to take a good look at your encounters down your path of clairvoyance, more than in any other of the paths. That person who is walking down this path, whenever his clairvoyance would awaken, however poorly he would control it, he always enters that circle of encounters in which his life passes on to the next ring of fire. The colour of the fire ring of every man – that's the result of his activity of ages. Here again the same law of cause and effect cuts down not only the small shrubs of man's errors

before him, but also roots out the big stumps from the fallen down trees of sin, doubts, treasons and vulgarity.

The fear of superstitiously understood “prohibitions”, as well as the constant address to authorities stop the development of the man’s spirit. Namely they become that deadlock in which the man’s searching ends and his “searching” begins.

In most cases the man’s habit to reconsider his encountered people, their words, their circumstances and not actions impedes him. When man encounters another person’s actions, he awakens himself effective emotions within himself. But when he puts only another person’s mental power from one place to another, then he is living only with that part of his organism in which his mind’s emotions prevail.

The disciple’s mind protects him neither from exhaustion of his nervous system, nor from tiredness, nor from senile dementia. Man’s mind tires out the organism cells, because physical organism is able to live only by being in creative harmony with the spirit and heart cells. Then he is really living.

The man’s opening, the secret of clairvoyance – that’s Love, Spirit, Wisdom which are poured into his organism through kundalini. They are poured in differently, in different ways and depending on it, man’s sight, hearing and other talents open up. But the path of the man’s opening is always the same: the matter of the invisible Spirit becomes visible for man’s brain.

The path is simple, the actions are easy. But the chastity of the man’s thought, as the result of the Light within him, comes to those who were searching not for joy for himself, but for loyalty for his Teacher...”

The record ended. I didn’t want to turn another page. Everything what I read was exceptionally deep and sacred. I looked at Eta who was sleeping next to me, and my thoughts strayed to the past centuries. Now it seemed to me that for the first time I understood what it meant to act. I was surprised how inactive I was, how much time I was spending uselessly, how much of my time was flying without any use.

Eta woke up and listened attentively to something. Also I lent an attentive ear to the silence, but I could hear only a light rustle of palms.

All of a sudden Eta jumped up, ran to the balcony by always turning around, as though by inviting me, too. I stood up and I saw Francisco coming to our balcony.

He was smiling to me and he waved me to come to him. I was happy when I saw this wonderful, radiating face. I forgot about the whole sadness of the earth, it seemed to me that heaven itself was smiling to me and inviting me...

Chapter 10

I visit the new places of the Community with Francisco in the night.

The new encounters and the new lessons

When I went downstairs, Francisco took my arm and told me.

“Let’s go, Lovushka, I want to show one part of the Community to you, which you haven’t yet seen.”

I thought that Francisco didn’t know that one night I was already walking in the park and that I saw the night life of the Community in the distant valleys and the little houses where brothers and sisters of the Community rendered help for the wandering unfortunate people. But Francisco turned to the absolutely different side and he was taking me down the path to the lake.

“It is already evening, Lovushka, and you’ve missed the supper. Here’s some fruit and bread for you. I took them for you. Our way isn’t very long, but we’ll come back only towards morning, and you won’t have time to eat. You might be surprised why I took so little and so poor food. But you see, you need

to try to eat little on the way. And moreover, if man is striving for the high discipleship, he has to accustom his organism to eat in such a way that he wouldn't feel a constant, irresistible need to eat. You don't need to think that you can achieve spiritual perfection or psychic self-control if you cannot control your appetite and force it to submit to a certain discipline. That person who fails to arrange his working day in such a way that feeding – which is necessary for each body that is living on the Earth – would be only a part of his strict daily routine, is unable to achieve the firm and strict system with his psyche which leads him to self-control. Man who always yields to temptation to feel hunger, who is always searching for a snack, isn't different in anything from the glutton who grows fat during the never-ending feasts. There aren't any especial, strict rules for food in discipleship, such as the conditions of monasteries for the monks. And no abstinence in discipleship should restrict the man who is trying to enter that path in which he may meet his Teacher. It is impossible for man to find the path to his Teacher until the images are living in his consciousness: to abstain in principle, to refuse in principle. Until the thought to refuse something is swarming, he didn't rise above those who are searching for a profit for themselves everywhere. His thoughts are still turning about himself, exactly in the same way as the thoughts of the person who is searching for a profit from everything. Such man is striving not for Eternity, but only for widening and development of his personality. Our disciples, brothers and sisters, move forward not with their heroic deeds. One moves forward only with love down the path of one's liberation. And that person who loves doesn't see any heroic deed when he shares his food with his close friend. He loves and he's happy to be able to support the temporary form of his brother and to serve his Eternity. Today you will visit the house in which the people are living who were looking for the Truth during their entire lives. You will see the people who are breaking into here as passionately as those millions of believers who desire to bow to the coffin of the Lord. Be vigilant. Don't enter the house with a condemning heart or eyes. Of course, also here you will see those whose searching was only "searching". You will understand that they are put under that roof and that they may not be allowed to enter the Community not because somebody selected them to live in this place. The joint power united everybody of them: their doubt. They didn't possess the power of spirit to develop their loyalty till the end. They wanted to accept one thing and to reject another one from each received news, to correct or comment something in their own way. They didn't manage to accept a single man who used to bring the news from us to their hearts easily, simply and joyously. Everybody seemed to be light-minded, inconstant to them, and not understanding them correctly. While they themselves didn't even notice how they were breaking the hearts of our messengers with their misunderstanding. My dear friend, now go to them with all the leaves of your heart opened. Open your heart like the gates, so that the power of your joy could break their superstitious self-love. Don't understand this word as being in love with themselves. No, I used it, so that I could define their main feature: subjectivity. The man who sees the universe in a subjective way is unable to enter the Community, because he doesn't have anything to do there. The atmosphere of the Community is like the air of the high mountains for such man where he would fall sick with the mountain disease instantly."

We went past a settlement behind the lake without haste and we got into the palm grove which I hadn't seen even from the distance and I didn't imagine that it existed. The hot night fell. The dark sky with the low bright stars, an especial scent of the flowers and the plants which I didn't know, the wonderful sounds of the night, an exceptional, tender Francisco's voice... I was walking, living, breathing, and everything – starting with Eta who was running next to me and ending with my friend's voice and hand – seemed to be unreal to me, everything was so incredibly charming.

Some of Francisco's words that matched with my brother's ones which I had just read in his note-book surprised me. I couldn't answer myself what was exciting me so especially, but I was walking by understanding that now I would see the people who spent their entire lives uselessly, but who thought that they were carrying the torch of light in their hands.

"We've already come, Lovushka. No, don't think so tragically about the people who didn't have strength to enter the Community. You only think that those cannot find the high path who weren't working on the earth, who were indulging themselves in the bed during the most part of their lives, who didn't get to know the discipline of work, who couldn't live neatly. The work of such people cannot direct their thoughts to that course where they could learn to open their psychic powers within themselves. To open at least as much so that they could liberate them with their love and will, so that they could have an opportunity to feel the vibrations of the high paths. Think about their misfortune and about their desire to reach us, about their own disharmony which they didn't notice during their entire life, and exactly it was an obstacle for them on their way to the Community. Love them, pity them, Lovushka, carry the whole manly courage to them, so that you could help their disappointment, heartbreak due to their ignorance when they understand it."

We came to the houses which were built at some distance one from another in the small, beautiful park. The lights were burning in some windows, but we couldn't see any people. Two big Great Danes whom Eta wasn't afraid of at all rushed at Francisco by greeting him like an old friend. Having stroked them, Francisco put my hands on the dogs' neck. The dogs gave a start, as though I had hit them, but soon they bowed their heads and licked my hands.

"Well, you are already accepted by these great watches. Now you can walk here freely and in all neighbouring houses. They will let all the dogs here and elsewhere know about you yourselves. How they do it – that's their secret. But once you make friends with them you become a friend for all our dogs, among whom there are also many dangerous ones."

Francisco took me to the door of one of the more remote houses, to be precise, to the hall. As soon as we entered the hall which was leading to the wide corridor, several doors opened instantly, and elderly people directed their eyes to us. A harsh voice from the end of the corridor asked us in an unfriendly voice.

"Who is disturbing us here so late? Didn't you have enough time to visit us in the day-time?"

The rest of them kept silent, but I felt a completely different atmosphere in this house than in those houses of the Community which I had an opportunity to visit. Of course, that wasn't a hostility for us, but the new prudence for me, which I hadn't felt anywhere in the Community.

"Don't worry, dear brother, we didn't come to you or to anybody from those who rushed out of their door now. You make pretensions to us that we disturbed your calm, although your monk had attributed silence personally to you. Why did you violate it? Were you appointed to keep watch by the entrance to this house?"

Francisco went to the end of the corridor from where the voice was heard, and I could inspect the man who was talking. That was a tall monk, dressed in daily clothes of the monastery. His pale face had distinct and regular features, with big eyes which were running about restlessly, with the strong, almost quadratic lower jaw and chin, with slender, compressed lips. There wasn't anything especial and unpleasant in him, probably he even was a kind man, but he surprised me with his anger and obstinacy, because I was used to see only calm and joyous faces in the Community. He was looking at us strictly.

"Seeker of the Truth," – the phrase flashed which I read in my brother's notes and which Francisco uttered. As soon as we went up to the monk and Francisco smiled to him, he changed immediately.

"Ah, that's you, brother-rescuer, that one whom my monk promised to me," his voice became soft, and once again I felt that he was a kind man. "I was waiting for you so much, I went on foot

more than a thousand versts only if I could see you, and they shut me in this house where I cannot see anybody else besides the obsessed fools. Understand for how long I was waiting for you, how I was suffering and I've already lost hope to find you, I already wanted to come back. Understand that I'm sitting here, locked for the entire month, I saw you several times only from the distance, in passing and I still didn't exchange a single word with you," this time a reproach and protest was heard in his voice.

"Are you kidding, my friend, do they really lock somebody up here? All the houses are opened during the day and night, life is in full swing around continuously. Everybody's needs are satisfied here. I can see from your clothes that you didn't have time even to brush the dust off them, your shoes are still full of sand, so you had left, you were in the mountains, you've just come back and you entered your room even without washing yourself. Didn't your monk gave three pledges to you?"

"Did he really write to you about them? Where from could you know about those pledges? And he is semi-literate, so he couldn't write anything to you," the monk felt more and more nervous.

"My friend, your monk told you: "Until you introduce three pledges to your life, you won't meet those who are serving the Truth.

First – rise with the sun, smile to the breaking day and help your first encountered person who needs your help. It doesn't matter what help he will need, it is important that your first work of the day would be for your fellow creature.

Second – give each of your smile not like a rare compassion, but start your every day and encounter from it.

Third – wash yourself before entering your cell, before each food."

That's what your pledges are. Which one of them were you carrying out now? Did you meet us with the smile? And you tell me that you were waiting for me. Did you wash yourself before supper? Did you come back clean to your cell?"

The monk kept silent by looking attentively at Francisco, and anxiety in his face became always stronger.

"Brother, please tell me whether you came to me or not. What I did I know that well myself. I don't ask your help, I will have enough strength for everything. I ask you: do I have to go with you now?"

I understood that two feelings were fighting inside of the monk's heart: haughtiness and puffing up which were reflected in the intonations of his voice clearly. His haughtiness made him to protest, while his respect for Francisco's love which was pouring to the monk like the whole streamlet made his heart humiliate himself.

"I've already told you, my friend, that I didn't come to you. Your curiosity for the strange life, the strange path forced you to go out and to look at us. Understand that man doesn't change only because he changed his living place. You are searching for God, for the sacred path, for the depth of the truth during your entire life, but you cannot live a single day calmly, although you've changed hundreds of living places. You say that you were waiting for me. But how did you prepare to meet me? Where is that ring of joy and tranquillity which people extend by greeting one another? You won't be able to walk ten steps after me, because your heart is obsessed with a riot, you will suffocate by following me. It isn't the place for you here. For how long you would be living here, you won't be able to come near to me. My elder brother will come soon to take you away from here. He will take you to the distant monastery. You will learn there how to live with the three pledges of obedience given to you every day, and only then you will be able to come back here. You will come back as soon as you understand that the entire value of your life on the earth –

that's its encounters, your ability to give not the poison of your "I" during each of them, but the power of cheerfulness by forgetting about yourself and thinking only about your encountered people. You will learn to start your encounter with joy and to end it with joy. Calm down. Don't flash your eyes and your heart, understand the obedient power of Love. Only she alone may bring you to me, if you were searching for the path of Love during your entire life. Don't think that power – that's persistence of will. Power – that's only joy."

The monk was standing pale and shaken. It seemed to me that since his searching and expectations didn't justify here, then his furious protest caused by the greatest disappointment might break in every moment.

We walked several steps and got by the stair which I didn't even notice in the beginning. Having gone upstairs, we found the same wide corridor as downstairs and the only living being who met us here – a big, shaggy dog of the breed and malice which I didn't know till now. He jumped out before us like a tiger, but having recognized Francisco, he bared his teeth, as though by smiling. He was looking at me with hostility, but Francisco put my hands on his head and stroked his shaggy ears by smiling and talking tenderly.

"Well, my brother, how stubborn you are! I've told you so many times that you should smile for everybody who comes with me, while you are keeping your smiles only for me alone again."

As though by understanding Francisco's reproaches, the dog licked my hand. Having stroked the dog again, Francisco knocked at one of the doors, and a weak, oldish voice invited him to come in.

I was surprised when we entered the room. Lately I was already used to see order everywhere in the Community, and there wasn't a single case where people would be lying in beds if they weren't sleeping or sick.

A complete mess was in this room, an old woman with the face furrowed with deep wrinkles, dressed and with her shoes on was lying in bed. Although the evening was hot, she was wearing a wadded waistcoat, a warm shawl was placed next to her and an inkpot was standing on the chair by the bed. A small palm plate with the white sheet of paper was in woman's hands and she was writing something. She didn't discern Francisco instantly and when she recognized him, as though a discontent flashed in her face.

"Ah, that's you, brother Francisco. As you can see, I don't have strength at all to live according to those requirements which you've made to me during our last meeting. I'm working by lying and I don't have any strength to put my room in order, while your sent girl is doing everything not right. She understands order in her own way, and nothing good comes out of it. You cannot even imagine what a lazy person she is. She's acting in one way by you and with you, but without you, with me she's completely different. I refuse her services. And besides, I have to ask you: if you want to help me, then please give your help personally to me and not through the other people's help to me. Helped through the third hands – that's not help, but a misunderstanding, and it may drive one to despair. That creates the whole row of troubles which never lack. Well, in one word, I organized everything in my own way, and it is not worth talking about it. You better tell me, did you come to me now as Ali's messenger? When does he come? When do I see him again and ask him all the questions which may not be postponed anymore?"

An indignation like a neglect or disregard was felt in woman's face and voice, as if an accumulate bitterness was pouring in her heart. She was trying to emphasize that the man was sitting before her, who was guilty of something for her, who pledged himself to do something for her and who was doing something incorrectly for her. As though she wanted to show Francisco how badly he cared of her. She surprised me even more than the monk. If he seemed to be a seeker to me, a stubborn seeker who

understood and who was doing everything in his own way, but who was searching for the Truth anyway, here it seemed to me that the woman's soul was searching not for the Truth, but for herself, for the powers of her personality and that she was trying to teach her each encountered person her wisdom. Her haughtiness and envy was pouring out of all opened pores of her spirit in this moment, which was imprisoned in her miserable, weak body and disorderly clothes.

"It is a great pity, sister Carlota, that as you said, there was little use from those three conversations of mine with you," I couldn't recognize the usual voice of my dear friend, because now the metallic notes were ringing in it, which I knew perfectly from Ananda's voice in certain moments. "Every time when I used to come to you I came as Ali's messenger. I used to tell you not my personal words, but I used to tell your Teacher's news to you. You call care of his love for you to be my demands. Sister, a judge, an officer, a good friend may demand something from you. Teacher – that's not a godfather or a benefactor, he is the messenger himself of Those who are walking higher than he is and whose loyalty is leading him. He may not demand anything from people. He can see every man and he knows that in the current moment of evolution of the universal development man is able to rise to the knowledge of higher levels only in such a way as he, Teacher, sees it. I used to tell you from him during all three times that you should change not only your external way of living, but also your entire inner way of thinking. Who told you that you were granted the right to estimate a man's personality? Every time you are trying to drop me a hint that my personality, in your opinion, hasn't yet grown till that level of perfection which my spirit has already reached. And that Teacher's words which I bring to people force them to try to overcome the judging consciousness within themselves, so that they were able not to see my personality, to go past me as by the big obstacle behind which Teacher's word of the Truth is hiding. At Ali's request, from the very first meeting I was trying to open the basis of any development to you, the primary level of the path of liberation. Everybody who is straining after his Teacher has only one prayer: "Let my eyes of spirit open for the Light and Calm that is living within man. Let my Love pour into his wounds and let your Compassion heal them. Let my day be the song of beauty, effective Love, Calm and Joy." What from all of it has taken root in the actions of your day? Did you accept the girl who was trying to help you as the Only One, as the encountered impoverished God, and did you extend the little part of your joyous work to her? You ask me when Ali comes almost with a pretention to me, because I haven't organized a faster meeting with him! If I hadn't Ali's instructions not to have it out with you, then perhaps I would try to explain your mistakes to you, but I'm acting in such a way as Ali sees your path and I give his order to you. In several days the group of people will go to the distant Communities. You will go with them. You don't have enough spiritual strength to enter the Community here and now. Meeting your Teacher may end with death for you, because you don't enough strength to withstand his high and strong vibrations. You were showed the path where you could become hardened and prepare yourself for this meeting, but you didn't accept it. The call isn't repeated twice. You will go to the distant Community, you will find those surroundings there in which you will be able to liberate your spirit and find the way out of the sheets of your personality which have swaddled you strongly now. You think that you are old and weak, that you won't bear the difficult way, that death is waiting for you in the new place. Cast away these superstitions. These are the superstitions of your unfaithfulness, or to be precise, of your loyalty not till the end, and that is like unfaithfulness for your Teacher. Man is living for as long as he is able to develop his spirit, although nobody could see it, or until there's hope that some superstition will fall off him, or until he is needed to help those with his work, who are walking down their spiritual path without the material possibility to maintain themselves. I'm not obligated to discuss the arisen situation with you. All your complaints and protests only burden your life. You came here, hence our compassion and attention was showed to you, but here you are living in the same way as you are used to among philistines in your previous living place. You cannot live Philistine life in the Community. The compassionate people give one more possibility to you. Hurry to take advantage of it. Stop thinking about yourself, about the needs of your deteriorating body. Don't judge people. Don't

demand anything from them, but try to learn obedience and joy to live your “now” by blessing people not with your words, but by really loving them. The path to one’s Teacher goes only through love for people. Remember it. Go in a simple and joyous way, by thanking and glorifying Ali for his care for you. He knows your entire path and not only that segment which you know yourself.”

Francisco stood up and he didn’t allow the woman to answer him with a single word, although she was trying to interrupt him by growing pale and red, by throwing her shawl off and wrapping herself with it again.

It was painful in my heart. I had already seen many times how blind the people were in their encounters, how they didn’t have strength to see who was standing before them, also how I myself couldn’t see not only my brother Nikolay, but I understood even I.’s, Florentian’s and Ali’s grandeur not so long ago. Both encounters of this evening, the negative encounters here, in the Community stunned me.

“Lovushka, take Eta in your arms. He is still young and he may be frightened with something in the dark.”

As always Francisco’s voice was sounding as if nothing had happened, he was full of love and tenderness. And how his self-control, his unshakable Love surprised me, although I was distressed, excited and confused.

“About what self-control of mine are you thinking, Lovushka? Does Love within man decrease, because it was poured and somebody didn’t take it? That place into which you pour your Love will always be the place of calm, although the other man won’t calm down and he will remain worried, while you are next to him. Your Love – if it was effective, if Life was pouring into the unfortunate person’s heart who didn’t understand you like the whirl of joy – will always create a refreshing stream around him. When he remains alone, he will calm down, he will recover his balance and tell others: “I’ve found the answer to my questions.” Therefore, if you ever get into the similar situation as now in your life, then spread only Light and Calm, spread the entire Love of your heart, be on guard of Eternity and don’t think about the consequences of your meeting.”

As soon as Francisco uttered these words, a shadow jumped out of the bush and somebody seized my arm. In the same moment the angry dog that met us upstairs stood on his back legs, he leant his front paws against the chest of the man who attacked us and mouthed up the hands of both of us. His bite wasn’t painful, but he mouthed up our hands so strongly that we couldn’t move them. The dog was looking at the man absolutely calmly, against whose chest he had rested his front paws. Having looked at him more attentively, I recognized the monk.

“What, Frisco?” I heard Francisco’s voice. “He isn’t a villain. He was simply waiting for me and he seized not me. Go calmly, my dear dog, everything is all right.”

“What have you done, brother Leonore? You disturbed even the dogs’ stillness, not only people’s. Don’t you understand that until you cannot control your passions and your outbursts like this, until your flights and aspiration for God may arouse violence against people or animals within you, you cannot work next to me.”

“Father, friend, forgive me!” Leonore groaned and fell on his knees before Francisco’s feet. “I cannot separate from you. Only you alone may take me to Christ. Only through you I can learn to serve God and to find salvation. Don’t send me away. I will be meek and silent next to you. Forgive me for my impudent words. That’s only my jealousy. Because you are walking with this lad and you give happiness to him to be next to you, actually I wanted to strangle his peacock. Don’t push me away.”

Leonore kept weeping with his arms round Francisco's feet. Again a growling was heard, and this time not of a single dog. I discerned the whole pack of dogs who were drawing nearer to us in the dark. Apparently they thought that a danger threatened to their adored Francisco. I understood like this their manoeuvre to encircle us.

"Stand up, my poor friend. I cannot do anything more than I'm doing for you now. One may bring the news about awakening and salvation to somebody, but salvation itself hides within man, and he alone may reach it along his own path by overcoming not only his bodily passions, but also his spiritual outbursts within himself. Horror and ecstasy, heroic deed and protest, self-will and meekness interchange within you, but there's never any calm within you. You are always thinking about the task which you've put for yourself, but the monk said to you that until you don't immerse yourself into the most ordinary daily routine of your life, until you don't get all your "searching" out of your head, until you don't become an ordinary, loving man who is working for the sake of others, you won't achieve anything. Only through your daily work you will be able to understand the grandeur and horror of the people's paths. You've been walking almost over all the countries of the world and you always compared where and how people believed in God. Finally you came to the Russian monk, you acknowledged his belief and his sacred life, and you left again. Now you came to our place. And here you always criticize, deny, select for yourself in the same way, you don't become involved in a single work offered to you, but you can see that everybody is working here, and nobody is spending his time uselessly."

"My father, this is only because I see you so rarely. I will be listening to you sacredly, only don't send me away, let me follow you."

"My friend, I say to you that you won't be able to take at least ten steps after me and you will start suffocating in my atmosphere. If you want to come to me after some time, there's only one path for you – to leave with my elder brother who will call you."

"Ah, father, father, why are you telling me such improper words? Why do you tell me untruth? You are shining like an angel and you tell me nonsense. Well, can I suffocate if this baby is able to walk next to you? Well, he still cannot walk with you without a doll, and you are talking about me as about a weak baby. If he was stronger than me, then would he catch hold of the bird like a girl of a toy? Drive him away, accept me, and you will see how I will be serving you."

"Good-bye, my friend. I told you everything what I could tell you. Fall out of the habit of denying, judging and you will find the way to me easily and simply. Frisco, accompany the guest home," Francisco addressed the dog who didn't step back from us. "Remember, Frisco, that the guest is our friend. Accompany and protect him. Let him into his house and don't allow him to leave anywhere till the morning. Go, my brother, let calm accompany you. Go, calm down and wait for my friend. Stop rushing about, go to the distant monastery. If you find strength to curb the riot within yourself, then you will find the tranquillity of the Truth and Wisdom."

I thought for a moment that the monk would attack Francisco. His eyes were burning like coal, he was clenching his fist nervously and grinding his teeth... But the moment passed, he bowed low to Francisco, touched the ground with his hand and uttered in a hoarse voice with difficulty.

"Let it be, as you told it to me."

He turned round and already wanted to go, but then he walked to me and told me benevolently.

"Forgive me for insulting you, I didn't do it maliciously."

"Oh, I understood instantly that you were kind," I bowed as low to him as he did it to me.

When I lifted my head, the man and the dog already disappeared in the darkness. Francisco took my arm, I let Eta on the ground, and we went back through the undisturbed silence of the night, as if nothing had happened around us.

I thought that we were going home, because I didn't understand where we turned in the darkness. The little edge of the big moon's disc emerged from behind the mountains, and soon it became as bright as in the day-time. Now I saw that we kept moving forward, and that the landscape reminded me of the desert more and more. We approached a small grove. The shadows of its trees fell on the lit up path in fantastic patches.

"Now you will see the same unfortunate people. They are also our people of God. Their long life was dedicated to God, fast, prayers and the Holy Writ. Every one of them was trying to find some association and fraternity by sacrificing their entire lives for the explanations who God was, what His aspects were and what man had to do for the sake of God. But they couldn't see the spirit of God within man himself and they couldn't bow to it till the end. The whole task of your searching for God – that's to learn to respect and to bless with kindness that form with which the Only One exists within man, so that your work for this form would be the sacred task of the day for you, so that the Only One would be not a formal symbol for you when you meet a man, but that the temporary, living form would flow into the wonderful sound of the joint Harmony. If you are full of the shining joy, you can see the miracle inside of man instantly, although he cannot see it himself. Everybody cannot see it due to the different reasons. One of them cannot see it, because karma is still holding him firmly, and he is unable to liberate himself from fear and vengeance, greediness and jealousy in any way, for which he was serving during the entire centuries. The second one is unable to break away from the row of the superstitions of his duty and personal love. The third one hit the barrier by trampling on the level of the tasks of narrow mind. The fourth one blocked up the exit to freedom himself with his constant running about to good work by leaving only dregs and irritation at home, and so on. Soon we'll drop in at a scientist's who is solving the cosmic tasks during his entire life."

Francisco fell silent. Having walked a little, we met an old man who looked like kalmuc. He smiled pleasingly to us and stroked Eta's neck tenderly. Usually Eta didn't like the touches of strange hands, but he rubbed his head to his leg.

"Mulga, why don't you sleep?" Francisco asked him by greeting the old man.

"I didn't have time to pull aside the rest of the fallen down tree, and it will be not good when somebody goes down the road in the morning. I'm using the moonlight, only I'm afraid that professor may start quarrelling that I disturb him. I try to work silently, but some twig crackles now and then."

Goodwill and tranquillity was blowing from the old man.

"What is going on here? Mulga, I have no peace because of you both during the day and the night. Because of you I have to stop my work, to open the window and to let all sorts of the night mucks, midges and moths into the room. Could you speak more silently with your unbearable dogs? I cannot even make a step anywhere, I meet them in any time of the day or the night. And what is here to protect? Just think, what treasures! Some rotten, little houses!"

His voice was irritated, I could feel that the man was pouring his old streams of accumulated bitterness and dissatisfaction on poor Mulga's head.

"And when finally do I hammer into your stupid head that you interrupt my thoughts on which perhaps the new perception of the star life depends?"

The voice was heard through the window, then it closed, and only the sighs of distressed Mulga were heard in the silence of the night. He whispered to Francisco by shaking his head.

"Forgive me, my friend, that because of me you had to be the witness of this unpleasant scene. I always forget that my voice is so strong. Ah, my God! How stupid I am, I troubled poor professor again, I disturbed everybody's calm here again. It is a real trouble if the palmer was also praying and if he comes here now. Well, here he comes already. Now there will be no peace till the evening both for me and for my poor dog."

Francisco was smiling by not moving from his place, although Mulga persuaded him to leave and avoid the meeting with the palmer who was coming straight to us by leaning on his long stick. His white, linen clothing contrasted strongly with his luxuriant, black hair that stuck out to all sides from under his cap, with his black beard and with his fiery, black eyes. He was going resolutely, and we could see his indignation clearly.

"Mulga, I told you last time that I would bear a complaint against you to the Community. Now I won't complain, but I will demand that they would send you away from here together with your stinking dogs. Last time you prevented me from reaching an ecstasy, and now, when I had already reached it, the sight was already opening for me, I could already feel how the Holy Virgin was descending to me, my heart fainted sweetly, then again you with your talk to your stinking dogs threw me down from the sight onto the earth."

Strong and commanding palmer's voice was harsh tenor of unpleasant guttural timbre. It seemed to be too high for his stout figure and it wasn't fit at all for his appearance, his beard and his white clothes.

"Forgive me, my dear brother," embarrassed Mulga told him. "I couldn't imagine in any way that my voice could disturb your sacred prayer. I was rather far away from your room, and my dog was next to me."

"You don't have to trill and justify yourself in Lazarus voice, to cry for my compassion," the palmer interrupted him, "can I forgive you that you dispersed my sight? Heaven was prepared to open up for me, and this crime befalls on you, because I didn't see it. You need to be thrown out of here, I go to the Community immediately, I will tell the whole truth to the chief there. And he is also good, that chief of theirs! They don't know and understand anything what is going on here: they tell me that the clairvoyant came, while he sends the order for me to wait here. Well, has anybody see such incomprehensibility anywhere?"

The clairvoyant wanted to add something else, but Francisco came out of the shadow, bowed to the stranger and asked him.

"Aren't you brother Jerome who has sent the cross with the sacred relics to the Community?"

"Yes, I've sent the cross with the relics and the kerchief with which I wiped the Lord's coffin."

"If you are clairvoyant, then why do you deceive people? You knew that there was the dried-up bread instead of the relics in the cross and you know better than others that you've never been by the Lord's coffin, not only you didn't wipe it. I give back both your cross and your kerchief to you, take them. I was sent to tell you that your future repentance was put both on your cross and on your kerchief. Until you

don't learn to tell only the truth, you won't be able to take the cross off you, which I hang for you, and you won't lose the kerchief which I put into your pocket. Wherever you would leave this kerchief, to whomever you would give it, it will come back to you anyway, it will find you everywhere. Only when your lips and your heart learn to glorify God not with words, but rightly and obediently, only then you will come back here and find the entrance to the Community. Now it is not the place for you both here and there. Leave this place, poor man, and in order for your talk not to disturb people, go in silence, lose your speech and recover it only when you really come to the Lord's coffin. Comprehend the truth: with what you were enticing in a deceitful way, that you have to expiate yourself. You were frightening people that you would summon the God's punishment upon them. Go on foot to Jerusalem, do the whole penance ritual there, which you forced to do to many people, find fearlessness in your heart. When the whole fear disappears from your heart, then love and the truth will awaken in it. So then you will come back here. I deprive you of speech not because I would like to humiliate and harm you, but so that I would save you from all those reckless words which boil within you. Go, my friend. Here it isn't the place for you now. You came to the Community only because you would understand the horror of your delusion and find the path to salvation. Here, this noble dog will take you to the nearest settlement alive and healthy, from which the local dwellers will accompany you on the camel back to the inhabited lands. There you will receive some food and money, and then travel yourself. The sooner you will lose your haughtiness, the easier your path will be. Go, let God bless you."

The clairvoyant was going through an exceptional inner fight. He was growing red and pale, while as ill luck would have it, the moon was shining straight into his face, and the grimaces of his efforts to begin to speak seemed to be even more terrible in this light. It was a sad view.

Finally, by seeing that his efforts didn't help him in any way, he began to pull the cross, to tear the kerchief, but he couldn't do anything with them and he decided to leave. Apparently, he was hoping to reach the Community anyway. Having taken several steps forward, he tried to turn aside, but the dog began to growl and he blocked his way.

"Always follow the dog, my friend. He will take you down the nearest way where I told you to go. If you try not to disobey him, he won't do anything personally to you, but he won't be able to protect you from the wild beasts whom you won't avoid by disobeying your guide."

While Francisco was talking, the man turned back to look attentively at his eyes, as though by wishing to make certain of the truth and earnestness of his words. He all flinched with fear, gave a start, somehow stooped from the last Francisco's phrase and then he followed the dog.

"What have I done, what have I done," finally nervous Mulga whispered.

"You haven't done anything wrong to him, Mulga, as well as to that professor. Go, pack your clothes, books and food. You will leave together with us from here, and I will show to you where you will be living and what you will be doing. Wait for us here, we'll be back in an hour."

Mulga bowed and went to his little house, while Francisco told me.

"Take Eta in your arms, Lovushka. I remind you once again to keep your heart wide-opened. Observe, so that not a single of its leaves would close. Pour your Love in silence and don't fall into despair if the man doesn't absorb your Love, if he doesn't calm down and become lucid. Don't think about the consequences, but always act now. To act not at all means to always overcome with lightning speed. It means – to always pour awakening into the man's spirit, although it would seem by appearance that you didn't give any quick calming to the man."

Francisco turned to the professor's house, who was angry not so long ago, he entered the hall and knocked at the door.

"That really becomes intolerable anymore," the voice in the room uttered, the hasty and small steps came hurriedly to the door, it opened, and a tall, lean old man of ascetic appearance was standing on the threshold.

"Just think, the night guests and even with a bird! I cannot bear birds, leave your burden in the corridor if you want to come here."

"I ask for equality for both of my brothers in arms," Francisco told him. "Professor, when you came here with your big luggage, nobody restricted you, did they? On the contrary, you were given the whole little house under only one condition: your compassion for people, flowers, birds and animals. Now I namely address your compassion."

"Your customs are strange. I came here to share my knowledge with your scientists, which may enrich the world. Instead of hurrying to me, they keep me in the absolutely unsuitable surroundings for me, and you show up first with your appeal to compassion. What is the meaning of all those sacrifices which I've made by travelling here? That I would stick in the woods with mosquitos?"

"You could have chosen another way. You were offered to go to America. You were told that there you could realize your erudition. But you knew that you didn't go there, because you were afraid of competition and that you wouldn't take the leader's position there."

"That's why I came here, because I believe in unselfishness of your scientists. I believe that they won't befool me as Yankees could do."

"A very serious problem arises before you now. That person who has founded the Community sent me to tell you that you are mistaken, that all your discoveries for which you've sacrificed your entire life are known for the long time in the East. You've reached only the very beginning, while our scientists have already solved all the initial tasks and drawn the final conclusions a long time ago. You are walking the wrong way and for the true science you should start everything from the very beginning. If you want to, you can stay here and, having started everything from the beginning, under guidance of our scientists, learn as an ordinary student, you can fulfil the tasks which will be given to you. You will be able to use all the books of the world in our libraries and you don't need to bring your scanty library with yourself. You will be able to choose any system for solving the tasks given to you, but you will be given the tasks of your initial work. That's not all. The people who deny all the characteristics within themselves, except their mind, are not allowed to do our scientific work. Man possesses his soul and spirit, too. That person who didn't care of the development of his spiritual powers like you, cannot become the scientific worker of the East. And it's not that you aren't worthy of this honour, as you are thinking now in a sarcastic way, but only because everything starts and ends with the bases of spirit in our science. It is impossible to explain this broad question to you during such a short conversation, and that isn't the most important for you now. The most important is your love for science – everything for the people's benefit and happiness. But maybe your entire interest for science leads only to your own "I" which you want to lift up on the highest level of the earthly glory? If you are searching for glory, then search for it wherever you would like to, but not in our place. If you are searching for the science for the people's benefit and happiness, then we and everything what we have are at your service."

The scientist's face that was very sarcastic in the beginning became very serious.

"I'm not an urchin who's seeking after glory. If you say that I haven't developed anything else except my mind within myself, then it could happen only because I didn't have time to think about anything

else except science. I was living in poverty and I was suffering from cold, because everything what I used to earn I spent for my books. I didn't have time to solve the problem of love and compassion, because I didn't have time even for my own personal life. I couldn't tear myself away from science and spend the time uselessly. But if you say that I was walking the wrong scientific way, that I've made some incorrect calculations or conclusions somewhere, - then that is serious, very serious. If any of your scientists can prove it to me, then I'm prepared to start everything from the very beginning and, you can trust my word, I won't be sobbing. I will be working without mumbling and in an optimistic way. Nobody is to blame, except myself, if I've made a mistake in my calculations. And it isn't a good sign of one's mind to persist if you understood that you were wrong. But this needs to be proved. Who is that Titan mathematician who can understand my entire life's work and show my mistake to me? There's only one man in the entire world, who is equal with his knowledge to me in this field, and he - my enemy - recognizes my work."

Having agreed with the possibility of his mistake for a moment, the scientist lifted his head proudly again. Sarcasm was twinkling in his eyes.

"If you would like to, you will be able to see that Titan tomorrow. But I repeat to you that you will have to accept the condition which I've already mentioned to you if you make sure that you were wrong."

"My God, what a strange man you are! You were just talking about love. Could any conditions, formalities, obstacles exist for love of my science? By striving for the truth in that field which is the goal of my life - not even the goal, but my life itself, - I agree with everything till the end, even if the question of my life or death was decided. What does it mean "to live" for me? Is it to breathe, to eat, to have a good time, to become rich? It means to learn, so that I could find correct and precise answers to the questions that are important to me. Science isn't any heroic deed or duty for me, but life, God, the universe - everything. Take me to your Titan, and I will protect myself like a lion, but if he defeats me, I won't die, don't expect it from me. I won't start hating your Titan and my science. You can argue with God, but you may not hate him. That person who will defeat me has to be at least a demigod. Take me to him, and the faster the better."

While the scientist was talking, his appearance was changing, and also his spiritual image opened up for me. I saw how his elderly face became younger, the power and energy drifted up from him, nobility and fortitude was pouring from all the pores of his being. He stopped before Francisco, looked attentively at his eyes and began to speak again.

"Often people used to deceive me, I couldn't orient myself in them as well as in my science. Actually, you say that I didn't orient myself in the science, too," the tone of the man's voice became lower, he gave a sad smile, he was silent for a while, he gave a sigh, looked at Francisco attentively again and continued. "In my turn, I would like to receive the promise from you that if I turn out to be right, then my conditions will be met, but... your face and something especial within you makes me confide in your honour completely. I don't ask anything. I don't want to know where my meeting with your Titan will take place, I repeat: take me, I'm following you."

"Let's go, my dear brother, this day of yours is happy. The great joy is waiting for you. And everything what you were searching for will open up for you."

We left the house and met Mulga in the agreed place. When we went out of the grove and got in the moonlight, the scientist took off his hat, inhaled the air, gave a laugh and uttered.

"However strange it is, but for the first time in my life I have to thank the man, because he prevented me from working. For the first time I'm walking free in the moonlight, without any remorse that I

left my science and that I'm spending the time uselessly. When I came here I didn't leave the room for a single time, and I came here in the night and I didn't know how beautiful it was here. By the way, it was beautiful also in that part of Germany where I was living, but I didn't have time to admire the nature and its beauty."

"Professor, if now you could carry all your manuscripts with yourself, then now your heart would get rid of the constant fear to spend at least a moment uselessly, without science anyway. The time has come for you to understand not only that what "emptiness" is, but also what the science itself is."

Professor roared with laughter, as though he had heard the funniest joke from Francisco.

"Actually I start rejoicing at meeting you. Excuse me, I didn't know your name."

"My name is Francisco, please you also can call me like this."

"So aren't you Englishman? I thought that such iron self-control was possible only for the representative of that nation. But that is unimportant. I wanted to tell you that for the first time in my life I enjoy myself and I feel the completely new power within myself: I am glad that the moon is shining, that this white peacock is running, whom I hated only an hour ago, that the people are walking next to me, although they don't understand anything in science, and I don't worry that they don't perceive the laws of the nature. Earlier I didn't even imagine a possibility to communicate with the people who weren't directly related to the science and now I am happy that I will spend several hours with you."

The scientist's intonation of the voice, his complete incomprehension who was walking next to him surprised me again. Now I already couldn't flare up passionately and calm down like before, but I felt indignation, vexation and... compassion in my heart. I was surprised by the rough insensitiveness of the man who considered himself to be a celebrity and almost a judge of the universal laws of nature. Where was his observation? How couldn't he feel those streams of love that were flowing to him from Francisco, and of course, they affected him, he felt like liberated from his duty from them.

The moon was hiding behind the grove, the night grew darker again, but I could feel already that the dawn would soon disperse the short night. We kept walking straight, and it seemed to me that we were going to the Community, but I had already lost my orientation a long time ago and I didn't know where we were. Suddenly the scientist asked Francisco.

"Tell me, brother Francisco, what is shining so much in the distance? If that was the fire, we could see the trembling of the flame, we could smell smoke, but I can see the big circle of completely still, bright light. I don't know such natural phenomenon of yours. What is it? But why am I, fool, asking you about natural phenomena? You probably don't know anything else except the penances given to you by your sect. The forces of the nature are as meaningless to you as the matters of your sect to me."

Francisco didn't react to the professor's attack and he simply answered him.

"Those people are living in that place where you noticed the circle of light, who control their natural powers and who can direct them in such a way that the wellbeing and happiness of their encountered people wouldn't be disturbed by the blows, streams of nerves and shocks from those people who observe only their egoistic incentives and who consider themselves to be the primary and most important things. If you could make yourself free from the erroneous duty for science which oppresses you, now you could see more than only the physical appearance of those people to whom you are going. You can see that place shining not because it is shining for everybody by itself. I connected you to the power of my thoughts, and you had the possibility to see the influence of people's thoughts, to see the energy of their actions. This fire of thoughts which you can see now belongs to unselfish people who don't consider

themselves to be the centre of the universe, but who give their energy to the construction of the universe, to the creative work of all of those who are able to receive their energy and to transmit it further as an inspiration, opening, power, harmony of thoughts and heart in everyday creation. There isn't any calm in your heart. You need to find calm of your heart in order to achieve harmony that is necessary for creative work. These people who spread their thoughts as light in the world don't think about duty in their daily routine. They are walking by loving, they overcome by loving and they pour the sparkles of their love for everybody. Also you can take a little part of their harmony, but in order to get it you need to throw off the superstition that some conditional differences among people exist. Until you see man only as a cultural unit and estimate him as mind and not as consciousness – the little part of Eternity, - you won't be able to take their harmony, because all the ways to it will be closed for you."

We were coming nearer to the shining light, I was happy and I understood that all the houses here were shining with a calm fire in the same way as the little houses in the distant valley were glaring in different colours, depending on the emanations which the people who were living in them were spreading.

"It is good that you are speaking now in an informal way and you don't need to ground your words with any logical explanations and proofs," the scientist's voice sounded sarcastically.

"Soon you will see such obvious experience of mind and heart that your entire need for the external logic will disappear," Francisco answered him calmly. "We come nearer to the group of houses. What are their colours, what do you think?"

"Your question is very strange. The bright beams are gushing from all the stone pores, from all the walls, but I cannot describe their colour. The most ordinary white colour of milk which a porous stone may spread. Usually it is invisible, but it is very bright here."

"Professor, give me your hand and allow me to touch back of your head," Francisco uttered again, he took the extended scientist's hand and he put his another hand on his head. "What do you see now?"

The numb scientist kept silent for several minutes, as though he was paralysed.

"What kind of the tricks do you show me here? The houses are blazing like the fire!"

"Keep watching. What do you see?" Francisco asked him again without taking his hands off him.

"I can see straight through the flaming wall. I can see an elderly woman sitting in the room. Look, but this is horrible! She will burn down! The flames have already covered all the walls of the room, all the things! Call her quickly, so that she could save herself, I don't have any strength to call or to run to help her," the scientist was speaking in the same silent way.

"Don't worry, this fire doesn't burn the body. That is the spiritual power that could burn you down and turn into ashes if I took you into this house. You would suffocate in this room in several minutes, because you aren't prepared and you don't control those powers of the fire of the universe which this room is full of. Don't dispel your attention, concentrate on the woman's figure, try to see and read her thoughts."

The scientist who was standing next to Francisco was breathing unevenly and with difficulty, as though the streams that were flowing from Francisco to him were heavy for him. Having kept silent for a while, he uttered.

"The woman is sitting before the opened book, but her thoughts are absolutely not about the book. She's thinking about the distant journey, about the house full of children. Now the images of two beautiful girls who look like twins rise in her thoughts. But how it is strange, one of them is absolutely grey. It is very ridiculous and strange: grey like the Moon and young like Venus. A man with a slender trunk, with military looks is standing next to them, but I cannot understand who they are one to another. Oh, here I can see your image clearly, but it is strange again, a red cup is in your hands, you wear white clothes..."

Francisco took his hands off him, the scientist gave a start, he staggered a little.

"What is the colour of the house before you now?" Francisco asked him.

"All the houses have the colour of milk, and if I hadn't just seen the house in flames myself, I would insist that there wasn't a red one among them. Your hypnosis is very strong, and I'm so tired of it that I cannot walk anymore."

"All right, sit here with Mulga for a while, he will protect you from the night lizards and scorpions. Don't be afraid of anything, sit under these palms for a while, there's a bench there. Eat this sweet, it will refresh you perfectly. I guarantee you that in fifteen minutes, when we with Lovushka come back, not only you will have enough strength to walk, but you even will be able to do it joyfully."

Francisco extended a small box for the scientist, in which big squares like chocolate were. The scientist put one of them into his mouth silently. Having taken my arm, Francisco took me to that house where professor saw the woman and he was reading her thoughts. He could see only some separate views, but he couldn't connect them, while I saw that the woman was waiting for Nikita and both of his nieces impatiently. We came up to the house, and Francisco knocked at the window.

The door opened after a while, and the woman was standing on the threshold whom the scientist called elderly. Now I saw that she wasn't so elderly, she was mostly thirty-year-old, but I could feel the traces of the drama that had devastated her life and crushed her. Her calm and joy with which she greeted Francisco surprised me, although I had seen many meek and joyous faces in the Community. Having bowed low to Francisco, the woman invited us to come in.

"Oh, Teacher, you came yourself to me. Such long and tiring way is injurious to you. Allow me to bring at least some milk for you and for your young fellow-traveller," the woman was speaking by pushing the chairs for us when we entered the room.

"Don't worry, Theresita, I came to take you with myself. I promised you that if your love found strength to hold out the three year test, then you would see Nikita, Laliya and Nina, while you've spent five years here and you didn't ask me a single time why your meeting was delayed, why you were still left here and why you couldn't even go to your grandchildren, to the distant Community."

"Teacher, I was happy here. Everything what you used to indicate to do for me was so important for people that I am afraid that only today I thought about Nikita and the girls for the first time. Ah, if I could save them, I could live here till the end of my days."

"No, my friend, love isn't standing in one place. Love – that's a living power, and you always need to pour it to another, new and bright course. You've matured for an action. Your inside has cleaned, and the new powers have developed in it. You cannot hold them without any work in your cup. You will travel to the distant Communities, you will take Laliya and Nina with yourself, and you will prepare them for the new life. You will explain to Nina who wants to take the pledge of chastity that she will need to change her path which makes her so glad and attracts her. That maternity which had to fall to Laliya's lot and which she didn't realize by not holding out the new, easy test, fall on Nina's shoulders. She will have to go to the

wide world and create the family in which that man is destined to be born, whom the lords of karmas prepared for incarnation and for a great deed of the path of Love. You will explain the whole importance of her new life to the girl. You will tell her that nobody chooses a great deed and only carries our given burden easily if he wants to serve the Truth in an effective way. I believe in Nina. This will be an easy lesson for you. It will be more difficult with Laliya, but... No fight against your passions is taking part within yourself anymore, so all new turns of your life won't bring any difficulties for you anymore. Go with me, my friend, leave this place easily and simply, and not with difficulty and by suffering as you did when you left those places where you were living before. Only those are suffering before the new turn of their path who are still carrying their not yet melted "I" in love within themselves. Everything has already melted inside of you, everything has turned into the Light. And therefore, I take you there where you will be an effective power for your encountered people. Peace to you, my dear friend, give my calm to everybody and always feel that you are carrying the red cup of Love in your hands. Press your lips to it and drink the hot Love of my heart. Spread it as your everyday activity and pass with your work not the weight of the great deed and duty, but lightness of knowledge."

Theresita went down on her knees and she was looking at Francisco by holding his hand.

"When you go to your everyday work, never walk alone, my baby. But by extending your hand to your encountered man, give our both hands to him and wipe his eyes with the shawl of Love. Let's go, my friend, they are waiting for us."

I had seen many wonderful faces in ecstasy lately, but none of them was radiating with such happiness and tranquillity as I saw now in Theresita's face. Maybe this face wasn't of the beauty's one, but it was great and it was shining so brightly that I wanted to screw up my eyes, although I was already used to the shining auras.

Theresita left us without taking a single thing from the house. I was surprised how she greeted professor and Mulga. She extended both of her hands to Mulga, which he kissed clumsily one after another, and she bowed to professor and uttered.

"You will still have to solve lots of questions, but you'll never experience such strong discontent anymore which you feel now," Theresita gave such nice and infectious laugh that I couldn't refrain and I burst out laughing, and also Mulga followed my example.

The scientist became so angry with me that he didn't even allow Theresita to tell me that what she was prepared to. He was so vexed that I began to feel sorry for my such untimely sounded, well-wishing joviality. Having poured his rage on me, he addressed Theresita.

"Dear lady, what can you understand about my indignation? Perhaps you also can read strange thoughts as brother Francisco practices it? Does your friendship with God limit itself with the dreams about those persons whom I saw in your brain due to your friend's hypnosis? I hope that you won't be able to solve the complicated tasks of my thinking, even if you are thoughts reader. Anyway, it would be rather interesting to find out how did you understand the reasons of my indignation?"

Professor was speaking loudly and in such sarcastic way that Francisco looked at him with sympathy and said to Theresita.

"Well, sister, start your new path of communication with rebels. Never be afraid of an irritated man, don't put his talk into your heart. Only stand firmly by the boundary of Eternity with your consciousness. Put so your feet on the ground so firmly as if you were grown into it, but with your thoughts and your heart live in the high Light and don't violate the precept given to you: always walk with me,

extend your hand together with mine, so that you wouldn't prevent the Light from pouring through you as through the new and pure path."

Francisco called Mulga who was always following him and he quickened his steps by speaking to him in the language which I didn't understand. Again I thought imperceptibly how many languages which I didn't know existed in the world.

There was quite a considerable distance between those who were going forward and us, because professor couldn't walk so quickly. He was panting and he could hardly move. I thought that he was simply tired, but when the dawn lit up his face, I understood that he was almost a patient already, that not only Francisco's, but also Theresita's atmosphere was difficult for him. Without directing his attention to me, I was trying to walk between them. When I already wanted to offer professor to lean on my arm, Theresita told him.

"It is very sad, my friend, that you understood my laughter as a mockery, as my haughtiness and desire to show you the phenomena of my especial and too strong powers. I don't possess any especial powers, but in that moment I was really thinking how blind man could be who's reached the grandeur in some field of knowledge and who valued it more than all the riches of Life. Your incautious words about my great Teacher and friend might have become an evil for you and harm you under different circumstances, but here, next to himself, the power that is pouring from his heart and burning everything turned your words into ashes. Do you want to know whether I read the reason of your indignation and vexation? Yes, I read it, but I will tell it to you only if you confirm again that you want to hear such not noble thoughts from me, which are unexpected also for yourself, although you are fair and noble man."

"That already exceeds all the limits and becomes a merry farce. My dear, I will be thankful if you give the honour to me to hear your opinion about the reasons of my indignation, although it seems to me that I didn't show it to you at all."

"There are three of the reasons which now break your heart so much and force you to sting me not in the formal sense of the words, but in that stinging tone with which they are uttered. I ask you once again, do you want me to tell you them?"

"Yes, of course, I want you to tell me them," the intonation of the professor's voice changed clearly, his voice sounded not so confidently anymore, even with an amazement, an embarrassment was heard instead of sarcasm, and he all seemed to be stunned to me.

"The first reason – that's your regret for coming here at all. The second one – that's your insult and humiliation that some monk whom you consider to be brother Francisco could force you to submit to his hypnosis which you mixed with his clairvoyance and his ability to control his natural powers. The third one – that's your envy for that scientist to whom you decided to go, your envy for his knowledge if it exists, for his power if he is really so developed that he may show your mistakes to you."

We were walking in silence for quite a long time, the dawn turned into the wonderful morning instantly. I looked at the professor's face, and his appearance stunned me. He turned yellowish, his eyes became hollow, the dark circles showed black under them. His nose was stretched, and it seemed to me that he could hardly stand on his feet.

Francisco stopped and waited for us. When we caught up with them, he extended the small box with chocolate squares to scientist again.

"That's nothing, professor. You are only tired of the unusual path. Eat another sweet and after the breakfast you can talk to doctor I., and I don't doubt that it will calm you down instantly."

Lovushka, be a hospitable host, take professor to your room and entrust him to Yassa. Professor, Yassa – that's Lovushka's servant. He can give such a massage that you will even forget this sleepless night. Good-bye, friend and brother, we'll see each other again. Lovushka, tell I. that I have brought professor and do that what I. will tell you to."

Finally we came to the park, and I have to admit that both myself and Eta were rather tired. I brought professor to Yassa who already knew about our arrival and he was waiting for us with the prepared bath.

I went to take the shower, I washed and combed carefully, I left Eta to sleep and only then I went to I.

While I was going to I., I was sneering at myself when I remembered how many lessons I. needed in order to teach me self-control in this narrow field of the ordinary education.

Chapter 11

I. accepts scientist. Aninov and Beata Skalradi.

Instructions for me and Bronski

When I entered I.'s room and I looked at the wonderful face of my dear friend, suddenly I comprehended that I still didn't know my idolized guardian at all. Now I. looked like a youth to me, the real personification of power, vitality and wisdom. He smiled to me and said to me tenderly.

"You make progress, my dear boy, you almost didn't get tired."

"Only now I felt strong suddenly, but I cannot boast that I came back easily. And I cannot tell you that the meetings of this night which gave an eternal lesson to me didn't exhaust my spiritual strength,

while I was living plunged in tonight's seen and comprehended suffering. The examples of people's blindness blinded also me temporarily. Today I understood that the very beginning of man's suffering, as well as its course, - that's his inability to comprehend the whole Life during every flying past moment. The more his thought is connected with the earth, with his passionately loved surroundings, his work and friends, the more he is dazzled only by brilliance of the earth. And the more difficult it is for him - the more he is suffering by trying to escape to the Light of Life. Not all tonight's lessons were unpleasant. The people who fascinated me with grandeur of their inner world and love also penetrated in my heart differently, about the complete opening of which Francisco reminded me even two times. He had to remind me two times that not a single leaf that covers the entrance to my heart wouldn't prevent me from letting my encountered person in. And really, not a single leaf prevented my love from pouring and concentrating my attention. But... meeting Theresita was very difficult and tiring for me. I comprehended and I still comprehend now how high her spirit is, how unshakable her loyalty is, how pure and loving she is, and anyway, something what I cannot understand now alienates me from her. "Alienates" is also not that word. As if I can feel a wall between myself and her. I respect her, but I cannot feel easily and simply next to her. However strange it is, but professor obsessed with vexation and blindness didn't cause trouble to me."

"I understand you perfectly, Lovushka. Theresita's path is a religious one. And you still cannot rise so high that rituals, any ritual would become not a constraining bliss for you. Theresita's activity of life, her activity of centuries, her activity of liberation - everything goes only through the ray of rituals and religion. She is still living in it as in a case, but it is shining anyway. If one of you was free till the end, then the wall of her shining case couldn't restrict your communication. The higher every one of you will rise in the path of your liberation, the simpler, clearer and closer your communication will be. Professor, being on the level of his consciousness, may not give any doubts, protest or obstacles to your favour. That's why you cannot feel his difficult emanations, while very high Theresita's emanations oppress you with their one-sidedness. We'll still talk about it on our way. We need to prepare. As soon as I will put professor by the books, we'll leave. You are surprised that the scientist who is so imperfect by appearance may live here, although the gates are closed for many people who wanted to get here during their entire lives. Look more attentively at your encounters. Although the scientist didn't know anything about two worlds with his mind, actually he was living in them. He was loyal to science till the end. Without thinking about people's wellbeing, he dedicated his entire work to them by dreaming that not a single man would experience neither fear nor poverty in the entire universe. He was always dreaming that all people could learn whatever and wherever they wanted to, and that their poverty wouldn't hinder it. Go, my friend. Yassa must have already washed all the night dust off professor, now he is hungry. Be hospitable and pleasant, be polite as the disciple has to be, and bring the guest to me. Don't pay attention if his mood will be bad. Take a good look at him. Probably he is an absolute child in his private life."

I left to fulfil my dear friend's orders. A recollection, to be precise, an echo of Constantinople experiences emerged in my memory. I remember how many times in my life I had to step back from my dear people, how often when I wanted to be with I. especially strongly, to hear out his answers to the questions that worried me, I had to leave him and to hurry to fulfil that or another business.

Now I especially felt the need to be with I. and again I had to go and to put another man's affairs in order. But not sighs or an irritation was heard in my heart, which I used to remember only with the smile, no, those times were gone a long time ago. I felt uncomfortable before myself that I didn't feel an enthusiasm, a wild joy that I could be of use for the man. I was walking accurately and calmly, in a very restrained and benevolent mood, but I understood myself that there wasn't the active and effective joy within myself.

Having approached the bathroom, I heard a merry laughter. I expected everything, but I couldn't even imagine that Yassa would be able to cheer up the scientist so much. Also the professor's laughter itself surprised me, which was pure, childish and infectious.

The door of the bath opened, and I saw professor. The white suit which Yassa must have pulled out from I.'s reserves fitted him perfectly, his face was shaven neatly and it reflected his inner satisfaction which... suddenly turned into a sour grimace as soon as the scientist saw me.

"Ah, that's you, youth. It was difficult to see you in the night. Now I can see that you are real Hercules, only his hair wasn't black," professor was talking in a grumbling voice by examining my Indian clothes critically. "Well, here how it is! You've become simpler till the sandals on your bare feet," he finished his examination with my feet and added. "You aren't monk as brother Francisco, and to all appearance, you didn't have time to take any pledges yet, did you? So why are those feet bare?"

"It is very difficult for me to explain to you logically why I look like or feel like this, professor, but I am still not used to the native climate in any way, and the heat affects me in such a way that I want to wear as little clothes as possible. Besides, all the people who are living here dress like this. And I am not any exception. Doctor I. is wearing the same clothes. By the way, I am sorry for not asking your name up until now and I don't know how I should introduce you to doctor I.," I answered professor who was standing calmly in the middle of the corridor and examining me like a monkey in the cage.

"Youth, my name is Hans Zalcman. That doesn't ring a bell for you, but if your doctor I. is educated man, then it will mean something for him. Are you taking me straight to him?"

"Yes, doctor I. is waiting for you."

We crossed the corridor, went to another side of the house, and I brought professor Zalcman to I.'s. I was concentrating my thoughts strongly, so that with my entire power of goodwill I would help scientist to meet I. not in such a way as he met Francisco. But already from the very first I.'s taken step to meet entering scientist, from his unusually warmly extended hand, from the intonation of his voice which blew with a gallantry, charm and obligingness I understood that all my efforts were childishly helpless and unnecessary, that I. was really Titan, and the scientist felt it immediately. His entire appearance, carriage, behaviour – everything changed. He all cowered like a ball, he became like a tiger, prepared for a jump, and I remembered his conversation with Francisco when he promised him to defend himself like a lion.

"Professor, I am very glad for the opportunity to greet the whole Western science through your personality. I congratulate your work and your knowledge sincerely," I. said to him, he extended both of his hands to scientist and seated him in the armchair. "Probably the trip to the East and staying with us exhausted you very much, but I hope that your devotion to science will be evaluated. Books are waiting for you in our library, and not only those about which you were dreaming, but also those about which you didn't know anything. I've already seen to it that you would receive a separate dwelling next to one of the branches of our library. The total calm in that part of the park where this my offered library is located will guarantee you that nobody will be disturbing your work by anything externally."

I. seated professor in the comfortable armchair. His slightly emphasized word "externally" made professor Zalcman prick up his ears.

"If nobody disturbs me externally, then I think that really nobody is going to disturb my stability and ability to work inside of me," he uttered unexpectedly quickly, as if he was hurrying and worrying.

"You never know," I. answered him with the smile by looking at the scientist's face attentively.

"I hope," professor uttered by hurrying again, "that you are not going to show the phenomenon of hypnosis to me as brother Francisco was doing it on the way here? The scientist won't fall till that level what the know-nothing monk who possesses the magnetic power allows to himself. I would like to start our scientific discussion immediately."

"Now, first of all you have to breakfast and refresh yourself. If after breakfast you want to go to the library immediately, we'll go there instantly, but I would advise you to wait till evening. Our son won't harm you directly, but it may exhaust you so much that we'll have to postpone your desired conversation with me for several day," I. answered him politely by inviting the scientist to the dining-room.

"Oh no, I'm much stronger than you think, doctor I.," Zalcman interrupted him, while going to the dining-room with us. "But solve the riddle for me, when and where did you have time to receive the doctor's degree? You are so young that you could pose for a statue of the Greek god, and of course, you couldn't receive it in the West. We don't give academic degrees to children, and if we subtract six or seven years from your age, then you would be of the same age with this teenager, although he is sturdily-built like Hercules," he added by laughing and pointing at me.

"But namely in the West I was given the academic degree: the first one in Germany, the second one in Rome and the third one in London," I. answered him with the smile.

"Wonderful," professor rather snickered than uttered.

"Although I don't read thoughts as quickly as my brother Francisco is doing it, but I can see clearly how the word "charlatan" is flashing in your brain. Be patient, soon you will be able to make sure of the indisputable facts of my education," I. gave a merry laugh.

Zalcman stopped, he fixed his gaze on I. in a funny way and he even opened his mouth with amazement, but I. didn't give any time to him to be amazed, he took his arm and introduced him to Kastanda who approached us.

"Allow me to introduce you. Here's the deputy of the master of our Community, brother Kastanda. Address him for everything what you will need, what you will be dissatisfied with. Everything is in the almighty Kastanda's hands. He only looks like strict, but in truth he is hospitable and kind host."

"I'm glad to be able to help you as everyone of us is, professor," Kastanda answered him by squeezing the guest's hand. "Please sit down here. If our meal isn't according to your taste, order everything what you want to. We'll try to serve you that to what you are used to."

"You are very kind, but I didn't pay attention to what I was eating during my entire life and almost always I was hungry. I think that you won't have any trouble with me regarding this. Hunger is as usual as the dry bread with water for me, which almost always were my constant food."

Professor sat down between me and I., and he was examining the people who surrounded us with amazement. He was chewing for a long time that what I. was placing in his plate. I saw that he directed his entire attention to people, and he really was eating without understanding what he was eating.

"Tell me, doctor I., where from did you collect so many people here? Since that time when I graduated the university I've never been in such gathering, in such cultured crowd. There's not a single vulgar face here. What is that? Are all of them scientists?"

"No, professor, the people gathered here not according to the signs of their talent and erudition, although many of them are talented. Those are the people whose consciousness opened up not only as mind, but also as a harmonious totality, as the creative combination of their mind, heart and spirit. The Light of their spiritual life – that's the distinctive sign according to which these people have gathered. Their spiritual powers are shining for you, while you, being loyal to your western habit, want to comprehend and put them together according to the presumptions and conditions of logic. You will always face difficulties while living here, if you don't estimate the power of spiritual consciousness as the fundamental human power."

Andreyeva who was sitting in her constant place suddenly pierced Zalcman with her electric wheels. I all cowered inside of me, because I was already waiting for some "little thing" for poor professor from her, but she directed her eyes to me, and the whole "little thing" fell to my share. I was glad that poor professor who had already experienced many "phenomena" during one day avoided another blow for his nerves.

"Yes, Lovushka, of course, it is kind of you to be a guardian and benefactor, but this is absolutely not your role. You interfered not only my wit, but also the quicker opening of this old fellow. And why did you think of playing the role of compassionate Samaritan now?" Andreyeva uttered by piercing me with the fire of her electric wheels.

"Either I didn't understand you right, or you didn't understand my thought completely, Nataliya Vladimirovna. Apparently, I've learned to protect myself against you a little, but I hope that you didn't say that what you wanted to not because I interfered you to do it, but probably I forbade you to do it," I answered her by laughing.

"Be glad to see to whom the not feathered hatches turn after several months of communication with I.," Andreyeva was also laughing with the most sincere laughter after saying it.

The scientist didn't understand the language in which Andreyeva addressed me, he was looking attentively at her eyes, then he fixed his gaze on me, finally he turned to I. and uttered.

"If I met this lady face to face, probably I would be frightened. By being next to you I feel as though I was in the zone of protection, but anyway I think that this lady's psyche isn't quite normal."

"This lady can speak all those languages perfectly in which you are speaking, professor, besides she possesses the quality which you don't like: to guess another's thoughts. I can confirm that most likely she knows what you are thinking now," I. answered him merrily.

"Oh, she wouldn't like it much," the scientist gave a careless smile, "but thank God, she won't guess that what I'm thinking about."

"You think that those little fires are jumping in my eyes for which Spain's Inquisition used to condemn the sinners for bonfire," a kind-hearted Nataliya Vladimirovna's voice was heard.

Many around burst out laughing, professor became embarrassed and he was looking at Andreyeva timidly.

"My friend, drink your cacao, and if you insist neglecting my advice, let's go to the library. Let's leave this sarcastic lady and let's take the pleasure from her to keep mocking at you," I. said to him tenderly.

Professor ate very little, he refused the cacao, asked for permission to take several fruits in his pocket, and we left. I. told me to put the felt hat with the net and to bring the same one for professor.

In the beginning professor was protesting and he was indignant, but as soon as we went out to the scorching heat from the shadows of the park, he pulled it over his eyes.

I. led us down the path which I didn't know yet. We didn't have to go down to the valley and then climb to the hill again. Unexpectedly, after having crossed two deep gorges along the two narrow, swinging little bridges, having come out of three tunnels, we got into the big park in forty minutes.

It was rather big surprise for me, because we went out to the wide cedar lane immediately, close to the orange I.'s house. Without turning professor's attention to the wonderful little house, I. took us down the hot lane to the shadier part of the park. Still several turns and... we got before the library, but absolutely from the different side. We came straight to the reading-room where people were sitting at the tables, they were deep in their work and they didn't pay any attention to us.

The reading-room, a great number of people in it and the heaps of books surprised professor so much that he stopped, while I. had to take his arm and to explain to him in a whisper.

"You can only work here, you can neither stand around nor talk here."

We went to another room where many people were working, too, but there were some free tables. Also here nobody left their work, so that they could look at us.

Although I. was taking professor by holding his arm, he was walking slowly, he was deeply touched, even stunned, and he kept whispering.

"The fortunate ones! The favourites of destiny! The sea of books and light! And me, me! Every book used to cost the entire working hours, torn away from science!"

We entered that hall where Laliya and Nina were serving out books. Now three more girls were working with them, and it seemed to me that namely they were doing everything, while Laliya and Nina only guided them and they were checking up on their work.

To my great joy, I saw Nikita sitting at one table behind the heap of books, I forgot about everything in the world, I rushed at my dear friend whom I hadn't seen for a long time.

As soon as I came up to Nikita's table and extended my hand to him, I heard a choking shriek behind my back and the noise of pulled chairs. I turned round and I saw several people who hurried to help I. who was holding fainted professor.

"That's nothing, my friends," I. was talking to three brothers who dashed to help him and who brought professor out to the chilly hall. "Lay him here, on the sofa. Our sun has harmed the northerner a little, but this isn't any sunstroke. He will come to his senses soon. Don't worry and get back to work. Lovushka and Nikita will stay with me. I will call you if I need anything."

The brothers who dashed to help I. from the reading room bowed low to him and they came back to work. We were left alone by the body of helpless professor. His face was greenly pale, his nose was lengthened out, and a thought flashed in my head that maybe he was dead.

I. was concentrated and serious. He turned to me and uttered.

"Lovushka, go upstairs to my room which you know already. You will find a built-in cupboard on the left side from the entrance, on the fifth step. Here's the key from it for you. Unlock it, lift the little door of the fifth shelf from the bottom up, take two medicine chests and the little bottle which is standing between them from there. Bring everything here. Be exceptionally careful and concentrated by unlocking

and locking the cupboard. Always remember where you are and that your delaying or carelessness might cost the man's life."

I bowed, took the key and, having overcome my excitement and concentrated my entire attention, I left to fulfil my Teacher's command. Now I was thinking neither about the aroma of the flowers, nor about the beauty of the stairs, nor about its likeness to the stairs in sir Vomi's house, in B. anymore, - I was going as probably the soldiers go to fulfil their commander's orders. I knew only one thing: I. will save professor if I bring all the necessary medicine without delay.

The emotional scientist's whisper, his woefulness and his uncomprehending, benign envy for the fortunate people who were drowning in the sea of books and light illuminated this diligent man even brighter for me, because he dedicated everything, his every sigh to his own God - science.

I succeeded to fulfil all I.'s instructions. I unlocked the cupboard and, although I was clumsy, but I opened the door of the fifth shelf, I didn't break anything, "I wasn't catching any crows." Of course, earlier I would have forgotten about everything after seeing the jewels before which both medicine chests and the cut bottle with the sparkling red liquid was placed. Now I fulfilled his command precisely and in several minutes I was already standing before I., I gave the key and the medicine back to him. I. put them on the table, he told me and Nikita to lift professor a little and he gave the bottle to him to sniff. The man's body began to tremble and then it got numb again.

We lifted professor even higher, and I. brought the little bottle to his nose again. For the second time professor's body trembled stronger, he began to breathe again. I. prepared the mixture of powder on the marble plate, he set fire to it and he was holding it by the patient's nose. His breathing became more frequent, it became even, his jaws relaxed, his eyelids were trembling. I. poured the medicine into his mouth, and they had a magical effect. Professor had a fit of coughing, he opened his eyes and mumbled something.

"Lie down calmly, professor. I warned you that our sun might harm you. This is exactly what happened. If we had come here in the evening, then you would have avoided this," I. told him.

"That wasn't the sun," professor answered him, but in such a weak and plaintive voice that I understood the seriousness of the situation, and I thought again that he was dying.

Professor was silent for a while, then he continued in the same weak voice.

"That were those two women and the man whom I saw in the burning house when I was walking with Francisco. The thoughts of that alive walking woman, which I saw surprised me so much that as though I felt two blows: one to the back of my head and another one in the bottom of my back. That's they who made me lie down, and the sun has really nothing to do here."

He could hardly finish the sentence, he closed his eyes, he began to breath with difficulty again and he was turning pale. I. took the drop of the liquid from the bottle with a thin glass stick and poured it out to the scientist's mouth when he was catching air at one time. A spasm, quick as lightning, rolled over his whole body, and he felt so deeply asleep instantly that I couldn't even hear his breathing.

"Unfortunately, professor isn't young anymore, his organism is overtired and he will be sleeping for no less than three days. All the shortages of his life affected him now. I cannot leave him until he wakes up. He will get up healthy, strong, and to his great joy, he will become younger even for twenty years," I. smiled and added. "But I cannot leave him now. When he makes up for his lost sleep, I will set his work in order, and we'll leave only then. Nikita, you will always stay by him. I will tell them to bring your books to the dwelling prepared for professor, not far from here. You will kill two birds with one stone:

nobody will disturb your work, and you will tend for the patient. Laliya and Nina will bring food and change the books for you. Perhaps it is difficult for you to take the lesson of silence and solitude upon yourself again, although it will be short?"

Nikita gave a joyous smile and answered him that he was glad to be able to pay an old debt to the scientist, that the meeting liberated him from his last old debt to the world.

I was looking at Nikita surprised, because I couldn't imagine in any way the connection between the old man who came from Germany and Nikita, a Georgian, who spent the long years on the peaks of the Caucasus. I could hardly refrain from crying in amazement and I was very glad that I didn't volunteer to stay with the patient, although I was very sad of doing nothing.

"Lovushka, you will have a lot of work to do during these days," I. uttered after reading my thoughts as always.

I. found two trained male nurses, he brought the stretcher with them and he laid the patient on it himself. He explained to everyone of us what we had to do, he stood at the front of the stretcher himself and he told us to coordinate our steps and the rhythm of our breathing.

We were carrying the patient along the paths of the park by trying to walk as carefully as possible. Suddenly a beautiful clearing opened behind one turn, and the grove of conifers showed green behind it. As it seemed to me, a small brick house, buried in flowers and verdure, was standing in the middle of the clearing. When we came nearer, a woman with a big white bonnet and the bluish net lowered on her face went downstairs from the porch. The net rose and... I was dumbfounded when I recognized lady Berdran.

"This is that patient about whom I told you, lady Berdran," I. uttered.

Lady Berdran bowed to us and she smiled joyously after seeing my amazement. We lifted the patient up to the porch and brought him into the spacious, cool room where the white bed was already prepared, and the ventilator was spinning under the ceiling.

When we put the patient to bed, I. thanked the male nurses who helped him and he returned the stretcher to them.

"Nikita, here's trained nurse Gerda. You are at her disposal as her assistant force during these three days, and here, nurse Gerda, is that Teacher whom I promised to you. If you are diligent during these days, and if your spiritual power helps you to understand everything what your Teacher tells you, then you can travel to the distant Communities with us. So long, my friends. The patient needs an absolute tranquillity, but you cannot leave him alone at least for a moment. I will be visiting you every day. Be blessed."

We left the scientist's house and again we came back along the path which I hadn't seen before. My thoughts got confused a little. In most cases a certain bitterness used to flash for me absolutely unexpectedly that I couldn't adapt my personal efforts anywhere. Everybody were of use for their brothers with their work, while I seemed to be the only one who enjoyed life so much.

"Lovushka, there are all sorts of work. And that what visually seems to people to be man's idleness or life for his own pleasure, often is the big stage of work of that man about whom they think that he enjoys life. Everything what you have to see and to know before leaving the distant Communities with me, everything isn't only work, but also the beginning of your self-control which is necessary for your creative work. You are destined to become a world-famous writer. Such a talent of gigantic power and observation is given to you, such inventiveness which have to influence people, to change and to teach

them radically, so that they could live by using high ideals of Wisdom. In order for you to go into the wide world to propagate Wisdom, you have to understand and know all the most secret little cracks of people's suffering and passions. Learn by teaching. Once you were a great writer already. You possessed the power to pour Wisdom into excited hearts, but there wasn't a single characteristic of spirit developed till the end within you. You possessed neither loyalty, nor devotion, nor faith developed till the end. You didn't love anybody till the end. One day you were flying in the ecstasy of vision of God, while on the next day you were crying and doubting everything. One day the nature and the God's creation fascinated you, while on the next day you saw only your own sea of doubts and you used to turn away from your previous victories. You need to understand and develop the whole of new powers, the new knowledge of the human heart during these years which you are destined to spend in the Community. Your experience of these years which seem to you to be without any real, useful work is exactly that great work of yours, that lesson of ages which you are going to take away from us for people's happiness and prosperity. Once you already tried to bring the news of liberation for people, but you didn't have any strength yourself to become free of influence of passions and authority. Your surroundings oppressed you. Your wife's and your children's love showed to you, the differences of your views, inclinations and interests – everything was preventing your spirit from striving for the Truth in a harmonious way. Now cast away the petty thoughts to which your mentality of perception of life only in one plane of the Earth accustomed you. Take a more attentive look at your encounters and people, think only about them. Don't add any of your thoughts about yourself in your encounter and don't fit the path of every other man as the clothing to yourself. It is impossible to wear the clothes of all styles, in the same way as it is impossible to experience all sorts of work. It is only possible, through the form of the eternal work given to you, to communicate your "now" to the paths of people's development with such grandeur of knowledge of the subtlest strings of man's heart, with such love and compassion that they would find new and easier possibilities to overcome by loving in every word which sees the world through your creativity."

I. lapsed into silence, because we already came up to Aninov's house – that was absolutely unexpected for me.

When we entered the musician's house, it seemed to me to be absolutely different than back then when we were listening to his wonderful music here. It seemed to me that sadness was hanging in the rooms, as if the man who was living in them was often sad.

I felt sorry for the great musician from the bottom of my heart, who couldn't find any happiness and light in his majestic greatness. Oh, if I could play like this!

"Lovushka, your playing, - that's language. Your greatness – that's the pen, your truth – that's calm of your heart. Leave your "if" for those hours of creation when the great assistants will be surrounding you. Then penetrate into the situation of each of your heroes in such a way as if you were living in it yourself, as if you were suffering and loving for each of them. Now, while greeting Aninov, remember Francisco's words and keep your heart opened wide, by extending your hand to him, extend it together with your great friend Florentian's hand. Now don't be occupied with observation of suffering of man's spirit, create the great prayer of Love, take compassion on the soul whose power doesn't correspond to the gigantic genius which she has to carry through the world," I. told me.

He stood up from the sofa on which we were sitting for a while under the big palm which occupied a half of the room, and then he went to meet entering Aninov. As always the musician's face was pale, and he looked like an ascetic, but the expression of his eyes, the hardly felt nuance of his movement in spite of merry smile with which he greeted I. told us about his inner suffering. Even if I. hadn't told me anything, anyway I would have called for Florentian, because I had already used to act like this in difficult moments after encountering the spiritual people's disharmony.

Having greeted us joyfully, Aninov took an attentive look at me and told me.

"How unusually you've changed for the good. The real miracle happened before my eyes: you turned from Cinderella-man into the prince of fairy-tales. It is a pity that I am in a sad mood and that now I am suited only to write requiem, because I would create a sonnet how the bewitched cob awakened."

He was holding my hands tenderly, while I was creating that great prayer about which I. was telling me from the bottom of my heart. All of a sudden I felt already familiar trembling of my entire body. I understood that my thoughts reached Florentian, that his heart could see Aninov, that he would send him help and support.

"Doctor I., you possess a wonderful quality," Aninov uttered, he let my hands go and turned to I. "As soon as you came in – as though you besprinkled me with the living water. Such a chaos was reigning in my soul, such disharmony that I was prepared to tear my heart or my mind out. I thought that I would never be able to coordinate them, but here, I saw you and the silence covered me. I thought that I would be able not even to create anything anymore, but also even to play. And suddenly I felt a passionate desire to write the prelude and to glorify your spread tranquillity and harmony with it."

"This thought occurred to you only because suddenly calm and harmony covered you, you understood and appreciated them and you felt like sharing them with all of those who could understand your language – the language of music. It is impossible to give that to another person what you don't control or possess. That's why there are so little preachers of the new ideas who can spread them successfully, because their sermons are merely formal. By inviting their nation to give away everything and to sacrifice oneself for high ideals, the preachers often create regulations and responsibilities, but they don't apply them to themselves and even keep all the privileges and merits to themselves. Those of them are successful who spread ideas not with their words, but with the living example. You want to give the whole beauty that has opened to you now to people. What could be better than such a path where one man is given the power to awaken the nobility of a thousand people for an action, to encourage the desire of their spirit to create in their own field only because one man's creation awakened them?"

"Doctor I., I cannot dissemble when I'm next to you. You think that I dedicate my entire creation, my entire life to people's happiness and prosperity? Oh, if I could really tell like this! It is true, some periods, long break-throughs exist when I'm living with the thoughts of beauty, when I am glad to say something in the language of sounds. And then I am happy during those wonderful periods. Then I comprehend that I serve my brothers, people as much as I can. No politics, social limits, thefts, poverty, deception worry me. Then I am all living a cosmic life, I am standing on the threshold of Eternity, I can see and feel its grandeur. My personal strength withdraws from the earthly life, then I send the sounding heaven to my beloved earth. Then I comprehend my place in the universe and I know that the power of Love is carrying me and it is echoing within me for the sake of the earth, for people, for the sacred work: to lift the man's spirit up. During those periods I perceive myself as a man, that is a man who is carrying the little part of God forever."

Aninov was walking across the room in wide steps. An inspiration was felt in his ascetic face. His eyes lit up, he was breathing deeply, it seemed that he could hear how beauty was pulsating, singing, flying in the Light around by ringing, coming to life and inspiring. Aninov was silent for quite a long time, then he stopped before I. and continued.

"But... these periods are only short moments when I comprehend that I am human being, that the divine spirit is living within me. Every time some nastiness of the earth breaks off the song of my victorious Love. Not a grandeur or power pulls me down from the sacred liturgy in which I'm living, but

some scanty slander, some little villainy like a nasty calumny or envy force me to leave my heaven, my muse. Then I start seeing all the people who surround me not like human beings whom I saw in happiness of my creation, but like villains, reptiles who stink with their poison and who fill the unfortunate earth with it. The blades pierce my heart when I see the prison, an arrested person, when I see poverty and humiliation, I am living in royal luxury, while my nation is moaning and taking pains. The whip is beating those who are living with God. Those who are living with God are beating with the whip!.. The unfortunate woman who has drawn down shame upon herself by giving birth by the fence without any marriage is also living with God? The unfortunate serfs who are sold with children for several roubles are also living with God? And... you are living on the earth, you are speaking about the power of Love and calm... And your help, can the unfortunate people of the earth feel it? You've helped me and you are helping me. If you and the sacred land of your Community where I find strength to regain my form didn't exist, then I wouldn't survive even for a year, I would die with horror from that suffering which I see, which I don't want to see... You say that I have my own language with which I encourage people to break into the Light. Ah, if you could see that darkness that reigns in my brain! I didn't have strength to go through the suffering of my nation, I ran away to America, so that I could find strength to live there. I didn't find it. I saw the same suffering, actually it was different, but no smaller, no smaller poverty and differences than in my motherland... I met you. I understood a lot. I found strength to live. But my spirit, to be precise my brain doesn't have strength to hold out that suffering of hell through which I have to walk. My heart says to me: "Overcome by loving," while my brain states: "Fight by hating." So where is the truth? Where, what is the path? Again I can write requiem from which I stepped back by squeezing this youth's hand, this life who has burst into bloom so wonderfully. But why should he live, too? Family? Glory? Travelling? Work? Science and creation?"

Aninov shrugged off and he started walking across the room again. Now he looked like a fanatic. His look was wandering, his eyes were burning, he was wringing his big, great hands till pain, which he was prepared to extend to the heaven by praying to God with love, as well as to clasp them for a threatening gesture by arguing and scolding.

"My friend, do you remember how once in New York the full house was waiting for you for more than forty minutes before the concert, while you didn't go on the stage? Do you remember how I came to you, to your dressing-room back then? How a few of my words passed to you from Florentian lifted you above your personal experiences which seemed to you to be the citizen's duty and the greatest honour of the gentleman? Do you remember how your psyche changed back then, how your entire personal mutiny, which you were full of, instantly seemed to be small for you, not worthy of the creating man, and on the contrary, how you understood your criminal carelessness before the audience that adored you and that was waiting for you patiently? Your spiritual life, life of the creator and musician was hanging by a hair back then. You could remain in your dressing-room and not go to the crowd that was waiting for you at all. Then you would have burnt down the fruit of your work of centuries in the fire of your personal, egoistic mutiny. The whole path of beauty would have been burnt down for you in that moment. You wouldn't have been allowed to unite people anymore, moreover, the ringing heaven would have closed itself for you. You say that you don't have strength to carry the cross along the stages of your creation? But the art, every step forward in it is difficult only for that man who has seized the piece of red fire from heaven without taking care of such self-control before doing so, with which the purity of his heart is equal to the power of spirit. If you were living by the edge of Eternity in every moment of your daily routine, then you would know that two separate worlds in the universe don't exist for man, that two places for his creation and serving people don't exist. You couldn't distinguish the people from those radiating genii whom you can see during the hours of your creation, but you would know firmly that every moment is and may be only the breathing of Eternity. I ask you what makes you suffer for the people's faults? Look round, think a little and you will see only those cracks of distrust in your own world outlook which you enlarge yourself by pouring irritability and increasing the people's thrown out poison with it. Look, life in this house

was in undisturbed tranquillity when you entered here. First of all, you said: "Finally! Finally I found the calm little corner! I will be able to create here!" Did you have many calm days of your creation here? Does your motherland worry you? The people's poverty and disturbances? The poor people, deception and hypocrisy? Now all of it is far away from you physically, but it is boiling violently within you, isn't it? If you could see yourself, see that circle of fire in which you are walking like in the bonfire and which you've created yourself, a horror and disappointment would cover you, and probably your requiem would be finished tomorrow already. By spreading the sounds on the earth which help people to live, you've forgotten about the power of disharmony that beats people like a whip in those cases when you are creating by being tired out with your own disharmony. Think for a while whether the talent is given to you so that you would whip people with it? His place in the universe isn't enough for genius, he also has duties that are different than other people's ones. By spreading his greatness on the earth, genius may not lose touch with the light joy: to be the herald of Light. Genius won't take the path of mediocre abilities. Heaven and the earth always cooperate in his work. But his work as happiness might turn into a punishment for him if he's changed the centre of his weight and if his soul has become weaker than his power of genius. In those cases, my friend, only one help may be: you need to forget about yourself and think about those for whom your genius is given to you. Last time you said to me: "I cannot come down onto the earth without being punished." Yes, it will always be a tragedy if you come down onto the earth. It will be a punishment and damnation personally for you, a loss for your genius and for people, because genius – that's a man who doesn't lose touch with Those who are creating together with him. To create... Oh, that doesn't mean to always overcome or to be always occupied with your work, with its details. That means to strengthen with your loyalty the bond of people with Those elder brothers who have taken the earthly cooperation with you upon themselves. Every time when you would hold back your inspiration of genius or squander it uselessly and you wouldn't reach your goal, then you would leave the energy of Love unused. And it used to come back to its primary source without bringing any use and happiness for people, because you, its conductor, didn't have strength to accept it and to pass it to your encountered people. You are indignant at falsehood, deception, thefts. Think well, look at your life from the perspective of cosmos and decide yourself: how in those cases your behaviour was different from any other thief who was stealing from his motherland? By having all possibilities, you didn't pass the jewels to them, which were sent to them through you, did you? They were given not to you, but they were dedicated to them through you. You took not only the beauty away from them, but also the possibility to find the new strength, new joy within themselves which could and had to awaken the energy of Light within them for their daily work, actions and relationships. Now don't stand dumbfounded, my friend. Draw conclusions and don't forget them in the future. The higher spiritually man is, the more he has to think about those brothers of his who don't have much spiritual possibilities. Worry not about their material, but about their spiritual poverty which you were making even poorer many times. Your path – that's not the one of a politician or reformer of the land, but the one of the faster awakening of the spiritual Light within people with the music. Don't mix up these paths. You may and you need to be patriot, but the path along which you are carrying the public spirit, love for your motherland and the work for it remains your personal path, and to mix up the sectors of work doesn't mean at all to broaden the consciousness or to turn your work to be even of more use for your encountered people's consciousnesses. Come with us. You certainly need to take a walk in the pure air. By the way, you will see the new paintings of senora Skalradi. Don't stand so surprised and absent-minded," I. added by smiling to Aninov, "one may think that you've drawn a conclusion from my speech that all other paths of knowledge and activity are closed for a musician, except his music. That isn't true, and I didn't say it. You need not to constrict the horizon of your activity and thoughts, but to expand it in such a way that the entire universe would descend to your heart and that you would become not only your motherland's, but also her son. All paths are opened for a genius, but only when he doesn't wander between heaven and the earth, when both worlds are united into oneness within him, because Harmony has already squared his "I" accounts with the earth within himself."

Having taken the confused Aninov's hand, I. took him out of the house and turned towards the Community.

"I cannot come to myself. I could imagine myself to be in the most different roles. And I have to admit that in most cases I felt drawn to be a great musician, enlightener, benefactor and gentleman. But that in the end I would turn out to be a thief!.. For God's sake! That is the last straw for me."

Aninov looked so comically by showing with his gestures his imaginary grandeur and where he got after being hurled away by I.'s words. He was swinging his hands in such a funny way and he was striding in such big steps, his voice was rising up to the highest notes and then falling down. Having forgotten about the dust, he raised the whole cloud of it and he was drowning in it like a ghost – I couldn't hold out and I burst out laughing.

The musician stopped as lightning-struck. He was looking at me with his eyes opened wide, apparently, he had forgotten about my existence. All sorts of feelings were fighting in his changing face, but everything seemed to be so funny to me that I didn't have any strength to stop laughing.

"Here it is, the comedy of man's life!" finally Aninov uttered. "I was nailed down to the cross, and it is funny for him! And indeed, how the poor thief who is wasting the people's spiritual wealth should look for the Greatest among them! O Lord, I came to my senses what that "Eternal Movement" was, and who those its bearers to the earth and above it were only today, now. Its bearers to the earth are only these who can understand – with their inner, intuitive loyalty – the power within themselves not as their own talent, formed from the positive characteristics, but as the union with the Power that is living forever, which is moving through time. Oh, if I could never forget for a single moment that my life on the earth – that's not a simple changing of days, fortunes or misfortunes in them, but that it is the Movement of the eternally living and creating Power in creation, which I can join only by uniting with it through the music in calm. The I could live so easily and simply! Every day would seem to be so opened and filled up to me, to the row of which I allow to fly past so meaninglessly now by longing for heaven, by stealing its riches from the unfortunate earth and by complaining of my solitude."

I felt very sorry for Aninov whose voice was hollow and sad now. I felt guilty and I wanted to apologize to him already, but I. began to speak again.

"My friend, not that is important that for a moment you remember or forget that you are herald of the highest Powers on the earth. Only that is important that you, a man of genius, would remember that you also have the duty for heaven. And this duty – that's to live, so that your heart wouldn't become gloomy so easily when she gets under the influence of the emanations that are strange for you. Only then the blows of these strange thoughts are striking the man's psyche if his loyalty for Those is weak whom he acknowledged as the high source of his bliss, with whose ideas he is delighted, whose opening he considers to be his life's happiness. You've lit a lot of creative joy in the crowds of people by passing your fortunate genius to them. You've drunk not a single cup of suffering until you entered that stage of creation in which the people of genius may give the Light of audible or visible Harmony to their brothers. Often you used to fall to thinking about your encounters with people. You were surprised many times why you didn't bring happiness to any of the living beings next to you, but you didn't think for a single time about your meetings with the crowds of people. Why haven't you thought for a single time of what great your happiness was, because you could lead those crowds which came to listen to you into the temple of Light, into the bliss of Love and Calm. How do you imagine your heroic deed to awaken the crowds of people for high feelings and powers? Could you stay unpunishable if you leave the silence of those crowds on the earth, their attraction to the earthly trifles, if you leave them without the tears of bliss, joy and gratitude when they can feel the radiance of the great heaven while you are playing? Joy, as well as horror, sadness, suffering aroused within man – everything is weaving the thread of connection for which the responsibility

of a genius is much greater than the one of an ordinary man. If genius pulled people out of the swamp of their passions into the radiating nobility at least for an hour, while they were watching, reading or listening to him, then their ennobled feelings and gratitude would grow as the wall around the genius if his haughtiness and power for the crowd were his only feelings. In these cases the connection of genius with the crowds of people may become a difficult bound, a tough partition between him and his surroundings, between him and his Teachers. I'm not even talking about those sad cases when genius mislead thousands of people, when he inculcates all kinds of vices upon them and obscures their path to Harmony with all kinds of his own breakings by presenting them as the new searching of the Truth, whatever field of creation those breakings would touch. Your aroused joy, all the people's tears, their suffering and sadness wiped off by you, your music to cure and to comfort them, if you weren't glad that you could gather them into the cup of your heart sincerely and respectfully by wishing to give it as a tear of your joy – pure as the crystal, as the wine of the Lord – to your Teacher, if you didn't pray for your Teacher to burn down all this suffering in the fire of his flaming spirit, then they will wind round you by creating the new partitions of conditionalities between you and your loved ones, between you and your Teachers. From now on, by going to the piano, by standing before the crowd, don't think about the form of your rendering to them, about the power and degree of your temperament and excitement anymore, think about the grandeur of the moment in which you are taking part: to awaken the new strength to live within people, to open the absolutely different path for their actions in their lives within them, only because you gave a push to them. You have to remember only one thing when you go on stage: your hands touch the keys together with your Teacher's hands, the sounds – that's the flying and shining bullets that cross accurately everybody in the crowd. You aren't destined to think about that how they cross them, what they hurt and pierce in man's heart. Your business – that's to know that there is no empty space between you and Those who descend with their spiritual image to create together with you."

We came up to our house and met Bronski and Skalradi. The actor was carrying a big, opened umbrella-tent and the little box with paint, while the painter who was hiding under the umbrella together with Bronski was carrying the little bucket with all sorts of brushes.

"We are just in time and we can admire your new paintings together with you, senora Beata," I. said to the painter.

"Oh no, doctor I.!" she gave an anxious cry. "As you know well already, I am painting one picture by memory, without any model and I really cannot show it to you. There's still only some little contours of it. The other one is also still unfinished, although the model is posing very diligently and gives a lot of time to me. I cannot show it to you, because your and your friends' disappointment may finish any desire to continue my work. And you know how many times the disappointment in my work already threatened me with the psychic disorder of my nerves."

"But the works which you mentioned to me as unfinished for so many times were bought by the best galleries, and the greatest painters acknowledged them as completed, perfect works. Senora, take us to your secret studio. It is time already to believe in your genius and not destroy your creative path by always winding down the tangled paths and forcing the entire circle of your friends and assistants to disentangle the loops of your lack of self-confidence and doubts. If you could imagine your creative path as the rope, then you could see thousands of knots on it, tied by loving hands of your compassionate friends. Let's go now, immediately. At least in this moment concentrate your energy of joy and don't deny, but begin to assert and take us to see your new achieved victories."

Skalradi was standing indecisive, and only now I noticed how much lack of self-confidence was in her figure, her look, and most importantly, in her always anxious hands and fingers. No happiness was blowing from this woman, although I. called her genius.

"If there weren't so many knots along my path, tied by your hands, Teacher, then I wouldn't listen to you, but your word is a command to me, I obey you and I don't answer for the consequences of this too early, in my opinion, review," the painter answered him silently and sadly.

She turned back, crossed several lanes and, having come to the grotto, entered it. I couldn't understand in any way where we were going. I already knew several grottos, but I hadn't yet been in this one. It was dark and cool here, but it was impossible to paint here. Bronski didn't fold the umbrella and he stepped forward firmly where it was even darker.

Soon we left this cool, wide and dim corridor of the grotto and entered the big clearing where three high palms were growing in its dry sand, while the great camel was lying by the promontory of one of the rocks.

"Well, you really don't need the camel anymore," I uttered merrily. "One may not say that you were very compassionate and that you hurried to return the animal to Zeiched."

"Teacher, soon you'll see yourself that the picture is still unfinished. Then you can decide whether I still need the camel," the painter answered him, still worried in the same way.

She put her little bucket on the ground and went to the most distant rock. Only now I noticed a big, moving frame there, and Skalradi together with Bronski turned it to us. They pulled the big cloth off, and I saw the picture – not even the picture, but alive Bronski in the Bedouin clothes on alive camel. His pose, face, hands – everything was alive. So I was waiting that soon he would jump off the camel and tell me: "Lovushka, where do you always disappear to? I miss you." I gave a cry of fascination, I couldn't hold my joy, I dashed at the painter, embraced her and kissed her dearly. Only when I heard everybody's joint laughter I understood how childish I behaved and I became completely embarrassed.

"Forgive me, senora Beata," I uttered by kissing both painter's hands. "I couldn't hold my enthusiasm and respect after seeing such perfection. That isn't the Bronski's portrait about which I was dreaming, - that's the life itself. And to see such painting – that's to understand the perfection of genius for whom "to know" means "to be able to do."

"I also ask you to forgive Lovushka for his unconscious embrace, full of fascination. He rendered the fascination of all of us with this kiss. Also I, by kissing these hands, express only my honour for the power of pure heart which could enrich the world with such beauty," I uttered. "At last believe in the power of your talent. Comprehend that not your doubts force you to hide your paintings from the people's eyes, but fear that has turned into the supposed self-love within you. Become free from your fear from this moment on. Imagine that today you are already living your last day. Won't you really have enough strength to throw down the mould of your fear and doubts? Won't you really manage to glorify Life without any sores of negation and fear? Start the new stage of your creation, take my hand firmly and, having concentrated your self-control, show the second painting to us," I was speaking by holding the painter's hands.

"My Teacher, I know that I need to enter the new phase of my spiritual life both in the art and in my daily routine, otherwise death should come. I know and I feel that I stopped with my entire consciousness. I begin to comprehend that in this stage of my development I can neither create nor live anymore, that neither my spirit nor my creation has any perspective of development anymore until I move forward along the path of liberation. But... to open my new painting for you now – that's exactly means to die for Beata who was living up to now. Let your will be fulfilled. I don't know whether I will have enough strength to come to life again by the canvas which I will open for you. Perhaps I will die there, but I go."

The painter turned towards the opposite promontory of the rock where only now I saw the big frame, covered with a cloth. She was going so slowly! It seemed to me that suddenly she became an old woman of a hundred and that some good weights were tied to both of her feet. I thought that she wouldn't reach it – so much effort she needed in order to cross the rather small clearing.

Finally her hands took the little rope and pulled it somehow. The first Skalradi efforts didn't give any results. I already wanted to run and help her, but I.'s look stopped me and at the same time reminded me of the creative action of my heart and prayer to Florentian. I felt how he himself was helping Beata by pouring confidence and power to her. I concentrated all my thoughts on Florentian by begging him to help Beata and I couldn't take my eyes off her anymore.

She always kept pulling the rope and, when it seemed to me that all her strength was exhausted, while she was almost bending by holding the rope, suddenly the cloth trembled and came open immediately. Due to the great effort and suddenly opened cloth the painter fell on one of her knees, she couldn't rise, so she remained kneeling with the little rope in her hands.

I heard a suppressed lament next to I. I took my eyes off Beata, turned back and I saw Aninov with his face covered with his hands and flinching from strong lament. I still didn't have any time to look at the canvas, because the painter's face had still fastened my look like the magnet. Now when I looked at I. who was looking at the painting and it seemed that he had forgotten about everything in the world, I recognized that unusual expression of tranquillity and bliss in his face, with which he was standing on the ship's deck after the storm when two whirlwinds of the Black Sea fell down on us.

I felt that something grand happened now, I turned to the canvas and I jumped back completely stunned. I myself was walking by carrying Eta on my shoulder. I don't know whether it was a play of light or an expression almost impossible for the brush was really caught on the painting, but it seemed to me that Eta was about to jump down from my shoulder and that I was smiling to him. I even touched myself whether my dear Eta wasn't on my shoulder.

There was something else on the picture. I could see I. between two pillars, behind the transparent curtain, to whom I with Eta hurried. But I couldn't understand what was going on with him. I.'s figure was more and more revealed in my eyes, his chiton was painted in always brighter orange colour, while the same orange blossoms were in his hands, which were growing and blooming on the tree in his house in the rock. One of his hands was extended towards Eta, as though by offering the flowers to the bird.

I turned to I. His face kept always the same expression of glorification of calm and Life. His left hand was extended forwards, with the palm towards the canvas. I turned back to the painting, and I.'s figure in it seemed to me even more finished. His face in the painting had the same expression that now was shining in his alive face.

I was stunned by guessing and not understanding what kind of the play of light was in the canvas and I was pondering whether I.'s image wouldn't lose that brightness as suddenly as it appeared there, but his figure was still finished. I. cast down his hand, and in the undisturbed silence his voice was heard which was so charming, so tender that I had never heard it like this before.

"Don't cry, my friend and brother. Now you take part not only in the baptism of the first painter's painting. Also you see her new birth. The man's spirit has acquired the new sphere of influence in your eyes. The creating man cannot stand in one place. In the same way as no two notes that have the same frequency of their vibration exist in the physical world – which you, the musician, know well, - in the same way no two plans exist which the painter could reflect by remaining only in the plan of the physical

vibrations. The spirit that doesn't have strength to hold out in the atmosphere of its invisible assistants, is unable to rise and to develop – as the conductor, as the herald of heaven which give help to people. Now you can clearly see the power of our co-operation with people. I realized Beata's dream, the dream of her entire life in the painting with the power of creative Love: to reflect the Teacher and his disciple with the brush. She didn't have enough self-confidence and calm, but when her loyalty defeated even the fear of death, then help came much faster than her hands could finish the painting and depict the Teacher in such a way about which she was dreaming. Look at senora Beata. Is this really the same woman whom you saw a moment ago? This is an absolutely different being who was newly born for life and creation. That is already the life after death of everything what was personal, the life of our herald to work on the earth, to unite people through beauty. It is enough for you to suffer. Understand that everybody has his own path of suffering. And this path on the earth is the only one for everybody whose heart is destined to become the source of knowledge. Only after death together with his passions, the creating man begins to walk the path of creator, the servant and assistant for his Teacher. Live not by breathing the poison of vulgarity in yourself, but by burning those misfortunes around yourself, which people pull out to the surface as a conditionality and simulation by thinking that they are values. Live and breathe so easily that your every sound could carry the note of your Teacher's heart, that it would sound not only as the note of your heart, but always as the note of the cord that was born in your Teacher's heart."

I embraced Aninov, he gave his hand to me and he came to Skalradi. She was still kneeling, he embraced her, helped her up and pressed her to his heart. It seemed to me for a moment that both of them disappeared and that in that place where they were standing I could see only the trembling and flapping flame – the big ball of fire which was shining in an orange colour with all sorts of all colour flame tongues and bands.

The flame cleared away in several minutes, and I saw I. again, who was holding the painter's hand. But my God! She was so changed. Her eyes were shining, she all was gushing power and will, her movements and her gait were quick and flexible when she came up to the canvas resolutely.

"Did I help your thoughts to reflect on the canvas like this, my friend?" I. asked her by smiling to the painter.

"Yes, Teacher. Only my hand would have never depicted the similar image. It is performed simply brilliantly here, but I didn't paint it and let this painting remain in the Community forever as the precious present of your compassion."

"Oh no, my friend," I. answered her. "The painting will go to the wide world and it will travel with your name. I only gathered your thoughts, your creation and your efforts. You would have painted the same image of mine anyway, only not so quickly. Reconcile yourself and walk the path of your life in such a way as I see and indicate it to you. Join the ranks of those our heralds who don't possess their "I" and "my" anymore, but who possess only joy: "through me". It is easy to live for that person who knows that every moment, that his every action is only a simple, pure kindness. Don't force your way up until the earth needs you. Crowds of people will be learning from this painting, while you forget about yourself and think about them."

I. kissed the high painter's forehead and he called us with Aninov. He addressed me.

"Lovushka, you are very good-looking man here. Where are you looking, my friend?" I. laughed when he saw that I was staring at his face. "Do I look more good-looking than you?" I. kept laughing.

"Ah I., my dear Teacher. I really deserved that you would laugh at me, because I turned into Lovushka the Catcher of Crows again. But now I actively experience that moment when we were sailing in the steamer with you and when the terrible storm ended. Your face back then and now is the same. The unearthly expression in it was back then – it is in it also now, it is alive also in the painting. I want to kneel and pray, I'm not already talking about your beauty and vitality in the painting. One really could say: happy is that person who will see you at least in this painting. He will perceive who the man is, who he may be and into what happiness life of those may turn, who've found knowledge, who are living with him on the same earth."

"All right, Lovushka, but in this moment I ask you to direct your attention to your own portrait. You have to be gentleman and cavalier, and to thank senora Beata for this wonderful work."

"Oh Teacher, I'm extremely thankful for senora Beata. I never expected such happiness, such undeserved honour as to be painted next to you. I cannot find any words with which I could thank you, senora. But if some time the power of my pen and my eloquence is able to be like your painter's talent, then I will honour you in my novel. And I will try to create your portrait exactly in the same precise way by my memory as you reflected mine, as Teacher put it in words. Everything what I wish you – so that people next to your painting would experience such grandeur of feelings as all of us did."

Aninov kissed the painter's hands and uttered silently.

"If you were as young as this awakened cob, I would write the sonnet "Sorceress – the liberator" for you. Now I understood so much from your paintings. I came here unhappy and I leave happy and comforted."

The painter kissed beautiful Aninov's forehead and answered him.

"It is so strange to hear the words about misfortune from you. The man who can tear the crowd of people out of any sadness with the gusts of his sounds, even out of the hopeless disappointment, and who simply fastens the wings of fascination, confidence, energy for everybody, suddenly begins to speak about his own disharmony. It always seemed to me that you might be dissatisfied with yourself, because you could see too far in the art, you bring the sounds down from too high and you don't have enough earthly means of expression to convey to people everything what your spirit experiences. I understand this dissatisfaction of the artist well, but that I should comfort you, the comforter, that doubts and your personal disharmony would torment you, such giant, I couldn't imagine it in any way."

"Well, let this case, my friend, be an example for you of how little people fall to thinking about the other man's soul when they meet him along the path," I. said to Beata. "Probably no one of you will stay only with your own thoughts and feelings during your entire life. A great artist and your Teacher's servant as the path of help for people in everybody of you will be in the first place of your earthly life. But even by knowing the grandeur of all people's paths on the earth, no one of you will be able to achieve such liberation that you would be joyous and happy. Why isn't there satisfaction in any of you? Why isn't there calm? Because everyone of you attributes the qualities of your talent to yourself, to the work of this current incarnation in your own way. The thought that every one of you deserved your own condition is still the fundamental and essential point of your life. Such notions as "I deserved it" don't exist in a free man's thoughts anymore, as well as there aren't fear, self-love, curiosity, envy and other notions. To comprehend "deserving" as merit – that's only the earth's notion which is living with the laws of justice. Everything is happening naturally and purposefully in the universe, everything submits to the law of cause and effect. There aren't any superstitions in the universe. Everything is happening accurately according to the laws of the eternal movement. Not a single star may begin to shine brighter or earlier, although it would seem to itself and to the milliards of its inhabitants that it deserved more. But some catastrophes may happen in its

surroundings, some neighbouring worlds may fall apart, and if its vibrations with the frequency of its waves will be harmonious with the lives of the worlds which died next to it, then it will draw the light of the dying stars into itself and it will shine brighter. All the works of genius – that's the works of his spirit's liberation during his incalculable earthly lives. That's his unselfish devotion to the form of the art which he has brought with him. His inextinguishable spirit chained in the case of his body which has to die and return to life many times used to come back to the Earth with the higher type of consciousness. His spirit used to achieve the certain stage of perfection through this constant process of liberation and it used to join the circle of always higher invisible assistants, into the harmony of spirit it could penetrate already. It used to unite with their harmony, so that it could carry the radiance of their Light to the earth through its conductor. Now you can see how heavily each moment is oppressing the man of genius when he forgets about joy to live by serving people with the source of Light and Love, which his assistants are sending to him from the toiling heaven. Let's go, my friends. Soon I will leave you for some time. Don't be sad. Every one of you has grown so much during these several months of your life here that you can go to the world again and become the effective conductors for people there. You, Beata, need to take your paintings to Paris yourself, they will make quite a lot of noise there. That way of painting with which my image was painted, this curtain through which it can be seen, the lucid paint – this secret will die together with you. It is not for the wide public. The pledge of your obedience: to keep silent about the real origin of the portrait in the painting. To all the questions and requests to reveal the secret of the paint for progress smile pleasingly and answer them that when you were striving for victories you didn't ask anybody to reveal any secrets to you. Answer them that you still remember well with what attacks of bayonets they met your first appearances in the halls of exhibitions. Let everybody achieve perfection in creation himself. Some things exist which may not be instructed, which the talent achieves himself. And the less they hinder the talent with their instructions, the more independence he receives, the earlier and faster he may develop. Don't tire your heart that you go to the world not completely with the truth. You still cannot see so clearly so that you would know why you need to see namely such light in your painting. And therefore, I give the pledge to you to keep the secret, but I cannot reveal more to you than I said. Go, my friend, to the world joyfully, easily, without feeling shy. Not only you've rested here, but also returned to life. Now it is time to affect your encountered people not only through your paintings, but also with your own living example."

I saw how surprised the painter was that she needed to go to Paris, to leave the Community. I saw her strong fight and her desire to beg I. to postpone her departure, but I.'s face now was strict and firm like the steel dagger, while his eyes were pouring radiance. Beata bowed to him and asked Bronski to help her to cover the paintings.

I. took Aninov's hands and told him.

"I also give the pledge to you, my friend: go to America obediently and don't waste your time uselessly there. Don't be lost in arguments whether the historical moment of life of your nation is developing rightly or not. All your arguments won't bring any use for a single person, but one chord performed by your hand may push tens and hundreds of people to the new growth, to the new power. Travel, you are healthy. Live in such a way that you wouldn't reproach yourself in the last hour for not doing enough during the period of your eternal work in this incarnation. Don't forget that man himself is building the path to his future incarnation, he creates his tomorrow himself, he draws the surroundings of his future life to himself with that energy with which he is living today. Man's completeness of feelings experienced today flies his spirit into the whole feelings of tomorrow. You can leave compromises only by walking this path. Travel, and here's my present for you."

I. took the ring with topaz off his hand and put it on the fourth finger of the musician's left hand. I had never noticed any rings on I.'s hands before and I didn't know that this ring was on his finger today. I had an opportunity to make certain of my absent-mindedness again.

I looked at Aninov's face. Tears were rolling down his cheeks, but what a difference it was between his tears now and an hour ago. He simply was shining with gratitude by kissing the ring given to him with honour.

"Teacher, I will do everything, so that my hands were pure, so that I would be worthy of carrying your present till the end of my life. I won't be talking about that how said it is for me to part with you. I don't even know what is stronger within me now: joy that I received the present from you or sadness that I leave you. I will try to work so passionately that I wouldn't get in the role of the thief anymore by hiding those treasures which I'm destined to achieve through the music. I will be living in such a way as you told me to by thinking that every day I'm living my last day. And if I can live some period of time deservedly, I will hope that I will see you again before my death."

"I promise it to you, my dear friend," I. answered him.

He embraced everybody present here again, he said to Bronski to go with us, he offered Aninov to help the painter and added that he also would send Zeiched to help.

Having said good-bye to Beata and Aninov whose faces were radiating energy and joy in spite of their separation with I., we turned to the park and went straight to I.'s room. Having seated us, he took a big folio from the shelf and said to Bronski.

"Both you and Lovushka need to read these pages of the book, which are marked here with bands. You don't know Pali language, but Lovushka knows it so much that he could translate the pages for you. The instructions will be given to both of you here about how you should behave along the path which won't be easy partly. Besides, you will understand how you should behave with those people to whom we'll be travelling. You'll see the people who are walking their earthly path with much difficulty in those houses of the Community which you'll need to visit. You won't see a single happy face among the mass of people gathered in those parts of the Community, except those who left from here, from our Community. In order for you to understand how difficult every day is for the unfortunate person who is always dreaming about the wonderful tomorrow, you need to liberate yourself completely. Try to develop your self-control during all the remaining days here and during all the time on our way. In order for the man's inner, spiritual vision to open within him, he has to enter the new perception of his own life. This moment – that's the birth of the new powers for your future work in a higher form. If a man is called to the higher work with his Teacher, then the complete liberation enters his inner and external life, the liberation from his all conditional chains which were exhausting his spiritual strength up to this hour, or more precisely, which were tightening his case with the strong bands of conditionalities. Every one of you has to prepare yourself consciously for this period of opening of the highest consciousness which is coming nearer. Such stages don't exist in discipleship which you could enter with a strange experience, with the strange knowledge. Man himself sets fire to every spark of the new Light within himself with his work. But that doesn't mean that the disciple doesn't need any experience and instructions from those who've achieved their liberation before him. He needs them very much, but not as some dry instruction, as education, but as the power of Love and benevolence which help the man to open and to find his own path easier with that harmony which his elder brothers pour to him. Those are elder in the discipleship whose power of harmony sounds louder. Also an ordinary cock may be Teacher, while his disciple – head of the monastery. The elder brother's Love helps his younger brother to become free from his conditionalities exactly in the same way as gentle mother is protecting her son during the war with her love. Her liveliness, courage and vital energy saves her son by giving the wings of inventiveness and fearlessness to him. An unwise mother keeps her son by her skirt without taking thought about his spirit. She imagines that with her care, protections, her blind defending by protecting him from any difficulties, she will save him for her and his happiness. A wise and selfless mother flies her spirit herself into the whole, wide world by forgetting about herself. She's

weaving the flying carpet for her son from her love for happiness and victory. Her liberated love unites with the best powers of his heroic efforts, while her help which isn't tied as one millstone onto his body of spirit carries him over all disasters, all abysses to that place where harmony close to himself, to the note of his heart is ringing. After having read this book, for which you'll need no less than three days, come to me, and we'll go to professor's. My friends, don't search for the right examples in the books, which you could imitate, don't admire its contents, but try to understand your own entanglement with the conditional concepts. Search for the path of the powers for your own love and tranquillity within yourselves, so that you could leave the net of conditional, oppressing superstitions and prepare the new possibilities for your hearts: to meet the man with the smile of tranquillity. With that smile of tranquillity in which the double bill doesn't exist anymore: "You've caused me pain and evil, I return good to you," because only the person who is buried in conditionalities may present such "bill of his mind." The free man is acting with the silent smile by pouring not thoughts about the action, but the action itself. Now go. I will send somebody to take you. I allow you to learn in Ali's room. Don't go to the common dining-rooms. Yassa will bring everything to you to my dining-room here where none of you have been yet."

We were listening to our Teacher's words with great respect. I. gave the book to me, we bowed low to him, he also bowed to us, and we went to Ali's room immediately. We were very surprised when we found Yassa upstairs in the corridor, who was waiting for us. He took us to the room of ablutions, gave the clean, white clothes to us and uttered.

"I will know when I should visit you."

Chapter 12

We read the book in Ali's room. The old fairy-tale

When we left the room of ablutions, I looked at Bronski and the unusual expression of his face touched me. An absolute embarrassment was seen on it instead of the daily cheerfulness and joy which had changed his previous, sad expression for some time already. He, this big man, reminded me of a child now and he was trying to be as near as possible to me by walking down the white floor of the corridor with fear. Apparently, not only the external view of the little house, but also the atmosphere affected the sensitive and subtle actor's organism strongly.

I remembered how I was surprised myself when I. took me here for the first time, how Andreyeva was suffering in Ali's room, and I was calling Florentian with my entire heart by asking him to help me to make the first steps of my friend here easier. I knew Florentian's compassion, I also knew Stanislav's courage and I didn't doubt that we would go well if I was bold and pure myself.

When we approached the door of Ali's room, I unlocked and opened it wide, and I saw the shining fiery record on the threshold.

"My friend, can you see the fiery record?" I asked Bronski.

"No, Lovushka, I cannot see any record, but I don't have any strength to step forward. As though my feet glued to the floor, and I'm like filled with lead. I won't be able to overcome the terrestrial gravitation and enter this light that is shining behind the door. Go alone, my dear boy, I will be standing here, behind the door like keeping watch and I will be waiting for you, it doesn't matter for how long you would be there. Believe me, I won't move from the place even if I had to die here, exhausted by the unusual heaviness. I will be waiting for you. If I'm destined to die by this door, send my gratitude, loyalty and respect to I. Go, I feel that I will fall down in several minutes."

Although very hollow, Bronski's voice was tender, calm, and the same childishness was blowing from him. I told him.

"Here are the words that are burning here, Stanislav."

Only that person may enter here who is bold, loyal till the end and who can protect the secret of his path.

It was shining above the door:

Enter, traveller, don't be afraid of the heavy burden. Enter, learn, be blessed. Leave this place with the knowledge and apply it in your creation in such a way as your talents and intuition will tell you to. Remember, traveller, the disciple receives the knowledge not because it would be put away and unused, it is given to him so that he would spread it on the earth by understanding and evaluating the condition on it. So that he would meet his every day with it as the wonderful happiness to live today – the day blessed by courage, wisdom and union with the workers of the earth and heaven – in inextinguishable Love of the Great Mother.

For a moment I saw Florentian's face that was smiling to me and I heard his voice telling me to give the hand to my friend.

I turned to Bronski, gave my hand to him and I asked him whether he understood, whether he remembered everything what I translated for him, I told him that the records were still burning and that I could read them for the second time. He answered me by leaning on my arm with difficulty.

"I understood and I memorized them. It is much easier for me now, and if you allow me to lean on your arm, maybe I will be able to enter the room."

The records went out, we entered the room and turned to Ali's table. I seated Bronski at the table and, until I opened the lid, until I put the book, I was doing everything slowly intentionally, so that the actor could come to himself, but I could still see embarrassment from unusual surprise in his face. I was silent for a while by the opened book, and finally he uttered.

"I'm ready, read, Lovushka."

That was already everyday, cheerful my friend's voice. I began to translate the text for him instantly.

"While searching for discipleship, people try to coordinate their high spiritual ideas with the most ordinary work in their everyday life. While they are trying to coordinate heaven with the earth in theory, their work is meaningless, it gives the fruit of their creation neither to themselves nor to their encountered people.

Only from that moment when their spirit becomes free from oppression of the constant thought "what that or another Teacher of humanity is talking and teaching" and when man himself begins to understand that his path – that's namely himself, from this moment on his life on the earth becomes significant, and he stops spending his time uselessly.

In this way, day after day, man achieves his first knowledge by always mastering his work experience – where his own spirit was stuck, where he could act according to his spirit's call, but where he acted according to his body's needs and his selflove. He moves forward or he stops only because he enters the wave of movement of his surroundings by loving or he covers his day by trying to keep away from his everyday earthly affairs and to shift them on the shoulders of those who aren't searching for the heights of spirit and who are satisfied with their material weekdays.

You need to remember when you are awakening for your spiritual life that your meeting with your Teacher is always the result of your earthly life lived joyfully and easily. Only that person who is able to carry his heavy everyday burden by smiling to his encountered person and by remembering that the strange pain is more sacred than his own one, - only that one will find his Teacher, because the path to him leads through love for people.

Man's passionate desire to be a disciple and the same passionate and stormy experience of his daily routine doesn't bring him to the meeting until his passion turns into joy.

Nobody on the Earth is able to develop his loyalty till the end without doubts within himself, without treasons and hesitations. But once man perceives clearly how his loyalty is still unstable, he directs his entire attention in order to make this quality stronger. When such moment is already experienced, man enters the path of liberation and tranquillity, that is the path of discipleship by expanding his consciousness little by little.

Once the disciple understands that the power of his own irritation and his exactingness for people are the main fetters of his slavery, he starts throwing off his conditional values and he opens the source of Eternity within himself, that Love in which all miracles are hiding and which gives power to the pure, unselfish action."

Bronski's face was calm and joyful. I could keep translating the book.

THE OLD FAIRY-TALE

Once upon a time there was a wise old man. His wife died early. She left him with three sons and a little daughter.

The boys were growing up easily. They didn't know neither illness nor tears nor envy. The wise father never beat them. He didn't educate them with any long and clever morals, but taught them three rules with his own example:

1. Never be afraid of anything.
2. Don't think about your future, but work with all your might now.
3. Don't take anything what doesn't belong to you and be compassionate, not condemning people.

The sons grew up. They were applying their father's rules in their lives. In the meanwhile, the little girl was growing up by being afraid of everything, she was dissatisfied with everything, she didn't notice how her "now" was flying past and she was always dreaming that finally, her real, wonderful and tempting life would start, and it would be noisy and luxurious. The girl used to answer in the following way to her father's and her brothers' questions about what she was dreaming, why she wasn't rejoicing at life, at the beauty of the mountains and streamlets, rivers and meadows.

"What kind of life is it? We are living like bears in a godforsaken hole. Yes, it is beautiful, very beautiful here! The wide distances, meadows and gardens, flowers and birds, the people's songs – everything is beautiful. But there are little people here, they are grey, dressed without any taste! Is that a life? The life is probably in the cities where the crowds of people are racketing, where everybody can do a lot of things, where different songs are, where clothes are colourful, where the things are golden."

Her brothers used to laugh at her. They didn't scold their sister for her childish dreams, but they used to joke that there was the most handsome prince somewhere, he would certainly come to her, he would be fascinated by her beauty and he would take her to his distant, noisy kingdom. Once, one of her brothers gave a hand mirror to her so that she could admire her not only in the water of the river.

The sons grew up, they became strong, and once their wise father told them.

"Well, my children, this is what I have to tell you. A monk from the distant monastery came to me and told me to send all three of you to the wide world. He told me that I have introduced strong fundamentals of honour and kindness to you and that you had to bring them to the world, so that it would be easier and merrier for people to live next to you. Go, my dear sons. Let each of you go alone. Don't take much things and food with you. You are young and you will reach a noisy city by earning your bread here and there. Once you are there, disperse to different directions, you will find your own city where you will be living among people by serving them in the best way possible. This is what the monk asked me to tell you."

The sons became sad, because they had to leave their father, their native house, their dear places, the forest and the mountains, the beauty of which they appreciated so much. But the wise father comforted them by reminding them that there wasn't anything eternal on the earth, except that love and peace which man possessed within himself. We have to part one with another sooner or later anyway, the death will separate us without any mercy, and apparently, there wasn't enough love and peace in the noisy cities, so it was everyone's duty to bring them to people if he succeeded to reach such joy by developing them within himself.

Although the sons didn't calm down at once, at least they reconciled themselves to their fate, and soon they settled down completely when they understood that not only their village, their house or their street existed in the world, but that people and life were everywhere, and they had to unite everything with love.

However, the girl was left uncomfortable. She was sad not because she had to part with her brothers, but because her brothers would go to the wide world, they would be living in the luxury and racket of the cities, while she would stay in the godforsaken place in the grey daily life, unknown to anybody. She was raging against the monk who had told her brothers to leave – the truth was they were well-built and handsome men – while she was told to stay at home, although she was the most beautiful not only at home, but in the entire environs.

And as the days were going by, her vexation became stronger. She didn't want even to help her brothers to prepare for their journey. She didn't believe them that it was difficult for them to part with their loved father and herself. Many times she was trying to ask them to take her with them, but her brothers used to answer her that they had given their word to their father and they had to keep it, and not because she wasn't dear to them, but because they believed their father, loved him and were glad to fulfil his will.

Every one of them was telling her that they would be glad to stay at home, in the wonderful silence and would change the roles with her, but their father's order was the order for their love and will, and although the separation may be difficult, the joy of their desire to serve people would overcome everything, to serve in the way their wise father wanted them to.

The irritated girl used to be exasperated at them, not being able to control herself, she used to accuse her brothers of lie and hypocrisy. She was explaining to them that their father wasn't wise anymore, that he had lost his mind due to his old age and that he was confusing everything, so most likely, he had confused the monk's words, too, she was telling them that, by the way, the monk wasn't very normal as well.

Every time the girl used to face the unshakable endurance of her brothers, so she decided to try to afflict every one of them separately, because she failed to achieve something from her brothers when they were all together.

Her oldest brother retorted her strictly from her very first words and explained to her the secret duty of herself to take care of her father if it seemed to her that he was weak and feeble. He told her many strict and bitter truths, then he added by looking at her sternly.

"You won't be able to get on with people anywhere, because you are merciless and ruthless, you are dissatisfied with your home, you don't value its cosiness, joy and purity. You shouldn't expect that somebody would greet you instantly, you have to hold the spray of peace in your hand yourself and to stretch it to everybody whom you meet. When you act like this, you will see that everything around you settles down if you bring your spray of peace to them. I feel sorry for you, my sister, but I cannot help you in any way. Unfortunately, you have to calm down yourself, and then you will see what an extraordinary miracle our father and our home is."

"I don't need your morals," his sister answered him with irritation. "You think that you are the oldest, so you can moralize us. I will leave this place anyway and find the way to escape to the bright and comfortable life. I'm beautiful, I want to be rich, famous and not to work as a hireling."

"My poor, little sister. And who has managed to disturb your spirit so much? When could you see our arguments or dissatisfaction? Where is that passion for riches within you from? Is the perfect life

only that one which is comfortable? I don't know what life is in the cities which our father is sending me to, but I certainly know that I won't find a better life than next to our wise father, even if I saw thousands of comfortable lives. And you, my poor sister, will be the most unfortunate person until every strange life is alluring you, until you don't love working and can't find peace in your everyday life. Maybe you will be rich, but the people whose life will be richer and more comfortable than yours will always excite you."

"Please, shut up," his sister interrupted him with vexation. "I have already told you, don't overdo it with your morals. I'm the most beautiful here, although there are lots of beauties around. Apparently, I won't make a fool of myself with my beauty anywhere. You don't want to help me and that's all right. Only you shouldn't use our father's wisdom and your obedience as a cover. You are thinking only about yourself! And when the test of your love came, then I saw what it was worthy of. The same your praised peace is worthy of. Well, go then, I'll manage without your help."

His sister slammed the door angrily, ran away from her oldest brother to search for her middle brother who always tried to pamper her with something, who was especially kind to her. This brother was sitting under the tree and putting his leather rucksack in order, which his father had told him to take for his journey. She went up to him and told him by fondling to her kind brother tenderly.

"My dear brother, you've always been the most kind for me among everybody in our home. I hope you won't deny my last request."

"Of course, I won't deny it, my dear. Could you have such a request that somebody could refuse to help you? Quickly, tell me, I will do everything for you."

"Well, so I knew it that I can't be mistaken about your kindness. Here's what I want, my brother. I want to leave for the noisy city with you silently, exactly to the one which you are going to go to. I will be living with you and I will be doing everything for you. Besides, you are so kind, everybody will harm you, take everything from you, and I won't allow anybody to harm you. Here I'm afraid of everything, and there I won't be afraid of anything. And you won't be afraid of anything with me."

Her kind brother laughed at naivety of his sister and answered her.

"You are still an absolute baby, my sister, although you are fifteen years old already. What does that constant word "afraid" of yours mean – I have never understood that and I don't understand it now. All kinds of trifles, which there was no need even to talk about, were always frightening you. I could lay down my life for you if I had to protect you or to support you with my work. But what are you asking me now? I can forgive you for your request solely because you don't understand yourself what you are asking from me. You want me to break our father's order? Is it really easy for him to send all three of us away, to stay old and alone and to do all work at home, at farm and fields? You can't help him, can't you? When he's left alone, he will have to take care of you, too, but he's not afraid of his heavy burden. He understands well that some day the separation with us is inevitable anyway. Because he's wise and he loves us, he's sending us to the distant lands easily, so that we could start living independently while he's still alive, and perhaps, his love will help every one of us to find that real path if we go astray. If you weren't occupied only with yourself, you could be simply kind and you could help our father to stand the silence of our home without us, because there were always so many of us here, there was so much laughter, songs and liveliness which he was used to and loved so much."

"Ah, so that's what your kindness and love for me are worthy of! And you decided to moralize me? That's my loyal brother," his sister gave an ironic laughter.

"My poor sister," her brother told her tenderly one more time. "You accuse me of unfaithfulness because of your ignorance. No, my friend, I'm loyal till the end not only to you and your

friendship, I will be loyal to my father during my entire life, too. Because both he and me – we are as two fingers of one hand. And my friendship with him – that's our one love, one heart, one wisdom. And I'm loyal to my brothers and to you as hands are loyal to the body. Our path may be different, but our foundation is the same and one. And I cannot double my loyalty, I can only carry my pure tenderness for everybody saintly by loving every one of you. My kindness which you reproach me with and call hypocrisy, cannot be it, because it's my entire life. Understand that I don't have another choice if my father told me how I had to continue my life. The God sees how I would like to exchange my destiny with you, to stay here in this blessed silence, in this wonderful air. Where else could you find such meadows and such flowers? Where else such forests and mountains could be found? This is the most wonderful land, isn't it – there's so much peace and purity here. And I have to leave all this miracle of light and charm because of the dirt and dregs of a noisy city! But our wise father sees things better than me. And my kindness would be weak if I was thinking only about myself. I love everybody here, there are no bad persons here, it is easy to be kind here. It seems that our father knows how much tired people need kindness in the noisy city."

This brother was also interrupted by an ironic laughter of his sister.

"It seems that you and your oldest brother are both made of the same clay - hands and fingers of the body. You can't think of anything better! Your praised kindness is worthy of his morals about peace. Well, what kind of brothers I received by fate! Calm down, I won't be troubling you with my requests again. But I think that one day you will creep to me yourself with your requests when I'm rich and famous already. You will have to ask me to let you into my wonderful house through the back door."

"My unfortunate sister... I would be so glad of your glory! But the God can see that you understand glory and riches in a strange way. Be blessed, my poor sister. It is difficult for man to live in such darkness as yours."

His sister laughed one more time, she mocked at the stupid kindness of her brother again and left. The girl was walking across the big garden of her father, in which wonderful flowers were growing, but she wasn't paying attention to anything. Boredom was nagging her heart, she wanted only people, people, people. She wanted everybody to admire her beauty, she wanted to be more superior than all others, she never wanted to be alone, she wanted to see balls, amusements, luxurious homes and clothes. In this way, walk after walk, she strayed to the steep slope and saw her third, the youngest brother there, who was sitting on the big stone. The youth was sad, oh how sad he was. His sad eyes were looking at the distance, opening from the steep slope, and his tears were rolling down his fresh face.

And his sister was amazed. She had never seen any tears in her family, except her own when she used to cry by being whimsical, angry or frightened of something. This third brother was notable for his especially easy and merry character. His laughter was echoing during the entire days by filling the whole house with his joviality as if some bells were jingling in it.

Having understood her brother's heartache and sadness because of his separation with his native places, his sister conceived an insidiousness. She came nearer to her brother, embraced his neck, dried his tears with her lips, sat down on his knees and snuggled up to him tenderly.

"My dear brother. We are the nearest one to another. Don't be sad and frightened. You won't leave this place. I have conceived a plan. In the evening when our brothers are getting ready for their journey, I will change into your clothes, and you into mine. You will cover yourself with my shawl as if you had a toothache, while I will hide my plait under your cap as I used to joke many times before. We look like twins, don't we? Even our father was unable to distinguish us. Everybody will be occupied with their own business, nobody will pay attention to our disguise. Only don't laugh, because our laughter is different. The day is closing in early now, I can imitate your walk. It is important to leave our home, then I will manage to

settle my affairs. And when our brothers see that all their morals didn't help, they won't leave me in the middle of the way. But you can be calm, I certainly won't come back, and you will stay at home instead of me. You like our home and this life, don't you?"

"Lord, what a baby you still are, my sister. I admit that I was thinking that you understood better the duties of the daughter and the only mistress of the house, but you are still a real baby. We are still playing childish games sometimes, we exchange our clothes and we want our father not to recognize us instantly, but I couldn't even imagine that you were still so childish in serious matters."

"What are you so amazed at? What my childishness has to do with it? I love you and I'm ready to leave this place instead of you. Everything will be all right for you here, and you don't think about me, it will be all right for me everywhere," his sister was speaking to him by snuggling up to him tenderly, although she had suffered a bitter defeat with her older brothers two times already.

"My poor, dear sister," her brother answered to her tenderness, "because of your innocent naivety and purity, you don't even comprehend that you are persuading me to step into a lie and deceit. Well, how could you tell a lie to your father and to your brothers and then start your new life without the truth? What will that life be then? Life is joy, isn't it? The whole power of the day is because you can be happy with your free heart, because you can admire the world and people freely and peacefully. Then you can sing your song joyfully, because it is easy and free in your heart. Then you can appreciate your family and love when no lie oppresses you. Your every action is right and free, and you can brighten every man's life with your joy when no hypocrisy is oppressing you. And I must go to the world if my father tells me to do so. Apparently, the people in the cities don't have much joy, and I have to bring it to them every day, as much as I can do it."

His sister jumped up from her brother's knees as bitten, she was even more vexed due to her failure. She stamped her beautiful foot, put her arms akimbo and gave a shout.

"Are you also bothering me with your morals? You shouldn't moralize me, and I shouldn't listen to your morals! You don't see an inch beyond your nose! You don't understand that I was always making a fool of you as much as I wanted and wherever I wanted to! And you! You are bothering me with your fairness and joy. What has happened to you all, you all have lost your mind at the same time or what? You agreed to befool me, didn't you? I won't believe you that people are dear to you and that you want to be of service to them. Just think what righteous persons you are! You are glad because you can escape this godforsaken hole, but you are ashamed to confess that you are happy to leave your father and to get rid of your sister who can see the truth and who can reveal it anytime. You fool declare joy," she was unable to calm down by shouting with laughter always angrier, because she saw that she wouldn't gain anything neither with her tenderness not with her anger. "Your joy is worthy only of a penny if you are a ruthless egoist. A strange monk told us to leave, and we are running to strangers by leaving our own people to die, to rot in this deep, godforsaken hole. But we are going to have a good time in the cities! Oh, you hypocrites, you angry, dishonest liars, what do your own people, your real relatives mean to you?"

The youth stood up from the stone on which he was sitting, and his bright face became darker than a cloud.

"Yes, you are absolutely right, my unfortunate sister, I really was a fool up to now. But you've helped me to get rid of my blindness that was covering my eyes. You've helped my heart to grow many years old in a flash. My heart knew only one joy and could see only one happiness – that's the fairness within people. It couldn't see any lie in them, and it wasn't any sadness in it. It was always easy for me to be happy and joyful under such conditions. Now my heart understood the most terrible thing in man – his lie and envy. And now I understand how it is difficult for one to keep one's joy, how one needs to hold tight

in order not to let one's joy die out in one's heart when lie is in full swing around one and one's envy is tearing the most beautiful thing what God could give to man. Now I understand that God is alive in man if it is possible to hold out and not to give way to despair after seeing how rotting is already destroying the miracle of another man's external beauty. I, the fool, certainly needed this lesson of yours. I will be glorifying compassion during my entire life, because it has opened up my eyes and liberated me from the illusion of beauty. I understood what was the most beautiful within man and what was his integument. O Lord, what would have happened to me if I had found out the truth not here, but in a noisy city? I would think that men were rotting from lies and temptations only there, while here only the saints were living, whom I considered you to be. Now I understand that everything is living within man and that not surroundings are creating man, but that man is creating his surroundings. I understand how strong and brave man needs to be, how calmly he has to go through his meetings and all his affairs, how calm he has to be within himself in order for his joy never to die out. I was still sad only a moment ago, I was grieving because I had to part with my native home and you. Now I understand that our father stays here only because of you alone, and he's sending us in order for us to become tempered and to serve God and His messengers by serving people. I can only sing the songs and amuse people with them. Luckily, here, through you I understood what living within man could be and how impure he could be. How could I sing if this blow had stuck in my throat. Now I have time to become tempered. And believe me, neither my heart nor my voice will ever tremble anymore. I have poured the first tear of my life here because of you. Let it be my last one! I will be singing by glorifying life and joy, trying to awaken everything what the best in man is, his love and compassion, his serenity and not condemnation of others. And I will never be waiting for any favours from the people that I will meet, but I will be carrying my firm and loyal joy to them. Let's go, my sister, God is your judge, but not me. Be blessed such who you are. If you didn't grow up better next to your father, it seems that you will have to search for your own path yourself. Nobody will be able to show it to you anymore. But remember, my dear, don't start any new path from a deception. You won't achieve anything along this path, there's no happiness with a lie not because it is sinful, but because the liar locks himself up in the fortress, he chains himself to the pillar."

Her brother wanted to take his sister's hand and to tell her something else, but the girl pulled her hand out, roared with a rude laughter and shouted.

"Another righteous brother showed up. Three righteous brothers are marching to the city to educate people and to teach them a new life! Watch out, so that they wouldn't put you behind bars, into the fortress for your foolish truth. Then you will send me a message to ask for your freedom, and then I will remind you of this hour. I will remind you of everything and I will mock you no less than you are doing it now for me."

And the girl ran away, she hid from the whole family and she wanted neither to bid farewell to her brothers nor to see them to the far end of the village, although the entire village, from small to big, came to see three young travellers off.

The brothers were walking for a long time. They used to earn their living by working. People everywhere used to accept three well-built, great workers willingly, everywhere they used to rejoice at them and at the songs of the youngest brother, they used to bless them and to see them off, but sometimes they used to nod their heads and tell: "It is rather far off" when the brothers would refer to the city which their father had sent them to.

Nobody knows whether they were walking for a long or for a short time, but finally, they came up to the big city and they found a little house in the city's very centre, on the market square. They rented a room from two old, childless people.

Having rested from their far way, the brothers started thinking on how to continue their way. They had to part for the first time. Every one of them had to solve the matters of their lives for the first time, without any advice from their wise father. It became sad in everyone's heart, they remembered their pure and joyous native home where they were living without any trouble, where there weren't any of the questions in every step: how to behave, what to say to the people they used to meet, how to comfort a sad man.

And the more brothers were thinking about their previous life, about their present, the clearer they could see how much happiness their father had given to them by training their self-confidence and comprehension of what that backbone was around which the whole man's character was formed.

The youngest brother was the first who shook himself from sadness. He laughed with his own laughter – the bells echoed – and he uttered.

"Why are we sad before our separation? Aren't we carrying the image of our dear father within ourselves? Aren't we holding his dear hand in our hands? Can't we hear his blessing voice? All our words and actions now have to be not of our own, but of such a height of honour which our father has given to us. And how well it is for us now, because we understood him, we understood and appreciated his endurance, peace and tranquillity, and now we can prove our endless loyalty with our own actions to him. We aren't going to sit here in sadness, are we? I will take my lyre and I will be the first to move to the south, to search for that big city where I will be destined to serve people with my songs and with my love, as much as I'm able to. Farewell, my dear brothers, I believe that we still will see each other on the earth, happy and by blessing one another. If we aren't fated to meet one another, then I will see one of you in every man whom I will meet and I will give my greeting to him in such a way as though I was greeting you. My task is simple, it is easy for me to leave, I'm carrying only joy on my shoulders, not a difficult feat. Good-bye, my dear, be blessed. I part neither with you, nor with our father, nor with our sister, all of you are living in my heart. Wherever my life would take me, all my songs will be heard for you and through you, because thanks to your love and help I could understand oneness in every man."

The youngest brother took his lyre, bowed to his brothers and left the city, although it was getting dark already.

Having seen their brother off, the travellers were left alone. They had their supper, helped their hosts to tidy up and told them that tomorrow at dawn they would leave, too. The old man nodded his head, felt sorry for the handsome tenants and asked them.

"Do you know at least where are you going and what are you searching for?"

"We know well what we are searching for, while only God alone knows where we are going," the oldest brother answered him.

"There are people everywhere," the middle brother added, "only if we wanted to love them and to get on in peace with them."

"Yes, you are right. If you aren't seeking after happiness, then you can help people a lot," the host uttered again, lost in thought. "There's a very big city on the bank of the wonderful and wide river to the north of our rich city, two hundred versts from here. My sister is living there. I could recommend one of you to her. Her son died, he was just like you," he addressed the middle brother, "he was a good soul, too, well-built like you and healthy. A plague took him away in one night. It exterminated more than half of the city during an absolutely short period of time. Since then the city is abandoned and decayed, everybody is living in poverty there. So, the people are living there like in the city of tears and maledictions, evidently, they have already forgotten the God's name. Everybody is angry one with another, they are scolding, while

some of them, like my sister, have become meek and obedient, they are plunged in such sadness and pain that it is difficult to describe it in words. During our last meeting, my sister was telling me that she understood well how terrible her sins were, that she had lost her son through her own fault. I know that she will die only when the merciful heaven sends a man to her, who will want to become her son instead of the lost one. But who will want to enter the mourning family that is living in the perishing city? I also know the secret thought of my sister that if a youth of the same age as her perished son came to her and stayed in her family as her real son, that would be a sign for her that her sins were remitted and that the toil of her life was passed. If you, my friend," he addressed the middle brother, "are searching for an opportunity to give people help and kindness not in your words, your dreams or vows, then go to the unfortunate city, find my sister who most likely now is impoverished and bring her the heaven's absolution in your heart, with your kindness."

Without asking for anything more, the middle brother took his rucksack, bowed to the hosts, embraced his oldest brother and told him.

"I've found my path, my dear brother. I will try to be a son to the strange mother, I will respect her in the same way as I would do it for my real mother. My task is simple. I will try to remember our dear father's wisdom and nobleness, and I will be living according to his example. Be blessed."

He asked about the road to the perished city and went to the north, not worrying about the dark night.

Having left alone, the oldest brother was still pondering for a long time, but he didn't feel any sense of loneliness, longing or lack of self-confidence. His heart was calm, he understood that his task was more complicated and more difficult than the one of his brothers.

He was thinking for a long time about how to find his own way, how to recognize his own path among the countless paths, how to bring not a call for peace, but the peace itself to people. He looked back for the first time and meditated upon his entire life. He couldn't remember a single time that he would have argued with somebody, that he would have made somebody angry or irritated, but everybody used to settle down next to him, and every strange heart used to find peace.

Only his beautiful sister who was more beautiful than all fairies of the forests never had any peace. Her desires were always surpassing all her possibilities. Whatever presents she used to receive, wherever she was invited, it always seemed to her that it could be done better than it was done for her, and nothing used to make her happy.

The oldest brother was deep in thought why his sister was able to take neither their father's wisdom nor the oldest brother's tranquillity nor the middle brother's kindness nor the youngest brother's joy...

Where did he had to go now? In which country did he have to search for an opportunity to serve people by calling them to accept their circumstances? And he decided not to guess about that what will happen tomorrow, but to live every passing-by moment, every meeting with the whole completeness of his heart. Now he understood his complete liberation from any bonds, from any oppressive and restricting love, any fear, any doubts or worries for his close or distant people.

His father's wisdom pierced the heart of the oldest son through one more time, who had sent all his sons free from any duty or engagement into the distant world. He decided to walk his new path not thinking where he would go or what he would do, but how he would go, what kind of man he would be himself and how he would be carrying his peace to people.

It was dawning on the other side of the window. He looked round the room in which he parted with his beloved brothers, blessed them and the careful hosts, and left silently by trying not to wake up anybody.

Not knowing the noisy city which was still sleeping in this early hour, he was walking down the streets for a long time until he went into the wide road that was leading to the west.

After some time, he met carts loaded with hay, bread, oat, vegetable and fruit; herds of cattle and flocks of fowl – everything what the big city was eating. However, the young traveller was surprised not by the unseen abundance of goodness, but by gloomy, dismal and serious faces of men and women, and sometimes, even the ones of the children who were with them.

Joking lads and mocking maids were nagging at him several times by asking him where such a clever man appeared from, who was leaving the city just before the great fair, before the opening of the merriest show-booths. But the youth wasn't paying any attention to their mockery and insulting words. Nothing was able to disturb the tranquillity of his heart. And the angrier word was cast at him, the clearer it was for him how badly and ignorantly the people were living here, how difficult it was for them to see the beauty around themselves, not only within themselves or others.

He was walking for a long time. The carts were gone already, and the wonderful coaches with expensive harness and dressed people were rolling down. But the faces of these people – who didn't have any trouble for their everyday bread according to their clothes – were also gloomy, angry and rude.

The traveller kept going, he crossed many villages, met many people, but he didn't hear a single pleasant word, nobody even looked at him pleasingly.

The sun was already setting, the herds of cattle were coming back home, while the young traveller was still walking alone, and the world that was alive and noisy was like a dead desert to him, across which he was walking, repudiated by everybody. A shadow of cold began to penetrate into the youth's heart when all of a sudden, he heard a terrible cry for help and saw a ghastly sight: a woman with two little children pressed to the stone was crying with terror, while a furious bull was running towards her. It seemed that neither she nor her children had any salvation.

Having thrown his rucksack down in a flash, the traveller ran in front of the bull, landed on his back like a hawk and seized the ring which was put through the wild animal's nose. Having bellowed with pain, the bull bowed his head down, but the bold spirit's hand was pulling the ring, and the animal began to rush about, to plough the soil with its hoofs by trying to fling the unexpected rider and to tread him down. But the strong hand was holding the ring with such power that the bull couldn't bear the pain and it was roaring horribly with rage.

"Get out from here," the traveller cried to the woman, "hide in your house."

People from all sides were already running towards the terrible roar of the bull, and in several minutes, they shut the tamed animal in the stall which it had escaped unexpectedly.

The traveller was surprised by the gloomy and unpleasant faces of the people one more time. Nobody thanked him for saving the woman and her children, they didn't even ask him who he was, whether he was hungry or needed a shelter for this coming night.

The tired youth gave a sigh and decided to pass by this village, too, where his help was accepted so ungratefully. He could see the last shack already and he decided to spend the night close to the highroad, hungry, when the door of the last shack opened, and his saved woman appeared on the doorstep.

"Please, come in, don't loathe our poor supper, rest under our roof. You must be coming from far away, you look tired. Don't loathe our misery, come in. I cannot find any words to thank you for your service. You saved both my and my children's lives, didn't you?" the woman was speaking to him by wiping her tears and inviting the traveller to her poor shack.

There was only one room in the shack, but the floor was washed cleanly, a clean tablecloth was spread on the table, and ordinary, but clean dishes were put on it. Her frightened children were also washed and dressed cleanly.

Having taken the guest inside, the woman invited him to the closed yard where the washbasin was arranged next to the well. She gave him some soap, a clean towel, she offered him to wash himself without restraint, because there wasn't anybody else in the house, except her and her children. She told him to come back to the room where they and the supper would be waiting for him.

The traces of difficult work and exhaustion could be seen on the woman's face which was young and very beautiful. Her sad and weak voice was painful, and one could feel not only sadness, but also despair from her entire figure. Now her voice was reflecting an infinite gratitude to the man who had saved her life.

When the guest came back to the room, the woman seated him on the wooden chair, put a white plate full of evaporating, sweetly smelling soup in front of him and gave a big slice of bread to him.

"Eat, my friend. This plate and this place belonged to my dear husband," the hostess uttered, and the tears began to pour down her cheeks. "What is your name, our dear rescuer? Without your fearlessness and your gigantic power, now we would be lying, killed by the bull, right? Those people who came running to help you weren't even going to move when they heard my cry. When my husband married me, he brought me from far away, while it is a custom here for men to marry only their own women. That's why we fell into disfavour here. My father-in-law gave the worst lot to my husband, and we had to feed ourselves from the trade by making our living with difficulty. Everything was all right, we still used to make both ends meet, but then my husband left for the city a year ago – and we still don't have any news from him. Some of them say that he died in the hospital, while the others say that he was killed on the road during an argument among drunkards. But it doesn't seem to be the truth, he was calm and kind, he never drank hard and he couldn't argue with anybody."

And again, the tears were pouring down the woman's cheeks. She wasn't eating almost anything, she was feeding her children and kept pouring some soup for her hungry guest, while telling him how much she was worn-out by trying to maintain her small farm, but she didn't have time to reap the entire patch of corn, and the grassland wasn't mowed down yet. The God alone knew how she would feed her cow and what she and her children would eat. Immersed in thought, the hostess was speaking to her guest sadly, evidently, she was glad at the rare possibility to talk to a well-wishing man about her misfortunes.

"Sister, my name is Alexander. Consider me to be your brother, while I will be an uncle for your children. I will stay with you and I will be working for you as a worker, while you will call and consider me to be your brother. I'm not hurrying anywhere, I will be in time where I'm going to. Show me your scythe, I need to hammer it out and to whet it. When we mow down the grass and dry the hay, then we'll get down to the rye. Don't grieve, pluck up your courage! When your husband is back, then I will leave. Believe me, not my hand has saved you from death, but the hand of my compassionate and wise father who has told me to go to the world and to carry peace to people. If I have saved you from the real death with his hands, then I will save your farm with his hands, too, and I will take both you and your children out of the jaws of starvation. Trust me, settle down. Laugh merrily by meeting every new day and live it in the

way as though your beloved husband was walking next to you. Train your children to joy, not to your permanent tears. Well, let's go, show me where your scythe is."

The guest's words sounded strange to the woman, and at the same time, as though it became brighter in the shack, as though it became not so cold and hopeless in her tired heart. She took Alexander into the hallway where all household tools were placed in good order and came back to the shack to her children. The children somehow came to life again, too, they were snuggling up to their mother and asking her whether the big uncle would stay with them.

While she was putting her children to bed, she was glad to hear the new sounds at home where the steps and voices only of her children and herself were the only signs of life for a long time already.

Alexander was labouring at the scythe for a long time, finally, he put it in order and came back to the shack. The children were sleeping for a long time already, while the hostess was embroidering by the little lamp.

"The scythe is ready, now it is time to sleep. Is there any little room where I could settle myself? Besides, my dear sister, I don't know your name," he told her merrily when he looked at her sleeping children.

"There's a little room in the loft, but I don't know whether it'll be all right for you there. It is very small, but the bed is comfortable there. And my name is Marta," the woman answered him when she noticed the kind Alexander's look at her children, and it became warmer in her heart.

Having taken the second little lamp from the stove, Marta accompanied the guest upstairs, thanked him for his kindness, blessed him again for saving both herself and her children from death and went downstairs.

For the first time, the dark night didn't see any Marta's tears, for the first time since her husband was gone, it was silent and calm in her heart. Having crossed her children and sent love to her gone husband, Marta went to sleep and was deep in thought about Alexander's words: "Laugh merrily by meeting every new day and live it in the way as though your beloved husband was living next to you." Marta was trying to think how she could imagine that her husband was always with her if he wasn't here, and nobody even knew where he was, but her fatigue and experienced fear overcome her thoughts, and soon Alexander was the only one who wasn't sleeping in the little shack. He put the little lamp out, opened the small window of the stuffy room, sat down next to it and, while looking at the play of the shining moon and the clouds, he was deep in thought about his father.

"I would like to know what my father is thinking about my act. Did I act properly by staying here to work for these helpless children and Marta? Maybe I didn't need to stay here, maybe I had to go to the noisy city where I was told to carry my peace?"

The youth remembered his father who would never leave the matters of his neighbours without any attention, how sometimes he used to send his sons to the neighbouring villages in order to help those families which had difficulties to manage their household for some reason. And the deeper he was in thought, the easier it became in his heart, the simpler and righter his own act seemed to be to him.

"Ah, father, if I could hear at least one word from you, I would be so happy," the youth thought for a while, left the window opened and went to sleep.

Alexander was asleep instantly, because he was tired after his long journey, his fight with the bull, his work when he was putting Marta's household tools in order and after all his experiences of the day.

And he saw a strange and unusual dream. It was so real, as though he had really seen and heard everything himself. He thought he heard his father's voice, he could see him, too. As though he was standing by the window that was left opened and telling him.

"Why do you doubt, my son? Not that day is important which will break, but that one which is flowing by now, isn't it? Did you do something wrong by saving the lives of three souls? The higher man's spirit is rising, the simpler his acts become, and it is easier for him to forget about himself for happiness of other people. Don't worry about anything and remember only one thing: whatever you do, do it till the end, wherever you will be living, don't lose your good fame for at least a moment. And it doesn't matter whom you ever have to associate with, don't condemn people. People here are gloomy and angry, they think only about themselves. They don't understand how one could be living his day, not searching for any benefit for oneself. Don't judge them, but smile to them calmly. I'm sending you not to educate them, but to show them the miracle in man, his living light with your own living example in your work and life. Don't think about what will happen next. Live and work while you are needed here. Life will show you both the day and the hour when you don't have to stay here anymore. Live and don't wait for any gratitude for your work, because it is mine. I have sent you to be my legs and my hands, my head and my heart on the earth. Live on the earth while your work is needed here for me."

Alexander wanted to thank his father for his words, he jumped out of his bed and saw that day was already breaking. He heard Marta's voice which was calling him to go downstairs for the breakfast. Alexander was surprised, he was unable to perceive in any way where his father disappeared, why the morning was here already if the moon was still shining a while ago. Marta's voice could be heard for the second time.

"Alexander, get up. You told me to wake you up at dawn yourself, didn't you? I'm sorry that I have to disturb your sleep, but I don't dare to disobey you," Marta was talking to him, while standing on the stairs.

"I'm coming, Marta, just a moment," the youth answered her merrily and ran to the well.

Soon, having left the children for the loyal dog to protect, Marta and Alexander went to the grassland. The way wasn't long, everybody was still sleeping, they weren't even driving their cattle to the pasture yet. When Marta took Alexander to the grassland, she started crying again, because everybody had already mowed the hay down and had taken it home.

"Marta, why are you crying? It'll take no more than three or four days of work for me here. I'm a great mower," the youth said to the unhappy woman, smiling.

"Ah, Alexander, you are wrong. You alone won't finish it here even in a week. Besides, when I remember the previous joy how me and my husband used to mow the hay down and rake it, as though my heart is pricked with a needle," still crying Marta answered him.

"My sister, it isn't good to remember your past with tears if you say that you still love your husband. This is a big ingratitude for him. You are thinking only about yourself, how it used to be, what you have lost. While I say this to you: don't waste your time crying. Live fearlessly, call your husband and think that he's next to you in every moment. Try to act in such a way that he would be glad of your actions, that the shadow of your heartbreak wouldn't obscure his face, but that the light of your smile would shine for him and make his path easier in any dark wherever he would be. Don't linger now, too. Go home, prepare

the dinner, take your children and come here with them. I will mow a lot of grass down before dinner. Bring another rake, we'll turn, dry and haystack it in the evening. Run joyfully, just look that I couldn't see any tears anymore."

Marta wiped the tears, tried to smile, but there was only a grimace instead of a smile.

"Not good, oh how not good it is," Alexander told Marta again and he began to mow the hay down with his heroic gestures. "Were the children, such kind children, given to you so that you would obscure their lives with your tears? Think about them. Try to amuse them and to make them happy with your every word. Especially today when the bull frightened them not so long ago. Try to do it in such a way that they would forget their fear for cattle. Run home quickly and come back here with dinner."

Marta hadn't heard such kind words for a long time. Nobody was interested in her affairs, children and life for a long time. A fervent wave of gratitude overflowed the woman's heart, she smiled joyfully and told him.

"Forgive me, dear Alexander. You have comforted and cheered me up so much that it is beyond expression. That day of my life was happy when I was nearly killed by the bull. I will be glorifying that bull during my entire life and I will thank destiny for the experienced horror. I run, my friend," and Marta gave a laugh. She hadn't laughed with such joyful and clear laughter for a long time, and she ran away as she used to do when she used to race with her husband.

Alexander was left alone in the silence of the blissful and flowering grassland and he began to think about his father's words which he dreamt of in the night. As soon as he started pondering about them, his father's voice seemed to him again and it seemed that he could hear his words clearly.

"My son, you are never alone! I'm always with you if your heart is calm, if your thoughts are pure and if you are doing your everyday work joyfully. There are all kinds of work. Some of them are simple, some are very complicated. But all of them are important only as much as much you are creating them with me, for me by weaving only one knowledge into them in every moment: everything what is living in a visible form, - everything is Eternity distributed into drops. And every drop of Eternity - that's a separate world. Man is one of the forms of Eternity. The whole world of passions, as well as the whole world of beauty is hiding within him. There aren't people who would possess only prevalent, spiritual powers, but there are people who are great, diligent persons, who dedicate lots of their strength for searching and perceptions about how to enter the path of love and how to give love itself to their loved ones so that it wouldn't be too heavy for them. There are lots of loving people, but there are few of them who can give their love by not demanding any wealth or gratitude in exchange for it. There are lots of mothers and fathers who love their children, but there are few of them who wouldn't oppress their children with their love. Rarely parents are able to respect their children and themselves within them so that they would be friendly to them and educated them with joy. Few of parents can understand the link between the living workers of the earth, whom they can see, and the same workers of heaven, whom they cannot see, and therefore, they are unable to educate their children properly and joyfully. Do your everyday work and comprehend that you are linked with the entire universe not only with your thoughts and your work, but also with your every breath. If you woke up in the morning and gave a gloomy sigh, you've already started your link with people in the wrong way. Then everybody whom you will meet, although he doesn't know anything about your gloominess and irritation, won't respond to your greeting so joyfully and simply as he would if your heart was free from worries about yourself and if your simple kindness was light and calm. Remember my words and realize them in your earthly work: one cannot disconnect oneself from other people, one can only strengthen people's happiness and peace with one's own restraint and peace, or one can litter up people's paths with one's passions, unrestraint and constant thoughts about oneself even more. Don't doubt. In every passing by moment, act simply and calmly, with the whole completeness of

your feelings and loyalty, then none of the moments of your life won't vanish in vain, although it would seem to you that you are doing the work of the least importance."

Alexander saw Marta with her children from the distance. She appeared on the turn, and his father's voice fell silent. His worry caused by the doubts about his deed settled down. In his thoughts he thanked his father for his help and for enlightening of his consciousness, and he understood that there was no big or small work, that it wasn't so much important how soon he would reach the city where he was destined to live. It was important only to tune the real perception of honour and kindness within himself with his ability to render this perception to every man whom he would meet.

"Only if I could always remember that the fire of Life was burning in every man, that I would serve it and address it and not that what I saw as a temporary form," Alexander thought for a while.

Marta who brought her children and dinner was looking at the Alexander's mowed down grass even with fear.

"Why are you so surprised, Marta? Our father has taught us all kinds of work, he would always tell us to do every work as easily and resourcefully as possible. I have my own way of mowing, that's why I work faster than others. Don't stand and be amazed in vain, grab the rake and start turning the somewhat dry grass. Look how the sun is scorching! I will mow the swath down till the end and come to help you, then we will have our dinner," Alexander told the amazed woman.

Marta seated her children in the shadow under a tree and went to the bushes on the other end from where Alexander had started mowing the grass. She was working in grasslands and fields for many years, she saw some great mowers, too, but she couldn't even imagine such an exceptionally strong man. She was trying to work as fast as she was able to, but she was unable to keep up with Alexander in any way, who had already mowed the whole swath down, and with the rake in his hands, he was already catching up with her by turning the grass.

Marta's thoughts were jumping without any logic. Now it seemed to her that her entire past had vanished somewhere, as though there weren't any difficult years of loneliness, unbearable work and tears, as though Alexander had always stayed with her, - she was feeling so self-confident and calm next to him. Then her thoughts would jump again, and fear would nag her heart - what would happen to her when Alexander would leave suddenly as he came, and her husband wouldn't come back? How will she be raising her children alone? What will happen to her cow and her house? Her thoughts were always flying back to her experienced pain and tears, and Marta couldn't see the shining sun, the birds chirping joyfully, she didn't feel the smell of the grass and the beauty of entire nature.

"Why are you so gloomy, Marta?" suddenly she heard Alexander's voice, who caught up with her.

"Somehow I feel unhappy in my heart, I have suffered so much, and what will happen in the future? There's only an obscurity - that's why fear is oppressing my heart."

And Alexander understood why his father was telling him about the passing-by moment. He understood that man is living on the earth and he is always thinking what has happened and what will happen to him, while his "now" is flying past anyhow and he doesn't even notice that passing-by "now". His futile, insignificant and not finished thoughts are oppressing his spirit and man cannot live happy and joyful, but he's afraid even of that what isn't here yet or what has already been.

“Marta, be glad, because we are mowing down the grass, your children are playing, and you will have great hay. Why are you looking forward, Marta? Turn the grass merrier, we’ll finish the swath and sit down to dine.”

Marta nodded her head, it was clear that she didn’t understand what it was to live now and not to think about what would happen tomorrow, but she didn’t tell him anything. She hadn’t finished her swath yet, while Alexander was already sitting with the children, and all of them were inviting her to dine.

Alexander was mowing the grass down till the late evening. He sent Marta and the children earlier to take the cow from the pasture and told them that he would be home late, only for supper. The voices of leaving Marta and her children hadn’t yet fallen silent when Alexander heard his father’s voice again, only this time he could hear his words even better.

“My dear and beloved son. Wherever you are, I will be with you. Whatever you do, if your thoughts are pure, I will be with you. Try to choose your thoughts, protect and keep your bright and bold thoughts and chase away your gloomy thoughts. There are neither diseases nor a bad man’s fate, there’s only that fate which he has created for himself, fate is the after-effect, fate is the result of his own thoughts and actions. Don’t worry if you cannot hear my voice for a long time. Keep doing everything as you have started and one day you will hear me again. Remember this firmly: you and me, the moon and the sun, the grass and the trees, any man and any living being, everything is he, the great, the only mind of the universe which is expressed differently in every form. There’s no death, don’t be afraid of it and explain to everybody that he is immortal, that his Self is God which cannot die and which exists everywhere. If anybody has to die with difficulty when a disease is tormenting him, it means that man was controlled by bad thoughts, self-love and gloominess which has brought him to such an end. Be joyful, choose pure thoughts, don’t separate from the universe and you won’t know any diseases. The beginning of them all – that’s fear and self-love. Protect your heart from rubbish, and your body will stay strong and tenacious of life.”

The voice ended. Alexander was standing in the grassland for a while, he thanked his father for his care one more time and he kept working until the very nightfall, he didn’t even notice when it became dark. Alexander came home, took supper, caressed the children a little, and from this day on his life was running by working and clearing everyone’s daily routine with his smile. And even the gloomy and rude neighbours began to talk to Marta’s brother, to Marta’s worker.

Suddenly a knock at the door and Yassa’s voice woke up Lovushka and Bronski who had forgotten about everything around, he invited them for the supper. Yassa took them to the room of ablutions, he offered them to have ablutions in the pool again and to change their clothes, which surprised both of them very much. But when Lovushka looked at his clothing which was white in the morning, he saw that it was all blotted. He shot a glance at his friend unwittingly and he gave a shout.

“Stanislav, where did we make ourselves so black dirty? We look like besmeared in black paint.”

Bronski who hadn’t come back to reality completely, who was still affected by the impressions of Ali’s room and the read text, looked at Lovushka, then at himself, he nodded his head and answered.

“How could we so dirty sit in the divine Ali’s room? How come didn’t we notice that we were wearing dirty clothes?”

“No, you put absolutely clean clothes on,” Yassa interfered, but every stain on your clothes reveals your thoughts which weren’t enough pure and firmly devoted. Every time when a valuable thought used to flash in your mind, but there wasn’t enough concentration for it, when you used to feel the echo of your former superstitions or disbelief – a sticky sweat used to spurt out of your bodies which turned into these stains on your clothes. When you are going to wash yourselves, the water will be dark and dirty, because now you’ve risen onto that stage of your liberation where not only your work, but even a defective thought isn’t left without any consequences. Here’s the clear and undisputed proof to you that not Teacher is holding his disciple in the certain stage by not allowing him to go forward or by hiding some secrets of the high life from him. Only the atmosphere of the disciple itself doesn’t allow him to live with the whole completeness of Light and Power of his the Only One. And only that forms the obstacles along the path,” Yassa was speaking to both friends by helping them to wash and dress. “Let’s go, my dear friends. Now you are well cleaned. I. is waiting for you in his dining-room,” he added tenderly by seeing the new disciples’ embarrassment.

It seemed to both of them that they didn’t want to eat at all, and even a thought occurred whether Yassa hadn’t disturbed them without necessity in the most important and interesting place of the fairy-tale. For the first time Lovushka was coming to I. without joy of his upcoming meeting, it was so difficult for him today to part with Ali’s room, with the wonderful book, with still inexperienced new life which he was living during all those hours in the divine room today. His coming back to the daily routine was very difficult for him in this moment.

Chapter 13

Conversation with I. We keep reading the fairy-tale.

Beata’s departure and the last farewell words of I. and Francisco

When Lovushka entered I.’s room he got under Eta’s wings. I. told to bring the peacock to him, and Lovushka felt as though a stinging remorse. He had completely forgotten his dear bird by not thinking about his needs, but he even forgot to ask somebody to take care of him. Having embraced Eta, Lovushka went up to I.

“My dear Teacher, my compassionate friend. My tongue doesn’t turn over to confess my egoism to you. Not only I’ve forgotten Eta whom you didn’t forget, but while coming back to you I had only

one desire to keep reading the precious book, to reach the wisdom of the read text faster. I cannot find the words, but it seems to me that I was even unsatisfied of Yassa's call. Will I acquire the balance of strength one day, which would give the absolute self-control to me?"

"Lovushka, the absolute self-control – that's nothing else as the organism's ability to work in all circumstances of one's life," I. answered Lovushka by embracing him, while he pressed to him passionately. "Each man's disease is man's, his entire organism's liberation from the rubbish of passions which accumulated within him through his thoughts and his actions. Even death, every death – one's death in suffering, death without suffering, death in fear, death by blessing, death in the battle-field, in a fight against the enemy – everything is only that Only One whom the needles of man's passions pierce and whom he is cleaning during each of his earthly lives in a special and unique way. Sit down, my friends, we will be eating. The fast day will remind you about appetite."

"Doctor I., when I was going here I was so influenced by the read book that I forgot that I was made of body and blood, that food and the need to eat existed in the world. Thousands of questions were swarming in my head which I wanted to ask you. Now not only I remembered that food existed in the world, but I also know well that I want to eat. And unfortunately... I forgot the whole million of my questions," Bronski uttered by looking at I., embarrassed.

"Don't be sad, my friend," I. gave a laugh by looking at the childishly embarrassed actor's face. "Eat. I think that also Lovushka remembered the wealth of the earth. While both of you will be appeasing your appetite, I will tell you how we prepare for the journey. First of all, Zeiched brought the whole caravan of camels and he assured us that there would be lots of inexperienced riders among the travellers who would get tired themselves soon and who would tire out the animals, so we would have to change them often. Besides, the caravan will have to go no less than two days until the first oasis of the desert instead of one, because women whom we take with ourselves won't have enough strength to travel for so long without any stop as Zeiched states by contradicting hurrying Nataliya Vladimirovna who argues that one day in the desert – that's a trifle and that everybody with healthy way of thinking will get settled with this simple task. Actually, as you know, professor detains us here. In several days, when you read the book, we'll go to wake him up. Now he is sleeping soundly, he is sleeping off for his entire former life, he already starts resting from all his shortages and he even grows young again."

I. was always keeping the thoughts of his disciples about the life that surrounded them by allowing them to rest from the stresses and experiences in Ali's room. Having finished the supper, they went out to the balcony, I. seated them there and told them.

"Today you saw clearly how man's thoughts looked when they didn't suit his other creative, valuable and active thoughts. Why up till this day didn't any of you feel, see and even suspect that your worthless, vain or even dirty thoughts could be reflected on your clothes? Because today you've reached that stage in which your inner Light has already become your atmosphere. While the anxious thoughts which don't suit it, which disturb the Light of this atmosphere only strike it like lightning by reflecting the sudden outbursts of your passions. The outbursts of passions whip the already stable matter as the whole, shining mass of Love, Calm, Joy and Fearlessness which has stuck together into the integral ring. When you reach the firmly stable powers of tact, purity and light in your atmosphere, then not a single thought will leave any dark tracks on your white clothes anymore. Not a single drop of the poisonous sweat won't be able to break from your body, because it won't exist in your thoughts. Who is that inner man? Only the part of God, expressed in a certain form and degree. If man's thoughts – that's the whole ball of snakes where his passions are boiling and they don't rise above the ground, then of course, you could notice some spot in this terrible ball who calls himself to be "human", but only when he is bleeding and when the red colour of blood is distinguished from the common mass among other sharp, biting, greedy thoughts. If man's

atmosphere which he's created within himself and around himself is full of thoughts about himself, about his family, about becoming rich for them, about the reserves only for their own stomachs, if it is riddled by the envy for the more successful destiny and wellbeing of his own people, - then such ball of thoughts is unable to reach his Teacher, although he would crave for him, call his name and search for the paths to faster liberation. If man has reached that stage in which he found his Teacher's word given to him sincerely - that doesn't mean that he received the guarantee of meeting his Teacher, the guarantee of his behaviour's rightness along his path. The path - that's a continuous movement where you cannot stop even for a moment. As soon as anger or irritation got onto the man's path, that is into his own actions, the whole path stopped. His harmony stopped ringing, and he needs to search newly how he could join the symphony of the universe which hurried forward with its creation while the man was standing in one place. Nobody has a chance to rise through the stages of the universe, if he is unpleasant to his encountered people, if he shouts at others angrily, if he moralizes others unsatisfied, if he doesn't help his encountered person to calm down, but only provokes his protest and desire to insult. Only then man is able to enter among other disciples when his help for people, his compassion become his prayer, his sacrifice for God whom he can see behind the pain of the miserable rags. Only then the disciple has lived the ordinary day of his life as the day of his path, as the day of movement in the universe when joy of his knowledge became not an aroma or a spice, but the usual atmosphere, beyond the limits of which he doesn't have an opportunity to breathe anymore and in which the simple words are shining: He is where I am, I am where He is, He is where my each encountered person is. To rise through the stages of development in that sense as one rises through the stages of one's trade, - that's the ravings of madmen. The heart's creation isn't born as the consequence of uttered or unvoiced formulae. It comes neither through great efforts or strained thinking, nor through perception that I am weighty and great cell of society. It pours with light and energy in every moment, because the whole man is always moving in the ringing atmosphere of the universe. And it happens not when one perceives what is Life within man and man within Life, but when the sound of one's heart melts with the ringing power of Joy and when life becomes not the row of facts and meetings, but an active prayer, a sacred canto where there isn't any place for futile trifles and irritability left anymore, where all daily troubles are only that everybody's inevitable, original conditionality to which man has to reconcile himself. Those are suffering most who haven't learned to suffer and to give, but who only demand and wait. Now go to your rooms, my friends. Don't share your opinions, don't try to share the light of your spiritual achievements. Try to learn to hear the Silence and to rejoice at every moment of freedom when you can calm down externally and strengthen that atmosphere of Purity, the deficit of which you could observe within yourselves today."

I. dismissed his disciples and went to professor's. Lovushka with Eta came to his room like through the fog, he went to bed as though in ecstasy, and it seemed to him that not the door, but simply gates rose in his heart and opened wide with love for each of his encountered persons, it seemed that not even five minutes passed when he went to bed, while Yassa was waking him up persistently and he offered him to hurry, because Bronski was already waiting for him in the dining-room.

Having jumped up instantly, still not comprehending how the night could fly past so quickly, Lovushka hurried at the maximal speed and in several minutes he was already asking Bronski pardon for being late.

"It is nothing, Lovushka! What kind of a delay is it? That's me who is driven by my impatience and desire. And since I can only meditate by looking at the book without you, then I need to ask your pardon for my hurry. Tonight a thought flashed several times for me about the miracle of my meeting with you, about my infinite gratitude to you."

"Stanislav, my dear, don't frighten me. What are you talking about? What do I have to do with it? Then what do I have to say about I. and others who've done so much for me? Let's leave this

talking. Since yesterday evening I don't feel to have my heart anymore, I feel to have the gates instead of it, which as though are opened within me, like a hole. It seems to me that nobody could make me worry and grieve anymore, even if I. told me to become the supervisor of a madhouse or to grow angry monkeys."

Bronski gave a merry laugh by imagining both of these Lovushka's roles clearly and he uttered.

"Not only I feel any hole within myself, but I also almost lost myself, I don't know where my limits are."

Having joked about their sensations, friends went to Ali's room again. Also this time they were surprised when the turbid and dark water was running from their clean bodies during their ablutions, as if they had wading in the desert for the entire hours, during the sand storm. Amazed Lovushka looked at Yassa, while he as though understood his silent question and answered him.

"What is there so surprising? You were very irritable not so long ago, weren't you? Stuck together and solid accumulations formed in almost all your nerve-knots. Now they are melting, while the whole energy of irritability accumulated in them rises to the surface, like the blown up puffball throws off the dark little cloud of spores from its case. Only the turbid water is flowing from your body, because you are very young and the greater part of your tears and grieving – that's only your childish sadness. Look at the water that is flowing from your friend. It is almost black, because his sadness – that's his grieving and disappointments of very long standing. They wash down with difficulty, because his whole life lived in sadness has turned that sadness into the hard rocks which now don't blow up so easily and penetrate through his skin depending on how joy is leading your friend through his everyday work."

While Yassa was talking, the water became always cleaner, and finally both of them got out of the clean pools. Having changed into the clean clothes, friends came to the door of Ali's room. It seemed to Bronski that he looked much younger, he was breathing easily, walking quickly, and there wasn't a single drop of sadness in his heart. For the first time during his entire life he didn't feel the heaviness within himself and he understood what it meant to be free, what it meant to the day of his life easily.

As during the first time, the fiery record stopped them by the threshold of the door. Bronski couldn't see it, but he had to stop, because suddenly he felt an invincible obstacle which didn't allow him to walk forward. Now he already understood himself that the fiery words didn't let him go, which he wouldn't understand without Lovushka's help, but the meaning of which he needed to comprehend before entering the divine Ali's room. Having bowed to compassion of the high guardian in his thoughts, who was sending infinite care and love for them, Bronski started listening to Lovushka's translated words:

Brothers and friends! Not that consider to be compassion what you give yourselves or what is given to you from duty, obligation as a heavy burden, because that is still only the stage of reasonings that is closest to the bestial existence.

Only that consider to be compassion what you give with joy, with the radiating happiness to live and to love.

Not that loves who is carrying the duty of his honour and loyalty, but that one who is living and breathing only because he loves, who is glad and who even cannot do it differently.

Love of such man's heart – that's not a dizzy and fascinating mess which creates the imaginary beauty, but the pure Beauty itself which brings calming and comfort for everybody.

Where you – my friend who are invited to become my disciple and colleague – read my word, there you turned it into calming in people's hearts, there you started the new wheel in the man heart's life, because there you helped the man's centres to turn in the new whirl.

Start your day with your own example by understanding how man makes himself free from his inveterate wounds and stains, how the brain beds form for the new perception of the day, how only then the brain may force its way through, get ready for work, become an action when the power which had enslaved it, existed in his organism as an old superstition, decayed, retired from him and liberated the place for his joy.

Joy is weaving the shining matter of the spirit, joy is leading everybody to uniting with people, that is – with us and the entire universe.

Suddenly the power that was holding Bronski's feet glued to the floor disappeared, and he could enter through Lovushka's opened door easily. For the first time Stanislav felt happiness, complete happiness, the hot wave of which overflowed his entire being, it was shining to him from every room's item. And the room itself seemed to him to be especially wonderful and white today.

When he looked at the radiating Lovushka's face he couldn't refrain from shouting.

"Lovushka, Lovushka, you are so refined! I didn't even think that you could become so inhumanly refined!"

"Stanislav, if there was a mirror here, then you also would see yourself inhumanly refined and absolutely young," Lovushka answered him, even his voice was different, it was more sonorous, deeper and more melodious than that one which Bronski was used to.

The already opened book stunned them most, although yesterday Lovushka closed it carefully and covered Ali's table accurately. Whose careful hands opened it? Whose loving heart visited their working place and blessed it with his compassion? There wasn't any time to think about it. When Lovushka started reading, he was surprised when he saw that the whole batch of sheets after their read place as though were stuck together, and that there was the title on the opened page:

"The second son's journey, his life and his lessons"

Having translated the title for Bronski and showed the stuck together sheets to him, Lovushka kept translating the book:

"The second son left, full of energy. He was walking for a long time, searching for the way to the terrible city. Everybody whom he used to meet and to ask about the city was looking at him with fear and telling him: "My friend, don't you want to live anymore? You will die there because of the plague, and even if you stay alive, you will become sickly from the townspeople hostility. You'd better go with us. We have lots of work to do, our soil is great. We'll help you to build a house, you will take a wife and you will be living with pleasure. Our girls are beautiful. Stay here, throw your thoughts about that ill-fated city out of your head. You won't be able to help anybody there, you'll only ruin yourself."

But the traveller wasn't listening to any tempting offers. He was dying to reach the poor woman's house, and even if he hadn't seen her yet, he was telling her this in his thoughts: "Dear mother, stay calm. I'm coming to you as fast as I can. Don't shed your tears. Life is sending forgiveness and comfort to you as you have asked. I would like to pick up all your tears and to change them into joy so much. Believe me, you will be my mother, and I will be serving you in such a way as I would do it for my real mother."

And the middle brother was meditating upon his many new thoughts during his long journey. People, whom he was telling why and where he was going to, used to disturb his thoughts with their talking many times. The conversation with one old man affected the youth especially strongly. Having found out that the traveller's goal was to become the son of the strange woman, the old man told him.

"Well, you've thought of a very difficult job for yourself. For man to accept a strange child to bring up is difficult, too. He has to find love for him as for his real child, and that is almost impossible to do. And in your case, mother of a grown-up man! How can you respect and love her in God's presence when you haven't seen her yet? What if you don't like her? Then you can hide it from people, but you cannot hide it from God and from your conscience."

The youth fell to thinking and he didn't know what to answer to the old man. He had really seen and heard many times that kind people were trying to ease others' lives and they were taking their children to their houses. But often they had to return the children back to their parents, because the children were irritating them, they were always making them talk in a raised voice, so there was always a mutual dissatisfaction and even tears of the children.

The further the youth kept walking, the stronger the old man's words were nagging his heart, like rust. And he couldn't find any answer to this, but he knew without fail that he wouldn't refuse his task or step back. And the middle son began to pray to his wise father by asking him to help him understand his tormenting question and to tell him how he should act. He lay down in the shade of the trees and he dreamt as though his father came to him and told him.

"My dear son. It seems to you that Kindness – that's your human quality. But in truth, this isn't your quality, but the God's quality, who is living within you. It cannot change because of the qualities of those people whom you give your kindness to. And you give it to them not because you want or you don't want to do so, and you give it not to that man who is visible with your eyes, but to that Light which is living inside of every person whom you meet, which is eternal and invariable as your own Light which you know as Kindness within yourself. If your Kindness is pouring out of your heart as the God's little part within yourself, then it was given to that little part of God which you were able to see. And then there aren't any reasoning left that people, children or grown-ups may be "strangers" or "your own" to you, that they irritate you or disturb the harmony of your everyday work and your home. You didn't see them when you gave shelter to them or helped them, but you were praying to Him, the Only One when you were associating with them. And now, don't be afraid of anything. Go to that woman whom your heart has called your mother bravely and easily. Trust your heart's wisdom and calm, bring your joy to That one who is living inside the woman's case.

From this day on, stop thinking that people are separated, existing separately. There's only one universal soul that is living in all earthly forms. Don't try to bow to all these forms with your work, but pray to the Only Soul simply and easily in all its incarnations which you'll meet. In the moments of confusion or lack of confidence, always call for me, so that those moments would pass faster. Each of such moments clogs the exit for pure power from your heart, and the surface of your heart becomes hard, it gets encrusted with rind and little knots. It doesn't matter how short the periods of passing doubts would seem to you, you can feel the difficulty that is preventing for kindness to get out your heart, as though a partition would rise between you and another person. Go joyfully. Don't push people away from you, don't refuse to

listen to their opinions, but smile to their childish twaddle when you see their foolishness and an absolute ignorance of the real essence of things. Your kindness given like a prayer, like a greeting of the Only One in man penetrates not into those visible cases of his, which submit to death and dispersion, but into that Eternal which doesn't change and which you glorify with joy that you were able to give your Kindness to the man you met. Live your working day easily everywhere a meeting stops you and know that there was a day if the smile of your greeting has helped the Only One in the universe to expand and to shine brighter from your meeting with a man. It isn't important how the circle of the Only One shined and expanded on the earth. It isn't important how you've helped a man to express Him wider, but it is important that your Kindness has awakened your neighbour's Kindness for an action.

From now on, live not within the boundaries of time and place where everything submits to change, dispersion and death, but in the entire universe by greeting the Unchangeable who is living within every visible form everywhere. Be blessed, stay calm in all situations of life and pass your prayer to His Only One without any words and morals. There are countless worlds in front of you, which you cannot see. And a countless abundance of forms is living in all these worlds. Never forget to bless all the worlds and to send your greeting to every bright brother wherever he would be living and whatever form of his work and actions would be. Your prayer, your greeting to man's fire depends neither on place nor on time, but it depends only on your purity, fearlessness and kindness."

The middle son woke up as if washed by the living dew, it was so easy and joyful for him. All his doubts seemed to be ridiculous to him, and he kept walking by looking at people whom he met in a completely different way. Apparently, people were looking at the youth differently, too, because nobody was inviting him to his home and they didn't call him strange or surprising anymore. Nobody was persuading him to stay or to refuse his plans to go to the terrible city. People acknowledged his task and became even kinder to him. More often someone's compassionate hand used to shove a modest parcel into his hands, while their lips used to whisper him modestly: "Take it, for the God's sake. That's not much, I'm sorry about it, but maybe it'll come in handy to you." Mostly, those were wonderful girls or completely old men who were doing this.

Finally, the middle son reached the city and found the house where he had decided to become help and joy to his foster-mother. He stepped into this house by remembering his father's words well, which he had told him in his dream.

As soon as he entered the yard, he saw the woman who was sitting in the porch instantly. She wasn't old yet, her face was tortured by heartache and disease.

"Hello, mother, I've come to you to replace your lost son. Accept me instead of him and allow me to help you with your work."

"Go with God, young man, do you understand what you are talking about?" the frightened woman answered him. "My house is infected, a disease has spread to our quarter. This time only a few people died, but the disease continues for many weeks, it exhausts people to death. Leave as soon as possible. I don't have strength even to talk to you. I cannot give you anything, because it's everything dangerous and infected where the disease is."

While the woman was talking to him, she was panting and when she was uttering the last words she swayed and almost fell down. The youth threw his rucksack off his shoulders, took the woman on his hands and told her.

"Don't be afraid of anything, mother. Only tell me where I should take you and stay calm. I'm here in time to nurse you."

The woman raised her hand with difficulty and showed him the door to the room silently. The tears were rolling down her face when the youth put her to bed which, evidently, wasn't made for a long time already. The air in the room was heavy and stuffy, there was a lot of rubbish on the floor which also weren't swept for a long time. The youth opened the window, he was smiling to the crying woman and he was absolutely calm.

"Mother, don't cry. I've told you that I've come to nurse you. Now I will give you something to eat. The good people knew that soon I would need their goods. I will cook the milky porridge and an egg for you. Just tell me where your stove is?" the youth asked her by looking about, not being able to see anything similar to a stove anywhere.

The woman showed him a heavy, motley curtain in the further corner of the room. Having pulled the curtain, the youth saw a little stove, a heap of rubbish and some fire-wood next to it. Soon he made the fire in the stove, cooked the meal and fed the patient who fell asleep after the meal instantly. Having taken advantage of her sleep, the guest put the room and the porch in order, took the rubbish and the buckets with the stagnant water out and sat down by the bed to wait for his foster-mother to wake up.

His thoughts came back to his father's words. He remembered his native house, compared his father's words to his own life, ran through his father's behaviour year after year attentively and he made sure that his father was living exactly in the same way as he was telling him in his dream. He was trying to remember his father's angry or irritated face or at least one of his words uttered in a raised voice, but he couldn't remember anything, except his always kind words, his kind-hearted smile which sometimes used to flash with humour.

He started examining the face of the sleeping woman attentively. There was so much torture and anxiety in this aging face! The youth felt sorry for the poor woman from the bottom of his heart and in his thoughts he said to himself: "I will love you with my entire heart, I will live with you, as though my father was next to me, as though the most important matter of my life was to replace your son and to awaken joy within you. I will live next to you in such a way that your heart would rest and Light would expand within you. I will try to transfer fortitude and belief to you that my father is next to us, that he can see and hear everything what we are doing. I will be serving you sincerely, and you will make sure that not only the bond of blood makes people happy. When you make sure of it, you will find your new goal of life yourself – to give the simple kindness to people. Then I will continue my way, and you will need neither crutches nor support anymore. A man needs them only while he is thinking about himself. As soon as he stops thinking about himself and when his first thought is about the matters of the person whom he meets, since then his days are flowing easily and joyfully, and joy is ringing in his heart."

While the youth was sinking into his thoughts, they were merging with his father's thoughts more and more, and it seemed to him that not he was talking to himself, but that his father was sending a blessing word to him again. And such joy, such peace filled the whole existence of the youth that it seemed to him that he had never experienced a happier day during his entire life. He gave a smile to the people's opinions about his difficult and terrible deed which he was undertaking. He equated his current life not with a deed, but with a victorious joy.

He looked at the sleeping woman's face again and noticed that its expression began to change. A reconciliation and peace, that peace with which joy begins, appeared on her face instead of sadness and anxiety. The youth didn't have time to be amazed at such change when the woman moved, opened her eyes and extended her hand to him with the smile.

"Is it for real? Are you really next to me, my son?"

"Mother, I was protecting your sleep for a long time. Lately, it seemed to me that you were feeling better, that your disease wasn't tormenting you so much anymore."

A disappointment flashed through the patient's face, a cloud of sadness lay upon it again, but she stood up with all her might, extended her hands towards the guest and told him.

"I'm stupid, forgive me. I dreamed of my son for the first time since his death. And I saw him as alive, so I even mixed him with you and when I woke up I was unable to understand instantly where the illusion of the dream ended and where the reality started. Therefore, I didn't smile to you, so kind and friendly, instantly. But you understand yourself who the real son for his mother is. In the future, I will try to be thankful to you as much as I can."

"Come, come, mother. Don't think about your gratitude to me and about your son's death. Only imagine that he's alive and that he's always thinking about you, just like you are thinking about him. But how has he always look at your tears, your anxiety, your suffering? You haven't thought about it, but if you fall into thinking, then it will turn out that your son is to blame for your suffering. While you are mourning over him, you are accusing him of your misfortune. And all your tears are flowing through all his current affairs and marking everything with the sign of heartache. And in truth, that's you who should tell everybody how pure and saint with his love to you he was, how he was taking care of you, how he was trying to fill your every day with liveliness and peace. Now try to prove to everybody that he was living next to you not without reason, that an eternal memory about his work for you remained within your heart and that you want to thank him for his life with you not with your tears and sadness, but with your work for your close people. With that happy and peaceful work which he didn't finish, because he left you so early, but which you will do for him. Think about his liberation, about how you can help him to become free, and not about your sadness. It doesn't matter how much you would ask Mother-Life and all wise men why your son died so early, - you won't be able to receive an answer, because the crying eyes cannot see the truth. One is always crying for oneself, although one is thinking sincerely that one is crying for others."

"It has never occurred to me that my tears could cause trouble to him, but now, my friend, as though I've become enlightened, as though the lightening has flashed across my thoughts that a living connection is existing among people, although they cannot see each other. Thank you. Be my son whom destiny has sent to me. I've been thinking many times that if Compassion sent me a youth who wanted to be my son, I would know that I was forgiven, that I could expect to expiate the whole falsehood of my life. I would try to love my son sent to me, to give all powers of my heart and thoughts to him anew, I would glorify the God's world within his personality, and now when you've come I didn't meet you with anything, except my yearning and tears," the woman was talking to him, still crying.

Her son stroked her hands extended to him tenderly and answered him.

"It doesn't matter how you've awakened, - the time has passed already and carried your act off. If at this moment you tell me that with your spirit you have understood how you should act in your life, then why should we talk so much about the past? Get up, get better and let's both of us bring the certitude into all our actions every day that exactly this ordinary work is the most important and fundamental. We'll be living like this with our attention and kindness concentrated, and let everything else happen as well as possible for everybody. Let's not waste our time for words. I can see that there isn't any fire-wood and water left. Tell me where can I find them so that I could cook some porridge?"

"I will explain everything to you, but tell me what's your name? My dear son's name was Boris."

"And my name is Gleb. Well then I'm your son's brother," the youth gave a laugh.

"It is so strange, my new and dear son Gleb," his mother told him, lost in thought. "Since his childhood, my Boris was always telling me that he would certainly have his brother Gleb, but I haven't give birth to his brother, and Mother-Life has sent Gleb to him only when he's gone already."

And the streams of tears were running down the woman's cheeks.

"Mother, you are crying again, but it must be difficult for Boris now. Your wish has come true, you aren't alone now, but you still cannot send your joyful smile of greeting to him, so that it would be easier for him. What do you think? We have just decided to live joyfully, so that it would be easier, simpler and merrier for everybody who is next to us, but that one whom you call to be your closest and dearest one you've upset again, you've burdened his path by pouring the new bog below your feet from your tears."

"I won't be crying anymore, Glebushka. You see, there's the woodshed over there. There is the fire-wood placed there, you only have to chop it into little bits, and when you turn around the woodshed, you will see a streamlet with a small waterfall. There's great water there. And the view is wonderful there, Boris loved it very much there."

Gleb took the buckets and pretended that he didn't notice how his mother mopped the tear secretly when she was uttering her son's name...

And Gleb's days began to run calmly. In some time, he put the entire home in order, he repaired the roof, revived the whole farm, and his mother's health was improving day after day. Her tears were rare, her face was always merrier, her voice was always brisker. However, her habit to be afraid of people, which was formed during the years when disasters befell both on the city and on herself, was still of great vitality...

Gleb was making lots of efforts to fight against his mother's fear, but anyway he managed to overcome this obstacle, too, and he persuaded her to open the gates, the doors and the windows and to allow people to visit them.

"Mother, think a little. Why were you living this day? In order to be afraid of something? Then you cannot occupy any place on the earth anymore. You are afraid of something, consequently, you are walking with death and not with life. You haven't passed your kindness with your greeting to any person – hence, only death was living within you, and you within it. In the meanwhile, your greeting to a person has to be – Life with God and for God. If there wasn't such greeting with people, then this day didn't bring anything, except death to you, so why should you be afraid of it? You shouldn't be afraid of it, because you weren't living during this day."

Little by little, experiencing all stages of fear, through big trouble and suffering, his mother was making herself free from the clutches of fear, which were burning her, although she was often disappointed in bold behaviour of her new son who was walking across the contaminated city fearlessly, she was reproaching Gleb that destiny had sent him to help her, but that he wasn't even thinking about her.

"I couldn't even imagine what happiness was to live on the earth when my heart was free from fear, it was so easy and calm to work," once Gleb's mother told him. "When you used to tell me that it was important only that what and how you were doing now, it seemed to me that simply you were still a child and that only childish thoughts were in your head, that the most important thing was to be a serious and practical person – to take care of his and his loved one's tomorrow. Not long ago, I understood what you were talking to me about when you were stating that life – that's "now". Only that "now" of yours has

explained to me how man needs to liberate his heart and thoughts, to clean them namely in this moment, because the future moment was born from the current one.”

“And the current moment is obscuring those eyes which are crying and it doesn't allow to see them clearly,” Gleb gave a laugh by embracing his mother.

“No, my son, my eyes aren't crying anymore and they can see clearly what they have to do, so that the power of joy was born.”

The days were passing by, his mother and her new son made lots of friends in the city. There wasn't any request which their hospitable home would push away. Every person was comforted when they were leaving their currently peaceful house which once was buried in tears and sadness. Everybody who was leaving their house used to think: “Well, at last I've found some faithful friends.”

And as though some partitions within the hearts of the new Gleb's acquaintances were melting away, which were hindering them to be ordinary men up to now. Earlier, some of them were thinking how to keep their superiority against men they used to meet, some were trying to be useful for their relatives with all their might, the third ones believed in God strongly and they wanted to teach everybody whom they used to meet how they needed to live, they valued them only according to their own ideals, the fourth ones were trying not to waste their time in vain, they were trying to educate people with their every word and action by thinking that namely that was their greatest merit, but an ordinary kindness wasn't flowing from their hearts. Only after meeting Gleb, many of them understood that not the people whom they used to meet were preventing them to be kind, but that the plates of conditionalities were placed within themselves, on which they were drawing different reflections of the people they used to meet by seeing not the Eternal, but temporary within them.

It would become brighter and merrier within every heart as soon as she used to see what was preventing her own simplicity in the relations with people. Many of them who used to tell the following before: “And where should I take that joy from?” – now they were smiling to their previous ignorance that was the only cause of their poorly spent day.

In his thoughts, Gleb often used to come back to his parting with his brothers. He didn't worry about his oldest brother. He always used to see his unshakable peace in all circumstances of life, he felt himself and noticed how another person's peace was increasing when he was next to Alexander. He was certain that his oldest brother not only would fulfil his task, but he would exceed it.

However, his thoughts about his youngest brother, the handsome singer, were disturbing his heart and worrying him. How will be the handsome boy living in the big city alone? Will his wonderful song be the sufficient way to unite with people? Not everybody liked songs, needed them and were able to respond to this language of love, did they?

And the youngest brother who left first was the last who reached the big, unknown city. He was walking for the longest time, because already during the first night he met three homeless travellers and joined them.

He didn't have time to walk five versts when in the darkness of the night he heard a silent cry, it was a child's cry – so it seemed to him. The traveller stopped, listened attentively to the cry, went out of his big way and went towards the roadside trees. A little dog appeared in front of him, he sniffed at him, jumped up, licked his hand a little, began to howl and ran forward as though by inviting him to follow him. He followed the dog and saw a ten years old girl under some blossoming, sweet-scented bush. She was holding a boy's head on her knees and crying bitterly.

"Why are you crying, dear girl?" he asked her, bent down and started stroking her head.

"My little brother is dying. Look, he doesn't answer anything to me anymore. And without him, both me and our little dog Whity will also die. We were making our living only because my brother was playing the violin, I was singing and dancing, while Whity was jumping and doing conjuring tricks which we have taught him to do. We had bad luck today. We didn't earn anything, and nobody accepted us to stay overnight. I was thinking that we would have time to reach the city while it was still light, but my brother became so weak that he could hardly walk, and we were overtaken by the night here."

The girl was crying while she was telling him about it, and he could hardly understand her mumbling words. The traveller sat down on the ground next to her, spread his warm cloak and laid the poor boy on it. He put his little pillow under his head, which his father had told him to take with him and which he didn't want to take by considering it to be an unnecessary superstition. Now he gave a smile by putting it under the boy's head, thanked his father in his thoughts, who had to repeat his words twice.

By lending an attentive ear to the weak, but even boy's breathing, he explained to the girl who was still crying tenderly.

"Girl, don't cry, your brother isn't dying, simply he has become weak because of hunger and tiredness. I have some milk, bread, eggs. Soon we'll eat to satiety. Now you drink some cold milk, have some bread and feed Whity. I will try to pick some dead wood and branches, we'll make a bonfire, cook some porridge for both your brother and ourselves. Forget about your heartbreak. Now I am with you, and everything will be all right. You are a brave girl, aren't you? Well, then show an example to everybody, don't cry, otherwise your brother will wake up and he also will start crying. As you can see, Whity is already howling. Be strong, wipe your tears, feed the doggie quickly and eat something yourself."

The youth stood up and went to pick some dry branches for the bonfire, but the little hand held him by his skirt.

"Did the God send you to us? You are a guardian angel, aren't you? Now you won't leave us alone, will you?" the girl was asking him fearfully.

The youth gave a joyful laugh from the child's naivety, squeezed her trembling little hand, stroked her little head and answered her.

"Believe, believe from the bottom of your heart, trust till the end that lost children don't exist in the world. Everybody will find his own happiness if he is working honestly. Believe me as much as you can. It is unimportant who I am, but it is important that your meeting with me has brought you joy, that both you and your brother became happier, merrier and more cheerful. Eat, feed your doggie and don't think about anything else anymore. If I told you that I'm going for some fire-wood, I will find it, and we'll be cooking our supper. Just don't cry."

Soon the night guardian came back with the fire-wood, the bonfire flamed up, warmed the children and the dog, and when the boy woke up, the porridge was already prepared.

The hungry boy was amazed and he couldn't understand for a long time that he could see the hot porridge with the butter for real, and not in his dream. In the meanwhile, the guardian angel who didn't want to take any reserve ration of food for his journey was thanking his brothers who had achieved their goal, and he was as happy as the hungry children.

When the heated and satiated, poor wandering musicians fell asleep with their doggie, all of them wrapped up in the rescuer's cloak and pressed to him, the rescuer himself began to think out a plan

of his upcoming actions. This first meeting of his was just in time. With his lyre and his songs, he couldn't be of more use to anybody except these begging poor things.

He remembered his home, his father, his joyful childhood, his little sister. So often he was trying to teach her his songs and to cheer her up! But every time, with vexation, she used to interrupt him by telling him that she was bored with the childish amusements, that they were singing and laughing so much in their home that both songs and laughter had bored her to death already.

He remembered his father's words which he often used to say to his daughter by looking at her gloomy face: "My poor baby! Only the angry persons need neither songs nor laughter."

The traveller remembered how his father was tormenting himself by seeing always gloomy face of his daughter. Now, while being surrounded by the comforted and calmed down orphans, he remembered his last meeting with his sister, his sadness and tears because of the parting with her whom he loved, he remembered his pain, disappointment and the blow from his sister's words.

"Ah, if I was able to bring consolation and joy for people during my entire life as in this moment. If trust and cheerfulness remained in people's thoughts from meeting me, as in these two hearts which are pressed to me like this during this first night. Let my meeting with them be blessed! The sun is rising! I will sing about this first meeting of mine, let my words fly into the world, perhaps, it'll become easier for somebody because of my song. Hear me, my wise father, bless me and direct me to the new life!"

And, having taken his lyre into his hands, having looked at the children and the doggie who were sleeping calmly at his feet, he broke into a song by greeting the dawn. It seemed that he had forgotten about everything. In this moment, with all might of his thought, he was living only within beauty, he was praying only for one thing: to live by uniting people with beauty, by awakening its need in their hearts, the need to work harmoniously for them.

Having finished his song, the traveller looked round and saw that the children were on their knees from both of his sides, with their little hands put for the prayer, while the doggie was standing on his back pads next to his feet and moving his front ones. The happy traveller wanted to laugh already, but he heard the girl's words.

"Uncle, now I really know that you are a guardian angel. Only the angels are able to sing like this. Ah, if we could learn this song from you! Then probably, people would always give us some bread and not turn us out of their houses for the night. Monk, do you think I could learn this song?" she addressed her brother.

"No, Fani, you are never able to sing like this," the boy answered her, "but don't be dispirited, I remembered the whole song and I will be able to play it with my violin, while uncle will tell you the words and you will sing it in your own way. Uncle, won't angels be angry if we sing it according to your words?" he asked the unexpected fellow-traveller very seriously.

"My naïve children, don't ram any fairy-tales into your heads," he answered Monk joyfully. "Life isn't a fairy-tale, and you know it very well from your own experience, although it is short, but sad. I'm exactly the same man like you, I also don't have my own home like you and I'm also a wandering musician like you, without any money and bread. Life which always knows what it is doing has sent me to you and you to me, so that we could live in the world easier and simpler. Throw all sorts of delirium about the travelling angels who are saving children out of your dear heads and believe strongly that your entire salvation, as well as your entire life, is in your own hands. If you are cheerful, if you don't cry because of the difficult work, but you are working joyfully, your life will be the happiest. Let's not waste our time, let's pick some fire-wood, I still have some coffee and milk left, we'll cook our breakfast and decide how we should

live. Monk has to rest today, but tomorrow we'll set out to our great path. I believe that we'll earn some living and that we won't have to starve. We'll make our new program during this rest day, we'll reconsider it well after breakfast and now, let's go to work."

The new troupe of musicians rose joyfully to pick up some cones and dry branches for the bonfire, because the trees on the roadside which they saw at night seemed to be like a little forest. The time flew by as the merriest feast for both the children and Whity who was running after them. It seemed to them that there wasn't any happier morning up to now. Having fed his new family, the youth told them.

"Well, my brother, play your song with your violin for me, I'll see whether you were boasting of it or you really are a master."

"Oh, uncle, if you knew Monk, you wouldn't be talking like this," Fani whispered him reproachfully.

The boy took his violin in silence. It was the real, big violin of the grown-up. He tuned his violin in an especially tender way, stroked it like a living being and told the youth by surprising him with his seriousness.

"This is my father's violin. He was playing the violin perfectly, but he used to say to me that I would play it better than him. Sometimes when I used to play the violin, he would weep and tell me this: "My God, what am I guilty of before you that I have no possibility to let this genius child to study?" Since Fani says that you are a guardian angel, then you'll understand yourself whether my father was right and whether I have to study somewhere."

Monk began to play, and the traveller recognized that song which he was singing in the morning, at dawn instantly. But it was sounding strangely to his ear. As the author, he admitted that the song was both that one and not. The boy was playing it in such an original way that now it seemed to the singer to be much better conveyed. It was difficult to believe that these sounds were flowing from the little fingers of the boy and not from the little pipe of the miraculous creature who was singing in a human voice. The Monk's melody needed only words. It filled up the youth's heart. He was sitting amazed, not being able to take his eyes off the little, serious, concentrated and feeble figure of the boy who was absorbed in himself. When the little musician stopped playing, he looked at his guardian modestly and asked him again silently.

"What do you think, our guardian angel? Am I worthy of studying? Has God sent you to us, so that you would become our guardian and help me and my sister to become artists? If you knew how Fani can sing and dance, then most likely, you would pity us. Allow me to play again, and Fani will sing and dance for you. Perhaps, at least she seems to be worthy of studying for you, our dear, compassionate guardian angel."

The youth was touched to the bottom of his heart. He jumped up, lifted the boy up like a feather, pressed him to his heart and kissed him heartily several times.

"You aren't only a great violinist, but you are a great musician, too, my dear boy, my joy, my wonderful meeting which life has sent to me so undeservedly. I promise to you that the best teacher will teach you, even if we had to sail across the sea because of this."

He sat down, seated the boy, the girl and the doggie on his knees and continued his thought, while stroking all three of his foundlings.

"First of all, my dear children, remember very well, once and for all: I'm exactly the same man, just like you, I've never seen any angels or been in their company, just like you. From now on, I'm your

oldest brother and I will have to replace your father for you in the best possible way. In this way, this question is solved. Life isn't a fairy-tale, everybody is working on the earth, and we are going to do exactly the same. I hope that it'll be easier and merrier for you with me. Now we are going to think a little what a program we have to prepare, so that people would like it, and we would always have bread and a shelter for the night. We'll go to the nearest small town along the big road where all travellers stop and organize our first performance there, which now we are going to conceive and to discuss."

Pretty soon, three artists accommodated one to another, only the fourth one, Whity, required more of their attention. Finally, the hard-working dog understood all the details of his role, and when Monk rested enough, the new troupe set out to the road.

"Uncle, wait," Fani stopped everybody. "If you say that you aren't an uncle angel and if you don't want us to call you like this, then tell us your human name, otherwise nobody will believe that you are our brother."

"My name is Apolon, call me your brother Apolon, just as I used to be called in my family," the youth answered them by hurrying the children, because the sun was high in the sky already.

The new family of musicians were very successful in the nearest small town. It was the market day, most people were in a cheerful mood because of the successful market and they rewarded the beautiful children and their young guardian generously for their songs and dances.

The children weren't so happy and satiated, they weren't sleeping in such clean beds as today a long time ago, because their earnings didn't allow them to rent a separate room. They were already admiring their new clothes and shoes in several days. Now they were always satiated and self-confident. All three of the little artists were idolizing Apolon. And only sometimes, snuggled up to their guardian modestly, they used to stroke him with their little hands and whisper timidly to him.

"Brother Apolon, you will never leave us, right? We won't be able to live without you anymore."

"I will take you to the big city. You will be studying there, and I will be singing and earning money for your studies. This is our program. Why are you thinking so often what is going to happen in the future! Your short and difficult life had to teach you that we didn't know a single tomorrow, that only this day existed. Be happy, sing and play, learn well and that's it."

The weather was favourable for the young troupe. Many times they heard all kinds of tempting offers from rich people, many were trying to allure the children from Apolon, silently they were promising wonders to them, but nothing was able to tear their hearts off Apolon, besides their only dream was studying. Every time there were less versts left to the great city, every artist already had a fat wallet, because they were working hard, they were always developing their program which was successful everywhere.

"You know, Apolon," once Monk told him, "although I've made sure that you always tell the truth, but I still cannot believe that you aren't an angel. You are so kind and you sing so well that when man is listening to you, he is all drowned somewhere. Please remember, maybe any of your grandfathers or grandmothers were related with the angels. Well, at least a little relationship is linking you to the angels. Remember, I ask you very much, you must have only forgotten about this," Monk was talking to him bitterly by showing the nail of his little finger to him.

Apolon gave a cheerful laugh and answered him.

"You see when you are playing your father's songs, then not only the entire man is drowned, but as though the whole universe disappears with him. Your sounds make everybody lapse into silence: both the birds and the dogs. But I don't suspect you and I don't think that you are hiding your angelic descent from me."

"Oh, I'm a man, the most ordinary man. As far as I remember our father and mother – people were always persecuting all of us for our belief. But I cannot explain it to you what that belief of ours was and why the people were harming us because of it. Sometimes our father used to comfort our poor mother and tell her: "Don't be sad, Garani. They are blind men full of superstitions. Go nobly, don't go out of your way, and life will reward either us or our children. Believe till the end and instead of your tears, smile to the ignorance of the hearts which are persecuting us when they are trying to please their God so much."

Monk was silent for a while, then he added bravely.

"I think that our father wasn't wrong. We met you, consequently, life has rewarded us instead of them. I believe that you will help me to study, and I will become an artist, as my father used to tell me."

"And I will be learning to dance. I want nothing more in my life as to dance," Fani uttered and threw her arms round her older brother Apolon's neck.

"I don't know whether it is the truth that you want only to dance, my dear sister, but I can see clearly that now you want only to sleep," Apolon told to the laughing girl while laying her to bed. "Children, sleep now and tomorrow we have a performance – it'll be our rehearsal before we reach the great city. We'll have to draw attention to ourselves, so that great teachers would want to teach us. Have a rest, concentrate your strength, so that tomorrow you would be cheerful and full of energy, while I'm going for a walk."

Having left the children under an attendant on duty supervision, Apolon left the inn and sat down on the secluded bench in the park. He wanted to stay alone for a while and to think about everything what had happened to him during this time. As soon as he started to remember his brothers whom he hadn't seen and about whom he hadn't had any news for so long, he heard the steps and saw a woman who was muffled herself up in a shawl hurrying towards him.

"I noticed that finally you went out alone, without your unbearable children who are always clung to you. Don't try to deceive me. I've been watching you for the whole month already and I've found out your entire story. People told me that the children have clung to you on your way, they aren't your true relatives at all, as you are telling to everybody. One can see from your manners that your origin is very high and that you cannot be a wondering musician in any way. I don't know what has pushed you into this path, but I think that I shan't be far out in saying that an unhappy love has made you to hide yourself and to hide your name. But perhaps, your unhappy love isn't so much unhappy as it seems to you. You had to notice that both me and my father were always trying to take part in your performances, we were sitting in the first rows and we were the most generous of all your listeners. I linger everywhere intentionally, so that you could catch up with us. My father adores me and he will do everything for me, he doesn't like my attention to the wondering musician, attention of the richest bride around to the strange man. Therefore, I came to tell you that I'm interested in your fate. Come to my father to work as his assistant. Although he is haughty, but I will force him to invite you at our table, and then we can see each other often and unhindered. You will be working as his assistant for a while, you will show your efforts as far as my father's business is concerned, you will become his senior assistant, then I will be giving you some money secretly, you will become his companion and then you can ask for my hand already. But I insist you on leaving your

nasty foundlings. There are many cloisters in our big city, so you can leave them there. I will give you some money for their maintenance. Now answer me quickly whether you agree to my terms? I was feeling your passionate look directed to me many times, I know that I'm beautiful and that it is impossible not to fall in love with me. Don't worry for the big distance that separates us. I will get everything what I ever want to. Leave all our matters for me to solve. I know that this meeting surprised you very much. I understand your perplexity and silence. But don't worry, although I'm the mistress of these lands with my riches and my beauty. I'm the mistress, hence I can ignore everyone's common opinion and I can act in any way I want to. Answer me quickly, because my father may be back from the inn in any moment, he loves to sit with his friends there for a while, in the evenings."

The girl threw her shawl down and moved nearer to Apolon. The aroma of her black plait and the glittering rings on her hands, her black eyes, her stout figure, even her rather sharp and commanding voice – everything was just like his sister's. The youth who was turning red and white several times during the entire speech of his companion because of his insulted manly pride remembered his father, he remembered where and why he was going, he stood up, bowed to the stranger and answered her absolutely calmly.

"Thank you very much for your attention to my fate, but you were wrong about everything. I left my home not because of my unhappy love, but because my father has told me to do so, and I have a business to do. I won't leave the children, because they are my most real brother and sister, and their fate is my fate, and one cannot escape one's fate. I'm a poor trader, and I cannot trade love at all. Besides, at the moment, not women are in my thoughts and in my heart, but that path of God about which you have no idea. I'm the least suited for you from all the men whom you could choose for yourself..."

The girl jumped up like bitten. She muffled herself up in the shawl again and interrupted Apolon in a hissing, furious whisper.

"You, unfortunate beggar! You, comedian! I will avenge you cruelly. You won't earn a penny in our city. I will avenge you in such a way that you'll remember it till your very death."

"If I've deserved such punishment, let the God's will happen through your hands, but there isn't and there won't be any anger for you in my heart. Live, I will always bless you, it doesn't matter how much evil you would do for me. God is living within you, exactly as in every other being, and sooner or later you will certainly find him within yourself."

As though an astonishment flashed through the girl's face, but she didn't answer him anything, she gave a sharp laugh by reminding him of his sister again and vanished in the dark.

Apolon went even further in the park and sat down in the darkest place where nobody could see him anymore. He was feeling some kind of disharmony within himself. That wasn't a longing or a sorrow, but his thoughts about his father, about his loneliness without him were pouring from his heart like a moan or a complaint..."

Having departed after the heroes of the fairy-tale in their thoughts, Bronski and Lovushka gave a start after hearing the knock at the door. Yassa was speaking to them.

"I call you for the second time already. It is time to go to the dining-room."

Surprised Lovushka closed the book, he looked at Bronski and saw no less amazement in his face.

"It is so strange, Lovushka, I just concentrated, and it seems that we need to finish here. Where did the entire day disappear?" surprised Stanislav uttered.

"Apparently, I am translating so slowly. Although only now I felt how numb my back and my legs are."

Friends went to the door, and suddenly Bronski stopped as though by striking against the invisible wall. Lovushka's face brightened up and he uttered.

"The fiery record detains us. Here it all lit already:"

Calm within man's heart – that's not the feature of his self-control brought onto the earth, but wisdom that has grown from his self-control and fearlessness.

To open some characteristic or talent within yourself – that's to liberate the certain area of love from your passions.

If the word of your encountered person insulted you – then your self-control isn't the part of Wisdom of centuries, but only your external restraint. Clear up well what the external signs of conditional politeness are and what the inner Love's self-control is, which knows only love for man, and not for himself.

When friends washed down their dregs and entered the dining-room, I. was already waiting for them there. He greeted them tenderly and invited them for the supper. He was telling them merrily about the life and affairs of the Community, about professor's health who was still sleeping calmly and about several new people who came here.

"Today we'll go to say good-bye to Beata who will leave together with her paintings at dawn. I see sadness in your faces, my friends. You are especially sad, Stanislav. But why are you sad? Beata has grown and matured to live among people who are longing and searching for happiness, she can serve people along their path to liberation and comfort them in the hour of their grief and helplessness. Do you really find only sadness because of your personal separation with her and you can send those feelings to her as your congratulation when she's entering the new life?"

"Teacher, I understand that if the great nobility was in the first place for me, then it would make me think about her, about her life, about her bright and new path," Bronski answered him. "This case proves to me how egoistic I am, how many personal feelings and attachments I possess. I love Beata very much, even more Lovushka and... I fell in love completely, I've given my entire soul, heart, work, in short I gave my entire life to you, Teacher I. I cannot live anymore without any bond with you, without following you, without trying to glorify you with my every action. To live for me – that's to take part in that life, work and affairs which you organize and which surround you. To live – that's to receive instructions for my every day from you. It occurred to me that one day I would receive the instruction to leave the Community like Beata, that I would have to part with you, - and the cold penetrated into my heart, as if I had heard the distant chime of bells from a funeral procession."

"My poor friend, you can decide from the moment of this acute pain when only the thought about the parting causes such heartbreak for you, for how much you are still living, communicating with people and perceive life of your flying past day as the final life of decay and death, and not as the whole Life, the Only One and Eternal which exists in everybody beyond his external form. Your habit of uniting with people still remains as the physical attachment of body and blood, while uniting of Spirit and Light

remains secondary in your encounters. Only then people leave this place, the Community when they are prepared for the new life, that is when they get used to living by greeting that who is living beyond man's external form. Nobody whom his Teacher accepted him once may be pushed away without any especial, even terrible reasons. Nobody may be sent to the new life until he isn't prepared. Another thing is in which external form his preparation or lack of preparation opens for that life with which his Teacher is fascinating him and the active participant of which he wants to be in his dreams, reflections and ideals. Man's thoughts – that's not an action yet, that's still only the period of his preparation. And only when the disciple matures till the end, that is when his thoughts and his heart merge in his actions, then the hour of his new uniting with his Teacher will come, and neither distance nor separation will make him sad anymore, because they won't exist for him anymore. Nobody may die earlier or later than his set time, only when he's done everything what he could during this incarnation; exactly in the same way Teacher may accept or send his disciple only when he is prepared. It is an impossible task to reorganize his entire organism. But to prepare the main paths in his organism and to have an opportunity to fulfil the tasks which his Teacher gives to him – that's nothing else as the constant, concentrated, vigilant attention to all his affairs and meetings, to be precise, to that behaviour with the absolute self-control which the disciple reveals by acting. There's no need even to check this for you. In this moment you can see yourself clearly how your talent, your love and creation are still oppressed by the personal perception of your day. That what you've just read, what worried you so much as the highest expression of heroism of selfless people's feelings now went out within you, only because your earthly attachment still seemed to be such power that it leaves wounds in your heart. Don't torment yourself now, don't cry in your heart. I can see how the blood drops are trickling out of it, although your eyes are dry. Remember the words of the fiery inscription which you've read today: "If your encountered person's word insulted you – then self-control within yourself wasn't the Wisdom of centuries, but only your inner restraint. Clear up well what the external signs of conditional politeness are and what the inner Love's self-control is, which knows only love for man, and not for himself." Only one day is left for you to read that what you need to know before departing. Don't waste your time uselessly. Become stricter to yourselves and don't relax your attention on your every flying past working day. The ordinary fairy-tale which both of you are reading now, - why do you need it now? What does it possess without which you, so distant from it in time and in nature of your external work, may not leave the gates of the Community even with my protection? The wisdom of the ordinary people's experiences from the old fairy-tale, as well as your Wisdom, is taking the external and the only course for all people, the course of the ordinary purity that knows no compromise with its loyalty. The old Wisdom, as well as the modern man's Wisdom, is developing not along the curved and twisting paths of his rushing about to all sides, his passionate searching and cold spells, his energetic jumps and depressed falls, but along the straight paths of his self-control which open not through his will, but through his liberated love which has poured into Joy to live. You cannot imagine a happy day without me? But did the people from the fairy-tale think about themselves when they were left absolutely alone in the strange land, in the darkness of the surrounding evil? The Eternal Movement of Life is the result of those active, spiritual powers which man pours into his day. And no other engine of man's spiritual life exists. Here comes the man, look at him, fall to thinking why you began to feel his influence to yourselves even from the distance. Your breathing becomes even, your faces brighten up, your bodies relax, your thoughts and your hearts become free of all sorts of grips."

The knock at the door was heard, and we saw wonderful, smiling Francisco. He greeted us pleasingly and uttered.

"Probably I came too early, brother I., but I hurried so much, so that Beata wouldn't think badly about me and take away the impression that I wasn't chivalrously polite in the last moment. I remember how once, a long time ago Ali said to me: "You may be occupied with very important affairs, but if you see a man off to his new life, by taking into account his time, you need to coordinate your affairs in such a way that you wouldn't give at least a drop of worry to him with your delay." Sometimes I am absent-

minded, but I always remember Ali's words when I see people off from the Community, - I am sorry if I came too early and disturbed your conversation."

"I don't have anything to say to you, brother Francisco, you can see the faces of these neophytes, you can see their joy which you've aroused in them yourself now. But let's go. You gave a great lesson to me now. I am glad that we'll come to Beata earlier and make the beginning of her new life easier."

We left in silence and we came up to the hill also in silence, on which Beata was living at the moment. We found an exciting scene here. Beata wasn't alone, Aninov was sitting on the small, low chair next to her among her placed things, and his tall, lean figure with his ascetic face looked especially clumsily among the travelling chests and small dressy painter's bags.

The musician's face was so sad, as if he was parting with his closest friend forever. We heard the last phrase of his conversation with Beata.

"I felt that this is our last meeting. I won't see you anymore. And nobody will comfort me during the fits of my despair when I am unable to call for I.'s compassion."

"Well, I caught you being in minor, my dear friend," I. smiled and said to him. "How do you think, did your love for Beata now sow many seeds of the bright cheerfulness into her new path? If I was in your place and my dear friends saw me off like this, probably my wings would bend down from helplessness and the view of such new path of the fearless soldier would look sad. Beata, Francisco took us here a little too early, and I understand how his love felt that we would need to draw you out of the nets of sadness here, which our great musician hung on the whole house. Give your hands to me, my dear friend, my new assistant and colleague in fight for people's happiness and calm. March forward bravely. The beating of my heart for you won't fall silent anywhere. Start your every breaking day by remembering forever that this day - that's a moment, one short moment of your eternal work, and that now it isn't only your work anymore, but that it is my and your work, your and Francisco's work. Wherever you would travel, whatever you would do, even if it is completely different from your usual creation and talent, - not that is important what you are doing and where you are doing it, but how you are doing everything what the day brings to you. It is important to remember for you that there may not be a single moment of depression anymore that not you are walking, not yourself being responsible, but that you are walking every day as the messenger of Calm and Light for people, the messenger who was set to them by the Community. Your work - that's not repentance or obedience, because that isn't your personal work anymore, that's already your merging with me and Francisco through work and joy. Always, always, always feel my and his helping hand in your hand. Be blessed. Don't give in to the vibrations of depression and heartbreak. Be strong. Remember us, and all the dregs which people will pour on you will clear away around you."

I. squeezed the painter's hands, he kissed her forehead tenderly and gave her trembling hand to Francisco. However Beata was trying to hold back her excitement, her big tears were rolling down her face, and one could see that no efforts would stop their flowing stream.

"My poor baby," Francisco uttered tenderly by wiping Beata's tears with his kerchief, and he pressed her to himself. "How difficult it is to be born for the new man, it is so difficult to liberate your heart from the superstitions of the habit: to see the physical body, to love the physical body, to be happy in the time and in space. Grow, my friend, grow easier. Believe me, not so many days will pass and you will make sure that I am always next to you whenever you will call me to yourself with your Love and address me with your Love. No limits exist for such unity, but you need to know one thing firmly and unchangeably: there won't be my answer if you were living in a way of a compromise today, but that's only because you were

living like this. Love of Life may respond only to the cry sent with the whole power of loyalty. While your loyalty to your Teacher – that's the day which you lived without any fear and doubts, with the absolute belief and with its little part. Take this kerchief. You will find my portrait on it which I give to you to remember. But you may not duplicate it for others, because it is given personally to you alone."

Kastanda entered the room and he said that the attendants offered not to wait for the dawn, because the night was bright and cooler than others. One could see that Beata didn't want to leave earlier than the fixed time, that every minute was dear for her, but she looked at I.'s face, wiped her tears and uttered silently.

"I am ready, how my Teacher will say."

"Travel, my friend. You are ready for the new life. Start it without any delay," I. answered her very tenderly.

Bronski kissed the painter's hands bashfully, with the childish kindness and tenderness, and he whispered hurriedly.

"Thank you for everything. I want only one thing: to prepare for my activity among people and on the day of my departure take out the same regards as you do."

Beata said to Lovushka who approached her to say good-bye.

"Your youth fascinated me. That miracle that happened with your appearance here made me fall to thinking about the miracle which had to happen inside of you. I will thank you forever for that painting which I take away now. I will try to be worthy of the portrait which you promised me to create in one of your novels. I believe and I hope that we will meet some time."

Nobody heard what I. and Francisco said to the painter when she was ready to get on the already kneeling camel, but her face lit up by the moon and the torches was so exceptionally happy that Bronski and Lovushka forgot about everything, they forgot that they had to wish something for Beata for the last time, that they saw the man off somewhere far away, that they were standing among other people.

"What are you dreaming about, Lovushka, the camel is far away already, isn't it?" I heard I.'s voice.

"I, I... I forgot about the camels. I saw the miracle: the man in whom God suddenly opened for a moment. I already got used to seeing the highest your, Francisco's Ali's perfection, but it was the real shock for me to see God in the man, in Beata."

"Go to sleep, Yassa will wake you up in a couple of hours, and you will go to read to Ali's room again. Let the sleep make you stronger, because there's little time left."

I. embraced every one of us, we with Bronski said good-bye to Francisco and we dispersed to our rooms.

Chapter 14

My reflections about the new Beata's life.

We finish reading the old fairy-tale.

Professor Zalcman

Having entered my room and stroked Eta who came running to meet me, I persuaded my white friend to go to sleep again, while I sat down in the balcony, because I didn't have any strength to overcome the storm of my surged thoughts and feelings.

That day when I came to the Community and saw the wonderful, grey Beata's head for the first time seemed to me to be such a distant past now. At the same time, as though it had happened only yesterday, as though only yesterday I saw that face for the first time. Why didn't I think for a single time

how old Beata Skalradi was? I understood that during my stay here I stopped to perceive a man by connecting him with his age, his body and with his appearance in general.

In this moment I wasn't in the balcony with my spirit, my thoughts were travelling nonstop after Beata. I was flying in the silence of the night of the desert together with her into the new, distant and noisy life. I could feel still unfamiliar pain in my heart, as though I couldn't coordinate two lives: life here and life among the daily troubles, passions.

But didn't the daily troubles and passions exist here? I remembered the monk's eyes burning with the wild fire, I remembered the old woman who was trying to prove her truth during her conversation with Francisco, professor, some difficult Aninov's, Andreyeva's scenes and I understood that two lives didn't exist, I shouldn't have compared them, because the whole essence of things was in man himself – his liberation and preparation, his ability to spread his purity and to keep it everywhere.

Was it possible to imagine I. who was sad that he would have to leave some place, some people? Who could feel the surrounding atmosphere, people's weakness and instability in a subtler and clearer way than him? But he, although sometimes he was tired, never reacted to the surroundings in a sickly way anywhere, however unusually and tensely passionate the surroundings would have been. I remembered I.'s and Francisco's faces when they were fighting against the angry shrimps. What an exceptional power was reflected in these faces, what a grand, concentrated tranquillity...

I was flying with my thoughts always further after Beata, I wanted to repeat Florentian's and I.'s words many times to her: "Self-control – that's the organism's ability to work in any, even the most horrible circumstances of life."

I imagined how difficult it would be for Beata to get to Paris, to immerse in the jam of the city, to bear her colleagues' envy and slander, their intrigues and traps, because her paintings will stun them and they will try to do everything, so that the paintings wouldn't be acknowledged. But I remembered instantly that Beata wasn't the same anymore whom I knew and to whose hesitations I was used to.

The inscription that was burning for us with Bronski told us that everybody entered the path as his Teacher's messenger only then when he was prepared. I. sent Beata by telling her during their farewell that she was ready for the work among people, ready for HIS work through her. I needed to be happy and rejoice at her new life, and not worry about her.

Once again I saw how many conditionalities were still left within me. Such conceptions as separation, distance, time, knowledge and a man's absence were still living within me and they used to pierce me actively. It should be so difficult to live for people in whose lives the Earth and all its conditionalities take the most important place, and only now and then the thought about heaven and its Wisdom flash among the conditionalities. I understood how still far it was for me till those heroic deeds of the ordinary people, about which I was reading in the old book.

My sadness was clearing away little by little. I started concentrating my thoughts on Florentian and I was begging him to bless travelling Beata. The new Light began to cover me concentrated like this, my thoughts grew to triumph, to joy and to the tranquillity full of calm.

I was sending the song of victorious love to Beata from the bottom of my heart by wishing her to never lose touch in her work with I.'s and Francisco's paths along her own path. I was trying to pour into her path the whole energy of my pure love, respect for the painter and her new path, so that her path would become stronger from my thoughts, but that it wouldn't absorb my instability, too. Suddenly I felt the already familiar trembling of my entire organism and I heard my wonderful friend's voice in a flash.

"There isn't a greater heroic deed in the first stages of discipleship as the disciple's separation with his Teacher. Every disciple faces this inevitable stage for each disciple. But only that disciple rises high with his knowledge who thinks about himself not like about a departing and sad soul already during his first separation, but who can see that work of his Teacher which he can do for him and those people to whom he can give his help.

Walk forward without thinking that you are walking, but walk by knowing how you need to carry the Only One Great Life within yourself to all places of the world and how you need to learn to develop all the qualities of adaptation within yourself and the people who surround you, so that they would do the lesson of eternity among the external conditionalities in an easier, simpler, higher and funnier way.

Grow stronger and remember – your friend is that one in whom you have recognized the Eternity. Therefore, the disciple may not have any personal enemies. The disciple may be sent even as the cause of death, but it won't be only a blind cause, he only will liberate that what is eternal from the helplessly fettered evil of this form on the earth."

It seemed to me that I didn't sit even an hour in the balcony, but Yassa was already standing before me and he was shaking his head by reproaching me.

"Teacher I told me to give this strengthening pill to you, and now I understand why he is sending it to you. He told you to go to sleep, and you didn't fulfil the instruction," Yassa gave the pill to me by still reproaching me.

"Yassa, my dear, it seemed to me that two hours – that's a lot of time, and it flew together with my thoughts in one little hour."

"Go, go, mister Flying Little Hour. Bronski who slept well and who is stronger than a tiger is waiting for you impatiently. While we had to strengthen you like a baby in the most important moment for you. Well, how could one confide in you at all? Think for a while, you got absent-minded because of the separation which is engraved in your life. What will happen with you if in that moment when you need to fulfil an important Teacher's task, your close person's death or a fire will be engraved in your personal feelings, or some other disaster will prevent you from fulfilling your Teacher's task? You will throw down everything, run to save those about whom you weren't told and you'll forget those about whom exactly you were told."

"Now I won't be able to answer your question, Yassa, but it is especially important and serious for me. Thank you for it, and I estimate it as a warning."

We left the room quickly, and I saw Bronski downstairs who was powerful and radiant: it seemed to me that the beams of power were spreading from him. Having greeted me merrily, he looked at me attentively and uttered.

"It is so strange, Lovushka, today your face isn't so calm as always. Did something unpleasant happen to you?"

"No, Stanislav, I am very happy. I was a little sickly, but I sent a pill to me, and now I feel perfectly."

We went to the room of ablutions, and this time the water from me was running much blacker than from Bronski. Besides, today Bronski was walking very easily. His figure became much slender during these fast days. Now his eyes were searching for the shining inscription attentively. He came up to the very door and stopped only on the threshold. I understood that the fiery inscription stopped him, but

today I didn't find it on the threshold where it usually used to be. Amazed I lifted my head and I read high above the door:

Pangs of love – that's the fruit of the earth superstitions. Longing for a tangible closeness – that's the power of fettering with his own desires of the man.

Discipleship – that's the science of man's liberation. While the disciple is becoming free and developing, his love doesn't get dry. He won't remain indifferent to his own people. The mist of his passions clears away, and he always can see clearly the whole life of the people who surround him, and not the single moment of their personal life and his connection with them.

Don't forget, disciple, that that gives the instructions of your Teacher to you who knows and who can see the paths both of you and the people who surround you.

Walk with the eternal, voluntary and undisturbed obedience, because it is nothing else as your loyalty with which you are following those who are leading you.

The inscription went out. But we still didn't enter through the opened door, today both of us wanted to be concentrated especially strongly, to call wonderful Ali whose room had become such temple for us and to send the blissful gratitude to him. The sudden trembling shook my entire body stronger than always, and I heard Ali's voice so loudly and clearly as if he was next to us.

"Remember, my friends, that joy is knowledge given to you – that's not the power of our care for you, but the possibility to create the new paths through you to help people by showing the living example to them where the path to us is and how it may be achieved. Everybody who will communicate with you has to become free of the superstitions and opinions rammed into their heads that you, our disciples and colleagues are saints or some fortunate chosen ones. They have to see your undisturbed loyalty to us from your behaviour during your grey daily routine – your eternal union with our work and our paths."

I passed to Bronski that what Ali answered to our blissful gratitude to him. Bronski squeezed my hand, for the first time he called me brother Lovushka and told me so silently that I could hardly hear him.

"Without your help I couldn't hear what Ali told us, but I can feel with my entire essence that what he was telling us. Today, for the first time during my life I felt an indefinite, triumphant joy in which there wasn't any memory about the earth, time and space left."

We entered the room and again we were surprised that the table was opened and the book that was placed on it wasn't opened in that place where we had finished it reading yesterday. In the high, white vase before the book, which was shining as if a white fire was burning inside of it, the flowers which I had never seen before were put, they looked like roses or lilies, they were absolutely white, of an exceptional subtlety and beauty, and they were diffusing a weak, but charming aroma.

We were surprised by the rather big batch of the stuck together pages between our read place and the one opened today.

"Apparently, we don't need the truths of the stuck together pages at this moment or we still cannot attain them," Bronski said to me, and I began to translate the book.

"Apolon, do you remember how you were sitting on the same bench several years ago, full of sad thoughts and pain because of parting with me? My voice gave you cheerfulness back then, I showed you the way how you should move forward without any fear, not showing your sadness to the children, how you should infuse them with self-confidence in all circumstances and strengthen their joyfulness with your own tranquillity. Your loyalty for my precepts haven't swayed. You didn't lament that as the precept I gave you the lesson to serve the masses of people by binding you with two orphans-beggars and their dog for many years.

Now your children are independent, well-known in their own spheres of art, and it is time for you to leave them by instructing them to serve people in their turn, as well as they are able to do it.

Don't be so sad for leaving your children whom you love like your closest relatives. Leave the last conditionality of your personal attachment and go to those places which I will show to you.

There aren't any superstitiously blessed places on the earth, but there are some places where many saint, selfless and pure people have purified the atmosphere of the earth around their living places in many miles with their pure joy during many years.

You will visit several of such places and leave there the symbols of Wisdom which I will tell you to and which you will perpetuate there yourself. Some of them, which I will tell you, you will bring to the people whom you will meet in the form of songs, cantos and prayers. An especially sacred part of them you will hide in the earth and in the stones. Those whose hearts will be pure will be able to see the Power of their Light. Those who are searching for the Truth and for the paths to it will try to settle there for many centuries.

Don't think that by travelling around the world you will leave my precepts to a certain sects or people who can see God only in their rituals. You will be travelling not for the believers, but for the sinners, searchers and for those who want to become free.

You were sitting here several years ago – the youth who hadn't yet known the whole abyss of sins and sorrows, the whole darkness of people's fall and hypocrisy. Here you have forgiven the woman and blessed her, although she poured you with poison of lie and malediction for your push away, bodily love. And just like your heart managed not to condemn her, but to extend the gift of love from the Only One for her, just so my heart united with your heart in Love of the Only One for your daily work.

That person is free, and God is living and shining within him, who didn't condemn his enemy and forgave her, who forgave her not with his mind, but with all his great and humble Love.

That person is free, and God is living and shining within him, who didn't accept the brilliance of external gifts, but who acknowledged the right to live for a nobody by noticing Me within her.

That person is free, and God is living and shining within him, who tore himself away from his family and understood love as the main body of Eternity in every person he meets, who doesn't regret for the bliss of his past, who isn't sad for his present and who isn't afraid of his future.

Go to those places which I will specify to you without any fear, easily and joyfully. Start the path in those places for meetings and liberation of dispirited people, so that the time of awakening could come nearer, exactly like the man leaves the seeds of Light by sacrificing his soul for his friends-relatives – and then the new power is born for the people's liberation.

I'm not loading you with a joke. My work will tie into your days not with a heavy burden, but your hands will be carrying the beauty of the cup of love, so that I could share with people their heartbreaks and the burden of their yoke. Pour fire from the cup of life into those places where you will bury the symbols of wisdom, so that it would be easier for people to open up the purity of their hearts and to hear my manifestation.

You didn't call me, my loyal son, but you were working on the earth as I had told you to. Your loyalty to me wasn't in your dreams and vows, but it was in your ordinary, daily matters. Now joy is opened within you. Go, fulfil my lesson and wait for my next instructions."

Not the same Apolon, still very young, was sitting on the bench now by remembering the first performances of the wandering musicians when he met the little orphans. The boy who was learning and working a lot since that time now was astonishing the world. The girl who was singer and dancer became celebrity. The orphans didn't forget their old dog and now they considered him to be their best friend, they were spoiling him and making his old age as easy as they could. They asked Apolon to visit that place where they met and to organize the concert in that city where they were accepted so cruelly seven years ago.

Now a young, mature man was sitting on the bench, he was broad-shouldered, tall, and his face was radiating. Only there was something in that young face that didn't allow people to act too unrestrictedly when they were next to him, to talk some vulgar things and to scold. Everybody whom Apolon's eyes were looking at wanted to hide his brutal characteristics and to show more of his beauty and nobility.

Now, having heard his father's voice, which he hadn't heard from that time when he was sitting here for the first time, and his heart was bleeding, as though he all changed. Now it seemed to him that he was waiting namely for this calling of his father for several days already. He understood that his task, that task which had delayed him before the great plan of actions, was now finished.

He was sad that he didn't have any home and family, that he was lonely back then, - and life sent him family, home and cosiness. He got to know the whole personal happiness of family and understood that it was an illusion, too, that Eternity wasn't there where the passing-by happiness was, but there where it was living itself. And Eternity is living there where man is creating.

Apolon's thoughts flew in the vortex by his entire experience of all this period. He understood that people certainly needed to find the paths to creation, otherwise they would suffocate in this atmosphere of death which became predominant everywhere where searching for one's freedom and peace of one's heart ended.

He understood why his father needed his centres of Light, why he needed the places where the people free from passions were living, and the new wave of happiness and triumph overflowed his heart. Now his personal separation with his close and beloved children seemed to be so easy and unimportant to him, and he could understand even better why his father wasn't crying or sad by sending all of his sons into the world. Apolon understood what his father was able to see in the path of each of his sons and whom he was serving by tearing them off from his heart and from the native nest.

Apolon was already prepared to get up from the bench and to go to the hotel which was built instead of the old inn when a woman muffled in the shawl stopped him.

"Mister, have pity on me, please come with me. The house of my master and my mistress isn't far away from here. I'm the old suckling mother of my current mistress. It's almost seven years already when my mistress is suffering and growing sickly from an unknown disease. No one of the doctors is able to

help her. We were told that the violinist came with his doctor and that you've learnt everything in the big cities. Don't be angry with me because I've disturbed your peace. The husband of my mistress will show gratitude to you by paying you big money, while I'm begging you to come with me in the name of the eternal God. My mistress doesn't believe in anything, and when I'm talking about God to her, she's scolding me and asking me why my God doesn't set me free from my slavery, why I'm unable to get Him to give her any help and health. Mister, have a pity on me," the woman was talking to him by sobbing and going on her knees. "No, don't get me up, allow me to kneel at your feet. As though a blessed warmth is pouring from your feet into the wounds of my heart, and my old sin isn't burning me so much. I'm to blame for everything, mister. I was exceptionally beautiful, and my previous master bought me as a dowry for his daughter. My young mistress was kind, she used to pity me and do me favours. Everything was all right for some time, but the young master started looking at me more frequently. Everything ended in such a way that I became pregnant and gave birth to my daughter, my current mistress. I don't know what has happened between my master and my mistress, but they took my daughter from me on the second day after delivery, and in the evening, they took me to their house and settled me in the room next to my kind mistress' bedroom. I didn't see her for a very long time. My girl was already two years old when once I was invited to enter my mistress' room. Ah, mister, a lot of life has flown past since that time, while the hour of that terrible meeting is still standing before me. She was lying like a skeleton, weazened, yellow like a wax, while her eyes were burning like shining lamps."

"Come closer, you poor, unfaithful slave," she told me silently. "Take this string. No one knows its age, it is precious. It has imbibed all my tears, moans and complaints, but I have put my great forgiveness into it, too. My grandmother gave it to me and told me: "Your happiness is in it." Ah, how I was crying where that happiness was by pressing this string to my bosom. My lungs didn't hold out my tears and sorrow, my health broke down, and the more I was suffering the clearer I could understand that no happiness was eternal, only kindness was eternal. And I have forgiven you, I told them to record your daughter as my true daughter. Live with her in this house, take the string, let it be your happiness and teach you to forgive and to love in such a way that you could see not only your own happiness, but also happiness of other people. Death is already next to me. I'm not afraid of it, and you don't be afraid of it, too. It'll set me free from my suffering and liberate the place for you in this house for your better life. Remember only one thing: be loyal till the end to those people whom you've chosen for yourself and teach them holiness of love."

"She gave me the string and fell flat on her back. I thought that she had died already. I was horror-struck. I wanted to run away, but my master entered the room and looked at me hatefully. Having seen the precious string on my neck, he attacked me by shouting: "You've already robbed us! Give it back to me immediately!" But all of a sudden, my mistress rose and told him in some frenzied, whistling voice: "Not she, but you've robbed both me and her. Give the string back to her. Keep the secret of my daughter's birth, and let my slave live next to her as her suckling mother and nurse for as long as she'll be living on this earth." With these words, she fell down for the second time, so that she wouldn't rise anymore. "Go to your room and don't dare to smack in my eye," the master told me secretly. Since that time I'm living next to my young mistress as her suckling mother, but I failed to teach her love about which the deceased was telling me. My life in this house was always terrible, I was always afraid of leaving my room, and since that time when my current mistress became sick I'm begging only death for myself and I'm trying to find that power of love in the string, which my kind, deceased mistress has rendered into it. Let's go, mister, perhaps you will save the patient's life. I'm asking you for this not because I'm afraid that her father could kill me, probably death would be even easier than my life for me, but because I'm frightened that my unhappy daughter won't find any peace for her soul. I'm sure that the black demon of evil, the demon of raging love is holding her tightly in his paws, as he was doing and still is doing it to me up to now. Don't refuse to

examine the patient, come with me," the woman was sobbing, while throwing her arms round Apolon's feet.

Having lifted the woman with difficulty, he seated her on the bench next to him, took her hand and told her tenderly.

"Calm down, my friend. We cannot go anywhere until you calm down completely. If you want to help a man as quickly as possible, you have to control yourself as soon as possible until you reach total self-control, you have to forget about yourself and think only about that man. Now you are asking me to help your daughter. Look back at your life. Stop crying and think for a while why you've failed to fulfil the precept of your deceased mistress. You were her beloved friend, she confided her secrets to you, while you deceived her cruelly. If you had confessed everything to her, she would have forgiven you, and if not happiness, then at least peace would have become prevalent at your home. If you hadn't concealed lie in your heart and if you hadn't slandered the deceased before her husband, then there would have been peace at your home. You loved and you still love your daughter, but with your milk, she was drinking your hypocrisy, your jealousy, your hurt pride and your excessively sensitive self-love – the characteristics of the slaves. Let's go. Press your precious string to yourself and call for the power of love of the deceased who has forgiven everything to you. In this only hour of your life, feel free from all lies, all chains which you yourself and other people have put onto you and stand before God, only before Him alone, as though everything had disappeared, you died and you were standing in the universe, - you were standing with your entire truth before Him."

Apolon helped the woman to get up. Now she was absolutely calm, and they went into the thick darkness of the night. The way wasn't long. The woman took him into the dark, soundly asleep home. She accompanied him to the big, luxurious room by using the lantern, which was empty and hardly lit. She went behind the heavy door-curtain which separated a part of the room.

In several minutes, she was back again by inviting the guest to go with her. She raised the door-curtain before him and let him go to another side in silence.

A strong aroma was in the room, the air was stale and hot. Several lanterns with the fragrant oil were burning in the luxurious, Oriental room. Regardless of the lanterns, the room was hardly lit. Apolon could hardly see the woman who was lying on the high sofa, motionless.

"Suckling mother, is that you?" a voice could be heard from the sofa.

The voice was weak, and it seemed to Apolon that he had already heard this rather dry and sharp voice.

"Mistress, I brought the new doctor for you. Everybody is talking about him here that he's very learned and that he has helped many people," her suckling mother answered her unusually tenderly and friendly.

"You grow stupid every day, not only every year," her mistress answered her with great sarcasm. "For how many times I have to repeat to you that I don't want to see any doctors and that I have enough experience to see their shortsightedness by taking into account my disease. You cannot bring me a clairvoyant, can you? Apologize to the doctor and take him out. Ask my husband to pay him for disturbing him," the patient was talking to her, not opening her eyes.

Apolon went up to one of the lanterns, took it in his hands and lifted it above the patient's head. Being dazzled with the unexpected and bright light, the patient opened her eyes and rose a little in her bed suddenly. From the angry expression of her face, one could expect a lot of sharp words for another

doctor who dared to violate the order of this house. But the first glance cast at the face of the man who had come here interrupted her thought. Having fixed her motionless gaze on him, the patient gave a shout.

"You? You? Is this really the truth? My whole disease is you, you wicked demon! How did you dare to cross the threshold of my house? Get out you, old fool," she shouted at her suckling mother by showing the door to her. "Don't dare to enter here until I call you. And if somebody enters the room while I'm talking to this man, your head will fall off."

Having bowed to her threatening mistress obediently, the suckling mother cast a pleading glance at the guest and left the room silently.

"Why did you come here? Did you know where she was taking you?" the patient addressed Apolon.

Having placed the lantern to its place, he came back to the woman's bed and told her.

"I didn't know where I was taken to or what I would find here, but I knew that I'm coming to the suffering soul, that's why I came here."

"Ah, that's how it is! Probably, you wanted to see a young beauty by dreaming to preach a sermon for her," the patient gave a biting laugh. "You can admire the work of your own hands. Where my youth is? Where my colours are? I'm completely exhausted from sadness and the witchcraft with which you have enchanted me. Now admire the results of your behaviour! You were casting fiery glances at me, you bewitched me with them, and then, in the last moment you were frightened, you ran away and left me. It's great that you came yourself. I had already decided to find you anyway and to put you to prison for your witchcraft."

"Poor woman, I'm so sorry that you are still feeling anger and hatred for me with which you left the park seven years ago. The whole eternity has flown by since our meeting, while you haven't made any move forward, and everything around you is telling you about your hatred. Think for a while, for whom, starting with yourself, it became merrier and easier because you are trying to shift your mistake on me or on my witchcraft. If I had had a goal to make my career with the help of the rich family and rich home, even then I couldn't have responded to your love, because you wanted to create your happiness on the misfortune of the orphans whom life had sent to me. I don't have any want to reproach you, I have even less desire to dig in the past which is gone already. If now I'm talking to you about it, then I'm doing it only because I want to explain to you that I didn't see you a single time during my performances. And my fiery glances, if they seemed to you to be like this, rose from those songs which I was singing, from those actions which we were performing with my little artists, and I didn't have any time to examine the audience. Both with my songs and my performances, I was glorifying joy and love for my father who has sent me to fulfil one of his tasks. If I tried to explain to you what kind of the task it was, you wouldn't understand anything from it. But you can and you have to understand that in order to fulfil any task, man has to know what the selfless love is from his everyday experience."

A sharp laughter interrupted Apolon.

"Are you continuing your sermon on the bench? You fool, a pitiful comedian, you've fought your way to the educated doctors and now you are trying to become the same pathetic, hypocritical moralist! That's why life has given this second meeting with you to me? You've filled my heart with poison, my veins are full of your poison. Neither food nor luxury nor my beauty which I loved so much can distract, comfort or divert me from your unbearable image. Your hated figure is burning my brain all day long and in the night, it is drying my body, making the hair from my plait rare. And you dare to talk about the selfless love? If this is your attitude, you must leave everything and live next to me. You are hypocrite, all your

words about love and help are nothing else as old, not valid coins which you are clanking by alluring the fools.”

“I will argue with you. Every man’s day – that’s his actions within it, and not his words. Look at yourself, seeing your unfortunate state, I can also see your actions during those years, but I’m not a judge to them. If you want to see my actions during those years, if at least from them you want to decide about some of my fruits of selfless love, then come to the concert tomorrow and listen to my little orphans. If you are following any news about art, you must have heard the Monk’s name, he is my foundling and now he’s the most famous violinist who’s giving concerts with his sister who is also the famous singer and dancer. If you really decided to listen to their concert, I will give you an advice: order to take you out from this terribly stuffy room into the pure and fresh air and drink this powder six times per day. This will make you stronger, you will have a good sleep, while the fresh air will disperse a part of the poison with which you are poisoning yourself by breathing the stifling aroma of your perfume.”

Apolon put a small box with the powder on the table, which he took out from his pocket, bowed to the hostess and turned towards the door, but the patient told him again.

“Stop, I cannot believe that the fate has brought you to me only to preach a sermon to me. You have to help me. Take your witchcraft off me, I’m dying because of it. Don’t you understand even now that not my hatred is killing me, but my mad, unquenchable love. In every moment, with every sigh, every sunbeam, every bit of bread I’m full of the desire to see you, the desire that you would love me...”

“Think for a while whether there is any sense in your words? If you loved me in the way as you say you do – continuously, faithfully, till the end – then how could you marry somebody else? If you love a person, then he’s the only one and there aren’t any others. If you tell me that you love one person, but you are living with another one, then check it out and you will understand that you don’t love anybody, except yourself. That’s how it is, my poor friend. You always loved and you still love only yourself, and therefore, you can never find any happiness and reconciliation anywhere. If you keep behaving like this persistently, if you continue your argument with the God and your fate in this way, you’ll only kill yourself by living your entire life without any meaning and use for the universe, being a misfortune and heartbreak both for yourself and your loved ones. Stop thinking that you are ill. You are strangling yourself with your thoughts only about yourself, while man is created in such a way that he cannot live in the poison of his self-love. Man has to have a possibility to love somebody else without himself, so that he could liberate a place from his egoistic thoughts within his organism, otherwise he will suffocate from the poison which is called self-love, fear, arrogance, pomposity. Forgive. Now I have to go. You won’t be able to understand me now anyway. But if you listen to the concert and want to see me again, then send your mother-slave to me, whom you had to set free a long time ago.”

“All right, let it be as you say it. I will try to drink your powder and I will listen to your music. I doubt whether such a magic music exists from which people would get better. But let it be, I will come. And my slave is my suckling mother to me, an ordinary nurse, and not my mother-slave as you said it, although she’s dedicated to me till her death.”

“Try to find your happiness in several directions at once. Take a good look at your slave whose face you have never seen very well, although she was next to you during your entire life. Perhaps, with your eyes free from self-love, having thought well about her, and not about yourself, you will find something new and unexpected for yourself, too.”

“You ask me riddles,” the patient told him in a tired voice. “Go, and I will try to breathe out the poison if it is mine, and not yours. I’m only afraid that all of it is only your fantasy and, to all appearance, your little musicians aren’t any better than any beggar comedian.”

She hit a small gong with the mallet, and her suckling mother entered the room with her face covered with the shawl.

"See the guest off and come back with four slaves, I want to sleep on the flat roof tonight," she said to her suckling mother by giving a nervous laugh.

Having left the patient, Apolon came back to the park again. His thoughts were spinning about his sister, because these meetings of the night reminded him of her voice and the cruelty of her character.

His thoughts came back to his father again. Why did his father send all his sons into the wide world, without whom his life has become vain and poor? And why did he keep his daughter for himself, whose thoughts, behaviour, ideals and goals didn't conform with his own work for people at all? Why has such cruel daughter who's seeking only for her personal goals fallen to their father's lot, who's almost a perfect man?

Apolon meditated upon all his meetings during this year again. He's seen so many monasteries! He's come across so many different sects and religions! And everywhere everybody was talking how they were searching for the God, for His paths, but their words were flying like irksome flies, not reflecting the actions of their hearts.

Rarely, he used to meet people who weren't telling some fanciful words to him, but who could smile to everybody. When Apolon used to meet such people he always knew that their love was a living power, that other people brightened up next to them and they kept carrying this smile of theirs as their own kindness.

Why is the cruel daughter living with her kind and wise father? What was the meaning of such meeting in life?

Apolon was unable to find any answer. He kept going forward and didn't even notice how he left the park, saw the bonfire and went towards it. An old man was sitting by the bonfire and he was persuading his dog affectionately, so that it wasn't barking at the passer-by without necessity, because he was a kind man.

"And how can you know that I'm a kind man. Perhaps, I'm very bad person, even a robber?"

"No, my friend. I'm old and almost blind already, but I've seen many people. When a kind person is walking, he's all radiating, and it is easier to breathe next to him, and when an angry person is walking, then there's only darkness round him, and he smells of a stench. You'll see those human nasty things yourself when you grow old. You are young, and you all young people are judging like this: beautiful – kind. No, young man, don't think that if the girl is beautiful, then her soul is beautiful, too, and the truth is living within her. Also don't pay attention to the fact that she's living next to her spiritual and wise father, and next to her kind brothers. Sometimes, such daughter is living in a peaceful family only because the nasty things of her heart wouldn't suffocate her, and their attempts to ruin the girl completely become hopeless due to her father's wisdom and her brothers' light."

It seemed strange to Apolon that he was unable to find an answer to his questions, and here an old man, an old beggar whom he happened to meet answered him, although he didn't ask him his question. Apolon took a seat near the bonfire and wanted to know why the old man was alone and homeless.

"Sit down, my brother. Here the porridge will be ready soon – don't be proud, treat yourself," the old man was speaking to him politely. He spread his shabby coverlet for Apolon and made more place for him near the fire.

"Thank you, old man, I'm not hungry, but I will sit next to you for a while with pleasure, because you have astonished me very much. I was walking and thinking to myself: why the girl is beautiful, but her heart is cruel and she's living with her wise and kind father. And you answered to my question, even if I didn't ask you to."

"You see, I have already told you that an age opens up the thoughts of the person whom you meet if you try to serve God. As soon as you came up to me, I saw the girl whom you were thinking about. I also saw your home and your father in it. Only the girl isn't there anymore, she ran away from home, but now she doesn't have any peace as well."

Apolon became surprised even more and he asked him.

"Old man, tell me how did it start for you that you could see from the distance?"

"My brother, I can't even describe everything like this. I was living in a monastery for a long time. I was a servant there. And the monk to whom I was serving was never speaking to anybody, he was only holding his rosary in his hands and whispering his prayer silently. And he was uttering one and the only prayer. When he was always whispering it, I also got used to work with it. So when I was hacking fire-wood, cooking the porridge or patching his and my own shabby clothes, his simple prayer was always murmuring in my ears like a melody of the waves. And I noticed that my monk began to smile more often to me. Since he didn't like to speak much, I wasn't speaking as well. It would happen that he would smile to me, then I would bow to him, then he would smile even more and bow to me. Sometimes, he would fall silent for many hours and sit like numb. Well then I would take his rosary silently and repeat his prayer. Once he came to his senses after one of such sittings of his and told me: "Tomorrow I will die. But you know firmly that death doesn't exist, only people decided to name it like this. Take my stick, my rosary and leave this place. If you are living purely, I will always be with you, and you will know what to tell to every person. I will show to you the thoughts of those persons whom you will have to tell something. And you will be hearing my voice – what to tell to whom. Go, don't look for any shelter in your life, and remember that death doesn't exist. There's only life, eternal, the Only One. Serve to it in every person. When the time comes to leave the earth for you, you will see me if you are serving to the God faithfully in every living soul." I've already been travelling for a long time, and I always succeeded to tell the words of my kind monk correctly to everybody. He's always been my loyal fellow-traveller. When I stop somewhere – a man comes to me, and he always receives my answer by not asking anything from me. My guardian tells me to tell you this:

"If you keep walking faithfully – you will approach love. You were thinking that you could only sing, but you realized that your song was also Love. Don't trouble yourself by thinking why you were told to put the symbols of Wisdom in the special places. Know that the most brutal wars of people will be taking place in those places many times, and the Wisdom there will create the centres of the people's rescuing. Three paths are stretching before you: peace, kindness and joy. But all of them unite into Love. And that person who is able to walk the path of Love, he will become aware himself not only of all misfortunes of the earth, but he will be able to give the purest fire of his cup to people. Go straight from here. Don't linger. Don't think about how your children are going to live. Life for everybody – that's only his own form. And nobody is able to help him until his passions are living within him, which surpass love. Go and be strong. Don't think about the temporary meetings, because now you have another task. Send my old man to your children and to the angry woman, I will tell everything to him how he should speak to them. He will help them."

Apolon was looking at the talking face of the old man in amazement, and now it was absolutely different – it was bright and radiating. Not doubting at least for a moment, Apolon was sitting next to the old man while he was eating his porridge, then he helped him to put his several belongings into his bag and took him to his room in the new hotel where everybody was fast asleep. Having put the old man to bed, Apolon threw his cloak on his shoulders, took his lyre, some bread, money and left.

The pages of the book stuck together again, and Lovushka kept reading in the newly opened place:

Having arrived on board of the Italian ship here, Apolon was walking with the caravan for a long time, and finally, he reached the Ganges river. He had to keep walking until he found the necessary place in Indian woods. Here, all of a sudden, he heard his father's voice.

"Put the last Symbol of Wisdom in the pit at the foot of the rock, cover it with stones and come back to me. There will be a Community in that place, which will support people in hard times. People from different paths, religions and searching will be able to come to that Community, but only those whose hearts and minds will unite in harmony. Those stubborn persons who won't be able to achieve harmony during their lives from centuries to centuries will live in more distant places where your task isn't to leave my symbols. Come back home, be blessed. Exactly like you were loyal to me during this life, exactly in the same way your loyalty will become stronger in your next life where the cup of Fire will become like the earthly death for you."

Apolon was lost in thought during his entire way back, and now nobody would have recognized that joyful and handsome youth who once left his father's home with the lyre in his hands in this lean and ragged traveller.

The ascetic face of the traveller was radiating an exceptional and bright peace, his tender voice was raising even the disappointed people's spirits, and he came back home with people's blessings.

The whole batch of the stuck together pages closed again, and Lovushka translated by making it out with difficulty:

"You who are reading, the further you are walking your path of knowledge, the easier you have to understand who is leading you along the path and how you can take part in the joint life of the universe.

Only that person is living the life of the universe who learns not only to see God in every man, but also to respect him in his daily routine.

That person who will learn to highly respect the Fire of the man whom he will meet, will associate with those who are walking in the advance-guard as with the leaders of his time.

Having reached this stage, the person never comes back to his next incarnations, but he passes on to the path of the genii and he continues his path by being led of those who are invisible to people. They never lose their self-control in any moments of the earthly life.

Having read these lines, understand again: there are no secrets, ranks or conditional divisions into high and low ones. There's only liberated Will and Love, the vision liberated from conditionalities, the Joy liberated from sorrows."

Yassa was knocking at the door. We closed the book, covered the table and left Ali's room being full of gratitude.

This time no inscriptions stopped us anywhere, only when we entered the corridor, the fiery letters as though were hanging in the air before the door of the ablutions room:

The temple isn't there where torchers are shining. The temple – that's man's heart; wherever the man would go, he is able to see only that what has grown in his heart.

Neophytes, learn not to judge people, no matter how they would look to you. Where the sinners are living, the most sinful from all is that one who saw the sin and not God within the sinner.

The words went out. As usual we followed Yassa to I.'s dining-room, only much earlier than we used to during these days.

As always I. met us with his hospitable smile, but we noticed that today his face was especially strict.

"As soon as you have your supper," he told us by not eating anything himself, "we'll go to wake up professor. While reading the fairy-tale of old times, you understood that there weren't any other principles to strive for development for people in any time as only those which you encounter in the current period. The Ancient Wisdom, as well as our time Wisdom, tells only one thing: how to liberate the seed of Eternity within man from the pressure of his own superstitions, rammed opinions into his head and his passions, how to strengthen the ability of the liberated parts of love within him to live with the whole completeness of feelings and strength without deviating to compromises of how to achieve this completeness which opens the inner sight and the inner hearing through different ways which make this striving easier for man, and finally, what are the main conditions that lead every man to his easiest, shortest and simplest path: loyalty, obedience till the end.

Now you are going to take part in waking up of the man who didn't know any compromise by serving the science. The science was his God whom he was admiring without having any strength even to imagine a possibility to step back from it even for a moment. Stop thinking that the man's path to development – that's only his spiritual searching, religion, the art or sermons of love where everything is subordinated only to the direct goal – to serve people. Those are rather rare paths. In most cases, people like professor, turn to the branches without even thinking about the idea to serve the mankind. But their path is the same great, they are living in a harmonious way, and it turns them into the moving spots of the universe. Their self-love, their personal desires don't fetter them. They can see their own God and they worship Him without those partitions which the narrow religious people and searchers build between themselves and God by dreaming to enter the new kingdom of kindness and love, but by staying with their own passions. Concentrate your thoughts, think about professor with the whole width of knowledge that opened to you, carry the entire purity and tranquillity of your hearts, and we will be able to enter the professor's little house.

Today both of you will understand practically what the effective meeting is. I need not the participation of your physical bodies which will be watching the fact, but I need the active power of your creative spirit, I need your Love-action, Love-concentrated attention on another man's life, Love – who has forgotten about himself as a body, Love – uniting with Spirit and Fire as the Light of the universe.”

Having opened his arms widely, I. pressed both of us to himself, and for a moment as though I was lost in bliss. When I. stepped back from us, I was dazzled, it seemed to me that I could jump over the whole eternity in this moment. I felt very strong, cheerful and happy. Such calm was prevailing within me, as if the whole earth and the whole heaven were greeting me with their song, while I answered them without feeling where my limits were to love and to respect them.

I looked at Bronski and I thought that I didn't know this man at all until this moment, that only now I understood how greatly talented he was – his eyes were shining with such fire, such power was spreading from his heroic figure.

We went to the professor's house in silence and bliss like three balls of love, but it seemed to me that we weren't going, but flying – so light I seemed to be to myself and so light my fellow-travellers seemed to me.

It was silent in the professor's house. Nikita met us in the hall, he saw off Laliya and Nina who bowed to us and soon disappeared in the dusk of the evening.

“Hello, Teacher, hello, my friends,” Nikita uttered by greeting us. “I did everything as you told me to, Teacher,” he addressed I.

“Great, dismiss nurse Gerda and tell her to go to sleep in her room immediately. She needs to calm down and to strengthen her organism. Both of you were so diligent during these days that you even failed to take into account how delicate the woman's organism was, you led her too far away and too quickly according to her experience and the level of her knowledge. Those limits would have sufficed for her, which I had determined for you. They were given to prepare her for the journey. Now, probably all of us will have to be delayed and wait until her organism regains the balance.”

Neither reproach nor blaming was heard in I.'s words, but we could feel very strongly that Nikita wasn't accurate by fulfilling that task of obedience which I. had given to him.

“Forgive me, Teacher, again my instability which I considered to be my kindness misled me. Nurse Gerda was asking me so much to help her to advance further than your instructed limits. She was persuading me that she had never been so strong and felt so healthy and self-confident. I couldn't resist her requests. I thought that I would help her to become more tempered and to prepare for the journey better. And only now I understood how I harmed her and maybe your entire business by delaying your caravan here. Forgive me, Teacher, my attention escaped the orbit of your task only for a moment, only for a moment I surrendered to my personal perception of this moment, I got under its influence and I made an irretrievable mistake by yielding to the personal man's request. Let it be the eternal lesson to me which I knew well in theory and in my dreams, but I didn't do well in the ordinary everyday actions. Now I will always be vigilant and I will always remember: my Teacher's sight and hearing, his knowledge and compassion are clearer, sharper and greater than mine. I have to walk in such a way as my Teacher sees, knows it and as he is leading me. Nurse Gerda wants to see and to speak to you. Can I invite her?”

“It would have been possible, my dear friend,” I. uttered especially tenderly, “if nurse Gerda, by staying in my set limits, had felt her part deeply in her acquired knowledge and gained the absolute, unshakable self-control. Now she looks like a boiling tee-kettle which throws out steam from all its cracks and pores. Accompany her to her home. Give my command to her, teach her during these several minutes

to understand your and her mistakes, and pass love and calm of your heart in such a way to her that she would understand that she needs to forget about herself, about her desires and to think only about the common great business for which she wants to serve and for which she wants to travel to the distant Communities. That isn't a picnic in the desert or oasis to see the luxuriant vegetation that is characteristic to the oasis of the deserts. That is the great power of Love which every planned traveller carries for joy and reconciliation of those to whom he is going. In order for them to be able to bring and to give their presents to their encountered people, they have to stand with the entire self-control and impartiality before those who are living and working around us. I have warned both you and Gerda: the lazy one not always may be accepted to the Community. He may be accepted only in that case when his laziness is caused due to his physical weakness which may be easily discerned in his aura. And such lazy person will never be untidy and slovenly. While an especially active and boring man who imagines that he is very diligent and temperamental may not rise higher than the first stage of the Community, because the slovenry of his spirit is hindering his self-control: he cannot do anything till the end, everything for him on a world scale – and in the end it goes flop. Go, my friend, we'll wait for you."

Oh, how I felt for Nikita who bowed silently and went to the house. From the bottom of my heart I understood how nobly heroic Nikita was for Gerda, how he wanted to help the woman, her requests excited him, he submitted to her and moved away from I.'s instructions. With my entire consciousness I was begging my compassionate friend Florentian to help Nikita to find the necessary words for sister Gerda, to lead her out to the highest joy: to understand her mistake, to bless the Light that showed it to her, to accept the lesson creatively by loving and overcoming obediently.

"You, Lovushka," suddenly I heard I.'s voice, "concentrate even stronger, while you, Stanislav, also wish Gerda and Nikita to perceive this moment not as a punishment or repentance, but as joy to become free of the illusory "expansion of consciousness." Not the cosmic Gerda's consciousness was expanding, not Nikita helped her, but her personality was expanding, and it dazzled both of them. Let this little lesson together with that what you've read in Ali's room illuminate everything for you what you will see in the distant Communities. Anxious people are living there who always feel enthusiasm for their spiritual wants and aspirations, and who don't have strength to forget them for the common welfare."

I. took our arms, and again I felt the bliss of Love, Calm, Joy and Fearlessness with which I was flying to Gerda in my thoughts, as if no partitions of space, time, form were left between me and her... It seemed to me that now all three of us were gliding above talking Nikita and Gerda who was crying, but I knew that we were singing the song of victorious Love for them...

I couldn't comprehend how much time passed. Again the whole eternity flew past for me. Having felt a tap, I saw me and Bronski standing in the same hall, and I heard I.'s words for Nikita.

"Amen, my friend. Let the knowledge remain within you forever that also kindness may not only harm a man's walking, but even lead to his ruin by taking him back from the highest to the lowest form. This time still nothing terrible happened. But some cases may be when a misunderstood kindness prevents the other man's self-control from developing. If your friend is unable to control his passions and irritation, you will be to blame yourself if you cannot calm him down and control yourself. And you will be to blame not for that what you see, that is for his temporary form, but you will be guilty for his eternal life, because your love contributed to his coming back along the stages of his eternal development. Your illusory compassion, your imaginary love for your friend in this case could be the cause of the difficult lesson of envy for other people's knowledge in his future incarnation. Also if your friend's behaviour next to you is in most cases full of the irritable strain and complete unrestraint, it might be that he will have to live not in the human, but in the animal's form during his future incarnation – you will be responsible both for him

and yourself. The spiritual path of communication – that's not the ordinary form of the narrow-minded friendship, one either glorifies the Only One or vulgarize the Eternity in it.

Now concentrate your thoughts on the path of that great soul whom you see in professor's body. Dedicate your entire, continuous attention to her, so that she could continue her earthly living and spread her loyalty to the science in the world not as her personal affair and achievement, but as great joy of the work for common welfare. Professor used to forget about himself during his entire life, but he wasn't thinking about the people who were living in the world together with him, too. He used to forget about himself, but he didn't forget about all his shortages and he was carrying them like a heavy burden, like an additional load to his science. Now we need to help this soul to find out about the free serving to his God, free, because His eternally free part is living within him and it may never be fettered by anybody. We need the efforts of all of our mind, spirit and heart, so that professor would understand it and create the life of a liberated being."

I. entered the house, and we followed him. Nikita lit up the light and... I almost turned into Lovushka Catcher of Crows. A man was lying in the bed, professor and not professor, if not a complete youth, then at least as young as he could be my friend. There wasn't any sign from that exhausted old man left whom I saw in the night, not to speak of the corpse that we carried out of the library.

I. went up to the patient's bed – now these words didn't suit at all the new professor's appearance -, showed where we with Bronski had to stand, so that we could see Zalcman's face better, and we put his hand on his head.

I was looking at the scientist's face attentively and the longer I was looking at him the clearer I could see that he was really the same professor, but his skin was even, without any little wrinkles, his hand was nice, with long, slender fingers, not of the old man, but of the young man in the flower of his age. I was so surprised that Nikita had to touch my shoulder, to take me back to reality and to remind me where and why I was here.

Professor smiled from I.'s touch, his face brightened up, but he kept sleeping. I. told him without taking his hand off his head.

"Wake up, my friend. You've already rested enough, you need to set to work."

Professor gave a start, he sat up in bed immediately, youthfully and he was looking surprised at I., me, unseen up to now Bronski and Nikita.

"Deuce take it!" he mumbled by rubbing his eyes. "Since I came to this damn country, the heat roiled my brain, exhausted me more than hunger, and it seems that my dreams want to drive me mad."

"Professor, you make pretensions to our dear and hospitable country wrongfully. Don't rub your eyes, you would rather tell us how are you now? Did our medicine help you?" I. asked him smiling.

Professor looked like fallen from the moon and he was staring at I. with his opened mouth and frightened eyes. I. took his helplessly drooped hand, he stooped and asked him.

"Don't you remember that Francisco took you to the Community, that you fell sick here from our sun?"

Zalcman kept silent for some time, then he gave a start and uttered.

"No, not from the sun, but from the woman who was burning in the house with her visual thoughts, and those living thoughts killed me. Where am I now? Yes, yes, I know you and... this Hercules. I've never seen the rest of you. But have pity on me! Do you do the hypnosis tests with me like Francisco?"

"I would be at least a demigod if I could hold you in hypnosis for as many hours as you were sleeping here calmly and preserve your life. Look around. You call Lovushka Hercules, but it seems to me that you are Hercules if we judge from that how your heart is beating and blood is flowing in your veins."

"Yes, yes, indeed as though I came back to the times when I was twenty-year-old. I can feel an unusual surge of power."

"That's why you shouldn't waste the time uselessly, get up and start the new, diligent work. You already know Lovushka, and here are my close friends – Nikita and Bronski. That's enough for the first acquaintance. You'll still have time to find out more about them. Now note that they are the same close, well-wishing people to you as everybody to whom I will introduce you here. Put on the robe which Nikita gives to you and run to the bath."

"Everything here is more than strange, doctor I. I comprehend well that you are doctor I. It is also clear that I am strong, as though young. It is also absolutely clear that... I want to eat, as if I hadn't eaten for three days and not went to bed yesterday evening. Only why my entire body itches, as if some mosquitos were stinging me badly, why I am all so stuck together, as if I hadn't washed myself during my entire life, I don't understand it in any way, simply I am indignant," Zalcman was talking by throwing up his arms, and his voice was echoing like the one of the opera singer.

He must have noticed it himself, again he looked at I. embarrassed and uttered.

"So what is going to happen next? I am talking as I am always used to, but only some lion's roar happens."

I couldn't hold anymore and I started laughing. Bronski who apparently was controlling his laughter laughed no worse than me.

"Well, look, this Hercules with his friend Zeus are laughing at me, while I tell you – give a beard to this giant, and he will be real Zeus."

Smiling Nikita offered professor to go to the bath as soon as possible. Me and Bronski bowed to Zalcman, asked him to forgive us and we made him sure that we didn't want to laugh at him, that I hadn't yet got rid of my laughableness and that it infected everybody.

Zalcman looked at me attentively, as though he immersed somewhere, he gave a sigh and uttered.

"You are young. Ah, how young you are! If I was as young as you are now! I could still do so much, it is so terrible that life is so short. You only began to think more seriously, understood something, and everything is over already, the old age came, and your work isn't finished till the end."

"It is enough for you to talk about old age when your heart is beating like this and it is crying: 'I am young, strong, I want to work.' Go to the bath, wash the desert dust, as you think, and the sticky sweat from the heat. Your young friends will help you to dress in our way, it will be much comfortable for you in this way. Wash, change your clothes, come back and eat your early breakfast. Look around, your short night has already passed, dawn is coming already," I. uttered by smiling tenderly, but only his lips were smiling, while his look was very concentrated and strict.

We left the room together with Zalcman. Nikita was leading the way. When I was judging about the little house by exterior I couldn't imagine in any way that it was so comfortable and spacious. Having entered the bathroom with the round pool to which the water was flowing through the lion's mouth straight from the wall, professor looked round and whispered.

"Everything is in such not European way."

He threw off his clothes with reluctance, but as soon as he got into the warm water of the pool, he gave a laugh of satisfaction and he began to splash in the lucid water.

"I never imagined that the bath could be such a bliss."

These words of his reminded me of my own experienced bliss recently, and I thought how unusually thankful I was to many people for those spiritual gifts in which I was diving during this entire time, starting from my acquaintance with Ali and his feast.

"My God! What is here? Why did such dirty water begin to flow suddenly? Something has happened to this water supply!" suddenly we heard professor's moaning.

The water was still flowing pure and lucid as before, but it was really unpleasantly greyish brown around professor. Zalcman noticed it and he was filled with indignation again.

"That isn't the water supply, that's your Oriental soap so nasty."

Nikita went up to the pool, took the soap from Zalcman's hands, soaped his hands and showed his white hands to him.

"That is neither water nor soap, professor. Your own body oozes out the sticky sweat. Probably I. will explain to you that it is the influence of our climate, the influence of our medicine and clearing of the organism, it is happening to everybody who is living in our Community next to such perfect people like Francisco, I. and others. As though it gives everything necessary for man's organism to eliminate spiritual waste from him," he uttered, invited professor to climb out of the bath and he was persuading him that not only today, but also during the next days or perhaps even years he would be washing obsolete emanations of his passions from his body, which his thoughts would liberate only gradually, so the cleaning organism would ooze out more and more of them.

Professor was very indignant at Nikita's words.

"Ah, so I am dirty?!" he gave a shout. "And my thoughts are unclean? And these goliaths here are clean?" he was indignant by pointing at me with Bronski.

"No," Stanislav answered him, "we aren't so clean as you are, professor, and the water was flowing almost black from us, especially from me."

This statement didn't calm professor at least a little, he got out all bubbling like the water in the pool. While I was helping him to dress, I was surprised how young and fresh his skin became, how even and young his hands were. Also I was surprised by my absent-mindedness why he looked so old and helpless to me when he was walking down the library, poured by the bright light of the Eastern day.

Professor was still indignant at everybody and everything, he was dressing the eastern clothes with vexation. He laced the sandals in such a way as I advised him to, because I had learned this art from Yassa in my own time. All of a sudden, he gave up his careful occupation, he put his left foot on the ground and lifted such childish eyes to me, which didn't understand anything, that I was prepared to press him to my heart like the smallest child by forgetting that he was famous European scientist.

"Tell me, dear Hercules, what is going on with me here," he addressed me in a trustful and tender way, although he was all bubbling before. "There was an uncured little wound on this foot for twenty years already, which always gave an irksome pain to me similar to the toothache. Now there isn't even a sign left from it. And also I don't feel any tiredness, but I am full of strength and energy. As though my youth had come back," he looked at his hands and continued by always asking me in the same way with his helpless eyes. "My hands were always red, because they were always frostbitten after I lost my gloves. There were some corns and lumps on them, and now they are even like yours. What is going on here? Indeed, I am very absent-minded everywhere, except my science. I paid attention neither to my feet nor to my hands when I got into the water. Is this pool really like Siloam springs and their water may cure the man in such a way that they would eliminate all his wounds and even return the youth strengths?"

"Now we'll go to doctor I." Nikita answered him instead of me, "and you will make sure during your conversation with him that no miracles exist in the world, only the levels of knowledge. Allow your new friends-goliaths, as you called them, to dress you as soon as possible. I. is waiting for us, besides it is time to eat for you."

"Yes, I want to eat. But I'm so worried about everything what is going on here that I cannot understand anything. Nothing intertwines into the logical chain in my thoughts, as if suddenly many holes had opened in my consciousness," he answered lost in thought.

"Allow me to take your arm, my dear professor," I told him. "I cannot compete with your mature and disciplined thoughts in any way, but I've experienced a lot of misfortunes and I understand your confusion which you feel now. Everything stuns you here, but nobody can disturb such gigantic spiritual power as you, whomever you would meet here. This hour of irritability that is tormenting you will pass and give the new harmony to you, with which you will see completely different I. than you saw and understood him up to now."

"Now the conversation with I. has become the culmination of my entire life. Now either I have to understand something what wasn't enough for my mind and what was inaccessible for it, or he has to make sure of lightmindedness of everything what he was telling me."

"Professor, I don't doubt," Nikita answered him by laughing, "that the strength of your youth which you can feel in your entire organism with amazement has passed also to your brain. Everything what seemed to you as the final result before now may seem as the beginning of your further achievements. But let's go, throw off all your doubts. Think neither about the past nor about the future, but only about this moment, about your meeting with I. You've overcome one of the most difficult of your journeys only for this goal, haven't you? Hence you also lived your entire creative life only for this goal with your devotion to the science and the shortages which accompanied it."

"Yes, yes, of course, everything is like that. I need to cast away all my thoughts about these never-ending questions and not search for any answers to them now. I need to concentrate my thoughts on the main point when I speak to your wise man I. whom you offer to me to see completely different," Zalcman gave a roguish smile and nodded to my side.

He took my arm, although he wasn't disposed to do it at all several minutes ago, and he was going with me by smiling merrily, as though he knew something special what nobody else except him suspected. Nikita took us to an absolutely different side of the house where the breakfast was prepared, but we didn't find I. there.

Chapter 15

First experiences of professor's new life. His conversation with I.

The scenes from his former lives. Francisco and once again shrimps

I had seen many people with great appetite, and my own appetite saw the ironical I.'s encouragement many times, but professor was swallowing the dishes in such a way that I could only wonder by being stiff like an idol and staring at him indecently. I. told that professor needed to sleep off for all his shortages. I thought that if he was going to eat like this, then he really would eat his fill for at least three of his future lives.

Finally he pushed away the plate with the last bit of melon and uttered.

"If now I hadn't observed with my own mind that I ate exactly as much, then I would have torn into pieces everyone who would have dared to tell me about such appetite of mine."

"I am glad that you've made sure with this trifle how much that what seems to be impossible turns out to be as the true reality," I. entered imperceptibly and said it to professor.

He extended both of his hands to completely embarrassed scientist, gave a joyous smile to him and invited us to the adjacent room. Surprised Zalcman found his tidily placed writing-books, notes, maps, books and dictionaries here which he left in his first dwelling, in that small house out of which Francisco took him in that night to remember for me.

"My God, everything is put in order, nothing is forgotten or thrown about. Who did all of it?" professor was asking by examining his scientific material nervously by dashing from the table to the shelves and then again to other tables and stools by surprising us with flexibility of his movements and his youth.

"Nikita with his nieces did it. They are experienced librarians whom you saw in the great hall of the library," I. answered him.

"Whom I saw not only in the great hall, doctor I., but also somewhere else. You know it well, too, but you don't want to notice it for the second time," Zalcman who was standing in the middle of the room told him, and as if a reproach rang out in his voice.

"Sit down, my friend. It will be useful for you personally and for everybody else present here to listen to our conversation," I. addressed the scientist, he moved a big, comfortable armchair to the table for him and he sat down on the one next to him. "Although you feel very strong, although the food made you stronger for many days, as it seems to you, eat this refreshing pill anyway. Now your rested thoughts acquired the possibility to move quicker and more precisely. Now your renewed nerves released so much spiritual energy within yourself that was chained before that your body, however it would seem to be renewed, won't have enough strength to submit to your will and to keep up with the work of your thoughts. It will take pains. This pill will give the possibility to it to withstand your spiritual energy, not to get tired and hinder her with its helplessness."

I. gave an orange little box to Zalcman, he smiled, took a little pill out of it, examined it ironically, swallowed it and announced.

"If my thoughts decided to fly with you not only around the earth, but also above it during our conversation, then anyway my body would have enough strength for many years and not only for this hour when we are talking. And besides, I hear it for the first time that spiritual matter would control the man's thoughts. Body, the matter of body gives power to the invisible matter of thought and creates the primary source and limits beyond which nothing exists. If sometimes I utter the usual word "God" from my childhood without thinking, then I utter it in such a way as if I said "wind" which I cannot see, or "ether" which I think I know, or any other hypothesis which isn't needed much and which is absolutely useless for science, for which talent and precise, real knowledge is needed, and not some metaphysical perorations."

"Namely here your first mistake is, because you are looking at the universe like a surgeon at the body placed before him, for whom his scalpel will be his last master and wonder-worker. That person achieves the miracle of knowledge as reality who managed to penetrate and perceive the part of Infinity within himself, who didn't submit to any measurements, decay and time, who formed the invariable and eternal basis of his life. Having come up to the source of spiritual powers within himself, a scientist comprehends where the entrance to that world of knowledge of a higher consciousness is, which he wants to give to people through the science applied in a special way, through the formulae obtained by the methods of mathematical calculations. Also he opens the new, simpler way to them to comprehend the

knowledge of the science of his field. If a geometer dedicated a half of his life only for searching for the multidimensional spaces and if he wasn't interested in any other forms of the mechanical movement, then he won't rise to that harmony in which two origins, two movements – body and energy – may reach the new point of contact. Because the new primary point of every branch of science – that's man's spiritual vision which he expressed by the signs perceived by his intuition.

You did everything what your mind was able to do in your work. Now you need to take advantage of the new opened power of your consciousness and enter beyond that limit, beyond that barrier where your mind is holding you. Your task is: not only to give important methods and facilitated ways to the people's minds of how to apply science in practice in the current moment of life, but also to open the new crack in people's minds, so that every man who comes closer to the science could understand the rising needs of mankind from the position of science not only in the current flow of time, but also could understand that cultural origin of science which leads people to uniting, which gives one more new possibility to perceive the unity of the whole life of the universe. The final matter with which you are accustomed to work, your own deduced formula of the new cohesion of the particles of your discovered new materials – that's nothing else as the same Only One matter about which you don't want to hear anything, the atoms of which are arranged differently in their eternal movement. You've discovered not the new materials, but the new ways of the atom revolution which other, not so attentive and faithfully devoted scientists could notice in this case. Your intuition, harmony of your entire essence, your devotion to the science gave the possibility to you to penetrate into that link of the universal Mind till the end. However, that doesn't mean that the link of this knowledge ends with it. People will discover new things and they will be spreading their achievements in the world again. You need to understand that not the matter of body was leading, is leading and will be leading you to your discoveries, but those break-throughs of your intuition which you are able to open within yourself as an enlightenment of your thoughts. Your consciousness - that's the path to the creation of the higher consciousness. And your made mistakes along the path are insignificant. You will see it yourself now. Your work may become a great push in the history of mankind, but "may" still doesn't mean that it "will" happen. Your thoughts, your heart have to feel the rhythm of the unstoppable Movement of the entire universe in order for this to happen. The matter of the visible items doesn't form the main background of the whole Life. The whole Life may not change depending on the form. The temporary, earthly form is changing depending on that part of Life which is expressed in it of those limits in which the human form may perceive the light as the kernel of his own foundation. And the clearer, the more precisely and widely this form perceived at which ratio and degree it is connected with the whole Only One matter of the universe, the deeper it may penetrate into the laws of this eternal Matter with its intuition. The wider the form may introduce these laws of the Eternal Movement into the everyday plane of the people's used conceptions as the certain branch of the science or the art. And the higher man's loyalty to the creation of his field is, the higher his service to people is, then he creates not grey, but radiating daily life to the greater mass of people. Now you've reached a deadlock. You got entangled in the nets of the matter, and it seems to you that the ravings about God, His wearing out through churches and religions has to do only with narrow-minded people who don't have enough strength to dare to live without the stupid hypothesis of God. According to your understanding if the creative life of nations developed successfully, then the evil would have disappeared in the world a long time ago. Those principles of the narrow mind would have pushed out the evil, which you call knowledge. Then benefit and practicality would keep every living being within the limits of good, and not a single man could be a thief or a murderer, because the knowledge would fill everything within him. But not everything within man is of the final nature, and a part of the eternal matter exists beyond all of that what is final within him, which doesn't submit to the influence of the final knowledge, final space and final time. This part of the eternal form submits only to the laws of eternity: to cause and effect. If you hadn't possessed this eternal part within yourself, if you hadn't come to the earth in the final form for many times already,

then you couldn't be here now where one of us is indebted to you from his past, from one of his previous lives lived next to you."

"Have pity on me, doctor I.,” professor told him angrily and sarcastically. “I was travelling here for the great science, now I came here to the most important conversation with the scientist and suddenly... I don't even know how I should evaluate your words. In my opinion of the man in his right mind, everything what you are telling me now, - that's a gibberish. Forgive me, but all of it began to smell of charlatanism."

I. smiled in the same way as they are smiling to small, silly children, he stood next to the indignant professor and told him.

"If you want to assert or to deny something, you need to have some weighty information, confirmed by your experience. Everything what I was telling you, - that's my life's experience. Do you want me to help you now to remember the small fact from one of your previous lives? Only tell me beforehand, are you really a great swimmer? Even being occupied so much, you would find some time for swimming and you've learned to swim perfectly. Why?"

"Because I was always passionately attracted to swimming, you've guessed it. It is also the truth that I've learned to swim perfectly and I did it even upon scientific fundamentals. Also the same truth is that I want to remember something from my past with your help, if only you succeed to fool me as Francisco did it once. But now I am not that helpless old man anymore, who could hardly drag his legs across the desert. I am sound and strong, and I hope that now nobody's will will break me down."

Professor was talking in a challenging way and with self-confidence, I. was smiling to him politely and compliantly. Nikita was nodding his head in a sad and reproving way, while Bronski looked like mad, as if he wanted to cry for Zalman: "Shut up!"

I. put his hands on professor's head, and the lightning change happened within him. A bliss appeared on his face, he leant easily against the back of the armchair and he got stiff as though by listening attentively to something distant and joyous.

All of a sudden, a weak and surprised voice was heard in the predominant, complete silence.

"I can see a strange, not European city by the sea... That's Japan!" he cried after a while. "My God., does this youth, devoted and pure, this Japanese who taught me to swim so well, now really has to drown only because I got a strong desire for winning the prize and because I dashed into the water without thinking? I swam out only because of his training. I incited him to compete for the prize, too, and now he won't swim out! Yes, I am tired, I am very tired," he uttered in a suddenly changed voice. "But I cannot leave him alone now in the danger after I involved him into this stupid game. Forgive me gods, guardians of science, that I couldn't finish the work dedicated to you. Acquit me for the destiny, but I must be noble. The youth has done so much for me. I am tired, oh, how I am tired now, I doubt whether I will help him. But anyway I swim to help him."

The silence became predominant in the room again. Only more frequent professor's breathing was heard, the stages of his entire stress and fight, even the horror was seen in his face. His breathing turned into a snort. For several moments it seemed to me that professor was in agony, that his heart wouldn't hold the desperate fight, but suddenly he became straight and he whispered.

"Well, we swam out, my friend. And I was already thinking that we wouldn't evade the shark and that the last wave would flood us. Glory to the gods, now we are on shore already. Let's lie down for a while."

I. made several movements with his hand, as though he pushed away some picture in the air, he looked at Nikita, and he went to professor's chair by submitting to his look. I. took Nikita's hand, put it on Zalcman's heart and uttered him by still holding his hand on his heart.

"Now you've gone through the scene of one of your lives which took place several centuries ago. Do you recognize your former friend in one of us for whom you saved his life?"

Zalcman opened his eyes, in the beginning as though he couldn't see anything and recognize anybody, then he looked round the room, smiled to us with Bronski by whispering "Goliaths" and only then he looked at Nikita who was standing next to him.

The scientist was very surprised, he raised his head, looked at I., once again at Nikita and uttered.

"According to the current appearance I cannot recognize my old friend and at the same time I can see the moving, shining band which connects the body by the sea with this man's body. The body there, on shore isn't left anymore, suddenly the fire flashed there, and now I can see that fire by Nikita's heart, throat and his eye-brows. What does it all mean? I don't understand anything, but I know with my entire consciousness that that Japanese friend of mine and Nikita – that's one and the same person."

"You've seen the essence, eternal and invariable, that little part of Eternity that is living unchanged in the temporary man's form. Will you now still be denying that you were already living on the earth and you know somebody from us not for the first time after you've made certain of your previous life experience by going through your already experienced heroic feeling once again?" I. asked him.

"No, I won't deny anything anymore, but I don't have the right also to assert anything, because I am sure that you've awakened some powers within me with your hypnosis," Zalcman answered him.

"If you think that I can transport you to the distant land with the power of my hypnosis, then you are enough great scientist and you know well that nothing happens from anything. In order for me to bring your recollections to your senses, I had to see them in the memory of your subconscious. When you were looking at Nikita you felt some excitement many times, which awakened tenderness and favour inconceivable to yourself. Did I understand your feelings rightly?"

"Clear and precise. But how could you guess them?"

"We'll talk about it later. Having seen your thoughts and your feelings, I was following the course of your and Nikita's previous lives. By following the shining and crossing lines of the eternal matter of spirit, I found that scene which you've experienced now. Do you dare and want to see your connection with me? I ask you, do you dare, because such pages in previous lives of every man exist when even the boldest hearts are struck with horror by looking at them. The page of the past of your connection with me – that's one of the most horrible and sad from all your lives."

"If you had told me that I could see some beautiful deeds of mine, then I must have remained indifferent to them. I can imagine that I did them, but to believe that I could do something mean to you, to absolutely strange man to me, this is as stupid as to suspect that I could kill a child," Zalcman burst out laughing. "Please, doctor I., show the pages of my crimes to me," he added by shooting glances at I. sarcastically and by shouting with laughter even louder.

Now he seemed to be mischievous to me, but I understood his entire ignorance, my heart felt very sorry for him and she didn't condemn him at all. I looked at I. His face was very serious. He didn't answer anything to professor's laughter, but he said to him silently by looking at him sadly.

"I warn you once again: you will have to see one of the most horrible scenes of your life, you need to concentrate your entire attention and your entire manly courage on that. Call all the highest in whom you believe for help and answer me once again: do you want to see your connection with me in one of your lives by paying no heed to the fact that it will arouse a horror for you?"

"Your face is so strict, your voice is so serious that they could frighten even a very brave man, but I am so certain that I could never be undignified that I want to know my connection with you. I have to confess a rather strange thing to you: when I saw you for the first time, as if a guilt for you flashed within me. I felt very uncomfortably, and only your really chivalrous politeness calmed me down."

"Be strong, look and remember forever that what you will see now. Carry out more expanded consciousness from this lesson, from this horror lesson. Comprehend the role of love in the movement of man's spirit forever. Appreciate the real power of love for people's encounters and their compassion one to another. Understand and remember that what a "people's encounter" is."

Again I. placed his hand on professor's head. My dear friend's and Teacher's face was shining with such beauty which I had already seen many times from that time in the steamer after the storm when he was standing with me on the deck. While holding his hand on Zalcman's head, he said to him so tenderly and affectionately as only the real mother could do it.

"I've forgiven everything to you a long time ago, my poor brother. Everything what man is doing along his path, everything divides his days into pain and joy, into power and weakness, into sadness and smile. Wellbeing doesn't just exist, only the laws of Eternity exist: accuracy and regularity. You cannot avoid consequences, but you can find the flame of the great Love within yourself, and all consequences will become only happiness to know how to pass your power, the greatest power – joy, so that the whole evil of passions and vices would become calm and help, warning and protection for your encountered person."

Again an absolute silence became predominant in the room. I joined with Florentian in my heart and in my thoughts by begging him to help professor in his hour of horror, and I didn't doubt that it would be horrible for him after I.'s words. I had never heard anything like this from him before...

A cry, a muffled cry of the man who was experiencing horror made me give a start. I looked at Zalcman's face and I flinched even more. As though I saw a panorama, the whole row of revealed and sinking views. I saw a house by the sea, a valley where it was standing, a cosy room in which a prosperous family was having supper. I saw the guest who came during the supper and he was stroking a small, handsome boy in an especially pleasant way. How terrible, I understood that the boy who was snuggled up to the guest credulously was I., while the guest was... Zalcman, although they didn't remind me of anything by their current appearance. He was a rude Greek, he must have had a great influence to the whole family. I understood that the hosts, especially mother was afraid of some enemies, while the guest calmed them and persuaded them to go to bed calmly by laughing at their fears. The guest asked them for the boy to go with him, but his mother responded him categorically which aroused his great dissatisfaction.

By hiding his anger with much difficulty for this answer, the guest left by leaving the difficult presentment of disaster and horror in the family. Soon, after having prayed for God, everybody went to bed, and the darkness covered the house.

The guest left the big and beautiful garden of his friends, he waited until the last light went out in the window, he gave a silent whistle and turned round the corner of the street. A short man with dark cloak appeared before him, the first one told him to depict a sign on the white gate of the house with black paint.

A company of robbers showed up on the street after some time and they dashed at the gate marked with the paint. They killed the watchman awakened by the noise instantly, but his cry warned the hosts in the house, and they began to run to the sea across the garden by hoping to save themselves with boats... The robbers caught up with them in the valley, but the very sea and... the hood of the cloak slipped off the head of one of the robbers accidentally and uncovered his face. That was the guest who visited the house, now he lifted the sword over the hostess and killed her. The boy dashed to help his mother, but the sword's blow reached him, and he fell down on his mother's body...

"Stop this horror, or I will go mad!" professor's voice was heard, which was breaking my heart.

"Hold tight, my friend. My love doesn't know any limits of compassion. I am happy to be able to help you now to leave the circle of those terrible lives forever where man's loyalty is swaying, where he is searching for the truth, he wants to get to the Light, but he is always plunged in anger, hypocrisy and falsehood by searching only for his personal life in a certain form, but not for life for the common welfare. Stand up, go with me to another room, there you will find strength to read one of the records of centuries. It will tear off all your hesitations and at the same time it will dictate the new rhythm of movement for you, which you certainly need now, so that you could finish your excellent work. Your work – isn't the task of this only life, but of many of your lives, it is the result of your searching and sufferings in them."

"I will go everywhere you will tell me to, but only when you forgive me," sobbing scientist fell down on his knees and uttered. "I understood that you were the boy whom I killed. How horrible..." he kept sobbing.

"Calm down, you didn't kill the boy, he only fainted away. He came to life, he stayed alive and got into such hands, such encounter which he wouldn't have found so soon without your terrible help. Be blessed. Let's go, the time doesn't wait. No need to waste the time uselessly for tears and sadness."

I helped Zalcman to stand up, he wiped away his tears, pulled back the heavy portiere, behind which the door was seen, which we didn't even suspect that it existed, and he left together with Zalcman.

I looked at Bronski. The actor was sitting with his face covered with his hands, from under which the streams of tears were flowing. Nikita came up to him, put his hand on his shoulder and told him very silently.

"You cannot cry during the moments of the soul's greatest suffering, in the same way as you cannot cry during the moments of your own greatest suffering. In order for the heart of the suffering soul to rise cleaned and liberated from the pain which you observe, you need that also your heart wouldn't lose her creative powers and skills. And you can do it only with your complete self-control. Remember this every time when you are suffering yourself or when you become the witness of the strange suffering:

Only those cry who don't possess the power of love and courage to think about others and who think only about themselves.

Only those cry for whom the earth, its provided dwelling, its attachments, its encounters make the only one and the strongest foundation.

Only those cry who are unable to open the fire of Creator within themselves, that little part of His with which man is associating with his own people, which is the only path of beauty for him and which is the whole essence of the man's living on the earth.

Only those cry who consider their tears to be an exceptional virtue and who cannot penetrate into their own centre of Love from which the man's connection with another man, with his Teacher, with God arises. God is Love, and tears don't go with His Light."

After some time the door opened, I. appeared in it and he called Nikita. We stayed alone with Bronski, we sat down one next to another, and I asked him what he saw and why he was crying.

"I didn't see anything, Lovushka. I only understood that horror is holding every one of us in its clutches which is called the past. Actually, I was crying for Zalcmán, for every one of us and for myself, for that great ignorance which is so difficult to throw off."

"Stanislav, Nikita explained to us now how we need to strain all the strength of our thoughts in a heroic way, so that professor would pass to the new creation of spirit. Stop worrying, concentrate your attention and I will tell you what I saw from the story of I.'s and scientist's lives."

I told him everything what I saw now and I added that I knew the sad story from I.'s childhood from himself. Both of us concentrated strongly our thoughts on Florentian and when I. with professor came back to our room, we bowed low to his suffering in the past and to his shining fire of Joy in the present.

The scientist's face was radiating. The man's youth which surprised me in the bath already now revealed his entire beauty, he was pleasant and so calmed, as though he hadn't experienced and known anything in his life, except happiness.

"I let you to Zeiched, my friends," I. said to me and Bronski. "Take the camels from him and rush to Francisco, call him to come to me, to the Community."

We bowed to our Teacher, we found Zeiched, got on the camels and we scuttled to Francisco with the greatest pleasure, happy like some little schoolboys.

We found him among the shrimps who were working tediously. We saw Francisco through the window, but we didn't notice the shrimps, so we broke into the room like a whirlwind, and the little ones met us very unfavourably, some of them covered their work with their hands and green aprons.

"You frightened my little ones," Francisco told us with his tender smile, "and at the same time you frightened the birds who were posing for them. These little ones – the best jewellers in the world and they achieve the subtlest peaks of the art in their work. Unfortunately, their eyes are created in such a way that they can do only one thing: to place white peacocks in a mosaic on any items, but they produce the little boxes from all sorts of metals with the background of enamel of different colours."

Francisco showed several stunning works to us, the examples of which I had already seen on my brother Nikolay's note-book, in I.'s and Ali's hands, besides, I had several little boxes myself.

Noble Francisco's politeness when he was trying not to show us that he could see our embarrassment due to our stupid, childish behaviour helped us to control ourselves, and I told him.

"My tongue doesn't turn over to beg you pardon when you, dear Francisco, have already pardoned us. I think that I will express my own and Stanislav's feelings if I thank you for your indulgence for our childishness. We came running so happy to you by enjoying beforehand the joy of taking you and coming back together to I.'s in the Community."

"Thank you, my dear. Today your camels will come in handy, and not to me, but to two unfortunate people. I. sent you here just in time. Wait for me for several minutes in my room. I will calm my little ones, I will give instructions regarding your camels, and my travellers and I will come back to you."

We went to Francisco's room in such restrained way now, as though we were walking down the sacred and glass ground.

"How I cannot control myself," Bronski uttered with annoyance. "My nerves are like old keys, they wince from the slightest touch."

"Stanislav, your nerves may be compared at least with the keys. I felt worse than an old guitar. Touch one string – all of them will buzz, you cannot separate any of them."

Both of us wanted to be silent for a while. We sat down on low Francisco's chairs and soon we felt light, blessed and especial silence of his room! It seemed that everything in this room was telling me: "Love and you will experience happiness."

"Lovushka, everything in this room tells me: "Search, search, work by loving and you will reach knowing that everything is happiness," I heard Stanislav's voice.

I didn't have time to answer anything to him – Francisco was already standing in the door and smiling to us. He looked attentively at Bronski and told him.

"Yes, yes, my friend. Not only this, but several more lives of yours will pass by always searching. All your searching – everything will be Love which you will carry to people through the art. Search not only for the ways how to convey the new methods of perception and to pass the works of genius of the great creators, but also how to expand the hearts of the masses, how to draw them into such harmony that everybody would penetrate into your uttered word with his heart, into your created actions. Let the door of your heart open as widely for each of your encounters as I open the door of my heart for you now."

Francisco went up to Bronski, he embraced him, took him to his red table and lifted its lid. Like during the first time I saw the cups standing in a semicircle, among which the red one with the burning fire in it was distinguished. Having taken this cup into his hands, Francisco put it on kneeling Bronski's head.

"Your tears were pouring many times, my son. Many times you had to pass the black pearl into the string of Father Life. Your spirit doesn't need to be worried. Both reddish and black pearl – everything is the Only One Life, the Only One Joy. You've sacrificed a lot of work, health and efforts during your lives by carrying and giving the elements of nobility to the masses, help to people by searching for the art within yourself, and not for yourself within the art. Your art has awakened the new channels of knowledge within people, helped those who were looking for the art within themselves to find God there. Let your path be illuminated also by my help from now on. You will travel to the distant Communities, you will see the abyss of people's heartbreak and blindness. You will understand there that a person who was searching for Light during his entire life may be walking next to it, he may come up to its limit and anyway not reach the liberation from his superstitions, not have enough strength to see that what another person who is lower with his knowledge and advantages not only can see, but he crosses the limit and acts. Experience suffering and joy of the heroes whom you represent on the stage, so that you would awaken people for the new aspirations of beauty with your highest nobility. By loving without any limits of form and time, carry your fire of God and destroy conditionalities within people. Let the heartbreak be born after people see you. That is only their form, their path, because they cannot tear their conditionalities to pieces in any other way. The form of your own path – that's not the Earth, not its laws, but Infinity where work – that isn't a conditionality, but the path of the ages, and sound and word in it – that's not the sign of the external call which you carry to people, but an action of your heart, the fire which I take into my cup and pour into your heart."

I heard Stanislav's moan. I saw how he fell on his knees by Francisco's feet like hit by the bullet, but in a moment strong Francisco's hands raised him and he touched the red cup extended to him with his lips.

My God, what kind of face it was! For the second time I saw God in an ordinary man, in Bronski's face, exactly as I saw it recently by seeing off Beata. Without comprehending what I was doing, I went up to Bronski and bowed to him till the ground.

As though I disappeared somewhere, I saw Florentian for a while, I felt his powerful embrace and I came to myself when Bronski put me on the sofa.

"It is nothing, you worry in vain, that's not a fit at all," I heard Francisco's voice, "that's his award for his selfless love for you, for his respect for your suffering and for your work of the ages. Well, he's already opened his eyes, his eyes are joyful and they don't look like the ones of the patient at all."

I understood that Francisco saw everything what happened to me. Since he didn't say anything about it to Bronski, I understood that I had to keep my current experience in secret.

"Now we'll visit the children in the dining-room, we'll talk to them a little and only then we'll go to I.'s. Calm down, my dear, we'll be in time everywhere and we won't make anybody wait for us," he added when he noticed Bronski's anxiety due to our delay. "You are worried that I. sent you here with the camels and you think that these quick animals are meant to bring me to the Community as soon as possible. Stanislav, you are worried that you aren't carrying out I.'s order precisely enough," Francisco addressed the actor again. "Concentrate, think about I., and when we are going to the Community, on our way I will try to help you to orient yourself in your thoughts which will accumulate till that time and to find the right solutions of the question that worries you now."

We entered the dining-room where the children and the shrimps were drinking milk with the sweet bread. Unexpected appearance of the favourite of all of us aroused the wave of joy not only among the children and the shrimps, also the sisters and the brothers of the Community who were on duty here were glad.

Wherever, whenever Francisco used to show up unexpectedly, no discipline could hold the little ones – they used to throw down everything, dash to him and stick all round him like the bunches of grapes. I was observing this view of the unstoppable people's attraction to Francisco many times, I experienced it myself, I was worried that his sickly body wouldn't hold the weight of the shrimps, and it always finished with the same outcome: the little people used to press themselves to their friend, put their hands together like for a prayer, stand in a semicircle round him and wait until he would begin to speak in the absolute silence. Also this time the same scene repeated, only today it affected me especially strongly.

I thought by looking at the touched children's faces and at the same excited shrimps, from whom some of them even went down on their knees by whispering something or they were gasping with their terrible mouths opened, as if they had run ten versts, or they were extending their hands pleadingly by wishing to draw Francisco's attention: what a terrible view it would be if I was looking at it only with my physical eyes! A company of the charming children merged with the most terrible degenerative shrimps to whom I could hardly bring myself to give a human name!

What a giant of spirit this man had to be, so that without any power, by overcoming only with his love he could control that little sparkle of God which was still smouldering in these unfortunate living beings and that he would interest them in beauty about which they hadn't heard anything during their entire miserable life.

I was trying to penetrate into the very essence of this Love Giant's meeting with the shrimps. Grandeur of the heroic deed of this man surprised me, who dedicated his entire life, not only soul to educate the spiritual invalids, it was like the phenomenon of heroism which was absolutely impossible and unimaginable for me.

"Hello, my little friends," Francisco's voice interrupted my reflections. "Why are you so excited today and don't listen to your careful nurses? Were all of my words told yesterday to you really useless? Yesterday you promised me to be calm in the dining-room until I came. Well, I came here, while you didn't keep your word."

"These angriest here are to blame for everything," one of the most degenerated shrimps uttered by lisping and breaking his words. He pointed to the small shrimp with pleasant, kind face who was holding a small, handsome, sickly boy in his apparently strong arms.

A small girl who resembled that boy very much was standing next to them and she was trying to help the shrimp to hold the boy. You could feel care for another's health and life already in her current age, so I was very surprised that somebody could accuse these children who seemed to be so innocent, so helpless and silent.

Francisco was looking at the accusing shrimp in silence, he shouted by looking straight at Francisco's eyes even in more impudent and angrier way.

"You are stupid, you imagine that everybody here believes in you. All of them are talking that you are pretender and liar, that you deceive all of us. You promised us that today we would see a miracle, but you came late and you don't show any miracles to us."

He roared with nasty laughter and he began to grimace so disgustingly that I could hardly remain calm. The fiery Francisco's look flashed like lightning when he looked at the degenerate.

"I've already told you many times not to lie and harm your friends, you miserable man. You accuse the calmest children and their friend whom you robbed, you took the dolls from them and you broke their toys. They didn't bear a complaint against you, while you even defamed them by showing your gratitude for this."

"Who told you that I took their stupid toys? These boys there did it, search their beds, you'll find everything there."

Two eight or nine year old boys accused by the degenerate took offence and they were already prepared to burst into tears, but Francisco extended his hand to them, smiled and stood them next to himself. In the same way he also called the accused, pleasant shrimp with his ward children to himself, and they happy sat down by Francisco's feet.

The same five degenerate shrimps like the angry shrimp grouped next to him. The degenerate who was speaking impudently to Francisco now cried even in a more challenging voice.

"Why do you keep us here? We don't want to live here, in your stinking house. We want to come back to our own home, from where you've taken us, we want to come back to our freedom, to our owls and snakes. We are bored with your ugly flowers and with all your pretenders. Let us go to our freedom, our masters called us three times already, and we cannot go out from here."

"Who is holding you? There are neither locks nor angry watchmen here. All of you may go wherever you want to. Right now, today I send you back to your masters, to that distant forest where snakes and owls are protecting you."

Francisco didn't finish these words when all five shrimps who surrounded the rioter jumped back from him with the screams of horror and they began to beg Francisco not to send them away, they promised never to lie, steal and idle. It was clear to me that also the malicious creature was frightened himself, but his enraged, scapegrace stubbornness had already taken him so far away that he didn't want to step back.

"You boast of sending away all of us, but will you have enough courage to send at least me alone?" the rioter was crying as though by inviting Francisco to fight against him.

"No, miserable, poor friend. I won't send you alone, but together with your friend whose commands you fulfil with pleasure. Come here, little coward, who hide behind strange backs," Francisco uttered to the space, as it seemed to me. "Obey right now," the voice that uttered these words reminded me of Ananda's clank of swords.

Such a terrible shrimp came out from under the table in another end of the room that it was already impossible to imagine an uglier human being. Moreover, it was difficult to decide whether he was a man. He rather reminded me of a monstrous dog who was walking on two legs due to the nature's error.

His exceptionally big eye-brows had fallen on his small, red eyes. His big, dishevelled beard and moustache covered his entire face and mouth up till the ears, and also his ears were big and they hung like the dog's ones.

I was surprised that children weren't afraid of the degenerate at all, but the shrimps became worried and they were hiding behind Francisco. Only the rioter remained in the middle of the room, he looked like a snow-man who was melting in the sun, so his entire impudence and mischievousness were melted.

The small scarecrow was nearing slowly, as though he told his feet to turn back, while Francisco's look made his feet go forward. When he was passing by his friend, a hellish anger and hatred flashed in his eyes. He extended his hand and wanted to hit his head, but Francisco made a hardly noticeable movement with his hand and the whole power of the blow was received by the head of the terrible degenerate himself. Having cried with pain, he wanted to attack Francisco and he was about to hit his stomach with his head, but in the same moment he fell down on the floor with his nose hurt badly with blood.

"Poor, poor thing, I feel so sorry for you, but I cannot help you in any way. Take your friend who wanted to serve you and not me, and go with him to your masters."

A horror flashed on the first bully's face, but he came to himself immediately and uttered a shriek.

"How are you going to send us away from here if we don't know the way ourselves?! Besides, we want to travel to an absolutely different place, not to our previous masters. We want to go to the free tribe in the caves."

"You will go there from where I've taken you. I didn't want to take you. Both of you were begging me to save you, you told me that you were tired out, that death threatened you. I could see your falsehood, but I thought that the Light into which I would bring you would help you to wake up. All of your friends became kind, only both of you didn't succeed to become free of the demons of anger. I would give a lot so I could save you from the horror of your existence, but it is impossible to liberate anybody from his chains by force. You aren't children. Many tens of ruined lives oppress your conscience. In spite of everything, Compassion gave a possibility to you for existence of joy, but also here you couldn't live without

falsehood and treasons. All the pure hearts who associated with you weren't afraid of you, because there wasn't even a hint of that evil within them which expanded within you. You were helpless before them. And now these little people are praying without any fear for you by sending you help and protection. Only those who were touched by evil are afraid of you, they hide behind my back, because their hearts already possessed the evil and attracted your evil to themselves. Remember it. Perhaps this lesson of children's fearlessness will help you in your life with your vicious masters. Don't be cowards, and your life will be easier. Don't ask me again to leave you here. You've already promised two times for me that you would be fighting against your inclination to falsehood, theft and treasons. Today your third plot had to happen, you dared to make an attempt on my temple and when you didn't succeed to do it, you robbed the children and sisters as much as you could. I can grant the only one and last compassion to you: when you cannot bear it anymore, say my name and defend yourself with my image from your enemies. See my image in your thoughts and, if there's no hypocrisy in your hearts, if they are full of prayer for me, you will see how my image will stand between you and your enemies, and they won't be able to harm you. That is all what I can do for you. And your requests which I can see already are absolutely unnecessary. There's a limit for everything – you've run out of Compassion. Step aside to the window and wait there until the time comes to get on the same camels with which I brought you here."

Francisco turned to the shrimps who were pressed to him, who supported the degenerate aggressively not so long ago and uttered.

"You heard my words: "There's a limit for everything." Be careful and vigilant in order not to run out of Compassion. Be vigilant with people, because everyone of you knows how many times he was traitor in his life, how many times he promised to himself and others to be loyal in all his affairs and encounters and how many times this loyalty turned into dust which could be blown away by the faintest wind. Go to your work. Thank life for the Light and calm again, which cover you while you are living here. Make certain again how cowardliness is followed by hypocrisy, while fearlessness is always living in pure and fair heart."

Francisco left the cheered up and calmed shrimps go, he blessed the children, helped some of the kneeling ones to stand up, covered the smallest ones with kisses and told them.

"Remember how you saw today that the thief who stole your toys punished himself by hitting his head with the head which stole the toys. Remember that image for your entire life and always know: the strange thing won't bring you anything, except evil. Love one another, forgive one another, don't peach one on another. Help each other in all difficult work, try to make everybody's daily burden easier, and your days will burst into bloom with joy."

Having told all the children and the shrimps to go to play, except those two whom he told to wait by the window, Francisco left us in the dining-room with the brothers and sisters on duty and he left.

Me and Bronski sat down on the bench from which we could see well both little criminals. What a terrible couple! I wouldn't have found any similar view and disappointment in any *kunstkamera*, which I saw in those two faces if one could use this word at all when talking about these two scarecrows.

The rogue sat down on the floor with his hands on his head, he was swaying to sides and howling like a dog by the dead body. And the angry shrimp's eyes were sparkling. Full of anger he always tried to hit his enemy, a friend not so long ago, with his hand or foot, but the blows always fell on himself, and it made him completely furious.

Finally, after having lost his self-control completely, he really flew into a rage, he seized the carving knife from the table and hit the first shrimp's back with all his might. But the knife slipped off without hurting him and it stuck in the floor by cutting through the slipped villain's shoe.

This scene came upon all of us who were in the dining-room as a shock, except the always howling and swaying first shrimp. It seemed that he couldn't see and feel anything around him, except his misfortune.

"Look, Lovushka, what a horror. The villain is trying not to pull the knife out, but to pull his hands from the knife, as if an invisible power bent him to the ground. That not only makes him furious, but also strikes him with horror," Bronski was whispering.

Exactly in this moment the door opened and Francisco came in. The shrimp who was howling and swaying up to now stopped immediately and he staggered timidly across the whole room to Francisco.

"I understood, I understood everything, saint father, also before I knew that you were saint, but I was very angry with you. Now it is already absolutely clear to me that you are saint, while I am ruined. Now you protected me," he pointed at the knife and the shrimp who was rolling on the floor. "There," he waved somewhere to the space, "nobody will save me. I am ruined. Here, take it, the old man gave it to me whom you told to teach me writing. He hung it and told me that it was the cross and that it would save me from disaster. But as you can see it yourself, it didn't save me. The disaster came, and it didn't save me," the poor thing was almost whispering.

I really felt sorry for him, and the tears were already prepared to pour from my eyes.

"This amulet didn't save me, probably it is not meant for the bad ones. It is of the kind ones, and you are kind, take it, it will save you," he was pushing the cross into Francisco's palm with his trembling hands. "Ah, I would need an amulet of the bad ones: with the eye of the snake, then I wouldn't be ruined, it would protect me. But that amulet is costly, I cannot afford it. I am ruined. Forgive me, if you can. I understand what you were talking about loyalty. Only now it is too late, if he didn't kill me here, they will kill me there," again he pointed at the villain who was lying on the floor.

"My poor brother," Francisco uttered silently, so tenderly and affectionately, so much inhuman kindness and love were in his words that tears were rolling down my cheeks, and I was prepared to fall before Francisco's feet and beg him to take pity on the shrimp. "Not you alone are to blame that life here was too difficult for you," Francisco continued after being silent for a while. "I didn't resist your requests and I took you here with myself, although I saw that you were still not prepared. And I take your whole fault upon myself. Here's the amulet which you are dreaming about. Only don't think that it is of the bad ones. That is the amulet of Great Love, she sends it to you to help and to save you. If you are carrying it on your hand and if you keep your heart pure, then not a single bad one will be able to hit you, to enslave your will for evil. But for this to happen you have to remember me, I will help you often in the difficult hour. You have to remember three things:

Not to steal anything from anybody.

Try to pour tranquillity everywhere by carrying my image in your heart.

Not only not to kill people, but never beat both people and animals.

Then my bracelet will be protecting you. If you are going to live as I told you now, then not only you will see me, but also you will come back to me."

Francisco took the red headscarf out of his pocket, he unrolled it and took out the beautiful childish bracelet-snake which bit its own tail. The red ruby was burning in the snake's head. Francisco fastened the bracelet on the shrimp's hand, and there weren't any limits for his happiness. He was kissing Francisco's feet and hands, he was laughing and crying at the same time.

"But remember that that's the Great Love which sends the present of her loyalty and help to you. This is the amulet of the kind ones which overcomes the evil with pure love. Stand up and come here," Francisco commanded the shrimp who was lying on the floor in a ringing voice.

"You can see that I cannot do it, there's no need even to try it. My back almost broke, I cannot get straight," he answered him, as if by spitting curses.

"Stand up, I told you," again Francisco's voice was heard, and once again I remembered Ananda and his clank of swords.

As if lifted by the spring, the shrimp jumped up from the ground and went up to Francisco immediately, without any delay. Strange things were happening to him. He took the first steps enraged by coiling, as if he was trying to throw some ropes off his shoulders and arms, then he stopped and in the midway he became even shy, what I didn't expect at all from this beast. When he came up near Francisco, a begging, fascination and amazement got stiff in his horrible eyes. Such expression drew even this degenerate nearer to the human name.

Francisco was looking at him in silence for a while by always holding that red headscarf in his hands from which he unwrapped the bracelet for the first shrimp. Then suddenly, with a quick movement he flung the headscarf on the shrimp's head, and uttered silently and clearly by not taking his eyes off the tamed villain.

"Lovushka, clean the unfortunate thing's face and hands with my headscarf."

I was so unprepared for Francisco's address to me, I was so involved in observing of the action instead of acting myself with my spirit that I didn't even comprehend instantly and I delayed. Stanislav gave me a twitch.

I rushed to fulfil my kind friend's command, I cleaned the shrimp's face and hands by calling Florentian to help sincerely. The shrimp didn't protest at all as I expected it from him, but having understood that I wanted to clean his hand higher, he rolled up his sleeves till his elbow himself, he stretched out his second hand, and when I finished, he gave a laugh, satisfied. He looked at Francisco timidly and pushed the headscarf in my hands.

"Clean his neck, the upper side of his chest and tie the headscarf on his neck," Francisco uttered again in the same silent and clear way.

When I fulfilled this instruction, too, he addressed the shrimp who was holding the corners of the headscarf with both of his hands. It seemed to me that now he didn't have anything dearer than this headscarf. He didn't take his eyes off Francisco and he was catching his every word by trying to understand with all his might the meaning of that what he heard.

"I give this headscarf to you, so that you would understand: I don't push you away now in the same way as I didn't push away your requests and vows for the first time, and I took you here from your terrible masters, their owls, enchanted paths and snakes. You stated me that you were intelligent, the most intelligent one from all the shrimps, that your masters designated you, the most intelligent, deftest and the most cunning as the chief of the whole company. You tried to prove to me that you understood with your mind the use of being honest, that you wanted to live in the free world among peaceful and not

angry people. I knew that you won't be able to live in the world of the kind ones, but I took pity on you, I took pity on you from the bottom of my heart, although my mind said to me that I was wrong, that I wouldn't save you, but that after crossing the limit of the actions allowed to me, I would pile a heavy burden on myself which nobody told me to carry, that I would accumulate debts and obligations which nobody told me to take upon myself. Exactly that happened what my mind showed to me. My Love wasn't functioning in harmony with it, and I have to accept that blow from you which nobody else except myself prepared for me. You cannot understand it, because your love is sleeping, while you are unable to awaken and liberate it among peaceful, kind brothers who favour you. Now you are withdrawn from the angry ones and misfit among the kind ones. Your situation is difficult. By wishing to make it easier for you, I gave this headscarf to you. Remember that you won't be able to lie and to beat others, to steal and to rob as you did it up to now without any consequences for yourself anymore. Your each hit for a living being will come back to yourself with the double power and it will hit that place in you where people's heart is beating, because your love is sleeping, and you don't know where it is within man. So your blows for others will fall to your heart, they will show that place to you with which people love, grieve, feel sorry for others and help them. Protect this headscarf. All your bad deeds and thoughts will leave some stains and holes on it. All your kind deeds will help you to keep it sound. Remember that until you have at least a little scrap of it, your bond with me will be strong. If the headscarf becomes used up and your good deeds don't cover even the palm, then your bond with me, your last hope to save yourself will be ruined. And only you yourself will be to blame for that. You will leave to your horrible forest. If you don't perform three repentances which I give to you now, then you won't survive even a year among your snakes and owls, they will peck out your eyes and strangle you, which you could see many times and you were glad to see the others' suffering.

My first repentance for you – when they send you to tempt a doubting man of shaken honour with riches and power by using the science of your dark masters, you explain everything to him, where you are taking him, to whom you are taking him, along what nasty way you will be taking him.

My second repentance – if the man doesn't listen to your warnings and he wants to go to your masters anyway by searching for the shining path of riches and disgrace for himself, stop when you bring him till the path of snakes and warn the man whom you are leading again by holding strongly on my headscarf with both your hands and thinking about me, about this moment, about the moment of your liberation from slavery and coming back here. Tell him that nobody who has entered the path of snakes is able to come back to the bright and free life anymore, that the snakes only let go to the forest, but they don't allow anybody to come back without enslaving his will and killing the last possibility within him to come back to kindness.

My third repentance – revalue the whole man's imagination of happiness and power not with your mind, but with your soul which now began to burn within you in a hardly visible little light. Remember that strong is not that one who can tell lies cleverly, but that one who is bold, strong and who can live with the truth. Not that one is strong who knows how to forge a protective amulet and to charm it on the evaporating blood, but that one whose love is able to protect one from all the amulets of evil, because his heart is pure.

Go with God. Don't cry. Poor thing, for the first time not the tears of rage, but the tears of pity are pouring from your terrible eyes. For the first time you understood where the storage of Love within man was. I extend the power of my Love to help you. Pave the path every day, along which you will be able to come back here some time. Try to understand that man himself creates his entire happiness or misfortune. Now leave. My friends will help you to get on the camels. Don't worry, the clever animals didn't forget the way to the forest. I warn you once again: if you try to exhaust the animal, he will throw you down, and the beasts of the desert will eat you. With this disgraceful, shameful death you will lose the possibility forever to come back here and save yourself on the earth. You will go to the planet of the angry

ones, and they will judge you there according to its laws, because you were living on the earth by following them.”

Francisco ordered us with Bronski to set the unfortunate shrimps on the camels, to give the food already prepared for the journey to them and to wait for him on the way along which he would come to us.

We were surprised when we left the dining-room with the shrimps and met Zeiched by the very threshold who was stroking and talking to the restless animals who began to worry even more when the shrimps showed up. Anyway Zeiched succeeded to persuade the camels to settle down. We set the shrimps with their luggage on them, Zeiched whispered something to each camel's ear, they as though gave a moan, broke into a gallop immediately and soon they disappeared from our eyes by taking away two hardly visible living beings with the gigantic amount of their invisible affairs and tasks.

Zeiched was talking to us with pleasure, he said that he had already chosen an excellent and experienced camel for every one of us, who were already walking across the desert with people many times. He was trying to dispel our low spirits in every possible way, which we were unable and which we didn't want to hide from him.

Francisco came after some time. My God, how extremely excellent he was! As though a radiance spread from his head, and the beams spurted from his eyes! Kindness was blowing from his entire essence like a living movement of the hot air. As soon as I looked at this face, the whole heaviness of my heart melted. Now I could feel joy instead of the heartbreak which oppressed me like a heavy burden.

What did I understand, to be precise, comprehend once again by looking at the radiating Francisco's face? First of all, I understood that he all was only a prayer, that he was in the unity with the universe. I understood the grandeur and horror of the people's paths on the earth. I understood that the entire man's life on the earth, good and fortunate, bad and unfortunate, - everything till the last encounter was only his own actions. I understood it earlier, too, but today as though I began to see clearly, as though I could see instantly the long row of records which unrolled before my spiritual eyes like a roll of an ancient parchment.

“Let's go, my friends,” Francisco addressed us and he took my arm. “Well, you see, Lovushka, what a complicated thing man's self-control is. You were just dashing to me on the camel full of joy to live, full of youthful enthusiasm and in love with me. Your another “just” was your anxiety to fulfil I.'s command “not rightly” and to delay the business given to you. This anxiety of yours didn't have time to settle down, and life fastened your heart and your thoughts to observe the stages of the strange lives. Think for a while, concentrate and analyse vigilantly: did you, I don't say absolutely controlled yourself, but were you at least absolutely calm? Were you thinking, my dear boy, about those people whom the flying past time brought together with you, or were you only thinking: “How should I not commit a crime for I.?” Such stages of discipleship exist when man doesn't have time anymore to think about his “I” even in such a form as you are doing it, that is, he cannot think “I'm doing it”, “I don't do it”, “I can do it”, “I cannot do it” anymore, because also his “I” doesn't exist anymore. Also his body doesn't exist anymore as separating him from the entire universe. All disciple's affairs are only acts of divine Love of the Only One – of that Only One through whom and within whom he is living, within whom he is communicating and within whom he merges with his entire surroundings. The day of the acts of his thoughts and actions doesn't exist for him anymore. The day for him – that's a prayer for Life. The body which separated the disciple from the rest of the world disappeared not because he destroyed, negated and exhausted it, but because he used to give Love, to overcome with Love, to protect any encountered living being, he could see not her body, but the eternal Love itself. Does it mean that you need to violate all the laws of the earth, to spoil all your encountered people by rejecting any discipline and to open the point of view of your spiritual powers and your

perceptions to everybody? Not at all. The higher your stage is, the clearer you can see and perceive how it is impossible to live another man on your spiritual stage. The easier you can understand that incomparable with anything kindness and compassion with which you can raise high your pure cup of creative Love that you are carrying for man. The higher the stage of the disciple himself, the clearer he can see in which place of the universe that man is standing with whom he communicates. And the goal of each communication for the disciple – that's not man as a form, but man as Life, man who is standing on his own stage in the universe. And the first, most sacred action of the disciple – that's the prayer for the man to Those who have directed him to the encounter, who have given the strength to his heart and thoughts to read the eternity of his encountered temporary form now. The most often mistake of the disciples who begin their stages in the universe – that's too great efforts to interest man in that opening which illuminates himself. Not that disciple is loyal till the end who only thinks where, to whom and how to pass the knowledge which he himself considers to be the truth, but that one is loyal till the end who hasn't overstepped his Teacher's instruction, the instruction of loyalty to him, absolute and voluntary obedience, although the external factors fought with the worldly perception of compassion.

I took pity on these shrimps when I was sent to save others, although I could see that their stage in the universe was so difficult that even the whole surrounding kindness wouldn't be able to withstand the weight of their passions in higher stages. By entrusting the work to me, my Teacher could see better than me. His kindness was greater than mine, his foresight was shrewder than mine, although I relied on the energy of the power of my own heart and I suffered. Because no separation exists. No my strength exists. No my body exists. Only that line of the universe exists on which the encounter of two moving spots of the Only One is taking part in that moment. Remember the lesson of this day: if your Teacher told you to restrict your work, if he instructed you – no matter whose lips uttered it, it is important that those lips pass the Teacher's word to you at all, – not to strive for any spiritual communication with the people who seem to be very high by appearance to you, fulfil that what was instructed to you without asking any questions, keep your loyalty for him till the end and don't search for any compromises of how to push something from your knowledge which you consider to be great and true through to them. And on the contrary, however low the external appearance of the man's case and his conditions would seem to you, if your Teacher commanded you, then carry all the news which he told you to, act without asking any questions, be loyal till the end."

Francisco was silent for several minutes which turned into the eternity for me, because I desired to hear this tender, manly voice, and he continued again.

"A supposed disciple's devotion, as it turns out after reviewing his activity, causes a row of false acts, among which one could find even some unconscious treasons. Every time when the disciple oversteps the limits given to him by his Teacher, although that would seem as a merit to himself, because he helped somebody actively, not only he wasn't in harmony with the Eternal Movement of the universe, but on the contrary, he burdened the movement of that man whom he really wanted to help in the evolution of the Eternity."

We came nearer to the Community, and I recognized I. from the distance who was coming to meet us. I even couldn't comprehend myself why Francisco's words affected me so much. It seemed to me that actually I knew everything what he was telling us. But only now I comprehended firmly and clearly that the man's "I" was his greatest enemy along the path of his improvement. And not because he is in love with himself, because he lifts himself higher than others with his self-love, but only because that stage in which this "I" stops hindering man starts there where man's solitude ends. Then he never stays alone, the two of them are always together: man and his Only One. Perhaps the man can rarely reach such merging with God due to the weakness of his mind and heart, due to the narrowness of his world outlook in which Infinity

may not find enough room, but every disciple may reach such forever indivisible merging with his Teacher if he is loyal till the end.

As though a lightning illuminated the most secret little corners of my conscience, my mind and my heart, and I understood, forever as it seemed to me, how happy that disciple had to be who destroyed the barriers between himself and his Teacher, which were holding him captive.

I understood why such people like I., Ananda, sir Vomi, Francisco weren't searching for any ways how to teach their disciples and why they were simply living next to them, helping them with the example of their everyday work.

I remembered Henry, Anna, Joan. I thought about that gigantic power of kindness which Ananda was carrying for people by never leaving them without his help, without his loyalty to them till the end, although they didn't have enough strength to live with self-control and faithfully due to their stubbornness.

"Why are you so thoughtful, my boy?" I heard the sweet I.'s voice, and only now I understood that I. had already greeted everybody, only I alone was standing like a pole, while everybody else went down already.

"Oh, my dear I., my compassionate Teacher, how dull I am, how slowly I perceive all that great what I hear from you. Now as though I am reborn, as though only now I comprehended what the man's liberation was and where his life in the stages of the universe began."

"You will be enlightened like this and awakened for new perceptions, new estimation of your place in the universe a hundred of times. Not that is important that you can feel how your spirit has enlightened, but that is important how Life is moving within yourself, for the actions of which you clear out always more place within yourself. During those moments which the disciple who is living on the earth feels as the transitional points of his sudden change, only the shells of all sorts of his dried superstitions and preconceived opinions fall down from his "I", which don't have anything to feed on his heart anymore, then they dry up and fall to dust. Nothing new has happened within you now, which I couldn't have seen within you shining already. But it got into your own consciousness only now, when your heart found strength to bow to the suffering of the man again, although that man is more horrible than an animal by appearance. Tomorrow early in the morning we will leave to the distant Communities. Take this small book, my boy, and read it to lady Berdran. Try to find the words of comfort for the poor woman whose thirst for knowledge almost took the possibility from her to travel with us. It was easy for Nikita to give his strength and power to her, and he didn't calculate how much the delicate woman's organism could accept. He repeated Andreyeva's mistake who also almost ruined sister Gerda's nervous system by burning with love. Go, my friend. Concentrate your thoughts strongly on your eternal guardian Florentian and help me with this meeting. Read the whole book to Gerda, but not a single appendix, and there are three of them here, don't read them to her and don't look at them yourself. They are neither for your nor for her strength at the moment."

I was glad that I could fulfil my friend's task, I felt doubly happy, because I could serve dear lady Berdran at the same time and, having looked at I.'s face and seen the well familiar humour expression in his eyes, I gave a joyous laugh.

"Again you caught my thoughts, dear I. Of course, I committed a crime, because I thought: "I am glad. I am happy, because I can serve you and sister Gerda." When do I understand and walk the stages of the universe with another note of my heart: I carry Peace, I sing Love, I create Beauty, I am living and

breathing, because I follow my Teacher with my loyalty, and I don't exist, only my happiness – my loyalty to my Teacher till the end and my creation together with it?"

"Carry Light into everybody's path, my baby, and search for that Light not in books, but within yourself. If you carry the book and your Light, then the book will reach the goal, because your Light – that's your loyalty to the Only One, with Him you communicated with the man and with your Teacher. This note of the heart is ringing, and the man doesn't lose touch with it, because not he gave birth to it, but he himself was born from it.

Man is born for the first time when he leaves his mother's womb and brings the fruit of his eternal creation with him onto the earth.

The man is born for the second time when he perceives that he and his Only One is living together with him in his earthly form.

The man is born for the third time when he meets his Teacher.

The man is born for the fourth time when he dies with the earthly death.

The periods between these births – the periods of the development of his creative spirit – happen only according to the inevitable, invariable laws of cause and effect. Don't be surprised in anything, fight and prepare her for the journey if you need to by forgetting about yourself and thinking about her as the affair of your Teacher."

I embraced me. I hustled down the shortest path to Gerda, having forgotten that I possessed the body, I felt so light and happy. I wasn't even thinking about I.'s words: "I whatever state you would find Gerda." Now it was the same for me: whether the sun was shining, whether the snowstorm was raging, whether the canons were roaring – I was walking with my loyalty. It was my life, my song, my breathing. I couldn't live otherwise anymore. I glorified God with each of my inhalation, I dedicated only to him my work for people, my respect for their suffering and joy, for their mutiny and weakness, for their calm and courage, for their entire earthly path, for the inevitable point of the evolution of Eternity of every one of us.

Chapter 16

I read the small book to Gerda. Our departure from the Community.

The first day of the journey across the desert. The oasis, encounters in it.

The night by the bonfire. I.'s farewell to professor.

His last instructions to the scientist

I stayed at lady Berdran's for a long time. When I entered the room, the poor, sad woman was sitting on the low, small chair, with her hands holding her head. Her pale, gaunt face looked aged, now Gerda didn't look at all like that charming beauty whom I met in our home when she recovered.

The wave of unusual happiness which I took with myself while entering the room was so big, I felt so much power that I didn't feel the slightest trembling of my aura from the encounter of heavy emanations of Gerda's sadness.

"Lovushka, I haven't seen you for so long," she met me by uttering the words sadly and indifferently, as if only despair was left in her life.

"Why, my dear sister Gerda, is your mood so sad, as if everything had been broken before you?" I asked her.

"You've used a very correct word, Lovushka. Indeed, everything what I had achieved with the greatest efforts was broken. You will leave with I., while I will stay here."

"It is so strange to hear such personal attitude from you. Our last conversation opened completely different side of your soul to me. Enough of that, we'll talk about it later. Did I. send you to me?"

I didn't have time to finish my phrase, Gerda jumped up, her cheeks burst into bloom, as though she all came to life, she clapped her hands and gave a shout.

"Has I. really not forgotten about me?!"

"Forgotten? You have a high opinion of loyalty of your dear friend. I. sent me to you, so that I would read, to be precise, translate this small book for you. First of all, let's fulfil his instruction, then we can talk about something else, if the words of the book aren't enough to answer all your questions and to light up your energy. I think that we won't need it, because I know how I. loves all of us till the end and how his heart gives the whole completeness of its strength and feelings to that, while caring for somebody."

I opened the small book and I began to translate it:

"The opening of man's inner powers is invariable and inevitable path of every man of the earth who is searching for liberation."

Gerda sat down nearer to me, as though it had seemed to her that she would comprehend the whole wisdom of the small book through the physical nearness.

"Doubts and desire of knowledge – are the inevitable stages of development of every man's spiritual powers, who starts his path of liberation. Both these characteristics have a common beginning: the fight against man's own "I".

The better man understands his modest place in the universe, the less doubts and desire for knowledge he possesses, because he perceives clearly the Infinity that surrounds him from all sides. He can feel clearly that no empty space exists around him, that Life fills up everything.

The more instincts of egocentrism man possesses, that is the stronger he is concentrating his thoughts on his "I", the bigger and stronger his doubts are, the more often tears are rolling down from his eyes, the stronger his fight against his body, against his passions, against his rebellious, lustful thoughts which don't know any peace is.

Nobody has ever found any salvation in fight against himself, because man goes forward only by asserting and not by denying. Man has to concentrate his attention not on the fight against his passions, but on joy of love for Life, on glorification of Life in all its forms and stages.

The more obediently man has accepted the hour of his life on the earth, the stronger and more joyfully he has lived his day by observing life in every living being, in every form of work, the more he did by developing spiritual powers within himself. He lived his day by rejoicing at every achievement of his own people, the power has matured in his heart during that day and it pushed him into knowledge and wisdom.

No calm and tranquillity in those living beings exist who are always searching for the new sources of opening. Everything what they grab from the books and notes that get into their hands they absorb with the external layer of their cortex, but few people get into their most Sacred place, so that they would create the origin of Spirit in their hearts.

The simple words uttered with joy, the words of great honour and concord uttered with a calm heart reach the goal quicker than a hundred of truths, picked and extracted from all sorts of "sources".

Man's desire for knowledge is meaningless if he doesn't possess the power of spirit to apply that knowledge in his daily actions.

The truth read with the crying eyes won't illuminate in the man's path through his grey daily routine. That day with his read truth will remain the same grey day of doubts and tearing desires.

The truth read without the crying eyes will illuminate the man's path through his grey daily routine. It will create several temples during that day, because the man was spreading it in his day's affairs. His day has become the shining day of happiness to live, and not the day of sadness and destroying of all his previously achieved spiritual riches.

Sadness of man's heart, anxiety and suffering due to his own unfitness are living within him while he is walking through his day by the stages of the worldly life of the earth. When the origin of Spirit opens within his heart, the worries about his suitability or unfitness disappear, man forgets about himself – he enters the great path of liberation in which people are walking down the stages of the universe.

Calm of man's heart is the sign of the great walking down the stages of the universe not because it is the goal of the life on the earth already by itself, but because it is growing and strengthening the stages of liberation of everybody who are next to him and it helps to create those temples of Light in which those who are obsessed with passions rest.

Courage isn't the quality of the man who can achieve it with his will. Courage – that's the aspect of God within man. It may shine as courage within the greatest sinner and anyway it will be the aspect that has come nearer to an action, although the man wouldn't be shining with anything anymore. And the man with one aspect of the Only One which made a move from one place will rise above a hundred

of "righteous persons" who are wrapped up in the sheets of the fearful piety, because not a single quality of spirit is opened within them till the end, all of them sank in the grey mass of the mixed images of their daily routine. These "righteous persons" have diminished all their heroic strains till nice and warm sincerity which looks pleasingly, but which doesn't have any value in Eternity. These people are equal to parasites on a scale of the Universe.

While craving for moving forward, love the energy of your encountered person. And the more you will help his energy to develop, the further you will advance yourself, even without feeling how you moved forward. Because by stimulating the energy of the encountered heart to grow, you were building the temple of Life, and its Light illuminated you and your path, as well as the paths of your encountered people."

The large print of the small book ended with these words. Then the appendices with the small print followed. I closed the book and put it into the pocket.

"What?" Gerda gave a shout. "But you've read only a third of it. Why did you hide the book, it I. told you to read it for me?"

"I've read as much of it as I. told me to. Then neither I will read it myself nor I will translate it for you," I answered her. "If you want to, I can read everything one more time, but nothing else."

Gerda wanted to hear that what I. told to read for her again, and I translated the text for her again where sometimes only one record was on one page.

"I understood how terribly unjust I was. I desired to know always more, while I was unable to apply a single drop of it in my daily actions. I was interested only in myself, I took care only of my negative side, and now I understood that I still haven't achieved obedience, that hidden haughtiness was still living within me. Lovushka, I don't know whether it was the power of the words of the small book or the power of your joy, but my sadness has passed. Even if I. now doesn't take me with himself, I will try to find joy and to strengthen the energy of everybody whom I will meet with it. My God, in what streams my tears were rolling down during these days! I regretted that I caused so much trouble for Nikita, but now there's calm in my heart. My dear Lovushka, thank you for this Light which you brought here, for your kindness and courage which you poured into me."

"I would like very much to attribute your recovery to myself, dear sister, but unfortunately, that's only I. who is sending his help and his greeting to you. Now it is too late already. Tomorrow we leave early in the morning. I have no doubt at all that I. will take you together with himself. Go to sleep, while I will run home. I still have to weave the nest for my friend Eta. Now he is so big, so it isn't an easy task," I answered her merrily by kissing lady Berdran's hands.

"Your Eta is as big as you are, Lovushka," lost in thought Gerda uttered by seeing me off.

"In some people's opinion, I was "sickly person" here before, while now I deserved the reproach that I am big. It only lacks that you, life professor, would baptize me Goliath," I joked by answering her.

"How far away that time of my follies is left when I really was jeering at you. Now I am not even ashamed, as though not I was that stupid woman. Only the current consequences of my folly are much more difficult both for me and Nikita."

"Let's not come back to that what happened with our thoughts anymore. Your "now" is so charming. Glorify it, let's thank I. once again and let's try to help somebody's energy with our love on the way to the distant Communities."

I said good-bye to Gerda in this way. I scuttled back home to make the travelling nest for my peacock. Having entered the room, I was surprised by finding the light turned on. It turns out, Yassa – who knows everything, who is in time everywhere, Yassa who always thinks about everybody – already make a wonderful little cage in which Eta was sitting with dignity now and he didn't want to come out of his new nest at all, he paid no regard to any of patient Yassa's persuasions. I entered the room exactly at the time of this comical scene.

Having seen the nicely made little cage, I rushed at Yassa's neck by thanking my wonderful educator for his efforts and care from the bottom of my heart. As soon as I embraced my friend, there were three of us immediately, because jealous Eta wasn't used to it that I would embrace not him after coming back home, now he jumped up on my shoulder and covered us with his wings. Having joked about my peacock's jealousy and calmed him down, I was strongly touched by Yassa's love and I told him.

"Simply I don't know how I will manage without you on the way and in the distant Community, my dear Yassa. How many remarks I will receive from I. who doesn't even suspect who is taking care of my whole appearance and belongings."

Yassa snickered, nodded at the table side where he had prepared the supper for me and said to me in his funny dialect.

"I. sent even the list of the belongings to me what I had to take for you and Bronski. And you are thinking of how you are going to travel without me! I would like to see both of you without me. That would be very funny! Probably Eta would die from hunger three times with his such frivolous master! Of course, I will travel and I also took lady Berdran on my current burden. Concerning the prickly-eyed, - he always used to call Andreyeva like this, - I said to Kastanda that it was meaningless for me to take care of her. I won't teach her to dress neatly, while lord American will gather up her scattered items very carefully anyway."

While Yassa was talking to me by sewing the last belts of the Eta's little cage, I ate and I felt like sleeping so much that I dashed off to the bath, came back hurrying and I was already sleeping in several minutes.

As it often used to be for me, also this time my sleeping hours flew past like one minute. Eta woke me up by pulling my pillow with his beak, as well as Yassa's steps and his laughter.

"Faster, faster, the bath is ready, everybody is going to breakfast already. The prickly-eyed is hardly alive with impatience and she is almost on the camel already, while you are still in bed," my dear friend and educator was telling me by giving some unusual clothes to me.

He responded to my surprised look that I couldn't travel across the desert with the ordinary clothes and that when I came back from the bath, he would put two more robes on these clothes with which I already felt too hot, that he would roll up a turban for me, and when I got on the camel, he would throw an Arabic cloak on me, because otherwise the desert sun would burn me down and its light would dazzle me.

This perspective stirred horror to me, but I couldn't do anything, I had to obey him. Imperceptibly I remembered the feast at Ali's and that terrible old man who was black, limping, with the turban and the stick, whom I saw in the mirror and in whom I couldn't recognize myself in any way.

Laughter, my constant laughter in the wrong place was simply destroying me only by thinking about that moment of the insupportable irritation when I was prepared to stamp my feet and when I was almost crying from the grievance by seeing my lame ugliness. Not much better I will look now with the wadded robe in the desert sun which, of course, will tan me black like an Arab and will make me ugly like the old man in the mirror. Only that inconvenient shoe was missing which would make me limp. I stretched out my head to Yassa by laughing at myself, at my so recent childishness. He cut my hair without mercy and rolled up the turban on my head immediately from the long, soft, see-through, green piece of silk. Then he gave a cup of milk to me, two scones which didn't look well by appearance, but which actually were very delicious and he told me.

"I. told to eat your fill neither to you nor to Bronski. The actor will come here soon and he will get the same food. I. asked me to explain to both of you that you needed to eat little during the journey, only as much as it was necessary for the organism to sustain, but no more."

Then Bronski came in, he was wet with sweat and he was grumbling on his wadded robe and his high boots. He received the same breakfast as I did, his head, as well as mine, was cut shortly and rolled up with the turban. Only his turban was made from the orange silk, while I looked to myself like a green frog.

Yassa put the bright green robe on me, he gave the orange one to Bronski, and both of us went downstairs by dying with the heat and the weight of the unusual clothes where Zeiched was already waiting for us with the impatient camels. As soon as he seated us on the small saddles and wrapped us up, to be precise, swaddled us in the cloaks – I. appeared, he got on the saddle instantly, and the caravan was off.

We were travelling in separate groups. I. was riding in front of the first caravan, me and Bronski were from both of his sides, other five wrapped up figures were behind us, I couldn't recognize them, because I was unable to turn, while Yassa finished our company. Within the certain distance – as far as the dust allowed me to see – another company with Nikita at the head was galloping, because I knew his camel well, and Zeiched was in the end of them. I already understood that we were not many and I thought that those were all whom I. took for travelling, but I was wrong. When we turned to the left in the right angle and rode out to the open desert, I saw another company which was much bigger than the first two. I recognized Kastanda who was riding at the head of it and I saw an absolute strange man in the very end, his face was almost black, he had a long, grey beard and he was riding without any cloak, only with the robe and the white turban. I couldn't see much through the short turn, but I could see clearly that the third company was riding much slower than us and that the distance between us was very big, even after estimating the deception of the bright desert air.

"Lovushka, don't turn in the saddle, because you will loosen all the belts and bands, and it will be difficult for you to keep the saddle in the end of the first journey. Hold the reigns carefully. The well-trained animals are very sensitive to each rider's movement. The first day of the journey across the desert, although it will be as short as possible, will exhaust every rider who is riding on the camels for the first time very much. Cover your face with the cloak more, however hot it would be for you under it, otherwise you will get sunburnt, and we'll have to leave you in the oasis."

Although the camels were galloping, I. was talking in the absolutely calm voice, without raising it. His face was uncovered, as well as Yassa's, Kastanda's, Nikita's, Zeiched's and already mentioned strange man's.

"You are surprised that some of the travellers aren't afraid of the desert sun and light. There's nothing unusual here. All people's skin and body are the same, but everybody controls them

differently. It is time to comprehend clearer for you that there shouldn't be any duality between man's body and spirit, as well as between his mind and heart. Everything within man is connected into one harmonious totality. The higher his spiritual purity is, the higher he rises with his knowledge, the simpler, easier and rightly he controls his entire organism. If such cases happen on the earth when the pure sacred people are ill or even die in great suffering, then they are such exceptional parts of the universe with their self-sacrifice, which intensify the development of their encountered people, as well as of their disciples and even of the entire mankind. They take up the rubbish of the people's sinful emanations into themselves, which destroy their own body. By knowing it, they destroy the harmony of their own organism consciously by transferring the too strong for their physical strength Life powers onto the plan of the earth through themselves like through a filter. Now you enter that stage of your training when you need to form the sphere of absolute harmony from your aura, that is you need to learn to control your body, all your muscles and functions once and for all. The man who knows the work of his organism well, who can always pour the energies into one or another of its parts, is never ill. No matter which man's illness is – that's only the stage of his spiritual disintegration, but never on the contrary.

The man who is riding in the end of the caravan, who has surprised you with his appearance and height, is the host of the oasis which we'll reach in the evening and in which we'll stay overnight. He leads a small tribe which he settled here a long time ago after taking it out of the island that sank during the terrible earthquake. He took out not so many people after choosing only the most honest ones from the morally ruined race, but now he is leader of already plentiful nation.

You will see a cultured life in every respect in the big, fertile and beautiful oasis, because Ali help them a lot by organizing the new life. You will see the nation in which there aren't any illiterate people, but everybody knows European languages, there are neither rich nor poor among them, even the personal wealth doesn't exist there, everything is created by collective work, and everybody gets everything what he needs. The people of the oasis don't have any understanding about the theft, although they left the country in which their forefathers were suffering much from the depraved and morally ruined surroundings. I tell everything to you not because you would think that I took you to the country of dreams in which such wonderful people's life is introduced as an experiment by using the methods of compulsion. No, culture and living example of several hundred people who really love their brothers helped their descendants to protect calm within themselves, and it created strong principles of goodwill of one to another. This oasis that is small on a scale of the universe didn't experience any troubles in the course of its spiritual development, joy for falling of their own people isn't characteristic here. Goodwill of one to another helps the whole nation to live protected from any possibility of the evil to penetrate into them. There were several attempts to disturb their stillness and to provoke hostility among them, but all these attempts failed just because the "educators" were ridiculous for those who were educated and they had to leave, because they didn't hold out the mockery of the oasis dwellers. The chief of the tribe is Rasul Dartran. When we stop at the oasis and he has some time, I will introduce both of you to him. Now try to accumulate the purest thoughts within themselves. Think about our final goal, where we are riding, about the unfortunate people to whom we are riding and about the same unfortunate ones whom we accompany there. While we come nearer to the oasis, think about the infinite activity of love of the people of the oasis who are lonely, about whom nobody knows anything, who have created the kingdom of harmony in the desert, in the nameless little patch of the land. Spread that what is the highest within you in it, so that the flows of your love energy would wash the sand under the feet of all of those who will be walking there by rebelling and grieving."

We were galloping like this for another hour, then I. slowed down his camel, and we were riding slowly for about an hour, so that the animals would rest, and then we broke them into a gallop again.

It was the real suffering for me when the camels were riding slowly. I didn't expect at all that the slow animals' walk would make me so sick – more than in the ship. Besides, the sun and the sand looked like the stove that was breathing with fire, while my white peacock Eta who came out of the cage and hid under my cloak was like a burden of five poods.

I saw that I was losing my strength, he advised me to co-ordinate the rhythm of my breathing with the camel's steps, and it helped me very much, and after calling Yassa, he told him to take the bird from me. It wasn't so easy to do, because the spoilt bird didn't want to leave me. Finally, he calmed down from I.'s look, he set off to Yassa with his little cage, he was unsatisfied, he turned his head from us and he was covered with a white, heavy cloth.

In this way, by changing the pace of the riding, when the rest periods became always shorter and the galloping became always longer, we were coming nearer to the oasis which we saw from the distance because of its high palms. The sun was still high when finally we rode into the oasis itself, and the camels were walking on the solid ground. We were riding across the thinly growing palm grove which looked like a park to me, to be precise, like the palm avenues.

It grew a little cooler, the breeze began to blow, the water began to babble, but my thirsty eyes couldn't see it.

"Soon we'll stop by the waterfall," I. uttered, "but you cannot drink its water. It is very saturated with minerals, it is valuable for the soil, but it is harmful for people. You can moisten your palms, and that will revive you, but no more. Here we'll dismount the camels, take our outdoor, most dusty clothes off and we'll go to bathe in the near lake with the suitable water."

I. was the first who dismounted the kneeling camel, while Yassa and I. simply took me and Bronski down, so stiff our joints were. I could hardly stand on my feet, Bronski didn't feel much better.

Be seeing our disability, I. uttered merrily.

"Professor was a little wrong by calling you Goliaths, but this weakness soon will pass. Try to walk with the full foot, till the very end of your toes. Let's go, the hosts already come to meet us."

I was so exhausted and stiff that I even didn't have any strength to be interested in who was walking at the head and who was in the end. If I hadn't been leaning on Yassa, I couldn't have made a single step. I was like a log, without any thoughts and strength. I comprehended that people were around me, that I could hear their talking and even laughter. I felt that a moan was breaking out of my overdried throat, and I didn't remember anymore how I fell down and how Yassa was carrying me in his arms.

I came to life and I understood that I was alive only by sitting in the bath with the warm water where Yassa, always the same nice Yassa, was massaging me.

"Well, now you are set in perfect order. Put these clothes on, drink this beverage and help me to revive Bronski. He feels even worse than you do," Yassa was telling me by wiping the streaming sweat.

I felt very sorry for Yassa who gave so much strength to me, but I brought myself neither to thank him nor to feel for him, because he didn't like it very much.

"Does Stanislav really feel worse than me, but then it means that he is dying?" I uttered by trying to dress as soon as possible and to run to help Bronski.

I looked around and I didn't understand where I was. That was like a tent with the stone cobbled floor, the square bath of which I got out was inserted in the floor. Everything was very primitive,

but very convenient and even comfortable under the desert conditions. The warm, lucid water was running straight into the bath and in its other end it ran out through two holes which were in such a height that the water level remained always the same and it didn't pour through the brims. Some very beautiful mats, covered with subtle patterns were spread on the floor. Only I couldn't see the exit anywhere from the tent of this bathing place and I couldn't understand in any way where Bronski could be.

"I am ready," I said to resting Yassa, "but I don't understand in any way how I could get out of here and where I should search for Bronski. We are like in the cellar."

"It would be great if it was so easy to leave all cellars," rested Yassa answered me and he pulled one of the walls made of mats, which I really thought that couldn't move.

The wall didn't yet move till the end, while I was already shocked by the view behind it. Bronski with his face pale till greenishness was lying stretched on the folding-bed. After Yassa's words I believed that he didn't die, but anyway I had a stitch in my heart, I wanted to help him as soon as possible. Having evaluated the experience of my previous, swift capabilities that didn't bring any use for anybody, I concentrated my entire attention and calm, and I was waiting for Yassa's instructions. The moments turned into hours, and Yassa's preparations which I didn't understand seemed to me as a tormenting delay.

Yassa was preparing the whole assortment of the means of his work: brushes, loofahs and the gloves made of the coarse material with which he was doing his famous underwater massage so well. Finally, he put a couple of the gloves on and gave the same ones to me.

"Put them on, Lovushka, do them up well and do everything what I will tell you to do precisely."

As soon as I put the gloves on, Yassa told me to stand by the Bronski's feet and to help him to sit him up in the stone armchair that was hewed deeply in the bottom of the stone bath. I was lifting his flabby body with difficulty, I didn't expect in any way that the lean man could be so heavy. While Yassa was rubbing his legs, knees, hands and his back, I was always holding Stanislaw's body and head. In about fifteen minutes Bronski gave a sigh, but he didn't open his eyes and he was still sitting in the same pose.

Yassa turned the tap on and lifted the dampers from both sides of the bath. The warm water came flowing in several minutes and it was filling the bath little by little. Now Yassa was rubbing his chest and his neck diligently. The water was rising always higher and it already reached Stanislaw's knees. His face became rosy, he yawned, opened his eyes and asked in a weak voice, surprised.

"Yassa, did everybody really leave without me?"

"Leave? Yes, if you are going to sleep like an epic hero more often, then I am afraid that even the palms will have time to grow from the little seedlings till the very sky. Senor sleepy-head, come down to the water, otherwise it is uncomfortable for me to massage you."

Stanislaw wanted to stand up immediately, but he couldn't do it. His legs didn't hold him at all. He tried to stand up three times and he succeeded to do it only with my and Yassa's assistance. In order to do it, I had to get into the bath and to make him lie down only almost by using my own hands. He was completely helpless, his whole body was aching and he could hardly suppress his moaning and grimaces of pain while Yassa's skilful hands were massaging him.

Yassa was labouring for a long time. Then he told me to help Stanislaw again to sit down on the stone armchair, but that wasn't so difficult for him anymore. Yassa rubbed down the whole Bronski's body with the aromatic water and after this new massage Bronski sighed like a lion, he gave a smile and uttered.

"Now I am Goliath again."

"Not quite yet, drink this milk and go to this bath," Yassa answered him, he gave the drink to him and showed to the bath of the first room in which I recovered.

Bronski rose as always easily and deftly, he went to my bath and uttered with enthusiasm.

"The bath was wonderful, you Yassa are even more wonderful, but your milk, excuse me, is such a nasty thing that you cannot imagine anything more terrible."

Life, strength and energy came back to Bronski, as if he didn't look like a dead man an hour ago. But the little Yassa was still crumpling him with his iron hands from which epic hero Stanislav was frowning, coughing and spitting.

"And now both of you dress as soon as possible," Yassa uttered, he took his gloves off and pulled another wall.

We went out to another room and we were struck with fascination. The star-lit sky was shining above us, because the room was without any roof, and the palms were growing around rather big area which was fenced off by mats. Judging by the sky, it was a late evening already, while it was bright as in the daytime in this room from the lamps shining brightly and silently, which were placed in the unseen as though pots or radiating pillars. Sofas and chairs woven from straw were standing here, on which we found our everyday clothes.

"Lovushka, the miracles never end for us," Stanislav uttered by nodding at the lamps and the sky.

I didn't have time to answer anything to him, because suddenly I got in I.'s arms who was laughing from my amazement.

"The miracles only begin, my dear martyrs, but believe me, you won't have to experience such tormenting journey anymore. You may and even you really will have to travel under much more difficult conditions, but not a single journey in the future won't exhaust you so much anymore. Only the first journey on camels exhausts the rider to death if he is riding without any rest as we did. Let's go, my children, the miracles are waiting for us."

While radiating from I.'s closeness I asked to wait for me, I dashed at Yassa, kissed him heartily several times and I thanked him for his help on behalf of both of us.

"Yassa, Yassa," I was whispering to him. "What are we going to do without you? We are so grateful to you."

"That's all right, Lovushka! Thank I. and yourselves. I only pay my debt. Don't forget to take Eta with you, his cage is on the right, in the dark corner."

When I came back to I., Eta was already in his arms, he was very happy and he had forgotten about all his wrongs experienced during the journey. Having taken the bird who didn't want to walk himself in the strange place, I was following I. and Bronski who still couldn't come to himself from so many experienced shocks and surprises.

We were walking down an excellent avenue which was decorated with the flowers of different types, and the flower aroma was spreading from all sides. The lights in the windows were put on in many places. Through the ones of them I could see how women put their children to bed, through the

others I could see the cosy and peaceful family life. Everything seemed to me like a dream, a fairy-tale, and I was always prepared to “catch crows.” Probably that’s why I. took my arm and he told me.

“Be attentive, be cultured gentleman, my son. Try to remember what Florentian was telling you about tact and charm, whomever you would meet tonight, be manly and well-wishing till the end. Forget about yourself, about your amazement, stimulate the energy of your encountered people to grow with your whole heart.”

I.’s words directed the course of my thoughts to another direction. I stopped being fascinated and observing, I stopped living only in the external world, I plunged in the deep and calm state of the active action. I stopped thinking whom and how I would meet, I felt the power to be and to become such Love in my heart when you can see the Only One in every case only with your own spirit.

We were coming nearer to the big summerhouse made of the fine, metallic net which was protecting from the night moths who were flying from all sides to the brightly burning lamps with which everything was lit up here. When we approached the very summerhouse, the man who was riding in the end of our caravan came out of it to meet us. Now I could recognize him only from his beard and the dark face that as though was hollowed out of the stone. While I. was introducing us to him, I had the possibility to examine the face of the oasis host. It surprised me that it didn’t have any wrinkles, its skin was absolutely even and youthful, but I couldn’t feel the youth in the face itself. Only the wisdom of centuries, as though he had been living on the earth for the entire centuries.

I didn’t have more time to reflect on Rasul Dartran. He took me to two women, they were young and they looked very beautiful with the long, tight dresses, with their loose hair, with many bracelets on their bare hands and the beads on their necks, he introduced me to them as to his great-granddaughters. I still had time to think in what language I would need to talk to them, while the younger of them began to speak in great French language immediately.

“We got used to call our dear lord grandfather, although actually he isn’t even our great-great-grandfather.”

“It is such a rare happiness to have great-great-grandfather alive,” I answered her. “I saw alive great-grandfather, not only great-great-grandfather for the first time,” I was speaking to her, while sitting in my indicated place at the table between both women.

My neighbours were very interested in Eta’s destiny and they were asking me why I was travelling with him through the desert. Both of them offered me to take care of my peacock until I was back, they persuaded me that I could calmly entrust Eta’s care to them during the entire time of my journey.

“Not a single caravan is able to cross the desert without dropping in at our oasis. Often the people who are ready for their journey across the desert stay for longer at our place if their health doesn’t allow them to continue their journey,” the elder sister uttered.

“For example, the Frenchman who has taught his language to us had to stay even for a year at our place, so that he could come back to his motherland, until our grandfather helped him to recover his health. The people of almost all nationalities and of the most different professions lived at our place. Our bathhouses, wash-houses, baths are built according to the plans of the best American engineer. He was living at our place for three years and he didn’t want to leave for anything. He fell in love with one of my daughters and he received permission from grandfather to marry her and to take her to his motherland. However I was protesting, grandfather persuaded me to let my elder daughter go. Still four of them are left for my comfort.”

This lady looked so young that I asked her amazed.

"Since how old may one marry somebody? It is hard to believe that you have five daughters, but even if I could imagine that, then anyway your elder daughter may not be more than eight or nine year old."

"The climate of this oasis and its water characteristics predestine our long life and keep our youthful appearance. My daughter was seventeen-year-old when she got married. Our grandfather doesn't allow men to marry earlier than twenty one and women to get married earlier than seventeen years old."

Our conversation was turning upon the daily routine of the oasis, it didn't prevent me from listening about the new, unknown to me form of life of the cultured tribe, and at the same time, to look attentively at everything what was going on around me.

I didn't see anybody else from our caravan, except I. and Bronski at the table. Bronski was sitting between two women and he was talking to them about the theatre in English, as I understood from the separate words which reached me.

"Is there a theatre here?" I asked my neighbours.

"Of course, there isn't a theatre here in the true sense of the word, but our grandfather excited the curiosity of the children, he helped to write the play for them and he was their first stage director for the long time. Now the children grew up, matured, some of them became actors, writers and stage directors. They are dreaming to see the performance of the real actor at least once. Grandfather promised it to them. Only I don't know from where he is going to take the actor here and even the real one. Unless a caravan with an actor would get lost in the desert and would find our oasis."

"If our grandfather promised it – then it would be so," younger sister interfered in our conversation. "You can believe me or believe me not, but our grandfather knows everything. He knows when the invasion of the wild beasts happens and how to protect against them, when we need to travel to the desert to help the lost people, when a lean year is going to be and when the plague is going to rage not far away from here, - actually our grandfather knows everything. As though he can see everything through, not only a man, on the earth and in the sky. If he told something, then you can be sure that it would be exactly like this. It didn't happen a single time, so that the soul of our life, our joy – grandfather – would have told a falsehood to us."

The supper was over, the host stood up, he washed his hands, rinsed his mouth with the water from the current that was flowing from the big sink in the end of the summerhouse. Everybody followed his example by taking big glasses from the table, the purpose of which I understood only now. All the people who were sitting at the table, the group of maybe twenty people, the greatest part of which clustered around I. and the host during the supper, now turned their steps down the dark avenue.

The avenue seemed even darker to me after the bright light in the summerhouse. A big bonfire was burning in its end, rather far away. I understood that we were going to it. Soon my eyes got used to the darkness, the stars were shining very brightly, and I caught I.'s look while I was walking, which as though told me: "Remember."

Bronski took my arm, as if he wanted to protect himself from the chatty companions. Now also I wanted to be silent for a while, although I was very interested in the oasis life. We were walking down the avenue for quite a long time, we came up to the crossing and we saw some small houses.

"This is where we are living," the elder lady told me. "Now it is time to be home for everybody of us. If tomorrow your caravan leaves not so early and if you have some time, I myself and my

family will be glad if you drop in at our place,” she added pleasingly and extended her hand to say good-bye to me and Bronski.

Not only the ladies said good-bye to us, but also all the men who were walking in front and they dispersed to their homes. Only Dartran stayed and Yassa who emerged from the darkness who made us very happy. Our mood changed immediately. As though I felt a sense of relief and I understood that the wave of I.’s emanations covered me wider and stronger, which always helped everybody who were next to him to be energetic.

The bonfire which seemed to be big from the distance was simply gigantic close to it. It was loaded on the high pedestal made of the black stone and it illuminated the surrounding space widely like a big torch. The big wood logs were burning in the bonfire almost without any smoke. We came up to the very fire. The host bowed to I. and uttered.

“Be blessed, Teacher, for everything what you’ve already done for us and for what you are still doing. Be doubly blessed, because you came to us today, on this great day for me. Since that time when many years ago Ali sent you to me with the dear letter to me from him, you’ve never forgotten to congratulate me on that day, to let me know that you remembered me. Today I especially appreciate your arrival, because I feel tired of all the work and I want to see you, the worker of Eternity, who knows neither tiredness nor sadness. Sit down, Teacher, let me introduce two my grandsons to you who came home during these days. On your instruction, I sent them to universities. One of them studied in Heidelberg, another one in Oxford.

He seated I. into the wicker armchair, he showed the places for us with Bronski behind I.’s armchair where the wicker sofa was standing and he brought two tall, handsome youths who were dressed in the white, long, linen clothes which all oasis men were wearing, only their hair was short, while their faces were neatly shaven.

I. greeted each of the youths pleasingly by holding their hands a little longer, which he usually didn’t do by greeting people. Apparently, the youths felt shy of so many people. I understood that they, just like I in the beginning of my acquaintance with I., suddenly felt the power of I.’s look with which he glanced through their entire spiritual world, and now they were standing before him like naked, with all their spiritual values.

I. told several pleasing, tender words to each of them, from which the youths became self-confident and calm, he seated them on my and Bronski’s sofa and he asked Rasul to sit down next to him. While doubting a little and smiling bashfully the giant didn’t dare to protest and he sat down next to I. His figure rose between us like a monument. I thought that he was even taller than Ali and Florentian. If I could see them sitting on horses finely, then I couldn’t imagine Rasul in any other way as only sitting on the camel, perhaps also on the centaur.

As soon as the view of Rasul on the centaur flashed, he turned to my side and looked at me with such mischievous, teasing look which I didn’t expect to see in his wise, stone face. I remembered my companions’ uttered words about their grandfather during the supper and I decided to control the free flights of my words more – and just in time.

“Yassa, bring friends of our both groups and Kastanda here,” I. told him without turning his head and by continuing to examine the plentiful crowd of people before himself.

Yassa left to fulfil the task, while I. used that time for talking with people, who were young and elderly, who came up to him to ask for his advices, and he seated all of them by the bonfire. The steps

of many feet were heard, and first of all I saw... radiating Francisco, professor was walking next to him. Both of them were of great vitality, young and strong, as if they hadn't even ridden across the desert.

I and Bronski who was pressed to me were so surprised that as though we turned into stone. Not only us, but also others could see anybody else, except this couple. Francisco had thrown a brightly red cloak which looked like fiery on his everyday clothes. The light of the burning bonfire gave life and movement to this only one red spot by falling down on it in the crowd of the white clothes. It seemed to me that I could see some little currents which were flowing through the shining and soft material of the cloak. Francisco's head didn't have any cover, while the scientist had a turban on his head which changed him beyond recognition. Rasul stood up to meet Francisco and he gave up his place to him next to I., but he answered him.

"Sit, sit, my dear, next to your careful Teacher. I will sit down here, everybody will be able to see me, I will see everybody well and I will seat my new wards next to myself."

He sat down on a rather high and wide stone bench on which some cushions and mats were placed, he seated professor next to himself, Andreyeva from another side, then – Laliya, Theresita, Nina and Nikita, while Oldenkot who couldn't take his eyes off him made himself comfortable at his feet. When he shifted his look at I. and Rasul, I was surprised by resemblance of his eyes expression to Francisco's eyes. Such kindness, such calm and happiness were pouring from Oldenkot's eyes that I understood instantly how high man's spirit had to be that his face could reflect the divine kindness at least for a moment.

My God, I understood once again how little I was going deep into encounters and how little I could perceive in them. Who was really the man who was serving almost as the personal, constant assistant of Andreyeva in his external life, if one could compare the kindness of his face with Francisco's face?

Without having time to come round from my amazement, I felt a light touch and I understood that Yassa took Eta from my hands, whom I was holding not in an absolutely cultured way due to my absent-mindedness.

"Lovushka, give the bird to me. It isn't a very gentlemanly way to treat Eta like this," Yassa was whispering me by taking the peacock.

Yassa's words reminded me of I.'s command. I tried to come back to myself and to follow the strict inner discipline. Only then I saw lady Berdran and Igor who were sitting next to I. Good Lord, I hadn't seen Igor for so long time, I even forgot that he was living in the Community! How many qualities I still had to acquire and how much to learn! I had so little friends and acquaintances, and I forgot about Igor, while I. who was holding thousands of people in his memory didn't forget one day in life of the host of the desert oasis for a single time!..

"My dear friends," Francisco's voice was heard. "I am so glad that in this wonderful night that is so important for many present here, I can remind you that neither ranks nor titles nor conditional paths exist for those who are searching for peace and happiness. Who is able to reach them in his earthly life? That one who is living according to Gospel? That one who is participating in several church services every day? That one who is travelling through the sacred places? No, only that one who gives kindness to his encountered people during his grey daily routine. The kindness under the conditions and perception of his own time, and not according to the code of conditional rules which defines the conception of kindness by following the current superstitions. Could anybody instruct every person how he should behave among people if his main quality with which he understands and perceives his encountered people's spirit is kindness? Such kindness that rises not from man's mind, that is when man is late to ask his mind how he should behave, and in a flash he covers the whole encountered person with his love, including all his vices,

sorrows, tears, stubbornness and suffering isn't the personal man's characteristic anymore, but the action of his Only One's aspect which is revived and which leads into the path of his uniting with people. Not the form is controlling man's actions here. Here the Only One warms the man's form directly with his Love in such a way that it becomes soft like wax and He warms up the layers of the peel of the encountered person's conditionalities. They become soft from such encounter with the kind man, their pores widen and give a chance for their own kindness to leak out to the upper layers of the form, to merge with the kind man's Kindness and Love. But there aren't many kind people of this category on the earth. In most cases the people who are walking down their path of the earth with kindness are carrying it by covering it with the covers of their mind, scepticism and even a certain negation. Such people always have to break out of compromise, and if they achieve any creative results of uniting with people, then only in those cases when after all the peripeteias of their conscious reflections they fight their way to the unconscious creation – the complete harmony of their own organism. What is man's harmony? Could a man achieve it from the knowledge received externally? Could the culture and all achievements of civilization give harmony to man? Unfortunately, many people who are seeking after knowledge – I use this word here in the widest sense as the power of the cosmic significance, – will have to be disappointed, because such knowledge that could provide harmony doesn't exist. Another power, another culture brings man to harmony: the culture of his heart. Why do all the misfortunes of the greatest part of mankind rise from the contraposition of man's mind and heart? What does the culture of man's heart have so especial in comparison to the culture of his mind? What cannot his heart achieve what his mind picks up so easily? His mind, like an omnivorous animal, picks up the experience of the strange achievements. And the less creation in man's mind exists, the more he shines with the erudition of strange achievements, the brighter he stands out of his surroundings and he is called to be "intelligent." Rare creating minds almost always remain unnoticed in the crowd and they are valued, recognized as the celebrities of the certain level only according to their work and production, and not according to their talent to be able to get on with people. The creating minds always reach harmony, because everything what people have created majestic could be created only in a harmonious way. Man heart's creation – that's the path of his individual originality. None of a strange experience may help a man to achieve this culture. If you want to conquer at least a small section of your heart's culture, you need to throw down the big chains of your superstitions and preconceived opinions. If you want to spread at least one truth of Love in the world, you need to devote several of your incarnations to the achievements of your heart's culture. How is the first stage to the path of man heart's culture going on? It sounds in the same way for all people of the earth, for all without any exceptions: "Love each man in the same way as you love yourself." It could seem that this truth doesn't prevent a man's mind from acting and seeking after his culture, that it doesn't take the strength from him which he devotes to the highest aspirations and strains. However, the daily routine shows the opposite to us. Man heart's culture with its words of Love is disturbing the intelligent man in his affairs and meetings live a boring fly. The first thing what the intelligent man wants to throw off most of all, the first thing what he wants to forget and to manage without, – that's the problem of love for man. He lets into his daily routine neither love itself, nor benevolence for another, nor sympathy and care for his own people as the creation of joy. He is losing his good spirits from people who are involved in the problems of their heart if he personally isn't interested in it. The culture of a man's heart starting with benevolence, passing into sympathy becomes a prayer when every action of his heart is the regards of his mind and his heart, a greeting of his totality to the encountered person's fire. The path of the culture of the man's heart from the initial till the highest stages – that's the range of the man's liberations where the whole series of his outdated comprehensions and conceptions fall off of him. The nature of man's encounters is different in every stage, but the cause of this diversity is always one: he himself. To reach the clear perception that all circumstances of your life and all your encounters that is only your own creation isn't at least a little easier than to stop condemning a man. It is as much difficult to notice the effect of the law of cause and effect as to throw off all the dirt of man's organism, which is stuck onto him during the centuries of his long lives. When man descends onto the Earth

he knows precisely what new quality he has to develop and what old powers of his passions he has to turn into the power of joy, that is into that energy which is the only one that stimulates man's creation and gives harmony to him. Those people who begin the new lessons of their incarnation from the culture of their heart turned their possessed Origin of harmony into the part of their actions, they reach certain stages of their opening. Sometimes, even if they are illiterate, they possess such high power of loyalty of Love that their spiritual vision brings them far away beyond the limits of the everyday perception of surroundings. The man who begins the path of his life from the culture of his heart doesn't have to doubt for every question, to stop every day when bigger or smaller obstacles occur by deciding with difficulty how to pass round or jump over them. What are the obstacles? Only unreadiness of the man himself for that action which he has taken upon himself after descending onto the earth. Let's imagine that the same task arises for two men – of the mind one and of the heart one. Let's say that a friend came and he is asking for a shelter and rest from the intelligent one who is trying to live by serving his own people, and from the kind one who doesn't strive to do anything, but who is living in his kindness by holding his Teacher's hand with his entire loyalty. Both of them, the intelligent and the kind one, are living in poverty. Their home is already full of other sick people who require constant care and attention, and they don't possess much physical strength. The kind one, while holding his Teacher's hand, simply will think a little: "I don't have any place, the house is not mine, but my Teacher's. If I accept one more burden, I won't be able to carry any of them. I know that this unfortunate person will find a shelter, while those whom I take care of now won't find it anywhere and they will be lost without me. Let the hand of my Teacher help me to carry his burden in the best possible way." He will say to the man without any compromise breaking his heart: "Now I cannot accept you, my friend, even when I remember your hospitality well." While the intelligent will be dodging before answering him, he will feel the pain in his heart himself that he refused him, that he acted in an egoistic way, unthankfully and so on, instead of thinking only about the essence: "Everything has its limits. Whatever measure I would use, my strength defines such measure for me and for my encountered people which everyone of us has measured off within ourselves for the Eternity. My personal relation with my friend doesn't exist, in which I don't see anything personal, too. Only the circumstances exist with which everyone of us is trying to carry the Only One and to serve him. I will keep an absolute calm, I will be carrying Light obediently and I will be working as much as my limits allow me to." No signs of the culture of the man's heart exist according to which one could divide people. One cannot say that the action belongs only to those who are walking down the path of kindness. Everybody has to understand that not that how his act is evaluated is important, but that that act would be the action of his heart. It doesn't have any meaning who encouraged, how the close people met his action of man's heart. All of that concerns only temporary forms. The whole meaning of every action is only that how much infinity was reflected in it, which man purified and spread along the path of his encountered people. The bitter poison of conditionalities that obsessed people isn't only the privilege of the great masters, as namely the thin coating of that crowd, of its racket where the man who is searching for liberation is living. There's no need to mix the conceptions up. It isn't that important that you are searching, it is important what you are searching for and how you are doing it. If you are searching by comprehending clearly your place in the universe, if you are searching how to climb the stages of the universe in a joyous and simple way, you're your searching rises from the Eternity within you and the chaos of passions doesn't exist for you anymore. Your thought doesn't stick in the bubbling mass of conditionalities in which the crowd that surrounds you is living, - you are among those vibrations where the thought is creating without descending to the racket of impermanence and its rot. There are lots of the crowds of the praying people around you who are always begging to help in their prayers. And you can see every day how all these prayers uttered to somebody, to some heaven that doesn't exist within man, always remain without any answer. Why? That's only because such inert energy – the God who is sitting in the lifeless heaven, - doesn't exist, - only the creating, always moving Energy exists that is living everywhere, also in every man. In order for a man to receive an answer to his prayer – if one could speak about the prayer here at all by calling the personal request by this word, -

it is necessary that the whole man would become only the pure glorification of Life. However, when he reaches peace in his heart which turn him into the ringing glorification of Life, he doesn't utter any personal prayers anymore, because he has lost his personalism himself. He knows the Impersonal who is living within his form well from the spirit's actions within himself. His temporary form gives the strength and joy to him to carry the Light of Life which is both Personal and Impersonal for him at the same time. Everything with what he is living is the Totality of millions of the earthly lives, that is he sees it – life – in these millions of forms. In this wonderful night when the melody of Light Energy is ringing especially strongly in everybody's heart, forever reject the doubts of how you need to solve the questions of your private life, so that they wouldn't take the miracle of joy from you to be the little part of Existence and to become the power that reflects its kindness and help. You need to live your every moment with the whole completeness of your thoughts and your feelings, and to remember only one thing: one moment – and your incarnation is over. One moment – and there isn't any possibility left to carry the ringing Silence in the physical form of time and space, to fill the commonness of the earth around you with calm, joy, confidence and kindness. Liberate your mind today from its constant desire to read always new, always another word of the Truth. Comprehend that only those pieces of the Truth may become the daily man's actions which he has opened within himself after cleaning them with his work for the common welfare, which he has strengthened with his entire loyalty by honouring and blessing the horror and grandeur of the people's paths. It doesn't matter how many Truths a man would read, if he is living with conditional compromises himself, then he won't spread at least a drop of the Truth by uniting with people. The clouds of mosquitos and midges which persecute and sting the man's self-love, is only his own amateur activities. Why should you complain that your friend is indifferent to your troubles? Why should you blame your friend of breaking off relations with you? If you are going to visit your friend – as well as your enemy, - go to him only when you are able to spread the power and grandeur of your own kindness in his home, his heart, his conditionalities. Since this night stop living and acting, walking and talking in the same way as the townspeople are doing it in the world of the racket, conditionalities and fears. While walking through the earth's time and space, carry the Power of Light without considering such way of your life to be a heroic deed, live easily always and everywhere by hearing the Voice of Eternity."

Francisco lapsed into silence, while as though not the flows of the warm desert weather, but Love pouring from Francisco's heart was hovering above all the people who were gathered by the bonfire. How fast the night was over! I forgot completely where I was, that the bonfire was burning an hour ago, and now the east already began to burn, that only ashes were left from the bonfire and that I could already discern the people's faces in the dawn that changed the night. Francisco rose and addressed Rasul.

"Allow me to say good-bye to you, dear host of this oasis. Don't say that you are tired already, the time hasn't come to you yet to finish your work on the earth. You can see yourself that your replacement hasn't come yet, although you've brought up several generations. You haven't come to your limit yet. You haven't given everything to Life yet, what he had entrusted you to do. The moments come for everybody who come to the earth to fulfil the tasks of Eternity when their spirit becomes weak, when their heart lacks the power and courage to go till the end, but these moments flash like the dew drops which get dry in the sun and they bring the new courage for their heart to do even higher tasks. Good-bye, my friends and brothers. Everybody accept my heart's regards. The distant, infinite path of work is waiting for all of you, but don't forget: however the distant and shining kingdom of Love would attract you, it comes nearer to each man as much as his "now" is filled with the creating spirit."

Francisco embraced everybody of us, he came to I. after everybody else and told him.

"Teacher, bless and send us back."

I. told me and Bronski to help Zeiched to saddle up the camels for Francisco, Kastanda and professor. While we were doing this job, I kept thinking about the miracle of strength in the sickly Francisco's body. Me and Bronski almost died from not even full day of riding through the desert, while he would be riding back by not even closing his eyes, after spending the night without any rest. He was real giant of spirit, he could control his organism, force to obey and to serve his will simply in a supernatural way.

"Lovushka, everything is only knowledge and not any miracles," Zeiched whispered me by setting the camel's saddle next to me.

I almost dropped the reins from my hands, because Zeiched surprised me so much by reading my thoughts. I didn't have time to answer him anything, because I., Francisco and Kastanda were already coming to us by talking to professor. The scientist was irritated, unsatisfied and he was speaking in a very irritated tone.

"What is so especial here, if I don't come back to the Community now? Why am I not allowed to ride together with you, doctor I.? The break in my has already happened, hasn't it? Isn't it the same if it is longer for five or seven days, or maybe weeks, or shorter? I am so strong now that I will have enough strength for many years ahead."

"Who told you that my journey would last for five or seven days? It may last for much longer, but the main point isn't in time. Where is your loyalty to the science? Were you really afraid of missing at least one minute uselessly during your entire life, you even reproached Mulga that he was disturbing you with his conversations and prayers, only because now, when everything necessary is given to you, when you are full of strength, you would betray your idol science and you would tear to pieces your loyalty to it from your interest to see the external life of desert Communities? Think about everything what you've heard during all this rather short, but full of events period of your life. Didn't really your experience of these days give some wisdom to you in order for you to understand what man could see if he was prepared and what he couldn't see if he wasn't prepared, although the miracle of Life would be standing next to him?"

"I understand everything, doctor I., but I certainly want to travel with you. I won't be able to be occupied with my science if I am far away from you. I am ready to do everything what you want me to do on the way, only let me be next to you," Zalcman was speaking obstinately, with the absolute German boringness.

"My poor friend, let this hour become the lesson of ages for you. Take a good look at your own heart. Think a little about that great calm which prevailed in it when you woke up after your sleep in the Community. Think about the great Love for science which was living within you during your entire life. Remember all the sacrifices and losses of your entire life which you've experienced only because you wanted to give the great discovery to the world. And the whim, the illusory happiness of one moment carries off the whole value of your life like the hurricane: loyalty till the end. Not so long ago you've read some pages from your previous lives, you've experienced both your unfaithfulness and... my infinite love. Was really everything in vain and your heart would betray again?"

I. didn't finish his speech, Zalcman fell down by his feet and uttered in a silent, sorrowful voice.

"Forgive the man old man! You've poured so much Light into my heart, so much love was born in it for you that it seemed to me that it was impossible to separate with you..."

"If so much love for me was born in your heart, my friend, then let it accumulate there even more, let it pour in the whole stream to everything what surrounds you, let it help each of your encountered person to be enriched with courage and beauty. It isn't absolutely important who that initial, secret source of your accumulated Love will be. By loving one man till the end, you will be serving millions on his behalf. In the same way, by loving the science till the end and by overcoming all obstacles in it with your loyalty, you will become an example of living loyalty to the whole mankind, you will open the new stage of development for it. Come back. I took you here, so that you could make sure how it was possible to work for the common welfare and what was possible to create even in the sands of the secluded desert. They showed the museum of the Earth world to you, which surprised you, you saw the oasis, the schools and the libraries which fascinated you, you saw theatre in which you could hardly believe that you were not dreaming. Come back. Take a good look at your heart and remember my last word uttered to you: the closer you will be to God within yourself, the brighter and clearer you will see God in your encountered person. I believe that God within Francisco will begin to speak to you very soon and also you love for science which seizes everything will come back to you very soon. When you are occupied with the science as I instructed to you and with those people whom I named to you, you won't have time to do even a half of your work, and I will come back again."

I. embraced the scientist. Now he was so calmed down, deeply moved and kind, so kind that it was difficult even to imagine this self-lover professor like this. His entire German self-confidence disappeared – a meek and gentle living being was standing before us, who was looking at I. with his eyes full of fascination.

"It was difficult for me many times during my life. I fell into despair many times," Zalcman was always talking in the same silent voice. "And always my devotion to the science used to triumph, but it was my goal, my beloved, my life back then. Now it isn't my goal anymore, but... through it, through my devotion to it I hope to conquer that stage of calm and power when I become worth of following you. That Zalcman who was living for so many years is dead in this hour. The separation with you was impossible for that man, it was equal to death, if not more difficult than it. Only the new man who begins to create his life anew, with new hopes and new perceptions is marching into it by obeying to you. Yes, you are right. The God within Francisco was the first who began to speak to me. And he says: "While searching for Light for science within yourself, you will find that limit, beyond which your body stops pressing the cosmos within you." I go, my Teacher. Remember me, while I will be loyal to you in the same way as I was loyal to the science."

Professor bowed to I., he wiped the tears which were rolling down his cheeks with the corner of his cloak, he bowed to all of us and he got into the saddle easily, almost without any Kastanda's help.

I. said good-bye to Francisco and Kastanda, they also got on the camels. Francisco turned his camel to our side with Bronski and told us.

"Goliaths, remember that abyss of the people's misfortunes which you saw in the dining-room and know that it is nothing in comparison to that abyss where you are traveling now, and it is equal to it neither with the power of the people's disappointment, nor sadness, nor heartbreak. Be strong. Search for courage in the Only One's Love for man and don't forget: Life is sending its chosen ones not for the righteous people, but only for the sinners, and the greatest sinner from all the sinners is that one who saw a sin within man, and not his God."

The camels ran quickly down the avenue of the oasis and soon they vanished in the cloud of the desert's dust.

Chapter 17

Our departure from oasis.

The second day of the journey across the desert.

A dreadful encounter. The distant community.

The first impressions

We were standing and looking at the riding away riders. I think that I won't be mistaken if I say that the thoughts and the feelings of everybody who saw them off were the same. Every one of us – as much as we could – were sending our blessings to the riding away professor and to his new life. For several times already I was participating when I. and Francisco saw a man to his new life off. Every time it sounded to me like a dissonance that everybody used to start that new life from sadness, tears, heartbreak – it didn't matter whether it would be a degenerated shrimp or a talented, or even a genius man. I had never

seen the man with such spiritual power with which he would go to his new life by rejoicing and triumphing that his hour struck to spread the part of his work into the wide world.

I thought about my brother Nikolay, I remembered his note-book, I remembered the feast at Ali's, Nal, young Ali and his suffering, and... for the first time a doubt penetrated into my soul whether my brother Nikolay was able to start his new life from joy.

"Don't try to solve the equation with so many unknown quantities, my dear tracker," I. told me joyfully by returning me back to the real space and time. "You don't need to search for the answer how life is going on with so many summands unknown to you, you need to develop the energy of love in geometric and not in arithmetic progression in your own movement, in your own changing "now". And by striving for this goal, first of all help Igor to pick up all Nataliya Vladimirovna's belongings. When we are preparing to travel, you together with Zeiched set her on the camel and stay as the knight-protector for our lady who is "flashing" instead of Igor during the entire journey. Stanislav and mister Oldenkot will be riding next to me, while you will be following us. If I entrust to you to take care of this woman's safety, it means that you have to forget about yourself and to think only about her in such a way as you were doing it in that hour when you started reading the book for her in Ali's room. Now the duties which I give to you are as sacred as back then. Finally forget about yourself, think about her and don't forget Florentian's words about the abyss of people's heartbreak," I. added and patted me on the shoulder tenderly.

I.'s love and delicacy shamed me a little and delighted me at the same time. He could always understand everything and turn his every set task which seemed to be difficult to be easy and sacred. When he ordered me to pick up Andreyeva's belongings, to become her knight on the way, the wave of protest and even indignation, heartbreak due to my estrangement from I. blew over me like a whirlwind, as if I had been unsatisfied that somebody else would take my place next to my dear guardian on the way. And all of it subsided immediately, he only needed to awaken that Nataliya Vladimirovna in my memory whom I was bringing to the divine Ali's room.

I bowed very low to my wonderful educator, from his return bow and his look I understood that not only he read everything till the end within me, but that he also pardoned me till the end, then I ran joyfully to call Igor for the new work. But all of a sudden I seized myself: also now I was instructed to do something new and I started it with sadness. "Is it really the universal law?" – I was thinking by gathering Nataliya Vladimirovna's belongings into the basket and being amazed how much of everything she had put in for herself. Everything was here! And knitted headscarves which she loved to carry on her disobedient hair, and childish toys, and earrings, and mirrors, the bigger and smaller ones, as if she had prepared to give them to some desert savages, and books, and biscuits, and dates... When I couldn't devise where I could find room for them as well and when I was almost disappointed, my yesterday's neighbours went up to me.

"Oh, you place everything in a wrong way," the elder one told me and she poured out everything on the high, stone table which I had crammed in with so many difficulty and which now looked like the luggage of the wandering merchant. "We'll sort everything soon and put everything into the small palm baskets, while we'll pack the dates and the biscuits into the specially woven small bags for such things, you will tie them up to the sides of the basket. Then you can reach them without piling up the big basket."

I didn't have time even to bat an eye, and the whole work was already done. I introduced Igor to the ladies, they greeted him very heartily.

"And now let's go to breakfast," the elder one uttered.

"Don't worry," the younger one added when she saw our doubts, "doctor I. and our grandfather are already at our place. Our grandfather invites you together with your friend. He wants to treat you to our daily breakfast, so that you could better imagine our life in the desert. Besides, it seems that he has hope to ask your famous friend actor to show us all how we need to recite the great poets."

"My dear, you weren't told to tell anything," the elder one interrupted her. "Our grandfather invites both of you very much to our place now. Let's go, because the coffee will get cold," she smiled to us.

We with Igor looked at our dusty hands and clothes, our ladies noticed these looks immediately, they understood everything without any words and accompanied us to that little house with the baths where Yassa was refreshing us. Also now we found him there. The women took Eta and went down the avenue. In several minutes we, too, caught up with them already clean and with our clothes changed.

I was happy that both ladies now were chattering with Igor after finding out that my friend was also an actor and that he often used to act with Bronski in his plays. In my thoughts I was travelling together with professor...

How different my feelings were now when in my thoughts I accompanied Zalzman through the desert and back then when I was sending my thoughts to Beata. Back then I could feel neither myself nor her to be separated from the entire life, back then I was with her, with the desert, with the entire universe, with God, merged into an absolute unity, I was singing the victorious hymn of Love together with the entire surroundings... Now I could see the separated, lonely heart that didn't have enough strength yet to comprehend himself as the little part of the entire universe. I understood that professor couldn't see the little part of the Only One within man yet, that he still identified him with his visible form and about his fellow creature he judged from it. And was it a long time ago when I was thinking like this myself?..

I don't know if we were walking for a long time, but when suddenly the gigantic grandfather's figure showed up before me, I was like fallen down from heaven and I didn't comprehend instantly where I was, I made everybody laugh with this, and especially Andreyeva who was unable to restrain her merry laughter and she told me.

"Well, I would feel sorry for those whom you would be entrusted to take care of in the desert, Lovushka. Probably you would forget that unexpected storms, very sudden and dangerous, happen in the desert and you would travel after your dream by leaving all your wards to their fate."

"It is very sad, dear Nataliya Vladimirovna, that I assigned such an unwise knight like me to protect you in the desert. My entire hope is only that this time his own great love won't allow me to descend from the strongest bliss and concentration in the same way as it helped me to serve you in Ali's room. Having received this command and found out about your lack of confidence in my strength, I will try to double my diligence," I answered her without being confused from the sarcasm in her eyes – electric wheels at all for the first time, with which she was piercing me through, - and from her stinging voice, although she covered it with sincerity.

Lady Berdran came up to me, she squeezed my hand cheerfully and uttered.

"I am so happy, Lovushka. I told me that I would be riding in the same rank with you."

When I approached grandfather, he put his powerful hands on my shoulders, and I made sure instantly that Goliath turned into David, because I reached only below his shoulder and I could look at him only with my head tossed back high.

"My dear guest, I received a parcel of books from my friend sir Vomi not so long ago and I read your story. I could hardly believe when I told me that the author was a youth, almost a boy. Even if you get absent-minded for the external things many times during your life, that depth into which you have penetrated in your work already now shows clearly, regardless of your age: you are guide of the path, and the daily scales don't suit you. Allow me to thank you. I would be happy if I could direct such aspiration to goal to the universe as you do."

The giant seated me next to himself in front of the evaporating cup of coffee. Now I was already completely embarrassed.

"Don't feel shy, my dear. Here, in the desert we are used to appreciate the talents of each other especially. We don't possess any superstition of envy, no jealousy is characteristic to us. Often we compete among ourselves and we always acknowledge our defeat easily and honourably if our rival overcomes us with his talent. Also you, don't feel ashamed of my praise. I am simply happy, because I can greet that power of talents within you which will help many, oh how many people to escape the wheel of their superstitions and to understand what it means to have their uncovered eyes and ears."

He pushed some little baskets, woven from the palm filament and full of bread, some honey cakes and biscuits to me. I understood that those were the products of the oasis which were prepared from flour in different ways, but the form of the products looked like potatoes, while the colour of some of them reminded me of sugar, the others – of carrots. I didn't know what I had to eat with what, I was examining all the little baskets and I couldn't bring myself to begin.

"We have to coordinate our daily needs with the conditions of the desert. We cannot expect that the caravans which travel to us will always deliver us flour in time, because neither wheat nor rye grow here. We always mix some flour from mangos and other fruit of the mealy trees which yield a good harvest here to the bread. That's why our bread doesn't look very well and it is too white for the European's eye. Not a single man who saw our bread for the first time was so lost in thought as you are now. But also in the same way there wasn't a single European who wouldn't praise it after tasting it."

Rasul was pleasant, there weren't any little sparkles of humour in his eyes, he was looking at me with paternal tenderness. He put several pieces of bread into my little palm plate, he pushed a small, beautiful, ivory butter-dish full of fresh butter and he gave a wide, short knife to me, which also was ivory.

I paid attention not only to the beauty of the things, to the snow-white tablecloth, but also to the giant's hand. It was big, dark, but beautiful and unusually proportionate. An ancient ring with the sphinx head in which a yellow brilliant was shining was twinkling on his second finger. I thought that the prophet's cleft on the host's head would suit well for all his figure and that Rasul would look like an Egyptian prophet with it. I didn't have time to finish my thought. Rasul looked at me again, also this time the same mischievous expression was in his look, with which he looked at me yesterday by the bonfire when I saw him galloping on the camel in my thoughts.

"No," he said to me by smiling. "The famous Egyptians didn't ride the camels. They liked horses and elephants. If, in your opinion, the horse didn't hold me, then it would be worth to seat me on the elephant. Me, dark man, would look very effectively on the white elephant."

Rasul gave a merry laugh, while I, having noticed I's smile and his tender look given to me, remembered that I littered up the passing-by time with the rubbish of my thoughts, I gave a sigh and I said to Dartran.

"I committed a crime again."

"Not at all," he answered me. "Only you need to eat more, because the time doesn't wait, soon your caravan will be off."

He entrusted me to one of his granddaughters, he commanded her to give me to eat to satiety, but since I knew I.'s attitude not to eat much before the journey, I couldn't fulfil this lady's wishes and I didn't eat even a half of it to what she was treating me.

The first was the host who rose from the table, then I. and everybody else. When we went to our camels down the avenue, it turned out that only the little part of our group was left in the oasis. The whole caravan which followed us yesterday had set off a long time ago already, led by Nikita. I was very surprised and I thought how sister Carlota had to feel in such difficult journey, who used to spend the greater part of the day in bed also in the Community.

"Don't worry about those whom I haven't entrusted to you, but concentrate on and be vigilant till the end with those whom I have entrusted to you and from caring of whom I haven't yet liberated you, Lovushka," I. told me. "The old woman is sleeping soundly and she doesn't feel any difficulties of the journey. Look," he showed Andreyeva to me who was tramping by her camel impatiently which Zeiched was holding.

I went up to her quickly, called Igor, and the three of us seated the woman onto the small saddle only with great difficulty, so that she could feel comfortably and hold tight. All three of us were wiping our sweat, and anyway, if obliging and deft Yassa hadn't joined our work, we couldn't have covered her with her cloak in any way and wrapped her up strongly enough, because she was always arguing, she used to uncover herself by gesticulating and she used to set all our efforts at naught. My remembrance about the white Ali's room helped me to keep my self-control, but it helped me and not the given work. Yassa, like the tamer of a disobedient lioness, while mumbling something in the dialect unknown to me, which as it turned out Andreyeva understood, was winding the stout woman round tenderly, tenderly like the most careful nurse, and she obeyed him without even thinking to protest.

I made sure many times how much I still needed to learn. I understood clearly that also self-control could be meaningless if it was only a personal act and not the acting power. Such power that takes the emanations of the irritated encountered person into itself and extinguishes them like a tight cover which covers the dish with red hot coals tightly and which controls their fire. Now I understood why I.'s and my other high friends' influence liberated people so much and gave a blissful relief to them. Their wise self-control without any thought about themselves – without their irksome, demanding, own "I" – is pouring the energy of their love into all the work of their encountered person. I understood that I was to blame because of how successful my encounter with a man was, which feelings his encounter with me awakened within him. In this moment I could see as well as never before the abyss between that stage in which I was living and the Light in which I. was living. I sighed once again and I heard tender I.'s voice.

"My boy, get used to do every work of the passing-by moment as the most important one. Get used not to pepper your noble thoughts during your everyday work. By doing so you cause trouble not only for yourself, but also for everybody who is living next to you. Go, say good-bye to the host. I will be the knight for a while next to Nataliya Vladimirovna instead of you."

I. came up very close to Andreyeva and he began to tell something to her, but so silently that I couldn't understand a single word. We with Igor left to say good-bye to Rasul. I was searching for Bronski with my eyes everywhere by not understanding where he could be, because he rose from the table before us and went somewhere, accompanied by two dwellers of the oasis. I couldn't see him anywhere and I already almost began to worry, but... I remembered the "pepper" of my thoughts in time.

When I approached Rasul, bowed and thanked him for this hospitality, he took both my hands and said to me by looking at my eyes from above.

"I am glad today. I am glad for many days ahead that the encounter with you gave the opportunity to me to pay my old debt to you. Once your white bird was your enemy," he showed to Eta who was pressed to my leg. "This enemy killed you in one of your incarnations, but you protected me from him with your death. I stayed alive, I remembered your deed, I remembered my debt to you, but I didn't have a possibility to return at least my gratitude to you for many centuries. Accept this small thing from me. It is very old. It belonged to one Egyptian and it reminded him of an inevitable stage of development of every man's path: harmony. Take it from me. The things are rare in life which aren't sprinkled with tears, concentrated with vibrations of heartbreak and moaning. If sometimes people get the things as presents from the great living beings who possessed pure and free souls, they make talismans from them, they address for help with their prayers to them and they give the invisible currents of their suffering to them. This thing is pure. It belonged to the living being of such high spirit whose joy didn't darken at least for a moment during his entire life, although there were many apparent reasons for this. Everything what I would like to wish you from the depth of my grateful memory, - keep the integrity of your loyalty in which you are living now till the end, and the great Life will help you - guide of mankind - in those affairs into which it has led you now. No one is able to fulfil the great task which the great Life gives to him during one incarnation. Their whole range, while they follow one another, lift the powers that are hidden within man into the height of perfection as the qualities in the beginning, then as the aspects of the Only One and then they gradually create man-fire from the man-form. Your fire that has already turned into a bonfire must acquire the form of the ball, so that it would become the harmonious path for the Truth. Let this thing of high and joyous spirit help you in that great and difficult work."

Rasul gave a little plate with golden chain made of small heads of sphinx to me. The sun and its beams were depicted on the plate; the sun itself was made of the big yellow diamond, while the same, only small diamonds were shining in the eyes of the sphinxes.

Rasul's words moved me, his present fascinated me, but at the same time it upset me: again I didn't have anything what I could give to the kind host in exchange for his present. He read my thought and he said to me.

"Life which once you gave to me, - that's your eternal present, while the warmth of your heart with which you've covered me now is more worth than all the presents which you could give to me. But if you wanted to, if you felt joy to do me a favour, then I would ask you for something."

By replying to my enthusiasm to be of service to him, Rasul continued.

"There are several houses in the distant Community to which you are travelling now where the people from our oasis are living. There are lots of unfortunate people everywhere who cannot find peace in their hearts. It seems to them that not their own stubbornness drives them away from people, forces them to hold aloof from their own people, but that their surroundings don't give them possibilities to develop their possessed spiritual riches. Namely such are our stubborn people who've travelled almost all over the world, but who didn't find peace for themselves anywhere and who now are living in the distant Community. Time after time we send news and parcels from our motherland to them, but in order to send the news to them, we need that our messenger would be loyal till the end, harmonious and kind. Only through such messenger sent news won't cause the new mutiny and the paroxysm of the new negation for those unfortunate people. You could be such messenger for us. Would you agree to become the messenger?"

"You read my heart too well, so that you still would need to ask this question," I answered him. "If you consider me to be the right messenger, then I'm ready."

Rasul took not so small batch of letters from the pocket of his cloak, which were tied up with a narrow band made of the palm fibre, he put them into the small, beautiful bag, woven in the pattern of mats and he uttered by extending it to me.

"I ask you to give all these letters personally to the people to whom they are addressed. But don't give them to them instantly. In the beginning you will need to become acquainted with each person to whom I ask you to give the letter. In this case it is important to communicate with stubborn persons, so that the messenger would know and remember not only love and care of Those whose compassion and their poured energies he is spreading in the prosiness of the earth life in general, but it is important that his own active power of kindness would live and be able to pour calm into the hearts of the stubborn persons at least during that short moment until the news will be passed by cooperating with their love in a harmonious way. The messenger has to find the real self-control within himself from which his encountered person's irritability dies out. You've covered the tormenting, constant path of irritability yourself, and your loyalty helped you to enter the stage of the whole kindness. Your new path of the vigilant attention to your every encounter gives the possibility to you to rise high onto the stage of your Teacher's harmony. Not every disciple is able to rise onto the highest paths in which his Teacher is acting. Only that one enters them who was able to reach his self-control as the acting power that helps his encountered person to get rid of his oppressing passions. If the disciple is more temperamental than he should be according to the opinion of the narrow-minded and insensitive people, then they consider him to be irritable and ill-bred due to their ignorance. You'll have to come across this many times during your life, but never pay attention to the people's opinions. They estimate within the limits of their mind, while your Teacher judges according to your actions. Only that one is able to see the culture of the man's heart whose heart is beating in the rhythm of the universe. Not so many of such hearts exist on the earth, and from here the certain external isolation of the disciple arises. You shouldn't worry about that. You need to destroy the inner partitions between yourself and people, and pour into your each contact the power of energy of Those who lead you, Those who never allow you to feel the great abyss between your and their spiritual worlds while they are leading you. Become personally acquainted with each of my addresses. Learn to make the emanations of their self-love and pomposity to obey. Learn to put out the fires of their too much developed astral. Learn to include the energy of your high friend Florentian as tact and charm into each of your encounters with them. And only then give the letter to each of them. You are surprised that Francisco who also gave the letters for the stubborn persons in the distant Community to you didn't warn you about anything, but simply he told you to give them to the addressees by holding his cup in your hands. You still can neither comprehend till the end nor completely take in the power and height of Francisco's Love. His liberated Love gives such invincible power to everybody that the hand which delivers his news may be only pure. Francisco's Power, his Joy destroys all the conditionalities within people by itself, without any messenger's help. If the messenger is able to pass his news, then his heart is pure. If the messenger thought of deceiving somebody, he would be burnt down in a flash and would turn into a handful of ashes, or he would go off his head if his crime was lighter than deception, if he gave himself to his encountered people and not Love."

Having finished his speech with these words, Rasul embraced me and he told his grandchildren to give all the parcels to me which were dedicated to the same people to whom he was sending the letters.

Rasul's words and his confidence in my strength moved me very much. I didn't part with my great guardian Florentian in my thoughts, I was begging him to help my hands to remain pure and to hold

Francisco's cup by always seeing his wonderful image between myself and each of my encountered person while I am staying in the distant Community.

As soon as I could control my excitement, I saw Bronski together with a big company of young men and women coming to us. By seeing Stanislav who was radiating with great enthusiasm, I understood that he experienced a creative inspiration and that he was still seized by it. From the separate words of his talking which reached me I could understand that those were the advices for some play.

When the whole company approached us, the actor stopped as fallen down from the sky, and his face acquired the everyday expression immediately like in a fairy-tale. Worried Bronski asked.

"Am I really late? Did I keep you waiting, Lovushka? You alone were waiting here for me?"

"Don't worry," Dartran answered for me. "Teacher I. gave you some time to see our theatre and to read several immortal works for my actors. The caravan rode off forward, and as always I. didn't lose a single minute. I thank you that you helped my grandchildren to find the way out of that creative situation in which they were stuck. Of course, your advices flashed and helped them to see what the real art was. But... one thing is to understand and another one is to be able to do. In your words which you told me yesterday: to know – it means to be able to do. Don't refuse the great help for us, live with us for a while and teach us if such selfless task won't seem to be too low for your genius."

"I omit your last words by considering them simply to be the form of the eastern courtesy which I encountered already many times during my life and I always lacked inventiveness to answer properly. I don't think that you cannot see how much the achievements of your comprehension of the art and dedication to it in the desert touched me. I want to live in your place for a while and do some work with your theatre. I also have an excellent director, my student Igor, whose devotion to the art surpasses even mine. But in this moment we have another task to do. We cannot leave our great friend Teacher I. to whom we submit now, but if he allows us, then on our way back we'll stay in your oasis and do some work for as long as Teacher I. will think to be necessary to leave us here."

Yassa gave a sign to leave, and we went to the camels, accompanied by the crowd of people who were looking at Bronski like a God. Here we saw that I. and mister Oldenkot had already ridden away. Stanislav who had to ride next to I. was confused when he saw his camel that was standing alone in the palm shade.

"Don't worry, my friend," Dartran uttered tenderly. "I. took care of it, so that I could help you to catch up with him. I told to saddle my especially quick camel for you, and I myself will be riding together with you till I. An hour will fly past quickly, and you will be with I., while I will come back. Let my camel called Reckless stay with you. He received such name due to his mischievous characteristics, but having understood that he was entrusted to take care of the rider's life, he will be very loyal and persistent. He will be carrying the rider from any danger till his last breath and he will deliver the man entrusted to him to the safe or necessary place. Now Reckless understood his task. He will bring you back to our place safe and alive, although he would have to fall down dead to my feet. Sit on the saddle, my friend. Before farewell read something else for your future students."

Bronski sat down on the big camel who was brought to him, Yassa wrapped him up with a white cloak – and I saw the revived Beata's painting. The actor's face was radiating the same enthusiasm which was in the painting. He as though fell to thinking for a while, and then... I didn't even understand instantly that he was reciting the Roman chief's farewell to his people before the long and dangerous feat. His speech was so simple and restrained, his address to persons and the words of the farewell oath suited this case so well that only his last address took me back to the reality: "Citizens of Rome, whether I will

come back myself, or you will receive only the news about my death, remember: I was loyal to you, and the glory will belong not to me, but to you, to the motherland if I come back famous. Live without me in such a way, as if every day you swore to gods to protect the peace in your motherland faithfully, as I am going to conquer the glory for it in a strange land. Goodbye, adieu."

Those were the last words of Bronski's farewell. But how they were read! Rome grew before me, I forgot who and where I was, that I was only Lovushka - Catcher of Crows. I was the citizen of Rome, the oath of my chief's faithfulness was uttered to me... Oh, the power of the art, the power of the man's heart and his talent, where were the bounds of your power?

Yassa gave a twitch to me by saying that it was time to ride, that "the prickly-eyed" would get completely angry. As though I couldn't jump over some bound, I came back to myself with difficulty, I saw the cloud of dust in the distance which hid Bronski with Dartran and I went to my camel next to Andreyeva.

I was prepared to hear out her dissatisfaction and I was surprised that when I met her eyes I saw her shining tears and such meekness, such sorrow, as though she was a five-year-old...

"I understand you, Lovushka," she said to me pleasingly. "How often I used to understand my insignificance in life when I encountered the real power of a genius. If I could remember this day forever, especially this hour, I would learn an effective self-control. When I rode away, I almost blew up with my impatience and vexation for your and Bronski's delay. Now I glorify the actor. His uttered words, written hundreds of years ago, which are dead when you read them yourself, cut the ropes of passions within myself, woven by myself, and helped me to set my wings free - the only disciple's wings, if he wants to move forward, - the unconditional obedience."

Nataliya Vladimirovna didn't add anything else, but I understood that the genius of Stanislav burnt down that within her what prevented her from reaching harmony within herself. Once again I was surprised how different and unexpected the pretexts were which led us to our liberation. And how unique and long everybody's paths till that moment were when the inner fight could take one's consciousness to that stage of harmony where the light could penetrate into the most sacred corners of one's own heart.

We rode away not alone. A rather big company of the oasis men and women on excellent Arabian horses encircled and declared us that they would accompany us for as far as their grandfather would allow them, that is until they would meet him coming back from Bronski's joining I.

It was nice to see how these graceful horses were galloping as easily as toys next to our camels, how they were snorting from dust and they seemed to be more allergic to it than to the ladies who were sitting on them and exchanging a few words with us and among themselves.

We were riding joyfully one verst after another. I didn't feel any tiredness and I was surprised that this time Nataliya Vladimirovna who was always so merry and witty in company was very serious, pensive and silent. I cannot say for how long we were riding down the desert, but I think that about three hours. I started feeling tiredness and thirst little by little, but the voices were heard around instantly: "Grandfather!"

I couldn't see anybody who could look like grandfather, especially by evaluating the giant's height. I could see only the monotonous, blinding sand, but the lady who was riding next to me showed a little cloud of dust which I wouldn't have noticed without her. I didn't want to believe in the woman's long-sightedness, but after a while I began to discern the contour of the rider myself in the centre of the dust cloud which was always growing. We quickened our pace and after a while we surrounded Rasul.

Having bidden farewell to us once again, he told us that in a half hour of the way I. was waiting for us in the small oasis of nomadic Bedouins. Having blessed our way, Dartran rode away home in the company of his family.

Indeed, we saw the oasis in forty minutes and soon we joined I.'s caravan successfully.

Again the wave of the new impressions seized me. I understood the language of this half-wild tribe and I was very glad that for the first time I found the possibility to use the language learnt in the Community. I was surprised by poverty, dirt and great lack of culture of this small tribe. Having been in Dartran's oasis, in the small desert space of almost European civilization, I expected that I would find that what I saw there in this oasis as well. Now it turned out how much work Dartran needed to do and, of course, what great support and help he received from Ali. It seemed strange to me how such darkness could exist only in several hours of riding from Dartran, in which this half-wild tribe was living.

Having seen I. speaking to somebody, I came up to him and I was listening attentively to his conversation with several old men who seemed to be the chiefs of the tribe. In the beginning it seemed to me that they were dissatisfied with something, that they made a complaint against something and that they were trying to make excuses to I. for something. Then I understood that the old men settled accounts with I. for their spent money and they explained their misfortunes by introducing his recommended innovations.

"The reasons of your misfortunes – that's not the applied new methods of processing of ivory and palm fibre, which I gave to you, but only that you didn't apply the new methods till the end by working in the new way. You were always trying to unite the new and old, but I was telling you from the beginning that either you needed to do everything by using your own methods and continue to stay the poor nomadic tribe, or to settle yourselves in the Dartran's oasis, in that part of it which he chose for you. You should build shacks and a little factory there and become a prosperous tribe. Loo, how few of you remained. Don't you, old chiefs, as you consider yourselves, really understand that your youth and everything what is the best die out, because you cannot take care of your growing generation, and not because some disasters of fate are persecuting you. You state that your new generation is growing angry, it doesn't obey you and make you poor by always violating your tribe's solidarity. And I state that you don't love your nation enough. You don't take care of its future. Your laziness makes you search for the market of raw materials instead of processing the ivory yourselves and making excellent things from it according to my examples given to you. Your young generation cannot live in that darkness and dirt to which you are used. I warn you once again: join Dartran's oasis, otherwise you will all die out. When I was speaking to you last time I explained to you that every tribe may keep its vitality only in that case if its blood is revived with another blood's current which possess the embryo of the most important power needed for victory – courage. You are feeble, apathetic, and the awakened thought of your young generation cannot see the path before them through which it could direct its energy. While people who don't know where to use their energy are using it for arguments and depravity. You tell me that you understand the significance of culture for your tribe, but those are only words, you absolutely don't care of your people. Don't think that heaven to whom you teach to pray your children will send help to you, while you will be wandering across the desert by waiting for it and look indifferently how your young generation dies out. If you love your nation – act, do as I've instructed you to do and remember: you've already received the call of Life and help two times from me. Two times I showed the path to work and light for you, and both times you persuaded me of your preparation for work. And both times, having squandered time and money, you would come back to your usual laziness and darkness. I warn you for the last time: you may not stand in one place. You understand that you couldn't separate from the whole world, that you will die if you separate. Only by uniting with people from whom you can learn to work and find protection, you will be able to survive. If also this time you don't listen to my advice, then the first storm of desert will bury you, because you are too

few to withstand it. Goodbye! Don't search for any excuses. You've undertaken to lead your nation, and there isn't any love for it within you. You are trying only to deceive yourselves by stating to me that the new methods of processing aren't suited for the desert. You aren't suited for the new methods, because you cannot see the furrow before yourselves through which the power of your new generation should flow. The destruction of your young people befalls on you and nobody else. You will be responsible for them, because not God punishes your tribe, but only your laziness, unconcern and cold indifference. No special education is needed in order to act correctly for your nation's benefit and happiness. Only an especial love is needed for this, which teaches to protect man. Not God, but you are here in order to protect your people. Don't try to transfer your responsibility to God. Only that man can see God in the sky who's learnt to see and to love Him within man. Remember that what I told you now and don't wait for any help from anywhere. You can find love only within yourselves. Your love will give birth to an energy, while the energy will open the new path of work for you. You will regain your health again by working."

I. turned to his camel, he told us all to get on the saddles, and in several minutes we were already riding across the desert. This time I concentrated my entire attention on my inside. I was looking at my heart, and it seemed to me that I could find all my mistakes in it, all the gaps of my attention when entire pages of my life, not only some moments flew past absolutely uselessly.

From all heard thoughts and words tonight, Francisco's words of farewell told to me and Bronski about the distant Community, about the abyss of people's heartbreak and their disappointment before which the suffering of the misfortunate shrimps in the dining-room faded, made the greatest impression on me. Then who were living in that distant Community? Why could people drown in such sea of heartbreak? This question was always ringing in my heart, I was trying to throw my whole personalism out of it and to think only about how to carry the pure temple within myself to that little part of the world in which so much suffering was accumulated.

I. slowed down his camel's pace, we were at a walking pace after a while, and he told us.

"Now you are all concentrated and every one of you is trying to concentrate everything the best within yourselves in your own way by trying to ride into the land of sadness with your entire purity and courage. I want to direct your attention, especially vigilant your attention to how to prepare yourself to the encounters if you know that your encountered person is great martyr. I used the word "martyr", because since this night there may not be the concept "sinner" for anybody of you anymore. Everything what a man has done during his incarnations, even if it seemed to be a deadly sin for an ordinary citizen, in your understanding may be only a certain form of suffering to which you have to convey the energy of Light and courage. Does it mean that you must stand up for the thief, to help the murderer, to cover the hypocrite? Do you have to give help to every criminal without any distinguishing by estimating him as a martyr whom you must comfort? No, on the contrary, you must distinguish in a doubly attentive way how strongly your encountered person is obsessed by the dark powers. Some cases of the bonds with dark powers happen which don't leave any hope for this incarnation of the man. Those are the cases of the faded away consciousnesses when egoism and greediness has destroyed the centres of the man's nerves and brain through which the pure solar energy gets into the organism. They are living, sometimes their physical bodies are even very strong, but they cannot produce any shining matter which certainly must contain the element of active love. They are living, hence the solar matter gets into their bodies, but only as much as they need it to breathe, to eat, to drink, to move, to act, but not to create. This shining matter for creation, for life in the stages of the universe isn't enough within them. By snatching some powers of the elements, they use everything only for their personal needs and they open all the doors within themselves for the sources of the dark occultism. From which signs can you judge whether your encountered person is obsessed by the dark power, or he is only a patient who doesn't have the possibility to find love in his heart which is necessary in order to extinguish his own karmic link that is persecuting him during this

incarnation? The man who is unable to find enough strength to extinguish his karma may be unstable, irrational, puffed-up, haughty, but the most sacred Temple is always within him, with which he is walking through his daily routine. He may fall and rise again, go to the bottom due to his irritability, but he always knows the divine place in his heart, and he understands what bliss and kindness is. When you approach the man by possessing these powers within yourselves, their trembling within yourselves helps you to identify that there's the martyr is before you who is torn by his passions, and not the dark occultist. He even may commit a crime, but his consciousness isn't faded away. Simply it isn't opened, it is propped by the power of his inner passions. Such man may become free of the covered bark layer of his superstitions and preconceived opinions, he may still find the narrow path to the way of his liberation. What do you have to do in such cases? Remember what Francisco was telling you by the bonfire in the night: "From the disciple's kindness and love the layer of the hardened man's passions and vices grows softer like a wax, his pores become wide, and the sun of your Love may penetrate through them into your encountered person." Always put my words into your consciousness, which I told you many times: "If your heart is pure, no evil may touch you. He is helpless before your purity..." From what could you judge that the dark occultist is before you? Do all of them have an ugly appearance which would mean instantly that the whole power that excites your disgust and pushes you away from the man is expressed in his appearance? There are many beautiful people among the dark occultists who look even charming. The legend about the fallen angel was born from it, who was never represented as a degenerate. The appearance of these people has the same diversity of forms as the remaining of humanity. Some of them are tall, some are shortish, some also have the most ordinary forms, normal height and psyche. But what is inevitably characteristic to all people who have gotten into the camp of the dark powers in one or another way? The most important for every one of them – their egoistic aim to take possession of their encountered person's will. Even before going deep into the meaning of the meeting, the dark man uses the power of his hypnosis instantly, however he would have developed it. He is trying to turn his encountered person into his subordinate. He knows perfectly that he may penetrate the man only through some passions which every attentive man may notice. And the dark occultists learn from their first steps to see the signs of people's passions and to define the degree of their irritability. Irritability – that's the first and basic card of the dark occultists in their system of people's taking possession. They are trying to disturb the man's balance in every possible way, then they excite his fear and greediness, they catch hold of these passions with the bulldog's bite and slowly – with their iron self-control and stamina – they draw the man, his will into the orbit of their consciousness. That is the first evangelic rule of the daily routine that is characteristic to all dark occultists... The second unchangeable rule of their behaviour – that's to spread falsehood, hypocrisy in every meeting and to mislead their encountered person's consciousness and attention in such a way that he would think that he met a great, well-wishing power who would give him help and protection in his aspiration for life career. In the same way as the light power teaches everybody to comprehend that everything is in his own hands, that he himself is independent and free creator and master of his entire life, the dark occultists try to suggest to everybody that he is helpless without an external help and that only the help may open the door to success, riches, glory and honour. The light power tells every man that he is never alone, the two of them are always together: he and his Only One. Therefore, also his power doesn't have any limits as the little part of the Infinity which he is carrying in his form, and which unites him with people. An invitation to separate always is heard in the dark man's talking. The dark occultist says to his encountered person by promising all material wealth of the Earth to him for his obedience: "Don't share your wealth with anybody. Put everything what I will give to you in storerooms and keep it for yourself. If that is material wealth, accumulate it, because that is power, and you can conquer the world with it. If that is knowledge – remember that you can reach the possibility to control people's will with it. Don't share it with anybody, always try to take the position of power and fight. You don't need any friends, and you need to defeat your enemies by setting them at variance. No other possibilities to conquer them exist. You can snatch success and riches for yourself only from the arguments and hostility between them. And the crueller you will treat

people, the greater your power will be, the more you will achieve as the master of life..." These lectures are the third rule of the dark occultists' Gospel. The dark occultists take possession of many sluggish and weak-willed, jealous and greedy, irritable and denying people who are longing for an external prosperity, career and honour by acting according to these three rules. A man's negation, his egoism, his aspiration to always satisfy and to extol his "I" everywhere often bring him to the meeting with dark occultists. Man in the main may be very kind and honest. His heart may be full of love and nobility. And anyway, a protest may be bubbling in his mind against the current period, against some restrictions of his activity or he may protest participation of some unpleasant people in his activity, or against those people from whom he receives the knowledge of Light... That is the new slave prepared for the dark power, who didn't even notice when and how he got into the iron net of the dark people. I repeat: the dark occultists may look charming, they may fascinate you with their manners, their persuasions may look like the babble of the mountain streamlet to the people who don't perceive much, who cannot concentrate their attention. And when the incautious man sips only a little of this mountain water, he can feel its bitter taste, the smell that makes all passions dizzy, to comprehend where he happened to come, what evil he's woven for himself with his imprudence. Why am I telling about all of it to you and why Francisco told you that the abyss of the shrimps' pain and disappointment in the dining-room – that was nothing in comparison to the misfortune of those people whom we'll meet in the distant Community? I am telling you about it, so that you would concentrate all your strength of the awakened Life within yourselves and pour them out of your hearts with flow of joy by greeting your new acquaintances, that the flow of this invincible Joy would help all those martyrs who didn't have any peace in their hearts during their entire life to breathe in easier, to let the Light go deeper in them. Francisco was telling you about them, because he knew your purity and loyalty, he knew that you could liberate at least the smallest crack inside of each of your encountered person, through which you will pour your calm and kindness into them. All the stubborn people without exception who are living in the distant Community have encountered the dark power through their revolt in one way or another and they have served it without even suspecting it. Their puffing up was the best crack for the dark people who have fulfilled their aspirations and ideas through the poor stubborn people, while it didn't even occur to them that namely they were the conductors of evil. Everyone whom you will see saved and settled in the distant Community was saved by the white Brothers' compassion, and the entire net of the kind people protect them, through the pure hearts of whom the evil cannot penetrate. By entering this zone protected by the kind ones, carry your help, your purity, calm and joy to them. Always think not about yourself, but about those martyrs to whom you came. If anybody of you doubts whether you will be able to forget about yourself in such a way that you wouldn't get irritated for a single time, then turn your camel back to the oasis. A recluse," I. added after stopping his camel, "is living here, among these several palms. Those of you who aren't self-confident, who don't feel the infinite self-sacrifice to be the conductor or your Teacher's energies dedicated to help these unfortunate people, those whose loyalty is trembling before the necessary absolute inner self-control and uniting with your Teacher's activity, stay here and wait for the opportunity to come back to Dartran's oasis. Concentrate, every one of you address your own Teacher and submit to him unconditionally whatever he would tell you. If he commands you to come back, know that by violating his order, by acting as it seems better and more important to you, not only you won't create any kindness, but also you will weave another thread of evil. You will block the opportunity for yourself to walk forward along the path of your liberation..."

I. fell silent. We stopped in the desert, an absolute silence fell around, even the camels' breathing didn't disturb it. I concentrated so strongly on Florentian as I had never addressed him before.

"Weave the protective net around the whole caravan together with me," I heard his voice. "Weave the doubly strong net around yourself and the woman entrusted to you on the way. Remember that My knight cannot stay alone with his task on the earth, he is always standing with Me. The cup in My hand – that's your everyday affairs and behaviour. Be strong and unite the Fire of My cup with the woman

heart's Fire who was entrusted to you to protect. I. told you to protect her only on the way, while I tell you to protect her also in the Community. Don't pull off the protective net between yourself and her during this entire time until coming back home. Be blessed, follow my Loyalty."

This time I experienced the moment of merging with my dear Teacher in a special way. I didn't feel any trembling of my body, joy of triumph overflowed me, all the bonds between "I" and "not I" disappeared...

When I came to myself, I.'s camel was standing before us, smiling I. was looking at us. I cannot find any words to describe this smile. That was the smile of God and baby, of innocence and Wisdom, of kindness and power.

"Amen, my children. Carry the fruit of your Love in a courageous and joyous way, simply and by confiding in yourselves. The first its test is already drawing nearer."

We rode away. I didn't understand about what test I. was talking, but very soon I was destined to find out about it. As soon as we let our camels galloping, we saw a small cloud of dust in the distance which was coming nearer to us.

"Here it is, Lyovushka, the first test about which I. was telling us," Andreyeva who was silent during the entire time up till now told me by pointing at the growing cloud of dust.

I looked at her surprised, because I considered the cloud of dust to be a sudden wind gust which was very unpleasant, dry, which blew sand to one's eyes and nose, because I have already experienced it several times on my way.

"That isn't the wind, but a man," she added by looking at me so seriously and attentively that I was surprised by the expression of her big eyes for the hundredth time.

Her face which often was full of irony, as if she knew so much that everybody's knowledge seemed to her only as a little, worthless trifle, now was not only strict, but the severity that appeared in it surprised me. She didn't add a single word anymore, suddenly as though she forgot about me and everything else, except the cloud that was drawing nearer to us, from which she didn't cast down her eyes.

By obeying Florentian's command, I rode up to Andreyeva. Rational animals were galloping one next to another, and I could observe all the nuances of Nataliya Vladimirovna's face expression. Soon the palm tops became apparent in the distance. I. slowed down his camel, and soon the whole caravan was going at a walking pace. The cloud of dust came nearer to us so much that I could see clearly a rider on the horseback.

The rider was riding to us at a furious tempo. Without slowing down his pace, he came galloping next to the caravan and he stopped only at fifty steps from it. He turned his horse across our way, as though by commanding us to stop. The dust still didn't allow me to see the rider's face, but his horse was excellent, while he was sitting on him like a classical sculpture. His goal to stop our caravan was clear for everybody, but I. didn't slow down the pace of his camel at least for a moment. We were coming nearer to the rider, and it seemed to me that I.'s camel would come into collision with the rider's horse inevitably. When there were no more than fifteen steps left till the rider, he rose his hand and shouted out.

"Don't you understand the desert language? If I stood across the way, the caravan must stop."

The stranger's face was harsh and sharp. Now I already could see his figure and face well. He was young and handsome, but this external beauty of his was alienating due to his demonstrated

impudence and challenging impertinence with his entire pose. I thought that he was a robber, although he looked elegant and not sloven.

I kept riding forward, while the rider was still holding his extended hand. It seemed to me that the animals soon would collide one with another. When there were about five steps left, I rose his right hand a little and waved his palm and fingers hardly noticeably, as though by shaking something off his fingertips towards the rider and his horse. The rider's hand instantly fell on the horse's neck like a whip, the animal reared up like mad, he started turning round, he carried the rider away from our way in a flash, and the rider couldn't control his excited horse for a long time.

Having remembered Florentian's command and by always repeating his name, I began to weave the protective net around the whole caravan, and especially around myself and Andreyeva. Apparently, she felt my spiritual strain, she took her eyes off the rider and said to me very silently.

"Thank you, Lyovushka. A protest and dissatisfaction rose within myself when several minutes ago Ali commanded me to be under your guardianship not only on the way, but also during the entire stay in the Community. Now your pleasing care touched me. I understood that you were that power of self-control which may be the extinguisher of my irritability. Thank you, my loyal knight, I am calm. This man was hoping to arouse a passion for somebody of us and to find a crack to our will by using it. But he didn't know that he isn't equal to I. My friend, remain so attentive, protect the whole caravan with your net. I will help you from the left, while you defend the right side, I, in front is unpiercing, while Yassa who is riding in the end is a reliable protection."

Finally, the rider controlled his horse, and he gave a strict shout.

"What is going on here?! Why didn't you stop the caravan and why you frightened my horse who isn't used to such rude behaviour? You aren't a savage, and no savages are riding with you, are you? I need to talk to you, that's why I was stopping the caravan."

A very wide range of nuances of the stranger's voice surprised me very much. He started the conversation with a very impudent note, and he uttered his last words as in an apologizing, peaceful tone.

"You didn't stop my caravan," I answered him in his usual voice. "And if you try to repeat your insolent manoeuvre, that will cost you death."

"Here's how you are talking in the desert, the lord of which I am!" the stranger gave an impudent shout again, he gave a strong tug at his horse and drew back from us.

That cheered me up so much that I couldn't hold my laughter and soon I was punished for my giggling. The rider rose a little in the stirrups, he pierced me with his black, bulging eyes and he shouted in a rage.

"The puppies of your caravan insulted me, and you keep silent!"

"Stop playing act, poor man, and tell us what you need. What are you asking?" I uttered.

"I don't ask you anything, I... I... I wanted to remind you that I protect the path to this Community and that I don't let anybody in there. You can rest here, at my place if you want to. There's enough place for everybody in my oasis, but you must come back," the rider was speaking as though by choking and uttering the words with difficulty.

"I must say that you are bad watch, because much greater part of my caravan is already in the Community, while you didn't even see it, despite all your imaginary power of this part of the desert. I've

already told you that one more of your tries to stop my caravan would cost your death. Try to concentrate your self-control at least a little and ask that what you ask Ali for a long time.”

“Ali – that’s Ali, while you... phy... I don’t know you and I don’t even think to talk about my most important affairs to you, besides next to your fellow-travellers. Ali is indebted to me for a long time, and he must hear me out.”

“Ali was listening to you for many times already only because you addressed him by reminding of his old karmic debt. Unfortunately, Ali returned a hundredfold to you and he has no right to save or to listen to you anymore. You’ve already run out of all your possibilities in your respect. Compassion opens the new possibility to you; you can address me personally if you want to. Only remember that it won’t repeat for the second time.”

“I like it! On which grounds you poke your nose in my business with Ali? Once Ali was my Teacher, and it is natural that I address him in heavy hour. I don’t need any intermediaries.”

“I’ve already told you that you didn’t have any possibility anymore to be heard out by Ali. I forbid you to move from the place. You settled yourself in this oasis by persuading everybody that Ali gave his consent to you, but you yourself, unfortunate man, know better than others that Ali didn’t give anything to you. Today you have the last chance to be saved by me and protected in the secret Community, because there is no place for you, conscious villain, in this distant Community. Today you may still be saved by the power of Light, but tomorrow it already will be too late. Those your associates of the dark powers whom you deceived many times will take you by surprise tomorrow, and you may not expect any salvation or compassion from them which you haven’t showed to anybody during your life.”

The manners and appearance of the brazen-faced rider changed strongly. While I. was talking, his figure, face, eyes already reflected not only fear, but even horror. Anyway, he was trying to control himself, to bring himself not to chatter his teeth and to give some sarcasm and impudence to his voice.

“You imagine that you can frighten me? What enemies of mine are you talking about? I understand that Ali could still reproach me with something, because he warned me. Last time he even made certain terms. I promised him that I would fulfil them, and I didn’t do it. But what do you have to do with it? Perhaps you keep it from me that Ali sent you to me?” the rider finished his speech with some suspiciousness and at the same time with a concealed hope.

“Even if Ali possessed all the possibilities to save you, liar and dissembler, even then he wouldn’t stop the hand of punishment that is coming nearer to you. Because you called this hand to come yourself and only you can eliminate its threat. Besides, I’ve already told you: Ali doesn’t have any possibility to bring you nearer to himself, because you’ve sowed the only one, narrow, little path of his old karmic debt with your falsehood, thefts and fraud. Through these walls which have already outgrown yourself you will never penetrate to Ali. I offer you my help one more – the last – time. Consent to go to the secret Community immediately. You know perfectly where it is and what it is. You promised Ali that you would go there yourself and instead of it you settled in this oasis by thinking that you were protected from your former friends whom you deceived and robbed. You betrayed their secrets and by doing this you’ve turned them into your deadly enemies! I’ve already told you: tomorrow they will find you here, and you know well yourself what unimaginable torments and death awaits you.”

“But aren’t the torments in the secret Community the same where they need to work during the day and night, where there isn’t any space left for one’s own will, where everybody is occupied only in redemption of their sins, where a tedium prevails? Where is the space for man’s will there? Where could I

learn there to enslave the people's will for myself and to make them my slaves and servants? Well, you've made a great offer to me! I would rather..."

The rider didn't finish the sentence. Apparently, the thought that flashed in his mind about the real encounter with his enemies forced him to experience an unusual horror again which all passed to his appearance.

I. was sitting calmly on his big camel, and he was looking down at the rider who was simply pulled by cramps from this look. A foam appeared on his lips, he had cramp in his neck, his eyes were flinging a furious anger. He was trying to lift his hand, but instead of it he only hit his horse's withers, that one got wild, and he was trying to throw his cruel master down.

"I would agree to hide, because I know that my enemies won't be able to get there!" the rider suddenly gave a cry and fell silent, as if his heart's spasm hadn't allowed him to speak. He continued in several minutes, "And if you deceive me by wishing to lure such power as I into your nets? And will you accept my conditions under which I will agree to live in your secret place?"

I. gave a laugh and he answered him in a sonorous like metal voice in which he used to speak very rarely.

"You could make sure what a power you were half an hour ago, not only now when your – ridiculous sorcerer's – game with your charmed bells, with which you and your horse are hung, doesn't help you, because neither you nor your horse can move from the place. My messenger visited you half an hour ago and warned you, he was trying to persuade you to calm down and to come to your senses. Now Compassion says to you through me: "The possibility is given to you for the last time to withdraw from evil. If you don't make up your mind in this moment, the continuation of ages of your life will end in suffering only together with the planet's life and then will disappear from the universe, burnt by the fire of your falsehood and the whole strange blood that is on you. Choose, there's no time left, your enemies are close already."

Again, the horror shook the man. It was clear to me that now he understood I.'s words completely and their truth stunned him.

"I agree," he whispered in a hardly audible voice.

I. told him to step aside and to join Yassa until we meet a reliable convoy that will accompany him safely to the secret Community.

"A reliable convoy? During two years of my life in this oasis your caravan is the first one which I've seen. Who can ride by here?" the rider was speaking by standing aloof until we rode past him.

"Yes, this caravan which you saw is the first one for you. Exactly in the same way you didn't see anything five months ago, too, when you met a trader and considered him to be only a poor Bedouin. And he saw you and talked about it to your enemies who sent him to search for you. He was searching for you very diligently, otherwise he couldn't have avoided a terrible fate, like yours," I. answered him.

We rode up to a beautiful grove of the oasis in a half-hour, and suddenly five riders on short Arabian horses came out of the dense palms before us. Having ridden up to us, they dismounted their horses, knelt, bowed to I. and touched the ground with their turbans.

"Stand up, my friends," I. told them. "Your sins were remitted a long time ago, and never cringe to me to the ground anymore. The last job which you can still do in order to become free of the power of evil once and for all, - that's to accompany this man to the secret Community where you've found

salvation yourselves. Don't be afraid of the dark men pursuit, although they are hurrying to this slave of theirs. Ride calmly and boldly, there will be the sandstorm between you and your persecutors. It will hide your tracks and set all the efforts of the persecutors at naught. Accompany my entrusted traveller to you in such a way as if I was riding together with you myself."

I. turned back to Yassa and uttered.

"Yassa, give the packet with clothes to this man, which I told you to take with yourself from oasis, and give the food to him which Kastanda left to you."

"Change into the clothes given to you," I. addressed the rebellious rider. "Give your tired horse to Yassa and get on his camel. You won't ride even up to the rocks in the desert on your horse, not to speak of the secret Community."

I didn't see the rider's face, but I could feel his protest and dissatisfaction with my every nerve. Only fear forced him to obey. He was grumbling and dressing for a long time even with Yassa's help, while I. was talking to the encountered five riders. I took a good look at their faces, and I was very surprised. It seemed to me that behind their current calm and tender expression another one – impudent and angry was hiding like behind a curtain. It seemed to me that the muscles of these faces suddenly would strain and the same fire of hatred and irritability in which the rebellious rider was burning would light in them, but no matter for how long I was looking at them, the Bedouins' faces didn't change, they remained calm and tender.

Finally, the rider clumbered up on Yassa's camel and rode up to I. Having looked at him attentively, I. addressed the Bedouins.

"My friends, here's your fellow-traveller. Remember how many years ago, in the same desert I saved you from your enemies who were persecuting you, what horror had obsessed you back then and how the storm hid your tracks by drifting the impassable sand dunes between you and your persecutors. You couldn't break off relations with your dark enemies for ten years. You used to respond to their anger with your hatred and fear, that's why they were still holding you under their control stronger than iron chains. Only the next ten years have taught you to forgive your enemies, and finally your hearts opened like a wide gate during the last five years. Love poured out of your hearts, and you forgave your enemies, you blessed your tormentors. Now the last boundary of selfless Love emerged before you: give the son of evil back to it. That's why I summoned you here. Ride, my friend. The reliable convoy will protect you. Call for my power to help both during this journey and in the Community," I. addressed the rider. "Think not about the difficulties of this day, about that difficult day when your passions are tearing you and prevent you from seeing anything else, except yourself. Think that your entire life up till this moment when you seemed to be powerful for yourself didn't bring any joy for you. Think about how you must understand what joy is. And as soon as you feel it for the first time you will open an invincible abyss for the dark people. Joy leads one to victories of Love, while black melancholy – to stubbornness of will. Stubbornness of will – that's the tool of evil. It may not operate where joy is living."

The man didn't utter a single word. While sitting high on the camel, surrounded by the guards who were sitting on their short horses, he looked like a criminal who was being taken to the place of punishment, so angry his look was, his whole figure was spreading such a hopeless anger.

I. gave a sign with his hand, the Bedouins bowed to him in the Eastern way, they surrounded the rider on the camel in silence, turned right at a trot, made a detour round the oasis and disappeared behind the dense grove of palms in the same sudden way as they had appeared.

Having waited for a moment and accompanied the riding away group attentively with his eyes, I urged his camel forward, he turned to the completely unexpected direction for me, straight to the left. Only now when we started riding again, I could evaluate my behaviour during this encounter. Unfortunately, I had to admit it to myself that also this time I was “observing” and not “acting” in that sense as the Gospel of the grey daily routine of my life in the Community was teaching me to do, that is to be and to become. I experienced all the feelings of the unfortunate, lost in life man very clearly, but I didn’t pass the power of my self-control to him, which I understood myself as an effective power of help that helped the encountered person to extinguish his passions and to become free from them at least during the meeting.

Why couldn’t I act like this if I understood how I needed to act? Why was I unable to pass the energy of my love to the unfortunate, suffering soul? And again, I answered to myself: to know – it meant to be able to do, while I only knew, but I was unable to do it. Again, I forgot about everything, about everybody, I forgot about time, space and I was always thinking about the poor rider...

“And now, Lyovushka, it is the most suitable time to remember Florentian’s task given to you and to become Nataliya Vladimirovna’s knight,” suddenly I heard I.’s voice.

I gave a start with surprise, I looked left and right, I was even more surprised that probably nobody heard I.’s voice, except me, and I concentrated my entire attention on Andreyeva.

I understood instantly that Nataliya Vladimirovna experienced the encounter differently than I did. Her eyes were radiating with energy, her face was pale, thin, her lips were strongly compressed, while her entire lumbering figure was concentrated into the fist of fire. I cannot find any other words to describe this impression. I perceived her like a loaded cannon from which the shells were breaking out in a continuous stream. I didn’t ask her anything, I knew myself well where her shells were flying, I knew that she was sending the enormous power of her spirit not only to the unfortunate, furious rider, but also to his entire protection.

I inclined my head before her spiritual grandeur. I understood how high her spiritual culture was and how nobody could ever penetrate the most secret other man’s temple until his own heart was still living by comprehending his encountered person only as the combination of the certain characteristics.

We were riding at such pace for about twenty minutes, and the contours of the walls with towers began to appear before our eyes, and behind them – the tops of the trees, the roofs of the houses here and there. I didn’t expect that the distant Community occupied such a big territory.

“I’ve never been here, Lyovushka,” Andreyeva said to me. “Although Ali himself was teaching me many things which were a forbidden zone for others, he didn’t allow me even to come near to this place for many years. I couldn’t understand why he forbade me to do it. I never asked him about it, because I understood a long time ago that only common citizens were weighing and thinking after receiving their Teacher’s instructions. While disciples know that they need to obey immediately and to fulfil the instruction. Today I received the answer to my unvoiced question. This just experienced encounter explained everything to me. There wasn’t any peace, complete reconciliation with my own circumstances in my heart up until this moment. Now when I saw not only the whole life of this poor man who got entangled in the nets of evil voluntarily, but also of those five martyrs who served evil through their ignorance and compulsion, I found the power in my heart to comprehend the law of Wisdom in every phenomenon of man’s life. I was indignant at innocent people’s misfortunes and suffering – as it seemed to me according to all external and visible signs. And in general, any path of the people who were walking it down in suffering used to disturb my balance. I was always prepared to open my arms for everybody by wishing to help them. The most important thing what I didn’t understand, - there wasn’t any peace within myself. And that desire

of mine to help everybody forced me to rebel, to defy, to condemn the actions of those who were higher than me and who possessed all the necessary powers and possibilities to help them, as it seemed to me. This most important thing opened for me now. I understood that you cannot always help a man, because the first obstacle hides within himself that prevents from doing it. The man's superstitions chain him so much that he accepts his loyalty to some friendship, love or belief understood in his own way as the unforgettable, unshakeable truth, as the greatest light and the goal of his life. For such a man who only personally comprehends kindness and the entire life, the rest of the universe with its laws of Life, karma and accuracy, regularity which accompany it, seems like a dead chaos to him where undeserved grievances and suffering fall to his lot. Now Ali helped me to see the lives of these encountered people. The first one was serving the dark occultists by knowing their goals well and by longing for some awards from them and possibilities to get as many valuable things of life as possible for himself as he understood them. Being afraid of the difficulties of the path next to Ali, he wanted to achieve glory, power and riches easily. When he understood that the science of the dark occultists is not only difficult, but also horrible, he escaped, deceived and sold costly that part of their poor secrets which he succeeded to find out. The hour of his settling a score with them would have been terrible if not I.'s compassion. Ali couldn't save him, because there wasn't a single aspect of Purity left within the man, to which Ali could have cleared the path. Now I. will settle him in the secret Community where only the same unfortunate people are living who are connected to the dark people, but who once belonged to the lodges of the White Love Brothers. Five riders who came on horseback later, on whose faces the signs of their experienced horror are left till now, couldn't be saved from the power of darkness in time. I. was trying to do it many years ago. These madmen had another friend in whom they believed, they chose him as their chief and always followed him everywhere. Once this chief explained to them that the great spiritual master called him by wishing to give a high consecration to him. The truth is that he came to the dark occultists, he promised them to bring five new slaves if they opened their great secrets to him. He found out a part of the secrets of the dark occultists through big suffering, only by destroying all human feelings within himself – compassion, kindness, love, sympathy, pity. The time to get even came. He had to bring five promised slaves to them – the slaves who obeyed unconditionally the whole gang of the dark occultists who had the net of spies all over the world. Our encountered five men were burning with loyalty and love for their chief. I. warned them several times through his disciples about their friend's treason. He sent the messengers to them many times who wanted to open their eyes to the truth. Finally, I. found the possibility to see them himself, he told them that all their friend's invitations were a lie, that he was attracting them to the trap where death awaited them in the dark people's place. Even meeting I. didn't help them. That what they called to be loyalty for their friend in their obscured consciousness forced them to serve the dark occultists at the instruction of the same friend of theirs, that is to say for his salvation. The unfortunate people covered a horrible way: they allowed the dark occultists to take possession of them always more until they finally understood from their own experience that they were only toys in the hands of the traitor and apostate. Then hardly staying alive after torments and horror they were crying for I., they were begging him to help them to die if it wasn't possible to save them anymore. And compassionate I. saved them. Lyovushka, how much power of heart man needs in order to understand the Truth and its divine Law about which we try to judge impudently without even understanding what we are talking about. All of it has opened for me now. All Francisco's words laid together into the strict system of creative power in which everybody who is creating may create only with a complete peace of his own heart. No searching for the truth, for the path of liberation or for life dedicated for love is possible until there's no harmony in man himself..."

I couldn't see anything around me. Andreyeva's words horrified me, how strongly one's personal passions and personal perception could blindfold one with conditional bands. That's why when my camel suddenly stopped, as though I fell from the sky, knocked out of the monotonous rhythm of his steps.

We were standing next to the high wall, built from white, even stones which reminded me of the walls of Ali's little house. Several brothers who were wearing white clothes opened the wide gates behind which I could see a crowd of people, dressed in white, brown and grey. When we rode in through the gates, I understood that we were riding down the short and wide lane of the park. I dismounted the camel with difficulty, only with Yassa's and Nikita's help, who rushed to me. I put a sweet into my mouth immediately, and I felt strong instantly.

I ran to help Nataliya Vladimirovna. Together with indispensable Yassa we liberated her from all her shrouds and bands, and we left Nikita to take lady Berdran out of the saddle. The poor woman was so stiff that Laliya and Nina who came to help her took her with them immediately by almost carrying her on their shoulders, while Andreyeva was strong and fresh, as though she hadn't been riding across the desert during the entire day.

An old man with white clothes came up to I., he had a stick in his hands, and his face was so bright and radiant, as though a cloud of light was covering all of him.

"Welcome, Teacher, you've come in time, oh how in time, my dear," he was talking, he embraced I. and kissed his hand.

I. bowed low to the old man, he kissed his hand in which he was holding his stick and answered him.

"Peace to you, Radanda. Those who sent me, give the new tasks to you, but not a liberation from them."

A light, little cloud of sadness covered the bright old man's face for a moment, but soon he lit up in joy and looked at us with his wonderful blue eyes.

"The tasks are new – well then, also the new Light will come. Peace to you and to those who sent you. I thought that my time already passed. Well then, I was wrong. Come closer, my friends, let me embrace you," he addressed us all.

He embraced and blessed each one of us. He was looking at everyone's eyes, he was smiling to everyone, and he greeted everyone, but in such a silent voice that only that one could hear his whispered words to whom they were dedicated. He said to me.

"Write about people in a simple way."

Although I was already accustomed that many people could read not only man's thoughts which worried him at that moment, but also describe his entire character and all his characteristics in a flash, I was surprised that he answered to the question which was tormenting me for a long time.

Many people estimated my creative work highly. Rasul – who was the last one who was talking to me about it – instigated the fire of my creative anxiety even stronger, which was always burning me with the question: how should I write? Suddenly the old man in the desert dispelled my entire anxiety with one word: "Simply." Yes, he showed me the way. This word explained the man writer's strength to me: how to describe people's types, but... what an abyss of wisdom the writer's heart should hold so that he could talk "simply" about his own or another's life?

I didn't have much time for considerations. The old man Radanda who turned out to be the chief of the Community accompanied us personally across the park in which there were many wonderful flowers and still unseen blooming trees. He brought us to a modest, white house that looked like a cloister hotel.

"I pass this house to you, Teacher. Let everybody who came personally with you settle here. Those whom you've sent before already settled where you desired, as Nikita told me."

The old man bowed low to I., then he smiled to us all and whispered: "Be blessed" he left. While my eyes could see him, it seemed to me that he was not walking, but rolling like a big ball by shining in all rainbow colours.

I. told men to occupy the upper floor, to leave the corner room personally for him and he offered the ground floor for the women.

Having remembered my chivalrous duty, I helped Nataliya Vladimirovna to settle and to place her plentiful luggage in that small room which she chose for herself. She surprised me by going past several big, comfortable rooms and choosing a small, white cell which could hardly hold a narrow bed, a little table, a wardrobe and a chair.

Having taken care for the lady, I came upstairs and met I. by his room which was separate from others. I wanted to ask him where I had to live myself, but he said to me by guessing my question.

"Lyovushka, the chief offered me to pick out a servant brother for connections with the members of the Community, because the distances are very big here. Would you agree," he gave a laugh, "to take this important post of my secretary and messenger? And would you like to settle next to me? Have in mind that you will have to run a lot in the Community and to train your memory."

I. didn't need to add anything else, because my fascination was beyond my limits. I fell myself on my dear guardian's neck and soon I could feel bliss and lightness in my heart from his return embrace.

In the same moment I felt the whole weight of my white-feathered friend on my shoulders, because he didn't forget his habit and he even gave a sharp cry by expressing his greatest joy.

Having heard Eta's shriek, Bronski and Igor rushed out of the door. While everybody was laughing so merrily, I received the first I.'s command already as his secretary.

"Tell everybody who came with us that the joint supper will be in an hour in which all of us have to participate without exception. Everybody must be dressed in white, clean clothes. Everybody will find them in his wardrobe. The women's bath is on the right side of the house, while the men's one is on the left. Warn everybody to be prepared in forty-five minutes and to wait outside, by the door. I will take you to the dining-room myself in which everybody will have to keep silence. Don't be late yourself."

I left to fulfil my first task in the Community, of course, my friend Eta accompanied me.

I was the first one who came to the agreed place in the fixed time.

Chapter 18

The dining-room. The events after the supper.

My new perception of the paths of people's lives

As soon as I sat down on the small stairs of the porch and stroked white as snow Eta's feathers, I heard quick steps and saw Nataliya Vladimirovna in the doorway. She was always one of those whom we needed to wait for if only she wasn't especially interested in something, but now she surprised me not only with her haste, but also with lightness of her movements and walk. Simply I didn't recognize this woman since that time when we rode out of Dartran's oasis.

"This time, Lyovushka," she said to me without any irony and humour, "I wanted to outrun everybody and anyway, I came later than you, although I saw how you with Eta were hurrying somewhere down the lane. I would like to help you very much and to express somehow my great gratitude for your gentlemanly behaviour not only with me, but also with everybody else. I still didn't see any dissatisfaction in your face for a single time or hear a single condemning word. While dressing and preparing myself for the difficult moment in the joint dining-room, I perceived clearly that what you, a boy, have achieved and I felt ashamed for my lagging behind in certain questions."

“Why do you think, Nataliya Vladimirovna, that meeting with new people in the dining-room is such a difficult moment?” I asked her, because this first meeting seemed to be pleasant and extremely interesting to me.

Nataliya Vladimirovna didn't have time to answer me. I. showed up in the doorway. I used to see him charming, but I couldn't get used to his face in any way. Every time it looked different to me. This time I suddenly understood that not I.'s face was changing, but always new possibility used to open for my eyes to see something more in this face, something which I couldn't see in it before. In the same way I found out not so long time ago that I didn't know even one thousandth of I.'s activity and that I could see only that what I encountered directly, besides I didn't comprehend the whole of that part at all.

Almost in a flash I experienced in my memory the entire period of my life from the feast at Ali's. My tears in the carriage and I.'s conversation with me. Separation with Florentian in Moscow. Despair of the first moments. The storm in the sea... I bowed low to I. without having any other way to express my endless gratitude to him and great honour for the whole superhumanly high compassion showed to me. Actually, only the higher living being could behave in such a way as he did with the small being as I was. When I straightened myself after my low bow, I saw his sincere smile and I heard his voice of the unique kindness.

“Everybody gathered here, very good. Our clothes shining with whiteness must correspond to that calm and joy in your hearts with which we will enter the home of sadness. Perhaps, nobody from you will notice any external signs of sadness in the people's faces. Perhaps, some of you won't be able to penetrate the infinite inner sadness of the people's hearts. But of course, everybody will feel into how difficult atmosphere he entered, and for everybody it will be even physically difficult to breathe in the atmosphere of the dining-room. So go there and give your joy, your Teacher's will and Love as help in a heroic way to the unfortunate martyrs. Once again, I remind you: according to the rules of this Community life you must keep silent in the dining-room. Only the chief may speak in it or that one to whom he will offer to speak.”

I. looked everybody up and down, smiled to everybody, looked at Eta – it already seemed to me that he would tell me to leave the peacock here, but he uttered.

“Take the bird in your arms. You will leave him to the gatekeeper by the entrance to the chief's house where we will drop in before.”

I took Eta as I. ordered me to do, the bird was very pleased with it, and we went down the wide lane in the already descending twilight by breathing in the aroma of wonderful flowers. In about fifteen minutes we went up to a little island which as it seemed to me in the beginning was isolated from the whole park with a big canal, full of water. Later I found out that a rivulet formed the island, which flowed out from the rather far away, from the lake in the park hills. We approached a small bridge and stopped in the little meadow in front of the small, old house built from the white stone.

I. was going first, I, Andreyeva, Igor and Bronski followed him, as well as lady Berdran, Nikita, Laliya and Nina who joined us. Yassa and Theresita were going the last. I couldn't see anybody else from our caravan. I also thought about sister Carlota, about the enraged monk, about all those whom I took with himself and who were not travelling with our company. Will they also come to the dining-room, or perhaps their life will begin differently here? I remembered the “pepper” of my thoughts in time, I concentrated my attention on the passing by “now”.

I. entered the house of the Community chief Radanda alone, while we remained standing silent in the meadow. Having looked at my fellow-traveller's faces, I understood how strongly they were all

concentrated and how they were trying to be effectively kind deep in their hearts. I became ashamed of my absent-mindedness, and I followed their example. I showed up in the doorway in several minutes by holding the chief's arm.

Both of them stopped shortly and looked all of us up and down. I was surprised that the chief didn't tell me anything about Eta. Again, Radanda seemed to me like a rainbow ball, but I cannot say whether that was the play of the risen Moon's light, or the illusion of the big stars light reflected on the water. It seemed to me that also I. was walking in the shining ball by drawing the whole Radanda's ball into his own radiance, so now Radanda's radiance was lack-lustre and diminished in comparison to I.'s one. I couldn't take my eyes off this new, inconceivable phenomenon to me. I could tear off this wonderful view not only with my external vision, I was all lost, as though I melted in happiness, in joy to live. Kindness and power simply filled me up. It seemed to me that kindness and power were pouring into me from I.'s ball and overflowed my entire consciousness. By smiling joyfully Radanda raised his hand and blessed us all. We were happy, cheerful, fearless, we desired to love and serve our own people effectively and we followed our chiefs. I say "we" and not "I", because in this moment there weren't any personal barriers left in a single of us – all of us merged into one totality in this harmony which the higher brothers were radiating to us.

An exceptional peace descended into my soul, the same peace, calm and light which overflowed me when I read the records in the green book that I found on my altar...

The dining-room wasn't so far away. Having come to the gatekeeper's little house, the chief stopped, turned back, smiled and waved me with his finger.

When I approached him, he said to me.

"My friend, give your bird to this gatekeeper. Although he was appointed here not so long time ago and he still didn't have time to find out all the rules of our Community, but he is kind man. Besides, you and your bird know him."

I was surprised again. Whom could I know in the Community? And even such a man whom also my bird knew. I couldn't see the gatekeeper's face in the dark. When the light from I. and the chief illuminated the gatekeeper who came out of his little house, I cried unawares: "Mulga!"

Cooing bird jumped in Mulga's arms himself. While smiling with his whole mouth and stroking Eta's back, Mulga nodded to me pleasingly, as if by wishing to tell me that I shouldn't worry about the bird.

"While we are having supper, keep the bird by yourself and fulfil all the duties of the gatekeeper in a strict and categorically precise way. I command you not to let anybody into the dining-room today, not a single spirit. According to the rules of our internal life, nobody has the right to be late for eating or to disturb anybody by inviting him from the table. Don't let those who are late now in in any way, however they would ask you, whatever arguments they would give to you. Even if somebody of them told you that a man is dying and that he calls somebody from the dining-room, remember my command and fulfil it categorically. So that it would be easier for you and no doubts would break your heart, remember: nothing prevents my eyes from always seeing my entire Community and everything what is going on in it. If a matter arises, I will come out first or I will send somebody to help. Remember this, my friend, and stand like a guard in the post, protect calm of the people who are eating."

I. looked at me.

"Lyovushka, I warned you that we would need to keep silent. Now concentrate your entire attention even stronger, my boy. Place Florentian's image between you and everybody whom you'll see here and act, act, act by loving and overcoming with your complete creative self-control. My friends, everybody remember what "kind" is," I. added with tender, soft voice and as though he poured the flow of kindness into us straight from his big heart.

We passed round a high, thick wall, entered the inner yard, illuminated by high lanterns and the light spreading through the big windows, and we went up to the big as temple's door.

Through the door we got into the wide, perfectly lit up corridor, although I didn't understand what and how illuminated it from above. It seemed to me that also above the windows were shining, but I was afraid of becoming absent-minded due to my external observations, I was trying to keep the image of my great guardian Florentian in my heart. Somebody took my arm. I saw Nataliya Vladimirovna next to me. Again, she looked to me like back then in the desert, the canon loaded with a thousand shells.

"Lyovushka, I am next to you. Don't forget to include me into your protective net," she whispered me.

"I don't know how to do it," I answered her by squeezing her hot, nervous hand.

"Place Florentian's image between yourself and me, include also me into every action of your thought and heart by thinking as "we" and not "I", she answered me by still holding me with her hot hand and as though by merging her power with my entire essence.

So, we entered the dining-room like this, hand in hand. Now I could feel her as my closest sister, as my mother, guardian and protector, which I hadn't experienced in my life.

My heart was beating strongly, joyously, as if I was coming not into the house of suffering about which Florentian was talking, but into the feast of Life and Light. Two old men in white clothes opened high, wide door of the dining-room before I. and Radanda, and we entered the big hall, full of long, narrow tables. The people who were sitting behind the tables stood up when we entered, and they were greeting us by bowing low.

The table that was standing by the entrance was half empty. The chief stopped next to it and bowed to I. by inviting him to take the first place from the right. He seated me and Andreyeva next to I., he allotted the others' places in such a way that Nikita and Yassa were the last who were sitting from us, next to the members of the Community, and they as though made a barrier between us and them. While we sat down, everybody remained standing.

When I. and Radanda sat down, everybody bowed to them again and only then they took their places. Several brothers began to bring the food on all tables at the same time. How everything was different from Ali's Community here! Laughter and merry talk were heard there, while a solemn silence of the grave prevailed here. They used to bring all kinds of food there to the tables covered with white tablecloths, decorated with flowers. Everybody used to take as much different food as they wanted. The tables were also white here, they were made of the white palm timber, clean, polished, but they weren't covered. A wooden, little plate with bread like the one from Dartran's oasis was placed before each man, as well as a wooden spoon and a small paper napkin. Serving brothers were carrying a not very big clay dish with soup for everybody.

Nobody even touched the food until the chief took the spoon in his hand and began to eat. Since I was afraid of doing something wrong, I was flinging my eyes at I. and I began to eat only when I saw that also he was eating. I must confess that when we were going to the dining-room, I felt hunger, but now

when I saw such unusual surroundings, I was prepared not to concentrate my attention on the food. It seemed to me that I didn't want to eat at all, because this sea of strange people into which I got affected me so much.

The people who were sitting at the tables surprised me with their behaviour of two kinds: some of them were looking attentively at us, as though by wishing to remember every one of us, while others were sitting with their hung heads, without lifting their eyes, as though by protesting against our intrusion into their kingdom. I felt a light tap from Andreyeva's side, I suddenly remembered that not only I failed to weave the protective net, but that again I was only observing. I looked at her and I almost uttered "Thank you", but suddenly I felt a blow into my forehead that reached me from Radanda. Automatically I raised my eyes at him and suddenly – I don't know it myself and I cannot say how – I understood that he told me to notice everything what I saw here and to pay an especial attention to the adjacent table from the left side.

Again I cannot explain how I understood that namely those stubborn people were sitting at this table to whom I had to give the presents from Dartran. For the first time in my life I understood the mute language and I saw how Radanda's thoughts were flying into me from his ball, how the little pieces of his rainbow of light merged clearly and precisely with my consciousness, how they became the images in it.

And what is more, I could feel the power which Andreyeva was pouring into me by helping me to concentrate my thoughts. Now I concentrated my entire attention on Radanda's indicated table. Men and women of different ages, from young to absolutely old were sitting there. One figure surprised me especially. That was a very tall man, he was similar to Dartran with his height and dark skin, but with his impudent, rebellious and challenging face expression he reminded me of the monk Leonore who attacked me in that memorable night when I with Florentian was going to professor's and Theresita's.

This time I wasn't thinking about this man's character and type. I was begging Florentian to hold the entire purity in my heart, so that I had enough strength to fulfil the task which Dartran gave to me. Unexpectedly, I felt shyness from the thought that I was responsible for all future encounters, the success and misfortune of which depended only on the purity and love of my heart.

The serving brothers brought porridge on the tables, but the chief still didn't take the spoon in his hand, and everybody was sitting in an absolute silence. Then he took the spoon, swallowed a little bit, and everybody's hands rose with spoons.

It seemed to me that Radanda was lifting his spoon only for the sake of appearance, because actually I could see only a very little porridge in his plate. Having eaten another bit, he put the spoon down and began to speak.

"Last time I was telling you, my brothers and sisters, about what patience was, why every man needed it and how nobody could achieve self-control without it. I was also telling you about hospitality, about benevolence with which everybody has to meet his guests. Especially those who come to our Community after covering the long and tiring desert way. Let everyone of you answer himself whether he was a hospitable host now, whether he was pouring love by greeting and meeting his guest. The Great Teacher is with us now. He has gathered the most of us here himself, he accompanied us here, saved us with his compassion and... except several of you who greet him respectfully, from the bottom of your heart, most of you now are occupied only in a critical observation of his fellow-travellers or in a meaningless revolt due to the imaginarily disturbed your life's tranquillity. My poor, poor stubborn people! My heart holds you for many years, my calm covers you, my joy leads you forward, but anyway a negation is the first that rolls from your spiritual waves. Your negation which you had already understood as a meaningless delusion for so many times, as a sheet of conditionalities which covered your eyes, today is again the same

persistent and it prevents you from finding self-control. Our high guest, Teacher I., will be telling you about self-control. Once again you will understand from his words that only that person who's found the strength within himself to mature the self-control of his entire energetic structure, of his conductor, is able to find the path to creation. While you – only with a small exception – are always proud of your creative talents without even comprehending that man's creation starts only from that moment on when he can get into the channel of harmony in at least a short moment. My dear, my beloved children, listen to the great Teachers' words. Oh, how not soon you will hear his cry again. Don't miss the flying past moment when Compassion is sending its light to you. Not that is important that after seeing your Teacher off you will always remember his words, you will meditate on them and repeat. In this moment it is important to be able to overcome the trifles of conditionalities within yourselves and to comprehend the word of Grandeur that descended upon you. Upon you who are always searching, always trying to prove to yourselves that your misfortunes are not within yourselves, but in the outer world and that life which you are living now isn't created by yourselves, but that it is the wave of sadness that got into you from exterior. Great Teacher, don't refuse to utter your miraculous word to us."

Radanda stood up and bowed low to I., I. answered him by bowing, he bowed to everybody present here and he began his speech by standing.

"My dear friends, my close brothers and sisters. I haven't seen you for many years. I haven't separated with you in my thoughts for many years. I haven't seen you for many years. I haven't separated with you in my thoughts for many years. There wasn't a single day that I would forget to send my greeting of love to you, as well as there wasn't such a case when somebody of you who addressed me with his entire faith and loyalty wouldn't have received my response and help. We'll still have time to talk to every one of you separately about his affairs. During this first hour of our meeting let's summon everybody from the depths of our liberated heart only joy hidden there. Let this moment, as well as every moment of creating Love tear to pieces all the chains of conditionalities which prevent us from communicating with fire and spirit. The tranquillity which I've brought to you today isn't only the tranquillity of my heart, but it is from the whole Bright Brotherhood which entrusted me to give its greeting, love, recognition and assistance to you. Your greatest suffering that brought you to the ranks of the rioters, stubborn and negating people arose because you weren't recognized by your period of time, your surroundings, your compatriots or people from other countries where you were searching for your popularity and recognition. But is it really the goal of the high man life's on the earth? The only goal of the man who has awakened for Life, that is for creation – that's to develop and fulfil the Divine plan on the earth with his activity. Every one of you not only knows, but even knows too well how the paths of the man's universal evolution are happening. So, who used to lead you astray from those paths along which those who serve the Bright Brotherhood are walking by helping it to fulfil the worldwide tasks for the mankind's help and growth? If you look attentively at your heart, you will see that not lack of love, selflessness or energy forced you to go out of the way of the truth and kindness, but only lack of joy and self-control. Let's think what self-control is? Is it the capability to control all your bodies, feelings, thoughts and words? No. Although for many ordinary people even such self-control is out of reach, and it is their ideal and dream. But for the disciple – for the man who desires to become the member of the Bright Brotherhood, – such self-control isn't even the initial part of his searching for the path. It is only the period of infancy by preparing for the meeting with Those before whom you may not be standing covered by your passions and riot... Well then how does the first quality of self-control reveal itself for the man who is searching for the path to the Bright Brotherhood? The first stage of the disciple's self-control – that's an ordinary acknowledgement of himself and everybody else as the equal quantities of the universe. The equal carriers of the Only One Living Being who pours his Power, Light and Calm into the entire universe. If the man's heart is free from the superstition of inequality, then he doesn't attach any importance that he is more talented than his encountered person. He doesn't feel his talents. He is hurrying during the day by pouring the powers of the

Only One revived within himself into all his affairs and encounters. And therefore, not only he doesn't wait for any rewards or praises, but he pours the beam of Light out of himself and draws into it everybody who comes nearer to him. Therefore, he carries an unshakable calm – the aspect of the Only One within himself. He doesn't need to always take care of the twinkling torchere, to persuade himself with his mind, the efforts of his will to remain calm, wisely patient and to live his day easily. You understand yourselves that with such unstable self-control when painful, spasmodic knots accumulate in all man's nerves, he doesn't have a possibility to think only about that person whom he encountered, because the rubbish of his own twinkling torchere has whipped the hard partition between himself and his encountered person. The Bright Brotherhood is sending the recognition to you, which you were striving for so much among your contemporaries and which you didn't reach, that's why the bleeding wounds have opened for many of you. It recognizes you as equal to itself. It gives its protection to you. It is sending its Love, its energy, its joyfulness to you, so that kindness would open in your hearts. The most ordinary kindness for people whom you recognize to be equal to you, in the same way as the Bright Brotherhood recognizes you to be equal to itself and to be worthy of respect. From that moment on when man understands once and for all that he is the centre of his encounter, that he is spreading that chord with which his entire day is ringing, the new power and the new path strengthened from all sides will open for his self-control, because he is calling for the vibrating beam paths of the Bright Brothers with emanations of his kindness and devotion, and he merges with them. From that moment on he may accept them as his own protective ring in which all his future actions and encounters will happen. The thought that your encountered person is still far away from your possessed knowledge, from the subtlety of your feelings and thoughts with which you are living, gives you the right neither to separate from him nor to justify your activity however high you would consider it in your "now". If the Bright Brotherhood till the very top of its hierarchy thought like this, then the mankind wouldn't have reached anything anywhere in its universal evolution. But on the contrary, you can see that nobody lacks the Bright Brotherhood's attention, that nobody is left without its help. And what power and joyfulness of this help is, you, everybody present here, may judge from your own example, from that assistance of the Bright Brotherhood that was given to you by saving you who suffered and became confused in your life. Every man's brilliant features may never get into that organism, in the heart of which the depth of Love hasn't created the most sacred adobe. The streams of the creative power are pouring only from this depth, only from it man can see and hear the high Creator's emanations, who is sending His power onto the Earth through millions of channels. To command yourself to create in exactly the same way is impossible, as it is impossible to teach another person to take over the system of your creation. In order for any teacher to be able to teach his disciple at all, it is necessary that he would comprehend the source himself, through his experience, from which the creative wave is pouring. Besides, the teacher needs to be able to adapt himself to his disciple's thinking and the way of comprehension of his flying past life. Only then he will be able to understand his disciple and to try to find such a system of teaching for him that the disciple himself could find out how to liberate his will and power from the personal pressure of his small, low passions and disfigured, flashing thoughts. Having looked over your life from coming to this Community, your first years of life in it and all the rest till the very last moment here, in this room, can you say that you considered and still consider uniting with people as your primary and the most important business? Can you say that after waking up, first you were weaving the thought for the breaking day: to share your work with the Bright Brotherhood, to contribute to the common plan of work of the Bright Brothers with the little part of your self-sacrifice? While possessing knowledge, you were delighted only with your personal life. You were telling that you were so interested in the activity of the common education – and externally as though you were acting in such a way. But actually, you were interested in this only as much as your own personality was growing and developing in that activity. The hour has struck for everybody without exception to move forward to a much higher self-control and to open the way within yourselves to uniting, to be close and joyous co-operation with the whole Bright Brotherhood. Do the physical screens really cover your eyes so strongly up to now that you still cannot understand clearly how

and from where the path opens to this high, bright co-operation? Do we really still need to repeat the alphabetical truths to you that the path to your Teacher leads through the grey daily routine, through the effective uniting with the people who surround you, through your attention and compassion to them? Look attentively around you. Why a half of you also still hasn't lost your sharp protest one against the others? Why a part of you holds itself aloof enviously from those who are living together in the Community? Why only some people are walking with a friendly smile for their friends? Only because self-control for some of you seems to be only their personal business: "Nobody except myself should worry how I behave if I don't disturb anybody." Oh no, my friends! Not only you are wrong by drawing such conclusions, but also your world outlook created on such basis – is a soap bubble. Because the initial basis on which you were creating it, your "I", your personality may not join the activity of the Eternity. Until the power of your opened Spirit doesn't unite your work for the sake of the Earth with the fire of Life, you won't be able to become colleagues of the Bright Brotherhood. And the man himself is weaving this bond, he is weaving with those parts of his heart and consciousness in which passions aren't bubbling, where joy reigns. When I was here last time, and that was rather long time ago, I said to you: "Be vigilant during every day of your life, so that it wouldn't be too late when we meet next time, so that your eyes possessed enough strength to look at Life surrounding you joyfully and merrily, so that your hearts would start to feel themselves as his little parts." A half of you keep sitting frowned in the same gloomy way with your downcast eyes. Did the chief spend not enough love for you? Do those brothers who were entrusted to observe your needs pay not enough attention to you? Will some of you make bold to blame the servants of this Community of too little kindness for you? Does a system of punishments or penalties exist here? For how many times every one of you was rude with many brothers of this Community, who serve you so selflessly. Before leaving this room, raise your heads and look at my eyes."

As soon as I. uttered these words, almost everybody's heads rose, and the people's looks pierced I. I gave a start – I read so much sarcasm, anger and even hatred in these suddenly raised eyes. I. stopped by every face with his look. His piercing look was rubbing the turbulence from these faces like a miraculous grace. The expressions were changing, they grew softer, calmer, even the tears were rolling down some faces, the people's appearance changed completely.

The eyes of those who fixed their gaze on I.'s face immediately, as soon as we entered the dining-room, and of those who met us in a friendly manner from the very beginning, now were full of fascination and tranquillity.

Three men kept stooped at their tables, and it seemed that no power could make them draw themselves up, their figures showed such stubbornness. I was surprised when I recognized that one of the bent low men was the man who looked like Dartran to me. Up to this moment he was always sitting straight and watching every I.'s movement and all of us vigilantly, but as soon as I. stood up and began to speak, he hung his head and he was bending always lower to the table, and he could do it with difficulty due to his gigantic height.

Other two figures which didn't raise their heads were sitting not so far away and with their black clothes they were clearly distinguished among all the people who were dressed in white. It surprised me for a long time already that a black figure was sitting at these two tables among the people who were dressed in white. The man who looked like Dartran was wearing the bluish clothing which reminded me of the soutane of the Orthodox priests. A sphinx head hollowed out of opal was hanging on his chest on the small chain of the same work, made of the small sphinx heads like the one which Dartran gave to me, only the sphinxes of his chain were made of opal. They were changing their colour wonderfully from bluish to the red fires like blood, they suited very well his soutane of the rippling colours.

Now I understood that his challenging looks full of hatred with which he looked me up and down several times were meant not for me, but for the small chain and plate which I was wearing. A fear of my helplessness to fulfil Dartran's task flashed within me several times again, but Nataliya Vladimirovna's punch returned my concentration in time. I don't know why, but the dinner at Stroganoff's in Constantinople, Bracano, his fight against sir Vomi and all later events rose in my memory. It seemed to me that this moment was not only as important as before, but even much more important both for I. and for three stooped figures. Having concentrated on my prayer resolutely, I was calling for Florentian and I felt his answer quick as lightning. And what is more, I understood that this time Andreyeva knew more than I did and that she was calling for Ali. I saw his mighty figure next to I. and the chief who was already standing with his hands crossed on his respectfully. I could see clearly the wonderful Ali's face, his piercing, burning eyes, I could feel his exceptional power that was spreading from him and filling the entire hall with an exceptional magnetism. I wasn't sure whether everybody could see his figure, and at the same time I didn't doubt that everybody could feel the presence of his exceptional power, because everybody stretched resolutely like strings, concentrated their attention, everybody was full of enthusiasm which they really didn't have before.

Three stooped figures for whom it was impossible to bend anymore, now completely shrank into balls like big, degenerated mushrooms and they covered their heads with flaps of their clothes.

Having smiled to everybody who was looking at them, who now was happy and joyous people, I. uttered.

"My dear brothers and sisters, my beloved friends who once were saved by the Bright Brotherhood through your meeting with me. In this great hour a turn of your external destinies happened together with the turn of your inner life. You were fighting against the dark powers for a long time to whom you served once, you couldn't escape their power for a long time. Not because the dark power could get here. No, it couldn't get here, to this protected place. But you were carrying its remembrance as the sign of the seal branded in your hearts. You couldn't forgive those hypocrites till the end, who used your credulity for their mean and even horrible goals by using their friendship and devotion to you as a cover. In this hour, being surrounded by love of the Bright Brothers, you've found the strength not only to forgive your enemies, but also to bless them, to put their misfortune into your kind heart as the lesson, to pray for them, and the enlightenment of this moment has worked a wonder: you've become joyous, and by becoming joyous, you've found the new way to liberation – the creation of your heart. In this hour no one of you is sitting, you stood up, because the power of your joyous harmony lifted you up. You can feel that the whole being of every one of you imbibes the new vibrations of the power that was inaccessible for you up to now. You can feel the happiness to live, you can feel the greatest from all man's feelings: the invisible Spirit's uniting with visible people's forms which surround you. You've been fighting and searching for many years for the path – everybody for his own, individually unique – to creation and liberation. And now, in a flash the turn of your destinies has happened: you've found the path and you walked it along. Forever remember this peace, this pleasing calm which pour into you in this hour. This hour of happiness is an hour of absolute self-control, that is your Love has opened within you and moved towards actions. Now you are free with your Spirit, that's why you are free also with your bodies. You won't need those external circumstances anymore with which you were living here. You don't need to be protected anymore, now you will be protecting your encountered people everywhere. You are free. Every one of you may choose any form of your external life in any place of the universe or stay here. You will be given any form of work and you will be sent to any place of the Earth wherever only you will desire. My last precept for you: wherever you would live, whatever you would do, whomever you would meet, never think that difficult external circumstances oppress and kill people. Cut into your consciousness, into your heart, into your external memory of ages that all external circumstances of every man, whatever they would be, however

difficult they would seem to you and to the man who is living in them, all – I repeat, all – circumstances protect his external life and not oppress or ruin him. Remember forever about the grandeur and horror of the people's paths, bless all of them without any distinguishing. Because from now on everybody is equally saint for you. Accept the blessing of Love which the Bright Brotherhood is sending to you, accept its calm, joy and help as the greeting of your new life and don't forget: it has acknowledged you as equal to itself, and let not negation of your achievements and talents oppress you anymore, not acknowledgement from other people disturb your stable harmony. Be blessed on behalf of the Bright Brotherhood – peace to you.”

I. blessed everybody and having bowed low to everybody, he touched the ground with his hand.

“Go, my friends and brothers, rejoice at the happiness to return those presents and talents to Life which it gave to you during the long ages. By expressing not yourselves through your talents, but your talents through yourselves, you will be spreading them clarified in all your affairs and encounters.”

The eyes of the standing people were shining. It seemed that it was a pity for them to take their eyes off I.'s face that was radiating with beauty and power. Finally, they bowed to him and began to leave the dining-room. Only now I understood that only one door was in the dining-room, that high and wide door through which we came in.

They left one after another, everybody by bowing two times: to the chief and to all of us, while we used to respond to them with a bow after I. I saw how Ali's hand blessed everybody who left, I could hear how he used to utter one or several words for everybody. I understood that with these words Ali instructed to everybody the activity and the place of his future new life. But I understood it with my spirit and not with my physical form. It seemed to me that Florentian gave this comprehension to me and that he told me to give his blessing, his tact and calm to everybody.

The dining-room became empty. The stooped figures were still sitting. The serving brothers were picking up the dishes and passed them to the kitchen through the little window on the left. The tables were soon put in order, cleaned and they began to shine with whiteness and cleanness. Only three figures remained at these white tables in almost empty dining-room, in the brightly lit hall by the shining lamps and the light from the above windows where, as I understood, were the cells of the Community's brothers and sisters.

The last brother radiating with happiness and joy bowed with respect and love, and left the dining-room. Now I saw that three figures remained sitting here absolutely unwillingly: they were trying to become straight, they wanted to go after those who were leaving, but they couldn't move in the same way as the unfortunate shrimp couldn't rise from the ground and resist Francisco in the small children dining-room of Ali's Community.

“Stand up, unfortunate, my beloved children, whom my heart couldn't carry along, and that is my fault, not yours,” the chief's voice was heard.

This voice was so tender and nice, so much love and exciting care was in it that the tears themselves rolled down my cheek and with all my might I began to call for divine Florentian's compassion. “Remain strong and create effective Love, only in this way I can help through you,” I heard his wonderful voice and I became ashamed of my weakness. I controlled myself in a flash.

“My Love didn't protect and open your hearts, and that is my fault, not yours. My efforts didn't draw you into the joint, joyous activity, and that is my fault, not yours. I was unable to find the ways to liberate you, I was only a weak and poor example for you, let the heaven punish me, and remain kind and compassionate for you. Forgive me, my dear, my beloved children, that I failed to protect you who

were entrusted to me. Let my heart remain for you the place of such protection and tranquillity with what power the fair and pure heaven may strengthen our bond.”

The chief's voice, his entire appearance, the whole ball of Light which covered him now like a big ball of fire was simply shaking my organism through which, as I could feel clearly, the gigantic Florentian's power was pouring by flowing into Radanda's ball.

I could see clearly how Ali's power and several other currents, fiery, red and blue ones were flowing into his ball and formed a big five-pointed star. This view was grand and solemn, I felt as if I was not only in a great temple, but also as if the powers of Life Itself had entered here.

Unexpectedly, Radanda knelt down and bowed till the ground to three sitting figures by still keeping his crossed hands on his chest. I forgot about everything, as though I left my body and merged with Florentian's fire. I could see not only the bodies of those figures, I could see their hot auras and I comprehended the differences of their trembling fires.

Purple, black and dirty greyish green lightnings were blazing violently in zigzags from the giant with opals, which he directed straight into the centre of Radanda's ball. But the fires, without reaching the ball, were rolling back with double force into the giant's heart and brain.

The last, more distant figure was sending a tender prayer to forgive her. Black and purple wheels and spots furrowed the fiery lines which were spreading from her prayer. I saw how the unfortunate living being was trying to squeeze the last remains of her purity out of her heart, how she was blessing the chief, she thanked him for his love and care, and how she was trying to stand up. But the purple lightnings of maledictions and commands, threats and terrible curses were flying from other two figures into her by preventing her from liberation and from breaking off the difficult bonds of evil with her enslavers.

“Stand up, my friend,” I.'s voice was heard.

He extended his hand towards the fighting figure, and I saw how the dirty lightnings came back to those who sent them, how they made to tremble them, and suddenly the liberated third figure began to shine in bluish and reddish tones and stood up easily. All wrapped up she left the table and turned towards Radanda, protected by extended I.'s hand from the enemies' fire.

When the figure approached Radanda, the cloak slipped off her face, and a middle-aged woman of rare beauty was standing before us. She reminded me of Laliya with something, with some indescribable resemblance. At the same moment I heard a stifling moaning and I saw the beauty's figure fallen on the ground before Radanda. Her entire body was flinching with lament, she was speaking by sobbing.

“Forgive me, saint father, forgive the great sinner. A folly love and jealousy drove me mad, and I yielded to the charms of this terrible man. But I don't send any curses to him anymore. Let my suffering be forgiven to him, in the same way as you've forgiven us all. You told us that our sins befell on you. Oh no, saint father, your holiness is on us, the seal of your Love is on us which gives us hope to save ourselves. And no evil or sin may cling to you, the saint. My rescuer, my protector, help the unfortunate man who has chained me with his terrible oath. Let my entire life be dedicated to saving him. Let my love which he was jeering at so cruelly be the bridge to his rescuing. Don't push him away, extend your sacred hand of help to him one more, last time.”

The woman bent down to Radanda's feet again. At that moment a horrible roar was heard, the big giant's figure became straight, he tore his chain with sphinx off and threw it by trying to aim its

entire weight to the woman's head. I understood from the sound of the flying chain in the air that the metal which connected the sphinx heads was heavy and that the woman would die inevitably.

I. extended his hand to the flying chain, a fiery lightning flashed in the air, something flashed, and I saw how the chain hit the owner's head. He fell on the floor by catching on the table and he piled it on himself. The long table covered his body.

At that moment when I. stopped the chain's fall, I felt how Florentian's power stroke several lightnings from the little plate which Dartran gave to me, they flew to the woman and merged into a wreath around her head.

Radanda bent down, lifted the woman, embraced her, called Laliya, Nina and Nikita.

"Help her out. The stretcher is already waiting by the gatekeeper. Help to carry her to the hospital and stay by her until I come. She will be unconscious, don't worry about it. I will come."

Radanda looked round, smiled to lady Berdran and beckoned her with his finger.

"You, too, go with them, White Creature. You also help them," he addressed Bronski and Igor. "Your help will be more necessary and important there."

During this entire time, I saw Gerda for the first time. She was as white as the lily, and the name White Creature suited her very well. I thought that she wouldn't go not only to the hospital, but also to the threshold, she looked so fragile, her movements were so weak and indecisive. When she came up to Ali, I saw how he put his wonderful hand on her head, but I knew that she couldn't see him. She gave a start from the touch of Ali's hand, but she drew herself up immediately, she became all radiant, her pale cheeks turned red, and Gerda became extremely beautiful.

As soon as all our friends left and took the hardly walking beauty out, whose beauty probably could be compared only with Mary Magdalena's one, the silence of the grave fell in the dining-room for a while. I felt that Andreyeva was concentrating her entire self-control and strength, and I followed her example. I concentrated for my prayer on Florentian, I was begging him to help the unfortunate people, because I felt the threatening moment of their lives coming. Like before, I could feel the same sensation, as if I had left my body. But without having time to orient myself, I saw Rasul who was standing by the giant lying on the floor. I wanted to make sure whether that was really him, but I saw another shining figure next to him and I recognized Francisco.

"My unfortunate brother. Compassion gives the last chance to me to address you and to try to persuade you," again the chief's voice was heard, only this time it was full of praying when he addressed the figure who kept sitting. "Stand up, my friend. Make sure of helplessness of your anger and hypocrisy. Your cruel friend has frightened you, but you can see where his stubbornness has taken him to. Little by little – from stubbornness to pride, from pride to puffing up and sarcasm – he passed to constant negation and anger. He took hold of your will. Now he is lying helpless and not dangerous to you. Come to the great Teacher, don't be afraid. You still may be forgiven, you will be able to work, to clean yourself through work and to contribute to the great Bright humanity. Only hurry up, my unfortunate child. The moments are flying past, your fate is still in your hands. But you are by the last boundary already, hurry up."

As soon as the chief's voice sounded, the black figure suddenly drew himself up, the hood slipped off his head and uncovered his face... Will I be able to describe this face? One could consider his features even beautiful. His black, bluish black hair exposed his brazen-faced, narrow, pale face. His narrow, slender, strong figure was inhumanly thin, wrapped up into a closely fitting clothing, and it looked more than a snake than a human. His eyes were also like the snake's ones, narrow and brightly yellow. They

surprised me with their unpleasant expression, full of oppressing gloominess, impudence, falsehood and fear. I didn't doubt that he was coward and dangerous villain, hypocrite and liar, but I couldn't understand why both of them with the giant were here in any way. The man was standing in silence, his eyes were shooting from I.'s face to the chief and back, as if by searching for a little crack on which he could hang. The moments were passing in an absolute silence. Suddenly, I saw another shining figure and I almost gave a cry of amazement when I recognized sir Vomi.

"Come here, unfortunate man. For the last time you are given the chance through the chief's lips to leave the circle of falsehood and fraud," I.'s voice was heard.

Apparently, the man wanted more to sit down again and not to go. A spasm distorted his face, he was coiling with his entire slender body – and by doing so he emphasized his resemblance to the snake even more.

I. was looking at him attentively. Finally, he rose his hand and uttered rigorously.

"Obey."

The man-snake all trembled from head to toe, he wanted to throw his black soutane on, but his hands were shaking so much that he couldn't do it in any way. The soutane fell by his feet which he liberated somehow, and the man began to walk slowly towards us. Now no signs of the snake were left on his face which turned pale already earlier. That was the face of a dead person, without any expression, like the mask that was modelled by the sculptor, but not inspired. Even the fear which was reflected on it not so long ago was gone, I couldn't feel any thoughts in this mask, anything. He was walking like a robot, as if everything what was the essence of his life a moment ago had gone now and left only this case. However slowly he was walking, anyway finally he had to approach I. and stand up before him.

I saw how radiating Francisco's and sir Vomi's figures stood up behind the unfortunate man, the chief and I. stood up from both his sides by forming a half-ring, and the big Ali's figure appeared in their places, from whom the fire was flowing and it turned into the high fire wall. The wall bent like the ring behind the backs of all high brothers and came back to Ali from another side, as if it was burning behind him and within him.

I understood that the man could see Ali, he could see the fiery wall before himself. When the wall closed up behind Ali, as though the man awakened. A horror appeared on his face, he was trying to jump aside several times, but as though he was hurled back.

"Stand still, because you will burn down," Radanda said to him. "You've already lost the possibility to go out of here. I offered you, to be precise, I gave the call of Compassion to you several minutes ago. I warned you that this was the last chance to save yourself. But you refused my help. Now, in the hour of your repayment, be strong and try to find at least the smallest grain of compassion within yourself, so that the Great Compassion could keep the human stage of your existence."

An unusual anger distorted the man's face.

"Why didn't I strangle you when I had a thousand of possibilities to do it," he wheezed instead of an answer to Radanda. "Just think what that stupid traitor did, whom you sent to the hospital, he stole my talisman. That's why I got into your claws, and I could have help from all sides."

"Your talisman is still dangling on your belt, unfortunate man," Ali's voice was heard.

If I hadn't seen how Ali's lips were moving, I would have thought that not him was talking. Now his voice reminded me more of a thunderbolt and not of the commanding, but tender voice of that

wonderful Ali who used to greet every man in a very attentive way, so that it would seem to everybody whom he used to address that Ali was waiting namely for him, that he wanted to help namely him.

“If I don’t bring you immediately into the ring formed by the burning, protective wall of the Bright Powers, then your imaginary friends, but actually your angriest and most merciless enemies, will reach you. You will be in their power forever and no self-sacrifice of your zealous defender Radanda or prayers are going to help you. You will be taken out of the walls of the Community, and the path of eternal suffering among the powers of darkness will be waiting for you there. Your recollections about your life here will increase your suffering ten times as much, where Radanda gave the possibility to you to save yourself after believing in your requests and vows, after forgetting about my warnings about you. He took a great deed of love upon himself, he was certain that his love would help you to awaken for the Truth. But by deceiving him hypocritically, you continued the dirty destroying of every soul to whom you could only come. Now you have to make your final choice because of Radanda’s purity who was carrying you in his heart for so many years, you’ve reached your final boundary. Being united by Great Love, we’ve come here, so that your guardian’s great deed wouldn’t come to naught. Compassion offers you through my lips: either enter the protective ring lead by my power and will, and then, having completely confessed your faults, having forgiven everybody and received everybody’s forgiveness yourself, you will die like this deplorable case, cleaned by Eternity you will enter the great flow of Life and begin your new incarnations. Or you will be taken behind the walls of the Community and you will get in the arms of your accomplices who are unsatisfied with you for a long time. Make your choice. We can still allow you to choose for several moments, because Radanda’s love has built the bridge for you, the remains of which can hardly hold already, but they will still hold during those several moments. When they pass, we will take you behind the walls of the Community and your destiny will be decided there.”

An inexpressible despair and horror changed his brazen-faced rage now with which the man who looked like a snake was listening to Ali’s words. Again his face turned into an absolutely dead mask. It seemed to me that he was so horror-struck that already neither thoughts nor feelings were left within him, that he already was even unable to make any decisions anymore. But I was wrong. The man’s hands began to search for something by his belt feverishly, where his talismans were still hanging as Ali told him. Finally, he seized one – unfortunately, I couldn’t see what it was, – he wanted to lift it up, but his hand opened, the talisman fell down on the stone floor and broke into small pieces. The man gave a moan, but he didn’t make his choice.

“The moments soon will melt. Your enemies are already by the gate of the Community, while the protective wall has grown into the height and width so much that soon neither I alone nor all of us together will be able to bring you into the ring through it. Hurry up, choose. Don’t wait for the third call, it won’t happen.”

Ali’s voice sounded tenderly, but firmly.

I saw how the fiery wall already reached Ali’s ears and it kept growing quickly. With all my strength of love, as much as I could, I concentrated on Florentian and I was begging him to help the unfortunate man that not the destiny of his temporary, unfortunate cases in which he sinned was decided, but his eternal life. I saw how Radanda extended his hands to Florentian pleadingly, while Francisco turned to the poor man, he illuminated him with love of his eyes, smiled to him with the smile of his divine kindness and extended both of his hands to him.

A cry was heard which I had never heard in my life before, I didn’t even imagine that a human being could cry like this, and oh, Lord, don’t let anybody hear such moan. That wasn’t a cry, but the whole scale, the whole chord of human feelings, thoughts and experiences. That was a life about which one could write a separate book. I comprehended from the cry that Francisco’s look reached this unfortunate

man's heart for the first time. I comprehended that the whole evil which surrounded his heart exploded, that repentance and regret escaped the man's heart in swift waves. I could see not a begging, not a fight anymore, but his comprehension matured once and for all that his death beyond the fiery wall remained his only one protection.

The man seized Francisco's hands. I knew the great strength of these hands and I was surprised when Francisco bent down from the man's weight, he couldn't lift him and bring into the inner ring. I didn't have time to run to help, Ali got next to them in a flash and threw the man over the wall in a flash. I thought that the man had to fall and to splash from such strength which I saw in Ali's movements, but Ali's hands put the man in the centre of the ring carefully. Now he was breathing loudly and frequently, as if he was running upstairs. His face regained colour, his lips were smiling, he was looking at Radanda and speaking.

"Forgive me, I hated not you, but my own weakness. I wanted to be kind, I appreciated your holiness, but my envy to you was driving me from one evil to another. I understood your sincerity, but I instigated myself purposefully to deny your kindness. Oh, I can feel such happiness, such lightness now! For the first time I found out what joy was. In which words should I thank you all for this enlightenment with which I die now? Thank you. I forgive my enemies in the same way as you've forgiven me."

He still wanted to say something, but then he grasped at his heart and fell by Radanda's feet. The smile of happiness was shining in the chief's face, his eyes were looking attentively at the lying man's face with such expression of love, as if that was his most beloved baby.

The wall was still burning, and it grew till the very ceiling. Now it wasn't reddish fiery anymore, but it was shining in all colours of the rainbow in which blue and reddish hues prevailed.

"Lyovushka," I heard I.'s voice. "Go to the gatekeeper and tell him to let the brothers with the stretcher in. Pass the command on behalf of the chief."

It seemed to me an hour ago that I couldn't control my body, that I couldn't even move from the place. And now, having received I.'s command, I left the dining-room absolutely easily. Having come up to the gatekeeper's little house, I heard Mulga talking to somebody, he didn't want to let somebody enter the little yard. I told him Radanda's command about the stretcher, he bowed to me and uttered.

"My brother, don't be surprised that I am speaking in a raised voice. All sorts of people used to come here during the entire evening, they came running even from the gates by demanding me to let in some newcomers. By remembering the chief's command, I didn't let anybody in, although some of them just threatened me with death. Having heard your steps, soon they hid in the darkness, and these brothers with the stretcher came whom you asked."

He opened the gates, and four brothers in white clothes entered the lit-up yard from the darkness of the park. I. took them to the dining-room where I found an absolutely different view already. Radanda was kneeling by the dead's head by telling some prayer, while Andreyeva was on her knees next to him. The shining fiery wall around them was already gone, but a many-coloured cloud like a thick fog screen was shining and trembling by the overturned table. Radanda stood up, he lifted Andreyeva and addressed the brothers who came.

"Carry the unfortunate brother who died suddenly out. Wash him, dress him in white clothes and bring him to my chapel. Pray for him in such a way as you would wish somebody to pray for you."

Having blessed the body of the deceased and those who were carrying him, Radanda turned to us with Andreyeva.

"My children, my dear guests. Never think about your encountered man as about a stranger. Remember that what you've already seen here and what you will still see. Know firmly: till the last moment you need to believe and to have hope to awaken his most sacred within man. You need to beg Life with all your heart's strength to help the gone astray, mistaken or dissented brother, because it is living in everybody, and neither the laws of human logic nor time are suited to awaken it. Having forgotten about yourselves, in the same way as you were doing it here today, keep pouring your love and kindness. However weak and small you would consider yourselves in comparison to the great brothers, know that every little part of kindness is very important for the Bright Brother's work, even the smallest one that is creating joy and assistance. Remain strong and your help now will be even more important and necessary than it was an hour ago."

He gave us a unique, characteristic only to him, sincerely tender smile, took our arms and brought us to the cloud of fog. Now the cloud changed its appearance, too: it became transparent, and the ruby little stars were flying in all directions in it. They used to merge into strange figures or to stretch in equal little lines. The view was wonderful, but I understood that it wasn't only the view, but also records, which unfortunately, I couldn't read, while Andreyeva was reading them easily, quickly and accurately. Now our roles changed – not I was reading for her, but she was doing it for me.

Having taken us to the very cloud, the chief stopped, he smiled to us again and addressed Andreyeva.

"Help your younger brother to read the language of fire, in the same way as he helped you to hold the fire of your heart. Both of you wait here, you will be invited when it is allowed."

He left us and disappeared around the cloud which near was much thicker than it seemed to be from the distance.

"Lyovushka, now I will read the signs of fire," Nataliya Vladimirovna said to me. "Listen."

Nobody can control the great moments of his birth and death, except the man himself. Externally nobody may predestine the hour of his death. No power exists which could throw the man's spirit back to the world of the earth. The incarnations are taking place only by the natural course of the actions of the man himself who is living on the earth or in other plans.

The nature of every physical or spiritual matter is spinning through the circles of that activity which the man himself was creating during the centuries. No sudden changes exist, as people comprehend the events of life of the earth which take place in their eyes. Everything is happening in natural circles and not in some curved lines. But only for the man who knows the whole Light opens in which he can see all the links of his own and strange paths.

The grandeur and meaning of man's life and death – that's not the facts that may be seen in physical eyes, but the power of those love outbursts which the man may pour out of himself or take to himself.

The little stars settled down. We were standing in silence, full of the great respect, by thinking about that man who was lying behind the cloud. We were trying to pour our entire love that only existed within us to help him.

As though the time stopped existing for me. Again, I felt the state full of bliss and joy. The near Florentian's presence merged with my entire essence so much that I was unable to distinguish anymore where "I" was and where "not I". I merged completely with my idolized friend. I was covered with a never experienced courage. My confidence and joy that I will be able to help Florentian in such a way as he will desire, took me out into the circle of complete calm. Through this experience I understood what the words meant: "To forget about yourself and to think about others." I also understood well what "liberation" was. No personalism oppressed me. I was absolutely free from any personal comprehension of the current events; I could see and understand the paths of the people's lives newly.

I wasn't surprised by tonight's events; I didn't compare them to the ones that I saw before. I could feel the great respect to the newly opened pages of the high Bright Brothers' work to me and I directed all my strength to join their work joyously.

I approached us. The cloud dissipated completely. The view behind it was already absolutely different. The high man who looked like Dartran wasn't lying on the floor anymore, but he was standing next to Rasul whose presence here I was unable to comprehend in any way, because I had said good-bye to him in the desert still not so long ago. Dartran was holding the heavy man's chain in his hands and looking at his duplicate's eyes attentively.

While seeing both together, I made sure of their exceptional resemblance once again, only the second one was a little bit smaller, and his hair was dark. But I understood why it seemed to me in the beginning that he only reminded me of Dartran. His facial expression, nervousness of his entire figure, the violent movement of his eyes and the muscles of his face destroyed his resemblance to Dartran whose face looked like stony to me in the beginning of our acquaintance. Having taken a good look at him, I saw that he was very calm and sad. Now I could see only Ali, Radanda and Florentian from the Great Brothers. I brought us nearer and put us between himself and Ali.

"My friend, my unfortunate brother," Radanda began to speak again. "From the bottom of my heart I forgive you for all insulting words which you told me here. You are innocent that you cannot see me differently, because your passions control you and cover your spirit's eyes. And may a man understand something if he is looking at things and actions only with his physical eyes? I forgive everything for you, and I beg the Great Mother and all her servants to forgive you, to protect you from all sad consequences which you've caused here during your entire stay here. Not you are to blame that I was weak and that I only encouraged your inner disharmony with my too great kindness. I had to protect you with my strictness and to help you with an external discipline by seeing how you couldn't achieve your inner discipline. While I was always hoping that by possessing an absolute freedom in the atmosphere of love and calm, you would find the path to self-discipline in an easier and simpler way. I made a mistake, and I didn't fulfil Ali's command to be strict with you. I am to blame. In the presence of the Great Life let your transgression befall on me. I am responsible that I didn't find the necessary way for you to adapt yourself to your life's daily routine. You were entrusted to me, while I failed to be your great pastor. Forgive me, be indulgent and compassionate, my son."

The man's face showed his inner sarcasm, apparently, he didn't believe a single chief's word, he was smiling bitterly, but he kept silent.

"My brother, my unfortunate Benja Jean, you stand before the Bright Powers not for the first, but for the third time and you take up the struggle against them," Rasul began to speak. "I could save you for the first two times, I could warrant for you before the Bright Brotherhood which gave a shelter to you here, gave all the possibilities for you for work and activity, allowed you to choose according to your own taste and needs. But, while being surrounded by trust and love, you were searching only for faults in the people who surrounded you. By always seeing only their stains, you brought your poor wife here

through deception and your now dead friend, you turned them into traitors, thieves and your slaves. I won't name all your mean acts here; you know them well yourself. I will tell you only one thing: I am helpless to help you this third time, I cannot vouch for you anymore. You may hope only for Radanda's and I's compassion, you may rely only on your own strength. For the last time I, sinful Rasul, may still beg the Bright Brotherhood to protect you from the powers of darkness after your death, to shelter you in such little corner of the Earth where you could prepare your spirit for death with your pure heart and calm by your constant work and strict discipline, because otherwise no power of Light will be able to tear you out of the everlasting power of the dark powers. Although it doesn't seem to you to be like this, you don't have any other choice how to leave this place in any other way, not because somebody holds you here. No, your constant irritability and anger, your condemnation and hypocrisy have paralyzed your hands and feet now. You cannot move from one place; you cannot take this wonderful chain into your hands which you've defiled with your crimes and blood. Choose your destiny yourself. Either you will go to the secret Community, saved by Compassion for the last time. You will be cured there, and during long years of hard work you will be preparing for your pure death, as I've already told you. Or..."

Dartran lapsed into silence for a while, his face turned into the symbol of sadness, a big tear rolled down his dark cheek. He wiped it away and continued in such weak, tender and sad voice which I didn't expect to hear from his giant. It seemed to me that there weren't any boundaries for his power.

"Or you will die here and now, and the powers of darkness will take possession of your spirit."

Dartran became silent. Only the difficult, wheezing Benja Jean's breathing disturbed the graveyard silence in the dining-room. He was standing motionless like a statue, and only his face showed his entire fight. Whatever courage I could feel in my heart, I fell on my knees, and I was begging Florentian, the most compassionate of the most compassionate ones, to save the unfortunate man, to lift his spirit, to hurry to his help.

I saw the divinely beautiful view of my great friend next to Benja Jean. He took one of the poor man's hands which was already absolutely without any signs of life, he put it on his heart, and he was holding it with his wonderful hand. With another hand he put Benja Jean's hand on his forehead.

"Look at the walls. You will see clearly the view there what is waiting for you if you die now."

The whole gigantic Benja Jean's figure trembled, a roar was heard from his throat, and if Florentian's power hadn't held him, he would have fallen on the ground again.

"Don't delay," Ali uttered. "One more moment, and compassionate Brother Florentian won't be able to save you. Decide!"

Another wave of convulsions shook the unfortunate man's body, it seemed to me that he saw something horrible again and he roared somehow.

"I agree to go to the secret Community."

Rasul drew a bench for his brother and seated him with Florentian's help. Florentian let go the unfortunate man's hands, and they were hanging helplessly till the very floor. He was still holding his hand on Benja Jean's head, and the suffering face calmed down from Florentian's power, his eyes stopped running about, his breathing became even.

"For the last time the Great Life gives its protection to you, disturber of calm wherever you used to live: you will be deaf-mute until you can find some kind and pure strength in your heart, until noble thoughts are born in your consciousness, until your work becomes useful for other people to whom you will

become benevolent yourself. Little by little, as soon as your spirit begins to clear up, your speech and hearing will come back," Ali told him, and again his voice reminded me of a thunder.

"Stand up, find strength to leave this place, to get on the camel and to ride till your new living place. Remember, always remember the view which Florentian showed to you, and let it help you to go out onto the bright path. Don't be afraid, a reliable convoy will accompany you, and nobody will be persecuting you in your new place. Live by being blessed by me, cry for my name in the hour of your unbearable disharmony, and I will share your burden, I will make the heaviness of your suffering easier for you."

Ali blessed Benja Jean and said to Rasul.

"Hang the wonderful chain on your brother's neck. You destroyed it," he addressed Benja Jean. "It belonged to the great, joyous living being who possessed firm harmony and who helped the Bright Brotherhood to pour energy on the earth. You stole the chain from your brother, but as you can see yourself, it lost its power, while the jewels which were yellow became like opals. The more you used to trespass, the more the stones changed, and they became like the tears, trembling in the sunshine and changing in all colours of the rainbow. You will be able to judge whether your liberation is coming nearer to you from the colour of these jewels. Their former yellow colour will come back with your every turn to kindness and your every higher thought. Lyovushka, take my cloak and cover Benja Jean with it," Ali finished and extended his white cloak to me.

It was difficult for me to fulfil Ali's command. As though his cloak was burning my hands, and it seemed to be so heavy and big that I could hardly throw it on Benja Jean's shoulders, I even had to climb up on the bench.

When I came back to my place all wet with sweat, as if I had dragged some stones, I could hardly stand on my feet, my legs were trembling, and my head was throbbing so much.

"Yassa," again I could hear the clear and strong, but not thundering anymore Ali's voice. "You will be the chief of the convoy and you will accompany this man to the secret Community. Take ten brothers and leave immediately. The people are already waiting by the gates. Take this giant's hand and always be next to him on the way. Wrap him well in my cloak and when you ride to the Community, give the entrusted man to you to the chief, throw my cloak into the bonfire, rest for twenty-four hours and come back with the whole convoy. Come back by riding through the rocks in the desert and across the small oasis of black people."

Little Yassa looked like a toy next to Benja Jean. He took his hanging, helpless hang, he covered well his entire figure with the cloak and went to the door by bringing the giant with his hand who was moving after him automatically, he lifted his feet with difficulty, as if a whole troop of soldiers was marching.

That was a terrible moment. It seemed to me that the heavy man's steps symbolized those future years of suffering and redemption to which he doomed himself.

"Come up to me," I heard Ali's voice, but I didn't understand that he addressed me and Andreyeva.

I felt how she took my hand, I turned to her, and I was deprived of speech. The face full of radiating power, confidence and bright kindness with the Light flashing eyes was looking at me. Nataliya Vladimirovna gave a tender smile to me and jerked me after her. Again, I could feel how close she was to

me, closer than the closest one, my mother and sister. If she was taking me to the desert and not to Ali, anyway I would have followed her by trusting her completely and with joy.

We knelt before Ali, but he lifted us tenderly, sat down on the bench and seated us by his sides. I looked round and I saw that there wasn't anybody in the dining-room, except Ali, I., Nataliya Vladimirovna and me. I didn't have time to be surprised, because Ali uttered.

"Now, my friend, you understood why I didn't allow you to go to this Community and which part of my work you could share with me only now. Everything what has opened to you here, opened only to you alone, remember it. If you feel that you can act during your encounter, - then act. But never exceed your strength. Where a boundary is indicated to you - never overstep it. Learn to understand that if only you overstep my instructed boundaries to you, you will be spreading unasked misfortunes and suffering instead of help by relying on your own strength, on your own kind intentions. Acquire the new knowledge as quickly as possible, because the world won't wait. You need to leave and to fulfil your mission in it."

Ali embraced Nataliya Vladimirovna, as though she was drowned in the stream of his fire which dazzled me so much that I had to cover my eyes. I felt how I. embraced me tenderly and I heard how Ali addressed me.

"When you were walking with me in the garden, I showed two groups of trees to you - reddish magnolias and black maples. I said to you that people were weaving into the Father Life's string reddish or black pearls. Be blessed, happy man, whom the great Light destined to bring the reddish pearls of joy into the world. Go, my friend, be blessed and pour the precious pearls of your talent to people. Although it would seem to you that you know little, spread your word, because it will always be the word of the Bright Brotherhood."

Ali pulled me closer to himself, and I fainted away instantly, as soon as I had time to feel an untold blessing...

I came to myself on I.'s arms, as soon as he brought me into my room, in our house already.

Chapter 19

The first breakfast. The school. I give Francisco's letter to the sick boy's mother.

I. helps me to become acquainted with the sector of the most difficult stubborn people.

Old man Staranda and my encounter with him

Although I recovered my consciousness still in I.'s arms, I didn't remember how I fell asleep, how the night passed by. I woke up in the morning from unusual sounds and tugging.

I couldn't understand anything for several minutes and surprised I was looking round the absolutely strange room. Finally, I comprehended that I was in the distant Community, that the unusual

sounds to me were the echoing chimes of the big bell, and that my dear Eta was tugging me uninterruptedly.

The bird was worried, he was running from my bed – a narrow, wooden plank-bed without any mattress, which was covered with the thick linen – to the door of I.'s room, as if by wishing to tell me that it was the time for me to fling my eyes there. I jumped up quickly and I remembered all the events of the yesterday's night clearly. Apparently, my physical organism still wasn't enough hardened, because I could still feel weakness, a lack of balance and I was even sickened a little. Now I was lacking my kind and tender nurse so much, my wonderful Yassa who, of course, would have cured me in a half an hour with his unique underwater massage.

Having concentrated my attention, I began to think what I should do first and I remembered that I was I.'s messenger and secretary. By hesitating to enter I.'s without washing and dressed disorderly, I snatched the towel and wanted to run to the shower-bath, but I. room's door opened, and he showed up himself, radiating, powerful, in white clothes which seemed to me radiating as himself. There weren't any signs of tiredness or sickness in his face. As always, he was young, charming and pleasing.

"So what, my friend, do you feel unwell?"

"It is the fact that I feel unwell, my dear I., but that's nothing," I answered him. "But that I, your messenger and secretary, overslept and got up later than you – that's my foul. Forgive me, my Teacher, I will try to be your zealous servant in the future. This morning I could hardly comprehend where I was. And what does the chime of the bell mean? Does it have any connection to my duty?"

"The bell will ring thirty times, and that will correspond to a half of an hour. During this half an hour all the dwellers of the Community must put themselves in order, to put their cells in order and to go to the dining-room for the joint breakfast with the last ring. But not to that dining-room where we had our supper yesterday. We go only to have dinner and supper there. We eat breakfast and lunch in several dining-rooms. The whole Community is divided in many sectors, and each of them has its own morning dining-room. Hurry to the shower room, come back, put both of our rooms in order, dress yourself neatly and then make the round of all our people in this house. Tell everyone to gather in the hall in ten minutes. I will take you to our sector's dining-room myself and I will introduce you to the chief of our sector."

I. came back to his room, while I with Eta ran to the bathroom. I could hardly resist the temptation to change the order of the affairs entrusted to me. I was worried that all my friends, just as myself, didn't know the agenda that was in operation here and that they might not be in time to do everything till the time given to them. But I.'s instruction had become the law of love to me, and I didn't bring myself to change them at my discretion.

When I came back from the bathroom and hurried to my room, I met Andreyeva and lady Berdran who came back from their morning walk with a bunch of flowers. Their fresh expression, without any signs of tiredness in their faces surprised me. I greeted them and I wanted to scuttle from them as soon as possible, but it seemed to me that far-seeing Nataliya's eyes which always noticed so much saw both my tiredness and ailment.

When I came back to my room, put it in order and knocked at I.'s, I saw him at the writing-table, gone deep into some work. By trying to walk as silently as possible, I put his room in order, in which, to tell you the truth, there wasn't anything to settle, everything was in order anyway. I was surprised that there wasn't any dust here, which I hated, and I didn't like to dust very much. When I finished to put the room in order, I dressed myself carefully and I hurried to announce the time and the place for everybody.

As I expected, some of my friends were still sleeping, and I.'s command was like a thunder with all the lightning for them. Especially Bronski was grieving, who could never hurry anywhere. Igor helped him in every possible way, and he persuaded him that they would be in time to come to the hall.

Having run round both floors, combed my disobedient curls before the small mirror in the corridor again, I checked my clothes, and I was the first who went out to the hall to wait for all other dwellers of the house. I felt to be responsible for my friends' being late, but at the same time I didn't know how I could help them. Thank goodness, Bronski and Igor dashed out of the bathroom like a whirlwind, and my heart felt relieved. All of a sudden, Eta tore himself from my arms and dashed behind the corner of the house with a joyous shriek. I didn't understand where and why he ran there, but after a while I saw him on Nikita's shoulder who was coming, while Nataliya, Nina and Theresita followed them. I was glad about this unexpected meeting, and I didn't notice in which order all our group friends gathered, but with the last ring of the bell when I. appeared in the door, everybody was in the hall already.

"Like in the great dining-room, you may not talk in the dining-room to which we will go now. Enter it with joy, by thinking about every man who surrounds you. Don't carry any exciting sympathy in your hearts. Carry the joy of assertion that Life protects the people who are living here, it gives the possibility to them to strive for perfection in such circumstances which they need. However difficult and tiring these circumstances would seem to you, don't judge according to yourselves, but try to comprehend the eternal people's paths according to your heart's love. Namely these external conditions are the results of the whole care of the workers of the Eternal Compassion of every man. Don't try to sort with your mind which of these circumstances you would like to make easier, to decline, to change, but thoroughly meditate upon Francisco's words who the kind man is, and act by loving, overcoming with this notion. Live in the invisible Eternity and carry your heart's greeting for it through the visible "now" forms that flash before you."

As soon as I. finished talking, an elderly brother dressed in white came to our hall, bowed and touched the ground with his hand.

"My chief greets you, Teacher, and he sends his love and calm to you. Please follow me together with your friends for breakfast, give an honour to us to eat with you."

I was interested in this brother's face and voice. He was smiling, but it seemed to me that he wanted to cry. He was talking about the simplest thing, he wanted to be kind, but I could hear a tragedy in his uttered words, as if a pain was breaking his heart. I looked at Bronski and I saw not only the concentrated attention and astonishment in his face, but even a complete oblivion, so much he fastened his eyes and heart upon the talking brother. I.s look slipped down the actor's figure and he uttered loudly once again.

"Remember what I've just said to you."

I. bowed to the sent brother.

"My friend, thank you for your greeting. Thank you for taking care of us so much and for coming to invite us. Lead us, we'll follow you."

Brother bowed to us again and he first went down the straight lane. We were walking for quite a long time. The size of the Community surprised me more and more. It was really huge, while the park was more like a forest, although there were many flower gardens in it. We were walking down the dense avenues, across the frequent, crooked, little bridges above the small rivers without meeting a single person.

Then we saw a clearing and a one-storeyed house behind it, which seemed to me to be without any walls. When we came nearer to it, I made sure that there were the walls, but they were made of the very thin and clear glass placed into the narrow, wooden bands which formed a frame. I couldn't understand in any way how such narrow frames could hold so much glass, but there wasn't any time to think about it. Having come even nearer, I saw the figures who hurried to the dining-room from all sides. When we were very close to the house, a tall man in black monastic clothes and with a big silver cross on his chest went out to meet us. He was young and slim. His chestnut-coloured, a little reddish hair fell on his shoulders in beautiful curls. He was walking with a limp, because one of his legs was shorter than another one. He was smiling to I. with all his mouth by revealing his beautiful, white teeth. Having bowed to I., he uttered.

"What a happiness it is for us, dear Teacher, that you came to our place and that exactly on this day you would enter the dining-room of my sector. Be blessed. Of course, you cannot remember all the dates and circumstances when, where and how you were saving people, because you've saved so many of them, but I, like everybody else, remember the day of my salvation, I bless my encounter with you, and I am happy that I have the opportunity to greet you where you've instructed me to fulfil my duties. Welcome," he addressed us, he looked us up and down with his well-wishing look and he bowed to us.

I embraced the monk. I noticed that his hands were beautifully shaped, but they were numb with physical work and sprangled with corns and scratches.

"Peace to you, my brother Vsevolod. The Bright Brotherhood sent me to congratulate you and it obliged me to tell you that your time here has ended. You leave from here together with me. The world needs joyful servants. You've matured for the activity. It is time for you to serve the humanity among passions and racket."

As though an inner light illuminated Vsevolod's face, his eyes lit up, and he answered silently.

"I will be walking in such a way as you will lead me. But I won't conceal that I feel some sadness by separating with those unfortunate children of yours whom you entrusted me here. In the beginning the difficult work tired me, but I understood, accepted and blessed everything for a long time already. I was happy to end my days here, but let be your will and of those who sent you."

He bowed again and brought us into the hall – a glass gallery. Having seated us at the table where the most honourable place was given to I., he sat down next to us, and only then the people who had come to the dining-room earlier than us sat down in their places, on benches. Vsevolod gave a sign, and ten brothers and sisters who were on duty in this sector began to bring the food for all the tables at once. I counted that there were five the same narrow tables as in the big dining-room here. Our table where we were sitting together with Vsevolod was the first by the entrance, as also Radanda's table. We could see everybody who were in the dining-room as well as from Radanda's place. There was a lot of glass in this hall which, as I've already mentioned, looked more like a gallery. The narrow frames made an illusion that you were sitting on the deck of the steamer, so clear the glass was and such wide panorama opened here.

As soon as the first impression of newness passed, joyfulness covered me. I merged with emanations which filled the room without any stress, easily, simply, joyfully and I felt instantly how the wave of kindness and effective energy was pouring out of my heart and coming back to it. I wanted to embrace everybody who were sitting here so much, to thank them for that kindness with which they met us. I couldn't compare this reception with anything. Everybody was silent, but every one of us was happy and felt to be dear, close brother to all the people who had gathered here.

Both young and old people were here. Also, some children were here – eight twelve year old teenagers who were sitting next to their mothers. Everybody's faces were merry and kind, their eyes were radiating joy and calm. I looked at brother who brought us food. That was the same Vsevolod's messenger who visited us. The signs of heartbreak were still felt in his face, but it seemed to be gone, experienced a long time ago. He reminded me of those Bedouins whom I entrusted to transport our encountered rebellious rider to the desert.

Everybody began to eat the porridge in silence, but only after their chief took the spoon in his hands. I noticed how Vsevolod himself was eating no more than Radanda, but he was trying to look like eating, so that he wouldn't spoil others' appetite and would encourage those who didn't have it. Although the porridge was tasty and sweet – I couldn't understand what it was cooked from, because I had never eaten such porridge, – I had to admit that my appetite that was always good was gone. I swallowed several little bits of bread and a couple spoons of porridge with difficulty, and I did it only because of the attentive I.'s look. It was difficult even to swallow for me, and in my thoughts, I answered to the last I.'s look: "You shouldn't eat much while travelling." He understood me, gave a smile and put his spoon on the table by allowing me to follow his example. They brought a ragout from carrots and cauliflowers with potatoes after porridge, which was served fattily, with butter. I didn't bring myself even to taste this dish and I was amazed with what pleasure everybody was eating it, except those who were sitting at our table. Andreyeva who was sitting next to me, just like me, wasn't eating anything, which seemed to be rather strange for me, because she was laughing at me several times in Ali's Community that the single our likeness was gluttony.

Having taken empty plates, they brought some excellent coffee, the tea for those who wanted it, and they even placed the big jugs with milk. Although the hands of the brother who was serving us were injured – his right hand lacked the little finger, while the left one didn't have middle fingers, – he was doing everything quickly and deftly, without any hurry and he even outran other tables where two waiters were working. Having looked at the cup of coffee given to me unwittingly, I admired its simple and beautiful form. The high cup made of thin China, as it seemed to me in the beginning, actually was made of glass and it was changing in blue, reddish and violet colours. A rose and several pansies were depicted on it. Having looked at my neighbours' cups, I saw that the form of all of them was the same, but the drawings were different. I admired the talent who could reach such high artistic value in the desert.

The breakfast was over, Vsevolod stood up, bowed to I., bowed to us all and, having turned to the other tables, bowed to everybody who were sitting at them.

"Friends and brothers! Today dear Teacher is with us, friend and rescuer of us all, for whose arrival I was preparing you. His arrival for many of you – that's not only joy and happiness to see the man who has saved the lives of almost all of us. That's also the call to the new life, to the new form of external work. The time has come for many of us to pour those riches of spirit which we've developed and accumulated in our hearts through actions. We've become hardened here, it is time to go to work among daily troubles for the general people's welfare. We have to respond to our Teacher who calls us to the new forms of work and to the new places of our living not with a heartbreak due to the separation with those to whom we have accustomed here, whom we have come to love as our closest friends and colleagues, but with kindness of our hearts and effective love, with joy that with his call, and through him also with the whole Bright Brotherhood's call, we can start the new life of uniting with our own people through beauty in the new places. Now listen to our dear, great friend's, our brother's and Teacher's word with a complete tranquillity and concentrated attention.

Vsevolod bowed to I. again and sat down in his place. I. stood up, he looked everybody up and down without distinguishing us, and again I felt that unusual state from this look when it seemed that

his speech was dedicated only to you. Having looked at everybody's face, I understood that everybody experienced exactly the same feelings – as though I's attention was directed only to him alone.

“My dear friends, my loyal colleagues. We met each other for the first time a very long, long time ago. With some of you earlier, with some of you later, but I met everybody for the first time a very long time ago, without any exceptions. Every one of you knows himself how he was suffering before meeting me. Everybody remembers well of what pangs of hell I tore him out and gave a shelter to him here. But, my friends, my dear children who are sending and who were always sending your gratitude and love to me, am I really the cause of your current achievements, haven't you yourselves found strength and ability to liberate your hearts with your work, to liberate your mind from superstitions, to help your spirit to flame up with it and to burn down all conditionalities, all illusions that were preventing you from communicating with fire and spirit like some bolts? Not me, but you yourselves, my friends, are the cause of your liberation. You are the searchers of gold yourselves who've found the fields of jewels yourselves, that most important of which is the undisturbed tranquillity which rises as the result of your capability to live in Eternity by carrying Him within your temporary form and by greeting Him in each of your encountered living being. Now it is the time for a new joy for many of you: to share the jewels which you've found with those unfortunate children of the earth who had neither strength nor possibilities – because their will kept silent – to turn their look to their inside. Your new task – to draw the new people during each of your encounters, wherever and under whatever circumstances that encounter would happen, into your aura, to ease their suffering and to develop their whole independence in their daily work. On what has this independence to be based? I invite you to awaken and temper people's independence based on the absolute honour and honesty, the example of which you already possess the strength to be. Based on justice which you may spread in your new relations with people. Based on fearlessness which has developed within you as the result of your habit to live in Eternity. Try to develop and strengthen this habit within them. The path of giants opens before you, the path of Eternity that calls you to work and actions in it. Don't give way to insignificance of your feelings. Don't allow your heart to become covered with body and blood of temporality, act with those parts of your conductors where each cell is rich and saturated with the radiating matter of the sun, where your body and your blood have become only its basis and not the axis of your own energies. The time of tests comes for every man and there's a time of tests for each matter of the universe when its resistance and strength are put to the test by trying its suitability for the universal construction. The mankind of the earth may not be an exception of the general law of the universe, as well as any other spiritualized matter or the one that is waiting for spiritualization. The time of the disciple's test – that's the time of the greatest joy. His self-sacrifice – that's not the form of renunciation, that's the assertion of Life, strengthening his powers through each encounter. The man who has achieved such self-sacrifice is spreading joy everywhere, because he has already passed through all those stages when his personal perception of the moment could give bitterness to him. Neither time nor space exist for you anymore – there's only the miracle of Life that is going through the earth for you, you are called to glorify this Life, to incite and purify its sparkles within your every encountered person. I congratulate you in this moment of your life, in the great moment of your turn when the Bright Brotherhood hands the key from the new door to you through my hands. You will be able to open the door of your encountered person with it, you will help him to leave his narrow life – which is happening only according to the conditional laws of the earth – and to enter the wide life of the entire universe, the uniting of the activity of heaven and the earth of the entire mankind, of the mankind that is living according to the laws of the universe – the laws of accuracy and regularity. Don't condemn anybody's visible life from now on. Know that that what is invisible, imperceptible and impalpable formed and still forms the grandeur of your life, but namely that has forced to shine everything what is material, visible and palpable within and around you. So, my dear, go to the raging world. Go merrily, simply and easily. Go without any fear, with

confidence and you will overcome everything everywhere, because you will be striving for victory by loving and knowing. The Bright Brotherhood wishes you calm through my lips. Be blessed."

I. raised his hand high and blessed everybody who were listening to his words by standing. It seemed to me that the big spurts of fire were flying to all sides where only I.'s hand was directed, they adhered to the people's auras and began to sparkle in them with a fiery little star. The wonderful silence continued for several minutes. It covered everybody like the power of the grand hymn, full of joy. Again, I could feel the unforgettable moment of my merging with the whole life, with all its visible and invisible forms. Once again, I comprehended what a power I. possessed if he could open people for beauty so much.

Vsevolod told to open the door, and people began to leave the dining-room after bowing to I., Vsevolod and us. When the last brother left, Vsevolod addressed I.

"Dear Teacher, would you like to see the workshop, tailors, handicraft and general schools, and my sector's hospital? Perhaps I still haven't achieved the high enough level of handicraft and education, although I was trying to follow your shown examples and methods. We had to move some shops, for example the ones of glass and unbreakable crockery, to the oasis of the dark-skinned people, as Radanda told me. Perhaps you will desire to ride there and see them?"

"Certainly, my friend, in the near future. But today I am going to break up my group. I will go to your school myself; I will bring along only my messenger Lyovushka and close Ali's disciple Nataliya. My other friends, from whom let me introduce the world-famous actor Bronski to you, will go to your handicraft workshops and factories. Bronski, Nikita and all others will have to advice something to your masters there, they will push them into even greater perception of beauty and subtlety, and they will learn something themselves. Here, I introduce two specialists of the library science to you, I know that you lag behind in this field. They will help you to put those books in order which Ali has already sent to you with the caravan. Don't be terrified, they will put everything in order, only give some helping hands to them, best of all from your senior disciples. They will go through the old books and find the place for the new ones. And I brought this siter along with myself especially for establishing the nursery-schools and children's home. You will need to organize this work in a completely new way. She will stay here; she will get some helping hands and instructions. Now give an attendant to her, with whom she could make the round of all children's establishments."

Vsevolod took care of doing everything as I. instructed him to, we separated from our friends and followed Vsevolod. We were always walking across the park which always looked more like a forest, and it seemed that it once really was such. We could see houses, people, groups of children here and there. I was not only surprised by the variety of the trees, but I didn't even imagined up to now that such trees could even exist. We came up to a lake, and the views of nature and people's lives here changed immediately. The forest turned into bushes; the green grass disappeared. The bushes were growing in a boggy, sparkling sand which looked like a desert. There were trodden paths in the sand that led to the near housed which looked like some barracks or workshops. We could hear a forging of the hammer, a hum of the saw, the people wearing light working clothes were planing the boards, carrying stones, making tables and armchairs, trimming the wood. The most diverse life was boiling.

We turned by leaving the lake behind our backs and went out to a rather big island where the young cedar forest was growing, and several beautiful little houses were standing. We entered one of these buildings which looked like a school together with the gong, and from eight to thirteen year old children spilt through many doors of the wide corridor, accompanied by noise and laughter.

Having seen Vsevolod, they lined up in good order by the wall, but their shining, merry faces only showed the desire for a permission to scatter and to rush at their beloved chief.

"No, no, this time you won't hear "stand at ease!" from me," laughing Vsevolod uttered. "Be kind hosts, polite and benevolent, become acquainted with your guests who were travelling across the desert with difficulty by wishing to visit you. Well, now I will see whether we succeeded to educate you, whether you are courteous cavaliers and ladies," Vsevolod kept laughing.

The children's faces became extremely serious. They divided in groups of ten persons silently and quickly, and a boy and a girl were standing in front of every group of ten who, as I understood, were the heads of the group.

One girl stepped forward, she lifted her hand by greeting us and bowed to us. All the children followed her example. Their eyes were burning and staring at us with curiosity. The girl who stepped forward uttered.

"Today I am on duty, and I greet you, dear senior father, and you, our dear guests. Welcome! On behalf of all the children I greet dear guests who did great honour to us with their visit. We'll show everything what we've learnt to you, only," the girl became a little embarrassed, "we are still small, and we cannot do much. But we can sing, dance, do gymnastic exercises, play dolls and animals."

Vsevolod gave a joyous laughter, he stroked the girl's curls and answered to the children's greeting with his bow.

"Great, but you'll show all your artistic talents to our dear guests later. This time try to show your knowledge to them. And now – let it be "stand at ease!"

And what started here! Vsevolod disappeared in the crowd of the children who stuck all around him in a flash by reminding me of Francisco who used to disappear under the children and shrimps stuck all around him in exactly the same way. Maybe ten children were holding the high Vsevolod's stick like some priceless treasure, the others were holding extremely carefully the high, round cap of the monk taken from his head in their hands, while the rest of them were telling the greatest news of their childish life to him by interrupting one another.

A group of children approached I., they were examining him attentively and carefully, as though by not being able to take their eyes off his face. He was stroking their heads tenderly, he asked them several questions – and the ice of seriousness melted immediately.

"May we also with you be "at ease?" one very nice boy asked him by snuggling up to I. timidly.

I. gave such a joyous and infectious laugh that I couldn't help laughing boisterously and I lost my whole seriousness myself immediately.

"At ease, at ease," I. kept laughing and he took the boy in his arms. "But I am old uncle already, while my messenger Lyovushka here likes to be a camel very much, get on him and ride to the yard," I. said to the children who surrounded him by pointing at me.

I didn't have time even to make sense of it, while the whole crowd of children were already saddling me. Vsevolod made my burden a little easier, and the children dragged me out to the garden. They showed around their little farm there to me. There was a rabbit warren and some open-air cages here in which several beautiful, tender-haired puppies of an interesting breed were living. A little, warm house for the African breed puppies was built next to the cages. They were black and completely hairless. Although there was a heat, they felt cold, and the children covered them with warm, wadded cloths.

The break flew by very quickly, the gong was heard, and now there was an orderly group of little people who were coming back to the classes harmoniously and silently instead of the noisy crowd of children who were forcing their way through by pushing one another in order to tell something especial and especially interesting.

I couldn't see Andreyeva anywhere and I didn't know how she managed to become acquainted with children, but when I was coming back, I saw her surrounded by the crowd of children whose little faces were especially joyous. I was surprised how always sharp Nataliya Vladimirovna could attract the children so much? I noticed the beautiful little bag made of the palm fibre into which I was trying to thrust a tremendous lot of her items in the Dartran's oasis so diligently. The fascinated girls were looking at the small mirrors, the boys were rejoicing no less by examining the little pipes, drums and other wealth. But there was no time left for this joy, the gong rang out for the second time, and the children had to be in time for setting themselves in order, because with the third gong they already had to sit in their benches.

I found I. in the corridor who was surrounded by the crowd of teachers. He was still holding the same little boy in his arms. When I took a good look at him, I recognized the boy to whose mother I had to give Francisco's letter. I saw her back then when Francisco was writing the letters and he connected me with his thoughts. The little one put his head on I.'s shoulder, he was stroking his cheek and telling him.

"Uncle, dear, kind, tell me, why you are the most handsome of all? You are just like an angel in my mother's picture. You know, I was often dreaming of you," the boy was mumbling, as though he was preparing to fall asleep soon.

I. pressed the boy to himself tenderly.

"Lyovushka, the boy is sick already, but now we still cannot see it very well. The illness will become more acute soon. Bring him to his mother. There you will give Francisco's letter to her and fulfil his instruction yourself. You will be going by our house, and you will drop in to take the letter. Vsevolod, please give a company for Lyovushka while I am admiring your children's wisdom and the methodical teachers' talents."

I took the boy from him. Vsevolod gave one of the nurses-managers as my company to me. Her face was very kind, still young and pleasant, she was wearing a beautiful, brown dress, with a white apron and a white hood. The nurse left with me; she also took the boy's breakfast. It was difficult to carry him: the heat was scorching already, while the boy's body seemed like fiery to me. We dropped in at my cell, I put the boy on my sofa, I took Francisco's letters, and I asked the nurse who accompanied me.

"What do you think, would it harm the boy a lot if I delayed a little and ran to the shower? It seems that I am simply burning from the heated weather."

"Of course, it won't harm him, I will take care of him and ventilate him with a palm leaf. Our climate is very difficult for those who are unaccustomed to it, that's why lots of showers are arranged one next to another here. If you want to, you can refresh yourself several times on our way. Everybody who come to our place are unable to get accustomed to the heat immediately, but they get used to it little by little and don't feel it anymore."

I seized the towel without any delay, I ran to the shower, and I remembered my dear, kind guardian, my friend Yassa again. Where was Yassa? How was he doing? Will he come back soon? My loving and blessing thoughts were flying after him, while my heart was proud of the great confidence showed to him, I felt for him in this difficult journey across the desert...

The shower refreshed me, and soon we were already walking down the shady avenue. Now the burden didn't seem to be so heavy for me anymore, although the boy's body was very hot. The nurse showed the little shower houses to me several times, they were built very nicely from the white stone. She offered me to refresh myself, but I still wasn't so much exhausted, I was marching cheerfully, and I couldn't comprehend when finally, this journey was going to end. The forest became denser. We were walking for more than a half an hour already; the houses were standing now alone now in groups here and there. I could see neither the walls nor the gates anywhere through which we rode into the Community. I could see neither the stables nor the farms, but they had to be here, didn't they? The nurse interrupted my reflections by pointing at the separately standing house.

Through the opened window I saw the figure of a woman who was bent over the big, white notebook. Having heard my steps and the voice of my company, the woman lifted her head, and I recognized her immediately from the view in Francisco's thoughts.

Having seen her son in my arms, she left her work immediately and went out to meet us by opening widely the door of her big and bright room. She fastened her eyes upon her son's face. There wasn't such anxiety, such passionate love and disappointment which I saw now in the woman's face which was left in my memory. Without giving way to the woman's excitement at least for a moment, I was calling for Francisco with all my heart. I remembered his instruction what my own state had to be, so that I could have enough strength and courage to touch the boy's little face with that little piece of the sacred material which he put into his letter.

Having put the boy on the bed, I thanked my company, I dismissed her, and I made her certain that I would find my way back myself, which unfortunately, I doubted.

"Stop crying and be worried, dear sister," I said to the boy's mother who was kneeling at the bedhead of her son. "I've brought Francisco's regards and his letter to you."

As soon as I uttered this wonderful man's name, the woman changed immediately. The tears were still rolling down her face, but her eyes already lit up, her lips were smiling.

"Oh, what a happiness, hence everything will be all right and my dear little son will recover. Be blessed twice: because you have brought my dear boy - and I know well how heavy this burden is during such heat, - and because you have brought the news to me which I consider to be the divine compassion. I haven't met and I don't know anybody else who would be more compassionate and kinder than the great Teacher I. who saved my life and brother Francisco who has helped me to comprehend the meaning of my entire life full of suffering, who has taught me with his kindness to accept all my misfortunes, to bless them and to become free of their oppressing suffering. Meeting them - that's my entire life. Not only I believed in their sacred life - I wanted to follow them with the whole loyalty of my heart. Their help, their compassion, their love - that's my whole temple which I possess in my life. I greet you, dear messenger, I thank you for the happiness, because you couldn't bring any greater joy than Francisco's letter to me."

I took the little bag out of my big pocket, into which Francisco had put the red headscarf with the letters. I took this sacred packet to me, and I concentrated in silence all my thoughts on that moment when Francisco was praying by the red cup before sitting down to write the letters and he was begging for purity of his hands. I was trying to merge with kindness of his heart in my thoughts, I was calling for my great guardian Florentian and only then I gave the letter with the scrap of the material to her.

"Francisco told me to wipe your sick son's face with that scrap which he put into the envelope, if only I have enough strength to merge with his kindness and love. With all the strength of my heart I try to connect my will and I cry fearlessly for his power by praying him to join my weak strength. Oh,

if Teacher I.'s hand could touch your son instead of my weak hand, how happy I would be! Then I would know firmly that Francisco's mission will be fulfilled, that your sweet little one will be healthy not only now, but forever."

"Dear brother, why should you dream of that what is impossible? My blessed rescuer Teacher I. cannot be here now. If he was here, I believe with my whole heart that he would visit me. When he brought me here seven years ago, he ordered me to live completely isolated and not even go to the joint dining-room. I am doing exactly like this. I was happy and calm during all those years. Everything was all right. But now my son has grown a little and he often is asking me why we aren't going to the dining-room as his other friends of the same age are doing. And I don't know what I should tell him. Now the days of my doubts and tears changed all those my years lived here in undisturbed tranquillity and happiness. Are really my sins going to befall on my baby? I really his separation from others going to obscure his innocent childhood? He is so sensitive to impressions; he is such tender boy. He is often silent and lost in thought, he is sadly looking somewhere at the distance, as though he is trying to solve some not childish, tormenting questions with his childish head. Let's not dream about the impossible miracle. Let's get down to work, my dear brother. If Francisco has chosen you as his messenger, then your hands are pure, your heart is pure. Let's join our prayers, and wipe my son in an energetic, fearless and joyous way. No greater happiness exists than that help which one man may give to another one, who has come to him as the messenger of joy from the great Bright Brotherhood."

We went down on our knees at the sick boy's head. I was trying to comprehend the great mother's power of love when she is able to forget about her fear and doubts, to forget about absolutely everything, to know only the needs of the struck hour of her baby's life and to penetrate intuitively into the Wisdom that shows the way for help.

I immersed in thought about Florentian, I was calling for I., I was begging him to hear my cry. I don't know whether the ecstasy of my prayer continued for a long time, but I came to myself as soon as the woman seized my hand and shouted in fear.

"What is that? Can it really be? Maybe I am delirious?"

She was pale, excited, while her hand with which she seized me was cold. With her entire appearance, excited, confused and even unhappy she reminded me of unfortunate, helpless Joan when I saw her for the first time with two small children whom she was snuggling up to herself by sitting on the deck of the steamer. Suddenly pulled out of the strong ecstasy, as though hurled downhill from the top, I could understand neither her words nor the cause of her excitement instantly. Having turned towards the direction of her stiffen look, I saw I. who was standing in the doorway and smiling to us.

"Oh, I., my dear friend and Teacher! You heard my call, my prayer," I rushed at him, and I embraced my compassionate guardian.

"Lyovushka, I came so that I would explain the first rule of the disciple to you for ever: "Be always prepared." It is valid for ever in all the worlds of the Universe and for all human consciousnesses, in whatever form, atmosphere, in whatever period of time they would be living, if they are walking down the path of discipleship. You need to fulfil your Teacher's task absolutely fearlessly, with an absolute confidence, however and whoever would give it to you. Concentrate your thoughts in such a way as Francisco was teaching you, take his scrap and wipe the boy. You need to fulfil any of your Teacher's task only by forgetting completely about yourself, about your personal characteristics and by thinking only about that man to whom your Teacher's Love sent you. Take the letter into your hands, merge your energy with Francisco's kindness and wipe the boy. Remember that only joy and confidence may build the pure bridge through which the curative stream of that power will be flowing, which sent you as the messenger."

I took the letter from the woman who was standing deprived of speech, I pressed it to my lips and to my heart. I could feel the exceptional warmth and aroma that was spreading from the letter, and the letter itself seemed to be radiating to me. I took the scrap out of the envelope, which I memorized well when Francisco showed it to me, it was reddish orange back then, while now it was burning, as though I was holding a piece of fire in my arms. But while being immersed in ecstasy, the highest inspiration and the state of happiness, I didn't pay a lot of my attention to it.

Once again I knelt down before the patient's head, I wiped his little face with the burning scrap and I crossed him with it by uttering: "Let the Bliss of Love, the Bliss of Calm, the Bliss of Joy and the Bliss of Fearlessness cover you." I took the boy's hands, I wiped his palms, his body, his little legs and I noticed that the piece of fire was always decreasing, and when I was wiping the sole of his second little leg, the burning scrap completely melted in my hands. When I finished my job I stood up.

I covered the boy carefully with a thin material, he turned to the boy's mother and told her.

"Dear friend Ariadna, why did my arrival surprise you so much? Haven't I promised you that I would come? Have you really forgotten that I promised the meeting to you if you fulfil all the terms that I made to you not as a slavery or a burden, but as the joy by considering them as the protection for yourself and for your son? You have fulfilled everything, you even stopped crying and only lately you remembered this pleasant occupation of yours."

I was smiling tenderly, and I noticed the well-known little sparks of humour in his eyes. Ariadna was still standing like a pole, she must have attributed I.'s appearance in her room to the miracle of miracles which she was unable to explain.

"It's enough, my friend, come to yourself. No miracles exist in the world, only the levels of man's spiritual development and knowledge exist. The higher his love is, the further he can see and the stronger he can feel his close connection with people and their paths. You considered your first encounter with me also to be the miracle. While that miracle, as well as this one, was only the result of your matured spirit that was able back then and that is able now to enter the new and higher degree of your opening. Come to yourself and hear everything attentively out what I am going to tell you."

I brought the woman further from the boy's bed, he seated her on the chair, sat himself down on the bench and told me to settle next to him.

"In this moment, my dear sister, you are standing in the crossing. The time comes for every man of the earth when he comes to the forking of the paths. The narrower man's consciousness is, the more of those paths exist for him, the brighter the colours of the illusion are and the stronger it attracts him. His attention is scattered down those paths, and he doesn't possess strength to choose that one along which his highest spiritual "I" could walk. When the inner opening of the man's heart begins, his desires stop being so material and abundant, his ability is born to recognize the value of another man's life. Later he is already thinking about his equality with the people who surround him, and the number of the paths always decreases. Finally, sooner or later, along one or another of the paths, every man comes to the crossing of four desires – the one of happiness, of joy, of glory and of knowledge. But all the fires on all the paths light only one clear word: "I". Here the first, individual man's creation is born that is characteristic only to him alone, that occasionally gives harmony to him, that is the moments of inspiration. Later the path brings everybody to the crossing of the three paths: the one of Happiness, of Knowledge and of Wisdom. Everybody's selfless love brings him to this moment of his life. This form of love may be the most different. The form isn't important, the man's spirit is important which rose to the height of selflessness, and which was poured into everyday work. It doesn't matter whether you are mother, or a hero who sacrifices his life for his motherland, or a politician who is creating politics for his beloved motherland, or a

nation's leader, a doctor, a cook, a tailor or an artist. Only the essence of the break-through of the man heart's selfless creation is important, because only it remains in the records of the eternal man's work. Later by developing man can see only two paths already: the one of Happiness and of Wisdom. In the end of his path everything what he achieved, everything what he took away from the bonfire of his "I" suffering and fight merges into the only one happiness to know: Wisdom. Now the path of your suffering and work has taken you to the crossing of three paths. Don't think that somebody from exterior may show you in which of them the Light is burning. All the paths themselves are dark. Only the Light that is within you illuminates them. And this Light isn't the sign according to which you are chosen, it is the power that opens the door which may not hold out against the pressure of the streams of your heart. That path on which everybody steps has an invisible door which leads the man's spirit onto the highest level and into the ruin of his external wellbeing which everybody can see. What does the record above your door say which I can see clearly and which nobody else can see? The record above the door which covers the entrance onto your higher path says: "The path of the cross is covered where every footprint is sprinkled with your heart's blood. Step into the contact with people, because your spirit has acquired fortitude and your energy has matured for the general work and wellbeing, that is for the work for the general wellbeing." Now your son is going to be ill for several days. You will have to concentrate your entire attention on him. You must go through your last splinter through this worry: fear for your son's life. You'll comprehend during these days that any fear – that's the lack of loyalty for your Teacher. Be calm, the boy doesn't need any medicine. He will be sleeping almost all the time. Whatever would happen to him, even if it seemed to you that he is dead, that he isn't breathing, remember only one thing: your Teacher told you that your son is going to live. While the boy is sick, you won't see me, but when he is recovered, I will come and bring both of you to the dining-room myself. Remember, keep calm and be fearless, because the lesson that fell to your son now depends very much on your state."

Before saying good-bye to Ariadna, I. told me to go to the nearest shower and to come back here. I became glad, because the heat and the running sweat was tormenting me. I saw a brother in the shower who surprised me, because as though he was especially waiting for me. Without saying a word, he took my clothes, gave the clean ones to me and at the same time changed my sandals. Only now I noticed that my sandals which were clean in the morning had even turned grey from the dust. It seemed to me that I already learned to walk without raising dust with my feet, but apparently, I still couldn't walk easily with the weight.

When I came back to Ariadna, she was standing in the doorway and looking at I. with her shining eyes. I couldn't have recognized at all that this young and charming woman was the same one to whom I brought her son if I. wasn't standing next to her. Teacher said good-bye to Ariadna, he took my arm, and soon we were walking down the avenue.

"We need to hurry, Lyovushka, now we'll go straight to Radanda, we'll be delayed at his place a little and we'll go to the dining-room together with him. There I will talk to some brothers and sisters, and after dinner I will help you to deliver Francisco's letters. If we have time, we'll also visit old man Staranda."

It was a bliss to walk next to I. Also earlier, I noticed that he didn't sweat, that he always looked charming, and I had never seen such nasty thing on him as the sweat flowing in streams from which I was suffering. Even today, in this scorching heat when it seemed that the trees were burning and not giving the shade, a cooling stream was flowing from I. to me like from a rivulet. I was going to ask him about this miracle, but we met that brother who came to invite us to Radanda's dining-room for the first time.

"Father, our chief, sends me to you, Teacher, to ask you whether you need my help. May I change your servant Yassa who left you?"

I looked at him attentively, and the surprise was waiting for me again: the whole tragedy had vanished from his face. He was smiling tenderly and joyfully, as if a magic stick had carried away the whole sadness from his face. I rubbed my eyes by making I. laugh with it, who noticed everything, and I was forced to believe that the sad brother's face became the happy face of the kind man.

"Thank you, my friend, that you came hurriedly to fulfil your father-chief's command. At the moment we don't need anything with Lyovushka, but I will ask you to come to our house and to tell everybody to gather in the hall in twenty minutes. Tell them not to wait for me and to go together with you to the chief where I'll be waiting for you."

The brother bowed and turned to the side avenue. I understood, although I didn't know how, that the cause of this brother's joy and change was I. But I had already learned not to ask any questions, I began to think whether I hadn't forgotten about some of my duties, and suddenly... I remembered Eta.

"My God, where is my poor little bird? Is he really hungry till now? And where is he now? Dear I., let me run to look for him."

"Calm down, your Eta spent the night perfectly with Mulga, while Radanda took him with himself in the morning. Your ungrateful bird now admires his new friend. Radanda knows the bird language well, and Eta likes it very much. Therefore, not only he isn't sad, but he's even forgotten about you."

I. was laughing, humour was shining in his eyes, while... almost a heartbreak stirred in my heart.

"Why suddenly do you look like a sad sanctimonious person? Do you really grieve that your little bird feels well and glad without you? Would you like him to pour tears while he is left without you?"

"No, I., my dear guardian. Of course, I wouldn't like that he would pour at least a single tear for me or through me, but... but... if I had to part with you, I cannot guarantee that I would have enough strength not to cry in the same way as back then when I was crying by parting with Florentian."

"That would be very sad, my little son, that would mean that the physical time and physical space still control you, while the spiritual closeness hasn't become your breathing, your everyday life, your work with it. Neither separation nor parting exists for those anymore who have merged their hearts and consciousness with their beloved ones, who can see not the image that physically looks like himself, but the eternal path of his beloved person. Only the joy of co-operation, the joy of complete harmony exists for them, of the harmony that doesn't depend on the fact whether their physical eyes or spiritual eyes, the eyes of Love see their friends. If you are still standing in that crossing in which the illusion of love of the visible form exists, you won't be able to find the stable tranquillity, because the heart's tranquillity possesses only one basis of growth: everything, the whole life is within yourself. You need to learn to worship this Life in every man, whoever he would be – a husband, wife, brother, child, friend, – to respect it and to liberate the path to it in every beloved living being with your love. And no exception from this rule exists for a single man, in whatever form of his private relations he would be living."

I was listening to I. with my whole concentrated attention, but... for the first time his words seemed to be out of reach for an ordinary mortal man, such as myself.

I. looked at me tenderly, and as always, he read all my thoughts and feelings till the end.

"Lyovushka, this scale is changing while the man's spirit becomes stronger. And that what seems to be out of reach for us today, becomes our usual everyday action of tomorrow. This "tomorrow" breaks in different time for every man. It is in the same way individually unique as the whole man's path. A moment – for one man, ages – for another one. And during this entire "tomorrow" man's life is divided into

the stages of the tension of his heroic spirit. But the man achieves the power of each of the stages which lead him forward and through him the energy of his Teacher to his surroundings only then when any heroic tension that is difficult, comprehended as a heroic deed, becomes easy and simple, when it turns into his everyday work. My child, never allow to enter the oppressing feeling of “unattainability” of another man spirit’s grandeur. Always bless joyfully the man who has achieved more than you did and pour your joy onto him, so that he would be striving for his high peaks in an even easier way. In a more joyful, simpler, easier, higher way. These Ali’s words – that’s the whole program for everybody. Perceive in these words that the height of spirit isn’t a burden, a renunciation, a heroic deed, but it is only an absolute harmony. It manifests itself in a constant joyfulness that is undisturbed even for a moment and it arises namely because the man is living in Eternity. And while he is living in Eternity, he can see it in all the worlds in which he stays in the certain moment of his spiritual and physical growth.”

We approached Mulga’s little house, he greeted us joyfully and he told me instantly that Eta was living at the chief’s now, that he was running after him everywhere, in the rooms, in the dining-room. It was impossible to separate them. When he had to stay at home by obeying Radanda’s command, he sat down in his armchair by making all the brothers indignant with it, he kept everybody away from him and he demonstrated his stubborn character. I imagined Eta’s fight against the brothers, the disturbed silence in the solid chief’s rooms, and this scene was drawn in such colours for me that I started laughing from its comicality by forgetting about the solidity of this place myself. Somehow, with the reproachful I.’s look I was able to control my goofiness.

As soon as I had time to steady down, I heard the joyous Eta’s shrieks who was scuttling to me across the yard. People started looking at him through the windows, but luckily for me, they were smiling pleasingly. Neither for my laughter nor for my white friend’s pranks reproached me anybody. I was waiting when Eta jumped on my shoulder, but apparently, the chain of today’s surprises hadn’t yet been worn out.

The naughty bird stopped in several steps before me, he stretched out his train – it must be said that I saw for the first time how his train had grown and of what royal beauty it had become, - he raised his charming head high, then he bowed low and almost touched the ground with his crest.

This my friend’s unseen trick surprised me so much that I remembered the old times instantly and I turned into Lyovushka the Catcher of Crows in the true sense of the word. First Eta bowed to I., then he straightened himself and in the same way bowed to me. Then he decided that he already acquainted me enough with his new breeding which he had acquired in this Community, he gave a lashing shriek and poured the whole joy of meeting me immediately. He rushed at me, I disappeared under his wings instantly, he was climbing on my shoulders and hands, he was tousling my hair with his beak and soon he achieved his desired result: I was tousled, sweaty, my clothes were wet and rumpled, and the crowd of laughing people gathered round me. I felt ashamed, but I couldn’t suppress Eta’s enthusiasm in any way. Finally, Eta was happy enough himself, he must have been tired of such sport, and he perched on my shoulder. I was standing all red in the face, but I didn’t have any time to think how I looked, because I saw Radanda who was sincerely laughing from Eta’s pranks, and I heard his words.

“Well, brother Eta, you disgraced me so much. I wanted to brag about my talent of education, while here’s how you performed! Now who is going to believe me that I am good educator?”

Radanda’s voice sounded tenderly, a radiance was spreading from him to all directions, and again he looked like a ball to me. I don’t know what Eta understood from Radanda’s words, but he jumped down from my shoulder, ran up to Radanda and bowed low to him.

"Well, all right, that's your gratitude to me that I'm teaching you good manners. But you need to apologize to your master for tousling him," Radanda told him by extending his hand over Eta's head.

Eta turned around and bowed to me by looking at me sorrowfully, without stretching out his train, as if by asking me for forgiveness. His behaviour made all gathered people laugh, while Radanda told him.

"Now go and show the way to the bath to your master. And when you hear the gong, go to Mulga, behave yourself nicely and wait until Lyovushka comes to take you," Radanda was telling him by stroking Eta's back who was pressed to him. "The gong will ring soon, hurry up."

It seemed to me that I could see how the sparkles were flying about from under Radanda's hand and I thought that they were his thoughts which Eta could understand. The peacock turned to me, gave a tug at my clothes and ran through the yard by glancing back whether I followed him.

Having recovered a little from my confusion, I followed Eta, and I came in the shower which was the same as the ones which I saw in the park. Only the water here wasn't so cold, and the surroundings were more comfortable. Radanda's messenger gave the clean clothes and the sandals to me, and he was always surprised how I was able to come right with such capricious bird, I even taught him to bow. I didn't have time to answer him anything, because the gong rang out already. Eta gave a shriek and ran to Mulga, the door of the adjacent shower opened, and I came out of it. I must have been occupied with my own sensations and I didn't even notice when I came to the shower. We left it together and turned to Radanda's rooms which I entered for the first time.

The room which we entered was big and bright. High, glass bookcases were standing in it and maybe ten elegant, little tables which were polished in such a way that they looked like made of bone. The little piles of books and notebooks were placed on some of them, as though somebody had just been sitting at them and had to come back to work soon. Professor Zalzman's image flashed in my memory, how he wanted to go together with I. I understood his sadness because of his separation with I., although I could also remember well my last conversation with him on our way back from Ariadna.

The second stroke of the gong rang out. All our company's friends - both with whom we separated in the morning and those who stayed in the school, - entered the room together with the stroke, the same cheered up brother accompanied them. Bronski and Igor were noticeably excited. Having greeted Radanda, they approached me instantly, and Bronski uttered.

"Lyovushka, if I wanted to tell you about everything what we saw with Igor, then I would have to write the whole, thick volume. Who could have imagined that such life could exist in the desert, the one not of some savage tribes, but of the highest culture which mankind hasn't yet achieved in the cities."

Andreyeva went up to us, and we heard I.'s voice.

"My friends, I remind you that we need to enter the dining-room concentrated, to keep silent in it and to think about the eternal people's paths. Try to penetrate into that essence of people's destinies which is invisible and don't scatter your attention by observing the external forms. Don't turn into the observers of the "strange" lives. Merge the best of what you are only able to do with the hearts of those whom you can see by striving for the highest stage of spiritual culture."

Radanda reminded us to sit down in the same way as the first time.

"Lyovushka," Andreyeva whispered me, "this morning I understood your path so strongly and absolutely newly that once again I have to apologize you for my previous irony."

“Dear Nataliya Vladimirovna, first of all I have already forgotten about everything what has happened, second you were so tender and attentive to me since that time that all of it has exceeded those unpleasant moments if they existed. Now I would like only one: to reach such height of selflessness, such power of care as yours.”

The third gong was heard, the messenger gave the stick to Radanda, and as the first time we went to the dining-room. Brothers opened the wide door; we entered the hall that was already full of people, and we sat down in our places. I saw Vsevolod instantly and I recognized many of those whom I saw in his dining-room in the morning. I had to do my best in order to concentrate my thoughts. The three figures, their suffering which I had seen here, and all my experiences kept rising in my imagination. That helped me to comprehend and to start respecting the grandeur and horror of people's paths in a completely new way. I had to acknowledge the fact that this whole new comprehension of mine didn't help my thoughts to fix on some one thing strongly. They were always breaking like some poor threads. Nataliya Vladimirovna felt my efforts, she nudged me slightly several times and whispered.

“Try not to prevent I. from concentrating.”

She was right. I comprehended instantly in what abyss of egoism and self-analysis I was turning round instead of acting and directing my little strength to the great I.'s work. I looked at my dear guardian and I was surprised: again, I saw absolutely different I.

He was especially concentrated. As though he was praying or calling for some high powers for help. Imperceptibly I darted a glance at Radanda whom my memory had captured smiling. Now my eyes were fixed on unfamiliar Radanda's face, although during the short time of our acquaintance I had seen many different feelings on this face.

Radanda was sitting motionlessly, his ball of coloured fire was shining even brighter, but his face was without any expression, as if he was stiff and listening attentively to that what was heard from very far away.

However I was trying to distract my look from these two faces, my eyes always used to come back to them. All of a sudden Radanda gave a little start, his face came to life and brightened up with his usual, kind tenderness, the coloured fire of the ball began to glitter even brighter. A strong concentration slipped from I.'s face, the streams of Light spread to all directions from him, and it seemed to me that it became brighter even in the whole dining-room.

I didn't even notice that everybody at the tables already passed to fruit, that the servants carried away the first two courses untouched from me. The brother with merry face pushed the small plate with fruit nearer to me, he also put several pieces of the sweet cake and several dates into it, because he thought that I didn't like the previous food. He brought a cup of evaporating coffee for me and looked at me with such a pleading look that I gave a nod to him, and I began to eat instantly. I emptied the plate in a flash, I understood that I was hungry and that now I would start from the porridge with pleasure. I gathered all the crumbs of the cake carefully and I encountered Radanda's look. My God, how ashamed I felt! I saw so much tender humour in the chief's eyes that I nearly choked with those last crumbs of the cake. I felt like a small schoolboy caught red-handed, I cast down my eyes and I couldn't bring myself to lift them up.

In the meanwhile, the deadly silence fell in the dining-room. I felt how I. moved, I lifted up my eyes and I saw him standing.

“This day, my friends, is the last one in this Community for many of you. Don't give way to sadness which is penetrating into some of your hearts. Chase away your fear and misgiving that you won't be able to accommodate yourselves to your life in the world which you've grown out of. Throw off all your

hesitations and fears and take away three precepts with yourselves. The first one which must become the basis of your every day, of your every work, - that's your thought about the Bright Brotherhood. Whatever you would set to do, you always must comprehend clearly and precisely: whether you are the assistant of fulfilment of the Bright brothers' activity, or the incentive to work is only your own egoism. The second one - an absolute wholeness, an absolute concentration on each of your tasks which the Bright Brotherhood will indicate you to do. A million of the paths exist through which it may send its tasks to you. Never look at the path through which the news came to you, concentrate your attention on the news and set to fulfil it. What does it mean to fulfil the news in the Bright Brotherhood's opinion? To believe that the task was indicated to you and to do it in a methodical way? No, it means to give such love for the indicated task that the man's spirit would rejoice, that no grey daily routine would be left in which you would set to do the difficult task in a heroic way and with tension by always thinking how much trouble fell to your lot. Only then you will stay loyal to the Community and the Bright Brotherhood when the task of the day will be as easy as joy to you and not only as anxiety and troubles. The third precept which you will take away with yourselves, - that's courage and tact. Never utter a word until your self-control will bring you to the thought: the man who is moaning and complaining to me now is in his own point of evolution in which it still hasn't opened to him that everything is within himself, that he was creating his own earthly life himself up to now, he is creating it now as well. Only then search for the courage within yourselves to answer his meanest question, his most dishonourable complaint to him. Today everybody to whom the chief told so, gather in the small hall of his house at five o'clock. You will receive the clothes and everything that you will need for your future journey in Dartran's oasis. Now don't waste the time for your farewell and regrets for parting, take as little of your belongings as possible, so that you wouldn't become their slaves along your path."

I. bowed and sat down, while Radanda stood up, he crossed everybody present here widely by blessing them and uttered.

"I will say my farewell word for those to whom I've already told it at five o'clock. While you, my dear brothers, remember that many of you have already seen off a lot of your friends many times to the distant world, you've comprehended many times that many of them have outrun you in their preparation for work and action, and anyway you are still drowsing in your spiritual dream. Wake up, my friends! Laziness and delaying are much worse than hastiness. They are equal to death, because not the free and selfless spirit is growing with them, but personality that is searching for a certain form of her expression, for an excuse by trying to grow and to enslave the spirit with her desires and passions. Go, my children, and think again how many chances you've lost to get in the ranks of the selfless servants of the creating Bright Brotherhood.

The brothers left again by bowing to Radanda and us. Only this time the dining-room became empty much faster. Some of them hurried by wishing to finish their business in the Community until five o'clock and to prepare for the journey, others hurried to help those who were leaving, and only some sad and sullen brothers didn't feel the general enthusiasm, they left indifferent, as if they couldn't see and hear anything.

When everybody broke up, Radanda invited us, but I. answered Radanda that he would go himself with me to fulfil Francisco's tasks, Bronski with Igor had to go home immediately and to write down everything what they saw today in the morning, Laliya with Nina had to hurry to put the books in order, Theresita hadn't yet fulfilled at least a third of the program of their daily routine, and only Nikita, Andreyeva and Gerda could go together to his wonderful library where he would give work for everybody himself.

Again, after having separated with friends, together with Bronski and Igor we came home to take Francisco's letters. The pile of the letters was rather big, the thickest packet for the old man Staranda was at the very bottom. I began to doubt whether we would have time to make the round of everybody until five o'clock, because I was certain that I. had to take part in the seeing-off. But I didn't ask anybody anything, I wrapped up Francisco's headscarf into the napkin, I put everything into the small bag, and I went downstairs to the hall to wait for I. Again, only now I remembered Eta, only this time I didn't worry about his fate anymore, I was worried more about the unfortunate brothers whom Eta didn't obey in the same way as myself in the yard of the dining-room.

I. came soon and took me down the shady avenue which was parallel to that one through which we rode into the Community. We were walking for quite a long time; he turned right and took us out by the wide gates and the high fence. The gates were closed. I. hit the iron plate in the gates with the hammer. An oldish voice asked us through the small window why we came in such a bad timing. I. answered him, but I didn't hear what, the window closed, the hasty steps shuffled to the gates, and they opened immediately.

The monk who opened the gates for us was very old. His wrinkled face was anxious. His eyes, his nervous gestures and his objecting notes while he was speaking – everything provoked the thought that a stubborn person was standing before us.

"We are so lucky, my friend Staranda, that today you are in duty by the gates. We need namely you."

"You need namely me? I would like to know why you come here in the name of the great Teacher and you don't know that now it is an hour of tranquillity in our sector and that everybody is taking a rest. Why hasn't the Teacher explained our daily routine to you? And what is more, you came in bad timing yourself and even brought a baby with you. Who is he, your favourite? Do you think that I will be talking about the sacred things to me with you next to this chap who doesn't comprehend anything? It is strange, for all I know you are thirty already, but you hadn't yet acquired any tact at least for a penny."

The old man's voice and his entire behaviour reminded me of the primary school teacher who was scolding a guilty schoolboy.

"Well, why are you silent? You didn't come here to be silent, did you?"

He didn't suggest I. to sit down, but he himself sat down on the wooden bench by the round table.

"You don't have any respect for old age and the calm that is necessary for it! What kind of times is now, what kind of education!" he kept grumbling under his nose, but rather loudly, so that we could hear it, too.

It seemed to me that I had already forgotten how people got irritated, but in this moment, I was prepared to remember it, to cry, to stamp my foot, to burst into tears. I was trying to control myself with all my strength, I even began to sweat, but probably no efforts would have helped me if not I.'s help. He put his hand on my shoulder, looked at me – as though he lit up my brain and my heart – and I came to myself immediately. I understood that I was thinking only about myself, about the imaginary my dear Teacher's humiliation and not about the unfortunate old man who didn't have enough strength to see who was standing before him. I comprehended that in this moment I had gotten into the blind alley of the spirit, I comprehended the moment in the personal way and not with the strongest love which I could carry for the Only One within the man.

"Poor, poor Staranda! When Francisco saved you and sent you here, you swore and promised him that you wouldn't disturb the Community's calm. Moreover, you promised him to spread calm in your every encounter, every work which you would be given. Everything was going well for the first three days..."

"Wait, wait, young man. Where do you know it from? I don't believe that Francisco could tell the secrets of my life to you. Probably the chief slandered me to you. Well, what kind of the chief he is! He is chief and behaves like this..."

Probably Staranda would have kept talking profusely, but I.'s eyes flashed, his voice with which he began to speak was silent, but at the same time also commanding that the old man opened his angry eyes wide.

"Be silent and don't interrupt my speech until I give the word to you. Sit and listen to me attentively, unfortunate man. Comprehend your horrible behaviour, otherwise you'll have to leave this sector in the same way as you had to leave the Community and all those calm places before which you used to get into. You possessed enough wisdom and kindness during the first three days of your life in the Community, so that you wouldn't rush to agree and quarrel with the people living in the neighbourhood. Unfortunately, later you used to bother everybody with your morals whom you used to have business with. While being an absolute know-nothing who crammed only some scanty knowledge, but who was never able to unite all of it, you were preaching everybody, it wasn't important to which work you were appointed. The results of your rationalization proposals were always the same, although the experts advised and even forbade you to do it: you were breaking expensive machinery, you were ruining good palm timber, you damaged the crop, you ruined lots of tubs of paint for mats and carpets, and so on. In all these cases you persuaded yourself that you were searching for the way how you could live in the simpler, easier and merrier way. You didn't notice that everybody whom you used to approach used to become sad and worried, a boring dreariness used to become prevalent everywhere. And only three men remained kindly disposed towards you... You know yourself what a terrible lesson you've experienced here, in the Community, with how high price of his love Radanda saved you and put you in this sector which is inaccessible for the three persons who were taking care of you..."

I. was silent for a while, as if it was difficult for him to continue this speech. The old man who was sitting goggled-eyed in the beginning – protesting ones and piercing I. through impudently – now stooped, he avoided I.'s look and with his stooping he looked like the three terrible figures in Radanda's dining-room to me...

"Don't you comprehend now that you fall down always lower? Will you really reach the final limit of moderation, and despite all the efforts of Francisco's love, the Bright Brotherhood will have to take the final means of your rescuing, to shelter you in the secret Community?"

The unfortunate old man gave a start, he covered his face with his hands and stooped even lower to the table. I understood that for the first time during the long time he comprehended his behaviour correctly and precisely. A great compassion broke my heart, a remembrance about Henry and Stroganoffs flushed. I was begging Florentian and I stood nearer to I. by trying to merge my scanty strength of kindness and selflessness with his power.

"Unfortunate Staranda," I. repeated these words once again.

But how they rang out for me! They penetrated into the very bottom of my heart like a regard of kindness, like the music of love which forgives everything, which gives cheerfulness. Of course,

also Staranda accepted them in the same way. He took his hands off his face, he looked at I. pleadingly and gratefully, and several big tears rolled down his wrinkled cheeks.

“Francisco was talking about two things to you. First what he wanted to explain to you: that everybody can see only that what his spirit – pure or impure one – allows him to see. Second what you were unable to comprehend: that all man’s actions are creating his connection with the entire world. However you would be living, you cannot break off your connection with people. With your behaviour you are able only to create your connection every day, to weave your net with which you will be catching people or into which you will get yourself. Whatever your net would be – whether it will be the net of kindness and love, of selflessness or beauty, or it will be the net of egoism and irritation, – you enter it yourself and you take your encountered person into it. You are weaving the atmosphere of good or evil. Good or evil don’t exist by itself. They show up only for you, as well as for other people, in the way as you’ve woven them. In the same way as no separate God exists for everybody, except that Grandeur which everybody’s spirit may achieve. Francisco told you that the Bright Brotherhood would see all your work clearly. That the records of all your work would be reflected in the chronicles of Eternity. Francisco’s compassion sends you the record form these chronicles about your life here, that is about the entire period from the moment when you met him. He was telling you that you had to begin your every day with glorification of the Only One within man, while you used to begin it by making a list whom and how you had to “teach”, whom and how you had to “pressure”. In other words, while living among people who were “searching” for God during their entire life, you were together with those who could see only the human characteristics of their encountered people, who could see only some stains on them, but who never lifted the eyes of spirit up to their most Sacred Temple. That’s why you were unable to extend your Temple, you always kept constricting the entrance into your own heart. The youth whose hands’ and his heart’s purity you didn’t notice, brought the letter and Francisco’s excerpts to you. Shut yourself in solitude for seven days. Try to comprehend Francisco’s and Bright Brothers’ love and care with your joyous thoughts. Clean the habit of your grumbling and irritation which are stuck on you and understand that they have taken you to the last limit. You still have some time. You still have a choice. You still can achieve your liberation. You were given longevity, so that you could throw off a pile of your superstitions which have chained your thoughts and your will. Throw off your habits to correct and to educate everybody. A crooked tree also may give joy to people with its leaves and help with its shadow. Concentrate not on that how to straighten it, but how to prop it, such crooked, with the prop of your care. What is the meaning to keep moralizing your encountered strange life? Who may believe that you love your “educated” person if he sees your constant irritability, your insults and your exactingness to him? May the words persuade one? Only the living example may attract man and to awaken his highest desire to follow you. It is meaningless to “educate” that within man what you haven’t yet mastered yourself. And on the contrary, your every word will pierce through the man’s heart and thoughts like a bullet if your true kindness sends them to him.”

“Oh, Teacher, now I recognized you. You are that wonderful brother who saved me in the desert from the sandstorm. My God, why didn’t I recognize you instantly? I promised to pray for you till the end of my life and I didn’t do it. Hence, I will find it in Francisco’s records, too?”

“Don’t grieve too much. Don’t waste your time uselessly for the repentance and sadness. Act, create with your Spirit, and remember not the old things as the facts, but that your behaviour with people was unjust. You could make them glad and feel sorry for them, but instead of it you hurt and make them nervous, you named their faults and punished them.”

I.’s voice was ringing not with a reproach, but with such tender compassion as though it wasn’t Staranda’s fault here, but only helplessness of the man who didn’t possess the spiritual foresight. I. approached Staranda who was standing helplessly and who could hardly suppress his tears.

"This youth will hand the packet to you. You will find Francisco's letter and Ali's letter in it, which I put there," I embraced the old man, and he was stroking his head tenderly.

Oh, how Staranda changed! The little old man who was all trembling, pressed to I. like a baby, he was quiet... and kind. He was changing before my eyes from I.'s hand that was stroking him tenderly, he turned into much kinder and meeker, much calmer and more pleasant.

"Both of you, forgive me. I mixed up everything, I forgot everything what I knew. And now it seems to me that I wasn't even living, it is so empty in my heart. The heaviness of dissatisfaction disappeared from it, but kindness still didn't enter it. Ah, will I understand it, that kindness?"

"Not only you will understand it if you are kind, but I am certain that even before my departure you will leave this sector, come back to the Community and you will adorn many people's lives with your kindness. Go to your chief, ask him for solitude and read many times everything that you will find in Francisco's packet. Lyovushka, hand the packet."

I took out the packet. I was calling for Francisco with all my thoughts strength and I was begging him to help Staranda. I asked him to leave his little headscarf for the old man, I believed that the sacred Francisco's kindness would pass into Staranda's thoughts with this relic and that it would help him to concentrate. Suddenly, I all trembled and I saw Francisco who was standing with the red cup in his hands, smiling and whispering me: "Hand it, hand it to him."

The view disappeared. I unwrapped the napkin resolutely, I took out all the letters from the headscarf, except Staranda's packet once again, I wrapped up everything into the napkin and I put it in the bag. I wrapped up the packet carefully into the headscarf, I bowed low to the old man and extended it to him. I took his cold, weak hand and put the packet into it.

"Francisco ordered me to give this headscarf to you, dear father. Wipe your face, your neck and your hands with it in the most terrible moments, and Francisco's Will and Kindness will help you immediately. Good-bye," I bowed low to the unfortunate man once again by feeling for him from the bottom of my heart.

"See you soon, Staranda. I will be visiting you in your solitude."

I embraced the old man, and we were already walking down the avenue in a moment. It seemed to me that not an hour, but the entire eternity passed, because I was feeling absolutely helpless and sickly.

"Concentrate your strength, my friend, here's Ali's pill for you. I didn't have to strengthen you with them for a long time already. From today's experience comprehend how you need to beware of irritation. Your spirit and your body have already merged into a harmonious totality. Your irritation pushes you out of the atmosphere of those who are standing higher than you, which you've grown into. This atmosphere, which you cannot see and which you can feel only as tranquillity and joy when you are in harmonious state, falls apart from your irritation, your conductor becomes empty, and you are suffering in an inhuman way. Remember this experience and don't accept a single of your encounters personally anymore. Always think why Life needs for this encounter to happen, because the disciple can see only Life before himself, he can see only its call during any encounter."

I seated me on the bench under the shady trees and he sat down next to me. My weakness and dizziness soon paused, Ali's pill restored my strength, and the heat didn't look so unbearable for me anymore. Having seen that I was breathing normally, that my heart stopped thumping, I told me to go to the shower which was five steps from our bench.

Having come back from the shower where the brother on duty gave the clean clothes to me in silence, I felt like the real Goliath. Anyway I. told me to sit in the shade for another ten minutes, and only then we kept walking.

“Although today I should spare you, anyway we are going to fulfil Francisco’s given mission to you till the end. Soon Yassa will come back from an especially difficult journey, this is the last level of knowledge into which he will be consecrated. You will have more work to do when he is back: to translate the books for him which I will specify. Yassa doesn’t know the languages which you’ve learned in the Community. He doesn’t have time to learn them anymore. His development was so incredibly fast lately that the new level of consecration opened the door for him itself. Today you will finish Francisco’s mission and tomorrow you will start delivering Dartran’s letters. I dismiss you from the supper today. Instead of it you will go to give my regards to two sisters from Dartran’s oasis, you will become acquainted with them, and they will help you to distribute regards and the parcels from oasis. Memorize today’s experience well and listen only to the call of Life in whatever external form it would be standing before you.”

We were walking in the Community for a long time, maybe for two hours. Many different figures left marks in my heart. I was so happy after becoming acquainted with these people! All of them were cheerful, pleasant and calm. There were both old and young among them. There were the people of high culture who surprised me with their manners and intelligence that was reflected in their every uttered word, there were also some very ordinary people who learned writing and handcraft only in the Community.”

This whole kaleidoscope of faces exhausted me, but the tiredness was joyous – it allowed me to feel the happiness of the successfully fulfilled work. The fact that all these people thanked I. respectfully for their once saved lives surprised me the most.

Unwittingly I fell to thinking when and how I. had time to do so much work and keep in his memory the images of all these people from India, Europe and Asia, and maybe also from those countries about which I didn’t know anything...

We came back home. I. called Radanda’s given serving brother to us, he told him the names of the sisters whom he mentioned to me and told him to come back in an hour to accompany me to them. I. spent that hour with me in his room. He seated me on the comfortable armchair, and he was feeding me with some excellent fruit.

“Today, after you’ve destroyed all the functions of your conductor so much, don’t eat anything, except fruit. If you feel hungry when you are back, wait for me, I will take some bread from Radanda for you. Don’t worry about Eta, I will bring him back. How he is educated in an elegant way.”

The serving brother knocked at the door. I. gave the letter and the packet for the sisters to me. He bade farewell tenderly to me, and I went to the park by feeling with my whole heart that Life was calling and leading me according to its great Wisdom.

Chapter 20

My new acquaintances in the Community.

The first misfortune after meeting the emigrants from Dartran's oasis.

The chapel of joy. I fulfil Dartran's task with Radanda's help.

All the people to whom I handed Francisco's letters surprised me with their joy of life. But I memorized not only this characteristic of theirs. Every addressee covered me actively with the net of their ordinary kindness, and I really made sure how man himself created the net of the connection with his surroundings. The new effective perception was born in my consciousness: to live it meant to pour the elixir of Life-joy out of oneself.

I took a good look at the brother who accompanied me. By appearance he was about eighteen-year-old youth, he was slender and rather handsome, although some of his facial features were irregular. He was cheerful, of great vitality and self-confident. He was walking easily, and he was always trying to hum a tune several times, but every time after shooting a glance at me he as though used to apologize for disturbing the silence, to smile and to fall silent. I asked him whether he was living in the Community for a long time.

"Yes, for a long time, I was born here. It is ten years already when my mother left to the sector of solitude. She left as soon as she saw that I was learning well in the school and that I didn't need her care anymore."

"And what are you doing here?"

"Now I prepare for the public examinations to some university where Teacher I. will take me if he considers that my knowledge is sufficient."

I simply froze and I turned into Lyovushka the Catcher of Crows in a flash. I could expect anything, but I couldn't have dreamt of such answer even in the best dream. Such expression of mine made the brother laugh. He burst out laughing, he infected also me with his laughter – I was shouting with laughter like a boy who forgot about everything in the world.

"My God," finally I uttered after recovering from laughter. "Your answer shocked me, even my entire tiredness disappeared. I made sure once again that I was unable to know people at all, to see the powers that were hiding within them. I was expecting everything, but not such answer. Please, forgive me: I didn't even ask your name by considering the encounter with you to be accidental, which flashed for a moment between the walls of the Community. I was thinking only about Dartran's given task to me and... I forgot to greet the Only One within you. Forgive me."

Brother stopped, his face became very serious, and it changed him beyond recognition.

"Your inattentiveness to me is absolutely natural," he uttered tenderly, and even his voice changed, it became hollower and warmer. "Everyone of us doesn't pay attention to hundreds of encounters, because we haven't developed the habit to direct our attention from one thing to another in a flexible way and till the end. Although we are taught here from the very childhood to develop the precise attention, I learned it only when Radanda started teaching me the ancient languages. Ah, what an excellent teacher he is, it is such a pleasure to work with him!"

The brother's answer shocked me even more. I considered Radanda to be almost saint, but that he was also scientist, specialist of the Greek and the Latin languages, that he could teach excellently!..

"You already visited many people here with I.'s company. I was at the old count when you handed Francisco's letter to him. Count is an expert of history and great linguist. He is teaching me the special course of literature and history of all nations. He gave so much knowledge to me that I don't have any doubts about the history and linguistics examinations.

"Please tell me what your name is?"

"They call me Slava. My name is Vyacheslav, while my surname is Silko. Well, we came already. Both sisters here are considered to be the best mathematicians. I've heard that they had diplomas of some universities, but they are very reserved, and they don't tell anything about themselves, except the matter of that moment, so I don't know anything else about them. They are living here not so long time ago, no more than ten years."

We came up to a beautiful house, it was the first orange one among all white houses of the Community. Two not so old women were sitting in the balcony. I understood from their clothes that they were from Dartran's oasis. Having heard the steps, they lifted their heads from the books to which they were bent, and one of them went out to meet us.

"Slava, are you visiting us?"

"No, I only brought Teacher I.'s messenger and secretary to you," Vyacheslav answered her, he bowed to the sisters and let me go forward.

The colour flew into the woman's face. Her sister ran up to the balcony rail and she almost cried.

"Is Teacher I. here? When did he come? With whom is he? Where is he?"

Slava smiled for the speed of her questions.

"This brother here will answer all your questions. I will leave him here with you and I will drop in to take him in an hour."

The sisters invited me to the balcony. I told them with what a mission I. sent me to them, and I gave his letter to them. Every sister read the letter and they reacted to it in an absolutely different way. The elder sister who met me in silence brightened up with joy. A happiness, almost an ecstasy was reflected in her face. While the younger sister who flooded me with questions looked depressed and upset.

"I thought that it was over already," she whispered in a hardly audible voice by sitting on the armchair by the table and she immersed in apathy.

"Dear Runka, stop being a child. Can't you see that Teacher gives the work for us to do? Can you really accept the first task of our dear Teacher who saved our lives with sadness?"

"Yes, of course, you are right, Rolanda. But I don't have any strength to live here anymore. I want to go home, to the oasis and to the wide world from there. I don't have any strength to live here anymore. I want to learn and to see people. At last, he could have pity on us, right?" Runka was talking in a weak voice, with tears, in French this time.

Rolanda embraced her tenderly; she was stroking her wonderful black hair and she was explaining to her tenderly and silently in the same language.

"You know yourself that the fit of irritation will pass. Sister, you are the best and the most diligent, aren't you? Remember your state when Teacher I. took us here. Only here you became stronger, you helped many people. Now calm down. Look how tenderly and in a friendly way the youth is looking at you. He gives a packet to you. Take it. He really didn't expect to find a dramatic scene here instead of the help which Teacher I. promised him, did he?"

Runka wiped the tears and she said to me sorrowfully like a baby.

"Forgive me, brother. I cannot reconcile myself for ten years that I am torn away from everything that is dear and close to me. I always remember the separation with my beloved people. But... I am myself to blame for it. I am very ashamed that I made you to become the witness of such unpleasant scene. I am ready to fulfil what Teacher I. desires from the bottom of my heart, with my whole love. Believe me, this will give only joy to me."

I gave Teacher I.'s packet to her which was dedicated to sisters.

"I understand perfectly how painful it is for the man's heart when he must tear away from the most precious in his life, from that what seemed to be his only meaning and beauty. The pain experienced because of such separation leaves signs for a long time. Even when the wounds of your personal pain are already healed, when you already comprehend that the whole meaning of Life – that's Eternity which you've found within man and not his temporary form, also then the remembrance about the experienced pain is still living in your heart, although it already seems to you only like an echo of the past."

"Many times, during the ten years lived here I used to reach this wisdom shortly, but always the smallest spark was enough, so that I would comprehend the whole instability of my inner calm. Your words made me feel even more ashamed. What a happiness that Teacher I. didn't come himself, but that he sent you. I still have time to recover my self-control. Oh, if you knew how compassionate Life was for me by sending such tender and careful friend, my sister Rolanda to me. She left the world and science to which

she is dedicated as to her only passion at her own will, she left the oasis and departed together with me. If she hadn't been next to me, I wouldn't exist anymore."

Runka could have not told me anything. I understood it myself – I read it like in the book – the sisters' life and their relationship.

"Perhaps we shouldn't waste the time? If you want to, already today we can start the acquaintance immediately and visit somebody from the oasis dwellers," Rolanda was trying to turn the conversation to another direction. "A mother with her son is living next to us. Both of them are very kind, but they don't control their balance. You will be glad to become acquainted with them, because many of their friends from the oasis always gather in their house. You will get into the company immediately and you will understand their interests, moods, the level of their culture and taste."

I accepted their offer to visit the adjacent house with joy. We left a note on the table for Slava by asking him to drop in at the adjacent house in order to take me. While the sisters were taking me to the house, the noisy voices were heard from the distance already which reminded me more of an Oriental style sitting room and not of that what I expected to see in the Community. The widest sofas were standing along the walls, carpets were hanging on the walls and the small, round tables with low armchairs were placed in the middle of the room. The people who were arguing loudly were sitting everywhere. They were divided into the groups; they were interested only in their nearest neighbours and they didn't pay any attention to the rest of them.

"My God! Our entire recluses!" an elegant, grey woman dressed beautifully in the style of Dartran's oasis uttered by rising from her place and coming up to us. "Where did this knight show up from on the Earth, who succeeded to drag the bewitched princesses out of the tower?" the woman was laughing, she embraced the sisters and looked me up and down cunningly.

"This knight is Teacher I.'s brother in arms," Rolanda answered her.

As soon as she uttered these words, the silence of the graveyard became prevalent in the room. All the talking fell silent in a half of the word, the figures were rooted to the spot like on the stage of a living theatre as if the magic wand had waved.

"Sister Leocadia, let me introduce you to Teacher I.'s secretary, brother Lyovushka as Teacher calls him in his letter," Rolanda disturbed the silence that was hanging in the room.

Sister Leocadia turned out to be the mistress of the house. She greeted me pleasingly, but I could feel the strong anxiety behind her external politeness. In the same strong way, I could feel the currents of the people who surrounded me in the ring now. All of them were confused. As though the wind blew their gaiety away, an oppressing sadness began to blow in the room.

"Demetrius, son, where are you? Leocadia turned to the door of the adjacent room and called him loudly.

Lots of eyes were examining me. I felt that I could get confused, but in that moment a tall, handsome man appeared in the door. In the true sense of the word, he was an irreproachable, very good-looking man. His hair was black like a pitch, he had black eyes and straight, grown together eyebrows, red lips, the most regular features. He had a beautifully draped, brightly red cloak thrown on his shoulders, it was so bright and shining that looked like fiery. The handsome man approached our group, he greeted the sisters very politely and looked at me with undisguised sarcasm. His look reminded me of Bracano with something, although there wasn't the horrible, bestial anger in these black eyes. I could see a contempt in

them for everything what didn't give a personal pleasure to him, and what contradicted his taste and convictions.

"Mother, the scientists sisters visit stunned you so much that you even forgot to introduce me to their cavalier," he said to his mother by smiling, but coldly and from high.

"That is Teacher I.'s secretary, Demetrius," Leocadia uttered very silently. "Let me introduce you to my son," she addressed me, and again I could feel anxiety behind her external politeness. "My son is painter. He doesn't participate in the joint work here, but there are many excellent paintings in his studio already."

I understood that the woman was telling the first words that came to her head by wishing to gain time and to control herself. Having heard his mother's words, Demetrius gave a rather feigned laugh, and he was trying to look not shy when he greeted me.

"I recognize Teacher I.! He always chooses his associates of the most incredible appearance and character, which interests me, as the painter, especially. Please tell me, is everybody who came with him this time so young as you are?"

He was examining me impudently; he pushed the man who was hindering his look a little without any ceremony and he adjusted his red cloak with his elegant hand by demonstrating his beauty. I didn't have time to answer him anything, because I heard Runka's voice.

"We have brought Teacher I.'s messenger here not for you to parade before him with your theatrical poses, Demetrius. He must have seen a lot of them while living in the world. We've brought him only because he could see better all the emigrants from our oasis in your mother's house. How terrible, I can see that ten years of your living here didn't change you at all..."

Runka was talking in the rich voice full of excitement. Rolanda interrupted her.

"Demetrius, the guest in the house – that's the most important man, the whole attention is dedicated to him. Such is our grandfather Dartran's precept. And the guest as Teacher I.'s messenger, – that's the saint man for every inhabitant of the Community. Why do you want to look worse than you really are?"

Demetrius turned to Rolanda suddenly, his face flushed and became as the colour of his cloak – he was already prepared to snap out rudely to my noble patroness. The scenes of my encounter with Staranda blew over my head. I remembered how my heart was beating with indignation and vexation when I experienced the imaginary humiliation of my Teacher. I felt to be next to my dear guardian, the flow of the well familiar vibrations to me ran through my entire organism – I became absolutely calm immediately and I said to the hostess of the house tenderly.

"I am to blame for coming so unexpectedly and disturbing such interesting talking of your friends. In the beginning I needed to find out whether you and your son wanted to see me, such modest Teacher's servant."

"Ah, what you say! We are sincerely glad to see you. We haven't heard any news from Teacher I. for many years. We were told not so long ago that he was travelling across Russia, that's why your coming surprised us so much. We were unable even to come to ourselves immediately. Please, sit down. Please tell us how you were travelling? Haven't you visited our oasis, our close relative Rasul Dartran? Where and when did you part with Teacher?"

Leocadia was pouring the questions one after another, she seated me and the sisters at one of the tables, so that her son couldn't approach me. Apparently, she was afraid of his new escapade, and she didn't trust my suavity very much.

"I don't know which question I should start from. If I start from your last question, then I have to say that I parted with Teacher I. and hour ago."

The cries were heart: "What do you mean?", "How could it be?", "Unbelievable!" – and similar "ah" and "oh" were spreading from all corners of the room. The strong Demetrius's voice drowned all of them.

"Do you really want to say that Teacher I. himself is here?"

I looked round and I saw an inexpressible horror in the guests' faces which were still so joyous a moment ago. I couldn't comprehend this panic in any way, because while living for a long time next to I., I got used to see the people's faces burst into bloom with smiles only after uttering my dear friend's and Teacher's name.

"Yes, Teacher I. is here."

All cries in the room merged into a moaning: "How could it be!", "Has the term expired already?", "What do we have to do now?" – and the room became deserted together with these cries, only we and the hosts were left in it. Now the deadly silence became predominant again, which was exposed even more by the heavy Demetrius's breathing. He was standing by the table in the same pose, but with his head hanging, he was absolutely pale and gloomy, he looked like a fallen angel with his red cloak.

Leocadia was the first who disturbed this difficult silence which I couldn't understand.

"Don't be surprised that your coming made such a strong impression on all of us. You see, we've come here through the ways showed by Teacher I. and every one of us is obliged to him. We were living here in a merry and careless way, so it is hardly surprising that we've completely forgotten about the unpleasant side of our undertaken obligations. We..."

"Mother, stop this talking. Maybe Teacher's arrival doesn't have anything to do with us. He may have all sorts of business in the Community. You see, mister secretary, we are living here supported by our grandfather Dartran and not by the Community. We have our part in the park in which no one is living, except the emigrants from the oasis. I don't deny that I, as well as everybody else, am obliged, but at the same time I am independent as everybody else is. Do you have anything to give personally to us from Teacher I.?"

"No, Teacher only ordered me to fulfil Dartran's task: to deliver the letters and the parcels from the oasis."

Mother's and her son's faces brightened up; both drew a sigh of relief.

"Ah, so that's how it is! Well, we don't lack anything here. Our grandfather Dartran could not worry about us. Of course, we will be glad of your arrival and received presents," Demetrius began to speak in an arrogant tone and with his beautiful head raised high again.

I looked at the sisters and I was trying to pour some tranquillity into their hearts with all my might, because they were excited and nervous with indignation. A gentle knock at the door was heard, and I saw Slava who came here.

"What do you need? Do you want to see me? I am busy now, come later."

Demetrius was talking from unusually high.

"No, he came for me," I stood up hurriedly and said to the lad. I was sad for such unfriendliness which my pleasant company had to experience because of me.

"Where do you hurry? Please, stay for supper," sister Leocadia addressed me.

"Yes, yes," her son supported her. "Unwillingly you've become the reason why we stayed alone, haven't you? As you can see, all our friends ran away. Now your direct duty is to keep us amused."

"Forgive me, I am only modest servant of my master, and I can only fulfil his commands very precisely, but nothing else. I must come back home immediately. Teacher I. may need me."

Mother with her son were protesting very persistently by insisting that the supper was already on the table, that it was unacceptable to leave in their Community, that the table was already set, that it was even impolite. But I only replied to them again that I couldn't exceed the instructions given to me. I escaped the home of too hospitable hosts with difficulty, only after using my entire persistence.

When I already said good-bye to the sisters by their balcony, Rolanda held my hand.

"I am to blame here. They are all great people, but their light-mindedness isn't even to compare to anything, unless to their liking for idleness. I needed to warn them beforehand, then you wouldn't have had to watch this difficult scene. I will try to prepare people for meeting you in the future."

"I am very glad that I could see and hear the people who didn't wait for this news. Now it is clear to me how much calm and joy I must possess within myself for me to fulfil the mission given to me successfully. Don't try to justify Demetrius. My heart has already justified him. Not Demetrius or anybody else is the whole essence here, but I myself – how much tact and charm I will find to fulfil and not to ruin the task given to me."

We said good-bye to the sisters by wishing calm night to them, and it was dark already. The sky that was spangled with bright, big stars was shining above us, we used to meet people who were coming back home from time to time. We were walking the little paths of the park in silence. Suddenly Vyacheslav stopped.

"Brother, I don't know how people in the distant world are living, so forgive me if I act tactlessly by disturbing your silence. But Radanda was telling me many times: "If you see that your encounter with people began and ended without joy, try to give the warmth and tranquillity of your soul at least to one from your unsuccessfully encountered persons." You are sad, and I want to explain to you, the new man here, about the incomprehensible behaviour of those whom you've just met. This entire part of the Community which is made of the emigrants from the oasis almost never join the general working life of the members of the Community. They came here after receiving the instruction to choose independently one of the fields of the activity of the Community. They didn't choose anything for a long time. After many talking with Radanda they decided to inspect all the fields of the activity here, but they didn't like anything. Only about fifty or sixty people, your already familiar sisters among them, started working together with us, they have taught us a lot, they have learned something from us. The rest of them criticized everything severely, they decided to work separately, they established their own workshops and schools, but everything ended in such a way that if their children are learning, then they do so only in our schools. They are living by idling and they don't create anything even for their own needs, let alone the wellbeing of the whole Community. Some of them, for example Demetrius, is trying to make only an illusion of work. He is drawing, sewing, planting something, but he doesn't show the results of his work to anybody. He is criticizing us severely. Don't grieve for your first failure. Radanda himself reminded them many times of

their promises to Teacher I., that the years are passing fast and that they would have to show the results of their work. I remember one of his phrases which he told them: "Man's laziness avenges him. Laziness burns down man's initiative, and the man without initiative is not much higher than an animal. The longer the period of man's laziness is, the more painful the decay of the energy within him is. A year lived in laziness shuts all the possibilities for man to enter any path of Light. For only that man can enter within whom the flexible will for work is living." You see how wide this thing is. Were you able to find the way to unite with them so quickly?"

"Slava, of course, you are right that the laziness of their joint work is wide, and not I have to decide about it. But I will have to overcome with the greatest joy and nobility that short segment of their life which I was sent to touch – to give the regards from their motherland to them. I will be begging my great friends to help me to fulfil this task."

We went up to the porch of our house, and the first person whom I saw was Nataliya Vladimirovna with overslept, heavy Eta on her knees. This view was both unusual and not typical for Andreyeva. She didn't feel any attachment for Eta. Many times, I noticed even her aversion for my wonderful peacock. Now she was holding the bird on her knees tenderly and carefully, her head was pressed to the soft Eta's back. It seemed that this time Nataliya Vladimirovna didn't hear us coming, although she was always reacting to the steps sensitively. Only when we already climbed on the first step, both she and Eta raised their heads at the same time. Eta leapt to me, while poor Nataliya Vladimirovna, although she was laughing merrily, but she stood up with difficulty by rubbing her numb hands and legs.

"Lyovushka, I wanted to talk to you so much that I asked Teacher I. for permission to bring Eta to you. I. looked at me very mischievously and he allowed me to bring the peacock to you, but... your naughty friend caused so much trouble for me! The whole Radanda's authority was needed so that Eta would be so kind as to obey and go with me. As soon as we disappeared from I.'s and Radanda's eyes, he jumped in my arms, and he didn't want to go on foot. That's how I had to carry him till the very home. And when we came here – he forced me to hold him on my knees. The sly bird was thanking me so comically for my services with his looks and coquettish movements of his head that I pardoned him all his trouble."

"I am very upset, dear Nataliya Vladimirovna, that Eta poured all his despotism onto you. I don't understand in any way how you could have so much strength to carry him home. He is already heavy even for me."

Both of us invited Slava to stay together with us, but he went home by saying that he still had some work to do. To my reproaches to Eta why he made Nataliya Vladimirovna carry such heavy weight, she answered me herself merrily.

"Well, the burden was light for me! I know such word. And I wanted to tell you how Radanda surprised me today. I found all originals of the greatest Greek and Roman writers in his library, and when I asked him why he needed such work here, he answered me: "I needed them before until I didn't know them by heart, while now all educated people of the Community need them, because they get ready to serve their own people in the wide world where they soon will go. Well, let me introduce you to some of them," he added joyfully by walking towards the group of young people who entered the room in which we were sitting. Lyovushka, can you imagine how I turned into stone and how inane my expression was when I was greeting the people who were introduced to me? Radanda was laughing no less than back then when Eta was tousling you in the presence of everybody, about which he told me in an unusually ridiculous way. Lyovushka, don't think that I was laughing at you. I feel for you from the bottom of my heart, and I was laughing only from comicality of the situation."

"I think exactly in the same way, Nataliya Vladimirovna, and now I am very moved by your attention to me. If Radanda surprised you with his education and young people, then one of his disciples who accompanies us in the Community surprised me none the less."

I told her about all my impressions of the evening by conveying my conversation with Vyacheslav with all details. The two of us were sitting, charmed by the shine of the stars and the miraculous silence of the park. Nataliya Vladimirovna was speaking in the silent, sincere voice.

"How my world outlook is different in this moment from everything what I had to experience before. An absolutely new liberation was born within me during those several days of my life here. When I had some hours not filled with my strenuous work, almost a sadness was breaking out of subconscious depths of my spirit. Even a wonderful night, if I wasn't working or sleeping, used to give not a wonderful, divine tranquillity to me, but thoughts about my solitude, that I had nothing else on the Earth, that I was standing naked among millions of people who are dressed in all their passions and attachments of the temporary love. I became alienated from them, but I didn't rise till heaven... I was feeling as hanging in the interplanetary space without any firm point of support. In this moment I perceive both the heaven and the earth within myself. Reconciliation, the clear perception of death and birth comes to me with every rustle of the grass and leaf, with every laugh and moan, with every bird's warble and an animal's cry. I can feel the great Light within myself independent of my surroundings, of time and place. This tranquillity, the newly acquired reconciliation – my constant Glorification of the Eternal, my loyalty to Him is unshakable anymore. Everything what was still left in my heart from my previous conditionalities and superstitions, everything what could still open the wounds of separation in it or press it with cold for my own people's death, their suffering, delusions – everything broke away from me, turned into ashes, liberated my thoughts and prepared my spirit for the path to a much wider perception of Life. Your today's experience, when you saw clearly how people's lives perished if they didn't comprehend the meaning of work on the earth, conformed with my new perception how man had to live on the earth. I never doubted that in principle the earth was the arena of work. But how? Who needs everybody's work? What is the meaning of man's everyday work for the arena of centuries? Only here I was able to perceive the exact connection of it all. The great layout: birth, work, death – rose before me in three new words: power, endurance, self-control. All these three words depend on the simplest truths. Every man is creating them himself and he is paving the path of joy for himself and others from them. Now these three initial truths sound in the words for me: kindness, love, loyalty. It is absolutely unimportant where and how man is going to express these three powers. It is unimportant who he is, a monk or a layman, a savage or an educated writer, it is unimportant whether he met some great people during his life or he was walking his entire way through an elementary society, it is important only that he realized these truths and that he was uniting with people on their grounds. If he was paving his ordinary day with them – he will reach the encounter with his Teacher. He will step into the perception of life's eternity reachable not only with his mind, but also an absolute knowing with his heart that neither dearth nor separation exist. Man, who has comprehended with his mind that he didn't need to cry for his departed friend, would be crying anyway when his friend departs. Of course, he will be drawing his friend to the earth with his tears. He will be injuring him with the views of his suffering, and he will create thousands of obstacles for him by violating his first duty in the new world which he will get into. And that only one first duty in the new world – the only one as an eternal memory with which he is accompanied during the church ceremonies, – is man's ability to work. That's why it is so difficult to communicate with an idler who cannot create any eternal paths for himself with which he could unite with the living beings in all worlds. The work on the earth, as well as in heaven, is individually different. One man's work may seem like a doing nothing for another one. That is unimportant. Man's habits, his habit to reflect in a harmonious way are important, that is by co-ordinating the kindness of his heart and flexibility of his mind. They lead him to reconciliation. Love is inseparable from the harmonious combination of all these man's characteristics, namely she is the path of living Life within him. Today the last clutches of my

personalism have fallen off me. The feeling of my bitterness disappeared that I was standing naked above the dressed and joyous earth, that everything was cut off between me and her, magnificent and thriving. On the contrary, I am dressed in Light, in the shining Light of kindness. The entire earth is inside of my heart's temple, and neither illusion of death nor separation from the earth exist for me anymore. Reconciliation is born and fortified its position within me. The earth and me, as well as that where my spirit will go after leaving the dear earth that is suffering a lot, - everything is oneness. Joy to live, fearlessness to die - everything has merged into one sacred conception for me: to work for the people's wellbeing."

Eta lifted his head, gave a cry and ran down the little dark path. I understood that my bird felt approaching I. from the distance.

"Good night, Lyovushka. I will go to my room. I will write down today's impressions."

Nataliya Vladimirovna said good-bye to me by leaving a strong impression of her words to me. These words penetrated into my heart. I was feeling pain for separation with my brother-father in my heart many times. However great love surrounded me, however I appreciated, respected my wonderful and great guardians, sometimes a moan used to wake up in my heart. I wanted to feel an incomparable, tender embrace of my brother Nikolay, the blood and the body that was kindred to me. I wanted to stand up and to go to meet I., but I decided to wait for him on the stair of the hall. Maybe also I. was immersed in his great thoughts, maybe also he needed this little hour of rest and solitude. I didn't finish my thoughts, I heard a conversation, soon I saw two white figures on the landing before the house and dignified Eta who was walking next to them. I was never surprised when I saw I. with some unexpected people. I was already used to see the most unexpected figures next to him. But this time I was surprised, because I. was walking together with grey-haired Radanda who was telling him merrily about the new achievements of the glass production. When was Radanda sleeping? I heard the people say that he was getting up earlier than everybody else, that he was occupied in the most different business during the entire day. When was he resting?

"So, Lyovushka, your tired body asks for the rest?" Radanda put his hand on my shoulder, and he sat down on the adjacent step quickly, absolutely not in an old man's way. "Boy, you observe, observe everything. Not without reason the path of the writer is given to you. Write about people in a simple way, as I've already told you from the first look. The paths of writers are different. One of them writes a lot of things, they seem like necessary for that period. But when you look, a quarter of the century flew past, and people forgot about the writer, although he was recognized and awarded in his time. Another one wrote a little or maybe even one book, and it is living for centuries, it becomes proverbs and citations. Why does it happen like this? There's nothing special. One of them was writing and estimating his work himself by thinking how to please his contemporaries and how to take as much advantages as possible of it. He was searching for impermanence, so impermanence responded to him. Another one comprehended the only one power within himself: the Fire of the Eternal. So, he was trying to see it in others as well. He was trying to see where and how man violated the laws of that Eternal and how he was suffering from the harmony that was falling to pieces inside of him. I used to notice how people become happy, how they united with the Eternal and how they decorated the lives of the people who surrounded them. Such writer is going not only to reflect the abysses of people's joy and pain in his work. He will try to learn to experience their lives in such a way as if he himself had had the hero's circumstances. But it isn't enough to feel one's part in the hero's circumstances, one also needs to find justification for everybody in one's kindness, only then the writer will understand what it means to describe the man's life "in a simple way."

Radanda's voice was sounding absolutely differently now. My God, how many aspects of this man I saw during such a short time! I could feel clearly that I didn't know at all who Radanda was. Without comprehending whether I could speak to him in such a simple way, I announced childishly.

"I imagine in what a deplorable situation I would get, into much worse than back then when Eta was tousling me, if somebody told me to describe your Community and above all you yourself."

Radanda gave a smile, he put his miniature hand on my head and looked at my eyes closely.

"Your path is great and distant, my baby. Now you are still only a child, and you can already do pretty much already. But the time will come, and you will write not about me, but about much greater things. Now go to sleep. Tomorrow, I will go myself to Dartran's colony with you. You will learn a lot there and pick up a lot from the eternal people's suffering. Don't wait for I., go to sleep. We will have to visit somebody with him, those who need our comfort tonight."

Radanda crossed me. I felt an exceptional lightness and joy. I forgot about everything like in a fairy-tale, I took Eta in my arms, and I went to my room. I was so grateful to Radanda! On the other hand, I understood my childishness so well! I could see many times how strong man's harmony had to be, so that he could achieve something in his daily routine, and how strong man's strength had to be.

Having put Eta to sleep, I was blessing everybody alive in the universe, I was blessing my guardians' compassion and I lay down on a narrow, little bed by perceiving for the first time that I was on the boundary which separated my childhood and my youth from the young man's maturity.

The night flew past quickly. I woke up from the chime of the bell and Eta's pulling. This time I could already remember well and clearly where I was and who surrounded me. First of all, I noticed I.'s note that was placed on the chair next to my head.

"As soon as you get up and put yourself in order, go to Radanda's house by the dining-room. Leave Eta by Mulga. Before leaving, visit Andreyeva and tell her that I entrust Bronski, Igor and Gerda at her disposal during this entire day. Let her stay with them till the very supper and find with what to occupy them at her discretion."

I.'s note gave me wings. I managed quickly and dashed away to Radanda's house. On my way I went back to Nataliya Vladimirovna in my thoughts several times and I couldn't guess in any way why she looked at me attentively when I gave I.'s task to her and she told me: "Happy Lyovushka." My thoughts jumped from her to her inseparable friend in Ali's Community – Oldenkot. Only now I comprehended that I couldn't see him anywhere from our arrival to Radanda's Community, that he wasn't living together with us, he wasn't going to the dining-room with us and that I didn't hear anything about him during these days. I decided to ask I. instantly about this nice and strange, good soul, but this desire of mine cooled down on the way, I remembered that my curiosity wouldn't make I. happy. Oldenkot, as well as Zeiched whom I couldn't see in the Community, must have had his own path. With these thoughts I gave Eta to Mulga, both new friends became glad about that, and I knocked at Radanda's door. He opened it for me himself and, having looked me up and down mischievously, he said to me.

"Go to the shower quickly before I. saw you. Where did you become so dusty, as if you were running about in the desert?"

I looked at my sandals, I felt ashamed and even distressed: both my sandals and my clothes bottom – everything was full of dust. While being carried away in my reflections and wishing to see I. as soon as possible, I forgot my caution and lightness of my step. I apologized to Radanda and dashed to the shower. Here I preached a long sermon to myself and finally I was standing clean before I. My pliable guardian didn't reproach me with a single word for my clumsiness. He didn't scold me for my being late and he greeted me tenderly.

"Lyovushka, go to the balcony, the meal is left for you there. Eat without hurry and come back here. As Radanda has promised you, you will go to Dartran's sector with him. Come back with him and then you will ride together with me to meet Yassa who is coming back."

To meet my dear, beloved Yassa! Then I understood why Andreyeva told me: "Happy Lyovushka!"

Yes, indeed I was happy. The door of my heart opened wide not only for Yassa who – as I was convinced – was coming back with victory, but also for the whole world which as though fitted in within me. It became clear to me how deeply one needed to penetrate into the consciousness of one's encountered person. I could feel alive and effective Radanda's yesterday words that are needed to be able not only to feel one's part in the person's circumstances, to describe them, but also to justify everybody by comprehending this word not in such a way as we use it in our daily routine, but as the pure heart may accept the eternal fellow creature's path into itself. I as walking, and the melody of joy was ringing within me, although I comprehended well: that what I've achieved today wouldn't be enough tomorrow. Anyway, I was happy, I couldn't help smiling, and everybody whom I used to meet responded me with their smiles.

"The path of joy – that's the path of the happy chosen ones," – I remembered I.'s words and for the first time I appreciated my great happiness, I perceived through my own experience that I was walking down the path of creative joy that was within me.

I had breakfast quickly, and the food today seemed to be only a boring necessity to me. I came back to I. where Radanda was already waiting for me with a stick in his hands. When we went out to the bright sun, I could discern well the chief's face in the bright light for the first time. I saw that Radanda's old age which surprised me so much during our first meeting manifested itself not through wrinkles, but through an exceptional wisdom. The skin of his face was even, like an old parchment. His kind, bright eyes were shining like chandeliers, while their colour was always changing from blue to dark violet. His entire figure, which as always was covered with a shining, rainbow ball, was straight, and now I couldn't understand why Radanda looked so old to me during our first meeting and in the dining-room. Anyway, even now I felt him to be very old, as if he had been living for entire centuries.

"My friend, don't go deep into too early questions. Think only about Dartran's task. He is the most important "now" for you."

All of a sudden Radanda turned into a shady lane.

I could feel kindness in his voice, but this intonation was unexpected for my musical hearing. There wasn't any strictness in it, but I could feel such an unusual seriousness which reminded me instantly what a sacred and main task I was going to fulfil. When Radanda looked at me, his face looked like the one of those saints whom Russian painters loved to depict radiating. As though some ruby sparks were jumping from his eyes, his forehead, his throat and pricking me like small electrical discharges. In the beginning they were just pricking me, but after a while I began to feel such cheerfulness and joy, such power of tranquillity covered me and penetrated inside of me that unwittingly I snuggled to Radanda and kissed his dry hand. He responded me by pressing my hand a little and he pressed me to himself.

"We are going to the chapel of the joyous ones. It appeared a long, long time ago. According to the legend, a Divine Power built it in immemorial times. Back then when the desert was the sea, and an island was in that place where the Community is now. There's another chapel of the same origin – the one of the crying ones – on its other end, behind the sector of solitude. We'll also go to the second chapel with you when you mature, when your spirit becomes stronger, and you are able to give comfort and justification to the crying ones. This time we are going to embrace the feet of the wonderful statue of Great Mother. They say that this statue was hollowed out of the white coral, but I know that that material is called absolutely differently. You will see yourself that the hand of an ordinary sculptor couldn't do the radiance of the statue, its proportions and beauty, the continuous lines that form the harmonious totality. The sculptor had to be rewarded not only with artistic talents, but also his spirit had to burn with the Fire of the Eternal One. Joy of the poet who created it couldn't cease to burn even for a moment, because otherwise he couldn't have been able to create such beauty. He had to possess a pure, undisturbed joy within himself, so that every consciousness who bowed to this reflection of his spirit, of his living Only One with her entire purity would become stronger and would concentrate on the invincible power of Joy. Life himself inspired the sculptor and it keeps inspiring his work up to now. By bowing to the image of the Great Mother that is protected here, whom we call the Ringing Joy, you need to ring yourself with the whole completeness of happiness to live, with the whole loyalty to your Teacher's precepts in order to merge with that power which the Great Mother is radiating to everybody who bows before her with the whole harmony. I have connected you with my aura and I was pouring the sparkles of my Love onto you, so that you would be able to enter the chapel by carrying the sound of victorious Love in your heart. Take my hand. Unite with my Only One. Ask the Great Mother to help you to dedicate your entire strength of devotion to the wonderful affair of serving to Life through his form – the mankind of your time – as the writer, the servant of your contemporaries. By bowing, say thank you, bless the Grandeur who gave a part of her talent to you. By bowing, ask Mother to give protection for your talent, so that doubts or hesitations would never obsess you. By bowing, glorify her and ask for lightness of your thought, for strength for your word, for picturesqueness for your phrase, for the power for your penetrating fantasy. For the creative fantasy which derives its strength from intuition and not from emotions. By bowing, ask her to help you comprehend where the path to the Eternal One in every man is stretching and how to justify the miry swamp of tears and passions in everybody. Then you will find the path how to write simply."

Radanda took my arm and turned into the narrow, hardly visible little path which was winding through the brush woods of the unseen up to now, curved and luxuriant trees. I couldn't have even discerned such small path without him. Sometimes it even seemed to me that there was an insuperable wall of thicket in front of us, but every time Radanda used to find the hardly visible path. After many turns through this labyrinth, we went out to the small clearing, which was surrounded by gigantic cedars in half-circle, while the chapel was standing in the very centre of it.

How can I describe this unusual view? In the background of dark cedars, blue sky, hot and burning desert sun, high, above white, lacework stairs like the finest knitting, the same white, light chapel was standing, it was so light that it seemed that the slightest breathing of the wind could pick it up and carry away. I could see the sculpture of a woman in the chapel. The red shroud covered her head and shoulders.

I was standing like bewitched, without any strength to take my eyes away from such unusual view. The statue was holding the bouquet of many coloured flowers in her hands of divine beauty, while the diversity of their colours made the impression of her vitality even stronger. The whole statue, its shroud and flowers – everything was changing in the most different colours, trembling in the fire of the sunshine, soft as the hues of Venetian glass. I was unable to get rid of the illusion that the statue was hollowed out of the gigantic white and reddish pearls.

“Concentrate the power of your spirit, throw away the physical covers from your eyes, my friend, and glorify Life. Only that one can walk the path of beauty and uniting through it who will merge his purity and Joy with this radiating Living Beauty.”

Radanda left his stick and sandals downstairs. I followed his example; I took off my sandals and I took the bag with the letters out of my pocket. Radanda gave his hand to me again, and we began to climb up the wonderful lacework stairs. I was climbing up easily the first steps of the stairs. They even seemed to be cool to me, but the higher we were climbing the more difficult it was to move. My heart was thumping, as if a hammer was driving in my temples. The steps were burning my soles like the hot sand of the desert. My whole body was trembling. Big drops of sweat were rolling down my face. The higher we were climbing the stronger these sensations were, but I was holding tight my compassionate guardian's hand. Now it seemed to me strong like iron and it was pouring coolness into my heated body.

We got on the last step. I was standing like in the bonfire, but the physical suffering seemed to be an absolute trifle to me. I was looking at the smiling face of divine statue to me by forgetting about everything what was earthly, and I couldn't take my eyes off the radiating figure. Indeed, she was an incarnation of the aspect of Life's Beauty. I let Radanda's hand go that was still holding me, I raised both my hands up, I fell on my knees, and I cried.

“Oh, Great Mother, in this moment I desire to burn down in Your fire and to give my life to You, because I saw You, I felt happiness and joy of the perception what the Light of Eternity was. If I am destined to live, accept me amongst Your servants, the bards of Your beauty and joy. I cannot live without You in my heart anymore. Let the hour of my death strike if I am not worthy of glorifying You with my every inhalation.”

I don't remember anything what happened later. It seemed to me that Radanda's hands were holding my falling down body. It seemed to me that the Great Mother smiled to me and gave a reddish small flower to me by telling me that it was the flower of Joy. A column of fire dazzled me...

When I came to myself, Radanda was kneeling with one of his hands round me, and he was telling me.

“Oh, Great Mother, you gave your flower to loyal and fearless son. Accept me, his warrantor, and him into Your Fire of strengthening and liberating Joy.”

Radanda lifted me up with an exceptional strength and put me on my foot. We bowed to the wonderful view once again, and my guardian took me out of the chapel by force, because I didn't want to leave it.

Having climbed down, I understood that I was all changed, as if I became a different man. As once in Constantinople, in the secret Ananda's room I cried my last tears of my childhood out and passed into the age of a young man, so now the last remains of my spiritual youth fell off me – I perceived myself to be an effective little part of the creating Universe. When on our way back I bent down to set my sandals straight, the wonderful reddish little flower fell out of my belt. I seized it falling down without letting it touch the ground and I looked at Radanda surprised – I wanted to ask him what it meant. But he put his hand on my little flower and he said to me silently.

“Don't utter a word, my friend. Such great and sacred things exist about which people don't talk. Remember forever where you were, and if you are loyal to your given oath – joy, - you will come here again. But don't talk about that what you've experienced in this place.”

He took my arm, and we kept walking down the died away park. Having taken a small box out of his pocket, Radanda extended it to me.

"Take this thing and put your small flower into it. Always protect it next to yourself, and let the sacred emblem given to you today grow into the voluminous creation of the writer, which people need."

The box was green, oblong, and my flower went in it easily. A peacock very similar to my Eta was depicted on its cover. I put my flower into the box, and I was carried away by it.

"Now think a little what a happiness it is for you and everybody whom we are going to visit namely on this day and hour of your great enlightenment."

Without even allowing me to thank him, Radanda walked away quickly, while I wanted to fall down on my knees before him and to glorify the whole Universe through him. We were walking quickly for a long time, but I felt neither heat nor tiredness. As though wings had grown from my shoulders, it even seemed to me that I could feel them moving.

First, we visited sisters Rolanda and Runka. I was dumbfounded, because they were already waiting for us, they were sitting on the small bench by their house, prepared to go and they weren't surprised by Radanda's arrival at all. I didn't dare to ask them where they knew from that I would come not alone, but from hardly noticeable Radanda's smile and from his short glance I understood that he caught my thought, although it only flashed in my head. This little incident reminded me of concentration of my attention again. I made sure once again how unstable my thoughts were, that only the smallest cause was enough, and I became absent-minded. I stroked my box in which I protected the divine present of Compassionate Mother, and I was standing before her again inside of me by asking my great guardians Florentian and I. to help me to live and to act in her atmosphere.

"No, my children. We'll meet Demetrius and his mother in the next house. They don't like sitting without any work, do they? So, they will certainly visit somebody to discuss the principal questions, so that they would spend the time till dinner with people," I heard Radanda joking. "First let's go to visit the painters of the China factory, the same untiring diligent persons as you, my dear sisters. They have just come back from the dark-skinned oasis where they created new paintings. They are full of enthusiasm; they are resting now, and they will be glad to see us."

Radanda was going first, and he was walking so quickly that it was difficult to keep pace with him with my feet, but it was joyful for my heart. Suddenly he turned to the beautiful house with the flower garden in which I could see planted flowers in an unusually artistic way, and he climbed up the steps of. The beautifully decorated terrace quickly. From every fold of the white cloth that covered the wide window to the harmoniously chosen range of colours of decorative and blooming plants – everything was telling that beauty was not an addition here, but necessity, the most ordinary expression of the spirit's need to live with beauty. Having heard our steps, a tall man with the white chiton that was worn in the Greek manner came out of the terrace and, having seen Radanda, he gave a joyous cry.

"What a joy, father, it is to see you and your company in our home! It is even a greater joy that you came exactly in the hour when I was calling for you. I am impatient to show our achievements to you."

This man whom everybody could perceive to be an artist reminded me of Bronski with some of his manners and his appearance features. Up till now I had seen such lightness of movements that was characteristic only to Bronski, which gave freedom and elegance to his entire figure.

"Hello, my friend! I am also very glad that I came to you in time. Here, become acquainted with our guest, young I.'s friend. He has brought a letter for you from the oasis and a parcel from Dartran. But for the parcel you'll have to visit him yourself, but you'll receive the letter now. This nice postman is called Lyovushka. He must have evaluated your work in the Community already. He is writer and he is very sensitive to beauty. Of course, you will strike up a friendship. Lyovushka, he is that artist whose drawings you admired so much, as well as the form of the cups of his production. His name is Gregor."

Gregor greeted me very pleasingly, he thanked me for my appreciation of his production which I had time to repeat, but his face, as soon as Radanda mentioned the oasis, became serious from radiating and joyous one, a sadness and even pain showed up in his eyes.

I took out my bag with letters and on the very top I saw the big envelope with a Latin note "To my friend, brother and son Gregor Staphilyon, the artist."

I gave the letter to him by asking from the bottom of my heart the Great Mother to help me to give peace and relief for the artist's heart. My soul, my inner spiritual eyes, as well as the physical ones, were so full of the Great Mother's vision, of the atmosphere of her Living Joy that by giving the letter to him I felt as being by her feet, begging her to become patroness and justifier of this man's sadness whose talent was radiating from his every movement like a torch that was shining in the marble vase.

"Thank you for the letter and for that benevolence with which you give it to me."

He squeezed my hand, and from its handshake even the bigger wave of warmth trickled into my heart, I was touched that Gregor felt my love sent to him and that he responded to it."

"What a joy! You are rare guest here, father, and even with fellow-travellers!"

Having turned to the voice which I heard behind my back, I saw a man of medium height, he was dressed exactly like Gregor and his face also was like his, but his figure, hair, manners and movements were completely different. He was a personified temperament. His speech was quick, his words were simply pouring, and it seemed that he was all full of mercury, but he wasn't flouncing about. His every movement was precise and deft. It should be noted that this man had his own, unique vision scale, that he wouldn't trip anywhere, he wouldn't brush against anybody with his swiftness, but on the contrary, he was able to do everything what he was thinking about and what he wanted to do. He got in the terrace, Radanda embraced him.

"Vasilyon, one will never see you without a flower-pot with flowers."

"But look, father, what a flower!" Vasilyon lifted the flower-pot with an excellent, red flower by Radanda's eyes and he was pouring his words. "Dartran brought me two feeble shoots of this variety during his last visit here. I had so much trouble until I raised these two mountain lilies in the hothouses of the oasis, and no one could have done it there without me. I didn't expect to raise them here, too, but look what a miracle of nature. What kind of colour, reddish, changing! What a radiance of the rainbow! They look in such a way as if the divine hand had hollowed them out of the reddish and white pearl. Such a beauty!" Vasilyon raised his hand with the flower-pot high. "Gregor, the first try-out to draw this flower on cups - for father and his fellow-travellers. Oh, I will try so hard, my dear father, so that the little flower on the cup would look alive and light up with the whole rainbow of pearls."

It seemed that Vasilyon forgot about everything around him. His figure reflected his erupted admiration. While I was looking at him and at his flower, I thought how whole this man was with his enthusiasm and that the chapel of the Great Mother was the best place for his flower which almost precisely repeated the colour of its statue's wonderful radiance. Quick Radanda's look and his smile

allowed me to understand again that he read this thought of mine as well. I remembered his words: "Such great and sacred things exist about which nobody is talking." I bowed to the statue in my thoughts again, without the atmosphere of which I couldn't exist anymore, and I sent my respect to the artist who was admiring the beauty of the flower so much.

"Brother, the flower is wonderful, but... your hospitality, as the one of the hosts, is far from being wonderful. Become acquainted with the new guest and thank the sisters-recluses who tore off their home for us," Gregor took the flower from his brother's hands, he brought him to us by trying to take him onto the Earth from the paradise of flowers.

"Be more attentive also because this young man isn't only Dartran's messenger, but he is also Teacher I.'s friend and secretary," Radanda added by looking attentively at Vasilyon who was greeting and smiling to me joyfully.

I saw a shocking change in Vasilyon's face. He turned pale, his paleness was seen even through the dark suntan of his skin. His hand that was shaking my hand was warm a moment ago and now it became ice-cold. He staggered and leant upon my shoulder which I was in time to slip for him.

"Oh, my God!" he was whispering with his head hung on my shoulder. "Oh, I am not ready, not ready. Did ten years really fly past so quickly?"

He squeezed my hand even stronger; he was leaning upon my shoulder even stronger. For the first time I felt my enormous physical strength. I didn't even know up till now that I could be so strong. For the first time I understood how tall I was, because Vasilyon's head was at the level of my shoulders. I had noticed myself that I was growing up strongly and I felt here only the miracle of the talents of I.'s education. And, of course, I acquired this so suddenly felt new strength after visiting the chapel. I understood even clearer how absolutely harmoniously everything in man's organism had to be. If I hadn't become Goliath, I wouldn't have been able to withstand such power of the waves of Joy and Light which went right through my organism, dazzled and made me nearly die for a moment by turning me into one of the notes of the Great Mother's divine chord...

Vasilyon who was gushing with energy and activity a moment ago now was inert and absolutely flabby. I seated him on the armchair, and I caught Gregor's look. My God! He was a complete opposition to his brother. There wasn't a sign of that sadness in his face anymore, which slipped through him after mentioning Dartran's name. He was shining like the sun with joy. I.'s name raised to the surface the whole idolization that was hiding in his heart. He was self-confident, calm and plain. He approached me.

"You entered this house as the messenger of such big happiness! There couldn't be any grander moment for meeting our rescuer, Teacher I., for us. Don't pay attention to my brother's confusion. His first words – the words of negation – is only the material, external echo of the oldest habits of the way of his thinking. Vasilyon has already become free of his negation that was killing his life a long time ago, as our beloved and loving father, friend and guardian Radanda knows it. He is trying to assert Life with all his might and to do its work during his grey daily routine. Condemn strictly neither him nor me," Gregor was telling me by feeling his part.

"To condemn you? Oh, my friend, what are you talking about? Could I really, such imperfect man, who received so much compassion in such undeserved way, condemn the paths of people's aspirations? The closer I draw to people, the clearer I can see and feel what compassion is, how I still cannot spread it myself by associating with people."

“Gregor, you will read your letter later. And Lyovushka will give the letter to Vasilyon later. You never need to begin to read the main papers or start any big business until your organism doesn't feel a complete tranquillity. My dear children, what is the complete creative tranquillity? For each disciple – that's uniting of his Only One with the Only One creating Life, and association with people or doing business that happens only through him. Man must always be prepared for such association. Vasilyon, pay an especial attention to my words. Here you received the news which you were searching for and waiting for more than a half of your life. You were expecting it, you were striving with respect for it, and you were trying to prepare your spirit. But the news came – and your first words with which you greeted and met it were negative. Remember this moment forever, so that you wouldn't repeat the mistake. Compassionate Teacher I. foresaw it and he protected you from a sudden encounter with him, so that you wouldn't harm yourself and your entire path irretrievably. He sent us with Lyovushka to you by strengthening us beforehand with his Love and Joy of the Great Mother, so that we, the sinful ones, would find Love in her atmosphere to accept the blow of your negation to ourselves, so that we could justify you and take you to the atmosphere of her calm and comfort. Stand up, recollect yourself, pass the whole inner rejoicing of your spirit to your external form and spread happiness to live your new day easily. Meditate on what made you utter: “I am not ready.” Fear. Only fear of the great responsibility before Eternity made your lips to obey your mind and to avoid the creative activity of your heart. That is what a Teacher is talking about by saying: “Kill your mind.” That means give time for all yourself to reach harmony, create silence within yourself, so that the enlightenment that is already waiting for you on the threshold could meet the wave of those vibrations within you, which it needs for you to perceive it. Your mind which is acting without any harmony with the creation of your heart may not rise to Wisdom. Therefore, it may not be filled with the vibrations of Wisdom, although it would be standing next to it. My friends and children,” Radanda addressed us all again, “let this encounter cut two rules of discipleship in your eternal memory:

1. No one is a friend for you, no one is an enemy for you, but every man is a great Teacher for you.

2. A precise and whole man's action is important now and not in ten minutes.

Let's continue our journey.”

Radanda took Vasilyon's hand, and he tugged him with such power that he even staggered, then he pressed him tenderly to himself.

“Now forget about yourself and think about others. Half an hour ago you were thinking only about the beauty for others' prosperity by trying to unite with them through the beauty. Ten minutes ago, you were thinking only about yourself by forgetting about all your surroundings. Unfortunately, my dear, neither the first nor the second is worthless. Only that one who is living in Eternity overcomes by loving. Then he isn't jumping in his thoughts from personalism to impersonalism, but he is working with the constant joy by passing that seed of Eternity to everybody through his work, with which he is living himself. From now on, live not with an imaginary, but with the true quietude. Then you will accept every present of Compassion with respectful gratitude. Your gratitude for the Truth will be expressed with your everyday work – easy, fearless, determined and simple one. You won't be thinking whether you are the chosen one, worthy or unworthy of the compassion given to you. You will be happy by being able to unite sincerely your every encountered consciousness with your own life and knowledge. That doesn't mean that offer for everybody to share your most Sacred. That only means that by protecting the secret of your opening you will try to draw everybody in the result of your living work, of your joy full of love. You will try to see the temple of your every encountered person. You will be searching for Light within him with the respectful joy and you will help his balance to become stronger with your justification.”

Radanda and Vasilyon were talking and climbing down the stairs of the terrace. Everything: the nature and the people who surrounded Radanda seemed to me transparent and radiating next to him today. This time Radanda's ball seemed to me changing in reddish and white colours which were so dense and material that they covered not only all other usual colours of his rainbow ball, but also Vasilyon's figure who was walking next to him.

Having crossed several lanes, we stopped by the very banal two-storied house in the architecture of which one could feel pretensions to the subtle taste, but actually the house was citified and showed the lack of talent of the person who built it. This building here, in the Community, surprised me very much. It was brightly green with white pillars, and it reminded me of a bad imitation of the ancient Venice palace. A Grecian pediment was parading next to it and an ordinary hall like the one of the French villas, which was hung all over with shells and decorated with the bunches of flowers. The pretentious balconies and terraces took the elegance of the work from somebody's fantasy.

This time, in the same way as back then when we were going to Demetrius's and Leokadiya's house, a loud talk of many voices met us from the distance. It seemed to me that the sonorous Demetrius's voice was distinguished from everybody else.

Radanda passed round the main entrance and the terraces, of which were even three, and he came up to my already mentioned hall. The hum of the voices here was heard clearer, it already reached the level of the market, and it seemed that it was coming from the last rooms. Radanda let us into the hall, and he gave his stick to Vasilyon.

"Sit down here on the chair and don't let anybody out if somebody wished to leave secretly due to his stupidity. If somebody tries to force his way, stretch my stick across his way. Then he will step back from you and come back. Don't frighten them and don't threaten them with any words, simply say: "There's no way out." My son, concentrate your entire attention to the words told you. Don't condemn these unfortunate people for their dull negation of the Truth, remember how the Truth has justified your negation and sent us, its messengers, to tell you about it."

Radanda's voice was kind and quiet as during that unforgettable night in the dining-room when he was talking to three figures... Vasilyon kissed the chief's hand. I noticed how Vasilyon's tear fell down on the dark chief's hand, and he stroked tenderly the grey man's head pressed to him.

"Be decisive," Radanda whispered him even more tenderly and he called us to follow him with a gesture.

We crossed three empty rooms which were furnished comfortably, but tastelessly, a big dining-room where remains of a meal were left on the table not in an aesthetical way, and we entered a big sitting-room which was full of people who were arguing very much. In the beginning nobody noticed us. We were standing silently by the door. I saw the especially concentrated Radanda's face. As though he was praying. All of a sudden, the reddish and white beams stretched to all sides from his radiating ball. The voices fell silent immediately, as if they had noticed Radanda all at the same time. Maybe ten people turned to him and us, and from all corners were heard: "Ah!", "Father!", "My God!", "How didn't we hear!" and similar cries full of amazement and embarrassment.

"Yes, yes, my dear children. Not in a vein they say: you know neither the day nor the hour when the man's son will come. If you, while knowing the exact day and hour when Teacher I. will come to you, were unable to prepare to meet him, then what will happen with you when death comes to you? You won't find out its hour, will you? Death doesn't exist for those who have opened the eternal life within themselves and who are carrying it. When you came here you swore to work during all the days till your

death. You promised Teacher I. to prepare the examples of your work, to show the results of your new life till his arrival to the Community. The entire spectrum of the Community's work was offered to you – from the lowest forms of work till the highest level of an artistic and scientific work. You rejected everything. Then I proposed you to create new forms themselves, to work everybody according to your own taste and discretion. I visited you many times, I used to remind you, hurry you, ask you not to waste the time uselessly, to set to work. Only few from you, no more than a hundred people, joined the working life of the Community. They merged with the Community, they contributed to its progress with their talents and love, and they expanded their consciousness very much. They – the workers whom you criticize and despise the most, who are labouring for the common welfare – now are already free from the necessity to live in the sector of solitude, they don't need any frames of discipline anymore. They have already mastered the strong self-discipline, they can go to the wide world as the new, useful parts of the universe who will be loyal servants of Life by helping to realize its plan of Eternity. What can you show to Teacher, my unfortunate children? There aren't any results from your arguments and talking, and ten years of your life have flown past. Teacher is here, and inevitably you must answer him about your work done, what you've done from your taken pledges."

While Radanda was speaking, the people were trying to step back from him as far as possible to the depth of the room, as if the beams stretching from him had been burning them, although I was certain that they couldn't even see them. Strange things were happening with my eyes. Now I already couldn't see man, his physical form as before. In each of them I could see several layers of the turbid or radiating matter which covered each other and penetrated one into another, while in the depth of them some turning centres of energies were shining. These centres of those people whose cases were bright and transparent were big, they were radiating and moving in the speed of a whirlwind. Where the cases looked like a miry silt of the turbidly grey or greenish black hue, these centres were hardly visible, and they were hardly moving. I looked at Radanda and I understood that that what I saw up to now as his radiating ball was the radiance of his turning centres, while the centres themselves looked like some shining flowers in the radiating matter which covered his entire body. Namely these centres used to make an impression on me of the ball, because they were shining, sparkling and they merged one with another from their fast turning.

As Radanda had foreseen, the people who were gathered in the room were trying to leave the house through the hall, but they used to come back by failing to pass through Vasilyon. Another door from the sitting-room was probably leading to the terrace, but it was blocked up with a bulky wardrobe which pretended to the Gothic style, but which had a very unattractive form. Nobody brought himself to pass through Radanda, everybody was flocking by the windows, they were embarrassed, gloomy, and some of them were even shooting angry glances at us.

Accidentally my look slid off to a slender figure who was standing separately from others. She was a very young, about fourteen-year-old girl, who was looking at Radanda with her shining eyes. As soon as Radanda's beams reached and covered her, she ran across the whole sitting-room quickly, fell down on her knees before the chief, seized his hand and began to speak quickly.

"Father, my dear, save me, help me. I want to learn so much, I love people so much. Grandfather Rasul told me to go to school, but neither my mother nor my brother wants to hear anything about it, and they don't allow me even to leave our home. I was trying to come to you many times, but every time they used to catch and lock me up at home. Help me, teach me to distinguish where the truth is. I hear around only the criticism for the Community, and I cannot understand at all who really are you and the Community, why we are living here if my parents and all their friends don't like it so much."

As soon as Radanda helped the girl to stand up and put her next to himself, a haughty woman, tall and beautiful, came out of the crowd and addressed Radanda in an arrogant way.

"Please, father, don't pay attention to hysteria of our ill-bred daughter. Everything is only her fantasies to which Dartran was making concessions since her very childhood. Forgive me, please, I was so embarrassed that I even forgot the first duty of courtesy and I didn't offer you to sit down. But my insane daughter's escapade confused me."

"Yes, yes, Anitra, yes, my friend. Nobody prevented you from dancing the fantastic dances which you consider to be the top of the art. You were never confused to disturb somebody's calm with them. I came to you so many times, but you, occupied with your fanciful step, could find neither time nor possibilities to offer me to sit down. And everything with what you used to see me off was only a carelessly told phrase to some spectator of your ballet rehearsals: "Thanks God, I got rid of the boring old man." Unfortunate Anitra. Don't think that I reproach you. No, no. You see, my friend, it is impossible to open eyes by force for a single man. Only then everybody's eyes open on the earth when he is working a lot and for a long time. You cannot live without work by idling on the earth. This place among all the places of the universe – that's the path of work. If you had been learning to dance by wishing to master the art of the dance and to pass it to others, to inspire your own people with it, to awaken the aspiration of nobility and beauty within them, then your path of the dancer would be sacred and blessed. But you were thinking not about people, but only about yourself, about your own charm with which it became difficult to enslave spectators without any mascara. That's why you've spent your time uselessly. You've forgotten about the most important law of the earth workers: to prepare the young generation for yourself. Not only you haven't drawn anybody to the aspiration for beauty, but you used to push away everybody who used to approach you by wishing to learn, because you were afraid of a competition. Try now, at least for one time during your entire life, to think about another man with joy and not about yourself. Give your daughter the freedom to live in such a way as she wants and understands it, to learn what she wants to..."

"What are you talking about, father!" Anitra interrupted Radanda sharply.

She was turning red and pale during his entire speech, now she could hardly control herself, so that some rude words wouldn't slip out of her mouth.

"But you really..." she faltered a little, "cannot understand my daughter's wants due to the lack of your life experience. If starting tomorrow I allowed her to live in such a way as she wants and understands it, then she would get a job as a nurse in your hospital already tomorrow by explaining to me that she cannot do anything else, but to nurse patients. She is an obstinate and angry child."

Anitra suddenly turned to the people who surrounded her and gave a strict cry.

"Adam, Ramza, men! Why did you, my husband and son, this time leave me, woman, to fight alone? Do you hear how I am insulted; he says that I was never kind, and you keep silent? I know well what you mean by uttering the word "work". I've seen enough of Rolanda and Runka from whose appearance one can see that they've already forgotten that they are women. It is enough to look at Gregor who is always besmeared with clay. I already don't say anything about all the rest who couldn't resist your sermons about the work for people's welfare. I believe that it didn't even occur to Teacher I. to comprehend the work as you do. Be so kind, return my daughter who hid behind your back due to her stupidity."

Seeing that Radanda was silent and that he didn't even move, Anitra dragged an elderly man out of the crowd, who seemed to be confused and unhappy. He looked at his torturer with his meek eyes, who was dragging him towards Radanda.

"Ask, Adam, demand him to return our daughter. Prove at least one time that you are man. Don't dare to resist me, go."

"Anitra, my dear, come to your senses. You are kind woman, aren't you? Don't try to look worse than you are."

Adam was looking at his torturer tenderly and pleadingly, while she didn't pay attention to his pleading at all. Then Adam broke away from his wife's hands with an unexpectedly deft and strong movement that wasn't characteristic to his weak nature at all, he took several quick steps towards Radanda and he knelt before him.

"Dear, saint father, I was dreaming of meeting you for so long. But every time when you used to come here, I wasn't at home. And I was afraid to search for you, to come to you. Forgive us. I've comprehended a long time ago that we were living not in such a way as we promised it to Teacher I. I've already started working. Gregor accepted me in his factory secretly from my wife, and it seems that he is absolutely happy with me. I beg you, save my daughter, save wonderful little girl Sana. She is kind and diligent. If there's at least some tranquillity and order at our home, then that's only thanks to her. Don't accept my request as a complaint, but..."

"Very nice, father! It is not enough that you were always spoiling the girl, now you disgrace yourself in public with this servility! Moreover, you confess that you are working in Gregor's factory! What are you doing there, do you really knead clay?" a youth came out of his mother's back, and he was exasperated with his thin voice of unpleasant timbre.

He was tall, but so corpulent that he looked like only fat. He looked like a plunderer with his wide mouth and upper lip which couldn't hide his big teeth. His head was so small in comparison with the width of his shoulders that it looked like a head of a pin on the whale's body.

"Ramza, Ramza, come to your senses, remember your last conversation with grandfather Dartran," Adam told him by turning to him and then he addressed Radanda again. "Father, let your compassion not abandon us, help me to understand how I must serve my wife and my son, so that my love would become help and strength for them. How I can open their eyes, so that they would see how strongly I am devoted to them, how I respect them, and I desire to spread calm and happiness for their lives. I am prepared to work during the day and night, to take all daily work upon myself, if only they smiled and weren't gloomy and irritated."

"Stand up, my friend, come to your daughter who is praying for you with tears. Comfort one another and try to think strongly about your relatives not as about the physical forms that are close to you, but as about the separate little parts of the Only One Life covered with the form of dear people to you. Dedicate your prayers and your care not to these external forms, but to that Grandeur, eternal and inextinguishable, which they are carrying within themselves."

Radanda embraced father and his daughter, he stroked their heads and put them next to himself. He told me and Gregor to stand by his sides.

Solitary figures began to walk from the different sides of the sitting-room and, having approached Radanda, they stood in a semicircle before him. They were pressed one to another and as though they were afraid of an attack of the people who remained in the depth of the room.

"Father, all of us are working in your workshops and schools secretly from our families. We don't have enough strength to fight against our relatives who don't allow us to join the Community's life, while it is very difficult for us to work secretly. We wanted to come to you many times, but... we didn't have

enough courage. We were afraid that you would push us away and then our life in our families would become unbearable.”

A youth with meek and sickly face was speaking in such a way by glancing back timidly and coming to Radanda. He must have wanted to come even closer and to hide behind his back, but he didn't dare to do it.

“Yes, yes, I know everything, my children, there may be no secrets in the Community. You were working well, and I didn't disturb you. I couldn't help you until you overcame your fear and began to speak. Go, go and stand behind my back, no one is going to touch you,” Radanda let the people pass into our circle.

Having received such results of the youth's speech, next ten figures dashed at Radanda, while he, remaining silent and smiling, let them pass into our circle.

“Yes, yes, now the goats have separated from the sheep,” Radanda uttered by shaking his head and looking at the sullen people tenderly who had clustered round Anitra. “Why are you silent? My children, won't you really find any kind words with which you would charge me to get justification and apology for you from Teacher I.?”

“What words do we have to tell you?!” Demetrius gave a rude cry. “You are the cause of the split of our families yourself, aren't you? Why have you exalted Gregor and Vasilyon so much? Why was Yassa the best of all for you? Why have you already sent Yassa and Zeiched a long time ago from here, while you keep us here as slaves? Tomorrow we will tell Teacher I. about your unfair estimation of us which rouses our indignation. Of course, you noticed my wonderful paintings. But there wasn't any estimation of them and my entire work from you. You've insulted self-love of every one of us. You used to incite Dartran against us and to illuminate us with such a light for him as you wanted yourself...”

“Poor, poor Demetrius, indeed your eyes can see only that what they can see. Let Great Mother be compassionate to you and those who are with you,” Radanda answered silently.

He crossed the whole room with a wide cross and he added silently.

“Let God help you tomorrow. I will be praying to the Great Mother for you.”

Having turned to us, Radanda showed us to leave with his gesture. A noise of the fight was heard behind our backs, I turned round, and I saw that Ramiza was holding Anitra who was trying to escape from his hands. Her proud face wasn't especially pleasant a moment ago, but she didn't lack beauty, but now it became ugly from her rage. Moreover, the big and heavy golden comb that was holding her artificial, long plait fell down from the fighting woman's head, it struck against the floor loudly, and now the plait coiled up by her feet. Some vicious mockery was heard here and there, but Anitra couldn't see anything anymore, she escaped her son's hands like a cat, and she was crying.

“Give me back the girl immediately! I am not a slave for you! How do you dare to take my husband and my daughter away? You cannot have any servants due to your stupid rules, so maybe you think that I will be ordering my house and messing with the meal myself? I don't give them to you, unfortunate old man!”

Radanda stopped. He gave a deep sigh.

“Anitra, the best conditions were given to you and all of you to become completely free of any additional work. You needed to take care neither of your meal nor of ordering your home. You could have spent your entire time for your favourite creative work. The thing is that not my clever or stupid

prohibitions are to blame, but every man's preparation to become free, to perceive what is temporary and conditional, what will vanish, and what will remain with the man in all circumstances. In any form of the social level you can be free or enslaved if you are living with passions yourself. That one who isn't tired by his haughtiness, envy and self-love as an acute form of fever is able to spread calm in his surroundings. Remember, unfortunate, where only you weren't living! You were wandering everywhere, and it seemed to you everywhere that everybody hated you, that you were persecuted. At least now think a little when your loyal servants who've devoted their entire lives to you leave you: who were you for them and with what you've made them step back from you? One moment of your complete loyalty, one moment of real, selfless love may take you to the new, unexpected happiness: to live in inextinguishable Love of the Great Mother. And then, believe me, my poor, everything will light up in the different light. You will be glorifying the greatest man's happiness: to live by working.

"Again your sermons! Again your words!" Anitra gave a shout, now she looked like a fury. "That was you who forbade us to beat our children by stating that such was the law of the Bright Brotherhood. That was you who were poking your nose in our family relations by reminding us of our promises to Teacher I. to live honestly and purely. That was you who forced us to splash in your showers by persuading us that they were much better than our fragrant ointments, that they could preserve our health and youth better. It is impossible even to name all your precepts. And you were doing all of it only in order to incite us one against another and to catch the individual members of our families into your nets. Tomorrow I will tell everything, everything to Teacher I."

"Silence, unfortunate," Radanda said to her silently, but in such a commanding way, and such sparks began to rain from his entire figure to Anitra that she stepped backwards, deprived of speech. "Be silent until Teacher I. will allow you to speak when you stand before him," Radanda told her in the same commanding way.

He turned to us again and this time he left the house without paying attention to the noise which was heard in the sitting-room as soon as we stepped over the threshold. Having repossessed his stick from Vasilyon and taken his hand again, Radanda told Gregor.

"Take, my friend, everybody who are walking with us now to my rooms by the dining-room. There explain to the brothers to let everybody take the shower, to give the clean clothes to everybody and to sit everybody down at my table in the dining-room. Take Vasilyon together with you, while I with Lyovushka will visit one more place. We will be in time for supper."

Having said good-bye to everybody, Radanda quickened his steps forward, I also bowed to the people who surrounded me, and I hurried after the chief. I had to state the huge change of my strength. From the experienced difficult scene, I couldn't feel any slightest weakness, any dizziness, any hint of an irritability or a nervous disorder. I was walking next to Radanda like made of iron and, as soon as both of us were left alone, the atmosphere of happiness which I carried away from the Great Mother's chapel embraced me again.

While I was walking next to Radanda, I stopped feeling myself, the Light was covering me, and the entire surroundings stopped existing as my separate, individual perception, I could feel it as one, indivisible totality.

We entered a narrow avenue from high acacias flowering in white. I looked up from where a giddy aroma was spreading, and I saw the white sea of blossoms through which the sky-blue was showed blue. The hum of bees, wasps, cicadas – everything merged into one symphony within me, I was living, I was glorifying everything alive, and for the first time Life was – I, and I – was Life. For the first time I embraced everything with my thoughts and spirit: I understood where the limit between the personal and

cosmic perception was, what was the collapse of old superstitions and conceptions and how the free thought was pouring from man into the earthly actions. I understood the meaning of the great words: Harmony is happiness. I understood that that person found an unshakable happiness who felt the Light within himself as the living impulse to live.

We came to a simple, pleasant house. A small flower garden was here which showed a not pretentious host's taste. A small dog came running before us, and two children, five or six-year-old boy and girl, after him. Having seen Radanda, the children rushed at him by laughing and screaming, I was hardly in time to take the stick from his hands, so that he could embrace the children. A woman with an ordinary, clean dress was running to us from the distance, and a man with working clothes came out of the house. It must have been a single family. Having seen Radanda, the grown-ups brightened up no less than the children. The chief told them without allowing them even to greet him.

"Well, my children, I've brought the news for you. Grandfather Dartran is sending a letter for you and a little parcel for everybody. There are parcels even for you, madcaps," Radanda added by stroking the children's heads pressed to him. "From the letters you will find out how Rasul is happy with you and your life, and you will come to me, to the dining-room yourselves tomorrow in the evening for the parcels. That's not all, don't hurry to thank me. Teacher I. is here. You will see him tomorrow. What are you afraid of? Aren't you prepared the foot-wear material for the whole Community? Can anybody else produce such excellent half soles as you did? Nobody will even suspect that they are made of the glass, because they are flexible and steady as the ones made of leather. Be calm, self-confident, take the children with yourselves and come in the evening. I will still talk to you. Lyovushka, give the letter to these excellent workers."

I felt uncomfortably, because I didn't know what I had to give to my new acquaintances, the names of whom Radanda didn't mention to me, but he smiled and added.

"Search for the envelope on which it is written by Dartran's hand: "To my grandchildren Adrian and Nataliya."

I found the letter quickly and I gave it to Nataliya. I saw such face for the first time in the Community. She was pale, freckled, she was looking at us with her calm, childish eyes, and it seemed that tears were going to pour out of them soon. Her husband was her complete opposite. If I had met him in other surroundings and if I hadn't heard Radanda's words that he was worker, then I would have considered him to be a military leader. His carriage, his manners, his look – everything told us: "I am warrior." He was looking at us in a cheerful, self-confident way, and an invisible power was felt in his every movement.

I didn't have time to think anything else about the destinies of these people, because Radanda already said good-bye to them, and he turned towards the house that was standing in the very end of the avenue. By saying good-bye to my new acquaintances, I was trying to give the whole happiness of my singing heart to them, and I hurried after Radanda with whom I caught up by the entrance to the house. This house looked like the one which we had just visited, but it was much more spacious. Having entered the hall, I saw that there were many doors to the rooms from the wide corridor. One of them opened, and a man in working clothes rushed at Radanda.

"Oh, glorious father, you've come! O Lord, not everybody is home yet. Ah, how sorry they will be that they didn't see you! Come to our reception-room, my dear. As by knowing it, we decided to arrange one common reception-room, and you will be our first guest."

The man opened the door and let us into the room.

The room was small. The walls were boarded with nicely polished wood. The modest, comfortable furniture, the floor covered with mats as in Dartran's oasis and several bookcases was the whole room's furnishing, but the wonderful aroma spread by the wood and exceptional cleanness made our hearts and eyes glad.

"Father, we did everything here with our own hands. We were dreaming to invite you, we were dreaming about your visit as about the greatest feast, while you came yourself! Ah, how my friends will be disappointed who won't see you today."

"Nobody will be disappointed, my friend Vasiliy. Go and cry for everybody who are here, - Dartran has sent letters for you," Radanda sat down on the chair, and he seated me next to himself.

As soon as Vasiliy left, Radanda told me to prepare the letters by telling one name after another to me. Several letters were still left in the bag, but he told me.

"And these ones protect. You cannot hand them now. When you come back from your journey and meet Yassa, then you will hand them. They are for those who left with me today, but I still must prepare them for this."

The door opened, and about ten people who apparently changed their clothes in a hurry entered the room. Every one of them was kissing Radanda's hand that was crossing them with respect and joy, and the chief returned a kiss to everyone's head.

"Well, my children, the hour of your liberation has come. Tomorrow you will see Teacher I. and you will follow him to work in the wide world. Be glad doubly that the term given to you grew shorter. Not only Teacher will congratulate you, but also the whole Bright Brotherhood will accept you as their members and acknowledge you with joy. Come, friends, don't shed your tears."

"Father, father, I don't want to leave you. I've found the Light here, leave me to become stronger in it," a woman who was crying the most of all was speaking.

"Well, ask Lyovushka to give you the letter from Dartran. Tomorrow you will speak to Teacher and then decide. Not you need to know whether you are prepared for a wider work or not. Only your Teacher knows it. You, my friend, need to remember: overcome your fear and doubts till the end, and be loyal to your pledge. Think for a while that your first thought now was that you were unprepared, wasn't it? You are afraid of responsibility, but you've heard many times from me that only assertion is driving the life forward everywhere. You receive the new cry of Life, but do you meet it by asserting?"

Radanda told me to give the letters personally to everyone, and by shaking everybody's hand I could feel the wave of the Great Mother as the vibration of warmth and happiness. I could see from the expression of the people's eyes that this wave reached their hearts. They thanked me with the most beautiful words, very simply, as though they had known me for a long time, and I understood that they thanked me not for the letters, but for that impalpable vibration which passed to them through my handshake.

When Radanda said good-bye to these people, he invited them, too, to his dining-room. As soon as we went out to the park, the first bell's strike was heard which called for the supper.

"Well, you see, my child, we are in time. Only you won't be with me in the dining-room. I. is already waiting for you; you need to ride to meet Yassa. You will find I. in the shower; there he will give the clothes necessary for such journey to you. And you don't even need to eat today till the evening. Now you are made of iron already," Radanda gave a laugh.

Everything was exactly as he told me. I met I. in the shower, he ordered me to change my clothes. I felt myself as in a case with these clothes: a cloak, boots with spurs, a helmet woven from the palm bands which covered my forehead and the back of my head, long gloves with wide flaps – that was my new outfit.

I. who was dressed in exactly the same way looked like a knight. While I could get used neither to the spurs nor to the cloak nor to the gloves with the flaps and I looked like a musical comedy robber.

When we went to the meeting place by the wall, I was destined to be dumbfounded once again: Zeiched and Oldenkot dressed in the same clothes were waiting for us by the horses.

Chapter 21

We ride to meet Yassa. I. tells us the story about Yassa's life.

An encounter in the desert and a vision.

Coming back to the Community and Yassa's consecration.

The dining-room. Conversation with Gregor.

Two I.'s speeches in the dining-room and in the balcony

From many new and unexpected impressions which every day was full of in the Community, I was able to retain the complete lucidity of my thoughts in comparison to my previous sensations, now they didn't wind up into one single ball as before when it was difficult for me to feel a logical connection. Now my thoughts were forming the straight line. I could feel not only this difference within myself. Neither the desert's heat, nor the heavy clothes pressed to my body, nor the dust – nothing tired me, I even stopped fixing all of it, as if it went without saying. Now I perceived myself completely differently. I could feel within myself not only different, incomparable with anything physical strength: I could feel the power of thoughts of the matured man, which was pouring out of me onto everything what I saw, did, observed. When I stood on tiptoe in the stirrups as always while sitting on the saddle, the horse even began to stagger.

"Mount the horse carefully, Lyovushka. Now you are strong and heavy. Calculate your movements well, so that you wouldn't hurt or cause trouble to the animal. Hold your thoughts, too, because now they also already possess a different, more fiery power," I. said to me very silently.

When I greeted Zeiched and Oldenkot, it seemed to me that they responded to me in a different way, too, as if I had grown up so much during those days of my separation with them, that now they treated me as their equal and not as the former boy.

When we had already ridden away quite a big distance from the Community, kind Oldenkot held his horse and rode up closer to me, so that we could have a chat.

"Lyovushka, I am very glad to see you so changed outwardly and with such inner strength gained. I don't even ask you whether Nataliya Vladimirovna is harming you, because now you may not be anybody's laughingstock," he smiled to me with humour. "If such a description could still exist in my dictionary, then I would say that I am missing you and Nataliya Vladimirovna. I would miss her during some moments of my new learning, because she could always make the phenomena easier for me which I had difficulty to understand. And I was missing you as the constant example of the entire loyalty without the slightest hesitations and doubts. I hadn't yet met the man who could follow his set path so straight and without any compromises."

"Your words surprise me very much. Today I feel in such a way as though only now I understood what the goal and the meaning of life was, and only now I discovered what joy it was to walk the path of Truth."

"I know this feeling very well. I've experienced it many times during my life by walking along the path of knowledge. And every time I used to stop lost in thought with the new world outlook what the Teacher himself's power was if his compassion for us, those who are walking and searching with such tension and instability, is infinite. Every one of us who has succeeded to reach that stage when Teacher accepts him as his disciple, experienced three unavoidable levels of psychological development. I noticed during my long life that everyone who started his path of discipleship encountered these three unchangeably repeating levels.

First – man began to loathe his life which was the whole meaning and charm of his previous days up to now. That is, he would begin to distinguish the values of Eternity from unreality of conditionality.

Second – he would begin to comprehend himself not as a member of one society, but as the worldwide unit. That is, the man would begin to act in the invisible and he would accept the visible as an indivisible totality, as a stage that is necessary for him, as the level of his experience and self-control.

Third – the most majestic of all the changes of the human creation – loyalty and devotion for that business to which he was serving used to open in everyone. He would begin to see the Eternity everywhere, depending on that what the man used to spread in his life as loyalty till the end, according to the scale of his perceptions and possibilities. And all the people's paths to that Eternity would become equally important to him.

I saw that the man who was coming nearer to the Truth overcame these three stages of consciousness. They lead him as high as his selfless love opens his encountered person's inner eyes. There are neither patterns nor the same conditions for everybody here. Everything is individual."

I wanted to put several questions to my wonderful companion about his personal path, but I heard I.'s voice.

“Only I and Zeiched know the whole story about Yassa’s life. In this hour, in order to understand the great deed of this man, I think that I need to tell you a part of his difficult and complicated life story. Of course, I will tell you only about the most important stages of his life, which will help you to comprehend how much you need to know about a man, how attentive you need to be for your encountered person before deciding to tell him your opinion about any man. Every one of us will learn the new lesson about the value of an uttered word from this story, and sometimes about its created, irretrievable evil.”

“A poor, large family was living in one of the small, remote China’s towns. One of the youngest boys, whom you know as Yassa, but who was called in an absolutely different name back then, was always distinguished for his love for his old father. In the beginning, as soon as the boy started walking on his weak feet, he was always trying to slip through everywhere unnoticed where his father was working. He would sit aloof silently for hours, hungry, sometimes even during the cold, by looking at his father’s difficult job and he would always come back home only together with him for the scanty, poor supper.

As soon as his legs became stronger, he was trying to escape during the days, he would run to the market, beg for alms, get back to his father with a slice of bread, and during some more successful days also with something more, he would give his scanty booty to his father’s hands worn out by work, which would look like a royal dinner for both of them. Not so much time flew past, and small Yassa already became his father’s assistant. I won’t tell you about the child’s tiredness and fatigue, because not only he was trying to work together with his father with all his childish might, but also to make the grown-up’s work easier. You can understand it yourselves, because you know today’s Yassa.

Often his father used to tell him fairy tales while working in the rice fields and wishing to make his son’s work easier. The boy would listen to them attentively and stun his father, because he would memorize them word for word and retell them to his brothers and sisters after coming back home.

Once the boy asked his father where he learnt such wonderful fairy tales from. When his father answered him that his grandfather told him everything, his mother – to grandfather, while an educated uncle – to his mother, the boy became interested in what an “educated” meant. His father explained to him that educated – that was a very important person who could read books, while very educated person could even write.

“And where do the educated people come from? Do angels give birth to them?” the boy asked.

Having found out that they were the same people to whom God gave the happiness to learn, the boy couldn’t live without the dream to become educated anymore. He was telling his father about his dreams many times, he said to him that he was begging God day and night by asking for only one favour: to learn.

The time was flying, but it was moving at a snail’s pace for Yassa who was waiting for the God’s miracle impatiently. His father saw his son many times kneeling in ecstasy with his eyes fixed on the sky, and his poor father knew for what kind of the miracle his son was asking for heaven.

The years of difficult work and shortages had taken the belief in miracles from his father. He was thinking with bitterness that the dead heaven wouldn’t respond to his son’s prayers, in the same way as it hadn’t responded to him during his long, full of suffering life.

During one of such Yassa's ecstasies, suddenly a tall man came out of the greenwood of dense bamboos, and his father recognized the famous teacher from the adjacent small town's school. His reputation wasn't very great, they said that he was a vicious sorcerer.

"Ha, ha, ha," the teacher stopped by the kneeling boy and greeted Yassa with a kick to his back. "Do you want studies? Who has thrust such nonsense into your head? There's no need to study for poor people. You, poor people, don't need any studies in order for you to stand in the water up to your belly and grow the rice or to clean the roads and houses of the rich people. And the poor people may not possess the necessary memory and talents for the studies."

"Forgive me, great man," Yassa's father meddled in. "I cannot object your erudite words, but the heaven has rewarded my son with the memory for us all. He can repeat any fairy-tale for you word by word, however you would tell it for him. Even our great mandarin liked him, and he promised to teach him, but his set fee is so big that our whole family is unable to earn it. While his mother doesn't want to sell her bracelets, because as you, she also says that poor people don't need any knowledge. Once I also was talented, but life didn't give a chance to me to learn. Probably my son's dreams won't come true, too."

"Well, I will check your son's talents," the teacher uttered and sat down on the cut off bamboo conveniently. "So, stand before me, look at my eyes and listen what I will be telling you. Try to memorize everything well and to repeat. Look, if you make at least one mistake, the studies will pass you by. Concentrate and memorize everything."

The boy admired the teacher, he was looking at him as a messenger from the heaven and he was listening to the language, the meaning of which he didn't understand. He was endowed not only with an exceptional memory, but also with artistry and an ear for music, so he memorized not only the words of the language which he didn't understand, but also everything else: all the teacher's intonations, the raisings of his voice and turning of his eyes.

"Now please repeat everything that I told you to the slightest details," the teacher was shouting with laughter at the top of his voice.

Yassa gave a smile, also his father, because both of them knew that the boy didn't miss a single teacher's uttered word, that he would be able to repeat everything till the last detail. And indeed, the teacher who was hoping to surprise the poor workers was surprised himself. The boy repeated the whole teacher's behaviour so artistically, he conveyed all teacher's raisings of the voice and turning of his eyes, swinging of his legs and his hand gestures so comically that Yassa's father didn't hold this test and he was doubled up with laughter.

"What, did you intend to jeer at me?" enraged teacher roared.

He jumped up off the bamboo, took out his belt and raised his hand by aiming at the child's head. Father's laughter lapsed into silence instantly, he dashed at his son like a tiger, seized the bamboo cutting knife that was lying by Yassa's feet and cried with such a voice which Yassa didn't even expect from his always calm father.

"Just try to hit my innocent son and I will cut off your hand like a bamboo's stick. You told yourself to the boy to repeat everything, so he was trying to do it with all his might. He, a juvenile, did it very well, and that was funny for me what you, a great man, consider to be the sign of erudition, but you know perfectly who is standing before you. We haven't seen any erudite people, and we cannot understand what good manners are in your surroundings. You must pardon us, ignorant people, explain our backwardness to us and not beat him for his diligence. So, that's all. We are too hungry and exhausted, so

that we would be searching for some amusements or laugh at people. I was laughing with joy; I admired my son's talents."

Yassa hadn't heard during his life that his silent father could tell so many words for somebody. The hand with the belt was still raised high, as well as his father's hand was still protecting his son's head.

"Well then," the teacher uttered and hung his hand by showing that father's words persuaded him, but his face was still distorted with anger. "Turn your back to me, listen what I will be telling you and repeat everything precisely again."

The boy turned away obediently, but his father didn't make a move by holding the knife in his hands.

"Your son turned away, so what are you waiting for? Are you going to stand here like this with the knife? You are protecting a treasure or what?" the teacher mumbled and pushed Yassa's father away.

"Don't push me, I am not a coward. While my son is as much dear to me as yours to you. I will be protecting him from any evil, as well as you yours, even if death threatened me."

"Ha, ha, ha, just think how sentimental those poor people are! I will give my son to you for free, not only I won't protect him from evil. He is idler, good-for-nothing and idiot. The whole misfortune is that fools aren't necessary for any powers of evil."

The teacher began to rattle phrases in the Chinese patter one after another at such a speed that in the end it seemed to father that a drum was rattling in his head. When the teacher lapsed into silence, Yassa began to repeat all that rattle, while his father couldn't hold from doubling up with laughter again.

Now the teacher's face was darker than the night. He was turning his eyes terribly, his lips and cheeks were twitching, his hands were squeezing the belt convulsively. The boy turned to the teacher, and he was looking at his face without any fear. Apparently, the naïve boy was thinking that all these signs were the inevitable attributes of his erudition. His father's laughter fell silent instantly, his whole joviality was gone as soon as he looked at his son's naïve face and he understood the prayer, hopes and desire of his childish heart to hear the torturer's praise, his want to please him, if only he could become erudite.

"Well, so how much can you pay for your son's teaching?"

The inner fight of his father's heart wasn't reflected on his face, only the drops of cold sweat stood out on his gaunt cheeks and forehead. To give Yassa to this beast? God knows with what joy he would give his son to learn to a kind man! But how to explain to his naïve, obsessed with a passion for science son that he will experience only misery from such teacher? How to decline this maybe the only one chance to acquire knowledge? Anyway, his intuitive power of love made him say.

"If you were a kind man, perhaps I would tell you that I cannot afford to pay you. But since you wanted to beat my son immediately, then I refuse to give him to you at all. God is great, he still will send a chance for the only desire of my pure and diligent son to come true. Good-bye, let his great erudition be glorified within you."

"Ha, ha, ha, one more wise man showed up! You are fool. If you told me that you will come with your whole family to work for me for a couple of days every week... Then maybe I would have pity on you, and I would start teaching your son."

"I said that what I said," his father answered him silently and set to work.

The teacher began to shout, to swear, to reproach him with ignorance and ingratitude, he would leave and come back to the bamboo grove where father and son kept working without uttering a single word. Father's heart was breaking by looking at his beloved son, seeing the heroic boy's efforts to keep calm and to conceal the accumulating tears from his father.

The teacher used to come back to the grove for many times and he kept reducing his requirements. Finally, he fixed his furious gaze on father, he called him a fool and idiot a hundred times, and he broke into a sweetest song.

"I understood that you were very intelligent man, my friend. I agree to pay a rather good amount for your boy every year to you, so that when he is educated, he would pay back to me three times more than I will pay to you for him. Besides, I will dress and feed him, but I forbid your entire family to see him. And he himself," he thrust his finger to Yassa's chest with such power that he almost fell to the ground, "must take an oath here and now with my belt with which you didn't allow me to hit him that he will be loyal, obedient, diligent, that he will be serving me alone while he is alive and that he will consider me his only one master, king and God."

"Do you really, my beloved, calm son, want to leave with this terrible man? Do you want to swear to him like to God?"

"Father, I certainly must become educated. I must reach it, whatever the price of the education would be. Give me to him. However unhappy I would be without all of you, especially without you, I will be happier anyway than by living without science. I swear my loyalty and obedience to him, but my loyalty to you and God cannot change because of it."

Yassa took an oath as the teacher told him to without understanding a single word from that what he was repeating. His father came back home alone in the evening.

Father's separation with his son, his grief, his entire experienced drama, which made him old and turned into a sickly, weak old man, was nothing in comparison to that tragedy which Yassa himself had to experience. The teacher didn't beat him, because he understood what a priceless treasure and weapon he could forge from the talented boy for his vicious will. He didn't know anything more except the writing and several formulae of evil rammed into his head forever, so the boy surpassed him in a month.

Then he took Yassa to the monastery, which was fifty versts away from the town, and here Yassa's dark occult sciences began. The boy didn't understand in any way what they were teaching him, while his innocence was the best protection of the school for his new teachers.

He was learning this for three years, and only when the teachers decided to start the moral depravation of their victim, Yassa understood which path he had taken, who surrounded him and what was waiting for him. The twelve-year-old boy who was developed not according to his age held out the terrible fight against himself. The result of all his suffering was his escape in which he took part. I was hiding him for a long time in one of the secret adobes of the Bright Brotherhood, then I took him to the Dartran's oasis. But they came upon his tracks there as well. I had to hide him in the secret Community of the deserts, and then he was living here for several years, at Radanda's.

Having mastered the power of the total protection against the dark powers, Yassa went to Ali's Community where you met him, some of you for the first time, while the others as their old friend."

As soon as I. finished his wonderful story, a cloud of dust appeared in the distance, in which I could see silhouettes of riders.

"I told you one man's story. Each of you understood why Ali chose Yassa to accompany the other man to the secret Community, who got under the same influence of the dark people. Yassa's loyalty for God of love and kindness has created the protective net which none of the sorties of the dark people may break through now anymore. This unpierceable net helped him to take Benja Jean from the persecutors' hands, to take him successfully to my indicated place and to come back. With this heroic deed of fight against the dark powers in the desert and protection of another person from them, Yassa became free from his last pledges which he took unconsciously through his childish oath for the dark occultism. Only the difficult work helped Yassa to shake off the terrible bond which he undertook with his childish fearlessness and fortitude for the only form of life dear to him – science. Now Yassa may be accepted to the ranks of free, pure and effective members of the Bright Brotherhood, and to begin his discipleship. Once again you saw from this example how individually different people's paths are, how it is impossible to achieve something in discipleship by following authorities and how the levels differ from which man has already been noticed, marked and he received help from the Bright Brothers as the answer to his cry. Don't yield to the illusions of an external help. If you get the sources in your hands, which lead you to knowledge, know that only those powers are leading you to the encounter with your Teacher which came to life within you, the aspects of the powers of the Only One through which – only through them – each man may communicate with Life in whatever form it would be. While preparing your passionate embrace for Yassa now, embrace Life Itself through him by not diminishing its grandeur due to accepted form. Rise to that height of Beauty with your embrace opened for Life, which every one of you has reached in the chapel of Ringing Joy of the Great Mother during these days."

We rode a little. I. stopped his horse; we all formed a semicircle behind him by watching with respect the cavalcade which was coming nearer at a walking pace with Yassa in front.

Lately I experienced many solemn and grand moments next to my great friend I. Anyway, if I hadn't become Goliath by the Great Mother's feet, I was sure that I couldn't have held the tears and trembling of my beating heart with an exceptional joy.

Without riding up five steps to us, Yassa dismounted his horse, he went up to I., knelt down, took the helmet off his head, gloves off his hands and he spread his cloak by I. horse's feet.

Having jumped off his horse, I. stepped on Yassa's cloak and embraced him by pressing him to himself. I couldn't see anything else for a few minutes except the big, radiating ball in the beams of which, as it seemed to me, the hot desert sun darkened, and at the same time also the desert itself disappeared. It was difficult for me to withstand this light, like the radiance of the continuously flashing lightning around us. I saw how a big, red star between the sky and the desert began to shine with the beams of such length and intensity that it seemed to the heaven eye that a half of the universe should drown in them.

I don't know for how long this divine view lasted. When I overcame my loss of sight, I saw I. who was shining no less than the sun itself, I saw Yassa who was changed and radiating like an angel, I saw all my fellow-travellers who were kneeling on the desert sand with the cloaks covering their faces, as if they couldn't withstand the blinding Light. I understood once again that only the Great Mother gave me strength to hold out this view without covering my face and not losing my sight.

Such a silence around was prevailing for several minutes that it seemed to me that everything – and the people, and the horses and the desert itself got stiff, covered by the great bliss and speechless respect...

"Stand up, my friends, uncover your faces," I heard I.'s voice, so kind and gentle that again it sounded to me absolutely newly. "Remember this moment of your new happiness. From now on, not only your life – after you've held out the radiance of the God's power itself, - but also the lives of all those whom every one of you will meet, will be different. You understood, you experienced yourselves that no other leading thread in a man's life exists than only the forever free God's sparkle that is living inside of him forever. You understood that nobody may ever and anywhere enslave your freedom, because your freedom – that's Eternity that is living within you. Before the external turns of man's destiny his inner man always comes to life or fades away. A possibility to pass from one state of man's inner perfection to another, a higher one, doesn't exist until the man failed to bless all his external obstacles. Now all of you will leave to the wide world, you will forget about the desert sand, but you will forever remember this blissful moment of your experienced happiness. Here you were free from the superstitions and negative attitudes of mankind. Here it was easier for you to protect your conductors from the small passions of the surrounding people and their draining desires. But from that moment on when Life drifts you to the streams that are characteristic to Him, you will be surrounded by passions from all sides. Since you will be changed, you will feel these passions stronger than the fiery whips. Keep in your memory forever the unshakable principals of your communication with people, which I will name for you as the precepts of your eternal work among people:

1. Never listen to any slander, interrupt any people's complaints with all your might of joy and kindness, any angry talking about your nation's people, about the nation itself, about your people, folk, government. Indeed, comprehend that by supporting or listening to the similar negative talking, you help the evil and irritability of the living beings of the earthly and astral plans. You help the lips of those who slander to destroy or ruin those paths which the Only One Power has planned by leading the entire universe according to the karma of nations, lands and the entire living humanity. Not only that one commits a crime who impedes to fulfil the plan of the Divine Power with his condemning word, but also that one who failed to interrupt the thread of such conversation and to pour calm into the rebel's heart with all his love.

2. Live your day as a moment of Eternity and try not to pour into it at least a smallest cruelty. Know firmly what the cruelty is.

If you see how a helpless baby is being beaten and you don't intercede for him, then you are guilty before the Eternity like that cruel hand that is beating the baby.

If you hear cruel words which swear an innocent man and if you cannot protect him, to take him away from the vicious man, you are guilty before the Eternity no less than the culprit himself.

If you are participating physically where helpless living beings are being tortured and if you don't protest and protect the unfortunate, then you are guilty even more than those who are torturing them.

3. The people's superstitions which you will encounter in every step of your life not only have to irritate or hurt you, but your cheerfulness must grow from your every encounter with such person to whom his superstition hinders to look at the entire world widely.

While walking during the day, gather the entire encountered pain into yourself and give it to me joyfully. Part with me neither by working nor by communicating with people. Live and act with my energy in your heart and mind, and our cooperation won't allow you to move away from the perception that the entire energy of your days on the Earth and their whole meaning – that's the work for Eternity. Always strengthen your courage and always control yourself whether gave it all to a man and whom within him you gave it to. Did you see the Eternity within him? Did you comprehend during your encounter what

your duty of Love for the man was? Did you try to help him to spread calm during the day? Because the least how you can help the Evolution of the Eternity, - that's to finish your encounter with a man calmly. Only when he leaves you with calm, he will be the least harmful for the only matter for which we are living: the realization of your Life's plan. Go calm, my dear friends, give joy to all your encounters, unselfishness to all your work which you'll get along your new path, calm and respite to all the people working next to you. Carry the strength within you and try to persuade people that their tears not only don't ease their own pain, but they chain them even more with the armour of blindness and superstitions by preventing their eyes from seeing clearly, because the crying eyes cannot see clearly. They also prevent those for whom they are crying from becoming free and walking the Path of Light, they burden their lives in whatever world they would be living in this moment."

I embraced Yassa again, as well as all his fellow-travellers who already opened their faces now. I was very surprised by recognizing among them all those riders whom we met on our way to Radanda's Community, whom I commanded to accompany the vicious rebel who was trying to thrust his will on us to the secret Community. I pressed to the Great Mother's feet in my thoughts, I was begging her with respect to cover the people who were leaving to the new path of serving her with Her mantle of Joy.

We were riding down the desert again in several minutes. Now also the horses who as though recognized each other were snorting joyously and hurrying to come back to the feeding-racks as soon as possible, and the subsiding heat, and my heart's joy for Yassa's happiness and victory - everything was pouring into me like a Ringing Joy, the atmosphere of which covered me always more. I was praying for my wonderful nurse - Yassa, I was glorifying the cruel and exceptional path of the boy who knew the only one God in his childish heart - "To Know."

"Thank you, Lyovushka, thank you, my loyal friend," I heard silent Yassa's voice when he rode up to me unnoticed and pressed my hand which was lying inertially on the horse's withers. If you could see what an exceptional miracle has happened within me, then your whole, new power would pour out with the words: "Let the hour of the man's death be blessed." Because now, Lyovushka, that Yassa whom you knew is dead and the new Yassa, changed and touched by the God's Fire is living. I wouldn't be able to tell you in any words how my experienced change manifests itself. I wouldn't be able to express it in any way. I can only tell you that I saw the entire Life in a moment, all the centuries of the life of the Universe: from the fiery streams of lava till the stone, from the primeval animals till man, from insects till birds and the stars. I saw Life in the centre of the Earth, I understood every living being's bond with the earth and the sky. I saw the living Work, the size and the power of which doesn't have any boundaries. Now a bare word, behind which the Power of Fire is hiding, doesn't exist for me anymore. No action exists that is separate from the experiences of life of the whole mankind. Words that condemn, deny, blame or cause a pain of the heart stopped existing for me in a single moment. Now I perceive the words only as the symbols of cheerfulness, compassion and justification."

Yassa lapsed into silence. I didn't want and dare to interrupt his silence, but I was trying to remember his every word, so that I could also rise till the great power of the spirit of the changed man.

"Soon we'll ride up to the gates of the Community, my dear friends and children," the wonderful I.'s voice was heard. "And the days full of happiness and the total liberation in the Community will fly past for you even faster. Don't consider them to be a repayment for your heroic deeds. They come to you as the natural consequence of your own work. Life is sending not a break for the rest to his loyal servants, but Life Himself comes to life in the hearts of those who are carrying their cup with their pure hands. You will go into the world, you will set to work in the racket, in the sites after a fire of passions, you will get into the whirlwinds of all conditionalities of culture and civilization which modern people value so much. While you, wise people, will value only that wealth of life which is impalpable and weightless. You

will accept the whole external life of this period, but you will be serving that what is real and what is hiding in all conditional forms. May your words, even in the most difficult situations, condemn or blame anybody? Remember, my friends, what I have already told you: recognize the strange superstitions, smile and give justification for everything. There aren't any personal conditionalities for you, servants of Eternity, anymore. There are incalculable forms of Life for you, serve him during the day and night, and the path both for you and your encountered people will be blessed and joyous."

I. lapsed into silence. The sun was drawing nearer to the horizon. The day of the desert was over. The walls of the Community were already visible from the distance, the distant hum of the bells was already heard, and I didn't even notice how the day flew past, how the hours spent on the saddle passed. I was strong, I could still do much, it seemed to me that I had just descended the stairs of the chapel of the Great Mother.

When we rode in through the gates of the Community, I. who was riding at the head slowed down his horse and called me. When I rode up to him, he looked me up and down with his kind look and said to me.

"Don't forget that now you need to set to my secretary's and messenger's duties again, Lyovushka, and don't move away from me."

However great my experienced moments were, I couldn't hold my smile with joy that again I would be accompanying my passionately beloved friend everywhere.

It was growing dark. Radanda with the brothers met us by the gates of the Community. He greeted everybody cordially, he told the brothers to take our tired horses away. He gave the warmth of his heart to all of us, but he didn't let Yassa go from his arms still for a long time. He was telling something to his ear silently, which nobody from us could hear, and we didn't try to do it.

We stood a little further from Yassa, I. and Radanda to wait for further instructions. Zeiched's attention moved me when he introduced me to Yassa's fellow-travellers whom he knew for a long time. They had already penetrated into my thoughts and hearts not only as Yassa's fellow-travellers, but it happened from the very first meeting in the desert when their faces surprised me so much. I already wanted to have a pleasant chat with them, but unwittingly my gaze fixed on Oldenkot's face, and... again I saw that expression of divine kindness in his eyes which stunned me for the first time during Francisco's talk by the bonfire. It seemed to me that this man had forgotten about everything. Neither time no space no people existed for him anymore. He could see only the heroic deed of the path of discipleship, the perfection of man's spirit, the brother to whom he gave his greeting, his fascination, his blessing before himself.

I bowed to the man once again who succeeded to always see one goal, one meaning, one conception before himself: life in Eternity...

"Lyovushka, go to my room, put my belongings there, change your clothes and give this note to Nataliya Vladimirovna. Also take Zeiched and Oldenkot to our home and settle them in two free rooms next to yours. Tell Slava to accompany them to the shower and to prepare clean clothes for them. As soon as you get ready, accompany everybody to Radanda's dining-room."

While talking to me, at the same time I. was writing the note. Now it didn't surprise me anymore, because I had seen many times how I. was doing several jobs at the same time: he was speaking to one person, dictating to another one, indicating the mistakes of the complicated mathematical task to the third one – not a single job was ruined, on the contrary, every participate could hardly keep pace with him.

Having taken the note, I called Zeiched and the nice American to go together with me, while everybody else followed Radanda. Not only I had to repeat my call for Oldenkot two times, but I had even to touch his hand, so that he would understand that I addressed him.

"Forgive me, Lyovushka, it seems that I delayed you with my absent-mindedness," he told me gently by coming back from that world in which his thoughts were wandering to the present with difficulty. "I am still unable to come down to the earth, to feel the weight of my physical body after I really saw God, when he recognized the man, recognized the great heroic deed which that man succeeded to fulfil during one incarnation. I rejoice at Yassa's spiritual grandeur so much, I feel happy that Compassion allowed me to see the new man's birth, so it is even difficult, painfully difficult to fit in my physical body."

Neither me nor Zeiched interrupted the kind-hearted man's words. We were listening to his voice respectfully, while I was flying to the Great Mother in my thoughts by begging her to cover my companion's pure heart with Her atmosphere and to ease his transition from the heaven's Light to the ordinary commonness of work. I couldn't comprehend in any way why this time it was so difficult for his soul, so bright, pure and always calm, to become reconciled with the flying past "now". My own soul was glad...

Having looked at me, Oldenkot as though understood my silent question and he answered even more pleasingly.

"The whole meaning – not that daily work which we do, but that heroic strain which we pour into all our work easily. Yassa is doing everything easily. While I am doing everything by comprehending a duty in my heart. But the disciple's path – that's not duty, but joy. Not work, but a reflection of his Love. And only that one who has become and not "understood" reaches the final moment of happiness, the witnesses of which we were today."

We approached our home. I gave Zeiched and Oldenkot to Slava, showed their rooms and, having told them that I would visit them in half an hour, I hurried to Nataliya Vladimirovna.

She met me unusually warmly, I gave the note to her, the contents of which I didn't know, I told her that we came back with Yassa, that her friend, as well as Zeiched, now would be living together with us. Having visited my friends in half an hour, I found only Zeiched. He explained to me that Oldenkot would be waiting for me in the hall, because he went to Andreyeva. I was thinking that Nataliya Vladimirovna had to go together with us, and I was very surprised when I saw that she still didn't change her clothes.

"My dear, aren't you ready yet? We will be late, won't we? You know how I. likes punctuality."

"If I was told to go with you, then I would urge you to hurry myself," she was talking as though calmly by appearance, but I could see her inner revolt clearly, not to speak of the nervous movements of her hands with which she was folding the note that I gave to her. "My governess's duties by babies aren't over yet," she added by being completely irritated already.

The sparkles of humour flashed in Oldenkot's eyes, and I hadn't yet seen a more ridiculous scene during my life than that, the witness of which I became now.

"I imagine how happy the wards entrusted to you are feeling, if you apply your usual methods of education to them, which I know so well," Oldenkot uttered, he lifted his hat a little in a gallant way and bowed to Nataliya Vladimirovna in the politest way. The whole range of expressions that blew over like a whirlwind was reflected on Nataliya Vladimirovna's face which was trembling from her inner

nervous strain. In the very first moment I thought that at least she would pull the hat out of his hands and slap it on the ground if her irritation doesn't manifest itself somehow stronger in a flash. Then a sharp sarcasm flashed in the woman's eyes, but suddenly it melted like an ice, a merry humour changed it suddenly, and... Vladimirovna burst in such kind, merry and infectious laughter that all of us were also dying with laughter, and after saying good-bye to her we were still laughing while going to Radanda.

This time the path seemed to be as short as never to me. My precise, meditated till the end visual thoughts followed one after another in an absolutely new way that had nothing in common with my previous, disconnected thinking. Radanda who was radiating today especially met us himself on the threshold of his brightly lit up house and, having smiled tenderly, he uttered so silently to me that I could hardly perceive his words.

"Many, oh how many stages each man overcomes. Don't think that today you finished one of your periods and started another one. The sections of the path straight like the bread slices don't exist for a man's spirit. In order for the man to hear and to understand much higher vibrations which are always living around him, but which he cannot hear, his consciousness must mix his entire current perception within himself with the new comprehension of Life so carefully like water and milk mix and become inseparable without any especial means. And in order for man to become effective with his new perception, the old from the new must separate within him in the same way as the water separates from the butter. Remember that you are still only milk and water. Find much more attentive observation within yourself and stimulate much faster separation of the water and the butter within yourself, that is the separation of your personality from your individuality. Then you will enter the constant habit to live in Eternity."

Now when I tried to convey Radanda's speech into words, I had to use many of them and anyway I must have failed to open the whole depth of the meaning of these words for other people's consciousnesses. And actually, the whole Radanda's speech lasted for only several short moments and entered my soul, heart and brain like a sequence of harmonious, quick as lightning moments which I absorbed in the same speed as they were spreading. Now when the conversation with views and colours didn't cause any difficulties for me anymore, I understood that Radanda helped me to awaken the capability within myself back then, which was only drowsing in that moment, and which was inseparable from words.

Having taken Oldenkot's and Zeiched's hands, and told me to follow him, Radanda turned to the narrow, hardly lit corridor and he took us out to the big, bright hall of which I didn't even suspect up to now. It was narrow, without any windows. Its walls seemed to me to be made of the marble, but after I looked more attentively, I saw that they were made of the same wonderful glass as Gregor's and Vasilyon's cups.

A high altar was standing in the middle of the hall, it looked like the one of Francisco, only it was much bigger. Seven wonderful cups were standing on it, they were burning in the same unearthly beautiful colours as the ones on Francisco's altar. The eighth high cup which was empty, made of glass and absolutely white was standing in front of the others, in the middle of the table. The whole hall around us was full of sisters and brothers dressed in white, they were holding the roses of different colours and hues in their hands. There were lots of roses in the Community. Apparently, Radanda or his gardeners loved these flowers especially. They were growing like a dwarf forest in many places of the park by stunning with their aroma and the size of their blossom.

Big ventilators were spinning high under the ceiling by filling the hall with the refreshing coolness. Radanda went to the altar and stopped not far from it by holding Oldenkot's and Zeiched's hands, and he told me to stand in front of them. A silent canto was heard, its sounds were spreading as though

from the distance, somewhere from the right, but however I was looking to the right wall I couldn't see any door anywhere.

"Concentrate your thoughts, dear children. In this great and solemn hour all of you are taking part in the act of the spiritual man's birth. And this great act is as much important as the physical man's birth itself. Pray now, so that the man after reaching his new birth would enter this hall naked, without any passions and personal feelings. Meet your brother who is coming here by pouring everything what only you possess the purest and greatest out of you, and help him to cross the threshold to Joy, the Light of which rises within him again, so that his new consciousness wouldn't be able to live anymore in the same way as the man of only one earth is living, as many of you are still living, that is you are still chained by your personality while living on the earth. Send your thoughts full of happiness to the entering man, so that Eternity would lead his thoughts on the earth. In this hour think that some time also you will reach the great liberation from your passions and desires, from your thoughts about yourself as about personality and you will pass onto that atmosphere where work is performed together with the living Life by perceiving him at the same time both within yourself and not within yourself, by feeling not only as individuality, as your highest "I". That one within whom Life has come to life is going not because of places, business, people, he is going through the universe because of the universe, with the universe, however narrow the sector of his work would seem externally."

Radanda lapsed into silence, the cantos began to ring right here, suddenly the wide, high door flung open in the very middle of the wall, and I. came in through it by accompanying Yassa by his hand. The big choir of sisters and brothers surrounded them, everybody like us were dressed in white clothes. A tender tenor was distinguished with the beauty and power of his timbre among the whole choir of excellent voices by drowning the whole choir which served him as an accompaniment. However I was concentrated and disposed for the high spheres, I wanted to thank the tenor for his efforts for Yassa, I began to search with my eyes for the voice that was pouring like a lava, but I couldn't see him in any way, because the tall brothers among whom I noticed Gregor covered him from me. But then the procession drew nearer, the figures divided, and I saw Vasilyon with his eyes fixed to the distance, his hands placed on his chest in which he was holding a flower. The face full of inspiration and the whole figure drawn into the canto reminded me of the episode when I saw this man with the flower in his hands in the balcony of his house. I remembered the exceptional colours of the flower, I flew to the chapel of the Great Mother in my thoughts, I pressed her given little flower to my heart and I uttered my first pledge in her presence.

"Oh, Great Mother, help me for ever to remember the brothers of the Earth, to carry for ever the sorrows of all my friends and enemies at Your feet, so that You, Ringing Joy, would send help and justification to them."

I forgot both time and place. I felt the familiar trembling, I heard Florentian's voice, and I saw him on the other side of the altar.

"The day of Yassa's consecration – that's also the day of your joy, because today you will see how man defeats the powers of darkness if he swore without comprehending it, due to his naivety. No such conditionalities exist which would become the obstacles of the man's path. If Teacher indicates the conditionalities to the man, then he is doing so only because they hinder this man. Look and memorize, learn to live your day with your entire power and strength. Both power and strength are the aspects of Freedom which man is carrying within himself."

The voice lapsed into silence, and the image of my great friend disappeared.

I. went to the altar by taking Yassa by his hand. Now I could see that I. and Yassa were dressed in orange clothes, that I.'s clothes were radiating with fantastic fires, and I saw the shining and

moving centres through Yassa's clothes, which I noticed by Radanda for the first time. I. stood Yassa before the altar in such a way that everybody could see his face and figure to a half. I. himself stood by Yassa's right side. Having looked at everybody gathered, I. gave the sign for the choir to fall silent. His voice was heard in the prevalent silence.

"Today there isn't a single man in the hall in whose life this hour wouldn't be important as the test of the power of his spiritual maturity. Everybody present here are connected with the threads of old karmas either among yourselves and with me, or among themselves and Radanda. You are taking part in the act from which you must take away the new form of knowing the spiritual world in your consciousness, so that you could be and become. Not the part of your spiritual power must become stronger and renewed here, but the whole power of every one of you must be devoted to the creative action – to create the new level of spiritual growth for everybody. Think not about yourselves. Think not for the "happiness" to take part in the great ceremony of the consecration, but create such pure atmosphere with your heart's joy to which the stream of the Divine Light could descend. Every time when people gather together – it is important why they would gather, – they open their hearts, and everybody is thinking one thought: "The real Life that is within ourselves is shining to the world." The Light of Life descends and responds to the glorification of the gathered people. During those moments when you are thinking only about the Only One Life's business, when you are working by forgetting that you may be rewarded for your work, you are creating the atmosphere of purity. The sum of such moments when you forget about yourself will create the path of the corresponding length and width for every one of you, which will be leading you always nearer to the Bright Brotherhood. Now you are here. Why? The heart of every one of you is beating only with calm and joy, you aren't spreading any revolt and negation, you've learned to affirm, that is to create Life. Many even very respectful people were left behind the walls of this hall who've done much more for their brothers of the earth than you did. Does it mean that they deserved it less than you? No. But by measuring with the scale of their harmony, there's too little calm within them. Therefore, their liberation isn't enough matured yet, so that we could bring them here. Although sometimes during their paths they could overcome such altitudes of which you don't even suspect, but their presence might destroy the surrounding people's harmony. Concentrate joy in your hearts. Let the flowers in your hands become the symbol of your joy. Throw your flowers under the feet of the brother who is entering the new circle of knowledge today. Chant the cantos which congratulate him and send help for his new path, his new perceptions."

While I. was talking, the tears were rolling down on many faces. But when he invited everybody for the creative joy, when he offered everybody to throw the flowers under Yassa's feet like the symbol of joy, there wasn't a single crying face left. As if a flame of a bonfire had blazed up, the canto was heard again, and the whole floor was covered with roses and myrtles.

I. took Yassa to the other side of the altar where Radanda was standing together with us. The canto lapsed into silence, all brothers and sisters went down on their knees, and two voices were heard in the festive silence – the one of I.'s and Radanda's. Now Radanda was standing on the other Yassa's side, and I.'s mantras were changed by Radanda's ones.

I. lifted some item high above his head, as it seemed to me it looked like a stick, but such radiance was spreading from it, as though a lot of shining sparkles had been splashing to all sides from a huge diamond. That's why I couldn't see well what I. was holding in his hands. His voice became always louder. Radanda's voice lost all intonations of old age, he responded to I. with the power and completeness full of inspiration. Both voices were resounding always faster and more often, it seemed to me that from every gesture of I.'s hand my entire body was starting. I could hear and understand the language of both of them, I comprehended clearly that it was the ancient Pali language, but all these words were penetrating into me not through the physical ears, but through that especial hearing with which I would understand

Florentian's and Ali's words, through the hearing from my second consciousness that opened within me when I isolated myself from those physical vibrations in which my body was living. The meaning of the words which both of them uttered was different.

"Do you hear us, Great Mother? We've brought Your son for You?" I. was speaking, while the rain of sparkles fell both on him and on Yassa.

"Compassion, Eternal Life, I testify You that Your son is already purified from the evil. His spirit is clean, accept him," Radanda was begging, while the sparkles fell both on him and on Yassa.

"Could the whole power of compassion and kindness of the Great Bright Brotherhood accept the new brother to its ranks and render help for his activity?" I. was crying, while the sparkles fell both on him and on Yassa.

"I testify for the whole Bright Brotherhood that the new brother's work, his love for man, his calm – are unshakable and unselfish. No negativity can penetrate through him into the great path of the Brotherhood's work," again Radanda was crying, while the sparkles fell both on him and on Yassa.

Here, I. extended the orange cup to Yassa which was standing in front of the other coloured cups, and which was absolutely white when we entered the hall. I memorized it well.

Yassa went down on his knees with the cup in his hands. I. raised his hand with the stick over his head, and Radanda took its another end. A loud canto of the choir was heard, everything around us began to shine, many coloured stars like butterflies began to flap in the air.

Now Radanda and I. were speaking both together, I couldn't listen attentively to their words through the loud chant of the choir. Suddenly, the entire hall began to shine in such a dazzling light that I even had to close my eyes. I fell on my knees...

It seemed to me that not so much time had passed, but when finally, I was able to stand up, Yassa wasn't by the altar anymore, the chanting brothers and sisters were leaving the hall, while Oldenkot who was standing next to me helped me to stand up. He uttered very silently.

"Not a single thought about himself exists within a disciple. Only the power of Love exists within him which he is sending to his brother, to his new path. Everything what one man can do for another one during the great moments of his life and death – that's to spread his own love in his temple, so that the Light would shine even brighter for him, so that he could cross faster the narrow intersections of the paths before him."

He took my arm. I could feel the great physical power within myself, but for several minutes I was still dazzled and deaf. When all brothers and sisters left, Oldenkot let my hand go and he approached Yassa. I couldn't hear what he was telling him, but I understood from the happy smile that illuminated Yassa's face that his words penetrated into the new consecrated man's heart and gave joy to him. I saw how Zeiched also approached Yassa and told him something meaningful, - only I was still standing in one place without any strength to approach my dear Yassa and to express my love for this tender nurse, friend and assistant. I addressed the Great Mother, I touched her little flower, and the new power of opening illuminated me. I saw myself somewhere far away, in the time passed a long time ago, next to boy Yassa. I was extending money, bread, milk for him... I dashed at my Yassa, I embraced him with an absolutely new feeling of our old, old friendship and love, and without holding my happiness I gave a shout.

"Yassa, Yassa, I remembered that when the sorcerer punished you, I brought some food for you. Oh, Yassa, if I could somehow serve you for all your compassionate care with which you've covered me now. Accept my loyalty, I will try to never forget anymore how I love you and for how long I know you."

"Ah, Lyovushka, you brought not only food and money for me, but you also helped me to escape. My debt for you is much bigger," Yassa uttered by kissing me.

I. and Radanda approached us, they congratulated Yassa and took him to the chief's rooms. I. told us all to go to the dining-room and to wait for him there.

We went to the dining-room. It was still almost empty. Only those several brothers and sisters were here to whom Radanda told to come here. Those who participated in Yassa's consecration came together with us, while the others were already waiting here.

As soon as we entered the dining-room, Gregor went up to me. Now his face was calm, but I could see both excitement and inner enthusiasm within him. I could feel that a volcano was bubbling inside of him, but only my new foresight helped me to penetrate through his external self-control. Without any opening remarks Gregor began to speak to me in such a way as though we had interrupted a conversation started a long time ago only a moment ago.

"Lyovushka, I must share my new knowledge with you, because I've discovered it only thanks to you. My first discovery: no especial conditions which always accompany a man are needed in order for him to be close to his Teacher. The second one: the man may be young; he may not remember anything about his past in this incarnation. And anyway, in the past he had to be prepared for the discipleship very well, he had to overcome its first stages. The third one: all the efforts to penetrate into the high spiritual path with power, mind's efforts to squeeze the height of the path into itself may not bring any results."

I was listening to Gregor with astonishment without comprehending what I had to do with it here, but he didn't allow me to be amazed and he continued.

"I was completely disappointed with my first encounter with Teacher I. to which I was aspiring so much myself. I was one of the most famous artists back then, I decided that I was walking down the path of beauty, that in such a way I was serving the mankind's education and improvement, and that I had the right to be the member of the Bright Brotherhood. You can imagine with what great opinion about myself, spoilt by my admirers and the people who idolized me, I came to the Teacher's to ask him to accept me as the member of this Brotherhood. I. didn't start explaining to me what qualities the man who wanted to become the member of the Great Bright Brotherhood had to possess. He only asked me.

"It seems to you that you are walking down the path of beauty and that you are serving the mankind in such a way? Could you remember at least one of your works which you began and finished with joy? Could you tell me that by going down to creation you forget about everything, except those souls to whom you are trying to open the beauty with your work? What is the beauty? That is the harmony of the one who is creating and his surroundings. That is his greeting for the Divine Power which he has revived within himself and which he is trying to spread outwardly. That is the only way to serve people with beauty. For if you are creating by being full of your personal feelings, your production will touch only everyone's personal level and nothing else. The creator of beauty is carrying it to people by forgetting about himself. He is creating where the personalism ends. He loves and respects people, therefore he may unite with them through beauty and unite them within beauty. He isn't obsessed with any passions. Your path wasn't like this, and it may not lead you to the uniting with the Bright Brotherhood.

"I. could also not add these words. While he was talking, the views of my entire life, of my entire creation drifted before my eyes like a range of visions. And of course, I understood how strongly and foolishly I was wrong."

Gregor fell silent. His eyes as though were turning the pages of the past again, he gave a deep sigh, passed his hand over his forehead and his sad face, he looked at my eyes, smiled and continued.

"I can see that you are waiting for an explanation: how I corrected the mistake when I understood it? You think that I became enlightened, that I thanked Teacher for his wise words and that I began to create in a new way for the same goal which I named to be sacred? Unfortunately, you are wrong. As I told you, I understood everything. I understood it till the end and probably not without I.'s help. But the mutiny which his words excited within me, my insulted pride of the "world-famous celebrity", my suffered self-love – this entire inner banality dazzled me so much that I left terribly irritated. I was raging during the entire week, I was pouring my misfortune – believe me, that was a really great misfortune for me – on all the people who surrounded and loved me faithfully. I gave up my work. I started drinking hard and smoking what I had never done before. The more I comprehended the absolute Teacher's rightness the more it enraged me, the more persistently I was searching for some external arguments, so that I could accuse him of a cruel injustice and justified myself."

Again, Gregor was silent for a while, and this time a painful expression flashed on his face, as though a spasm of pain, then he began to speak in a much more silent voice.

"I was trying not to think about the later events of my life for many years. Today I will review them briefly, because without them my conclusions that I am grateful to you for many things won't be clear."

"I left that city where I met Teacher and where, as I knew, he had to live for a long time. For several years I was plunged in a stormy and dissolute life by hurling myself as far as possible away from his path. But the more I was trying to get my remembrances about my meeting with I. out of my head, the deeper they were penetrating into my head. I reached the stage when I.'s image became my duplicate. When I was already prepared to come back to him, to search for the new meeting and to beg his pardon, suddenly... another strange encounter happened, the whole horror of which I comprehended neither back then nor much later.

My painting was such a stunning success in one of the exhibitions that a huge crowd of people was always by it, while the other halls were completely empty. I arrived at the very height of an aristocratic commotion, and I was received with ovation when I showed up. The public's enthusiasm persuaded me even more that I was namely that one who could unite people through beauty. Unfortunately, I was trying to persuade myself in every possible way, but I heard a silent voice in my heart that was telling me: "That isn't the path of beauty, but your desire of honour. You are carrying not great love for people, but you are only glad that they glorify you. You are searching for yourself in beauty, but not for beauty in yourself." You understand how desperately I was trying to stifle this voice within myself...

There was one especially beautiful woman among all who admired and confessed love to me. One can even say that she was irreproachable beauty whose beauty was no less than her persistence. But something prevented me from loving her: perhaps it was this persistence of her or something inside of her which I couldn't express in words. Just like the aroma of the flower. Not every flower's aroma arouses desire to breathe it in. The same was here. That "something" that couldn't be expressed in words prevented me from crossing the limit of an ordinary and polite court, although angry tongues probably considered us to be close people.

That time she approached me in the encirclement of the crowd of my admirers by demonstrating her closeness to me and she said to me merrily: "Gregor, you've conquered not only Europe, even the Himalayas want to bow to you. That is already like too much."

A miserable madman! I all trembled, the fire began to burn in my heart, I thought that I came here. Of course, only my constant thought about him could mislead me so much. By living such dissolute life, always surrounded by the fieriest emanations of passions and even with the woman hanging on my neck, who wasn't unpleasant to me... A pathetic madman!

A dark-haired man was standing behind her. His Indian, or to be precise, Tibetan bright-coloured clothes were irritating my eyes with their lack of taste and harmony. His look was piercing, unpleasant, and something in it, as well as in the lady who introduced him to me, pushed me away even more. His entire figure and face were gushing health, strength and, I must admit, even power, but there wasn't even a hint about the charm of the "saint Himalayas".

By hiding my disappointment, by trying to disguise my embarrassment and my changed face carefully, I bowed low to him and asked the lady what language was acceptable for her friend.

"I know all languages in which you talk, honourable painter. I couldn't resist the temptation to become acquainted with such a genius of world importance. I am sorry if the encounter with me is undesirable for you, but if my company isn't too much unpleasant for you, then maybe you won't refuse my humblest request to have dinner with you. I can cure the wounds of people's hearts very well and liberate them from their irksome recollections," my new acquaintance uttered these last words so silently that only I alone could hear them.

He was holding my soft and tender hand squeezed strongly in his strong, large palm. This Eastern man's palm surprised me very much, because I could see such ones only by the skilful speculators.

I don't know what happened to me in that moment. I wanted to refuse this excessive Eastern invitation in a polite and dry way. I even wanted to be indignant at his bothering and impudent meddling into my inner life and... instead of everything, I bowed again and agreed. By doing so I insulted my close friend very much, with the family of whose I had promised to spend that evening and where guests were invited for "my honour."

The black stranger's eyes were running through me like a couple of mice. His lips were smiling, while his eyes were piercing, disturbing and commanding me. My lady took my arm, we went downstairs accompanied with ovation again, we got into an excellent coach of my new acquaintance and rode down the streets of the noisy city.

"Don't be surprised, I am magician of a very high rank, and I can read people's thoughts easily. If you have any hidden or unrealizable desires, I can lay them all under your feet."

It would take too much time to tell you the story of three years of my life. I will tell it briefly. As soon as I entered his house – the real parody of the tasteless, provincial, vulgar Eastern Museum, – I ceased existing as Gregor. I became a shadow, a reflection of this man who took possession of my will and thoughts. He was teaching me magic which turned out to be black, he showed all sorts of miracles to me, and... I's image vanished from my memory, as if I had never met him. If back then I was straining to serve people with beauty, so now I was living only with thoughts about profit, about the desire of luxury and glory. The woman whom I didn't love before became my wife now and she was helping her friend in every possible way to twist ropes from the bag of my passions. My glory kept growing. My paintings were in great demand, but their nature changed very much. They reflected only the earth, the passions of which in them were burning with tempting fires by revealing the vices sealed with goodness. I must have urged many souls into temptations during that period. My new guardian helped me to pour a devilish power of colours and expressions into the work. So, he was that dark occultist whom they call "dugpa" in the East.

I was rolling down, I completely forgot heaven, purity and kindness. All my previous friends turned away from me, only Vasilyon alone remained loyal, and I was drawing him down together with myself.

And the time was going by. Once dugpa gave notice to me that soon his order's meeting had to take place, while I would be accepted and consecrated to its members. My wife fell sick, and dugpa had to leave with the order's business. By considering me a reliable victim of his will, he decided to leave alone, and I went to see without any attendants how the paintings were hung for my new exhibition. The weather was fine, I told the coachman to go to the exhibition palace alone, while I decided to go on foot.

Having come to the bridge across the nice, wide river, I was gazing with admiration at the sun play, at the reflections of the clouds and riverside trees in the water, and suddenly I comprehended that I hadn't seen the sun, nature and the sky for several years already. My thoughts were flying violently one after another like clouds. When I was standing, stunned by this discovery, without comprehending what had happened to my life, where I was, suddenly wonderful I.'s figure shot up next to me.

I don't dare to repeat everything what he told me back then, but I told only one word to him: "Save me."

The blessed heart didn't push me away. I. opened my eyes to that abyss, on the edge of which I was standing and to which I was taking Vasilyon...

In two hours, we were sailing to the East in the steamer together with other ten people..."

"I can see that you still don't understand what the connection between my life told to you and you is. Very, very big, Lyovushka. During my last conversation with I. he told me, it happened already in this Community to which he accompanied us after some time spent in our motherland, that is in Dartran's oasis, because both of us with Vasilyon were born and grew up there: "Don't think, my friend, that devotion and selflessness, and most importantly – unbroken loyalty and service to the Truth comes with age for a man. When you liberate your spirit so much that you will stop thinking about yourself and you will be able to see the people who surround you in such a way as they really are, that is as the parts of the Truth, then you will make sure that the Truth may be opened also for a very young form without any necessary conditions of the earth existence. You will see and make sure that the old spirit that was working a lot for her liberation may possess an absolutely young form. You will understand that one cannot serve an idea with one's mind, that one needs to reach a simplicity in communication with people. The simplicity opens the heart to feel respect for each encountered person at the point of his evolution, while this respect will open your heart for an ordinary kindness, and you will comprehend easily that only loyalty, solid till the end, takes the man to harmony of his mind and heart. And already for the first time when you see these three truths in man, you will also read the first rule of discipleship: be prepared. For only in that moment, you yourself will be prepared for the Bright Brotherhood's work, you will be able to carry out its tasks in the wide world." Lyovushka, the first man in whom I was able to read and comprehend my three truths was you. Now you understand why I am so excited, why I am so grateful to you, the first man from whose example I comprehended that I could see, that I could live free, that I will be creating for people and for their wellbeing. I am happy. I want to embrace the entire world and you the first."

Gregor embraced me tenderly. It is not even worth of talking with what joy I responded to this embrace.

As soon as we stopped talking, the wide door of the dining-room opened instantly, and I., Yassa, Radanda showed up in it, Zeiched, Oldenkot and many other strange people followed them, and in

the very end to my amazement and joy, I saw Nataliya Vladimirovna, Bronski and all the rest whom I was charged to take care of today. Slava with several youths finished this procession.

As always I sat down at Radanda's table, Yassa sat down next to him, from the other Radanda's side. I looked at the hall, his look stopped by me with Gregor. He smiled and invited us to come to him. He told me to sit down next to himself, while Gregor sat down next to me. When everybody sat down to the places indicated to them, I found myself before Nataliya Vladimirovna, while Oldenkot and Bronski were sitting next to her. It seemed to me that Andreyeva's face was sad, that she was nervous and unhappy. That was strange, because my heart was so happy for Yassa and for everybody gathered here that I couldn't understand in any way how one could concentrate one's attention only to oneself and be gloomy. I didn't have time to think about my dear friend anymore, because Radanda gave a sign to the brothers to bring the food, he stood up and addressed everybody present here.

"Hello, my dear friends. Today is the great day almost for everybody who've gathered here. Calm, great heart's calm, joy as a wish to those who leave for the great path - that's what everybody present here must feel by seeing off his own people to the distant path of the new serving for people. Everybody who are still unable to pass their spirit to the height of their thoughts about help for their brothers and sisters who leave from here and to bless them, change the course of your thoughts, forget about yourselves and think only about how not to disturb the joint harmony with the streams of your prickly aura. While walking through this day, man must mostly think how to spread as much calm as possible in all his work and encounters. Calm which one soul is pouring into another one, - that's the glue which draw up the wounds of irritability, that's the curing compress for the bruise of the bubbling passions, that's the balsam for the injured company's soul. Never forget that your entire activity, whatever it would be, in most cases will be difficult for your encountered people if you are obsessed with mutiny and disharmony. The most valuable activity won't be available for the masses if the man who is doing it in the world is still unable to keep his self-control. Only few people will comprehend his work, even if it is the one of genius, because only that one is able to impart both great and insignificant idea to the crowds of people whose strength is stably balanced. Now everybody who leave or stay here feel an absolute calm within yourselves, so that the time that is left for you to stay here would become the moments of serving to the Truth and not only your thoughts "about" serving to it."

Radanda sat down. One could hear the people's breathing in the silence of the hall. The brothers - waiters were already carrying the second dish. I looked at the faces of the people who were sitting in front of me, how different their expressions were. Always kind Oldenkot's face now looked like the one of a stone statue, it was so calm and resolute, as if an oath was taken once and for all, which no one ever could affect. Andreyeva's cheeks were blushing, her eyes were flashing, she was trying very much to gain her balance. Since I knew about her kindness and her exceptional goodwill for people in the serious moments of their lives, by remembering what she was telling me in the porch about her newly found reconciliation, I was surprised, and I couldn't understand what the cause of such bubbling of her was. Also, Bronski surprised me no less. It seemed that the actor now didn't exist here, or to be precise, that the whole surroundings didn't exist for him. His eyes were fixed on the distance by piercing through everybody who was sitting here. His figure? It was straight, strained. His head was highly raised, as if he had been listening to something that wasn't present here, but that was so important and unusual that he was unable to tear off from it. I understood that a high ecstasy covered him and that there wasn't any need for me to think about him, that he and Oldenkot were carrying the Truth within themselves in their own way, that they were serving it entirely, in the best way as they could do it.

I came back to Andreyeva. By sending the strongest love to her, I touched the little flower of the Great Mother tenderly by begging her to pour some calm into my wonderful sister who looked more like a deep sea than an earthly body.

I felt a light electric current flowing from I. through me, and I saw a lot of little red stars which were flying from him across the whole table to Nataliya Vladimirovna's aura, they were spinning around her head and her anxiously moving hands. In a moment the flush disappeared from her cheeks, the sparks thrown by her big eyes became tender and pleasant beams, and a smile flashed in her lips. She looked at I., gave a deep sigh and bowed her head towards I.'s side by thanking him – thanking him obediently.

It was still silent in the hall. Only a harmonious, unusually beautiful canto was heard somewhere – it seemed that from very far away. As if a huge, unseen and unearthly choir had been singing the Hymn of Life...

When this canto disturbed the silence of the hall, I. stood up in several minutes, he raised his hands up, as if by summoning the Highest Powers to bless everybody gathered, then he crossed everybody with a wide cross and began to speak.

My God, how many times I had already heard I.'s speeches. I had seen his face in the most different circumstances, and I couldn't get used to this beauty in any way, to this melody of his wonderful voice and simply divine harmony of his entire being. I.'s speeches always stunned me, but this time his words were pouring an especial comfort and calm straight into my heart that desired to become involved in the activity of my dear Teacher and friend, the most yielding from all my guardians.

"My dear brothers, children, colleagues and friends. Not for the first time I met many of you along my path. The most part of you present here today is connected with me with old karmas personally. The other part of you is also strongly connected with other members of the Bright Brotherhood, and that doesn't have any special significance, because if man is connected with one member of the Brotherhood, he is connected with all its members: there aren't any conditionalities in the Bright Brotherhood, it is living and acting only on the grounds of Reality and Eternity. In this hour, the great hour of everybody's life who are here, I congratulate you in the name of the whole Bright Brotherhood as its younger brothers and loyal colleagues in the universal activity of the Great Love. You've become free from the whole cloud of superstitions and also for your work in the wide world of strengthening your loyalty to serve the only goal – the people's wellbeing. You will go to America, to that Community which one of our highest Brothers, the Great Teacher Florentian is organizing now. You will become his joyous assistants; you will be spreading in the Community everything what you've achieved and learned here. My friends, what do people mean to you now? What does the Earth mean to you? Does a little patch of the Earth in which you will be serving people have any meaning to you? People for you – that's the little parts of the Only One Life. The Earth for you – that's the eternal path, a short stage of this Only One Life, the blessed stage of work under those circumstances which everybody has created for himself during their previous incarnations. Not everybody reaches such level of liberation on his earthly path, so that he would treat the place, the time and surroundings indifferently, without any bolts of his personality. You've achieved it. You've become the paths of the Bright Brotherhood. You can fulfil its tasks; you can be the spots of passing of the creative Fire to the people's happiness. What are your nearest tasks? Does your work with yourselves, with the endless development of your spiritual achievements finish only because you've become the means of work – the harps of God through which the high spiritual beings may play, that is to work? Think yourselves. Do any limits to develop his creation exist for man? Does the work of a brilliant actor with himself ever end? The more he achieves by working with himself, the greater his influence becomes for which he prepares the place for his work, his creating spirit. Exactly the same is with you. The higher your self-control, your purity and love is, the more helpful your serving to the selfless diligent workers of the Bright Brotherhood will be. The greater your loyalty will be, the clearer you will comprehend that neither praises nor rewards don't exist for you anymore, that you are burning this rubbish of conditionalities in the fire of Eternity, the greater that help will be which the Bright Brothers may spread through you on the earth. Courage! Of

course, all of you are from body and blood, but you also are from spirit and Light. Not always your auras may be firmly unshakable when they encounter the pressure of the blows of the auras that are harmful for you. Such encounters are inevitable for you in the bubbling muddle of life to which you leave. But don't lose courage and self-control namely during those moments. Don't let an irritability enter your heart. Protect your thoughts, remember that nobody from you is alone, that you are walking together with millions of dedicated, diligent workers of the two worlds who are always sending help to you. Only be able to catch it. Don't become dispirited if you have to meet some narrow-minded religious people or some rude sectarians who don't consider their encountered person to be a man if he doesn't worship God according to their form. In those cases try to show them with your example that religion doesn't have any significance and in most cases it also isn't necessary for those who worship the Truth, who are serving it, who greet it in the living man. In the new place you will meet one of the highest Teachers, the most charming and compassionate from the great leaders of mankind. You who are now sad, because you will have to leave the place where you've found strength to enter the vibrations of Harmony, comprehend that not the place has helped you to find them, but the Power of Life that has developed within you; its aspects have lifted you to the level in which the waves of those vibrations exist. Having risen to that level with your spirit, you are able to hear the vibrations, to feel them with your heart, that's why you've entered the Harmony. Can you lose this acquired power only because you will change your living place? Man may lose the power if the passion from which he was thinking to be free, but actually it was still living in him, will come out in his life in the first possible case. It will raise its head like a revived snake and disturb your harmony. What do you have to concentrate your attention on in your new life? What daily tasks do you have to raise for yourselves? If your surroundings – that's the Moving Life Himself, then you are Him yourselves. Concentrate your attention not on that who and what they are doing, but how you react to it yourselves. Under the wise and compassionate Teacher Florentian's leadership you will comprehend your earthly lessons even in easier and simpler way. Go joyfully, easily, merrily. Remember how Radanda was teaching you to start any work only when you are in good spirits. Keep this rule also in your new life. Let your days be easy for you and joyous for everybody who surround you. Leave this place with calm and spread it in your every work and encounter."

I. crossed everybody with his wide cross again, and the light would flash in the dining-room from his every gesture.

People began to break up from the hall in silence. Everybody would come to Radanda, bow low to him and almost everybody expressed their gratitude to him with the same words.

"Father, bless with your love to the distant path. I thank you for my rebirth. I thank you for your kindness and care. Here I understood what kindness, love and joy were. Your image will be helping me, don't forget me, father."

Radanda would embrace everybody tenderly and answer.

"Carry out loyalty in your heart and strengthen it in your encountered people. Be blessed. My heart won't forget you."

By bowing to I., almost everybody was telling.

"You've saved me. Be blessed, Teacher. I want to have served my time to you."

I. would answer everybody.

"You are path, and I am path. Neither the ones who save nor the ones who perish exist, only the ones who love and doubt exist. Be strong, grow and overcome by loving."

When all brothers left, I. gathered us around him, looked at Andreyeva tenderly and uttered.

“What on one man’s scale is very much, that on the other man’s scale is disastrously little. It doesn’t have any significance for the eternal man’s path in which ceremonies he is “taking part,” to what he is “admitted.” But only that has an enormous significance how he is taking part everywhere, what he brings with him to his surroundings, that is how much tact, self-control and foresight he lacks, so that he could perceive the strengths of the people who surround him in a flash, evaluate their possibilities and the level of their spiritual maturity, and not disturb, but strengthen the surroundings’ harmony. If the man who is walking on the Earth forgets about the laws of tact and assertion, then he hasn’t yet got rid of his personalism, first of all he is thinking about “I” and by carrying the wealth of invaluable knowledge within himself he resembles an electric battery around which one needs to create a protective net, so that it wouldn’t kill somebody. While the real carrier of the most secret spiritual knowledge is creating the protective net for everybody who surrounds him.”

“I know, I understood everything,” Andreyeva answered silently and obediently, so silently and obediently that Oldenkot looked at her very surprised.

I. squeezed Nataliya Vladimirovna’s hand strongly and he left the dining-room by always holding her hand. I. invited all of us who were sitting at the table to go together with him. We went out to the spacious balcony of Radanda’s hall. The night had already covered the wonderful park of the Community a long time ago, the stars were twinkling in the sky to which beauty and unusual position I couldn’t get used in any way. I always knew where and which constellation I could see, and anyway every time when I lifted my eyes up, I was hoping that I would see the Russian sky which I knew from my childhood. I was thinking about the power of habits and as if newly I comprehended I.’s words about the necessity to create the new habits within myself, so that I could walk the path of development faster and easier. The light of the stars now used to sparkle now to die out, just like the man’s spirit when his unstable harmony begins to sparkle or to die out from the pressure of his encountered people’s auras.

As though by answering my thoughts I. uttered.

“Soon we’ll leave this place and come back to Ali’s Community. And when we come back there, it already will be time for some of you to travel to work in the world again where you were working up till now, and to spread your hearts’ creation to people in that form which Life has given to every one of you. The power of your previous habits, although it has weakened, it still controls you. The more you understand how powerful the habits which took root in your organism are, with what difficulty you were rooting each of them out of yourselves, the more you must try to create new habits within yourselves which help you to unite with people. In the beginning the new habits must become habitual and irreplaceable, and later that must become the only one way to communicate with people. The people of that world in which you will have to live, the servants, assistants and friends of whom you get ready to become, still haven’t expanded their consciousness as much as to comprehend themselves and the entire universe as the Only One Matter, the Only One creation, therefore they are controlled by conditionalities. While they are communicating, they cover themselves with them like with a screen by trying to cover the beauty of their souls, by being afraid of uncovering their souls before their encountered person. They think that the whole wealth of their souls belongs only to them, that it is only their wealth and property which they may give or hide depending on that what gets into their heads. While you who know that the real man’s life on the earth is, not only may not isolate yourselves in gatherings or sects where you help the ones and push away the others, but you must be the same brothers and servants for everybody. Only that the difference of your behaviour is that by being farsighted you know where you can give the Light of Wisdom and where you need to remember: “Don’t throw pearls before swine...” Only joy is the guiding thread for the disciple in his encounters. Only in this background the reciprocal likeable and related to you

vibrations of your encountered people may develop. If you want to resurrect the creative elements of your encountered soul, which are buried in the head of his stuck personal and egoistic incentives, you need to open the first aspect of God within yourselves, and that is joy. That one who is standing sad in his Teacher's presence is unable to hear that what is the most valuable during the encounter, because sadness covers like a smokescreen his first power of perception of Grandeur – joy. Man may be very spiritually developed. Even some powers of nature may submit to him, and anyway, if he is sad, without the balance and irritable, then he will take away less from the encounter with his Teacher than the man of ordinary abilities who is pouring a radiating joy into his encounter. Don't give way to sadness as almost every one of you is doing it now. Strengthen your habit to live beyond the limits of time and space, independent of your separations and meetings. Live in the Eternity by comprehending that no poor conditions exist for it. Your eternal work, work of joy that is inevitable as the Earth's breathing itself becomes easy and pleasant depending on that how your spiritual powers are growing, how your thoughts stop turning only in the cases of bodies and home, and how they start gliding in the universe where every one of you possess his own place of creation. As soon as the man's habit to live in the universe matures, he throws the conditional bonds of bodily love off his eyes, and he begins to unite with those who are living in all cases. Now some of you are sad that you will leave the Ali's Community. The new distant land where once you left your old world outlook seems to be so vague, full of unpleasant noises and spiritual poverty. It seems to you that here you were moving forward easier. Check it out. You will see how often you were irritated, impatient and sad in that "here." Don't idealize this place as the one that "is closer" to the Great Bright Brotherhood. I've already told you many times that you can inhabit a man together with angels, and he will be spending the time there only by searching for some stains on their clothes. The distance to God, the distance to Teacher is always and everywhere the same: everything is within the man himself. Work and reconciliation – that's the only one thing that may help you to achieve liberation. It may open the ways of aspiration to your inner discipline, so that you could develop the new elements for your more noble habits within yourselves. I can tell you that you need these new habits if you want to tear off the old ones, which like the leaves that cannot fall are preventing you from developing the powers of the Great Life within yourselves. But only you yourselves may act and create your path. In this moment one of the hearts that is beating here has the most fundamental reasons to want to go to the new land, to his great friend-Teacher and his brother-father. But not only such want didn't arise for a moment in that heart, but even a thought about such want didn't flash in her. Neither a moan nor a sigh for his separation slipped off for that heart. That's the loyalty till the end. That heart is the youngest of you all. Today every one of you were flinging the lightnings of sadness and doubts, while this heart was pouring only her joy."

"I've already understood a long time ago from this heart's example what it meant to achieve self-discipline through the path of loyalty. That means to leave behind everybody by galloping on the winged horse," Nataliya Vladimirovna uttered loudly.

"And I understood it completely differently," Oldenkot contradicted her. "I understood that the man's path, of whatever components it would consist, leads everybody to that place where the vibrations harmonious to his joy are living. I always comprehended it only with my mind. My thoughts, my logic were telling me that it was exactly like this. Now I understood it with my entire being. I saw that exactly like joy is the first aspect of the awakened Life in man, loyalty is the first stimulus of the human existence which everybody must overcome. And namely loyalty is the happiness of achieving harmony. Everything starts and ends with it."

"And more precise: loyalty is an absolute knowledge that every "now" is nothing else as a glorification of God, glorification of all living beings till the end," Radanda uttered. "Go, my dear, my beloved, go to sleep calmly with your thoughts about Eternity and prepare for the new encounters and

escorts of tomorrow in such a way that your behaviour would be the direct result of the newly lit Light within you.”

Radanda said pleasant good-bye to every one of us. I. with Yassa and Radanda still remained, while we went out into the dark and hot night. I took drowsing Eta; he clambered up in my arms by pretending that he was very tired and that he wanted to sleep. And actually, the clear head was observing me in a funny way, and he was always trying to press his head to my cheek. I was stroking my friend, as if I had believed in his tiredness and his desire to sleep, but he understood my feelings as well as I his.

No one of us wanted to speak, every one of us was carrying like the greatest treasure that Love in his heart with which he was covered in Radanda’s balcony. Gregor with Vasilyon said good-bye to us in silence by their little house, also we dispersed to our rooms in silence by respecting one another’s completeness.

Chapter 22

The last breakfast of the leaving ones. A word of farewell for kids. Once again Ariadna. Mulga’s story about Radanda. The sector of the stubborn people’s solitude. Staranda and Gregor. I.’s conversation with Andreyeva and Oldenkot

Having returned to my room, I still wasn’t sleeping for a long time, while my dear Eta who didn’t want to separate with me was drowsing on my knees with his head shoved into my sleeve. Having glanced at my behaviour through the entire day, which was full of impressions and encounters, I always used to come back to Nataliya Vladimirovna in my thoughts and I was sending her the most tender love which only my heart was able to find.

For the first time I felt how difficult the path of always agitated person was and how precisely Radanda’s words described what loyalty was, and that first of all man had to strengthen it within himself and in his encountered people. Any excitement arises from man’s strained personal life and arouses the personal, reciprocal reaction in another person. The personality covers man’s individuality, hence the part in which loyalty is living of that man goes out. In that time his loyalty stops existing. The whole individuality choked by the bright light of personality steps back into the shadow.

I. caught me reflecting like this, he entered my room silently, as only he alone could walk in and as always, he filled its entire place with his wonderful light and power.

“Stop solving philosophical problems, my dear secretary, Slava will wake you up tomorrow earlier than usually. You will go together with me to eat the early breakfast and to see off the ones who will leave. The night will fly by very fast, while you will have to get up still in the darkness. So, there are only a couple of hours to sleep left. Go to bed, tomorrow we will talk how to give help, calm and comfort to people.”

I. stroked Eta's back, embraced me and went to his room. In order not to disturb my Teacher – and I was certain that he wouldn't be sleeping, but he would be working, – I went to bed immediately by protecting his calm and necessary silence. As always, I fell asleep instantly, and when Slava was waking me up, it was difficult to comprehend that the time given for the sleep was over and it was the time to start the new day. I hurried to the shower, Eta, of course, was running together with me. Having managed very quickly, I went to put I.'s room in order.

I was surprised that the room was already tidied up, and also Yassa was sitting in it with I. Both of them were already waiting for me, and we left to Radanda's immediately. We found Gregor with Vasilyon there who were waiting for us. We became glad of our meeting, and all of us went to the dining-room. An unexpected view was waiting for me here today. Everybody who were leaving were wearing the widest robes and they were wound round with mantles from their head to toe. Having had breakfast quickly, everybody went to the square from which an alley was leading straight to the gates. I. went out together with us, and he was instantly surrounded by the group of children together with their parents who were leaving to the distant road.

I used to see I. among children and speaking to them often, but I had never seen him so concentrated and attentive during conversations. He was looking at the children's faces so piercingly, as if he had wanted to remember every child's face and their inner image forever.

"My dear children. Memorize this hour when you leave this place. Memorize how undisturbedly happy you were here. Memorize my image and my last conversation with you.

You are still children, but all characteristics of grown-ups are already living in you. I will be speaking to you briefly. Try to memorize it, whatever you would do in your life, wherever you would be living, observe three short rules which I will tell you now.

First which you must memorize the most: attention to every man to whom you are speaking, to every work which you are doing. The whole man's life – that's only attention. This is the first necessity of life. That one who doesn't develop his everyday attention, won't be able to achieve something more in any field. You are still small, you cannot do big work, but you already can do everything with your full attention. During every flying by "now" think about that work which you are doing in that moment and do it well till the end.

Second: when you are speaking to a man, go deep into and listen attentively to his words. Look at his eyes, observe how he is, calm or excited. Don't rush to do anything until the man didn't finish talking, listen to him till the end what he is telling you. If you notice that the man is irritated, try to answer him in such a way that he would feel how you love him and want to help him. During the conversation think not about yourself, but about that man who is speaking to you.

Third: never cry. There's only one unshakable power in life, and that is Joy. Every time when something doesn't work well for you, when you want to overcome all obstacles and achieve some results, overcome by loving and being glad. Your every smile will bring your victory nearer and spread your strengths. Every tear and every sad word will muddle up all your achievements and move your victory away for a long time.

The third rule, as well as the first one, – that's the program of your activity for your entire life, for all your work, science and the art. The second rule – that's your eternal work with yourself. Remember: if you started your day with love and if you were spreading it one to another, all your work, no matter how many of them you did, was the work of joy and creation. But if you weren't spreading love, then the greatest and the most thoroughly done work will be worthless. For everything that you are doing by loving,

you are doing for the general wellbeing. And everything where you weren't spreading love and joy for all people, you were doing for yourselves, and that doesn't have any value in the presence of the Eternal Life. You are going far away. You will see big cities, rivers and mountains, valleys and the widths of the fields. But know: any place, wherever you would be living, doesn't have any significance as the place. Only that is important what you have brought into it. Try to spread that love, calm and joy to the new places and your new friends, which you understood here and with which you were living here. Carry namely them everywhere in your heart and you will be spreading happiness everywhere, you will show to people that you know how people are living if they pass the greeting of love one to another."

I. blessed and embraced every child, he hung the little picture with the Great Mother on the thin chain on every child's neck, and once again it seemed to me that his piercing look was fixing every child's image in his consciousness forever.

When everybody got on camels, and high seats were prepared for women and children, which reminded of the nests with pillows and canopies, the gates of the Community opened and once again I. blessed the whole caravan by seeing it off with the farewell words.

"Go, my friends, easily and joyfully. Don't carry the unwanted burden of sadness in your hearts. Let your hearts be empty and free from everything that is personal. You are going to the world not for searching for the luxury for yourselves and expansion of your personalities with your new knowledge and new creation. You are going to the world to help people to accept their day such as it is. Your new encountered people to comprehend that the day that dooms pain and suffering for them doesn't exist, but that every day and all their circumstances – that's everything that man himself has created. And if the day is difficult, then it is only the ball wound up from the screens of his own superstitions. Live without making cleverly. Try to be as simple as possible with every man. And again, search for this simplicity not with your mind, but with the warmth of your heart. Every time when you experience an ill success with your own people, check whether you were absolutely free, whether you managed to keep the purity of your hearts? Whether you were beyond the limits of the earthly conditionalities? Whether your meeting was taking place in the presence of your Teacher? Whether you were flying by being carried by the laws of Eternity, or perhaps you surrendered to the charm of your personality, you submitted to the influence of its sadness or joy and you were sharing not Eternity with your encountered people, but with that temporality with which they were living? Carry vigilance, the most attentive vigilance of your foresight not as a stick or crutches, but as the great power of joy of knowledge, the only one valuable and necessary knowledge: to live every flying past moment as the moment of the running by Eternity. So long, my friends. I will meet many of you still on the earth, and with the rest of you – in other worlds, but I promise one more meeting with me for every one of you. Be blessed, let my calm lead you."

The caravan rode out through the gates with the regards and blessings of those who saw them off, and soon it disappeared in the haze of the breaking day. I. dismissed everybody, except me, Gregor and Vasilyon. We turned to another side of the park which I had visited only one time when I was carrying the sick boy to the woman to whom I had to give Francisco's letter. Soon I understood that I. was going namely there, to Ariadna's whose name I memorized well. As though only now I comprehended how much time we had already spent in Radanda's Community. Everything flashed, as if only yesterday we had been riding across the desert, but at the same time, with this feeling now I comprehended the months spent here as the entire long life.

"Now we'll call at the woman whom – a girl-beggar back then – you, Vasilyon, once saved and whom you were taking care of. A poverty and dissolute life would have threatened her without you, you saved her from it, although you were hardly older than her. Now you will see her, recognize her, and at

the same time you will remember a lot from your past. Do you want her to remember you and thank you for the good that you have done for her?"

"Teacher, have pity on me. If I am destined to recognize the woman with your will and to wish her further happiness under your guardianship again, then be compassionate, save me from her gratitude. You don't tell us to show our gratitude to you, but you know yourself how much we owe you. It would be very awkward for me to listen to her gratitude for once done little favour. I beg you, help me to avoid this destiny," Vasilyon answered him with such a begging intonation that I. gave a laugh, embraced him and told him.

"Once I met a boy who surprised everybody with his clairvoyance to see illnesses. He could see precisely the painful man's spots and he could describe the nature of the malady that there wasn't a single death, however complicated the operations were. But the boy was complaining of people not in those ninety-nine cases from a hundred when people were ungrateful to him and they forgot about him on the same day when they recovered, the boy was complaining of those who expressed their gratitude to him by wasting his time "in vain," as he used to say. Vasilyon, aren't you related with this boy by chance?"

"Ah, Teacher, what can I answer to this joke of yours? I really was trying to avoid the people's gratitude for that little good when I could help them. But not because it would have meant to spend the time in vain, although it is exactly like this in my case. Also, not because of my shyness, but because I can see so many difficult sins of my own that all my good work will hardly cover my path to people with Light."

Now Vasilyon's voice was so sad that I cast a glance at him surprised. I imagined him as a very pure and bright living being and I couldn't understand why there was so much sadness and pain in his heart. I. sat down on the bench; he invited us to sit down next to him.

"I've already told you, my friend, don't live with the past. You aren't to blame for your wife's death. She would have been dead in the same hour, even if your love hadn't doubled between her and Gregor even if you hadn't turned to his sad path with him. Forget your sad thoughts about your past, stop reproaching yourself that you haven't done something for your wife, that you haven't helped her to live satisfied with everything on the earth. Whenever you revive her sad image, you forget that such her image which you create doesn't exist for a long time already. The light of the radiating living being – such her current form is now – turns pale whenever you cover her with your thoughts of heartache, sadness and repentance. Sad thoughts, personal tears by remembering the form who left a long time ago, are unbearably difficult for every living being who is living in that world in which her connection with the earth is still unbroken. Remember that the sadness of your past is hanging along the path of your liberation. It is the greatest obstacle for your spirit to become free, it prevents you from becoming the Light along the paths of your encountered people."

I. said several words to every one of us, to what we had to pay attention during the nearest time, then we continued our path in silence and soon we reached Ariadna's house. When it was already broad day and the first bell's striking was heard, the door opened and Ariadna got stiff on the threshold of her house, surprised by unexpected I.'s appearance.

"Hello, Ariadna. I promised you that I would come and accompany you with your son to the dining-room myself where you would be always going to from now on. And you won't be living in this house anymore. Radanda will show you the rooms in one of the houses in his neighbourhood. It is far to go to the school and the workshop where you will be working now. You don't need to take anything with you, go with me as you stand."

"Unfortunately, Teacher, my little son is too weak to go so far. The medicine which you sent yesterday is finished. And the child is still weak and so pale, as if he wasn't treated during these months."

"That is nothing, Ariadna. Get ready quickly. Lyovushka brought your son here, he will bring him to the dining-room, too. Radanda will give the new drops to him, and tomorrow you won't recognize your boy yourself. Come in, Lyovushka, help the mother to dress the boy, wrap him into the blanket and catch up with us. We will be going very slowly. Don't hurry, we have something to talk about also without you, and we'll be on time till the last striking of the bell."

When I entered Ariadna's room I was stunned when I saw the boy. I brought him still absolutely small back then, while now a grown teenager was lying in bed, as if somebody had rolled him out like a dough. He was pale and lean, he was cold, although the weather was already hot. I helped the mother to dress her son, and that wasn't easy to do for her, even with my help. Then she left the room for a short time, and she came back changed in another dress. I took the boy in my arms, and we hurried after I. and his companions. The burden seemed to be so light for me now, although the boy who had grown a lot during that time was much heavier than back then. He was lying in my arms, pressed to my shoulder, indifferent to everything what was going on around him.

"I absolutely didn't expect that Teacher would visit us today. I lost neither faith nor hope that Teacher remembered us, but deeply in my soul I was thinking that the separation with my little son was waiting for me, and I was always accumulating strength, so that I would meet the moment of our separation heroically. That was difficult for me to do."

Adriana's voice was trembling and twitching. We went out to the straight lane, and I saw three figures in front. I quickened my steps by wishing to shorten the distance between us and them, but I kept such a distance that the words of their conversation would reach us. I. stopped near the dining-room, and he waited for us. As soon as I came up to him, the bell struck for the last time, and I entered the dining-room together with others. I. went straight to Radanda's table, he told me to sit down to his constant place and to seat mother with her son next to me. I fulfilled his instructions, but the boy didn't have any strength to sit, and he was almost lying on my shoulder, held by my hand. Radanda came up to Ariadna whose pale and worn-out face was confused, while her eyes were full of tears. He put his hand on her head tenderly and, having taken her headscarf off, under which she was hiding her beautiful, thick plait, he stroked her even hair.

"Why do you doubt, my friend? Teacher I. told you that your son would recover, so there's no reason for you to be worried about him. If you had been always tending your son by remembering those Teacher's words firmly, then he would have recovered much faster. Your doubts, your heartache, your constant hesitations disturbed him very, very much. You are sure that you love your son with the whole strength of your selflessness. But during the entire time of his illness, you were thinking about yourself and only about yourself, but not about him. You were searching for the strength within yourself not in order to strengthen your loyalty for your Teacher and to help your son to recover with your energy. You were worried only about one thing: how to prepare yourself to separate with him. At least now be really devoted mother and think only about your son, forget about yourself."

Radanda lifted the boy's head a little and poured several drops into his mouth quickly from a very small glass which looked like a toy tea-pot and which he was holding in his hand. The boy gave a little start, he opened his eyes in several minutes, stretched himself and looked round.

"Mother, are you here? Where are we? Why there's so many people here, and why is it so hot?"

Radanda answered him instead of his mother.

"My child, you are in the dining-room to which now you will be going every day, as all the children of the same age do. And you are hot, because you get better. In order for you to recover faster and to run to the school again, now go to my room together with your mother. There you will get some special food and care. I will be treating you for several days more, and then both of you with your mother will move to the new house. Go, my child, it will be fresher for you in my room."

Radanda called one of his attendants, he told him to accompany the mother with her son to one of his rooms and to give them to the doctor to take care of them, who was already warned about it beforehand. To my great amazement, the boy stood up himself, he gave his hand to his mother and he waked cheerfully after Radanda's attendant. Having sat down in his place, Radanda then told to bring the food, and everybody ate calmly. I noticed that there were many new faces in the dining-room, but neither Andreyeva nor Bronski with Igor were at our table this time.

Now when I was already used not to think without necessity where and what could be, having understood once and for all that if a person wasn't present in the Community where he usually was, hence he was working in another place, I was waiting calmly until I. told me the further daily routine. I already understood that soon we would leave this place, and I didn't doubt that I. still had several very important and urgent meetings. A thought flashed that we would go to Staranda's and the old Carlota's. The intuition didn't deceive me this time, too. As soon as the breakfast was over, I. whispered to me.

"Go to Mulga and wait for me. We'll go to Staranda and Carlota."

I became glad of the upcoming meeting with Mulga who as usual was protecting my Eta. I admired this man's integrity and devotion, as well as his kindness for a long time already, but only today I saw the wisdom of this heart. There were so much calm and trust in every Mulga's word that I used to ask myself many times: "Where has an ordinary man Mulga acquired all of it?" Was it characteristic to him still in Ali's Community or has he acquired everything here, in his silent little house of the watchman, which was standing in the very end of the lane where the most beautiful flowers were growing. Mulga answered my untold question in a typical manner characteristic to the Eastern people.

"My eyes have seen many places, many people. My ears have heard a lot of crying. My heart was comforting many tears. But I didn't meet such kindness anywhere, so that I would forget about everything that I had seen up to now instantly, that I would understand: everything what I had seen and heard was unreal. And that the real – the truth, eternal as God, was that what Radanda and Teacher I. were doing and telling. I had heard many great preachers before as well, but I used to sense that those were sermons. And here I understood the word action and I created such calm in my heart which like a tower is looking straight at heaven from my heart and my head. I am not breathing in any other way as only through my heart straight to heaven, to God, and God is living in my heart. All of it happened instantly. Once I heard in the night that Radanda left alone, and he was going to the gates in the desert. I became frightened. How is that: he is alone, such old and he is going to the gates? I followed him through the distance. And I saw how he opened the gates and went straight to the desert. I couldn't bear and I followed him. The moon was shining, and the night seemed to be even cold for me. I must have already been used to the heat. While Radanda kept walking, he probably had already covered a verst from the gates. I regretted that I didn't take at least a stick, because many jackals were running here in the night. With what will I protect the old man? As soon as I had time to think about it, I saw that Radanda stopped by somebody – as if a fallen camel was lying, and I heard somebody crying. I came running to him, as much as my feet could do it, and I was just in time. Radanda was already taking a woman with a baby out of the fallen camel's saddle. I had a small knife, I cut off the belts immediately, I took the baby from the woman, I gave him to Radanda and helped his mother to get free. She was young, she was still a child herself and she was so stiff from the long sitting on

the camel that I had to carry her here in my arms. The camel was already dying, and it was impossible to save him.”

“This woman is an innocent victim of a slander,” Radanda said to me when we came back through the gates. “The oasis of a warlike and cruel tribe is here in the desert. They punish their guilty wives by tying them to the saddle of the well-fattened and satiated camel. They drive the animal so far away that he can’t find the way back, and they put several sharp thorns of the cactus under the saddle, so that he wouldn’t reduce his frantic speed until he falls down exhausted and without any strength. In the beginning the animal doesn’t feel the thorns, then they only tickle his back, but while he is running, they pierce him always deeper and make him furious. When the enraged animal falls down without any strength, he dies quickly, almost instantly due to his exhaustion. But the other victim of the people’s cruelty experiences the whole horror of the scorching sun and thirst, because she is tied firmly, or the desert beasts eat her alive. This camel was stolen not so long ago, to be precise, he was seized from one caravan of the Community. Having remembered the way to his native place, he brought his misfortunate riders here and saved the mother’s and her baby’s lives.”

“In my opinion, your kindness saved them, saint father.”

“Mulga, nothing exists in the universe what one man could do. Everything in the world is connected with the threads of love. If a man has developed his attention till the end, then it opens for everybody the continuous process of people’s destinies. Be attentive to the people who surround you and you will be expanding your attention more and more. You will see from many versts who and where will need your help. Man’s attention becomes blunt and narrow, because he pays a lot of attention only to himself for a long time. When you stop concentrating on yourself, your attention doesn’t get tired. It is a long and difficult work for many. It seems to the man that he is thinking about the people who surround him, but actually, his nature is simply more talented than others, and he is always looking for the ways how to apply his talents more broadly. And here two paths exist: the one of the mind and the heart. The one who is walking down the path of his heart doesn’t ask himself: that what I am doing will be good or bad. They are going and doing. The ordinary kindness is leading them in the same way as it led you after me now. You pitied the old man, because he went out to the desert alone in the night, and only later you fell to thinking that you didn’t have even a stick to defend yourself from the beasts. Don’t be ashamed,” the chief added, as if by seeing in the darkness how I all blushed for my foolishness, because I wanted to protect the saint man who was the protection himself and who was going to save people. “Your kindness will open your eyes sooner than the wisdom of the books will come. Let’s go to the hospital and pass the misfortunate ones to the reliable hands of the nurses. Don’t be afraid, your burden didn’t die. She was constrained by exhaustion and her experienced horror. She will recover, the great and bright future is waiting for her and her baby.”

“Radanda didn’t add a single word anymore. We passed our foundlings to the hands of nurses of the hospital and we came back to Radanda’s house. He stopped by my little cabin, looked at my eyes and smiled. Believe me, brother Lyovushka, I always had the desire during my entire life, since my childhood, as far as I remember: to live next to God. My father who allowed such foolishness of the child jokingly in the beginning was so bored with me that he used to drive me away. While my kind mother used to smile to me gently and answer: “God is far away, my child. Love people and you will be living next to God.”

I didn’t understand her words back then. I was attending the sacred places. I came to the Ali’s Community where you met me and I still couldn’t understand my mother’s words. And when Radanda smiled to me, when he crossed me, I understood everything immediately. I understood that everything and everywhere was God, because people are carrying God in their hearts. And I fell down under his feet.”

"Go with peace, my son," the chief said to me by lifting me up from the ground. "You are the God's path, and I am the God's path. Every man – that's always the God's paths. Don't try to understand how, where and from where the man is going if you met him. Try to give help to him – that moment of your encounter. For nothing is more important on the earth than the encounter that is happening now. If you are able to spread calm during your encounter, then Compassion will embrace both you and your encountered person. Give vigilance to your attention, and your entire life won't pass you by even for a moment."

"Radanda blessed, embraced and pressed me to himself. I won't be able to tell you in words that joy, that happiness which I was feeling back then. As though the wings that grown behind my shoulders since that time. Well, namely back then the tower has grown above my head."

As soon as Mulga finished his story, Radanda, I. and Yassa stopped by his cabin. Eta didn't last long to bow politely to everybody who came. Although I had already seen these elegant tricks many times with one of his legs cast away to the side and his completely stretched out train, but anyway, I couldn't suppress my laughter. My feathered friend considered this laughter to be undesirable and unsuitable, he jumped up on my shoulder, and as always, he wanted to tousle my hair. Unfortunately, this time my strengthened hands squeezed him like tongs, and the joker was calmly put on Mulga's bench. The peacock who stopped being a small bird not so long ago looked at me with an inexpressible amazement, and it seemed that for the first time we changed to a friendly relationship where I showed myself to be his senior friend. Eta had to admit it as the new form of our communication.

"So, my brother, you had to become a subject," Radanda was laughing by stroking Eta's little back. "There's nothing you can do, but I will teach you another trick, then you will captivate your master again. And now you will have to be his servant for a while. Follow him with dignity, show him great respect and protect him with all your might if a danger arises."

I don't know what Eta understood from this speech, but he jumped down from the bench, bowed to me and walked after I. and Radanda with dignity. Yassa was walking next to me, in the distance from our great friends who were speaking in a language which I didn't know. I didn't know their language, but I comprehended from the intonation that they were discussing some important questions. I pressed to the Great Mother in my thoughts, I touched her wonderful flower with which I didn't part, and I was begging her to help me spread calm and joy in my future encounters of the day. We were walking down an unknown part of the part to me, and I saw several charming, tidy, little cottages in the distance with beautiful meadows, flower gardens and kitchen-gardens, as though they formed some separate, small properties. That was so unfamiliar to all the dwelling-houses which I had seen up to now that I looked at Yassa surprised. He understood my silent question and he smiled to me.

"Lyovushka, you are still young, and you cannot notice some people's characteristics and peculiarities. There are many people who still have a lot of their unfulfilled desires in their old age, from which their hearts are still aching. They drown everything else for them, and they cannot perceive their real situation well. They are searching for God and the paths to Him during their entire lives, but they cannot come nearer to a single path that is leading to these paths, because in their every step one of the thousands of their unrealized desires which disturb their souls dazzle them. Separate properties are given to every one of them here, so that they could completely satisfy their proprietary instincts. Not a single man can enter the union with the Bright Brotherhood until the instinct of the propriety is holding him enslaved, right? Now you will see yourself how difficult the path of even a very good man is until the memories about the past are living in his thoughts, which alienate him from others, the desire to live in an independent way without putting his own work into it, I am not talking about their desire "to teach" everybody."

We passed by many of such houses, and finally, we entered one of them which was very beautiful, overgrown with blooming climbing plants and buried in the sea of wonderful flowers. Several cats and dogs were lying calmly in the sun heat with their bodies stretched and their heads hidden in plants. When we showed up, they didn't even intend to move and they kept lying stretched out lazily.

Nobody met us, so we entered the hall of the house, crossed several cosy, but untidy rooms, in many places of which the dishes with the cat and dog food were placed. For the first time during my entire time here I saw such disorder and so many flies. There were no flies in the Community due to the ventilators that were always turning quickly, and anyway, I couldn't see them anywhere else, only in this part of the park. Eta jumped on my shoulder by squinting at the surroundings that were unusual to him.

Again, a never experienced feeling of compassion for that one who was living here penetrated into my heart. I related these surroundings with Yassa's words, and I thought that the man who was living here first of all had to be extremely lonely. A longing for the pleasures of the earth had to oppress him, a desire to be always surrounded by the living beings who loved him, although it would be at least the animals, but that the illusion of love would hang around. I was as though illuminated by perception of these very unhappy people. They were dashing through the life with their eternal desire of love and attachment instead of spreading calm to everybody and giving help according to their strength.

We went out to the opposite, shady side of the house and we heard two arguing, elderly voices of a man and a woman. They were spreading from behind the blooming, brightly blue hydrangeas which were big and thick like the lilac bushes.

"No, no, it isn't that simple as you imagine it," the manly voice was heard. "How is it here, in your opinion? Heart is more important than head. Then everybody who is the most stupid and ordinary, if only he is kind and loyal, may reach his Teacher? But how much man should know, so that his Teacher could accept him as his disciple."

"I don't realize what and how much man needs to know, but that he needs to love and not be as dry as you are – I am sure of it," the womanly voice answered him.

"Don't you think that you will reach your goal by loving your cats and dogs? Could such love be counted? You love not your cats, but yourself in them."

"Well, you are arguing again, I don't say that you love yourself when you are teaching your poor gardener Chinese script, do I? If you were teaching him his native English language, then it would be clear. He is Englishman and he is almost illiterate. Well, but you are teaching him namely Chinese. Why does he need it? He will learn maybe only three letters till his death, won't he? Don't you love yourself?"

"And how could I explain it to you? He will be a missionary during his next incarnation, and both of us will be travelling to China. Is it clear to you? I am working for his future."

"Well, no, I would rather work for this cats' life. We won't find the common speech with you," the nervous womanly voice answered him.

It isn't clear how this classical argument would have ended if the irritated old woman hadn't turned round and emerged from the shade of the bushes onto the path on which we were standing. Having seen us, recognized Radanda, she was so confused that she let the cat slip from her arms, who must have been drowsing on her knees. An old man came out of the thick after her, he was tall, probably still strong, with the steep forehead of the stubborn person which suited neither his face nor his figure at all, with obedient, blue eyes.

"Good morning, sister Carlota," Radanda greeted the old woman.

Only now I remembered that she was the same woman to whom I was going together with Francisco on that memorable night when the rebellious monk Leonore attacked me and when we brought professor and Mulga to the Ali's Community. Now I could hardly recognize her. She had put on weight, she was recovered, I would say, she even looked younger if this word could mean something in her age.

"Father Radanda! I didn't expect to see you so early," embarrassed sister Carlota uttered.

"Is it really so early, my friend? Yesterday I sent Zeiched especially for you to say that today I would come to you with Teacher I. whom you were asking me to let you see so much, so that you could speak to him personally."

"Yes, yes, I forgot about it. My neighbour always distracts me from my business, and I didn't have time to prepare myself."

"Friend Alexander, go home. We will come to you later."

The old man bowed to Radanda and vanished in the bushes quickly.

"Well, let's take a seat here, in the porch," Radanda addressed sister Carlota again. "My friend, the air in your rooms is very bad, and there's a mess. Leave your cat, perhaps she will find another place for herself temporarily, not necessarily on your knees," he added by seeing that sister Carlota was trying to snuggle the cat to her pouch, who was forcing her way through into the freedom by mewling piercingly.

"Forgive me, farther Radanda, but you don't know that my cat is sick. I will bring her to the room quickly and come back," Carlota uttered and took the cat into skirt hurriedly with her trembling hands, but the hissing cat escaped and ran away at breakneck speed.

The stunned old woman was looking after her, while we were looking at her in silence. I looked at I., and my heart was pierced. His face wasn't strict, as always it was compassionate, but... an insurmountable wall of grandeur covered his entire figure. I saw an opened abyss between her and Carlota, for which to cross she didn't possess any strength.

"Carlota, don't you understand whom I've brought to you? During the whole month, during your conversations with me you stated that neither Francisco nor I could understand and know you. That we could be wrong, that we could comprehend neither your nature nor your essence. I was trying to explain to you that until you were occupied only with yourself, your encounter with Teacher would give you neither calm nor use. Well, now you are standing before him, and you don't bring yourself to raise your eyes from the ground. Dare at last. The moments of the encounter are slipping by. Teacher may not wait for a long time until you think from what to begin and how to put the rubbish of your accumulated grievances and bitterness during your long life for him."

"Father Radanda, I cannot speak in your presence, besides you've brought complete strangers to me."

"Well, these kind people aren't so strange to you, my dear sister. We will step aside. Teacher, forgive me once again that my kindness pushed me to make the mistake and that you must experience difficult moments unnecessarily."

"Lyovushka, stay," I. commanded me briefly by seeing that I was prepared to step aside together with Radanda and Yassa.

"Sister, don't waste your time for meaningless thoughts how and from what you should begin to explain to me why you haven't developed that level of great courage and joy which the people

achieve who really are searching for the encounter with their Teacher, who have really forgotten about themselves for the people's wellbeing. Don't name the people to me who were "preventing" you from living in a heroic way. You consider also Radanda to be too weak to solve the problems of your life, although he was visiting you every day, he was persuading you to set to work at least by cleaning out your house, he was pouring his love to you in scoops. Whom from the people whom you met during your entire life did you love not because that they were kind to you? To whom did you give calm and rest with your existence? And if you gave it to some, then why not to people, but the happiness to win your devotion and friendship fell to the animals to share? You exchange the Only One in people to the Only One in animals. Don't obscure your days with great condemnation and bitterness which have settled in your heart. The people whom you were condemning many times, whom you considered to be unjust to you, have left this world, and you don't have an opportunity anymore to apologize to them and to help their tranquillity. Now find a justification for them and a condemnation for yourself. But not that lifeless condemnation and regret, but the living, active action of love: try to see Eternity in your every new encounter. Francisco was telling you many times what a kind man was. He, like Radanda, said to you that you could reach your meeting with Teacher only by uniting with people through work. Work also may be different. You many possess a little physical strength, but every day, as soon as you wake up you may join the great tasks of the day of your nation together with all people of your nation, to see them, to give help of love with your spirit to them. One's fortitude is born only from all factors of one's spirit, brain and heart. They join the work of the day; the man's day begins to shine with them. You think that you may justify your slovenry with your old age and weakness? No. They are only the reflection of your spiritual weakness and your deep-rooted habit to shift your care to the strange hands. You think that your sadness, your solitude and bitterness are born from your sad external circumstances? No. They are also the reflection of your inner disorder. Your integrity is only formal. You are repeating the words of the instructions given to you, while Life doesn't spread its aspects within you. Only because of your once felt kindness for these people whom you named strangers in the distant past, you reached Ali's Community and came here. But fear to continue your poor inner existence. Your negation gives birth to the action. Your day – that's the day of the gathering tears of sadness which you are trying to diversify with occasional meetings, occasional services, occasional animal care. You are dreaming of paying "a visit" somewhere, while a woman, a mother who is sick for a long time already is living next to you, at a distance of several houses. Have you offered at least once to keep watch by the patient and to change her exhausted daughter? Come to yourself, my friend. Concentrate yourself. At least once really direct your thoughts "from yourself" within you, and not in the external way. Think a little during the last months of your life on the earth, prepare your spirit for the great transition to the work of the waves of the different length which you cannot receive now. But don't forget that it will be the work for which you developed neither the strict and precise habits, nor discipline... Think over: instead of asserting the flourishing life all around you, you used to disconnect from it in every place, you didn't acknowledge anybody, you didn't consider anybody to be your Teacher and guardian. You knew well the first aphorism given to the disciple: "No one is a friend for you, no one is your brother, but every man is your great Teacher." You knew and you still know it formally, as well as many other things. Come to yourself, take an action. Tomorrow you will leave for the sector of solitude in which the stubborn people are living. Try not to disturb anybody's calm there, not to disturb anybody's thoughts, not to irritate anybody's heart even for a moment, not to pour sadness due to your pathetic existence. Understand forever: one's aspiration to see his Teacher – that's a futile scattering caused by one's roughest superstitions. That who is prepared may see his Teacher, that one was living and working calmly during the years namely for this, with joy, he was carrying the image in his heart, he was working in his invisible presence, and by doing so, he has developed his fortitude and unshakable honour. You can see from today's experience that only that one may speak in his Teacher's presence who was living by communicating with him by hiding his image in his heart that was invisible to anybody. When you understand love for people, you will understand how those are working who want to contribute to the

plans of the Bright Brotherhood work. Go to the sector showed to you, concentrate there and reorientate your understanding what the living Life within yourself is that is extending its loving hand to the same Life within your encountered man.”

Carlota who was always listening to I’s words with her downcast eyes, fell on her knees with her face covered with her hands. I crossed her, he held his hand on her head that was trembling from her strong sobbing, and he went to Radanda with Yassa.

I rushed to the old woman, I lifted her as light as the down, and I seated her on the armchair in the porch. If not for my new fortitude and the Goliath’s strength, I would have burst into tears with heartbreak and my sympathy for her. But now there was so much fortitude, self-control and joy in my heart that I touched the elderly hands which were wiping her hands with convulsions with the Great Mother’s little flower, I kissed both of them, I bowed low to her and I uttered silently.

“Don’t cry, dear sister, Teacher gave the pledge of fortitude to you. Call the Great Mother for help. She will help you to find the path. It is never too late until man is alive. I will come tomorrow, I will ask Teacher to allow us with Yassa to accompany you to the sector of stubborn people. We will be visiting you there until we leave from here, and we will be serving you as diligently as we can. If Teacher couldn’t see a possibility for you to find the real path, then he wouldn’t have talked to you today.”

I kissed both her knobby hands again, I bowed to her again and I hurried to chase after I. by seizing Eta in my arms who was waiting for me patiently, as if he had understood the whole importance of my comforting words.

I caught up with I. exactly in that moment when he was speaking to the old man whom Radanda called Alexander.

“My friend, how many times Radanda was repeating you that it was not important who you were or who you will be during your lives. Only one thing is important: who you are now. The truth is old and banal that Life – that’s your now flying past moment. Anyway, it still isn’t the real knowing for you, but the formal problem. And on the contrary, the shadows of the past and of the future drown your thoughts, they force you to lose the precious time of your life on the Earth in vain. You are spending your time, which you have promised Radanda to give to children to teach them, for meaningless arguments and conversations, and for even more meaningless education of illiterate people with such knowledge which they may use neither during this nor during their future lives. It is enough for you to mess about with yourself, with your independence and your eternal thoughts about your children’s and your grandchildren’s lives. Already today go to the school and tell its superior that I sent you to help the old teacher to teach children the Greek and Latin languages. Teach them in a joyous and merry way, so that they wouldn’t work by the sweat as your gardener, but so that they would yell cheerfully and would remember the alphabet from those funny figures which you can draw so excellently. Settle in the school itself and become the best servant and not only the teacher for those children with whom Life will bring you together today.”

I. bowed to Radanda.

“Would you be so kind, father, to look that both members of the Community entrusted to you would fulfil my instructions of today precisely. Yassa and Lyovushka, you are going to go together with me.”

We and Radanda separated. I. turned back, he went out to one of the widest avenues and turned to the sector of the stubborn people. We were walking in silence for a long time, and only when we approached the sector’s gates, I. said to me.

"Knock at the gate, in my tell them to open it and leave Eta to the old man who is on duty by the gate."

I did everything as I. had told me to do, and we entered the big sector's yard. Many flowers were also in bloom here, many beautiful benches were placed around the house and along the avenues. We kept walking further to the park along the houses. To my amazement, a rivulet was streaming here, perhaps even a small river, while the park changed imperceptibly and become like a forest of unseen, very interesting and beautiful conifers. No avenues and flowers were left in the forest, there was only a narrow, twisting, hardly noticeable path along which we were following I.

In the beginning we were travelling across the flat forest, then the path began to descend. We were walking along the very ground of the ditch and, having clambered up on its opposite bank, we came in front of the settlement from white houses, which was enclosed with a low, wooden fence. I understood that the ditch and the hills were nothing else as the ground of the sea that once was stretching instead of the desert.

There was nobody by the gate, I. opened it himself, but nobody went out to meet us. All houses were like dead. In this way we approached a little church and saw the first alive man. He was tidying up his little house, he was shaking mats. That was a lean man with monk clothes, he was working with his back turned to us, and probably, he didn't hear our steps. I. turned straight to him.

"Hello, Staranda," I. came to the man and uttered louder than usually.

That one gave a start, turned to I. who greeted him quickly and dropped the mat out of his elderly hands. My God, how Staranda had changed! That was always the same old monk whom we visited once. I saw two phases of him: the rude denying man, intractable stubborn person and the pitiful, misfortunate man who comprehended the depth of his delusion and who was suffering painfully for this comprehension. Now, after the first fit of unexpectedness and surprise had passed, the man who was smiling joyfully was standing before us, whose face was radiating goodwill and tender love. He was wearing Francisco's headscarf on his neck, the ends of which were neatly stuck under his poor, faded cassock.

"O Lord, you took pity on me, Teacher! I didn't expect that your compassion would take you to me, the sinner, so quickly," Staranda was talking with a cheerful and happy smile. He stroked his grey, curly hair reaching his shoulders with his hand, which must have been done up in a plait before work. "You've taken me by surprise, Teacher, and I look so disorderly! And even with your guests," the old man continued by feeling ashamed and he was cleaning his dusty hands on the long skirts of his cassock. "Perhaps you would drop in at the chief's with your dear guests? While I would put myself in order and run there."

"Don't worry, my dear friend," I. said to him in such a voice that even I, who was already used to the divinely tender Teacher's voice, was excited from this especial kindness and tenderness with which he addressed Staranda. "We will drop in at your call."

Staranda, who reacted sensitively to the wonderful Teacher I.'s voice, as though became stronger, self-confident immediately, his smile lit up his face even brighter. He wanted to bow to I. till the ground, but he embraced him and went to the nearest house together with him by holding his hand on his shoulders.

"And I untie the headscarf neither during the day nor during the night," Staranda uttered silently by touching the corners of Francisco's headscarf, and he brought us into his tiny cell.

The clean walls made of palm timber were polished as beautifully as the tables in the dining-room. A little desk with the Gospel before which a big, white cross was hanging and the little lamp was on, a hard couch with a headboard, a little table and a stool – that was the whole cell's furnishing. An inkpot, a water-bottle and a cup were placed on the windowsill.

"I came to take you away, Staranda. What will you answer if I propose you to change your living place and work?"

"Let the God's and your will be, Teacher. I am glad: you need my miserable work. I am good for nothing else here, except the church cleaning. I have little strength left; I can cope only with such work. But I will try to do everything what you will order with the God's help."

Staranda touched the headscarf with his hand again, he looked at the cross, gave a sigh, crossed himself and bowed to I., as if by waiting for his further instructions.

"Staranda, you aren't even interested where I will be taking you?" I. looked at the monk attentively and smiled.

"Teacher, that Staranda is dead already who was arguing and who considered himself knowing everything and always right. Now Staranda is living who knows only one truth: I loved people little during my entire life and I was thinking not about them, but about myself. It was difficult for former Staranda to live everywhere. Current Staranda came to love people. Sadness fell off him, he is standing naked before his Creator, the same naked as he came to the earth. Only love covers him, and it is easy for him to live his day. Only sometimes my heart is breaking that I didn't understand you, the messenger of God. I thought that your compassion wouldn't be enough to forgive my sin quickly. Now you visited my shelter, and the last burden has fallen off my heart. Be blessed, great father, let me follow your steps till the very death and after it."

Staranda knelt by I.'s feet, but he embraced the old man and seated him next to himself. I couldn't see anything else, except the rainbow cloud which covered the whole cell and in which both the old man and I. disappeared. When the thick cloud cleared away, I saw I. and Staranda again. Both of them were already standing on the cell's threshold, and Staranda turned to me and uttered.

"I don't ask you to forgive me, dear brother, because your given headscarf told everything to me. It told me that man's heart was a fairy-tale – a wonderful fairy-tale, that everybody's life is namely this fairy-tale which the man's heart is telling. Don't condemn me at least for a moment, and the Great Father Life won't condemn you, he will give the shelter of his Kindness to you forever. Let joy protect you during your long days."

Staranda followed I., we with Yassa took a peep at the miserable cell in which Staranda found his liberation and, having wished happiness and calm for its future dweller, we hurried after them.

Having left Staranda's cell, we saw the brothers dressed in monastic clothes who were hurrying towards I. from all sides. A tall monk with the signs of a rare beauty in his face was walking in front of them, he was lifting his old legs with difficulty, and he was supporting himself with the stick. From the respectable distance which the rest of the brothers kept from him, I understood that he was the chief of the sector. Without reaching I., still from the distance, he wanted to kneel down, as well as all the monks who followed him, but I. stopped him.

"I've already told you that I didn't allow you to bow to me to the ground. Bow to God, if your souls desire so. Teacher can see your humility also without such bows, as well as he can see your stubbornness in your lowest bow. Be strong, my brothers. Don't lose courage, because your hearts are

unable to become free from your imbibed habits to argue and to philosophize instantly. Expand the effective love in your hearts with the ordinary daily work. Don't think so much about yourselves, about your sins, about the heroic deed of your salvation. Think about the World, about the Universe more and more often, about the people who are living in it, who are searching for love, who call and pray for help and salvation. Send your heart's greeting for every soul. It doesn't mean absolutely anything that you cannot see the people and the world here. You are the people, you are the world, you can love so widely and bless sad and misfortunate people in your wide world that the waves of your kindness will reach them and bring calm and comfort to them. Each passion which you will overcome within yourselves, from which you will liberate your heart, will fly to the distant world like a beam of joy and energy. No energy sent by man with kindness may vanish in the world. The energy of evil covers only those within whom it encounters irritability. Then it penetrates into the man. While the energy of kindness doesn't go round a single living being in the world, and if it doesn't liberate her, then at least it will ease the pain for every suffering person whom it will be flying through."

"Forgive me, Teacher, that I did so little for my secretary since that time when you appointed me as the chief. My illness is holding me chained to the bed almost every day, the brothers are doing everything themselves and in addition, they also must take care of me. I have already asked Radanda several times to release me from the chief's duty, I was trying to prove him that I was invalid, and how an invalid may be chief if he is working the least from all."

"Don't torment yourself, Matvey, also the grievance that you may not work in such a way and as much as in your opinion the chief must work, isn't the sign of liberation, isn't it? Are you, your spirit, your thoughts, your heart inert when you are chained to bed? Aren't you always sending your love, your blessing, your joy and calm to the distant world, to any alive brother in whatever place of the universe he would be living? Do your duty obediently. The brothers of your sector are growing, in the same way as you are doing it yourself by uniting with them without any superstitions and attitudes. You wanted to talk to me about the stubborn brother Georgy whom you cannot overcome with your love. Where is he?"

"He must be in the greenhouse. If he has heard that you were her, Teacher, and that we were all happy by seeing you and receiving instructions from you and your blessing, then he needs to behave in his own way and to run away to the most distant corner. And actually, he is dying from the desire to see you, Teacher, and if it happens so that your kindness won't find a possibility to see him, then his eyes will swell up from tears and his heart will grow heavy from the real heartbreak. He is kind, Teacher. He is nice and his is tender by nature. Only his external character is stubborn. Not him, but I am to blame that up to now I was unable to open the essence of the brother entrusted to me and that he has spent so much time in vain," the chief was speaking very sincerely, and the intonations of purely fatherly, pliable love were heard. "Let me go to search for him, I will try to do it as soon as possible and not to detain you, Teacher," the chief added by looking at I. pleadingly.

"Spare your sickly legs, my friend. Sit here with Yassa for a while, you will find what to talk about. He came back from the secret Community not so long ago and he has brought a lot of words of gratitude and letters for you. Don't worry, accept calmly the gratitude of many people who owe you for their salvation. Remember how quickly your legs used to run, how precisely your hands used to hit enemies, and don't be sad that now the lesson of the numb body that is carrying the alive, effective and creating spirit has fallen on you."

I. showed to me with a sign to follow him, he took Staranda's hand and, having gone round the houses and dense undergrowth, soon we got into a big clearing where the whole complex of greenhouses and hothouses was standing. Majority of them were covered with dark curtains which protected the exotic plants from too hot sun. Now I understood why the Community had so many excellent

and rare fruit. I. told us to stop by one of the biggest greenhouses and he pointed at the lonely man who was standing sadly under one big, unknown tree. The man was wearing monastic clothes, he was standing with his hanging head, and he was holding a shovel in his hand. He used to look at the window sadly now and again, and he used to mop the running tear from his cheek. I. was standing for a while, as though by listening attentively to the man's talking to himself, then he smiled and, having showed the sign to us to follow him, he entered the greenhouse.

"Where is gardener Georgy here?" I. asked loudly when he went up to a big, wide palm with such wide leaves that all three of us hid under it.

"I am gardener Georgy. Who is asking? Who needs me? Now is the rest time, what is anybody's business where I am?"

The voice that came was soft, pleasant, of course, it belonged to a singer – my ear had already learnt to distinguish it. Although his answer was rude, I understood instantly that the man was of culture, he was kind, only maybe unhappy.

"One very serious patient needs you very much," I. answered him. "May the patient's care wait until your rest hours will end?"

"It is really strange. Who are you? I haven't even heard such voice here. Why do you teach me the duties that are given to me here? I've prepared everything for my patient," he uttered and turned straight to our palm under which we were hiding.

Having come up to the tree, Georgy simply struck against me and cried surprised.

"Soon you really will hit the roof of the greenhouse! I imagined from your such unusual voice that you must have been created by God, as harmony itself. While you soon will reach the sky, although your face is still absolutely childish."

I. went out before him, and that what I had already seen a hundred times happened. Georgy threw the shovel out of his hand, and he fastened his eyes upon I.'s face, as though by not being able to tear his look off him. He was standing exactly like this, now by growing pale now by growing red. He was a young man of medium height, but his shoulders and his chest were so wide, as if they were added from another figure. His big, lightly grey eyes and his steep forehead which showed his stubbornness – everything was telling that he was persistent, capricious, self-loving, maybe even rude, but kind and pure man.

"Georgy, why didn't you go out together with all brothers to meet me? Is self-love within you higher than love for man? You've promised me during our last meeting that you would be thinking about people and forget about yourself. Apparently, it is difficult for you to exchange roles with your brother who is thinking too much about people and who absolutely doesn't care about himself, although he is still living there, among the people of the world, in Moscow."

Georgy gave a start, as if I. had hit him, and he whispered.

"My brother? What has my brother to do with it? I absolutely wasn't thinking about him for many years already. What do you want to tell me with it?"

"I want to remind you how rudely you answered to your brother's request not to withdraw from the world, although he replaced your father for you. He wanted to prove to you that a man could be pure and honourable everywhere and a devoted citizen for his motherland, that he could love people everywhere and serve them. You came here. And during all this time, the struggle of your heart, the

struggle and protest against every other man's told opinion still takes the most important place in your thoughts. What is your day here formed of? How is it different from the days of your worldly life? How do you help your encountered people? How do you help them to live in kindness? Matvey was telling you many times that you cannot give calm to others if you don't possess it in your heart. You can give to others only that what you possess yourself. Do you remember the pledge which I've given to you? I said to you: spread calm for everybody, especially spread calm and rest for those who are working next to you. Why also here, in the sector of calm, you are still the same uneasy Georgy who may not adapt himself anywhere in the entire world and who may not get on with anybody? That's only because also here love for yourself and not for a man takes the most important place for you."

Georgy covered his face with his hands, and I saw that tears were flowing in streamlets from his miserable, well-worn, faded cassock.

"Don't cry, my friend," I. approached the monk and passed his hand over his long, black hair. "Calm your thoughts that are wandering in your unreachable dreams. You were dreaming only about meeting me. I came, while you ran away from this meeting timidly. My love found you here where you hid yourself by wishing to see me. Your heart has grown heavy from heartbreak and from your desire to tell me about it, and your lips keep silent without any strength to put your heart's complaints into words."

Georgy fell by I.'s feet, he lifted his tear-stained face and uttered with heat.

"Blessed, you've appeased my whole revolt. My entire irritation has disappeared in your tenderness, you've brought calm to me. I understood in one moment what the real love for man was, my heart was enlightened in one moment, it experienced calm. And now I will be carrying it everywhere, because you gave it to me forever. Forgive me for my stupid, childish stubbornness," the monk was speaking by kissing I.'s hands.

"Stand up, my friend, now come together with us and still live here for a while. Comfort Matvey with your calm and love before his soon death. Pay your debt to him by taking care of him, and when you have done your last duty for his remains, Radanda will take you to his place. You will be learning with him, you will prepare for the state examination in the university, and when you are ready, I will send a messenger for you. You will become professor, and your yearning for the science will be suppressed. Calm down, find self-control, so that you could approach Matvey with calm and joyous face."

I. embraced Georgy tenderly and blessed him. Now the monk's face was radiating, while we came back to Matvey and his brothers, we found them speaking to Yassa vividly. We still were delayed in this settlement for a while. I. embraced every brother, he told a tender and very important word to everybody and then, having taken Staranda's hand, he went straight to our house. He told Slava to settle Staranda in one of three rooms. Having taken the shower and changed his clothes, he ordered me to invite Andreyeva and Oldenkot to him.

I didn't find any of them in their rooms. Without knowing where to search for them, I went to the park, and Slava whom I met here told me that he had seen both friends not a long ago, sitting in the white summerhouse and reading a book. I hurried down the avenue, and indeed, I found both of them reading a big book. Both friends reacted absolutely differently to I.'s invitation which I told them. Nataliya Vladimirovna's face turned extremely red, as if the whole blood had poured into it. She was in a hurry, as always, she started picking up her scattered belongings feverishly, and all her movements showed her inner anxiety. The pleasant American remained calm, no anxiety was seen in his excellent face. He closed the book calmly, he helped Andreyeva to collect her belongings, he was standing in thought for a while, as if by concentrating on the upcoming conversation, and he said to me.

"I feel uncomfortable to go to Teacher with this book. He told me to read it, but I didn't have time to do it. Would you be so kind, Lyovushka, and shelter it in your room while I will be at Teacher I.'s. I would take it from you after our conversation."

"And again, I prevented you from fulfilling I.'s instruction, because I certainly wanted to read the book together with you. How often I am to blame for the unfulfilled work that was given to you!"

I noticed a little surprised Oldenkot's look and his shy smile as the answer to Nataliya's hasty remark. I took the heavy book from his hands, and I hurried back by reminding my friends that I couldn't find them immediately, while I. was already waiting for them. Having accompanied both friends to I.'s room, I wanted to leave in silence, but he stopped me.

"Give the bundle of the letters from the night desk to me and also put these letters together by date."

When I gave the necessary bundle to I., he told me to sit down next to him and he moved several more letters to me which were written in a clear, large Ali's handwriting which I recognized instantly.

"You put the letters in order and double your attention, listen attentively to the essence of the conversation. As my secretary, you will have to know and keep many of my work in your memory. To be precise, not my work, but the one of the Bright Brotherhood."

I sat down in the indicated place and for the first time I was learning to coordinate two jobs, and in the beginning, it seemed to be very difficult to me, but soon it became usual and later easy. During this first time, I always felt that either the conversation would slip off my attention, while I was ordering the letters, or on the contrary, the letters would stop existing for me, while I was trying to follow the thread of the conversation. Finally, I finished ordering the letters and I concentrated my entire attention on the conversation.

"Many of the things that you told me are right, Nataliya Vladimirovna. But it is right only in the sense of the Earth mode of life, and it is absolutely not right according to the real meaning, courage and accuracy of the universal law – the law of the constant moving forward. The experience of your past which has brought sad external consequences, that is which has split up that big association which Ali told you to create into small organizations, doesn't belong only to the work of the earth alone. Everybody who participated sincerely, without any puffing up and self-interest in the activity of the association established by you and Oldenkot, found liberation from many personal feelings and superstitions which oppressed them. While the important and eternal sense, which Ali and sir Vomi gave to the association through both of you, will be living and changing according to that regularity to which everybody obeys who is living in two worlds. Some values exist, the invisible sense of which isn't opened even for the looks of those who have brought them with their hands into the wide world from the depths of the repository of the most sacred Spirit. Everything what you still need to master before leaving to the world with the same Truth, that's – strong self-control. Only with such self-control the man's constant living in two worlds is possible, only such life guarantees an impeccable choice of fellow workers from one side, and from another side, a constant assertion both of Life itself and of that little part of the Truth in it which you are sent to pass. Do you, Nataliya Vladimirovna, personally possess all these qualities which are necessary for the work entrusted to you? No. That's why an assistant and colleague is given to you, whose spiritual and physical qualities partly fill the gaps of the strength which are needed for Ali's work. And even both of you together don't possess everything what is needed for this gigantic work. Ali and sir Vomi fill in these deficiencies. Now memorize one thing very well: if you were denying one drop of work, you poured the poison from forty barrels into work, and the people who surrounded you gathered it inevitably. They couldn't even have

heard your single word, but your negation has soaked into the vibrations that surround you and helped the people who deny come nearer to you. If you can see that the work which you were sent to fortify on the earth has split up into separate, small groups instead of wholeness, then there will be exactly that amount of the people who deny in these groups for which you opened the door with your discontinuous loyalty. Ali and sir Vomi have already connected the people with strong ties where they could be sending strong and stable assistants to them, whose loyalty could patch all the holes and cracks of spiritual disability of the principal founders and bearers of the new idea, that is both of you. Don't surrender to the suffering of doubts and regrets. You told me and yourself many times, Nataliya Vladimirovna, that you understood so much, that you made yourself free from so many oppressing personal superstitions and opinions, that you have found reconciliation. That is only partly true. In order for you to find an absolute calm according to the scale of your spiritual avalanche, you still need to get over some stages. Life cannot wait until you reach harmony and bring your entire big organism which is always bursting into the complete self-control. Life isn't waiting for anybody anywhere. It is marching forward in every moment, and it is the driving force of everything what it needs in every "now". It doesn't mean anything for Life if in people's opinion it is perfect or imperfect, if it suits or if it doesn't suit somebody. It is leading forward those who correspond to the accuracy as the course of destined events, and not according to opinion or will of the temporary forms. And still here you must be in time to learn to fulfil the instructions given to you absolutely precisely. Get ready to leave the Community in a month. You will see Ali in his Community and you will receive his final instructions there personally... While you, my dear friend Oldenkot, will always need to stay by Radanda during this entire remaining time. He will reveal a lot for you from the field of the people's treatment, and this time you will have to pay more attention to children and not to grown-ups. You were walking the straight line during your entire life, but your excessive modesty prevented you from developing greater talents within yourself. You need to understand that man doesn't receive abilities and talents by chance. They are living in his Ego for a long time already, even till that moment when man may express them through his actions. The whole circle of invisible assistants is protecting them. The excessive man's modesty prevents not only himself from acting as the universal energy, but it also impedes the whole plan of Spirit and Light to which the protected man belongs. Modesty that grows into the real humility doesn't possess any self-love. While modesty arises namely from self-love, and it impedes the heralds of Life – the Bright Brotherhood – to direct and to use people in the most accurate way. Now the bell already rang out, we will meet with you in the dining-room."

Having seen his company off, I. told me to tie up the ordered letters again, and when we went out to the park, he said to me on our way to the dining-room.

"You've become the witness of several people during this time. In most of the cases you were acting according to the Teacher's instruction, in other cases your own love encouraged you to take part in your encountered person's fate. You understood during this time that neither your own nor strange people existed, that all lives are connected one with another and that every encounter – that's you yourself. You've learned to act actively during your every encounter. Later, during your every day you will be developing your psychic powers always more, you will mature always more. If you happen to meet some elderly or even absolutely old people who haven't found not only calm within themselves, who haven't learned to give help to the people who surround them, but who always need the strange comfort themselves, – know that these people haven't found anything what could have encouraged them for the work of Eternity. While nearing to the end of his earthly life, each man must possess two universal Elements within himself, to extend the frames of his spiritual world outlook in such a way that all the dregs of conditionalities stopped existing, for example, insults, explanations, persistent searching, a desire to force people to recognize his authority, his will, his comprehension. Only that who understood that his role in this moment of time was only a small moment of the segment of Eternity that descended into the form during the course of her work, will be able to become the Light on the path of his encountered people. If a

mother didn't understand that the meeting with her children wasn't an accidental episode, but a natural movement forward of the great importance, she won't be able to create the harmonious surroundings in her family, but she will destroy a lot of her children's strengths. Her children's grievances and misfortunes won't come into their lives just outwardly. They will come as the logic consequence of her egoism and her absolute certitude of the fairness of her actions. You've never fallen to thinking about your personal life, Lyovushka. How do you imagine your future?"

"Life – you were teaching me like this – that's "now". My heart is clear for me. I know that my entire nearest future – that's a row of years of discipleship. I haven't graduated from the university yet; I can see every day how far it is for me to achieve at least the tenth part of your knowledge. What else should I think about? I've chosen my path. I follow you. You promised me that I would be able to follow Florentian during my life. I will be walking as he, Ali, you will need it. I am happy by living next to you and I don't desire anything else, except knowledge and serving the Bright Brotherhood."

We approached the dining-room, and we met all the dwellers from our house, as well as Gregor and Vasilyon. Having greeted those whom he hadn't seen yet, I. uttered.

"Tomorrow, we leave for the oasis of the dark-skinned people, we will ride out by the end of the night. Everybody get ready for this journey. It won't be very long, but it won't be the one of the easiest. Yassa, you will have to take care of everybody and to prepare everything. You, my friend Staranda, will go together with me to visit the chief after eating, and he will show the new duties to you."

Staranda who now was wearing the white clothing that was accustomed for the brothers of the Community, bowed to him, and such joyous and childish smile flashed in his face that I couldn't even believe that not so long ago I could see stubbornness within him and his desire to argue for every word, not only for work.

We entered the dining-room, everything here was going on in the usual order, and the atmosphere of calm and joy due to I.'s presence passed to all hearts.

Chapter 23

I.s conversation with Bronski and Igor. Instructions for their work in Dartran's oasis. An unexpected encounter with lady Berdran. A doctor. Ariadna, her son and her tragedy. The second I.'s conversation with Andreyeva and Oldenkot about their mission in the world. The last preparations and departure to the oasis of the dark-skinned people. The first impressions in the oasis. Mother Anna

When all brothers and sisters as always bowed to I. and Radanda and left the dining-room, I. told everybody who were sitting at our table to follow him to Radanda's rooms. Here, in one of the rooms where big sofas were standing by the walls, I. sat down next to Radanda and he offered us to sit down as comfortably as possible. Me with Bronski pulled low, little chairs to the sofa and sat down by I.'s feet.

Having looked at us, two tall men on the low chairs, I. gave a smile and he joked that Radanda's weakness for the reliable, stable items this time helped us not to crush the miserable little chairs. From the light and tender jest that the goliaths shouldn't grow anymore, while we were still growing, I. passed to the common conversation. Although this whole conversation, as I understood it later, was meant for Bronski and Igor, but everybody was thinking that that what I. was speaking directly affected everybody personally.

"Soon, all of us will leave this wonderful place in which every one of us received so much during that time. I say, "every one of us" and not "every one of you", so that you wouldn't think that any difference between Teacher and his disciples might be with respect to the eternal movement forward. Teacher may not stop even for a single moment in the work of his spirit. He is connected to the work of Life Himself. He is one of His little screws, and his entire earthly life is only one of the aspects of Life which came to Life and developed in the Teacher's physical form. If Teacher's spirit fell out of the joint Movement of the entire energy even for one moment, then the entire universe to which his form belongs would feel a catastrophic blow, similar to that one which any automatized device would experience, like a factory or a plant if its belt drive, a bolt or any other component broke. In the same way the whole Bright Brotherhood and all disciples of the Teacher who stopped would experience traumas of their conductor-bodies and spirit, while many of them – the weakest ones – would fall down dead. Some of you used to ask me: "Why

is it so difficult to become disciple? Why doesn't the Bright Brotherhood accept more people who want to serve it and mankind?" I think that you've found the answers to these questions during this time spent here by seeing clearly what the not strict selection of disciples or too great kindness and lenience for them meant. That return warranty, that connection which may not be broken off by anything, which merges the Teacher's and disciple's spirit into the totality also exists between all other people, without any exceptions. The people who are living only their physical life can feel it as the blood bond, as "their own" and "strangers." The people of high culture comprehend it as the necessary spiritual union by choosing their friends according to their taste, while those who have become free from their passions and superstitions are carrying the Light for all living beings without choosing and not separating from the people's mass, but by pouring the energies of the Great Life into everything what is alive. The higher and wider the culture of the man's heart is, the clearer his look can see the Image of Life, the simpler and easier it is for him to carry his work into the people's masses. However difficult and complicated the Teacher's life and work would seem to you, it is easy, joyous, merry and simple for Him. The whole comprehension of the people's earthly life and their actions in it depends only on the power of loyalty which man's consciousness was able to achieve. The Teacher's loyalty that doesn't know any hesitations and doubts brings him to that point about which I told you: Teacher becomes the living aspect of Life. Life is carrying Him within himself through the days of the earth and his constant work. While creating within Him, Teacher acknowledges neither difficulties nor disharmony due to his disturbed calm within himself, nor anxiety due to some coincidences in the earthly conditionalities. The Teacher's loyalty may not begin to hesitate from the difficult life of the living beings of the earth who only know the law of the earth alone, who observe only it, and that's exactly why they are living by suffering, drowning in tears, without any harmony. Teacher is acting not at his own discretion, but as one of the belt drives of the Only One Life by creating everything in the earthly life strictly according to the laws of accuracy and regularity of the entire universe. He may not reckon with the superstitions and opinions of the earthly justice which exists only for the consciousnesses that have grown heavy from personalisms and that are slaves to them. The great distance between Teacher and his disciple increases or decreases depending on the disciple's loyalty, whether it grows or diminishes. Why the whole system of discipleship is based namely on loyalty? Because loyalty helps the man's clear vision to open faster and in a shorter path by cleaning the rubbish of hesitations and doubts from his spirit. And he begins to see Life in all his encounters. He gets used to associate with Him, and imperceptibly for himself, he enters other waves, the vibrations of which Life is always sending to the universe. The greater the disciple's loyalty is, to the greater number of high vibrations he becomes sensitive. No less important factor of the Teacher's and his disciple's drawing closer one to another is man's work. As soon as the disciple's loyalty takes him into the waves of the other frequency of vibrations, work instantly becomes the necessity for him. His look begins to see how the entire universe is working, and his own time spent uselessly is oppressing his spirit more than the most difficult work. Idleness for him becomes an unbearable burden not only as a laziness or a complete dissipation, but also as a feeling of his stopping by following his Teacher. He still cannot see and understand that his Teacher is an aspect of Life Himself, but he can feel clearly that the only path of following his Teacher, which may be expressed by the law of the eternal loyalty, is work. Man becomes happy when he begins to understand that he is never alone, that his work, which often is not acknowledged on the earth, has another, eternal meaning which the earthly acknowledgments, awards and praises may neither diminish nor exalt. It is very well, and it is a great happiness for man, if his work was acknowledged and appreciated by his contemporaries. Then the spiritually developed man may leave his incarnation calmly, because every incarnation during which man was able to serve the people masses shortened his eternal path independent on the fact whether he comprehended himself as the member of the Bright Brotherhood that is working for the general wellbeing of the mankind. That also is sufficient that he comprehended himself as a people's servant and that he loved his nation unselfishly. You, Stanislav, together with Igor will stay in the oasis, as you've promised themselves "the old man" voluntarily. While you were living here and learning in Radanda's library, you've acquired a lot of knowledge that turned your

standpoint not only to the art, but also to the entire life upside down. Both of you were interested only in the theatre from your very childhood. None of the world wealth attracted and allured you, if they were not connected to the theatre in one or another way. Till your arrival here, the theatre was your entire meaning of life, your goal, the form of your union with the nation. Only it alone was your necessity. It was dictating you how and where you had to live and learn. It realized the whole meaning of life for you, and your spirit couldn't live without the theatre. The theatre gave life for your every day, it was carrying interest, calm or disharmony into your hearts and thoughts. Your entire personal life and characteristics was only the consequence of everything what the theatre required from you. You were its prophets, while it was the sun around which you were spinning. And what about now? Who is now leading you through your days? What power is lighting the fire of your talents? Did you understand that your talents – that's the aspects of Life? What does now occupy the most important, to be precise, the only place in your spiritual world? Where is your sadness and sorrow? You didn't even notice that your entire devotion to the theatre, liberated from your personal passions, has grown into your loyalty to Life himself. Now you are carrying not the theatre in your hearts, but the aspect of Love herself which has acquired the form of serving people – through the theatre. Are you now excited by the amount and quality of the applause dedicated to you? Are you drawn onto the stage to show the halo of your achieved glorification to the crowd? You are interested in the new, living aspect of Life, to be precise, it commands you now – to unite people through His eternal beauty. You aren't searching anymore for your expanded personality or its incarnations in the alluring personages that only stimulate your self-love. You are trying to attract the surrounding people with the sounds of the hornlet of the Eternal Beauty. These people aren't the strange forms for you, they are your brothers and sisters, the little parts of the Eternity, as you yourselves. You see the Eternity in them, you address Her, and no other uniting with them in the work of the theatre exists for you. Soon we'll be in Dartran's oasis again. What new will you be able to bring into your art, into the methods of your teaching? Your every word uttered for people before was only the word of your unselfish and friendly comfort for them. The "I" of every one of you prevailed in all your conversations, and it used to colour everything what you were telling the listeners with sadness, heartbreak and discontent, but what they didn't understand. You couldn't understand in any way that the real comfort – that's such power of courage, such absolute loyalty to the law of the accuracy of Eternity, with which joyfulness is growing and hardening. This joyfulness that is coming to man's consciousness as a harmonious Origin which has revived within him, may neither cease to burn nor weaken due to the stormy or terrible, sad or tormenting events of the moment of your experienced Eternity on the earth... Just a second – and man's incarnation is finished. And the man is unable to bring any corrections anymore to his passing by moment of Eternity. He has left his physical, earthly form and he cannot the remaining people with his courage anymore. I am not talking now about the exceptionally rare facts of the double life. I am talking about the mass phenomena, about the life of the ordinary forms of the earth, because you are walking down the path which leads you to be their servants. You've entered the completely new perception of your role on the earth through the usual expansion of your consciousness. Everyone who is walking as the herald of his Teacher by carrying any of his tasks is ascended above the level of his contemporaries by the whole amount of skills and psychic talents. But it doesn't mean that he is perfect and that he may not be wrong. It means that the path to those waves and vibrations is opened for his spirit, which majority of his encountered people may not reach. Externally you will be the same charming artists when both of you come back to your motherland after finishing your mission in Dartran's oasis. Few people will notice the big change that has happened within you. But now both of you will go out to the people through the completely different path, and they will perceive you differently. Your new spiritual path, that aspect of Life that has revived within you and that is invisible to them, will attract their attention, and your influence will be far greater than the previous one. The theatre for you now – that's not an idea of existence, but Life Himself. He is leading you into the people's hearts now, and with His openings you will convey the personages and epochs to the people on the theatre stage. Not your external forms will attract the spectators' hearts to you, but that living and powerful Love which

will gather all the hearts to her Light through you. Now you can see from your own living example of life, how the man's inner change is taking part within him. It was a long process for you, full of suffering. You had to go through and experience the whole suffering of the earth with your hearts. During long years you had to be the heralds of sadness, misfortunes and disasters for all your encountered people. Now you will be the messengers of Wisdom, and not a single of your encountered living beings will leave you not comforted, she will touch that Life that is operating through your talents. The law of Eternity is one for everybody: one moment – and man's incarnation is finished. The mission which the Bright Brotherhood entrusts you with is big. Not only don't waste your time in vain, but also even during each of the most insignificant visit or encounter don't step back from your main task: to awaken beauty within a man. It will be easy for you to work in the Dartran's oasis, because "the old man" has prepared the generation that is free from self-love and envy, from the tragic perception of the external destiny. A very big group is waiting for you there, which desires hotly to comprehend the path to the real art. You will come to the people as the scientists – researchers. They don't understand the incentives of the glory, they don't take offence for the "small" roles and for the desire to have the priority with "big" roles. You will be instantly leading the people who are free inside to that joy of creation that has revived within you as the aspect of Life. This inner freedom of theirs will help them not only unite with you in work and creation unselfishly, but also to awaken the living creative Power within every one of them. But when you come back to America, your new inner condition will suffer very much not only because of the wave of the people's emanations. Your physical conductors with the subtle and sharpened nerves, with the whole row of the new brain opened for the action and the nerve-knots will react painfully to the rough surroundings which you could bear rather easily before. In order for your physical and spiritual suffering to diminish to the minimum and not to disturb your work, you must harden your organisms by using the system of the constant physical and spiritual exercises. For that you need an earthly guide. That's why Yassa will go with you, for whom both of you are indebted a lot. I can see in your thoughts together with great gratitude for Yassa also the great sympathy, because he will have to leave me and to live in the difficult, thick atmosphere full of passions next to you, in the noise of the cities. Don't feel sorry for Yassa. Every brother who is walking down the path of fulfilling the tasks of the Bright Brotherhood is living joyfully and willingly there and in such a way as it is necessary for the whole Brotherhood and as his closest Teacher and guardian sees it. Yassa's path will be easy for him, which would be unbearable for you, that's why you feel sorry for him, while he is smiling and rejoicing. Start hardening and habituating yourselves already now, immediately. From this moment on you become Yassa's disciples, you fulfil all his instructions in such a way, as if I was standing next to you, and the whole goal and meaning of the flying past "now" was concentrated on it."

Bronski and Igor stood up, bowed to I. and went up to Yassa by bowing low to him. Smiling Yassa stood up, he also bowed to them low and addressed I.

"Teacher, bless us to fulfil your assignment with the greatest diligence and selflessness, and some time to come back to you again, to your wise leadership."

"Amen, Yassa, be their guardian as I was the one for you, if you think that I was your good guardian."

I. stood up and bowed to all three our friends, united for one goal.

"I still wanted to add several words. In the night we leave for the oasis of the dark-skinned people. The goal of our journey – that's not only the glass factory where they produce unbreakable and coloured glass according to Gregor's and Vasiliyon's discovered system, but also the dark-skinned people of the oasis whom you need to see in order for you to understand their infinite wisdom with which the eternal evolution of mankind is walking down its path. You also will see how Life Himself prepares the levels of the higher development of each human branch by overcoming the element there and in such a way as He sees

it. This tribe stuns everybody who visit them for the first time with their quietism, calm and love for people. There are neither illiterate nor poor people in the oasis. They don't possess any property and they are free from many personal passions which oppress the nations of Europe and America which consider their culture to be the most advanced. Radanda is taking care of and observing these dark-skinned people for long years. That's he and his Community have prepared that small oasis to which you will be travelling now for this not numerous tribe's life. A question flashed for each of you: who are those people whom Radanda was and still is taking care of? Life Himself is taking care of them through Radanda. They are emigrants from the secret Community. Their forefathers were living there for many years. Compassionate and powerful Ali hid them there, who was fighting against the dark occultists, from the power of whom he snatched those miserable people. Ali set the task for Radanda to prepare an oasis in the desert, close to his Community, he showed the underground water source to him, which was suitable for people, plants and animals, - and well, tomorrow you will see what a man's love could do, what Radanda's love turned the desert into and the souls of the ordinary people. Now all of you may go to do your work till the very supper. Only Lyovushka, Nataliya Vladimirovna and you, mister Oldenkot, stay."

I. smiled to Yassa and his new disciples, then together with us and Radanda he went to that room with the balcony where he was already talking to us one night. He left Nataliya and Oldenkot here by asking them to wait for him and promising them to come back soon, while he told to me to go together with him and Radanda.

We crossed several rooms which looked like small studies, furnished with bookcases and scrolls of manuscripts. Two or three people were sitting in them, and even more in some of them. No one from them stopped their work or paid any attention to us. Capacity of this house surprised me. The rooms were rather small, but there were so many of them! Probably it would be very difficult to orient here without any attendant. Finally, we went out to the very long corridor in which one could see many doors from both its sides. I thought that it was a later construction, because palm timber shining here with such newness, cleanness and brightness.

Having stopped by one of the doors, Radanda knocked three times at it, and a woman with the white headscarf and white clothes went out of the room. I recognized lady Berdran instantly. My lips as though themselves smiled merrily instantly.

"Let's go, sister Gerda," Radanda said to her. "One mother and her child need you very much today. Only your patience, your precisely fulfilled instructions and your kindness may help the child to recover soon, and most importantly, to show to his mother an example of complete loyalty and courage. The child will survive, but his mother stopped believing in it and therefore, not only she cannot quicken his recovery, but she hinders it with her entire behaviour. We need to divert her from her direct influence for her son, but in such a way that no new wound would open in the already wounded mother's heart. You, my clear head, will be able to do it," Radanda was talking by stroking sister Gerda's head tenderly and, having pointed at my smiling face, he added, "while Lyovushka here can't wait when he can squeeze your hand. First maybe you speak to him, while we with I. will visit another room."

We with Gerda sat down on the palm-tree sofa. I wanted to ask her how she was going on, but Gerda didn't allow me to utter a single word, she was only pouring the phrases which at first sight looked disconnected, but I could understand their deepest meaning perfectly.

"Lyovushka, no miracles exist in the world, and I understood it here through work. Also, I understood this: when man's heart opens as the most ordinary and slightest kindness, then even the most daily life becomes the miracle, song, joy, because not just a heart is beating in his chest, but a hammer is thumping in some bottomless, radiating bag. Whatever you would put into it, the bag becomes always wider... It seems that today you've already achieved some limit of your perception, but when you wake up

in the morning – nothing from yesterday is left, everything is new, everything is easy what seemed to be impossible not so long ago. In the beginning as though I was solving the mathematics tasks, and I was thinking every day: how should I approach man? How to pour my heart's kindness onto him? Now everything is working easily when I don't think anymore, but simply I am doing the most ordinary work for a man, without even thinking what deep inside of him is, but only by calling Radanda's image for help, and I behave as my heart tells me to do. An attack of sadness started not so long ago for me, and it always seemed to me that I was doing a little and that I couldn't do anything. Then I remembered how you were reading I.'s given book to me. You read it till that place where he told you to stop, and later nobody could force you to read at least one more page, even if you were crucified. As soon as I remembered it, I understood that I wanted to open the page of the book of my life before the time for which I haven't yet matured. I gave a smile, I thought about your loyalty, and my sadness was gone as the melted hoarfrost... Lyovushka, but how you've grown! My God, how everything is going to end? And how handsome you are – you are never tired of looking at you! Where did that ragamuffin disappear whom we with Andreyeva met by the bathing place? Just like in the fairy-tale! But what am I talking here? My own life – that's the most real fairy-tale, isn't it!?"

In this way I didn't have time to answer Gerda anything, because exactly in that moment when she finished her disconnected tirade with her merry laughter, I saw I. with Radanda in the end of the corridor, and we rose to meet them.

"Well, Lyovushka, you probably didn't have time to utter a single word?" I. smiled. "Don't be ashamed, Gerda. It is useful for him to be silent for a while. He will have to talk so much during his life that every minute of silence will be as precious as the dearest pearl for him. I think that he understood everything what you told him, even if your words didn't express your thoughts absolutely precisely. But now we will visit the woman who was suffering very much namely because there was too little precision in her actions, work and deeds. You will experience the double lesson by communicating with her and her son. Not only you will become help for her, but also she will be help and a great lesson for you. Next to her you will have to always reconsider and observe attentively your every uttered word. There are some people around whom their suffering gathers in a high wall. There are lots of such people, and it is very difficult to communicate with them. But also there are such people among them, the walls of their suffering are poked with their irritability and imprecision of their thoughts as pins. Their thoughts are jumping one over another one in these walls. Abandoned and distorted they get stiff as the stalactites by not allowing the spirit of the victim to escape their own created prison. You will always need to train the woman to answer your questions as precisely as possible with an absolute precision of your own thoughts, as well as with the harmony of your spiritual and creative impulses. Try to do it in such a way that a belief would take root inside of her that she needs to go through each "now" with the whole completeness of her feelings and thoughts, so that the new feeling wouldn't drown the previous one which is still not experienced. Direct her thoughts from her son and his illness to the optimism which she lacks so much, with which she covered him during his childhood, show the entire her own melancholy to her, in which she forces her son to live now. Let's go. The optimism that is gushing from you now will help to destroy all the invisible walls among which the miserable woman is sitting like in a prison."

I. was speaking to Gerda by one wide window of the corridor which was tangled with the blooming roses so much that not even the sunlight could penetrate through it. Having exchanged joyous looks with Gerda, as though both of us together would be going to fulfil the task given to her, we hurried after our guardians who turned to another wide corridor where there were many more doors, so probably the rooms here were smaller. Radanda knocked at one of the doors. An elderly man with the white robe, a doctor as I understood, opened the door. His kind and pleasant face was worried.

"Here, I brought the sister for the sick boy, for whom you doctor were asking. Don't worry," Radanda uttered by seeing how the doctor's face got irritated. "The sister is young, but she is experienced and not light-minded. We all drop in briefly, and certainly, we won't wake up the sleeping boy."

"Sleeping? If he, so unusually agitated would succeed to take a nap now, then we could think about his salvation. But unfortunately, I was taking pains over him for three hours, so that I could calm him down at least a little, and I left disappointed, because I didn't manage to change anything."

"Anyway, doctor, your efforts, although not so fast, but gave some desired results. The boy fell asleep, and you may already not worry about his life," smiling Radanda interrupted the doctor.

"But when could he fall asleep, father Radanda?" the doctor gave a shout. "I have just left from there and I got completely nervous that for the first time during many years my medicine which I considered to be reliable didn't help the man. Also, my conscience torments me, because I forced my company upon you by insisting that I could be of use for you. And here's the misfortune in this case."

"Calm down, doctor. I already told you that the boy is sleeping. You may make sure of it yourself. This is that doctor about whom I was telling you, Teacher I., and for you, doctor, I was telling about Teacher I. as the incomparable specialist. We will visit the boy, and Teacher I. will explain to you in detail what regime you will have to apply for the patient."

"Regime? Miracles! If in this hour of the fight between life and death, when death already almost won, we can still talk about the patient's regime, then Teacher I. must be incomparable doctor who is like God."

Having looked at I.'s face attentively, the doctor continued in a much more silent voice and in a calmer way already.

"Who had the luck to look at your face, Teacher I., that one needs only to follow you, although he would know so little about you, to be precise, nothing, as me."

"All right, all right, doctor, enough talking, come with me and you will find not miracles, but the path full of new knowledge," I. told him by squeezing doctor's hand, smiling him and taking the first step into the room.

When we went up to the boy's bed, I saw weeping, unfortunate Ariadna with her head buried on the son's pillow by the other side of the bed. Broken-down with her pain she couldn't hear and see anybody, while her lament was breaking Gerda's heart who was looking at I. pleadingly with her clenched fists. He nodded his head for her, and Gerda went down on her knees next to Ariadna in a flash.

"You cannot disturb your sleeping son so much," Gerda embraced the mother tenderly and said to her.

"He is dead, he is dead!" a moan escaped Ariadna's heart, like a scream of a deadly injured living being.

"Calm down, he is sleeping," Gerda uttered in a commanding way. "Take his hand. Do you feel the warmth? You don't love your son if you are screaming like this next to his bed. Stand up, come to yourself, look round, who's come to this room," Gerda continued by trying to lift the kneeling Ariadna and tidying her loose plait.

"Teacher I.," Ariadna came to herself and whispered. "Teacher I., I didn't learn the lesson given to me again."

"You will speak to Teacher later, now step aside and don't disturb your son to come back to life," Radanda said to Ariadna by showing the sign to Gerda to take the mother to the window.

I. was looking at the sleeping boy in silence for a rather long time. In the beginning it seemed to me that the little one was sleeping calmly, but having looked more attentively, I noticed how time after time the boy's chest was heaving with difficulty, how the veins on his neck and temples were throbbing. Finally, I. took a small box out of his pocket, he took a small bottle out of it with bright red, as though boiling liquid, he told me to lift the boy's head slightly, and as soon as I made his mouth open, he poured a drop of the liquid into the boy's mouth. The boy gave a sudden start with his entire body, while I almost let him go from my arms, because I didn't expect such a sudden move and I was only holding his body lightly. I was so scared that only with my new power of Goliath I was able to put his little, lean body in the bed.

"When you are by the patient's bed, you always need to be prepared for all sorts of surprises and to be very vigilant. Remember it, Lyovushka."

Then I. addressed the doctor, and he told him by showing to him the motionless, as if fainted away boy.

"The medicine, one drop which I now poured into the patient's mouth, as you could see yourself, renews all the cells of the organism that the man as though is reborn for the new life. Usually, the influence of this medicine reveals itself already in three days. But in this case when we also need to defeat the negative influence of your given medicine to him, the organism will renew slower. After the usual three days in such cases the patient will need to stay for two more days in bed, in order to defeat the poison that spread in his whole organism from your injections. While watching this case, memorize that you cannot do any injections at all for the people with a more sensitive nervous system, who are inclined to higher consciousness, that is to the development of the higher psychic powers. And especially as your injections, with such amount of albumen which may deadly poison some organisms. Exactly that would have happened now with this boy if my medicine hadn't come for help. Radanda warned you to keep from injections, and you didn't listen to him..."

The conversation was in Latin, probably in order for the unfortunate mother, who was staring at the talking doctor and I., not to understand the seriousness of her son's condition.

"As soon as I came in, I understood instantly that the boy's goose was already cooked. But now when you, Teacher, say that the boy will sleep during these days and comes back to life again from one drop of the red liquid, I would like to get this bottle from you and to analyse this red miracle of yours."

"Unfortunately, my red miracle, in order for it to be really miraculous, requires not only physical analysis, not only the eyes that can see physical items, but also an inner spiritual power that gives birth to the psychic sight which can see and evaluate not only the illness itself, but the whole patient's organism. You are trying to cure the illness, but you need to cure the patient, with which the most progressive representatives of the science of medicine agree a long time ago already. Besides, the miracles exist only for the ignorant consciousness. Don't be offended, doctor. No limits exist for the man's development and his knowledge. And that one who is wise man according to the minds of the earth is only the one who starts learning in opinion of the men of wisdom of the universe. I told you that you may follow me if you want to, and you will find knowledge."

"I want to follow you, Teacher I., and absolutely not in order to acquire some knowledge from my field. It seems to me that for the first time in my life I understood what God was not only through the scientific methods of compassionate people's salvation. He is also in man. I don't know if He is in every

man, but that He is within you, I can feel it with my every nerve, and... for the first time I, haughty person, bow to God within man, to be precise, to Godman!"

The doctor's voice trembled, tears sparkled in his eyes which were looking strictly in the beginning, and now he seemed to be completely confused.

"Let's go with us, doctor. You have nothing to do here for a while. Later the mother will be waiting for you, to whom I will give my medicine through you and who we will have to cure by using some physical methods. But you will have to observe that regime which I will prescribe for her strictly. I will tell you about her son later. I will send an experienced male nurse to him, who will be nursing him together with Radanda's brought nurse. You, Lyovushka, stay here until Nikita changes you. As soon as he comes, hurry up to me, he will tell you where you can find me. Now stay here alone and put the compresses with this liquid on the patient's head."

I. gave the bottle to me and addressed Ariadna.

"You will go with us, Ariadna, and you will see your son only when he is completely recovered. When I was talking to you for the last time, you promised me and yourself that you would be wise and courageous, that you would accept your inner and external destiny calmly. You had already started living in Eternity, but with your first test which the Great Mother sent to you, you – mother – showed your weakness and not your heroism. If you could find neither courage nor self-sacrifice in order not to think about yourself, but to help your son to go through the moment of Eternity, at least now try to find the most ordinary kindness for your son and not disturb the calm which not only his body needs, but, and that is much more important, also his spirit. Try to understand how your passionate disappointment prevents him from recovering, and don't delay his recovery. Besides, both you and he aren't destined to live your entire life here. Therefore, learn and understand from this case when your spirit's weakness broke through for you unexpectedly – how shallow your achieved self-control was, not speaking about harmony. In order for you to be prepared to lead your son to the wide world, to have the strength to protect his ability to work and joy, you need to become strong and optimistic yourself, the living being who doesn't lose her self-control under any circumstances. Start training an absolute self-control and only then you will be able to help your son to prepare for his life. Try to become a valuable, industrious and efficient living being. Life – that's a fight. That's an eternal work and eternal fight. Go and start your self-education. I give a lesson for your loyalty: not a single question about your son till that hour when I send Lyovushka to you. The sooner your loyalty becomes stronger and deeper, the faster your son will recover."

The room became empty, and I remained alone by the patient's bed. I prepared I.'s given liquid as he told me to immediately, I found a wide, linen bandage and began to put the cooling compresses on the boy's head. I was surprised that the cold liquid that didn't grow warm at least a little while standing in the dish with water, and on the contrary, that as though was getting colder even more, used to grow warm on the boy's head in a flash. I imagined that I would need to change the compresses only now and then, but actually, I had to work quickly, because as soon as I used to put one of the compresses, it would grow warm immediately, and I had to put on another one quickly. I was ready to reflect on many things, but I saw that I needed to concentrate seriously on the job entrusted to me. I damped the patient's pillowcase unintentionally and I wanted to change the pillow, but when I already wanted to lift his head, I noticed the spasms on his face. So I had only to cover the wet spot with the towel with some difficulty and to tell myself that I was a poor trained nurse.

Having refused the pleasure to think about something, except my direct job, I was unable to comprehend at all how much time had passed when a light knock at the door was heard, and Nikita entered the room.

“Go, Lyovushka, I. is waiting for you in Radanda’s balcony. First of all, he told you to go to the shower, to wash your hands with this liquid and to change your clothes. I. thought that you would be all dirty, because he forgot to warn you that this liquid left yellow stains, but it washed off easily.”

Nikita gave a gentle smile when he noticed how I became embarrassed when I saw the yellow stains on my hands and clothes. Having interrogated everything about the way to I., I said good-bye to Nikita, and I was trying to go to the shower unnoticed. Having washed myself cleanly, I hurried to Radanda’s balcony. I. was already here. He was holding two big packets in his hands, and apparently, he had just come, because Oldenkot offered an armchair to him. I. sat down, he gave the packets to me by saying that I had to give them to Yassa, and he addressed Andreyeva and Oldenkot by smiling who were waiting for him.

“I detained you for an inexcusably long time, but I hope that both of you understood that only very important and unforeseen circumstances could force me to be not punctual. Today, last time before you leave to the world for the second time with the same mission, I want to talk about that what you will need to pay your attention to in your future work. During that time which passed since your first journey till this day, both of you have developed so much that all your experienced suffering, misfortunes and disagreements with people which made you so sad in your previous work, today look not like misfortunes, but like some childish misunderstandings. But, not only you have developed and changed. Also, the people among whom you were working were growing from your work, however those little parts of the Truth seemed to you, which you would open and leave for people. It is unimportant what and how people were thinking about you while you were living and working among them. It is important that the work as the result of your unselfish labour has taken root. It has taken a strong root, despite its absolute newness and inadequacy to the general mind of the current time. It has taken root and embraced the people’s hearts and minds in such a way that the people cannot live anymore without the new ideas that you have brought to them. If also the rest of the qualities of your character in every one of you – and most importantly, your self-control – would be developed in the same entire way as your loyalty, then now you wouldn’t need to leave with the same mission to people again. By doing everything in order to unite people, to destroy the partitions of conditionalities among them and to pour Love glue into their communication, you left not an entire, monolithic kernel melted in the Only One axis after you, but the whole net of little groups which are fighting for the truth and erring in their own way, because the personal perception of the Truth is the most important among all their superstitions. Your lack of absolute self-control gave the beginning for this separation. Now for you who have grown, become stronger and liberated as much that you’ve found reconciliation, the most important must be not the Truth itself, but the net of the paths which leads and directs people to it. Now you will have not to defend the Truth among people, but to create such circumstances for them, which would help everybody to concentrate their attention on self-education and education of each encountered person – it doesn’t matter of a grown-up or a child – with your own example, that is to show the first path to the Truth, to liberate oneself. Now both of you are strong not only with your loyalty, but also with the trust in the only one effective form of the influence for your encountered person: to see the Eternity within him, to address Him and to call Him to life. That doesn’t mean that you are going to be occupied with the propaganda of the ideas of the Eternity among the little or average cultured people. That means only that by overcoming your fears you will be communicating with the Eternal within a man and not with his visible form. You failed to work by feeling the constant presence of your Teacher during the first task of your mission. You were working with your Teacher inside of his protective circle, but when you were resting, you used to step back from his will. Now you’ve learned to remain in the vibrations of the Bright Brotherhood not only when you are working, but also when you are resting. Your entire life has become an inseparable existence with Them, and it is impossible to distinguish or perceive anymore where your “I” or “not I” is, because everything – whatever and however you are doing – everything is only the paths of your Teachers towards the Only One in your

encounters. You and the Bright Brotherhood – is one body, one breathing, one path. The eternity has imbibed your whole brutality and returned all your former talents to you, because the heroic strain of the spirit stopped being only some separate outbursts of your creation, it has become the constant atmosphere of your work. Go cheerfully and never experience any doubts. You won't experience them, and those who will follow you won't break up into small groups, but they will be living as one free, joyous whole. Now there's not so much time left anymore till you leave for the desert. The bell is inviting for the supper. Go to bed immediately after supper. Yassa will wake you up and he will explain to you how each of you should dress."

All of us together went to the dining-room where we met the rest inhabitants of our house. After the supper I ordered everybody again to go to bed immediately and to rest calmly until Yassa told to get up.

I was very sorry that I couldn't help Yassa to prepare the outfit for everybody, but he smiled and answered me that Gregor and Vasilyon, the own people in the oasis of the dark-skinned, had done more than a half of the work for him.

Having taken my dear Eta whom I saw so little today and who was already waiting for me at Mulga's, I thought sadly that the poor bird would be missing me tomorrow even more. As though by understanding my thoughts, Eta rubbed to my leg, he lifted his beautiful head high and he was walking dignified next to me, as if by showing to me how his courage and strength had grown.

Having entered my wonderful, silent cell, I was asking the Great Mother for the blessing for all my today's encountered people, for all crying and rejoicing in the entire universe, and I fell asleep instantly next to Eta.

I woke up not from Yassa's knocking, but from Eta's tugging, whose sensitiveness had grown extremely from his close friendship with Radanda. I understood that Eta wanted to tell me that Yassa was coming. And really, a light knock at the door was heard soon, and when I opened it, two figures were standing before me. One of them, - although his clothes had changed his appearance, - I recognized him immediately: that was Yassa, while the other one... Only when I took a good look at him, I guessed that - it was Slava whom his costume changed beyond recognition. He gave a bundle of clothes to me, which seemed to be heavy by appearance. He was smiling that his appearance surprised me so much. Yassa extended a bottle full of some liquid by saying to me.

"Don't go to the shower, but rub your body with this liquid, Lyovushka. Moisten a sponge with it and rub yourself strongly with it. Only don't forget that your strength is like the one of a Goliath, work carefully. What would seem to be strong for normal people, it may seem like a completely weak action for you."

"Well, Yassa, you exaggerate here. I was holding the boy so weakly yesterday that I almost dropped him when he gave a start suddenly. So, my "weak" and "strong" are no more and no less than the normal ones."

"Not your strength was to blame, but the lack of your deftness and attention. Today you will have an opportunity to observe a very difficult work, and these people will look like strong men to you. But actually, their deftness and attention serve as strength for them, and they aren't as strong as many other people."

Yassa sent Slava to Bronski and Igor with the same liquid which he gave to me by telling him to help them rub their bodies and dress, and he said to me.

"Well, Lyovushka, the nurse Yassa will help you to rub yourself and dress by our old acquaintance," and he began to rub me instantly, while I was joking that probably one could attribute his "strong" only to the dictionary of the Goliath.

Soon I was ready, and to my great joy, all Slava's brought clothes and high, laced boots were light, pleasant, made of light and dense silk. Only the big, green cloak was heavy, which Yassa told me to take in my arms. Looking like this and also with helmets on our heads we went out to the hall. Still nobody was here. Without wasting the time in vain, Yassa gave his helmet and cloak to me to hold, he told me to wait for him here and he ran upstairs. Bronski, Igor and Slava went downstairs in several minutes, then Oldenkot showed up by saying that it wasn't easy for him to settle with his new clothes, while Nataliya and Yassa still wasn't here. I was afraid that I. had to come soon and that our friends would be late. I didn't doubt that Yassa ran to Andreyeva who was out of luck with something. I was feeling like running to help him very much. But soon I remembered what Yassa was telling me about deftness with which I distinguished myself by the patient's bed. I gave a sigh when I understood that I wouldn't help much, I sent help to Nataliya Vladimirovna in my thoughts, and I addressed the Great Mother from the bottom of my heart by asking her to bless all of us before our upcoming road.

Finally, hasty steps were heard, Nataliya with Yassa went downstairs to the hall, and the elegant I.'s figure appeared after them. Having stopped before Andreyeva, he looked at her eyes and uttered silently.

"How do you think, dear, if Ali had needed you tonight, wouldn't he find a better way to tell you how to force you to violate my given command and to leave you without sleep namely when you need to concentrate all your physical strengths, so that the weakness of your body wouldn't prevent you from doing your future work? I warned you and Oldenkot that you would need to devote more strengths and attention than others in the oasis of the dark-skinned people. I was hoping to prepare you for the meeting with new people during the journey, the part of whom you will have to take from here to America and to send them to the new Florentian's Community. And since you weren't sleeping when I told you to, and you fell asleep when you already needed to get up, you won't be able to hear me out with the necessary attention and to memorize precisely everything that I must tell you. Therefore, we'll have to delay the whole hour when we come to the oasis, so that I could talk to you. Now you won't be riding on the camel, but you will be sleeping in a special, little cage for women until you are awakened. Hasn't the work of Ali and others with you that continued for so many years taught you yet to fulfil the received instructions precisely, and not to correct them as it seems to you? Avoid violating the accuracy of the instructions given to you in the future. That could cause the whole catastrophe personally for you and to incur big loses for the entire Bright Brotherhood."

I. went forward, we all followed him. I couldn't see Nataliya's face in the dark, but from her hung head, her heavy breathing and uneven walk I could imagine how her heart was breaking from this shoot wide of the mark. Oldenkot was walking next to me, and I could feel the depth of his sympathy and anxiety for his loyal friend. With my new ability to see some of the scenes from the past, I understood that the noble man was persuading Andreyeva to obey I.'s instruction and to go to sleep, but she was insisting with persistence that she surely knew that namely this night Ali would be talking to her.

We were walking in silence for some time by giving way to the sadness of one of us, but I. stopped us without coming to the dining-room and told us.

"My friends, I've told you many times that all people are connected one with another with the invisible threads of love. I understand that you feel sorry one for another in their misfortunes, you rejoice at your friend's happiness, but to feel for somebody – does it mean that you need to be filled with sadness? It means that you need to love one another in such a way that the whole cheerfulness of your

heart would weave the protective net around her. Join the joy together with me, so that we would have the opportunity to carry our doubled energy into the day's work and to take out our friend's mistakes on our shoulders. We will shorten the time of eating, the time of sitting on camels, we won't visit the hermits, the original way of their living I wanted to show to you, - and we will save as much time as I will need it for my conversation. Easier, simpler, higher, merrier, without any gloomy faces and heavy sighs."

The cleaning wave of I's energy ran through us, and we entered easily the well-known little yard of the dining-room where Radanda was already waiting for us. We ate quickly and went out to the clearing to which I. had already told to bring camels. First, they brought a big camel with the big cage covered with canopies for Nataliya Vladimirovna. In this moment I could read a lot in her soul. She was always condemning weakness, so much she didn't like travelling in the way of the eastern harem, and now she had to climb up the ladder into this nest and sit separately from us!

"It's nothing, my friend," I heard the tender Radanda's voice. "The lion always remains the lion, even if you put him in the hare's cage! You are lioness. You were, you are, and you will be one. But, while you are living on the earth, you need to observe the laws of the earth: to eat, to sleep and to take care of your physical conductor in such a way that you would always be capable of working. The lion may defend himself against mosquitos with his claws. But only then the lion may live in the brotherly family of the Bright Brotherhood when he finds joy to obey that one whom the lion's heart has recognized to be his Teacher and master instead of his stubborn lion's will. Such obedience is the sign of liberation from the oppressing clutches of one's own personality... Here's a sweet for you, my dear. You haven't yet seen such one till now. It will bring calm for your heart immediately and sleep for your body. Well, climb up merrier. You see, everybody is already sitting in their saddles and cover themselves with cloaks, while you won't need it. They will let down the curtain - and you may sleep."

Nataliya Vladimirovna climbed up into her tower easily, a young brother sat down on the very small saddle almost on the camel's neck. Unexpectedly, I recognized that that brother was Slava. When I. gave a sign, he urged his camel and rode away in front of the group towards the gates of the desert. The last ones whom I could see in the darkness of the dawn were Radanda with Eta on his shoulder who were sending regards of their farewell to me.

We were riding across the desert for several hours already. The sun rose, and my skin must have been burnt if I hadn't the big, thick cloak through which even the sun of the desert didn't burn. My body rubbed with I.'s liquid almost didn't feel any heat under the cloak into which Yassa had swaddled me like a mummy. Only I. was riding without any cover, only with the net of his helmet lowered, so that it would protect his eyes from the unbearable shining sun and the sand. Nowhere, as far as my eyes could take in, I could see anything except the sun and the sand. I remembered I.'s words about what Radanda's love had done to the people from this sea of death and sand entrusted to him, which was scorching any life.

The questions that were often flashing in my head like a whirl began to turn: who was that Radanda? How old was he? For how long was he in the Community? Who was its first creator? All these questions rose absolutely not from curiosity to me. They were so unclear to me that I could comprehend clearly how little I still knew and understood if I could see hundreds of riddles in one man.

My thoughts flew back to Ali, to everything that I had experienced from my first meeting him, - from the wonderful Nal's face up to this moment. Nal was the first woman who was seen off to the wide world in my presence. I remembered how Beata left the Community, how I was accompanying her across the desert in my thoughts. How much poetry, beauty, the art this woman was carrying with herself! And again, that same great, mysterious I. who enriched all his encountered people with his presence

returned her to the world liberated, energetic, with huge inner treasures with comparison to that poverty of spirit in which she was living until meeting him.

And now again, the woman is travelling in front of the caravan whom the same I. returns to the world, and he gives the mission to her to carry the great Light to people, but in the completely different way, in the way of clairvoyance and knowledge of the powers of the higher consciousness within herself and her encountered people. And Bronski, And Andreyeva, and Oldenkot, and professor, and thousands of other people whom I didn't know, leave to create in the world through the most different ways of the spirit of the man, accompanied by the same I., Ali, Radanda. Oh, Great Mother, enlighten my spirit, who is I.? Who is I., next to whom I am living my every day? Man-God, as the doctor told yesterday?"

I understood even deeper that although I was absolutely changed, but I was always the servant who could only clean dust from the most expensive books, but who was unable to read anything, even the titles from the greatest treasures of the man's spirit. In the same way I was before I. I could clean his sandals and sort his letters by date, but I could answer only this to the question who I. was: extremely compassionate friend of every man. That was all my knowledge about I.

"And who are you, Lyovushka, can you answer me?" I heard the merry I.'s voice next to me.

It turned out that I was so immersed in my reflections that I became the well-known Lyovushka, the Catcher of Crows. By using such absent-mindedness of mine, my camel lagged from others at quite a big distance.

"Not so long ago, my dear boy, you made sure by the bed of another boy how it was necessary to concentrate your entire attention and to be prepared for the surprises of the passing by hour. A little bit earlier you were trying to concentrate your attention on two jobs at the same time. And you took away the experience in both cases: what a persistence and self-control your attention required," I. continued by forcing my camel to start galloping and to catch up with the caravan. "In this moment you can see again that the cause of everything – that's your scattered attention, or more precisely, your one-sided concentration that didn't embrace anything more except the thoughts which interested you. Every man is composed of spiritual and physical powers, and while he is living on the earth, he must live in the equilibrium of these powers by never jumping into one or another of these worlds till the end and by always keeping harmony between them. The disciple who has comprehended firmly that he is living not only on the earth, but in the two worlds, that he is carrier of the two worlds – the one of his personality and individuality – must create, develop and harden the habit to always remember about the life in two worlds in every moment. Only then the disciple's loyalty may bring him into the unbroken merging with his Teacher when his attention, that is alfa and omega of his eternal life and work, will get accustomed to act in such a way that his division between the heaven and the earth won't require any efforts anymore. So that the question: "Did I do it rightly?" would rise not after his act, but the shining image of his Teacher would be standing next to the disciple before his act, as the control and joy of his actions. The people who are living with the earthly worries, who judge about everything only through the net of their superstitions and conditionalities, in this hour would consider your absent-mindedness as the great concentration, as the honourable quality which not many possess, the external absent-mindedness is often considered even as one of the signs of the great mind. While actually, it is only the embryo of one's self-discipline. The absent-minded disciple – that's the lamp, which is blinking unbearably, which prevents both Teacher from sending the Light to people and people from accepting it through such conductors. Unfortunately, Teachers must fulfil even very high tasks through such lamps blinking and lighting again, they must always adjust their actions. My friend, try to get rid of this blinking as fast as possible. You understand how it delays the Teacher's work, don't you? You possess everything, so that you could accelerate the process of your inner growth. Only never forget: nobody can do your spiritual work, except yourself. You've read about it from

the first fiery records, and this is the principal laws of the Whole Life. Neither the high, powerful friends, nor the Great Mother Herself may do that work of love and calm for you which defines the place of every man in the universe. Those compassionate ones who have forgotten about themselves and who are working only for the people's welfare may show the path for you. But only you yourself may walk it down."

We caught up with our friends, and... I couldn't understand in any way what was before us. A wall? Both the wall and not the wall. It looked like a big, green wall, like in the French parks, but it was as high as the highest tree. When we rode up closer, I saw that the wall was grown from the crosswise intertwined trunks which were strewn with long, sharp thorns. And as far as my look could see through this tangle of the thorny trunks, only the same dense tangle was everywhere, so that not only the beasts of the desert, but also the birds could get inside.

The higher the trunks rose, the thinner the tangle was, and at the top they not only became straight, but they were all strewn with red and white blossoms which looked like the ones of the hawthorn, only they were bigger. I was looking at this beauty amazed, and to I.'s look and smile to me I could only answer him.

"This is what Radanda's love could do!"

I wanted to bow till the ground to the green wall by greeting this gift of Radanda's love and by estimating his work not as an expression of human, but divine powers...

We were riding along the wall for several minutes and we rode up to the high gates which were painted in green and grown from the same thorny trunks, but in such a masterly fashion that it was difficult to see them instantly. Two gatekeepers opened the gates for us – they were young, slender, tall and handsome. They were dressed in an original way: they were wearing white shorts almost till their knees and the tunic without any sleeves, fastened to them through their body; they were almost barefoot, they were wearing only sandals with one big toe and short counter for the protection from the hot sand. One of the gatekeepers blew a horn, a very pleasant sound, most likely an uncommon signal, was heard, because people came hurriedly to us from all sides to help us to dismount the camels.

By thinking that the strange people's help will not be very pleasant for Nataliya Vladimirovna, I jumped down from my tall camel by surprising and fascinating everybody who had gathered to help me to dismount him quite a lot by doing so.

However I was hurrying, but when I ran to Nataliya Vladimirovna's camel who was always going in front of the caravan, dear Yassa was already here, the ladder was already placed, and the clumsy Nataliya's figure was already climbing down. I wanted to express my love to her somehow, and when she climbed a little down and when I already could reach her with my arms, I took and put her on the ground in a flash. That aroused a wild rejoicing of the entire crowd of the spectators, and the merry laughter of the victim of my love herself.

I understood the language in which the people around me were speaking, I learned it in the Community as I. had told me, but I thought that it was the language of an ancient tribe that had died a long time ago, and I really didn't expect that I would see the alive people speaking in it.

All kind of people, old, young and children were in the crowd that had gathered around me. All of them, independent of their age and sex, were dressed in the same way, like the gatekeepers whom we saw already. Only elderly women had tunics reaching their shins thrown on themselves. Everybody's skin was dark, but really not brown, it had a bright hue. Everyone had regular features, you could feel the culture and nobleness in them. The form of their eyes and eyebrows was beautiful. I paid my attention to their small, very white teeth.

As soon as we could recover from our first impression, we saw a tall, very slender, elderly, but looking young woman coming to I. She was wearing a white dress, girded with a long, silky ropelet. The sleeves and the bottom of the dress were bordered with black, wide bands, embroidered in gold. The woman's appearance, except her slenderness and very light step, was nothing out of the way, but benevolence of her face, kindness of her smile and radiance of her eyes were so unusual that I could compare her only with Radanda.

Having approached I. and greeted him with a low bow, the woman began to speak. My God! Where could I hear this wonderful voice of the low contralto? I was so surprised that I forgot about everything in the world and "I was catching crows" by trying to remember where I could hear this voice. I've heard it, I've really heard it. And suddenly, Anna came out in my memory like alive – and I gave a shout without comprehending anything: "Anna!" The woman gave a start from my voice, she looked round and went up to me.

"Yes, I am Anna, my friend. But how could you know my old name by which nobody calls me anymore?"

The music of her voice carried me to Constantinople, to the Anna's sitting-room, I saw her and Ananda by the grand piano, I remembered their songs... I was unable to utter a single word, I didn't have any strength to answer her, although I comprehended well all my impoliteness and bad behaviour.

"Mother, forgive my secretary for his absent-mindedness," I. uttered by approaching us and putting his hand on my shoulder. "You can see not for the first time how people cannot remain calm when they hear your enchanting voice which is like nothing nearly in the entire world. We met your great-granddaughter in Constantinople, about whom Ananda was writing to you. Her voice is very similar to yours. That was her name which my enthusiast-secretary exclaimed. Allow me to introduce him to you, his name is Lyovushka. Pardon him for his poor self-control and accept him into your wide heart."

When I bowed to the wide, but charming hand of the one whom I. called "mother", she embraced my head and kissed my temple. I felt the entire stream of tender love that was flowing to me from this woman. She covered me with her love like with a harmonious circle.

"My child, if your heart was sending love to Anna, if you admired her so much that you were even touched by the resemblance of our voices, then what else except gratitude I can feel to you for your devotion to my great-granddaughter? Ananda wrote to me that you, great Teacher, would bring her together with yourself. Then where is Anna?" mother was speaking by holding my hand, stroking it and comforting me by doing so.

"Mother, later about it. I didn't plan to begin my conversation with you about it immediately. But... due to some new instructions which I received on our way here, today we won't come back to Radanda, but we'll be living in your place for at least three days. We'll still have time to talk about Anna. Allow me to introduce the rest of my fellow-travellers to you, except your friends Gregor and Vasilyon. They must thank you by way of exception for the praise of their work."

Having introduced us all to mother, I. addressed us.

"That is the chief-mother of the Community whose name nobody knew here up to now. Lyovushka has awakened the long-forgotten mother's name for life. From now on, mother, be not just chief-mother, but shine for everybody as mother Anna, Anna the Grace of God."

"Let your will be, Teacher," mother Anna answered I. by bowing to him, and when she straightened herself, tears were flowing down her cheeks, and her radiating eyes looked like shining lakes.

"There's not a single little dust from the past left, mother Anna. They say that the Truth is told by the words of babies. The infantile pure heart exclaimed your name. Remember what the chief told you in the secret Community when he saw you and the little group of your company off to life and work in this oasis. Let your name ring for the new people's joy and victories, for their new perception and freedom. Let everyone who will approach you be glad and comprehend that he is carrying the whole Freedom-Life within himself."

Mother Anna wiped the tear, smiled to me, took my hand again and uttered.

"You are dear to me, my boy, for your love for my great-granddaughter, but you are even dearer for the great joy about which you don't know anything yourself. Many years ago, before sending me here, to Radanda, my chief said to me: "You will become free when pure lips of the person whom you will encounter for the first time will call you Anna." You are the herald of my joy. Let me thank you and by my dear guest."

Mother Anna bowed to me, she bowed to all guests by adding that she was glad to welcome them to the oasis, and she invited us to follow her. She took us to a beautiful, little house, planted all around with wonderful flowers and trees, and she charged two brothers to take care of us, while Nataliya Vladimirovna was entrusted to a charming girl. Mother Anna wanted to take I. alone to another house given to him.

"Mother Anna, I will have a lot of work to do. Would you allow me to take also my secretary with me?"

"As you wish, Teacher. I am glad to have this baby of joy closer to me. I thought that you would need a complete outward silence. There are only two rooms in the little house in which I will settle you, while the house itself is standing in the little island, as Radanda told us to build it. The trees there grew and became stronger not so long ago, while the brushes grew around the entire island like a wall. I don't allow to walk there anybody, except the old watchman. Your feet will be the first that will enter that sacred, little house from that time when it was finished and furnished, in a convenient and nice way as far as my possibilities and strength allowed me to do it."

Mother Anna was walking in front of us with her unusual gait – she was as though swimming, by hardly touching the ground with her feet. We were walking for about twenty minutes, in the beginning through the scattered, poetically looking little houses, covered with palm straw, then through the white, little houses which looked like the ones made of marble, with beautiful roofs, as if covered with leaves of reddish flowers, but actually, made of Gregor's and Vasilyon's glass, applied for the roofs. The glass didn't allow the heat and the sand to get inside.

While I was listening for these explanations of mother Anna, I didn't even imagine that I would have the possibility to make sure how the clouds of sand penetrated even through the high, green walls during the sand storm in the desert, and how only the houses made of the glass became the only one place of salvation for people and animals.

As I will tell you later, the storm in the Black Sea wasn't much more horrible than the sandstorm which I. allowed me to observe from the high lighthouse which mother Anna built for this purpose with the signal lights and the bell, the strokes of which showed the way to the oasis for caravans that were overtaken by the storm in the desert.

The section of the little houses ended instantly, and we entered the garden of date and coco palms, and of big breadfruit, the fruit of which was the main food of the dark-skinned people. It was noisy and lively by the houses, there were lots of children and grown-ups, but here an absolute silence and calm

prevailed. We approached a little island in several minutes, which was surrounded by the canal with pure water, across which the clear and white, little bridge was thrown, as if it was finished only yesterday. Mother Anna stopped next to it.

"Teacher, this house is a sanctuary, an altar for me. Having arranged everything in it, I didn't enter it anymore. Enter it alone with your secretary if you please, as you wished, and send him to me if needed. I am living here, in the clearing, very close."

"According to the Eastern custom I take the right from you to enter first as the chief, but please follow me according to the same right of authorities as a guest, friend and colleague of the Bright Brotherhood that passed great assignments through me to you."

"I obey your will with joy, Teacher," mother Anna answered him.

But she didn't agree to go in front of me in any way, which made me so confused that I was still standing by the bridge, although I. had already crossed it to the island. As always, by saving me from such situations, I. turned around and said to me.

"Mother Anna, as the hostess of the oasis, dismisses you from the duty of the cavalier. Go first, you will still have time to prove her that you are knight and cavalier, and that your young appearance hides the old spirit that isn't strange for her."

Encouraged by my friend, I stepped first unceremoniously by forgetting about my conditional tactlessness. So, we entered the little house, we went upstairs to the charming hall, buried in flowers, with palm panels, and then we got into the room.

It was difficult to imagine something more wonderful. Everything till the rack for clothes was created by the hands of the inhabitants of the oasis. And everything seemed to me like the goods of the art and not the details of one's private life. I was already prepared to "catch crows", but I. didn't give me the time for this, he told me to move up two very beautiful arm-chairs to the window which was opened to the side of the garden.

"While I will be talking to mother Anna, you Lyovushka, go to Yassa and take the packets from him, which I told you to give to him. Moreover, take the letter from the basket given to Gregor, which I gave to you when we left Radanda's Community. Bring everything here, but do it carefully, because everything is of great value for mother Anna. And you must bring everything only with very pure hands, with very pure thoughts. Be attentive, my boy, remember that you were the herald of joy and liberation for another soul, remain the worthy messenger of the Bright Brotherhood till the end."

I bowed to I., left the room and thought what poor my loyalty was through I.'s eyes that he needed to remind me about it. Once again I thanked I. in my thoughts and I promised myself to think only about the flying past moment now which was so important for another person. I touched the little flower of the Great Mother with my hand, I found the way back easily, I found Yassa's house without any obstacles and Yassa himself.

Yassa met me in such a way as if he was waiting for my arrival. The clean clothes prepared for me were placed on his bed, he accompanied me to the shower, he helped me himself to wash down the liquid rubbed before the journey, he combed my hair himself, he pressed my curls very beautifully and only then he gave the packets wrapped in the white silk to me.

"Lyovushka, here is the wonderful dress and here is the veil. All of it is dear to mother Anna not only as a symbol, but also as Ali's present. And you know yourself in what a royally generous way this Teacher rewards his chosen ones if they had the luck to become the ones."

Yes, I knew it well, and Yassa's words who was never speaking anything without necessity made me concentrate even more. Both of us went to Gregor whom I asked to give the letter to me. By giving it to me, Gregor stopped for a while, he stepped back by looking my entire figure up and down with his attentive look of the painter.

"Ah, Lyovushka, it would be so great to draw you like this! No one would believe that you are a living man and not the painter's trick! And who has combed your curls in such a way?"

"That's the limit, Gregor! Why did you decide that I was a trick?" I asked him offended, by making everybody in the room laugh. "I am the most real person, the man, and not a toy for the painter's fantasy. You'd rather helped me to bring these packets successfully by knowing what a gawk I am."

Yassa accompanied me till the very little bridge, he smiled tenderly by saying good-bye and gave I.'s given clothes to me, which he was carrying in the case together with other articles of toilet.

I entered the room as carefully as possible by trying not to rumple and drop anything. I was as proud as an Asian carrier who has fulfilled his received task successfully. I. took the greater packet and gave it to mother Anna. He held the second packet in his hands for a while, as though by inviting her to fall into a special bliss, then he gave it to her, too. He put the letter from Gregor on the table and said to her.

"The Bright Brotherhood is sending the clothes to you in the packets which I gave to you, which all its representatives, Teachers-Chiefs are wearing. The hour of your liberation has struck, mother Anna. While I go to the shower and change my clothes after the journey, you, too, change into you new clothes. No black bands may be left on them anymore – the sad recollections about your own unsteady loyalty. Don't open the packets which are placed on the table, I will open them myself."

With these words I. left the room, while I followed him by carrying his clean clothes and I helped him to take off the travel ones. I wanted to take them back instantly to Yassa, but I. told me to fold them neatly, to put them back into the case nicely, to take them to the small stockroom under the stairs where the palm-tree chest was standing and to put everything into it.

Until I did everything, although it seemed to myself that I did it very quickly, I. was already prepared – when I came back, he was lacing his sandals. I. had girded with a golden belt; he was climbing up the stairs by inviting me to go with him.

Having entered the room, we saw mother Anna dressed with the new clothes. What had happened with her? Did the conversation with I. or the clothes change her so much? Actually, I was so engaged in my mission to give the items given to me in such a form which Yassa gave them to me that when I entered, I was looking only at I. and not at mother Anna, but I remembered her face well before leaving. It was calm and reminded me of Radanda with its kindness. But now I could see a radiance around her head, shoulders and hands which wasn't there before leaving. Her dress was white, long, from the same material from which Ali sent the robe to my brother Nikolay before the feast in K. Mother Anna's waist was girded with the same golden belt as I.'s.

Her radiant eyes were shining even more, and it seemed to me that her face became even younger from those flows of joy and happiness which were spreading from it. This woman was standing before I. like a living incarnation of energy, and if I understood what Radanda's love had done by the walls of the oasis, now I understood that everything what was created in the oasis itself was created by mother Anna's hands and love, that this little corner of the universe had to thank only her for its entire culture. But only on the next day when there was the storm in the desert, I perceived the whole altitude of mother Anna's spirit and her significance by serving people and saving them.

I took one of the packets which he had told not to open without him, he took a flat, ivory case out of it and opened it. A big, green cross was in it, as though it was all hollowed out of a solid emerald, on a thin, golden chain. I hung it on mother Anna's neck.

"Florentian is sending it to you, so that when you leave the post of the chief, would give it to that person whom you will consider to be worthy of changing you. And this," he added by opening the second packet out of it and taking a wonderful, black, little box with a golden peacock on its cover, "your great friend Ali is sending to you."

I took a golden hoop and a long, thin veil out of the box, with which he covered mother Anna's head and fastened it with the golden hoop. The veil covered her shoulders and back, it all began to shine in changing nuances – from golden and reddish till violet one. She looked so wonderfully that I was gazing with admiration at her, and I came to myself only when I helped kneeling mother Anna to stand up by blessing her.

"The Great Bright Brotherhood charged me to lead you into the ranks of the consecrated chiefs and they are sending you the material symbols of your matured great powers. Accept through these items, illuminated with love of the Great Brothers Florentian and Ali, the blessing of the whole Brotherhood and its eternal help. Your entire past has disappeared from the chronicle of centuries. Your loyalty and work for the common welfare has erased its tracks. You have exceeded the instructions given to you and improved the life of the tribe entrusted to you much more than you were instructed to do. Be blessed. Here are the letters from the senior brothers for you."

I gave the letters to mother Anna, he gave her previous clothes, the case and the box to me and he told me to go together with the chief and to carry everything to her house.

When we left the island, the sun was already setting. The chief's house was very close, and in several minutes, we were already standing in her room by crossing two spacious waiting-rooms where her subordinates were usually waiting for her. While we were walking through the garden, we met several people. The new mother's clothes and her new radiance stunned them so much that they dropped everything from their hands, and they were leading her with their surprised looks with their mouths opened. It made me laugh so much that I could hardly hold my serious appearance which was necessary for the Teacher's secretary.

Mother Anna's room was furnished very modestly, but it was radiating with cleanness, and it was full of the wonderful aroma of flowers. A small, very nicely made writing-table, two armchairs, several chairs, a bookcase, a glass dresser with saint images, before which a little lamp was lit, a sofa which replaced the bed, everything was made of the white, polished palm-tree, several excellent Gregor's vases – and that was the whole furnishing of the small room.

"That's, my little child, the herald of which happiness you were for me. Be blessed and accept this clasp from me as my remembrance, fasten it to your belt and pray the Great Mother for me," she said to me as soon as the room door shut after us.

I thanked the chief, I expressed my congratulations and gratitude to her as only I could do it, and I came back to the island. The old watchman met me here and he explained to me that a signal would be in half of an hour, and the sounds of the horn would announce it. Then the same, second signal would be fifteen minutes before the supper and finally, the bell's strike would call us to the dining-room. He explained to me how I could find the way to the dining-room, and I went to my dear I. I found him at the writing-table. He told me to sit down on the armchair and to wait for instructions.

Having finished the letter, I. told me to bring it to Oldenkot, to tell Yassa that he would take everybody to the dining-room after the bell's strike, and to take Andreyeva to him immediately.

I scuttered down the paths of the garden by remembering that there wasn't much time left till the bell's strike. Having done everything and found Nataliya Vladimirovna, I hurried so much to come back to I. that the poor woman could hardly catch up with me. Along the entire way she was sending not very pleasant epithets to the suffocating heat of the oasis.

When we approached the little island, she gave a releasing sigh and declared that only here it was possible to breathe. I don't know if I could feel her mood rightly, but it seemed to me that she was irritated and disappointed with something. I stopped by the door of the house, I touched the little flower of the Great Mother and I was begging from the bottom of my heart that this woman would enter the room, in which the consecration was just given, where congratulations with high acknowledgment and happiness of liberation were given, by feeling harmony.

As it had happened many times before, Nataliya Vladimirovna felt my state immediately, she took my hand, breathed in deeply several times, she smiled to me by covering her eyes with another hand and said to me humbly.

"Thank you, my loyal friend! You haven't forgotten about me in your prayer at least a single time. I am ready."

And we went to I.'s. He met us with a smile, he pushed an armchair for Nataliya Vladimirovna closer to the table where he was still sitting, and he told me to sit down by the window.

"It is not the time, my dear, to be occupied in your thoughts about yourself. Many things have changed during those hours while we were riding here. If you haven't violated my instruction and if you had been sleeping during the entire night, then you could orientate yourself in our circumstances. So now, hear me out very attentively, because there won't be any time left for any additional explanations. During this night such a storm will rage in the desert, which not only this tribe of the dark-skinned people, but also even Radanda's Community had never experienced. The circle of invisible watchmen will protect the oasis itself, but people will experience the fear of the horrible element. And all of us need to share the job wisely to calm them down. I charge you with children and the weakest women – all of them, by instruction of the chief, will gather in one of the big houses, the strongest and the most resistant one. Mother Anna's messengers will help you – strong, brave and hardened women. Bronski and Igor, under Yassa's leadership, together with the strongest people of the oasis will be keeping watch by the gate, they will let in and bring in those who will be saved from the storm in the desert. Slava and Oldenkot will unite the old, weak and sickly, as well as the most cowardly men and teenagers, although I must say that mother Anna's tribe is very brave and strong. But as I've already mentioned, the rage of the element will be terrible also for the most courageous ones. I hope that the power of your loyalty will help to calm down those whom I charge you to take care of."

"If Lyovushka was together with me, I could hope for the success of the job given to me..." Nataliya Vladimirovna started, but I. only smiled, and he didn't let her finish her thought.

"Another mission is waiting for the strong man Lyovushka tonight. I've just said to you that we need to distribute our forces as wisely as possible. Gregor and Vasilyon will be protecting the plant. They are no strangers here, and people love them very much. While for you a possibility arises tonight to show such love for our brothers-people, the example of which may leave the tracks in the hearts of everybody who will spend this night with you. Take this little box and memorize, memorize precisely the instruction which you will hear now: its content is only for you; when you are completely exhausted,

swallow one pea. Don't give any pills to the natives, although it would seem to you that somebody is dying. Decide yourself how you should behave in the crowd of the women and children who lost their mind with honour. Try to avoid the panic. Act by the example of your own tranquillity and strengthen their belief that they are absolutely safe next to you."

The sounds of the horn were heard, I. told me to take Nataliya Vladimirovna to the Yassa's house and to come back to him immediately.

I came back with the bell's strike, and I found I. already waiting for me on the house threshold.

Chapter 24

The first supper in the round mother Anna's house. The hall of the dining-room. Mother Anna's and I.'s speeches. I.'s work, his instructions and preparation of all dwellers of the oasis to meet the storm. The lighthouse. The terrible night of the storm. I.'s performed "miracle". We leave the lighthouse. Yassa, his lifeless sleep and my despair. My job by the gate. The dogs-searchers. After the storm. We come to see Oldenkot and Andreyeva

We hurried to the dining-room immediately. We passed round the little island and got into the second part of the oasis which I hadn't yet seen. Having crossed the same calm gardens of palm and fruit-tree through which mother Anna was leading us to the island, only here they were thicker and reminded more of the forest, unexpectedly we went out to the clearing. Some rammed grounds were built here. But it only seemed to me like this from the beginning, because actually they were made of the mat glass. The grounds were built for all sorts of games of children and grown-ups. The nets for the game with the ball were hanging here, also there was the cricket, trapezes, swing – my look couldn't even take everything in.

Now an old man was walking on the grounds, he was picking up balls, skittles and bringing them into a big storehouse. The storehouse was so pleasantly clean, nicely furnished, white, with beautiful ornaments that many Europeans would like to live in such a wonderful house.

And I thought again what a man's love for his own people could do and in what a beauty Gregor helped mother Anna to train her tribe. My thoughts flew past like a hurricane: for how many years Gregor with Vasilyon were living by Radanda, they were still rather young people? What was their real age? Where was their factory here? I.'s voice sent me back to the balance.

"We arrived. Don't rush about. Not so much time has passed since the storm in the Black Sea till this sandstorm which you will have to experience today. But back then you were a weak boy who didn't know anything, while today you are already hardened and grown-up man. Concentrate all your thoughts on that help which you will have to give to people today. Always think about Florentian and ask the Great Mother to bless our joint work. Forget about yourself and all the questions which could interest you personally. During the great moments of life when thousands of people are standing in the presence of

death or natural disaster, we need to leave all conditionalities and to live only in Eternity, to fulfil all the work in Her presence and to save Her by saving the temporary, mortal forms.”

I was taking I.’s words deeply into my heart. They awakened my spirit, but my external attention became completely weak: I didn’t even notice through which paths we turned here and there, although when the watchman explained the way to the dining-room to me, I understood it perfectly. I gave a sigh: I was great secretary! But there wasn’t any time to pity myself. I tried to concentrate even deeper and I entered after I. a big, two-storied, round house.

Such form of the house surprised me very much. The hall which we entered was absolutely round. The windows which looked more like hatches were seen only above, there were so many of them, and all of them were firmly closed. A lot of ventilators were spinning above, just like in Ali’s Community, but they were arranged somehow differently. There was a wide corridor around the hall, in which kitchens and a lot of rooms were arranged. Mother Anna met us on the threshold and she accompanied us to her table that was laid only for three persons.

Although there were many tables in the hall, but there wasn’t enough room in it for all the inhabitants of the oasis. The same hall, but much bigger one was above it, on the first floor, and there was much more room for tables in it, because there wasn’t a corridor which surrounded it. Even the lower hall looked like a big theatre, so I thought how many people could go in the hall of the first floor.

Having seated us at her table, mother Anna distributed our friends and entrusted them to Gregor and Vasilyon – the hosts of the oasis, as she called them. She came back to us and told the servants to bring the food immediately. A group of young girls and boys began to bring the food on the tables immediately by taking it straight from the windows-niches, arranged in the wall of the kitchen. Other girls and boys put the food on small lifting machines, they were pulling the ropes and lifting it on the first floor.

The first course was a very tasty soup with a lot of crackling cakes. There wasn’t such strict silence here as in Radanda’s dining-room. Everybody who wanted to was speaking. But they were speaking silently, and there wasn’t such hum of voices, too, which I remembered from the dining-room of Ali’s Community. An unrestricted freedom was felt by all the tables. Therefore, how educated and cultured everybody was! The atmosphere of a complete calm and satisfaction surrounded us from all sides.

The people were dressed already differently than by the gate. Although women were wearing ordinary dresses, but they were made of diverse colours and models, reaching the middle of their shins. All elderly women were wearing dark grey or brown dresses, and almost all of them were with long pelerines. Men were wearing tunics of diverse colours as well; they were woven from silk yarns. Their shorts were dark blue, and they were fastened on their knees. The legs of both women and men were very beautiful, almost all of them were barefooted. Only few of them were wearing such sandals which we saw by the gate.

There weren’t any children here. They were living in the children’s home, as mother Anna explained to me. The people from fifteen years gathered here, and this meant full age in the oasis and the right to register a marriage in a year.

The second course were different vegetables, then – fruit and hot cacao with delicious, sweet date cakes.

By jesting at my appetite, I. was persuading me to eat more, because I would need a lot of physical strength. I was laughing and eating with great pleasure.

I couldn't help noticing thousands of looks during the entire supper, which were directed to I. and mother Anna. She must have been not only the soul of the whole oasis, but also its deity. And today, with her new dress, she attracted everybody's attention especially and excited fascination. Having finished eating, mother Anna stood up and began to speak in an unusually musical voice.

Her voice was like a signal. Men passed silently the majority of tables through the windows-niches to the corridor, while the people from the first floor who finished their eating were coming to the free space. Soon, without any noise, as if the decorations of the theatre had changed, the hall was full of standing people, only the old men who were closest to our tables remained sitting.

"Brothers and sisters, only some of you have seen our great friend and constant compassionate assistant, Teacher I., who is among us now. Since that time when we are living here, since when Radanda accompanied us here for the first time, none of the events of our oasis has happened without the Bright Brotherhood's help. Now and again the Compassionate Ones were sending us one or another of their chosen ones, and they used to rescue us or help us to overcome difficult and sometimes disastrous events of our lives."

Like a gust of the wind, the whisper of the excited crowd blew over the prevailing silence in which the music of mother Anna's voice was pouring, and then the same silence fell. I understood that a presentiment of some disaster penetrated into the hearts of everybody present here. Personally me, this wonderful voice affected me in such a calming and strengthening way that if mother Anna had been reading a death sentence to me, also then I must have been thinking not about the horror that was waiting for me, but about the Light and charm of her power which were simply pouring from her.

"Concentrate your entire power of spirit, the whole courage of your heart and prove in this hour when you are listening to the news, which Teacher I. will tell you, that the whole work of the Bright Brotherhood and Radanda dedicated to you hasn't vanished in vain, that you've grown into a strong and brave tribe and that you are prepared in every moment to encounter the danger with staying power and to repulse it strongly and decisively. There's no need for me, my dear, to remind you of the unconditional obedience with which you need to fulfil all Teacher I.'s instructions. Listen attentively, so that you would fulfil them precisely."

Mother Anna bowed to I. and asked him to tell all gathered people that what Teacher had to pass to them.

"My dear friends, the presentiment of disaster has squeezed your hearts in this moment. But take a look at your mother, your teacher and chief. Have you noticed her excitement and anxiety? Can you see some shock in her face, even if a natural disaster menaces your whole oasis? Today is the great day of her life. The Bright Brotherhood has sent the new clothes to her, which all the chiefs are wearing who were consecrated by It and who were worthy of being called to join the ranks of the leading brothers of the Bright Community of the world. You don't see the black bands anymore, which remind you of the reconciliation, about the passenger from the secret Community which the initiator of your tribe your mother, has left. Her clothes are embroidered with gold patterns, the stitches of which unite all the people of the universe who have dedicated their lives for the people's welfare into one family. Your mother, the name of whom you didn't know up to now, from this day on becomes mother Anna for you, and this, as you probably know, means God's Grace. Today the Bright Brotherhood called your mother in this name. The Bright Brotherhood is sending the God's Grace through her to you not because the death would befall on you, her children and your work. She has grown and educated you not for death. On the day after tomorrow, when the element moves away from your oasis, I will talk about the tasks of your tribe which the life of the world of this period raises for you. Today I call you for the heroic strain of all your feelings and thoughts. Mother Anna was telling you many times that life – that's a fight with her own example. She

was teaching you staying power and complete self-control in the fight for life. The hour of your joy and happiness has struck for you to show with your work how you are able to protect your mother's business, your motherland. This is the great and blessed hour of yours: to forget about yourselves, your fears and suffering, and to save the travellers whom the storm today will overtake near your oasis. Get ready, lucky brothers, for the selfless work to save your own people on the other side of the walls of the oasis, and to save the animals and the factory on this side. Let the men and the women from sixteen to thirty years divide into the groups of ten persons, and each of them choose their head. My fellow-travellers will take care of the children, weak and sickly women who don't fit my mentioned age groups. They will receive precise instructions how to work. The men above thirty years will protect gardens and animals. Gregor and Vasilyon will protect the factory, because the storm will hit the eastern part of the oasis the strongest. Bring animals to the cattle-sheds immediately, drive them to the stalls. Not a single dog must be left under the open sky, because during this storm they won't be useful even as the rescuers of the dying in the desert, because the element would kill them. When the time for their work comes, you will receive the instruction to let them out. The people whom the animals are used to must shut in together with them right now, immediately, and to strew that plant on the floor, which I will give to you. The animals will fall sound asleep, and that will help them to avoid the fury from the horror of the storm. Empty this hall right now and bring mats, rugs and pillows into it. Assign a hundred of strong and deft men to keep watch in both halls. Those who will be rescued will be brought in here. I will come here again in an hour, let all the chosen heads of the groups gather here."

I. told Gregor and Vasilyon to go to the factory immediately and he instructed them how to prepare the machinery and the buildings by adding that they should choose two hundred men to help them and to distribute them in the parts of the factory with the weakest protection. He gave a little bottle with a liquid for each of them and he explained its purpose only to them. Also, he put a little stick into Gregor's hands, which he took very carefully and kneeling respectfully.

Then together with mother Anna I. led all our friends to his showed places of the nightly watching. The last ones – Yassa, Bronski and Igor – he left by the gate together with several groups of tall and strong natives by telling Yassa to dress them all with warm, dense knitted clothes which he would be given in mother Anna's storehouse.

"Also take the helmets with the eyes of unbreakable glass from there, otherwise all of you will lose your sight. The gloves are sewn to the sleeves of the knitted clothes, but we'll have to teach the dwellers of the oasis to put long boots on, because they don't have any understanding about them," mother Anna gave a smile.

While we were walking round the house where we left Nataliya Vladimirovna, Oldenkot and Slava on duty, while I. and mother Anna gave the last instructions to them, more than an hour passed by. There still wasn't any feeling of the approaching storm anywhere in the atmosphere, for which the oasis was preparing so feverishly. The gardeners were running about everywhere, and they tied big cases to big rings threaded deep into the ground, with which they covered very valuable fruit-tree, palms, flowers and hothouses.

Having come back to the dining-room, we found a big group of people who were waiting for us – heads of the groups whom I. had told to gather. Having charged everybody with the different spots of the oasis, I. repeated once again that nobody alive would remain under the open sky and that the heads would shut in immediately with all the dwellers of the oasis entrusted to them in the assigned houses. He reminded them to check the water supply in houses, stables and hothouses. He assigned some special groups to protect the water supply and the machines which produced light.

Only now I paid attention to the hall lightning. The light was coming from the lamps which looked like the ones which I saw in Dartran's oasis, only it was bright white there, while here it was blue. But I had no time for these thoughts, I remembered I.'s instruction well and I didn't scatter my attention about. Soon I. said good-bye to everybody, he blessed them for a successful and sincere job and said to me by leaving.

"Now the part of your job will begin. Let's go to the gate."

We turned to the exit from the oasis. Here I. checked all the people entrusted to Yassa for this night, he repeated their tasks once again. He didn't miss anything; he also mentioned the signal signs which would be passed from the lighthouse to the posts of watching. He explained to them how to prepare to go out beyond the gate, how to open it, so that the storm wouldn't knock it down, how and where they needed to take the caravans or the parts separated from them, where to pass the rescued people.

Having said good-bye to Yassa and his company, we went straight into the thicket of the green wall, and only now I saw a round tower built from a very thick, green glass in this high, impassible tangle. I couldn't imagine its volume, but I understood why I didn't notice it in this disguising verdure while riding into the oasis.

Mother Anna turned some wheel, the tower lit up inside, and I saw that it was gigantic not only to the width, but also to the height. It was rising above the alive green wall. Having stepped to the right, mother Anna pressed another hardly visible switch, and the sound of a released spring was heard, as if something jumped to the side with power and sound, and a cleft between the ground and the bricks of the tower opened in several minutes. The block made of the glass that was as thick as the rock, which was pressed closely to the adjacent layers of the tower, was rising up slowly. Having reached the height of a half of man, it stopped, while the spring sounded again like starting it. Mother Anna wanted to press the switch again, but I. stopped her.

"Let's not waste the time. We'll get through such cleft, too, it is time already to switch on the signals of the light and alarm, so that the travellers who don't expect the storm would hurry to the oasis."

And indeed, two gusts of the wind swept past one after another from which all the trees of the oasis began to roar and tremble. A cloud of dust flew past by wailing, as if a dark crowd of vicious witches had flown by. We got through the cleft, mother Anna pressed the spring from inside, the glass block slipped down, and we got in the deadly silence in several minutes, just like under the ground. I. started climbing up the wide, spiral stair made of the same white glass as Gregor's cups. The stair was shining wonderfully, like some cleanly washed China plates, the round handrails were winding above it, which were of the same green colour as the mat tower itself.

I counted a hundred and seventy steps, while we still didn't reach the top. Two clearings of the stair were left. All the clearings were spacious, because the tower didn't grow narrow upward. There was a water tap and a small reservoir in each of the clearings. Mother Anna turned on the taps in all clearings, and the water was running not only from them, but also from several holey, narrow, little pipes by flowing into the reservoir, and after filling it up, the water was pouring down. Only later I understood what a bliss the coolness of this water for us was which saved us from the stuffiness of the heated air of the sand. Although the glass didn't let the heat go inside, but from the outside the walls of the tower became heated like an iron. The water that circulated up and down kept a rather low temperature in the tower which had imprisoned us.

Finally, we got on the last clearing of the stair. Here, too, the glass walls were of the same thickness, but they were absolutely transparent. The narrow, little stair led us to the dome itself, and having climbed it up, we got above the green wall of the oasis.

There were four wheels here. I put me to two of them, which were one next to another.

"You can see the records: "Alarm", "Light". It is instructed here how many times you will need to turn the wheel when I say to you: "Double alarm", "Single alarm", "Continuous alarm". Having received this last command, attach the wheel with this chain. Also, with mother Anna's commands act in the same way. She will be controlling the light signals. It isn't complicated to understand it, but it is very difficult to attach the wheels, besides you will also need a lot of physical strength for turning the wheels. Here are two small switches on the wall with the records: "To prepare", "To leave". Those are the signals for those who keep watch by the gate. I will pronounce those words exactly like this, while you will press one of these switches. Be attentive. Whatever phenomenon you would see behind the walls or here, inside, even if it seems to you to be supernatural or even the real "miracle", don't lose courage and act by the wheels precisely by remembering that the lives of many people depend on your attention."

I looked through the transparent wall, the little patch of which was before my wheels. As far as my look could take in the space illuminated by the lighthouse, the desert sand had already begun to rise in waves in it. The desert which I used to see still up to now began to look like a sea now.

"Single alarm!" suddenly I heard I's command. I turned the wheel, and I even gave a start with unexpectedness. Such a powerful bell sounded somewhere very close, as though above our heads, that it seemed to me that everything around gave a start.

"Double light!" mother Anna uttered.

I turned the wheel of the light, white and red waves of light spread from the lighthouse by spreading the longest beams, and they illuminated everything around like the sun. The sand in the desert was waving much stronger already, the waves were higher, but anyway they still didn't reach at least a quarter of the arshin.

"Double alarm! Continuous light!" one command followed the other one, and although they were heard almost at the same time, I fulfilled both successfully.

During those several free minutes which were left for me between the commands, I had time to observe the changing view of the desert. Now the sand waves which were crawling along the ground were above the arshin, the entire poles of dust were rising in waves.

"Continuous alarm! To prepare!" I. was commanding.

I attached the alarm wheel in a flash, and the strong din reached even this stronghold which was almost soundproof. I pressed the switch for Yassa.

As soon as I pressed it, I heard.

"To leave!"

While standing by the wall assigned for Yassa's switches, I saw a caravan that was hurrying to the oasis on the animals who were stumbling and tossing without any keenness of wit. Also, I had time to see how Yassa with his friends opened the gate, and then the dust cloud covered everything.

"Continuous alarm! Continuous light!" both commands were heard at the same time again.

In this way, while commands of my chiefs were always sounding, I was working by the gate and signals by almost not having any time to fling my eyes behind the walls. But when I looked at the desert during the first break, the new view shocked me. The sand waves were already higher than two arshines. Their view was always changing. The wind wail and whistle were heard even in the lighthouse, the lightning flashed, but the thunder didn't roll to us, or maybe I couldn't hear it through the wind wail.

Again, the commands followed one after another for a rather long time. Suddenly, it seemed to me that the light was out. But not the light was to blame, but a gigantic pole of the spinning sand was moving towards us, the vortex of which hit the green wall and luckily not the tower, and it hit us only on the rebound, from which everything became dark behind the walls. The whistling gusts of the wind blew the layers of the sand off the round tower, and I understood why the lighthouse was round. The commands were pouring in a continuous flow, my hands and feet were already moving with difficulty, I was dazzled. I. threw a small bottle to me, and he uttered without taking his eyes off the desert.

"Drink it."

Having chosen a moment, I drank it, and I felt a sense of relief and a fresh surge of energy instantly. My eyes could see clearly again, my hands and feet became like iron. The real hell and chaos were in the desert, neither the sand nor the space itself existed here anymore: only the continuously moving darkness was here, and the wail and flashes in it.

"Continuous alarm! Continuous light!" I heard almost at the same time.

I thought that it was already impossible to save anybody in this hell, in this deadly chaos of the sand and wind vortices when I heard.

"To prepare!"

I all trembled, because I was certain that that person who would dare to leave the gate now would die immediately, and the hot sand would burn him down. Unfortunately, I still didn't know the worst back then: suddenly, the cold changed the exhausting heat, and it turned the little grains of sand into the cold crystals which were striking sharply.

"To leave!"

I was begging for the Great Mother from the bottom of my heart to help my friends, to spare them and the lives of the people whom they were saving. I pressed the switch with such a feeling as though I had been pronouncing a judgement to them.

I looked through the wall and I saw how a caravan of camels was hurrying with all its might through the narrow gap between two big mountains of the moving sand. My God, I was calling for Florentian, I wanted to give a cry for I., to ask him to save the unfortunate people who would soon perish in the always contracting corridor between two poles of the sand when I saw completely stiffened I. by the wheel with his hand extended towards the terrible corridor.

I thought that I. was dead. One more moment, and I would have rushed at him, but mother Anna's figure shot up before me. She looked at me piercingly and she put the finger to her lips by commanding me to be silent. Having turned my face towards the desert, she pointed her hand to the nearing caravan in the front of which... all radiating I. was walking. In several minutes the caravan rode up to the gate, while both poles of the sand flowed together into the continuous sea of the sand that again began to rise in waves immediately and it flew forth in the vortex...

A deep sigh was heard behind my back. I turned back. I. was standing in his place, as though I hadn't seen him dead. I stiffened a moment ago. I.'s face was smiling joyfully, and he said to mother Anna.

"The strongest and main cyclones have already passed."

Although the main cyclones had already passed, but our lighthouse used to tremble from the blows of the sand poles, as though they had been firing us with cannons. I was still working for a long time at commands of both of my chiefs, and finally, the horizon was revealed in the hardly visible light. But what a view opened when the horizon began to brighten. Instead of the clean, white and even desert sand to which my eyes had already been accustomed, as though a depicted landscape was stretching, which reminded me more of the view of an ancient city that was exhumed by archaeologists in the full swing of their excavations.

I still had to work at the gate for a long time. The wind was still wailing and whistling, but I could already see several times in the faint light how the gate opened, held by several dozens of the strongest men, and how the injured and hardly alive camels carried in the motionless figures of the people who were hanging on their necks. It became always brighter in the desert, I. tugged some little rope, and the light in the lighthouse was out.

"Our watching will end soon. Don't worry, mother Anna, those for whom you are waiting saved themselves in the grotto. Now they are already riding to the oasis. No more than two hours will pass, and they will be here. We only need to turn on the continuous signals of the light and alarm, so that they could orientate themselves and comprehend how they could ride between the sand mountains piled up into drifts."

I think that more time had passed than I. told it until I heard the commands.

"To prepare! To leave!"

But maybe it only seemed to me like this due to my renewed tiredness. When the gate opened and closed for the last time after I.'s commands, he told us to leave the lighthouse.

I set the wheels to the initial position, and I followed mother Anna and I. downstairs. Only now I understood how I was tired. My legs were trembling, I could hardly hold the handrails with my hands. The more down we were going, the stronger the wind wail was heard. I saw that there wasn't a single petal left on the green wall, the peaks of which were decorated with the most wonderful blossoms when we came. The wide holes without any leaf were wide opened in those places where the sand poles hit the wall, in which thick thorns like horrible, black teeth were sticking out between the bare, broken trunks. Already from this view alone I could judge how mother Anna's flower gardens and gardens were destroyed.

The way back seemed to be endless. I even felt giddy, which didn't happen now and about which I had already forgotten. But there's an end for everything, and we reached the exit.

"Lyovushka, prepare not only for the strong wind, but also for the stinging cold. The cloaks are placed over there. Cover mother Anna with one of them and wrap yourself up in another one. And in order for you not to worry about me, I will throw it on myself, too," I. added by taking the cloak.

The cloaks were soft, light and warm. Mother made the spring speak again, and the glass block rose up. This time I. asked to press the spring for the second time by explaining to me that I needed to get used to the sudden change of temperatures a little.

Oh, what a cold blew to us when the block rose till the end. The stinging wind that was carrying cold sand crystals strewed my eyes, nose and mouth instantly, and I couldn't even move when

suddenly somebody's hand pulled the cloak on my face and dragged me after him. I was walking by all trembling with cold, stumbling and comprehending neither where nor who was leading me. But then our feet tapped the firm pavement, I was taken to the warm house through the threshold, my cloak was torn off me, and the clear Yassa's voice uttered.

"Don't open your eyes until I put you into the bath. Then you will wash your eyes."

Yassa told me to wash my hands very well and he poured some nicely smelling liquid into my palms. I was washing my eyes for a long time until he allowed me to open them. Then he gave a small bath and a big mug of water to me. I was rinsing my teeth and mouth with joy, although it really wasn't easy for me to remove the squeaking sand between my teeth. Finally, the strict Yassa's commands how and with what I had to rub myself ended, I also washed myself under the pouring shower and only then I could take a good look at Yassa himself.

I had seen Yassa tired many times, but I never imagined that my careful friend could be till utter physical exhaustion as in this hour. Deadly pale and flabby Yassa's face hardly reminded me of the familiar expression.

"Yassa, what is wrong with you? Are you sick? Let me show my gratitude to you as soon as possible for your constant help and worries. Please, don't protest. I will prepare the bath for you immediately and I will massage you. You are hardly alive, aren't you?"

"No, Lyovushka, the bath won't help me. I. gave a little bottle to me, and he told me to drink it when I feel the complete exhaustion. I was always thinking that such exhaustion hadn't come yet, and it seems that I am late. Now it's probably too late. My legs don't hold me anymore, and the bath won't rescue me."

Yassa was speaking in a hardly audible voice, with difficulty, but anyway, he pulled the small bottle out of his pocket, and he drank the liquid that was in it. He was lying stretched on the armchair for several minutes, absolutely motionless, worn out by the deadly fatigue. I dashed at him, I put the little flower of the Great Mother to his lips, and I was begging the Divine Patroness on my knees to help my dying friend. I was begging Her to give back his life to him, which was so valuable and necessary for the earth. I thought that Yassa was late to fulfil I.'s instruction by remembering well how I. threw the little bottle with the strengthening medicine to me during the moment of my utter exhaustion. I took the helplessly hanging Yassa's hands, I put the wonder-working flower into them, and I was calling for I. with all my might to come and save Yassa who had delayed fulfilling his instruction not as consciously, but with the great respect for his command.

I don't know for how long I was kneeling by Yassa, weeping and grieving. Yassa's hands became always colder, I was trying to warm them with my breathing. Tears were streaming from my eyes and pouring on these dear and diligent hands.

"The boy has gone absolutely crazy!" I heard the dear voice from the distance, the well familiar steps were coming nearer to me quickly, and I.'s figure was already standing next to me in a moment. "When will you mature, my Goliath? Yassa is sleeping and he is very happy in this moment. We need to see how to protect his body and not to disturb his spirit to work and develop with anything. Very well that the last thing what Yassa has taken from the earth in his memory was your care and love, your prayer for him to the Great Mother. His path will be as high and easy as your pure love has testified his useful and full of love serving to the earth. I thought that you would understand yourself that Yassa would be sleeping from the taken medicine in the same way as professor was sleeping, and he would wake up from the sleep in the same way as rejuvenated Zalcman did. Stop grieving, wrap Yassa up into the cloak and

bring him to your room on the first floor, which by the way you haven't seen up to now. Put Yassa on the sofa, pull the curtain on the window, although there won't be the sun today, and remain sitting by him with an absolute self-control until I send the shift for the watching. You made me leave a very important job with your calling. Next time, if you happen to observe a similar case, know how you need to behave, never be afraid of anything, and let not a single tear pour out of your eyes anymore. I will send two persons to you. One will remain by Yassa; the other one will take you to me. Now we need every strong man, hurry to help me."

I left as fast as he had come. I wrapped Yassa up in the cloak and I brought him carefully to the room which I called to be mine. Oh, how I was glad at the opportunity to do a service to my friend, to express my endless gratitude to him for his care and attention. I never had to ask him for anything. He knew everything beforehand, and he always used to show up next to me when an obstacle used to rise for me. Yassa, Yassa – I testified from the bottom of my heart not only about his useful activity, but also about his selfless devotion to every man who approached in the orbit of his attention.

Having gone upstairs to my room, I found a sofa, I put Yassa on it as conveniently as possible, as only I was able to do it. His body was hardly warm, but flexible. Having pulled the curtain, I moved an armchair to the sofa, and I sat down by my friend who was sleeping in such a strange sleep. The wind behind the window was still wailing, but its gusts were rare already. I could see the shadows of the swinging palms through the pulled curtain. I's words calmed down my soul for Yassa's destiny, but... they awakened a lot of sad thoughts within myself about my own weakness.

But then I remembered immediately that I needed to think not about myself, but about the unknown Yassa's path to me, in which my love and joy could be the witness and help for his easier and higher advancement to the light. I knew well that not only my love and my prayers were blessing this soul with gratitude. Again, I knelt down by Yassa, I took the divine flower from his hands, I snuggled up to it and... I felt that as though I left my body, that I was standing by the feet of the Great Mother, in Her white chapel of Joy. I heard a voice.

"I have a lot of children, loyal workers of Eternity, but there are few of those who know the direct and continuous path without any hesitations and doubts, without any doubling and decomposition between the idea of service and his own actions on the earth. Go, my son, by asserting some or other ideas on the earth not with your character's strength, but carry them within yourself by following your Teacher's loyalty with your own one. With your live example present the new ideas to the world through your word not only as the fruit of one mind, but as the heart's opening and its culture..."

I came to myself still by kneeling by Yassa's bed, while mother Anna was standing next to me and she was waiting silently until I would finish my prayer. I stood up, bowed to her by wondering of what a great vitality she was, as if she hadn't been working in the lighthouse during the entire night.

"I've brought one brother for you who would stay here to keep watch instead of you, while you will go with me to help I.,” she said to me.

Having come to the door, she brought an old man with a long, grey beard into the room. He was with a turban, dressed in the eastern style and he was leaning on a high stick. His dark and austere face, his dark and beautiful hands, his tall and military figure made him look like an old chief. I thought exactly like this by looking at him: "Such people die by standing."

The old man gave a smile to me, and that smile changed his face immediately, which became kind, tender and joyful. He moved my armchair to the side, he took the tabouret that was standing in the

corner, he sat down on it, leaned on his stick with both of his hands and got stiff, as if he was a statue and not a living man. Mother Anna gave me a sign, and we left the room.

She showed me the knitted suit and the helmet with spectacles which were placed on the bench in the clearing of the stair, and she said to me that I would like me to work by the gate where the dog-searchers were now taking everybody alive from the desert. I certainly needed to change my clothes, because otherwise I couldn't work. The echoes of the storm were still felt very strongly in the oasis.

Mother Anna waited for me until I changed, she took me out of the little island, and she gave me a youth who was wearing the same suit as mine and waiting for us on the bridge to accompany me. He took me instantly to the gate. I surely wouldn't have found the way alone, because there weren't any paths left anymore, only the sand sea which reached the knees was everywhere. There wasn't absolutely anything by what I could orientate myself, and also a cloud of dust used to strew us time and again. The sand struck against the spectacles glass and tinged like a hail. The youth who saw that I stopped by every sand cloud took my hand and dragged me forward by force. I was surprised by the strength of this slender figure who was still childish in comparison with mine, and I pressed the youth hand slightly by thanking him and agreeing to hurry after him. In this way we reached the gate hand in hand.

Exactly in this moment here several tall men left the watch post to open the gate. I saw I. next to the gate, who helped to tie the bottles with water and wine to the dogs' backs, they were placed in small bags made of some transparent material which looked like an oilcloth. The dogs were standing calmly, they weren't afraid of the desert at all. Apparently, they were used to such work. Actually, one could call these dogs to be even small tigers, so big and frightful they were.

The gate opened, and these four-legged-rescuers prepared for the feat ran out of it, while other three exhausted, panting dogs came back to the oasis, after whom several camels without any riders, without any saddles and several more brisk animals with riders were walking slowly. A hardly alive, exhausted woman was walking after the third dog, she was holding at his forehead-flap and two children who were sitting on the dog's back. Having crossed the threshold of the gate, both the woman and the dog fell down, I thought that they were dead. I rushed at the woman, I. seized the children, while the natives lifted the dog.

"You take the woman and go together with me, while you bring the dog into the post and give him milk with my given mixture to drink immediately," I. told me and his colleagues. "And you run to the watchman on duty and on my behalf tell him to ring the alarm bell every three minutes," he added to the youth who took me to the gate.

We came to the round building of the dining-room, passed the woman with children to mother Anna who was taking care of many lying and moaning people. Many of them were injured during the storm and now they were lying carefully bandaged. Those who were healthier helped brothers and sisters to take care of those who suffered more.

Having passed the resecured ones quickly, I. turned back, also he said something to mother Anna, and we hurried to the gate again. The alarm was buzzing in several places at the same time by accompanying the main bell of the gate, the strokes united into one strong and even, deafening sound. The gate opened and closed many times, the dogs would bring through miracle more and more alive and found people. It seemed to me that there wouldn't be any end of our job, but finally, I. uttered.

"It is meaningless to keep ringing the bells and sending the dogs. The storm has drawn farther, beyond the limits of our possibilities. The sound and light signals, as well as the dogs, cannot overcome such distance where people might need help in this moment. The storm is moving to the side of

Radanda's Community, and everybody there is already prepared to rescue the people who were caught by the element in the desert. I think that the warning alarm signals of Radanda's Community have forced many caravans to change the itinerary of their journey and hurry to hide at his place. Everybody go to rest. The food is waiting for you in the dining-rooms, hurry to the shower, eat and go to sleep. You, Bronski and Igor, go with me."

Only now when two tall figures separated from the others, I recognized my friends. All of us together went to that house in which Oldenkot was keeping watch during the night. Everything here was in order, smaller children were sleeping or playing the games invented for them. He was cheerful, he was in time to observe and organize everything as it seemed to be the most purposeful for him, and all men and senior children entrusted to him prepared bandages, ointments and compresses according to his instructions, the supply of which might not be enough in the oasis due to this unforeseen case.

There wasn't any doubt that Oldenkot managed not only to avoid the general panic, but also, he created an industrious atmosphere in the sector given to him. I felt an absolute trust and love instantly which he created around himself during this night. Slava who helped him a lot now was hardly standing on his feet, although he was trying very much to be cheerful. I told him and Oldenkot, as well as everybody else in this house, to go to sleep immediately, only to leave several people to keep watch. I explained to everybody that the food would be brought here for them, that they still couldn't leave the house without the special clothes, because it could harm their eyesight. We would still have to wait for several hours until the storm would settle down. We left Bronski and Igor here by entrusting them to take care of the natives.

From Oldenkot we turned to the house entrusted to Nataliya. We still hadn't come to the door when the noise that was coming from the house met and surprised us quite a lot. The two-storied house reminded of a boy's school during the long break when the class masters were occupied in their own affairs, and they left the schoolchildren without any supervision. I stopped by the door, he listened attentively, smiled and uttered: "Inventor".

When we entered the big room of the ground floor, I almost gave a cry with surprise.

"Take your helmet off, soon you'll be even more surprised," I said to me by laughing.

At best the room reminded of a Gipsy tribe. Everything what could be used as curtains or partitions were used for pitching tents. Beds turned on the side replaced the walls, mattresses were placed on the floor, both children and grown-ups were lying on them, some of them were squatted, all of them together were acting the scenes from the tribe wanderings, which was caught by the storm in the desert. Some of them were wailing, the others were blowing small horns, the third ones were playing the dog-searchers who were bringing the rescued, the fourth ones were doctors and trained nurses, while the greater part was running across from one tent to another one as to the oasis of salvation. Having seen us, both children and the grown-ups rushed at us with the same enthusiasm by shouting.

"The rescued, the rescued, prepare the places for them!"

She crawled out of some cage; she was all dressed in some many-coloured rags which had to replace the expensive adornments of the tribe chief.

"Sha! You know that according to the law of our tribe that was established tonight, the whole tribe is silent when the chief is talking. Bow to our rescuer, thank him for the saved lives tonight and sing the glorifying hymn to him, which I've taught you."

Children and grown-ups lined up in a flash and struck up a joyous canto of majesty. I don't know where Nataliya Vladimirovna took this hymn from for the great chief, but now it sounded in such an

unexpected power and beauty that it became clear for us what this exceptional woman was doing during this exceptional night.

Having felt that panic began to penetrate into the hearts of those who were entrusted to her to take care during the first gusts of the storm, Nataliya Vladimirovna directed their attention to those unfortunate people who were caught by the storm in the desert. She poured so much energy of compassion into the hearts of everybody who surrounded her, she invented such an interesting game to play about the tribe that God sent to save those who were wandering in the desert, she introduced such a law of unconditional obedience to the chief that she took hold of everybody's attention. She was using every stronger thunderclap, every rage of the wind by trying to strengthen the feelings of compassion and heroism in everybody's hearts. With power of great will and hypnosis, Nataliya Vladimirovna was leading people further away from fear. In everyday life she never used this power of her influence upon people, but during such night with the element she invoked them by saving people from fear and thoughts about themselves.

Having finished the hymn, everybody bowed to her and together with her to I. Only now, after having spent the entire night with her, the people began to comprehend their behaviour and that the storm had ended, that nothing threatened their lives anymore, that life was joyous, and it was smiling them.

"Thank you for the wonderful hymn. Friends, the storm has ended," I. uttered. "If after this night at least one immature heart was still among you, then this hymn which you have learnt, would remain anyway as the remembrance about the woman who not only has taken you out of fear with her own example, but also she showed to you that your thought about your own people, about their suffering helps to forget about yourselves, your fear and sadness, and to act in the most menacing circumstances. You made sure that the power of your heart is changing the circumstances and not the circumstances oppress your spirit. Thank your guest-chief who was serving you tonight with such selflessness and remember: if you encounter something terrible in your life, you need to think about help for others, to act, to search for work for the common welfare and not to search for rescuing only for yourselves."

I. said good-bye to everybody. He told Nataliya Vladimirovna to change in the warm clothes which a girl had brought to her and to go to her room to rest, also some food would wait for her there.

And I was surprised again when I saw that the girl who served Nataliya Vladimirovna was the same youth whom mother Anna told to accompany me to the gate and who was dragging me after her with such strength. The girl was laughing at my astonishment, and she asked me cunningly whether she had to accompany me to the gate again.

Having left the house, I. went straight to his room in the little island. A notice was waiting for us here that Gregor and Vasilyon were doing rather well. The servant gave some hot cacao and rusks to us. I. told me to eat and to go to sleep on the sofa in his room. I only had time to put my head on the pillow and I sank somewhere immediately.

Chapter 25

My awakening. I. is working in the factory as an ordinary worker. The first dinner in the oasis after the storm. I.'s conversation with the dwellers of the oasis in the dining-room. The masters of the oasis

I woke up as though from some blow, as quickly as I had fallen asleep. The impression of an unusually vivid dream didn't allow me to comprehend anyway where I was and what was really happening with me.

I was dreaming that I was in Radanda's Community together with I. and Yassa. We are keeping watch by the gate. The storm is wailing and raging around us, but we are working persistently, together with Radanda and his brothers we open the gate, and now we let the caravans in, now we bring the victims, hardly living people and even animals, in.

The dream was very real, my organism could feel the raging storm there strongly, so a little time had to pass until I finally understood that anyway I wasn't at Radanda's, that Yassa was sleeping in the adjacent room, that I was sleeping in mother Anna's oasis and that I.... And where was I.? He had to be here, with me, didn't he? But the room was empty, I didn't see any signs that he was sleeping here. I jumped up from the sofa, I already wanted to run to the shower, but I noticed a note: "Set yourself in order without delay. The watchman will give the cacao to you and tell you where you can find me. There's a lot of work to do, remember what I've already told you – every strong hand is needed. Remember it and don't become absent-minded."

I hurried as much as I could. The old watchman brought the food, and he said to me that I. was in the factory and that I had to go there immediately. Needless to say how I was hurrying to fulfil this instruction.

I left the house, went to the little island and I saw that the sand mountains were already tidily shovelled away from the paths, but the flower gardens still didn't look very well. The watchman explained the way to the factory to me. I was walking down the quiet palm and fruit-tree gardens. Even if I hadn't seen their luxuriance and abundance of fruit before, anyway I would have been taken aback from the sorrowful remains of these devastated gardens. Only a half of the trees were left, and only those that were covered with cases and bent down to the ground with ropes. Now a lot of people were working here, they were examining attentively the rooted out and broken trees. People would only replant some of them into the newly prepared ground, they would saw and take out the others by planting the saplings immediately into the empty places. Several tall men were trying to lift a big palm with all its fruit up, but they couldn't come right with the gigantic tree in any way. I hurried to help them and here I could use my strength of Goliath without any restrictions. In several minutes of our joint efforts the tree was planted into the renewed and well-fertilized hole. Everybody who was planting this tree thanked me very much by wondering at my exceptional strength and deftness. They asked me timidly to help them to lift another big palm up. I liked it very much that I could help them, I was glad that for the first time I was recognized to be deft. We had to be delayed by this tree a little longer, because we needed to take the palm out of the case, to untie the ropes, to renew the hole, and all of it took almost an hour. I didn't forget about my main goal even for a moment: to find I. as soon as possible. But in this morning, everything was against me, somebody always delayed me.

As soon as I went to the playground, accompanied by a hundred of words of gratitude and blessings from the gardener's lips, I heard a moaning old watchman by the beautiful warehouse of games and sports inventory. It turned out that he wanted to open the gate of the warehouse, which was shoved inside by the wind, he didn't estimate his strength well, fell down, the gate fell on him and broke his leg. I had to carry the unfortunate man to the hospital which also wasn't so nearby.

By being afraid of causing more pain to him, I was carrying him in my arms like a small child, although he was very ashamed of it. The people whom I met on my way volunteered to take my heavy burden, but I knew that everybody had a lot of work to do, I remembered I.'s words: "Don't be afraid of the heavy burden." Until I carried the unfortunate watchman to the hospital, until I gave him to nurses, quite a lot of time flew by. I couldn't comprehend at all what the time was now. I couldn't see the sun, a continuous greyness was everywhere, which could be called in the same way both the predawn light and the evening dust which always descended here so quickly. By knowing about the way to the factory as much as the watchman of the island had told me, now I was wandering across the oasis by not finding the needed path in any way. I came up to the youths who were cleaning the paths and taking the sand mountains away. I asked them for the way to the factory and finally I reached it.

I still hadn't come up to the line of the buildings when I heard from the distance the hammer strokes, the loud voices, the saw clanking and dragging of some heavy items. Having entered the grounds of the factory, I stopped in order to let the line of camels to go by, who were pulling big, two-wheeled carts with sand and some glittering dust which I considered to be the wooden chips, but actually it was the glass powder.

I could see a lot of people by the big building. Everybody was occupied in his own job, nobody paid attention to me, and I didn't know whom I could ask about I. Accidentally I raised my eyes up and I saw Gregor up there who was standing on a high, wooden stair by the wide window of the first floor. He was giving commands to somebody deep in the room by holding some instruments in his hands. I was afraid of disturbing his work, so I didn't give a cry to him, but I walked through the wide gates of the factory by wishing to go upstairs to him. A woman stopped me by warning me that the walls and the roof of the factory had suffered a lot in the night, that now they were lifting new blocks up in order to stuff the holes, and that it was dangerous to walk here. She gave a smile to my question about I., she took me back to the

yard and showed me the same narrow stairs which led to the upper balcony. The woman brought me to the stairs and explained to me that I would get to that hall where I. was working through these stairs and balcony.

That what the woman called balcony actually was a wide gallery that surrounded the whole factory from that side, and the stairs which I considered to be wooden were made of glass. I was climbing up by doubting whether they would hold my goliath weight, because they reminded me more of a subtle element of decoration and not the interior detail meant for such heavyweights like me.

But independently of what I was thinking, my doubts ended, because I reached the very top successfully. I still hadn't entered the gallery when I felt the coolness instantly in comparison to the heat downstairs and I heard I.'s voice.

"Lyovushka, you could prepare yourself even for longer," he was laughing by seeing my embarrassment that I couldn't see him among the dumped different size blocks of glass.

"Here, to that side, you'll either crack yourself there or you'll break the wall and floor blocks that aren't fortified yet," I. was crying to me.

Finally, I saw a narrow passageway and I. standing in its end... he was wearing the native clothes, commanding and at the same time he was helping several workers with the same clothes to put the blocks into the gaping holes in the walls and the floor.

"Change your clothes quickly, here are your clothes. I need an accurate, impeccable eyes and very strong hands," he continued by laughing again at the moment when I simply turned into stone by turning into Lyovushka the Catcher of Crows.

My God! I. was so charming! If during the first days of our acquaintance I wanted to put the wreath of flowers on his head and I saw him as a Greek God, then now my soul was filled with respect and charm. I could imagine everything – I. who was saving people in all sorts of circumstances, who was risking his own life, till the miraculous rescuing of the lost caravan in that night. But I. in the native worker's clothes who was turning stones, half-naked, dirty with clay or some grey powder... and anyway, he was more charming than anybody whom one could imagine among the living beings of the earth.

Having changed in shorts and tunic in a flash, I took the place instructed to me, and according to I.'s commands from one side and Gregor's commands from the other side, I helped the workers to place the glass blocks precisely into the necessary places.

We had to work hard and tensely, but finally, the holes in the walls were fixed and only some of them were gaping on the floor, and the heaps of the blocks were gone. A horn signal was heard, I. commanded everybody to finish the work and to get ready for the dinner. Everybody was working joyfully, but even more joyfully they hurried to the showers. Gregor approached us, Vasilyon climbed down somewhere from the roof, and all of us together finished some of the remaining work.

I. who didn't overlook anything was still delayed a little by instructing Gregor how he needed to finish fixing the holes on the floor, while I took advantage of this break and scuttled to the shower which I had seen downstairs. Having put myself in order quickly, I went upstairs, found I.'s clothes and said to him by giving them to him.

"Yassa isn't here, Teacher, allow me to remind you that it is time to dress, I can hear the horn for the second time."

I. was laughing merrily, and he asserted that he didn't expect in any way that mother Anna's oasis would affect my discipline so much. Gregor and Vasilyon accompanied I. to their bathroom which was right here, next to the workshop. In a moment we were already walking across the garden, and we entered the dining-room with the strike of the bell. Not only a single sign of any patients and injured wasn't left here, but everything was so shining here, as if it was washed and newly covered with the shining varnish. Mother Anna seemed not only younger to me, but even more charming with her shining veil and wonderful dress. Having invited us at her table and showed the previous seats at the adjacent tables to our friends, mother Anna sat down on her constant place, she told to bring the food and addressed I.

"Your presence, Teacher, makes a miraculous influence. No one from the severely injured died. Also, mother with two children, whom the dog unearthed from the sand, also the dog survived, although nobody expected to save these lives anymore. Only your given drop of the liquid saved mother, her children and the animal. Besides, the most valuable trees and hothouses covered in your instructed way remained sound. No hunger threatens us. Thank you."

"No hunger threatens you, mother Anna. But most importantly, the caravan with grain and flour, as well as with the new fertilizer which will allow you to cultivate the area of the desert prepared for you for growing the wheat, reached Radanda's Community successfully, as I was informed," I. answered her. "Ali is sending to your oasis both the new breed of very tough donkeys and the new equipment which reminds of several joined ploughs which will plough the desert deeply. Having heard Radanda's sent signals of alarm, the caravan was in time to hide in his Community and neither people nor animals suffered, although they had to experience the horror of the desert storm. An agronomist is coming to you, who turned out to be a strong and brave man. Only due to his help the packs remained sound when the camels began to rage from the storm horror."

That came upon me as a shock. I saw clearly a white-skinned man as alive in my dream, who looked like an Irishman, didn't I? He was sitting on a big camel, loaded with packs, completely furious already, roaring, with a lather falling from his muzzle. The man was stroking the animal's neck by trying to give his calm to him. I myself rushed to help him and I brought the mad camel in, who didn't perceive anything anymore and who didn't see the gate. What does it mean? Was I. dreaming the same dream?

I. looked at me, the sparkles of humour only flashed in his eyes, he smiled and said to me.

"When man's spirit becomes stronger, all "miracles" and all dreams, Lyovushka, come true when the powers of his spirit and heart become equal. Only a know-nothing may acknowledge a part of science and deny its conclusions. If man has taken the path of knowledge, he doesn't have to give in to superstitions or stop halfway only because some of his observed actions or events seem to be "impossible" to him. In the same way as Yassa's sleep when you can see his sleeping body and you cannot see his working consciousness, so your sleep when you cannot see your physical body, you don't remember the work of your consciousness, - without knowing what and how your body is doing, that is whether it was sleeping or it was given as a new form, - those are only small stages that lead to the great knowledge. The paths are different. In the beginning they explain to some, instruct them precisely, and only then they are working. They don't explain anything to the others how to work. They are spiritually prepared. Only their highest consciousness and its actions descend into the physical orbit of their lives, so they don't remember the work of their consciousness in the higher worlds. Draw conclusions from everything what I told you yourself, remember your "dream" precisely, how you woke up - and you won't need any of my detailed explanations. You've seen many times already the invisible help for the others. You only need to remember the storm in the night in the Black Sea, Florentian's image which you saw, but which the captain didn't see. Probably now you will understand and evaluate differently many things that you've seen before. And now - eat. Learn the absolute self-control, although a storm would be raging inside of you."

My dear friend's and Teacher's answer really caused the whole storm of sharp and incomprehensible questions in my consciousness. On the one hand, I felt that I certainly needed to receive answers to them, on the other hand, I comprehended immediately, as if in a flash, that I needed to pass this lesson of the absolute self-control. Both of these contradicting feelings – my desire to find out everything immediately and my determination to wait for an opportunity, - was lost in an absolutely new happiness: I understood that my dream was not a dream, but the reality in which I was working together with I. and Yassa. But how? How could it happen? I couldn't comprehend it, only I knew with my entire being that it was the reality.

All of it like a chaos in the desert blew over me in a flash, and one task rose above it all: the task of the passing by "now", now I had to do the lesson of the absolute self-control. Having laid my great respect by I.'s feet, I controlled myself, I concentrated my attention, and I began to feel my part in the lives of the people who surrounded me. The faces of almost every native were tired. There were many injured, with their hands and legs dressed. I could see bandages on some heads and eyes. As I found out later, enraged animals injured several people severely, which were successfully brought back from the desert only with help of I.'s given leaves. Frantic camels and several elephants didn't obey even the most experienced guides.

From everybody who had gathered in the hall, today not so abundantly as always, only few had an inclination for conversations. The silence was prevailing like in Radanda's dining-room. Everybody's face was concentrated, determined and firm, but one couldn't feel any strictness in them. Like during the first time, I could feel friendliness and satisfaction as the main waves of emanations from the people here pouring around. There wasn't anything that looked like the storm of a protest or indignation that brought so many sad events for the oasis. As if everyone here was a wise man, and he was pouring his wisdom and culture of his heart into the joint boiler of love.

Absolutely unexpectedly for me, I. rose, and his wonderful voice began to flow like a refreshing stream. I had never felt so strongly the flow of cheerfulness and joy from this voice.

"I promised you, my dear friends and children, to talk about the tasks of your lives in the modern humanity. I promised it to you on the eve of the storm. I called you to concentrate your courage and to hold an absolute self-control. What does an absolute self-control mean in the moment of horror? That means to keep the complete ability to work of one's organism. That means to possess such power of loyalty that it would be possible to extinguish the agitation of the man who is working next to you and even to pour calm and self-confidence into him. Have you succeeded to keep the power of your self-control during this horror night? Were you courageous till the end and devoted to our common business, to that creation and fortification of life for which mother Anna was preparing, educating and calling you? Have you responded with the heroic tension of all your strength when the time of tests came, when you had to act and not hesitate?"

I. made a little pause. Now he looked like the storm of God with his power and radiance which were spreading from him and filled the entire hall. While the people were listening to him standing, with their hands put respectfully, they were looking at his face, as if their eyes had been fastened to that power. As though they turned into stone while they were waiting for the word that evaluated their behaviour. A thought flashed to me that probably in the same way people should wait for the judgment during their last hour of the eternal Judgment Day.

"Oh yes, you've fulfilled your task of the passing by moment of horror. You turned the decisive hour of fight into the hour of the Creating Life. You've defended the oasis, you've consolidated Life."

I.'s voice was so silent and gentle when he uttered these last words. If not the deadly silence, probably it would have been very difficult to hear him.

And suddenly, as though an exploded echo of the storm flew around the hall – the gratitude escaped everybody's chest so strongly. God, how the people's faces changed! They were so strained a moment ago and now they were radiating happiness and joy which I used to see radiating only in the faces of the people who were living with undisturbed tranquillity.

"Everybody who was able to serve the task of the passing by moment tonight, everybody was courageous, everybody was fighting by loving, overcame by loving and reached the consolidation of Life on the earth. The whole Bright Brotherhood is sending its congratulations and regards of grateful joy to you through my lips. You've shared your work with it and brought it on the earth, you've fulfilled its task on the earth. Be blessed! With your demonstrated courage and strength, you've joined the big troop of invisible assistants who now may be closer to you and help in your work easier, because tonight you've erased all the conditional boundaries between them and yourselves with your fearlessness. Every spiritually developed man is carrying one or another task within himself during each of his incarnations, and sometimes several of them, depending on how many talents came to life in the flames of his strengths and which of them have grown into the creative aspects of the Only One. The first and most important boundary of conditionalities that prevents the man's talents from developing – that's fear. Not only you've overcome, you've opened your courage and fortitude as your actions which you've done by forgetting about yourselves and thinking only about your motherland. Be happy! By crossing this first limit, you must walk forward. You know that Life is the Eternal Movement. People who've reached fearlessness may not live only on the narrow section of the path of their personal development anymore. Like lighthouses they must become an attractive fire for the people's uniting. Your hour has struck. Many of you will leave your beloved oasis where you were hoping to live your entire life and lie onto the desert sand, in the shade of the rustling palms, next to your parents and your work. The hour has come for you – those within whom the courage has matured, - to leave this little patch of the soil. Those will leave together with me who are heroically prepared to renounce the silence and the nature's beauty, the simple and pure life in the dear, poetical place of the earth, who will be able to live in the entire universe, to see not places and people in it, but the paths of the universe towards the Only One, towards His work. First of all, they will go to Radanda's Community about which they've heard. They will see there different habits of the conditional adaptation to the external communication with people. Then they will go to Dartran's oasis together with me where they will be observing another phase of the external habits and internal people's life. And then they will leave for America, to the great Teacher Florentian. They will master the external culture of the progressive humanity there, they will bring into it the whole fire of their loyalty, the whole depth of their honour, nobility and honesty, their liberation by uniting with people, the whole height of their spiritual knowledge, everything that they have tempered within themselves under mother Anna's guidance. I am happy that there isn't a single heart among all the people gathered here who would be suffering from the thoughts that they need to leave their dear and habitual life, and to go to the end of the world, to bring there the actions of their love and tranquillity for the general people's welfare. Prepare, my friends, for the distant journey. Some of you are destined never to come back here, the others will come back as grey old men, but with the same young and pure hearts with which they will leave their motherland. They will bring here that higher external culture which they will master in the distant lands, and with that they will increase your oasis significance in the universal evolution of humanity even more. It is destined for your small, unknown to anybody oasis, lost between the little islands of the drifting sand, to play the role of the spiritual laboratory during the moment of the universal evolution of this time. It is destined for your descendants to become the first pioneers of the race rewarded with high psychic powers, - the race which Life is preparing by wishing to change the race which is still thriving now, but which leaves the historical scene. Be strong. Create your day with love and joy, and don't step back from uniting with all invisible assistants whose work

will be so easy and clear from now on, as well as the work with all the people living on the earth. Heaven and the earth for you – that's the continuous unity. We'll still talk in the evening, and tomorrow night we'll leave for Radanda's Community. The storm will fall completely till that time. Today go to finish cleaning the oasis, so that before your departure you would leave as beautiful and orderly as it was before the storm."

I don't take to describe everybody's joy who were present here. They were running about, congratulating one another, jumping, laughing, as if they were celebrating some great feast. The hall was soon empty, only our friends remained whose faces betrayed their inner excitement.

"Bless us, dear mother Anna, for the further work," I. addressed mother Anna.

Mother Anna's face surprised me.

I thought that up to now I hadn't perceived at all who mother Anna was. Now I saw not that alive face before myself which turned to me when I cried: "Anna!" That – as it sometimes happened with Radanda – was an image of ages, made of ivory, an icon of centuries. Some courage forced its way through to the surface and covered the whole woman's kindness, womanhood and usual tenderness so much that one could consider this face to be a man's one.

"God will bless you, Great Teacher. Of course, you want not only to finish setting the factory in order, but also to introduce your closest disciples to the chiefs of my oasis and their laboratory," mother Anna answered silently, and even her voice seemed to me to be a little lower than usual, as though an echo of some unearthly bell had become its background...

"You guessed it, mother Anna, today, for the first time during the time of separation in your oasis, its Masters must start communicating with white-skinned people whom the Bright Brotherhood has sent to them. As you know, seven such encounters are foreseen for your protected Masters, and only then all of you will become free from the earthly work. I promised you to talk about Anna. Tonight, you will hear about her. Now I will tell you only this: don't wait for a replacement for yourself from her. Her loyalty has become unsteady, and you know yourself that that one who has devoted himself to his personal feelings at least once and to their guidance after he was called to serve for the Evolution of Eternity, may not be your successor anymore... Now we'll go to work. There aren't more than three hours left for the most important work in the factory which I must guide myself. Please visit us later and take us to the Masters. I will take all my disciples with myself."

"Let your will be, Teacher," mother Anna answered him silently again, and again as though a bell of the universe began to din in my ears.

I concentrated my attention to I. and his conversation with mother Anna, and only now when we left the round hall and we were following I. to the factory in silence, I had the possibility to look more attentively at my dear friends whom I could see only in passing during the night of the storm.

How all of them were changed! I couldn't say that they had become old in one night, but some new resolution and maturity appeared in their faces, as though the night of the storm has opened an absolute fearlessness in their hearts and fixed them in that fearlessness. I could see their new perception: the merging of the passing by "now" with the whole Eternity and an indivisibility of every passing by moment from Life of the entire universe.

The faces of my friends, as much as I knew them, were firm, but now as though I could see a resolution of some part of I.'s power in them. As though only today, through their fearless work of the night they were able to merge with him much closely.

Soon we reached the factory, and we were immersed in our urgent work. I found a proper and useful work not only for us, but also for Nataliya Vladimirovna. While he, although not changed in his working clothes, was leading all of us at once, we could hear his voice from the most unexpected places, he was in time everywhere to help to fix the smallest damages and to dispel any misunderstandings.

I was working next to Bronski and Igor. Under Gregor's and I.'s guidance we were all putting the blocks delivered to us diligently and accurately. The work was difficult, because we had to lift and fit big and heavy blocks, besides I was always drawn to all sides where they needed an exceptional, physical strength. I was happy to help everybody, and there is no concealing that I was even proud of my reputation of the strong man. This quality was so new to me that in a hurry to help somebody I was still thinking whether my strength of Goliath hadn't yet disappeared.

Everybody broke into a sweat, we didn't feel the time flow at all; it seemed to us that only a half an hour had passed, so we were very confused when I.'s voice was heard.

"Well, my patient workers, now all the most crucial work is done. The rest of it will be done without you. The most important was to save the section of the machines and not to derange its work. Soon mother Anna will come."

When the heaps of the glass blocks were put in their places and the natives, who were always ordering the hall from the constructional rubbish, cleaned almost the whole place, I saw several big boxes that were tied to the rings with ropes, which were threaded to the floor. I understood that those were some valuable equipment which Gregor and Vasilyon protected from the sand and the wind before the storm. The ropes which were holding the boxes went through the floor to the ground floor and they were also fastened to the floor there.

However we hurried to put everything in order, anyway we came later than mother Anna who was sitting between I. and Nataliya Vladimirovna, and who was talking about something to Andreyeva who was arguing furiously (at least it seemed to me like this). I only heard the last mother Anna's words.

"The path of the earth and the work on it will be difficult for you still for a long time, my friend, because the earth, in whatever of its places you would be living, requires the development of all man's instruments if he is walking through it as the carrier of spiritual discoveries. It is impossible to carry the Divine work in your heart and – while carrying it – not to develop the tact that corresponds to its scale. It is impossible to possess the fiery power of the spirit and not to develop the instruments within yourself, which are given to the full perception of your encountered person's strength and character, which is needed in order for you to always know precisely till what level you can and must draw him into the fire of your power. It is impossible to touch the grindstone of the God's mill in any other way as only by taking out the ground presents of the Truth for people. If you give the most secret knowledge to the ignorant person, he may die from his ignorant behaviour with it by being of benefit neither to his surroundings nor to himself. Also, he may suffer after his incarnation, because after leaving his body he will understand what he possessed, and due to his regrets, he will be delayed in the world of passions for much longer than he would have stayed in it without knowing anything. The development of the vigilant attention has nothing to do with cowardice, as you understood my words in the beginning. But I think that your acquaintance with the chiefs of my oasis will be of use for you more than for anybody else. And you will understand for sure how the man who is rewarded with his developed physic powers and who is chosen by Life, but who completely doesn't possess any self-control, harms the people of the earth and the living beings of the unearthly worlds."

"Get ready, my friends," mother Anna addressed us all, "for one of the greatest encounters of your life. Those whom you will see, came to the earth from another planet a long time ago in the scale of

the calculation and perception of time of the Earth. You aren't destined to know about their lives for a while. All that I can say to you – that Radanda together with me took out from the secret Community where Ali, still an absolutely young boy back then, rescued and hid them by his Teacher's instruction. The chiefs, or the Masters of the oasis, as Teacher I. calls them, finish their obligations for the Earth here. You heard that today their first encounter with the white-skinned new-comers would take place. You start the sequence of those encounters, seven of which will occur, and then they will become free from the duty for the Earth, and I will become free together with them. I am that messenger whom Life has chosen to inform the Masters about your arrival, about the beginning of their liberation. You are those messengers whom Teacher I. has chosen to give the results of their work to the wide world. Teacher I. is that messenger who was chosen by the whole Bright Brotherhood, all the Great Beings to introduce the new tasks of the culture of the spirit, heart and matter into the commonness, into the atmosphere of the Earth that is conditioned by the time and the space. Teacher I. has developed all his instruments, because all aspects of the Only One have come to life within him, that's why he was chosen by the Bright Brotherhood. The only one law supports us all during the great and not great moments of our work and actions: the law of our loyalty. Now, in this important moment, concentrate your spiritual strengths, rise with your thoughts, address the highest whom you know and remember by strengthening this loyalty: no miracles exist, only one or another level of knowledge exists. You will enter not the world of fairy-tales or miracles, but the world of the greatest reality. Respect the Eternity that is flowing through this moment."

Mother Anna stepped down and went to the green wall of the oasis next to I. This wall was far from the factory, we were walking fast for no less than twenty minutes. It was strange to see the big part of the wall that wasn't touched at all by the storm which was raging during the night. Everything next to it was destroyed and broken, while the big gap of the wall was showing green nicely, and even the blossoms at the tops of the thorny trees seemed to me more splendid and brighter next to the devastated areas.

I couldn't understand in any way where mother Anna was leading us. We already went up to the very wall, and there wasn't any possibility to keep walking. But suddenly, I saw that I. opened something like the little gates which were also grown imperceptibly into the thickest place of the wall of the crooked trunks like the gates of the oasis. As though a stony grotto was behind the gates, but when we approached it, it turned out to be the tunnel made of the same glass as the lighthouse.

When we came out of the tunnel, we got into the internal small yard which was unusually tidy and decorated with the most beautiful flowers. I had seen some Spanish patios in engravings, some internal little yards with fountains and sculptures, so I felt instantly some features of the ancient Mauritanian style and culture of that time in the surroundings. Everything here wasn't modern, even by evaluating the fact that we were far away from the European civilization. A high fountain was playing in the middle of the yard, the pure water was babbling calmly in its basin. The green wall here was twofold, while the whole yard was overgrown with one more high wall that was buried in the blossoms of divine beauty and forms of the climbing plants.

Even mother Anna's warning that rose in my memory didn't help me to get rid of the thought that I was in the world of the dreams. Apparently, I. felt that I was turning into well familiar Lyovushka the Catcher of Crows, and he took my arm by returning me to the present. I concentrated my entire attention.

Now mother Anna who reminded me more of the view from a fairy-tale with her shining veil and not the real woman, was going alone ahead of everybody, she approached the small, hardly noticeable, black, carved door and tapped on it with a hammer three times. The door opened immediately, as if it had been waiting for us. We entered the bright gallery, stuck all around with blossoms, and we got into the spacious, paved yard.

Several buildings were here, they were so original, built from the same unknown stone. If not I.'s hand, I would have certainly stood gaping at them again.

The biggest, main building was round, with the glass roof that was shining even in the present, gloomy light. I could only try to imagine the brightness of its shining in the sunbeams of the desert.

The walls of this building were white with three, wide, black bands above and the same four ones below. There weren't any windows. A golden ornament was winding down the black bands, but those could be the inscriptions unknown to me.

Seven very high houses were standing in the yard, separately one from another, they were absolutely dark, almost black, but I couldn't understand what they were built of. All their doors were so artistic that they could take the honourable place in any museum.

While I was preparing to inspect the nearest house better, the doors of all seven houses opened at the same time, and seven figures went out of them. God! I had already seen the man of the stunning height. I had seen Florentian of an exceptional height. I had seen Ali of enormous, stunning height, but those who showed up now could be equal only to the giants from the fairy-tales.

I. stopped, mother Anna stopped next to him, also all of us stopped. The figures who were dressed in the same way as mother Anna on the day of our arrival, with long sticks in their hands, gathered by the round building, lined up and bowed to us in silence.

"Welcome," the man with the shining, five-pointed star hanging on his chest, who was standing in the middle uttered in Pali language. "In what language could I talk to your disciples, Teacher, so that all of them could understand us?" he addressed I.

"Some of my disciples can speak the language in which you are talking now, Master. But if you want that absolutely everybody understood you, choose one of the modern European languages if you please," I. answered him.

"Is English language all right?" the Master asked him again by passing to this language which by the way has already become the everyday means of our communication.

"All my disciples know this language well. If you are so kind as to speak it, there won't be any difficulties."

Having taken Nataliya Vladimirovna's hand, I. brought her to the senior Master and uttered.

"You know this disciple from other times, other places and in other bodies. Today Ali is sending her to get your wisdom, and he asks you to teach her all the occult knowledge in your laboratories, about which he was talking to you and which the Bright Brotherhood considers to be necessary and suitable for this time to spread in the wide world... This brother," I. continued by bringing Oldenkot to him, "will accompany faithfully the first one, he will be her assistant in the Earthly work and educator of her childhood. Both of them will go through the new cycle of life with absolute chastity. The power has been given to him to cure people, help him with your knowledge and pass those stones which are destined to give to the Earth, to discover them as the new chemical combinations. The Bright Brotherhood has made this decision... Here is Gregor. I've already told you about him. Give the new paint to him and help him to paint pictures, so that he would bring their secret into the world for the wide usage. Help him to reach the portrayal of reality in your laboratory and the new processing of the canvas for the painting with oil, so that the masses could use it, and it wouldn't stay as only an individual achievement. He must create the new epoch of the art... Here is his brother Vasilyon. He has already done everything what you've passed to him

about the glass through mother Anna. Through him the Bright Brotherhood asks you to bring the new technologies of production of glass, China and also the enamel discovered by you into the world."

The senior Master took Vasilyon's hand and put him before his neighbour from the right, while Gregor – before his neighbour from the left. He put Andreyeva before himself and he took Oldenkot to the last Master from the left.

"We took care of four of them," he smiled and said to I., and this smile began to shine like a sunbeam. "Three more are left. What is foreseen through them?"

"Those are the former carriers of sadness in the past," I. took Bronski's and Igor's hands and uttered. "They will come together, too. The Bright Brotherhood has brought them into the circle of the carriers of joy. They will have to pour the new power of the influence of beauty into the world through the art that is changing in time. Open all the secrets of creation of Eternity to them in your laboratory, so that they could instantly penetrate into the new nerve-knots of people by influencing the fire of the crowd of listeners consciously and seeing clearly how and what is attracting the man in their art. Open the path to them in your laboratory to treat mad people with the sound and the word."

The Master brought Bronski and Igor to two of his friends from the right side. I was left the seventh disciple from everybody, and only one Master, the middle one from the left side still didn't have any disciple.

"Florentian is sending this disciple to you, Master. He asks you to remember how several times and not during one Earthly life you passed your plentiful knowledge of the occult worlds to several writers and how all of them used that knowledge for their personal goals, which directed the regiments of the dark powers to you and your colleagues by drawing around you the biggest army with resistant fortresses. Your repeated efforts and Florentian's help liberated you from the terrible bond with dark powers, but the knowledge to which Life destined to penetrate into the people's world in a poetic and literary form, remained not brought to the masses. This boy at whom you are looking now with your sad eyes, as if you were reading his future destiny among the people who are always denying those great pioneers who destroy their persistently protected mode of life of conditionalities, possesses the sufficient power of spirit, so that he wouldn't lose his joyfulness and wouldn't give in to depression. Also, he is carrying an unshakable loyalty for which Florentian warrants you. Accept me as the second warrantor. Open to him all the inner path of knowledge of the spiritual creation of the unearthly worlds and take him around all the plans, so that he would perceive the whole integrity of the creators of the earth and heaven through his own experience. The nearest task that is waiting for him: to tear the restrain with religion, with all its allowed and not allowed conditionalities off the people's consciousness. He must help man to create his earthly life as a basis of his own honour and fearlessness with his powerful talent of the writer. Your other friends will pass their knowledge to the rest of the disciples for the same goal: to liberate man. In this way the first circle of passing your knowledge and work to the Earth will begin and be set. The Bright Brotherhood was protecting you, all seven Masters, as it was instructed from higher. Finally, the race of Atlantis suffered, through a conscious or unconscious fault, but when all seven of you were actively participating. Now the period of preparation of creation of the new race has come. You are given a great circle of seven meetings with the most prominent people of the Earth who will bring your knowledge into the wide world in parts, about the timeliness of which the Bright Brotherhood will decide. During this first meeting it asks you to give everything about which you were told yesterday to my disciples. As soon as this task of yours will be fulfilled, one of the black bands that surrounds the laboratory will disappear, which were painted not by you, but which appeared themselves when you started working here. That will mean that your task will be perfectly fulfilled, and the last circle of your liberation will start, because it is also the circle of your last serving to the Earth. Your disobedience of remote ages was the beginning of the downfall

of the thriving nation and one of the most psychically talented race. Now the time has come for you to start creating the new, liberated race with no less developed psychic qualities. Accept the Bright Brotherhood's regards and its congratulations and joy for you – the Masters of Power – joining the general work by creating the new race and its consolidation on the Earth."

He bowed to the highest Master, and all seven of them responded him with their low bow.

"I will take your disciple, writer and the future apostle of liberation myself," the senior Master answered him by taking my hand and placing me before himself, next to Andreyeva. "But while I will be occupied with my old familiar and rebellious friend," he continued by pointing at Nataliya Vladimirovna, "the writer will be learning by the most famous, ancient writer to whom the creative paths of many worlds are opened for a long time already." Having said this, he brought me to the only one remaining Master from all seven.

As soon as all of us were assigned to the new Teachers, the senior Master bowed to I. once again by inviting him and mother Anna to go together with us to the laboratory, but I. answered him.

"In the same way as you have the general task and you are conductors of Life in this hour, who will load its new receivers, so I have the task received from the Bright Brotherhood that doesn't allow me to be delayed. Mother Anna is walking next to you, who is conductor for everything what the Bright Brotherhood entrusted her to give to you, and also through you for this place of the Earth and for its inhabitants, as well as for the distant Communities of the deserts. Her path, although it is closely connected with you, anyway it isn't your path. The Bright Brotherhood has directed me to her today. After leaving my seven disciples to you, I come back to the little island together with mother Anna, so that I would give the tasks of her nearest and later days to her. Be blessed, Teachers and Disciples! Let the calm and devotion accompany your mutual work. This significant hour in life of everyone's of you has struck in the alive God's presence, and the great hour of the new, general task of the whole Bright Brotherhood begins."

I. and mother Anna bowed together to everybody and disappeared in the blooming gallery. Only the silent sound of the narrow door that closed behind them told us that now some uncontrollable obstacles separated them from us.

The silence and stagnation, as if the Masters had turned into statues, continued for a long time in this internal yard. The silence, deadly silence of the desert – that's what I heard for the first time in my life. I never heard the similar silence anymore, although I happened to be alone in the most silent and uninhabited places.

The Masters kept standing like some statues. I still didn't tell anything about their appearance, except their height. The colour of their skin was copper red, but the colour had a very pleasant hue. Their hair was black or dark brownish, and it reached their shoulders in beautiful curls.

Their faces?.. But it was impossible even to call them faces. Those were some enormous images which reflected their Ancient Wisdom. They were symbols, but really not people anymore. If, as mother Anna told us, they came onto the Earth from another planet, then it was absolutely nothing surprising that they looked like the living symbols of Eternity on the Earth to me.

God, how many questions blew over my head like the wind. How I wanted to know about their life and their work, but the senior Master interrupted all these thoughts with his silent, but so clear voice which was impossible on the Earth.

"Let's enter this house of knowledge, newcomers. You are the first people during the very long time whom we are ordered to let into the laboratory of the elements. Lots of surprises are waiting for

you there. But remember one thing by entering: no religion higher than the Truth exists. The Truth is alone, and a tremendous lot of the paths to it exists. You will enter this house of knowledge, so that it would be easier for people to understand how to throw down the domination of their accumulated conditionalities during the ages from them and to give the possibility for the Creating Origin within them to rise to the surface. No one from us is demanding any pledges from you, because you enter here not to remain silent, but to tell people about the new principles of life that turn into the people's actions. If you were brought here, then you are prepared. Only the fearless and pure heart may cross the threshold of the laboratory of the elements. You are destined to give new knowledge to people, to talk and to write about it. But to talk in our language means to bring the power in, to prove with actions that what you dared to say. Every word must open for the listener his path to act with the new knowledge. While talking, evaluate not only the knowledge itself, but search for the new principles within yourselves – the awakened aspects of the Only One which will open within you when you enter the house of knowledge. Now begin to value the word in a new way, and only such clearly perceived words of yours will come up like the seeds and not the chaff. Perceive the power and purity of your sowing from the harvest. Because there aren't any obstacles for the paths of God".

Every Master took his disciples hand, and we followed the Master of the Masters to the door of the laboratory not in that order as we were standing now, but as I. had passed us to them. So, I was seventh again and I was the last who was walking with his Teacher.

Chapter 26

The laboratory of the elements. The rays of the paths of the mankind. The great Teachers who lead them. The Bright lots of the invisible assistants.
An unexpected view in the seventh ray

The Masters drew up before the place in which, as it turned out, was the door of the laboratory. This door either was fixed in the wall in such a way or it opened in some especial way that although it was high according to the Masters' height, but I noticed it only when it opened up wide. It opened at once by cracking, as if some discharges of many batteries had sparkled. And what was even stranger – a narrow, shining band of the bluish red fire appeared around the opened space, to be precise, around the whole doorframe by forming an oblongly roundish frame.

I remembered the words of the Master of the Masters that the fire of the elements would burn down a liar or a hypocrite on the threshold of the house of knowledge.

All Masters were walking from the left side by holding their disciple's hand with their right one. Since I was taller than all my friends, although I was the last, I could see well the whole interior of the building. It was lit up, and I could see another round building in it. It was all white with the only narrow stair, with big and steep steps. The stair was leading to seven floors, it ended with a balcony in every floor, and it rose from it upstairs again. The stair was straight, while the balconies surrounded the whole building. This building was without any windows.

Although my new Teacher-Master wasn't the tallest one, but I was only a little higher his trunk and I was feeling like a child by holding his hand. He read my thought immediately and he answered me with his smile with lightning speed by squeezing my hand a little.

There was so much warmth and benevolence in this smile and squeeze that any embarrassment of the first moments of our acquaintance disappeared, and everything in my heart was calm again. I plunged in the only one feeling – in perception of the great task that rose before me. I was begging Great Mother and Florentian to support me in this most significant hour of my life, so that I could take out the new knowledge for my brothers-people with the whole purity of my heart.

Another squeeze of my Teacher-Giant showed me that he could see through me again, and this helped me to concentrate more.

The Master of the Masters rose his hand high and uttered some absolutely unknown words. He was holding his risen hand until the fire of the frame concentrated into the big ball on top of the doorframe, and then it turned into a wonderful five-pointed star in the same place above, which was shining in such inexpressibly charming colours which my eyes couldn't imagine existing on the Earth.

All Masters went down on their knees and struck up a hymn. I cannot tell what really touched me in this hour. Whether it was the exceptional shining of the star, or the shocking sounds of the hymn which were clear like a glass, not from this world and they were sung in unearthly voices, or maybe the hymn itself, the music of which had nothing to do with the one that I had heard on the Earth up to now, but I fell on my knees and again I experienced that state of the blissful nonexistence which I felt when I came to myself in the chapel of Great Mother. As though I could see everything at once with my consciousness, I could see everything through, through the thickness of the menacing, double tower of the elements I could see the whole desert, the whole earth, the whole heaven – and the living beings were living everywhere, who were sending us their blessing, calm and help.

I saw Florentian who was blessing me with a wide cross, I heard his voice.

“Press my black jewel to your heart. If your heart is pure, the whole evil done by the people who possessed it illegally will stop existing. The fire of the elements will burn it down, and it will be easier for the evil spirits to pass through their terrible stages of redemption if your heart lifts their tear and your lips say a prayer for them. Don't lose your courage, my son, march fearlessly and honourably. And that what you will take out of here will stop being the secret as only your own knowledge and actions. But you will have to keep the fact itself where you have received your knowledge, who has consecrated you into them as an absolute secret until I tell you that you may already reveal it to people.”

The Masters finished their hymn, they stood up, and the star became the ball again, while the ball overflowed through the whole doorframe again by turning into the fiery frame. As soon as the whole frame began to shine, the Master of the Masters crossed the threshold by holding Andreyeva's hand, and Oldenkot with his Master stepped after him. Although the Masters were lean, but they were so cumbersome that they could climb the narrow stair only by two, one after another.

Having climbed up on the first balcony, the Master of the Masters opened the door of the first floor immediately and vanished behind it with Andreyeva. The second Master with Oldenkot disappeared behind the door of the second floor. In the same way all Masters went to their floors with their disciples. Me and Bronski were walking the last.

While we were going upstairs, my sight was going out, and when I climbed up till my Master's door, I could see everything only with my physical eyes already. This wonderful state of the absolute vision that was gone now, when I could see not only the small piece of this place of the Earth and its light, but the whole universe and when I understood that I was living in the Light of Life, left an impression as if I had become absolutely blind. This feeling of blindness during the first moment made me sad, but I remembered I.'s words immediately and that the believed in my stable joy. I smiled to my new Teacher who was still holding my hand. He directed my attention that another stair was rising above us, there was another balcony and the door to the dome itself which was shining very brightly externally even in this twilight that was still hanging after the raging storm.

When I looked at the dome from inside, not only it seemed to me shining, but even mat and lustreless. I couldn't decide in any way whether it was really like this, or it was only the result of my poor sight. A range of thoughts was swarming in my head: what was in that eight floor? Wasn't it a lighthouse which looked like that one in which I spent the night of the storm with I. and mother Anna? Or maybe there was some kind of a workshop? Maybe there was a joint hall of all Masters?

My Master smiled at all my flashing thoughts as they smile to children. I already stopped being astonished at his behaviour, I understood that he didn't need any language instruments, any words and I heard his answer respectfully.

"There's an observatory above. Later about it. We'll enter my hall. Keep an absolute self-control. You will enter the world of new ideas. This room for you is the most sacred temple in comparison to those places of the earth into which you could get with your physical body."

He opened the door – I didn't even notice how, - it moved to the side without any sound, and we entered the big room lit up with the bright light as the one of the desert sun. In the first moment, maybe from the unusually bright lightning which dazzled me a little, it seemed to me that the room was empty. Only when I got used to the lightning which was spreading from several balls from the ceiling, at which it was simply impossible to look, I noticed that there were many narrow, big tables in the room, which were unusually high for my height and unusually low for my Master's height.

I could see everything what was on the tables well, because they reached only my shoulders, but if I had to work at them, then I would have had to climb on some chairs.

I looked round and saw that there was not only a lot of the tables with round tabourets at them in the hall, but that a lot of glass cupboards of different sizes and forms were hanging very high on the prefabricated metal walls, shining like gold. All sorts of flasks, instruments, test-tubes and many other items were placed in them, which I hadn't seen up to now and I didn't know even the words to name them.

Every cupboard, every table, every shelf with books, the dimensions of which and their number said that only the living beings of such height and power as the Masters could use them, - everything was marked with such unusual characters that I only gave a sigh and accepted the circumstances once and for all. If Ali's room oppressed me with the variety of its languages, then what could I tell about this room? A life wouldn't be enough here to memorize where one or another item, or a book was in this temple of the science, because in comparison to my height this room had not one, but at least three floors. It was annoying that from such high post of observation that was higher than the seventh floor of the lighthouse laboratory I couldn't see the desert and know what was going on in the external world. The Master smiled, stroked my head and eyes with his hand, touched my forehead between the eyes, my neck close to the chest – and all of a sudden, I could see, I could see not even through the walls, but as though they had been absolutely gone. The whole desert was stretching before me, it was still bristled up, but already abated, without any wind and dust. I didn't need to turn my head to all sides or to turn back. I could see not only with my eyes, but with my entire consciousness. And I could see not only the bare desert. I could feel Life in it, behind it and under it. I could see that everything was Light. And the Light was pouring not only onto all visible items, but also from them it was spreading to all directions by connecting everything among themselves with shining threads, independently whether it was an alive or lifeless nature. Only in the first case the threads were brightly red, while in the second one – shining bluish and reminded me of the moonlight.

Between this Light I saw Radanda's Community, and Dartran's oasis, and the shining figures of Florentian and my brother Nikolay who were standing side by side and sending their blessings to me. I was feeling like merged with the entire universe, and the feeling of an exceptionally blissful joy embraced me. The Master touched my head lightly again, my sight returned to the normal powers, and again I felt like an imprisoned poor man...

Having accustomed myself to the unusually bright lightning, accepted that I had to walk between the legs of many tables and chairs and that I had to stand on tiptoe if I needed to put my hands on the table, I concentrated my entire attention on my Teacher.

Having noticed that I already got used to the state of the small boy in the giant's room, the Master brought me to one of the highest and widest tables. I didn't have time even to comprehend what happened and I already was sitting on the high chair, lifted by my guardian. If I had to seat a three-year-old child, anyway I would have spent more time. As though I lost my weight in his hands: like a pen which one shifts from one place to another on the writing-table.

"You can see several apparatuses here which are still unknown on the earth. Don't think that I invented them. They have been lowered into my consciousness from the higher worlds. Their creators have merged the powers of nature in such a way that the elements of the planet Earth could manifest themselves on it as the sequence of the new physical phenomena, chemical elements and psychic characteristics. While you are observing my work at this table, get rid of your superstition to separate the work of the earth and heaven once and for all. A task is waiting for you, which is no less difficult than mine, which my higher brothers – the Masters of power – assigned to me. My task is to prepare your consciousness to comprehend a part of those new discoveries which the Bright Brotherhood has recognized to be well-timed to send to the Earth. In order to realize this task, I had to develop new instruments, because my and your consciousnesses must merge into a complete harmony, so that they could create by bringing use for millions of consciousnesses of the Earth. You will have to leap the entire century, to leave your brothers on the Earth behind and to take away a lot of new knowledge for the masses through your talent. In order for you to do it, you need not only to open the new paths of consciousness within yourself, you also need to develop a lot of completely new instruments, so that you could pour the power of Light into the people masses, dedicated not only to destroy the old superstitions, which is much easier to do, but also to create a different, free and powerful, new man with liberated psyche. And that is one of the most difficult tasks. Look here, and you will see the work of the out-carnated humanity, the Masters of the elements and the Brothers of power in one powerful cord. You will see the view of the whole future life of the mankind in this small apparatus..."

The Teacher moved me with the whole big chair – again, as if both me and the chair were only some weightless feathers – nearer to the apparatus which he called small, but I was looking at it with an honourable fear, it looked like some tower to me. Actually, it didn't reach the ceiling, although the devices on other tables almost reached it. The Teacher took a wire, connected it to a glass socket in the wall, and the many-coloured flames began to run in the tower immediately. It seemed to me that I could see a glass sphere inside of it, but the Master told me.

"This sphere – that's the miniature of the Earth. It possesses all characteristics which the scientists of the planet will discover during its seven future cycles of the movement of eternity. Look here. The whole history of the Earth up till this moment and the further continuation of that part of life of the mankind, the pioneer of poetry and literature of which you are destined to become, will pass by before you on the living picture on the wall."

The Master uttered some words – I think that they were like those which the Master of the Masters uttered downstairs, by the door of the laboratory, – and on the very top of the wall, in that place where he was standing, several red, five-pointed stars began to shine. The he hit the golden surface of the wall – but maybe it was only shining like gold, – and such powerful blow was heard that I almost fell down from the chair. The smoke appeared on the wall, like a whirling fog of the mountains, only it was reddish. When it cleared away, I saw a lot of bright images, they were transparent, as if woven from some shining matter, but who kept their human forms. They were working with the sphere form balls which were made of the matter much thicker than themselves. The shining figures were placing a drop of the Fire of Eternity into those ball forms of the matter, which now was shining inside of every form.

The Master hit the wall again with his, to put it mildly, mallet which looked like a hammer weighing several pounds. The view disappeared in the mist again, and when it cleared away, I saw more concrete and denser human figures who were also shining and carrying down the ball masses with the Fire flittering inside. Hundreds of these figures were flying in a hurricane speed.

After the new hit of the Master the new view appeared in which even clearer human figures were carrying the same balls of the matter with the Fire into big halls and passed them to completely dense figures whom I comprehended as the Masters of karmas.

A blow was heard, the view changed, and I saw how the Masters of karmas were writing something in their big books, they passed the matte balls to even more material spirits, which became like some compressed little bits, but the Fire was flittering within them with the previous power.

The blows of the Master were changing the views. I could clearly see a strange place of the earth, I could see houses, and the spirits of Light were carrying the future people embryos – the origins of an incarnation into them.

I could see the process of an out-carnation in the new views. In the beginning, the spirit of the departed used to rise alone, then she merged with the most different spirits, corresponding to her karma and the level of development of her spirit.

“Now you can see how only creators are walking, the consciousnesses of whom completely comprehend the serving to their contemporaries. Observe attentively and you will understand the incessant circle of the Eternal Movement that is creating Life forever,” the Master uttered by hitting the hammer again.

I saw how the bright spirits were taking the shining shadows of the out-carnated people into some big halls. Here the people shadows were working with all sorts of devices, books and records like in big working studies.

In the changed views I could see how the people shadows were rising after finishing their work, they would become brighter, and finally, when they became absolutely bright, they would reach the radiating heights, disappear in them and set out again to that plan in which the workers of heaven were placing the drops of Fire into the matter balls. Having plunged themselves into the new matter ball with Fire, again they would continue the whole circle of life and work on the Earth and death on it.

The Master pulled the wire out, and the tower went out. Then he sat down next to me.

“You saw the scheme of the actions and work of the Eternity. Now when you know the whole circle which the man of the Earth covers along his spiritual path, we’ll pass to the analysis of the individual life of the man who receives his mission from the Masters of heaven.”

With these words my Teacher seated me at another table, next to the distant wall, and he lit a little bit smaller tower of an absolutely different form, with the five-pointed star on the top.

“You were allowed to make sure that death didn’t exit, that only the path of the eternal life and work existed. Now we’ll examine the path of the eternal development of separate people... There are seven Great Teachers who control the development of all people of the Earth with the Bright Brotherhood’s help. Those are only principal stages that are inevitable in the evolutional movement of every human consciousness. The entire world is divided into seven big sectors. An individual tower is burning with his own inextinguishable planetary Fire in every sector. The tower with his sector covers not only human spirits, but also the spirits of all lives (the ones of the living and lifeless nature by naming them in the modern terminology), which are moving actively or relatively actively with respect to the Earth. You already

know that not only in the world of the Earth, but also in the entire universe, such places in which an absolute calm would prevail don't exist. Everything is moving, independent of whether you comprehend this movement with your feelings or not. Now you will see one of the towers of the earthly universe and you can see those rays of light in it which your physical conductor is unable to comprehend in usual conditions."

The Master put some little as though glass plate into my hands, he explained to me that I was sitting on the chair that was impervious to the energy of Fire and he ordered me strictly not to move or express my feelings with any emotions, even if something surprised me very much.

I concentrated my entire attention. The Master hit the tower with a very small, but probably very heavy mallet. The rain of all sorts of colours and forms of sparkles began to pour, the walls of the laboratory completely disappeared, and again I began to see the entire universe and to perceive myself merged with its Light. I saw the tower overflowed with Light - I cannot say "in the distance", because both distances and the time vanished for me, - which was burning with the white fire on the Earth, and which was rising to heaven together with the whole fire. Its size surpassed all man's possible imaginations. The Caucasus Elbrus seen many times was only a small mole in comparison to the tower.

The rings of blue, green, yellow, orange, red and violet flames and transparent bands were shining in this strong, white radiance, inserted between the powerful white colour like some small rays. But what kind of the rays they were! I had never imagined that the rays of light could burn like this! If I could compare them with something, then maybe only with those fires in the many-coloured cups which I saw on I.'s and Francisco's altars.

"Look more attentively," the Master uttered by touching my vertex. "Maybe you will see somebody whom you know very well."

My view became even clearer, and I saw Ali's image of an unbelievable size, as though he was a chief of the whole tower. From his image that was buried in the white fires of the tower, the radiance was spreading very far, as much as my eyes could only reach. It was spreading with rays and gigantic rings, the vibrations of which were very charming. Hundreds of spirits who subordinated directly and indirectly to Ali were flying in all directions of the rays which were bringing in the action and harmony everywhere.

The nearer to the Earth the bright shadows were falling, the darker and denser their rings became, while close to the Earth they would gather into some solid channels, through which the lightnings of Ali's thoughts were pouring and dividing into a huge number of dots which inspired people-creators, the spirit of whom had reached courage and power. All Ali's thoughts which were flying to the Earth would acquire the most different forms of shining, wonderful lightnings.

"You can see the Master of power of the earthly universe, while we are his direct servants on the Earth. That's why Teacher I. called us the Masters of power. This great, selfless servant of the Truth starts the first circle of our liberation. You will receive talents and enlightenment from this ray of power, with which you will leave from here to the world to help the new race to settle, the leader and protector of which this colossal servant of the Truth will be. Those workers of the Earth are living in this ray, the loyalty and love of whom have reached the steady power and become unshakable. Only such living beings may withstand the fire of his powerful thought which is flying to the Earth like burning lightnings. Look here," the Master continued by bringing me to another table where a tower of almost the same size was standing.

Having done the same actions, waited until the swarm of ruby stars would shine, the Master directed my attention to a gigantic blue pole. Having looked more attentively, I comprehended that it also was the tower, of the same width and size as the white one. It also was spreading the rays of all colours and the rings in the sea of the living, trembling, blue fire.

I didn't have time to get used to this unusual shining when I saw the wonderful sir Vomi's image who was leading the blue tower. I was so surprised; I didn't expect to see this figure hovering in the sky, so I already was prepared to rub my eyes by not believing in the miracles which I saw one after another.

"Miracles don't exist, only the stages of knowledge exit, as your guardians were telling you many times," I heard the Master's voice. "He is the closest colleague, friend and brother in arms of Ali whom you saw already, but whose name is not Ali, as you will find out later. He is leading the wisdom of education and science. While taking care of the growing generations, he is sending periodically great chiefs and educators to each period of time through the Bright Brotherhood. They are taking care of the new personnel who possess much higher psyche in comparison to the leaving generation, subtler and many-sidedly developed instruments of spirit and body. Everybody who has a calling for education and teaching gets under the influence of this ray and the Wisdom that is descending through it if their serving is unselfish. Look more attentively what the work of the spirits and alive people is, who belong to this ray."

I saw that clear, blue rays were spreading from the whole sir Vomi's figure, all of them had the most captivating, many-coloured insertions, and the splendid blossoms of different forms were shining in the very depth of the blue abyss.

The Master touched my vertex lightly, and I began to see even clearer. That what in the beginning I considered to be the blossoms swaying on the long stem turned out to be the images of thoughts which were flying from the whole sir Vomi's figure. All these images of thoughts were connected to his figure and among themselves with the finest, bluish golden red sparkling threads.

While the images of thoughts were coming always down, they were changing their form little by little, and their original brightness was growing pale. Shining spirits were catching them like this and carrying down where they passed them to the denser forms.

The images of thoughts were coming down in such a way, and finally, they would reach gigantic, wide, shining funnels with a big cavity above and a narrow exit below. But of course, when I say "wide" or "narrow", this is only a relative rendering, because no earthly scales suited the plans of the universe. And the words themselves didn't quite correspond to that what my eyes saw.

Exceptionally charmingly beautiful spirits who always stayed in one and the same level used to take the images of thoughts from the descending upper workers and bring them to the funnels which were always spinning in a quick vortex. They would throw one and sometimes several forms of thoughts into their mouths. The funnels themselves, which in the beginning looked like the matter of a concentrated mist, were heterogeneous after taking a better look. They were made of a huge number of almost transparent, subtle human forms who were pushing everything from their protected brims of the funnels what didn't have to get into them, and they accepted only that what the concrete funnels had to accept.

The frequencies of the vibrations and waves of every funnel could draw into themselves only that what corresponded to their wave frequencies, while the protectors of the funnels were observing attentively that the vortex wouldn't draw something in by mistake. The spirits who were carrying the images of thoughts would often fly past ten and hundreds of the funnels by searching for some harmonious vibrations for their possessed images of thoughts.

"You are mathematician, and Teacher I. has revealed many mechanical laws of movement, that's why you understood so clearly that no mistakes could exist here. The law of gravitation is functioning here, but not so much distorted as on the Earth. The power of gravity here isn't physical, but spiritual. It has zero gravity, it is immaterial, invisible, it is living and affecting everything according to the law of cause and

effect," my Teacher was telling me, while I was observing the work of sir Vomi's assistants as bewitched. "Those mistakes that the workers of heaven, as well as the ones of the Earth may do, arise – or to be precise, may arise – only when somebody from the workers violate the same, the only one and the most important law of loyalty. Man's personal kindness in spiritual relations, his wrongfully comprehended sympathy, that is his desire to introduce somebody to the world of the new ideas and spiritual creation; not response to somebody's spiritual needs, but a persistent calling of an unprepared man to those heights where already the full organism's power and the whole harmony is needed – always lead to a catastrophe. In the same way as a flower bud dries off and not burst into bloom when it is placed in too bright sunlight by force, also the man's spirit, introduced to a higher plan than her harmoniously developed strength of the whole organism will call themselves and attract the vibrations and frequencies of the waves of the higher plan, not only gives any fruit of the creative Fire, but also brings distortions. She grows some big branch and dooms the whole organism for a degradation. In this way you can often see how an absolutely silly, weak man is doing some most complicated calculations by heart before a crowd of some gawks. Such man may tell you almost immediately what a day of such and such year was, tell you about some or other famous dates nearly from the beginning of the world, translate Cicero quotes into any language, calculate the size of Julio Cesar's army and other, insignificant phenomena which don't open any creation. The kindness of the people of heaven and the earth makes these mistakes which draw somebody to the spiritual rise too early. "Ask and you shall receive," – those aren't only the words of the Christian Gospel. This is one of the eternal and invariable laws of the universe. But it doesn't mean that you need to give to anybody who is asking the most sacred opening and to introduce him to the Saint of the most Saint. For a man who has set the saint goal for himself to serve people, to realize the God's plan, it means to dive deeper into that level of spiritual culture in which the asking man is living. You must enter his situation, his circumstances to evaluate all his possibilities and to give that part of the knowledge with the greatest tact and love to the man who is asking, which he may assimilate with an absolute harmony of his being. The third ray which we'll review now is leading this quality in the universe – an ability to develop the tact and all instruments for serving the mankind usefully."

While the Master was talking like this, he seated me at one of the highest tables on which the tower was standing and almost leaning the ceiling. It was covered with very beautiful, small drawings. The Master switched the tower on in the same way, with the hit of the mallet. He came to me and uttered.

"I warned you that you needed an absolute self-control. Whatever you would see – keep silent and calm. Don't give way to the flow of your thoughts at least for a moment, so that not a single of my words, not a single of your observed facts would stir your concentration. This ray will be the most important for you not only during this earthly life, but also in life of your heavenly, eternal work, and it will help your talent to open for people the essence and meaning of their earthly life."

The Master put his huge hand on my shoulder. It seemed that I should feel the whole weight of his palm which covered my shoulder of Goliath and of his fingers which almost reached my trunk, but I could feel only the coolness and the light needle prick, as though an electric current had been flowing through me. The walls that had already vanished for my sight before, now as though merged with the transparent air, in which I saw the balls of the green fire which were spinning swiftly around the colossal green poles.

In several minutes I saw that those were not poles, but a huge tower, the whole green background of which was carved with the fiery picture of the same hues as the towers which I saw before. Only maybe there was a little more orange and whiter colour here. Also, there were more shining, transparent and very fast, gigantic, medium and very small workers of the spirit. Actually, it was much more beautiful, and some gently joyous feeling of love was attracting me to it. I wanted to fall into the depth of

the green fire, to the workers of the spirit and to offer them my help. But I couldn't understand in any way what my self-control had to do here.

Suddenly, I felt that the Master's hand squeezed my shoulder stronger, and the electric current that was flowing from him into me became stronger. I rose my eyes up... and only with the efforts of my will I held back the cry of my astonishment and joy. Only by keeping my self-control with the Master's help, I was looking in a blissful ecstasy at the wonderful figure of Florentian who was leading the green tower. My dear, idolized friend was keeping here his whole earthly beauty and the proportions of his elegant figure, but at the same time this majestic and powerful image wasn't the same earthly Florentian whom I was used to see as my Teacher in the physical life...

In the silence of the desert, I could hear well the noise caused by the flying green balls, which reminded me of the thunder. In the beginning I could see only them. Little by little I began to notice how a huge number of shining workers detached a ball from the tower, how the spirits were carrying it in the necessary direction and how everything was accompanied by the threatening thunder. They were tearing the ball into separate parts which in their own turn were broken up even more until finally, a tremendous amount of flying, shining, miniature living beings stretched like the Milky Way, which was carrying the mass of the green ball broken up into little parts onto the Earth.

A goldish green thread connected every miniature being who was carrying her little green part with Florentian. It seemed that the countless lot of threads should get entangled in such a way that no force could untangle them. But all the threads intertwined by forming such harmonious and wonderful pattern which I'd already seen on the Master's tower in the laboratory of the elements.

"This ray isn't only necessary, but it is even unavoidable for the whole mankind. Only the creators of the mankind may reach the first two rays. Only those may follow them who can merge one or other creating elements of the planet and carry them out to the brothers on the Earth through their work. Only those who are distinguished for their talents of wisdom and spirit may follow the paths of these two first rays. All other paths for such spirituality talented – only the harmoniously developing occult scale. While the third ray for the whole mankind – that's the Origin of expression of everybody's spiritual characteristics. Until the man with ordinary talents and ordinary culture doesn't develop this tact, his ability to comprehend precisely the circumstances of the present time, until he isn't filled with the benevolence for everything what surrounds him in his living epoch, he won't be able to rise to the new path of his development. Don't imagine the meaning of these paths as some separately existing elements of the nature which direct people along some isolated paths which they may choose for themselves. Everything is connected in nature; everything penetrates and passes one through another. Also, the people are walking along those rays for which their spirit has matured, that is the vibrations which they radiate into the World, into the Universe draw them into the circles with the similar surroundings. Until the man passes by the third ray, he may not keep developing. Because the ray harmony follows it – the culminating point of the man's spiritual maturity. These two rays, the third and the fourth ones, are closely interconnected. If the third ray is the passable post of the whole mankind further to the eternal Evolution, then the fourth one is a barrier for everybody who bring out at least the smallest creative Origin to their work. The third ray has the most people who are walking it. For many, oh for how many times, the people come back to it until they reach such height of tact and develop such adaptation which would help them to stir up their Creative Origins."

Again, the Master brought me to another, not so big, absolutely yellow, round tower. The tower was buried in the shining yellow flame after the blow of the mallet. This time, as though a little further away than in previous towers, I could see the sea of the many-coloured tongues of fire which were curling fantastically in the yellow background. A round tower with the burning dome was rising from the

sea, above which I saw a figure with yellow Egyptian clothes who was holding a sceptre in this hand. I had never seen such or at least similar face before. He stunned me not with his beauty, although of course, he was handsome, but with such a divine tranquillity that was blowing from him, such a benevolence that I understood what the harmony was from one look at this face.

The more I was looking at the face of this Teacher whom I didn't know, the clearer I could comprehend and understand this expression of undisturbed tranquillity, love and kindness by remembering it in the faces of my well familiar, great friends Ali, sir Vomi, Florentian, I.

"As you can see a lot of workers bring their balls of the matter here and lead the separate out-carnated and incarnated people in their astral cases here. The difference between the moving in this and other rays is that everybody here go towards it and not from it. One goes towards this ray only consciously, and nobody may enter it with a strange help, without one's own active action. Here you can see the saying "work and you shall be repaid" in the direct meaning. Look at the Earth."

The Master directed my look into the atmosphere of the Earth as in the previous cases, and I saw the crowds of people who were working feverishly. All of them as though were buried in the fog. A sparkle of fire was shining in every separate living being, it was hardly noticeable in some of them and brighter in others. The views were changing before me like in the screen. Here the atmosphere became clearer, I could see the people well in the fire, their creative thoughts were shining around them by forming a moving aura. The atmosphere cleared up completely, and I saw my brother Nikolay who was writing something in the book, Nal next to him was drawing something on the anatomy atlas, and the light figure of a woman was sitting at the ground piano nearby. And the piano itself, and the woman's fingers running on it, and the room – everything was shining in yellow light, like brother Nikolay's book, like Nal's atlas...

"I showed the people in all their phases of work to you, some of them walking to harmony and the others who were already living in it," the Master continued by directing my attention to the yellow tower again. "Everybody who may enter the fourth ray through his work with himself begins his path from perception that work isn't a necessity, but joy. Having understood that he may not live without the work for the general welfare, man is radiating completely new waves of the vibrations of reconciliation, he starts to understand through his work, through his everyday actions that all his earthly circumstances are his own circumstances. Then he comes to the gates of the ray of harmony, where, as you can see, his brothers – the spirits of light meet him and take him to the tower of fire. If the man was here at least once, he will never come back to the spiritual confusion, although his external life would continue in the same conditions of strain and confusion. While going through the ray of harmony, every man's spiritual crisis introduces him into the new circle of births and deaths, he will never fall down in the phasis of his spiritual development, but he will keep walking by rising. However great talents a man would possess – depending on his karma, - he will keep doing mistakes and sticking to the personal standpoint of life and its values, until his spirit matures as much as to cross the boundary of harmony. Only after this second baptism the man becomes the creator completely and till the end from the standpoint of the universe, and he may enter that circle of births in which one goes out into the direct merging with Life. An incalculable diversity of the paths and ways exists through which people merge with Life in their work. The Bright Brotherhood is a guardian angel of the people who have crossed the boundary of the fourth ray. A tremendous number of Teachers and disciples pass the task of Life to people. The Bright Brotherhood appoints them as the chiefs and warrantors of the people of the Earth, as the assistants of their work and even custodians of their mode of life. The name of this great Teacher of harmony is Egyptian, because he has finished the path of his knowledge there. Now they call him Serapis. You've seen the work of the people of the Earth and heaven up to now, merged into one totality in the monolithic fires of the towers. The Earth and heaven, the path of work in the physical and spiritual worlds – everything is functioning through one conductor – the Fire of the planet. Now you will see one of the greatest workers among all the rays who is leading the fifth ray of the evolution

of mankind. Teacher of the fifth ray is carrying his work onto the Earth through two conductors of the planetary Fire, and his tower is double, to be precise, it separates into two independent towers in the certain height, which merge into one only with their peaks. Concentrate your attention even more, and you will understand yourself that you already owe much to this Teacher and that you will be forever tied with him in the future, because everybody who possesses one or another level of clairvoyance, although the smallest one, is closely connected with the rays of this tower of exceptional diligence.”

The Master seated me at an especially big table where I could see an orange tower of an unusual form. It was absolutely round on top and only from nearly the middle it separated into two octagonal towers which widened more and more downwards. A lot of floors were in every tower. And I was surprised the most that the ornament of every floor was made of absolutely the same flowers which surrounded the secret I.’s house in the rock, in the distant park of Ali’s Community.

“Don’t start reflecting and guessing riddles, but act with your inside. Mature with your spirit. Your self-control and endurance aren’t the same anymore, with which you entered this place. But they still aren’t enough for you, so that your shoulders would withstand the worldwide tasks,” the Master told me by lifting the mallet that also had two heads on one haft. “Nobody is doing the worldwide tasks alone, because also in the universe nobody is living and working alone. As you’ve already seen, everybody receives help, but now you will see clearly the infinite compassion of the Wisdom and her servants.”

The Master hit the tower with his double mallet. Everything was buried in the orange fire, and I instantly saw the entire sea of the orange fire between the heaven and the earth, which was whirling swiftly in the space.

The Master put his hand on my shoulder again by passing his unearthly self-control to me, which strengthened me in a flash, as though I had become a part of himself. I noticed that the fire balls were spinning evenly and when I looked even better, I saw that they covered two very elegant, gigantic towers which merged into one round dome on top as on the Master’s table.

I cannot tell whether my vision got accustomed to the sea of fire so much, or the closeness of the Master who merged himself with me helped me, but now I could see all the floors of the tower, wonderful ornaments of flowers on them and a lot of light, wonderful workers who were working on all floors. The lower the floor was, the brighter their shadows were, the higher a worker of the sky was rising, the more transparent and beautiful his form was.

“First of all, look at the great Teacher who is chief of this double tower. Understand once again that no miracles exist, - only one or another level of knowledge exists. Make sure clearly how endless and immense the knowledge of everyone who is alive in the universe may be - and there’s no limit for it. Make sure that due to the scale of his perception, the man who is even standing closest to the physical form of his Teacher, knows little about the extent of his Teacher’s actions, knowledge and work. Look at the top of the tower.”

I looked at the top of the tower, as the Master told me, and I completely lost any perception for a moment: who I was, where I was, who was next to me and what was going on with me. I. was looking at me from the very top of the tower. If I used to say vividly on the earth that I. needed only a wreath on his head that he would be a Greek God, then... an orange wreath was on his head here, and I. was really God here.

But that wasn’t only the God of beauty, also such a spirituality could be felt within him, such power and harmony at the same time, that it was impossible to describe this Godman in any words. And this I. allowed me to be so close to him on the earth! He was guiding me as only the most compliant and

compassionate teacher of a small child could guide! He reformed my former, terrible character and turned me into Goliath from a sullen youth!.. Tears of honour weren't pouring from my eyes anymore, I was bowing to the Great Life from the bottom of my heart without knowing how to express my gratitude to Him, how to glorify Him! I understood what compassion was and how one needed to prepare one's heart for it while communicating with people-brothers. I understood what Love-Action, Love-Work, Love-Joy were...

Shining views of thoughts were spreading from the entire I.'s figure, as well as from sir Vomi's ones. Only here they were flying in two directions precisely and undoubtedly by never passing from one tower to another one.

The Master squeezed my shoulder stronger, and I began to distinguish that more transparent spirits were carrying only orange, yellow, red and violet views of thoughts to one tower, while white, blue and green ones buried in the orange sea – to another one.

"Two paths of one ray are before you. You may be surprised that such by appearance incompatible things as the exact sciences and clairvoyance are united into one tower, and one Teacher is leading them. It wasn't like this in ancient times. But such changes of controlling of the people's paths happened in the plan of the Divine Powers and the time which you may not comprehend now, while the time demanded back then and which the Powers of Life recognized to be necessary according to the plan of accuracy. Each exact science may develop and strive for creative results only when the scientist is inspired by intuition or inner opening. All inventors, great travellers who discover new things for the mankind, all great astronomers, mathematicians, chemists who bring the fruit of their work into the science, - all of them are rather good clairvoyants, although they don't comprehend their clairvoyance themselves. But we are talking here only about the scientists-creators, although their creation would be very insignificant. The second tower in which only orange, green, red and violet views of thoughts exist – the tower of the essential clairvoyance, - encompasses the mankind that is rewarded with talents inversely proportionally to those who are working in the first Teacher I.'s tower forever. Only those clairvoyants are here whose spirit in some work has reached the creation. It is absolutely unimportant whether it is science, poetry, music, painting, sculpture – the clairvoyance that is prevailing in them brings them to this ray. Their powers always bring new ideas into the world of the Earth, because their disinterestedness is unshakable anymore, their loyalty may not sway to any side anymore. They can see, while their loyalty is namely the spiritual clairvoyance. The ignoramuses and stupid sanctimonious people of their time may burn down these creators in fire, but they are the pillars of the Eternal Movement, His servants, not some slaves, but free and enlightened colleagues in the eternity. This path is the most difficult one, because the path through the conditions of life during his time may not be easy for any clairvoyant. And the people-creators who merge this tower are sent to the very thickness of life namely due to the conditions of life."

The Master lapsed into silence. I kept looking at I. and only now I noticed that his hands were moving, as though by turning some wheels which he used to push now in one now in another tower. Then a tremendous amount of shining, many-coloured view balls of thoughts used to fly out of the top of the tower, the spirits wound them into plaits, made buckets from them, always smaller and smaller, sometimes they used to take only one small blossom and fly to the goal with it. These lots of the workers never mixed the balls according to their colours, but they used to carry precisely that what was meant for every floor of the tower.

There weren't any funnels here, and the spiritual channels through which the spirits were flying were unidirectional, that is the workers of the sky who were carrying the views of thought for a concrete place of the tower were flying along the clearly drawn channel, protected by a tremendous number of spirits. Having done their job, they would come back to the top of the tower through the free

space. They would vanish for a moment in it and fly to the same floor of the tower again which they were serving; they would take the new view of thought from the Masters of karma of their floor and fly with it through the corresponding channel again...

"You can see that also some very dark orange channels exist among a tremendous amount of clear and bright ones," the Master explained to me again. "Take a good look. Sad spirits of light come back through them very rarely, but it happens sometimes anyway, who failed to give the view of thought allotted for a man. Or mother refused her fetus still in her womb, or the child's surroundings lost tranquillity and joy so much that the sky worker was unable to quiet the elemental enough that is protecting the child's body of up to seven years, so that he could give his carried view of thought to it in order to weave it into the growing body of the little man. Or when according to the circumstances of karma, a man's quality could be given to him only after some heroically held out, difficult tasks, but the unfortunate person didn't have enough power of joy to live a creative life, he was sinking into depression and he was unable to accept the view of thought given to him anymore. Or a man was sinking in depression and depravity instead of the pure and heroic life, or he plunged into egoism that led him to the bond with the dark occultists, - then his sad brother, the sky worker is coming back through one of these dark orange channels. Such sad workers undertake a double work: they are searching for the most vicious enemy of that unfortunate person through the Masters of karma, to whom they failed to pass their carried view of thought. Sometimes they help this enemy to clean himself from angry and hatred for many years, they bring nearer in his thoughts his reconciliation with his former enemy and then they pass a new view of thought to him by connecting it strongly in the man's consciousness with the view of his former enemy. His spirit comes to life little by little, cleans up when one is working for two and reaches the new stage during the new incarnation when finally, she receives the previous view of thought assigned for her. As you can see, the work here doesn't end with the man's death. Everybody who started working in this ray may pass on to the other rays later if his karma or his spiritual development require it. The entire universe is moving naturally and accurately, and her separate little parts - people - aren't any exception from these universal laws of the planet. The spirits of the upper floor of the tower are working in the mental plan. They distribute work for all out-carnated in big spiritual laboratories, as well as for those incarnated whose consciousnesses they bring to that plan for their faster development. The Great Teacher himself is leading the laboratories of his ray by choosing such form and such view, with the help of which he could help everybody who is learning in an easier, simpler and faster way and facilitate the comprehension of the Fire forms for them. Now we'll pass on to one of the most difficult paths of the evolution of mankind - the path of Love."

While the Master was talking like this, he carried me to the biggest tower from all in the room. It had a shape of a cup, and it was buried in the ornaments of red flowers. Only the range of red hues could be seen here - but what a combination it was! Only the sky could play with the red colours like this: simply impossible purple, bright red, reddish combinations, without any drawings and with little veins, with a figure drawing and with some bands, but not irritating the eyes... The Master hit the tower with his mallet, the red fires flashed up like a fire - I saw an elegant tower of the cup form far away in the space, which was burning with red fire and rising up to the sky. The same cup which I had seen on Francisco's altar was burning by pouring the red fire through the brims like an avalanche. The sparkling fire was pouring down through the leg of the cup that was engraved with a red ornament. But also the ornament itself was alive. It was formed from the sky workers who were passing the currents of Fire from one to another, from top downwards. These brightly reddish spirits were radiating with joy, as though by standing out with it from the rest who were much darker than them.

"You can see the alive ornament," the Master said to me by approaching me. "Love is flowing onto the Earth through a huge number of layers by renewing and raising the people's and animal's hearts."

If this ray didn't exist, the whole planet would stop existing, because Life that is compassionate for everybody destroys only those forms which may not open for Love. You can see all the nuances of the egoistic love in this moment – from the most wonderful colour of Love – Joy till the very dark red animals' love and spiritually undeveloped people's bodily love. Here you will find love that is coloured in all nuances of superstitions developed by nationalism. Pay your attention to the very clear lines of the beautiful, dark, bright red colour in the ornament. You can see that this line is made of the sad workers with their hands hung. There is the same number of them as the reddish, charming carriers of joy. Now it isn't the time to explain to you the meaning of this phenomenon. That one from you will receive this explanation whom the Bright Brotherhood destined to bring the new love ideas and the new perception what love is onto the Earth. In the meanwhile, you can see the consequence here, - as in all other cases of the knowledge that you receive – that the law of the energy stability prevails in the entire universe. An absolute balance of powers stays in the whole creation of Wisdom. Those who are joyous and sad, that is those who are carrying joy or heartbreak for the encounters of the earth, are completely equivalent servants of Life, as well as all the rest of His colleagues. Nobody committed a crime and deserved something especial, because Life doesn't have any conceptions about the rewards and punishments. Only people decide by loving or fearing, by punishing or rewarding, - and here you have the unfortunate ones who always hesitate for their compromises with their conscience. The workers of love who in the sections of their work protect those who fear and doubt, who don't possess any loyalty till the end within themselves, whom the eternal compromises are nagging, carry the reflection of the psyche of their wards with themselves. Those blows which their protected brothers-people fling, eat and poke their light bodies till holes. The Great Love that is pouring from the tower of Love fills the injured bodies of their colleagues with always new streams of her fiery compassion and turns the holes in their light bodies into the charming drawing of Love which you can see in the ornament. Let the people understand in your work in which the whole new power of your heart, lit up by the new knowledge, must pour out, that all sorts of love are good, even an egoistic one, if only she is pure and unselfish. Your talent must ring with the new note by showing to people the greatest sin, not smaller than a murder – the sin of one's crime before love, the sin of the sold and bought love. The inquisition – the sin of the sold and bought love – is terrible to the world namely because of its consequences, that by using its devotion to God as a cover it was violating millions of people's spirits. Can you see the dark edging on the brightly reddish background of the ornament? That is the kingdom of animals and birds, their desire for love and blood. This is the only one ray in which you can see the world of the animals woven into the people's lives. The use and harm of the co-existence of the people's and animals' worlds is clearly expressed here. Only this ray may unite all the most conflicting forms of life of the planet. Life that unites people and animals in the ray of Love gives the possibility for the lowest forms to develop, to rise in the vibrations of the man's love, the man who is standing higher than them. But only then the people's love that possesses a great significance for the evolution of the kingdom of the animals will rise them when she will be spiritual and wise herself. The worthless, light-minded and chaotic attachment, without any ideological devotion to the animals' life, without the constant attention to his inner consciousness is worthless in the universal evolution, and it is out of the question here. Only the spiritualized, creative aspiration to unite with everybody who is living on the earth through Beauty exists here. Direct your attention upward, press yourself to the Great Mother from the bottom of your heart and look at the radiating Teacher's face of this sixth tower."

The Master embraced my shoulders and merged me completely with his consciousness. I was all covered with the sense of an exceptional power, as though my whole spine was filled with electricity, I could feel it as a fiery axis of my whole being. Now the Fire of the tower became transparent for my look. And I saw a strange face covered with the dark hair, with big eyes which were pouring such kindness which was impossible to describe with any words. Now I comprehended that expression of tranquillity, kindness and love of Francisco's face, which not so long ago seemed to me as the limit of

possibilities, only as a hint to that what I could see now. Also, I could feel such courage together with the inexpressible kindness, love and compassion that I understood in love of this Godman couldn't be a single drop of sentimentality or weakness, compromise or hesitation. I understood that love that could see clearly couldn't be at fault and make concessions, because that gives only a temporary comfort for man in his external circumstances by causing damage to his external path and work. The seeming "kindness", kindness as a "tearful sentimentality" didn't have nothing in common with the brave kindness of this face.

"Now you understood a lot also without any of my explanations," the Master was speaking by still holding my shoulders. "But I also need to tell you about the ray itself. No restrictions or barriers exist in it, no conditions for those who are searching for the path to this grand, colossal tower. Love – and you will find the path to the Master of this tower. Man may know nothing about God. He may be know-nothing in the meaning of the conditional culture of his time, but his heart may be full of pure love, and his radiated vibrations will draw him here according to the elementary law of attraction. This Master's name is Jesus...

Now you need to know only about the last, seventh ray. After the third ray in which, as I have already explained to you, the people who come back not for a single time group, the seventh ray is the most plentiful. The greater part of people is walking down this ray. This is the ray of religions and rituals, but at the same time, also of many fields of science, especially the ones of technology and mechanics. The greatest discoveries descended onto the earth with direct help of this compassionate assistant and patron of the mankind. Having experienced himself many persecutions during his earthly incarnations, imprisoned many times, he is the closest patron and assistant of all those who are persecuted and imprisoned. He has put a lot of work by broadening the world outlook of those who rule on the earth and by bringing the light into the cruel darkness of the former bourgeois system. Not a single revolution of the mankind could manage without him. This Teacher's wisdom and culture used to help people to find the new forms of social life during revolutions. He is a sage among sages. His consciousness is so developed that he encompasses such gigantic amount of knowledge that there isn't a single work field of the modern mankind which he wouldn't understand. His name is Saint Germain. This Teacher is known better than other Great Ones among people, the work of whom in their rays I have already showed to you. All religions have a direct connection to Teacher of this ray if they were propagated from pure hearts and unselfish devotion to God Whom they teach to confess their followers. Most people who are really and strongly connected to the Bright Brotherhood go through this ray. Look here."

The Master moved me at the last of his big tables and showed to me a high, rather narrow, very elegant violet tower. It seemed to be very light. It was all engraved, open-worked, and it surprised me with its unusual style. All its bottom was round, while the floors were changing: now they were absolutely rounded, now octagonal, now of a cross form, and at the very top the cross was shining with a five-pointed star above it. The Master hit the wall and the tower almost at the same time with a golden mallet. Puffs of fog began to pour from the wall, while the tower lit up in a very beautiful, gentle violet colour full of the most different and wonderful nuances.

"Look at the wall, otherwise you won't comprehend the sacred meaning of the religion that is existing in the fire of this tower," the Master said to me silently.

The fog in the wall cleared away, and I saw three divinely charming figures who formed a triangle. The fourth figure, even younger, more charming and transparent one was standing in the centre of the triangle, who at the same time was radiating power, beauty and such grandeur that I couldn't bear her radiance – I already wanted to cover my face with my hands, but the Master took me in his arms, knelt down and bowed till the ground. While he was still kneeling with his head raised, he pressed me to his chest like a mother her sickly baby, and he addressed the figures who were radiating the unbearable light.

“Eternity is the law of God, and this law is leading the universe and everything what is alive in it. Accept Your slaves who are working for You. Help to see Your Face clearly, not to forget It, to work for the people’s happiness and welfare on the Earth with It, in It and for It.”

A small five-pointed star came flying from the wall and settled on the Master’s head. A golden thread stretched out from the central, divinely beautiful figure, which connected all three figures of the triangle one with another. A beam of golden rays flew towards the tower from the first one of them who was the top of the triangle and who was standing with her face towards us. The golden beams pierced the whole tower through. As soon as the tower plunged into the golden radiance, the view on the wall disappeared. The Master stood up, seated me on the armchair again and stood next to me.

“You can see how the whole violet tower was buried in the sea of the golden Light which poured out of the Divine Power that protects, defends, creates and rules the Earth. These Divine Masters are above everything what exists on the Earth. They finished their path of the highest creation in another planet of much higher level of development and they descended on the Earth led by the feat of incomprehensible compassion and self-sacrifice for the people’s consciousnesses. Their consciousnesses are so much higher than the earthly ones that not only incarnated, ordinary people may reach or come nearer to them, but even not everybody highest from the out-carnated ones may comprehend them. These forever young Masters – that’s the centre of the Divine Powers on the Earth. But that’s all what I can tell you about them now. The Divine Power that showed Herself to you blessed your work by acknowledging your unselfishness, self-sacrifice and loyalty. And you remember what you’ve seen, work, carry the Divine Face in your heart that considered you to be worthy to see It with Its Love, develop new ideas about God within people. Clean the people from superstitions and opinions about God and pour the belief to them that everybody on the Earth, all its levels of lives are living under the guardianship of the Alive God in the vigilant and unceasing, compassionate and salutary way. These Masters have created everything what is alive on the Earth by bringing plants, people and animals to its “chaos”. Everything what you can see on the earth, under the ground, - everything is work of compassion of these Divine Masters... Now direct your attention to the tower. What does this unusually strange its form mean? This form – that’s one more confirmation of the highest compassion of the Divine Masters. The people immersed in all possible superstitions want to pray for God in such a way as it seems to them to be the most pleasing and purposeful. And now you can see the forms of all religions that currently exist on the Earth in the separate floors of this tower. If only the basis of the religion is love, purity and unselfish self-sacrifice – then the Divine Power accepts it, it is reflected in the tower of Religions and Rituals. The most sacred – everything what really is the most sacred for people, - finds not only the direct reflection here, but also receives the Divine Enlightenment and Purification which you can see as the golden rays sent by the Diving Masters and piercing through the tower. I have already mentioned to you that Teacher Saint Germain, the sage among sages is the closest to the Earth with his compassion and patience, with his tolerance and assistance and he is carrying much greater burden of human vibrations on his shoulders than other Compassionate Teachers. That’s why the purifying God’s power is burning with the constant, golden Light here by helping the superhumanly difficult feat of this Teacher. Nothing more difficult exists as to straighten the curve of the religious mistaken paths, because the people’s consciousness in this sector of religions is the most personal and obstinate. Observe closely what a diversity among the servants of Teacher is here. Many of the bright spirits, even after finishing the path of their unearthly serving for mankind, after reaching joy of their complete spiritual liberation in other sectors of creative consciousness, stay chained to the narrow path of love for their God. Some of them are transparent, but they keep Catholic soutanes, monastic robes of their orders on their forms, while the others keep details of the clothes of priests, Muslims and Chinese. And only on the very top you can see the unity of all religious forms without exception, united with the emblem of the Deity of our Earth – the five-pointed star. You know the Pali language. An inspiration is shining above the star – read it.”

The Master embraced my shoulders, and I could see perfectly a figure shining above the star, who was holding an opened, golden bull from the folding pages in her hand. An inscription was shining in fiery letters on one of the pages:

The World-Universe is a part of the Truth

The Truth is one – many of the paths to it exist

The letters were violet on another page:

No religions higher than the Truth exist. The man with pure heart who has become free from the narrow religion finds the Living Love. Having perceived Her, he takes his knowing to the Eternity, and he is walking his entire future path as the creative associate of the Truth.

When I finished reading the inscriptions, the Master took me down from the high chair, he opened the door in the wall of the building which I hadn't seen up to now and he took me to a little outer balcony, as he called it himself, through the inner, closed tunnel. But in my eyes, this "little balcony" of the boat form was as big as all the items which surrounded the Master. As he explained to me, we were above the Himalayas. After the laboratory where it was just cool, it was so cold here that the Master wrapped me in the furs which were hanging on the balcony rails. I didn't know of which animal the furs were, they were light, soft, fluffy and silver.

The Master who was reading my thoughts like an opened book explained to me that these were the furs of the very old species of silver foxes that now became almost extinct on the earth.

"I took you here, so that you would understand well that now your vision has already grown, and you could see through. You can see through really thick walls, the thickness of which you could evaluate, because now you went through both of them yourself, you could see the burning tower of the seventh ray so clearly as you can see now. You can see both the Teacher's figure and his bull with the inscriptions – you can see everything well and you can read. What is the meaning of the violet, little star on my head sent by the Great Divine Master to me? If it was only the symbol of the fact that the Divine Master has accepted and acknowledged our common work, recognized our unselfish glorification of Him through this work, then the star would be golden, because that is the colour of Divine Radiance. If He has sent the violet star to you, it means that you must receive a special, verbal instruction from the Great Sage himself, Teacher of the seventh ray. Concentrate the greatest honour of your heart and read the words dedicated to you. This Teacher's education is so universal that you will receive this instruction in the language that you know the best."

"Master, is it really possible that the French letters would light up in the universal, eternal tower?" even in this moment I couldn't hold my temperament.

The Master stroked my head so gently by smiling that I couldn't even imagine such kindness in this strict face.

"My obedient boy," he whispered. "You even don't dare to hope that Teacher Saint Germain's compassion may reward you with the Russian language if the instruction is given to you alone."

Read it. Protect loyalty, purity and obedience during your entire life, and Life will accept you as His eternal associate."

He snuggled me tenderly to himself, and I saw how an exceptionally charming hand turned over the bull's page. In the beginning the page was absolutely blank, then the balls of the mist began to spin in it, as on the wall of the Master's laboratory, and finally, fiery letters began to appear on it:

A man comes here once in hundred years to receive God's instructions for his work on the earth.

The inscription went out, it was written in Russian language.

No artificially created transitions from heaven to the earth, supported by conditionalities and inventions exist. Only the Only One Life exists in the entire universe. He goes right through everything, unites and inspires life for everybody.

Your searching during the last centuries, your devotion for Love returns Love to you. Your talent isn't yours, but it is the Movement of Life. Convey that what you can see and hear here with the earthly means and adapt it for the comprehension of your time.

Expand people's consciousness. Help her to acquire flexibility.

It is necessary to break the superstitions which divide the work into the one of heaven and the earth for the creation of the new race that is destined to be born with high spirituality and subtle psyche. It is no less important to defeat the superstition and fear of death.

The inscription went out again, and the charming hand turned over the page once again. When the balls of the mist cleared away, the words on it lit up again, they were burning with fire even brighter:

The World-Universe – that isn't the path of a destruction and revival, that's – the path of the eternal Evolution where no other principle exists as only the incessant development.

The man who is walking with the creation useful for the people's masses isn't walking as a lonely, separate talent, but as the whole link of the Only One Life, which He has marked as the path for the people's masses, for their easiest, simplest and shortest liberation.

Carry not your work and your talent into the grey surroundings of mediocrity, but pave the new path of Life, so that he could make holes in the people's consciousnesses for their liberation through your talent.

The liberated man – that's the one who can reach such Love that he would forget about himself and serve only for her, serve in such a way and there where the Bright Brotherhood will instruct him to."

This inscription also went out. I thought that the inscription given personally to me had already ended, but the Master showed me the cross, which was shining under the star in the reddish violet and golden Light, by saying.

“No limits for compassion exist when he gives instructions for his chosen ones. Read one more, the last instruction dedicated personally to you.”

The cross – that’s not a symbol of suffering. It is the symbol of karma, the symbol of the eternal law of the Universe – the one of cause and effect. Your karma isn’t only with those whom you knew personally, but also with all those whose hearts were touched and will be touched again by the word of your talent.

When you give your word for the world, derive an inspiration for it not from your emotions and observations, but from the Power of Light which you can see and hear now, which you read now. Search for the Light within people, pour Her into your represented pictures, unite people with Her.

That was the last inscription announced, and when it went out, the charming hand opened again those pages of the bull on which the inscriptions in Pali language were burning.

“Now look at the violet hues which are shining on all floors. You can see that there isn’t a single floor of the tower on which there weren’t the colours of the rays that you saw in previous towers. What kind of denying people would exist, however stubborn they would be in the superstitions of their denying – God always exists in their consciousnesses. Even if they are sincerely denying for themselves, but their spirit is pure – without any doubt, they have the link with this tower. Everything what is pure, kind and unselfish – from a great hero till a humble worker – everything is drawn into the fires of this tower in one or another way. Not a single action of a man or an animal exists, which wouldn’t be reflected here and drawn into the eternal chronicles by the servants-spirits of this ray. The reflection of the man’s behaviour on the earth is brought here in with an incredible speed, if only he was acting in the name of God. Move closer to me and look what you will find in common among all such strange floors of this tower?”

I moved closer to the Master, my consciousness brightened up even more, and I saw that all shining shadows who were flying from one tower to another had a little golden star which was shining on their foreheads between the eyes.

“You can see the energetic centre of spiritual development of everybody who are working here. Not a single being who hasn’t reached enlightenment along her way, comprehension of Eternity and serving to Her, may not enter the spheres of the higher creative life of the spirits who are working here. Even if people are carrying a benefit for their time with their lives, they remain in the chain of the same development until their spirit won’t conquer the concept the “eternal now”. While walking through their days, the denying people become free from their superstitions little by little, not very easily. Every denying person, whatever form his denying would take, started from denying of Eternity. Having acknowledged Her, pressed by the enlightened spirit, he used to lose the positions of his denying one after another, and finally, he could already be drawn into the fires of this tower. The ceremonies, their great, strengthening and refreshing significance descends to people through the fires of this tower. They are carrying their refreshing power only to those who are calling for the God’s name with their pure lips, from the bottom of their unselfish heart. An effective prayer – that’s not a plea for oneself, but a glorification. The glorification which a man utters with the greatest joy, rising during the religious ceremonies, - that’s an invincible power. Such prayer will always reach God through His servants, in the spheres of whom it rises. Now look more

attentively at this ray's Teacher himself. Won't you find also in his surroundings something exceptional in comparison with the other towers?"

The Master took both of my hands into his powerful palm, he leaned to my head, and I saw the entire circle of bright figures below Teacher. I had never seen most of them, but I recognized Ananda and Radanda in a flash who were standing in the very middle of the circle.

"This circle – that's the closest associates of Teacher Saint Germain, his assistants who are carrying the power of Love and Divine Kindness from here and helping people to adapt themselves to their circumstances on the Earth, to serve for the Truth and the realization of Its plans. That's all what you must pass to people about the rays. Your strength is almost exhausted already despite the entire power which your great guardians and personally my magnetism gives to you. Here's some food for you. We aren't eating the products of the Earth for a long time already; we prepare food from the ether and the electromagnetic waves of the space. You couldn't always eat our food, but you will be completely satisfied with it for a short time."

The Master gave to me something that reminded me of a big bean, it was rather tasty and so nutritious that I couldn't eat even a half of it. Then he gave me to drink a clear, as though gassy water from a glass, to be precise, from a jug, and he took me to a room through another balcony-tunnel.

A sofa of great measurements was standing in this room, the Master put me to it and covered me with the furs of the same silver foxes. The last thing that I remembered was a wonderfully kind Master's smile, his blessing hand and the words uttered somewhere upward, the meaning of which I didn't comprehend. Only now, after I lay down under the warm furs, I understood how tired I was.

Chapter 27

My awakening in the room with sofa. Coming back to the laboratory. My conversation with the Master in it. A divine view

I woke up suddenly, as if from a blow, as it used to happen to me often. The room was lit up with a gentle light, but I couldn't decide in any way where it was spreading from. Now it seemed to me that a lamp was hidden somewhere in the room's interior, now I started thinking that the desert light penetrated here, but anyway, I couldn't guess the secret of the light source, because other things of the unusual room always attracted my attention.

Contrary to my almost settled habit to comprehend the circumstances with difficulty after waking up, now I understood perfectly where I was and what was happening, to be precise, I remembered precisely everything what the Master-Teacher was talking to me about and what he showed to me. Only one thing disappeared from my perception – the time.

I could see a niche in the wall before me, which reminded me of an altar. I couldn't see this niche before entering the room – I remembered it well. And now I understood why I couldn't see it: it was closed with a curtain from a wonderful, golden brocade back then, which hid the altar from my look.

The altar of the same form as the Francisco's one, only very big and all white was standing in the niche, at the level of three big stages. A high, cut cup that was shining like a gigantic diamond was standing on the altar. Both the cup and the altar were changing in many-coloured fires. All of it was the normal size things in comparison with the Master's height, but I doubted whether my hands could hold such cup, even with my current strength of Goliath.

I didn't have time to admire the wonderful, diamond radiance of the altar and the cup, because the five-pointed star that was hanging under the ceiling attracted my attention with its radiance. It was shining very brightly, and after some time I began to distinguish the letters of the forming script in this radiance above the star. In the beginning I thought that I would be unable to read the letters in such height, even if I knew the language of the record. But after having stood up on the sofa at my full length, I could read the fiery words in Pali language easily:

That one who has discovered the heroic tension and purity of one's heart, - has entered the fire of Eternity.

And the Eternity has burnt down his entire bestiality by returning all of his previous talents to him.

And the man who has become servant-friend for people, will become Servant of the Truth Herself and he will bring Her New Gospel for people.

Only that one may become Servant of the Truth who has learnt to overcome by loving.

The inscription went out. I got down from the sofa and bowed low before the Master's altar by begging the Great Mother to help me to become a valuable servant for people and to fulfil the will of the Only One Truth, to overcome by loving and to create only Her will by loving.

The Master found me namely in such pose. He pressed me strongly to himself and uttered.

"The Truth hasn't yet announced to anybody during the entire time on the Earth about her choice with the fiery script above her cup. While this cup – created not by me, but received from those who are above me – is aeons years old. Only the really humble man who comprehends clearly his place in the universe could receive the instructions of Fire here. This is like the second baptism, the one done with Spirit and Fire. So, brother, walk the path given to you here. Be humble till the end and understand in your obedience that you are the one chosen by God. Remember: the path of every prophet is difficult. While the path of the prophet who preaches the New Gospel is doubly difficult. Now let's leave this place, this "Most Sacred from the most Sacred ones", but still look at the wall by which you were sleeping, perhaps the image of the Master of power will open to you, who is the guardian of everybody who follows the ray of his power with complete loyalty till the end. The greatest compassion of this Teacher of power doesn't know any limits; and this chief looks austere only for those who are weak in spirit. His external severity – that's the protection namely for those weak ones who don't possess any strength to hold out his power. Because man must encounter also the power of Compassion with the power of his courage, so that he could understand it."

The Master embraced me and took me to the sofa. He drew back a heavy portiere at the head of the sofa, and I saw a wonderful Ali's portrait that was shining on the white wall. Like alive he was standing at his full gigantic length. His black curls came out of the white turban, a shining cup was in his hands, it was absolutely the same as the one on the Master's altar, only a little smaller, with the white, fiery liquid bubbling in it.

That was the same Ali who was walking and talking to me in his garden; the same Ali whom I saw in the avenue in K., in the feast at his home, and finally, that was the same Godman whose image was shining in the heights of the white tower. And... at the same time that was another, new Ali whom I had never seen, and I couldn't even imagine that his face could have such an expression of the triumphing joy, happiness, love, calm and that divine kindness which I saw in the face of the Great Teacher Jesus. Oh, how charming he was! Without feeling anything what I was doing, I knelt down and whispered by bending down till the ground.

"Be blessed, Ali, messenger of God! Let everyone who will utter Your name with hope and love be glorified, even if he doesn't know You."

The Master lifted me up, he wiped even unnoticed tears of the sacred honour which were rolling down my face with his fragrant handkerchief and he uttered.

"Find out the real name of this great servant of God, the soldier of His power. His name is Morya, and from now on call him in this name when you address him. This creating guardian won't leave you on your way, and by confirming his compassion and help to you he showed his image here which not a single man's eye had ever seen up to now. Comprehend strongly: no miracles exist, only the levels of knowledge exist. And depending on this level, everybody can see that what his spirit is able to see."

He took me out of the room, and we went to the laboratory again through the inner tunnel.

I cannot describe precisely what was going on inside of me. But some change happened inside of me again. I already don't talk about that that my eyesight became absolutely clear. I could see everything through without any Master's help, I could see the burning towers, all their activity, the whole Life that was moving in different forms and living in motionless forms. I was united with the entire universe again, with her Creating Origin. I was in Him; He was in me.

At the same time, I comprehended precisely that I was only a small screw of the Eternal Movement, tied into Him harmoniously by keeping absolutely independent my thinking, movement and ability to work. In this close bond with everything I was a separate, free spot of consciousness. And my freedom was exactly that lightness of my heart and the emptiness about which I. used to tell me often and a long time ago: I was living free from passions and personal attachments.

Only now I began to comprehend the happiness to live liberated, the happiness to be the little, creating part of the Entire Harmony. The joy was ringing in my heart, and I understood the great name of the chapel of the Great Mother to which Radanda took me: "The Ringing Joy".

It seemed to me that the divinely charming and compassionate Ali-Morya's image was still accompanying me now, in this room and that it helped me to master the Teacher-Master's lessons for my new consciousness.

"The World-Universe is only a part of the Truth," – you read it in the fiery record. This part of the Truth that seems to be unattainably high for the man of the Earth now opens for you as a small field of the work of the universal, divine power. Follow this last incarnation of yours, and you will see that a deeply hidden feeling was always living in your intuition since your very childhood that a different path was being prepared for you than the paths of all the people who surrounded you. Externally you weren't distinguished with anything from the mixed crowd of people, unless with your talents. And anyway, you knew that you would have to fulfil some mission for this crowd that surrounded you. Also, all your brothers who came here with you knew the same... Why could you know about it, to be precise, why namely this presentiment was living inside of you? Why did Morya's face stun you already during your first short encounter? Why did that man whom you got used to call Florentian, but whose name is actually Venetian, arouse such love of yours during the shortest time, which perhaps your real father could have aroused? Well, simply because all these great servants of the Truth and Her selfless associates were preparing you for this mission already for a long time and teaching you to understand Life in all His forms which are working in the visible and invisible way, in two plans: the one of the earth and heaven. But your character, the nature of your personality experienced in a karmic way during this incarnation prevented you – until a certain time – from bringing the memory into the Earth about the work of your eternal individuality, the memory about your night lessons. I.'s self-sacrifice, who has left his heights for you and your associates and who has descended into the thickness of the private life in order to lead you, the chosen ones of the Bright Brotherhood in a quicker, simpler, easier and merrier way, to carry out the feat of the work and assistance for the modern mankind, helped you to find, develop and strengthen Harmony between your personality and individuality, between your earthly form and Eternity that is in it in a right way. You will reveal for people in your works, through your literary heroes not only that death doesn't exist, but also for everyone who comes to the Earth about the whole necessity of his personality. A man's personality – that isn't any

evil from which he could isolate himself and turn away; that isn't a karmic burden imposed on him for the passions of which he could moan and complain. The man's personality – that's the greatest of the gifts from Compassion, the Light given to everybody in such the cleanest little lamps which all the assistants of the invisible surroundings could weave for the man's Eternal Fire by merging their own help and care of Love with his own work and love. Many millions of consciousnesses, in whom the door of Spirit is still closed, go through their lives with material ideas of their mind and they are living in the fortress of their mind, locked up as firmly as those millions who are "searching" for spiritual paths during their entire lives, but who are living in the narrow frames of their personality. The first ones who deny the spirit are often not so complicated and they find the exit to the Truth faster and easier. The second ones – "the searchers" – often die like this double-faced by searching only in ideas and fantasies, but by living in the iron claws of their personal desires in their earthly private lives. Look here."

With these words the Master seated me by the green tower, on the top of which a wonderful image of that one was shining whom I got used to call my friend and guardian Florentian, but whom now I was calling from all my heart as the Great Teacher Venetian.

"Can you see the movement that always renews in the narrow band of white flowers, which stretches till the Teacher's chest and ends with the fiery greenish read threads? A tremendous number of workers from the white Morya's tower carries the string of the wonderful, white flowers. Take a good look... An entire swarm of shining, white spirits whom you can see clearly, but whom not all brothers of the Bright Brotherhood know, are waiting for their turn to tie their little flower into the completely defined white ornament of the precise harmony. Why are these selfless workers waiting? And what are they waiting for? They are waiting for their – to be precise, for that one for whom they are carrying, - place and turn. Here, a worker with a white, little flower – the power of Morya's thought – flew out of the green fire field of the Venetian's tower back into the white tower. Follow his path. His little flower looked absolutely white in the green tower. Now, thrown into the furnace of the white fire, it merged into it with a greenish ornament and drifted further away by shining and expanding, that is by acquiring the form of active power as an action of Wisdom, the combination of Her Power and Tact. A new spirit has matured in the human living being for a new, higher service in the field of his work. Another invisible assistant waits for his turn and ties his little flower in the empty place of the green tower – and this continues on and on. Life – an Eternal life in forms and without any forms is taking place. If you keep observing all the towers of work which have opened for your vision, you will see in all of them the same purposeful and natural Work of Harmony. Can anybody be forgotten here? Can at least one man be ignored? Can the help for him be late? Can a worker of heaven stop along his way? Can he change the path of his carried consciousness of a man at his discretion? Everything is moving along the strictly defined channels of Wisdom, with Her complete Compassion. And all external and internal changes of a man's destiny – that's an answer for him to his maturity. A man is prepared – also an answer of Life is prepared for him, this answer is always purposeful, although on the level of his private life it would be considered as "undeserved". All people are praying, they call for God and for His saints, but majority of these prayers – that's a futile noise with their own blind personalities, therefore they remain unheard, without any response and help. These unprepared people who consider themselves to be the centre, the mind of the Earth will abuse you most. Not a single catastrophe in life of mankind happens just like that. An exaggerated development of the final arouses all of them, rather often when the mind starts cooperating with the dark occult powers. Majority of the people who start such a cooperation start dreaming about the world's submission to their power, they try to introduce the meanest ideas of materialism into the present, to kill the man's spirit and his living Fire – and a catastrophe matures on the Earth. The Great Life directs his forms into the course of regularity and accuracy. That is Life takes those layers of mankind, the spiritual stagnation of which has reached such a limit that it was already impossible to introduce some civilization or a higher culture into these temporary forms, to other levels of his forms by giving a rest to them, by lighting up their stiffened consciousnesses

with the new spiritual waves and by sending them back onto the Earth again – only into the more flexible and brighter forms which accurately correspond to their own and the entire humanity's eternal evolution. While the people who judge about everything only according to the standpoint of the Earthly justice are talking: a war, an epidemic, an earthquake, a famine, a massacre etc. Now look here, take a more attentive look at the red tower. Already during the very first time when you were observing the work of its invisible assistants you understood that the distinguishing feature of the sixth tower – not recurring anywhere else – that's a continuous pouring of all sorts of waves and layers of Love onto the Earth through the workers of heaven – the servants of this ray of Love. Their activity intertwines into the ornament full of beauty and harmony. But what is the difference between the work of the assistants of the Love ray and other rays? Why is this path – one of the most difficult for mankind? Everybody who has reached such a liberation that they can work in this tower-cup, already passed those central circles of spiritual development in which the conception of condemnation of brothers-people exists. And not only condemnation or superstitions exist in the consciousness of the workers of this ray, also the conception of the temporary wellbeing, the law of justice – a pure earthly invention – don't exist in them. Their consciousnesses react only to the Eternal within a man. They address only this Eternal, and they help only this Eternal in every form. The brave Love of the Master of this ray – that's a heroic tension which this Master himself and all his associates are awakening within people by tempering their characters. Only those people who stopped complaining of their destiny, who stopped hoping for their hopes to come true during their grey daily routine, with help of strange hands, through protections or patronage, which they thought as though they were "worthy of", while those who provided them – "had" to do it; only those people who have reached the power to live their grey daily routine with the heroic tension by considering this form of life as their most ordinary and natural joy, - are walking along the ray of Love. One of the distinguishing features of these people is always that they bring in calm everywhere, with the example of their everyday heroism they calm down, reconcile, put out the dramas of their encountered people, which seemed to be so difficult for them. Not only the streams of passions calm down next to them, but also the people's hostility among themselves melts. Bring this new heroic spirit of feelings and thoughts into the people's consciousness in your future literary activity, for which the Great Father Life is preparing you now, through the distinct, enslaving, unknown characters of the grey daily routine. Step by step emphasize the power of spiritual development of the ordinary people, such people who introduce the new forms of their mode of life just because their own living Love doesn't confess any decomposition, any death, She comprehends the constant change of forms of the Only One Eternal Life firmly and unshakably. Now take a good look at the blacksmiths of the power of spirit of the first ray and try to comprehend how their work is different from the blacksmiths of the power of spirit of the sixth ray."

The Master seated me in such a way that I could see both towers – the white and the red ones – as if by moving them nearer one to another. Both of them as though rose in the first plan, while all the rest of them were burning brightly behind them. But I understood that actually the towers didn't move, only the Master helped me to concentrate my attention in such a way with the power of his exceptional will that it concentrated on the first and the sixth towers by leaving the rest of them, as well as the entire remaining universe, existing only in my consciousness.

Also this experience – to concentrate my attention in a new way – I was learning for the first time. A thought flashed how much I owed the Master, but his voice interrupted any possibility to become absent-minded for me.

"You can see that the heavenly workers of both towers, who help people to temper the power of their spirit, are walking the different paths. They are walking along the brightly reddish ray in the white tower, while in the red one – they are walking along the pale reddish one, furrowed with white veins, intertwined into a complicated and beautiful ornament from white lightnings – Morya's thoughts. As you

already know, all the mighty men of spirit who are walking along the ray of the first tower are creators. These creators always have a clear mission: to lead, to awaken, to organize the crowd. That's the leaders of mankind of the Earth, the founders of states, the reformers of politics. But that's only those leaders of mankind, those wise men who are working on behalf of their nation or the whole mankind. Their expanded consciousness doesn't drown in the turbid waves of their personalism anymore. Their love becomes such a power when without throwing a lifebuoy for hundreds of self-sacrificed people they possess enough of Spirit-Fire-Will-Love to doom hundreds for death – death of temporality – if they know that self-sacrifice of these hundreds with their heroic death will take the Life in forms of the new millions into a higher wave. The heart's trembling from the horror of temporality is strange for loyalty of these leaders. They are working for Eternity, for Her evolving forms, for the new ideas of Light and constant work that unites people. The rulers and leaders of governments who are striving for the general goals of wellbeing, the leaders of political parties – all of them are walking along this ray. This is the ray of extraordinary, exceptional powers. All the leaders – whether they would be the people of the art, literature, education or the authors of discoveries who cover big masses of people with their activity, - are walking along this ray. Fire is always carrying their Love-Power. And one or another mode of their life doesn't have any significance personally for them. They may not be filled into any “mode of life”. On the contrary, almost always they destroy narrow, self-interested, settled norms of existence, they shake the psyches covered with mould. They, the ones who aren't personally interested in mode of life, are certainly needed as a destroying power that enables to create the conditions which thoroughly correspond to their time. While for the characters of the fiery Loyalty-Love power of the sixth ray the most important place of their work – that's their mode of life, the work of the grey daily routine, family and the foundation of morals. But the ethics of these characters aren't a lifeless moral which bases its “principles” with dry brain when also the kindness is only the product of mind, dry and “motivated” in very detail. The Fire of their hearts is leading these characters of power, the world peacemakers full of love through their everyday work. Don't think that they aren't suited for any wide-ranging work. But their love is so big that they save everybody instantly, in every present moment, in current circumstances by giving all their purifying strength of Love-Power to help a man to become free from his protests against those external circumstances which he got into in his “current” stage of Eternity. And this activity of theirs, as of those who have chosen their most ordinary daily routine for themselves, is so filled with their thoughts about their encountered person, to be precise, about every one of them that Life may not use them for the revolutions that shake the masses and create the future. These workers are carrying the whole everyday heaviness on their shoulders by turning the poor, pale, grey daily routine into the radiating Light for every encountered person, these humble people are really humble. They know their place in the universe precisely. Therefore, the calm of their hearts is pouring onto all those places where they are living, in the same way as the fiery Love itself from the tower-cup, along the ray of which they are working, is pouring. Their Truth, as well as their Love, - isn't a principle, but the Fire of their hearts. Their creation, although it isn't big on its scale, but it is great with the power of its help. Remember what I said to you: they help their encountered person now, in his circumstances by going into the level of his perception. Which of the rays are they close to with this characteristic of their activity? You answer me without any words: “To the third one”. Maybe to the third one, but I asked this question only for you to comprehend firmly: no separation exists in one's life work, and it may not exist. You have already comprehended the tasks of power development of the sixth and the first rays. You have acknowledged the tasks of the sixth and the third rays to be common yourself. But aren't the tasks of the second, sixth, third and first rays related? Do the fifth and the seventh rays keep aloof? I tell you everything, so that you wouldn't be surprised and shocked anymore, independent of in what shape you see the Master of one or another ray. Everything is merged into one totality in these perfect people whom you call Godmen and perceive them like this with your consciousness. They are so much liberated from all their passions with the harmony of their power, with the harmony of their Fire that many hundreds of consciousnesses may see them simultaneously, and every one of them exactly in the

way as it is the most purposeful for her, according to her possibilities. You are stunned that you, who consider yourself to be weak and unworthy of it, were chosen for such a great mission. Not for you to decide, my son, - you must obey. Carry the new talent given to you by Life obediently. Carry joy and lightness into your encounters, become stronger through them. Life himself has burnt down everything from your karma what would have burdened your new talent, what would have prevented you from taking out the New Gospel of daily routine into the society of your time. Life has given the Greatest, direct guardians to you. Those Greatest, for the path to whom people are searching for entire centuries and whom they find rather rarely. I repeat once again: not for you to decide. You must obey. You still cannot understand the whole regularity and accuracy of the work of Life. But you can comprehend till the end that only joy is the weapon of your victory. Only armed with it you can fulfil the mission given to you, the motto of which will always be the words to you that you read yourself in the fiery inscription: "Overcome by loving".

The Master fell silent. Having looked at him, at his gigantic figure and his bright face, I saw that he as though turned into a stone with his arms placed on his chest. I was afraid even of making a move, so that I wouldn't disturb his ecstasy. My eyes which always kept the full and bright vision could see the brightly burning towers and the incessant work of the workers of heaven in them.

I cannot say whether the Master was silent for a long time, because I have already mentioned that the time didn't exist for me, as well as the space. I was living only in Eternity, and now I could understand and comprehend everything what was happening around and within me only in such a way.

All of a sudden, I heard a silent sigh and, having raised my eyes to the Master, I was stunned: not only his face was radiating, but also his entire gigantic figure. The Master was all radiating. His hair, shoulders, hands, eyes, forehead, neck, legs were radiating... I could see clearly his turning centres which corresponded to his body proportions with their size, but I hadn't yet seen their colour and radiance.

"Stand up, my friend," the Master told me in a hardly audible voice. "No limits exist for Compassion when she prepares her children for heroic deeds of love for the general wellbeing. Look at the towers. You will see and hear there what is dedicated to you for the memory of ages. Man lives many lives. And externally these lives aren't different with anything saint from those who surround them. Not because there really isn't anything saint in them, but because ordinary people cannot see a man's sanctity with their eyesight. They can see only that what they can see. In most cases, people can see the problems of mind and moral, but not the Truth that is living and moving forever in the Temple of the chosen one's heart. Get ready to accept that Gospel of daily routine into your Temple which you will carry out to people into the Earth through your new, enslaving characters."

The Master knelt down, he spread an edge of his chiton and helped me to kneel down next to him.

I concentrated my attention so much that it seemed to me that I got in the towers myself and I saw a dreary, lifeless desert. After a while, the fog bubbled in the distance, just like on the golden wall in the Master's laboratory. The fog grew up into a big ball, the ball began to shine with gold, it was growing and soon it covered the whole space. Having become absolutely golden, it began to shine in all the colours of the rainbow and to pour beams and rings of light, but so powerful and bright that the earth and the sky begirded with them got into the very centre of the rings and the beams. The ball kept clearing up, several big five-pointed stars separated from it, while the biggest from them rose high and got stiff in its dazzling radiance. Now the fog cleared away completely, and I saw an incredibly charming garden under the gigantic, shining star, and in the clearing of the garden's centre I saw the same, divine, youthfully charming figures that I saw on the Master's wall for the first time.

The most charming from the divinely figures, shining like the sun, who was standing in the middle of the triangle back then, now was standing in front, while three figures who formed the triangle back then, now were standing in line, behind her.

In spite of the Master's help – who spread his chiton for me and who covered my head in his hands – the first figure was shining with such a power of light which I still couldn't bear that I comprehended that I was on the limit of death. I was feeling as though I had been dead, and that only my consciousness was living.

The hand of the divine figure spread – as though strewed a beam of Fire that dazzled me – a roll of an ancient papyrus. Three figures who were standing behind her unrolled it, and absolutely easily and simply I read three inscriptions which were shining in it. The first inscription said.

The row of lives doesn't reveal man's bond with Wisdom for his consciousness. A catastrophe always reveals it by burning down the bestiality within man. Man enters Harmony!

This inscription was shining in the bright yellow fire. The second one, brightly red, fiery inscription said.

Man who has entered Harmony accepts the gift of consecration. For he has become a part of Love himself!

The third inscription which was burning in brightly white fire said.

Having become Love, man puts a cross on his shoulders. He steps into the density of life, and he is carrying the New Gospel for people, such one, in such a way and where his loyalty is following the loyalty of those who lead him, where loyalty of those who lead him follow My loyalty.

The man who is walking by carrying the New Gospel for the Earth, for he has become Power.

The inscriptions went out, the figures of Divine Beauty pulled the fog on themselves, and fog merged into the gigantic ball again.

I was trembling and I was close to death, as it seemed to me.

My last remembrance was: the Master puts me on the sofa and covers me with furs.

Chapter 28

My second awakening in the exceptional Master's room. What was the living portrait on the wall telling me. One more divine vision. The last sermon of my Master-Teacher. I visit the Master of the Masters, the conversation in his room and in the "temple"

I woke up immediately by feeling such power, joy and happiness that it seemed to me that I had never experienced anything like this up to now. The Master brought me here so feeble and deadly exhausted, but on the contrary, I felt enormously strong when I woke up. Since the time had vanished from my life, I couldn't comprehend what the time it was now, whether it was morning or evening, day or night. I couldn't comprehend for how many hours I was sleeping, and I couldn't comprehend at all for how much time I was in the domain of the Power Masters.

I jumped up from the sofa quickly and I remembered that once my friend Venetian surprised me by rising from his deep sleep in the carriage in a flash, flexibly like a cat. By blessing that wonderful time when I still didn't know anything about Venetian and I was living when my friend Florentian was rescuing and soothing me, I sent my respectful greeting to him, and I looked at the wall at the bed-head with radiance of happiness and calm which I was full of myself now.

The fog was curling on the wall by covering Morya's image, but his burning look reached me even through this screen. This time I comprehended the lightning of Morya's eyes as the ray of joy. My heart opened for happiness even wider, I comprehended the Divine words even clearer: "The Ringing Joy." I went down on my knees in the flight of love and gratitude, I extended my hands to the portrait in gratitude and I exclaimed.

"Morya, Morya, Morya! I beg Life to save everybody who utters your name with belief and hope. In this moment I bless you, my Great Teacher, with joy of my heart for those words which you told me by the lake, - to me, an unfortunate, poor boy who I was for everybody back then. Your love, as well as Venetian's love, as well as I.'s compassion, gave shelter to me and helped me to enter that path in which I saw joy and happiness to live for the people's wellbeing. Let the Bright Brotherhood be blessed! Let the paths of joy to live and create open for everybody to whom the Great Mother is sending me! Oh, Morya, be an example and an eternal memory about that to me how I must learn one thing: to forget about myself and to think about others."

By blessing my divine friend's name, I bowed till the ground to the fog screen which covered his portrait. When I raised my head, a charming Morya's image was looking at me. His lips were smiling happily and gently, a cup in his hands was shining in all colours of the rainbow, and the silent voice was telling me, as though straight into my ear.

"Grow stronger, my son. The fiery inscription told you: "Man is walking by carrying the New Gospel to the Earth, because he has become Power." And where you enter the path of Power, your path and mine intersect. No one is walking alone, and especially that one who is carrying the New Testament for people. But there aren't many people who would accept the New Testament of their time unconditionally, with a whole loyalty. Majority is trying to coordinate the new word with the old superstitions in the way of compromises. And the result – that's an old, worn-out robe with new, bright patches. They don't feel this horror, they don't suffer from disharmony, because they comprehend harmony childishly. They don't possess any stability; and they aren't living in Eternity, although they consider Her to be the essence of their passing by "now". That one is suffering the most from the crowd's storms and negation who has brought the New Testament onto the earth. The dark mankind offers the cross to the messenger of heaven and rewards him with contempt and vulgar jeer instead of gratitude and joy. I lower the cup of my power onto your head, and from now on, wherever you would be, whatever you would do, however you would go and where your paths would take you, I am with you everywhere. Call my name and remember: I share your every work, I do together your everyday work. No one is alone, and the more you, although only a very little part of your contemporaries would accept the heroic deed of your work. It is important to remember one thing by uniting with people: you need to choose not the people's personality and its deformed splinters, but to force – with the power of your stability and joyous loyalty – to melt the personality of your encountered person, to awaken calm within him and thoughts about Eternity; to erase the limits of conditionalities and to unite him with you not only with a high nobility, but also to pour so much calm and satisfaction into his heart that he could take into his friendly arms his encountered people by deriving his brotherhood with them from the Only One within him and in them. Approach the altar. Those whom the Truth is sending as her messengers, She hardens with unity with Herself. My Love will warrant and help you in your last conversations with the Masters of Divine Power."

Morya's voice fell silent, while his hand pointed me to the steps of the altar in the niche of the opposite wall. I stood up, bowed low to the living Morya's image again and I was climbing onto the altar by smiling joyfully from the efforts of my hands and legs to overcome the obstacles one after another: the steps for the Master's height were like gigantic massifs of rocks for an ordinary man.

Having climbed onto the upper step, I concentrated my attention on a white cup, and I was calling for the divinely charming Master of Power who flung me the divine papyrus with the beam of Fire which dazzled me back then.

The cup that was already radiating before, now all began to shine in the golden light. A mist began to bubble above the cup, on the wall of the altar, a star began to shine above, and I saw a figure of young Master of Power, the figure of the Living God covered with an unusually clear light, - I couldn't name this patron of the Earth in any other way. But now not helplessness, not a desire to shield myself from the radiance of the Divine Light poured me. I was covered with Joy, with the silence of Spirit which I hadn't experienced up to now, the silence which I can describe only as a Divine tranquillity, a desire to do everything what this image of the Living God will tell me to do, to do till the end, to be loyal till death, till the deadly crucifixion if that strengthened that new word in people's consciousnesses which Life charged me to pass to them.

The entire wall, the entire room began to shine in such a way as if the sunbeams had penetrated here. And now I could see like a face woven from the clearest beams in that light, which was

spreading from the wonderful, shining figure. I cannot describe the smile, the kindness and compassion of the face in any words and I heard a voice.

But how can I describe this voice? It was gentle and soft, musical and charming like the one of a fife; at the same time, it was powerful and sonorous, as though the entire universe had been pouring her ringing into it.

“The creators of life – that’s only those who have matured with their spirit and crossed the childish conception of the death fear.

Everyone who has reached such state becomes My associate, independent of the external conditions in which he is living on the Earth.

The chosen ones – aren’t those whom the conditionalities of the earth mark with honour and merits, but those who have united their Spirit with the God’s Work.

The Work of God and his associates has one feature which not all people can see, but which the Bright Brotherhood always sees: unselfishness. The Bright Brothers find My associates according to this feature in the sea of hypocrisy and passions and take them under their patronage. By training them according to the laws of Eternity, the Bright Brothers lead every one of My associates to his level, woven from his own exceptionality.

No “ways” exist on how to become the chosen ones. The spirit’s height is burning within man, which the Bright Brotherhood can see and which in most cases the people who surround My chosen ones cannot see.

Sometimes the Masters of karmas connect the “tails” of man’s former karmas in one of his incarnations by knowing his power of Fire, and the chosen man is walking by being consciously covered from the looks of the people who surround him. They can see his great and stunning personality, but they cannot see Me within him.

Your path is different. Carry the New Gospel which excites and strengthens the people’s spirit without any consecrations or rituals. Clean the heaps of rubbish and superstitions of people’s activity and work with the power of your pure joy, into which they buried themselves like ants by thinking that their work is an inevitable slavery while they are living on the earth.

Everybody must work without attaching himself to work, not searching for its results for which he is rewarded, but by glorifying God and his own people with his activity. The man’s work is glorification of his day.

Bring in clarity and perception that work is a joyous foundation of one’s life and freedom. Bring in the conception of the integrity of the earth and heaven, as well as the integrity of life of the earth and heaven.

I give the whole help which you can accept to you through the Bright Brotherhood. By obeying to Me and to My servants, Brothers of Compassion, carry the burden of your day not like a hero who is carrying his great deed, but like a happy man who comprehends that his life’s day is easy, that it is the power of his heart, that is that neither his thought, nor his feelings can feel the heaviness of the heroic tension, but they are living easily and joyously, because they can see Me and they are acting with Me.”

I don't know for how long the Light was shining until the figure of the Living God was covered with the shroud of mist, - I wasn't living on the Earth, I merged into the flow of Light - and no words exist with which I could name the moments experienced in bliss...

When I came to myself, the Master was standing behind me with both of his hands placed on my head and he was telling something silently by addressing the cup, but I couldn't distinguish any separate words...

The Master took the big cup from the altar which began to sparkle with the golden fire. Having raised it above his head, he uttered.

"By your order."

With these words uttered in Pali language he put the cup on my head. I felt a blow of an exceptional power and a sparkling; my body was flinching like from a thunder, I became deaf and blind. But it lasted only for a moment, and that active silence fell within me and in the whole room after it, which I had already experienced by this altar when I saw the radiating, divinely charming figure on the wall.

"To You from Yours," the Master uttered silently by still holding the cup on my head.

Then he put the cup on the altar, he climbed down together with me and stopped, as though by obeying the order which I couldn't comprehend, and he uttered in the same silent way.

"Let your will be."

I didn't know whom the Master was talking to, because only the wonderful star was shining in the room, from which the golden, always changing thought forms which I couldn't read and which were flashing in its beams, were flying to the Master.

Having bowed to the star that was still shining, the Master said to me.

"No miracles exist, only the levels of knowledge. And only wise men know it. But without the levels of knowledge also the levels of Compassion exist; and not only ordinary people don't know anything about them, but also the greater part of wise men. The levels of Compassion don't open for the people of the earth, because they rarely reach the real power of Spirit, that is, actually, they are rarely living in two worlds in their active activity of their routine by standing in them absolutely unselfish and by glorifying the moment of the passing by eternity. If the Divine Masters command, then some high member of the Bright Brotherhood is leading the man through every level of Compassion. There is an innumerable abundance of the levels of Compassion. And, once opened for the man as a climb to the Truth, they don't close anymore. Once the man has stepped on the first level of Compassion, he will also come to the last one which ends under the feet of the Living God in that planet in which the man is living. Certain efforts are necessary for the man to climb up the levels of knowledge, so that he would open within himself already existing, but not yet clearly comprehensible knowledge. The man doesn't need any efforts in order to climb up the levels of Compassion: the God's eyes can see the man's purity and absolute unselfishness, and the Divine order is given according to these characteristics - always for the certain members of the Bright Brotherhood - to promote the man into the new level of Compassion, that is to help him to enter the path of activity and contact with God. I told you: there is an innumerable abundance of the levels of Compassion. If the people's levels of knowledge always conform with the work of the invisible assistants of the seven rays of the mankind, then the levels of Compassion never submit to any laws determined for the mankind. The God's eyes of that planet in which the man is living direct the look of His power to the man, pulls him out of all his former conditions of karmas, unites him with Himself and puts his wreath of co-operation on him, while people are telling about him: the sacred one, the martyr, the Lord's Anointed, the hero. For the God's

eyes to begin to see the man, he also must acquire the absolute self-control, not only unselfishness and purity. If you can see the people who can absolutely control their body and character, that is the people who are completely free from the pressure of their personality, always know for sure: those are the people who are climbing up the levels of Compassion. All the paths of Life are opened for every man. You understood that man may not be chosen according to the signs of his supposed morals. He may be introduced only into those layers of vibrations of Harmony which are vibrating within himself, which are invisible to people, but which the God's eyes can see. On which level of Compassion a man will put his foot – that depends on the strength of the man's will. The power of the Christ's or Buddha's will was dependent on their absolute liberation, and the God's eyes could lead them to life and actions of the last level of Compassion where they completely merged with God. Delve deeply into one more instruction which the Great God, the Lord of our planet – Sanat Kumara entrusted me to explain to you."

The Master knelt down and touched the first level of the altar with his forehead. His entire figure showed honour and happiness when he uttered the Divine name. I followed his example by whispering the wonderful Name and blessing Him for the whole Compassion poured to me from the bottom of my heart. The Master stood up, he was all radiating, and he continued.

"Never, nowhere and to nobody utter this Divine Name without the special permission. The time will come, and you will receive an instruction to pass to people everything what you've experienced here and from your entire life. Your entire life is, was and will be dedicated only for this, you came here only for this. But that one whom the God's eyes began to see – by leading him out of the general laws of the people's movement, by accepting him as His direct associates, - must live not on the earth, but in two worlds by comprehending clearly that he is living in the world of heaven, but he is working in the world of the earth. Carry the Name uttered here always alive in your heart, dedicate your prayers to Him and know with whom, where and how you co-operate while you are holding the hand of your Teacher, your closest guardian and assistant by walking with him through the activity of the earth. That is all what I was ordered to impart to you, to be precise, to explain to you. I will add from myself: be blessed not only as the man from whose arrival our – the Masters of Power who were living on the earth for so long – liberation begins. Be blessed as the chosen one by God, as the part of Power that is given to people for their faster liberation. Accept my blessing, my friend and brother. I finished everything what I had to pass to you. Now I received an order to take you to my senior brother, to that one whom you call the Master of the Masters."

When the Master finished talking, a smile full of humour slid down his face, it suddenly changed his always serious face, serious even when he was smiling, or he was lit up with the exceptional kindness showed so many times to me during my stay here.

Having thanked my compassionate Teacher for his blessing and everything what he gave to me, I wanted to ask him to let me go to his laboratory one more time and to look at the burning towers for the last time, but he read this desire of mine.

"Enter, my friend. You can look at the towers and their Masters one more time. You can express your honour and gratitude to them and their work again, but you are wrong by thinking that you can see all of it for the last time: there is no "last time" for you – as well as for all those who have entered this house together with you, - nowhere and never anymore. If the Divine Master Sanat Kumara accepts somebody as His associates, then all the knowledge and discoveries which man receives under His instruction, remain in man's consciousness forever. The man who He has consecrated Himself is walking along the levels of Compassion and he is carrying the Fire of Knowledge with himself everywhere he would be destined to live. The towers will be always burning in your sight, and you will comprehend the scale of the Activity on the earth of God and His associates always more and more comprehensively. But let's enter... Your heart is so overflowing with gratitude and honour that it needs to make itself free even from

these sacred feelings, so that the “Ringing Joy” could echo loudly in it. Only like this, absolutely free, stable, reserved, with absolute self-control and trust you may go and see the Master of the Masters.”

The Master took me to the laboratory once again with the smile full of kindness. I could see everything very clearly: it seemed to me that the towers were shining even brighter than back then when I saw them for the first time; I could see the boundless desert behind them and... I already knew that there was a wonderful island with gardens in its centre, I knew Who was living in it... I bowed by glorifying the entire universe, by glorifying the Activity of God and people, by glorifying people’s sorrows and joys, their love and tears, their belief and hopes, their activity and disappointments...

“Let’s go, my friend, the Master of the Masters is already waiting for us,” the Master uttered with a nuance of humour by emphasizing my invented name “the Master of the Masters.”

I looked round the big room and I couldn’t control the sadness of farewell in my sigh.

“Strange boy,” the Master uttered silently. “You are really still a baby, and you didn’t even understand that “farewell” didn’t exist for you anymore. I will always be with you, because that one who is the highest on the earth has connected both of us, He blessed our inseparable activity for the wellbeing of our brothers of the earth. You will often come here; you will add to your knowledge here and temper your strengths. Your closest guardians will explain to you how you will get here. Don’t hasten the events. Live and act so actively as though you would be living your last hours, and carry the whole completeness of your feelings to people by not thinking even about the single minute of the future, by knowing that only this single passing-by minute of the Eternity exists.”

The Master embraced me, I kissed his big, wonderful hands warmly, I looked over this whole, unusual room once again, and we went to the stair, because the Master of the Masters was already waiting for us on the ground floor.

I was surprised even myself how easily I could stride the big steps of the stair. When I was climbing up onto the sixth floor back then, it was difficult for me despite the Master’s power: my heart was thumping, I broke into a sweat. Now, by understanding that it was much more difficult to climb down the steep stair, I was jumping down the steps easily, by feeling the power of the lion inside of me. It seemed to me that I could jump like this endlessly, and I was surprised when my Master stopped me and uttered.

“We have come. Immediately remember everything what you’ve taken out of my laboratory in your heart and consciousness. March to my senior brother with absolute self-control about which you were reading in the Fire and about which I was telling you.”

The wave of joy, big as a billow of the ocean rolled over me from the Master’s words. I comprehended once again what a great change had happened within me. My sight, hearing, physical body – everything was light, flexible, nothing caused any troubles, and I couldn’t even imagine that a weakness could penetrate into any of the organs of my conductor. Only that surprised me that I could see through the walls of the building, but the wall which protected the Master’s laboratory remained impenetrable. The Master who could read my thoughts like an opened book smiled and said to me.

“Now you encountered the principle spiritual law in practice: no secrets and obstacles exist for the spiritual movement. Only the power of spirit and the purity of spirit within a man exist. You can see everything where you’ve grown with your spirit and comprehended everything, but where your power of spirit is weaker than the power of your encountered phenomena, you can neither see nor hear. Be prepared!”

Together with these warning Master's words, the door flung open without any sound, and the space covered with the fiery frame opened before us. I could see how the Master of the Masters with Andreyeva entered here through the same fiery frame when we entered the laboratory of the elements for the first time. Only now it seemed to me that the fire of the door frame was burning much stronger. Therefore, I was very surprised that this fire wasn't frightening me, but it made me glad by awakening my energy. These thoughts only flashed in my head, and I uttered: "Morya", and I crossed the terrible threshold together with the Master. While taking the first step into the room of the Master of the Masters, I heard a crackling and like a distant thunder; but everything around us was steeped in the mist, and I comprehend neither where it was thundering from, nor where I was, I didn't even know whether my Master-Teacher was walking next to me. I stopped, full of joy and power, and I uttered silently once again: "Morya".

"Why, my friend, you enter my room by uttering this name, although you know much more powerful name of the Great One Who has sent you here?"

The Master of the Masters was standing before me in the clearing away mist. Namely his voice I heard in this thick space.

"Greetings, Master of the Masters," I answered him. "Forgive me for calling you like this, but I don't know your any other name. I uttered Teacher Morya's name that is sacred to me, who has helped me so much during my life just because I didn't dare to utter loudly the divine name that is now alive for me forever. Forgive me if I acted differently as I had to."

"Enter, my friend, be not guest and disciple here, but comprehend clearly yourself as the little part of the Only One, because you entered here for His activity and serving, and see me also only as the little part of the Only One. Everybody who could see the Deity of the Earth is carrying His activity not only into those places where they are living, but also into all people's souls who are prepared to accept the new word which God is sending to them through his messengers. I congratulate you in the name of the Only One God, and let His blessing descend on our joint work."

The Master of the Masters took my hand, and I saw that this room absolutely didn't look like my Master's laboratory. There weren't any tables with the towers here, a lot of bookcases with books, several writing-tables and only one big device as big as the tower were standing here.

I didn't have time to look around, while the Master of the Masters put the question to me again.

"Why don't you greet your friend? You were thinking about her when you were going downstairs, didn't you?"

I looked at the Master without understanding anything, because I couldn't see my dear Nataliya Vladimirovna anywhere.

A sonorous laughter travelled from above, and finally, I saw that one who had remained in my memory as a stout and lumbering woman, but now she looked like a small child under the ceiling. She was sitting on the most upper shelf, surrounded herself with the heaps of books, where the Master of the Masters must have seated her. The light was spreading from her entire figure, which I hadn't noticed before, and even her laughter seemed to be especially melodious to me, without any sarcasm that was characteristic to her before.

The Master of the Masters came up to the bookcase – and Andreyeva came to me in a flash. Having looked at her face and eyes, I got numb with amazement and I couldn't utter a single word. The

change that had happened within her didn't seem even to be a change to me, which I had seen, but the real transformation.

She looked the same whom I knew well, but at the same time, all her features were absolutely unfamiliar, exalted and spiritual. An unusual seriousness, kindness and light of calm were spreading from her. I was looking at her with my eyes opened wide, while she was staring at me in her turn.

"Come here, my friends," the Master of the Masters invited us. He was sitting on a wide armchair and He showed the place on the high bench next to Himself, which was like a threshold according to his height. "Soon all of you who entered this house will leave it all together, so that you could break up on the earth for the people's happiness and wellbeing. Every one of you knows your mission precisely; everything what the Divine Power told to give you was given to you. Providence has destined that only to you," the Master addressed me, "not only the Activity of Eternity would be revealed, but also an absolute perception of the psychological tasks of today's mankind. Namely due to this task you came to me. What else from the great truths which were given to you to spread in the new way, you must reveal to people first, besides what my brother has already explained to you?

The first truth which you must spread through your new work: only that man may enter the perception of his own role on the earth and the meaning of his earthly life, for whom his daily bread doesn't become bitter, that is from whose life the feeling of envy has already disappeared once and for all.

There's no place in the people's activity of the future race for that one who still compares his destiny with the others' ones. The principal feature of the future humanity – everyone's absolute, joyous independence.

How could one achieve it? Through the complete liberation from one's passions, what you have already comprehended not only with your mind, but also with your active actions. Bring these conceptions into the life of people's mind and spirit practically with your enslaving characters.

Second: no duality must exist in the man's earthly life when he is exerting himself to the utmost between his serving to God and his wealth.

The liberated man is living without any compromises. Only the daily bread and the activity with which he always glorifies the day exist for him. The split in one's psyche, the question: "How to unite one and another?" – that's only the call of the personality who is living on the earth.

Bring in the conception of the only one possibility to live joyously: to enter the continuous life of the two worlds with your spirit and thought.

Third: no religions must exist as the thrust moral norms, the props and crutches of the Light, so that the earthly mode of life could be supported with them: such path is leading only to even greater slavery.

An inevitable and eternal rule for everybody exists: to establish one's relation with God and religion as the only one law of Life which everybody establishes himself for himself. Help to throw off the superstition that when the man fortifies his position in the fortress of materialism, then he can create a free existence for himself. Freedom – that's the man himself, his revealed God. Freedom doesn't come from exterior – Freedom is Harmony.

Fourth: spread not a teaching, but the New Gospel. What is the difference here? The teaching is the knowledge, not backed up with one's own example. It may be important, but it isn't the God's word which the messenger is bringing onto the Earth.

The messenger is going with the God's word, passed onto the Earth, that is with the New Gospel, by receiving the power for himself to live in such ways as his passed words sound.

Even the death cannot stop or force to hesitate the God's messenger. The God within the man and the man within Him – everything is merged into one.

Fifth: you will carry the word of calm and love to people not as a renewed dogma, but you will teach people to live without any dogmas with the Living God in their hearts.

Try to clear up the most erroneous point of view: to live spiritually by listening to another's instructions.

The future man must live absolutely free, that is completely liberated. Both independence with respect to the daily bread and activity, and an independent development in Spirit and Fire are necessary for the future man whose psychic feelings and strength will be developing very easily. But the condition of their harmonious and correct development must be the absolute stability of his independence, and that is equal to the unshakable loyalty.

During the certain periods of time which Life Himself sets, He gives the new challenges to people with which – as with the steps of the stair – they are rising to the heights which seem to them like coming from the exterior. And actually, Love who is watching the development of the people's strengths vigilantly sees that moment when the humanity already may move forward, and she is sending her pioneers to it who help to burn any far-gone superstitions and to begin the new cycle of rise."

Having finished his speech, the Master of the Masters stood up, came up to Nataliya Vladimirovna, put his big hand on her head and added.

"Now finish studying those last volumes that are still left, and don't forget the notes given to you," with these words he seated her on the shelf again where I saw her when I entered the room.

The Master of the Masters lifted her easily, like a little feather, exactly in the same way as my Master-Teacher was lifting me.

"A separate conversation with me is still waiting for you, my friend. It is for you alone; not only now, but also in the future you will never be telling about it to anybody. Not a single man, in whatever height his place in the universe would be in your opinion, may know about our conversation if you don't get any separate instructions. The silence instructed for the disciple is the same loyalty through which he achieves his consecrations. That isn't a secret, but that Fire of Spirit that may be usefully poured only in such a way and there where it was instructed. If the disciple violated his obedience, he would destroy and burn the tasks of Life instead of creating."

The Master crossed the whole big room quickly, he opened the door on the wall, in the same place where the room with the sofa above was at my Master-Teacher's, and he let me go first into the brightly lit room. This room absolutely didn't look like that one in which I was sleeping two times, covered with the furs of silver foxes.

The altar here was standing straight before the door. It was big, seven big cups, burning and shining with all colours of the blazing towers, were standing on it, along the whole height of the wall. Like

alive, the portrait of the Teacher of that ray, the light of the colour of which it reflected, was inserted into the wall and it was shining above every cup. The cup of the colour of every Teacher's ray was shining in every Teacher's hands.

Everything was shining so much, changing in vibrating beams, the vibrations of which couldn't have passed any of the most miraculous lantern, that I, stunned by this grand view, fell on my knees by glorifying the God's name.

"You are right, my son, Life Himself is settled here, and you can clearly see His eternal movement in this perpetual vibration of the beams."

The Master lifted me up, pressed me to himself all trembling and perplexed, and he continued.

"For many times already, Life was choosing a man for His mission of love, help and rescuing of the mankind. His call was given to many, but not everybody could accept it. Some of those who used to accept it, didn't have the strength of their loyalty to put it on their shoulders as the cross of joy. In this moment when you are standing in His most Sacred Temple, don't think whether you will have enough loyalty to carry His cross till the end. Don't think about the heroic deed that is waiting for you, about that what will happen when you leave this place. Think only about the highest happiness: to be able to hear the God's voice in this moment. Listen to Him by forgetting about yourself, with the whole purity of your heart, your entire joy opened, so that His every word could get into your consciousness forever."

The Master knelt down together with me, and he started his conversation.

I still haven't received an instruction to tell anybody about this conversation, so in this place I pull the curtain of my honour.

Chapter 29

The tower of the elements of nature in the laboratory of the Master of the Masters. His explanation and the tower of the elements in the space. The watchmen of the elements, their activity in passing of the creative inspiration. The Great Teacher Maha-Chohan. His universal activity. The last precepts of the Master of the Masters for me and Andreyeva. We leave the laboratory of the elements and meet I.

Having finished the conversation, the Master of the Masters invited me to his laboratory again. The door of the sacred room closed, the wall merged into one totality, and no one could even suspect that it once opened and let us in.

Having taken me to the only one device in the whole laboratory, which was gigantic and looked like a tower, the Master uttered.

“You saw the burning towers of Energy and Love. You saw their associates – the workers of the heaven and the earth, you saw the continuous connection of the heaven and the earth in the Activity of Eternity. You are also destined to see the activity of the Only One Life, His merging with the elements of nature. No miracles exist here, as well as in the entire Activity of Eternity; only the knowledge exists. As you can see, this device has seven floors. The lower four floors correspond to His Life in four elements: the one of fire, of water, of the air and of the earth. Fire is the most furious and effective of all the elements. This element, the entire activity of its Masters is reflected in the lowest floor of the tower, which now you can see calm and golden, because its work doesn't open to your eyes. Take a good look at that part of the tower, and you will see the activity awakening for your sight. Also understand and remember once again: one may be standing by the source of Life and not see it. Therefore, never be surprised in your future encounters of the Earth when people will be listening to your words and not hear them, that is they won't understand their meaning. They will be reading your work, they will choose that what they will like, they will pull their shoulders for the rest of the text which they will attribute to your personality which they won't like or understand, and they will be telling: “Whatever somebody makes up?” In such cases you won't be able to help people with anything, because their eyes are still not awakened, therefore they cannot see.”

The Master took one of the seven small mallets which were placed on the table by the tower. All the mallets had the same form, dimensions and the same golden colour. As soon as the Master took the closest mallet into his hand, it seemed to me that it turned into a piece of the hot fire immediately by keeping the form of the mallet, but by surpassing its previous dimensions many times. I was surprised

how the Master could hold such big, burning hammer in his hand, because it seemed that one single would be enough for a man to turn into ashes. Suddenly, I heard the changed, loud Master's voice.

"Only a fearless man may approach the altar of Your activity, Great Master. Purity of the fearless man's loyalty to You is protecting him, and Your Fire doesn't burn him down, but enters him into the Eternal knowledge which only You Alone reveal."

The Master's words were still ringing in my ears; I was all still covered with his changed voice and the charm of his eyes which were radiating an exceptional power when his hand touched mine and put the fiery hammer into my palm. By pointing at the protuberance in the wall to which he put me in a flash, he ordered in a commanding way.

"Hit with the hammer of joy and rejoice at the happiness to live another moment with the whole might of your pure heart by cooperating with me in the presence of the Living God."

I could feel neither the burning fire nor the weight of the hammer, I became an incarnation of joy that covered me, in the same way as in the chapel of the Great Mother. I hit the protuberance of the wall showed to me with all my might by whispering: "Great Living God Sanat Kumara, let the only goal of my life be – to live and act in your Name."

I and the whole room trembled from my hit to the protuberance of the wall, everything around was plunged in sparkles. The Master's hand took the hammer from me, which I was holding with both of my hands now. The sparkles cleared away; the whole wall was burning with a bright fire. The lower floor of the tower was also all burning in red colour.

Having put his hand on back of my head, the Master showed me through the wall silently. I saw the desert and the wonderful garden in its hottest place. In the depth of the garden – for a moment – I saw that One Whose name I uttered when I hit the wall, I saw His blessing hand...

"Here, the tower of the fire element is burning in the space," I heard the Master's voice, and I saw a high and very wide pillar of fire which had erupted from the ground like from some gigantic crater. "Can you see the moving fiery figures? That's the spirits of the fire element, her workers, people can rarely see them, but the eyes of all the liberated people can see them clearly. These spirits are strongly connected with all the workers of heaven with their activity. Each area of the Universe has its own Master who is always a high member of the Bright Brotherhood. The activity of the people, of the animals and of the workers of all four elements of that area subordinate to Him, as well as the entire life of the plants of the Earth and the whole work of the invisible assistants of the area. You can see how the workers of fire take the pieces of fire out of the very entrails of the earth. Observe closely where they are carrying the pieces of fire of the earth first?"

I concentrated my attention on the burning lower floor of the tower. It was divided into four floors in its turn, and I could see the working spirits of the human form in all four floors.

I started observing the work of the fiery living beings and I saw that all of them were different. I began to distinguish some brighter and more pale, some bigger and smaller of them; some of them were forcing their way through in a furious, uncontrollable way, by drowning in the flame, but also there were some of them who were carrying the fire tenderly.

The furious, biggest workers used to bring the biggest bonfires, but this fire didn't rise up. It was blazing and bubbling like a stormy sea of the Earth. Having thrown down the pieces of fire, as though by shaking off the burning flames at the very bottom of the tower, the big spirits used to dive into the

entrails of the earth again. They were always, periodically vanishing in these entrails and they were rising at the foot of the tower again, wrapped themselves up with the bubbling fire.

Their whole work was to take the fire from the entrails of the earth and to throw these burning balls into the bubbling sea of fire. Their faces were gloomy, their actions were concentrated, while their colour was dark red.

The smaller spirits with the lighter forms were ordering the fire balls on the ground floor of the tower. As though they were combing them, making them straight and they were carrying the fire bands prepared like this to the first floor. The forms of the spirits here were lighter and clearer, they were smaller and not so brightly red, with the touch of violet, reddish, orange and yellow colours. These spirits who reminded me of bodies with their forms were weaving like ropes – the bands of red colour – from the fiery bands by also tying in the fires of the mentioned colours which were shining in their own bodies.

On one floor higher, the light and deft fiery workers used to tie the fire threads of all the nuances of green, blue and white colours in these ropes. On the very top, the charming, merry, smiling spirits were shining pleasingly with their soft fiery colour with the bright golden touch. They used to tear off small pieces from the received fiery ropes, they rose high, and they were flying with them in the space towards the burning towers of the rays.

One could clearly see a strict regularity in the activity of these wonderful fiery workers. Some of them were always taking the pieces of fire from one side of the tower, the others – from another side by never crossing somebody's set limits for their work.

"You've heard many times both while staying with us and next to I., that there is no separation in the activity of Life – everything is interconnected, everything is in harmony. You saw how the work is done for the people's salvation and wellbeing in the towers of the rays. Now you can see that the towers of the rays – that's already the later phase of the activity of the Creator, the protector of our planet and of His associates. His associates take the Fire thrown out by the Creator from the elements of nature, and having woven such plaits from them which the Masters of karmas told them to, they are carrying them to the towers of the rays. Our creative activity, the one of the Masters of power, is closely connected with their work: we help them to create the psychic power of every man by reading their Eternal Chronicle. Each floor of the tower of the elements has its own amount of the workers of the Masters of karmas. They receive direct instructions from the Highest Master who leads all five towers from the third to the seventh, through which the whole mankind is walking its own earthly path of development. Concrete powers of nature and of the fire of the Earth are placed into the consciousnesses of the future people according to their instructions here, in the tower of the elements, which determine the people's characteristics. Later, when they are already incarnated, they become travellers of the seas, military leaders (if they are destined to use the destroying Fire), aeronauts, investigators and fearless researchers of nature, heaven, the stars and the seas. The spirits of the elements carry the elements of Origins from here – from the towers of the elements according to the primary instructions of the Masters of karmas to the towers of the rays, and there the workers of heaven, under the leadership of the Masters of karmas of the current cycles of the people's lives, make up and carry the elements of Origins out of the tower of the elements. You've already seen their work many times, and now, by connecting your knowledge about the activity of the tower of the elements, you can see it even clearer and comprehend even better that the connection of all closely related Origins of nature is already hidden beforehand in every living being."

The Master fell silent, as though by allowing me to comprehend deeper the processes which I had seen.

Already earlier, the creation of the great towers showed to me by my first Master-Teacher caused a respect and trembling before Wisdom within myself. And now, the grandeur that I had seen – the strictest regularity and accuracy of the Life's Activity, Love and care for every living being, lots of selflessly loving workers who possess the only goal: the people's wellbeing, - made me get stiff in the ecstasy of respect, and I gave a shout unawares.

"Oh, how charming Life is!"

"Yes, my son, you are right, Life is charming!" the Master of the Masters uttered silently. "And although Life is taking care of the people incessantly, you know yourself how rarely man is happy on the earth. How rarely the thought penetrates into his consciousness that the only invincible power is joy. And even more rarely you can encounter a liberated living being on the earth who has reached the knowledge that every loyal son of Life must carry joy and justification for his encountered person in his heart. Having separated from other people with his madness, with his egoism, man is feeling lonely; and when he is bound with them in his personal relations, he calls his life to be full. Now you already understand that neither the first ones nor the others may not find the path to their liberation, that is the path to the Truth. Because only those will find it who are searching for the connections with the workers of heaven and the earth on the basis of the Truth which they are carrying inside of them. Now look at the activity of the Masters of the elements of the water, the air and the earth."

The Master took a threefold, golden mallet from the table, which turned into a big, three-headed hammer in his hand, shining and trembling in golden and silver fire, twisted in balls. Having put this hammer in my hand, the Master moved me a little to the right, he showed to me something that looked like an anvil, shining in gold, and uttered.

"Your call till the end – for the loyal and fearless till the end. Accept Your Own called son."

Having uttered this, he showed me the anvil again. I hit it by uttering the Living God's Sanat Kumara's name. A crackling was heard, like some underground rumbling, a noise like during the storm in the sea, a wail of the wind which reminded me of the trembling of Anna's lighthouse during the most terrible moments of the sandstorm in the desert.

"Everything is for Your honour, Lord, because everything – that's You," I whispered by hardly keeping my feet from my hit.

"Yes, my son, once again you are right. Everything – that's He, Merciful. While the entire Activity, the entire creation of the Earth, everything – that's love of Sanat Kumara, the greatest Guardian and Patron of the Earth," the Master continued. "Look at the tower. What did your hit awaken in it?"

I look at it, as he told me to do, and I saw that other three floors of the tower, which were calm up to now, began to burn in the most fabulous fires. The fire of the water element, white like a spume, was curling and surging next to the floors of the fire element. Above it, on the next floor, the golden liquid, transparent fire which looked like sunbeams was changing. It used to wail, as if the wind had been raging in it. That was the floor of the air element.

The third from the burning floors which reflected the element of the earth was all bristled up, buried in the smoke, through which the tongues of reddish-brown fire were forcing their way through. And from above, like a reflection of lightning, bright streams of fire were pouring into the smoke of the earth by mixing on the bristling surface, like on the back of a monster.

The floor of the element of the earth looked like a heavy press that was pressing all other elements with its weight.

“Look at the space and observe,” the Master told me.

I turned to the wall of the Master’s laboratory which became transparent for me now, and I saw the revived floors of the tower of the elements. My God, what a view it was! Everything what I described now as alive processes, which were taking part in the device that looked like a tower in the Master’s laboratory, was trembling in the space before me, only multiplied hundreds of times.

The tower of the elements – differently from what I had seen up to now – was all widening to the top. The Earth covered all the remaining elements like a gigantic fungus. The view was oppressing and dazzling me, I could hardly control myself.

The Master of the Masters was standing next to me in silence. Finally, he put his hand on my head and began to speak.

“The earth and heaven were constantly repeating about the absolute and perfect self-control to you for many, many times. Not only that one whom the Only One has called for the high mission of cooperation with Him, but also every ordinary man who has started his really human and not half-human stage of his life on the Earth, must achieve the absolute self-control. You, like every messenger of the Bright Brotherhood, may not lose your self-control at least for a moment. You may not be standing by losing concentration of your attention at least for a moment in the presence of any phenomena, any circumstances, any encounters. Every moment – the moment of the passing-by Eternity – in which you lost your absolute self-control, has thrown overboard not only you, but everybody with whom you are connected in your thoughts, your activity, your work, your correspondence and even with your temporary encounters. Everybody who is connected with the messenger of the Only One, through him becomes connected with the Eternity, and they cover his karma, his consciousness, his active activity like a veil. The Light flashes across this veil through the messenger’s energetic centres and his attention. The energetic centres of the messenger’s encountered people, with whom they were tied with spiritual bonds, are spinning and are cleaned through the messenger’s energetic centres much stronger and much closer than they would be cleaned through the centres of the Master of the field. You are destined to come back to the people’s society with a great mission. Therefore, your self-control may not leave the limits of the complete joy.

Where does the power of your self-control, as well as of every other man’s, arise from? From the complete knowledge, from the constant, living sensation of Life within yourself. You always feel the direct influence, your bond with the Only One. You also feel this bond through all the members of the Bright Brotherhood, and through every elemental phenomenon, and through every encountered heart into which you are pouring the current of Love that enters you through all the paths from the primary source, from the Representative of the Only One on the Earth, from its Great Guard and Master Sanat Kumara. You were living without knowing this great name up to now. And your Life was flowing through all the channels which were harmonious to you, by protecting you everywhere, by revealing always new and higher levels of the saint hierarchy to you. What are your duties for people and heaven now? To show with your living example how the powerful power of Love’s help and care is passed into an ordinary life. You will have the happiness to reveal to people the great and stunning panorama of the activity of all the bright powers of the Earth, and care of every living and dead man. You will have the happiness to reveal not thoughts, not only comprehension within man that the Bright powers of the earth and cooperation with them exist, but also to clean the path for every man into his own heart, so that he could feel the eternal bond there – in the vortex of his everyday activity – with the Divine Power of Sanat Kumara. You must come back to the people’s society not only as the hardened fighter with an absolute fearlessness and self-control, but also with the loyalty full of calm. With such loyalty for which no hesitation or confusion exist in the presence of any nature disasters, events or people. Both your whole daily activity and your greatest upswings, -

everything is only the straightest path to pass the power, knowledge and help of the Bright Brotherhood to people through your word. First of all you must explain to people in your work what are the duties of every ordinary man for his family, his neighbour, his encountered person. No less important for the man who has stopped being blind to comprehend, to feel and to fulfil his duties for his encountered person and for himself during this incarnation. The man's duties in his family life – that's not a karma and its oppressing yoke. His duties – that's joy to pass the lasso of relief and calm for his encountered person's heart. That's not a passive comprehension of the passing-by life, as the result of the past, but an active fight for the Light in everyday activity without any compromises and a tiring, inner, moral duplication. I., Venetian and your main Teacher, the great brother of mankind and powerful friend Morya will be explaining to you about it more in detail many times. Now when you've regained your absolute self-control again, take a good look at the tower of the elements. Why is the earth so bristled up? Why is its atmosphere so smoky and greyish brown? Why is it throwing the fire in pieces? Why does it press all the remaining elements with all its weight, as though by burying them under itself? This pressure is just an illusion. Actually, they penetrate one through the other. And the fire, which you can see breaking out in pieces, is the Earth's fire that penetrates through everything what is alive on her. Not a single small beetle or animal could exist on the Earth if the fire of its entrails wasn't poured into everything what is alive in the equal part with the sunlight. The Earth that extends before you – that's the result of the activity of Sanat Kumara and His Associates, the result of Their infinite self-sacrifice. They have forgotten about themselves, they could see only man and his development while they were working. Sanat Kumara was creating the whole life on the Earth with this law of Love, which the Only One has given to man as a precept by incarnating on the Earth. Everything what is accomplished according to this law is full of happiness and light, because it is walking down the paths of Harmony, and it develops easier or with more difficulty. Everything what gets under the dominion of egoism is drawn in the dark paths in which they finally perish by being at fault always more and more, without fulfilling the task of their incarnation and by losing it meaninglessly. You can see the cavities in the fungal form of the Earth. Bright wheels of the energetic centres are spinning in each of its cavities. Those are the prototypes of the man's centres. Those are the centres of the Earth which draw the powers of all elements into themselves. They grow narrow downwards, they have a funnel form, and the light below is much brighter and purer, while the spinning is stronger than above, on the wider end of the funnel. This is the result of the activity of the Masters of the elements, the workers of heaven and the Bright Brotherhood of the earth."

With the Master's help, I could see a tremendous amount of moving spirits in every centre of the funnel form of the Earth. Their exceptional diversity and abundance told about the different sorts of their activity. But one could clearly feel that they directly belonged to one Master of the elements in every centre, as well as the system and harmony of their activity.

The Master continued after being silent for a while.

"The activity of the elements, which in people's opinion are blind, sometimes disastrous, sometimes salutary, is dedicated for the prosperity of the universe, it is occurring according to the same universal laws of accuracy, according to which also the activity of the universe of everything what the highest Wisdom has created is occurring. And this everything doesn't care about the laws of justice invented by the Earth, nobody who is living in two worlds and who doesn't understand any separation cares about them at all. While extending further, into the very entrails of the Earth, the prototypes of the centres – I will call them like this for you for a while – turn into shining, tiny centres due to the activity of a lot of assistants, which are hidden in the most inaccessible places for people and beasts. When I say "tiny", you can see the relativity of this conception, because they are gigantic on the scale of the Earth. These nests in which all the Origins of the elements are concentrated, support the planet's life. Every planet is living and breathing until the Origins placed into her centres warm, feed, illuminate and help to develop her

and everything what is living on her. The Origins of the elements keep Harmony and fulfil the Wisdom of the struck hour even when people are horror-struck from the catastrophes that happen around them. You can see the workers of all elements in every centre of the earthly Origins. Pay your attention how they are connected with their activity with the clear spirits of the towers of rays. You can see that the circles of the centres are located at the foot of every tower, under it, around it and at the certain distance from it, they are like some fiery crests, with their tops up, protecting the accesses to the towers. No dark power is able to approach any tower of the Sacred Power, although many dark sects control some individual elements. But only that bright and loving may master all the elements for whom the engine of his activity is joy. The dark ones don't possess any joy. Their weapon – that's the stubbornness of their will. Namely that is the sword of evil, the weapon of light – that's joy, her sword – that's the motto: "Overcome by loving". The accumulations of the centres of the Origins are located not only by the towers of rays. They are also hidden in many places of the Earth. The nature in those places is always generous, the soil is fertile and picturesque, people are musical, beautiful, their character is easy. The centres are alive – the planet is alive, the centres of the Origins went out – also the planet is dead. The atmosphere of the Earth, which now you can see as covered with smoke and brownish red, actually is transparent if you take a better look. The spirits of the air element, even the brown ones, the small, cheerful living beings, always clean the smoky accumulations of the Earth. What are these accumulations? That's the people's emanations. There are some periods when the spirits of the elements succeed to dissipate almost all smoky accumulations of the Earth atmosphere, because in that moment the people's emanations don't concentrate into big, brownish red clouds. Those are the periods of the peaceful construction on the Earth, a joyous rest from bloody wars and from greediness that torments them even more than wars. As you can see, greediness and stinginess enlarge the smoky accumulations with no smaller fog than the fiery blackish grey fog of murdering, crime and fear. Later in your life you will find out how the Masters of karmas of the towers of the elements are fighting with self-sacrifice by protecting the coming of every born living being onto the Earth. These Masters, closely connected with the workers of the sixth, Love's ray with their activity, liberate – by taking the greater part of passions of the man who steps into his incarnation – every living being in such a way that she could choose independently the path of light or darkness with the whole completeness of her consciousness. These Masters of karmas of the elements help to choose not only the elemental which builds the man's physical body for the first seven years, but also the patron and guardian from their surroundings for every man during the entire time of his activity on the Earth. The folk fairy tales call such patron as a guardian angel, and when somebody is saved unexpectedly, people say: "Your guardian angel didn't sleep through." Now concentrate your attention on the upper floors of the tower. This time we won't touch the elements of the air and water. You haven't matured yet to know something more about them, that is to acquire the possibility to control them. You will leave this place by possessing the powers to control only the elements of the earth and fire. You will come back here again to learn to control the remaining two elements, as I've already told you during our secret conversation. All three upper floors of the towers belong to the Masters of karmas of the elements. Now you can see their work, the tireless and the most difficult one from all works of Love, and to understand it only partly. But everything that you will see and understand you will pass to people, so that they would comprehend more easily that no "fate" may hinder their absolute, spiritual freedom. The upper tower floor from these three ones – that's the sphere of the activity of the Masters of karmas of the earth and fire. Like the most tedious jewellers, these Masters tie the Origins of Eternity in the results of the previous man's karmas, which are coloured in all colours of passions. I man's thoughts used to reach the levels of humanism and compassions, then there may not be so much great kindness and sympathy in any cup of justice anywhere, except here, by these fair Masters. These Masters are absolutely free-living beings. Not only something personal may influence them, but also, they themselves are nearing the radiant image of great Kumaras with their structure and rank. You can see that two watchmen are standing from both sides of the tower of the earth and fire. They are radiant, transparent, and it seems that they are created from the air, although you can clearly see their human

forms. You can see exactly the same watchmen one floor lower, where the Masters of the elements of the air and water are working. The watchmen are those who know everything and who are everywhere. They reflect these qualities of the living God Sanat Kumara on the Earth. They are creators of the great books of Akashic records. They are the memory of the Earth God. With their instruction, the incalculable soldiery of the Masters of karmas of the elements is spreading the God's love and care for the people's crowds. Now I won't explain the whole net of their great activity to you. You can see yourself that their work is exceptionally diverse, how exceptionally abundant the variety of forms of their hierarchy is. The watchmen look like radiant gods with their beauty. Their commands like wonderful lightnings pour into the creation of the Masters of karmas who subordinate to them and who are directly connected with them. Although there aren't many of them, they are powerful and kind, and they lead the chronicles of Eternity in their big fields. Under the instruction of the watchmen, they are pouring their own thoughts onto their abundant subjects, which take the form of flower garlands. These subjects of theirs, in their turn, lead the records of the eternal chronicle in smaller sections, they read the lines of every newly incarnated man and pass them – without their own sanction – to those Masters of karmas whom you've seen before. As I've already mentioned, they, the most tedious and the best jewellers are weaving the protective net for every man and sending their messengers to carry over the results of this activity of Love into the tower of rays. From here start to explain to the people of your time the senselessness of their fear. Try to reveal them that they themselves pollute their bond with God. Everyone who is trying to find the path to his liberation is trying to clean the rubbish out of his path to God with his activity. And the nearer he comes to God, because he has cleaned himself from the mess of his personal passions, the nearer he comes to his tolerance by carrying love and joy for his encountered person. Try to reveal to the man's consciousness with the characters of your works that not a single ideal of one's mind may influence the encountered person's heart and spirit actively. Only man's own calm of heart and simple kindness may weave such communication without any superstitions and conditionalities into his encounter, through which a crack for the ray of Love will open. Now concentrate your entire attention especially and see how the creative impulses of the Divine Thought are descending onto the earth. You can see the balls, protected by joyous and bright spirits in channels, which stand out from all other millions of thought forms, and which visually are made of rather solid matter and of the same colour proportions. One side of the ball is unicolour, which corresponds with its colour to one of the colours of the tower of seven rays, while the other side was coloured in equal parts in the colours of the remaining towers of six rays. All these colours and hues are laid out in such a way that the eyesight of the modern man of the Earth would perceive them without any physical or optical devices. These colours and hues correspond precisely to all man's spiritual conversions of the current epoch. You saw that all Origins of Life were tied in every man's organism of the Earth. You saw that the activity of a tremendous amount of workers of the Masters of karmas both protect and help man to develop. But Sanat Kumara's love of the Great Divine Power, as well as His activity, doesn't stop at least for a moment. His Eternal Movement, merged with the Divine Movement of the entire universe, is always developing, as a man would put it, but actually, it always throws kindness and compassion for the moving people's crowds out of itself. Here, those balls which change in the exceptional range of colours, which, as you can see, a lot of invisible assistants already direct to the corresponding channels, - that's creative God's thoughts, an effective power which people call an inspiration or talent. These powers awaken in people sometimes suddenly, during the years of their adolescence and youth, after their childhood which didn't promise the man any especial abilities. Sometimes the talent shows up late, in people's opinion, even in one's old age, although it wasn't expressed at all up to now. But also here, as in any case, no miracles exist, here, as well as in the entire life of the universe, the logic of Eternity reveals itself. Look. Here, the ball of Sanat Kumara's thought is flying. Four watchmen of the elements take it immediately. They don't give it to the Masters of karmas who subordinate to them. As every time, they give it to a tremendous number of special spirits shining in the rainbow colours, who carry this ball of thought to the tower of rays dedicated for it. Whom do they pass it to there? In the first two towers – directly to the greatest Teachers, the masters of the

towers. And here you can see how the ball of thought acquires that combination of colours which I showed to you before by rolling down their mantles, by getting saturated with the magnetism of the Teacher's heart and thoughts. Having rolled down the Teacher's mantle, this thought is again taken by special spirits and passed to the region of the Earth dedicated for it, for a concrete Master, and through him – for a concrete man. The bond of this thought with the Teacher and the man who was painted with it is so strong and great that its every negation or a defective point of view to it comes back like a boomerang to the Teacher who sent it to the Earth to his chosen man. The installation of the magnetic channels – that's also the work of the Masters of karmas, this work is especially important for the remaining five rays – from the third till the seventh one, – through which the entire mankind of the Earth covers its path. Now, for the first time you see the Great Teacher of the World Maha Chohan whose activity encompasses these five rays. You saw that the watchmen of the elements took over the God's thoughts in the first two rays and they sent them to the first two towers with help of a tremendous number of special invisible assistants. Teacher Maha Chohan receives the balls of thoughts directly from three Great Kumaras. Each of the great associates of the Living God of the Earth has a tremendous number of his invisible assistants who carry the thoughts and inspiration of God to Maha Chohan. Transparent, special assistants who subordinate to Maha Chohan are flying from him, they don't mix up with the hierarchies of the workers of the towers; and they are always carrying the God's thoughts to the same, concrete tower as the Highest Teacher instructs them, who is a chief of this field of the God's work in the towers of rays. This field of the God's work which His three closest, firsthand assistants, three brothers of His, pass to the universe of the Earth, is accomplished without any hierarchic levels and rules which are set for the usual path of development and advancement of the medium man. The law of Love is applied here: that one wins who finds the strength to bless all the circumstances of his epochs, his personal life, his surroundings. Only that one may attract the magnetic current to himself, which is being passed onto the Earth through this path, who has created the bridge for this current from kindness and courage of his heart, from his purity and stability of his thought, from his fearlessness and unselfishness. Three Kumaras, who saw a man and accepted him to their arms and under their guardianship, pass the power of their heart to the Highest Master Maha Chohan for the creation of the bridge of the spiritual channel of the stabile Harmony. And then, already Teacher Maha Chohan himself passes and pours the power of creation and inspiration of the Third Logos incarnated by three Kumaras to the concrete tower of rays. His creative work in the universal construction is finished with it. Teacher himself, the Highest Master of every tower of rays passes to the Master of karmas who subordinates to him the new magnetic current of Divine help for a concrete man, and later everything is happening according to the logic of the Creation of Eternity. Look farther, behind the towers of the elements. What can you see there? What is the meaning of the big sand sea which emits smoke like a still not extinguished volcano? Those are stiff layers of soil which turn into the new – fertile in the future – soil for the future streams of mankind, thanks to the work of the highest disciples-people. The emanations of the people's evil and sadness exhaust the fertile soil and healthy air, as well as the people's work activity. The nests prepared during the centuries die out from all sorts of cataclysms: everything, as well as the soil itself, dies in those places. On this smoking surface which you can see now, under the direct leadership of the watchmen of the elements, with the work of the high disciples on the earth and the work of the invisible workers of all elements in the earth itself, the new nests of Origins of Life are created, which we decided to call the centres of the Eternal Movement. Now the view of the activity of the Creator of the Earth is as clear to you as your consciousness can comprehend the view of the Eternal Existence of Life now. Remember forever: everything is inside of every man. And only he himself is creator of his path. To be precise, every man is the path, and this path is as close to the God's creation as the man was able to liberate God within himself."

The Master called Nataliya Vladimirovna to himself, who was sitting so high and so far away from us that she couldn't hear a single word of our conversation. Now she answered by responding to the raised Master's voice.

"I finished my work exactly at this moment, Master-Teacher. But I cannot climb down to you, because I haven't learned to jump like a tiger yet."

I heard the slightest, hardly perceptible, but anyway the nuance of irritation in her intonation. If these words had been uttered in the circumstances of everyday life, then one could understand them like a humour. But everyday people's words in this grand cell of Wisdom, meant to make fun of their won helplessness, sounded not only like a disharmony, but they even cut through my heart.

"My friend, you won't be able to leave this room without leaving your irritability that is so characteristic to your character in it. You can enter it not with an absolute self-control, too, because Sanat Kumara's power creates His exceptional vortex for such man. But only that one may leave this place in order to cooperate with Him, to share His activity for people's prosperity, in whom an absolute transformation has occurred, and you've just read about it yourself. If you had kept an absolute self-control in this moment, then you would have seen clearly the way out of your situation immediately."

The Master didn't add a single word anymore. He went to the wall, touched it with both of his hands – and both towers, both of the elements and of rays ones, closed for my look, as though they went out, as though they had never been burning.

Suddenly I became blind from the darkness when the light of the towers went out, but I didn't have time to analyse this phenomenon, because the sad view of my friend who was sitting on the shelf, between piled manuscripts, prompted me to help her as soon as possible.

Having looked round the room, I saw a ladder rested against the bookshelves by the opposite wall, exactly of the same height which I needed to reach Nataliya Vladimirovna. The ladder was huge, and it seemed to be too heavy even for my Goliathan strength. At the same time, I noticed that the shelf on which Nataliya Vladimirovna was sitting was so wide that she could walk by the edge of the shelf till its end and climb down the side carvings of the decoration like some steps.

But I knew from my experience that my dear friend's irritation only grew from my instructions uttered in such difficult moments for her self-control. Therefore, I decided to try to carry over the ladder to her bookshelf, although it seemed to be impossible to carry such a heavy load over the high tables.

"Don't be afraid of a burden," I remembered the words of my guardians which I heard many times, and I smiled to such still childish psychology of mine: to reflect where one needed to act. I went up to the strange ladder by calling my dear friend Venetian.

It turned out that the ladder above was attached to a thick, golden wire, and it was impossible to lift it. Having looked immediately, I noticed that the golden wire was stretched parallelly to all the bookshelves, while the ladder itself was standing on a rail bent inwards. I tried to push it towards that shelf on which Andreyeva was sitting, and it moved rather easily. It was the most difficult to push it through the open space of that part of the wall which was without any shelves. I couldn't imagine how such rather thin, golden wire could hold the weight of the ladder without resting on any shelves. Sweat was pouring over my eyes. Almost suffocating, deadly exhausted, anyway I could pull the ladder through the open place of the wall, and I pushed it to the shelf on which Andreyeva was sitting.

It was easier to work here, and in several seconds the latter was standing by her feet. She was looking at me with her gentle eyes full of tears and she uttered very silently.

"My friend, my dear baby, oh if you knew how you risked your life while you were walking along the part of the wall not filled with books! Forgive me. You gave simply priceless help to me once again, and once again I cut your name in my memory of ages with gratitude. But how am I going to climb on this ladder – it is absolutely vertical?"

"Well, this is very simple," I answered her, I got on the upper step in a flash and seized Nataliya Vladimirovna with my left hand, and in a moment both of us were already standing by the Master's feet.

He was looking at us smiling, in silence, and there wasn't any sign left from that strict voice with which he was explaining about self-control to Andreyeva.

"It is more difficult than death for a man who gets irritated easily to develop an absolute self-control," the Master was telling. "One could be born and die for many times, possessing all the data for high merging with the Divine Power, and always come back to the same obstacle – absence of an absolute self-control. You were dragging the ladder with such difficulty through Sanat Kamara's working place in this laboratory. Besides, your physical body is almost not capable of holding out the vibrations with which He has filled his working place, and your heart would have been broken without my help. I could help you and send my power to you, protecting your organism from too great Light, but I was absolutely helpless to help your feelings and thoughts with which you were going through His working place – along the altar, through the place that is sacred to me, in which His and my cooperation is taking place for the prosperity of the people of the Earth. A slightest thought by pitying yourself, a slightest hint to not at all disinterested your work, a slightest trembling of fear or honour in your heart – and you would have been burnt down, turned into ashes in the Fire of the elements, because it doesn't burn only the pure one till the end, as you've read in the records of Fire given to you."

The Master pulled both of us to himself and took us to that part of the wall which he called the God's working place, his altar.

"Go to the world and leave this place not simply rewarded with new strengths in your transformed organisms, take the eternal memory out of here about the activity of the entire Bright Brotherhood which opened here for you not as a fairytale, a legend, but as your everyday experience. Now when you are telling people that no other path to development exists as only the daily routine and everyday work, you will know yourselves clearly and firmly where this daily routine begins for everybody and who is cooperating with everybody in his everyday activity.

For you, my dear friend," the Master addressed Nataliya Vladimirovna, "the path of a very difficult work is assigned. You will leave this place, because my power, that is the care of the Great One given directly to you, brings you to the ranks of those messengers of His who can carry His mission on the Earth. But since you – in everyday trifles, by uniting with people cannot reach an absolute and unshakable calm yet, then your life also will be of two kinds. You will be serving the heaven loyally till the end, while for the people, on the earth, first you will always be searching for the place where to jump like a tiger and only then you will look round and see that the tiger strength of yours isn't equal to the gentle and weak dogs, cats and horses who surround you. Forgive all the people who were wounding you strongly up to now when you leave this place. Understand that they wounded you only because there wasn't any calm within yourself. And understand once again that this characteristic of yours to get irritated immediately disturbs everybody who must live directly next to you, according to the laws of karma. Any wound done to you, and an insult meant to you is only the echo of your own work among people. Remember this forever. Now it is

time for both of you and everybody who came here with you to come back and to work among people. Exactly a year has passed according to the earthly time since that time when you came here.”

Having heard these Master’s words, we both with Nataliya Vladimirovna got stiff and we must have looked very comically, because a smile flashed even in the Master’s face which was always serious. Without uttering anything else, the Master of the Masters pushed a small plate on one of his tables. A very melodious sound was heard, like a wonderfully ringing little bell, then a second one followed it, a third one – all these major sounds intertwined into a wonderful, musical phrase.

While still smiling from our numbness, the Master explained to us that this musical phrase of the bells was the signal for all the dwellers of the laboratory of the elements of the Masters of Power to go out to that little yard where the Masters met us for the first time.

The Master took his stick. Its form, weight, jewels and elegance of this exceptional item surprised me. That what the Master called his stick, one would have called more accurately as a sceptre. A diamond of such a size was placed on its upper part with a big, golden bulge, which refracted so bright sparkles and beams that every time when they would flash, we with Nataliya Vladimirovna had to cover our eyes.

Seven not much smaller, protuberant jewels surrounded this diamond, which corresponded to the colours of the towers of rays. The stick itself was made of gold, and also a golden snake wound it round, protuberant like some real stuffed animal. Some inscriptions and figures were written along the entire length of the stick, the meaning of which we didn’t comprehend.

“When you come here next time you will take away the knowledge about the remaining two elements which to master now you didn’t have enough strength, then you will find out what kind of the stick I hold in my hands, what its meaning for the activity for the people’s prosperity is,” the Master turned to me and uttered. “And now,” he said to both of us, “as the last precept of mine, carry out the eternal memory about that that the path of Eternity opens only to the man with an absolute self-control. Only with the loyalty till the end the man can reach that fearlessness which allows him to enter the cooperation with the Bright Brotherhood. Only after having mastered these two characteristics, you can see where the man’s daily routine begins and ends, and who shares it with the man. Be blessed! Be blessed for how you’ve managed to refine the Only One within yourselves that the Bright Brotherhood could take you here, for the act of the people’s destinies dedicated by Love from ages. Be blessed, because we could pass the part of that new knowledge to people through you, for which the time has come to reveal for the eyes thirsty for spirit. Be blessed as the first heralds of our liberation and forgiveness for us. Glory for the earth and heaven, glory for them as the Activity of Eternity, and glory for you who are in the ranks of these workers. Accept our gratitude; and let our eternal merging with you in this activity remain in calm, let it keep the diligence for the prosperity of everything that is alive. Let your activity pour in such a way as your Teacher sees and hears it; let your loyalty stream through his feet, as well as let our activity and loyalty be only the reflection of the Light of Eternity.”

The Master turned towards the exit, he stopped before the fiery doorframe, the fire of which now was burning in a small flame, without any smoke, and it didn’t frighten us anymore.

We went out to the yard. The rest of the Masters were already waiting for us by standing in the same order as during the first time, every one of them with the disciple standing before himself. Everybody greeted the Master of the Masters by bowing low to him. He answered them with the same bow, also both of us bowed after him. He instructed us to take our places, and he lifted his sceptre up high. A strong crackling was heard, and a five-pointed star began to sparkle on the big diamond of the sceptre.

The Master of the Masters stood in his place in the centre. He let the sceptre down by holding it in his right hand and leaning on it. He raised his left hand as if by giving a sign for all Masters. Every one of them – and we after them – fell on our knees, and the same Hymn of Life was heard again, which the Masters were chanting for the first time by the door of their laboratory.

I don't know for how long the Masters were chanting this time. I don't know what was going on in the yard. I was in the chapel of Joy of the Great Mother. I thanked Her respectfully for the whole compassion given to me. The divine figure gave a living little flower to me again and uttered.

"Now go to the chapel of Sadness and bring my little flower of Joy and comfort to it. The people's word of philosophy isn't important in everyday encounters. The word of calm and comfort is important, so the man could find the path to Me within himself. I am not a Destiny. I am not an inevitable karma. I am the light within man, his Joy. The path which leads to Me through the others' help doesn't exist. The path through one's own calm leads to Me."

When I came to myself, the Masters had disappeared, and I. was standing before me. He was extending his hands to me. I fell in his arms. Now I wasn't that boy anymore who was sad without him in Constantinople and who used to hang on his neck like a dog missing his master.

Now I embraced my friend-guardian as a ray and path of that Light which he revealed to me, as a part of the entire universe which I could get to know, embrace, glorify and bow low respectfully through him.

As soon as I pressed myself to him, also this time I was covered with the same power of joy, happiness and exceptional tranquillity which always used to cover me from his physical presence next to me. But this time I could feel stronger the influence of his spiritual power for me. That trembling of my entire body was already gone, which was the first reaction of my conductor to any I.'s touch before.

Now I could feel that my whole body strained itself: a strong current was flowing through my spine, my legs, my hands, my head, which my sensations fixed like a hum which you can feel by standing next to a powerful, working machine, to the work of an engine from which everything around is resonating with a rhythmical and strong vibration.

This vibration of my whole organism was the real ecstasy of happiness now. With my power I merged with the certain part of I.'s power and I could feel this merging as the happiness of the entire harmony with him.

I didn't need any I.'s words anymore. I comprehended in a flash that I. assented to my behaviour at the Masters'. I comprehended that also my spiritual power, merged so harmoniously with the power of my dear Teacher, had cleaned itself and grown, so I could flow into his wonderful vibrations. He accepted me again with even greater sincerity, for even greater closeness.

"My boy, you've already outgrown myself," I. said to me jokingly. "If you keep growing up like this, then you will really become Goliath soon. Probably, you must stop growing up, otherwise you will attract too much people's attention in the streets which you will have to walk," he was telling me with a smile, and I understood perfectly that my Teacher was telling these pleasant words to me by giving me some time to control the ecstasy of my happiness.

I concentrated with my whole heart on the Great Mother who was the first to greet me with the coming back to the world; I pressed her new, little flower to my heart and only now I noticed that the former one, tied to the black Venetian's diamond, was gone. Also, the black diamond itself was gone, a big

jewel, breaking the rainbow of rays, - an electric stone on the finest chain was shining instead of it, on my chest.

Apparently, the Master of the Masters took the black jewel off me and hung his present on my neck during our secret conversation when he explained to me how I had to act with the dark powers. I thanked him in my thoughts, I hid the little flower under my clothes, I glorified my new marching into life and activity, and I looked at my friends who returned together with me for their new serving to people.

A part of my friends had already greeted I. and they were standing next to him, shining with cheerfulness, power and beauty. A part of them were still waiting for their turn, while Bronski was standing before him, with his eyes full of ecstasy and bowing low to him.

I was looking at the artist surprised. What had happened to him? Of course, that was him, but at the same time - really not him. That was a youth, twenty-year-old Bronski, and not the man who got over forty years. That was a handsome man who looked like an angel who had come flying on to the earth from the shining tower of rays. What had happened to him?..

While I was thinking about it, I.'s words reached my ears.

"You were already prepared for the new birth a long time ago, but you needed to cover the entire path of the abyss of the human suffering and not to mumble a single time in such a way as you did it, my friend Stanislav, so that the hour of our new encounter could strike. Now the duality along the path of your earthly activity is never possible anywhere. You will see both heaven and the earth in every encountered person and his activity, you will be carrying for everyone within yourself both heaven and the earth through your greeting and encounter, as well as through your mutual activity."

Radiating youth Bronski stepped aside, and Andreyeva approached I., to whom he also extended both of his hands, he pressed her gently to himself and uttered.

"My friend, the indelible impression about the duality of your activity on the earth as not completely overcome result of your irritability, which the words of the Master of the Masters of power have left, made you so sad that even in this moment of your new life and activity for people some not poured tears are shining in your eyes. Don't forget, my dear, that every tear - that's the tear only for yourself. From this moment on, forget about yourself forever and leave your thoughts about your personality in this yard. No such cases among the elements of the Earth exist that one could say: "I've reached the perfection, now I can rest and stand in one place." We all, the servants of the Bright Brotherhood, are moving only forward, and nobody from us may expect to remain without any sin in our activity. But every servant of God must learn the accurate, active action with the constant, restrained Joy. From whatever countries the servant of the Bright Brotherhood would come back to work again among people, however high vibrations he would have mastered during the periods of his development, if he starts his activity among people sad again and again, the whole Radiance which he carries inside of him won't become the path of calm and help for people; although he is living only for them, he is working only for them, the goal of his life is only comfort for them."

I. let Andreyeva's hands go, he put her next to himself and he addressed us all who surrounded him in a close circle. Now I could hear absolutely new notes of unshakable will in his voice, as well as I could see the big resemblance to that powerful, divine Teacher's figure of the fifth ray in his entire figure which surprised me so much on the top of his tower.

"My friends! Every one of you comprehends clearly where he was, what he has learned, what he has carried out. You comprehend and feel your absolute transformation, you comprehend your new, enormous powers for the new earthly activity. Not I must teach you how and whom you should thank

for all the knowledge which Compassion has sent to you. But I, as the most senior among you, and therefore the mostly responsible before life for you and your activity, must shelter you and help you to walk the first steps of your new life. Leave your thoughts about everything what seemed to be important to you before in this yard: your conditions of life and your relations with people. If you were doing something among people what you charged to do and what you considered to be sacred and great, then you were always thinking: "How is it beneficial and enlightens people's spirit?" In the meanwhile, now by working with your eyes opened, that is by knowing that the man's daily routine is his movement by existing in Eternity, by cooperating with Eternity, go by fulfilling your tasks easily and don't wait for the fruits of your activity instantly. You are the new ploughmen; the fruits will mature. Take care not of the fruits of your activity, but so that the desire of some rewards or praise for your work wouldn't flash within you at least a single time. Don't expect that you will be met sincerely, that they will appreciate and acknowledge you. Go with the Light of Eternity, so that you wouldn't separate from Her in your earthly activity at least for a moment. They will humiliate and hurt you; they will make fun of you and slander you many times; but go deaf and blind for these circumstances. No response was left for them in your hearts. Only Joy-Action is living in your hearts, He meets and sees off everyone. How does the Joy-Action of your hearts meet everyone? Everybody equally according to their love and everybody differently according to the wisdom of their actions. Love that has given knowledge to you, so that the people would move forward, also has given the perception to you on how to apply the whole strength of your organism, so that you could protect the man from the possibility to deny and get irritated during each of your encounters. As soon as your foot crosses the threshold of this yard, your first duty will be – the complete perception on how to show your entire kindness and tact during your meeting with one man or a thousand people. Let's honour the great workers of power, let's thank them and let's get back to the ordinary life. I don't need to remind you about your silence, because everybody has received the special instructions regarding this question."

I. bowed low to the closed door of the laboratory, and he touched the ground with his hand. I went down on my knees; I touched the sacred ground to me with my forehead and kissed it. When I stood up and looked at sixth and ground floors of the sacred tower for the last time, I saw the figures of two Masters there who were blessing me with the wide cross. The Master-Teacher was holding a slim, little stick in his hands, and a small, five-pointed star was shining on its end. The Master of the Masters was holding the sceptre in his hands, and a triangle was burning on it, and inside of it a big, golden, five-pointed star was trembling.

That was the last of my visions.

I. marched forward, we followed him, we crossed the gallery that was buried in flowers, as if only yesterday we had crossed it, we went to the mother Anna's community and... neither the little gates nor a small crack was left on the Masters' wall.

This "yesterday" flashed like a dream inside of me, which has only left a great, effective "today" of Love in my heart and in my consciousness.

One life was over, we were following I. to start another one by knowing from our experience that only one Eternal Life existed.

Chapter 30

Coming back to life. Once again mother Anna's oasis and our first meeting with her. The new avenues and the monuments of our love and gratitude in them. We start building the chapel of the "ringing joy"

I was walking in front together with I. who gave his hand to me, and I couldn't see all my friends with whom I had spent a year in the Masters' laboratory, as the Master of the Masters told us with Andreyeva.

Yes, I couldn't see them, but I comprehended with my entire consciousness that their inner state was the same as mine. As though we were born newly for life: as though these years of our learning at the Masters' continued for a hundred years, and in this moment, we stepped into the new life, separated by the entire century of our learning from the "yesterday" passed rather recently in mother Anna's oasis. I cannot say that joy wasn't ringing in my heart. No, of course, it was ringing, it was even buzzing with the whole strength, also there wasn't any sense of bitterness anywhere, in a single bend of my thoughts that I had to leave the place saturated with the vibrations of the Divine Power.

It was difficult to accommodate myself even to this bright, pure life of the oasis, full of work and joy. Everyone of us, saturated with the highest emanations, coming into us from the Masters themselves and through them, was unable to react flexibly to the emanations, radiating from the people of the oasis. And everybody understood how sickly sensitive our nerves had become and how everyone of us needed to harden our physical and spiritual conductors, so that we had enough strength to pass everything to the people what we had received and that we wouldn't remain only the protectors of those great truths which were given to us for the people's development and happiness.

It seemed to me that I. comprehended our state better than ourselves. While holding my one hand, he gave the end of the golden band which girded his chiton to my other hand by telling Bronski who followed us to tie himself to him with his band and to give its end to Igor who followed him. He tied his band and gave its end to Oldenkot and so on. Nataliya Vladimirovna was walking the last now, she had lost her band somewhere, and Gregor who followed Vasilyon extended the end of his band to her.

When I took the part of I.'s band into my hands and gave it to Bronski, I felt that the band was buzzing like a wire of the telegraph. I. created a protective net for us, and I saw a tremendous number

of invisible assistants who were protecting our very sensitive physical conductors with a thick wall, our conductors were still not fully hardened for the new life and new activity on the Earth.

I. was purposefully walking down the roundabout, distant paths which didn't exist here at all a year ago, as it seemed to me, so that our painful sensitiveness would abate at least a little. By choosing a longer route, he gave us the time to control ourselves in our own way and to force our organism to obey.

Now, by following I. I understood that all these paths which we were walking along was the newly cultivated area of the desert. The verdure was luxuriant, but one could name these little trees the bushes of willows in comparison with the powerful trees of mother Anna's old oasis.

When we came closer to the new wall, we saw wide, arched gates in it. Having gone through them, we got into a charming, little island, surrounded by the ditch with water. An absolutely white, clean house, made of palm-tree and woven nicely with blooming flowers, was shining on it. We could see a lot of flower gardens everywhere. We got into the sea of flowers, and I, fallen out of the habit of the earth's beauty during this time, was not only glad: I wanted to lie down into these flowers, to embrace them and to thank everybody who were working by cultivating the dead sand of the desert in order to meet us with such bright, living expression of love and beauty.

I. took us to the little house in silence, on the threshold of which Yassa was standing, the first man who greeted us in the oasis.

We didn't need to utter any words to express the joy of our meeting with Yassa, also he didn't need to say anything about our happiness to see him. But our joint surprise rang out with the loud "oh" when we saw Yassa's face closer.

Not only Yassa was radiating with joy and calm which were the constant features of his behaviour. He was radiating with freshness, youth and beauty which wasn't characteristic to him before. I was especially surprised and glad, because that Yassa's image was left in my memory when I was crying next to him bitterly by considering my friend to be dead. This new Yassa could compete boldly with Bronski in his youth and freshness...

I. took us into the house, he showed the rooms to everybody and told us that Yassa would help us to wash, dress ourselves and to get ready in two hours when he would come back to take us to mother Anna's together with him.

Dear Yassa helped us, men, in the same diligent way with his underwater massage, which everyone of us felt much stronger. Only Nataliya Vladimirovna had to manage herself, but this time she didn't get irritated at least a little, as if it was never characteristic to her.

Having eaten bread with milk for the breakfast, which after the Masters' food seemed to be too heavy and satiated for us, we hurried to break up to our rooms. Every one of us wanted to begin his new movement into activity and his new uniting with people with absolute self-control and concentration.

When I was left alone, I pressed the jewel of the Master of the Masters and the little flower of the Great Mother to my chest. I was begging Her to help me in that great work which She was blessing in the first moment when I came back to the everyday life, as soon as I left the laboratory of the Masters. I repeated her words, the first words of Life which congratulated my return to the everyday activity of the Earth: "Now go to the chapel of Sadness and take my little flower of Joy and comfort to It. The word of the people's philosophy isn't important in everyday encounters. The word of tranquillity and comfort is important, so that the man could find the path to Me within himself. I am not a Destiny. I am not an

inevitable karma. I am the light within man, his Joy. The path that is leading to Me through other's help doesn't exit. The path through one's own tranquillity is leading to Me."

This congratulation of the Great Mother as though engraved itself in my consciousness. It cut in my heart with the law of Life. I understood, I felt it as a creative action of my heart in the future range of my days. I accepted and blessed the Divine law to act in the alive gallery of the human encounters which started again.

Everything what the Masters had taught me, my whole new strength and knowledge – everything was offering this conclusion, this sacred precept, fitting in a couple of words – "Overcome by loving", - which I whispered honourably by putting the little flower and the jewel to my lips, and I heard instantly I.'s call who came back.

When we all gathered in the hall, I. addressed us with encouraging words, and he added by finishing his pleasant speech.

"We won't stay here for a long, in mother Anna's oasis. This place of the universe is especially watched over by the High Powers, everybody without exception who is living here is walking up the levels of Compassion, that is the high members of the Bright Brotherhood are observing them directly, who pass the Light of Eternity and Her direct help to all the dwellers of the oasis. Neither a task nor a work here is assigned to anybody of you. But every one of you will receive a task in Radanda's Community. Let's hurry to it, and let the Great Mother help you to fulfil your tasks. Even here, in this little island of purity, in this chosen place, it will be difficult for you to live and to breathe during the first hours, after leaving the great world of the Masters of power and the place of communication of the Bright Powers with the representatives of the Earth. During your remaining short time here search for the ways within yourselves to become hardened and to acquire self-control, because the absolute self-control has already become the basis of your organisms. Don't think that after reaching your absolute self-control once and for all you may calm down at least a little. No absolute self-control will protect the man from the possibility to be shaken by one or another event, if the man's spirit separates at least for a moment from that One Whom he is carrying alive and powerful in his heart. Exactly that has happened with you now. Every one of you was thinking about that happiness which he has left and not about that much greater happiness to which he was going. An infinite courage and joy is necessary for the messengers of Eternity in order to fulfil His tasks on the Earth. And this power of courage and joy, independent of the size and significance of his task, is necessary for every messenger. Because also the exceptional, new power opens in every man to whom the task is given. Only in that case the man can live, act and create with it if he has forgotten about himself, about the possibility to be sad when he leaves one or another place; he knows only one thing: to carry the Light with firm joy and to pour It into his received task in that place, time and form which is indicated to him. If you had been full namely of such loyalty till the end – the people's vibrations of this surrounding wouldn't have been difficult for any of you. You wouldn't have even felt them if you had been creating the protective net together with the invisible assistants who take care of you and not destroying it with thoughts of your personal nature. From this lesson remember how much you still will need to achieve, so that you could undertake the tasks given to you by Eternity. While you still didn't know the name of the Great Creator of the Earth – the orbit of your actions allowed you, so to say, "to rest" from the Light of heaven. And now no possibility was left anymore to live in that state which people call "rest". Your rest is only where your cooperation with the whole Bright Brotherhood is taking place, with Her Master – Sanat Kumara. Cut this Light of the Great One in your heart, call this name by starting and finishing your working day; because from now on you know that only with Him your every working day begins and ends, because only with Him your power remains, grows and develops. Remember that Compassion hasn't charged anyone of you with a work in the oasis. The Merciful was taking care of you; thinking about your state, about tranquillity, physical and spiritual aspect of your creation and gave the instruction in such a way to

you that you should have a possibility to keep all your new strengths in balance and to act successfully. Carry out the eternal memory about his Compassion; always, when meeting people, when helping them or giving some wealth and knowledge to them, be able to prepare their souls in such a way that they would be able to comprehend the thing given to them. The first worry about the man if he is entrusted to you, - to be able to get into his situation and not to cross the limits of his possibilities. Remember very well not as a theory, but as a practice of your everyday activity: "May happen doesn't mean that it will happen." Every time when first you thought about yourself, that is you said to yourself: "How it is difficult to pass these conceptions to people," - you've already opened a crack in the protective net and decreased the success of the work entrusted to you in half. By starting your day, as well as every activity, remember only one radiating Name who has sent you to the Masters of power and who is sending you to the crowd of people. Walk across the desert like a valuable caravan and carry the cup of God, full of His Light, in your hearts. To pour a drop of Fire without preparing a bonfire which She could set fire to, - that is like the evangelic truth: to throw pearls without any use and meaning. During these several days evaluate the encounter which Compassion has prepared for you. Nobody was living in this house which you entered; nobody was walking on this island, except Yassa. Evaluate and understand this care for you not like for one or another personality; but every time when you meet people yourselves, who have one or another assignment from the Bright powers, give your entire attention to them, try to take care of their external destiny in such a way that they could fulfil the task given to them in the most useful and meaningful way. For you, the messengers of heaven, no division of the time and space exists. Only that life exists for you, in which the eternity is being forged, independent of the time and space. You won't be dividing the man's life into the outer and inner one anymore. For you only the man-path exists. And you will be protecting every path, because you are bridges through which Sanat Kumara's love, help and knowledge is flowing to people."

I. told us to break up to our rooms, to reconsider what he had told us and to go downstairs again in an hour, where he will be waiting for us and he will take us to the little mother Anna's house, and from there - to the dining-room.

Having come back to my clean, pure, but very modest room, once again I pressed the little flower of the Great Mother and the electric jewel of the Master of the Masters to my chest. It seemed to me that I wasn't agitated at all when I left the domain of the Masters and crossed the threshold of their high wall which took us to the oasis, I was only feeling the butting of all my nerves, as if they had opened bare and ached from the vibrations which I had already fallen out of.

Now I understood how completely in person I comprehended my new appearance in life, how weak my heart was which was unable to open wider immediately, to embrace at least the oasis and to pour the new love, the new power which I received during my studies into it.

Once again I understood much clearer and better who was I. This Godman didn't interrupt his bond with the Only One Master, whose name illuminated all his work, all his encounters and his entire activity like the sun, at least for a moment even when he was communicating with animals. He used to lift everybody and everything up, because he didn't possess the thought "to lift up". He was acting like the light, because only the light was inside of him, and not his "I", in whatever form that "I" would be hiding within man.

I understood not the method "how to master myself", how to apply one or another knowledge and power, I understood that only then man really forgot about himself when his spirit merged with that man to whom he was talking, or with the work which he was doing. I understood the continuity of the merging with the Highest - which only then was possible when His power tied together you and everybody else.

When I.'s voice was heard again, calling us to go downstairs, I had already regained my balance and I was feeling myself to be only the joyous, working bridge through which the Light of Eternity was flowing from I. to me in this moment, who was working together with me in this moment.

When we gathered in the hall, I. looked us all over, he smiled to us gently, called Nataliya Vladimirovna, said something silently to her, gave a new band instead of the lost one and he said to me.

"Go together with me to mother Anna's. The rest will go with Yassa, and they also will visit several patients who are waiting for them impatiently."

I was surprised that there were some people in the oasis who were waiting for my friends, but I already knew the whole variety of the human paths and I didn't doubt that my friends still had to do some duties before meeting mother Anna.

Mother Anna met us as always the same, smiling, as we left her a year ago, only it seemed to me that now her face, her eyes, her veil were shining even more, as though a piece of the rainbow would always fly from her head. I understood that I learned to read her thoughts which I couldn't even see before.

"Lyovushka," she said to me by squeezing my hand gently and kissing my head when I bowed to her hand. "The human heart wasn't sounding with joy so strongly next to me for a long time, to be precise, she wasn't buzzing, as I hear it now. Of course, I am not talking about Teacher," she added by nodding to I.'s side, "because Teacher's heart isn't human anymore, but God-human. I know everything what you have done and acquired during that time," she continued and added after being silent for a while. "Teacher I. promised me to bring you alone with himself as soon as you would come back to the oasis. The Masters of Power told me that I could select seven people from my tribe who suffer for their own people who have slipped on their spiritual path; and that I myself could be one from those seven ones. We are allowed to address every one of you with a request..."

"Oh, mother Anna, there's no need for so many words, I understood everything," I interrupted this wonderful woman in whose eyes the tears began to shine. "You want me to meet Anna and help her to reach the dedicated path: to replace you here. I will be happy to fulfil your wish, because I know that Teacher I. will bless it. He will help me to be worthy of your request. I will give that entire Power of help for which I will mature myself to Anna as much as I will be able to do it."

"You've guessed my request, Lyovushka," mother Anna answered me. "But I must tell you what you still don't know. Having left the Masters of power, every one of you now possesses the power and right to take care of an unfortunate person whose spirit in the main is pure, but he has made himself dirty with his bond with the dark powers, and you can give help and guardianship of the Master of power who was teaching you to him through yourselves. The power of your joy may help very much in Anna's case, because the Master turned the black Bracano's jewel which you were carrying on your chest into the jewel of Life on that altar which he called the God's working place, and it was called the electric jewel. Now you know who has given His Fire to your jewel. Do you want to direct the first power of the jewel to unfortunate Anna?"

"Oh! How can you still ask me about it?" I gave a shout when only now I understood that the jewel itself, its setting and chain were the same Bracano's items which I was wearing. "I repeat to you: your request is a big happiness for me. If Anna is allowed to come here, so that you could become free of the earth as soon as possible, then I believe that she will concentrate your entire power of spirit, her energy and efforts, and she will hurry to make happy not only you, but also her great friend Ananda."

Mother Anna kept silent for a long time, as if she had been drowned in the ecstasy of a prayer. I. came nearer to her, and I saw Ananda's and Anna's images above her head, who were throwing flowers for mother Anna.

"Thank you, my friend," finally she uttered silently. "I won't stay with a stain in my heart. Anna will be here."

As soon as mother Anna uttered these words, a knock at the door was heard, Yassa came in and asked whether our friends could come in.

All invited friends came to mother Anna's room. We all left our house only an hour ago, and I still remembered well how they looked like. And now it seemed to me that they were living in the oasis not for an hour, but for the entire year: they greeted mother Anna with such confidence, easily, simply and joyously. Somehow, they got used to the atmosphere of the oasis instantly, as if they had never left it.

"That's what it means to forget about yourself," I thought.

While greeting us all, mother Anna was telling that under Teacher I.'s supervision so many changes had happened in her oasis that we wouldn't recognize it. Having congratulated us with the beginning of our new life, mother Anna invited all of us to the dining-room and added that somebody was already waiting for us there impatiently.

On our way to the dining-room the oasis seemed to us like a blooming and smelling sweet paradise, and it was difficult to believe that we had left it, devastated by the storm of the sand a year ago. A strange feeling began to grow in my soul. Only several hours had passed from our life at the Masters of power, and it began to seem to me that everything there was only a blessed, joyous dream, while life – as well as activity and work of the earth – wasn't interrupted at all. In this moment of my return to life I was feeling in such a way as if there wasn't any break at all which lasted for a year, as if I left the oasis yesterday and came back today by spending one short night somewhere near here.

Only in my consciousness I could feel a big change. Now I could see what kind of love I. was carrying for every man; how man was the goal of his work and activity everywhere, always and in everything. I understood that during my future encounters also I couldn't act differently, as only love man, see the goal of Teacher's activity inside of him, find an entry to everyone's heart with love and ease his life with my harmony...

In the same way as I comprehended my return to the oasis like a separation with it for a moment, also the dwellers of the oasis understood our appearance like our new, repeated arrival. That stunned me. Of course, when we disappeared, they could think that we left in the night. But I. stayed with them... Why now when we entered the dining-room, the oasis met I. with such great ovation by thanking him for this new happiness – such an unexpectedly soon visit? Then what was he doing during that year?

I remembered the tower of the fifth ray in the space; I remembered the night of the storm in the lighthouse; I.'s image between the mountains of the sand in the desert, while the wind, lightning and thunder was ranging; and at the same time him stiff by the wheel in the lighthouse, - and for the first time I understood clearly that if Teacher wasn't omnipotent and present everywhere, so it was at least clear that people could see him in different places, almost at the same time, and there wasn't any miracle here, but only the result of his knowledge.

So, I. wasn't living in the oasis during that year, but he was "observing attentively" the course of the new life in it, as mother Anna told us. I. responded with a short, pleasant speech to the wild greeting of the people gathered in the dining-room, which he finished with these words.

"Thank you, my friends, that during this entire time you were fulfilling all my instructions diligently and precisely, which I gave to you through mother Anna and Yassa. Also accept my friends' gratitude, in whose names you called the new avenues created in the park during those years. Every one of them will leave for you something as a remembrance in his avenue. There are some famous artists and sculptors, scientists, writers and inventors among them. Today, after this dinner, all of you who have created the new avenues, gather by dividing yourselves into seven brigades. My friends will tell you their desires of where and what every one of them will want to leave for memory of his avenue, and with joint strengths we'll do that work. But we need to hurry, because this time we cannot stay with you for a long time."

The joint request muffled the noise which arose from joy for I.'s promise and from sadness due to our quick departure: to lift I.'s statue on the gates of the oasis, dedicated to remember the miraculous rescuing during the night of the storm.

Having called this desire of the dwellers of the oasis childish, I. answered them with the smile that he would try to leave his portrait as a memory for them, and not on the gates, but on the lighthouse, and he asked everybody to calm down, to sit down at the tables and to eat calmly, so that we could start inspecting the avenues as soon as possible and discuss the perpetuation of the remembrance.

Everybody was eating in a hurry. It was clear that everybody wanted to participate in the new work together with us, independent of whether he was taking part when the new part of the park was created or not.

When the dinner was almost over, mother Anna announced by seeing the general desire to go together with us that only those would go to the new avenues who were creating them, but that the supper would be an hour earlier, all the dwellers of the oasis would gather in the new hall, and then it would be announced about the results of our inspection. Everybody there would have the possibility to spend the evening in our company and to tell their desires and opinions. While Teacher I. and his fellow-travellers would see the new hall that was built without them during that time, but according to their plans and instructions.

"Tremble by waiting whether the high friends and guests will praise your work," mother Anna finished her speech, and her voice and smile when she uttered the last words were full of an exceptional kindness and love.

After the dinner every one of us was surrounded by a group of people from those who didn't go together with us to work. These pleasant dwellers of the oasis told us about the miracles of Yassa's kindness and energy: about the exceptional methods of his curative massage, about the new gymnastics which he taught a special group of people.

Unfortunately, the youths with working clothes were already gathering next to us. It was the time for us to go to the new avenues. I. told us that he had to do a lot of work in the old part of the park, so he didn't go with us.

It was difficult to believe that everything in the old and newly cultivated area of the desert had grown during this year! Now we couldn't see the factory at all, thick bushes surrounded it like a wall from all sides. When we approached that especial place where the entrance to the Masters was, - I knew that the entrance was here, because I could see their laboratory through the wall, I even saw the pleasant Master-Teacher who gave a smile to me on the sixth floor, - I was wonderstruck. A wall of trees surrounded this place, like a living boundary of the oasis protected by giants for ever...

A wide area with a flower bed was arranged before this thick wall. Everybody wanted mother Anna's statue to be built here, but there wasn't such a piece of marble. Gregor with Vasilyon suggested to cast it from the local glass by stating that now Vasilyon knew the secret of an indelible and unfading glass paint which was glaring in the sun nicer than mother-of-pearl.

We were walking along the new avenues for a long time by reflecting on what everyone of us could leave as the present of gratitude for the oasis which had become for us the centre of big enlightenments, the beginning of our new life and activity for the people's prosperity, the promised land to which some of us were destined to come back again in the future.

When we went out to the avenue which the dwellers of the oasis called "Lyovushka's paradise" jokingly, I comprehended immediately what present of my eternal gratitude I had to leave in it. A round ground was formed in the middle of the avenue, in which the sand of the desert was shining and in which the dwellers of the oasis wanted to arrange a big summerhouse. The whole avenue was planted with broad-leaved palms which still reached only the man's height and look dwarfish in comparison to the trees of other avenues. But the palm leaves were so broad already that the avenue became shady. Some cedars surrounded a part of the ground in a semicircle, and they also reached only the man's height. Having seen my concentration, everybody took it for a disappointment, because the trees of my avenue were still so short. They began to explain to me that this avenue was planted the last, and therefore, the trees had grown only that much, but they would outgrow all adjacent avenues in a year or two.

"I'm not disappointed at all that my avenue is so shortish," I answered them. "I fell to thinking what must be built on this wonderful, little ground. I would like that not a summerhouse of "Lyovushka's paradise" was standing on it, but a chapel that would give the purity of paradise and power to everybody who will come to it. But I don't know whether I have the right to create here a copy of the sacred, divinely charming chapel which I saw in one wonderful Community. I will answer you only in the evening when I talk to Teacher I."

Since my avenue was the last one from all the visited ones, and only I didn't solve my question, while everybody else knew what they wanted to create in their avenues, so we spent a lot of time by discussing, and now everybody hurried home, so that they would be in time to get ready for the earlier announced supper. Everybody dispersed, Gregor with Vasilyon still stopped next to me, and Gregor whispered to me.

"We understood your thought. Oh, if Teacher approved your idea! Everything is as though especially created here, so that the copy would appear!.."

When I was left alone, I sat down on the sand, and I leant my back against the central cedar. The Great Mother gave me the task to bring Her Joy and Comfort to the chapel of Sadness in Radanda's Community. Will She allow me to leave the copy of Her chapel of Ringing Joy that is standing for centuries in the place, which is under the wardship of Great Powers, so that Her image would help to develop this small and exceptional tribe that hasn't experienced any bitter human passions and traps of self-love, that doesn't pour tears and meets everybody with a smile?

I was prepared to put my greatest treasure under the cornerstone: Her little flower and Venetian's jewel which the Master of the Masters cleared from evil and Bracano's hatred on his altar which he called the God's Working Place. Having covered my face with my hands, I was moving away from the earth; with my whole consciousness I was flying to the chapel of Joy by trying to find the first instruction there... Suddenly, I heard a voice.

"My place is everywhere where the pure man's love is calling for Me. But the power of My help depends only on the loyalty of those who come to Me. Put not only the treasure which you are carrying on your chest under the cornerstone, but also the items given to you in Dartran's oasis – the ones of the whole and passionless people's love. Wait for I.'s instructions. He will give the jewel of Light dedicated to the foundation of My chapel to you, which the Divine Powers will give to the Master of the Masters."

The voice lapsed into silence. It already became dark in the oasis. I didn't know where I should go, to which direction to turn, but suddenly I heard quick I.'s steps. My great and wise guardian hurried to help me, as he was doing it in every case of my difficulties.

"My friend, didn't you see instantly that I prepared everything here, so that another chapel of Joy could appear in the desert?" he uttered when he came up to me. "It is your great happiness that you had enough strength to carry the cleaned jewel out of the laboratory of the Master of the Masters, which was loaded with the magnetic current of the Great God, and the new, living flower of the Great Mother sent to you. Don't worry about the technical side of the construction."

I. took my arm. I was happy, my sense of time and space was lost. And we walked away down the dark avenue, under the sky spangled with bright stars.

"Oh, how charming Life is!" I repeated several times silently by walking next to I.

And again, I comprehended newly my high friend's presence next to me! Now I didn't feel any trouble with my vibrations: I didn't even notice any peculiarities of I.'s gait and the rhythm of his breathing, to which it wasn't easy to adapt myself before. Now I grew together, united my consciousness with I. easily and simply, and it was clear to me: I could feel the Only One inside of him with the entire Light of my soul. And if I still couldn't see the whole I.'s light, then I was living with all the powers of Beauty of my own Only One in His Light. I didn't feel I.'s personality, because in this time I couldn't feel even a hint to something personal within myself. For the first time I could really feel what the absolute liberation was and what an infinite happiness was to live with this feeling in the daily routine of the Earth!..

When we entered the lit up hall of the dining-room and as though drowned in the sea of heads and eyes who were waiting greedily for I., for the first time during this short time of my newly started life not so long ago, the emanations of the people crowd didn't stun, oppress and even disturb me. Earlier I could always feel how I. was protecting me from injuring people's thoughts and the streams of their desires. Now I felt not that only I needed any protection, but that I was carrying power for people within myself. And I comprehended clearly that I was carrying it, because I had become absolutely free from everything personal. Once again I moved to the altar of the Master of the Masters and, having whispered the great Sanat Kumara's name, I uttered in silent voice unwittingly: "Oh, how charming Life is!"

"Only today you understood what it meant the blissful happiness to live your day bravely and wisely, in the unity with the workers of heaven and the earth, in inextinguishable Love of the Great Mother," I. answered me, and he addressed immediately the dwellers of the oasis who were waiting for us and who stood up in order to greet us. "Excuse me, my dear and respectable friends, for those several minutes of being late, which we had to delay. Believe me that their cause was a very important thing for you which will bring a lot of joy for all of you with Lyovushka's help. We needed to solve the question about the monument – the miracle of beauty which will be left for you in the avenue of "Lyovushka's paradise", as you named it jokingly. Having named the avenue like this, you didn't even think that you've hit the target

very accurately, because indeed, a chapel will be built in it, in which not a single living being can feel anything else except joy: such a heavenly beautiful statue will be built there.”

I. invited everybody to take their seats. Having waited until mother Anna gave the permission, everybody started eating, but their eyes were burning with impatience that the supper would end faster and our information about the work of finishing the avenues would begin.

Indeed, the supper ended quickly, and the hall turned into an auditorium. I saw this new hall for the first time. It looked like the old one and reminded me of the inner premises of a big fortress. I understood that the builders had foreseen beforehand about the possible fight against the sand storms of the deserts. My heart began to throb unawares, I thought about the future chapel in my avenue, but I remembered the words of the Master of the Masters instantly: “Loyal and fearless till the end – Your call is till the end. Only with an absolute loyalty it is possible to reach that fearlessness with which man can enter the cooperation with the Bright Brotherhood.”

I calmed down completely in a flash; I smiled to my flashed anxiety for childishness of Holiness, and I began to listen to Gregor’s speech. Gregor was talking not only on behalf of us all. He depicted a plan of the new avenues in black ink on a big glass board and he added on it those buildings which would decorate them.

I always knew that Gregor was an artist of genius, but now I was looking at his work with an exceptional respect. On the ground in which the rays of six avenues intersected he depicted mother Anna’s figure who was standing with a stick in one of her hands and a snake with the tail in her mouth in her other hand. The hand with the snake was raised high, and as though it was directed to the side of the entrance of the little yard of the Masters of power.

In several minutes the figure depicted in everybody’s presence manifested itself like alive in the white background of the board. Her resemblance, expression and manners were conveyed so alive that the spectators became quiet, numb and only after a long period of silence the applause and joyous cries of approval for the artist burst out.

There were no discussions about this statue of mother Anna. The dwellers of the oasis asked only one question: why there was a snake in their patron’s hand?

Gregor explained to them that the snake with the tail in her mouth symbolized the Eternal Knowledge which only that one could achieve who would open the Eternity within himself and perceive it.

Here I. stood up and uttered that during the entire remaining time in the oasis he would organize discussions every evening after the supper, during which they would comprehend this symbol of Eternity better and find out a lot of new things about the spiritual world.

Gregor was still drawing in detail, for a very long time Bronski’s theatre, Oldenkot’s library-reading-room, Igor’s professional school and observatory, Nataliya Vladimirovna’s chemical laboratory, the wonderful, very beautiful Gregor’s complex of baths, Vasilyon’s greenhouse and the buildings of the agronomical courses.

“And my own statue which you requested I will do myself, entrust this business to me,” I. answered them with a smile. “I will try not to yield to Gregor’s line accuracy and figure’s vitality. We won’t be discussing about Lyovushka’s chapel now – there’s no time, it is after midnight already. But when you start building it under our leadership and supervision, you will see yourselves that this Holiness may not be discussed as a work of art. She is your great happiness.”

Soon we said good-bye to mother Anna and everybody present, and we went to our house. The conversations about the future constructions of the avenues and about the transformation of the oasis into the real “city” of culture, as the dwellers of the oasis who had never seen any cities imagined it, were going on still for a long time during that night in different corners of the oasis.

Not for the first time I was walking next to I. like this, in the darkness of the desert night, shining with the stars. And every time, everything – the night, the stars, the sounds of the desert inaudible in the daytime – I used to perceive differently. Today I was walking with my eyesight opened wide and I could see clearly the whole view of the Working Life.

The shining towers of rays didn’t prevent me from seeing the miracles of the activity of the towers of the elements. The flying lots of invisible assistants excited my heart and my feelings, and I could comprehend clearer than before that the activity of the Eternal Movement couldn’t stop even for a moment.

All my friends were walking in silence, in the same way as I did, and our general respect was leading us through this first night of our new, sacred life on the Earth. We went up to our house, and I. stopped us by its threshold.

“A great turning point has happened in every one of you. And in this night no one of you possesses the comprehension of neither your personal desires, nor your personal work, with which you are destined to comfort, alleviate and decorate the lives of your encountered people. But not that is the essence of your choice. You’ve experienced clearly while staying at the Masters what the Earth was, who was leading the whole activity on the Earth and in what height that one should be who is striving, searching for and who receives the honour and happiness to cooperate with the Great Master of the Earth. Once you’ve seen His activity, you cannot look at the Earth anymore as an ordinary place of only your birth and activity. You know, and therefore, the Earth for you stopped existing as the place of your fortune or unfortune, of your duty and obligations. The Earth has become the saint place for you, because you know that the living place-altar and temple of His work for all bright people is standing in it. Now you can live on the Earth only like in a temple where every moment of your activity is pouring as a glorification of this sacred place – the Earth. All your former perceptions about the good and evil, about punishments and rewards, about the future and the past, about the choice of an exceptional situation and place of activity – everything has turned into ashes. You’ve seen clearly that the entire Earth and everything on it is only the work of God. And from now on you are summoned to share this work by comprehending and knowing how one can reach the altar of the temple of the Earth that is saint for you now. In this night, while entering the new orbit of movement of your entire strength, every one of you keep in your memory the beginning of your path, of your searching. Remember that you weren’t always strong. Not always love used to overcome inside of you without any irritation and bitterness. And it will be easier for you to cover with your love, compassion and tranquillity that spiritual abyss which stretches – not visible to anybody, except yourselves and those who are higher than you – between you and those people, to whom you will be carrying your knowledge. And however long you would be living on the Earth – you will always and everywhere feel this abyss between yourselves and the masses. You will be calling to beauty and calm. And you will always feel that you are calling for a herd of buffalos who are roaring menacingly and protecting their personal happiness, prey and profit. Your power is the knowledge that the Earth – that’s your sacred place. This power will protect you from all vicious sorties. It will protect you from all the trials to trample down that knowledge into mud, which you are destined to carry for people. The abyss between you and people won’t broaden, but will narrow only when you are working in the temple of Sanat Kumara – the sacred earth. Be blessed by coming back to the Earth. All of you came back sound and alive, hardened soldiers of the Only One. Don’t think that there weren’t any trials before to bring people to the knowledge which you received now. They were. But the people who were pleading for knowledge, who had sworn loyalty, couldn’t pass

the first, easiest tests, not being able to stay pure till the end and forget about themselves. They were straining to use their scanty, new knowledge for their personal goals – and they had to start the entire circle of rising almost from the beginning, from the animals' world. These cases were still the best, because some really terrible situations used to happen when they used to get into the hands of the dark powers from where nobody could save them till the end of the planet's existence. Comprehend that degree of your preparation with which you are standing here now. Don't forget about the covered path of your victories in which you always used to win by loving, be indulgent to the people who are searching and who want, but who cannot achieve the harmony of their thoughts and heart. The abyss between you and them will become the greatest what you know on the Earth for you, - the God's working place. It is living in every one of you if you are pure till the end."

I. finished his speech like this. He embraced tenderly and blessed every one of us. I could see in the light of the breaking day how respectfully excited the faces of my friends who came back to the daily routine of life were.

It was dawning more and more, and when I came to my room, the sun had already reached the middle of her way into the horizon of the desert. The first day of the daily routine began. I couldn't even think about sleep, but I also didn't feel such a need. I concentrated my thoughts on the altar of the Great Mother of the Earth and I asked all the compassionate brothers who helped me not to leave me without their friendly guardianship, so that I could bring in the modest part of my work and that the abyss between me and the people who surrounded me would narrow at least for one little grain of sand, that the altar of the Great God would fortify stronger in people's consciousnesses.

I was begging the Great Mother to send the strengths of purity and joy to build Her wonderful chapel which would protect the oasis during the entire row of its future days.

There came a silent knock at my door, and I saw dear Yassa who as always was thinking about everything and everybody. He told me that the breakfast, that is milk and white bread, were already waiting for me, and he offered me to go to the shower. I accepted his proposal, I heard that the water was running in the adjacent booth and I understood that my friends were also getting ready for the first working day.

When we entered, Nataliya Vladimirovna, Oldenkot and Gregor were already sitting in the small dining-room.

They were discussing passionately about the project of the library-reading-room where dear Oldenkot wanted to arrange a lot of rooms, so that people could live in them, and those who separated from the common life of the oasis could devote themselves only to the scientific work.

I didn't want to eat at all. The milk and the bread seemed to be very heavy dishes for me, and I was prepared to refuse even the wonderful fruits which were placed next to me for a little bit of the Master's food.

"Lyovushka, you must eat," I heard I.'s voice behind my back. "You all, my friends, must get used to the daily food, even if it seemed to you absolutely unattractive. While you were living torn away from the earth and you were living in the vibrations that surpassed your individual possibilities, your food had to be minimal and light. Now your work will be done in the vibrations that are lower than your individual ones from one side, and from the other side – under the burning rays of the desert sun. Therefore, some rough materials must be in your organism, which would help to temper and harden your organism externally against the streams of your encountered people and the desert atmosphere. While we are living in the oasis, every one of you must develop not only the habit absolutely not to tremble your

nerves while communicating with people, but also the ability to instantly create the protective circle for yourselves and your encountered person and to communicate with the man only in it. Here you are surrounded by pure vibrations, because not a single foot of the dark being has ever touched this protected land and may not enter it. Either only pure and bright beings can live here, or the ones who have cleaned themselves from all sorts of darkness and become bright beings. And anyway, even these wonderful emanations were difficult for you during the first hours of your coming back to the Earth. You must be already prepared for that in Radanda's Community – in the active place of fight against evil – that you wouldn't think about yourselves regarding that question, but only about the business of That Who has sent you to people... Eat everything that is placed before you. Change into the working clothes, and we'll all go to the new avenues. We'll break up into working groups there and start the construction of the new buildings according to the methods and means created by Gregor, Vasilyon and Igor. I show the example for you myself," I. finished with a smile by pulling the cup with milk and bread with honey to himself.

Although I wanted to swallow the milk and the bread as soon as possible by wishing to go to my avenue as soon as possible and to start my first – and so divine – work on the Earth, anyway I wasn't spending the time only for eating and I was observing the faces of my friends attentively.

These faces surprised me. I felt myself very easily and simply. And my new existence was growing always lighter. I was simply shining with happiness to start building the chapel of Joy here and I comprehended that this inner radiance was brightly reflected on my face.

Gregor's face attracted my attention first. He was concentrated, almost worried. And I understood that now his spirit was solving some other creative task for which he was preparing within himself, and externally, he looked like being busy with the matters of the oasis.

Nataliya Vladimirovna who was recently discussing about the project of her laboratory somehow became quiet from the very first I.'s words, as though she was assembling powers for creating the protective circle around herself and every encountered person by wishing to leave this dining-room already with it.

Oldenkot's face as always had the same noble, childishly nice expression of kindness and tranquillity. He didn't have to think about how he had to pour his calm and light for somebody. He was calm and light himself, he was shining and giving out warmth without thinking about it, because he already was unable to live otherwise.

Igor was all burning with such power of the inner fire that he could hardly bring himself to swallow several sips of milk. He would have jumped up from the table and run to his avenue if not for his so exceptional discipline and respect for I.

Bronski, renewed, young, handsome Bronski, also wasn't in the oasis in his thoughts. I could see clearly the moving images of his rich fantasy above his head, in which the whole scenes of his new productions were already living, and I even recognized separate figures of the dwellers of Dartran's oasis in them.

I could see a lot of new questions for the newly born life in everybody's faces, and everybody's spirit was trembling and concentrating in her own way by waiting for the first happy moment to start the given work and meeting with new people. There was only one worry in everybody's heart: to be worthy of the given task.

Only Vasilyon's looks almost didn't change, unless he looked as strong as a matured oak-tree. That wonderful expression of rejoicing and happiness remained in his face which I saw during our first encounter when Radanda accompanied me to the brothers house. Exactly the same expression of his

triumphing love I saw back then when he was holding the wonderful, little flower in his hands. That wasn't the same Vasilyon singer who had forgotten about the Earth and who was chanting for God, torn away from it. No, that was the face of an admiring gardener who knew which flowers he could grow for happiness of the people of the Earth and into what roses the people's hearts could turn if the gardener was living on the Earth – the temple of the God's work.

Yes, this man was already living and acting on the Earth-Temple. He didn't have any questions anymore how to start – he knew, he started, not only he was absolutely calm, he was already cooperating with That Who sent him.

I. looked all of us so different up and down with his eyes comprehending everything, he smiled, as though by wishing to say that it couldn't be otherwise as only differently for everyone, and he offered everybody to go to change in the working clothes, of course, prepared by Yassa.

"Yassa, dear Yassa, is it possible to live in the world without you?" I uttered to my friend-nurse who took this place next to me voluntarily again.

"Look, Lyovushka, you'll talk to your heart's content, if you thank me so much for every trifle, you will receive me as your eternal company," he answered me merrily.

"Oh, to have you forever next to myself?!" That would be an absolutely undeserved happiness for me!" I answered him, and after a while we were the first ones in the hall due to his efforts, to which all our friends were gathering quickly, every one of them still put in order a little by Yassa.

Soon I. joined us, and we all went to the new avenues. This time the way was much shorter, because I. was leading us through the central part of the oasis. The groups of the dwellers of the oasis, which were already waiting for us, joined us on our way, and I. divided them by distributing more or less people for every one of us. Until we came, not a little brigade of workers formed around me, as well as around the others. All of us poured to our avenues after receiving the first, precise tasks from I. and Gregor on how we had to level the grounds and to dig out deep ditches for foundations.

Having distributed the work, I. remained with me. After a while we started digging out ditches for the foundation on the already prepared ground. I had never seen before how a building was built. And everything surprised me. Some special machines were digging out deep ditches by throwing out mountains of sand. The sand was immediately taken to the factory on camels and donkeys, and big blocks of glass were dragged from there and piled, which was prepared for the foundations instead of ordinary stones. I understood that such deep foundations were prepared against the sandstorms.

The work was in full swing. It seemed that the strong foundation of the chapel was growing simply at an incredible speed. Such deep ditches were dug out not only for the chapel, but also for the stair to it. I noticed some holes prepared beforehand for connections in many of the glass blocks. Little by little, while the work was gathering momentum, I comprehended that while I. wasn't here, he was a chief of the dwellers of the oasis through mother Anna, who prepared the building materials – according to the plan which only he knew – for all the future buildings which everyone of us had to leave in the oasis, imaginary in our name.

Once again, I saw the infinity of I.'s knowledge and activity! Once again, I bowed to this man! And not only this I understood once again – I understood my modest place in the universe! I thought that the idea to build the chapel of the Ringing Joy in mother Anna's oasis had struck my head; now I understood through the experience of my work that I was only a visible instrument through which the Great Life was sending the sign of His invisible compassion to the people who deserved it. I., the real builder of the chapel, visually stepped back to the shadow by pushing my name forward for the memory of

the grateful oasis! And this shadow, this grandeur of the great spirit, which didn't require any people's gratitude anymore, revealed my entire weakness for my consciousness: the support of the grateful hearts, their blessings in this chapel were still necessary for my support, so that I could do my tasks. And for me to receive this help from those who were praying here, I had to possess an absolute purity and selflessness of my heart.

When I was dragging the ladder in the Masters' laboratory, the Great acknowledged that to be within myself. Now, by stepping in the working day of the earth, I received this acknowledgment for the second time...

"Lyovushka, strong man, if you are saving your strength and resting in the most important moments," I heard Yassa's voice, "we'll never achieve much. Well, hold the crane, and let's start laying the biggest blocks."

I came to myself from my reflections, and I started working again with even greater honour. I hadn't seen I.'s grandeur so obviously for a single time. As though today my heart broke in two parts, like his towers, and I saw everything in the world as a living double life: the one of the earth and of heaven. Everything, without exception, was only a shadow, a reflection of Eternity. But only a few were destined to understand it during this short moment which we call an incarnation...

The work was done so quickly, easily and simply that when the signal for dinner was heard, no one could believe that so many hours of the strained work had passed. I was still fresh and brisk. I didn't need any rest, and I was surprised when I saw tiredness reflected on my friends' faces from work and exhausting sun.

I. who was in time to lead everybody and everywhere left our avenue shortly and came back again. He praised everybody for an excellent work and dismissed the natives immediately by telling them to come back to work in a couple of hours.

When three of us were left with Yassa, I. told us to level some piles and to go to the factory together with him. Here we met Gregor and Vasilyon who were waiting for us. I. brought us to a small building in comparison to the factory, and here every one of us were taken aback. The wonderful, carved, half-finished details of the chapel and the stairs were completely finished, and the statue with its entire height was standing under a thick cover, in the purpose of which no one of us had any doubts.

"This is the work of Radanda's Community," I. explained to us. "You didn't know that this great old man was also an excellent sculptor. Only he made the statue itself and all flowers white. We will have to do the most difficult work and to paint them. Now Vasilyon knows the secret of the new paint and the methods of this art of centuries. Now we'll carry several blocks and beams, and we'll prepare the foundation on which our assistants will keep building the complicated construction of the stairs."

Soon we loaded five carts which camel dragged to the construction place of the chapel. We still covered this path several times, and when our colleagues came back rested after the dinner break, the foundation of the building was already completed. They only had to throw up their arms by not comprehending the pace of our "miraculous" work, and they put it into words, and they continued our started construction. Having refused their light afternoon meal – the meal between the dinner and the supper was called like this in the oasis – our assistants were working with us till the very evening, and they were ready to refuse even the supper if only they didn't have to part with I. to whom they attached more and more simply in every moment.

By obeying the command of our respectable chief, both natives and we left the construction ground. I. promised the inhabitants of the oasis to come to the new hall together with us, as soon as the

supper was over. He explained to them that he would have the supper in the dining-room of our house, because he needed to specify the work for tomorrow. Although upset that they will have supper without I., our dear assistants left in a cheerful mood by assuring I. that they would eat very quickly and they would start waiting, waiting, waiting for him...

Having gathered in our little dining-room at the supper table, we were waiting for I. who was delayed this time as never before. While sharing my impressions with those friends whom I hadn't seen during the whole day, again I was rather surprised when I found out that all half-finished products for the new buildings were prepared in Radanda's Community. All the sculptures and the art goods were produced there and delivered here. Only the foundation blocks were prepared in the oasis factory, while mother Anna didn't explain their purpose to anybody.

I was no less surprised by Andreyeva's and Oldenkot's story about that what they received from their Masters-Teachers: Nataliya Vladimirovna received a lot of boxes with devices and all other equipment of the chemical laboratory, while her friend received a whole bookshop. Igor received several chests for his future observatory and the promise of his Master-Teacher to send three scientists to help him.

While sharing this important news, we didn't notice how much time had flown past, - and it wasn't standing still, only I. was still absent. Suddenly we heard his quick and light steps, the door opened silently, and... divine I. entered the room.

He was wearing white clothes, embroidered with gold. He was holding the familiar stick and a small cup that was burning with orange fire in his hands. I could take my eyes off his wonderful face in which nothing human was left in this hour, and only the pure, joyful spirit was shining. An undisturbed happiness covered the whole I.'s image, and his expression now reminded me of the Moria's portrait which I saw at the head of the sofa in the room of my Master-Teacher. Having looked at us with his radiating look, I. uttered.

"My friends and children, you were waiting for me for supper. But man is alive not only with the daily bread. I've brought a great Light of Life for you, which we will put with you into the pit under the chapel foundation. Let's go all together there and together with the present of heaven let's carry everything what is the purest, highest and calmest from our hearts, what only everyone can pour together with the prayer glorifying the whole Life. By praying, pour into this Fire - the material sign of the Great God's immaterial participation and cooperation with us - all that nobility of love, compassion and courage which only you can show, so that everybody who comes to pray would find help for his weakness, the strengthening energy for his difficult existence on the earth and never be afraid of his heavy burden... The prayer and blessing of fearless people by this chapel and great guarantee of help and calm for those who will come here to search for protection and wisdom."

Having raised the cup and his stick above his head, which all began to shine in many-coloured rays, I. blessed us and turned towards the door. The dark, silent night, radiant with the stars was so dark that it was difficult to discern even a little path. But the cup in I.'s hands was pouring such bright beam of light that not only the whole I.'s figure was illuminated, but all of us could be seen clearly.

I didn't feel a slightest tiredness, hunger or any signs of my physical body. I could feel only joy, and my prayer for the future pilgrims of the chapel was flying to the flame in I.'s hands. I was whispering the divine name: "Sanat Kumara" by tying into it the whole happiness to live for another moment with courage and wisdom by uniting with all the workers of the heaven and the earth with the inextinguishable love of the Great Mother...

Having approached the laid foundation, I. ordered me to lift the heavy, central block. I had never lifted anything heavier than this huge, glass block during my entire life. And I had never felt such joy which covered me in this hour. It seemed that the heaven and the earth joined into one totality, everything was ringing in one, joint feeling of Joy...

I. knelt. We followed his example, and when I. put the cup into the niche under the block by putting the stick burning in seven colours next to it, suddenly the hymn of Life was heard behind us, which the Masters of power were singing with their unique, unearthly, glass voices.

Nothing could look like "a miracle" in this unforgettable, great hour. How and when the Masters of power got here? These questions didn't even cross my mind, because the reality with its "miracles" completely surpassed any fairy-tale charms.

"We came here to take part together with you, messengers of the Earth, by establishing the new, magnetic centre of the Diving Power on the Earth," the Master of the Masters uttered, who was all shining like a huge pole of light in the darkness of the night. "Today we came to bid farewell to you. Be blessed and happy by going with your work and activity for people's welfare. Every one of you has received His Own cup of Fire and Tranquillity. But remember that the cup isn't a symbol, but the spirit and power of your life and activity. Press yourselves to it, draw in its power to yourselves and put this power into the ordinary activity of your daily routine. Come to us not because of symbols, but for the real knowledge and the Truth of Life. Let the image of the cup buried here remind you, help you to comprehend the meaning of your own earthly life and with this meaning – the primary meaning of the entire human existence – lead all your encounters, do all your work. Life gives His Power to you not because of certain places or time. He reminds you once again: that one is loyal to Him who has learnt to live within Him and in His presence, beyond the limits of time and space."

I. ordered me to cover the burning cup with the block, he stood up on it and he ordered us all seven to form a ring around it and to join our hands. The Masters also joined their hands by forming a big ring around us. Once again, they sang their Divine hymn and disappeared in the darkness of the night as suddenly as they had appeared.

I could see through the thick block how the cup was burning in the niche and how the stick was shining next to it. I didn't dare to ask I. where and when I had to put the sacred relics given to me, but my compassionate friend invited everybody to bow to the buried Sacred Thing again, to hurry to the new hall where people were waiting for us, and he told me on our way.

"When the time comes to lift the statue of the Divine Mother, put your treasure under Her pedestal.

We entered the hall full of people, where mother Anna had already finished her conversation, and I. took her place in the small cathedral if one could call like this the big armchair with wide arms which could replace a table if needed, in which the whole figure of an orator could be seen.

I.'s appearance with his solemn clothing which the dwellers of the oasis had never seen before, which had kept its entire radiance and with which he entered our small dining-room, stunned everybody present here so much that they stood up and they were waiting in silence for his words with respect.

Chapter 31

I.'s conversation with the dwellers of the oasis in the night of the beginning of the construction of the chapel. I.'s, Vasilyon's and my work by painting the statue and its construction in the chapel. The last night before the chapel's consecration. Demetrius and his task for me. I.'s speech during the inauguration of the chapel

"You expect to hear a miraculous revelation from me," I. began silently, "but if you had been listening attentively to mother Anna's words and sermons during the entire joint life with her, and especially during the last years, now you would comprehend well that help for man comes not externally, that the revelation within himself is leading him, tempting and forcing him to search for the new ways to knowledge.

You asked why there was a snake mouthing up her tail in the hand of the future statue of mother Anna. There isn't any secret in this symbol. The whole man, all his eternally living powers of spirit and consciousness are moving in a circle, as well as the earth in which we are living. As you already know, man isn't living a single time. He comes back to the physical earth not for a single time, so that he would go through his personal development in a solid and material form and would help his own people to strive for it with the final goal – cooperation with the Bright Brotherhood.

The circles of man's life cycles not always pass in the same places. Once the man lived several incarnations in China, for his further work he may incarnate in the south of France or the north of England, among you or some wandering desert tribes, in the industrial centres of America or some gloomy corners of Siberia or perhaps Africa.

The geographical location doesn't have any significance for the cycles of man's life. Even his nationality, religion or similar characteristics don't have any significance if the man hasn't attached himself to them with his hatred or crimes, as well as with superstitions or painful love.

Among the powers, which bind the freedom of man's spirit, the hatred of the man himself is weaving the strongest, unbroken bonds. If man hated his nation while he was living in it – then he will be incarnating in the same nation for many times until he overcomes his painful circumstances or may be crimes which were born due to his hatred with his real and free love.

In the same way man's hatred or contempt for some nation or land, for their exceptional characteristics creates a difficult karmic bond for many centuries. The greatest goal of the man's earthly life – to become free and to help the people living next to him to become free.

But what does it mean "to become free"? To be rich? Not depend on any work? To have a possibility to travel around the entire world? To acquire some knowledge? To see the whole beauty with which creators adorn the earth?

The more external beauty and knowledge you acquire by considering them to be the whole life's power and meaning, by considering them to be the essence of man's freedom, the heavier and more pressing burden of your knowledge will be, the more difficult it will be to move with it without joy and lightness which is the greatest value of the working man's day.

The meaning of life is to achieve the harmony of the entire universe, to make sure that all elements and storms of the Earth, all the catastrophes and disasters in it don't disturb the harmony of the universe.

Every one of you must enter such liberation of your spiritual world that no outer or inner catastrophe, any favours, joys, exaltations, humiliations, separations or disasters could disturb the constant light of harmony within yourselves, could neither disturb nor destroy your happiness to live during this passing by day.

If you've kept the complete balance of your strengths during this passing by moment and you didn't think: "Ah, how happy I am!", but you were pouring the result of your happiness – tranquillity – for your encountered people, then you've already strengthened tranquillity on the entire Earth. You were an effective centre of joy for your encountered people, you strengthened not only their nerves, but also their external ability to work and inner strength of aspiration to their spiritual freedom.

No one of you has experienced that suffering of self-love and greediness, envy for strange achievements or high position, which suffer the modern, cultured nations of different lands during their best years. Namely that happened there about what I was talking in the beginning of today's conversation: the heavy and oppressing burden of their external knowledge has fallen on the spirit and fire of their hearts. If no harmony between one's thought and heart exists – then no completeness of man's life may be without this harmony.

How could you distinguish what is that measure of value of man's work, of his private worries which opens and not destroys the channel of his spirit? How to understand what knowledge and work is leading to Light, what external efforts of duties, obligations and worries don't lead to any devotion, but only waste the precious time in futile din which doesn't have any significance for your external life?

Any knowledge, any work – even if it externally doesn't look much like a hero's activity and reminds you only of a laundress's work in the trough – if it gave you more emotions, cheerfulness, an ordinary kindness and if it didn't irritate and tire your body so much that you can hardly stand on your feet, such work is leading you into Light, it liberates your Spirit from the conditional clutches of the external life. But if your efforts to do your duty oppress you and you don't radiate from within, but you even forgot that you possessed an inner Light for which your physical body is only a frame, then you ruined not only this day of your life, but also many of your future days. So, how many valuable days, which not only you, but also your encountered people need, have you ruined? As many of them as you will need for rest, so that your spirit could rise again, which was squeezed up from too great tiredness of the physical part of your conductor. You will need even three times as many days for your spirit to reach the level of full-pledged work then you needed them for your physical body to rest from your unjustifiable physical tiredness.

The same is with harmony if you are living pitilessly and spending your time idly. This oppresses and destroys man's spirit no less than an exhausting work. A thought – the greatest of all powers with which man is rewarded, – may not act if it is trampled by somebody. If the spirit isn't concentrated, work cannot be full of inspiration.

Only a complete spirit's liberation can lead man into such cheerfulness from which his creation begins, that is into a joyous harmony of man's spiritual and physical parts. An exalted cheerfulness exists. An artificial, demonstrative cheerfulness exists, an imaginary energetic state behind which man wants to hide a well-perceived vanity and senselessness of his own life from people's eyes. But that doesn't have anything to do with the real cheerfulness of spirit. That is always the same remembrance of man's own "I", only in another form. While the real cheerfulness is the honour for the Divine Energy within himself and within his encountered person, and also the harmonious activity with Her by forgetting about his own "I".

In most cases you can see a meaningless waste of strengths in the families with the medium and little income where it seems to people that by exhausting their body till the half bestial condition, they are creating the world, salvation and help for their own people. When you meet such families dying in superstitions in the cities to which many of you will be going soon, try to change their views and to help them to perceive the meaning of life. Remind them more often that man is alive not only with bread.

With this I finish my conversation with you today. I can see many young faces that lit up with a hope to leave with me to the distant lands. At the same time, I can see the same number of faces that became sad from the thought about the separation with their beloved places and people.

Both of them are wrong. You, who were educated according to the new rules of high love and ethics, who are living next to that place where Life Himself is acting by protecting, blessing and taking care of you, you may not orient yourselves into your personal wellbeing, into your personal joy in the great, fatal moments. Only one choice can be for you: for Life, together with Him, by forgetting about yourselves, to step into His activity that is given to every one of you in such a way and there, as the Bright Brotherhood will instruct to you.

Not I must drag you after me, and you don't have to follow me where I will instruct you to go. Your Life's energy, ringing with joy like a swift stream of Love must lead you to people. You must carry the most ordinary kindness and benevolence to them. And wherever you would be working for people – you will be working for Life within them everywhere. And people who are working for Life are working beyond the limits of time and space, beyond the limits of everyday circumstances and forms, by respecting Him, Eternal, in everything what is temporary.

Train your courage. Mature. Everyone comprehends in what level you are already prepared to go beyond the limits of the narrow world of your tranquillity and love and to carry it into the noisy cities for the exhausted, worried and embarrassed people."

I. finished his speech with these words. The whole audience, in the silence of which one could hear the beating of the people's hearts, was standing and listening to the wonderful friend's words – they were excited, full of inspiration, with their eyes radiating with joy, it seemed that they couldn't see anything else, except the bright I.'s image. By saying good-bye, he smiled to them, rose from his armchair quickly, and only when we went out to the silent avenue of the park, not disturbed by a single little leaf's rustling, the listeners came to themselves from their ecstasy, and the silence that was hanging up to now turned into a deafening storm of gratitude for the orator who had already left the hall.

I. was leading us in silence and only when he came to the house he uttered.

"Everybody, except Vasilyon and Lyovushka, go to rest. The night will pass soon, and in the morning a lot of responsible work is waiting for everybody. Both of you change into the working clothes and wait for me here, in the hall," he addressed Vasilyon and me, who were standing one next to another.

Having said good-bye to my friends, I went upstairs to my room quickly, changed my clothes and I went down on my knees by begging the Great Mother to help us to concentrate all our thoughts and strengths, all purity and joy of our hearts, because I could feel that we would start from the most responsible work – preparation of the statue. When I went downstairs, Vasilyon was already in the hall. I looked at him and I saw the face of the undisturbedly pure and kind child, in which big, blue eyes were burning with the bright contrast, which reminded me of the kind, wise and solemnly charming Francisco's look.

When this association flashed, I invited heartily this man's unshakable Will-Love to help me.

"It is great, Lyovushka, that for today's work you invite all that is purest, highest and the best what you can on the earth," I.'s voice was heard. "Everything what man is doing on the earth, he must do it with the protective net of the Bright Brotherhood. The disciple not only of high levels, but also of the lowest ones must start his every work from creation of the net of compassion," I. continued by walking towards the factory between me and Vasilyon. "The higher man's stage of liberation is, the wider, more powerful and bigger that protective net is which he is creating. And the higher the disciple's self-sacrifice and fearlessness is, the smaller his personal needs, the wider and brighter his protective net is shining, and he can cover with it not only himself, but as many people as his liberation allowed to stretch and radiate his protective net. Some exceptionally powerful and great Radiating Brothers exist among the members of the Bright Brotherhood. Their protective net can cover and protect any disciple in any place. Then why so many disciples fall away and why they cannot be saved from their falling? Because the net sets on burning fire only when this fire – the great fire of Light of Love – can penetrate into the disciple's heart and to light in it a pure, harmonious, creative sparkle that has strength to unite with the creative work of that Great Brother who extends his helping hand to him. Everything is within man himself. Nothing in the spiritual world can be reached with a passive, inert plea. Only an active, creative life of man's heart can attract to herself a high spirit of a distant or close – depending on the distance – helper and join the happiness of cooperation with the Bright Brotherhood with the efforts of joy."

We already reached the familiar, small building to me, in which the construction material of the chapel was placed.

"In this moment concentrate your entire joy to live," I. continued by going down on his knees before the gates of the building, "and pray together with me, ask the Great Mother to draw you into the net of Her work. Concentrate your entire attention on the power of your heart's purity, because nothing for a man, the builder on the earth, is more important than his purity and selflessness. You've heard many times that you would receive from this visible mankind neither gratitude for your selfless work nor acknowledgment for the knowledge which you will carry to the Earth as new discoveries dedicated for mankind. But the invisible, bright mankind has already recognized every one of you many times, recognized and assented to your loyalty and work for your chosen path of serving the Light. Love and tranquillity in your hearts isn't a passive thought anymore: "I need to carry tranquillity everywhere," but it is an active and living love of your heart which knows the power, the effective power of Thought-Love. Concentrate the fire of this Thought-Love on one will: to join the coworkers of the Great Mother in the construction of Her chapel. We must leave not a beautifully cleaned place of harmony with some artistic forms and lines in the oasis, in which everyone who came would find a rest, but we must fill every laid block with such nobility and purity of spirit, with such active love and loyalty that the heart of the one who will come to the chapel

would rise again for the new work, that his grievances and disappointments with which he came to the place of Light would seem not like a misery to him, but like a vanity, and that he would understand what a small place they must take in his own spiritual world that the Ringing Joy would cover him all and draw him into His vibrations, would give him winds, would lift his eyes of spirit from temporary forms into Eternity. If our prayer for people is sincere, if love of our hearts is active, if you remember the only one goal by creating: to create a pure place in which Purity could reveal Herself, - you will see a sign of Eternity. It will shine above your chapel when we lift the statue on its place, under which you, Lyovushka, will place everything what was told to you."

I. lapsed into silence. The moments were passing, but I didn't know for how long it lasted. I pressed my jewel and the Great Mother's little flower to my chest; I absolutely didn't feel my form; I forgot about everything personal; I was only one Thought-Love. I concentrated all my strengths of spirit on one thought: everyone who will come to the chapel must feel Life within himself. Everyone who will be praying by the chapel must feel Life - a joyous creation, and leave it with a firm resolution to carry kindness and calm to his daily work immediately.

When I came to myself from my prayer, - by the way, it seemed to me that my whole body, everything within me was buzzing from the power of joy, from happiness and inexpressible tranquillity, - I saw the radiating I.'s figure and also radiating Vasilyon next to him, they were trying to open the gates of the building.

I got next to them in a flash, I opened the wide gates widely, and my strength of goliath had never seemed such happiness, such joy and easiness to live. Not letting my friends even to come to themselves, somehow I perceived myself which and where I had to lift the heavy blocks, how to prepare the temporary pedestal for the statue, so that I. and Vasilyon could work by it.

By seeing that I didn't need any instructions and that I didn't need any physical help by this difficult job, I. smiled and he began to prepare the paint and the instruments which he brought with Vasilyon in the box. And again, I cannot tell for how long my work continued, but I know that when I already prepared everything, lifted the statue on the solid pedestal and prepared a firm scaffold around it, I. with Vasilyon had also prepared everything. Having climbed a little on the pedestal, they helped me to take the thick cover off the statue.

My God, with what a beauty the figure of the Great Mother began to shine among the blocks of the lack-lustre blocks! In this moment the moon that had already risen high illuminated the whole statue with its light, and it seemed to be alive and light, illuminating everything with its smile.

"Oh, Radanda, Radanda, do you hear me?" I. addressed him. "Your hands had never created anything more beautiful, and even if this time you finish your activity on the Earth with this work, let your path be blessed, great old man! Let your love for people be blessed, in whom you didn't see anything else, except the Only One, for whom you never felt any vexation in your heart, you were just carrying justification and calm for them. Let them follow you, let your work on the earth end and let the Ringing Joy accept you into His arms! Bless us, pure heart, to finish your work, as we are instructed to do it. Let your reconciliation be a living example of your work and love for us."

I.'s voice lapsed into silence, and I saw the calm figure of this old man in the air, by the statue's feet, with the unforgettable smile in his wrinkled face, blessing us with the five-pointed star which began to shine in his hand.

We all bowed low to Radanda, and when I raised my head, he had already gone from the statue's feet.

I and Vasilyon were working till the morning by giving such colours and radiance to the statue in which she was shining in Radanda's chapel. But it still wasn't changing in that unique white and reddish pearl which stunned us there.

"It is enough for now; it is dawning already. We need to rest a little, so that we could go to work fresh together with everybody," I. told us.

I wanted to object that I wasn't tired at all, I wanted to ask for a permission to say here, but I already knew that any, even the smallest deviation from Teacher's instructions always led not forwards, but backwards, because a personal element was always hiding in it.

Having covered the statue with the cover quickly, we put everything back to the former places, we got back in our house even faster, or at least it seemed to me like this, and we broke up to our rooms in silence.

I woke up from the strong Yassa's shaking.

"What is going on, Lyovushka? Should I pour some water on you? I wake you up for the third time, and you always fall asleep! I. will get down soon, everybody has already gathered in the hall, only you are still sleeping!"

Yassa knew perfectly how to get me. It was terrible even to think about being disgraced before I., besides I didn't understand myself why I had fallen so deeply asleep this time. Anyway, I was at fault, because I came to the hall together with I. who looked at me with his joyful eyes, gushing with humour. It seemed to me that these nice eyes were telling me without any words: "You weren't tired at all and you didn't need any rest."

The day passed by working resolutely and persistently. Gregor had to work much more than others, because we were less experienced builders, and only our diligence and concentration helped us to fulfil the set lessons of architecture.

Many days passed by working like this. The sounds of hammers, saws, steps of camels and donkeys became a usual thing in the avenues of the new park, as well as the constant movement of people and carts with sand and construction materials. But this difficult work wasn't tiring anybody. The laughter of young voices united with the general noise of the construction, and the hearts of everybody who were working were waiting impatiently for one hour: the evening I.'s speech in the new hall.

Not only the dwellers of the oasis were waiting impatiently for his conversations. Every one of us used to receive a huge help from them. It seemed that every evening I. touched deeper and deeper theme, and while looking into it, every one of us who was also going into the new life, as well as the dwellers of the oasis, had more possibilities to check our preparation for the future tasks.

Many times, it seemed to me that I had already solved that or another question finally and irreversibly, that they couldn't rouse any doubts for me anymore. But then some I.'s word would cast an absolutely new light on that question. And then I saw that a sparkle of my personal feeling was still hiding and sleeping in some remote, little corner of my heart.

The days were passing, the work was moving forward. Finally, the great hour came when we had to put the prepared statue of the Great Mother who was shining in all colours of the rainbow and pearl in the right place.

The commanding I.'s voice woke me up still before the dawn and told me to put on clean, white clothes, to gird myself with his given golden band, to gather up all the jewels which Dartran, Radanda

and Morya had given to me and to come downstairs as soon as possible, silently, without making up anybody.

I pressed Venetian's jewel and the Great Mother's flower to my chest, which I had never left, I picked up the instructed things, I took Dartran's chain especially tenderly by remembering his words: "This rare thing belonged to a joyous living being whose spirit wasn't disturbed in any circumstances of life even for a moment."

I flew round everybody in a short moment, who had given their material blessings to me, I bowed to the Master of the Masters with gratitude, who purified the Venetian's jewel, I pressed the Great Mother's little flower to my lips by whispering: "Let the living power of energy for the new life awaken for everybody who bows to Your image. Let the perception open in his heart who is his fellow creature, and let the most ordinary kindness – instead of condemnation – help him find calm and justification for every encountered person."

I rolled all things in Dartran's headscarf, I ran to the shower quickly and back, I changed to the clean clothes which were placed by the bed, probably prepared by loving Yassa's hands, and I climbed down to the hall where I. was already waiting for me.

He took my arm silently, and we went to the building of the statue like this, in silence. Its door was opened widely, while the radiating statue was standing on my prepared, temporary pedestal absolutely uncovered. Mother Anna was kneeling by her feet.

I. told me to give the packet with the things to mother Anna. He put his hands on my head and uttered.

"Take the statue in your arms and carry it to the chapel."

Oh, how happy I became! I didn't even comprehend that the unbearable weight of the glass wouldn't allow me to fulfil his command. I already wanted to take the statue when I heard I.'s voice.

"You still aren't consecrated to control the air element, and her servants won't obey you. But I tie my power into your fire, K. and air elementals will help you. Now go, lift the statue – it will seem to be absolutely weightless to you."

I felt a strong movement of the air wave around myself, and I saw a tremendous number of small creatures, stuck all around me. When I lifted the statue, it seemed to be made of cardboard to me, and also I was walking as easily as though I was sailing on the ground. Unawares I responded to the smiles of my wonderful assistants with a joyful laughter. I climbed up the stairs to the very top step in the same easy way, I entered the chapel, and I placed the statue in the very middle of already prepared pedestal.

I saw that I.'s cup was burning in orange colour exactly under that place, deep in the ground, under the heavy block. And its fire was rising straight up by covering all the steps of the stairs, the floor of the chapel, the whole statue. And the seven-coloured fire of the stick began to shine on all the flowers which were in the statue's hands and by her feet.

The whole ground, as much as my eyes could take in, was shining in the fire of the cup and the stick. The whole avenue, as well as the radiating underground tunnel, was blazing with Divine flame.

I. and mother Anna approached me from both sides and went down on their knees.

"Take the things and put them here," I. told me by opening the unseen door in the pedestal and pointing to the hiding-place which I didn't know who and when had made. "If your heart is pure and loyal till the end, if you don't have any other desire, but only to be the servant of the mankind, to be

brother for man not in your dreams and fantasies, but if you are searching how to be the main chain of the spiritual communication between man and Life in your everyday activity, - all the things which you put here will flare up with the fire of the cup and unite with the fire of the statue. Everybody who has given these things to you will unite their power of purity and joy with the heart of everybody who will be praying here. And with this, they will help the completeness of prayers and spiritual development of every creature who will be searching for help in the chapel. Then the power of your love and joy will become so tempered that not a single future test will obscure and stir it."

Also I went down on my knees. Now I could see that not only the ground around the chapel and the avenue was shining; the Masters' laboratory was shining, and they, with their faces turned to our side, were singing their hymn, the sounds of which reached my ears. Also the towers of the rays were shining, and the rays from the images of their Masters shining wonderfully were spreading straight into the chapel. The tower of the elements was shining. Happy, covered by ecstasy, I took I.'s given things, unwrapped them from the headscarf, also I put the headscarf there, I took the jewel and the Great Mother's little flower off my chest, and I already wanted to close the door of the hiding-place, but I.'s voice stopped me.

"Take the headscarf back. The Great Mother gives it to you as her loyal son. Let it remind you of this moment of your earthly life, the higher of which you won't experience anything on the Earth anymore."

I took the headscarf out, which was burning in all fires of the stick, but which didn't burn my hands, I closed the door and I bowed by the feet of the statue by blessing the heaven's compassion which had arranged the new centre of His Power on the Earth and which had given an opportunity to me to take part in the creation of this Holy Thing.

When I raised my head, all the things placed in the hiding-place were burning in a wonderful fire by spreading their rays across the whole chapel, and on top, above the statue, the golden star was burning.

The Masters finished singing their hymn. Their laboratory went out the first, then the towers of the rays and elements went out one after another, and only the five-pointed star and the blazing underground fire remained burning.

"My friend, Anna," I. uttered by standing up and pointing at the shining five-pointed star. "Here's the promised sight for you. That your magnetic centre has been built, in the place of which you were instructed to live and work. It was said to you: "If you are able to live absolutely purely by forgetting about yourself." And you did it. The living heaven accepted the gift of your love today and gave its own to you. Soon you will become free from your body. Your granddaughter Anna will change you. But "soon" doesn't mean in this hour. It is beyond description in this earthly time that is passing quickly. Wait for that hour calmly when Lyovushka will bring Anna and Ananda here for you."

I. bowed low before kneeling mother Anna. He crossed her with a wide cross and helped her to stand up.

"Don't think with a longing for how many years you still will have to carry your earthly form. Think only about the great happiness to live: to live in the body of the earth and to carry the Light of the Eternal, to serve only to Him, to cooperate with Him. Look at your cross which was always an ordinary golden cross up to now. It is all shining like a wonderful, adamant, electric light. It reflects the light from the five-pointed star which has descended into you, and which hasn't gone out in your purity. Only that soul will be able to change you whose heart's purity and liberation will be able to hold the burning of the

Fire of Wisdom in your cross with which you will bless your successor. Comprehend well how much work Anna still has before her eyes. Don't hurry her. Send the thoughts of your help to her patiently and pray for her on this sacred land. The fire which you are carrying in this cross will be laying the path to her with its rays little by little. The purer and less self-seeking your prayers for her will be, the sooner the ray of your cross will touch her."

Having finished talking, I. bowed to mother Anna again, he crossed her again and added by addressing both of us.

"You've seen the real grandeur of outpouring of the Divine Love on the Earth. Wherever and for how much every one of you would be living, don't forget this moment, the moment of your happy Participation in work of the Great God, Living and Powerful Guardian of the Earth, Sanat Kumara. It is out of the question about "duties and obligations" for those people who had the happiness to see the actions of the Divine Power, Her work on the earth. These people have already become free from the superstitions of the elementary ethics. They don't possess the attitude: "I must." They possess the only joy beating in their hearts: to give cheerfulness and understanding to their encountered person that every moment of living on the earth is happiness to live in the Eternity. They don't divide words into right and false anymore, business – into important and unimportant, people into welcome and unwelcome ones, because all these concepts – that's only an essence of the earthly superstitions. While the real Life's elixir is the thought that goes right through all man's actions: everything is happening in Eternity, as well as Eternity is taking part in everything. Only knowledgeable and ignorant people exist according to this attitude, those who are coming to the knowledge, those who stop in one or another level, those who are living with one or another power of happiness or misfortune only because they know where they have come with their knowledge and what they have achieved with it. You can see the underground Fire. But those who will come here won't see Her. But those who will come here searching for help and comfort will receive it; the hour hasn't struck for them yet to see, but the time has come to feel their uniting with the living heaven. Carry out the unshakable fortitude in your hearts and always comprehend that your hearts – that's the bridge on which the Power of living Harmony may encounter your fellow creature on the earth. Now, my friends, go home and rest. Tomorrow at noon announce the ceremonial inauguration of the chapel. Let all the dwellers of the oasis gather here and wait for me in the square. I will come together with my disciples. Let everybody dress in white clothes. Now leave me alone.

Having bowed low to I., we climbed down the stair, which was burning in the colour of red gold, we crossed the entire avenue which was shining like a crystal vase, and we went out to a little ground where mother Anna's statue was standing, finished several days ago already.

The underground rays were spreading from the chapel across all six avenues, which met here like in the centre of the circle and they were pouring into a big sphere under the very mother Anna's statue. Further from this sphere, seven rays were going straight to the laboratory of the Masters. They melted into a sphere in it again, which was radiating with such power that its circle of light covered the whole laboratory, rising almost till half of this big building.

Surprised by this dazzling view, we were standing before the statue in silence for a while and then we hurried to the old part of the park, so that we wouldn't disturb I.'s work in the chapel with anything.

Mother Anna gave me her hand by drawing my attention that the whole ground was radiating in the old park, too, till the very green wall, although not so brightly, but we could see the whole underground world of the tree and flower roots.

We came up to mother Anna's house in silence, by holding our hands. Then she said to me.

"You are just a baby in comparison to my age. And anyway, you gave several lessons to me during this short time when I knew you. I saw that my whole integrity of service which I considered to be irreproachable wasn't worth much, because there was a crack in it: I was always thinking about the wound of my heart. Because my goal was the liberation itself, that's why every event used to become a barrier for my liberation. While I was thinking that I was working only for people by fulfilling the will of those who had sent me. When I put the things in the hiding-place of the statue's pedestal, when you took the burning headscarf – I understood the whole integrity of your loyalty, the whole purity of your selflessness. No thoughts about them exit within you, you are living with them. That's why your hands, and not mine, put the things of bright people under the statue's pedestal and strengthened with it sensitiveness of the people of the earth for the heavenly flow. Be blessed. I understood how joyfully I must live, so that I would facilitate the task: to bring Anna here, on whose chest the heavenly flow wouldn't go out."

Mother Anna embraced me and disappeared in her little house. I was all full of bliss, great inner silence and calm. I was so far away from the earth, so happy that I was walking without knowing where, when suddenly I felt a light touch of somebody's hand.

"Forgive me, brother, for disturbing your reflections. Father Radanda sent me. I am searching for a possibility to approach you for a long time, but you were always occupied and not alone. The chief sent me namely to you and not to my future, Radanda's promised to me, Teacher Gregor. The chief told me to give this small chest only to your hands by saying that you would know yourself what to do with it."

To my great amazement, although not instantly, but somehow, I recognized the impressive... Demetrius. I could expect everything, but only not this metamorphosis which had happened in the man who was standing before me, who once was self-confident, handsome Demetrius, who considered himself to be the finest cavalier and painter in the world.

Also now his face was still beautiful. His eyes were shining, his facial features were without any deformation. His figure remained slim. He was still young. But his expression of pain, sadness, some relentless anxiety, inner tension, suppressed swiftness turned into such vivid caricature in the previous background of his grand confidence and calm that I couldn't even instantly evaluate the whole depth of the change that had happened in this man.

This messenger rang like a signal of a panic alarm of the earth to my festive mood. Demetrius's tiredness, his cloak covered with dust told clearly that he had a possibility neither to wash himself nor to change his clothes after his journey. I didn't know how to find the guesthouse of the oasis. I didn't know whether I could take him to my house and I already wanted to go to mother Anna's to ask her where I could inhabit and feed Radanda's messenger when I noticed that we with Demetrius were standing by the threshold of her house where I came back again without comprehending it myself for some reason.

As soon as I thought about mother Anna, the door opened, she smiled pleasingly and said to me.

"Lyovushka, bring the guest to me. My girl still isn't sleeping. While you accompany the guest to the shower, we will prepare a supper for him. Where is your camel, traveller?" she addressed Demetrius tenderly, who was standing before her with a chest in his hands and who must have been stunned by her appearance and voice.

"My camel brought me till the very gate of your settlement and fell dead. When I rode up close and I even could see the fence of your garden, mother, two robbers showed up from somewhere and attacked me. They were threatening me by demanding to give Radanda's chest to them. I took the chest and pressed it to my heart, prepared to protect it till the very death. Arrows of the enemies missed me.

Then they directed them to my loyal camel whom Radanda had commanded to bring me alive to you here, even if he had to die himself. I don't know, mother, whether you know Radanda. That old man is full of so much love for everybody that even animals understand his speech. Also my camel understood his command. By concentrating all his strength, the camel tore off from the persecutors by leaving them at always greater distance, but when your gates opened before him, he didn't have any strength to cross it anymore," Demetrius answered her sadly.

"Misfortunate, brave animal," mother Anna uttered silently. "Don't grieve over him, traveller. Your camel was no less brave and fearless than you. His suffering along the way was no less than yours. He fell in death of the brave and loyal till the end ones, while you fulfilled your task as it suits the loyal and fearless messenger. Accept my honour, saint Radanda's messenger. Bring happiness to my home, dear guest, but first, give the chest to that one to whom it was sent."

Mother Anna bowed low to Demetrius who couldn't take his eyes off her face. Tears were rolling down his cheeks. But that was not due to his pain which was oppressing his face with big sadness before. Now this face was joyful, happy, it was shining with energy, it changed the whole man so wonderfully that it was difficult to believe in existence of that broken down Demetrius whom I met several minutes before. He gave his hat to me and answered mother Anna.

"What words, saint mother, did you say to me?! Oh, if you knew what door to happiness and light you've opened for me! Be blessed! You, without knowing it yourself, have led me to the new path."

Demetrius wanted to kneel before mother Anna, but she embraced him, kissed his head and uttered hardly audibly.

"I know everything, my friend. Let's go, you are tired, it is time to rest. Don't worry for the delay. Radanda told you: "Come back if you don't find a new friend who would know you for a very long time and would recognize you as the welcome guest," didn't he? You met this old friend – that's me. Let's go."

We entered mother Anna's house. I put the chest with the dusty cover on one of the tables and accompanied Demetrius to the shower. To our amazement, Yassa was waiting for us here. Having left the exhausted traveller under his protection, I came back to mother Anna. I found her kneeling before the table on which I put the chest. Now I saw that the chest not only was shining, but also big beams of light were spreading from it by filling the room with radiance and divine aroma. I saw some flowers placed inside of the chest; they were like in a bonfire. I comprehended in a flash what flowers and from where Radanda sent for the chapel's inauguration. I went on my knees next to mother Anna before the chest by sinking into the bliss of calm and love and I heard her unique, charming voice.

"Hurry up, Lyovushka, I. is waiting for you in the chapel."

She helped me to take the dusty cover off the chest which turned out to be from the same matter of the reddish pearl like the whole statue of the chapel of Ringing Joy. Having pressed the burning chest to my heart, I brought it to I.

I still hadn't come to the chapel when I saw from the distance I. who was going downstairs to meet me. He took the chest, raised it high above his head, he turned his face to the laboratory of the Masters, and – as though by responding to his actions – the whole laboratory lit up, and the Masters bowed low to the chest. Then also all the towers of rays and elements lit up, a big, golden sphere began to shine high up in the sky. A golden, five-pointed star separated from it and fell down on the chest where it remained burning. The wonderful view lasted only for several moments and soon went out. The star kept

burning on the chest and it was radiating in an unwinking light. I. brought it exactly like this into the chapel by whispering me.

“Follow me.”

Having placed the chest by the feet of the Great Mother's figure, he knelt down, opened the cover of the chest and took several alive flowers from it, which were diffusing a strong and unusual aroma. He covered the chest again, on cover of which the star kept burning, and put it under the statue itself by opening one more hiding-place, the dimensions of which exactly suited for the chest and the star. He told me to give the shovel to him, already prepared mass of glass and the instrument for this purpose, which was like a wide, glass knife, and he bricked up the doors of the hiding-place so nicely that it was impossible to find them.

He put the flowers into the statue's hands exactly in the same way as they were in the chapel of Radanda's Community.

It seemed to me that the surrounding ground, the chapel, the figure, the stairs – everything was shining dazzlingly also before, but it was impossible to express the current radiance, the play of the beams which were spreading from the figure in any way. “My God, my God! – I was repeating in my thoughts for myself. – And namely Demetrius delivered this Light, this great gift of Compassion here! What is the power of Love and indulgence for people of the Eternal that yesterday's sinner could deliver His gift!”

I felt on the ground, pierced by the grandeur of Love of the Only One Life again, by praying ardently that everybody who will come here would be able to comprehend and turn the great words into the energy of honour: “Glory to God in the skies, calm to the earth and bliss for people!”

I rose from the ground from light I.'s touch. If my soul was all full of trembling and joy, then how could one describe I.'s appearance in this hour? There aren't any words to describe many things in life, what the real facts of the man's existence are, because the human language is unable to express man's beauty in these moments when God awakens and is acting within him, and man becomes His reflection...

“Let's go, my brother. People soon will gather here. You and all six of your friends need to dress in white clothes and to come here earlier than everybody else. You will stand on the seven steps of the stair and will protect them, because nobody can climb to the chapel earlier than mother Anna. Everybody can only crowd around, but nobody's feet can touch the stair earlier than hers.”

Having noticed that I was a little worried whether the dwellers of the oasis wouldn't be afraid of stepping on the burning ground, I. just smiled to my voiced question.

“Not everybody can see the underground fire. Even not everybody can feel the power of the magnetic current that is flowing under the ground. Only those in whom their fire has risen again can feel the power hidden by the earth. Nobody will see the Fire of heaven here, but everybody will feel its influence for himself as the new wave of energy.”

Having come to our home, we parted with I. He went to his room, while I hurried to wake up my friends. I told I.'s order to them, and very soon all of us were already standing on the stair to the chapel. I wanted to stay downstairs, but Nataliya Vladimirovna didn't agree with me by shaking her head.

“The lowest step of the stair is mine. The highest one is yours. Climb on the seventh step by the very door of the chapel. Nobody will withstand the power of the fire that is burning there, except you. Oldenkot will climb above me, Gregor after him, then Bronski, then Igor, and Vasilyon will stand on the sixth step, next to you.”

As soon as we had time to stand to our places as she instructed us, we saw the Masters of power – for the last time – who were blessing us from their shining laboratory.

We still had time to bow to the Masters with gratitude when people already started gathering to the chapel from all sides. Of course, if we hadn't hurried to protect the stairs, the crowd of the people would have thronged it in a flash. Nataliya Vladimirovna was explaining patiently to everybody that nobody could enter it until mother Anna climbed to the chapel. The natives weren't used to restrictions of their own once accepted customs – an absolute freedom of the oasis, – so they were surprised and not much happy. They were trying to prove her that they were decorating all the buildings with flowers, which they had constructed in the oasis up to now, while mother Anna used to enter only when everything was already prepared, and they used to bring their guardian as the first guest with celebrations and songs.

“Friends, those were “buildings,” Nataliya Vladimirovna answered them. “When you will be inaugurating your new “buildings”, everything will be as always, like you are used to. And you will bring your mother to them according to your own invented, dear ritual. But it isn't a “building” here. That's your Temple, your happiness as Teacher I. told you. That's your welfare on the earth, your sanctuary which you didn't have up to now. Now you will come here to get comfort and joy. And it is necessary that your mother would step into the temple first, there aren't anybody better and higher than her among you.”

Now the crowd was expressing its feelings with respect to mother Anna violently, they understood and accepted Andreyeva's words and started waiting calmly and joyfully. Soon the chapel was lost in the sea of the people's heads. We didn't have to wait for a long time. A tall figure, shining with white clothes, showed up in the end of the palm avenue, and a part of the crowd ran to meet him by pouring flowers on the ground.

That was I. He climbed up on the seventh step of the stair and addressed the people who were standing silently around the chapel.

“Don't expect some exceptional rituals from me, some external ceremonies of the chapel consecration. The essence is not to fulfil the external ceremonies, but only why and how you go to the temple. If you take the Temple of your heart with yourselves to the Temple by entering the temple of the oasis, then the Light of your temple will become stronger, your temple will shine not only by illuminating everything on the earth, but also that life which is going on underground. The power of your pure thoughts will attract all the living workers of heaven, whom you cannot see, and your entire oasis will flow into the joint life of the universe through your consciousness. By coming here, carry with yourselves not only everything what you possess the best within yourselves, not only clean your thoughts by approaching the chapel. Already by approaching the avenue try to forget about yourselves and think even not about your oasis or the people dear to you. Think about the whole Earth, about all the people living on it, sad and unsatisfied, melancholic and complaining of everything, those who have forgotten what joy was. I was already telling you many times that among all the powers which push the universe into the Light and calm, into the progress of culture and inner growth, the most important, invincible power is Joy. Today the great compassion of Life has showed the sign of her help to you by helping you with different means, which you called “miracles” many times, to build this temple, the temple of Ringing Joy. Everybody can see this figure of the Great Mother of divine beauty sent to you as the present of Radanda's work and love. You are fascinated by this wonderful statue, by the inexpressible kindness that is spreading from it. Every one of you would like to snuggle up to it in the ecstasy of your prayer. You can see – no obstacles exist. You are free to go. Every one of you can climb up these steps unhindered and snuggle up to the Sanctity. In spiritual matters no obstacles exist at all. Everyone is acting at that level to which his spirit can lift him. The same is here. Only that one will be able to climb up to the very top joyfully and enter the chapel whose spirit is free from passions and pure, who is living on the earth not for his personal wealth, but for his work for the

general welfare. Many of you already today will try to enter the chapel, but nobody will be able to do it. Such ones will be who will climb up till the sixth step; and there will be such ones who won't get even on the first one. And not because ones of you are worth it, while the others not. Only because passions and desires will still be burning by destroying not only their harmony, but also their self-control. I have already told you: man cannot live on the earth without self-control. Everyone who wants to achieve such level that he could serve people of the earth, that his life wouldn't be like some weeds, without any meaning and use, must achieve tranquillity inside of himself. When he achieves it, he has already walked a half of the path to his conscious existence. Then – after becoming free from his personal superstitions – man already experiences the joy to live his day by working for Eternity. He begins to comprehend that the Earth isn't the place of pleasures or suffering, of good or evil, but the sacred temple of God's work, in the work of which also man is taking part according to his strengths. The Eternity has given a sign of her love and patronage to you by allowing you to start building this temple. This temple of Ringing Joy will be standing for as long as your oasis will be existing. And for it to live here – bring joy in your hearts to it. Only through this power you can merge with the divine vibrations which saturate this place. All your guardians, starting with mother Anna who leads you now, will be high chosen ones who will be able not only to climb up to the chapel, but also to snuggle up to the very divine figure of the Great Mother. Those will be the people who have become free from their personal life, and all their passions with which every man is born in his conductor will already become the currents of joy. That's why the invisible Fire of the steps of the stair and chapel floor won't burn them in the same way as it would happen to every man who hasn't yet overcome the passions within himself if he tried to climb up these steps. The stronger the man's passions will be bubbling, the stronger the invisible God's Fire will be burning him, which is placed here under the foundation for the protection and help of your oasis. Only a joyous, that is free one, will be able to climb up to the chapel. Step aside from the way, here your guardian is coming. Now you will see that power of spirit and heart which creates harmony in man by uniting. Harmony pours in waves of joy and lifts the man on those steps on which only the fellow-worker of the Great God may climb."

The crowd made way, and mother Anna went up to the stair steps in a solemn silence. Her shining cross, flapping veil and ornaments of her clothes, embroidered in gold, were shining in the sun like beams in the brims of a prism. She started climbing up the steps slowly, and the higher she was climbing, the clearer her veil was shining. But now she climbed on the seventh step – and as though a golden fog covered her entire figure. She turned her face to the crowd, raised her hands and blessed her children to whom she had dedicated her entire life, love and work.

After a while, still covered by the golden cloud, she disappeared in the chapel.

"Now also you can climb up here, friends," I. addressed the crowd again. "Don't be afraid of anything. The invisible fire won't burn anybody. Simply everybody will put his flower where he will be able to climb."

The people began to go towards the stair one after another, but a rare one of them was able to put his flower higher than the third step. A pile of flowers was next to the first step and below it. About then flowers were placed on the fourth step, and only two flowers were placed for the fifth and sixth steps. And the people who put them there were climbing down by fainting from the heat of the invisible fire, as once I was fainting while climbing up to the chapel together with Radanda...

I. entered the chapel, he took the flower from the Great Mother's hands and gave it to mother Anna. She left the chapel with this flower, blessed her children again, this time by holding the flower in her blessing hand, she went downstairs and went towards the dining-room by leading the whole crowd.

I. told everybody who were standing on the stair steps, except me and Gregor, to follow mother Anna by saying that a small business was still waiting for us, and that then we would join them soon.

"Bring Demetrius here," he told me as soon as the final group of the leaving ones disappeared at the bend.

I couldn't imagine where Demetrius could be now, but I. pointed to me at the circle of fire that was burning at the bend of the avenue. Having run to that place, I saw Demetrius who was sitting on the ground with his back against a palm trunk. His hands covered his face, and hot tears were streaming down his hands and clothes.

"Demetrius, my friend. Teacher I. is calling you. You cannot cry. Now you are sitting next to such a place where Life-Joy Himself has given the sign of eternal absolution and hope to people. Only the law of compassion and mercy is operating in this place. Calm down, take my hand, be happy that Teacher is calling you. But if joy doesn't surpass your fear, regret and all other powers and thoughts, then you won't hear anything, and the Teacher's call will be to no purpose."

I wiped his tears away how I could, and I tried to inspire him with the energy of my heart. Demetrius was touched by my efforts, he smiled and whispered.

"Ah, brother, I am so guilty before heaven, the earth and myself – while you are so kind and pleasant to me."

"You will find out what it means "to be kind" only when you approach Teacher I., although you've already experienced enough kindness next to Radanda," I answered him.

The nearer we were coming to the chapel hand in hand, the brighter Demetrius's face became. When we approached the stair, I. went downstairs and put his hands on kneeling Demetrius's head. Having called Gregor, I. told him to put his hands on his hands and uttered.

"I am your protection, my friend. Don't be afraid of anybody anywhere anymore in the same way as you weren't afraid of the villains who were chasing you across the desert till this oasis. Feel strongly that you are always not alone. The aspects of the Only One which you possess within yourself haven't awakened within you yet, so you cannot feel that confidence which is characteristic to the people who always and everywhere feel in God's presence, as His messengers for help and realization of His work on the suffering and sad earth. Those are fearless messengers who have forgotten about themselves and who know only His will. But you can always feel my and Gregor's hand in your hand, who will be your future chief. By leaning on this loving hand, you can go through your day without any fear, no matter in what frames of the external surroundings your spiritual creation would be framed. But if only several ideas remain from everything what you hear and see, what you comprehend and take away from your communication with the people of high spiritual culture, which are lost in your mind to no purpose, and if your life's activity and work is still running on the same rails of fear, doubts, compromises and hesitations – then you won't become man-disciple, although you would hear Teacher's call several times. Not Teacher is sending tests for his disciple by testing him in one or another way, but Life – through the Bright Brotherhood – calls man to the disciples by tempering him with one or other tests. Through these tests man himself has an opportunity to test himself and to comprehend on which step of his spiritual temple he is standing. Check yourself, my friend, your unshakable loyalty, fearlessness and joyfulness. If you can always feel my and Gregor's hand in yours, you don't need to fear anything – you will be everywhere thinking about the man or the people for whom you will be taking part in one or other events, and not about yourself, your fears, your conveniences or troubles. If you encountered a man and didn't think about

him that he was only a case, inside of whom the Only One's life is concentrated; if at the same time you didn't remember yourself how you had to greet him with your shining fire by holding such pure and strong Light of your heart that you would look like a clear vase of marble in which the eternal fire is burning, then think that you didn't encounter the man and that you let my hand go yourself. If you accepted a man in your home – and you know whom you accepted – and evaluated him as a support sent to you, as help for your merits and diligence in social work, as a personal help for your mode of life, and if you didn't create joyous life for him by forgetting that not he was sent to you, but you were given to him for help and protection, so that he would learn to smile next to you and become free from fear; if on one beautiful day Life took a whip in his hands and lashed your circumstances with it, which made your spirit stamp in vain in one place, if Life decided to give an opportunity to you to correct your wrong point of view and behaviour with your encountered person whom you sheltered, and you responded to him with your tears, fear, complaints and melancholy by evaluating newly all the circumstances as your personal ones – then you've already rolled down that step on which you had climbed up, and my hand cannot raise you anymore, because your spirit has fenced itself off with a hood of itself by throwing away all saint ideas which you respected, from which you became lighter, with you admired. Go, my friend. Think well about everything what I told you now and hold my and Gregor's hands even stronger. Come back to Radanda. Bring him a great gratitude for his work and help from us all and tell him what you've seen here with your own eyes."

I. helped Demetrius to stand up, he pressed him to himself, and he gave a shout by looking with his fascinated eyes round the blazing temple and the stair, the burning ground and its underground world, shining in fire.

"Oh, Teacher," Demetrius gave a cry, "what does it all mean? Everything is burning in bonfires of flames. The flame is bubbling under the ground like lave, trees and flowers are blazing – and everything remains unburnt! And you are burning, Teacher, and your friends are burning, and my clothes are burning, but I am alive, and this fire doesn't injure me. What is it?"

"This is that fire which Life gives to people as help and a sign of uniting of the entire Universe which is made of one matter. Come back to Radanda, tell him what you've seen and go in the way as he will instruct you until I come back to his Community and give you directly under Gregor's guardianship. Here, Yassa comes hurriedly to us. He will help you to harness the new camel and he will be riding with you to Radanda."

I. blessed Demetrius and Yassa, he told them to ride out immediately and give his letter to Radanda, which he told me to take from his room and to give it to Demetrius. I also received one more of his commands: to see off the travellers to their distant way and only then to come to the dining-room where I. himself was going now, instantly.

Having said good-bye to I., Demetrius and Yassa went to the stables to pick and harness their camels; I went to I's room for the letter, and I found it on the table, and next to it a small box was standing, also dedicated for Radanda.

Having taken both, I also turned towards the stables, but on the way, I met one of the watchmen of the oasis whom Yassa sent to me. Yassa asked me to wait for him by the gates, because they still had to change into travelling clothes and to take their food ration for the journey. I had enough time to pack the parcel for Radanda nicely and to prepare a light and convenient basket with fruit for the travellers.

While waiting for my friends, I was sitting on the bench silently by glancing through some pages of the past in my thoughts and partly, also my meeting with Radanda. A thought crossed my mind about the constant people's dissatisfaction of one with another and their complaints that their fellow

creature gets on their nerves or annoys them with his unbearable stupidity by disturbing their joyful and successful day.

I imagined Radanda, such a high guardian, and a smile slipped through my lips when I asked myself: "Could Radanda feel any annoyance for a sinner who disturbed his great spiritual tranquillity?"

And once again I went through and meditated upon I.'s words: "An encounter – that's you."

Heavy camel's steps were heard, two Bedouins rode up to the gates, and I could hardly recognize Demetrius and Yassa. Having given Radanda's parcel to Demetrius and tied the basket with fruit to Yassa's saddle, I sincerely wished a good journey for the travellers. I was standing by the gates for a long time until the desert dust hid I.'s messengers from my eyes and then I hurried to the dining-room.

Chapter 32

I.'s farewell speech with the dwellers of Mother Anna's oasis. Coming back to Radanda's Community and the first joint supper. I.'s precepts for those who were leaving and for those who stayed. The chapel of sadness. Gregor's, Vasilyon's Bronski's and Igor's departure to Dartran's oasis. Andreyeva's and Oldenkot's departure to America

I came to the dining-room just in time. The dinner was already over, and I. rose to talk to the dwellers of the oasis for the last time, as I understood from his speech. Having examined everybody with his attentive look, as though he sent his blessing for everyone separately and he began to speak.

"I've met you many times during this time in this hall, we've discussed about many thoughts here. Soon I and my coworkers will leave you. Does it mean that separation of our physical bodies won't allow us to communicate spiritually, that by continuing our own development we will lose the possibility to help develop those friends from whom our physical bodies are torn away? I've already told you that the most powerful of all effective man's strengths – that's his thought. If a man has achieved his self-control, his thoughts got smooth. They don't jump in any zigzags anymore which torment an intemperate man. For self-control of the man who doesn't control himself, everything is injurious, any smallest external obstacle. The man who has achieved an absolute self-control can control his thoughts in the same calm way, without worrying for any distance, as he can control his speech by communicating physically. But for this also the purity of his devotion to those is required to whom he is sending his thoughts, as well as his complete liberation, and you know that liberation and joy – they are synonyms. But to know theoretically, in the level of thoughts and ideas – that still doesn't mean to know for real. Only that knows the essence of the Truth who is acting with Her, for Her and in Her presence. The man who used to act with the Truth stops dividing everything in two worlds – of the earth and heaven; only one new world exists for him then, the one made of the merged heaven and earth in which he is living, thinking and acting. Only then the man can pass into this mentality when he was living for a long time already by drawing both himself and his encountered person to act in two living worlds – the one of heaven and the earth. This preparatory period which brings every living being into the life of the merged world, into the actions of the joint creation of the Entire Only One World lasts for her as long as she needs it along the way which leads her into the integrity of her thoughts. Vague, not mediated till the end ideas lead the man into a cloudy, compromise existence. While a seized pinch of some strange thoughts and ideas, not experienced as a daily experience, brings irretrievable disasters into the man's life. He is "searching" for a kingdom of happiness, he cannot find it externally, he is complaining and feeling unhappy, he accuses the closest people from his surroundings of inability to live in peace with him, while actually, he is unable to create the peace within himself and to give Her to his own people. In the noisy crowds of people to which many of you will leave together with me, always search for the beginning and the end of your unsuccessful communication with people within yourselves. While those

who stay in this pure and wonderful corner, remember how I explained the power of thought. Don't forget those with whom you part today. By training the integrity of your thought send the power of your ability to think in the new way, continuously till the end to your leaving friends. Don't think that you can start cooperating with your Teacher only because your Teacher is calling you. "Many are being called, but not many are chosen," – it was told about it a long time ago already. Well imagine, if someone from you received your Teacher's instruction or a task in one or another way and, instead of dedicating his every minute of time for work with yourself, of constantly striving for the greatest integrity of your thoughts and turning your concentrated thought into an action, you would start looking round and talking: "Of course, I cannot live peacefully with these or other people. And I cannot live with them not because I don't have enough peace in my heart. I am peaceful, but the people who are living next to me don't support me. A single commanding word would be enough to tell them, and those rude people with whom I must communicate every day would become very peaceful and polite with me. And of course, then it wouldn't be difficult for me to live in peace with them." You are laughing. I could laugh with you too, if my given example of the spiritual poverty wasn't very frequent among the ordinary citizens in those countries to which you will be travelling with me. Such people there consider themselves as "following" their Teacher and "respecting" Him, and you are destined to develop the real culture of spirit there...

Now I address you who stay in the oasis. It is absolutely not important for the cultural growth of the universe that the mankind that is living now, that is so distant for you, doesn't know about you absolutely anything. Your role, as well as the role of every historical phenomenon that has influence on the growth of people's culture, is hidden from the modern mankind's eyes till a certain time. But soon – of course, soon not on the scale of this earth where a short period of a hundred years is called a century – you will step on the stage of life as creators and characters. The desert around you soon will turn green with some cultured plants, and cities will grow nearby. Your oasis will become a big and beautiful city, the centre of high civilization. And what about you? How do you have to live during this preparatory period while you are doing your work with joy, whom the eyes of other nations cannot see, but whom God's eyes can see? Wisdom doesn't have an influence externally; I've already mentioned it many times. But She doesn't penetrate into the depths of spirit too. She is living there. Only man himself can awaken Her within himself. And only the man himself is the limit for his own Light. In this hour we came to push you towards the external civilization. To help you to colonize the area of the desert soil for the needs and goals of the new mankind that Life will bring here. Your cooperation with Life – that's to take part in His construction for the new mankind, to prepare such new external conditions of civilization in which the future generations could develop high psychic powers, to penetrate deeper into the nature's secrets and to develop the stunning activity of its strengths for people's benefit and prosperity. Not you are destined to carry to the external world the new values which Life gives to people. You are only destined to prepare the field for His future revelations. But is your work, your cooperation with Life less significant because of it? Answer this question yourselves. Master the first rule of the people who want to keep abreast with their nation, with their time: no small businesses exist. Any business is either an assertion of life – and then it is a cooperation with God, or a melancholic thought about yourself, that is a negation, an incomprehension of the main law of one's existence on the earth: everything is inside of you, everything is for everybody's prosperity, because everything is love. The existence of the man who doesn't comprehend this law is a pure ignorance and egoism. Follow your mother Anna as you were doing up to now, in a bright, joyous and peaceful way. But add an absolute comprehension to your everyday tasks: to live on the earth means to take part in the Only One's work actively. To live means to assert every moment. And only that one asserts who has mastered the law of kindness and who can pour calm around himself. We leave tomorrow. Life leaves for you the chapel of Ringing Joy built by our hands. Appreciate it not as a help for you, but your recognition as Life's coworkers, as His loyal friends, as protectors and pioneers of the new spiritual principles for the future generations life."

I. left the table, and he was talking to the dwellers of the oasis still for a long time. People surrounded all of us as well, and every one of them was trying to express their gratitude and regret, because we were leaving so soon. On this day our hosts didn't want to part with us in any way. I. offered to go to the new part of the park and once again to admire all new miracles of the art which now embellished the oasis as the new, grand buildings.

Surrounded by a big crowd of people we were walking after I. and mother Anna for a long time by watching the new buildings which looked wonderfully in the thicker verdure. Then a group of children approached I. from somewhere, and I heard one girl's question.

"Teacher, but you haven't yet fulfilled what you've promised, and you are about to leave tomorrow. How could it be? If you promised her – that's sacred, isn't it? However difficult it would be, but you need to do it. You cannot leave tomorrow in any way."

I. took the girl in his arms and asked her by laughing.

"What haven't I fulfilled what I had promised, my baby?"

The crowd stunned with the girl's question became quiet, and everybody could hear the little childish voice clearly.

"How could you forget about it. You promised your statue for us, didn't you? Everybody was even arguing: some of them wanted to put it by the gates, the others in the hospital, we, children, wanted it in the school, while you, by wishing to reconcile everybody, decided to leave your portrait on the gates. You cannot leave in any way until you don't keep your word."

I. was still laughing merrily, but what was going on round here! The people who had already completely forgotten about their request as though became ashamed for such oblivion. Some of them accused themselves of their oblivion, the others – for ingratitude, the third ones were begging him to stay and to fulfil his promise. It was difficult even to imagine that this peaceful oasis which was fearless and calm in the most tragic and terrible moments, which could hear out the facts of colossal significance with a complete self-control, could suddenly change into such a stormy sea.

Having raised his hand up and at the same time by asking the crowd to calm down and become silent, I. uttered.

"In this hour every one of you has received a couple of lessons. First – how easy it is to lose your external self-control and how it is harmful for your inner balance. And the second lesson – how it is bad to look only at the ground and rarely raise your eyes to the sky. If you had been looking more often at the wonderful constellation of the Cross which is shining straight above your lighthouse, you would have noticed that my promised statue was already standing in its place. The girl reminded you about my portrait to which you attach so great importance now. And if this baby's lips hadn't reproached me for my promise, then probably, you wouldn't have raised your eyes up to the lighthouse soon enough by searching for my figure there; although I believe you that it is very important for you. Let's go, and you will make sure that Teacher keeps his word: let my image realize one of the laws of the honour code for you: if you gave your word – keep it. If you promise something to somebody, and then it will turn out that it is impossible to fulfil it – look at my image, imagine that I am alive, that I am standing next to you, and tell yourselves: "Lord, it is easy for me!"

While carrying the girl in his arms, I. turned to the old part of the park. The way wasn't near, it was growing dark, and when his led crowd approached the lighthouse, the constellation of the Cross was already burning brightly in the dark sky.

Many times I had been a witness of I.'s performed "supernatural" phenomena. And every time they still surprised me in one or another way. Also on this evening the gigantic heroic dead of his will and work stunned me.

I.'s statue was standing at full length on the top of the same lighthouse – and I remembered its height well, because I was climbing myself the innumerable steps of its stair. How big it had to be that it would look like the one of the natural height of the man from the ground?!

And after all, was that a "statue"? That was alive I. with white clothes, embroidered in gold, with orange cloak on his shoulders, with the five-pointed star in his raised hand. And that star... was burning so brightly as her shining sisters in the sky...

The crowd was standing in silence, and it was looking at the inexpressible view. And as though by waving with a miraculous hand, everybody fell on their knees, while the seven of us, I. and mother Anna began to sing the hymn of the Masters of power. When we finished singing it, I. told silently to the kneeling crowd.

"Learn this hymn from mother Anna and sing it in the most solemn occasions of your life. Let it symbolize only happiness to you: to live by asserting Life!"

I. embraced mother Anna who stood up first. Then he was blessing every dweller, and to each kiss of his hand as a farewell he responded with a kiss to their heads.

I. didn't utter a single word about his departure, but everybody understood that Teacher said good-bye to them in this way and that they wouldn't see this wonderful man maybe for a very very long time.

Everybody's eyes were wet when I. uttered his last words.

"Now you will go to your rooms, and many of you will go to sleep, so that you would wake up tomorrow for your ordinary, daily work. Some of you will find your travelling clothes when you come back. They will change their clothes and come here again, so that they would start their new life, torn away from their old habits, full of new, unexpected and unknown things. But all of it – that's only the external side. While everybody will be carrying power, essence and Life himself within themselves. And only that is important for the man of the earth. Remember it and be happy and joyous, my children."

It was already after midnight when the last dwellers of the oasis, blessed and embraced by I. left.

"Farewell, mother Anna. Let me thank you for your shown hospitality. Say good-bye to us here and show an example to your children – don't accompany us."

One after another, all of us came up to the patroness of the oasis, and she said a word of her love for farewell to every one of us, which hit everyone's sensitive spot especially accurately. She said to me.

"Your communicating with people stopped being "difficult" for you a long time ago already. Now sometimes your heart still aches with regret when you need to utter a stricter word to your close person. But that will pass, too. Remember that regret and mercy don't have anything in common. Mercy – that's the law of regret. And it is eternal. While the regret – that's a superstition, because the conditionalities of the earth give birth to it. And not a compassion is expressed with it, but only an imaginary, false love, that is sentimentality."

Having accompanied mother Anna up to her house, we came back to our rooms, and for the first time during our stay here in the oasis I saw... Slava. Slava overtook Yassa's duties. My God! Not long ago I was surprised that the small girl reminded to the crowd of people about so desired I.'s statue. I didn't understand how thousands of people could forget about the Teacher's portrait which they desired so much. And what about myself? I forgot, I completely forgot about the living man with whom I was riding together the entire way across the desert, and I crossed the threshold of mother Anna's oasis together with him! Where was Slava during this entire long time? Had he come back to the Radanda's Community? Or was he living somewhere here, separated?

To my perplexed look and total petrification Slava replied with a merry laughter, he showed me the clothes prepared for the journey and uttered.

"Such is my place in our interrelationship – to amaze you constantly with surprises, my brother. Perhaps I will have a chance on the way to tell you how and where I was studying during that time. I told you that Teacher I. would take me with himself and that I would enter one of the universities, didn't I? But dress quickly. The camels are already waiting by the gates of the oasis. It is an enormous caravan. I brought two hundred camels from Radanda alone, apparently, we will take as many of them from here."

He helped me to dress in pretentious clothes and to pick up my belongings quickly and deftly, he ran round my friends even faster and, having inspected everything everywhere no worse than Yassa, he visited me again. Together with him I went downstairs to the dear hall for the last time where everybody till the last had already been gathered. Soon I. came and we followed him till the gate. The first group of the caravan from the leaving dwellers of the oasis was already prepared here. We were delayed for more than two hours until the people were seated, and a row of camels lined up behind the gate.

The whole caravan was divided into seven groups. I. was riding first, and in front of every group – one of us. I was riding with the last group, and Slava – in the end of the caravan. On the midway a big company from the people of Radanda's Community met us, whom I. divided also into seven parts by entrusting our groups to them, so that now they would be occupied with the people whom we took from mother Anna and then they would be taking care of them in the Radanda's oasis itself. When we left mother Anna's, the dawn was coming soon, and when we rode across the desert successfully and safely and we saw the gate of Radanda's Community, it was growing dark already.

As after my first visit, when accompanied by I. I rode in through the wide gate of the Community and I instantly saw sweet Radanda's face with the smile of unforgettable kindness, - also now the first was this old man's look who responded to my look. As soon as I got down on the ground, he didn't allow me even to bow before him, but he extended his little, dry hand above my head, kissed my forehead and uttered.

"Well, you came back to me, friend. Much, oh how much of everything I will tell you and pass to you what is told me to add to your knowledge and power. And I know everything about you, you can not tell me anything. You can not tell and demonstrate your love by any external means," Radanda laughed merrily and continued. "But excuse me for your other friend! Any of my pedagogical talents will help you to avoid his exactingness. Anyway, he isn't a man, but only a bird, although he is much more intelligent than thousands of his biped brothers," Radanda finished by laughing in the same joyous way.

Having torn my look away from the wonderfully shining Radanda's eyes, I was amazed how big Eta who was standing next to the chief became and with what beauty he was shining. With his wonderful, golden stretched out train the peacock was standing motionless and he was looking at me amazed, not recognizing me in this new, changed form. But if Eta was amazed at my appearance, then no less was I amazed when I saw the image above his shining, little head. I could clearly see there such portrait

of mine as I was when I left Radanda's Community almost two years ago. Although they already nicknamed me Goliath also back then, but then I hadn't yet grown as much to the top and width as now. And not only that amazed me. I could see all the efforts of mental work of my dear bird as the sequence of the images which were changing one after another. Eta's amazement revealed itself as the fight of two of my images in his consciousness. Now he would refuse to recognize my current form, now he was ready to dash at me and drown me in his feathered armful. Finally, without being able to comprehend anything, he turned to Radanda by demanding him for a help and explanation.

"So that's what a sceptic you are, my brother," the chief answered Eta by smiling calmly. "I was explaining to you every day that the time was running and sweeping away the past, wasn't it? And that past didn't exist anymore. While you are thinking about a man what he was, he already had time to change in everything and he has forgotten himself completely what he was. Loyalty is namely formed from the ability to accept all your friend's changes and send your love and tranquillity to him. That is him, Lyovushka, your friend and master. You should greet him joyously, while you are standing and solving the question: what has happened here that my friend came in a new form?"

Radanda was speaking, while the bird's eyes became calm. Suddenly, some light flashed in the chaos of the fight between two of my figures above his head, everything disappeared for a moment, and one figure came to light, which corresponded to my current appearance. Eta gave a cry, he forgot all his good training, he clasped my head with his wings, he pulled both the helmet and hood from it, he was tousling my hair, as though he recognized only it as the real distinctive sign of his old friend.

However I was used to lifting heavy weight, however well I evaluated the big Eta's height for his species – anyway, his weight surprised me. I seated him on my shoulder with great difficulty and I had to carry him like this till the very home, because I could feel that no persuasions would make him part with me in this hour.

Radanda told me to hurry to I. and to occupy my previous duty of his secretary, only now I wouldn't need to serve him anymore and I would have a brother and disciple for this duty to make easier.

Since my group was the last one to come, then I didn't see who met the previous groups except Radanda, where and how they tenanted our accompanied people. Not only grown-ups, but also children met my group, they met us as their best friends and let us in all directions after Radanda greeted everyone with a pleasant word.

I hurried to I. I understood that he settled in the same little house where we were living before our departure. It was exactly like this. Life was already boiling here, people used to come in and out energetically, the door of the rooms in which our friends settled again were closing and opening repeatedly, and I saw Demetrius among many local dwellers whom I had seen before, who entered Gregor's room.

When I approached the door of my cell, it opened, and I. was standing on the threshold. He had already washed himself and changed into the wonderful, white clothes.

"Aren't you ashamed, Eta, to burden your tired friend so much after the journey?" I. asked the bird merrily.

Eta jumped down from my shoulder, he bowed low to Teacher, he stretched out his head to his hand, as if by asking for his forgiveness and blessing.

"Ah, clear head," I. was speaking by smiling. He mended the feathers of his little crest carefully. "But see, don't ride on Lyovushka anymore, it is time already for you to ride him."

Eta bowed even lower to I., he stood next to me with dignity like a loyal guard. I. looked my dusty clothes up and down; he nodded his head with reproach and uttered.

“How did Yassa miss you here? He had to meet you by the gate and accompany you to the bath. He prepared clean clothes for you.”

Light, urgent steps were heard – that was Yassa running.

“Forgive me, Teacher. The joker Eta is to blame for everything. I saw how he was running to the gate, and I told him to accompany Lyovushka right to me. He promised it to me by nodding his head three times, but he didn’t keep his promise. I am three times to blame,” Yassa was speaking.

“Of course, Yassa, man is always to blame when he is trying to pass his received task to the other one. But I cannot see any reason for your sad voice. Only pay better attention that no petty things exist. You’d rather take Lyovushka faster. We will go already; I will be waiting for you and him in the little watchmen house. Also Mulga will be there, you will leave the bird to him. Try to order as soon as possible,” I. also added.

This time Yassa didn’t have to linger with me. I didn’t feel any tiredness, I was cheerful and fresh, as though I hadn’t been riding all day across the desert. When Yassa gave the clothes embroidered with gold which I. was wearing to me, I looked at him so stunned that Yassa burst out laughing.

“Aren’t you thinking, Lyovushka, that I could fulfil I.’s order inaccurately for the second time? Dress without any doubts, it is the present for you from the Masters of power. And so that you wouldn’t forget about your eternal bond with them, the Master of the Masters gives the ring to you which you will find in the pocket of your clothes.”

I put the wonderful clothes on, I thought how they obligated me, and I was inspecting the ring of the Master of the Masters with respect. An unusual excitement covered my heart. A white reddish jewel was fixed in gold, in which the laboratory of the elements was engraved. The words were cut in the inner side of the ring: “A joyous man is carrying a living Life, and he draws to it everybody whom he encounters. Live like this until the next encounter.”

When we approached the watchmen house, Mulga and the new watchman took Eta from us, while I., Radanda and all my friends with whom I was studying in the Masters’ laboratory were already waiting for me in the doorway of the dining-room. The door of the dining-room opened wide, and first what I saw in the hall was the dark giant Dartran’s face.

Radanda seated all of us at his table in the same way as we were seated during our first arrival. Again, brothers started carrying the food according to the chief’s sign. Again, a solemn silence was prevailing in the big hall. And again, Radanda was pretending that he was eating zealously from his almost empty, small platter. So much of everything inexpressible had happened in my life and in lives of all the people who were sitting here now! And again, I was here, as though that passed time, journeys, events, unforgettable visit of mother Anna’s oasis hadn’t even existed...

Anna... this name in my memory associated with another charming face, with another unique voice, with Constantinople, Ananda and with the new obligation for mother Anna – with my promise to bring her assistant and liberator to her...

I. touched my hand lightly, and I understood that I needed to plunge into this passing by “now” and not into what would happen with all my heart. I gave a smile to I. by confessing that I was no less to blame than Eta.

I really couldn't eat. After the Masters food also the bread with milk at mother Anna's seemed to be too heavy, it was difficult to get used to it. The hot soup that looked like a splendid dish to me not so long ago, affected my smell negatively, and I couldn't even taste it. My friends had more luck, and they pretended successfully to be eating with relish. Like sometime before, the brother who was serving our table took the soup from me and gave a dish with different fruit to me, for which I thanked him very sincerely and I started eating without any insincere appetite.

Having met I.'s look accidentally, I saw some sparkles of humour in his eyes, but when I looked at his small platter, I responded to him with the same: there was the same fruit salad as by me...

I directed my look at Dartran who was sitting at the adjacent table with his face directed to me. Have I changed so much, or this giant? His face which looked stony and indiscernible during our first acquaintance, which was protecting his inner world from a strange look like a stony armour, now looked clear like a vase made of the dark marble in which all his thoughts were shining, and it was full of the powerful joy. Dartran, old man Dartran, the oak of ages, looked young to me now. I could see not his external destiny; I was reading the pages of his Eternity. Apparently, he also was looking at me with absolutely different eyes, because I couldn't see the careful protection with which he was looking at me in his oasis. I could discern only joy in them, as if he had been sending a call of victory to me.

The supper was over. Brothers gathered the last dishes. Radanda stood up, bowed to I., and his silent, clear voice began to ring in even greater silence, although it seemed to be absolute before.

"Teacher, today you came to see us again. And this visit of yours brings liberation for many of us. Once you brought many of us here, but many more people you took from here and you will take them into the distant, wide world. Please tell us how and whom you will appoint as your assistants and colleagues.

Radanda sat down, I. stood up, and again, only even stronger this time, the whole hall brightened up from the light of the beams which was spreading from him.

"My friends, you were waiting for my coming back as for "a miracle". Also now you are waiting that I will start "choosing" you, that I will take those whom I will like, whom I will consider to be "prepared" for the new life, to be precise, for the new form of work. Your chief was trying to explain to you many times that the Teacher's call isn't a choice. If a disciple is prepared – also his Teacher is prepared for him. If the man's spirit is prepared and matured – also the new form of work and activity is prepared for him. No one can "lead" a man, the man is walking himself. And according to that how the man is walking himself, his Teacher can respond to him by illuminating – with one or another power – the horizon of his spiritual path. If some passion is still burning inside of someone of you, however disguised it would be, he cannot leave with me to that wide world in which covered and opened passions are blazing, because his personal passion which doesn't reveal itself in any way externally, but which is smouldering deep in his heart will burst into flame instantly, as soon as it encounters the surrounding flame. The work under those conditions of life of the world which all of you once left, persecuted by your own passions, may be fruitful only when you don't need to think about yourselves anymore, when there isn't any interest in your person anymore and when the energy of joy is ringing in your heart that now you already live freely, easily and simply under any conditions by taking care only of the work which the Only One Master of the Earth tells you to do. Every man who starts cooperating with other people in big, densely populated cities can and must open an absolutely new page of his activity in his mentality, in which there isn't any sense of narrowminded "happiness" from one or another realization of his dreams, from the personal level of his livelihood and career left anymore. That one who becomes a real man, that is who is walking with his opened spirit through the ages, that one cannot help seeing that the entire mankind is walking down the path of development, that all their power grows ten times from everyone's aspiration for kindness and

universal welfare. Such man starts uniting only with the essence in man, and everyone's ability to unite with his close person in such a way is the first talent which the man develops by liberating his spirit from his personal passions and outbursts. He embraces the entire Universe with his entire consciousness and he is creating a peaceful Community for it. You – those who want to go with me to serve people as a step to their spiritual progress – you aren't just "people", but you are also disciples. You must possess not only the talent of uniting of kindness, you don't have another path anymore as only joy to perceive that you are engines, the new spiritual engines dedicated to destroy the superstitions of the cycle of the habitual people's conceptions. Our striving to the distant worlds – that's normal and usual way of our thinking. From the very first steps in the strange society of the modern culture you will encounter two most difficult expressions of your egoism: solitude and exactingness for people. Do you comprehend how widely, how strongly, without any hesitations the Living Joy, the living perception must live within you so that no solitude may exist for you, disciples? The creative union with the Only One fills the disciple's heart every second so much that there isn't any place for his thoughts and feelings about himself left, but only one thought is left: my every business is the business of That One Who has sent me to the earth. My path – that's His movement, and if my personality has squeezed my heart in this moment – His business has been broken off through me... Check yourselves during these last days in the Community. Open the depths of your spiritual treasures yourselves, dig all the remains of your personal feelings and self-love, and delve deeply into my words: not I choose you, but you are walking to your heart's call where no other incentives exist as only to be the God's servant. That one for whom at least the slightest thought will flash: "He has received more Teacher's or people's attention than me;" that one who will think: "It is difficult to live alone on the earth;" that one whose eyes already can see the panorama full of his pride before himself: "I will help the mankind," – all those stay here, don't go with me to the flames of people's passions and blood, because you haven't yet thrown off the mask of your own "I". Only after reaching the living Love, that is by carrying it for everyone, man stops being alone, because this conception disappears from his spiritual horizon. When you are living among people with this point of view, you can destroy everyone's superstition about his solitude and bring him into the circle of the new, joyous conceptions, change the previous cycle of his ideas with them, in which the man suffering from solitude was living. The first result of man's moral narrowness when he is feeling alone is the moral degeneration – his exactingness for others. First of all, his exactingness for those who were trying and who agreed to share his solitude. If that's a friendship – then this friendship has some hidden claws of jealousy, a desire to serve as "everything" for his friend. If that's love – that's love that objects to the most elementary human perception that it is a rendering of light and tranquillity and not a desire to receive everything what is the best. The feeling of ownership – that's the first stimulus of man's devotion to the captivity of passions. Fear threatens man in thousands of different versions and thoughts, and it complicates his everyday communication with his friend, with society, with his colleagues by displaying scarecrows that exist for everyone only in his own consciousness: "I will lose", "they will be fascinated", "I don't get enough attention", "he or she will be ill, will be overtired, will leave me", "I will lose my position and career." Fear clasps all man's spiritual strengths within himself, and in the same way, it clasps a circle around the man. No communication is possible for you with your Teacher and your Teacher through you if you've allowed fear to enter your heart. Fear has taken possession of nearly all the people in those cities where you will have to work for the people's welfare, and they are unable to work by standing in Eternity's presence. Now and here understand what a liberation you must achieve, so that they could say about you: "These people are prepared for their Teacher's work, their spirit neither becomes anxious nor rebels when they communicate with the people enslaved by their passions. These people possess the talent to recognize, their "kindness" is an ability to see the Only One in everyone..." Throw not only the absurd thoughts about your shyness off yourselves, but also all your thoughts about the difference between your culture and the culture of those people and places where you will be going. Only one culture exists for you – to carry tranquillity to all hearts, however big the differences of development and civilization between you and the people standing before you would be, however deeply you would

perceive that the heart who is communicating with you is still sleeping in a deep and dense ignorance – destined for her with respect to the real path of the earth – and who absolutely doesn't comprehend the meaning of her incarnation. Don't be afraid of any horrible external events of the nations in the rhythm of life of which you will be destined to become involved, because no separate rhythm of one nation, torn out of the joint life of the universe, exists for you. The only one rhythm – the one of Life of the Great Mother – exists for you. Start the day of your work and love among people, to whom you will leave together with me, filled with this rhythm, with your hearts and thoughts directed to the distant worlds. But if at least for a moment you allow a longing to enter that not always you will be carrying the feat of your work next to me, physically next to me, that not always you will be able to tell me your thoughts, to hear my advice out, to have me as a physical colleague who give cheerfulness, - then don't go with me, stay here, behind the protective wall where the racketing streams of grief and mode of life of the people's crowd may penetrate. Everyone who is going together with me must search not for my help, but to open the aspect of the Only One within himself and with them enter the rhythm of the Only One Master of the Earth, enter that rhythm with which He is working for the Earth herself, for whom you, disciples, colleagues and brothers "are prepared". Not a single man is able to open at least the smallest perception of the universal life for his encountered person and his own responsibility until he hasn't developed himself the habits to live only with the rhythm of the universe. I've been telling you thousand times that you can give only that what possess yourselves. Otherwise, all your efforts to bring calm and comfort for a man will be futile, they will be only reasoning for your mind, the words released to the ether without any sense and goal where there is enough rubbish also without them. Some of you still have time to overcome the remainders of the passions which restrict your spirit. The others need to solve the question right now and in the main how to become involved in the Only One's work on the earth, because the first party led by Gregor and Bronski will leave for Dartran's oasis in two days. You will be living there for as long as your new chiefs will decide, you will be studying that and as much as it will seem necessary for them, and only after they will instruct, you will leave together with them to the distant and unknown lands to you. I remind everyone once again: "Everything is within yourselves." Man must feel great assistance within himself, independent of his place, his surroundings, his obligations and external conditions. And only those from you who have gotten rid completely of your weakness and desire to search another protection and help for yourselves and not for the Only One within yourselves, only those will be able to be the servants and colleagues of their Teacher and through Him of the Only One Master of the Earth. Always feel that the image of your Teacher who is working next to you, who is alive, who loves and who is living in the rhythm of the Great Life, accepts every expiration of your love and shares your joy to live with your work of uniting with the living workers of heaven and of the earth. Everything is unity, no gaps exist, there's only one Community of the world, and the Great Bright Brotherhood invites you to become its members."

I. bowed to all who were listening to him, he bowed to Radanda and he gave the sign to leave the dining-room. When everybody left, I. called Dartran who greeted us as sincerely loved friends.

"Well, Dartran, the first part of your work is done. The Great Masters of power are sending their decrees and instructions to you though Bronski, Igor, Gregor and Vasilyon. You see how many messengers you have received! But it still doesn't mean that you are liberated from the future work or that the messengers will stay with you for a long time. They will carry out the revolution in your oasis, they will return the reformed kingdom to you and leave to join me in order to fulfil their worldwide tasks."

I. dismissed us all, he told me to order letters in his room and to wait until he comes back. He, Dartran and Yassa went to Radanda.

Having taken Eta from Mulga, who greeted me very pleasingly and told me that he had already received I.'s instruction to come back to Ali's Community together with him, which made him very glad, I came back to our little house. Eta was marching next to me with dignity by not disturbing the

solemnity of my mood with anything, which I.'s speech had arisen for me. Soon I heard hasty steps after me, and in several minutes, Bronski caught up with me.

"Lyovushka, my dear friend. I didn't have a chance to talk to you for a long time, since Ali's Community. I didn't have a possibility even to exchange my thoughts with you, although I was next to you, and my destiny conformed with yours. To tell you the truth, I didn't even need any words, because I felt that all my thoughts reached you, as well as yours reached me. I could feel a firsthand nearness with you, as well as with all those who are now carrying the tasks of the Bright Brotherhood for people. But also without this ideological bond, dear friend, the exceptional warmth of your heart attracts me to you. I cannot forget how warmly you used to meet me in all moments of my heartbreak, and how I could find a comforting kindness in you and not some words "about" a comfort or moral what I often used to experience in my life. Now when my whole way of thinking has changed and not even a possibility is left to think about myself and to live for myself, when we can see each other joyfully, maybe for the last time in this form, because soon I will leave with Dartran, while you will accompany I. in his further journeys around the world – I want to tell you once again what an example of cheerfulness and great calm you always were for me. Together with you we could see many divinely charming images and shining, sacred figures during this rather short time of our happy studying next to I. and the Masters of power. But I could see the result of the big work of many years of all those people. I perceived them already not as some ordinary people, but as some "super-people", as those whom we call "saint" in the private speech. No limit existed for them anymore between the ordinary world of the earth and the eternal heaven. But I couldn't comprehend how they have achieved their superhuman existence. Having met you, although neither you nor somebody else explained anything to me, I understood myself immediately which principal characteristics could lead a man to the high and bright existence of the superman, that is to the Great Bright Brotherhood. The living example of a complete integrity, an absolute purity and devotion, an absolute loyalty when not a single thought may arise in the brain of the man who is communicating with you about his injury, not only about some treason, - this living example which I comprehended when I saw you, forced me immediately to throw off the whole swamp of my doubts off my heart and to accept strongly the accuracy of always developing and changing circumstances of every man and the entire creativity. Now I take away one thing in my memory by parting with you: no accidental encounters exist, and the encounter with you will repeat again if the eternal memory about your loyalty is living in me. Let me embrace you, friend. Perhaps, we won't have an opportunity to talk the two of us anymore. I. told me with Gregor to go to Demetrius's house and to choose everybody who is prepared to come back to Dartran's oasis. I give my last regards of love to you in this small box, on the bottom of the cover of which we with Igor engraved those buildings, his and mine, which were left in mother Anna's oasis. Gregor was bursting with laughter from our childish engraving, but he was always correcting us mercifully and, in the end, he even praised us. Accept this joint present of ours and... help us. My Master of power told me that you were the strongest from us all. To tell you the truth, I didn't doubt it."

Having embraced me several times, by taking a good look at me, as though he wanted to keep my image in his optic memory for ages, Bronski kissed the box from the white reddish glass with gold granules and he gave it to me. Deeply moved by this tenderness, I uttered silently by answering my friend for this sincere embrace.

"Once you told me several times: "Where have you disappeared, Lyovushka? I missed you so much." I couldn't understand your state back then. You – such a talent of genius – looked such a rich man to me, always so full inside of you that you didn't even have time to think about something what else your creation would lack. Now I understand that the creator's happiness is namely that his heart never allows anything personal inside of him, and it is always opened for the creative flight, it lets everybody inside of him and gives all his heart to him. Once it has given it, it never forgets that encountered person anymore,

who has accepted this love. Not a boredom or a longing, but completeness of communication is necessary for the heart that has learned to give love. Stanislav, wherever you would be, whatever you would do, I will always tie the greetings for your heart and work into my first greeting of the day, into my glorification of the universe. Don't wait for the new heights immediately, but I know that when we meet next time, there will be many followers of your theatre schools in every city of the world, and the new epoch of the art will begin. Allow me to express my love to you, too. Dartran gave this cross to me as a present by charging me to pass it to that friend in whose loyalty I won't have any doubts. As though he foresaw that soon I would need such talisman. I am wearing it still only for several hours, but the sense of joy and warmth from it has already spread across my entire body. Let the joyfulness of this cross protect you during the hours of the human hostility that is looming around and remind you of your friend Lyovushka's love and devotion."

Having hugged one another again, we separated with Bronski whom Igor was already searching for by calling him in an agreed whistle from the distance. Without delay I hurried to my cell, all full of Bronski's love and impressions of our friendship, I put Eta to sleep, changed to my everyday clothes and went to I.'s room where I was instantly immersed in the ordering of a great number of letters and papers.

I didn't even notice how the night flew past, how the sun lit the desert with its first beams. The sound of the bell prevented me from working, and also I. and Yassa who entered through one door and Eta who entered through the other one.

Eta made us all laugh by bowing to everybody respectfully, according to subordination: first to I., then to Yassa and only then to me.

"Well, you didn't guess right, friend. God has destined your master to be higher than Yassa with his position on the earth," I. gave a laugh. "Remember, Eta. In people's presence he, Lyovushka, is your master, while Yassa is a worker. This is in people's presence. But they are both equal for your heart. For Lyovushka's wellbeing, Yassa must be next to him. Remember it well and protect both of them in the same way. Did you understand?" I. continued by stroking little Eta's head.

I don't know what and how Eta understood, he just looked attentively at me and then at Yassa. He went up to me and bowed low by touching the floor with his head by my feet. By not allowing me to not even to come to myself, he went up to Yassa, bowed to him, rubbed his head into his arm, then he stepped back a couple of steps, gave a trenched shriek, stretched out his train, flapped his wings and flew upon Yassa's shoulder, he embraced his head with his wings and pressed his little head tenderly to his shoulder. Having expressed his love to Yassa in such a way, which he hadn't applied to anybody till now, except me, he came back to me again, flew upon my chest and he almost suffocated me in his strong embrace by making my friends laugh from it quite a lot. Having calmed down, Eta stood by my feet by wishing to show me that he understood and remembered everything, and that this time the show was over.

"Lyovushka," I. addressed me, "I can see that you haven't yet allotted all the letters. But however important they would be, today neither you nor me will have any time anymore. Now put yourself in order, and we'll go to the dining-room. From there together with me and others you will go straight to Demetrius's house where all the emigrants from Dartran's oasis will gather, who have found strengths and desire to work. After my conversation with them, every one of you will spend the rest of the day by talking to those people who will address you by asking for an advice or wishing to ask you for something."

After a while, we were already in the dining-room and we were glad of meeting Demetrius, his mother and his sisters mathematicians whom we met by the threshold of the dining-room, talking to Radanda.

Having greeted everybody pleasingly, but not even stopping, I. went straight to the table where we sat down in our placed immediately. Everybody who was talking to Radanda also sat down at our table. Demetrius was sitting next to his mother, straight before me, and I had enough time to evaluate their changed appearance well. Now Demetrius didn't remind me of his former appearance by anything, which remained in my memory well, of that suffering messenger who was imprinted in my heart in mother Anna's oasis. Now a calm living being, controlling himself and not trying to exalt himself at all was sitting before me. He wasn't even interested in where and when he would go, where we would work, in which surroundings he would get. I could see the bright light in Demetrius's heart, several times I noticed his look fixed on I. and almost idolizing him, and I understood that the new, creative and joyous life had started for this man. It seemed that his cheerfulness was simply inexhaustible, and there wasn't a slightest patch of disappointment or fear in his aura.

His mother who was sitting next to him was his absolute opposite. I could hardly recognize that beautiful and elegant lady who accepted me in her home a couple of years ago and whom I could consider to be rather his older sister, but not his mother. Now there was not a sign left from her beauty. She was an old woman, although she was sitting straight, and her manners were still elegant. I could see that some disaster had trampled her, destroyed her entire future, and in the present, she could find neither tranquillity nor calm obedience to the inevitable circumstances. Sad, dead look of her once beautiful eyes didn't have any expression, except bitterness, depression and despair.

I fell to thinking about her destiny, about that why this incarnation of despair was going to Dartran's oasis, and suddenly I received an answer to all my questions. The look with which she looked at her son when she noticed how he was looking at I. with his idolizing eyes reflected Demetrius's admiration like in the mirror and revealed her secret. Mother who was idolizing her son experienced his renewal and becoming a disciple of Radanda, I. and Gregor as her personal drama, as a disappointment and crush of her heart. Since she loved him deeply, she didn't resist his aspirations. She stepped aside from his path, and she couldn't find a place in the universe for herself where her heart could find some work or joy for herself and join the common people's life. Failure of her personal attachment turned her into Demetrius's shadow, and everything in her path looked like a failure of her own life.

I felt very sorry for the unfortunate woman, but I understood that I couldn't do anything, so that I could make her path easier, in which she was unable to calm down without the absolute power of her idolized son. Her "I", "I", "I" was oppressing her from all sides.

I moved my look to sisters mathematicians who were sitting on the other Demetrius's side, and my heart trembled joyfully, as though I had sipped from the source of the living water. Both Rolanda and Runka were spreading the power of tranquillity, warmth and energy like some blazing flowers. Not only former discontent was already gone from the younger sister's face, not only desire to be taken care of and support from her senior sister, but as though she had torn herself forward with her spread streams of calm energy.

The breakfast was over, all of us together followed Radanda and I., and we turned to the Demetrius's home. I had to go together with Leokadia. The woman must have felt my kindness in her respect, because she went a little and uttered.

"Thank you for forgiving me and my son for that not very respectful reception in our home, although we knew that you came to us from your Teacher."

"Is it worth to remember that bad deed now which was so long ago, and which didn't leave any signs of bitterness in my consciousness? If in this moment it emerged from your memory, then it is only for you to perceive deeper and better how many times we lose important and necessary encounters for us

only because we don't take thought at all about the great meaning of our daily routine, because every of our days consists only of our encounters and preparations for them. Please, don't grieve for the past. It doesn't exist anymore; you always restore it yourself from the ashes of your psychic energies. If you could see clearly now, in this moment your spirit is growing cloudy from your heartbreak, bitterness and passions of anxiety, and how they prevent you from pouring joy and imbibing Light into yourself, which surrounds you and which is pouring into you from I. in whole rivers. But the thick peel that showed up from the hold onto only one wound from your heart: "My son has left, I don't have anything left in my life anymore," – the peel of your impenetrable egoism doesn't allow a single beam to touch your heart. Only those hearts who have achieved tranquillity are able to perceive invisible, but very effective powers of kindness which surround them. Calm down, push the thoughts about yourself that are always oppressing you away from yourself and think about your son's path if you really love him. You are creating the illusion of your motherly love, but actually, you are sinking only into instincts of your bestial love where no place for the most important human element exists: giving. Forgive me, we are almost here, and who knows if I ever meet you again and have a possibility to talk," I interrupted Leokadia who clearly wanted to object me. "If the power of your love is namely the Power of that Life which every one of us is carrying within ourselves, then be vigilant in this most serious hour of the beginning of your son's new creative life and try to find reconciliation within yourself. Only your absolute self-control, forgetting about yourself and impassivity of your thoughts and decisions while Teacher I. is here, with you, may help Demetrius to grow into a strong spiritual unity whose beautiful and pure creative path evil won't be able to ruin anymore."

We approached the Demetrius's house. I. stopped, looked every one of us up and down with his attentive look by stopping longer by Leokadia, and he began to speak with the voice full of such kindness, peace and sincere attention for each heart that I trembled joyfully, and I receive one more lesson what the Teacher's mercy was.

"Stop for a while, my dear friends, don't step the threshold of this house if you are confused and worried. Believe in the Great Father Life very strongly, put the law of Life's accuracy into your consciousness and carry such power of benevolence for people everyone in your heart, for which every one of you has matured. You cannot stand in the crossing before the beginning of every business, every encounter and every new creative impulse of your heart and think: "Where? How? What can I do?" You need to stand on the steady and fiery path: "I am carrying love by loving, I will touch my encountered person's Love with it and not the case of his body." Concentrate yourselves. You will enter the house in which people were waiting for the moment of this encounter for many years, and here everyone's of you loving and strong will may help your encountered people to win only when every one of you is absolutely loyal, that is with an absolute self-control. Only with this power of your spirit, only with the greatest strain of your love, calm, renunciation and joy to serve your own people, according to your spiritual strengths, a lucidness of everyone's of your encountered person may happen during your encounter."

We were standing in the blissful silence for several minutes, while I and my friends – I could feel it very clearly – were calling for the Masters of power, for the Great Compassion which we got to know through them, by affirming the name: "Sanat Kumara."

Finally, we moved and entered the veranda of Demetrius's house. And again, like during the first time, the noise of many voices reached my ears.

Having entered the house, I. let Radanda go forward, and then all of us entered after both Teachers. As though by being filled with I.'s words, Leokadia was trying to not step aside from me by whispering that she felt strong next to me.

I recognized Leokadia's room to which I came with sisters mathematicians for the first time. Everything was the same here, and at the same time, absolutely different. First, a lot of all sorts of wares

struck the eye, which were placed on all Leokadia's and Demetrius's tables, which were used only to treat guests up to now.

Men and women were standing behind every table, for whom the work was placed here. There was everything here! The finest lace, heaps of batiste washing and clothes, ivory wares starting from some ordinary knives till the most artistic statues, glass cups according to Gregor's and Vasilyon's models, paintings, sandals, carpets, children's toys, books, manuscripts, big fruit and vegetables...

My look couldn't even cover everything. The big room reminded me of an exhibition. But actually, it was really like that. Emigrants from Dartran's oasis met Teacher I. with the fruits of their work, every one of them presented that what they were able to create. How this day when the quiet workers were worried whether their work wouldn't look too poor for the great Teacher, didn't remind me by anything of that stormy choir of protests and negation with which Radanda was met here two years ago!

Teacher was met with low bows and the secret hope with which people were looking at I. The Teacher's image in the thoughts of all the yesterday's sinners who had gathered here associated with a severe storm, while Teacher entered as... mercy and joy.

"Hello, my friends and brothers, working for the general wellbeing. I can see that I don't need to ask you whether you fulfilled your work with joy and voluntarily. Everything what I see displayed here radiate so much energy of the efforts of your love and kindness that no questions arise anymore. You've learned to work diligently, you wanted to join the life of Radanda's Community yourselves, but... what are you afraid of? Why do you bring so much fear and doubts into this encounter with me, the meaning of which I don't deny? Your greatest friend and patron father Radanda was always telling you about fearlessness and he stated that the whole new meaning and power of your existence – that's to learn not to be afraid of anything. Not a villain's fearlessness, who kills and robs his victim if the law's eyes cannot see him; not a strong one's fearlessness, who understands that his fist hits stronger; but fearlessness of the one who knows that the whole justice is within himself, that the exterior is only the effect created by a man himself from his inner causes – namely that fearlessness to which Radanda was inviting you, to which Dartran was inviting you, to which I invite you and to which the entire Bright Brotherhood will be inviting you, in whomever person you would encounter her. Courage, my friends! Leave this horrible superstition of fear, leave the superstition of vengeance and punishment, stop feeling standing before a giant Teacher, perceive yourselves, me and everybody who live here now as the little parts of the Only One Creator, as his servants, as His creating breathing of Eternity, and no other law may exist in Eternity, except the law of love and mercy which becomes the law of cause and effect on the Earth. So what and why should you be afraid of, if everything is only within yourselves, if the Only One Everything is indivisible like the ocean from one and the same Matter of the entire Universe, divided into separate living beings, the one part of whom is called people? You look at the stars and the sun – and you can see that they are shining. Why? Only because those worlds from the same the Only One Matter as you are unreachable for your imperfections. You cannot carry your obscurantism over into them, and only that's why they don't die out from your short-sighted ignorance. Why can't you see any radiating people? Because still before meeting a man you have already hung dark sheets of the mist of your own egoism to him and first you saw this mist born by yourselves. You were searching not for the Only One within him with the most ordinary kindness of your heart, you were carrying not justification for his ignorance – you were searching for what he was lower than you, of what he was more guilty than you before the universal life, if only your way of thinking already was able to develop till feeling itself as the little part of the universe. In the worst case – you are drowning in the swampy bog of the size of the street or one hose or one apartment... Don't be sad, cheer up! No such earthly living being exists who couldn't go to development, if she perceived that no other path as the eternal evolution, the final goal of which is namely this perfection, exists for the man of the earth. Make bold. Don't stop halfway to mourn over the wrong

steps of your past. Each of such stops sticks a nagging plaster on your present. Those are learning from their mistakes who are growing with their spirit by perceiving their yesterday's insignificance. Those who have become stronger today, because they've seen their yesterday's misunderstanding or an argument with people as their mistake, and they decided not to repeat it anymore, those have grown a span today in all their businesses and encounters. Those who have poured their tears, complaints, melancholy over their yesterday's misfortune, the fate of a weed is waiting for them, which even the cattle avoid... By trying to imagine your future, don't search for any great work, high goals and dreams about the new beauty which will be flowing into everyone whom you will meet in streams of milk and honey. Think only about the flying past day, remember that its every minute – that's your flying past kindness. Meditate upon three things when you go to sleep: 1. Were you kind for every man? 2. What have you brought when you entered a man's room or house? 3. In whose name you, who know what love is, blessed your encounters, people and the entire life of the earth, the inseparable part of which you are yourselves? Observe yourselves, but observe easily. Don't be knowing and strict patrons for yourselves, in the same way as you don't want to be like this for others. The soul of every one of you – that's a tender little flower that needs tenderness and care. But you need to understand that your soul is growing, and she purifies only when you open kindness with your heart when you encounter a person, and with the efforts of your will. To submit to your will without any easiness and kindness – that's the path of the people of evil... Tomorrow you will ride out home, led by Gregor whom I assigned to be your Teacher and chief, together with even a bigger group of people also assigned to him. Many of you are waited passionately at home, the others will find your former home empty... Don't carry any pain in your heart while coming back to the oasis. From Life learn His wisdom and build new home with the new power of your heart. Don't carry any regret with yourselves that you need to go from one condition to the others, carry only one everywhere: happiness to live one more day bravely and wisely, to unite with the workers of heaven and the earth, to perceive that heaven and the earth – that's the Only One Love, the Great Father Life. Be blessed. Everything what you will need to know, everything what will increase the perception of your heart's creativity in your daily work, Gregor will explain everything to you, while Dartran, Bronski and Igor, whom you can see here and who also will go together with us, will help the individual development of those whom Gregor will tell to go to the wide world together with him. And I entrust all your children to Vasilyon whose kindness you all know well, because he has saved you many times. Stop considering yourselves to be good teachers. I doubt whether there is at least ten people from several hundred of the grown-ups who are living here, always supported and watched over by Radanda, whom one could call in the resounding name of a teacher. Many of you don't even comprehend by seeing your children's faults and rudeness that they are the consequences of their own poverty, egoism and lack of kindness. Rely upon Vasilyon and educate your children as he will instruct you to."

With this I. finished his speech. He started walking along the tables, he was examining everybody's work attentively, he was speaking to every man, he would embrace everybody and tell him the new path of his work development. Then I. left Demetrius's house, he dismissed all our friends in the park by telling them to be prepared to ride out early in the morning, and he told me to stay with him and Radanda. Having said goodbye to our friends, we went straight to the chapel of Joy down the shortest paths, and when we could see its contours in the greenness of the park and in the blue sky from the distance already, I. asked me.

"Lyovushka, do you remember well the Great Mother's assignment given to you when you came back to life after leaving the Masters of power?"

"Oh, Teacher, could I forget about a single letter from the Divine instruction?" I answered him hurriedly. "Here are they, the unforgettable words that are shining in my consciousness as a fiery seal: "Now go to the chapel of Sadness and bring my little flower of Joy and sympathy to It. The people's word of

philosophy isn't important in everyday encounters. The word of calm and sympathy is important, so that the man could find the path to Me within himself. I am not a Destiny. I am not an inevitable karma. I am the Light inside of man, hi Joy. The path which leads to me through the others' help doesn't exist. The path through man's own tranquillity is leading to Me."

"Accept the wonderful joy of the messenger who has received his task from Life itself with your entire consciousness and heart. Remember that your harmony – that's the bridge through which the energy of Light is flowing to the earth. Go down the path of calm, be the path of calm yourself for all sad and protesting people, for everybody who has thrust his spirit in his own prison of complaints and tears. Be blessed."

I took on of my arms, Radanda took another one, and we started climbing up lacework stairs. Oh, how it was easy and wonderful to climb up to the chapel this time. No fire was burning me anymore, and the higher we were climbing, the easier it was to breathe. When we entered the chapel, and all three of us knelt by the Great Mother's feet, I was covered with the bliss of Joy, of Love, of Fearlessness and of Calm, and for the first time I perceived the happiness liberated by the earthly death...

I still don't have the right to tell you about the experiences from here. The Great Mother gave an alive, little flower to every one of us, and told us to bring them to the chapel of Sadness. She told I. by giving the flower to him.

"Set the first Light of hope and wisdom in the chapel of Sadness."

She said to Radanda.

"Bring the faith in mercy and the faith in kindness in the chapel of Sadness."

She told me.

"Leave the little flower of calm in the chapel of Sadness and knowledge that no work disappears uselessly if it is done unselfishly, by thinking about the general wellbeing. Give all love of your heart and all enlightenment of your consciousness to the little flower, so that everybody who will touch my image would feel the desire to escape the circle of tears, the desire to know and perceive the Truth."

We bowed before the Great Mother three times in silence and, having hidden the flowers under our cloaks, we left the chapel. Radanda was going first, I was in the middle, I. was the last one. Now I could see not only the usual radiance of Radanda's and I.'s spheres, but it seemed to me that a ship of Light was sailing together with us on the ground. We were walking down a narrow, little path through some shrubs, through the places which I had never seen or been, and I didn't even suspect that such an impassable thicket of prickly bushes could be in Radanda's Community. This blooming thicket didn't frighten me with anything, but I comprehended perfectly that everyone who got here without any attendant had to lose his way inevitably like in the catacombs of the first Roman Christians.

Unexpectedly, we went out to a group of houses which were scattered in quite a big distance one from another. I didn't understand instantly what happened, where we found ourselves, but as though I all cowered, it was very difficult to breathe here, my legs were hardly moving, as though somebody had suddenly attached a pound of weights to each of them.

"Lyovushka, those are emanations of tears and sadness that hit your body so strongly, which isn't yet used to such big differences of the vibrations of the waves of people's thoughts and feelings. Several minutes will pass, and you will adapt to the new surroundings. Press the little flower stronger to yourself, and your strengths will come back to you immediately."

We crossed the settlement, silent like dead, and we entered a thick avenue of huge poplars. It led us to a spacious clearing where white maples were growing in a semicircle, and in the centre the exact copy of the chapel of the Great Mother was standing, the same lacework and light, but... completely dark. In the beginning it seemed to me to be black by the white maples, but I saw immediately that the chapel, the stairs and the statue itself – everything was hollowed out of the dark grey pearl. I stopped, stunned by this view, and I heard I.'s voice.

"This chapel was white eons of years ago. It was given to people, so that their energetic centres would clean, renewed by the Light of joy and comfort, so that Life-Joy would illuminate the sad one's heart and would help the weak one by pouring into the consciousness of the ones who pray. But the people's tears and complaints which the Great Mother used to take into herself darkened the upper layer of the statue with emanations of their sadness, the power of which you've just felt. To be precise, those complaints soaked in her radiating matter during ages and covered the whole Great Mother's figure with a case. And now it looks for people like hollowed out of the dark grey pearl. And actually – observe closely and you will see how the white reddish figure is shining under the layer of dark cases which have accumulated from people's heartbreak, sadness, tears, complaints and illnesses. Let's enter. Let's do the great task given by Mercy to us. Once in a hundred years the present of the Great Mother's Love is brought here - Her living flowers. If Life didn't renew his care of the suffering man, he would suffocate himself together with the source of his inspiration and Light."

We climbed up to the chapel, and all three of us put our flowers into the hands of the Divine figure where previous flowers were placed already, they were absolutely black, darker than the statue itself.

Apparently, hands and lips of the suffering ones touched the flowers mostly.

As soon as we put our brought flowers into the statue's hands, the fire flashed up in the chapel and above it. The whole figure disappeared in flames for a moment, and when the fire died out, it became dark reddish, even brightly red from the dark grey one.

"My God! That is real red pearl!" I gave a shout, being stunned and charmed by the wonderful view.

"Yes, son, that is the pearl of Love, that is mercy and kindness brought by Life here. That is the Light of hope and wisdom, that is calm and knowing that work is happiness, because any unselfish work is creating the Community of the world," Radanda uttered.

"Be charming and pleasing messenger, messenger-comforter everywhere. Let your charm help people to comprehend everything what Life entrusted you to give to the people's masses," I. added by embracing me.

"Remember this hour when the universal Energy has poured her purifying fire to help the mankind, and you were the witness of this action of Love-Will. No one from us possesses the power that would be equal to this phenomenon. But every one of us can pour this fire of His Love to help people's actions and hearts everywhere. Never forget what you are carrying into your actions and encounters, where and before whom your every day of the earth begins and ends, and what it really is."

When we left the chapel and came back to the settlement of the sad ones, I didn't even recognize this sad, little village instantly. As though a heavy shower had washed off the houses and gardens. As though the dew that was impossible in the desert had washed the whole layer of dust off the grass and the flowers. Excited figures showed up on the thresholds already, and in a while, the excited crowd with pouring tears hurried to the chapel, radiating in the flame of a ruby.

Again, we hid in the thicket of the blooming and prickly brushes. After our long journey back, finally we came up to Radanda's house and his dining-room from absolutely other side, unknown to me.

It seemed that so much time had passed, that the dinner had already been eaten a long time ago, and soon was the supper time. I told me to set myself in order after the journey and to call Gregor, Vasilyon, Bronski, Igor, Andreyeva and Oldenkot to him. Yassa who was here explained to me where I could find them, and he called my friend Eta who was sleeping calmly in the watchhouse by waiting for my coming back.

Of course, my dear bird assisted me everywhere, he also accompanied me to Radanda's bath. But that wasn't enough for him, he jumped into the pool and started bathing. I was frightened that he would drown in the deep pool, but the self-confident rascal continued his toilet, not characteristic for peacocks, by looking at me cunningly and comically. I understood that also this trick was the influence of Radanda's training, I stopped worrying and I was so rocking with laughter that Yassa came to put down our too great joviality and he gave both of us a pretty big scolding.

Although I was guilty for my external childishness, I concentrated my inner strengths very easily, I wiped Eta dry after the bathing and I walked with him to Yassa's told places.

I gathered my friends quickly, much quicker than I had thought, and I brought them to I.

"My dear," I addressed them, "I can talk to you for the last time today in Radanda's Community. I hope that a regret that you part with me hasn't occurred to any of you at least for a moment. Go to people's daily routine and carry that new strength to them with which you are now rewarded. By revealing the great treasury of the nature's powers to you, the Great Master of the Earth has foreseen his bridges within you, through which His energy must pour onto the earth. Go and fulfil His will. You know how to fulfil it, it is impossible to teach it. Creation is within you. It is spiritualized by the fire of Eternity – go and sow by knowing where to sow and by remembering how to choose the place for sowing, so that you wouldn't throw pearls for those who don't deserve them. Be blessed. Everybody will ride out to Dartran's oasis at dawn. And you," he addressed Nataliya Vladimirovna and Oldenkot, "won't stop at Dartran's, but you will ride straight to Ali's Community where a small, armed company led by Yassa will accompany you. You will give my letter to Castanda in Ali's Community, and he will send you immediately to America where you already will find Teacher Venetian and you will receive all necessary instructions for you from him."

I embraced all his brothers and sisters in arms – disciples, and he hung his portrait on everyone's neck. It was of such wonderful work, that also here I suspected his own creation.

Soon the signal for the supper was heard. Also this last supper of my friends in the Community was over, Radanda rose from his place and addressed everybody with his soft and loving voice.

"I cannot see the sad mourning of farewell here and I don't hear any complaint before the departure to distant and unfamiliar places of your new work in any of your hearts. Yes, my children, those always start the new life who have understood the eternal life, who have accepted all their earthly circumstances as those frames of their circumstances, into which the sparkle of his Eternity is placed, and who blessed them. Don't start a single day, a single business without directing your spiritual look to those distant worlds, from which you carried out your knowledge. Make glad and be glad. Overcome by loving and carry only justification for that ignorance, to which the Great law of Mercy directs you to serve. Don't tire your heart while working and your body with a sweated work. But keep one image in your eyes and spirit: the image of those who have sent you.

Radanda blessed everybody. He whispered several words for everyone who was leaving, while I gave a small medallion for everyone with the image of the burning fire in the cup.

“Lyovushka, for the last time thank you for everything,” I heard Nataliya Vladimirovna’s voice. “Everything what you were doing for me before, probably also another one could do. But that what you did for me in the laboratory of the Master of the Masters only you could do. With this act you have attached me to you with the ropes of eternal gratitude. Be blessed and don’t forget about me in your thoughts, as also I won’t forget about you in my prayers.”

She was the only one from the departing ones with whom I exchanged the word of farewell. I. told me to take over all Yassa’s duties and then to go to order his correspondence and to wait for him there.

Having done all Yassa’s work, visited several of his patients, I came back to our little house and sat down in I.’s room to order his letters.

I didn’t participate in seeing off our friends and their huge caravan through the gates. Only at dawn I accepted their thoughts of farewell, and I responded to every one of them with the whole love and calm of my heart which I only could find within myself.

Chapter 33

Once again, the chapel of sadness and the settlement of the sobbing ones. I.'s speech for the sobbing ones. I say good-bye to the chapel of joy. The feast of farewell in Radanda's Community. The last I.'s speech. Our departure to Ali's Community

I accompanied the caravan in my thoughts through the desert in the distant road. I had already accompanied the people dear to me to the new paths of their activity for so many times. My and their experiences were so different while bidding farewell to them. Now I remembered the unforgettable views: Beata and the scene of her farewell in Ali's Community, as well as dear Aninov took a considerable place in my heart. And everybody whom I saw leaving from Ali's and Radanda's Communities were leaving sad and with tears up to now.

For the first time, the caravan of the dark-skinned was going to unfamiliar lands to them, to the strange conditions, and they were leaving in an easy, joyful, simple and fearless way. My friends were leading it joyfully, for whom neither external nor internal conditionalities existed now. They didn't "go" by "leaving" something somewhere, - they "continued" their creative path by seeing only one thing everywhere: to be the bridges of joy for the Master who gave the presents of His love through them.

I immersed in these thoughts, my wonderful friends fascinated me - now they had already become the people of power and integrity, - whom I knew to be as hesitating, occupied in themselves and not capable of taking any other decisions, but only the compromise ones rather not long ago. I was sending my fascination to them and respectful love for their work and encounters.

"Lyovushka, it seems that you aren't very zealous secretary, my dear friend," I heard I. laughing behind me.

"On the contrary, Teacher. My task, or to be precise, your given task to me is already completed. There are many requests and moaning for you in these letters, but one letter here made me fall to deep thinking, and I didn't know where I should attribute it to. I left it separately, because I couldn't decide how you would look at it," I answered him.

I extended the letter written with a womanly hand, signed by "Jenny" to I.

"I know about this letter. Put it aside. We'll talk later about it. And now, as soon as the bell will ring, we'll go to the dining-room and from there we'll visit the settlement of the sobbing ones together with Radanda. You were the witness how Love sent Her purifying emanations for the Earth. The emanations of such a power that man's organism may comprehend them only as the fire. Today, together with us you will bring your love to that sacred place where the Great Mother gave the possibility for people to throw sadness off themselves and the burden of tears all their hearts. Don't think that you are still not enough strong spiritually or that your emanations aren't high enough to help the suffering ones to recover their calm. There are no limits for improvement, and it is unimportant who is higher and who is lower with respect to the stars. It is important to do every action till the end on your scale, to be loyal to the Only One Life till the end with your selflessness. To carry belief for people that life of the Earth - the entire earthly universe without any exceptions - is simply one phase of the passing by and changing forms, of the same forms in which you, I, Ali, Radanda, Mulga and Benja Juan are, that the desert and the stars - that's the

sparkles of the Only One, shining, dying out, twinkling or burning in a calm Light. Not the form of your present incarnation is the bridge of Life through which He is sending His strengths to the Earth, but your Eternal Power which you can make neither better nor worse now, if yesterday you were living only with dreams about actions, while the others, walking next to you, were acting, whose fire of spirit may be even weaker than yours. But they were acting, while you were only thinking how you would act, and you let your Eternal Power go through this doing nothing by losing your passing by “now” without any meaning and use.”

As always, the bell rang, as always, we did our morning preparations, and as always, we had our breakfast. But not as always, I felt myself inside of me. As though I woke up again, I perceived newly what it meant to act once again. It seemed to me that also the day itself didn't continue from the morning till the evening as a certain number of hours and actions through them, that it was only a narrow, little path of Infinity, along which man was walking.

After the breakfast we went down the same avenue, through which we came back yesterday, came to the thicket of prickly bushes and approached the chapel of Sadness. Oh, how beautiful the chapel was now – red, radiating and changing in all colours of pearl – in the background of the blue sky and white maples! It seemed to me that only now I could evaluate the great Mercy enough, who had sent His action for the Earth yesterday in my presence...

We found a crowd of people around the chapel. Everybody was sobbing here. One woman who was holding a blond girl in her arms was especially breaking my heart with her lament. Many of them looked so exhausted and pitiful, such a despair was restraining their bodies that it seemed to me that it was impossible to lead them out of this lethargy of despair.

We were standing unnoticed for some time. I saw how powerful rays from I.'s and Radanda's spheres spread towards the completely depressed woman, and they started covering her and her baby with their light. The woman's lament was growing quiet little by little, her face pulled by convulsions calmed down, and finally, an expression of real calm appeared in it. She pressed her baby who felt asleep silently to her heart even stronger, she leant upon the stairs and became quiet, as though she had recovered her calm suddenly.

While the woman's despair grew quiet, Radanda's and I.'s rays were spreading wider across the crowd of the sobbing people. Tears and moaning began to calm down little by little, and all of them, as though agreed, turned to us. Having showed with the sign to follow him, I. climbed up the stairs of the chapel a little and addressed the unfortunate people who couldn't take their eyes red with weeping off him with pleasant and gentle words.

“My friends, miserable sobbing brothers and sisters! How many tears you've poured during your life! How many heartbreaking prayers you've sent to heaven during your previous life and during your life by this chapel. And... how many reproaches rose from your hearts that your tearful prayers were left without any response. Didn't you really get any response? Is the “dead” heaven silent so cruelly, as you state in your reproaches to him? Are the “saints” so deaf, whom you addressed? Or perhaps, you are too occupied with themselves, your tears and you are unable to notice the signs of compassion and mercy showed to you? Yesterday you saw this chapel dark. It seems to you that you've “washed off” its every little patch with your tears. That everyone's heart has given the dearest present to the chapel – your tears. Think a little: if your eyes are pouring with tears – can they see clearly? At least as much clearly as to notice another martyr who is standing next to you? No, the weeping one is weeping for himself. He is so deeply occupied only with himself, only with his pain that the person who is standing next to him arouses neither his sympathy nor his desire to forget about himself at least for a moment and to help his sadness. Now you stopped sobbing. But you stopped not because I aroused new emotions externally – kindness and sympathy

– but because Life helped you to set free your suppressed, grieving spirit and energy of joy by burning down the heaps of your tearful emanations, invisible to you. Now you can breathe easier. The shroud of sadness doesn't cover you anymore, which didn't allow your thoughts to notice the most important phenomenon of life of the earth: the minute of an experienced sadness – that's not the whole life. The earth, the form of life and its action in it – that's only one moment in that eternal path, along which you were, you are and you will be walking. Who are you? Why did you get here? You don't even know that you are living in the distant corner, but of high culture one where the energetic life of science, the art, handicraft is thriving, from where not a few inventions spread to the wide world for people's benefit and general wellbeing. You comprehend neither who you are nor who is living around you. You are only sobbing, indifferent to life now, in the same way as you were sobbing when you left the world. You left it indifferent to its entire life, because everyone of you experienced a shock in your personal life. The members of this Community met some of you in different places of the world, the others of you came yourselves by wishing the only one: to live separated and to pour your tears unhindered. Did your tears give a relief to you? Have you helped at least a single man who was grieving next to you with the energy of your heart, with your tenderness and kindness? You could see only your own sorrow, and nobody existed for you except yourselves. You were praying by asking only for yourselves and your own people, and you kept living by complaining, by feeling that you were doing a heroic deed of great self-sacrifice, while living your tearful, worthless life. Life – that's a continual action. That is an eternal movement, the goal of which is the regularity of the universe and accuracy in it. Only that one is living in the true sense of the word, who enters this Eternal Movement as his little, harmonious part who has caught His rhythm in his actions and work. The running of the eternal power doesn't stop, as the actions of that one who considers himself to be a man, that is the sparkle of the Only One Life, cannot stop. But for you to enter this work – the general work of the universe, – it is necessary that your eyes could see clearly, your ears could hear accurately, and your heart could beat in harmony with the rhythm of the Only One and the Movement of the Eternal. I've already mentioned: the eyes that cry cannot see clearly. As well as the ears of those who complain, moan and hear only their heartbreak cannot hear the Life's call. And the heart that is beating in a minor scale is beating monotonously: "I, I, I." Such heart knows only about the fear of the future and the rendering yearning for the past. But it doesn't have any strength to see and to hear the passing by, flying past moment "now", because it is dead for the flying past moments now, that is for the True Life, behind the moaning and suffering for the past that doesn't exist anymore and for no less ephemeral future. You, my miserable brothers and sisters, you who consider yourselves to be alive, carrying the great deed of love, you, sad weepers, – are... the dead. Not only the people next to you may keep their vitality, not only children may laugh, not only the grass and the flowers fade and drop, but the dark shroud of your sadness covers even Love itself. Were you sent to the Earth to think only about yourselves? Let's acknowledge this egoism, – if life was given to you only for your thoughts about yourselves, it would mean that you could exhaust yourselves and wound everybody who could see you so weeping? Life has sent you to the Earth by giving you Joy as His symbol. While you, having hidden His present, turned into some worthless urns of sadness. You are standing in one place even when you see how the days are flying past. You are looking at the ground sullenly without even taking thought why the sun has risen today? And the sun has risen, so that the power of Light wouldn't go out within yourselves, so that you would raise your faces to the sky not with the prayer: "Help us!", but with the smile: "We are messengers of Your kindness." Stop considering the mourning of your personal life as some kindness. Wipe your eyes, open your ears – and you will be able to hear the silent voice of Joy that tells you: "You are carrying God within yourself. He is alive within you. Try to comprehend that you are never alone, that everything is within you. But everything opens His face only for the Joyous One." You are living in this godforsaken place, behind this thicket, and you don't even imagine that the chapel of Joy is near you, and that the people who have perceived the absurdity of tears are living there. Not a single of your actions may bring you any relief, because you poison yourselves with the eternal irritant of your tears. Responsibility for their own lives falls to the man himself. Every one of you

must look at himself as a suicide who is killing his life with the poison of a slow effect – his tears. And how you must look at yourselves through the eyes of the society? Who are you for the society? For your children? For everybody whom you encounter in your day's work? Don't you understand in what a killing way you affect your encountered, healthy people? You think that it's not a crime – to put out the merry close man's smile, to break into his surroundings with the hurricane of sadness and tears? If it's a crime to destroy the calm of a happy man with strong character and self-control with your tears, so what to say about those weak, hesitating people whom it is so easy to throw down from the unstable stairs of harmony. From this moment on and forever remember that the meaning of your every lived minute – that's only to assert everybody's best strengths. Were you working when with your clenched teeth you were always prepared to shout for everybody about your dissatisfaction and to protest for your working difficulties and your life's misfortunes? Even if you haven't opened your lips and uttered your complaints, then your heart full of the dregs of your not poured tears has already woven the impassable wall of disharmony around you. Only you yourselves can untie the ropes of your tears, with which you have entangled yourselves, burn the shroud of sadness with which you have dressed yourselves, and not those "saints" for whom you are calling. If you want to receive answers from those whom you call, you need to create pure paths inside of you and around you, through which their answers could come to you. And first of all, you need to throw off the shroud of your tears and sadness with which you are living now. How could you do it? There's only one path for all the little parts of the Light: Joy. You can find and enter this path of Light only with your own work of spiritual renewal. You need to understand that your entire working day which you begin and end with tears doesn't exist as a phase of your eternal life. That is only the worthless phase of that ignorance of yours which doesn't comprehend that every flying past moment of the Earth's life – that's a moment of Eternity. But it is like that only when it is experienced till the end by comprehending your incessant bond with the Eternal Movement. And this bond means only cheerfulness, kindness and reconciliation with your circumstances. Maybe you won't rise till the greatest revelations of the spiritual world, although everybody can achieve them and no obstacles exist to them, but if you don't rise till the elementary comprehension that the Earth is only the place of work and cheerfulness, of calm energies and kindness for your close people, - then you won't be able to enter this path of Light, even if you prayed during your entire incarnation or cried in the temples by the feet of all saints. You – sorrowful grieving people – will find only the dead sky, because you are dead yourselves and not the sky. Come to yourselves, look around and look at those who are standing next to you, the same sorrowful and sobbing ones. You heard the moaning and lament of the woman with a baby in her arms, but you were deaf and dumb to her heartbreak. Find the most ordinary kindness within yourselves and, having forgotten your moaning, throw the pain of your close people over on your shoulders. And then you will find that place where Joy is living. Stop weeping at least for a moment – and you will see where the Light of the man who is next to you is living. Stop living only with misfortunes of your own path, dry your tears – and you will see the entire universe, full not of the diamonds of the stars, but of living images of Joy... Tomorrow Radanda will come to visit you, and if he finds among you the ones who were able to forget about themselves and to think about the help for your neighbour, he will take them out of this place of tears to the thriving Community. They will be able to find a work for themselves according to their liking and skills there. But you need to understand that life is given to you for work on the Earth, for pouring your kindness and joy into its activity. You need to realize well that no separation and withdrawal from people exist. There's Only One Life, in the rhythm of whom everybody's hearts are beating. Every heart is ringing and beating in its own note, but this note joins the universal harmony only when it expresses cheerfulness, kindness and joyfulness, that is when it finds the way to join the rhythm of Life. Comprehend by looking at the perfect forms of this Divine figure which is burning in red colour that Love has extended Her help to you by burning down the emanations of your sadness, and evaluate all the consequences of it. In exactly the same way Love burns down the results of harmful, evil-minded and disgraceful human actions in cataclysms, which the Earth and Its inhabitants cannot hold out anymore... Be blessed, dear brothers and sisters. Strive for

liberation, because only that one who is free from the burden of his own passions can hear the rhythm of Life and to feel himself as the little part of the entire universe. The first sign of joy which you will recognize in your heart also will be the first sign of your starting liberation.”

I climbed down the stairs, he answered the questions and requests of the people who surrounded him tenderly and pleasingly, and he gave every one of them to Radanda by telling them the words of love, sympathy or guidance. Then he created one more phenomenon which I hadn't seen up to now. He covered me and himself with a thick light by forcing his energetic centres to radiate only the white light which looked like the daylight. This wall of indiscernible light hid both of us so well that we became invisible for everybody who was around us. Now they could see only Radanda's figure before themselves, they gathered around him, while we stepped back from the chapel and disappeared in the thicket of hearth and brushes where I regained his usual appearance instantly.

He was walking in a quick step in front of me, and I didn't need even to ask him, so that I could comprehend how strongly concentrated he was. By trying to disturb I.'s reflections as little as possible, I slowed down the pace and I was trying to walk as silently as possible by protecting his calm that was saint for me.

The sad figures of the people distressed by their heartbreak, whom I had just seen, were still standing before my eyes. My thoughts like the wind flew to Bracano, Benja Jean, to the emigrants from the secret Community, who had lost the path of Light and then recovered it again, and they stopped by mother Anna.

Oh, the paths of the human soul! The paths of the immeasurable diversity – from the most elementary grievances to the quag of the greatest crimes and the height of a heroic joy! The paths of the big, noisy cities, capitals, villages and deserts! And all of them are the only one path of an awakening and expanding consciousness. The path which leads man to creation only when he gains calm and self-control. The path in the end of which such bright figures like I. who is walking next to me and Radanda left behind our backs, are living, where differences between the man and the angel don't exist anymore, but where only the work of an absolute liberation exists. And only this path of the eternal and continuous development exists for everybody.

I was praying the Master of the Masters to bow to the great altar of his laboratory which he called the God's working place, and to say a prayer for our left sobbing people who so strangely considered their tears to be the greatest quality...

“You don't disturb me, Lyovushka,” I heard the melodious I.'s voice which seemed to me even more pleasing and tender than always. “You don't disturb me for a long time already, my friend, and therefore, you may not lag behind and disappear anywhere if I don't tell you to,” smiling I. continued. “You can't even imagine how soon your activity without me will begin and even far away from me, Lyovushka. Together with you we will leave from here to Ali's Community. You won't stay there for a very long time, and the reason of our quick separation and your hastened independence – that's the letter which you didn't know where to attribute to and which was signed by “Jenny”. Sir Vomi forwarded this letter here, to whom it was addressed directly. Now I won't tell you anything about that person who wrote it. This story began three years ago in London. Lord Benedict and sir Vomi took place in it by saving several people from Bracano's intrigues. You will find out all the details from sir Vomi to whom you will go after staying a little in Ali's Community. You will find a loyal assistant and your co-worker Chava at sir Vomi's, who once frightened you so much. You haven't had a possibility yet to evaluate this pure heart. Now, while working with her for the liberation of unfortunate Jenny, you will find out who Chava is and what the loyalty and devotion of the heart, free till the end, is capable of doing. You will snatch Jenny from the horrible Bracano's clutches. You will help Anna by passing the part of your new knowledge to her, and you will bring both of them to Ali's

Community. Not you will accompany Jenny to the secret Community where we'll have to hide her. And you not alone will be fighting for her, sir Vomi and Ananda will help you, they will take care of her future destiny. But you, Chava and Anna will be her protection on the way till Ali's Community. Not so strongly as for Jenny, but you also will have to fight for Joan, and here you'll have a devoted assistant – the duke. Not an easy and long fight is waiting for you, my son. During this departure from Ali's Community of yours, your brother and Nal, Venetian and his other co-workers will come here. And not your look will be the first which will meet your brother-father. Isn't there a smallest hint to a vexation in your heart, Lyovushka, that your happy life next to me is coming to an end? Now you are living in the zone of the Light, and you will have to descend to the anxious emanations of the people who are excited by their passions and who are inclined to crimes. Aren't you annoyed? Doesn't your heart break that the most dearest and closest people to you won't find you where they expected to meet you soon?"

"Oh, Teacher, you can read my heart and see it till the bottom! How terrible it would be for a Teacher to train his disciples whom couldn't rely on as a force, whom he couldn't use where it is necessary and exactly in the way as it is necessary for the arisen "now". My unconditional obedience to you – that's my joy, my job for the Bright Brotherhood, that's my happiness."

"Be blessed, my boy, I will give Yassa to you as a company of your life. You won't have to think about any trifles of your life, he will be your loyal friend-nurse. And let this side of conditionalities, and the worries related to it, not touch you. You will have to deal only with the spiritual side of any business and with those external situations which will arise as the consequence of the tasks of your spirit. Your bond with me won't break, and if necessary, I will keep sending new assistants for you."

We approached our little house, and a driver from Ali's Community was already waiting for us here. He told us that he had brought a big caravan for Radanda with loads and people, and that he had Castanda's instruction to take us with the returning caravan. He took two camels specially for us, who covered the whole way here without any burden.

The bell's stroke was heard, and I. told his attendant Slava to take care of the guest and to accompany him to the dining-room where Radanda would be and where all of us together would solve all the remaining questions.

Till the very end of the dinner I didn't have at least a minute of time to think about our soon departure, about all my encountered people during this time and about dear Ali, to whose Community I was supposed to come back and maybe even see his white room again. People were pouring on me like nuts from a cedar branches, and I hardly had time to solve their businesses. After the dinner I. said to me.

"Lyovushka, you are free until the supper. These are the first hours of the rest which I give personally to you for the first time during these several years lived with me. Forget about me, forget all your duties and spend this time as it will seem to be necessary for you. The caravan will be resting only for twenty-four hours, and then we will leave the blessed places for a long time. Go, my friend. Peace for you."

I walked down one little path which began from Radanda's house, which was showed to me not so long ago and which was winding imperceptibly in the verdure, so that I could spend alone the hours of the rest given to me. My friend Eta who was guarding all the exits from the dining-room vigilantly, probably wouldn't have agreed to leave me alone now by thinking that he gave too much freedom for me already.

In the beginning I was walking down these secluded paths without any clear goal. But the further the little path was winding, the more the sounds of the everyday life grew quiet, the easier I was breathing and the clearer I perceived my merging with the nature.

By starting to smile a little, I went up to the thicket of the heath and the prickly brushes, I went round the chapel of Sadness, and I started searching for the avenue of poplars, leading to the chapel of Joy.

Having wandered a little, I found it anyway and I went out to the dark cedars which surrounded the white chapel. I was here not so long ago, and I saw this creation of the art, sent by Life Himself for this little patch of the desert, chosen by Him! And it seemed to me that I could really see the whole beauty of the chapel and the whole divine harmony of the statue. But in this hour, I comprehended that the eyes of my spirit had opened even wider and that my physical eyes could see that what was invisible for me not so long ago.

The whole white reddish statue spread a lot of clouds of small, golden spheres, which dissipated in all directions and settled down on the whole nature that surrounded the chapel. I could see how the mighty cedars absorbed these spheres, how they disappeared in flowers and the flying by birds, how they soaked into the ground and the roots of the plants. Having looked more attentively at the ground, I saw that swift streamlets of fire were flowing there in flames, from under the chapel by winding across the entire Radanda's Community. Now also here I was observing the underground fire which I had seen under mother Anna's chapel of Joy, only much stronger. This view surprised me, but at the same time, how I couldn't see it before.

I stopped by the stair, and I concentrated my entire attention on the Divine figure of the Great Mother. I was blessing the man-sculptor, creator whose hands were so pure that he could express the features of the Revelation sent to the Earth.

The entire surroundings stopped existing for me like the Earth separated from the entire universe. All the sorrows and tears, all the humiliations and worries, joys and personal achievements – everything vanished as the world of the earth alone, as forms, living one short moment of the earthly incarnation.

I could see only one path of the Infinite inside of me and in everything else. I had never perceived the solidity of Life so clearly, which looked so broken into millions of spiritualized and spiritless forms.

I climbed up to the chapel and pressed myself to the feet of the Great Mother. I was begging Her to bless my new work and independence in my path; I desired to extend – according to my strengths and possibilities – my whole loyalty till the end. I heard a voice.

"It was said to you – only the joyous one can see clearly and act with full might.

Remember one lesson the most from all ones given to you: who wants to serve the Only One Life till the end with his loyalty that one may not leave the circle of joy at least for a moment.

Every inhalation and expiration of that one who is going to the world to co-operate with the Only One, must be pure joy and fill up the entire surroundings with the energy of cheerfulness.

No other precept for the bright son exists as only the precept of undisturbed joy.

Epochs of wars, downfall of ethics and disorder of the stable people's balance, degeneration of honour and nobility – nothing may disturb the joy of those who went out not to the fight against the defects of their brothers-people, but who went out to be the messengers of Love by carrying Her precept of calm.

Joy doesn't sound like some golden coins and doesn't shine like the radiance of wealth. Joy hits the sinner, forces the villain to fall to thinking and gives wings to the pure one, if the son of Light, loyal till the end is carrying it."

The voice fell silent, but a little flower of the Great Mother appeared in my hand, the same as the one that She gave to me during my first visit of the chapel.

If during that first time I was burning in the fire of ecstasy, I comprehended my physical weakness and I was alive, then now my heart was full of fortitude. I accepted solemnly the wonderful obligation to be the messenger of Joy. For the first time I felt the great happiness in my heart to love God and all the forms of His Life with my entire essence.

An ordinary kindness merged with a persuasion inside of me that I didn't have to "think" anymore of that I was always not alone, that the two of us were always together: my Lord and I. I perceived myself directly inside of Him and Him inside of me, and only in this way now I could feel the entire universe and my everyday work in it.

My new path, my future work in it and soon separation with Godmen, like Radanda and I., - everything was only the path of the Infinite for me, and my thoughts about myself not only didn't disturb me anymore, but they didn't exist anymore.

There weren't any gaps in my consciousness anymore that the Teacher's work - that was only some carried powers of Revelation, while every work of the passing by daily routine - that was only an ordinary mental or physical work that touched the private life of the earth. Neither easy encounters nor small businesses existed for me anymore - everything what I was thinking about, what I saw and what I was doing, - everything now became the business of not me alone, two acting persons were everywhere: my Lord and I.

As sometimes I would feel an especial calm in my heart, an especial tranquillity during high spiritual moments, so now I couldn't feel the limits of my body and the desert's sand. I knew firmly how far the rays of Light could reach, how they accompanied everybody in their work and activity if the two of them were doing this work and activity: man, and his God.

A canto was heard in the distance, somewhere in the desert, and I recognized the unearthly voices of the Masters of power which sounded like some crystal bells. I recognized the Hymn which they were chanting, and I understood that they were sending a blessing for my new path.

Having concentrated even deeper, I saw all seven Masters of power who were standing by the laboratory of the elements and sending the blessing to me. I remembered the last words of the Master of the Masters with which he saw me off to the world, - that I would come back to them one more time in my physical body, only not so soon, but that I would see personally him, the Master of the Masters, and my kind Master-Teacher several times.

Now I could see all of them, I accepted the wishes of their farewell, and I understood that they would support me in all the hours of my greatest stress, work and fight if only my hands are pure enough and my spirit is inseparably united with the Only One inside of me.

The undisturbed silence around me, the solemn tranquillity and joy inside of me - everything created such a harmony, such happiness to live that I didn't even notice how the desert dusk fell. The new energy to live by comprehending myself as the messenger of the Bright Brotherhood was pouring in the streams of joy out of me, and at the same time, I felt how my body absorbed the golden sparkles of the

Great Mother by becoming always stronger and more cheerful. For the last time I pressed myself to the Divine hands and I pledged to carry the energy of Light and to remember that in the work among people my breathing had to be only an expiration of joy and tranquillity. I was lost in the deepest happiness which had no name in any human language...

I. sent me back on the earth by taking my hand.

"My son. The periods of work and rest change many times one after another in a disciple's life. But the disciple's rest doesn't look like the one of an ordinary man. His rest – that's also work, and a very strenuous work, always for the same goal: for the people's wellbeing. The disciple's rest – the rest-work, that is the raising of his spiritual powers and the following consequence from it, a deeper comprehension of the secrets of nature, a greater knowledge. The new, wide path of work rises before you, which you will overcome like a winner, because you've entered that level of your spiritual consciousness, in which you and your Lord are acting together. Since such moment of a man's spiritual recovery of sight neither earthly conditionalities nor the world of heaven existing separately exist for him anymore – only the paths of Eternity in the incessant earthly movement exist for him. Only from this moment on, the whole power of man's honour opens, and he is walking on the earth after becoming wise man, although his literacy would be only elementary. The frame of the human conditionalities disappear – the man's spirit is living liberated. All the encounters which tired you before now will be easy for you, because also the people's frame will break by not holding out the power of your harmony. And everybody, independent of his personal desires, will reveal everything the best, for what he has matured during his encounter with you. Go, my son, remember that the most important task of your serving – that's to be a writer. That's your path – to summon and strengthen the best people's strengths inside of them with your thought's creation. No matter how many duties, businesses, encounters you would be carrying now, start writing right now by taking advantage of your every free minute when you can find it. No disorder of the earth and the nastiest and most troubled emanations of the people's crowds can harm the work of those who are carrying the Living Eternity inside of them."

I. embraced me, and we left the chapel together when the darkness of the night had already completely changed the evening dusk. As soon as we went out of the poplar avenue, we heard the bell's toll for the supper for which we were hardly in time.

This time the dining-room looked absolutely different, and its solemnity surprised me. It was always shining with cleanness, but this time it was simply dazzlingly white from white tablecloths, embroidered very beautifully. The most beautiful vases and bowls were full of flowers and fruits. Some artistic table tools made of ivory and silver, and the same cups were placed before us with I.

I admired the setting of the table which was so unusual for the modest and almost strict life of the Community, and I couldn't comprehend in any way what the occasion was, because it reminded me more of a solemn feast and not of an ordinary supper of the Community.

When Radanda gave a sign, everybody took their places, and they were having their supper calmly. But there were more dishes, the wine instead of the milk jugs, while the food corresponded to the setting of the tables.

Yes, it was a feast. The farewell feast which the Community organized for its high guest I.

"For the last time today, we see here our beloved friend, master and patron, Teacher I.," Radanda stood up and uttered. "Teacher had visited us many times, he left us many times, but neither his participation nor his departure had ever been connected to such happiness and such changes in the Community as this time. If you look one at another, if you examine the ones who are sitting at the tables,

today you almost won't find those faces in this festive hall, who were sitting here during the first days of Teacher I.'s arrival to our Community. Not a single and not two generations have changed during that time. The whole stream of people has changed, because their best powers have awakened joyfully in some of them and become stronger in others. Don't think that this massive renewal of spirits has occurred only thanks to the presence of the Great Teacher. No, if people are prepared – then also an encounter with Teacher is prepared for them. But of course, the stormy growth of the people who were prepared to become renewed has occurred when they directly touched the sphere of Teacher spirit's purity and power. Today is the feast of farewell dedicated to our friend and his associate. We've decorated this hall with everything the most precious what only we had. We wanted that the external radiance and the radiance of our thankful hearts would merge into the joint harmony of beauty with the radiance of the Teacher's rays... Thank you, Teacher," Radanda addressed I., "for everything what you've done for us. My lips that express our feelings of gratitude, love and respect cannot convey in words the whole joy of our hearts for your kindness for us, for the happiness to meet and to get to know you, Teacher. You've helped us many times with your lectures. Don't leave us without your uttered word for farewell now when we know that we part with you for a long time," Radanda finished his speech by bowing low and respectfully to I.

By responding with his bow to the chief, I. turned to the people who were sitting in an absolute silence, and his voice began to carry everyone in the cascades of comfort and calm.

"By bidding farewell to you, first of all I want to remind you once again that no separation exists for the spiritual people's sight. However physically far away from me you would feel, you are always living, and you will be living in my memory, in my active love. Who has met his Teacher once and achieved unity with him that one can never be forgotten, because such is the power of love of Teacher's heart. His heart holds everything alive inside of it, who once was able to attract his attention till the joint level of work. But that's – the power of Teacher's heart who keeps connection with people. Can an interrelation remain strong with a one-sided traffic? Of course, not. Teacher's and his disciple's relation, as well as everything in the universe, can become stronger only with harmony. Only with the principle of the cause and effect, only with a two-sided traffic. However strong one-sided Teacher's love would be, it cannot draw to itself a dead heart that doesn't sound with love.

You can speak about your devotion and loyalty to your Teacher, about your absolutely pure desire to follow him, about your loyalty of serving to him as much as you want to. But a disciple's and his Teacher's bond is "alive" not with words, but with actions. Where a man agrees with everything formally, but a mess and impurity prevail in the actions of his private life, arguments or pretensions for people, an exactingness for them, it is helpless to talk about the discipleship there. What is more, the constant hints to a "Teacher" from the lips of these people are disgraceful and even insulting.

I have mentioned several times to you the words from the old Gospel: "If you don't love your own people whom you can see, how can you love the God whom you cannot see?" In these words – the whole wisdom of the actions of the earth: to be and to become. To carry the cup of kindness for the earth and people through one's everyday actions. Such an action is done in the name of the Supreme, but it is done on the earth, for the earth and not above it, and namely under the circumstances destined for everybody. The circumstances for everybody are his "own" ones, but that doesn't mean that you need to accept them as a "burden", that you don't have to fight and overcome them in every hour by loving.

All people – it is unimportant whether their spiritual culture is low or high, whether they are healthy or sickly, young or old – possess the power in their hearts which is called: gratitude. When you are communicating with your own people, this power is the main engine of your development. It is one of Love's aspects. If a man hasn't yet developed his spiritual strengths as much that this quality in his heart would look like an electric torch which casts beams to his encountered person's heart, then he can still

enter the path of development of such Life in his heart through the feeling of gratitude. Gratitude to those who have showed the smallest attention, kindness or tenderness to him. Namely from this feeling of gratitude which people pour on the Earth, the second line of the two-sided traffic is created that leads to the Teacher's heart.

The worst is for a man who considers himself to be Christ's follower, disciple of his Teacher, if he starts accepting the presents, help, care or indulgence received from people as "due" for his merits of the past.

If the man has taken this path by thinking that his used energy and money were returned to him, then he is only a poor businessman who has wasted his wealth by not being able to calculate his profit and loss. Such businessman who is waiting for the "heaven" to reward him for the mistakes of his own speculations through the hands of his encountered kind people, cannot wait for the Teacher's response to his prayers, because his heart is full of pride and self-love, and not love for a man. An absolute unselfishness doesn't exist in his heart, not only the devotion and loyalty to the precepts of his Teacher.

Gratitude in man's heart – that's the sign of his vitality. If there isn't any gratitude in man's heart – then he is dead, as well as in that case when there isn't any joy in his heart.

The whole course of the development of the man's spirit is developing from this refreshing source of power-gratitude. Gratitude for the people of poor culture and education helps to forge the rails through which all the features of man's character rise up. It leads the spiritually developed people to an encounter with their Teacher, to the cooperation with him.

Remember that not your Teacher, God or your encountered person needs your gratitude, but only you. Because it is the most important power of the real revival, the power of the real reconciliation, of the real calm of your heart, that is an absolute perception of your place in the Universe.

By saying good-bye to us this time, in the surroundings of the solemn feast, in the shining beauty, remember that everything what your eyes can see was done by your brothers and sisters whose hearts were full of gratitude. Now you take advantage of the fruits of this gratitude, although you had never seen them, and it may be that you will never meet them...

Stop saying the word "karma" so often. You've already developed a habit to shift everything on this short word. If you've gotten into the difficult conditions of your physical life due to your own inertness or restrained energy – then karma is to blame. If you failed to create your personal life based on kindness and calm – you grasp karma's tail like some grass-snake-guardian. If you failed to create the joyous surroundings, of course, only due to your state of chaos and inability to concentrate on the Only One – again karma is to blame. If you haven't become some great people – again karma, and so on.

The result of that – the complete disappointment in your current life (the surroundings are to blame), depression in your heart and then... Either you get here, saved from the worst crime – suicide, or you've lost your incarnation by ending it with your suicide, or you've paved the path to evil with your constant irritation and envy...

That person who often repeats the word "karma", but who is still living in the same way as a year ago, yesterday, today, tomorrow, by not searching inside of himself for the refreshing strengths of kindness and joy – that one is absolutely the same dead person among the living ones, as well as that one who is always thinking about death and who is afraid of it.

The man who is afraid of death is carrying it inside of him and he cannot be free in his actions at least for a moment. He has befouled his own eyes, the eyes of the spirit, he is crying, sobbing and he is

afraid of the moment of the horrible change of his life's form by not comprehending that he is creating a new form for himself only with his everyday actions...

In the name of myself and my secretary, in honour of whom you arrange this feast of farewell, let me thank you for your attention. Don't create any illusions how you need to aspire to unity with your Teacher. Give the power of your gratitude to your encountered people if you still cannot express your love for them in any other way. And the bridge of your unity with your Teacher will grow and become stronger through this gratitude to people."

When the time came to leave the dining-room, I. blessed everybody, he embraced everybody and said several comforting words for everyone. Of course, the Teacher's words penetrated deeply into the hearts of embraced people, because also those faces which came nearer to him with anxiety and sadness used to light up.

When the last man Radanda left the dining-room, he pointed at our tools made of ivory washed and placed back on the table, and he uttered.

"Don't refuse, Teacher, allow your secretary to accept this miracle of the art of an ancient master from me. Let him have these unbreakable tools placed in the case conveniently always by himself as a remembrance about me and as an article of the art. Let him remember while he will be looking at them that he must live in beauty already. And if only the spiritual beauty is enough for somebody, then that isn't enough for him. The path of the earth for him may be only the unity with people in beauty."

I. gave a smile and showed his consent with a nod of his head. Then Radanda addressed me.

"My dear son, whom I've brought to the chapel of Joy himself. Accept these two, invaluable sets as my regard to you and everybody whom you will offer at least a bit of bread from them. If there are days when you sit at the table alone, place also the second set of tools for that one who will visit you unexpectedly and offer him to share your food. If such a time comes when you are surrounded by a big company of your own people, place it next to yourself for an unexpected guest and greet him in my name, whoever he would be. Be blessed. Come to me. I still have a lot to give to you in the Masters' order."

I bowed to I., and I followed Radanda to his rooms. I also didn't get the permission yet to tell anybody about my conversation with the chief. It continued all night long. At dawn I. came. Radanda had already finished everything what he had to give to me, and all three of us were soon in the dining-room again, only now for the breakfast.

This time I found Mulga, Slava and many other brothers and sisters at our table, whose names I didn't know and whom, as I understood, I. had gathered yesterday evening and whom he took to the journey with himself.

When the breakfast was over, the caravan's driver came and explained to us that the camels were already brought and that we could go. I. gave the list with the people who were going with our caravan to him, and he sent Mulga, Slava and several other brothers to help to prepare the caravan.

Together with Radanda we went to our little house where, to my amazement, everything had already been packed and prepared for the future journey. I didn't need to ask in order to comprehend that loving I.'s hands had done my duties while I was learning by Radanda.

"Don't blame yourself, Lyovushka, that you didn't pack your belongings beforehand. You couldn't know that you would be occupied with your business till the last minute," I. responded to my look.

“Farewell, father Radanda. We are still destined to meet each other many times. This time I thank you for all your help.”

Tender Radanda’s smile was the only answer to I.’s words, but he turned to me and uttered.

“Here it is, Lyovushka, the living example of the real encounter. It is clear to you without any words who and whom must thank. My son, follow in your Teacher’s footsteps, and let your path stretch in such a way as Life has destined it for you, as the Bright Brotherhood has opened it for you.”

Radanda embraced both of us and he went to the gates together with us where the caravan was lining up already. And here I was destined to be surprised again, because the same, my dear Yassa, who used always to shoot up out of the ground in the last moment, was leading the work.

I didn’t have any time to ask how and when he showed up here, we only greeted one another with our hands from the distance, because I. ordered me to change my clothes for the journey immediately by adding that I would be riding next to him, at the head of the caravan.

Having done my best to change my clothes as soon as possible, anyway I came back to the caravan later than I. when he was already sitting in the saddle. Having kissed the small, dry Radanda’s hand for the last time, I jumped into the saddle, because I had already learned not to bring my camel to his knees for this, and I started chasing after I. who had ridden away already.

In such a way one more stage, a great stage of my life was over. The life in the wonderful harmony among high hearts was over, and the new life of work among people began.

The first living beings for whom I had to set for a distant cruise were called Jenny, Anna, Jean.

I was blessing them, and I remembered the last words of the Great Master in the chapel. “Joy doesn’t ring like some golden coins or shine like the radiance of riches. Joy hits the sinner, makes the villain to fall to thinking and gives the wings for the pure one, if the son of Light, loyal till the end, is carrying it.”

I pressed myself to the Divine hands in my thoughts, which gave a wonderful, small flower to me during my visit of farewell, I pressed it to my heart, and I whispered.

“My Lord and I,” and I caught up with I.